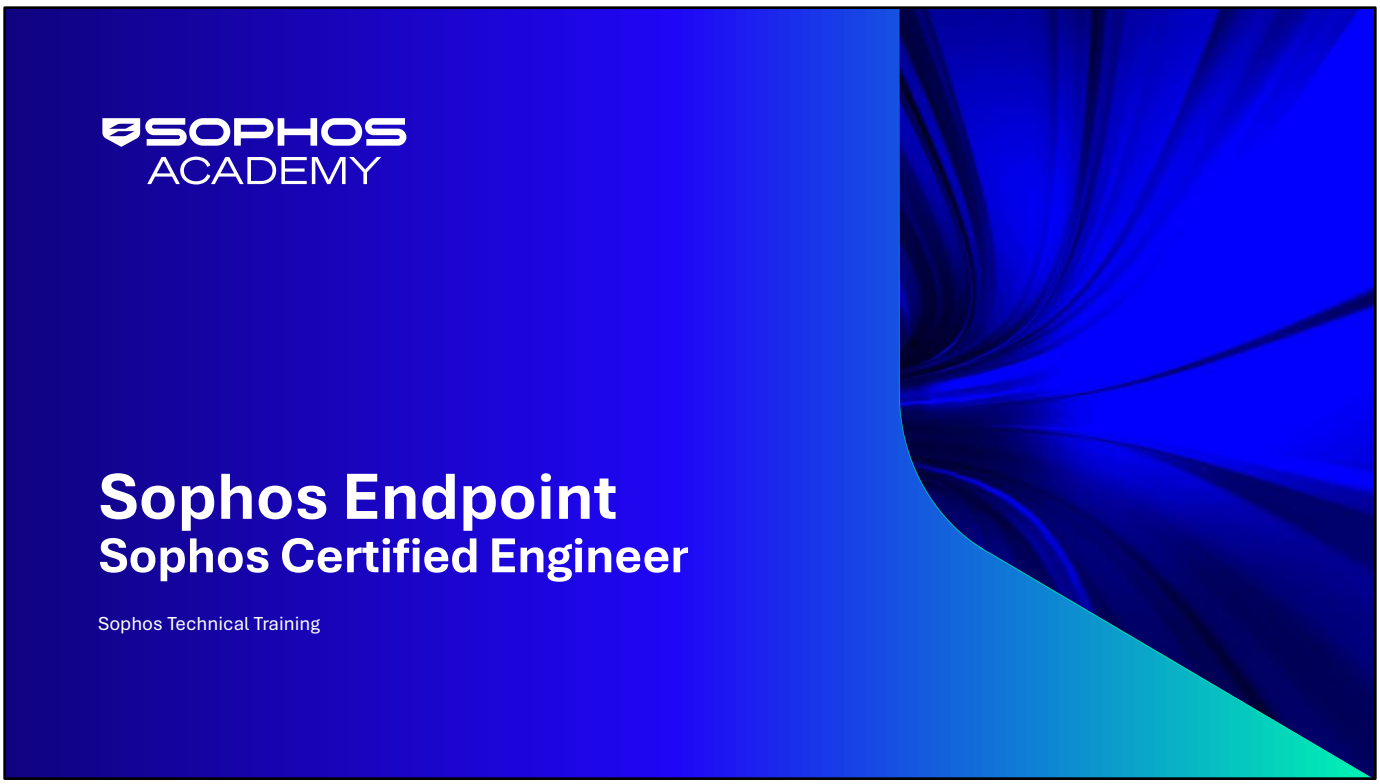
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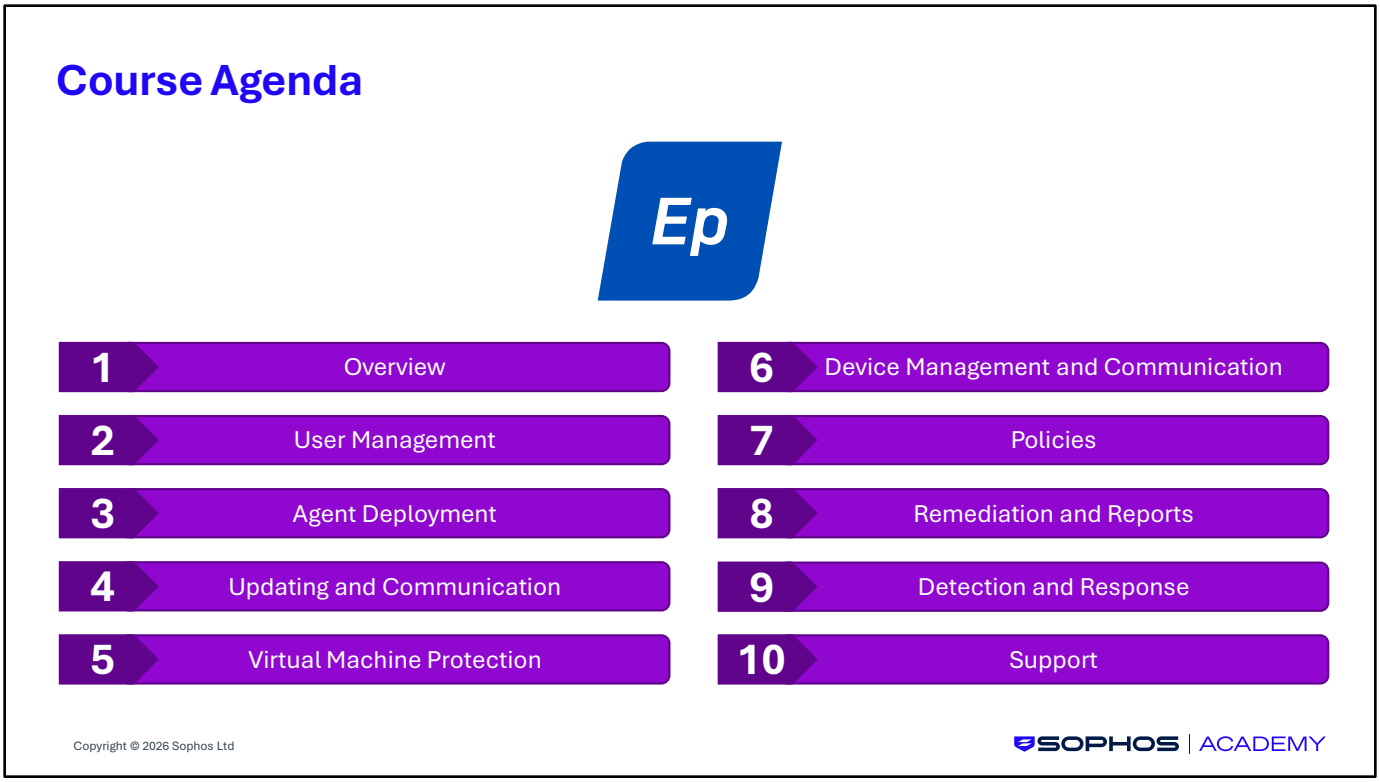
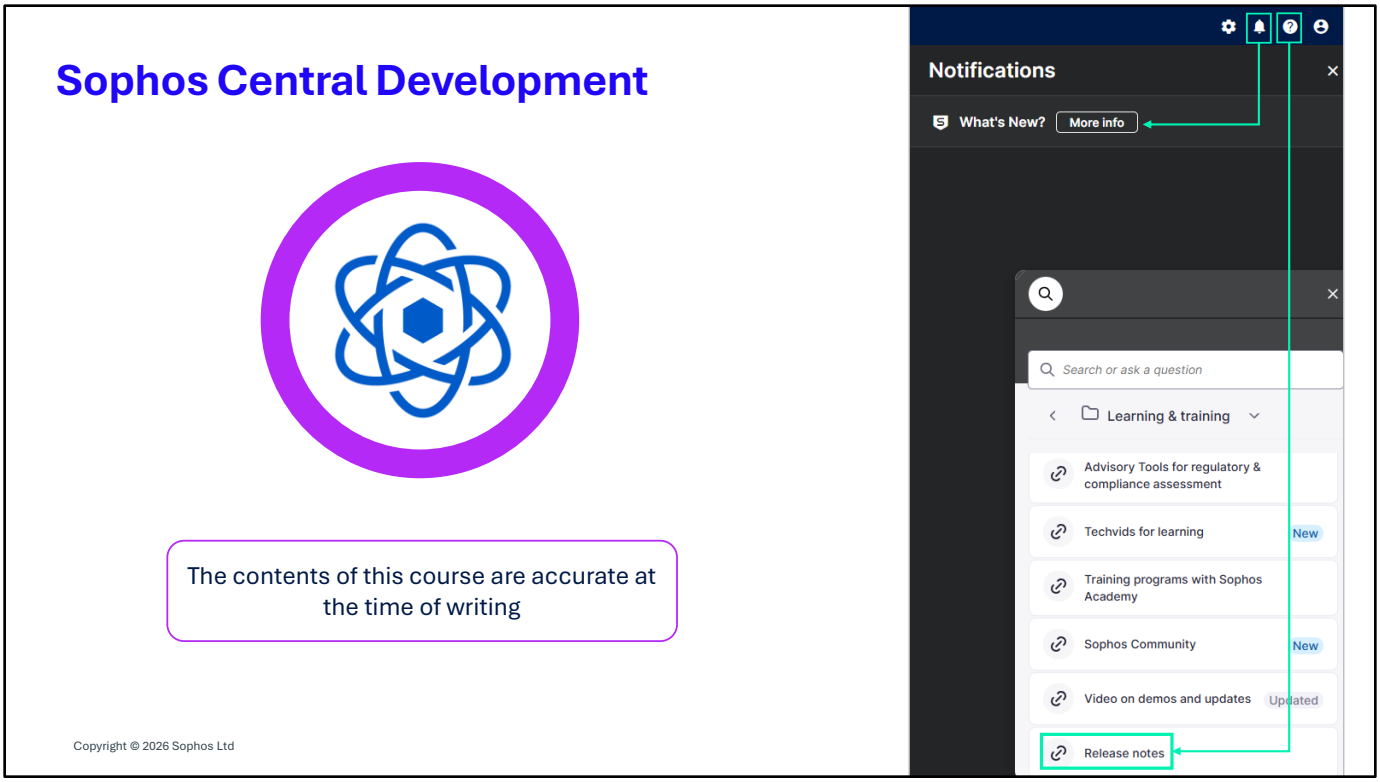


This course is split into **10** modules which each module made up of chapters.



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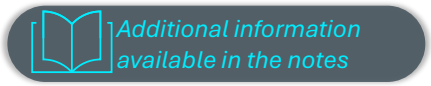
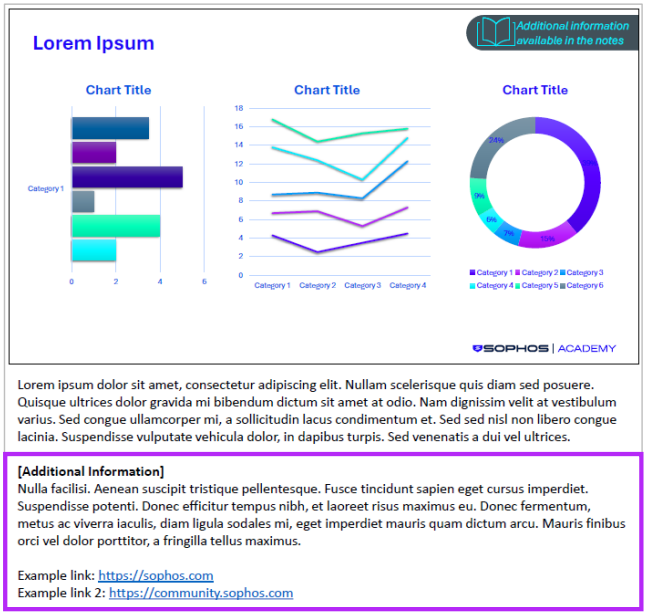
The contents of this course are accurate at the time of writing.

Additional Information

- When you see this icon, you can find additional information in the notes of the handout



- A glossary of technical terms used throughout our courses can be found in knowledge base article **KB-000034650**



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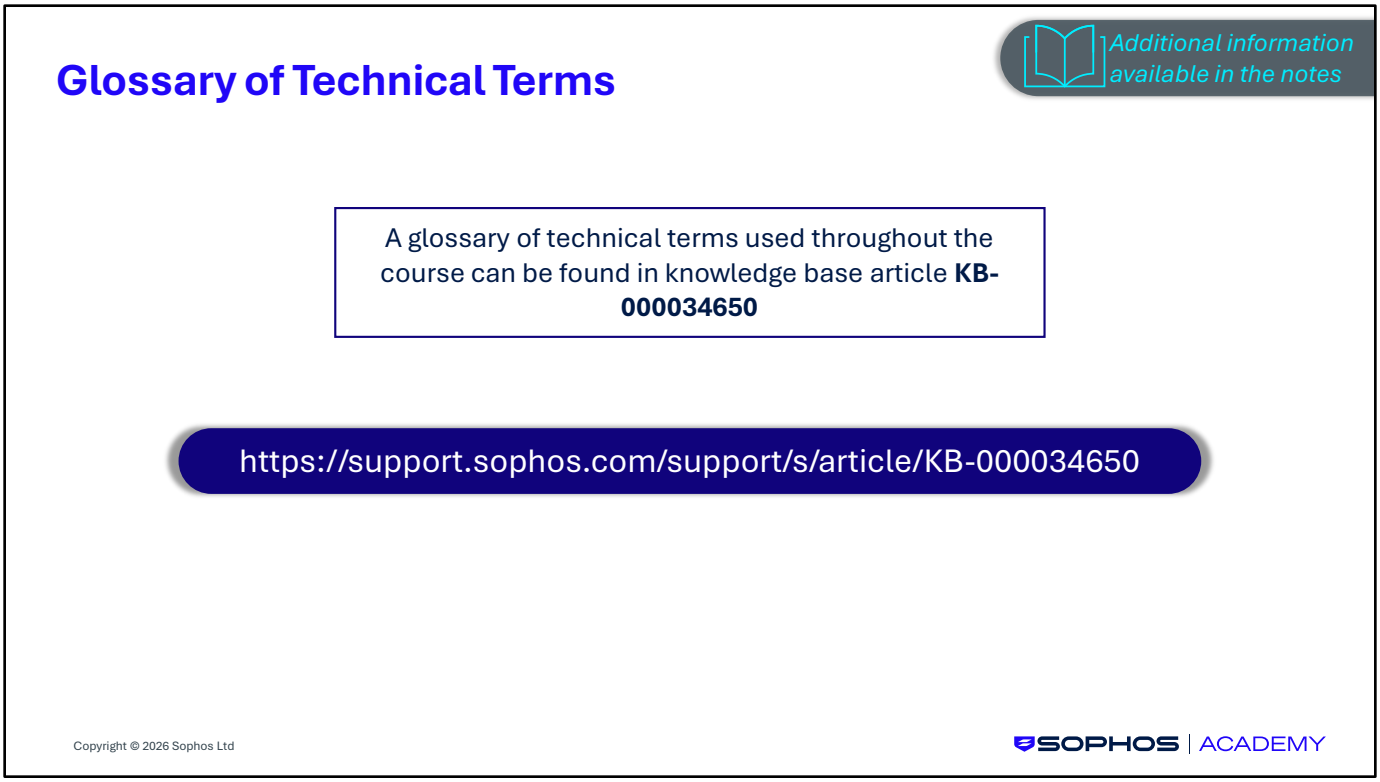
When you see this icon, you can find additional information in the notes of the handout that you might find useful.

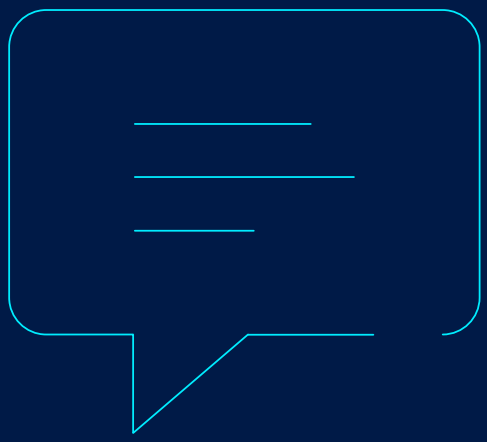
Additional information will not be narrated in the course.



A glossary of technical terms used throughout all our courses can be found in the knowledge base article detailed.

[Additional Information]
https://support.sophos.com/support/s/article/KB-000034650

TRAINING FEEDBACK



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Sophos Endpoint Overview

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[Additional Information]

Sophos Endpoint
EP0510: Introduction to Sophos Endpoint

September 2026

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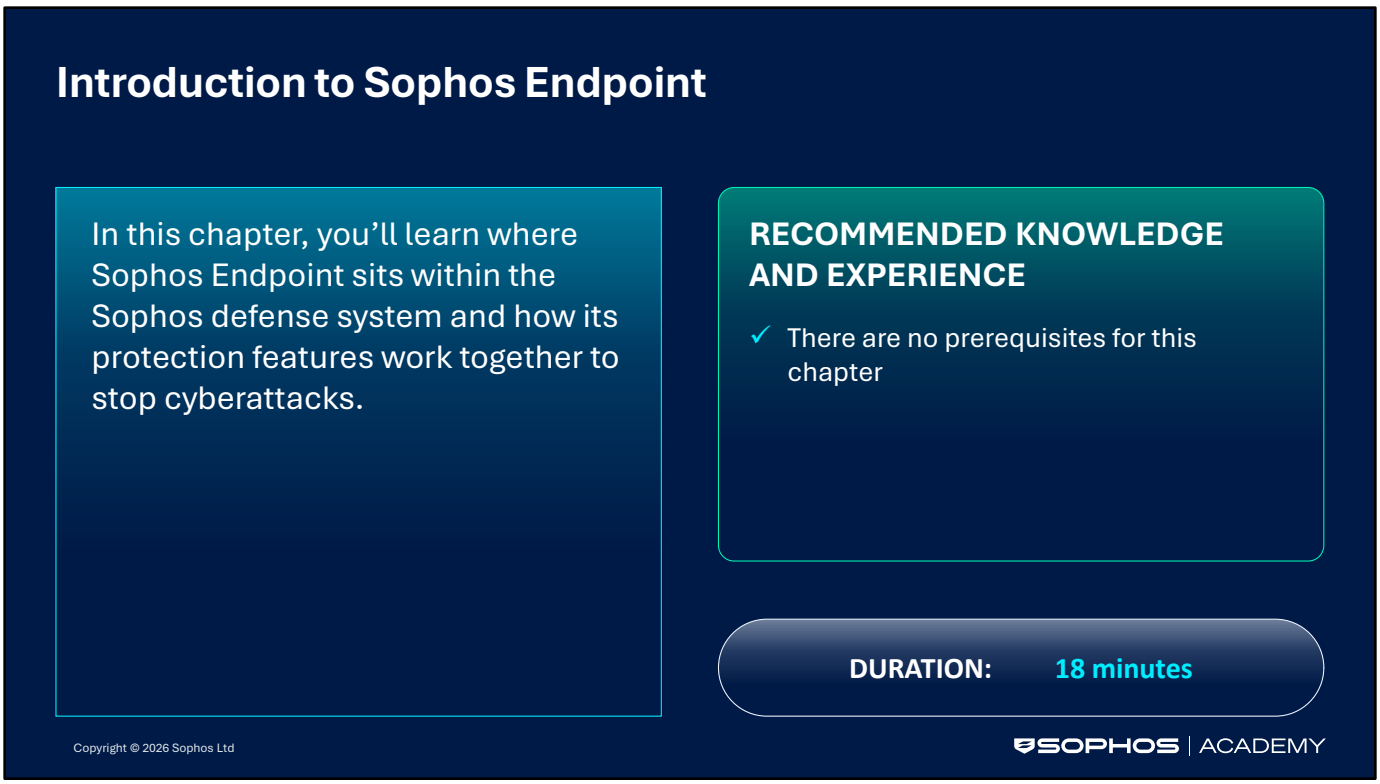
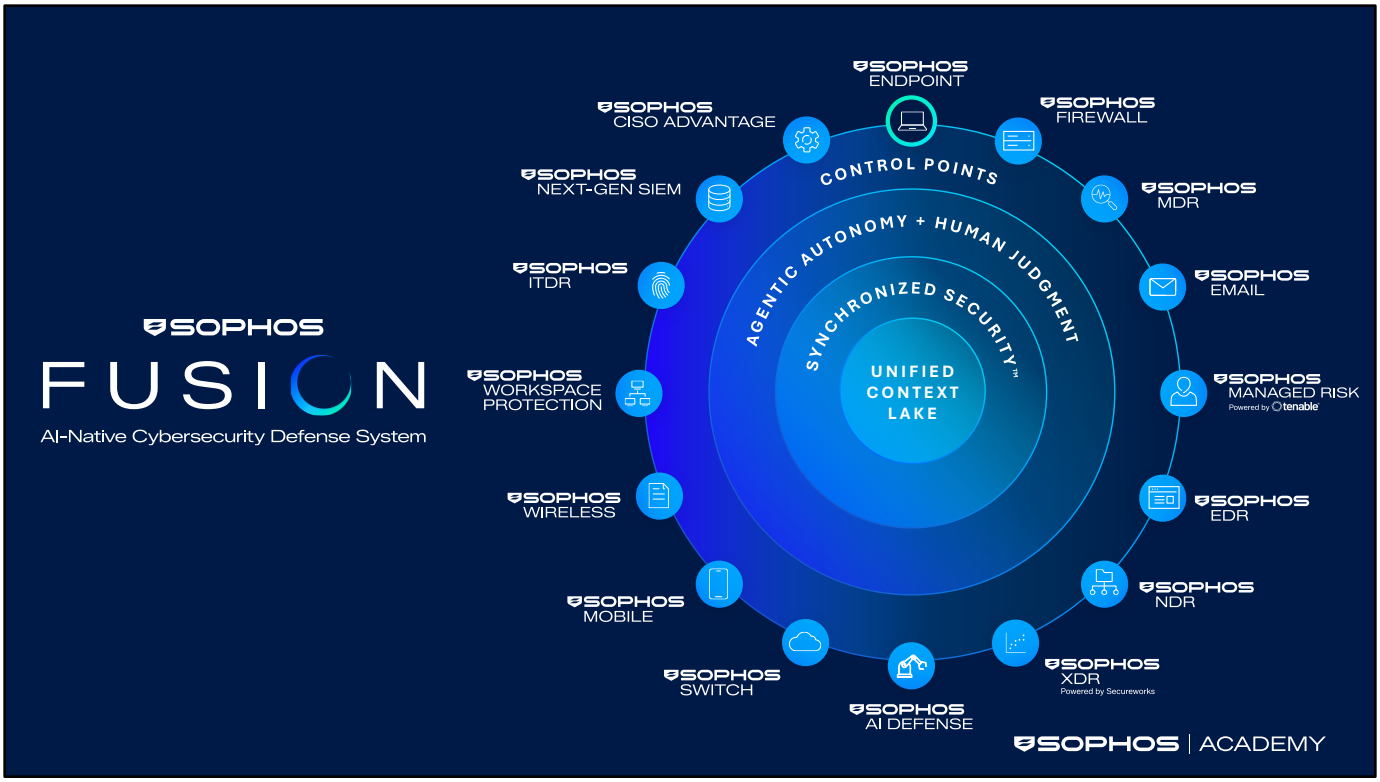


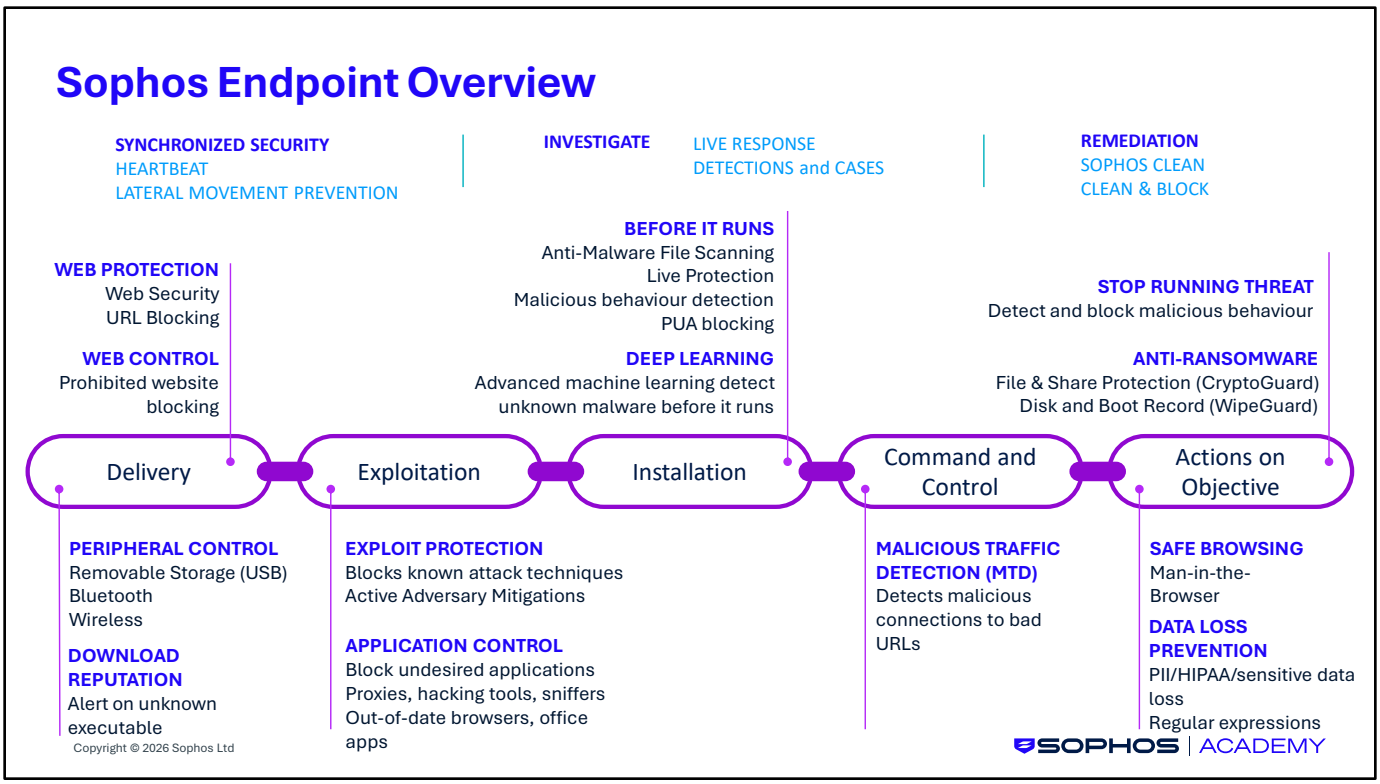
In this chapter, you'll learn where Sophos Endpoint sits within the Sophos defense system and how its protection features work together to protect against cyberattacks.



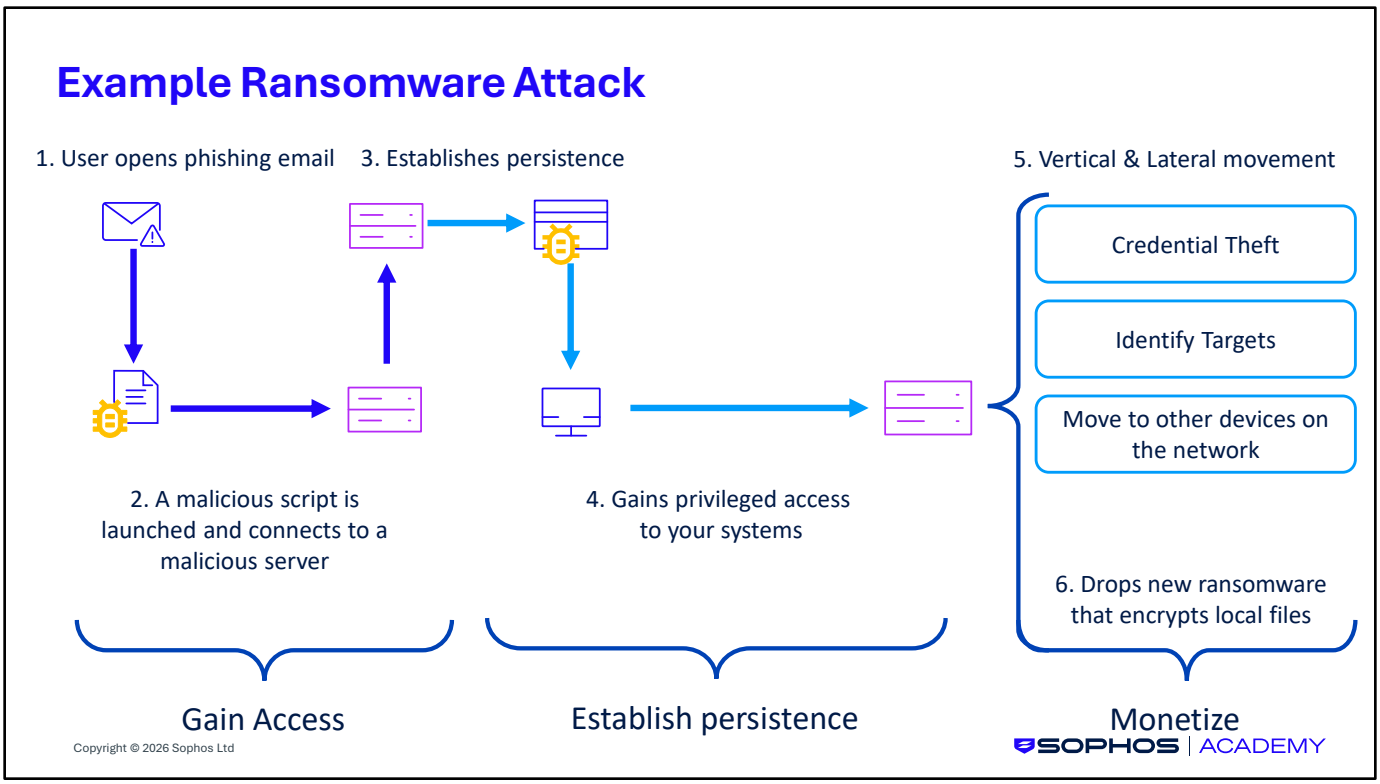
Sophos Endpoint is one of several control points in Sophos' AI-Native Cybersecurity Defense System, alongside firewall, identity, email, network, and cloud.

All endpoint telemetry flows into the Unified Context Lake, where it is correlated with signals from other control points. Synchronized Security lets these products share status and act together, for example isolating a compromised device.

Sophos Endpoint is deployed and managed from a single, web-based console that updates automatically. Access requires a Sophos ID and multi-factor authentication.



Sophos Endpoint consists of multiple layers. We'll examine the protection features included, highlighting adversary tactics and techniques, showing how Sophos Endpoint prevents them.



To demonstrate the multiple layers of threat protection, let's look at an example ransomware attack.

Example Ransomware Attack

1. User opens phishing email

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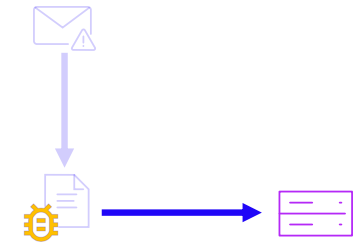
A user opens a phishing email that links to a document. The user opens the document, containing an embedded link to a unique malicious script.

Example Ransomware Attack

1. User opens phishing email



2. A malicious script is launched and connects to a malicious server

Gain Access

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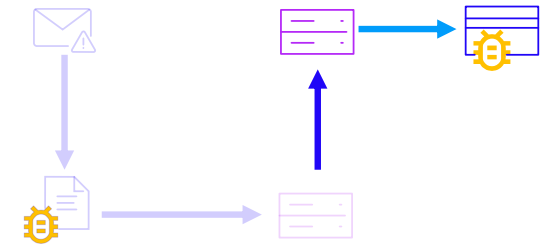
The malicious script is executed and communicates with a malicious server.

Example Ransomware Attack

1. User opens phishing email
3. Establishes persistence



2. A malicious script is launched and connects to a malicious server

Gain Access

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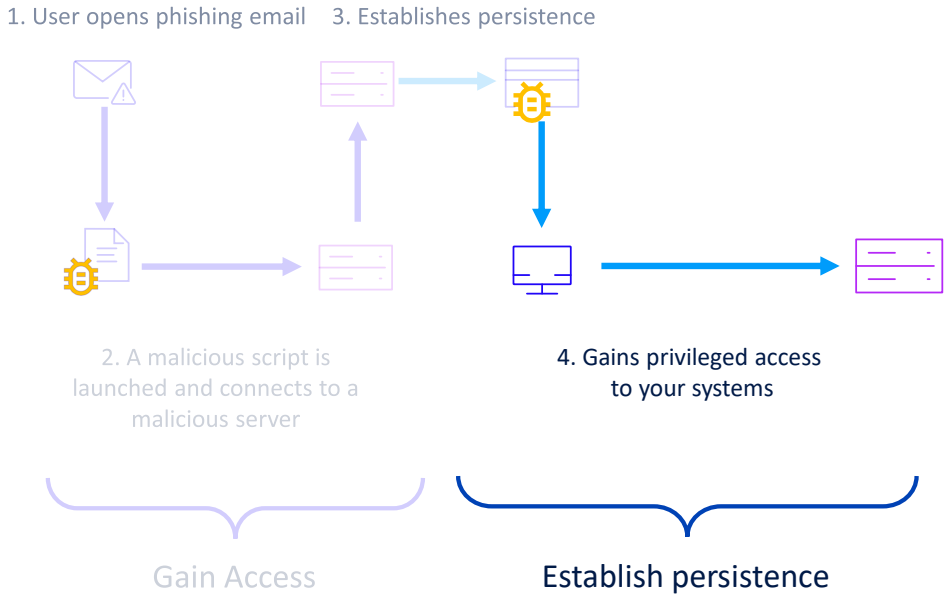
To establish persistence, the attacker compromises another device application that is in constant use.

Example Ransomware Attack



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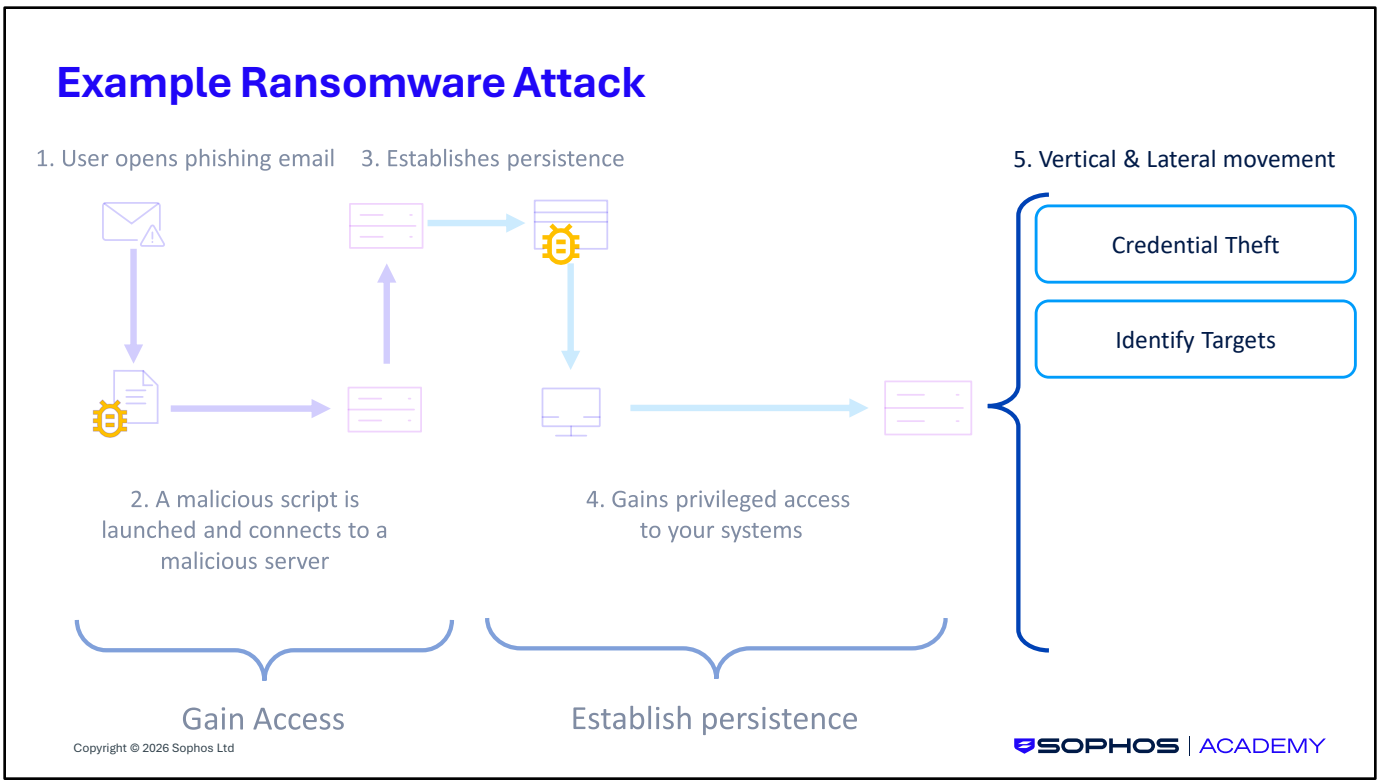
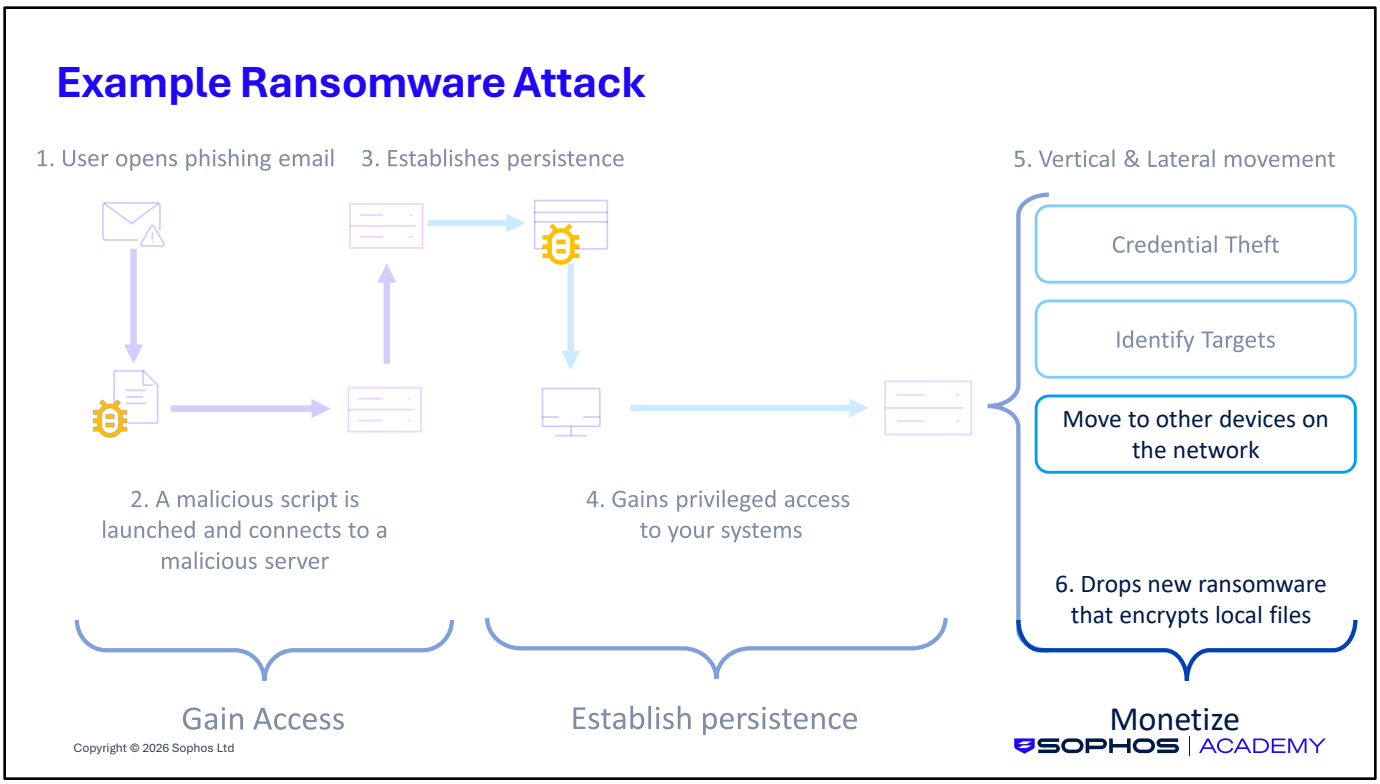
The user closes the document; however, the attacker has access to internal systems.

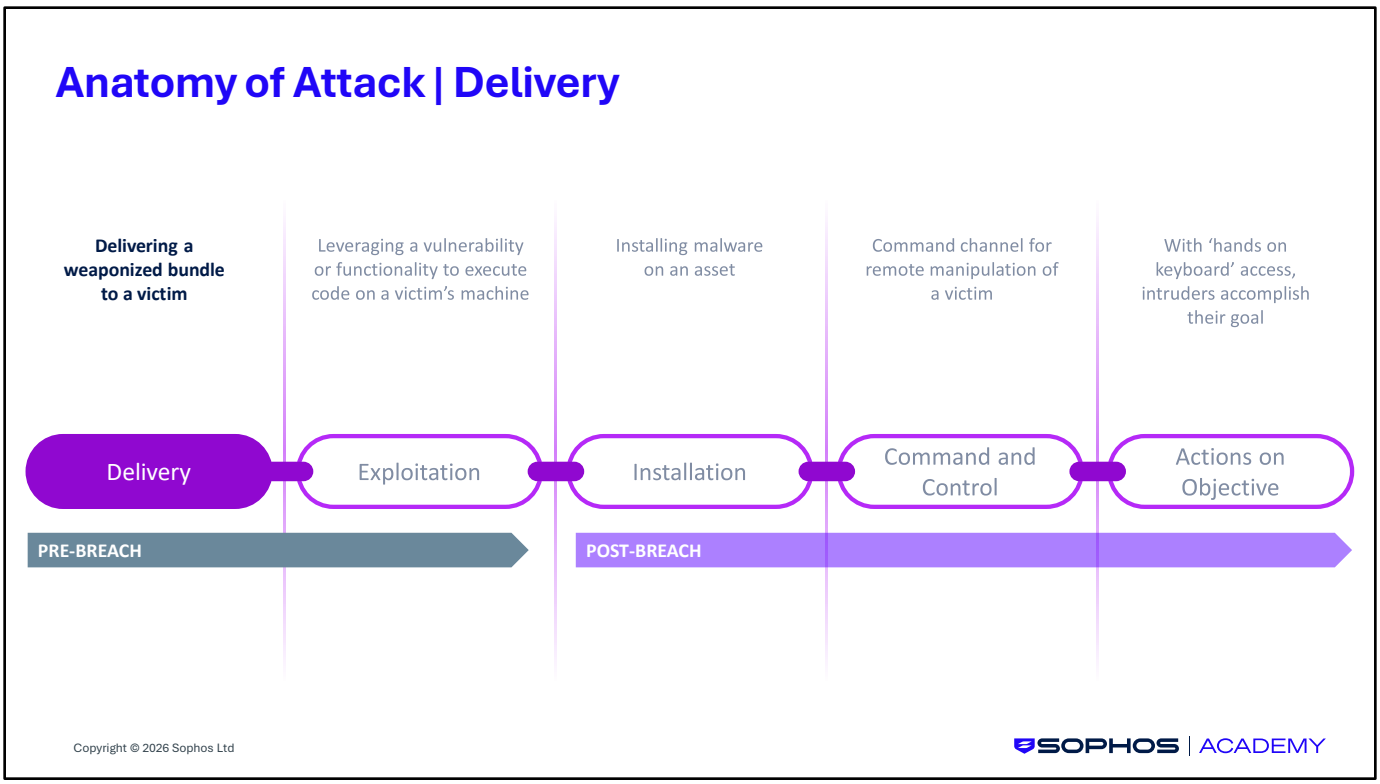


With this access, the attacker can steal credentials and scan the network to identify targets for movement across the network.



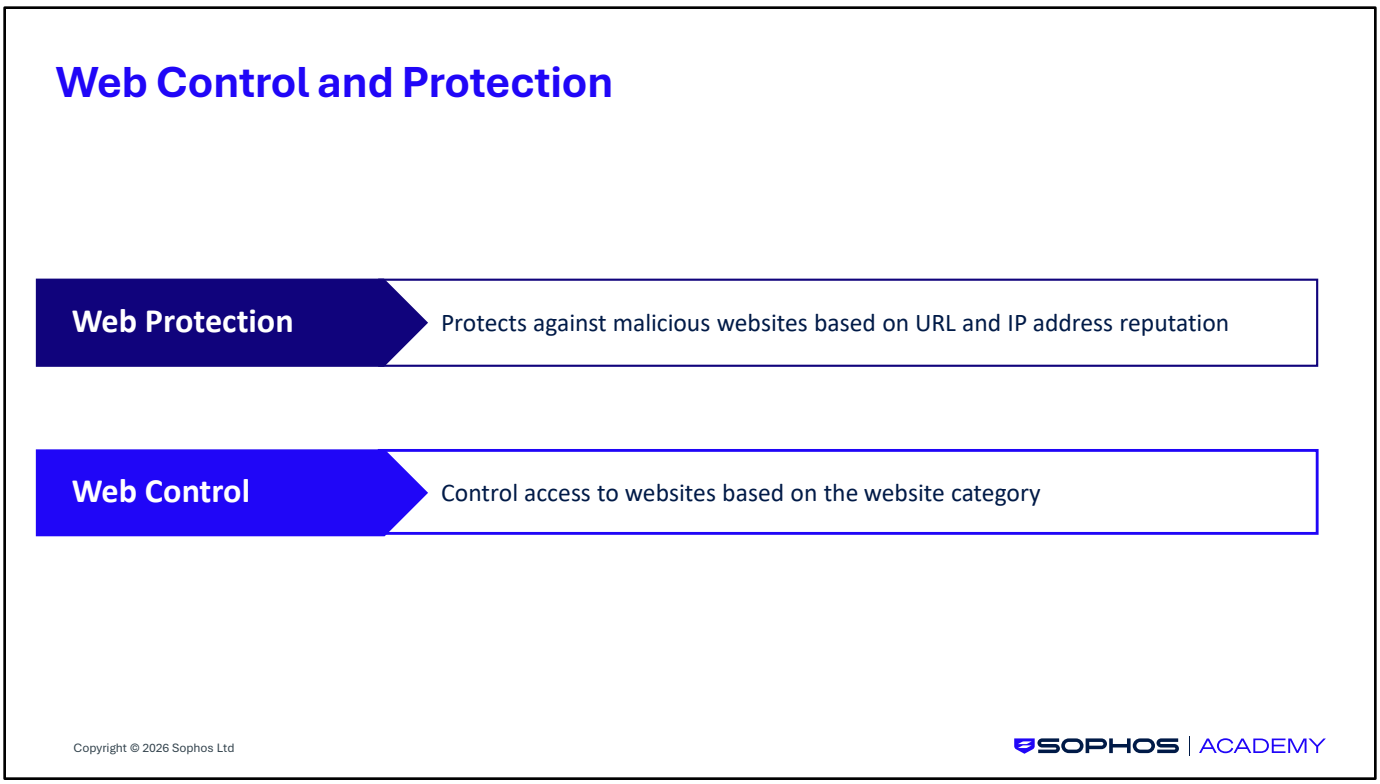
Using the stolen credentials, the attacker moves to other devices on the network. The attacker can now drop ransomware, encrypt files, and prevent the organization from functioning.

Let's examine the protection features that can prevent cyber attacks.



The first stage of an attack is the delivery of malicious content, for example, a file or a link. There are several techniques used by attackers to deliver malicious content.

Sophos Endpoint provides tools to control which websites users can access, the peripheral devices they can use, and the data they can download.

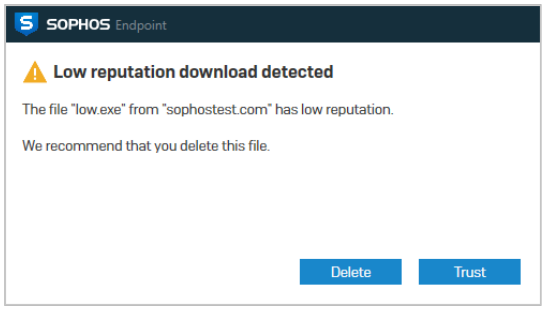


Web Protection protects users while they browse the internet. It scans the web stream and blocks malicious websites.

Administrators can also make use of the web control policy, which helps to limit the security vulnerabilities introduced by malicious websites. Web Control uses category-based URL blocking, and when configured, checks the category of websites being accessed. If the category of a website is restricted based on the Web Control policy, the website is blocked.

Download Reputation

- Download reputation checks the reputation of files as they are downloaded.
- A file's reputation is determined by performing a file checksum lookup from the device against known files and their reputation created by SophosLabs.
- Download reputation is supported on Microsoft Edge, Google Chrome, and Opera.



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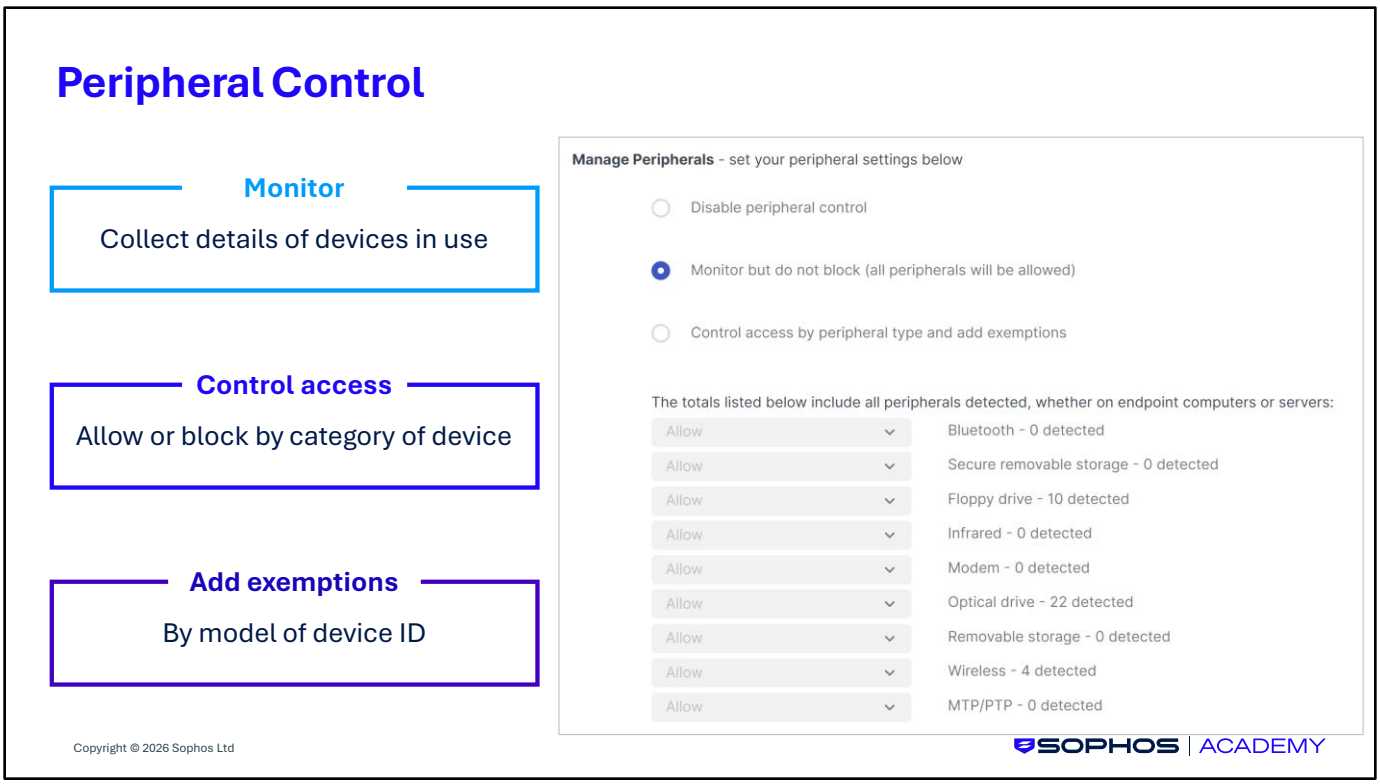
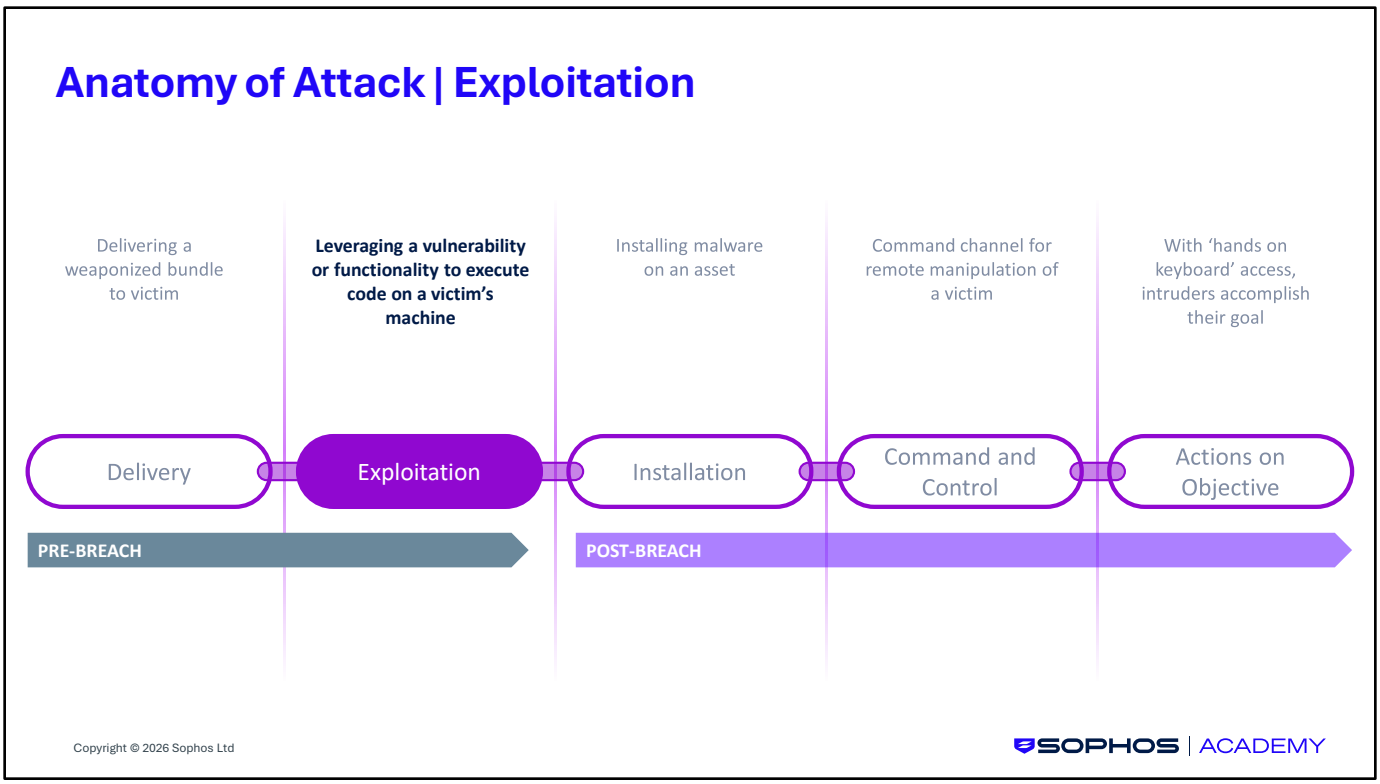
Download reputation is part of the web protection feature and is enabled by default. It checks the reputation of files as they're downloaded from the internet. If an unknown or low-reputation file is selected for download; the user will be prompted to either delete or trust it.

A file's reputation is determined by performing a file checksum lookup from the device against known files and their reputation created by SophosLabs. Download reputation is supported on Microsoft Edge, Google Chrome, and Opera.



Peripheral control restricts access to external devices such as USB drives. It can be used to prevent the use of untrusted devices that could contain malware. By default, the peripheral control policy is disabled.

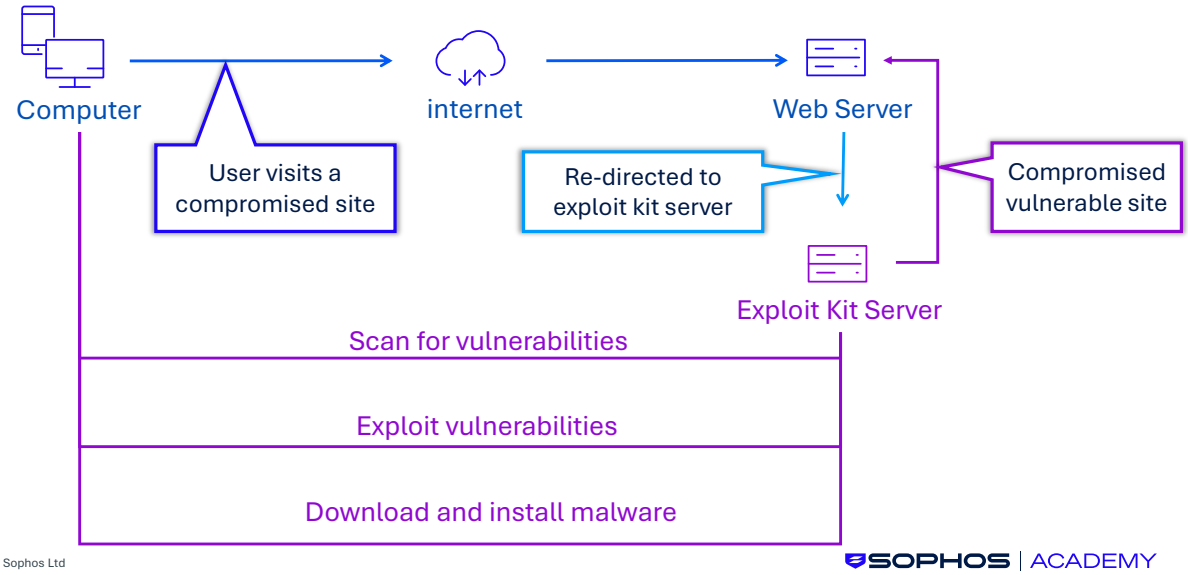
Any peripheral devices detected can be added as an exemption, allowing the use of specific trusted devices. You can configure each device category to be allowed or blocked. Secure removable storage, floppy disk drives, and optical drives have the option of read-only, allowing users to view the peripheral device but not add or remove data from it.



Once an attacker has gained access to your estate using a delivery technique, they'll typically attempt to leverage a vulnerability to run malicious code.

Attackers are looking to exploit devices; they are looking for a method or tool to abuse the vulnerabilities of any software in use. Although exploits can be complex, a cybercriminal does not need to be skilled to develop them; they can use an exploit kit.

How Exploits Work



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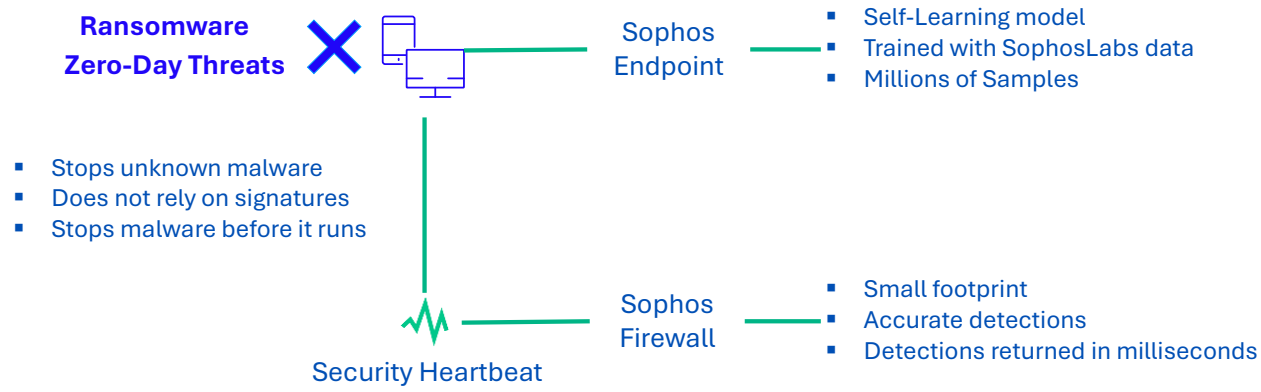
Exploit kits come with pre-written code and target users running insecure and outdated software applications. In this diagram, the user visits a website that has been compromised. As a result, the user is redirected, without their knowledge, to the exploit kit server.

An exploit kit is usually engineered to perform at least two core actions: scan the system for vulnerabilities and exploit those vulnerabilities to download malicious code. Exploit kits can be used online with limited technical knowledge; sometimes, kits even come with a user-friendly interface and technical support!

How Sophos Protects Against Exploits



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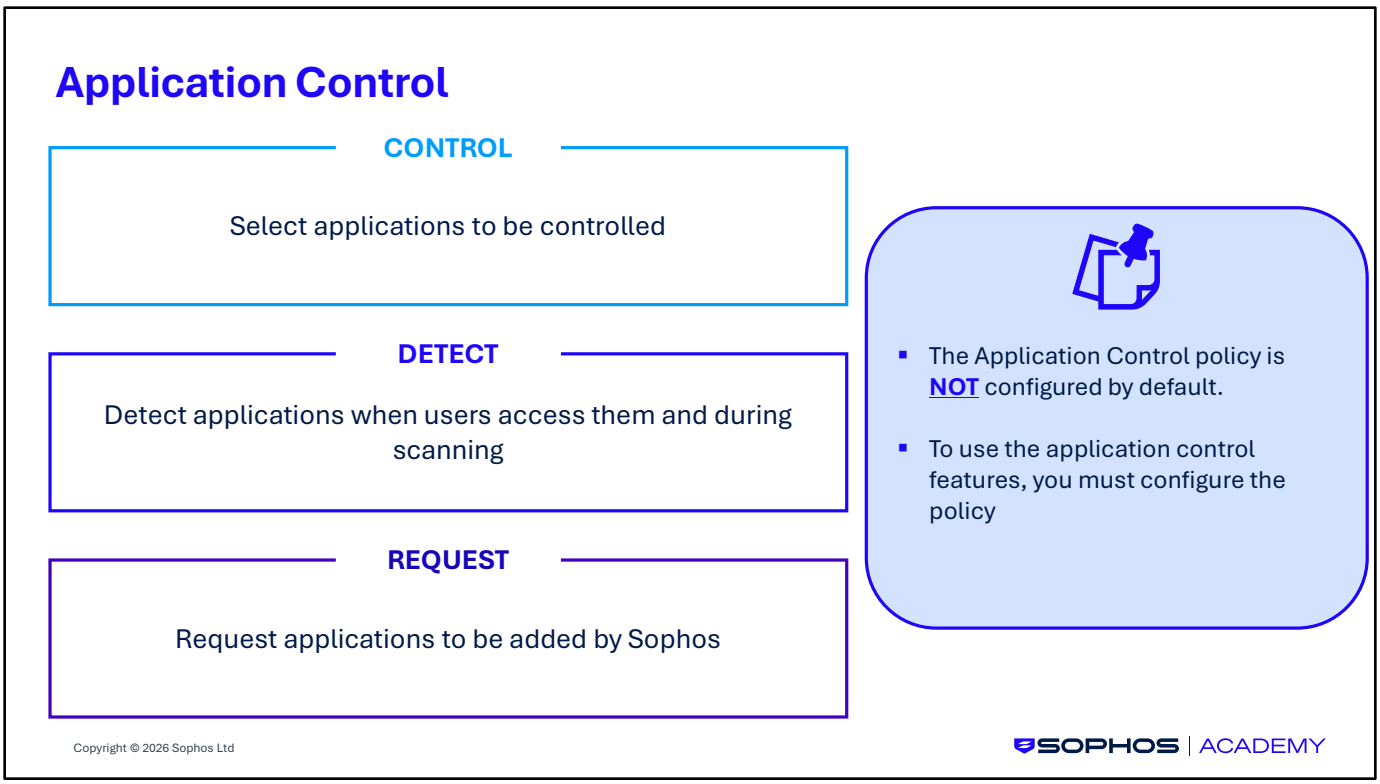
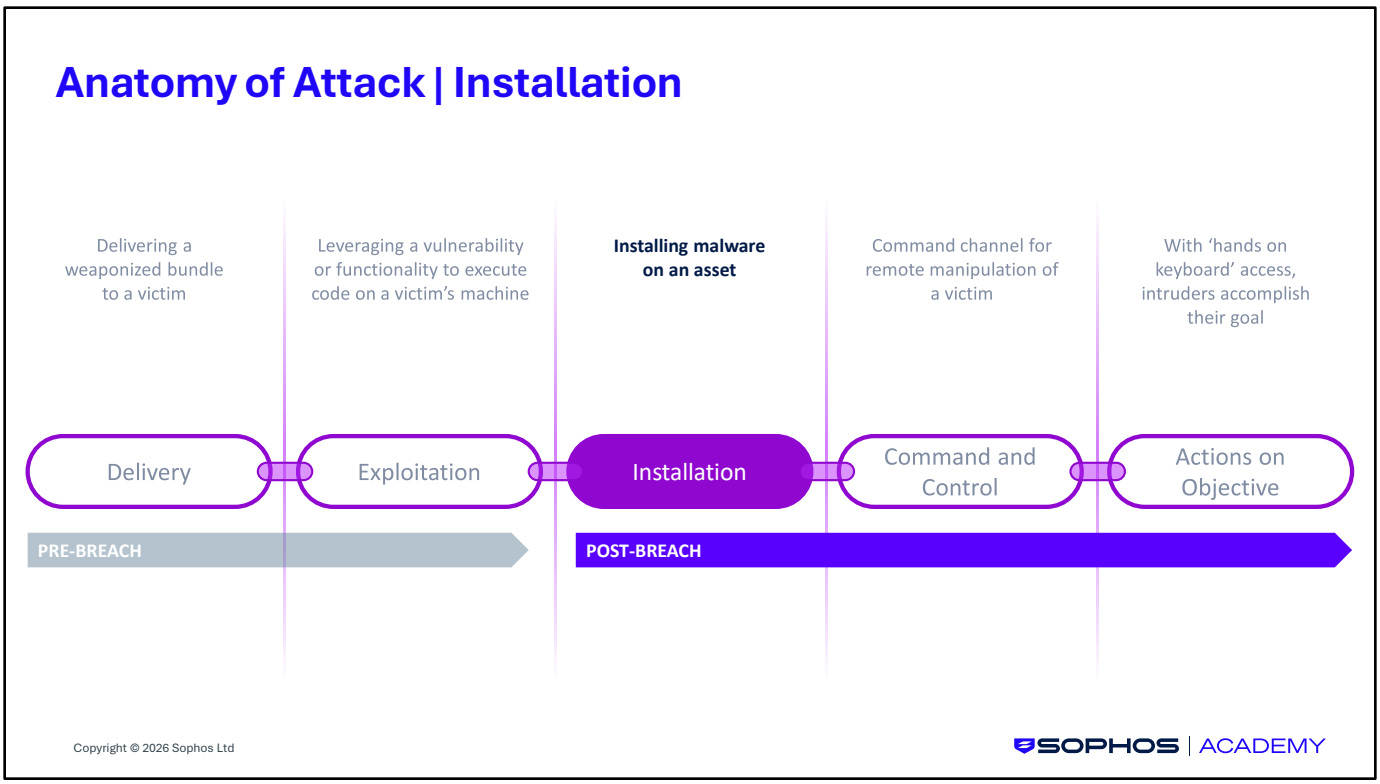
Sophos Endpoint protects devices against malicious threats that bypass traditional antivirus solutions. Typically, these threats are zero-day and ransomware. It focuses on identifying the techniques used to compromise a device rather than the threat itself. It denies attackers by blocking the exploits and techniques used to distribute malware, steal credentials, and escape detection. It uses three main methods: exploit prevention blocks known attack techniques, machine learning recognizes similarities to known malicious files, and anti-ransomware protection looks to detect and roll back the damage of a ransomware attack.

Detections are reported and displayed in Security Operations, allowing administrators to remotely control all protected devices. If a Sophos Firewall is being utilized and Synchronized Security has been enabled, administrators can block any traffic passing through the firewall from a compromised device, protecting your entire network from the attack.



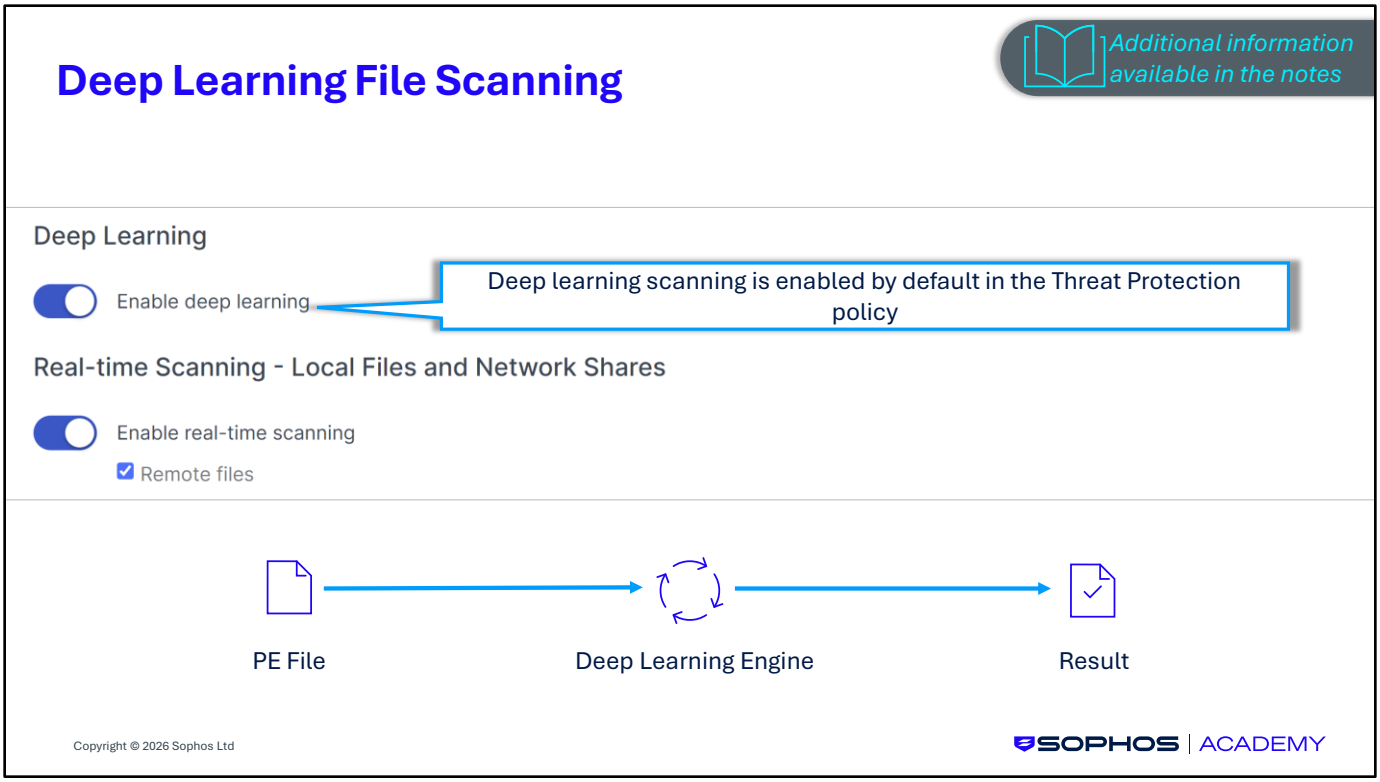
Application control can prevent users from running applications that are considered unsuitable for business use, such as games or instant messaging applications. It also improves security by controlling the types of applications allowed, which reduces the attack surface and prevents the exploitation of system tools.

The application control policy can detect applications in use and then control access to these applications. Applications that are not included in the application control policy can be requested. Please note that the application control policy is not configured by default; to use application control features, you must configure the policy.



The installation stage of an attack is when an attacker downloads and installs malicious content to run on a compromised device.

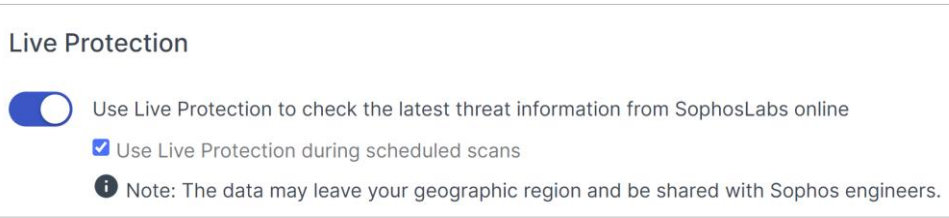
Deep Learning File Scanning



On-access file scanning is used when a user interacts with a file on a protected device. The file is automatically scanned to determine if it's malicious. If the file is identified as malicious, it's automatically cleaned up.

[Additional Information]
For more information about the reputation scores for files, see knowledge base article **KB-000037118**.
https://support.sophos.com/support/s/article/KB-000037118

Live Protection



- Sends file characteristics, such as checksum, to Sophos for checking
- **Performs instant in-the-cloud checking**
- Returns a decision as clean or malicious

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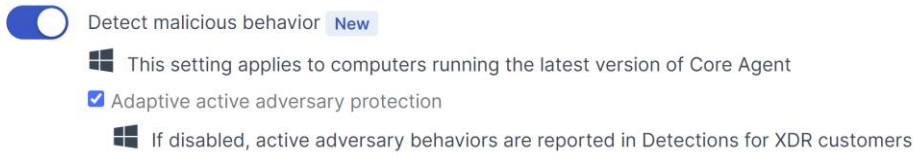
Live protection provides an instant lookup against the latest known malicious files. Live protection means that virus definition files don't have to be downloaded to a protected device for the latest protection to be in place.

Malicious Behaviour Detection



- Scans **inbound** and **outbound** network traffic
- Traffic is scanned and known attacks are recognized
- Blocks threats before they can infect the operating system or application

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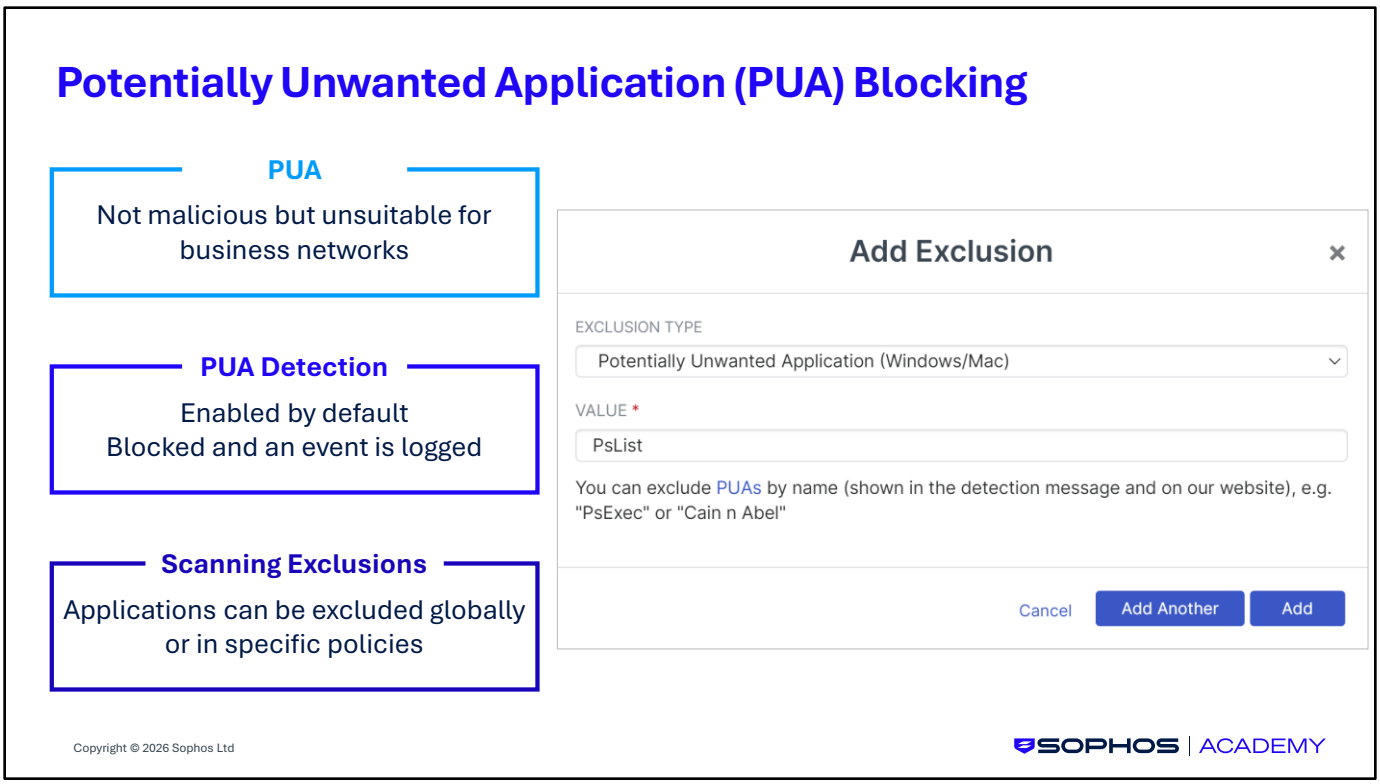
Malicious behaviour detection scans inbound and outbound network traffic for malicious attacks or suspicious behaviour patterns. If an attack is detected for outbound traffic, a device is likely being used to attack other devices on the network.

Inbound traffic is communication from a remote device to a device within a network.

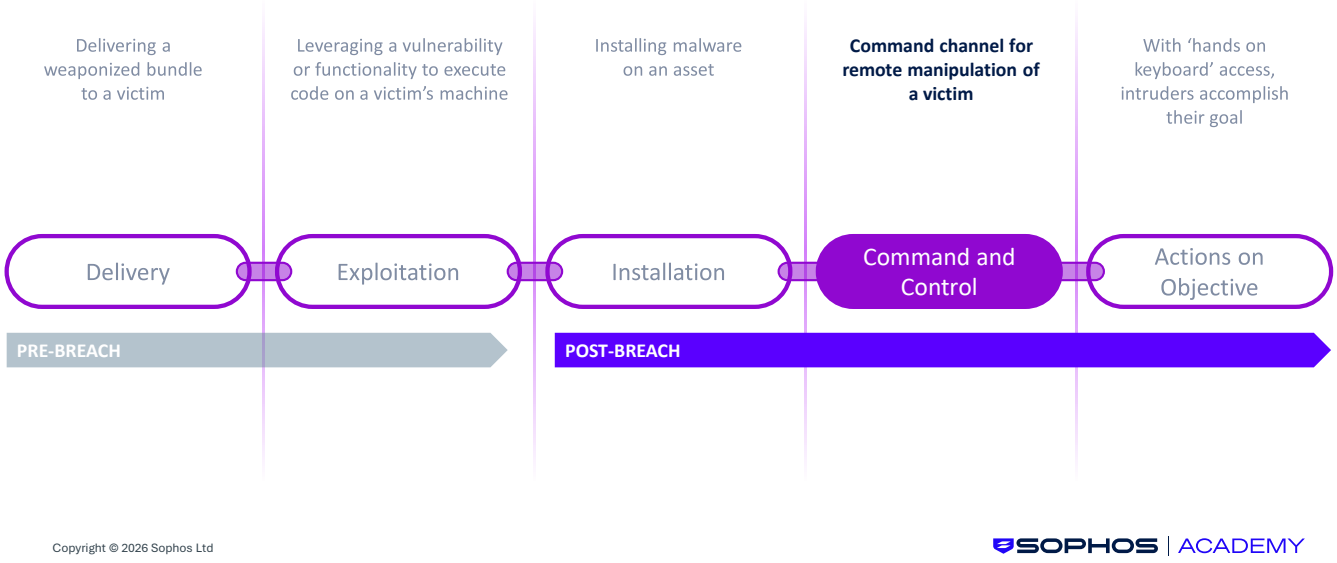
Outbound traffic is communication from a network device to a remote device.



Potentially unwanted applications, or PUAs, are generally considered unsuitable for business use. The major PUA classifications are adware, non-malicious spyware, remote administration tools, and hacking tools.

PUA scanning is enabled by default; any detected applications will be blocked, and an event will be logged against the device in the Sophos Endpoint Agent. An administrator can configure either global or policy exceptions for applications where required.

Anatomy of Attack | Command and Control



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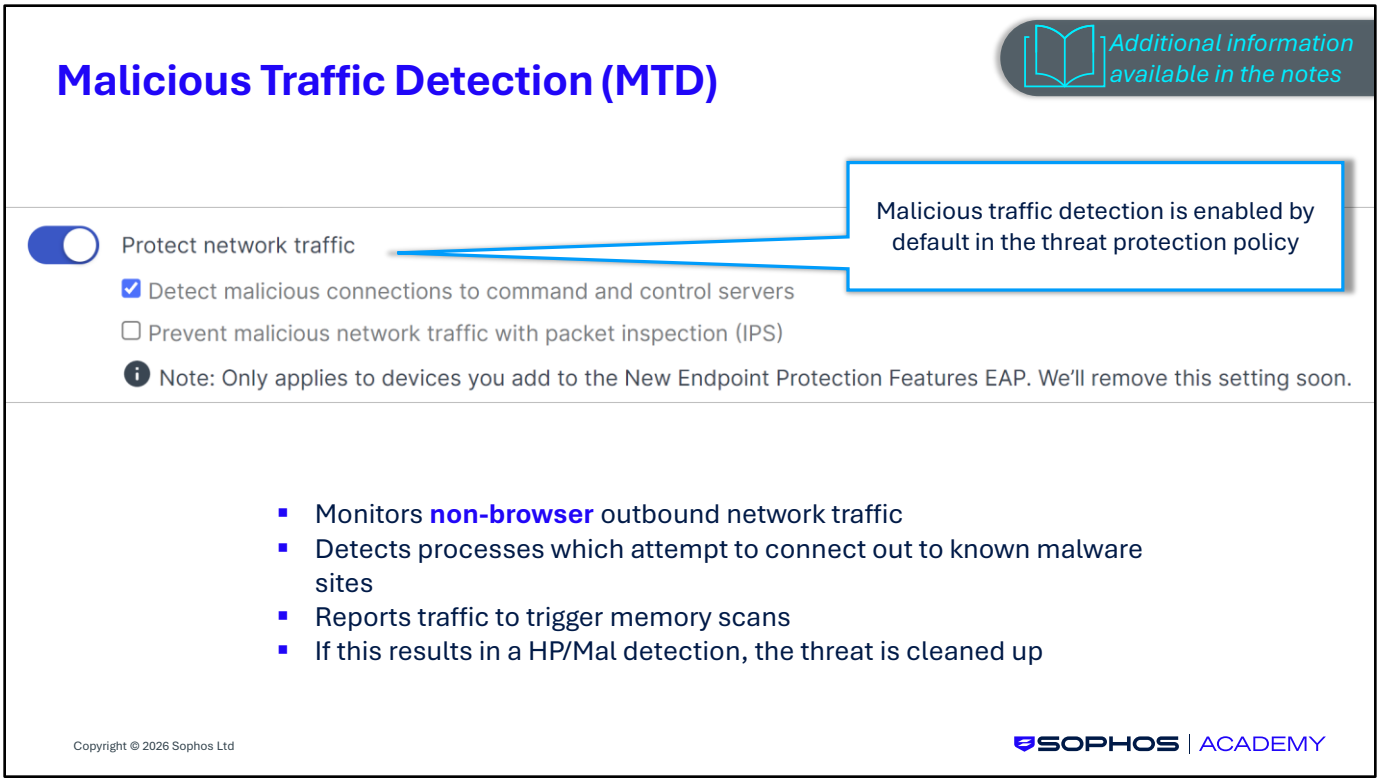
Once an attacker has gained control of a compromised device, they can establish contact with a command-and-control server. This server typically sends commands to upload or download malicious code or files.

In a typical scenario, the command-and-control server communication is a repeated process that allows malware to adapt as more knowledge is collected. Complex malware includes communication to remote servers for further instructions.

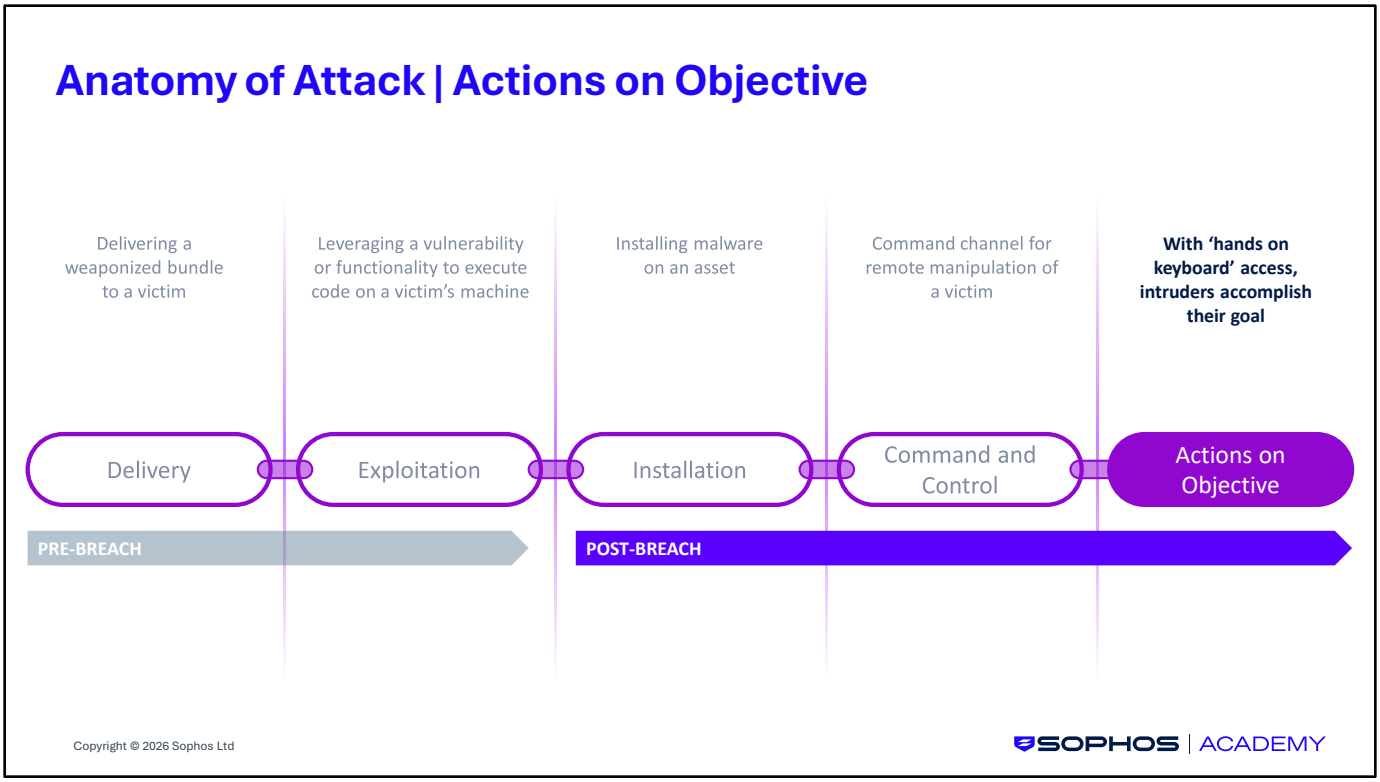


Malicious traffic detection (MTD) is used to detect and prevent communication between protected devices and suspicious or malicious servers. MTD monitors HTTP non-browser application traffic for signs of connectivity to known bad URLs. If malicious traffic is detected, it's an early indicator that malware may be present on a device.

A command-and-control server connection is very dangerous, as an attacker can use it to register devices as part of a botnet, allowing them to attack more devices across a network. If a malicious connection is detected and Sophos does not have a signature for the detection, a sample of the URL detected is submitted to SophosLabs, and a specific detection for that traffic is then created.

Malicious traffic detection can also use packet inspection to scan inbound and outbound network traffic for known attacks. If an attack is detected, it's blocked, which protects against lateral movement and external attacks.

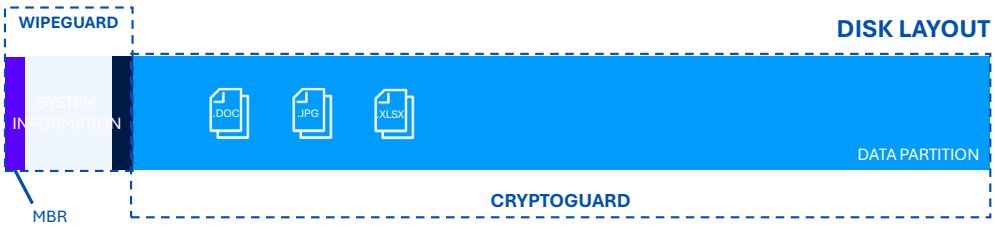
[Additional Information]
Sophos provides a test script for malicious traffic detection that can be downloaded from the knowledge base article **KB-000035314**. https://support.sophos.com/support/s/article/KB-000035314



If an attacker gets this far into an attack, they'll perform the malicious action they intended to.

This action depends on the type of malware. For example, a ransomware attack aims to encrypt data, whereas spyware tends to log keystrokes to gain access to intellectual property.

Ransomware Behaviour Protection



WipeGuard – Disk & Boot Protection

- Prevents malicious tampering with system areas of disk
- Stops malicious processes

CryptoGuard – File Protection

- Takes just-in-time file cache
- Identifies malicious file encryption behavior
- Isolates malicious process
- Automatically rolls back affected files

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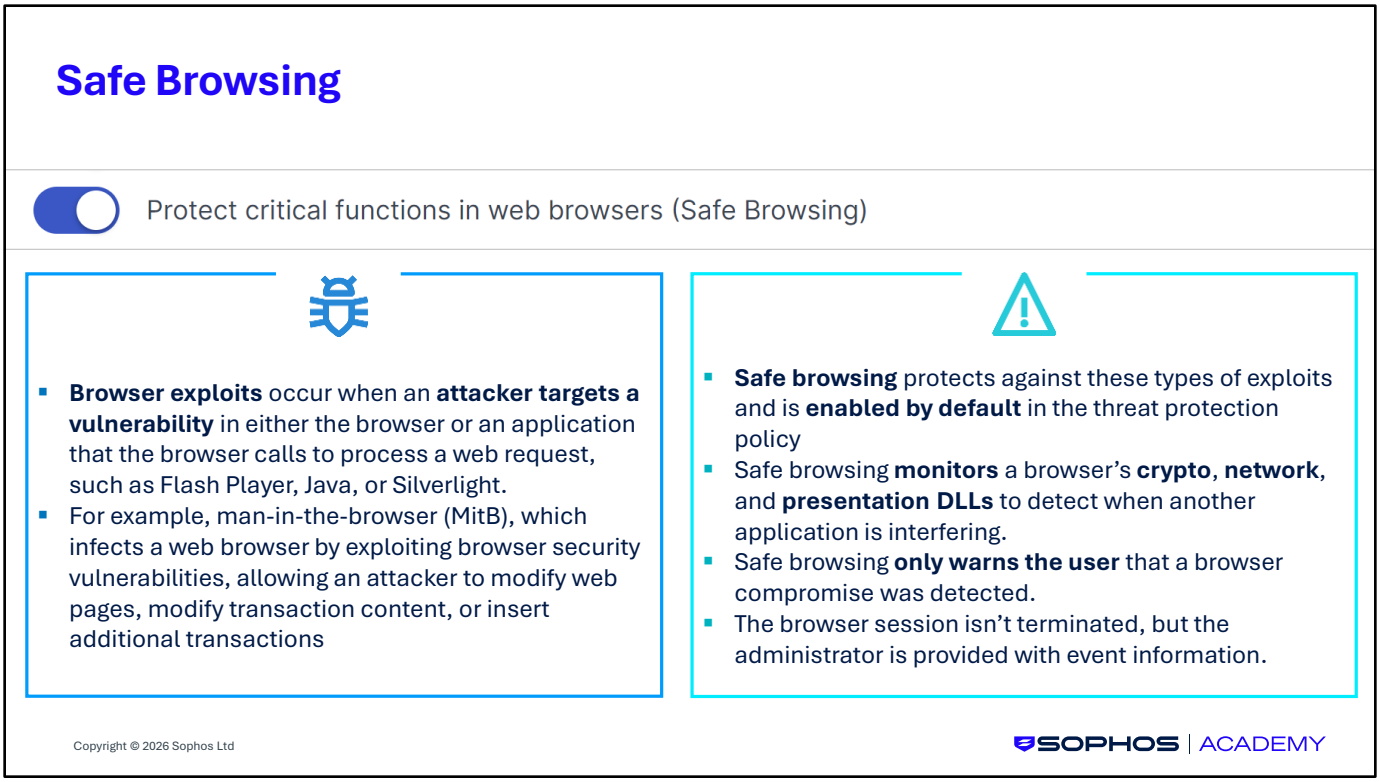
Sophos Endpoint stops ransomware by intercepting the behaviour. It prevents common file encryption as well as less common ransomware that impacts the disk and master boot record. These attacks are intentionally destructive and can wipe a device.

WipeGuard prevents attacks that target the master boot record and prevents bootkit installation. A bootkit is a variant of a rootkit that infects a device's startup code and can be used to attack full disk encrypted systems.

CryptoGuard protects against remotely run ransomware and file encryption. It does so by monitoring specific file types in specific locations, looking for actions that indicate ransomware. One action could be a process that opens and writes to multiple files in a short period of time.

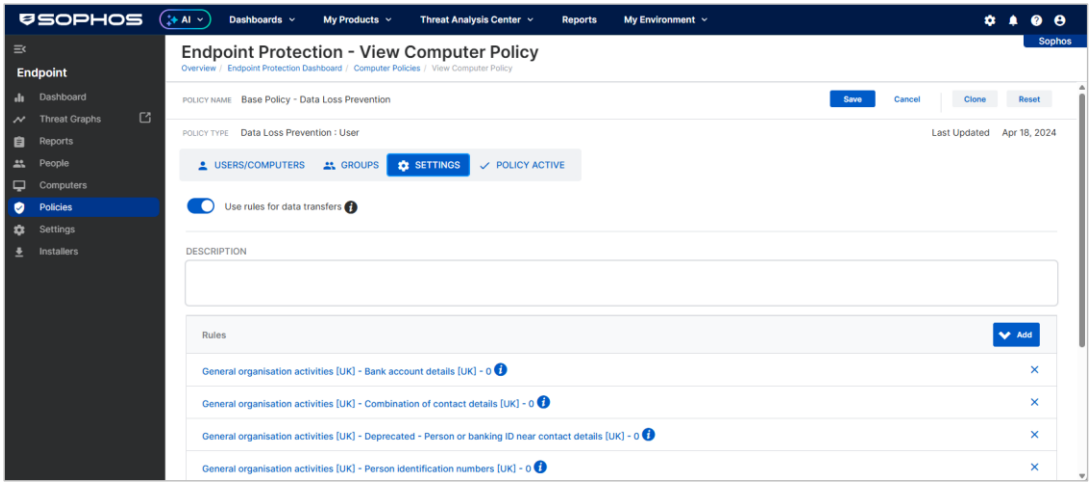


Browser exploits are a class of threat where the attack targets a vulnerability in either the browser or in an application that the browser calls to process a web request, such as Flash Player or Java.

An example of this is a man-in-the-browser attack, a form of internet threat that infects an internet browser by taking advantage of vulnerabilities in the browser's security. This allows an attacker to modify web pages, transaction content, or insert additional transactions.

Safe Browsing monitors a browser's crypto, network, and presentation DLLs to detect when another application is interfering. Safe Browsing only warns a user that a browser compromise was detected. It'll initiate a scan but won't terminate the browser sessions. The user is alerted that the browser session is potentially compromised, and the administrator is provided with event information to support investigation.

Data Loss Prevention (DLP)



- **Control** accidental data loss
- **Monitor** and restrict the transfer of sensitive data files
- **Prevent** users sending data using common file sharing applications

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Data Loss Prevention controls accidental data loss and enables administrators to monitor and restrict the transfer of files containing sensitive data. For example, an administrator can prevent users from sending sensitive data outside of the organization using web-based email accounts.

DLP uses rules that can be applied through a policy to protect devices. The DLP base policy includes multiple templates that cover standard protection for different regions.

Remediation

Detected malicious files are **Quarantined**

Synchronized Security Heartbeat allows for the network isolation of an infected device

Sophos Clean removes detected files

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If malware is detected, it'll be quarantined and automatically removed from the protected device.

The Synchronized Security heartbeat will communicate the device status via Sophos Endpoint. If Synchronized Security is enabled and a Sophos Firewall is in use, the Sophos Firewall can isolate the device so that other devices on the network aren't compromised.

Once Sophos Clean has successfully removed the threat, the device's clean status is communicated via Sophos Endpoint. This will remove the device from network isolation.

Investigation and Visibility

Dashboard

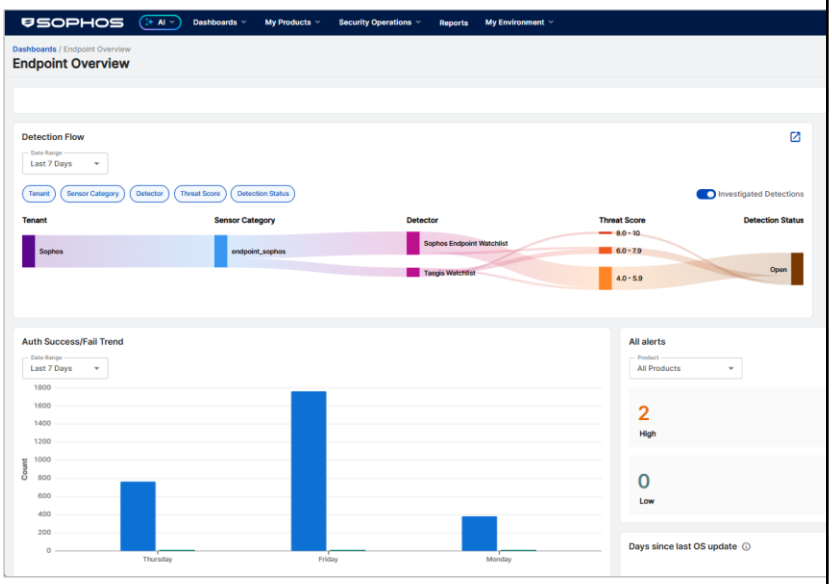
Alerts

Logs

Reports

Data Sharing API

Security Operations



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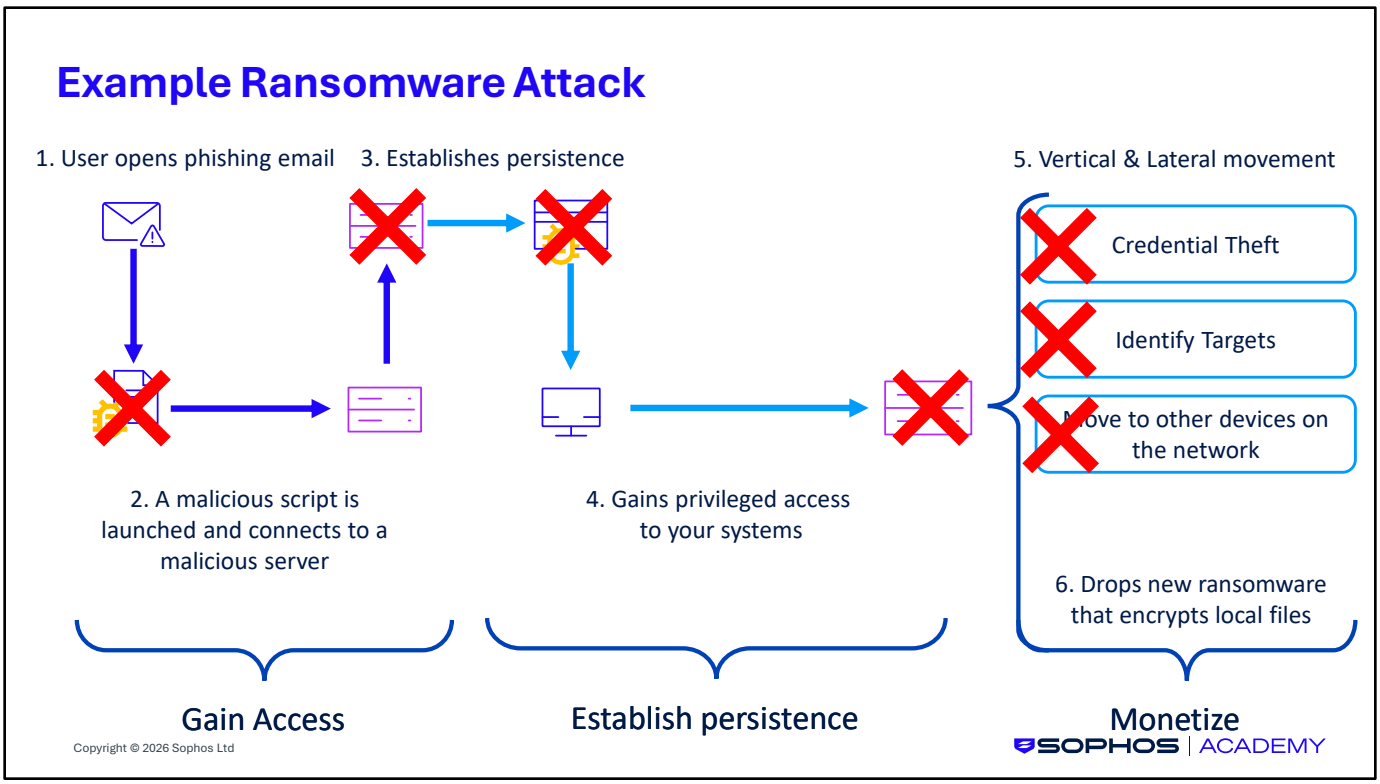
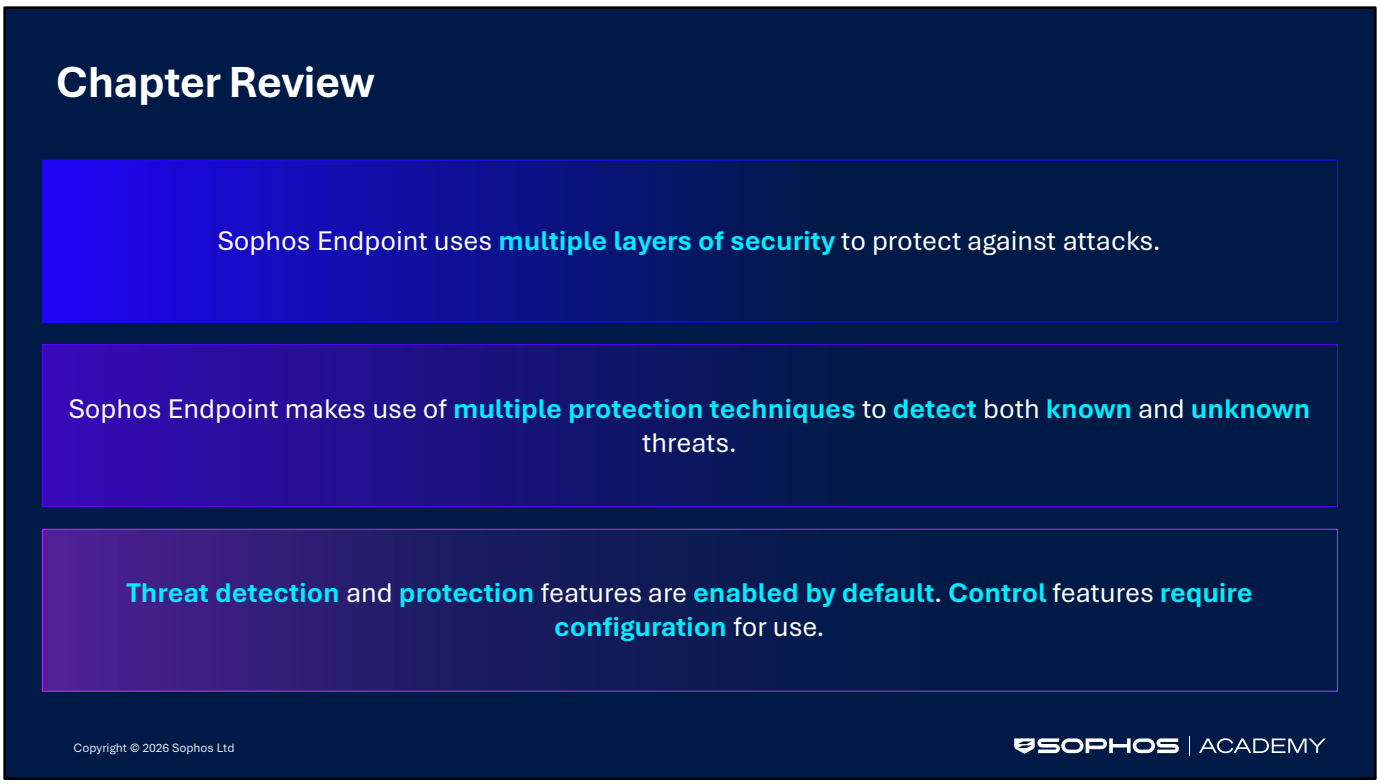
The Sophos Endpoint dashboard provides full visibility into your organization. It can show the health of protected devices and users, and alerts are split by severity. Critical alerts are shown immediately.

Multiple logs and reports can be customized to suit your requirements, and you can use data sharing APIs to connect to third-party applications.

Security Operations allows you to view security incidents. Detections show how an attack started, which files and systems were impacted, and how the threat was responded to. Case investigation tools allow active threat hunting and investigation across your organization, and Live Response allows you to perform tasks remotely on protected and enabled devices.



To summarise, using our ransomware attack example, to prevent an attacker from gaining access to a protected device, Sophos Endpoint implements control over applications, peripheral devices, and website access. It monitors file behaviour and prevents communication with malicious servers and bad URLs. It scans and detects malicious files and uses exploit mitigation features to prevent vertical and lateral movement across the network. It prevents an attacker from compromising the boot and disk volumes and prevents ransomware from encrypting files.



Here are the three main things you learned in this chapter.

Sophos Endpoint uses multiple layers of security to protect against attacks.

Sophos Endpoint makes use of multiple protection techniques to detect both known and unknown threats.

Threat detection and protection features are enabled by default, whereas control features require configuration for use.

[Additional Information]

Sophos Endpoint
EP0515: Introduction to Sophos Synchronized Security

May 2026

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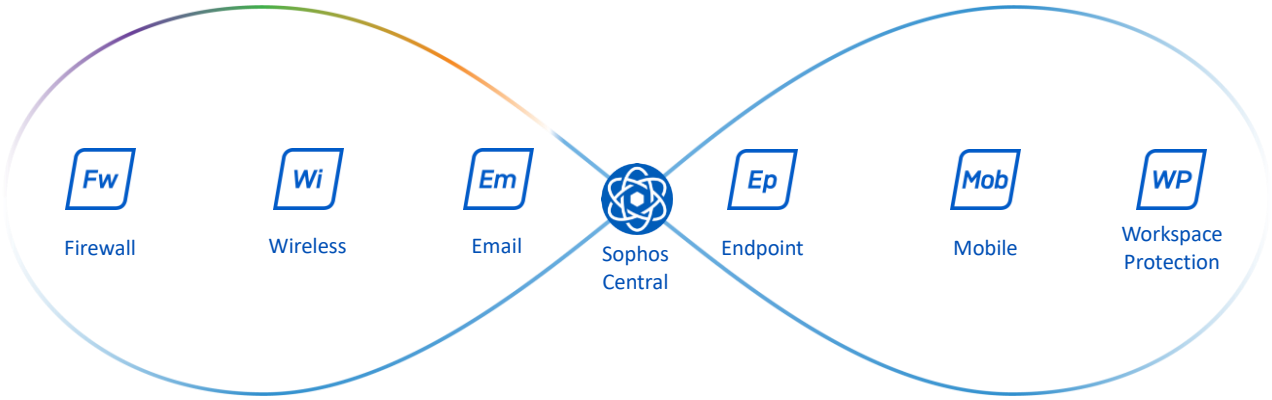
In this chapter, you'll learn how Sophos Synchronized Security allows Sophos products to communicate intelligently with each other to respond to threats.

What is Synchronized Security?



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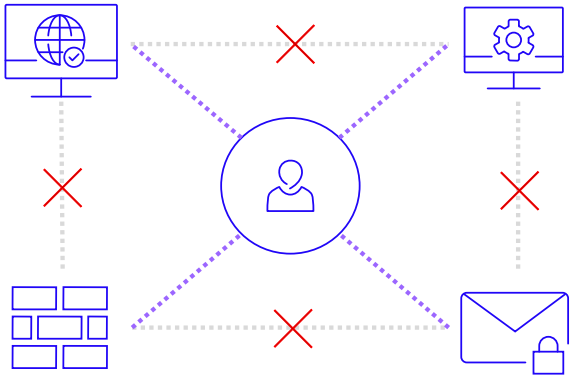
Sophos Synchronized Security is cybersecurity as a system. Security products work together in real time.

What is Synchronized Security?



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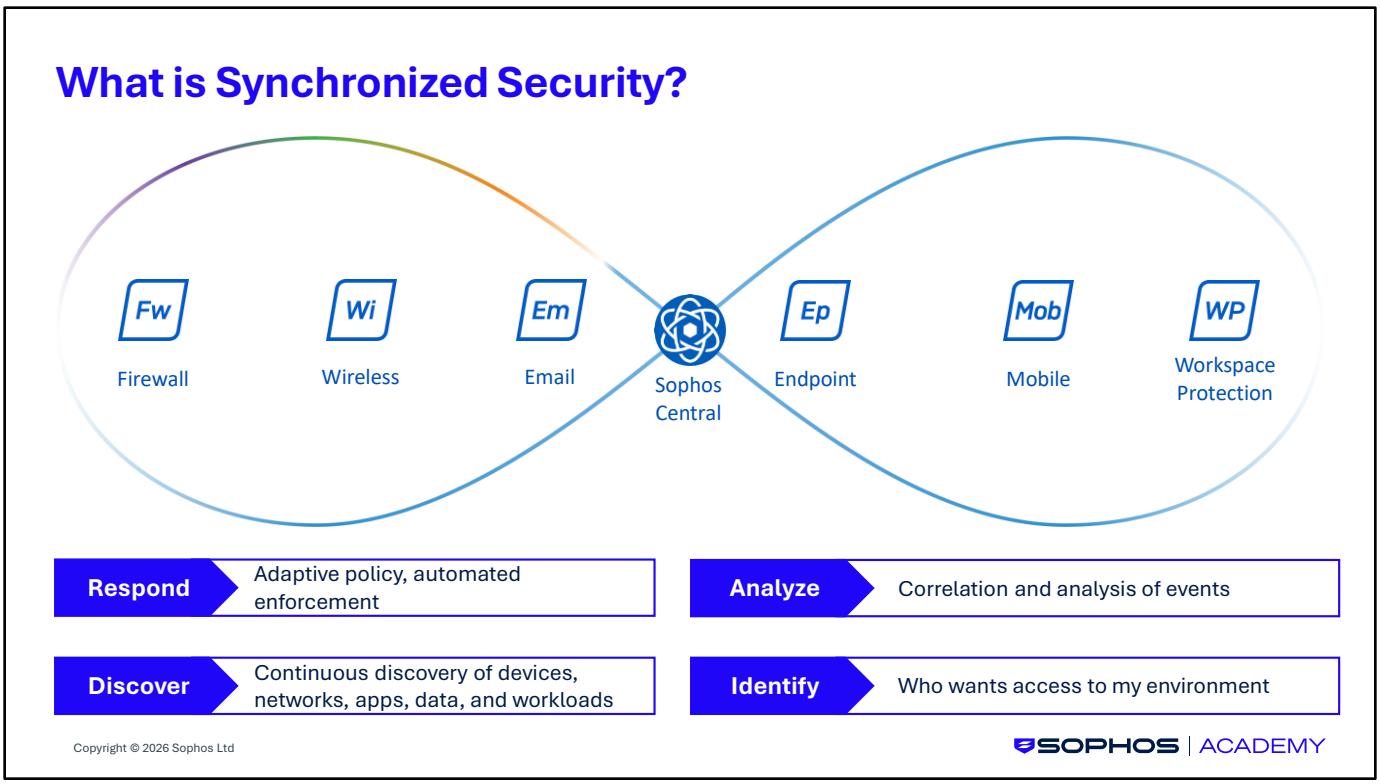
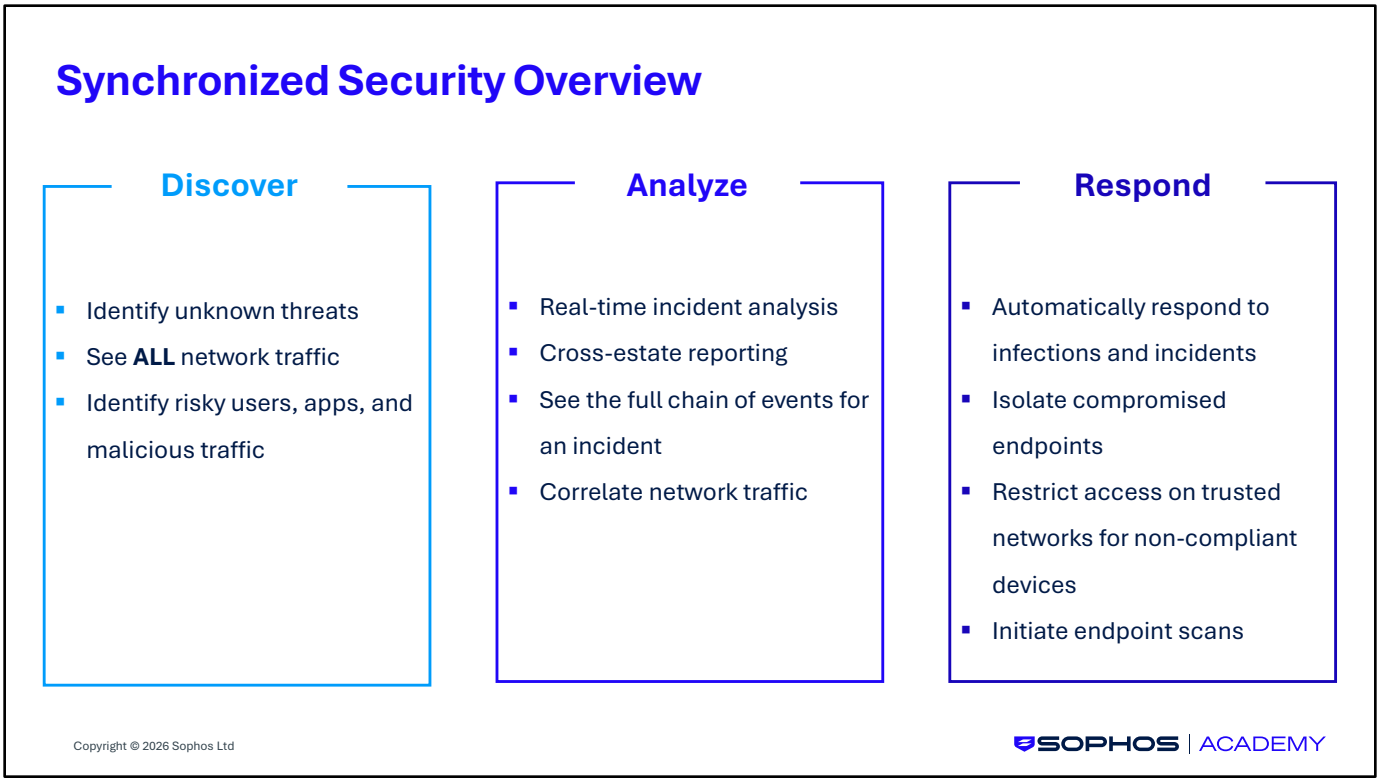
Traditionally, cybersecurity uses separate protection products to identify malicious files and detect and stop malicious traffic. These products work well in isolation, but they are disconnected from each other. This approach results in an IT team manually correlating data between systems, which can take time and often means threats are missed.



Sophos Synchronized Security automates detection, isolation, and remediation results, neutralizing attacks quickly. It also creates new ways to connect security products that protect your organization.



The synchronized security system has three pillars: Discover. Sophos Central products automatically share information to reveal hidden risks and unknown threats. This enables administrators to see all network traffic, identify risky applications, and correlate behaviour across multiple activities.

Analyze. Real-time incident analysis and cross-estate reporting deliver instant insights, allowing administrators to view the full chain of events for an incident.

Respond. Sophos Central automatically responds to incidents, isolating compromised devices, protecting the entire estate, and giving time for threats to be investigated and cleaned up.

Synchronized Security Heartbeat

Communication between protected devices and Sophos Central

- A regular heartbeat. A few bytes every **15 seconds**
- Event information
- Device health status
- Threat source information

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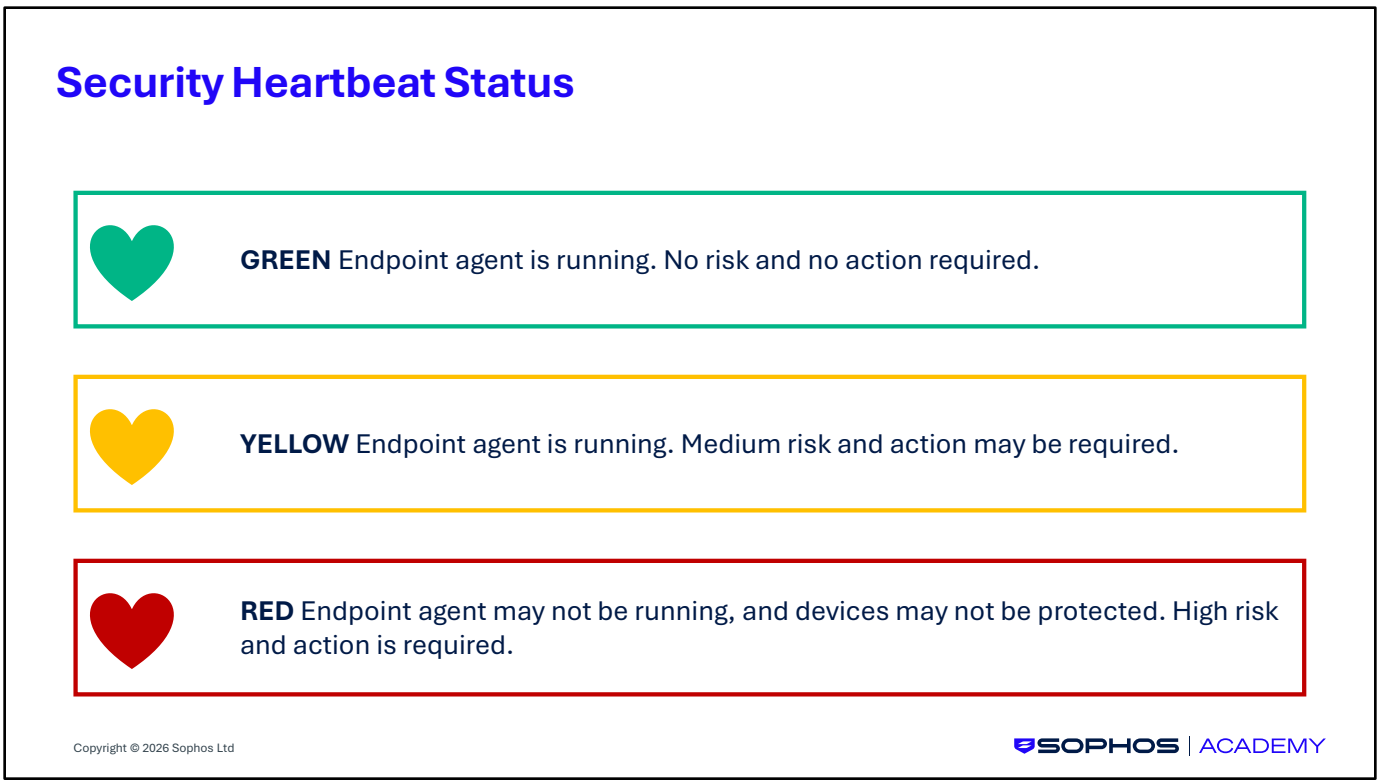
The Sophos Security Heartbeat facilitates communication between Sophos Central products by creating a secure two-way tunnel.

The Security Heartbeat allows for intelligent communication between Sophos products, allowing for a coordinated response to threats. The Security Heartbeat includes a regular heartbeat (a few bytes every 15 seconds) that identifies the device and communicates that the device is active and protected. It communicates event information, the device health status, and threat information.



Here you can see what each heartbeat status means.

If an endpoint has a GREEN status, this means that the endpoint agent is running, and the device is protected. No potentially unwanted applications, active, or inactive malware have been detected.

If an endpoint has a YELLOW status, the endpoint agent is running, meaning that the device is protected. However, inactive malware or a PUA has been detected, which can indicate that the endpoint agent is out of date.

If an endpoint has a RED status, it can indicate that the endpoint agent may not be running, so the device may not be protected. Alternatively, it could mean that active malware has been detected or that malware hasn't been cleaned up. It could also mean that malicious network traffic has been detected, or communication to a known bad host has been identified.

Synchronized Security Examples

Sophos **Synchronized Security** integrates with **all** Sophos **Central products**

Let’s have a look at some examples

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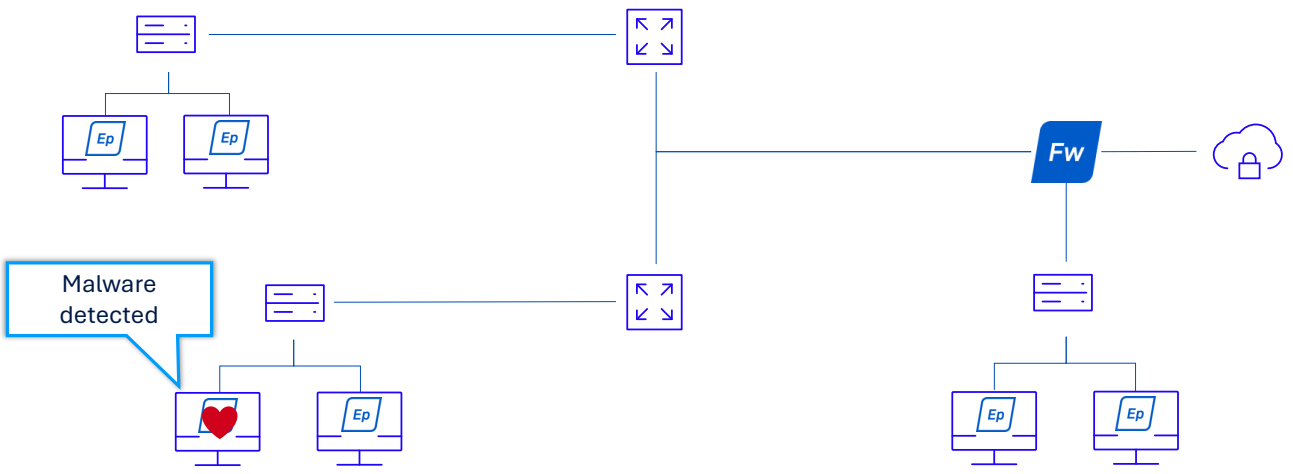
Sophos Synchronized Security integrates with all Sophos Central products. Let’s have a look at some examples.

Security Heartbeat with Sophos Firewall



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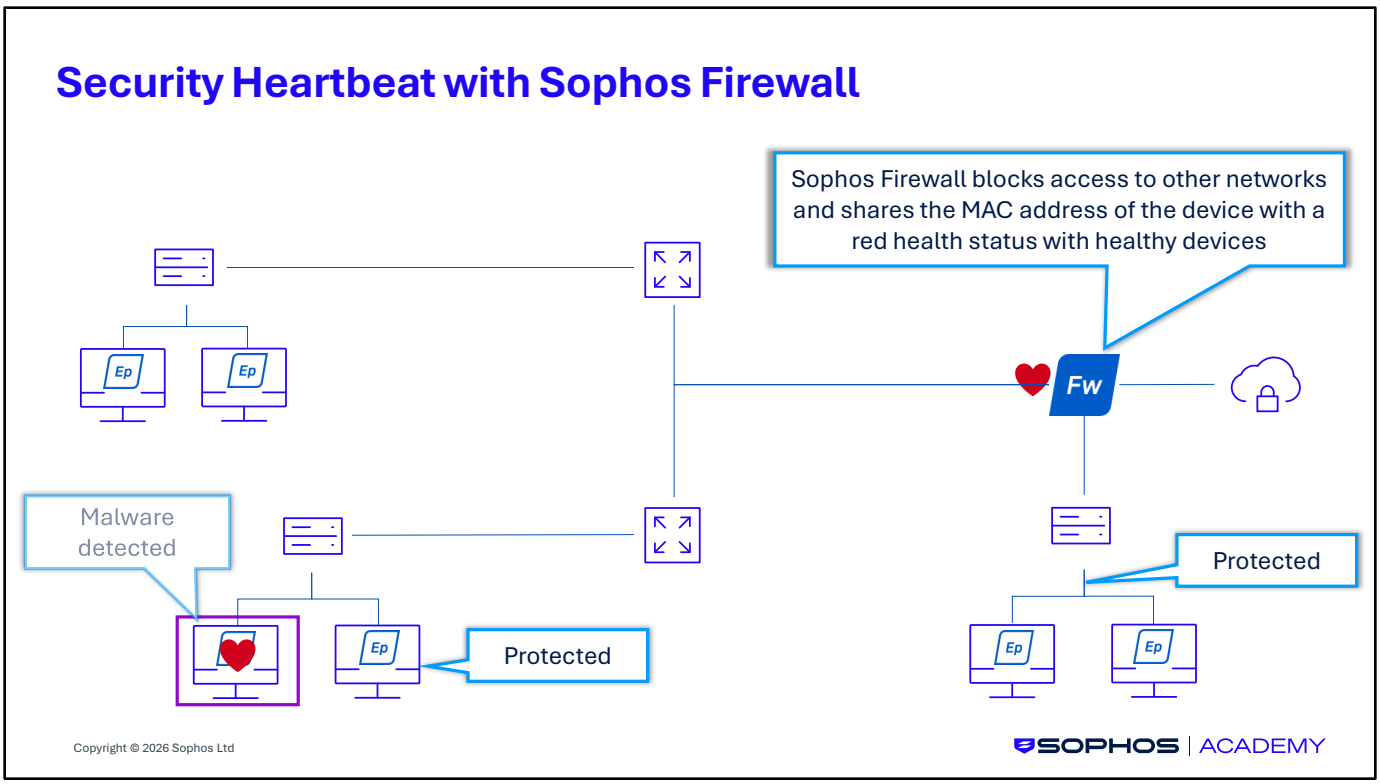
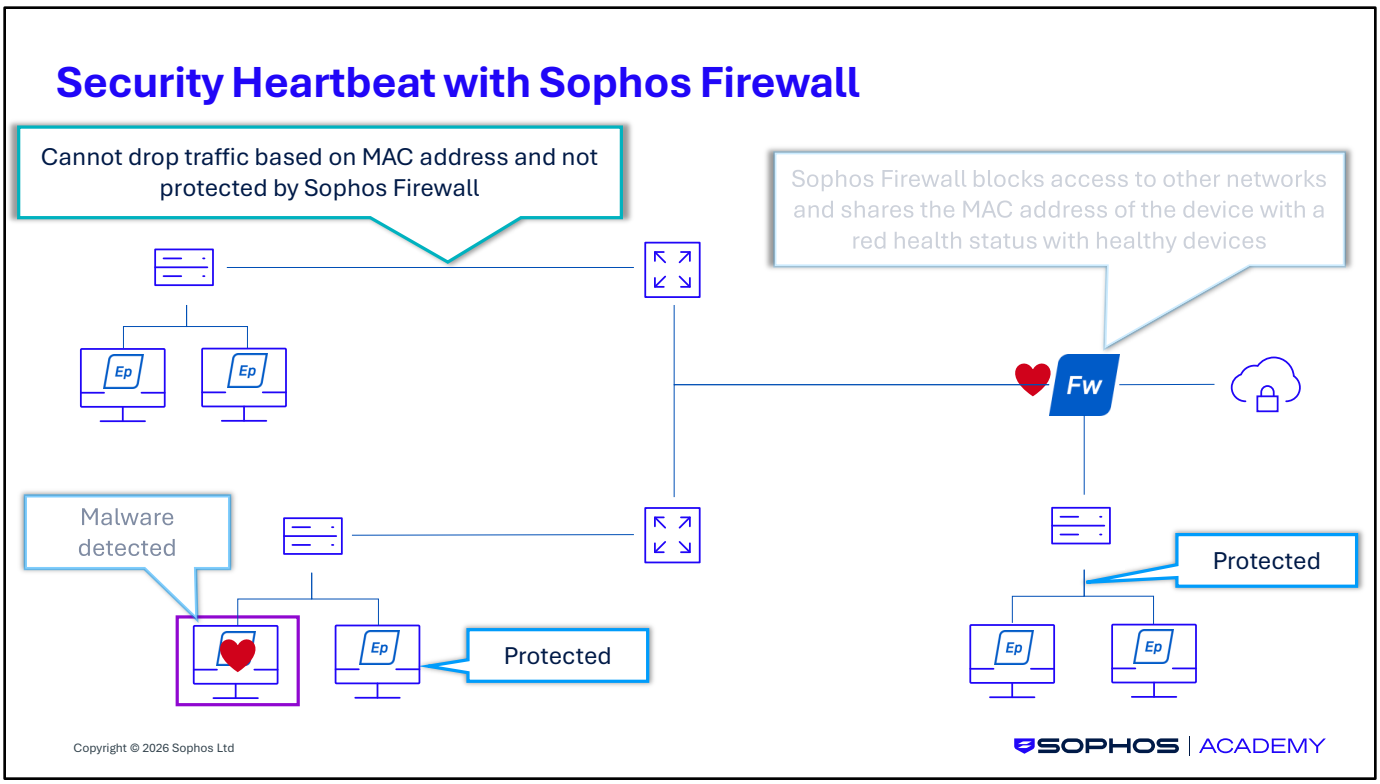
What would happen if malware were detected on a Sophos Endpoint device that is part of a network protected by Sophos Firewall with Synchronized Security turned on?

If Sophos Endpoint detects malware, the Security Heartbeat sends event information along with the device health status to the Sophos Firewall.

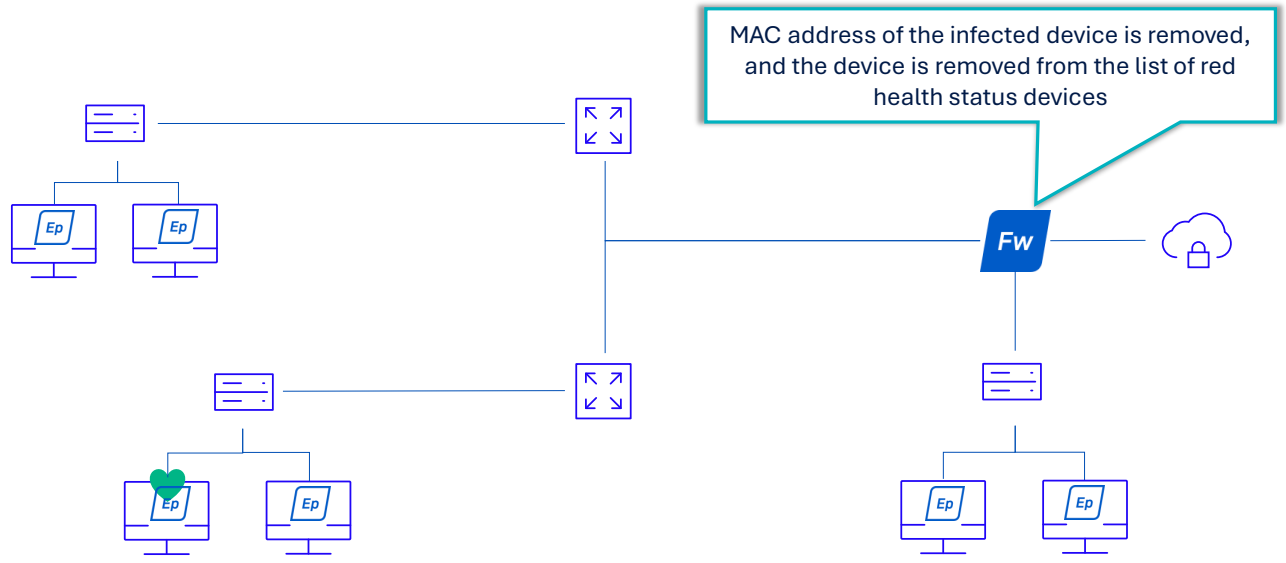


Which shares the MAC address of the device with other devices on the network. Healthy devices drop traffic from the device with the red health status. When traffic passes through the Sophos Firewall, it can prevent the device with a red health status from connecting to other devices, thereby protecting healthy devices from potential infection. The Sophos Firewall will only block traffic from a red health status device; all other devices will have network access.



Only local network segments are protected, if traffic is passing through a router, it will not be dropped.

Security Heartbeat with Sophos Firewall



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Once the endpoint agent has cleaned up malware on the device, the Security Heartbeat sends the updated health status to the Sophos Firewall, which then allows the device to access hosts and networks as normal. It also updates all devices, removing the MAC address of the compromised device from the list of devices with a red health status.

Sophos Endpoint and Sophos Firewall

1. Malware Detection

Sophos Endpoint detects a malware attack

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What happens when a device is protected with Sophos Endpoint and a Sophos Firewall is in use?

The Sophos Endpoint agent detects malware.

Sophos Endpoint and Sophos Firewall

1. Malware Detection
Sophos Endpoint detects a malware attack

2. Cross Estate Communication
Device status shared with the Sophos Firewall

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The device's health status is communicated via Security Heartbeat with the Sophos Firewall.

Sophos Endpoint and Sophos Firewall

1. Malware Detection
Sophos Endpoint detects a malware attack

2. Cross Estate Communication
Device status shared with the Sophos Firewall

3. Device Isolation
Sophos Firewall isolates the device

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Which isolates the device on the network.

Sophos Endpoint and Sophos Firewall

1. Malware Detection
Sophos Endpoint detects a malware attack

2. Cross Estate Communication
Device status shared with the Sophos Firewall

3. Device Isolation
Sophos Firewall isolates the device

4. Clean-up
Automatic clean-up on the device

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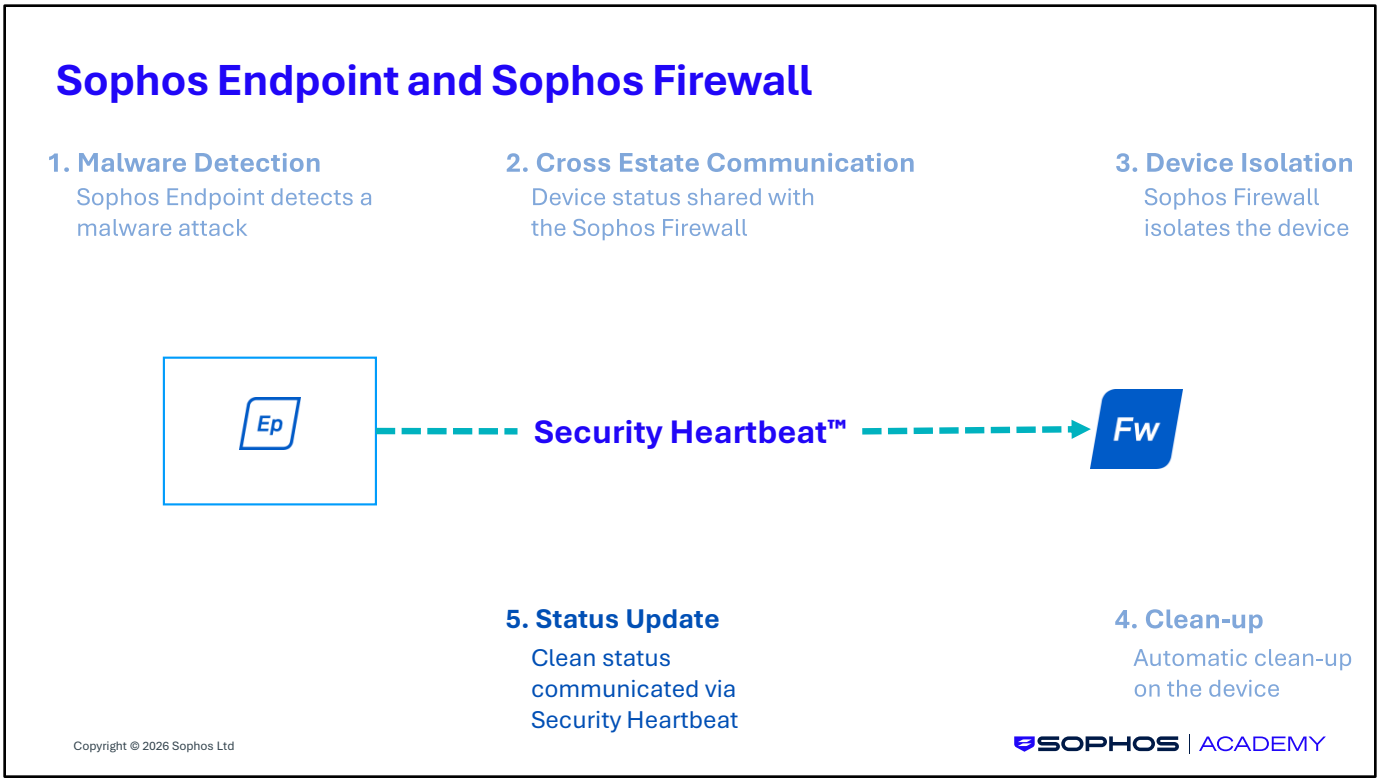
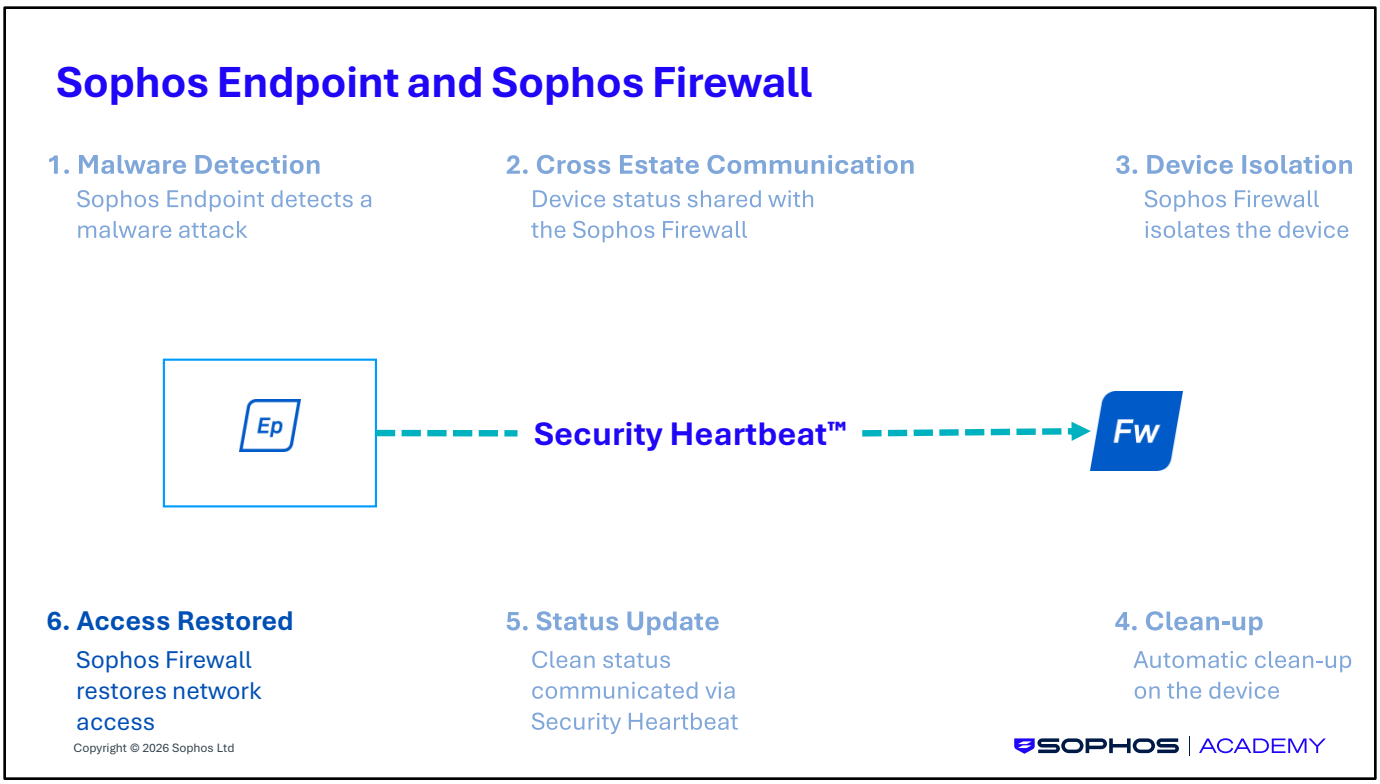
Automatic remediation of the device ensures that the threat is cleaned up. Once the device is clean, the health status is updated and reported via the Security Heartbeat to the Sophos Firewall, which restores network access.



Once the device is clean, the health status is updated and reported via the Security Heartbeat to the Sophos Firewall.



Which restores network access. This automatic incident response takes seconds with no human interaction required.

Sophos Endpoint and Sophos Email

1. Malware Detection

Sophos Email detects a compromised mailbox

Security Heartbeat™

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Here we can see a scenario where a device is protected with Sophos Endpoint and Sophos Email. Sophos Email detects a compromised mailbox that is being used to send outbound spam emails.

Sophos Endpoint and Sophos Email

1. Malware Detection
Sophos Email detects a compromised mailbox

2. Mailbox Isolation
The mailbox is isolated

Security Heartbeat™

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The mailbox is automatically isolated.

Sophos Endpoint and Sophos Email

1. Malware Detection
Sophos Email detects a compromised mailbox

2. Mailbox Isolation
The mailbox is isolated

3. Cross estate communication
Isolation status shared with the Sophos Central

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The isolation status is shared with Sophos Central via the Security Heartbeat.

Sophos Endpoint and Sophos Email

1. Malware Detection
Sophos Email detects a compromised mailbox

2. Mailbox Isolation
The mailbox is isolated

3. Cross estate communication
Isolation status shared with the Sophos Central

4. Device Scan
All known devices of the mailbox are scanned

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The endpoint protection agent identifies and scans all known devices associated with the mailbox for malware.

Sophos Endpoint and Sophos Email

1. Malware Detection
Sophos Email detects a compromised mailbox

2. Mailbox Isolation
The mailbox is isolated

3. Cross estate communication
Isolation status shared with the Sophos Central

5. Clean-up
The detection is automatically cleaned up

4. Device Scan
All known devices of the mailbox are scanned

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The malware is automatically cleaned up, and the status is communicated with Sophos Central.

Sophos Endpoint and Sophos Email

1. Malware Detection
Sophos Email detects a compromised mailbox

2. Mailbox Isolation
The mailbox is isolated

3. Cross estate communication
Isolation status shared with the Sophos Central

6. Mailbox Restored
Mailbox sender privileges restored

5. Clean-up
The detection is automatically cleaned up

4. Device Scan
All known devices of the mailbox are scanned

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The mailbox is restored.

Zero-Touch Lateral Movement Protection

1. Malware Detection

Sophos Endpoint detects a malware attack, and the health status of the device is set to **RED**

Security Heartbeat™

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An attacker typically wants to move across your network to gain better access to your data.

If a protected device detects a threat, the health status of that device is set to red.

Zero-Touch Lateral Movement Protection

1. Malware Detection
Sophos Endpoint detects a malware attack, and the health status of the device is set to **RED**

2. Cross Estate Communication
Device status shared with Sophos Central

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…and shared with the Sophos Firewall via Security Heartbeat.

Zero-Touch Lateral Movement Protection

1. Malware Detection
Sophos Endpoint Protection detects a malware attack, and the health status of the device is set to **RED**

2. Cross Estate Communication
Device status shared with Sophos Central

3. Infected device isolated from the network and LAN
Isolation status shared with the network

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The Sophos Firewall isolates the device from both the network and the LAN.

Zero-Touch Lateral Movement Protection

1. Malware Detection
Sophos Endpoint Protection detects a malware attack, and the health status of the device is set to **RED**

2. Cross Estate Communication
Device status shared with Sophos Central

3. Infected device isolated from the network and LAN
Isolation status shared with the network

4. Infection cleaned up
Endpoint protection automatically cleans up the threat

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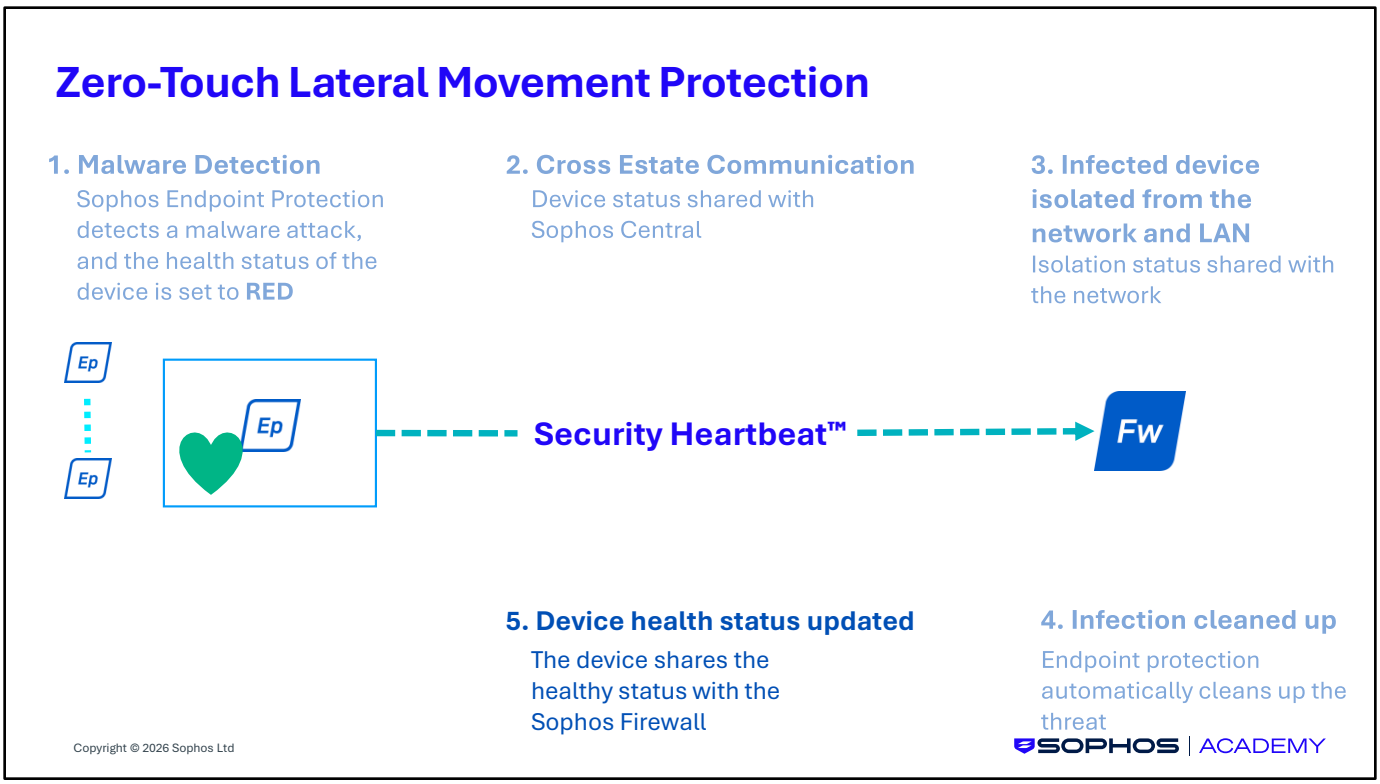
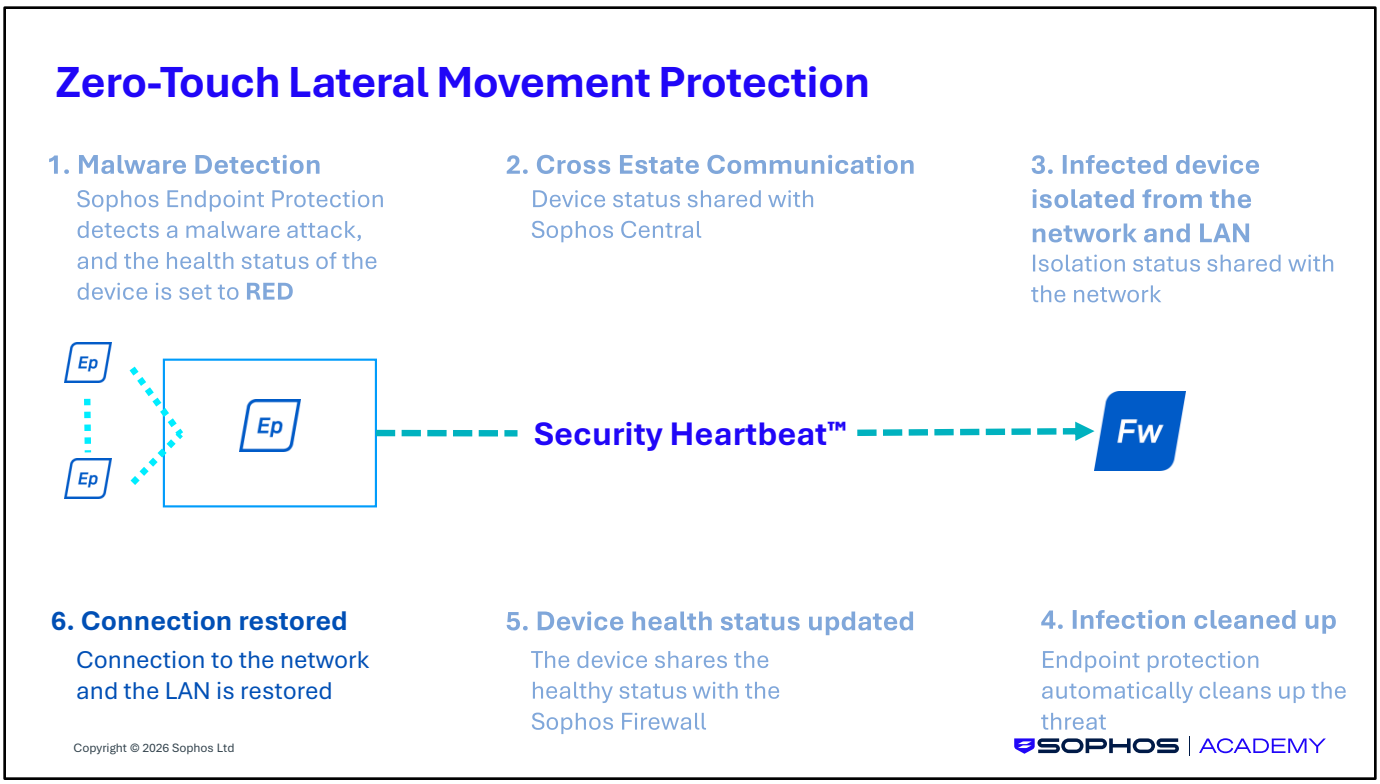
The Sophos Endpoint agent automatically cleans up the threat.



The now healthy device shares the updated health status with Sophos Firewall.



The connection to the network and the LAN is then restored. This process happens in seconds by sharing information and using dynamic policies that respond to incidents and events.

Here are the three main things you learned in this chapter.

Sophos Synchronized Security automates detection, isolation, and remediation results, which means attacks can be neutralized quickly.

There are three pillars to the Synchronized Security system: discover, analyze, and respond.

The Sophos Security Heartbeat facilitates communication between Sophos Central products by creating a secure two-way tunnel.

[Additional Information]

Sophos Endpoint
EP0520: Sophos Endpoint Access and Navigation

September 2026

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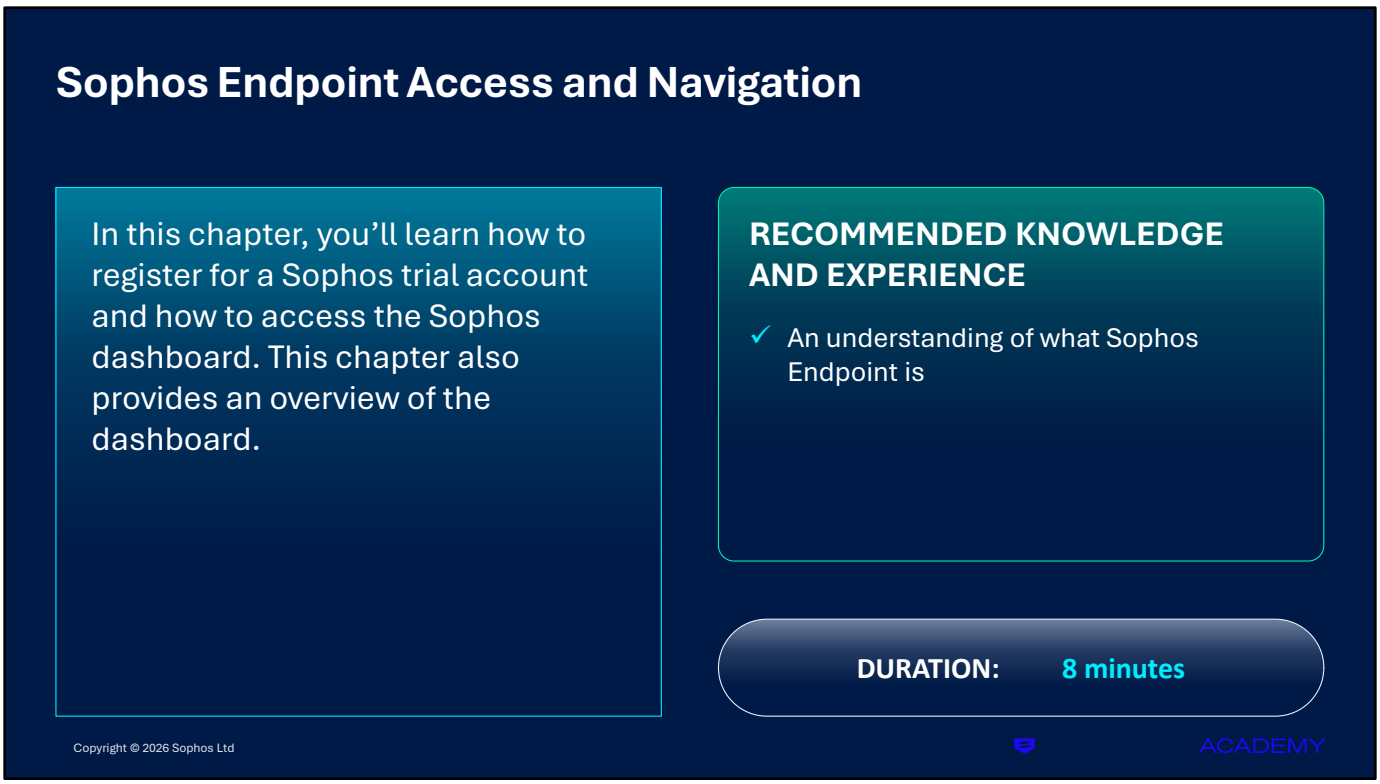
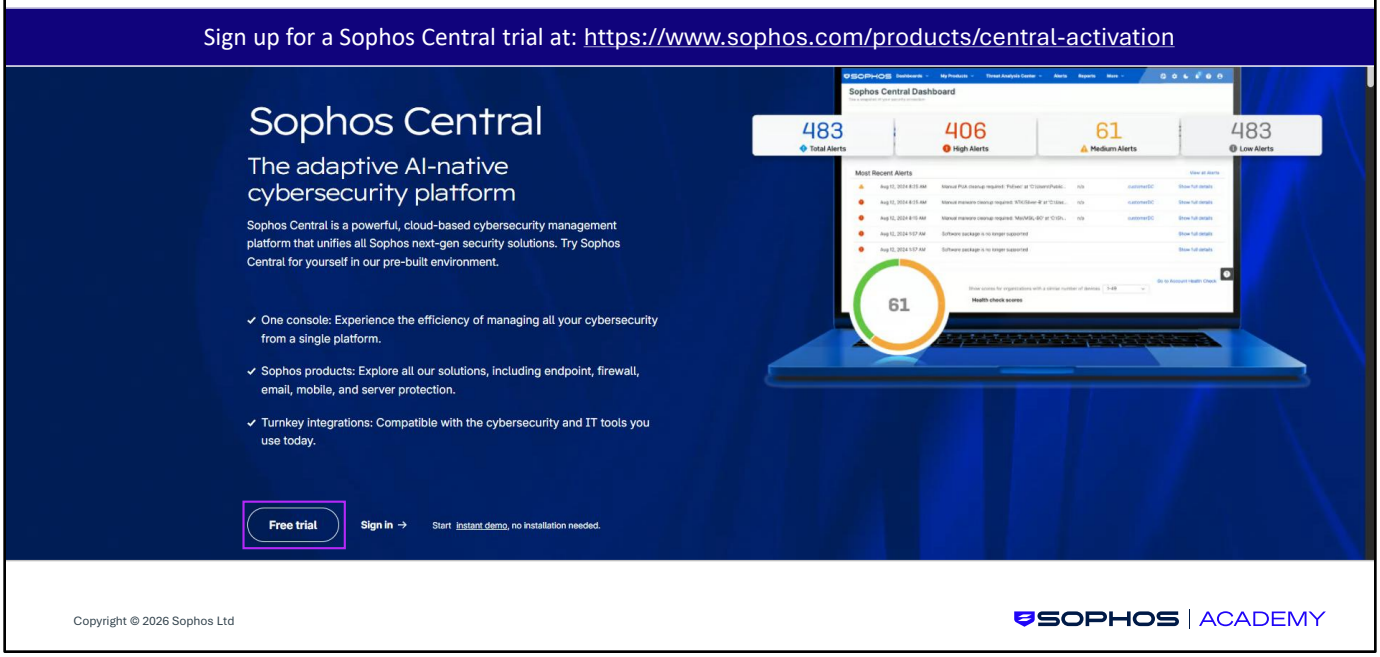


In this chapter, you'll learn how to register for a Sophos trial account and how to access the Sophos dashboard. This chapter also provides an overview of the dashboard.

How to Register for a Sophos Trial

Additional information available in the notes

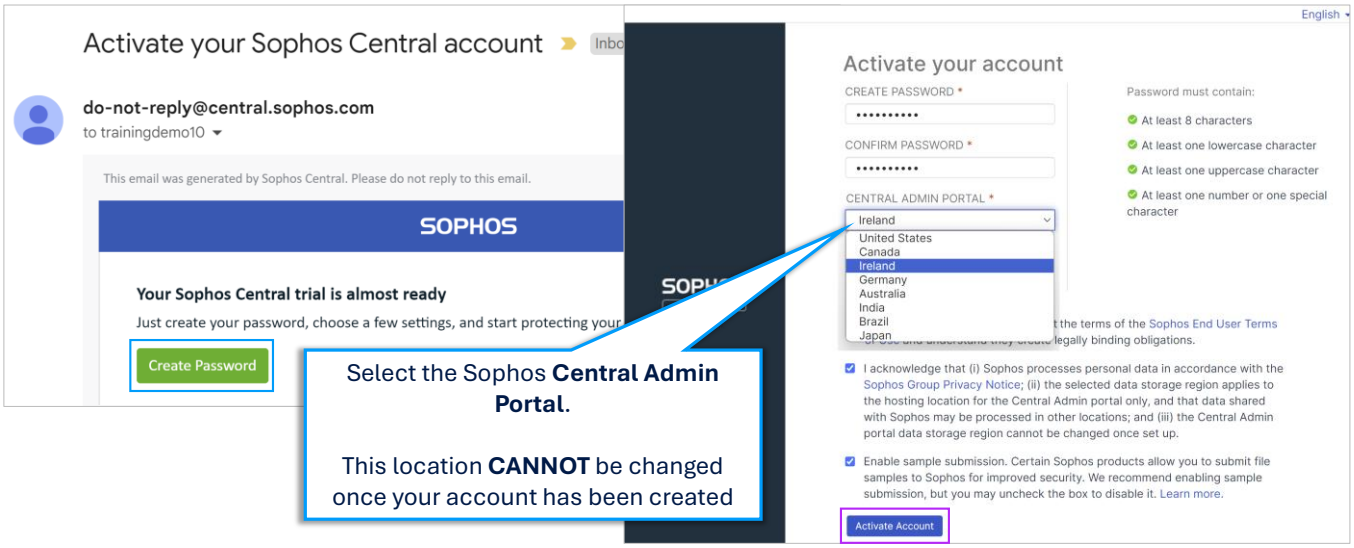


To get started, sign up for a trial account via the Sophos website.

All trial accounts are valid for thirty days. This period can be extended by contacting your Sophos account team if required.

[Additional Information]
https://www.sophos.com/products/central-activation

Activation



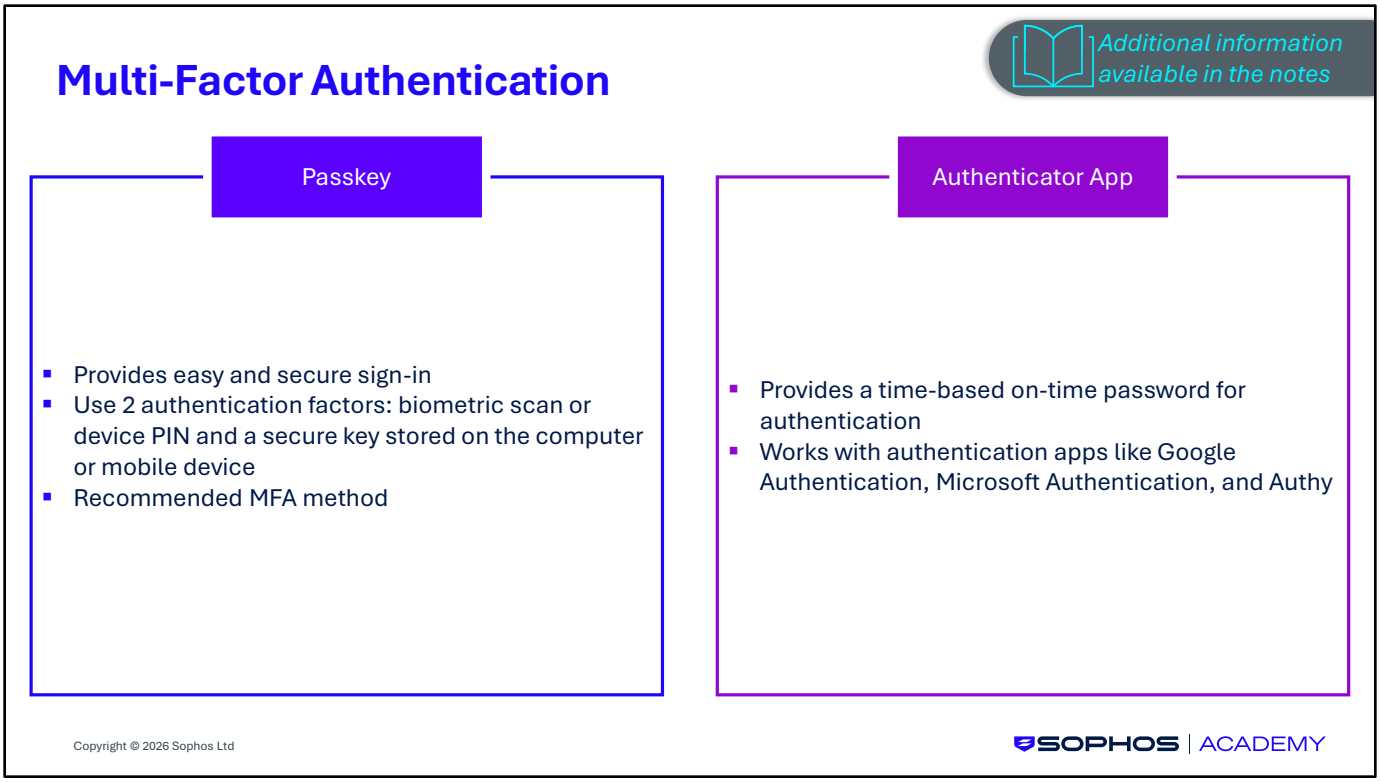
After entering your credentials, you will receive an email with the details of how to activate your account. This email is sent to the email address you entered when you signed up for the free trial. The activation email includes the link to create a password for your trial account. You will be prompted to create and confirm a password.

You must select the Sophos Admin Portal from the drop-down menu. Please note that this location cannot be changed once your account has been created. The privacy policy, sample submission, and the Sophos end-user license agreements should be read and accepted. To activate your account, click **Activate Account**.

Accessing Sophos Central

Following activation, you will be automatically logged into your account.

For future access, go to **central.sophos.com** and enter your Sophos ID. This is the email address you used to sign up for your account and the password you created when you activated it. Multi-factor authentication is required for access.



Sophos admins can authenticate using either a username and password pair or a passkey.

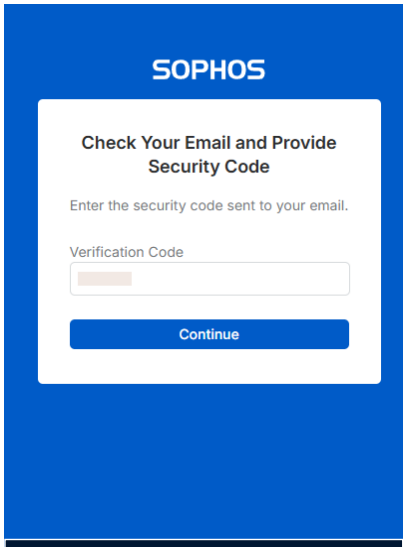
Authenticating with username and password requires multi-factor authentication using a time-based one-time password (TOTP) authentication app like Google Authenticator, Microsoft Authenticator, or Authy.

Passkeys provide an easier, more secure method of logging in. They use two authentication factors: a biometric scan or device PIN and a key stored securely on the computer or mobile device. They're phishing-resistant because they can't be faked or hijacked, and they're secure from your computer to the cloud. Passkeys only need a single action, such as pressing a finger on a fingerprint reader, to authenticate the user to the service.

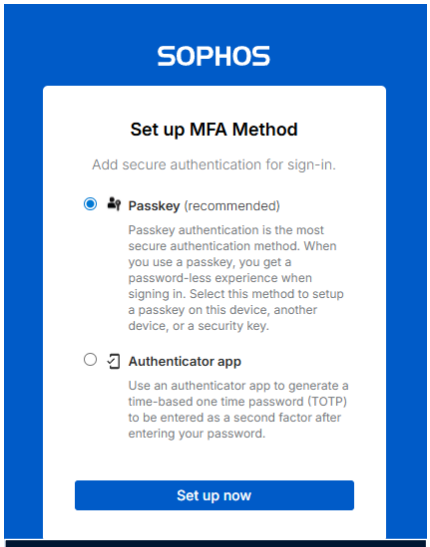
[Additional Information]
For more information about authentication methods including deprecated authentication methods, the see the help file here:
About authentication - Sophos Central Admin
https://docs.sophos.com/central/Customer/help/en-us/ManageYourAccount/ModernAuthentication/ModernAuthAbout/index.html

Multi-Factor Authentication

Additional information available in the notes



Enter a verification code



Select MFA authentication method

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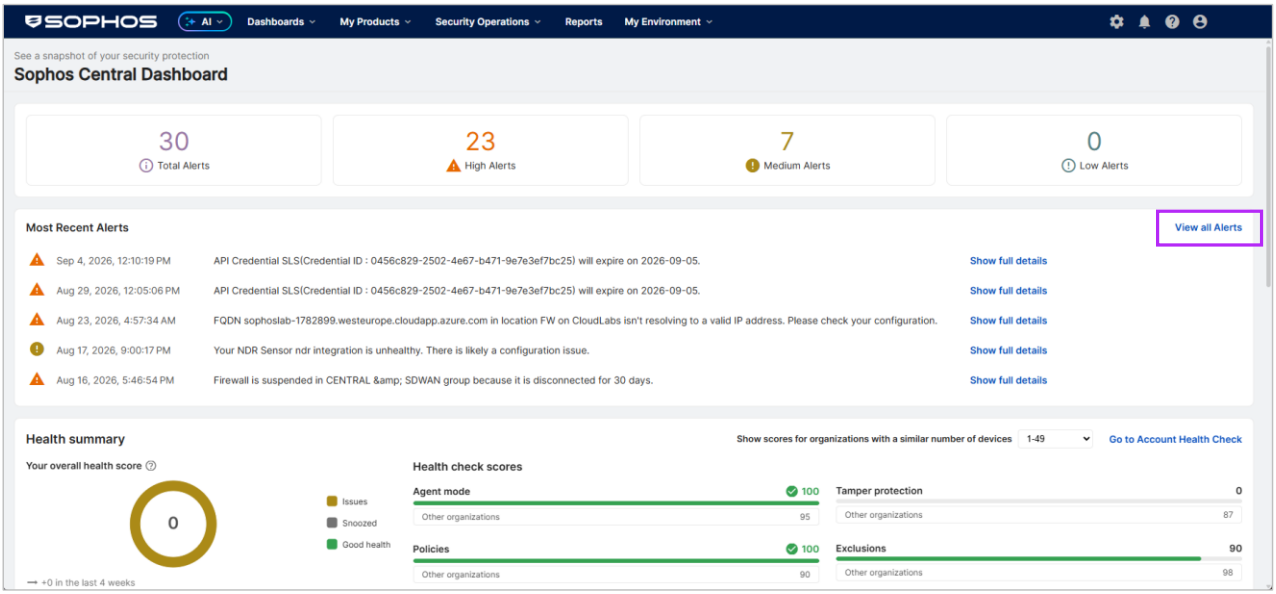
Multi-factor authentication must be set up when you log back into your account following activation. Once you have entered your Sophos ID and password, a security code is sent to the email address you used to sign up. Enter the security code from your email and click **Continue**.

Select the MFA authentication method you want to use, selecting either a passkey or an authenticator application. Once an authentication method has been selected, additional steps will be presented.

[Additional Information]
For more information about authentication methods including deprecated authentication methods, the see the help file here:
About authentication - Sophos Central Admin
https://docs.sophos.com/central/customer/help/en-us/index.html?contextId=modern-authentication-about

Sophos Central Dashboard



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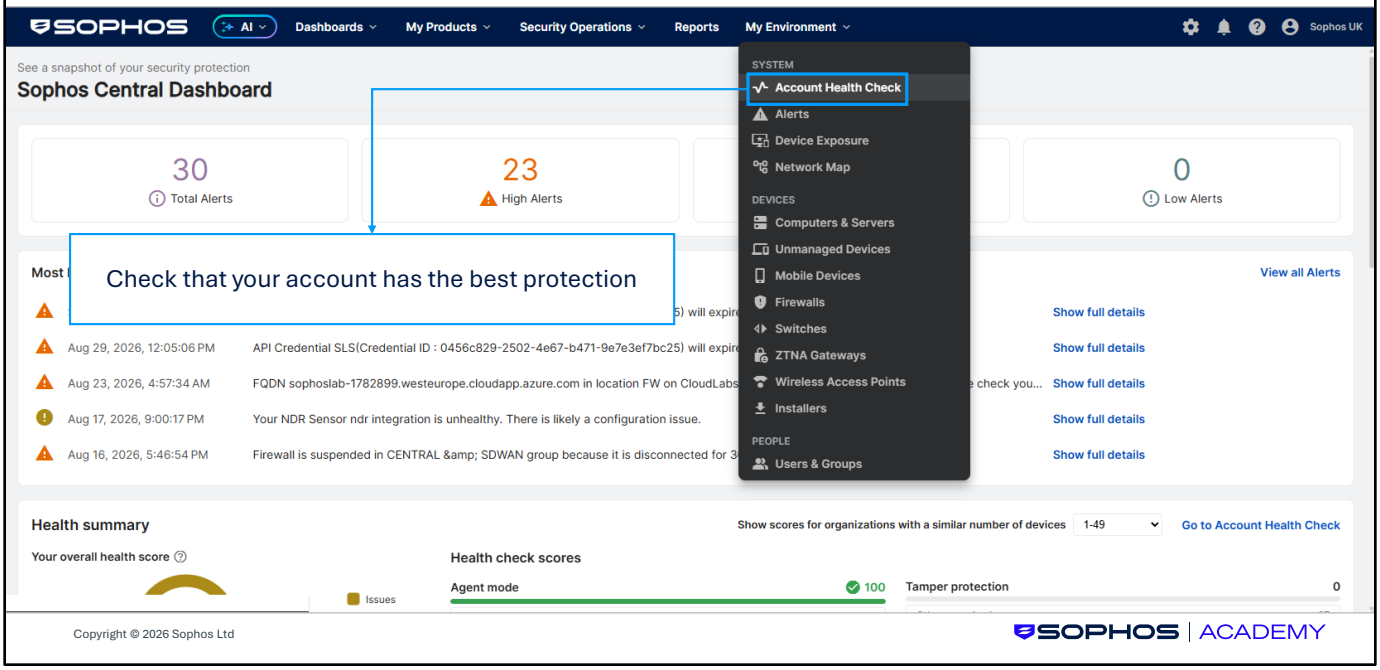
Once logged in, the dashboard is presented. The top section displays the alert summary, which collates the number of alerts by severity. In the most recent alerts section, you can select individual alerts to view the full details.

The dashboard displays a health summary of your organization, a summary of your protected devices and users by their active status. It also displays any web pages that have been blocked or a warning message returned. The dashboard can be customized to use additional widgets that will show additional information.

All summaries include links to the specific pages that provide more detail.

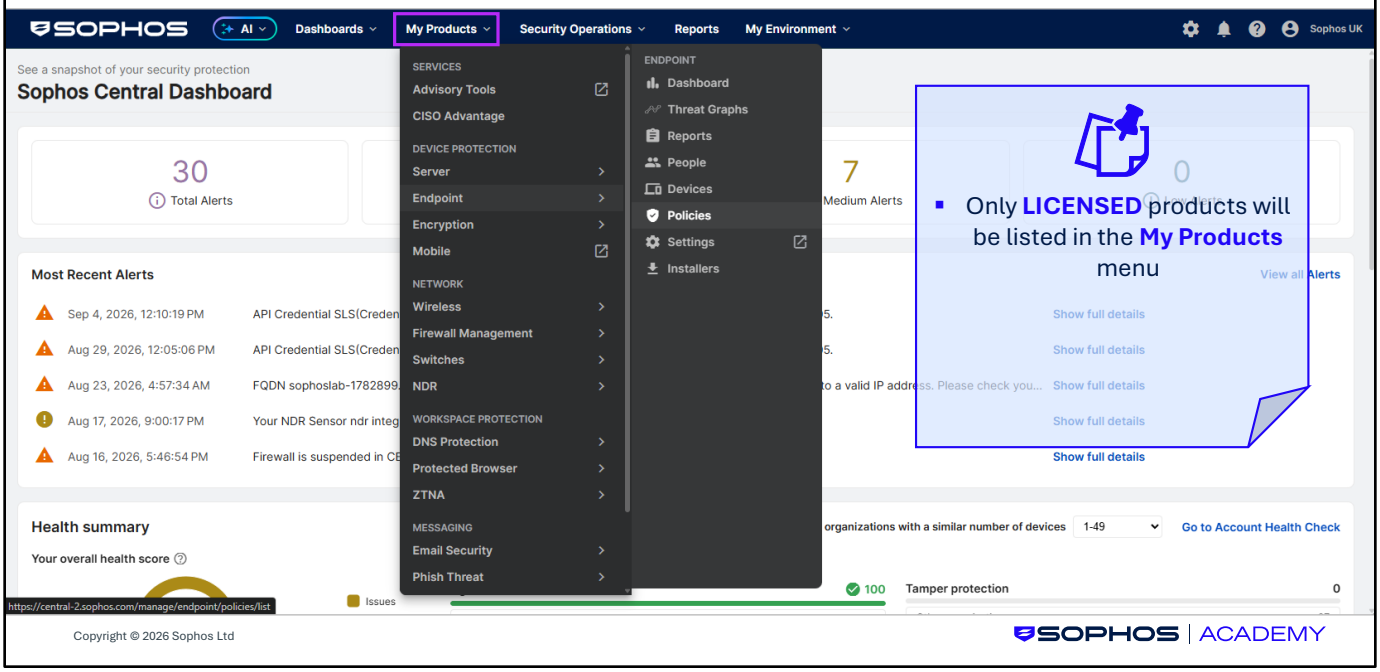
Sophos Central Dashboard



The top menu bar provides access to key functionality. The **My Environment** tab includes all details related to your environment.

The **Account Health Check** page allows you to verify that your account has the optimal protection.

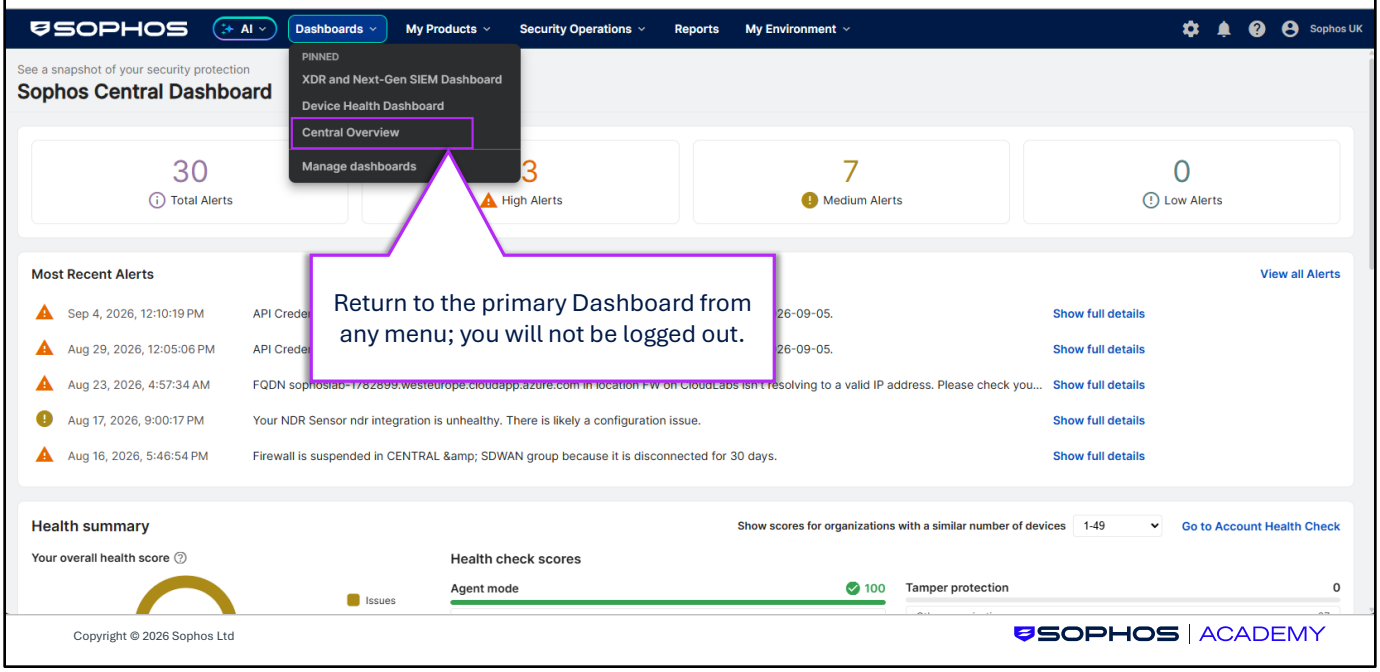
Sophos Central Dashboard



Your licensed products are listed in the **My Products** drop-down menu in the top menu bar.

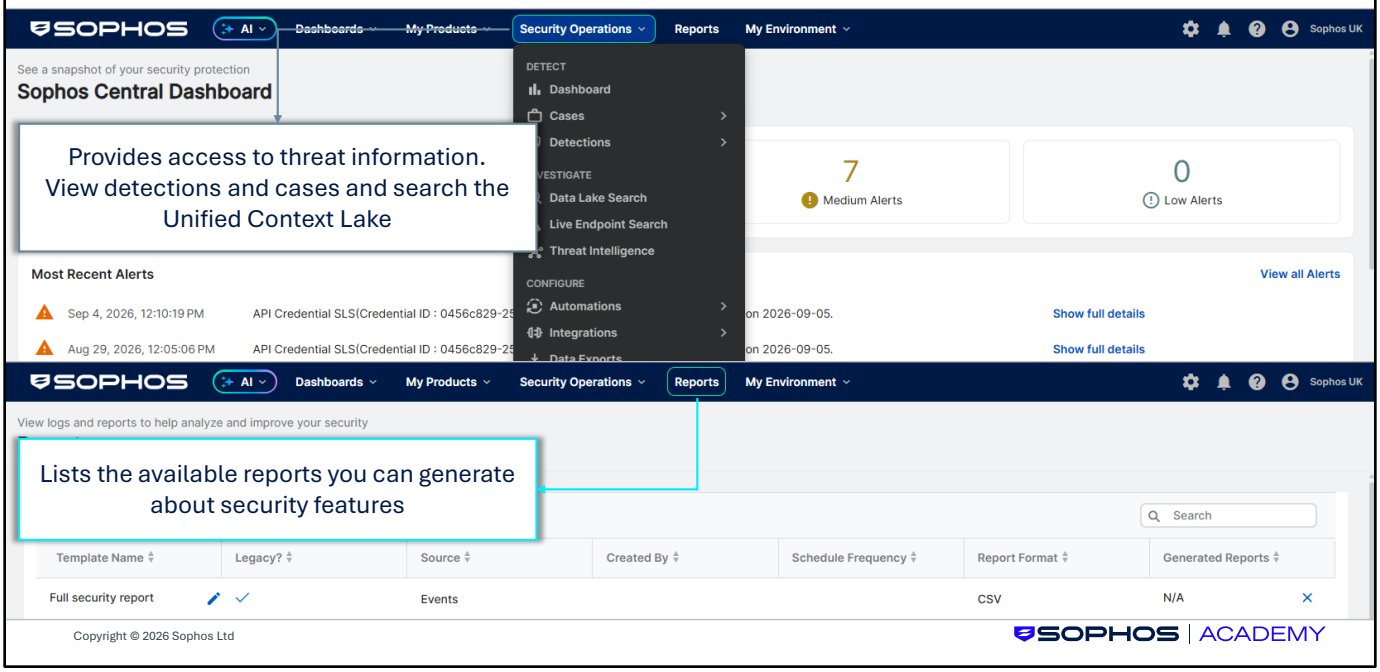
Hovering over a product will open the product menu. You can select which page you would like to go to, for example, the product Dashboard, Reports, or Policies.

Sophos Central Dashboard



You can return to the primary dashboard by selecting **Dashboards** and selecting the dashboard you want to view**.** You will not be logged out during this process.

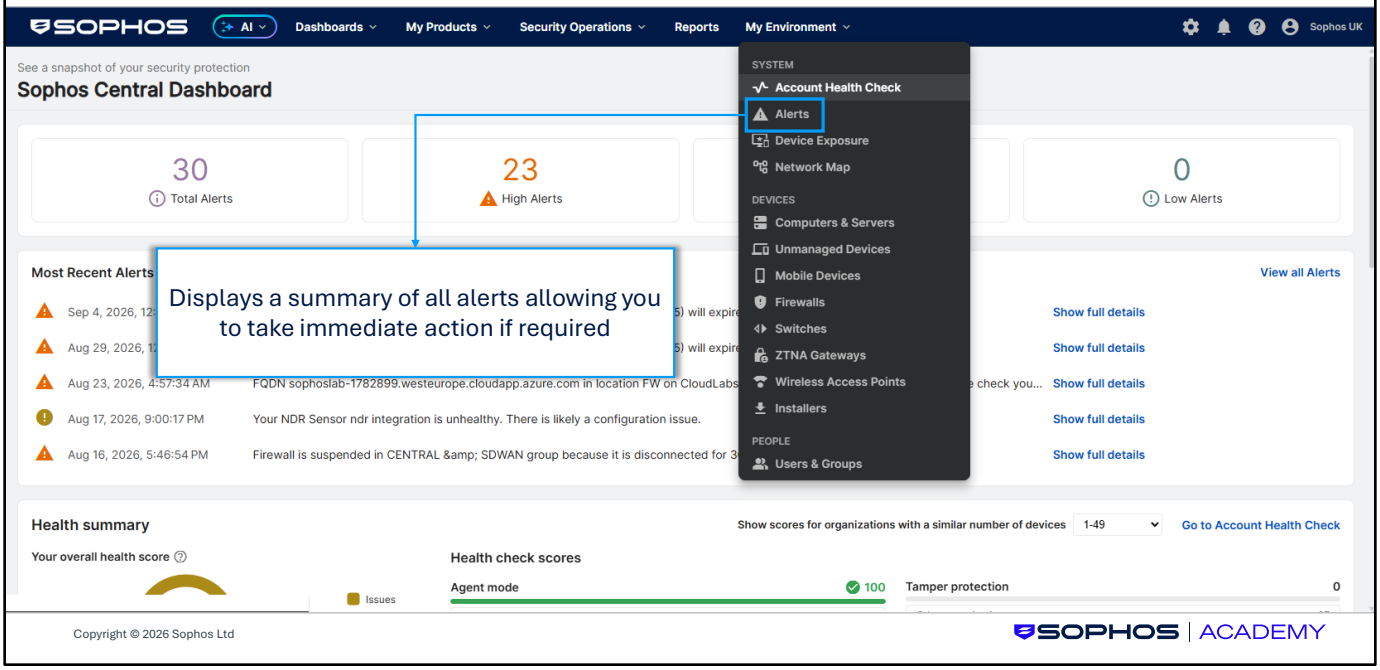
Sophos Central Dashboard



Security Operations provides access to threat information. You can view detections and cases and search the Unified Context Lake for endpoint data.

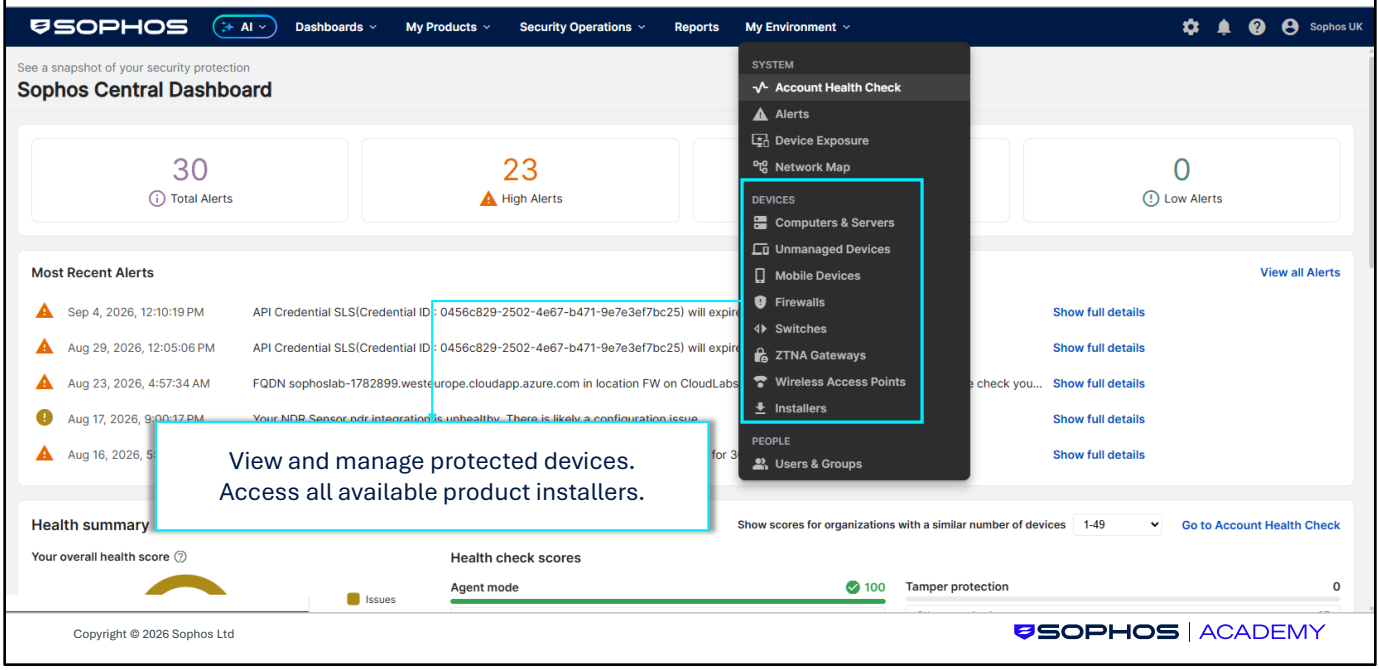
The **Reports** page lists the reports that you can generate related to Sophos Endpoint.

Sophos Central Dashboard



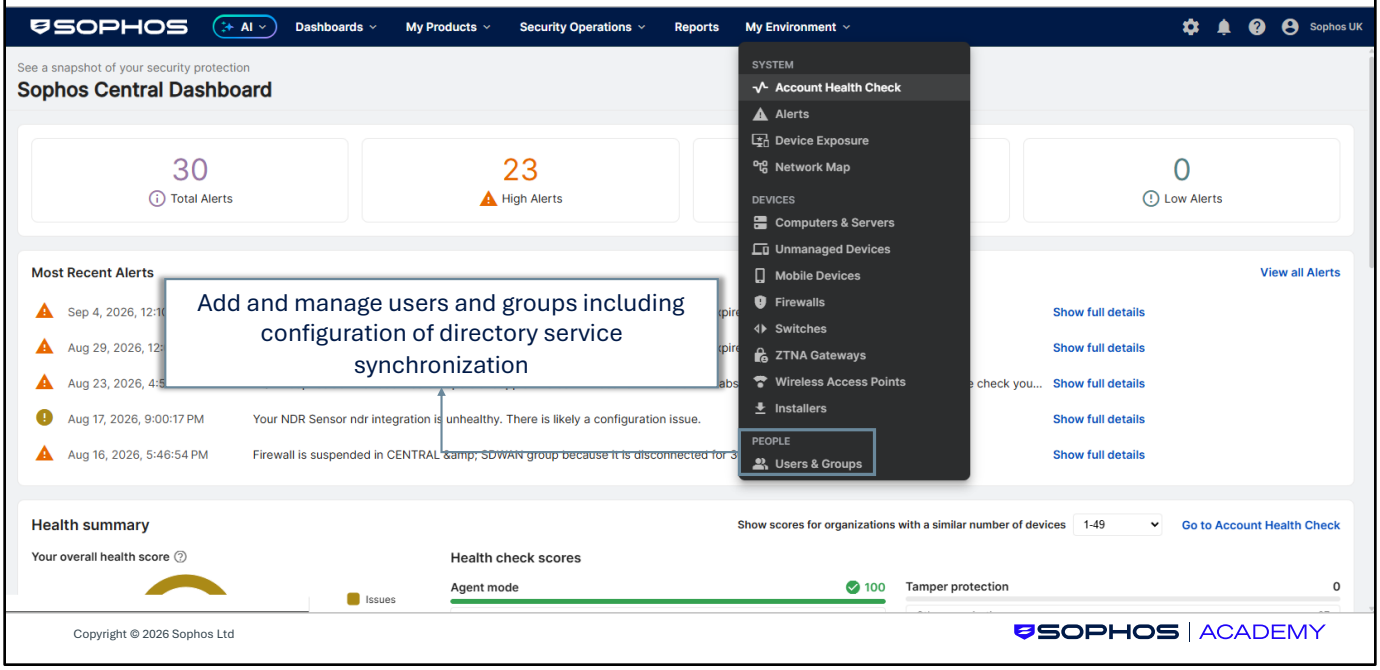
The **Alerts** page is accessible from the **My Environment** drop-down menu and displays a summary of all alerts, allowing you to take immediate action if required.

Sophos Central Dashboard



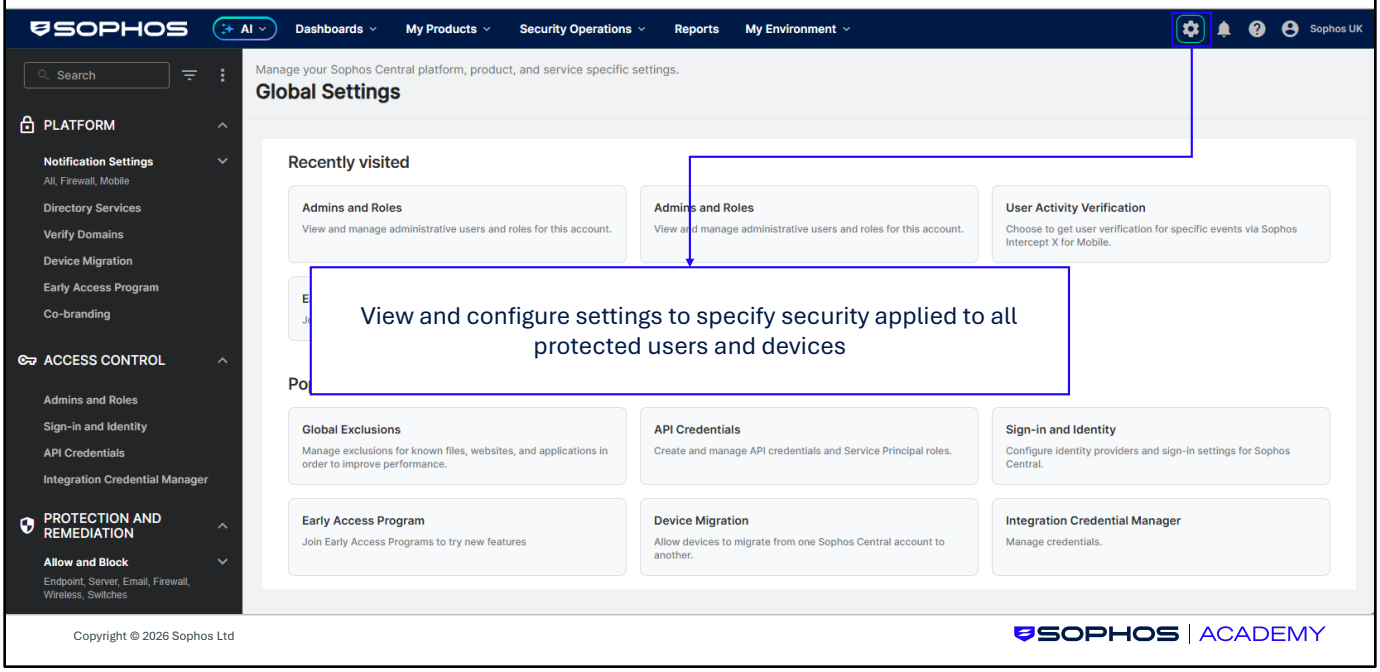
The **Devices** section is where you manage your protected devices. You can also access all available product installers here.

Sophos Central Dashboard



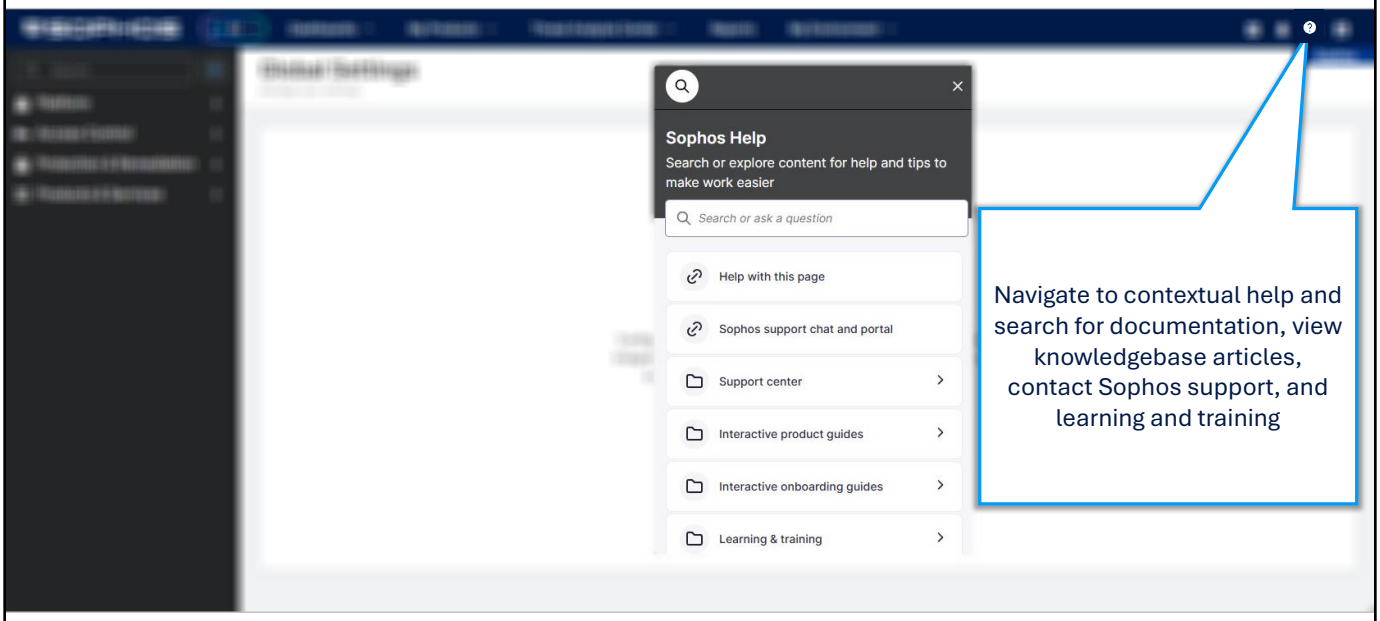
The **People** section is where you add and manage users and groups.

Sophos Central Dashboard: General Settings



Global Settings specify security settings that apply to all your users and devices. They're accessed by selecting the cog icon in the top-right corner of the top menu bar.

Sophos Central Dashboard: Help



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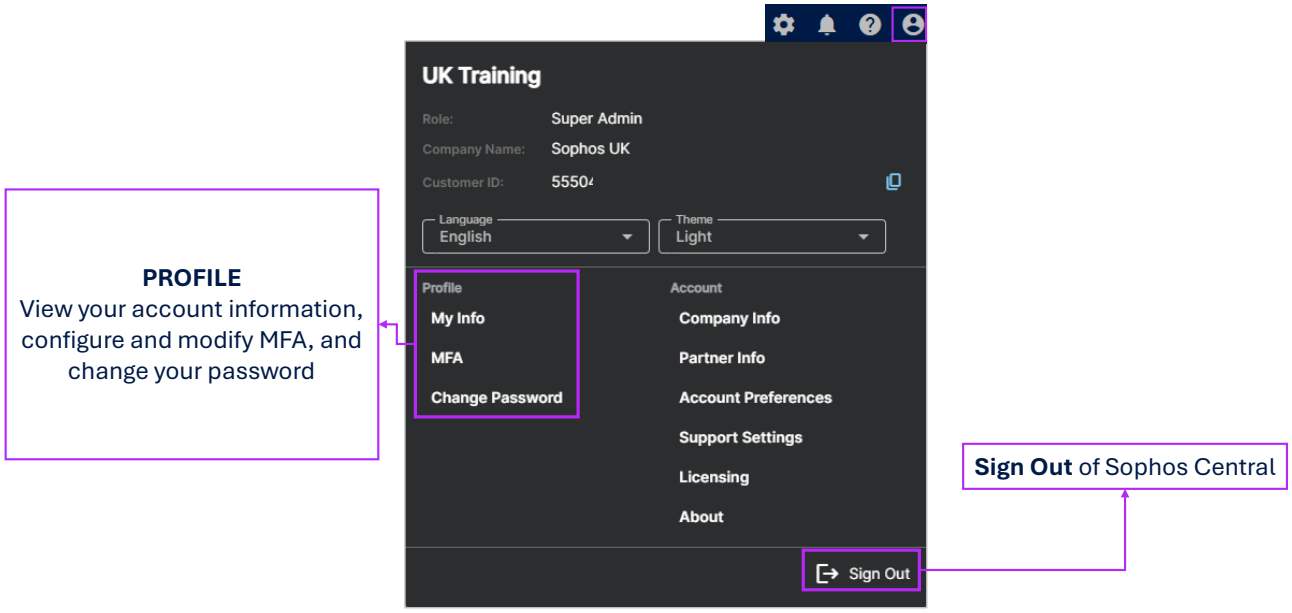
The contextual help menu provides a search field as well as links to the support center, interactive product and onboarding guides, and learning and training. From this menu, you can view product setup articles, contact Sophos support, provide feedback, and view knowledge base articles.

Sophos Central Dashboard: Profile Menu



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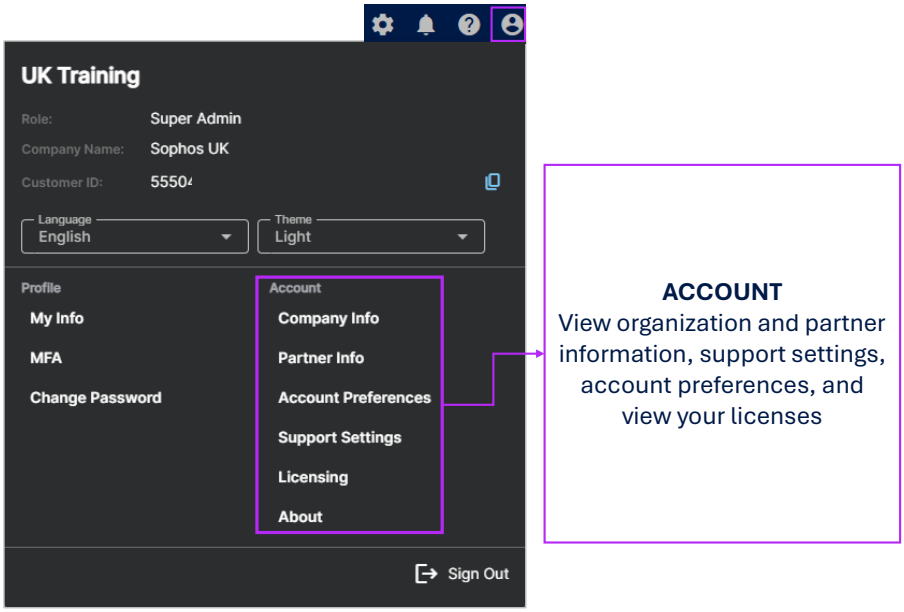
Selecting the profile menu in the top-right corner of the top menu bar will provide links to your account and profile information. From the profile menu, you can view your information, configure and modify MFA, and change your password.

Here is where you can **sign out** of your account.

Sophos Central Dashboard: Profile Menu



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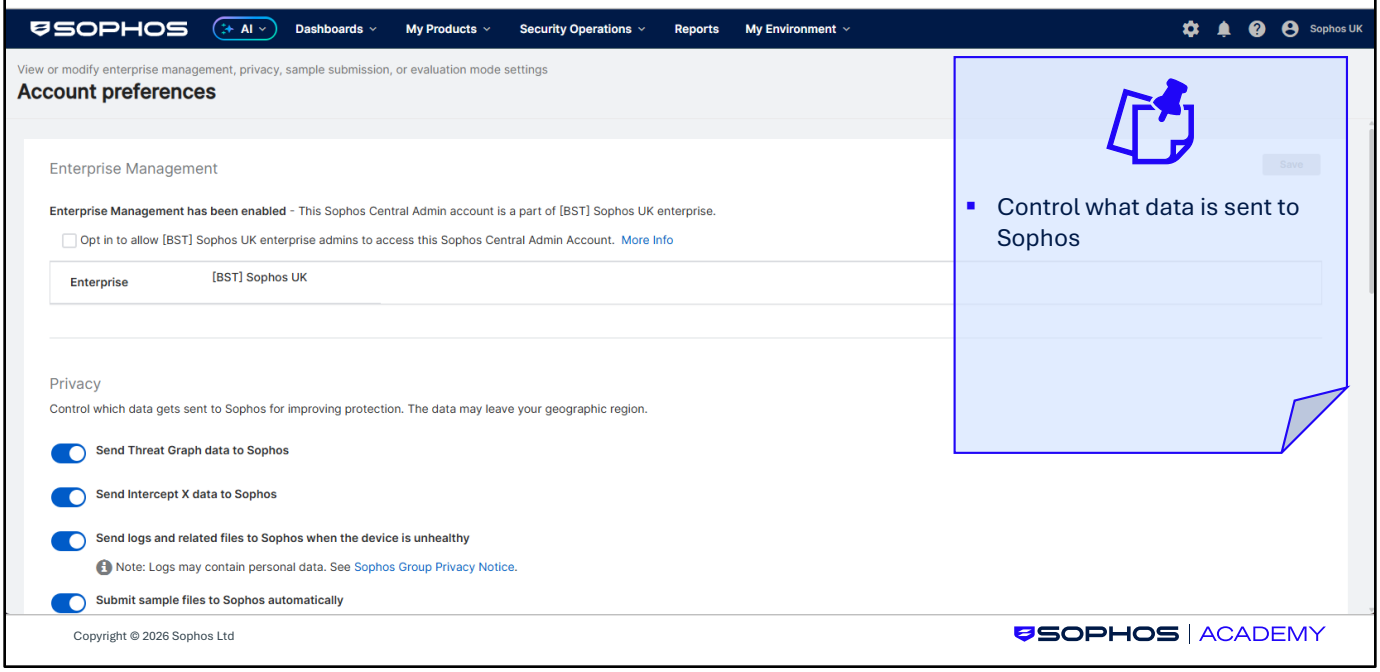
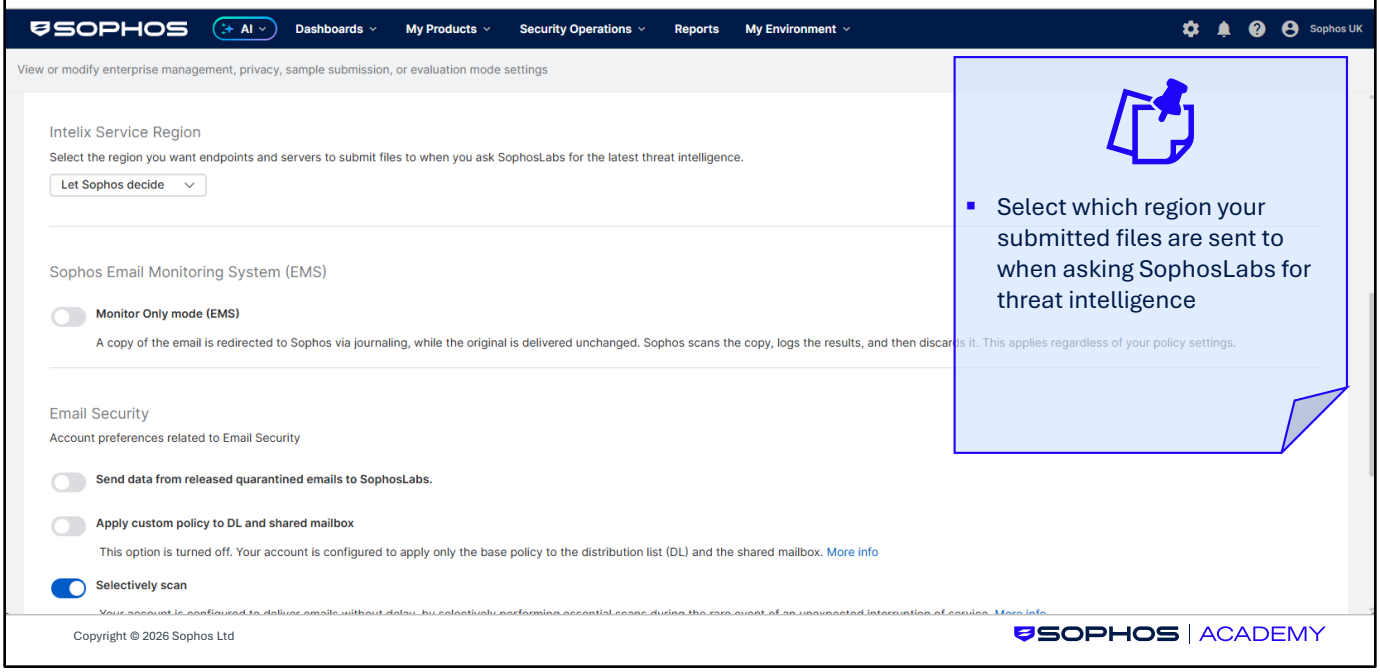
The ‘Account’ menu provides links to your company and partner information. Here you can configure your account preferences and support settings. You can view and apply licenses.

Sophos Central Dashboard: Account Preferences



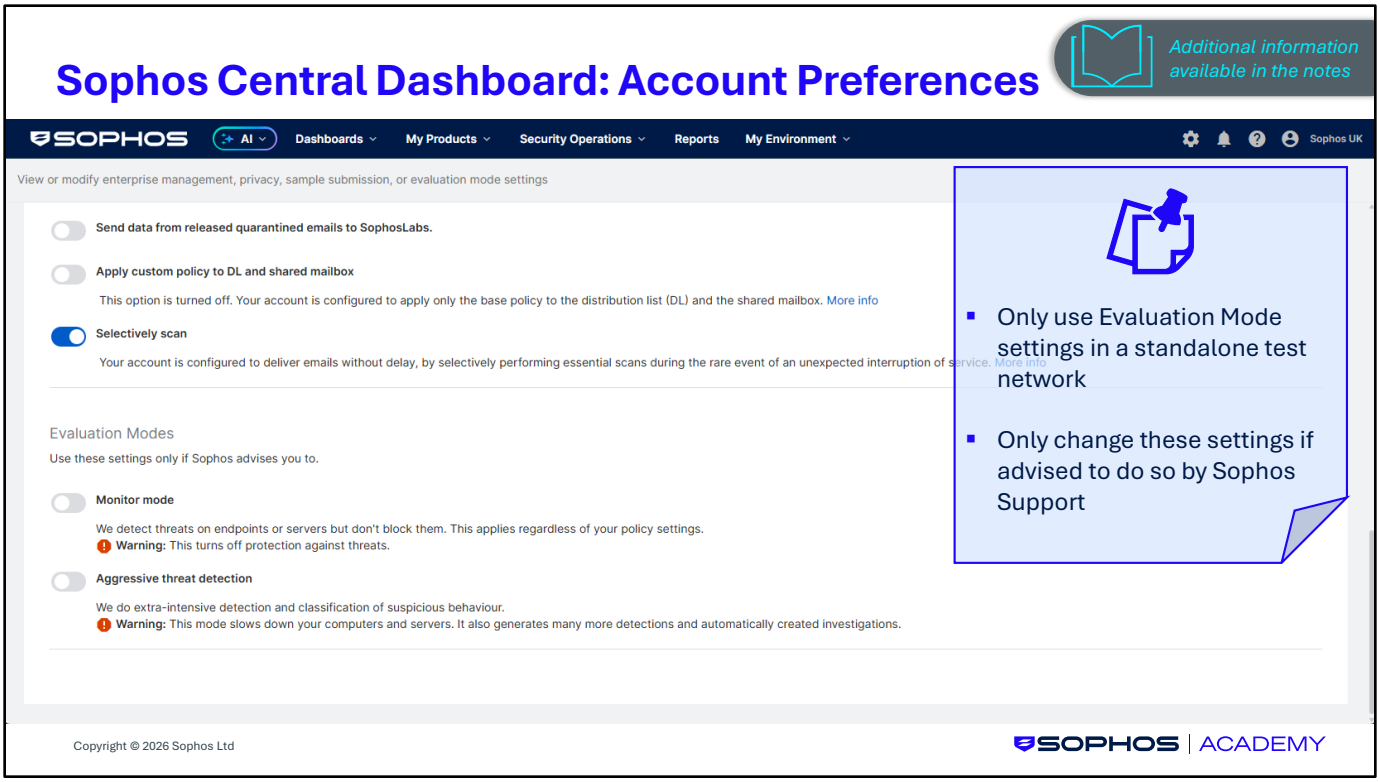
In **Account preferences,** you can control what data is sent to Sophos for the purpose of improving your protection.

Sophos Central Dashboard: Account Preferences



- Select which region your submitted files are sent to when asking SophosLabs for threat intelligence

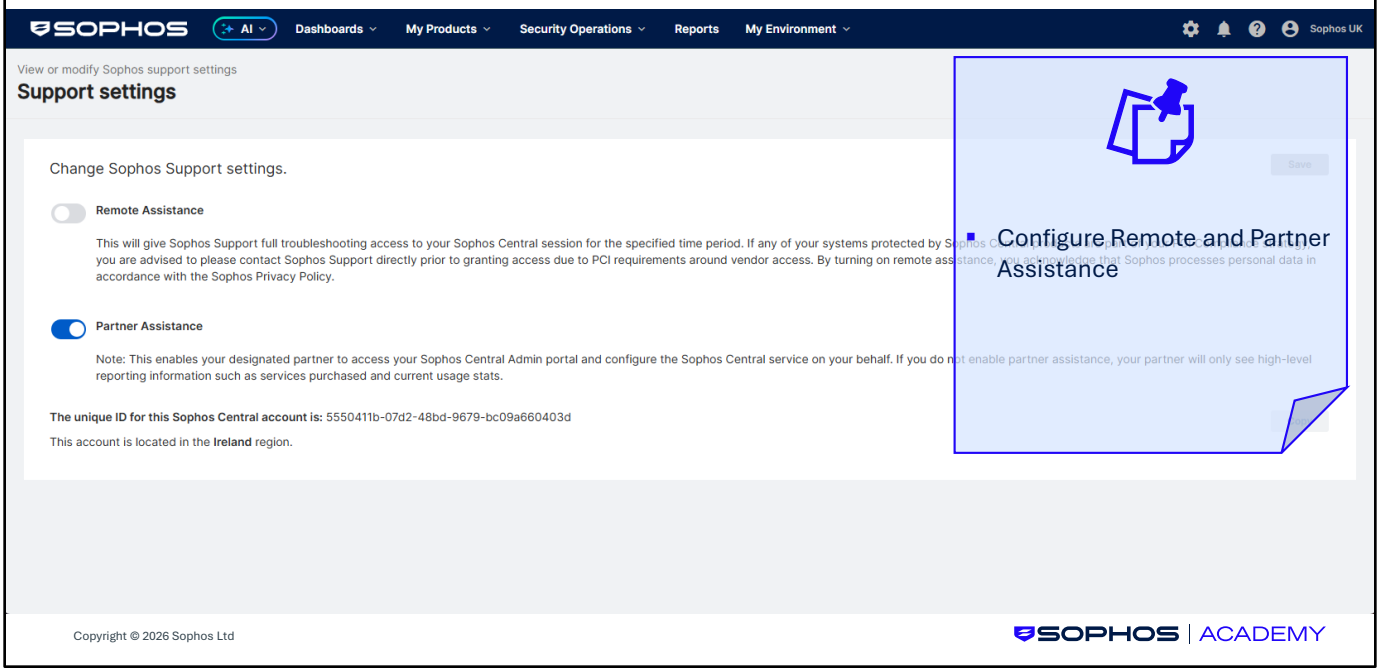
You can select the Intelix service region, this is set to ‘let Sophos decide’ by default. This region is where you want protected devices to submit files when you ask SophosLabs for the latest threat intelligence.



You can also enable and disable evaluation modes, monitor and aggressive threat detection. We do not recommend changing these settings unless Sophos has advised you to.

[Additional Information]
More information can be found in the help documentation here:
Account details - Sophos Central Admin
https://docs.sophos.com/central/Customer/help/en-us/ManageYourAccount/AccountDetails/index.html#privacy

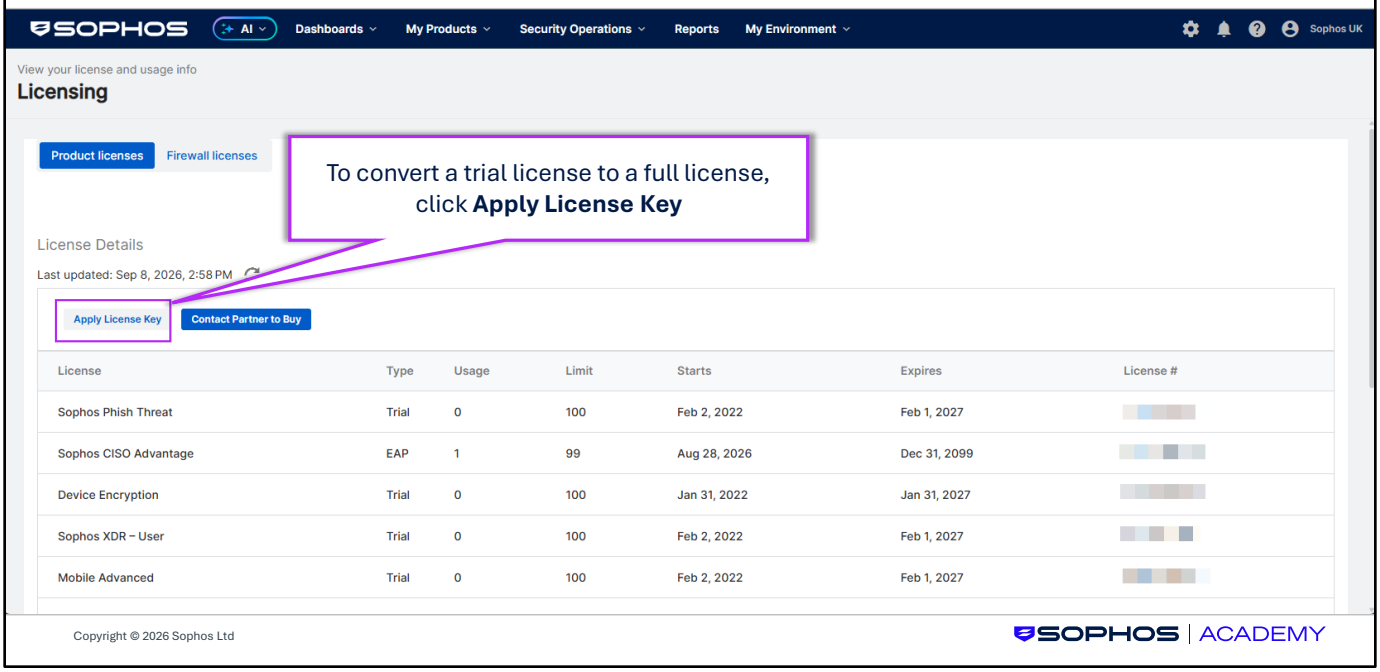
Sophos Central Dashboard: Support Settings



In **Support settings** you can enable remote assistance from Sophos support. This will give Sophos support full troubleshooting access to your Sophos Central admin for one hundred and twenty hours.

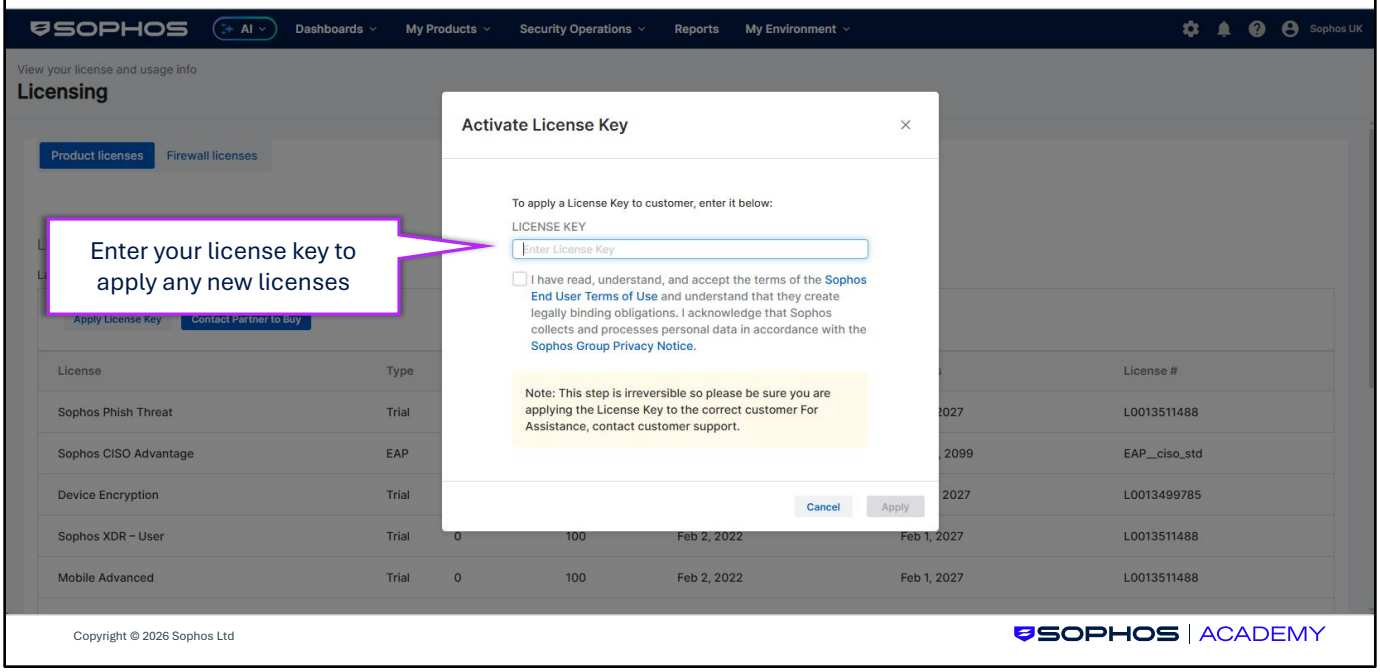
This is also where partner assistance is enabled or disabled. When this is enabled, your partner can access your Sophos Central admin console.

Sophos Central Dashboard: Licensing



In **Licensing** you can view your licenses, the list includes the license type, usage count and limit, along with the start and end date of each license. To convert a trial license to a full license, click **Apply License Key**.

Sophos Central Dashboard: Licensing



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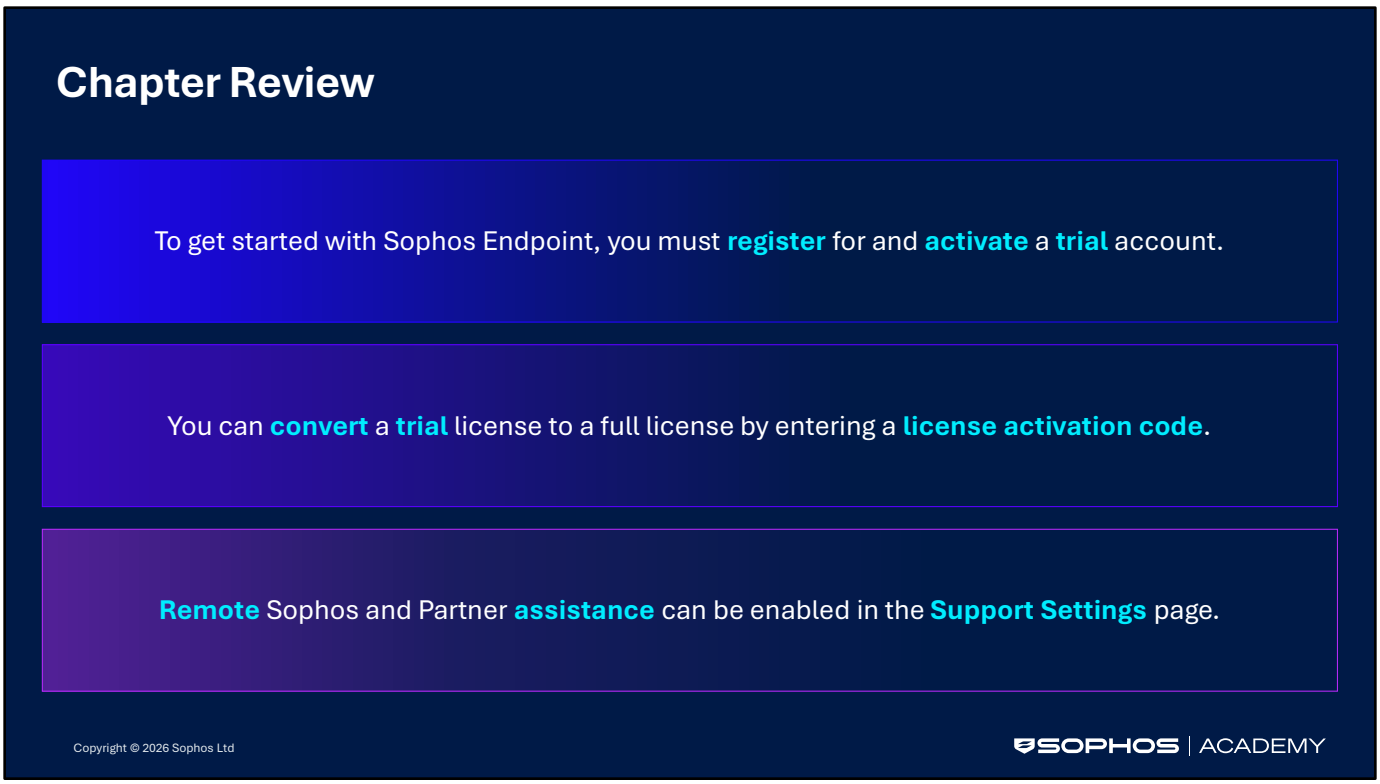
Enter the license key details. Once you have completed this, the license status will be updated to show the full license details.



Here are the three main things you learned in this chapter.

To get started with Sophos Endpoint, you must register for and activate a trial account.

You can convert a trial license to a full license by entering a license activation code.

Remote Sophos and Partner assistance can be enabled in the Support Settings page.

[Additional Information]

Sophos Endpoint
EP0525: Getting Started with Sophos Endpoint Global Settings

September 2026

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Getting Started with Sophos Endpoint Global Settings

In this chapter, you'll learn about the frequently used global settings available for Sophos Endpoint.

RECOMMENDED KNOWLEDGE AND EXPERIENCE

- ✓ How to access and navigate Sophos Central
- ✓ The protection features included with Sophos Endpoint

DURATION: 5 minutes

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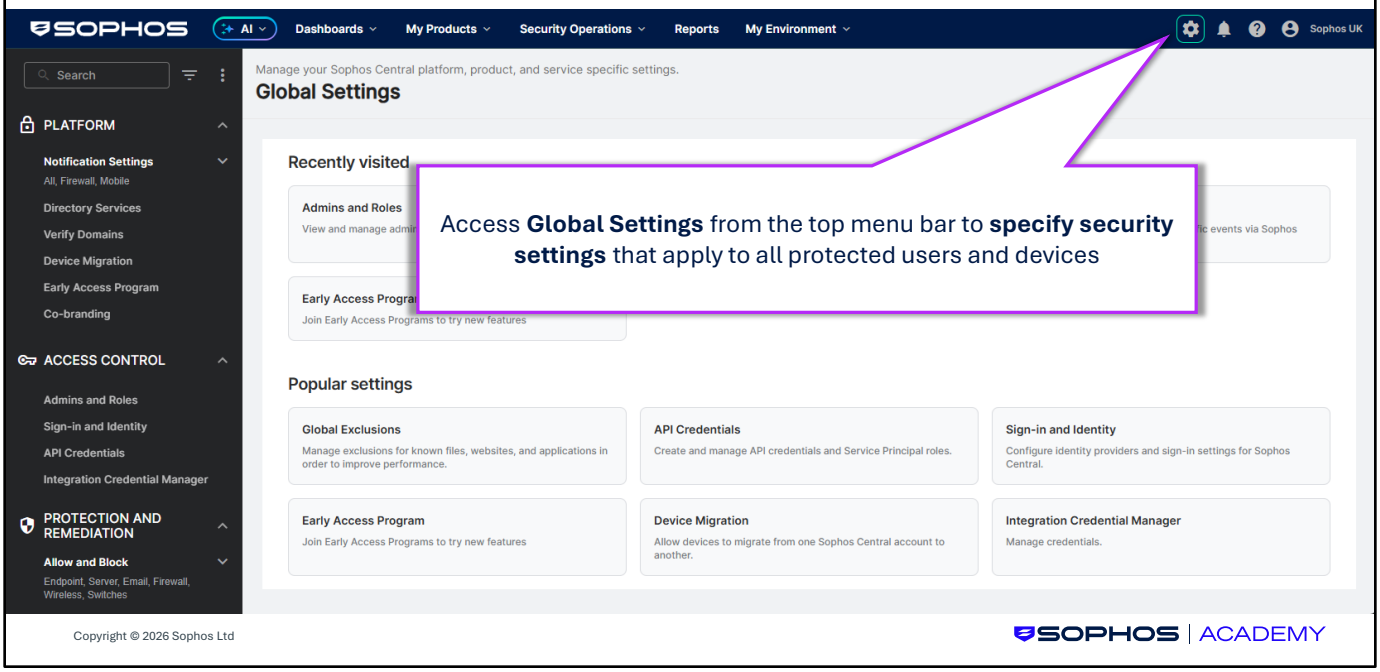
In this chapter, you'll learn about the frequently used global settings available for Sophos Endpoint.

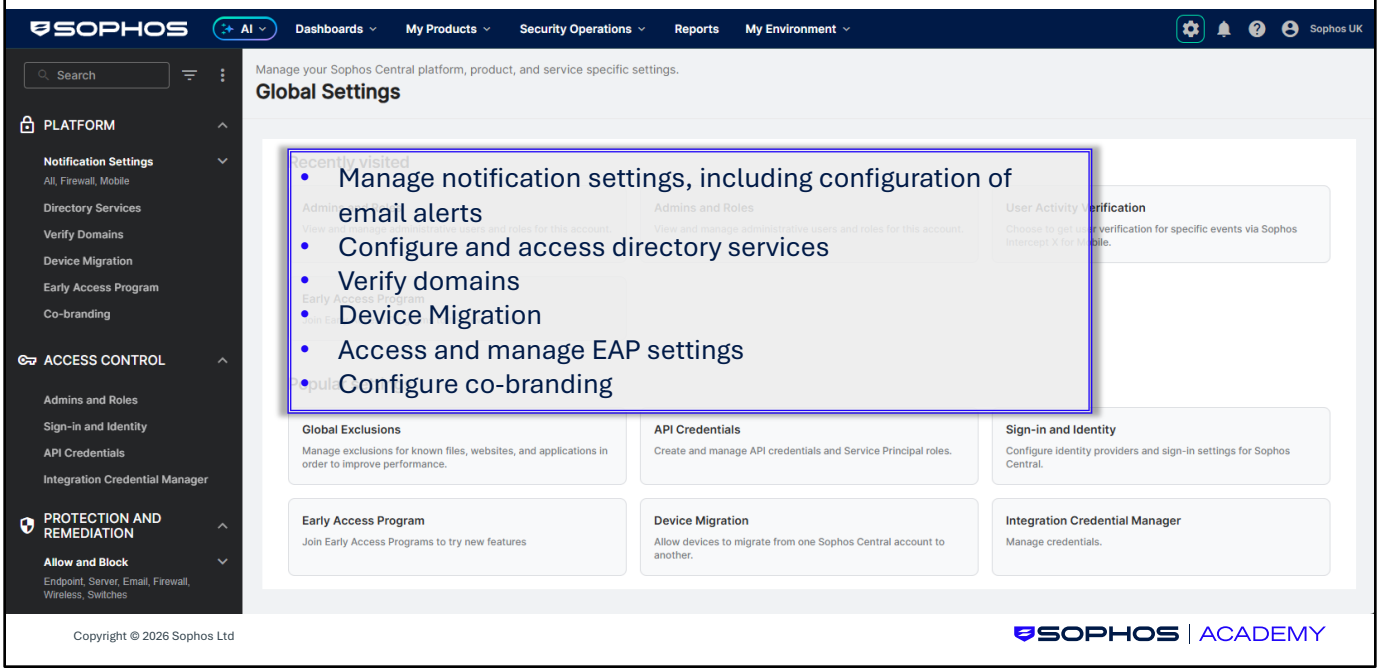
Global Settings Overview



Global settings are accessed from the top menu bar by clicking the cog icon. They specify security settings that apply to all protected users and devices.

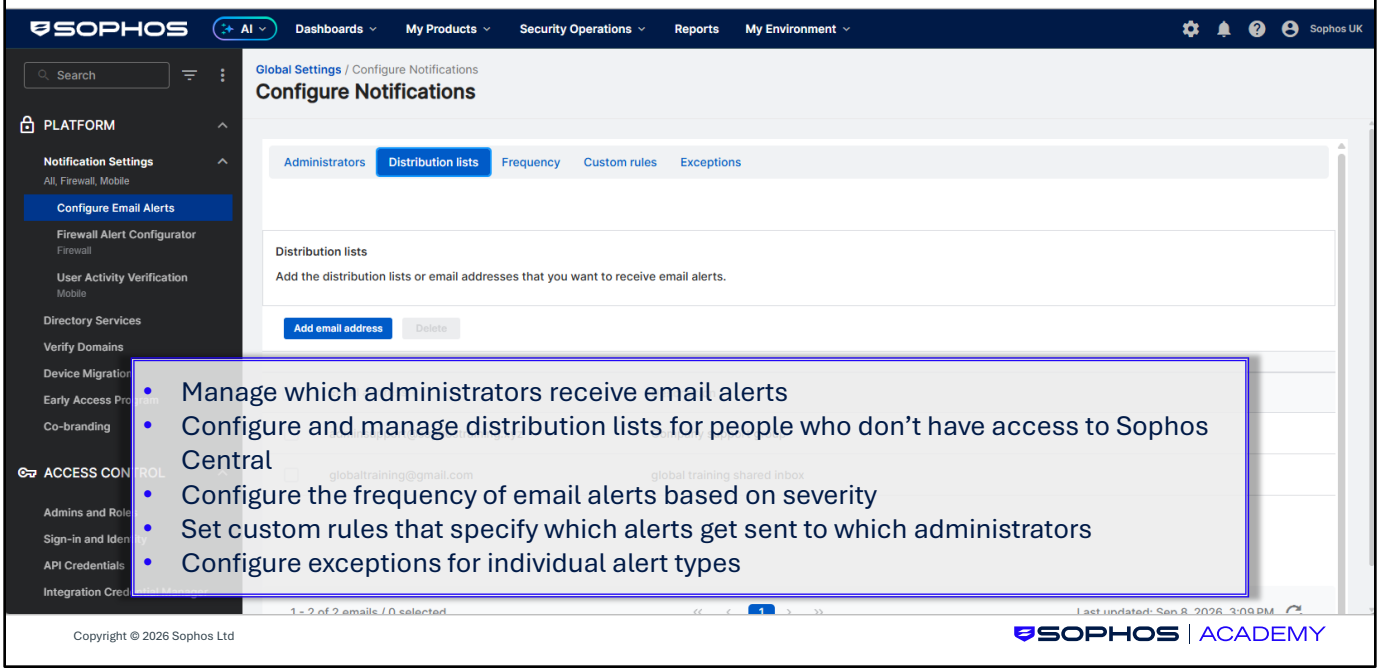
Let's have a look at some of the settings.

Platform Settings



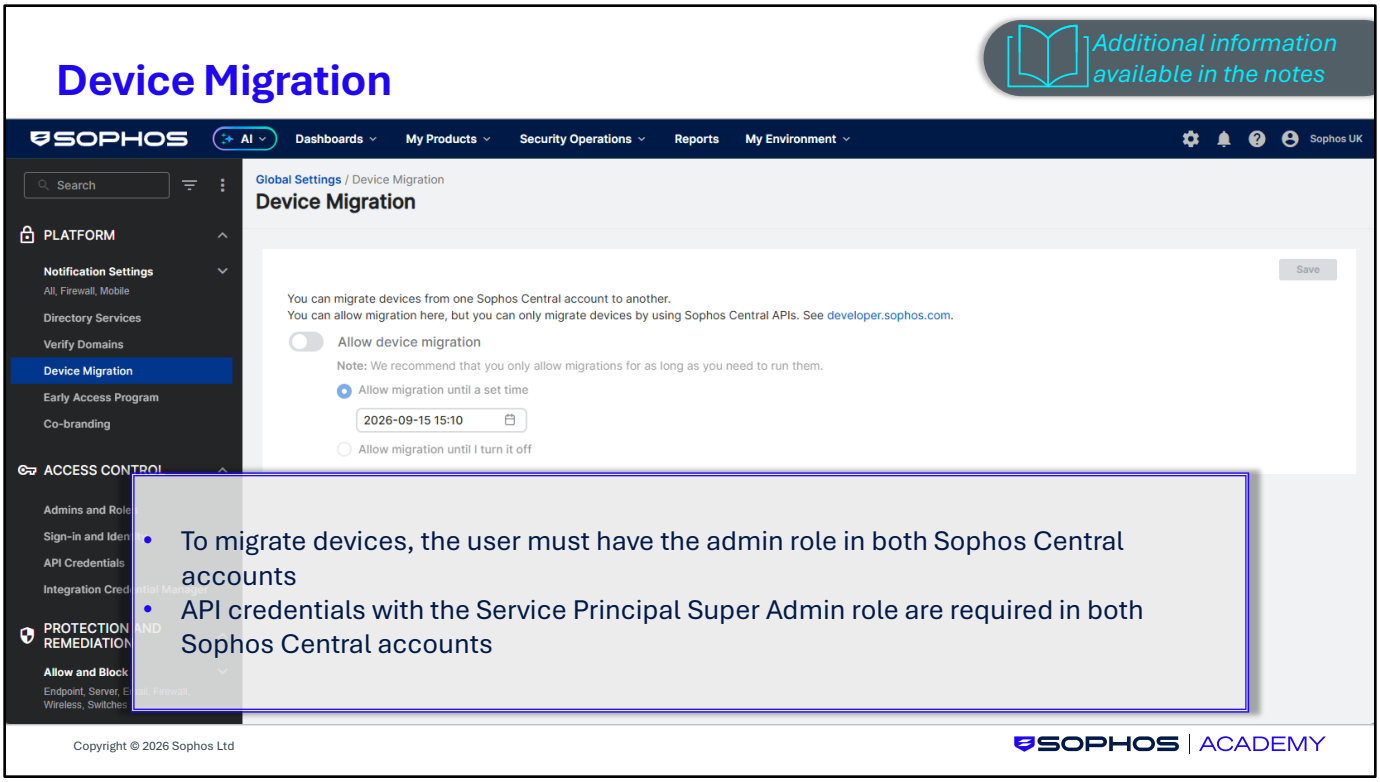
The global settings menu is split into sections. The platform section provides the global settings for the Sophos Central platform. These are notification settings, email alert configuration, directory service configuration and management, domain verification, EAP access and management, and co-branding configuration, which allows you to add your company logo to the self-service portal.

Email Alerts



A user with the Super Admin role can manage how administrators receive email alerts. Click yes or no to turn alerts on or off for specific administrators. You can manage distribution lists or email addresses that you want to receive email alerts for. This option allows you to send notifications and alerts to people who don't have access to Sophos Central.

You can control the frequency with which administrators receive email alerts depending on the severity of the alert, the product, or the category the alert is in. Custom rules allow you to set which administrators get which alerts. Note that using a custom rule will stop any existing recipient settings, including distribution lists. The exceptions list shows the exceptions configured. These are set up on an ad-hoc basis in the alerts page.

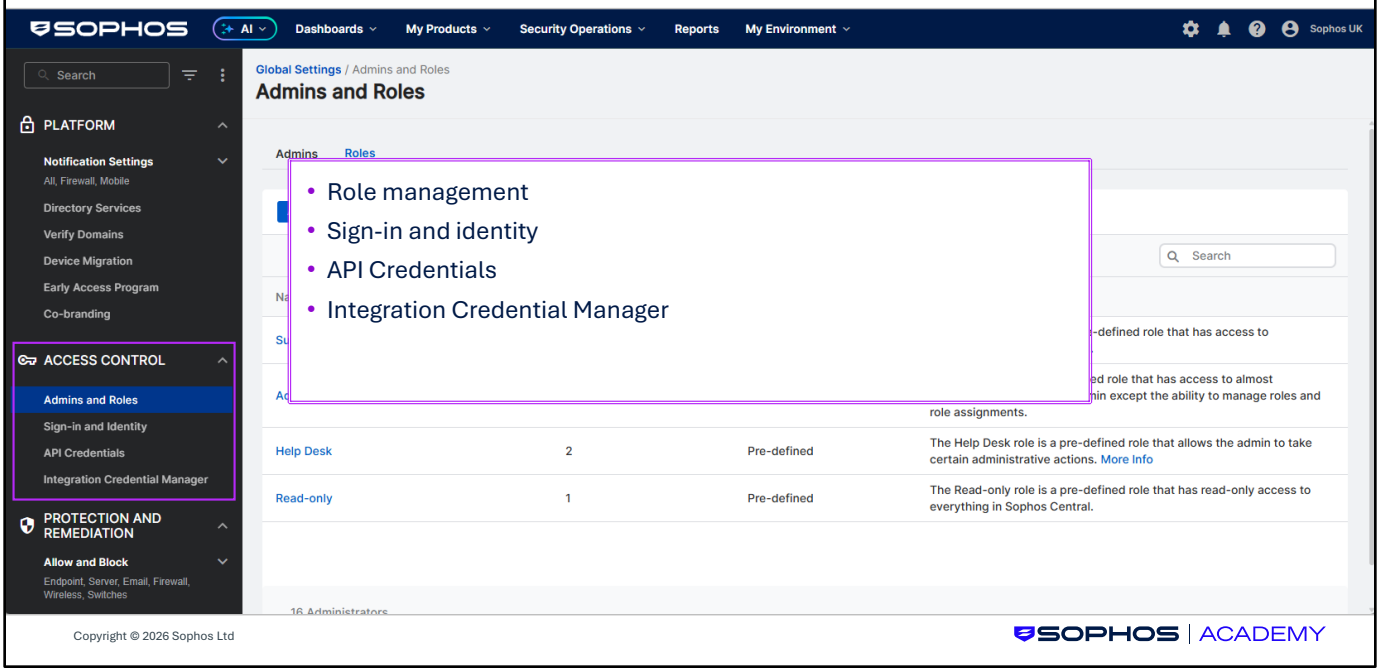


You can migrate devices from one Sophos Central account to another. To migrate devices, the user must be assigned the admin role in both Sophos Central accounts. You'll also need API credentials for both accounts that have the **Service Principal Super Admin** role.

We recommend that you limit migrations to a limited time. To migrate devices, use our Endpoint API and follow the instructions in the help guide. A link to this guide is available in the resources document.

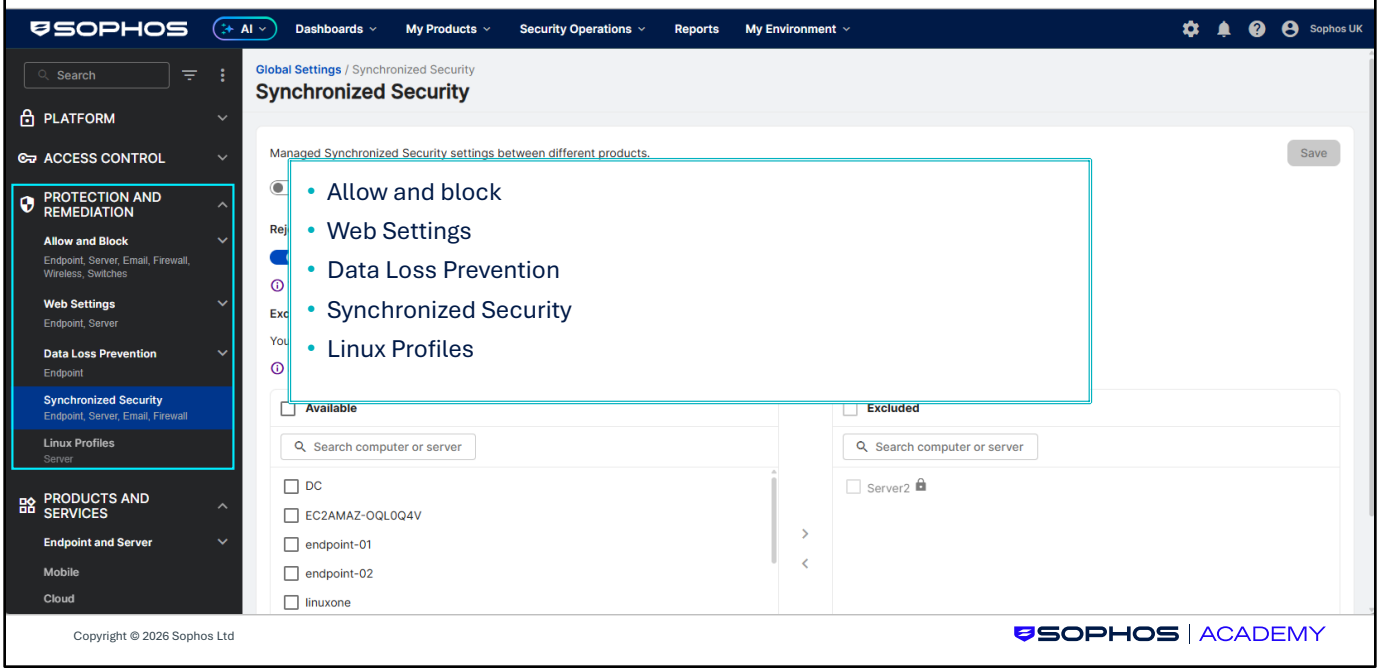
[Additional Information]
Device migration - Sophos Central Admin
https://docs.sophos.com/central/Customer/help/en-us/ManageYourProducts/GlobalSettings/DeviceMigration/index.html#use-endpoint-api

Access Control



The Access Control section contains the settings for Sophos Central access. Here, role-based access is managed for users and administrators. The configuration of federated and Sophos sign-in settings. Configure API Credentials and the Integration Credential Manager to create credentials for integrating other products with Sophos Central.

Protection and Remediation



The protection and remediation section contains the allow and block settings for your licensed products. The configuration of global exclusions for endpoint protection, allowed applications, blocked items, active threat response, admin-isolated devices list, and blocked IP addresses.

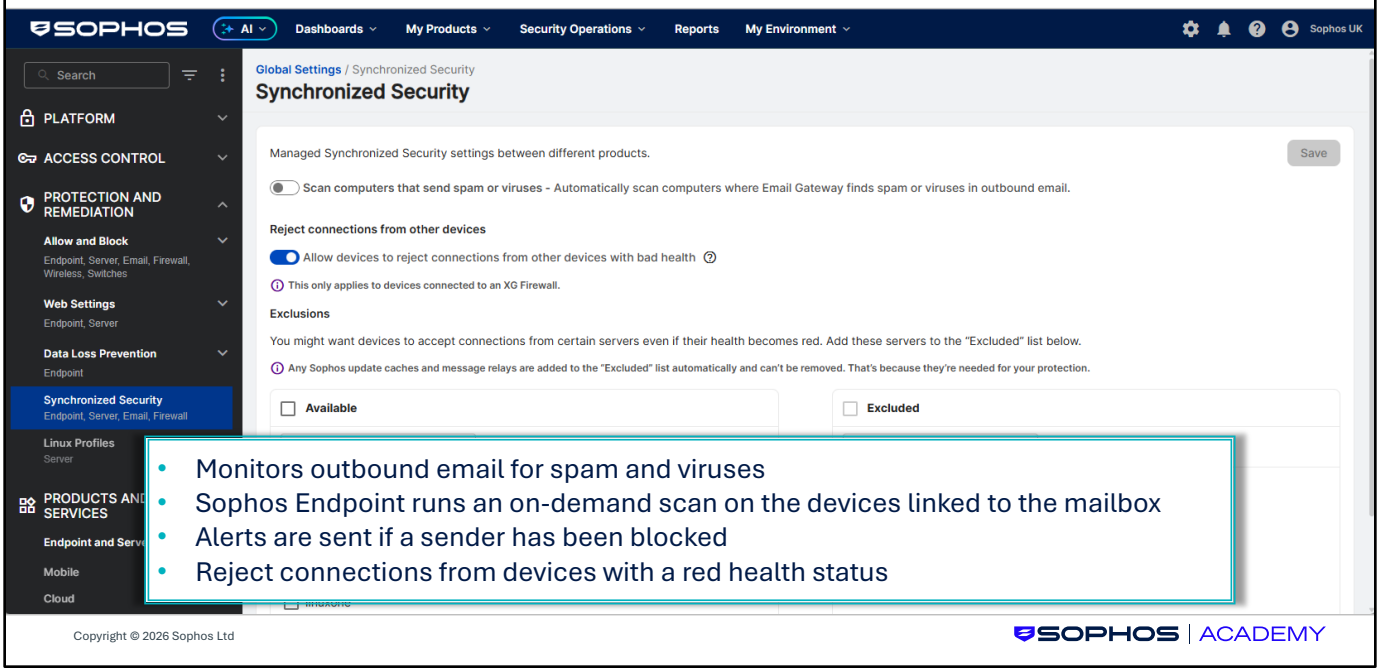
Web Settings for the customization control of specific websites, and SSL/TLS decryption of HTTPS websites.

Data Loss Prevention, configure rules and content control lists.

Synchronized Security settings, turn on the setting to reject connections from devices with a red health status.

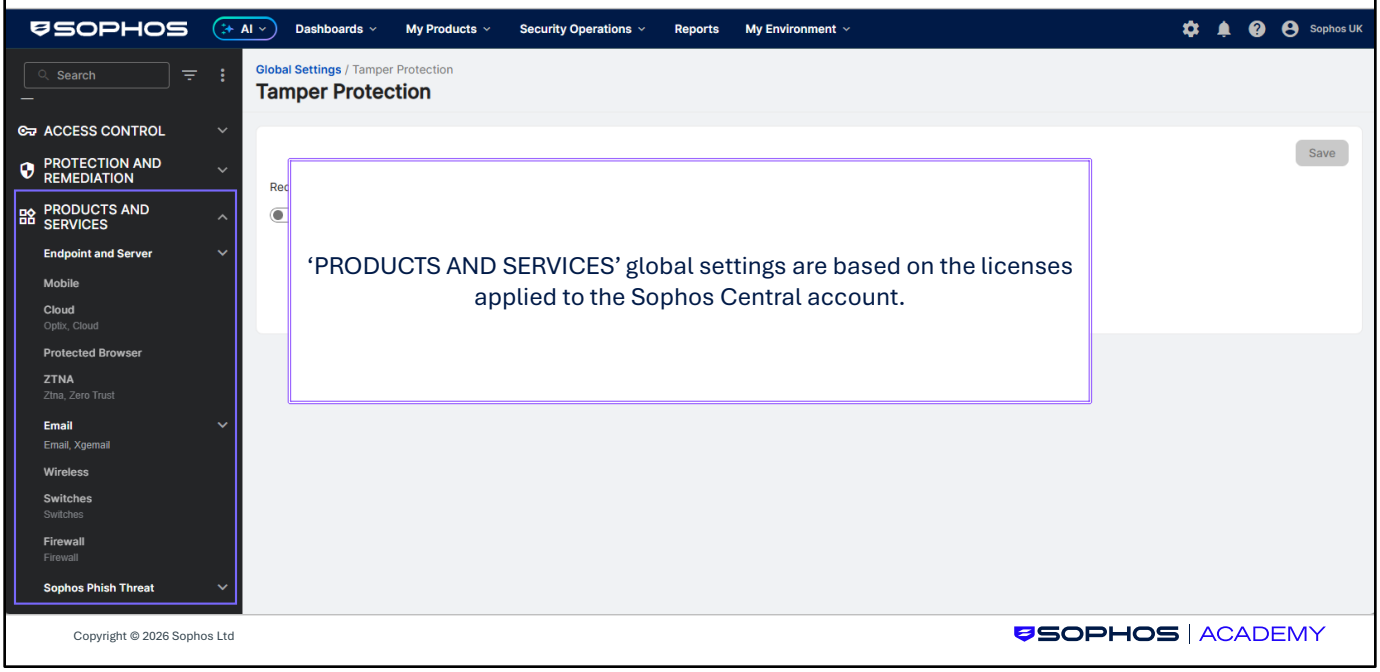
Create and configure your runtime detection profile for Linux workloads in the Linux Profiles section.

Synchronized Security



When Synchronized Security is enabled, it monitors all outbound mail and acts if five or more emails are classified as spam or contain a virus within a 10-minute period. If this happens, it will identify the originating mailbox from which the virus or spam was sent, along with the owner and any devices assigned to that owner. Additionally, that mailbox will be blocked from sending outbound mail for 1 hour, and an alert will be automatically sent to the administrator. Sophos Endpoint automatically runs an on-demand scan on devices linked to the identified mailbox.

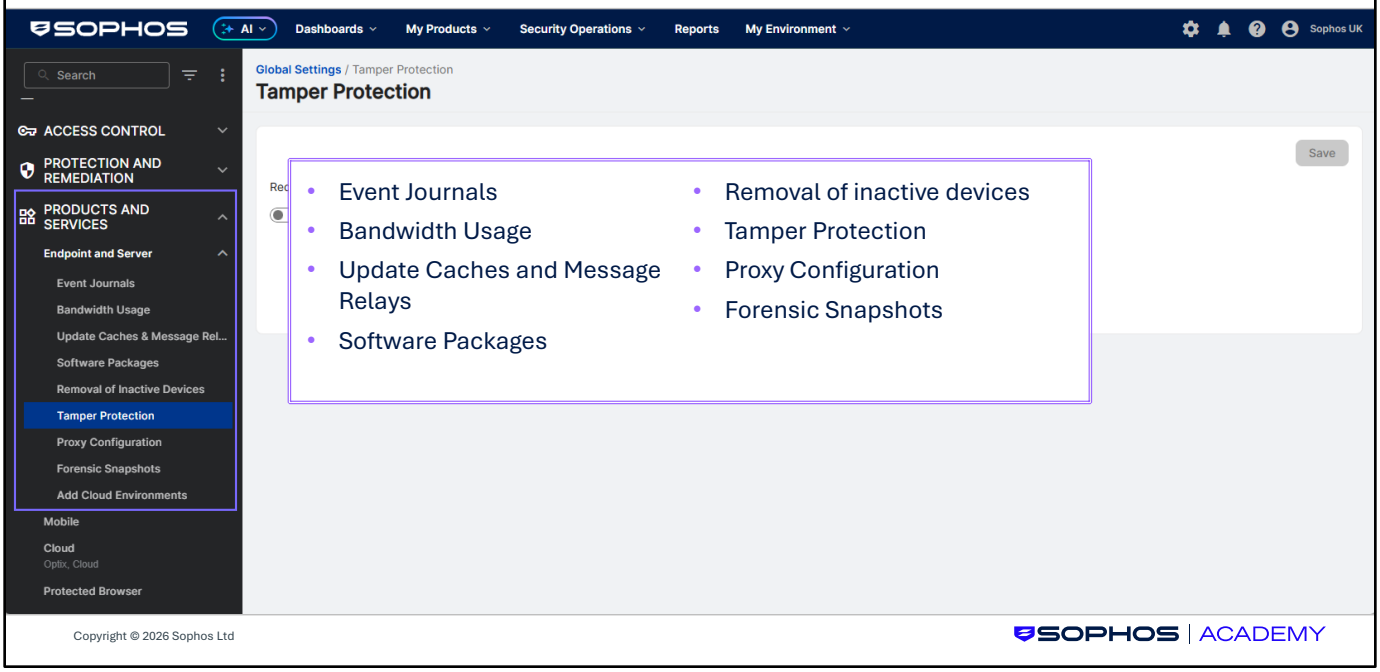
Products and Services



Product and services global settings are contained in the Products and Services section.

This list is based on the licenses applied to the Sophos Central account.

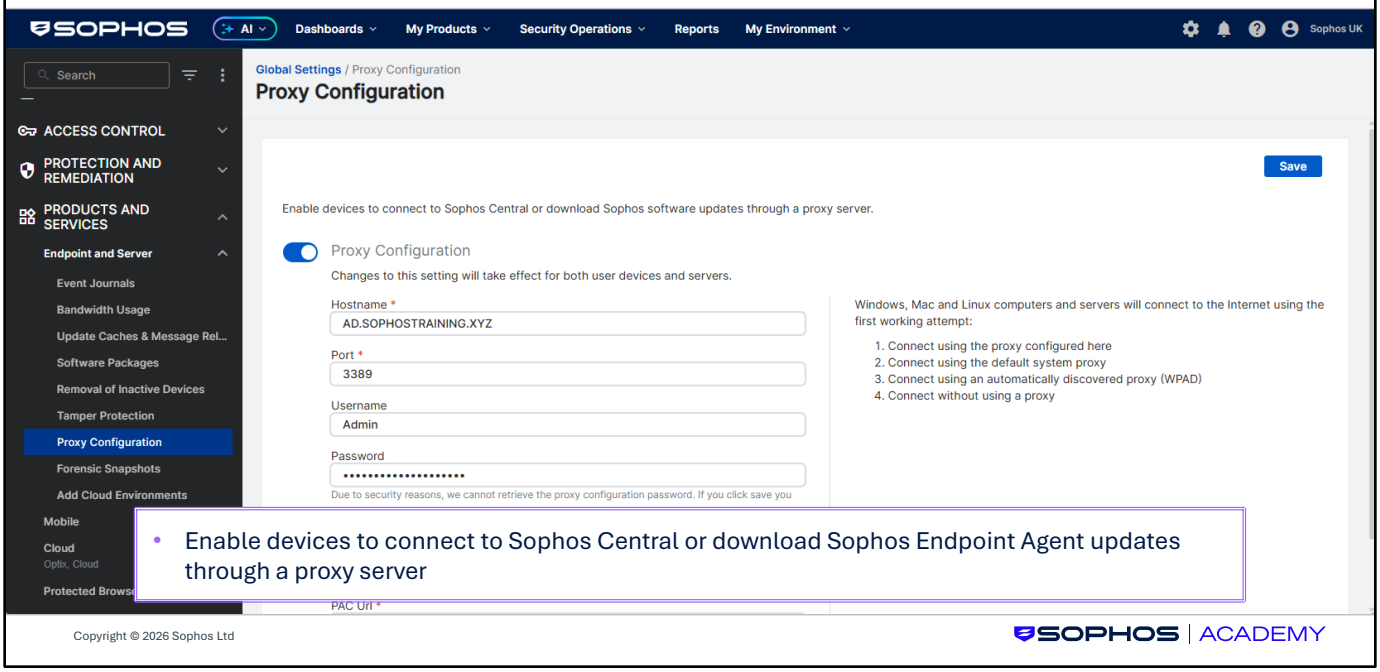
Products and Services: Endpoint and Server



For endpoints, the global settings contain event journals that record endpoint activity, which can be queried in Security Operations.

Here, you configure an Update Cache and Message Relay, define software packages, remove inactive devices from your account, and configure tamper protection settings for all protected devices.

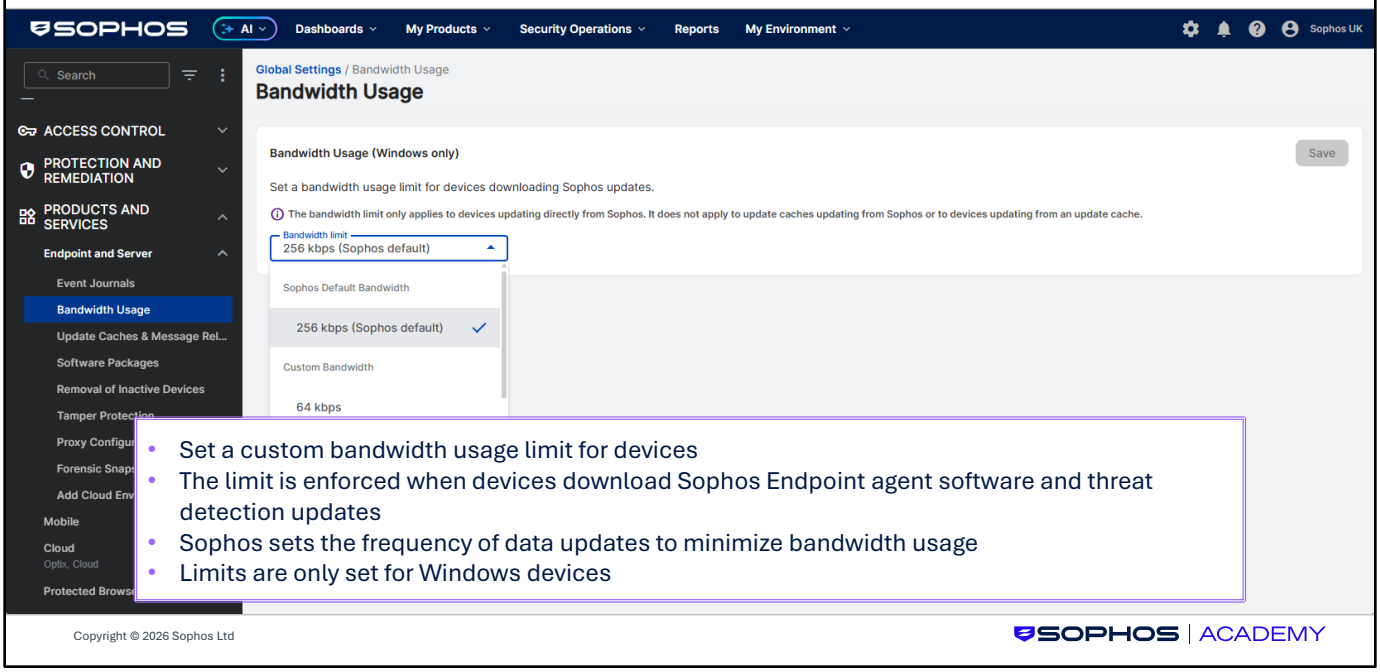
Proxy Configuration



The proxy configuration setting allows you to define an explicit proxy to access the internet. If the proxy requires authentication, you must provide credentials. Note that you can only define a single proxy server.

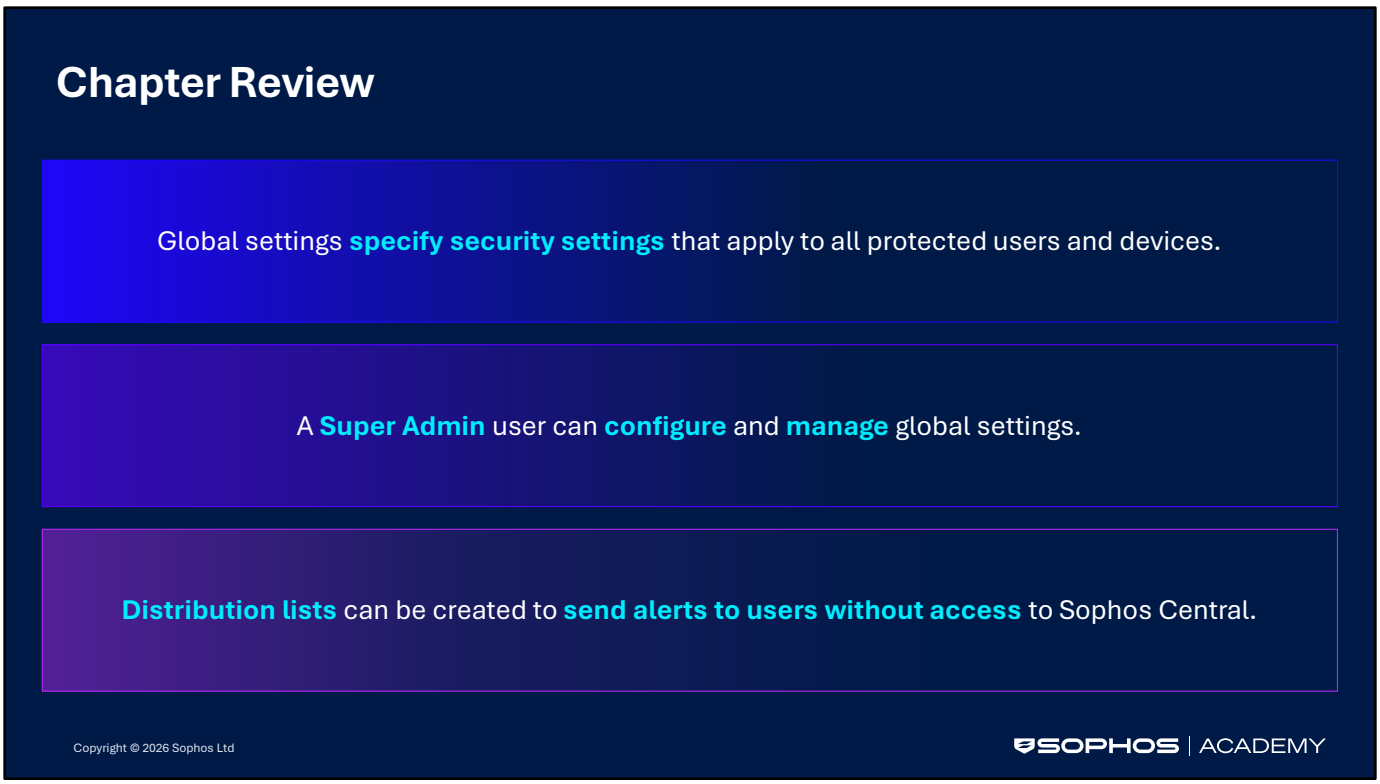
Any changes made here will affect both computers and servers.

Bandwidth Usage



You can configure the bandwidth for updating the Sophos Endpoint agent software only on Windows devices. Currently, the default bandwidth limit is 256 Kb/s. You can specify a custom bandwidth limit or unlimited bandwidth. This limit will be enforced as computers download the Sophos Endpoint agent and threat detection updates.

By default, Sophos sets the frequency of data updates to Sophos Central to once a week. This helps reduce network bandwidth while ensuring devices are kept up to date with changes in the threat landscape.



Here are the three main things you learned in this chapter.

Global settings specify security settings that apply to all protected users and devices.

A Super Admin user can configure and manage global settings.

Distribution lists can be created to send alerts to users without access to Sophos Central.

[Additional Information]

Sophos Endpoint
EP0530: Sophos Endpoint Protection Features and Requirements

September 2026

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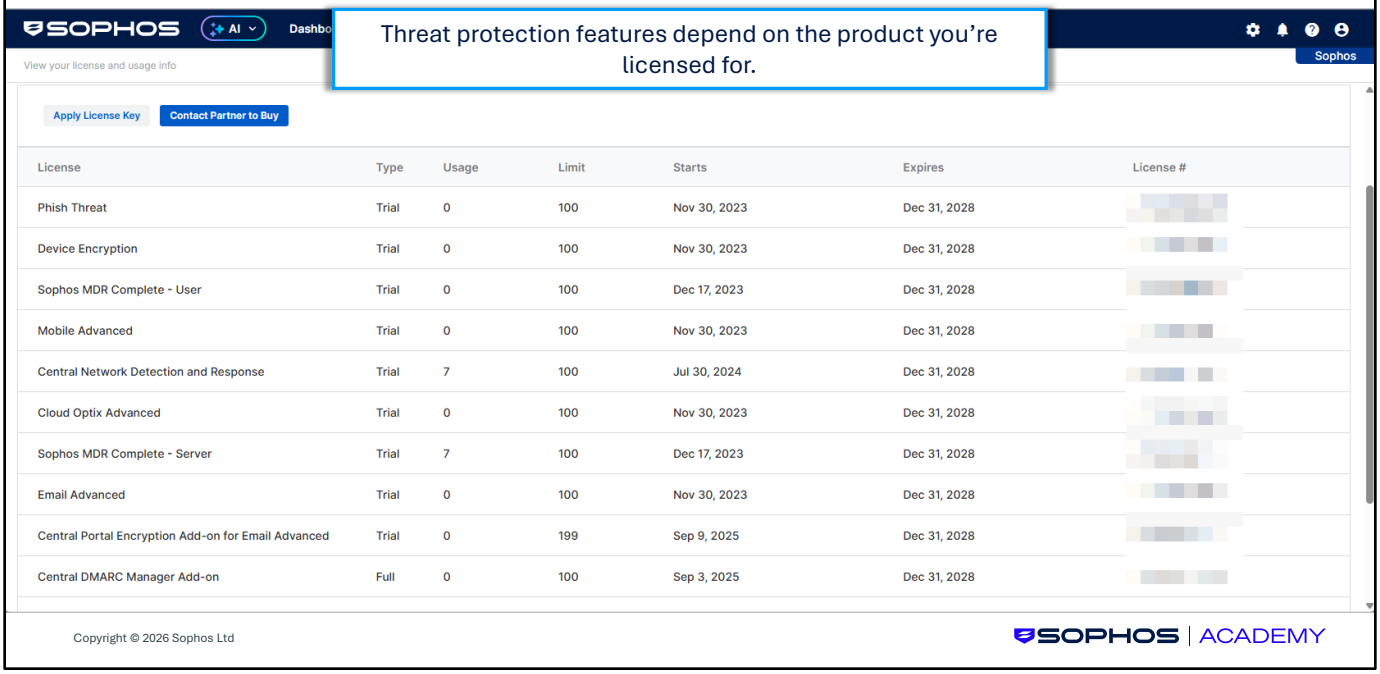
In this chapter, you will learn about the Sophos Endpoint features available per license and the specific system requirements for devices.

Sophos Endpoint



The threat protection features you benefit from will depend on the product you're licensed for. The license page in Sophos Central lists your licenses.

Let's look at the licensing options and view the features included.

Endpoint Protection and Control

Additional information available in the notes

Features	Sophos Endpoint	Sophos EDR	Sophos XDR
Threat Exposure Reduction Web Security, Download Reputation, Web, Peripheral, and Application Control, and DLP	✓	✓	✓
Threat Prevention CryptoGuard, MBR protection, Adaptive Attack Protection, Critical attack warnings, Deep Learning (AI), Antimalware file scanning, PUA blocking, Live Protection, Behavioural analysis, Anti-exploitation, Application lockdown, AMSI protection, MTD, IPS, File Integrity Monitoring (Servers), ZTNA agent	✓	✓	✓

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We will start by reviewing the protection and control features included with each Sophos Endpoint product.

All Sophos Endpoint licenses provide threat surface reduction features, including web security, peripheral, and application control. To prevent threats, all licenses include behavioural analysis, deep learning malware detection, exploit prevention, and malicious traffic detection.

It's worth noting that features apply to specific platforms; all features listed here are available for Windows devices, while some are also available for Macs and others for Linux. For more information about the features, refer to the technical specifications link in the resources document and the student handout.

[Additional Information]
For more information about the features included with each license, see: Sophos Endpoint - AI-powered Endpoint Security
https://www.sophos.com/en-us/products/endpoint-antivirus/tech-specs.aspx

Additional information available in the notes

Endpoint Detection, Investigation and Response

Features	Sophos Endpoint	Sophos EDR	Sophos XDR
Detection Real-time insights, suspicious events detection, MITRE framework mapping, Device exposure, detection prioritisation.	✓	✓	✓
Generate detections on third-party data, cross-product event correlation and analysis			✓
Investigation RCA threat graphs	✓	✓	✓
Case creation, threat intelligence, case summary, command analysis, AI Search		✓	✓
AI Assistant, forensic data export			✓
Response Automatic malware cleanup, ransomware file rollback, process termination, synchronized security	✓	✓	✓
Adaptive attack protection, on-demand device isolation, Live Response		✓	✓
Microsoft 365 response actions			✓

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Detection and investigation features vary depending on the license applied. All threats are detected and reported, and a threat graph is created for all licenses. Features such as AI Search and adaptive attack protection are available in Sophos EDR and Sophos XDR licenses.

[Additional Information]

For more information about Sophos XDR, see: sophos-extended-detection-and-response-br.pdf
https://assets.sophos.com/X24WTUEQ/at/hmqsbvkr2mfw65spx438ccb7/sophos-extended-detection-and-response-br.pdf

Endpoint Detection, Investigation and Response

Additional information available in the notes

Features	Sophos Endpoint	Sophos EDR	Sophos XDR
Data Ingestion Data on-device and in the cloud	✓	✓	✓
Cloud data retention		30 days	90 days
Additional cloud storage retention		1 year [add-on]	1 year [add-on]
Ingest and correlate data from third-party investments			✓

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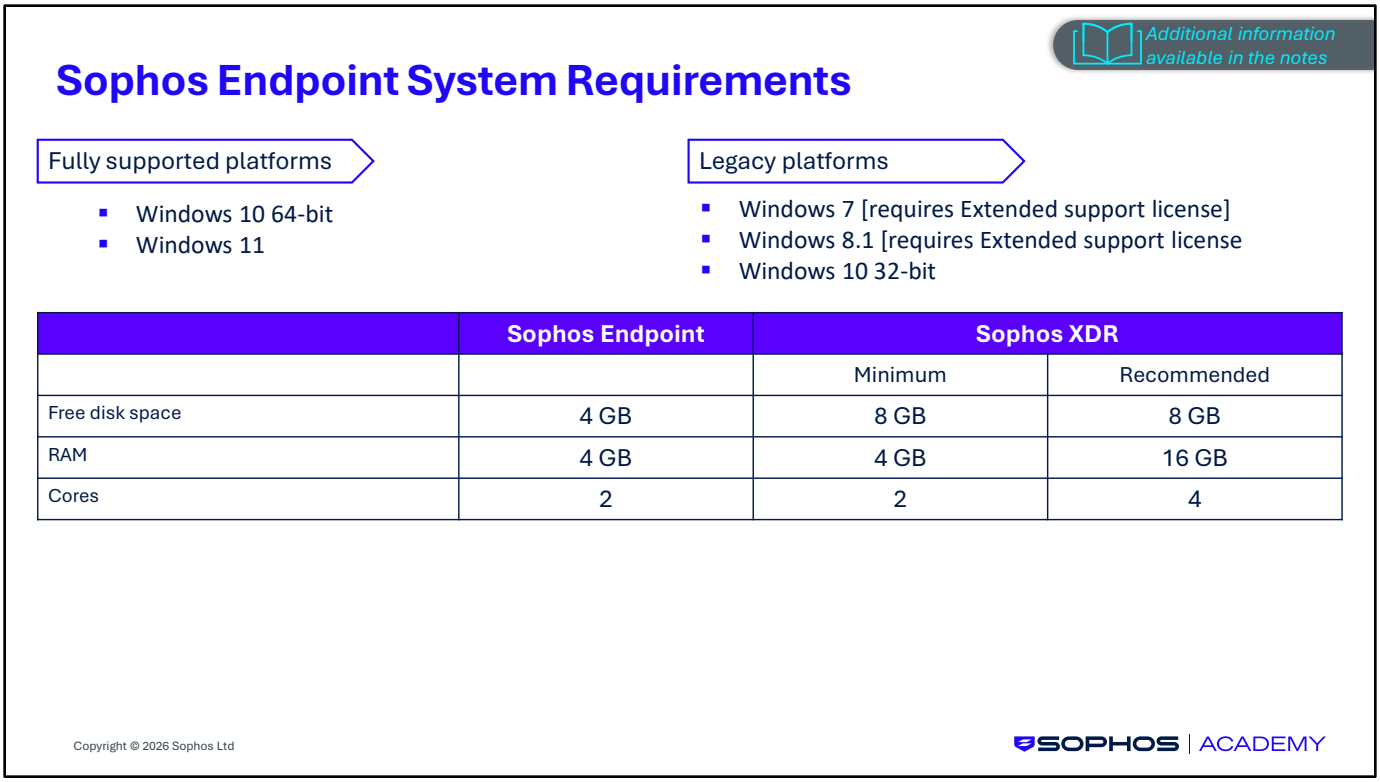
Sophos EDR and XDR licenses include cloud data retention, with optional additional retention periods available.



Before you protect your endpoints, ensure they meet the system requirements. This table details the supported platforms and the free disk space and memory required. For Windows endpoints, this changes depending on the license that is applied. You may need an extended support license for legacy platforms, some of which are end-of-life.

[Additional Information]
A list of all Windows system requirements can be found in the knowledge base article **KB-000035144**.
Sophos Endpoint: System requirements for Windows
https://support.sophos.com/support/s/article/KB-000035144

Additional information available in the notes

Sophos Endpoint System Requirements

Fully supported platforms

- macOS 13, 14, 15, 16, 26 intel-based Macs (64-bit)
- Apple Silicon M Series (ARM)

	Endpoint Protection	Sophos EDR and Sophos XDR
Free disk space	2 GB	2 GB
RAM	2 GB	2 GB

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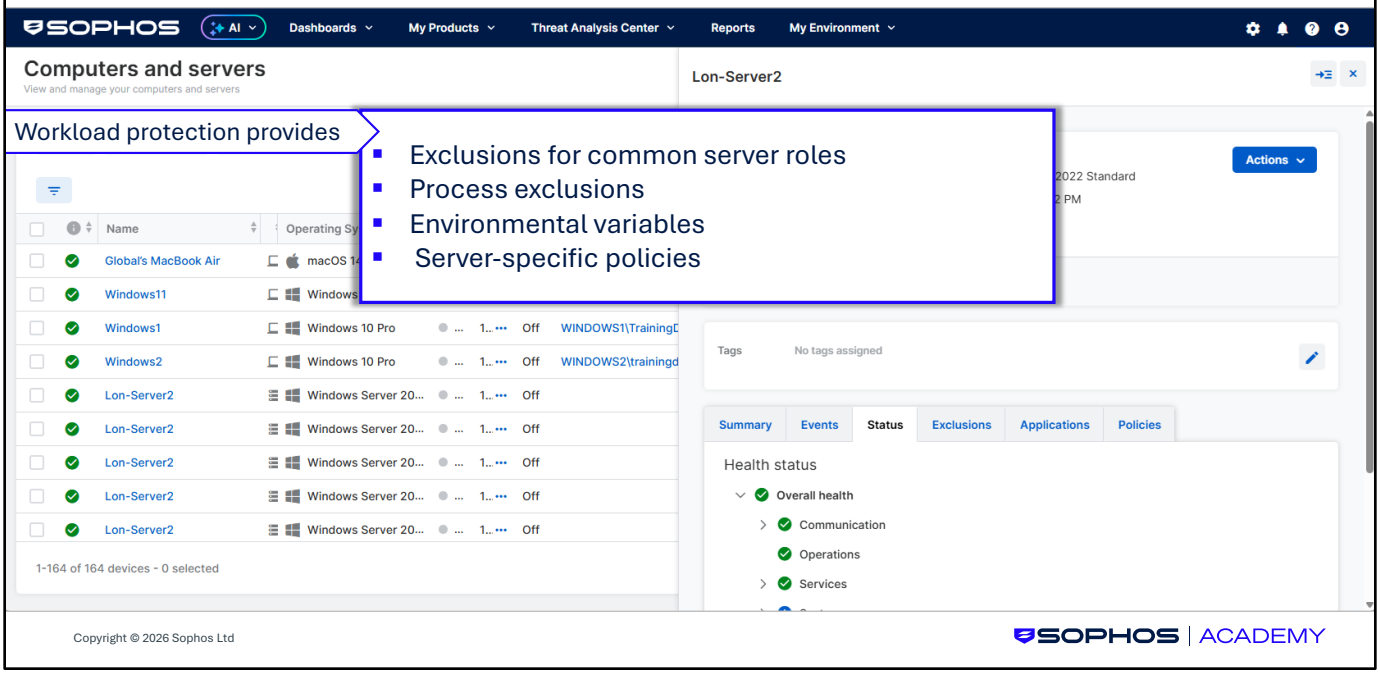
The requirements detailed are correct at the time of writing. We recommend that you check the knowledge base article for the latest supported platform details.

[Additional Information]
The list of recommended system requirements for macOS can be found in the knowledge base article **KB-000034670**. Sophos Endpoint for macOS: System requirements
https://support.sophos.com/support/s/article/KB-000034670

Workload Protection



Workload protection is designed specifically for servers. Exclusions for common server roles are automatically applied. Process exclusions and environmental variables can be added to server policies which provide a greater level of control for protected server security.

Workload protection is available for Windows and Linux servers. It also includes virtual environment protection for VMWare ESXi and Microsoft Hyper-V, as well as support for servers hosted by Amazon Web Services (AWS) and Microsoft Azure.

Workload Protection Licenses

Additional information available in the notes

Features	Sophos Endpoint	Sophos EDR	Sophos XDR
ATTACK SURFACE REDUCTION Application, peripheral and web control, unauthorized file protection (Windows Server)	✓	✓	✓
Download reputation, web security	✓	✓	✓
PRE-EXECUTION PROTECTION Deep learning malware detection, anti-malware file scanning, Live Protection, behaviour analysis, PUA blocking, IPS	✓	✓	✓

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All workload protection licenses include standard malware detection, file scanning protection, and live protection. They include controlled updates, policy control, web protection, control policies for peripherals, applications, web, and application whitelisting. The features supported on Linux Servers are highlighted in blue in the tables shown.

[Additional Information]

Sophos Endpoint Tech Specs
https://www.sophos.com/en-us/products/server-security/tech-specs

Workload Protection Licenses

Features	Sophos Endpoint	Sophos EDR	Sophos XDR
STOP RUNNING THREATS DLP, Behaviour analysis, AMSI, MTD, Exploit prevention, Active Adversary mitigations, CryptoGuard, WipeGuard, Safe Browsing, Enhanced Application Lockdown	✓	✓	✓
DETECT Data Lake Search, on-disk data storage, cross product data sources, prioritised detection lists, Unified Context Lake, container runtime visibility and detections		✓	✓
Unified Context Lake (Cloud Data Storage)		90 Days	90 Days
CONTROL Synchronized Application Control, Update Cache and Message Relay, Automatic Scanning Exclusions, File Integrity Monitoring	✓	✓	✓

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All workload protection licenses include the threat protection features that detect and stop active threats from running. The investigative detection features, including Data Lake Search, on-disk data storage, Unified Context Lake, and container running visibility and detection, are included in Sophos EDR and XDR licenses.

Workload Protection Licenses

Features	Sophos Endpoint	Sophos EDR	Sophos XDR
INVESTIGATE Threat Graph (Root cause analysis)	✓	✓	✓
Deep learning malware analysis, advanced on-demand SophosLabs threat intelligence, forensic data export, AI-guided investigation		✓	✓
REMEDIATE Automated malware removal, Synchronized Security Heartbeat, Sophos Clean	✓	✓	✓
Live Response, Server isolation, single-click 'clean and block', Container runtime visibility and detections		✓	✓

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All licenses include the automated removal of detected threats. Note that some features are platform-specific.

We recommend that you check the licensing guides available.

Linux Protection Licenses

Features	Sophos Endpoint	Sophos EDR	Sophos XDR
Linux Protection Agent Including malware scanning, exploit prevention, and file scanning	✓	✓	✓
Linux Sensor Integrate Linux and container runtime threat detections with your existing threat response tools via API		✓	✓
Cloud Infrastructure Security Monitor cloud security posture to prevent security and compliance risks	✓	✓	✓
XDR Extended detection and response		✓	✓

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As well as acting as a protection agent, Linux protection can also be installed as a sensor. Sophos Linux Sensor uses APIs to integrate runtime threat detections, in host or container environments, with your existing threat response tools. This provides a wider range of detections, control to create custom rule sets, and configuration options to tune host resource utilization.

Additional information available in the notes

Workload System Requirements

Fully supported platforms

- Windows Server 2016, 2019, 2022, 2025

Platforms	Sophos Endpoint	Sophos XDR	
		Minimum	Recommended
Free disk space	8 GB	10 GB	10 GB
RAM	8 GB	8 GB	16 GB
Cores	2	2	4

Legacy platforms

- Windows Server 2008R2 [requires Extended support license]
- Windows Server 2012, 2012R2 [requires Extended support license]

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Before you protect servers, ensure they meet the system requirements. These tables detail the supported platforms and the free disk space and memory required. For Windows operating systems, this changes depending on the license that is applied.

For legacy platforms you may need an extended support license, and some of these platforms are end of life. Check the knowledge base article in the student handout for the latest supported platform details.

[Additional Information]
Windows system requirements **KB-000034920**. Sophos Server: System Requirements for Windows
https://support.sophos.com/support/s/article/KB-000034920

Workload System Requirements

Additional information available in the notes

Only last two minor releases of a test platform version are fully supported

Platforms	Sophos Endpoint	Sophos XDR
Free disk space	2.5 GB	2.5 GB
RAM	2 GB	2 GB

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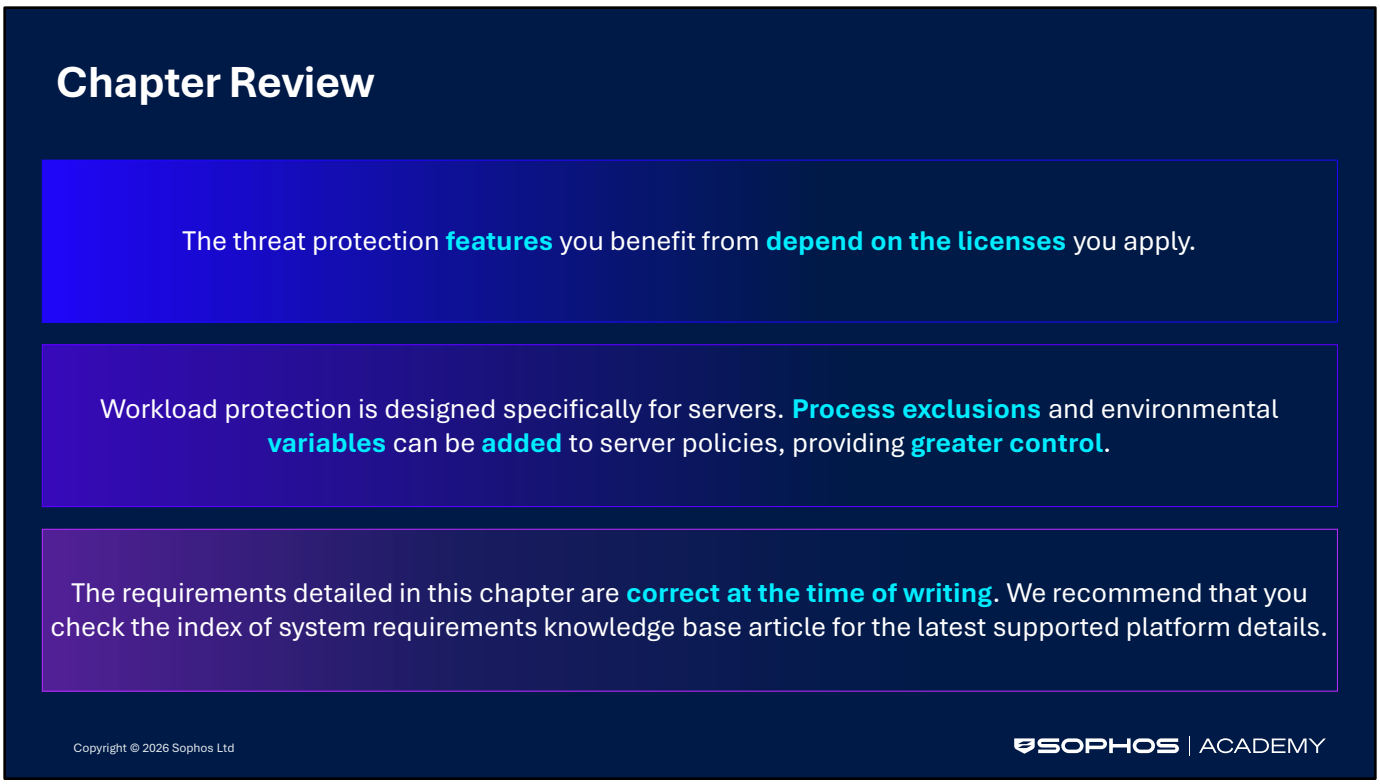
Only the last two minor releases of a test platform version are fully supported for Linux servers. A Linux server must have systemd supported and running, a kernel that supports GLIBC version 2.17 or later, and bash installed.

The requirements detailed here are correct at the time of writing. We recommend that you check the knowledge base article linked in the student handout for the latest supported platform details.

[Additional Information]
Recommended system requirements for SPL **KB-000039161**. Sophos Protection for Linux: List of system requirements and tested platforms
https://support.sophos.com/support/s/article/KB-000039161



Here are the three main things you learned in this chapter.

The threat protection features you benefit from will depend on the licenses you apply.

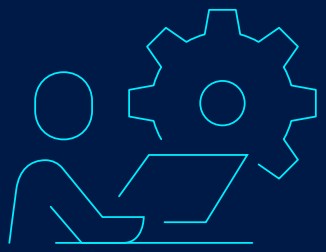
Workload protection is designed specifically for servers. Process exclusions and environmental variables can be added to server policies, providing greater control.

The requirements detailed in this chapter are correct at the time of writing. We recommend that you check the index of system requirements knowledge base article for the latest supported platform details.

Lab Tasks

Complete the lab tasks for **Introduction to Sophos Endpoint**

- **Task 1**: Register and Activate a Sophos Central Trial



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Complete the lab tasks for this module.

The lab task information can be found in the Lab Workbook which is available in the **Lesson Resources.**

User Management

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[Additional Information]

Sophos Endpoint
EP1005: Introduction to Users in Sophos Central

May 2026

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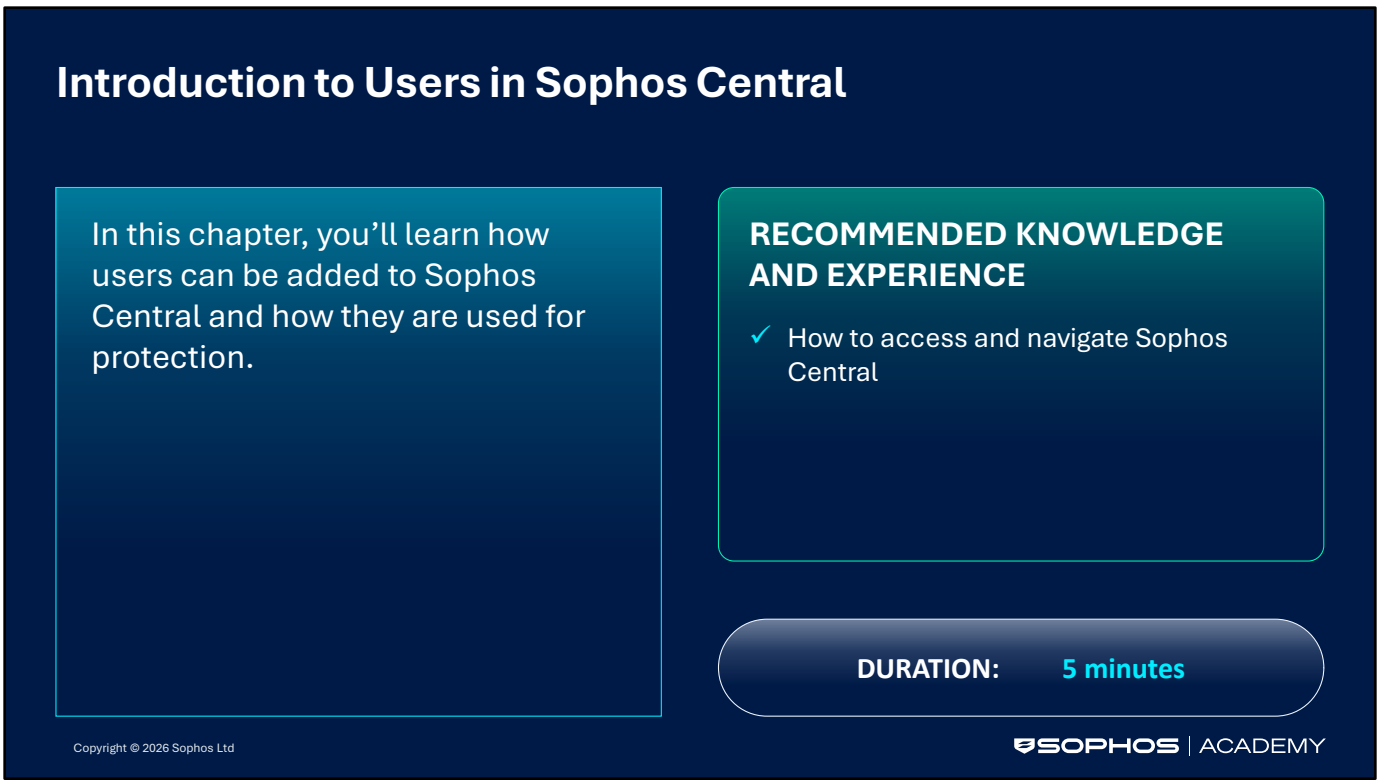
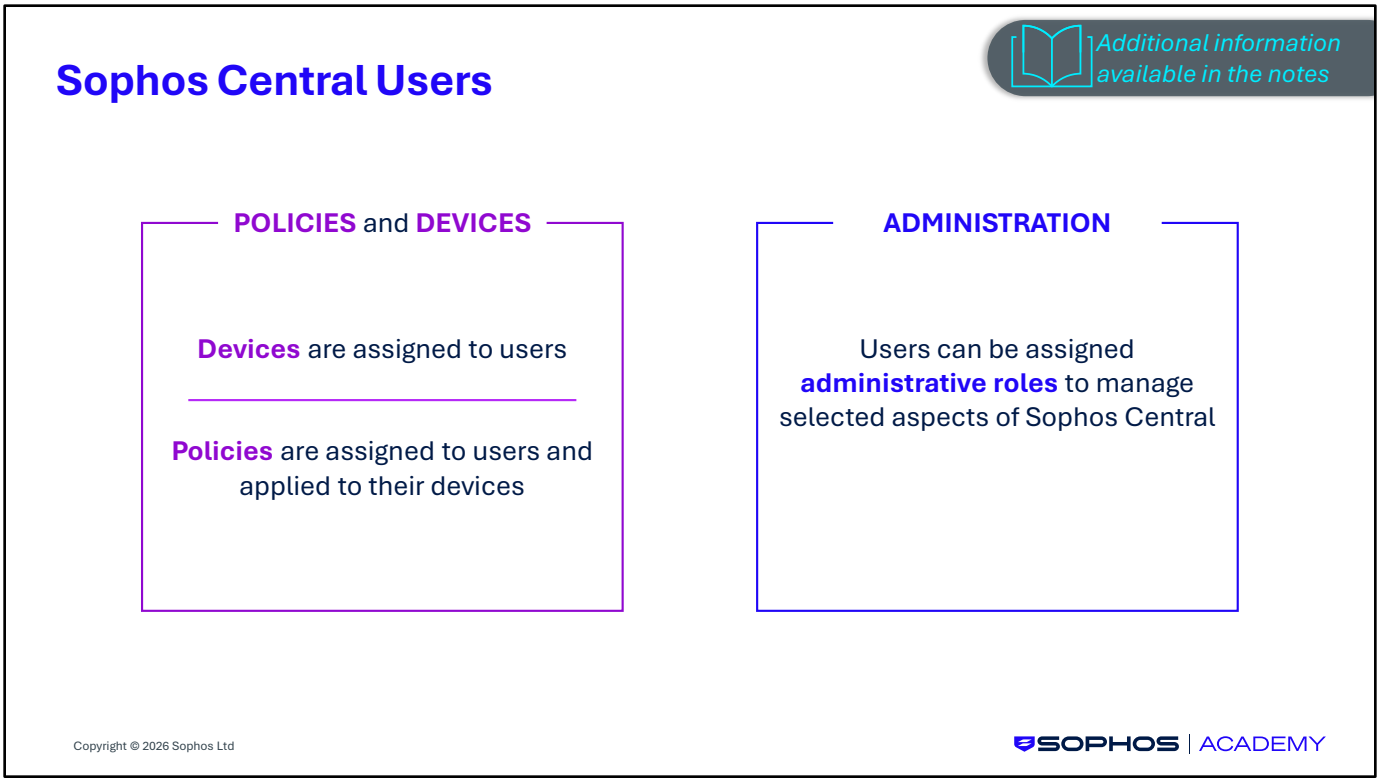


In this chapter, you'll learn how users can be added to Sophos Central and how they are used for protection.



People are a key element of management in Sophos Central. In Sophos Endpoint, policies are assigned to users, not devices. When a user logs into a device, the device is assigned to them, and their user policies are applied.

Users are used to manage administration in Sophos Central and delegate access to selected aspects of the Sophos Central Admin console.

[Additional Information]
People and devices - Sophos Central Admin
https://docs.sophos.com/central/Customer/help/en-us/PeopleAndDevices/index.html

Methods for Adding Users

- Add users **manually**
- Import users from a **CSV file**
- Synchronize users from a **directory service**
- The **current user** is added during the device installation
- When a **new user** logs into a managed device

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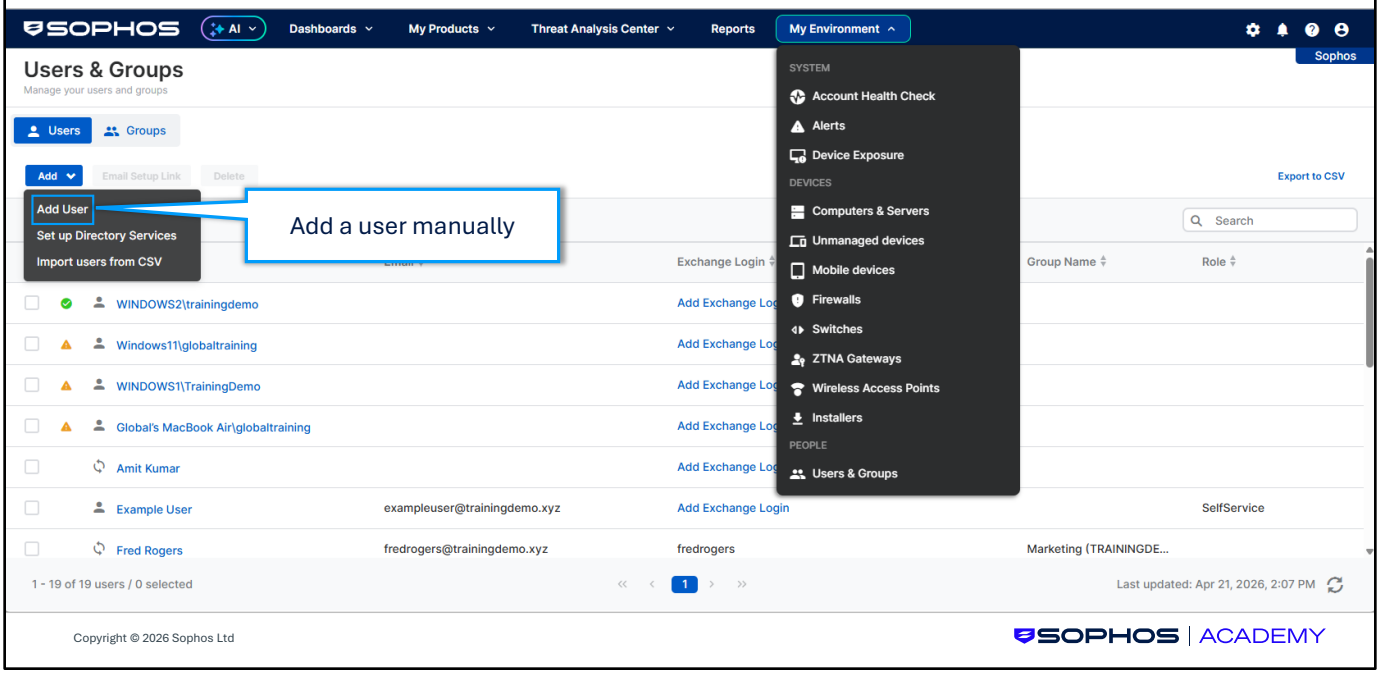
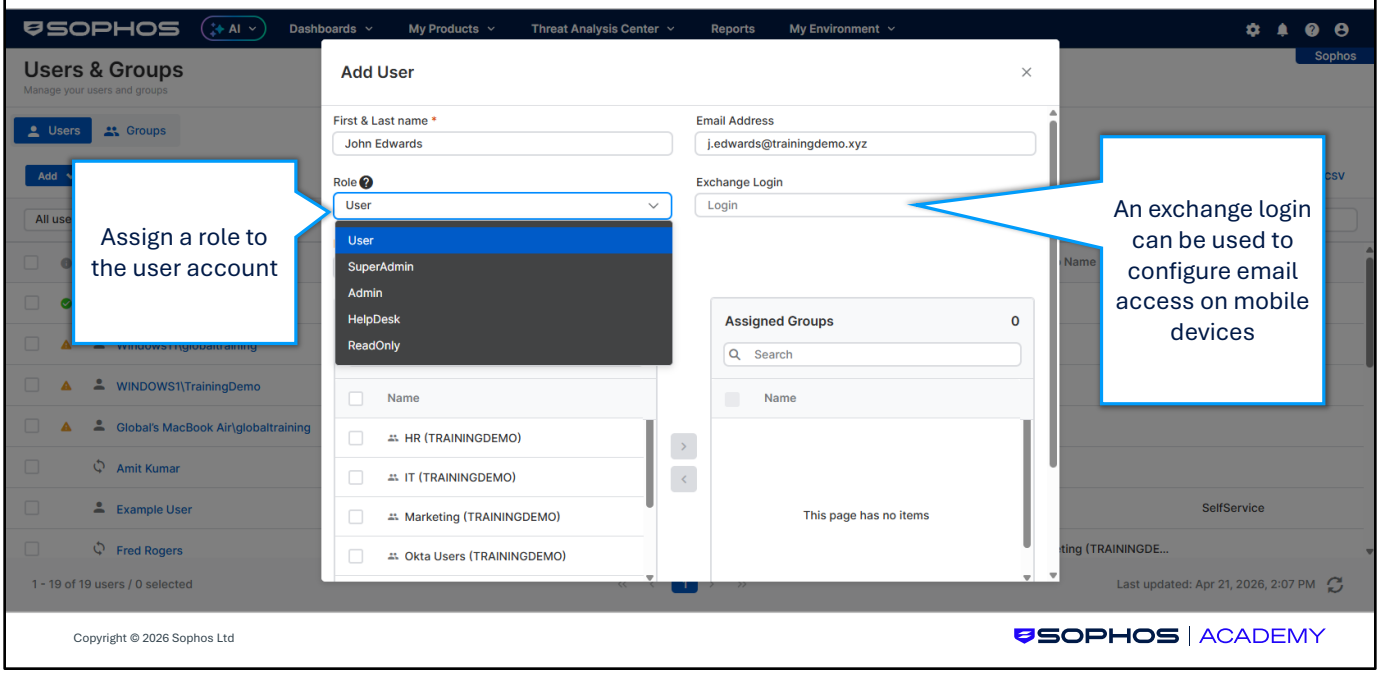
There are five ways to add users to Sophos Central: manually, using a CSV file to import users, and synchronizing users from a directory service. Users are also created automatically during device installation and when a user logs into a managed device.

Adding Users Manually



Let's start by looking at how to manually add a user to Sophos Central. Users are managed in the 'PEOPLE' section from the **My Environment** drop-down menu. Here, you can add an individual user and protect them by clicking **Add > Add User**.

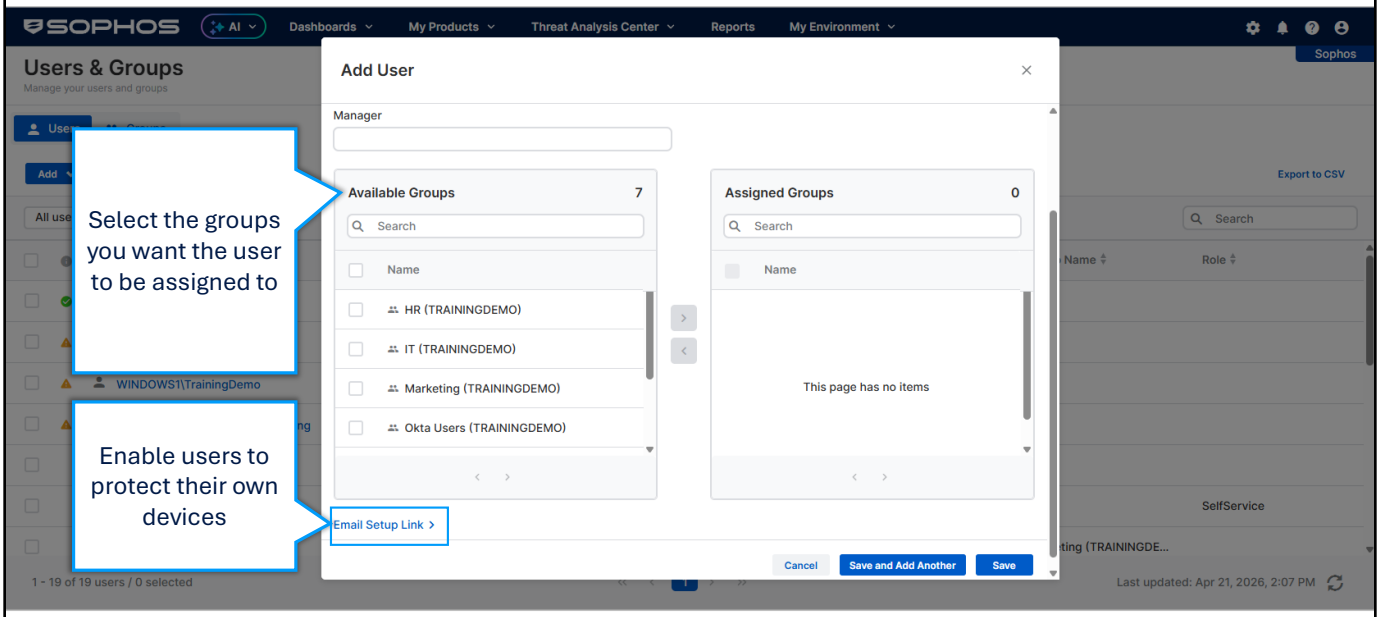
Adding Users Manually



Enter the user's first and last name along with their email address, and then select an administration role for the user. The default role assigned will always be ‘user’.

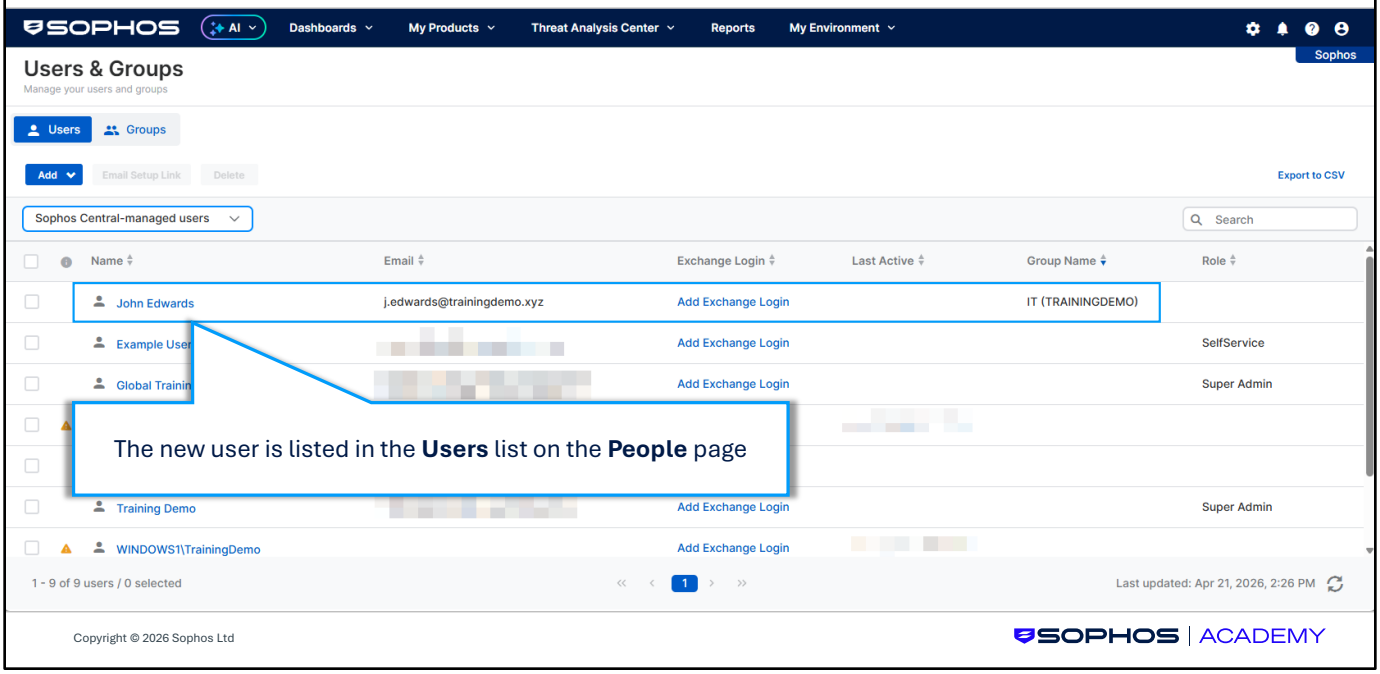
You can select to enter an ‘Exchange Login’ for the user you’re adding. These details can be used to configure email access on mobile devices.

Adding Users Manually



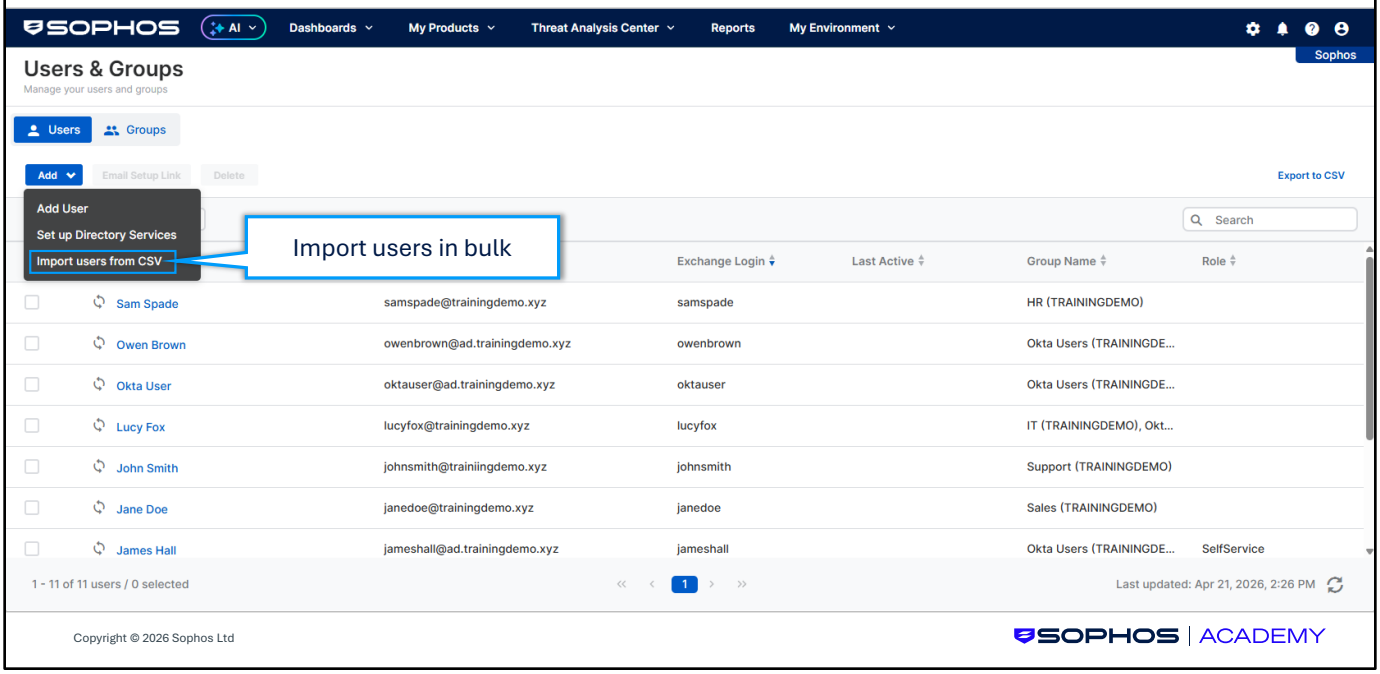
You can select which configured groups to add the user to. To enable users to protect their own devices, click the **Email Setup Link**.

Adding Users Manually



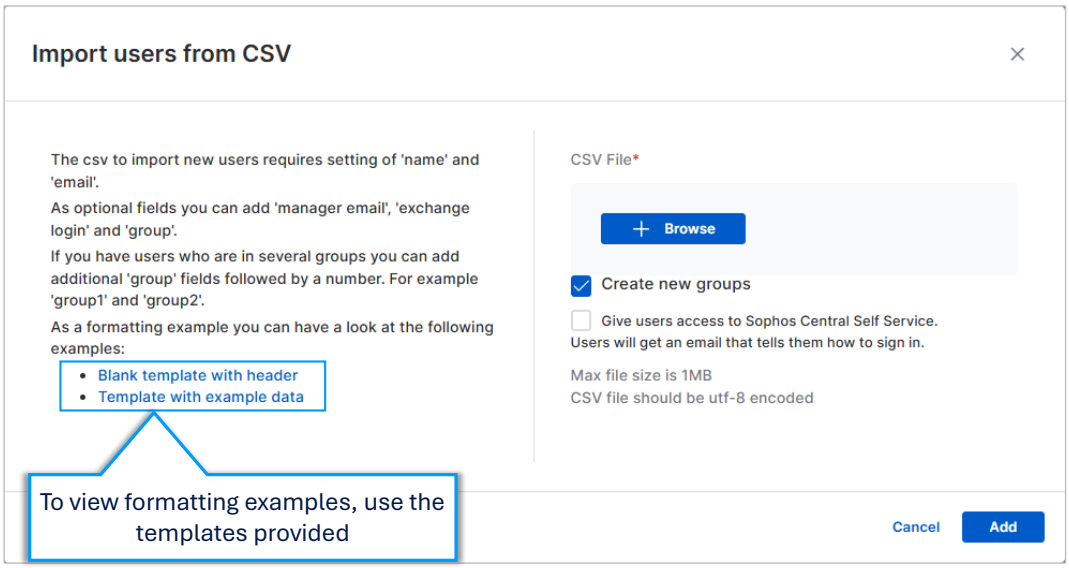
Once the user is saved, they'll appear in the 'People' list. When a user downloads and installs the Sophos Endpoint agent, their device is automatically associated with them as a user.

Importing Users from a CSV File



Importing users using a CSV file allows you to add users in bulk. To import users from a CSV file, go to **My Environment > Users & Groups > Add > Import users from CSV**.

Importing Users from a CSV File



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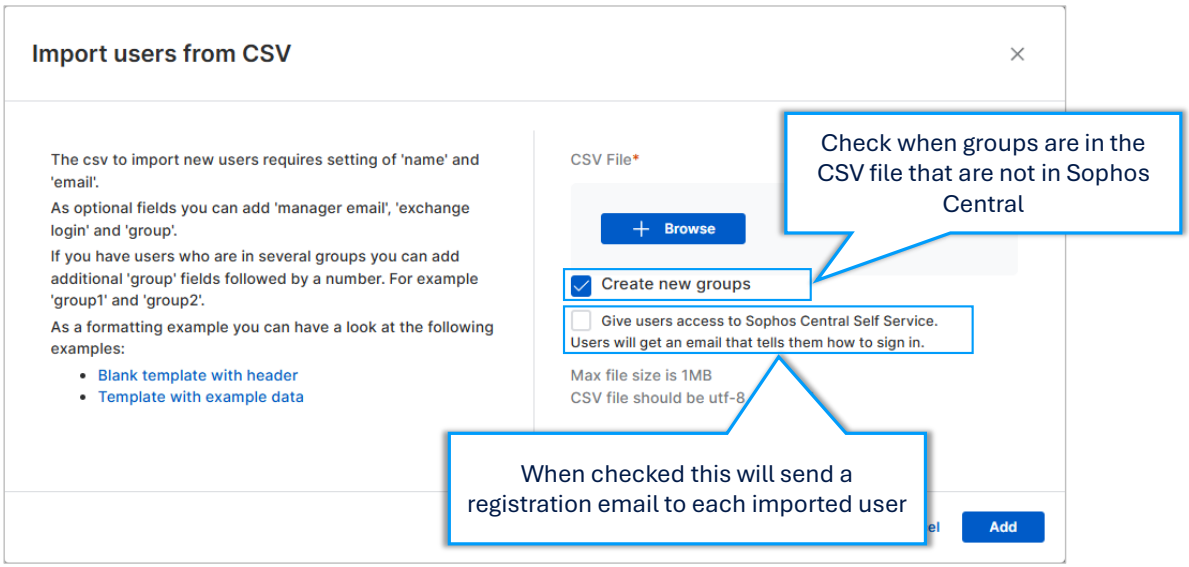
You can download a template to ensure you include the correct details for your users. There are two versions of the template: a blank template with only the header information and a template with an example.

Importing Users from a CSV File



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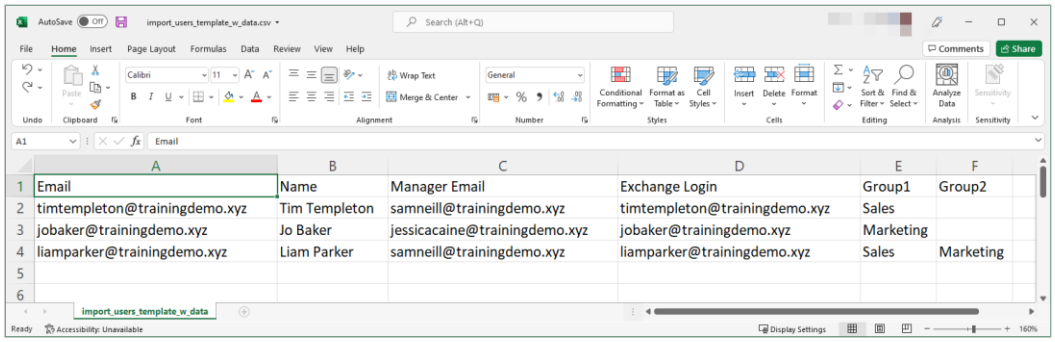
The ‘Create new groups’ tick box can be selected if you want to include user groups that have yet to be created in Sophos Central in the CSV file.

The ‘Give users access to Sophos Central Self Service’ tick box will send a registration email for the Sophos Central self-service portal to each imported user.

Click **Browse** to select your CSV file and click **Add**.

Importing Users from a CSV File

- A CSV file can include the email address of a manager for each user. If the manager isn't already a user in Sophos Central, a user account is created.
- If an email address in the CSV file **matches an existing user** in Sophos Central, the **existing user account is updated** with the information in the imported file.
- If an **existing user** account is managed through a **directory service**, the user will be **skipped** during when the CSV file is imported.



	A	B	C	D	E	F
1	Email	Name	Manager Email	Exchange Login	Group1	Group2
2	timtempleton@trainingdemo.xyz	Tim Templeton	samneill@trainingdemo.xyz	timtempleton@trainingdemo.xyz	Sales	
3	jobaker@trainingdemo.xyz	Jo Baker	jessicacaine@trainingdemo.xyz	jobaker@trainingdemo.xyz	Marketing	
4	liamparker@trainingdemo.xyz	Liam Parker	samneill@trainingdemo.xyz	liamparker@trainingdemo.xyz	Sales	Marketing
5						
6						

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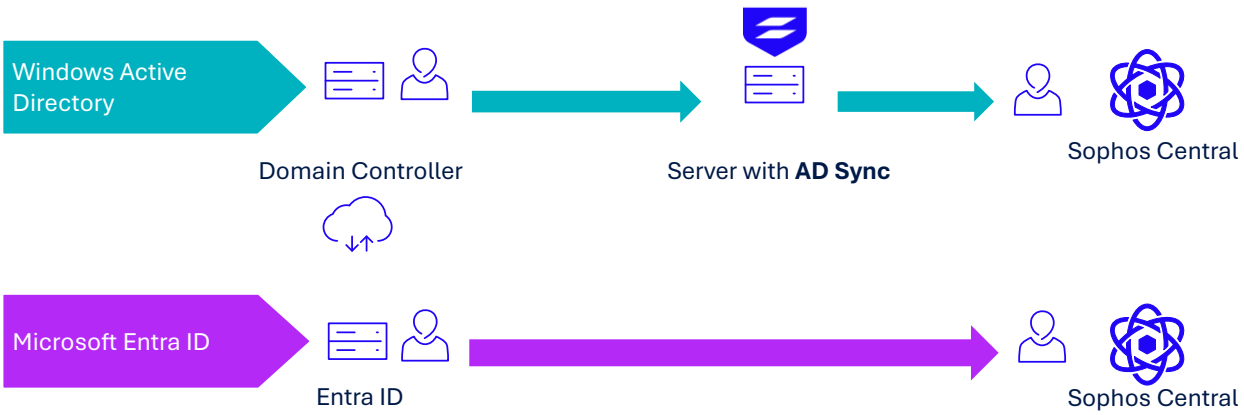
Here is an example of a CSV file with some example users.

Your CSV file can include the email address of the manager for each of your users. If a manager is not already a user in Sophos Central, a user is created. This means the number of users imported may exceed the number of rows in the file.

If an email address in your CSV file matches an existing user in Sophos Central, the user is updated with the information in the imported file. However, if the existing user in Sophos Central is managed through a directory service, the user is skipped during import, and no changes are made to the user account.

Synchronizing from a Directory Service

We recommend installing and configuring a directory service before you start deploying protection



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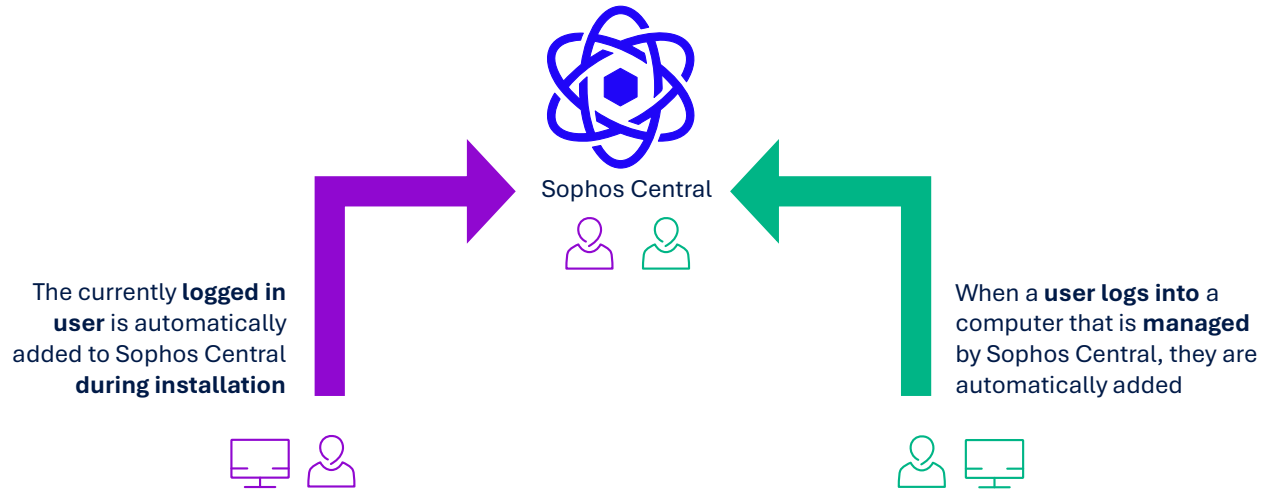
If you are using either Windows Active Directory or Microsoft Entra ID, you can automate the adding and removing of users and groups in Sophos Central. Sophos Central can also be configured to perform a regular one-way synchronization from the directory service to Sophos Central. This ensures that users in Sophos Central match those configured in your organization's directory.

We recommend installing and configuring your selected directory service tool before you start deploying Sophos protection to any devices, so that you can preconfigure policies and apply them to users and groups.

Note that other directory services, such as OpenLDAP and eDirectory, aren’t currently supported.

Adding Users Automatically



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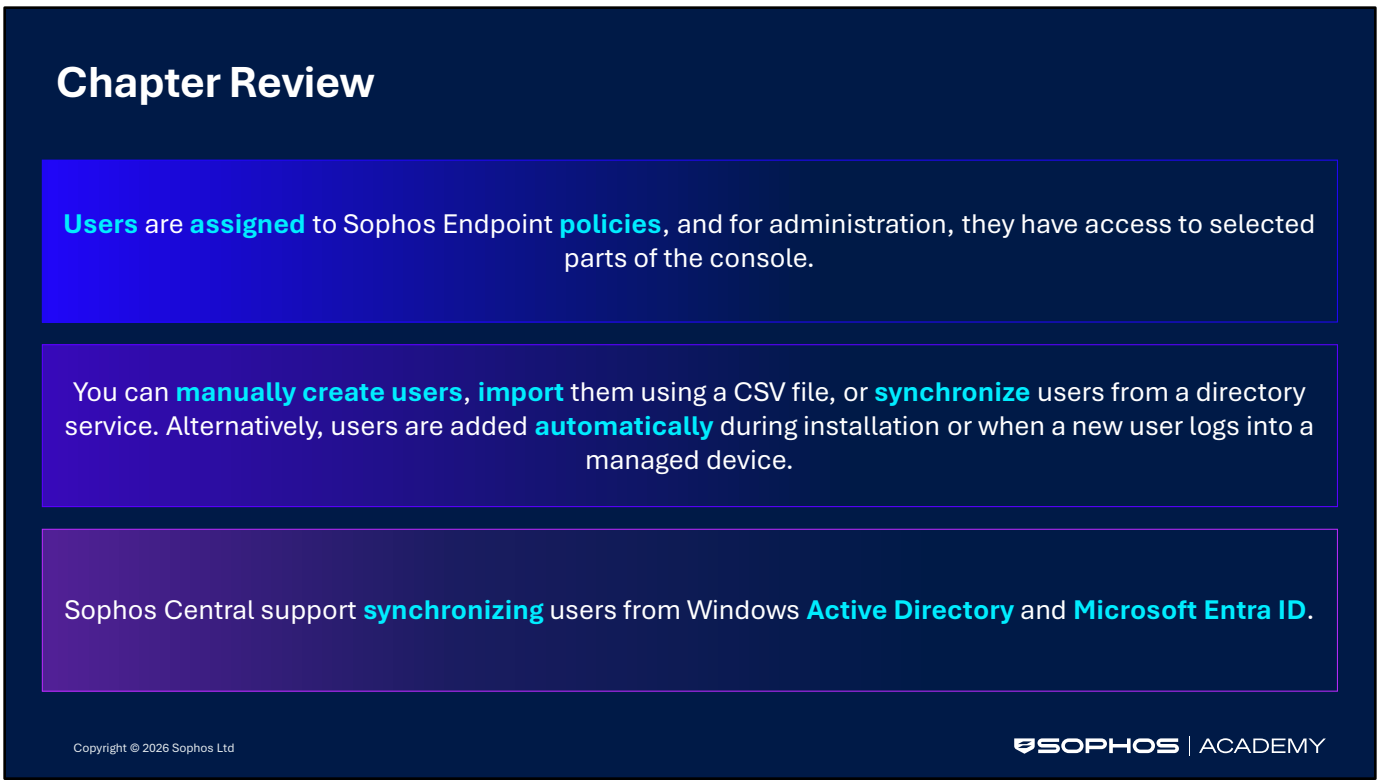
Users will automatically be added to Sophos Central in two scenarios. First, during the installation of the Sophos agent on a device, if a user is logged onto that device. Second, when a new user logs onto a device that is already protected by Sophos Central.



Here are the main things you learned in this chapter.

Users are assigned Sophos Endpoint policies, and for administration, they have access to selected parts of the console.

You can manually create users, import them using a CSV file, or synchronize users from a directory service. Alternatively, users are added automatically during installation or when a new user logs into a managed device.

Sophos Central supports synchronizing users from Windows Active Directory and Microsoft Entra ID.

[Additional Information]

Sophos Endpoint
EP1010: Getting Started with Sophos Central User Management

May 2026

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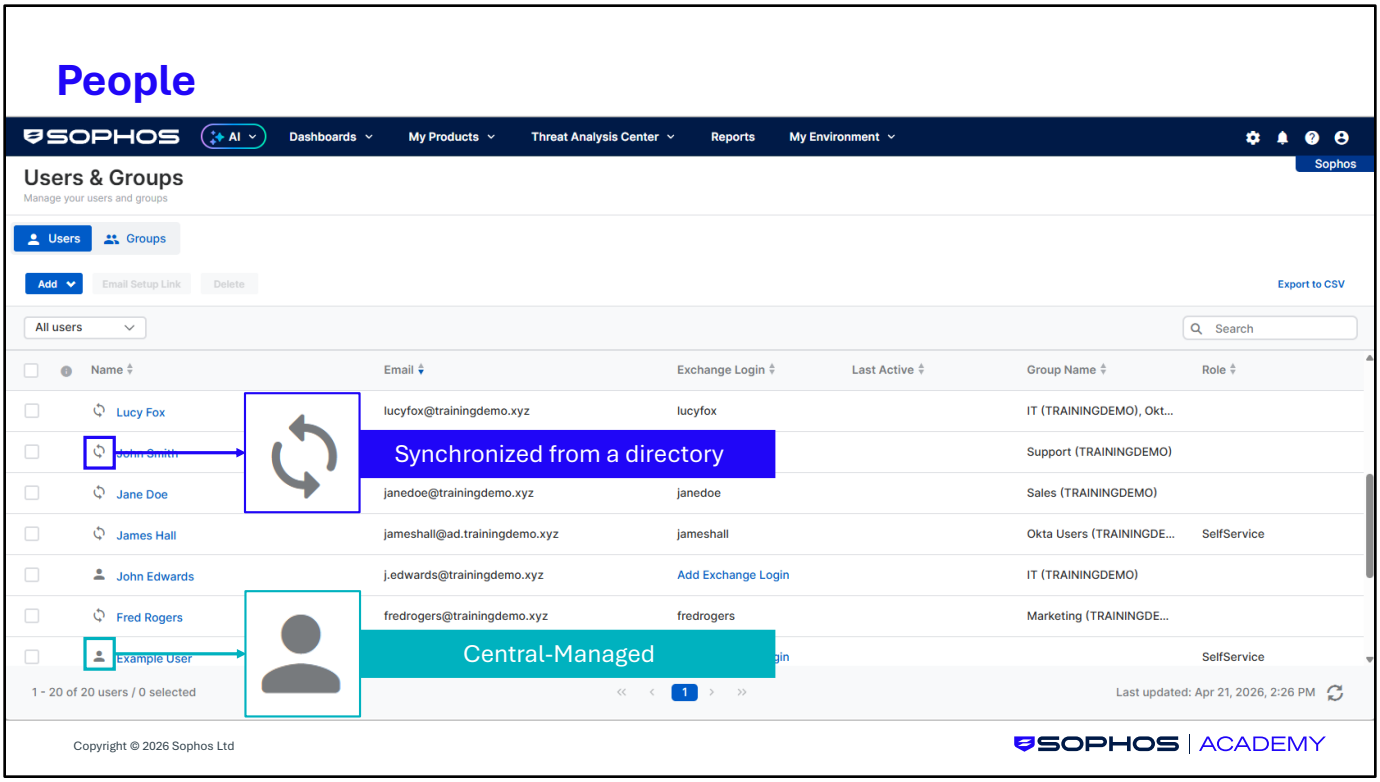
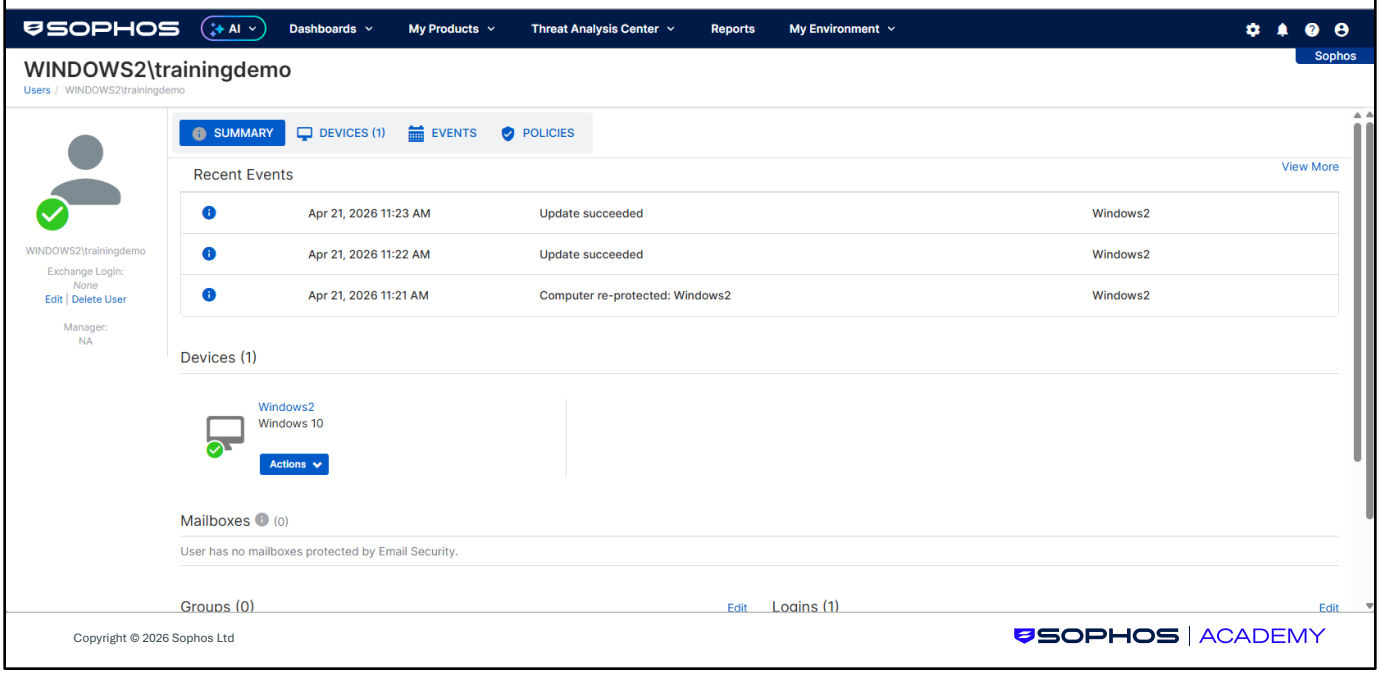
In this chapter, you'll learn how to manage users in Sophos Central using groups, how to set up and manage multi-factor authentication settings, and how to create API credentials.



Once users have been added to Sophos Central, they'll be listed on the **My Environment > Users & Groups** page.

You'll notice that there are two different icons for users, one to indicate that the user is synchronized from a directory, and the other for Central-managed users that have been added manually or automatically.

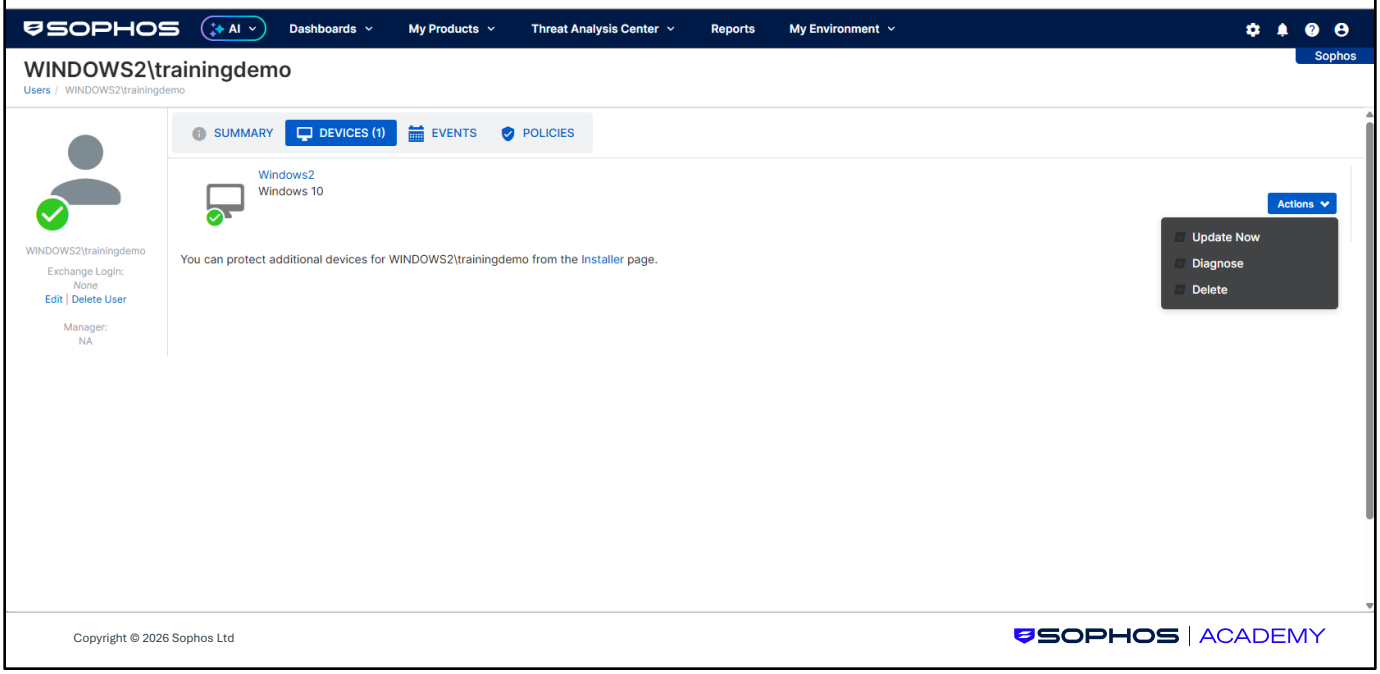
User Details: Summary



Clicking a user opens the details page for that user. This page includes four tabs: summary, devices, events, and policies.

The **SUMMARY** tab contains an overview of recent events, devices, mailboxes, groups, and logins.

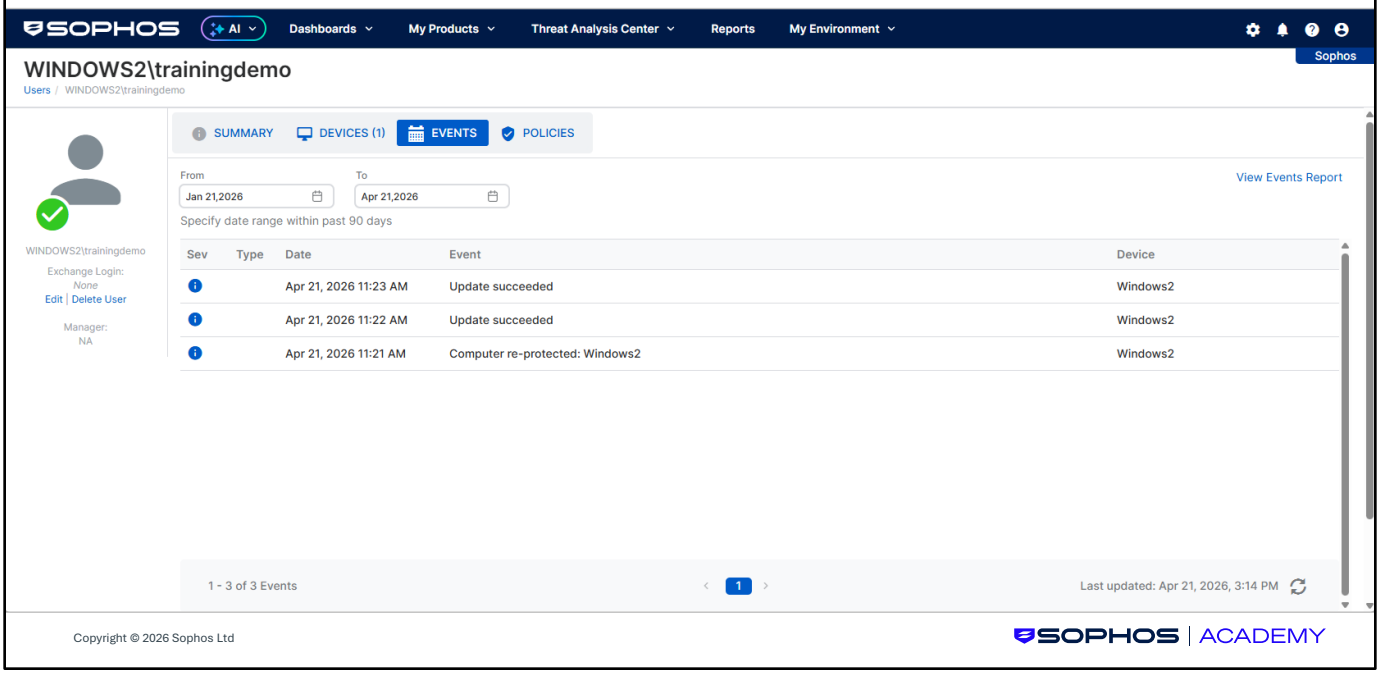
User Details: Devices



The **DEVICES** tab displays all the devices the user has associated with them and allows you to perform actions on them.

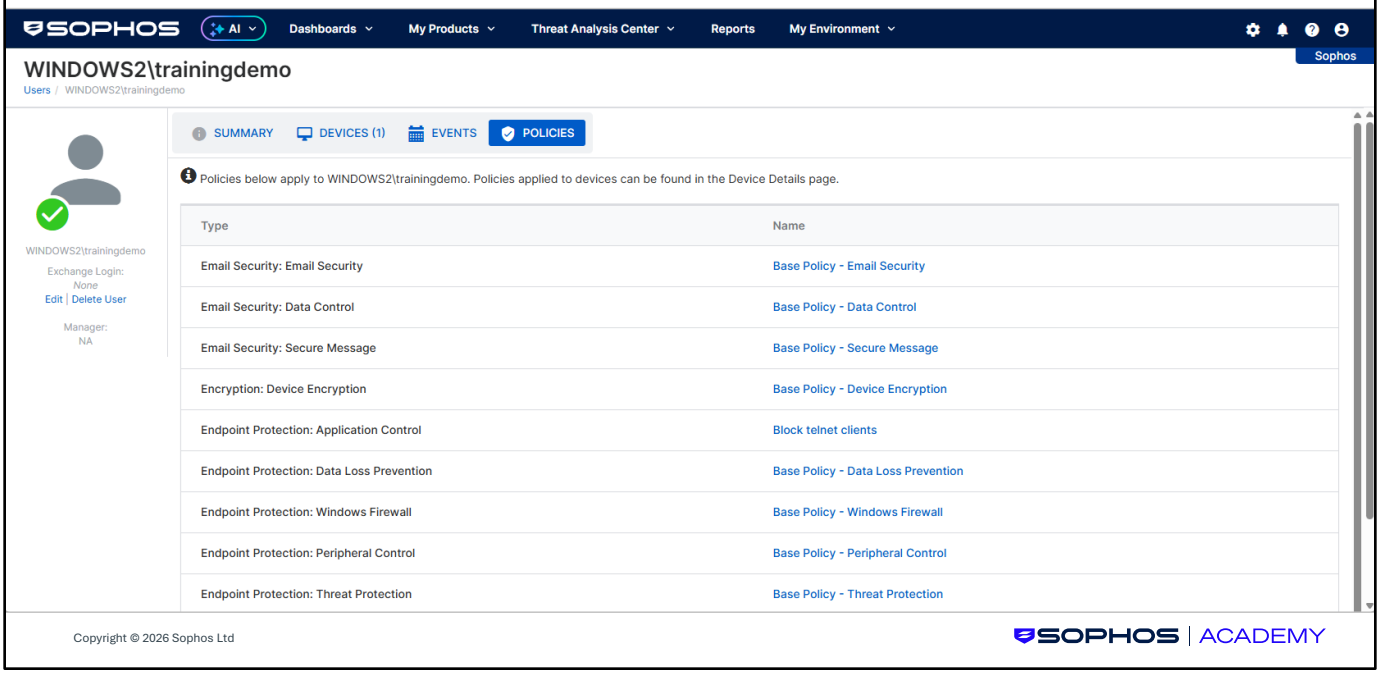
For example, you can initiate a scan or update, gather troubleshooting information, or delete a device.

User Details: Events

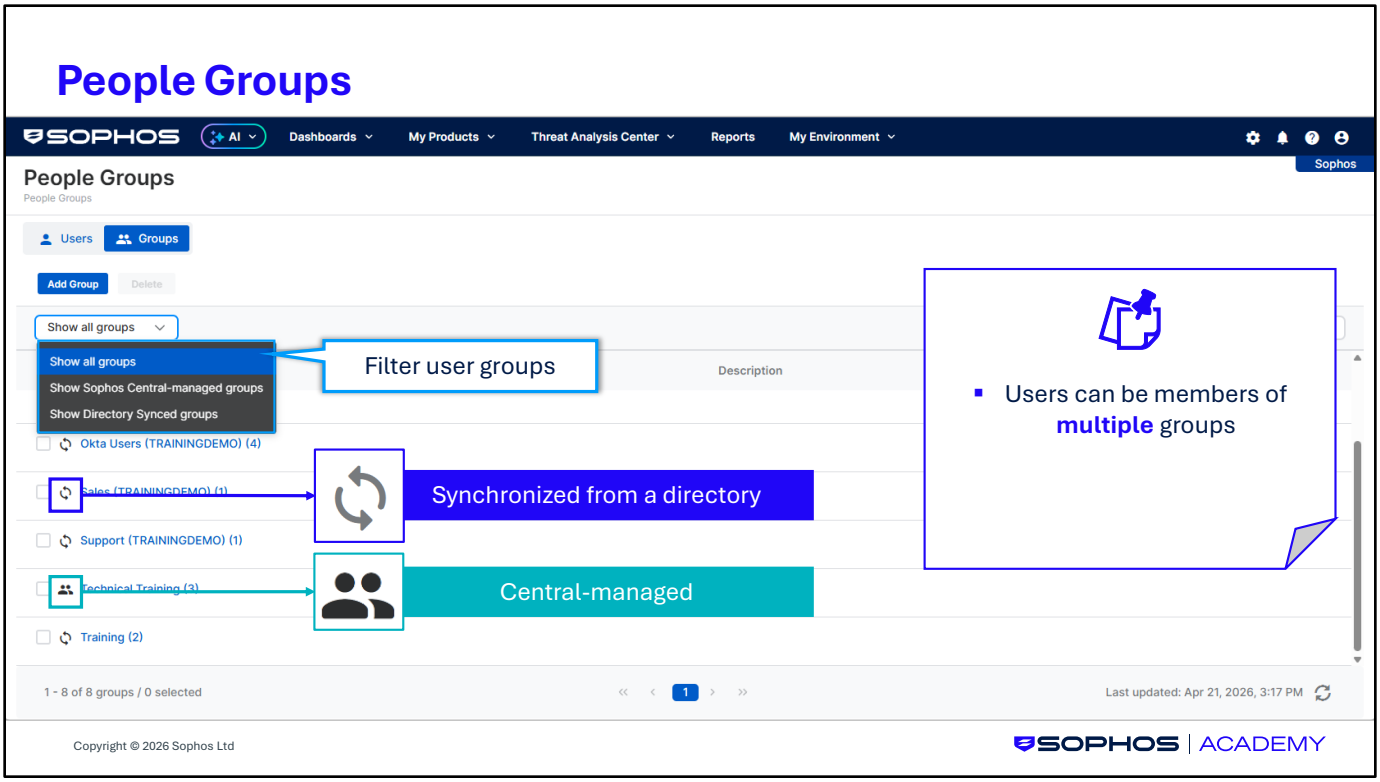


The **EVENTS** tab displays all the events logged for the user and their devices. These can be filtered by time.

User Details: Policies



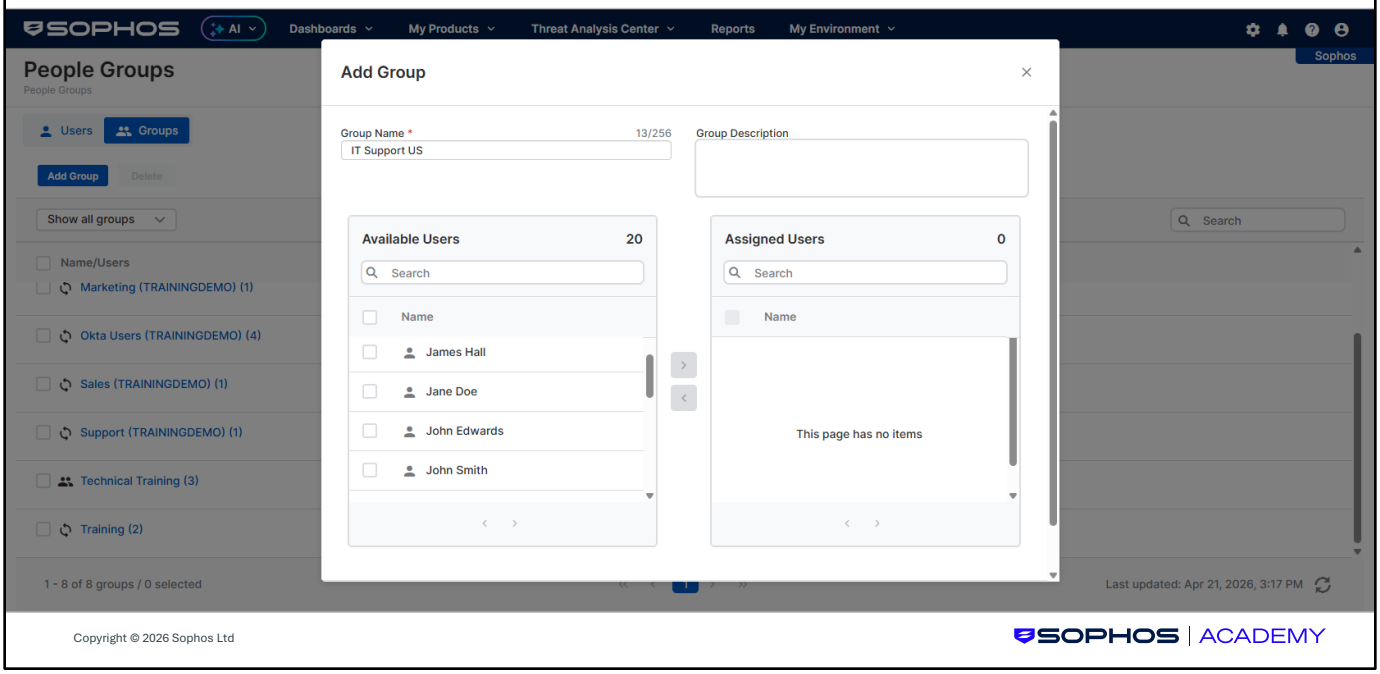
The **POLICIES** tab displays the policies that apply to the user.



People groups simplify applying policies to users with the same requirements. Groups can be manually created in Sophos Central or synchronized from an active directory service. As with users, groups have different icons to indicate how they are managed.

At the top of the page, you can filter the user groups to show all groups, only Central-managed groups, or only Active Directory groups. Users can be members of multiple groups.

People Groups



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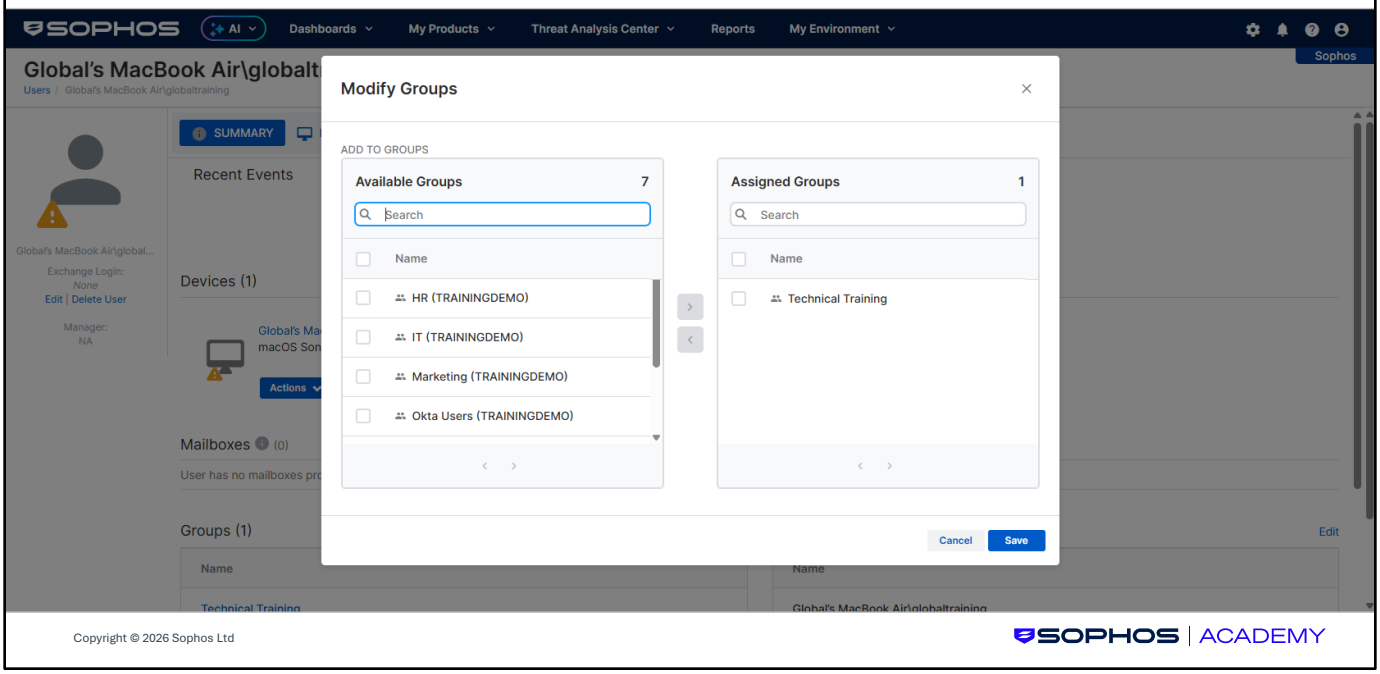
To create a new Central managed group, navigate to **My Environment > Users & Groups > Groups > Add Group**. Enter the group name and optionally a description for the group.

Move any users you wish to be a member of the group from the 'Available Users' list to the 'Assigned Users' list and click **Save**.

Edit User



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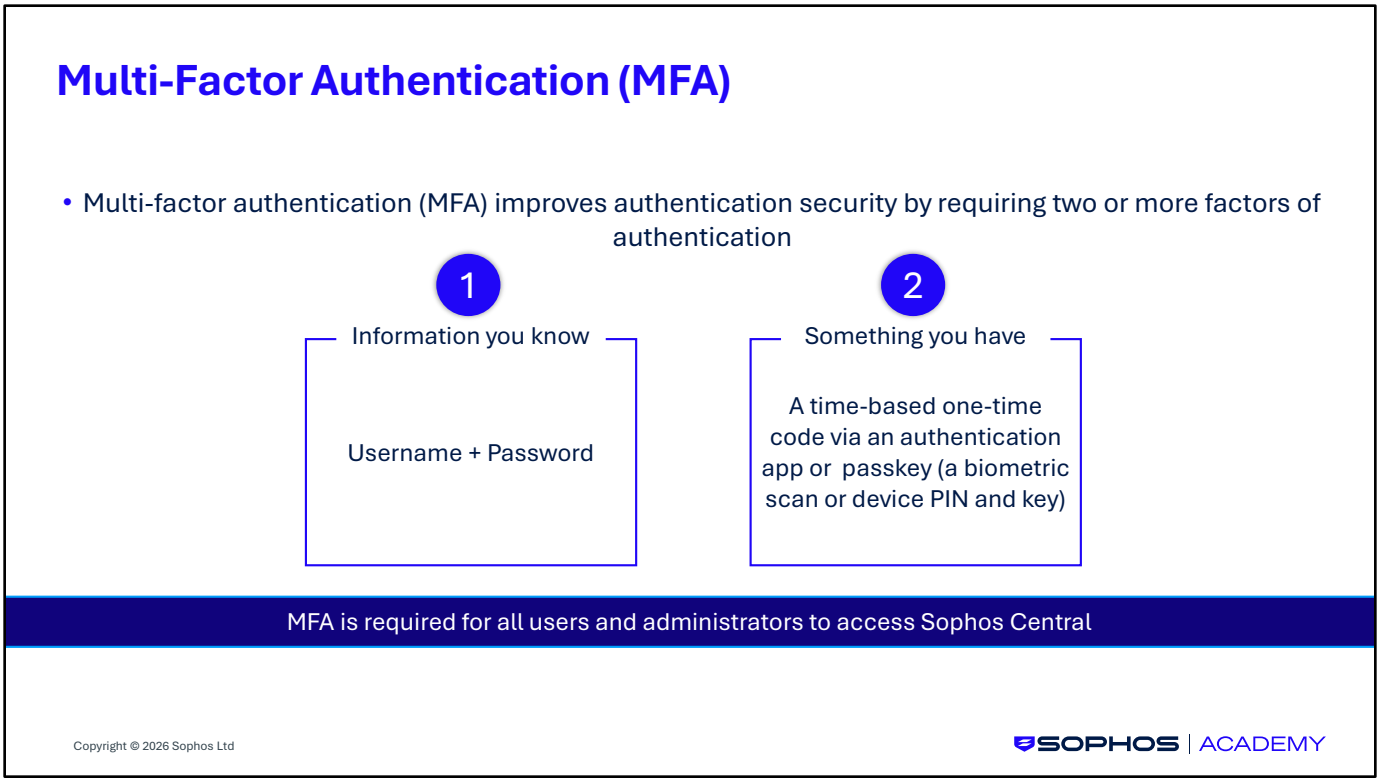
You can change the groups a user is assigned to by editing the user.

Select the user from the users list. Under the username, click **Edit**. You can assign the user to multiple groups.

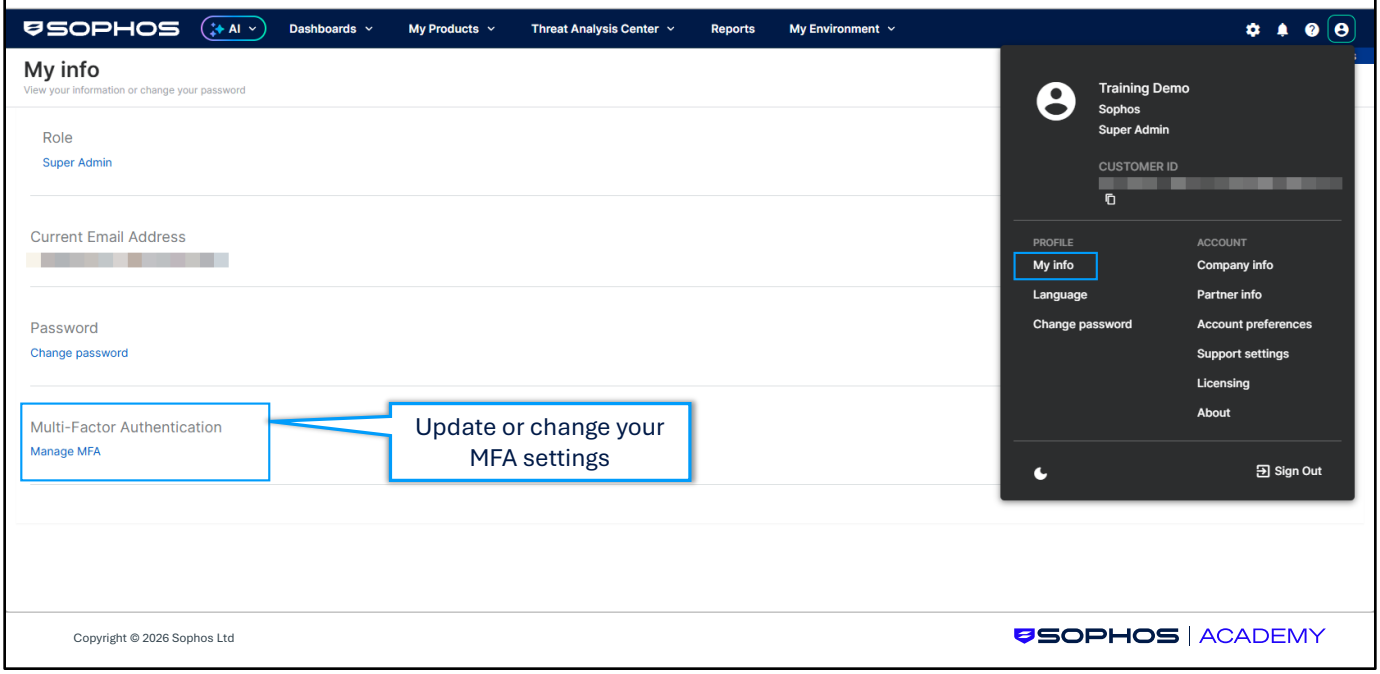


Multi-factor authentication, or MFA, improves security by requiring two or more factors of authentication to log in to Sophos Central. It is required for all users and administrators to access Sophos Central.

Your username and password are required for authentication; this is information you know. As a second factor of authentication, you need to use something you have. This can be a time-based one-time code from an authenticator application like Google Authenticator, Microsoft Authenticator, or Authy. We recommend using a passkey, as they provide an easier and more secure method of logging in. They use two authentication factors: a biometric scan or device PIN and a key stored securely on the computer or mobile device.

If you lose access to the authenticator app, you can reset your authentication method to regain access. This can be completed by a Super Admin account, or you can contact Sophos support.

How To Manage Your MFA Settings



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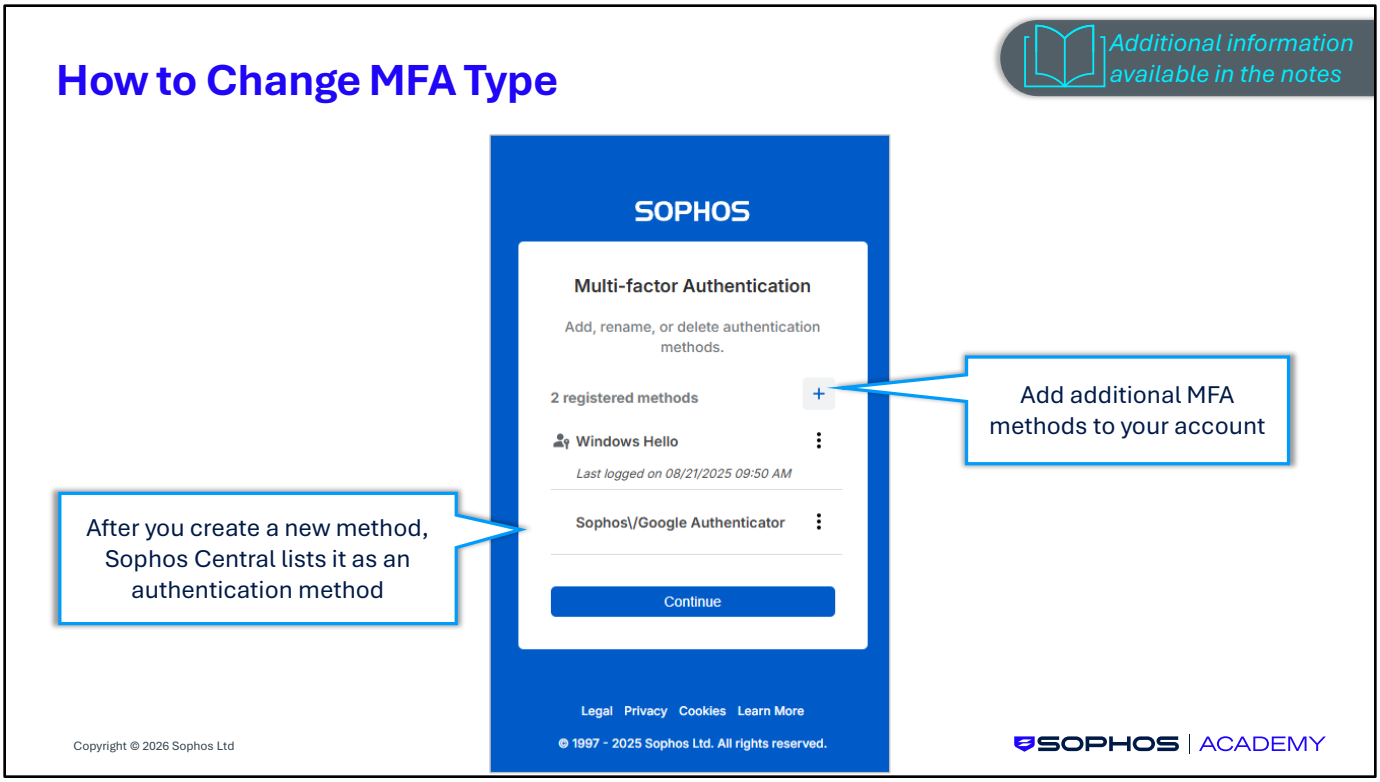
You can update your multi-factor authentication settings from the user menu in the top-right of the admin console.

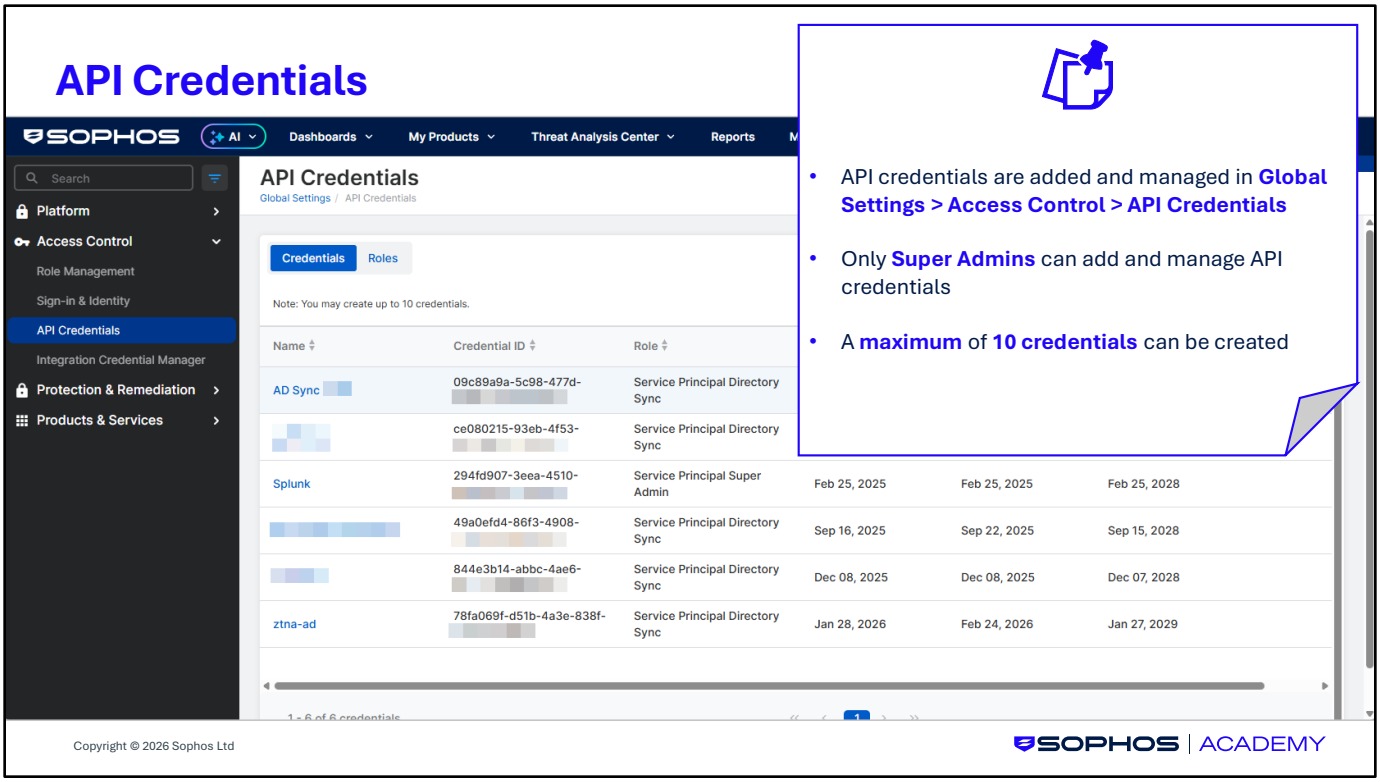
Select **My info > Manage MFA**.



Here, you can view, rename, or delete the multi-factor authentication methods you have configured or select a new method.

Adding new authentication methods follows the same process as the initial multi-factor authentication configuration, giving you the option to either select to configure a passkey or an authenticator app.

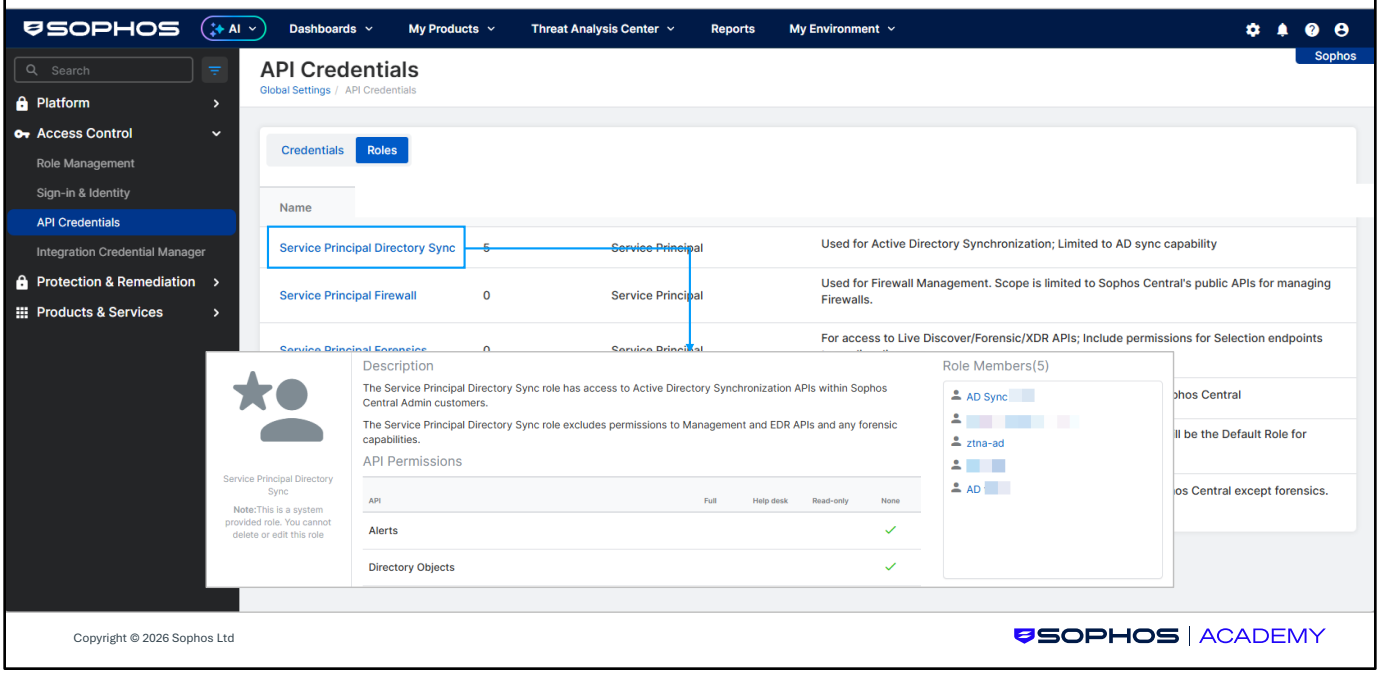
[Additional Information]
More information about managing MFA can be found in the help documentation here: Manage authentication methods - Sophos Central Admin
https://docs.sophos.com/central/Customer/help/en-us/ManageYourAccount/ModernAuthentication/ModernAuthManage/index.html



You can use Sophos APIs to manage users, endpoints, alerts, and security settings, as well as perform forensic analysis. API credentials are created and work like username and passwords to manage API permissions. An API credential will have an ID, a secret, an expiry date, and a role.

API credentials are added and managed in **Global Settings > Access Control > API Credentials**. Only administrators with the super admin role can add and manage API credentials, and you can have up to 10 API credentials in Sophos Central.

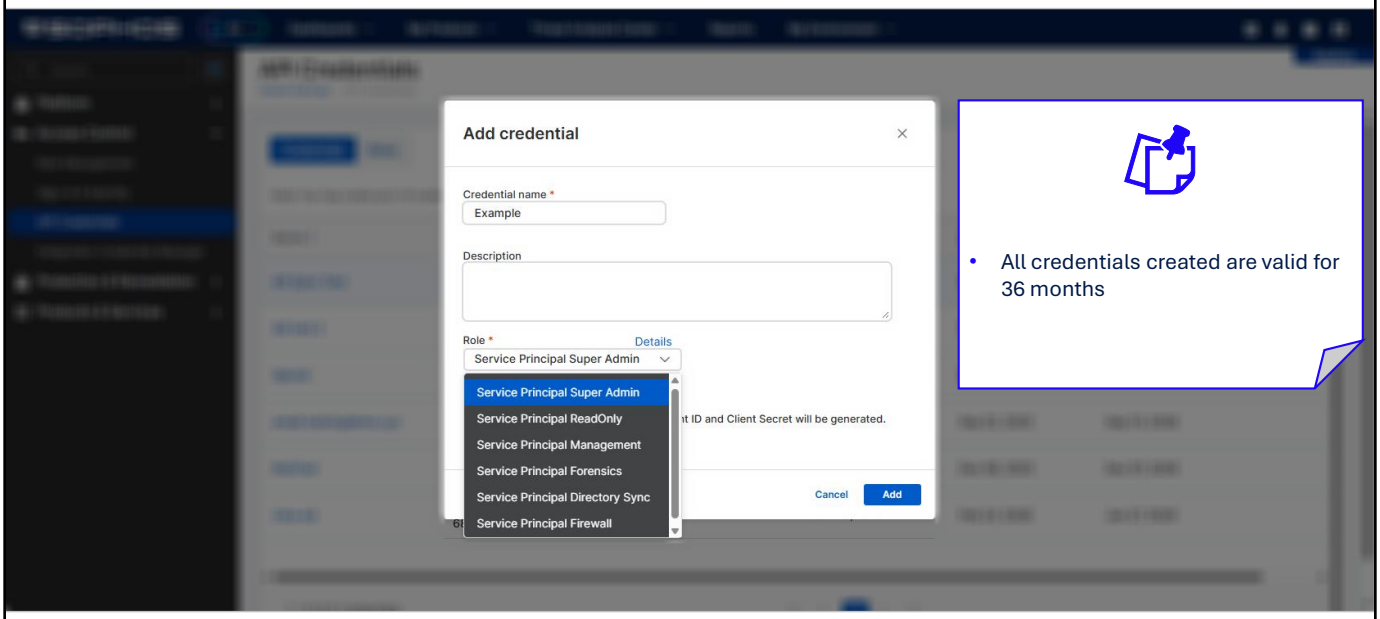
API Credential Roles



Roles control what API users can do. You assign a role to each of the API credentials when you create them. We recommend giving API users and applications only the level of access they need, keeping their access as specific as possible.

By selecting the **Roles** tab, you can view the descriptions for each role and the API permissions given to each role.

API Credentials



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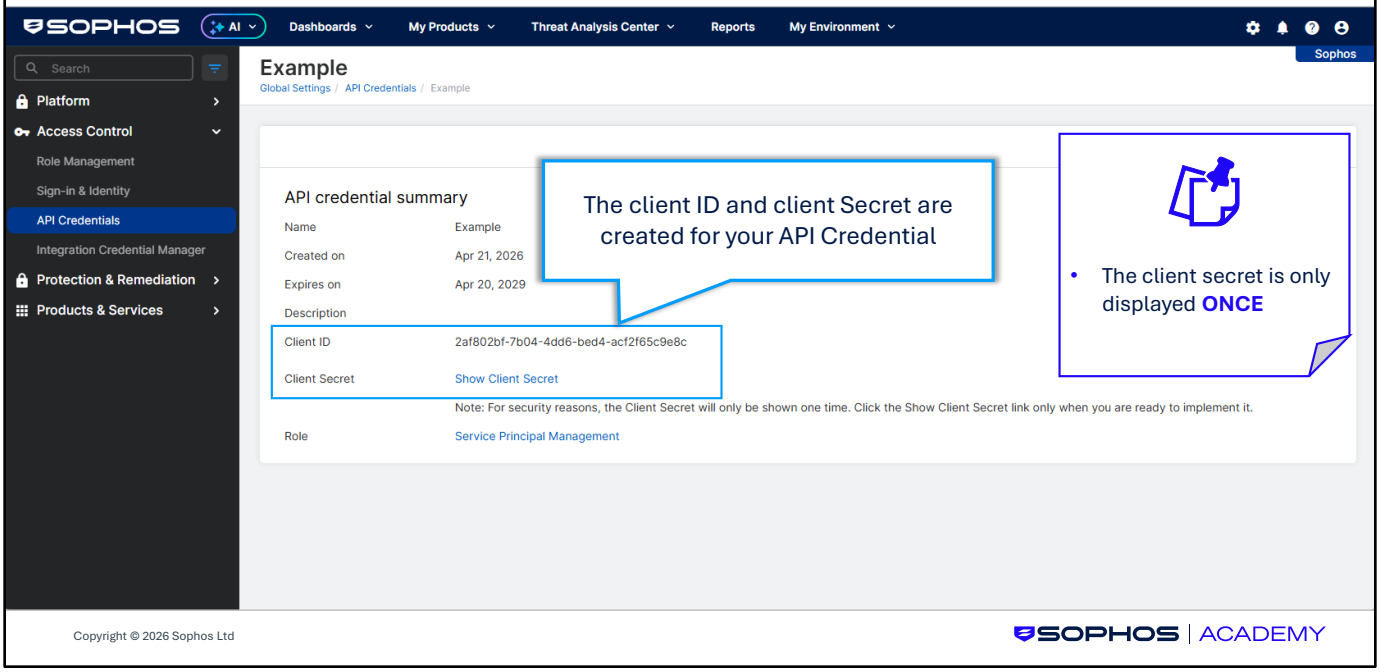
Creating API credentials is easy. Click Add credential and enter a name; optionally, you can add a description. From the drop-down menu, select the role you want to use. The role will determine the permissions the API credential is given.

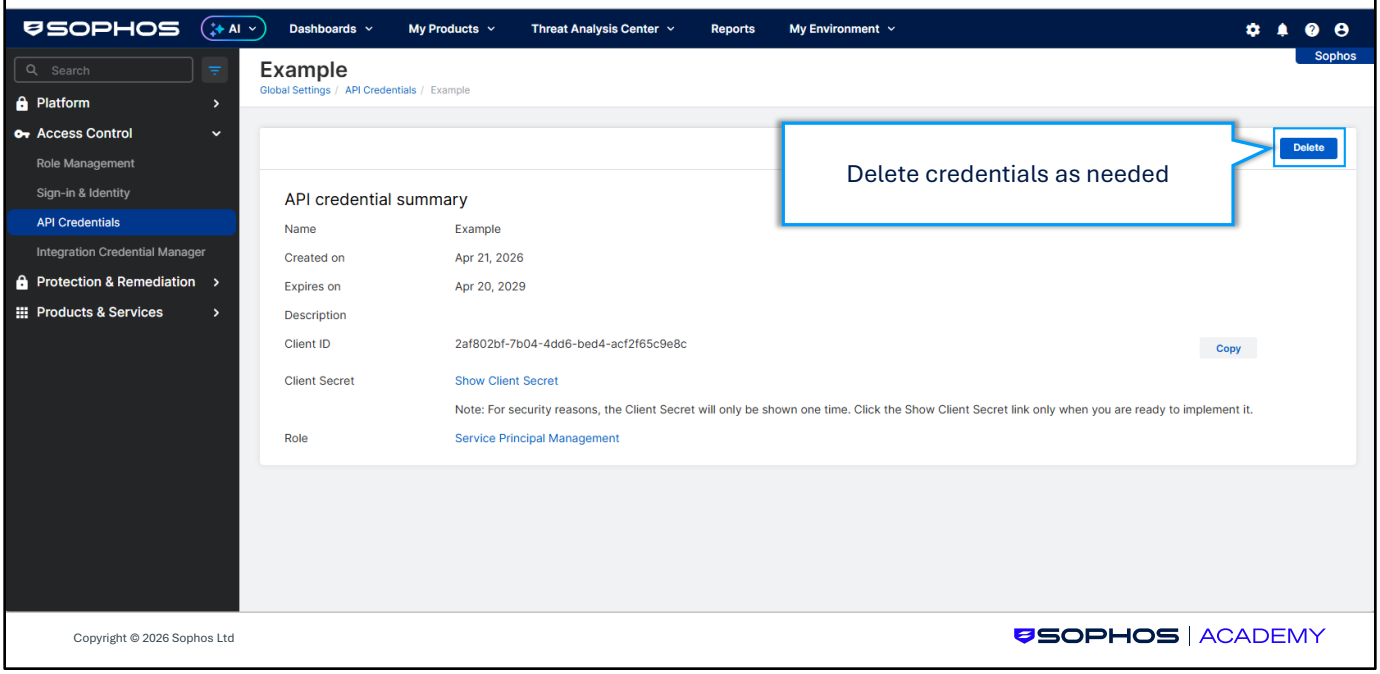
All credentials added are valid for 36 months.

API Credentials

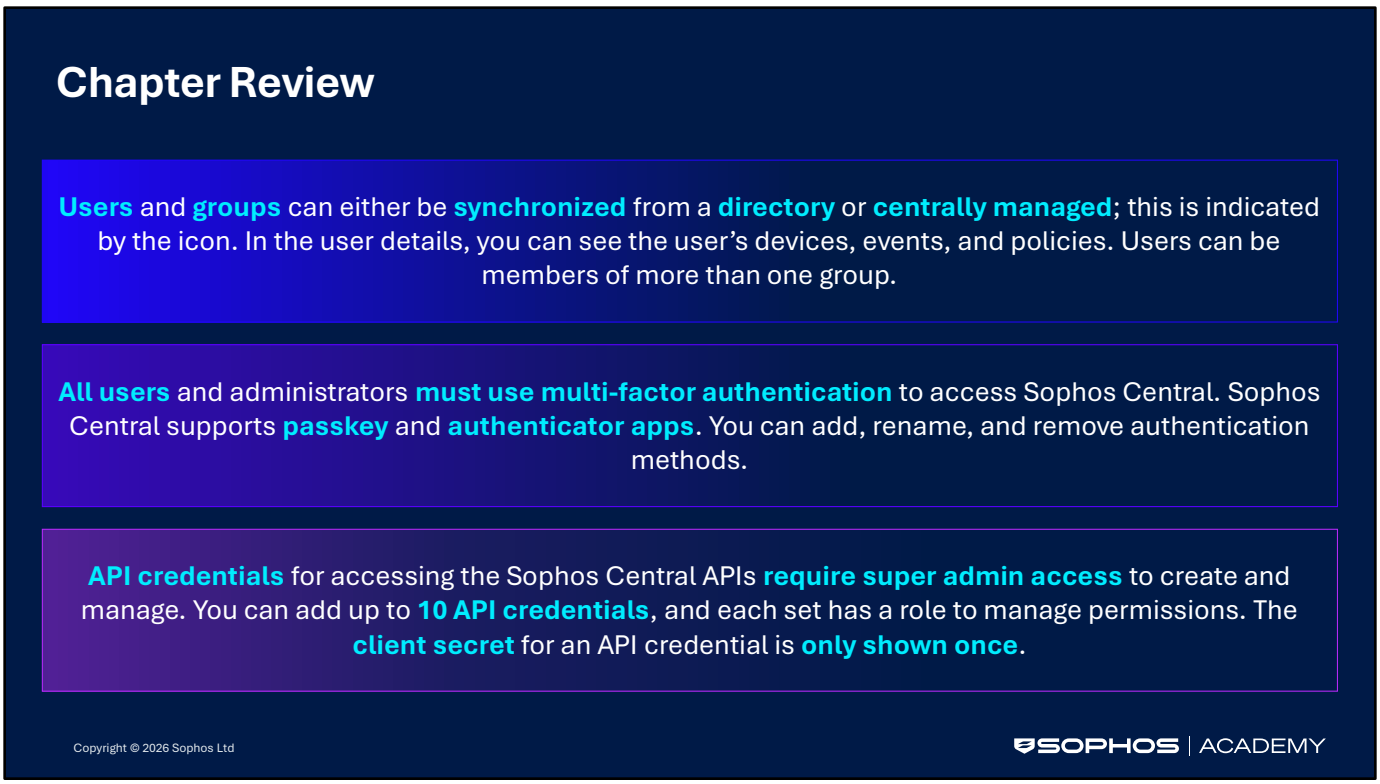


Once a new credential has been added, the Client ID is displayed. It's important to understand that once you click **Show Client Secret**, the secret will only be shown ONCE. Only select to show the secret when you're ready to use it.

API Credentials



To delete a credential, simply click **Delete** when viewing the credential record. This may be required if you must re-create an API credential to generate a new Client Secret.



Here are the three main things you learned in this chapter.

Users and groups can either be synchronized from a directory or Centrally Managed; this is indicated by the icon. In the user details, you can see the user's devices, events, and policies. Users can be members of more than one group.

All users and administrators must use multi-factor authentication to access Sophos Central. Sophos Central supports passkey and authenticator apps. You can add, rename, and remove authentication methods.

Credentials for accessing the Sophos Central APIs require super admin access to create and manage. You can add up to 10 API credentials, and each set has a role to manage permissions. The client secret for an API credential is only shown once.

[Additional Information]

Sophos Endpoint
EP1020: Getting Started with Directory Synchronization in Sophos Central

May 2026

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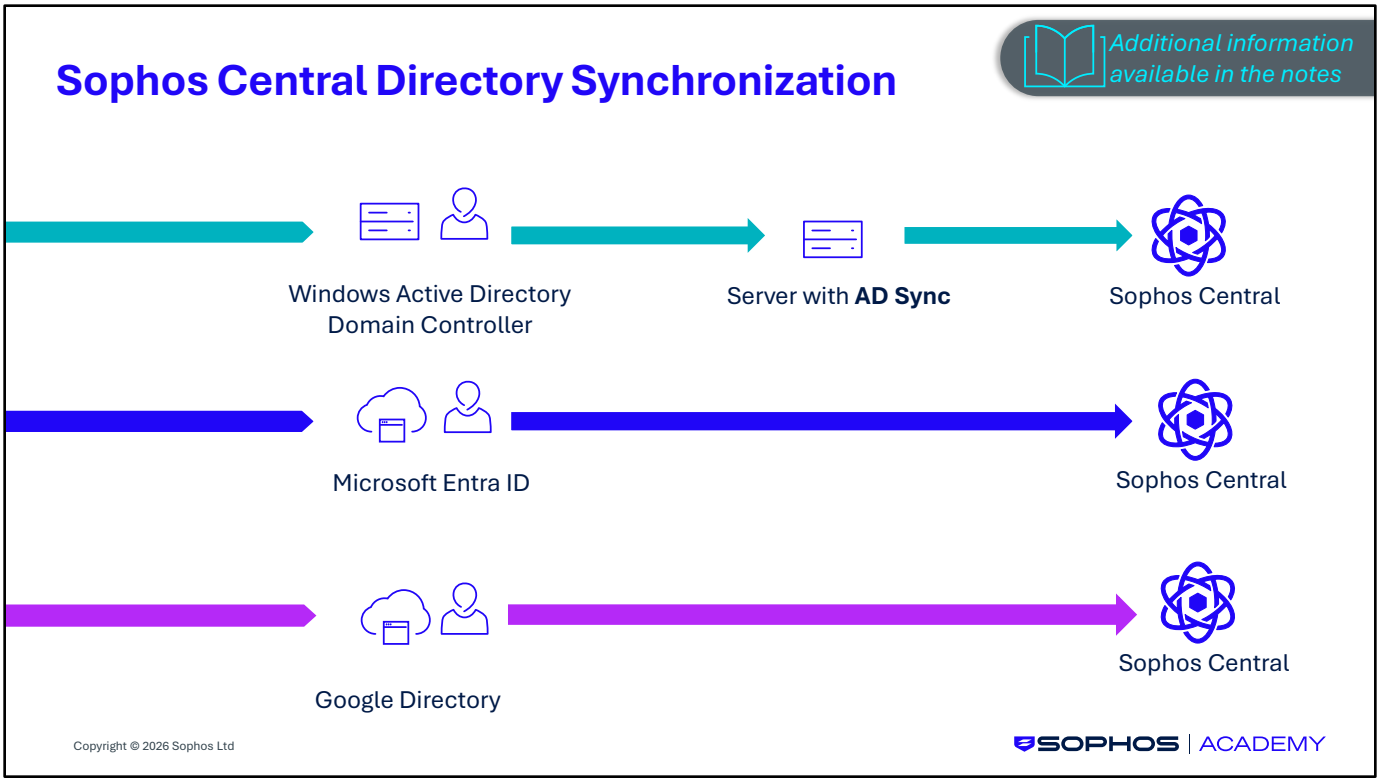
In this chapter, you'll learn how to get started using directory synchronization with Windows Active Directory and Microsoft Entra ID.



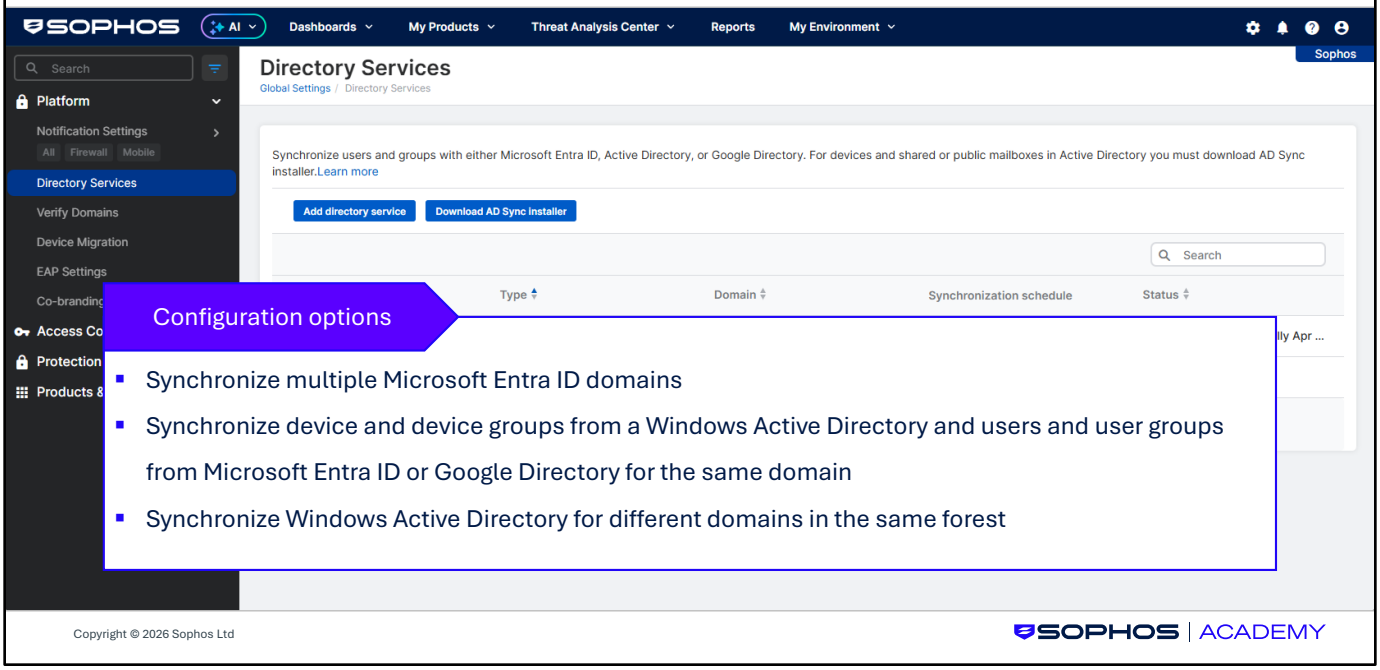
Sophos Central supports one-way synchronization of users and groups from Microsoft Windows Active Directory, Microsoft Entra ID, and Google Directory.

For Windows Active Directory synchronization, a small tool is installed on a server that can connect to the domain controller.

For Microsoft Entra ID and Google Directory synchronization, Sophos Central is the synchronization tool and will connect directly to Azure or Google to perform synchronization. Note that Google Directory synchronization is only available if your license includes Sophos Email.

[Additional Information]
Microsoft Entra ID is an updated name for Microsoft Azure AD.
Synchronization with Google Directory help documentation: [Directory service - Sophos Central Admin](https://doc.sophos.com/central/Customer/help/en-us/PeopleAndDevices/DirectoryService/SetUpSynchronizationWithGoogleDirectory/index.html)
https://doc.sophos.com/central/Customer/help/en-us/PeopleAndDevices/DirectoryService/SetUpSynchronizationWithGoogleDirectory/index.html

Directory Synchronization



You can synchronize users and groups from multiple sources as well as synchronize devices, device groups, public folders, and mailboxes from Active Directory.

You can synchronize multiple Microsoft Entra ID domains to Sophos Central, devices, and device groups from Windows Active Directory, and users and user groups from Microsoft Entra ID or Google Directory for the same domain. You can also synchronize Windows Active Directory for different domains in the same forest, selecting multiple child domains in a single forest.

Directory Synchronization

Restrictions

- x Synchronize users or email addresses to multiple Sophos Central admin accounts.
  - x Users and email addresses must be unique in each Sophos Central account
- x Synchronize multiple Active Directory sources for the same domain
- x Synchronize users using both Windows Active Directory and Microsoft Entra ID from the same domain
- x Synchronize from more than 25 sources

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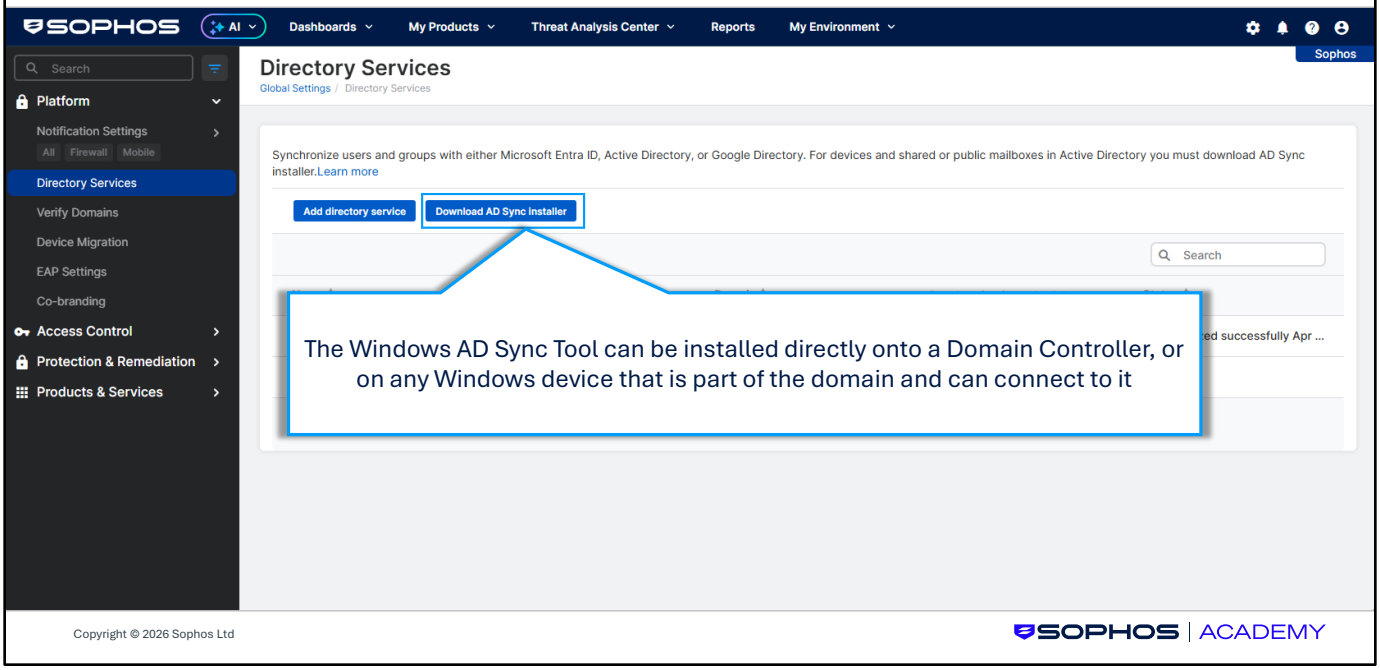
There are a few restrictions when synchronizing a directory. You're unable to synchronize users or email addresses to multiple Sophos Central admin accounts. Users and email addresses must be unique in each Sophos Central account. You can't synchronize multiple Active Directory sources for the same domain or synchronize users using both Windows Active Directory and Microsoft Entra ID from the same domain. It isn't possible to synchronize from more than 25 sources.

Windows Active Directory Synchronization

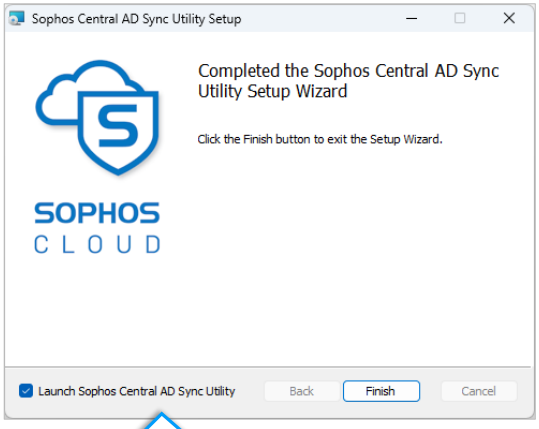


We will start by configuring Windows Active Directory synchronization. First, go to **Global Settings > Directory service** and select **Download AD Sync installer**.

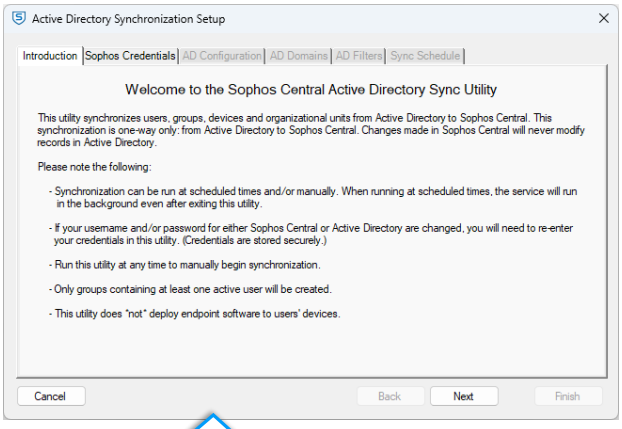
The AD Sync Utility uses a small background service installed on a Windows device in your organization's domain. This service performs regular one-way synchronization to pull selected users and groups from your Active Directory and uploads them to Sophos Central.

The AD Sync Utility can be installed on a Domain Controller or on any Windows device that is part of the domain and can connect to it.

Sophos Credentials



The installer will complete installation



The AD Sync Utility Tool is ready to configure

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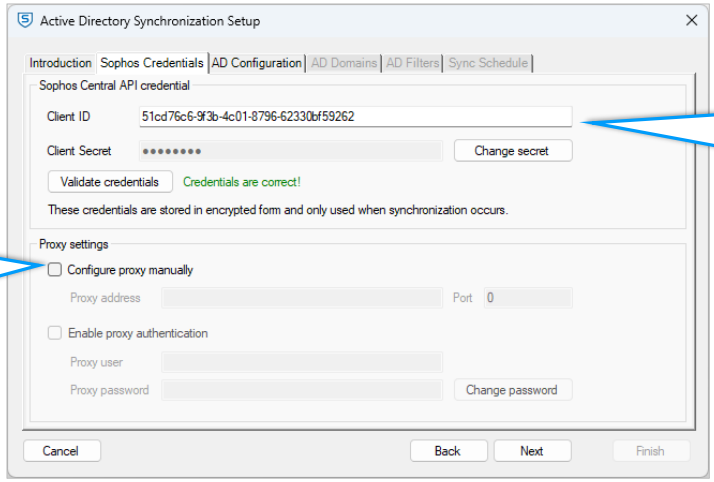
Once the installer has been downloaded, run, and installed, the Active Directory Sync Utility tool will run automatically, ready for configuration.

Sophos Credentials



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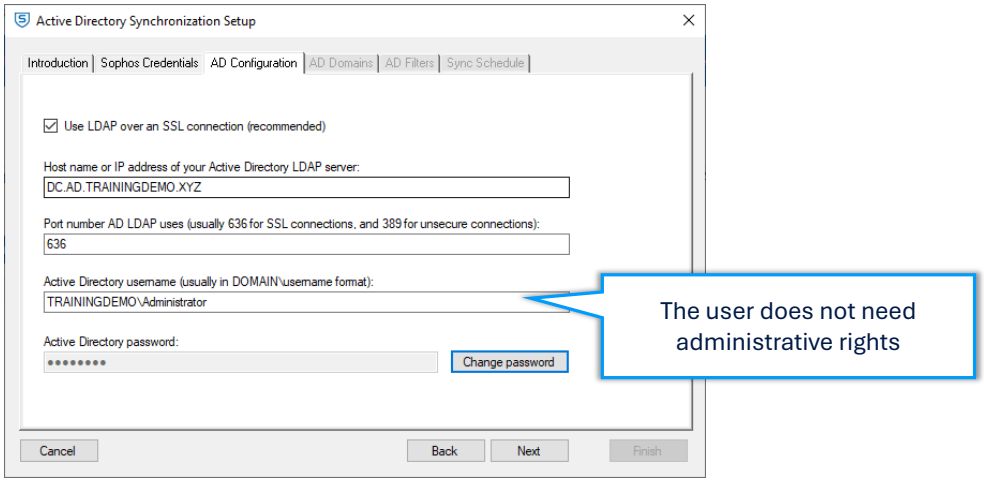
First, you must set up the connection to your Sophos Central account. This is done using API credentials with the ‘Service Principal Directory Sync’ role.

Optionally, you can also configure a proxy if this is required.

Active Directory Configuration



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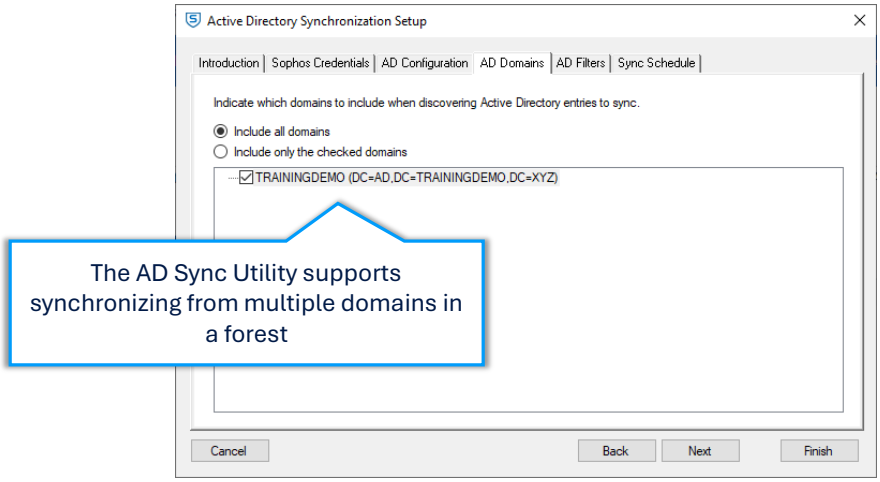
The next step is to configure the connection to your Active Directory. We strongly recommend using a secure LDAP connection to the Domain Controller.

You will need to provide the domain controller's hostname or IP address, the pre-populated port number (which can be edited), and user credentials.

The user does not need administrative rights; any domain user who can read the directory will be sufficient.

Active Directory Configuration



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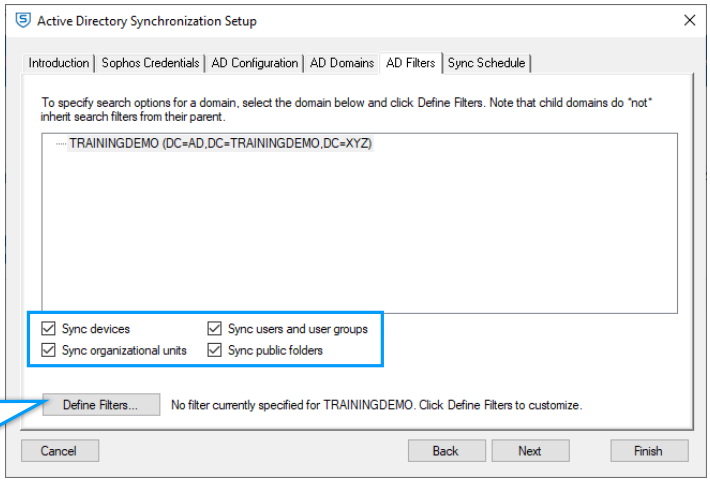
AD Sync Utility can gather and synchronize information from multiple domains within a forest; however, as you can only configure a single set of credentials, you can't synchronize from unrelated domains.

If you need to synchronize data from unrelated domains, you'll need to install the AD sync utility tool on a device in each domain.

Active Directory Configuration



Configure search bases and filters for users and groups

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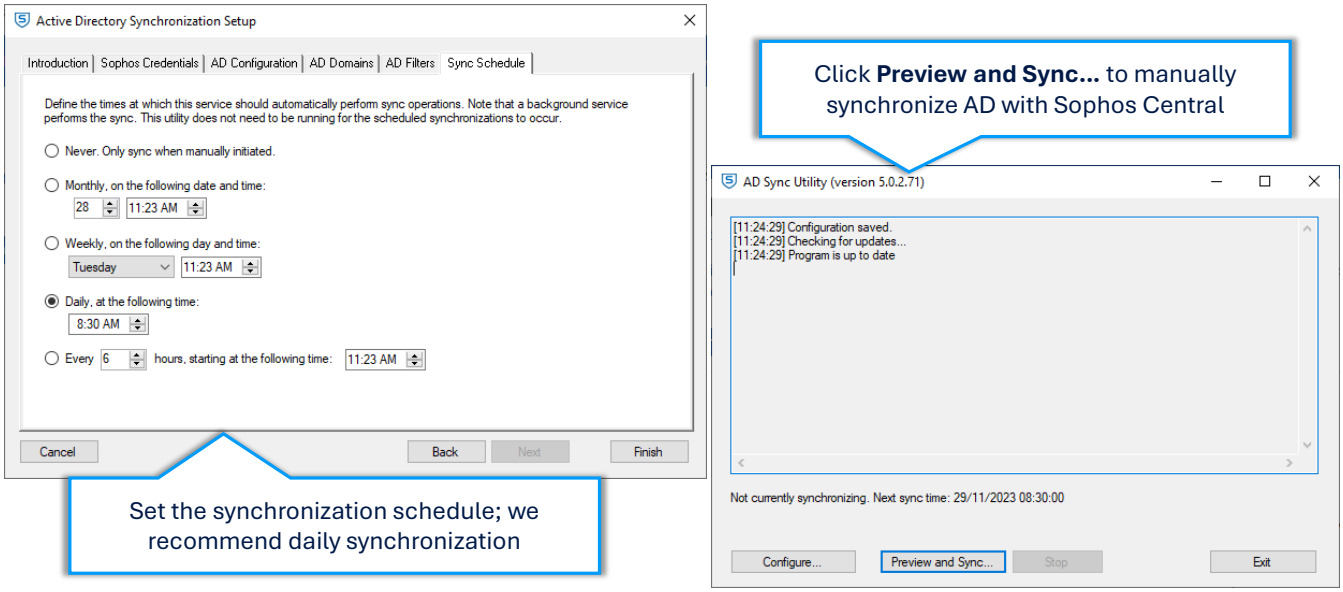
By default, the AD sync utility will search the entire domain and synchronize everything. However, you can control the types of objects that are synchronized using the four checkboxes highlighted here. The options are to sync devices, organizational units, users and groups, and public folders.

These can be managed by configuring search bases and filters for users and groups. This can be particularly useful if you're working with a large domain. To do this, click **Define Filters…**

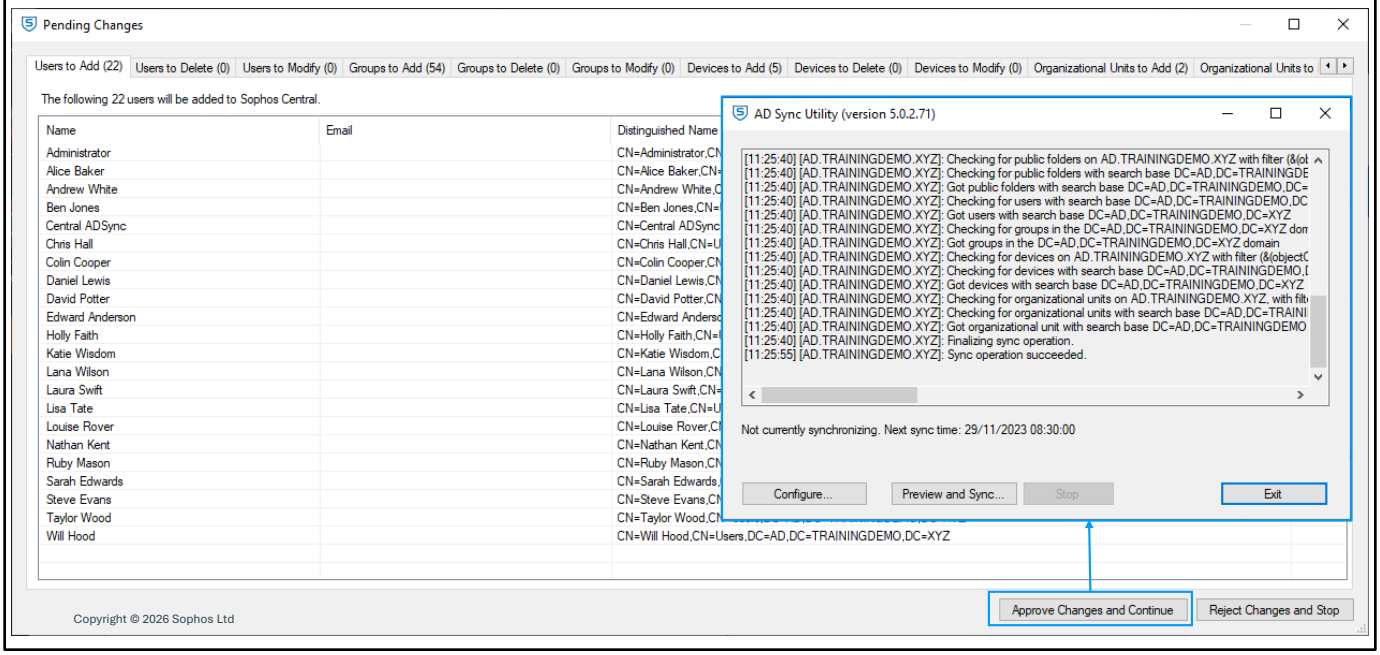
Active Directory Configuration



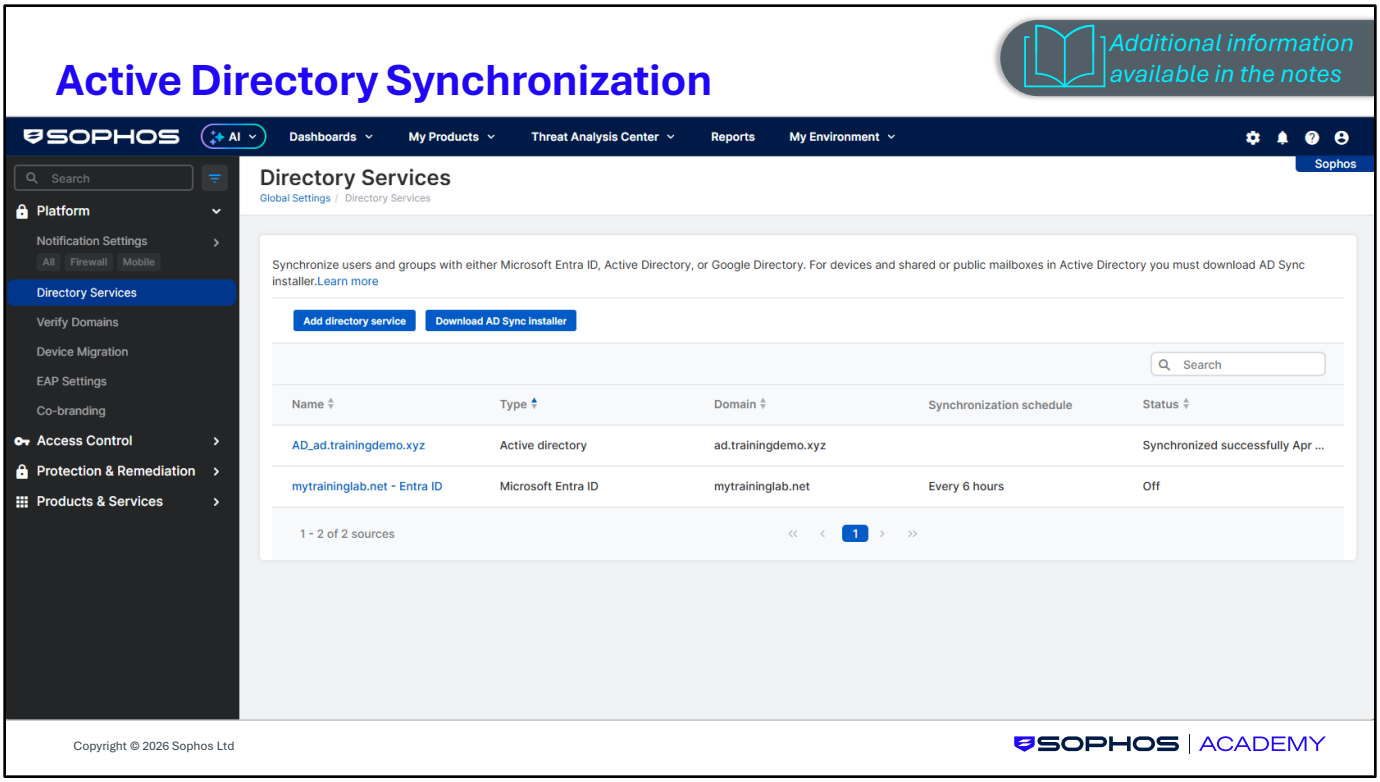
In most environments, Sophos recommends configuring the AD Sync Utility to synchronize daily; however, you may want to ensure that any filters and settings work as expected before enabling the schedule.

Once the configuration is complete, click **Preview and Sync**…

Active Directory Configuration



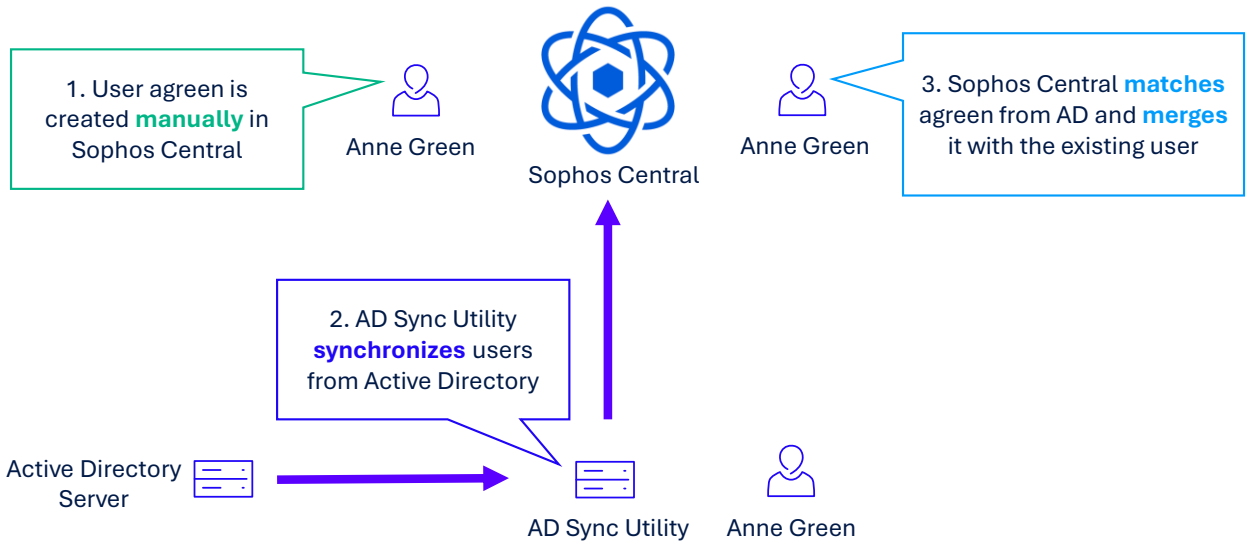
You can review all the changes before committing them. The tabs indicate how many users, groups, devices, and organizational units will be synchronized and split them into additions, deletions, and modifications. This allows you to confirm that your configuration is working as expected. Once you approve the changes, you can preview and synchronize the data with Sophos Central.



In Sophos Central, the directory will be listed with the synchronization status.

[Additional Information]
View the TechVids Sophos Central: Install and Set Up AD Sync Tool video here: [Sophos Central: Install and set up AD Sync tool - Sophos Techvids – Expert Tutorials & Cybersecurity Insights](https://techvids.sophos.com/watch/zr9WVXVikmoVuPaMX3ntFb)
https://techvids.sophos.com/watch/zr9WVXVikmoVuPaMX3ntFb

Merging Users



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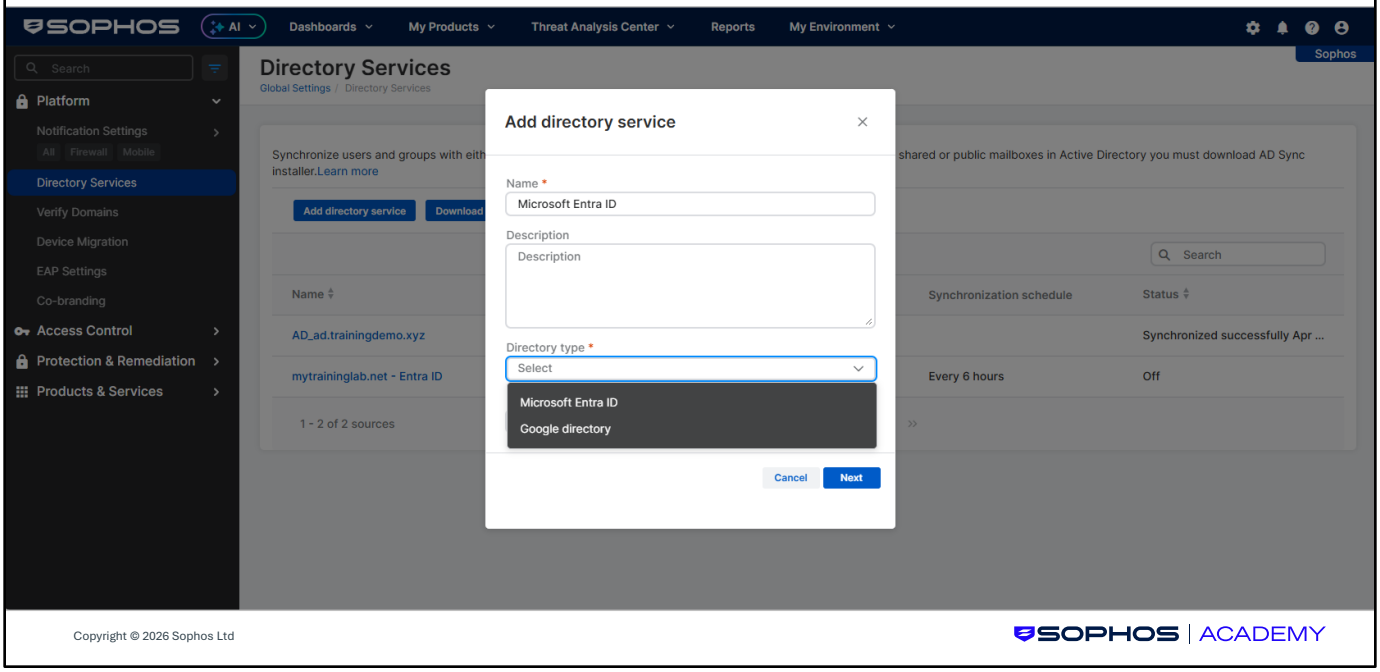
In some cases, the AD Sync Utility may be set up after some users have been created manually, for example, users created during an evaluation or pilot phase.

In this case, AD Sync Utility will merge new users from AD with existing users if their email addresses match. This will also apply to users created automatically when a domain name and logon name of the user match.

For example, the user Anne Green in Sophos Central is merged with the user Anne Green from Active Directory.

Microsoft Entra ID Synchronization



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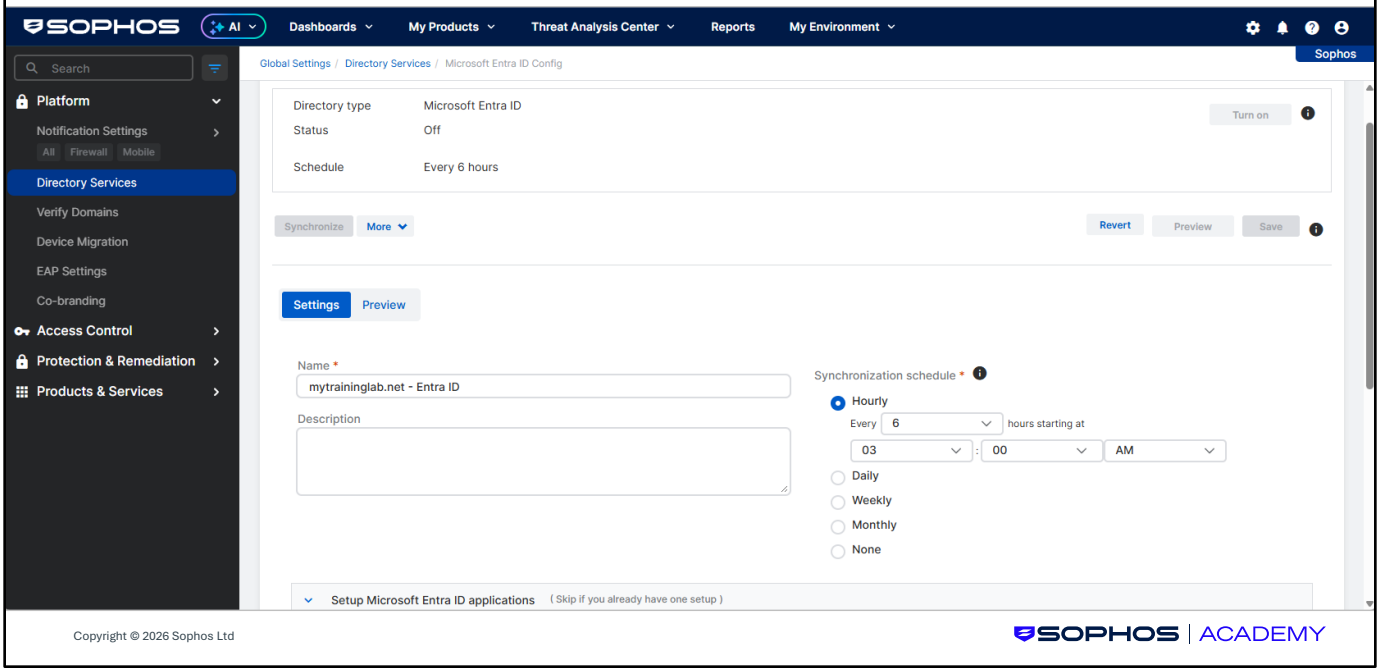
Let's look at getting started with Microsoft Entra ID synchronization with Sophos Central.

From the 'Directory service' page, select **Add directory service**. Enter the name of the service and select the 'directory type' from the drop-down menu. You must enter the domain you're going to synchronize.

Microsoft Entra ID Synchronization



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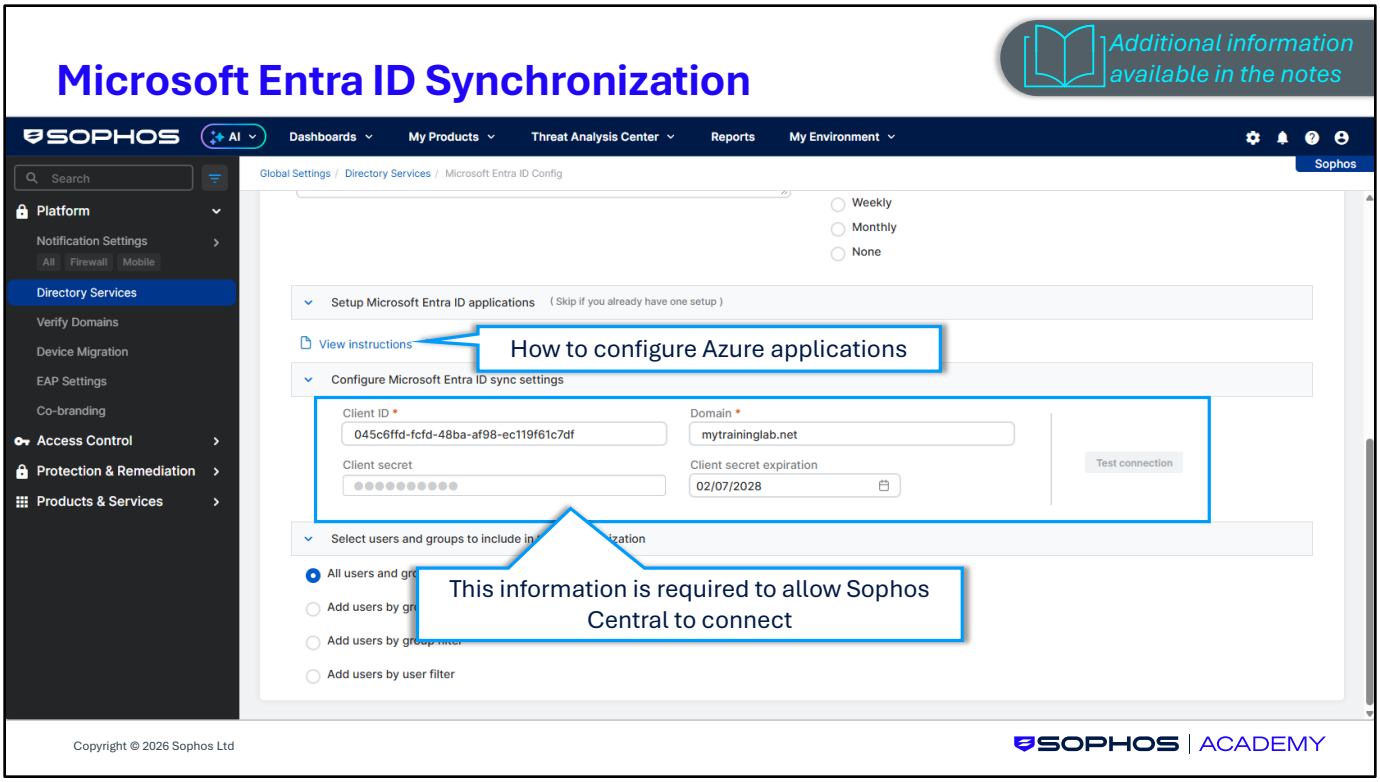
Once you have entered the details, you will see the synchronization schedule allowing you to determine how often the directory will be synchronized with Sophos Central.

Microsoft Entra ID Synchronization



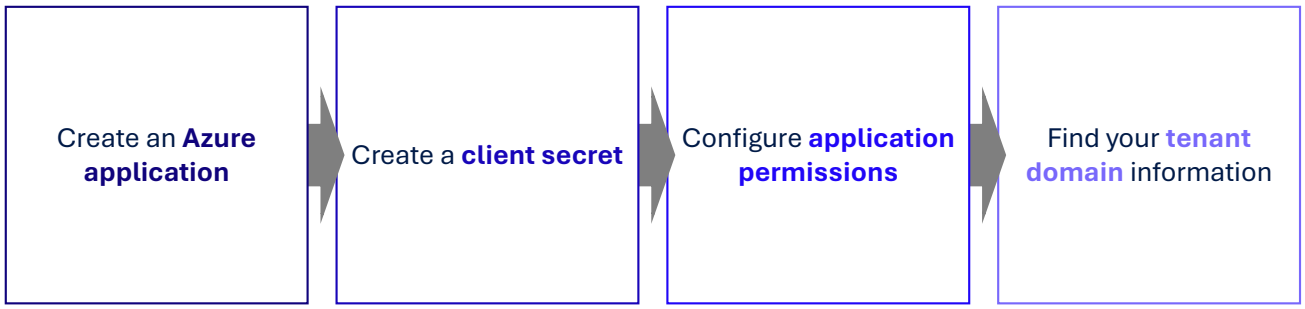
In the configuration section, you can view instructions on how to configure an app in Azure so that Sophos Central can connect to your Microsoft Entra ID. We will cover these steps shortly.

Once you have configured the directory, you will need four pieces of information. These are required to allow Sophos Central to connect: the Client ID, client secret, tenant domain, and client secret expiration date.

[Additional Information]

Directory service - Sophos Central Admin
https://docs.sophos.com/central/Customer/help/en-us/PeopleAndDevices/DirectoryService/SetUpSynchronizationWithAzureAD/AddAzureApplication/index.html

Azure Application Setup



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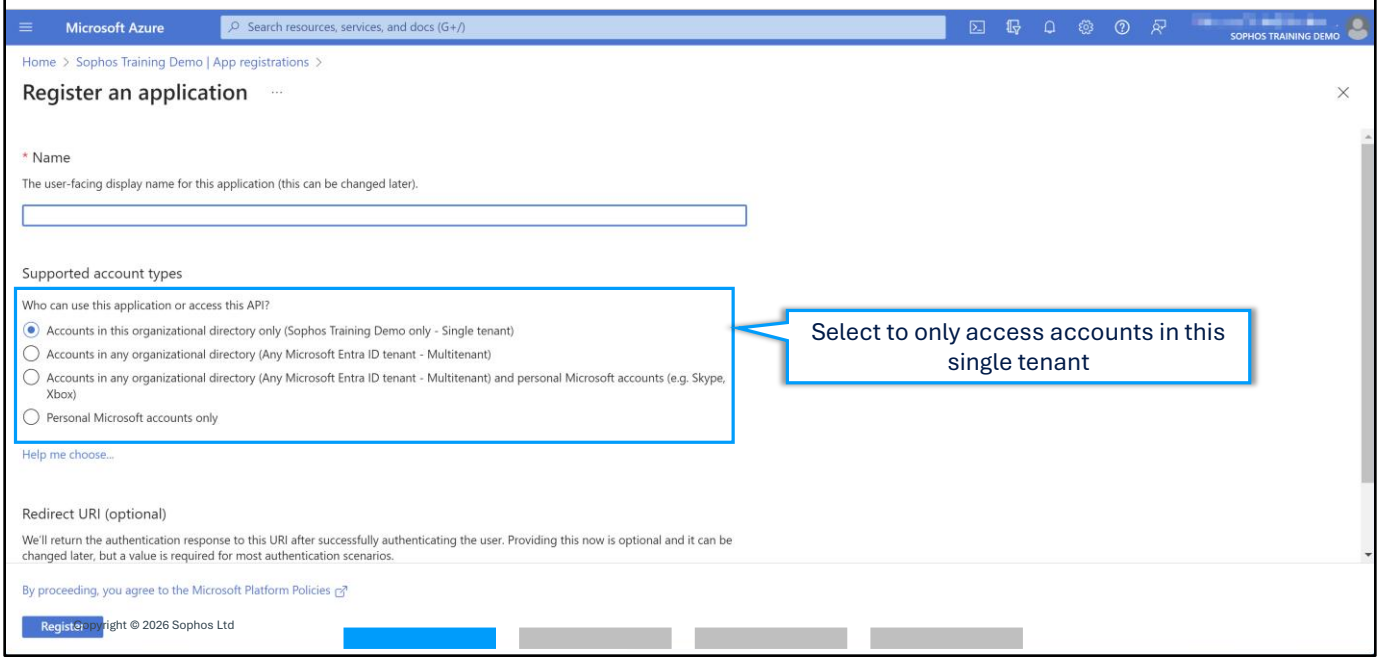
Azure directory configuration is completed in four steps: first, create an Azure application; second, create a client secret; third, configure application permissions; and lastly, locate your tenant domain information.

All these steps take place on Microsoft Entra ID.

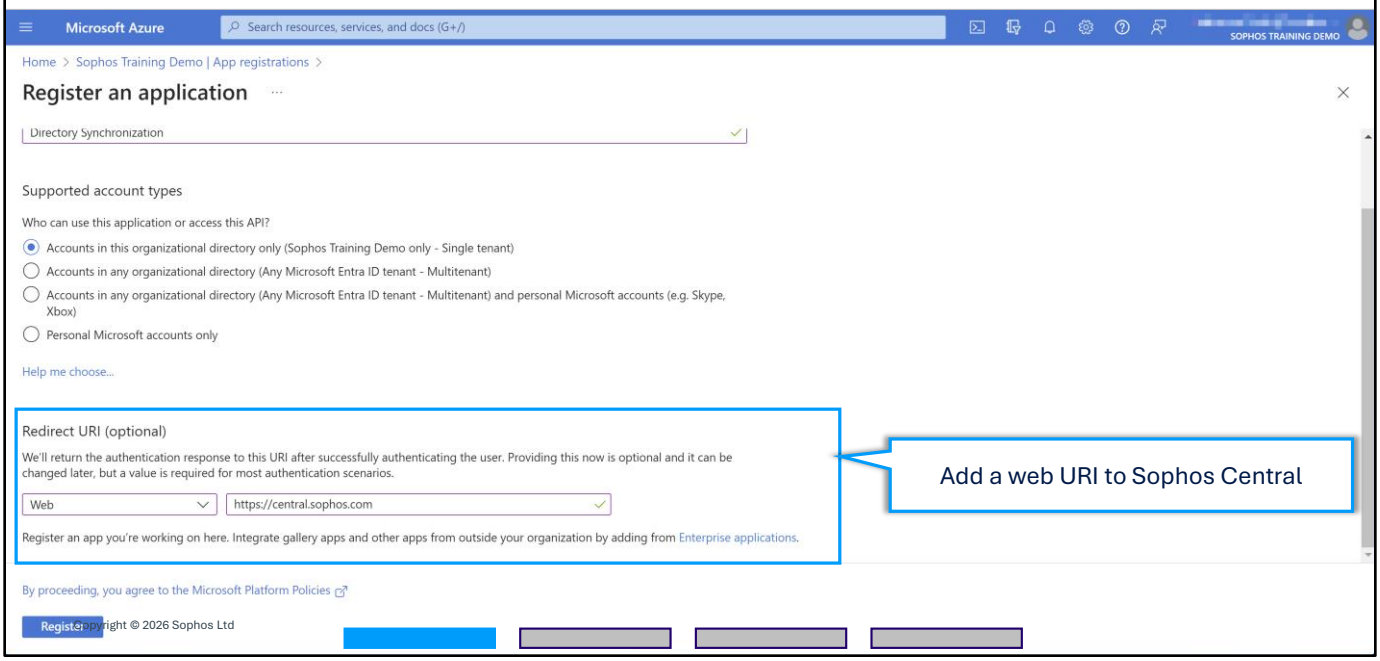
Create an Azure Application



The first step is to create or register an application in Microsoft Entra ID. To do this, select **App registrations** > **New registration**.

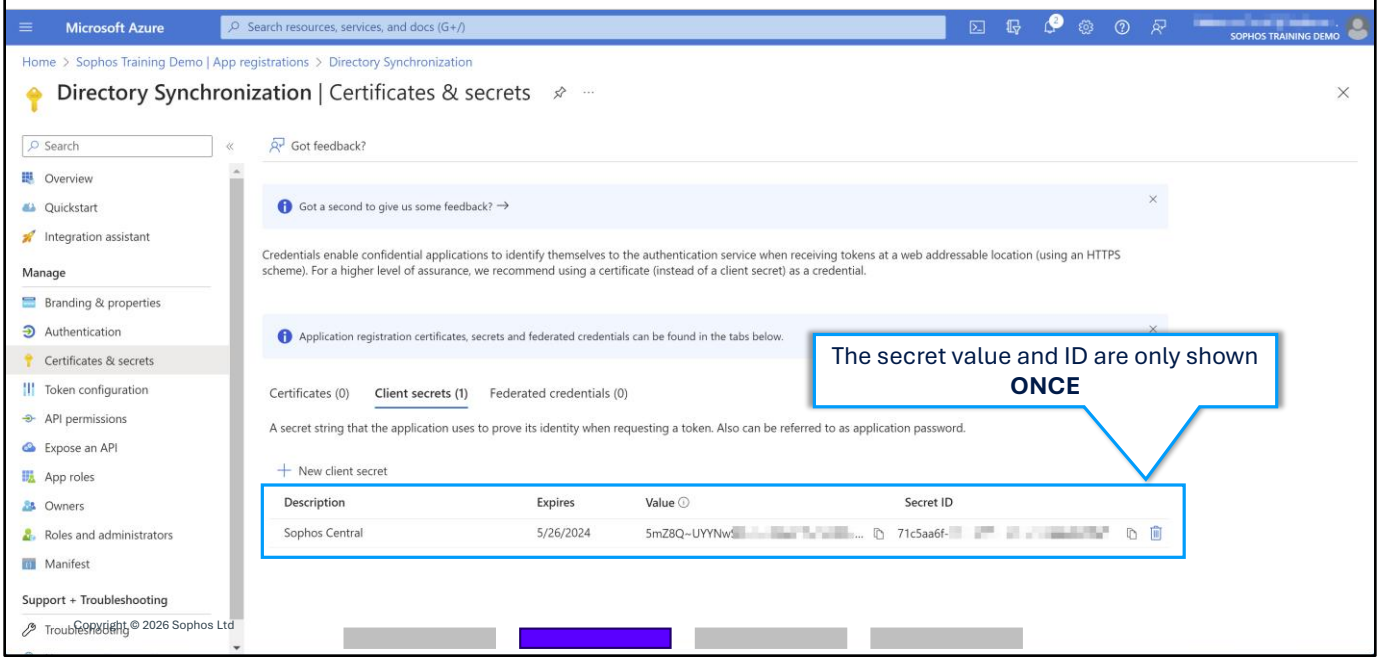
Configure the account types as **Accounts in this organization directory only**.

Create an Azure Application



In the 'Redirect URI' section, add a **Web** URI for **https://central.sophos.com**. You can now register the new application.

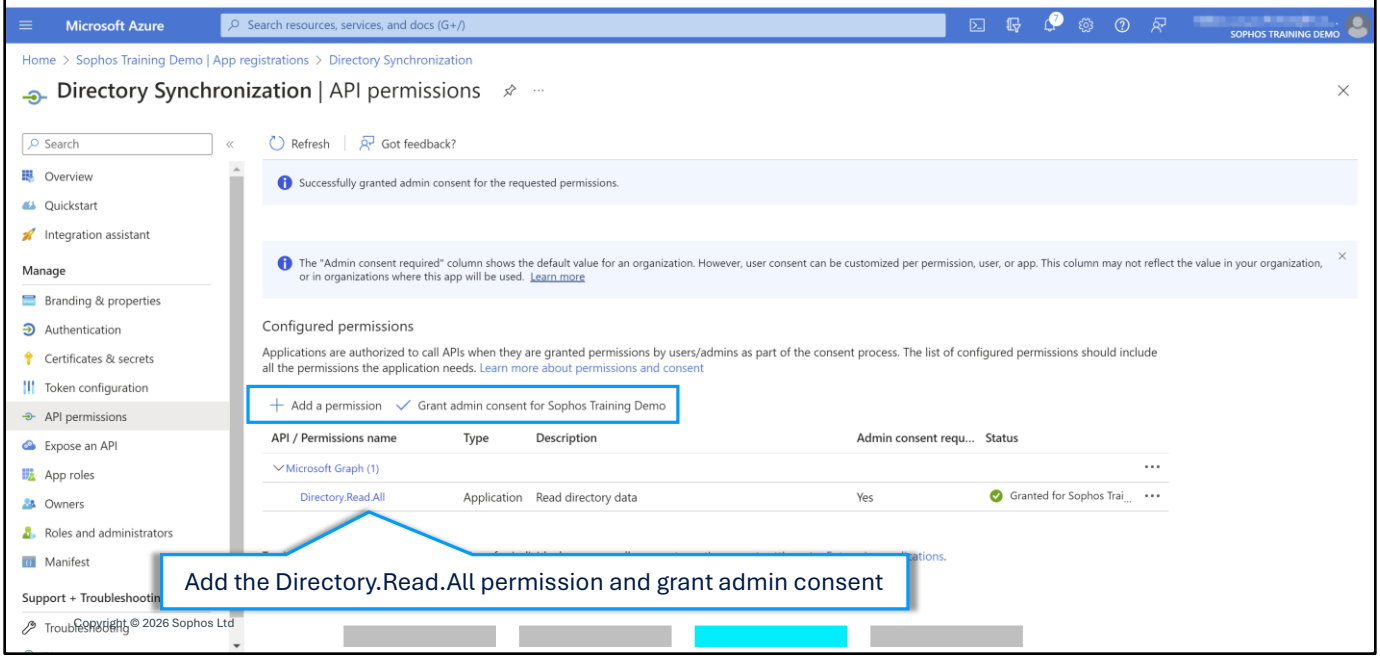
Create a Client Secret



In the app registration you created, select **Certificates & secrets**, then click **New client secret**. Select the length of time the secret will be valid, and click **Add**.

You need the secret's value and expiry date. Note these and keep them safe. The secret value is only shown once when you create it and cannot be shown again.

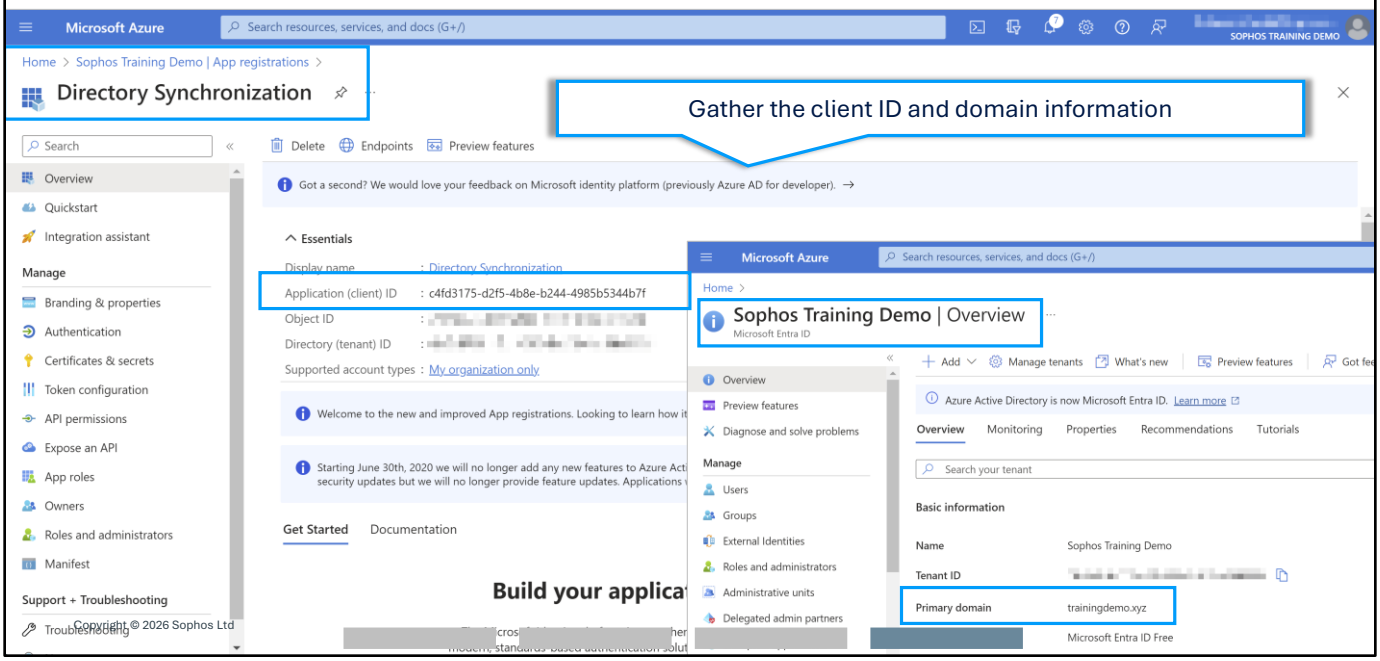
Configure Application Permissions



You then need to configure the permissions for your app registration. Select **API permissions** in the left-hand menu.

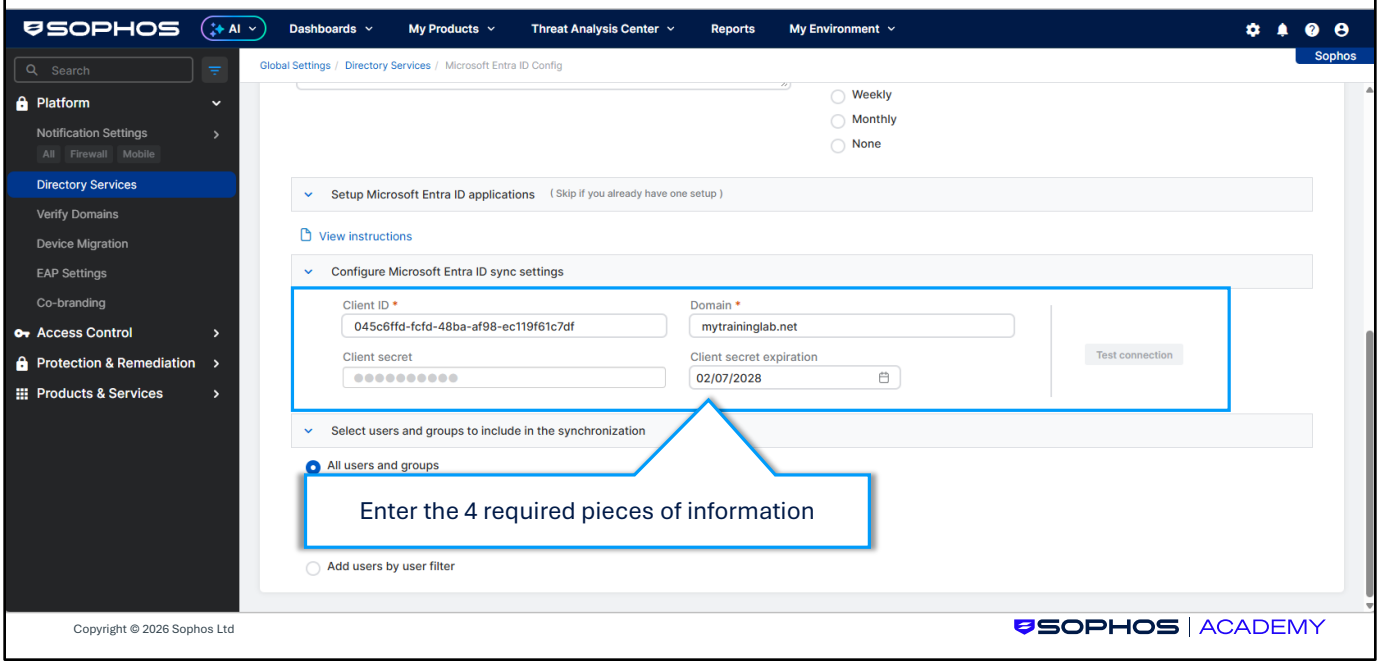
You'll see a default permission here; this can be removed. You need to add the **Application** permission for **Microsoft Graph > Directory.Read.All**, then click **Grant admin consent for your Microsoft Entra AD**.

Find Your Tenant Domain Information



Finally, you need to locate two more pieces of information: the ‘Client ID’ of your app registration and the primary domain, which can be found on the overview page of your Entra ID.

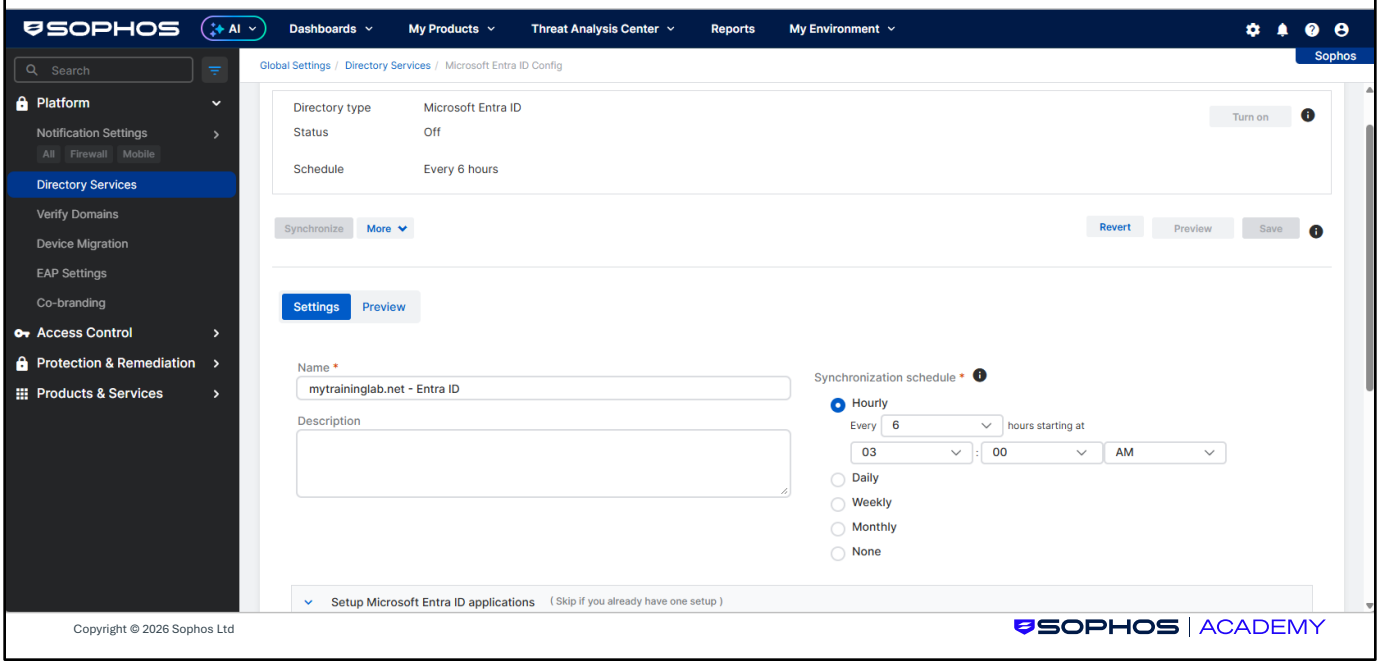
Microsoft Entra ID Synchronization



Using the information gathered, you can configure the directory synchronization in Sophos Central. In the client secret field, ensure that you enter the client secret value, not the client secret ID. Enter the required details, then click **Test Connection** to validate the details entered.

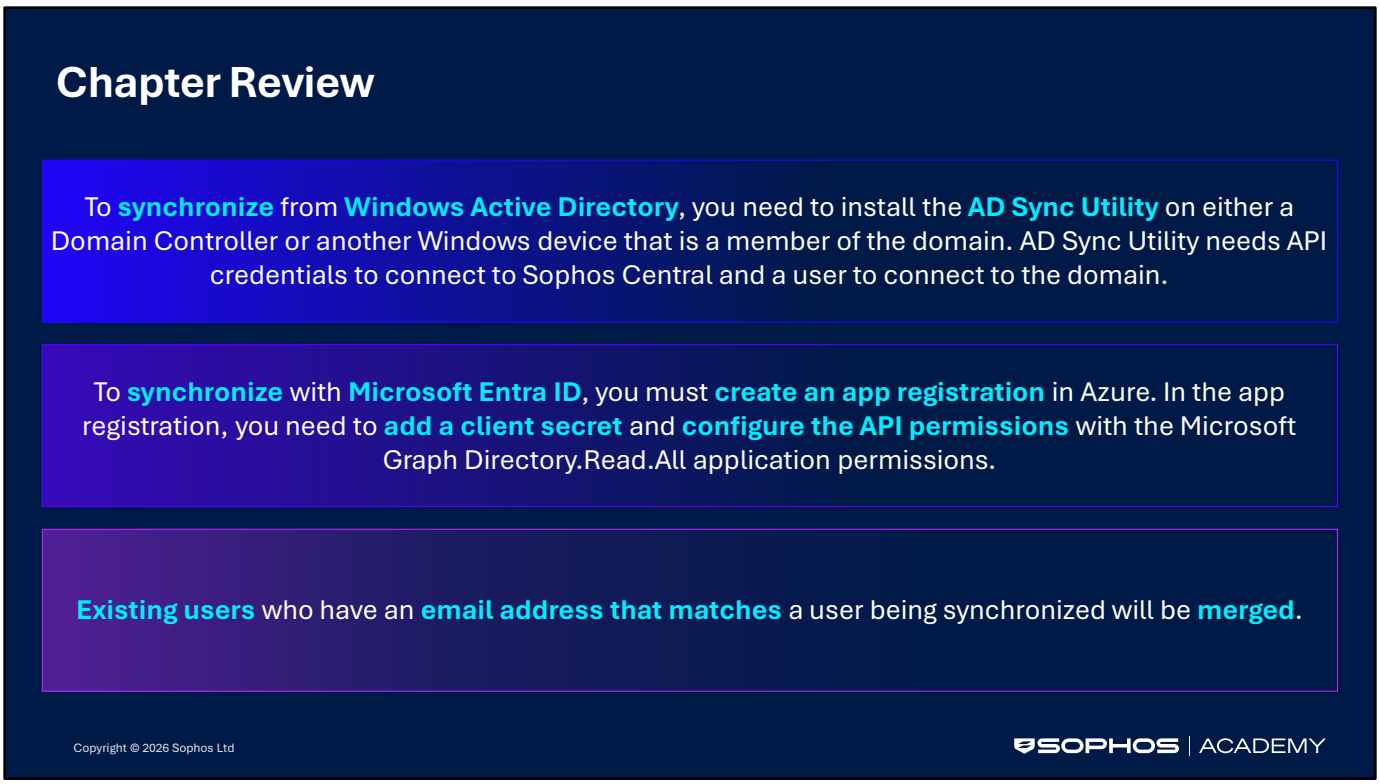
You can optionally filter the users and groups that will be synchronized.

Microsoft Entra ID Synchronization



To finish, click **Turn On** at the top of the page to save and turn on the source. You can select **Save,** which will save the configuration changes but not apply them.

Once synchronization has been turned on, you can manually synchronize users or test the connection.



Here are the three main things you learned in this chapter.

To synchronize from Windows Active Directory, you need to install the AD Sync Utility on either a domain controller or another Windows device that is a member of the domain. AD Sync Utility needs API credentials to connect to Sophos Central and a user to connect to the domain.

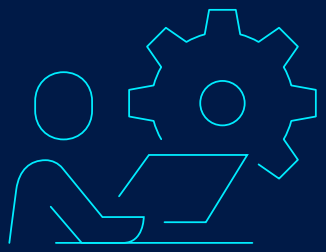
To synchronize with Microsoft Entra ID, you must create an app registration in Azure. In the app registration, you need to add a client secret and configure the API permissions with the Microsoft Graph Directory.Read.All application permissions.

Existing users who have an email address that matches a user being synchronized will be merged.

Lab Tasks

Complete the lab tasks for **User Management**

- **Task 1**: Manually add users
- **Task 2**: Install and Configure AD Sync
- **Task 3**: Configure Role-Based Access



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Complete the lab tasks for this module.

The lab task information can be found in the Lab Workbook which is available in the **Lesson Resources.**

Sophos Endpoint Agent Deployment

SOPHOS | ACADEMY

[Additional Information]

Sophos Endpoint
EP1505: Getting Started with Sophos Endpoint Agent Deployment

May 2026

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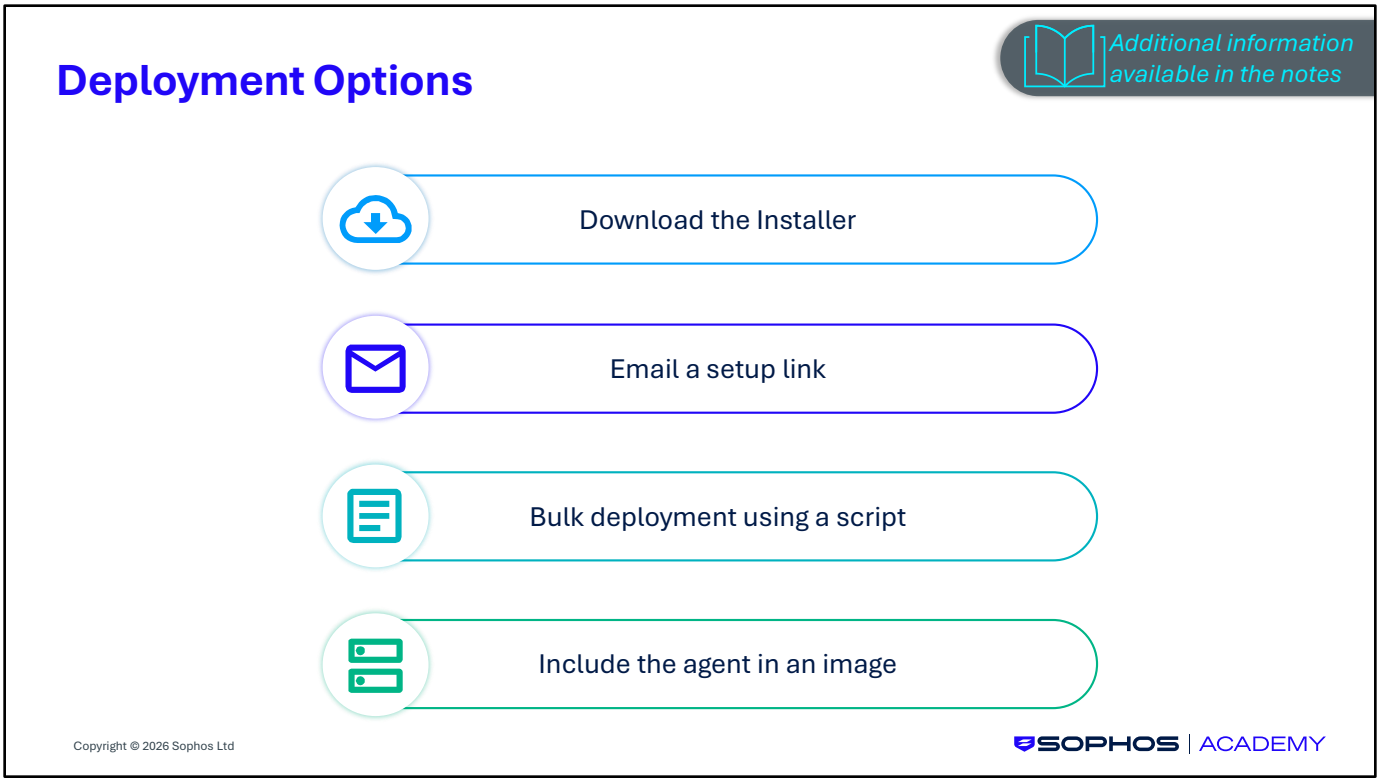
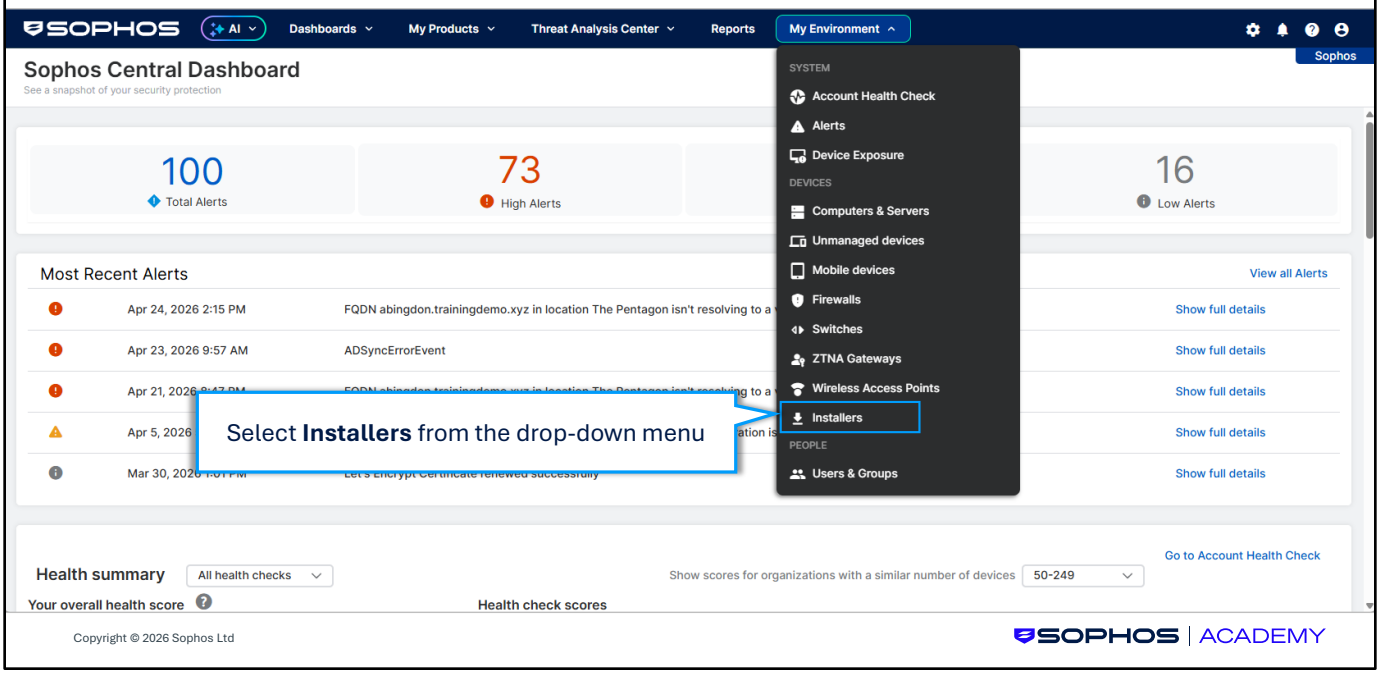
In this chapter, you'll learn how to install the Sophos Central Endpoint agent on Windows and macOS.



There are four ways to deploy the Sophos Endpoint Agent: downloading the installer directly from Sophos Central to the device, emailing the setup link to the device owner, using a script to deploy the agent to multiple devices, and including the Sophos Endpoint Agent in an image.

[Additional Information]
For more information about software deployment methods, see knowledge base article **KB-000034831**. Sophos Endpoint and Server: Installation methods
https://support.sophos.com/support/s/article/KB-000034831

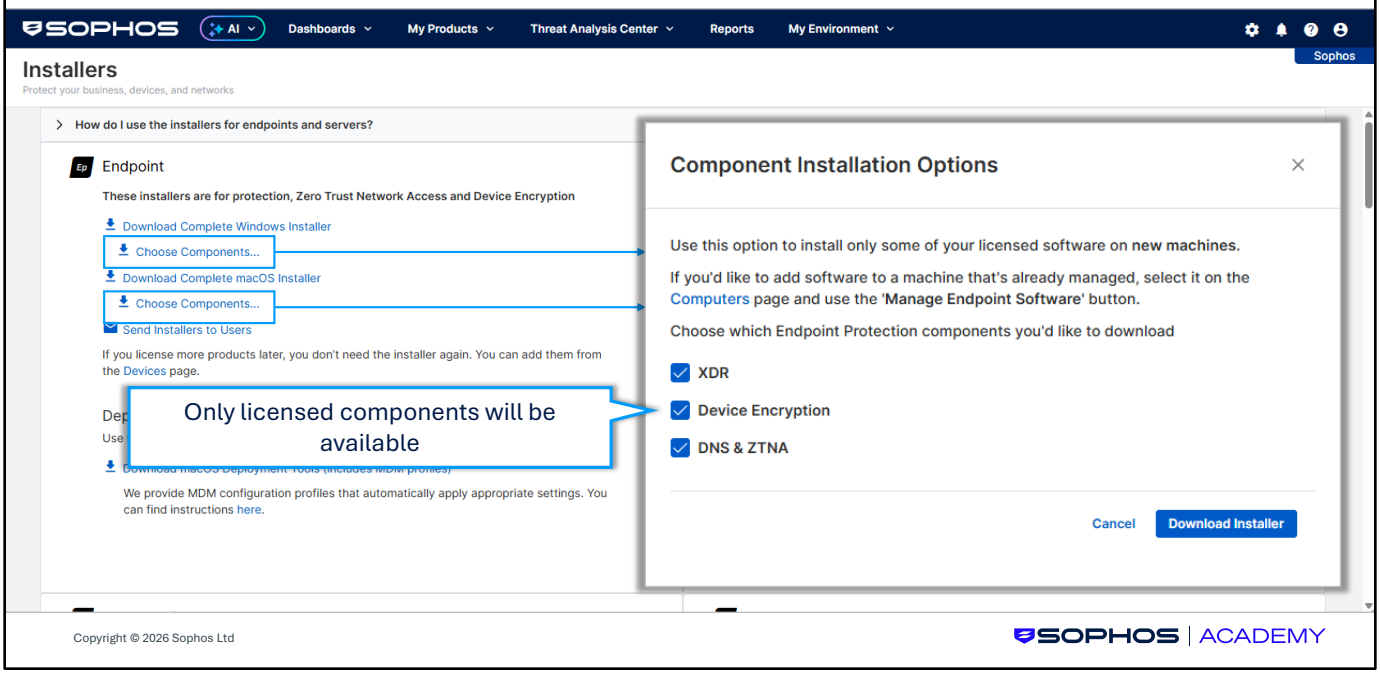
Download the Installer



To download the installer from Sophos Central, select **My Environment** in the top menu and then select **Installers**.

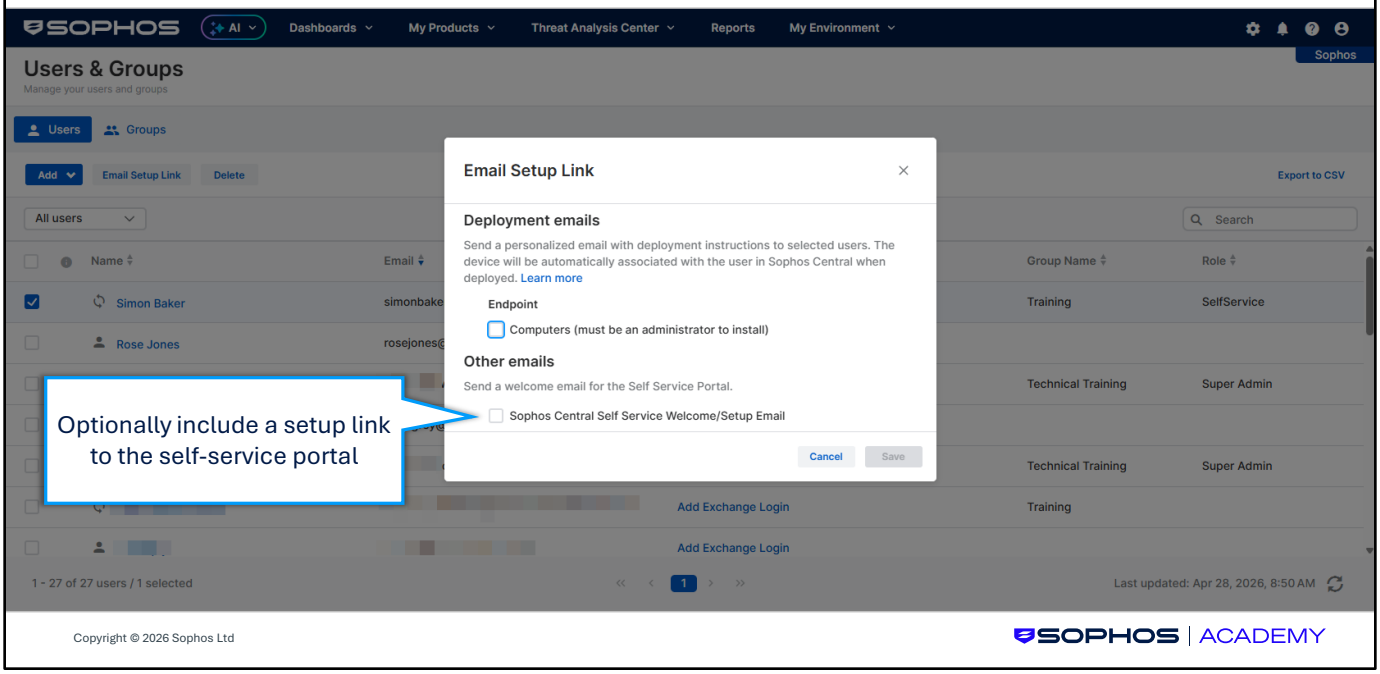
For Endpoint, Server, and Encryption products, the installer menu is also available when you select the product from the **My Products** menu. When the installer is run, it detects what operating system it's being installed on. The appropriate packages are then installed based on the device type.

Sophos Endpoint Agent Download



For Endpoint installers, the complete installer can be downloaded, or specific components can be selected for Windows and macOS devices. Note that you can only select the components you're licensed for.

Sophos Endpoint Agent Email Setup Link

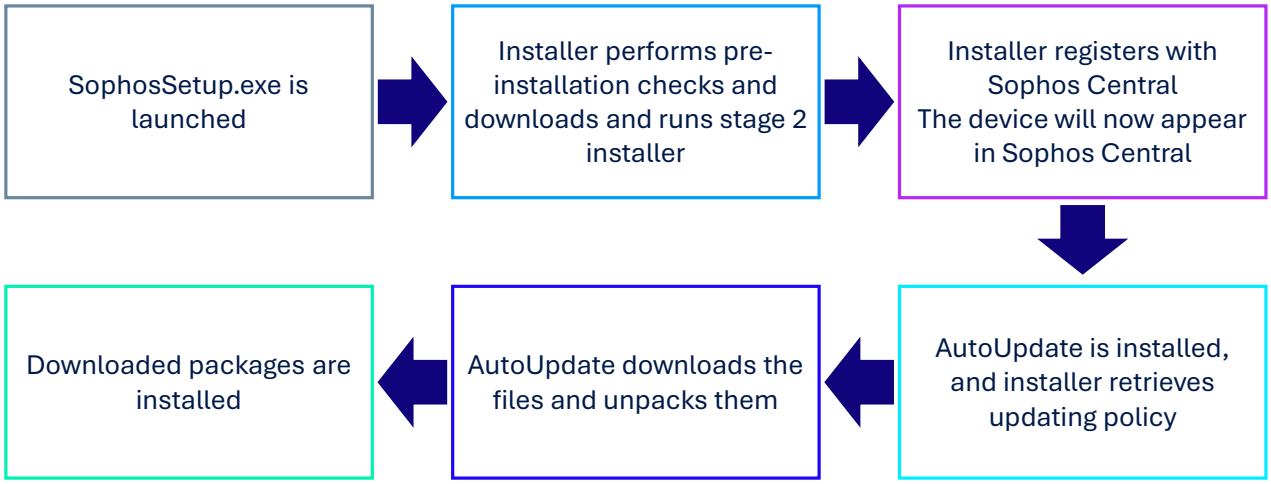


If your users have local administrator rights, they can install protection on their own devices using a link emailed to them. To send an installation link, navigate to **Users & Groups.** Select the users you want to send the link to, and then click 'Email Setup Link'.

You can choose which setup links to send to a user. You can select to send an installation link for deploying the Sophos Endpoint Agent and a setup link for the self-service portal. The self-service portal allows users to manage their devices, view their quarantined emails, read emails using an emergency inbox, and get recovery passwords for device encryption.

When emailing an installation link to users, you can't select individual components; all licensed components will be included.

Windows Installation Process



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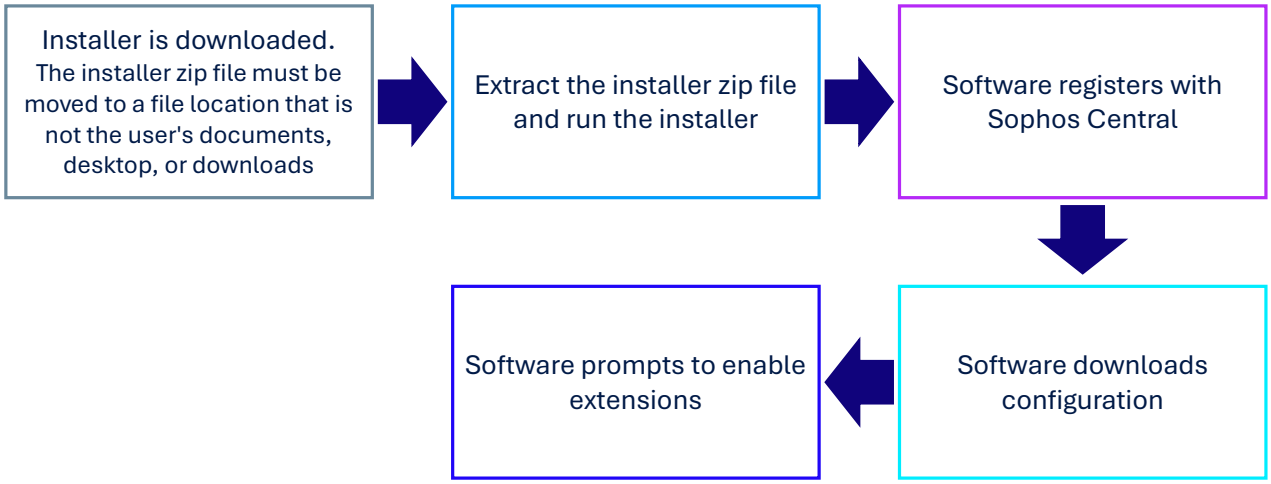
Manual installation on Windows is very simple, but let's consider what steps the installer is taking in the background.

1. Installation starts when SophosSetup.exe is launched.
2. The installer performs pre-installation checks and downloads and runs a second-stage installer.
3. The second-stage installer takes over the installation process and registers with Sophos Central.
4. AutoUpdate is installed, and the installer retrieves the updating policy, which includes the details required to download.
5. AutoUpdate downloads the files and unpacks them.
6. The downloaded packages are installed.

macOS Installation Process



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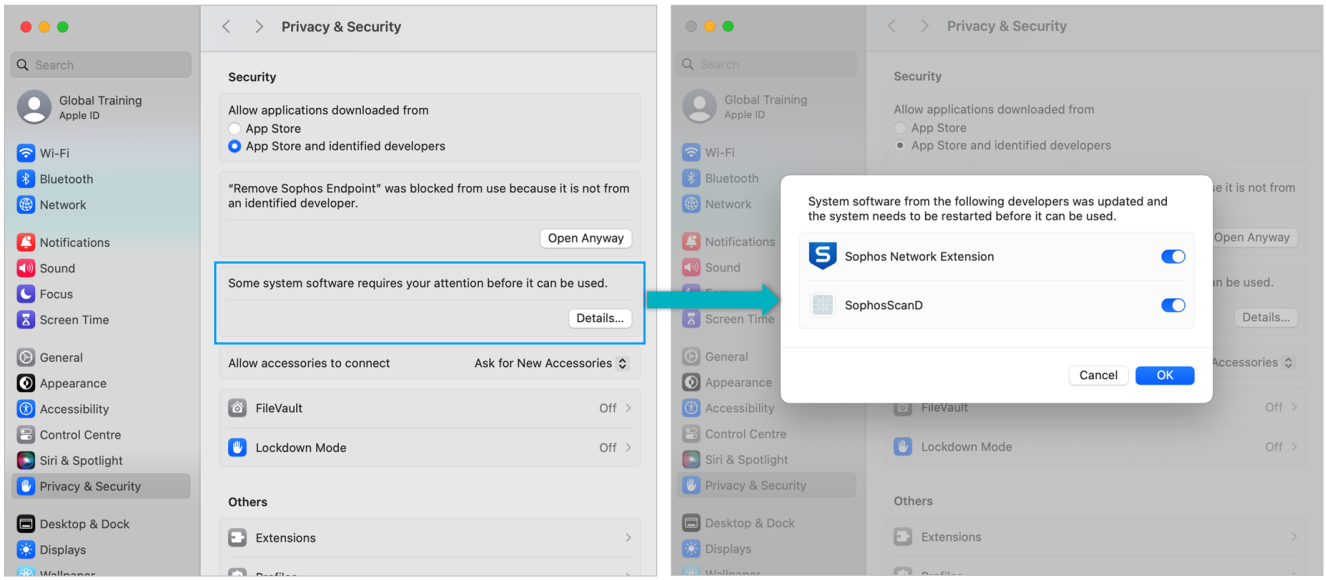
The macOS installer works in a very similar way to Windows but does things in a different order.

1. Start by downloading the installer. The installer zip file must be moved to a file location that is not the user's documents, desktop, or downloads folder.
2. Extract the installer zip file and run the installer.
3. The Endpoint agent registers with Sophos Central so it can be managed.
4. The Endpoint agent downloads the configuration.
5. At the end of the installation, the software will prompt you to enable the extensions required for Sophos to provide protection. This is done in 'System Preferences'.

macOS Installation Process



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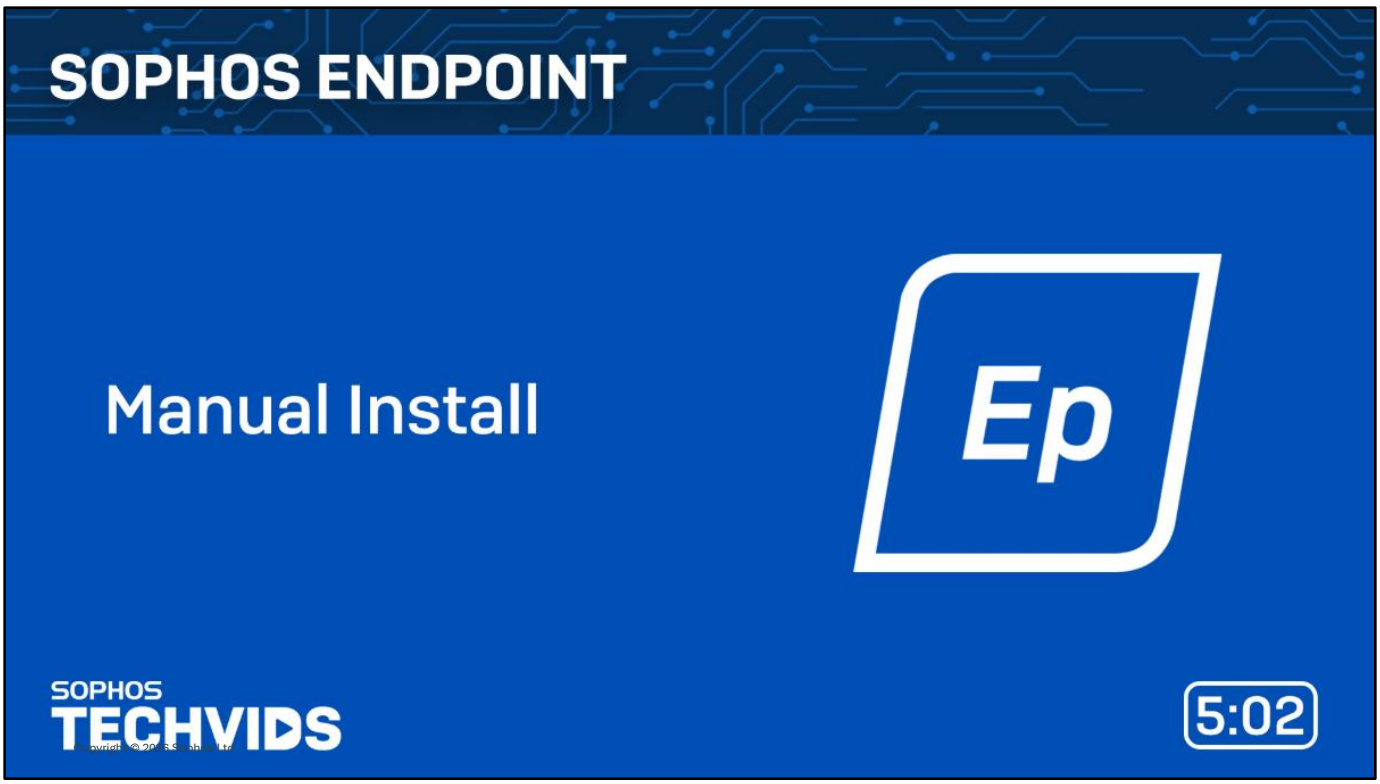
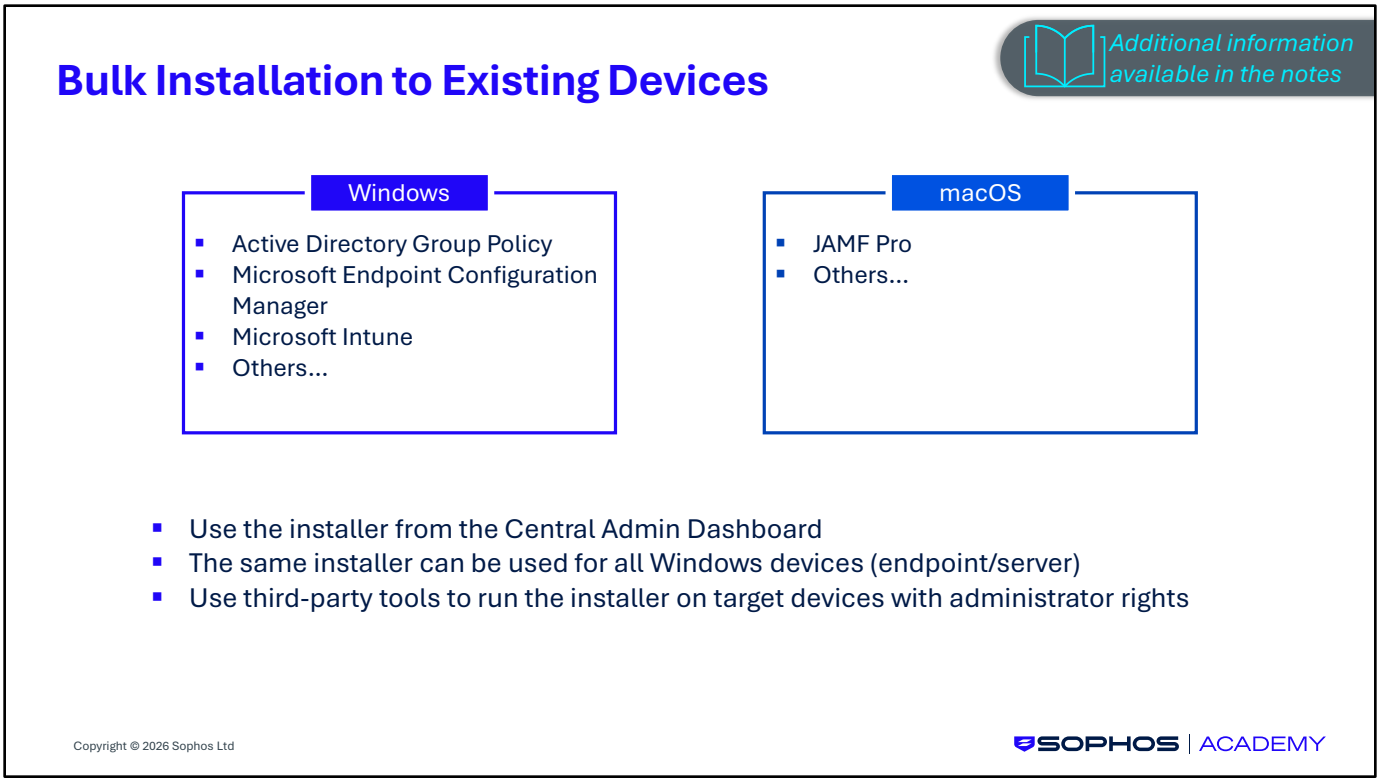
When prompted to enable extensions, open **Security Preferences** and select **Privacy and Security.** Click **Details…** You will need to enter the password for the device to make any changes. Ensure both extensions are enabled and click **OK**.

Let's look at an example of an endpoint install on both Windows and macOS.



[Additional Information]
This tutorial shows you how to manually install Sophos Endpoint on Windows and Mac devices.

Sophos Endpoint Manual Install: [Sophos Endpoint: Manual Install - Sophos Techvids – Expert Tutorials & Cybersecurity Insights]
https://techvids.sophos.com/watch/CL5M5TAtaiWiZTSH7cStov



If you need to install the Sophos Endpoint Agent on multiple devices, you can create a script that will automatically install it. You can either use Active Directory scripts in your Group Policy, or alternatively, you can choose to use an RMM tool. For example, Microsoft Endpoint Configuration Manager can be used to distribute and install the Sophos Endpoint Agent.

It is important to note that bulk deployments should **NOT** be created using an installer sent using the email setup link. If this installer is used, all devices will be associated with the Sophos Central account that sent the email.

[Additional Information]
The steps required to force devices to re-register with Sophos Central can be found in knowledge base article **KB-000035040**.
Sophos Endpoint: Automate the software deployment to Windows devices
https://support.sophos.com/support/s/article/KB-000035049

Including Sophos Central in a 'Gold' Image

Additional information available in the notes

- Device **identity** is **set** during **install**
- **Multiple images** of the same device will **try to use the same identity**

To resolve this...

Install using **`--goldimage`** to detect name change and register a new identity

Install then remove the identity causing it to register on the next boot

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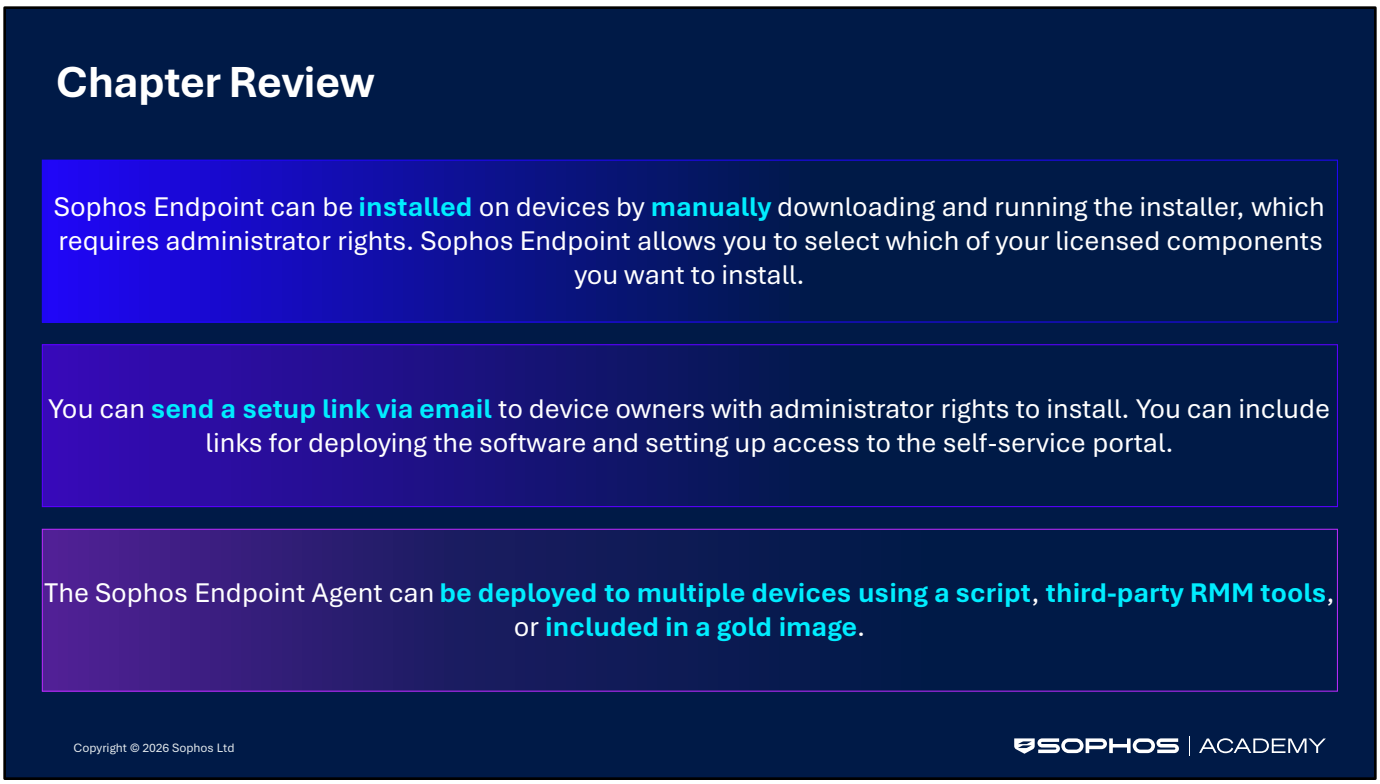
For organizations using virtual machines, it's common to create a gold image and run multiple instances of that image. During the installation of the Sophos Endpoint Agent, the device identity is set. This is used by Sophos Central to identify individual devices. If you run multiple images using the same identity, all devices will report to Sophos Central as the same device. To prevent this issue, new images created from the gold image must register for a new identity. There are a couple of ways this can be done.

For Windows, you can run the install with the --goldimage option. When the device name changes when a new instance is created from the image, the Sophos Endpoint Agent will register for a new identity. You can remove the identity, which causes the Sophos Endpoint Agent to register for a new identity when it next starts.

[Additional Information]
Removing identity from Windows to create a gold image **KB-000035040**: Sophos Endpoint: Avoid duplicate identities when installing on a gold image
https://support.sophos.com/support/s/article/KB-000035040



Here are the three main things you learned in this chapter.

Sophos Endpoint can be installed on devices by manually downloading and running the installer, which requires administrator rights. Sophos Endpoint allows you to select which of your licensed components you want to install.

You can send a setup link via email to device owners with administrator rights to install. You can include links for deploying the software and setting up access to the self-service portal.

The Sophos Endpoint Agent can be deployed to multiple devices using a script, third-party RMM tools, or included in a gold image.

[Additional Information]

Sophos Endpoint
EP1512: Getting Started with Sophos Endpoint for Linux

May 2026

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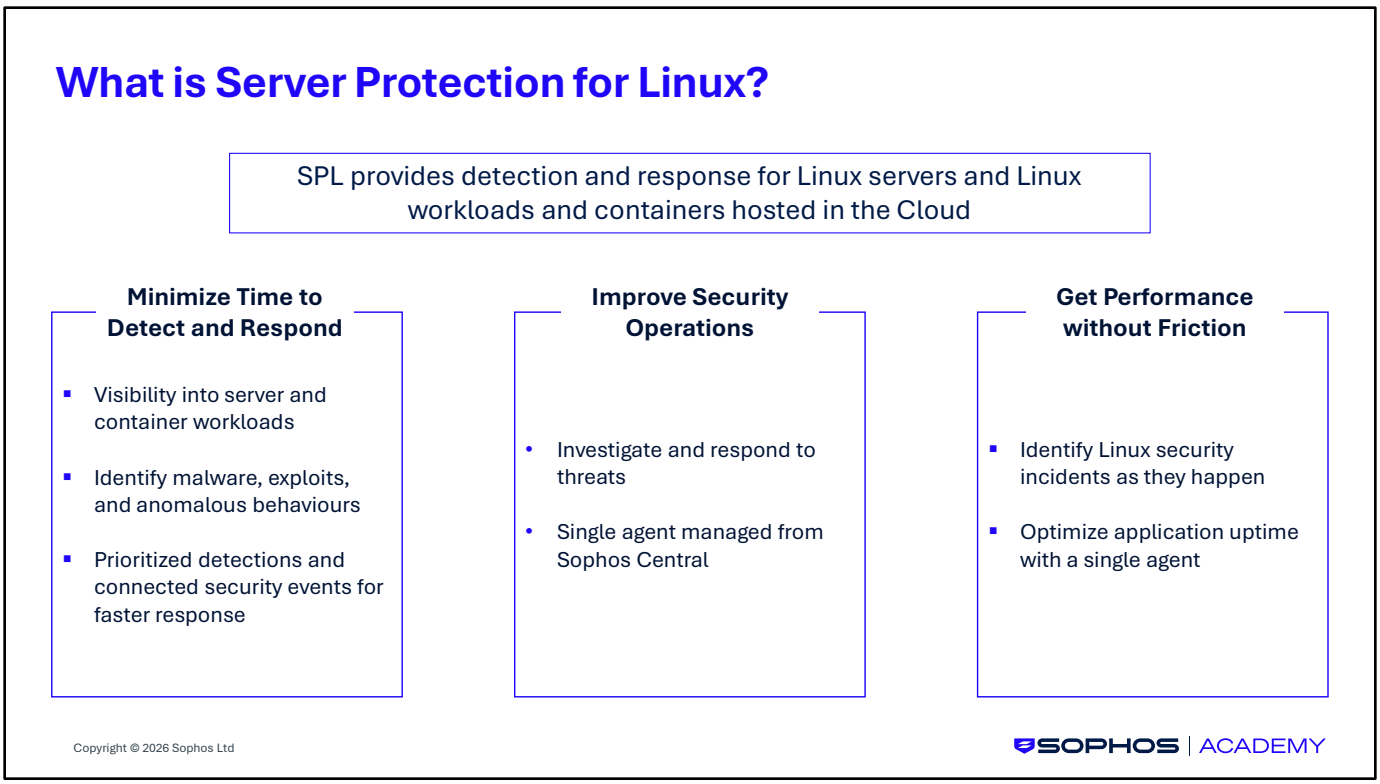
In this chapter, you will learn about Sophos Endpoint for Linux, its features, system requirements, and how to install it.



Sophos Server Protection for Linux provides detection and response capabilities for Linux servers and Linux workloads and containers hosted in the Cloud.

You can protect both physical and virtual Linux servers against threats and view those servers in one place. This optimizes performance and integration with security and development operation workflows.

Agent and Sensor Features

FEATURES	SOPHOS SERVER PROTECTION FOR LINUX AGENT	SOPHOS LINUX SENSOR
Deep learning malware detection	✓	
Anti-malware File Scanning *(on-access/on-demand/scheduled)*	✓	
Live Protection	✓	
Quarantine *(malware detections only, does not currently include machine learning detections)*	✓	
Cloud Security Management	✓ Requires Advanced license	
Runtime detections	✓ Requires XDR or MDR license	✓
Live Discover	✓ Requires XDR or MDR license	
Live Response	✓ Requires XDR or MDR license	
Cross product querying	✓ Requires XDR or MDR license	

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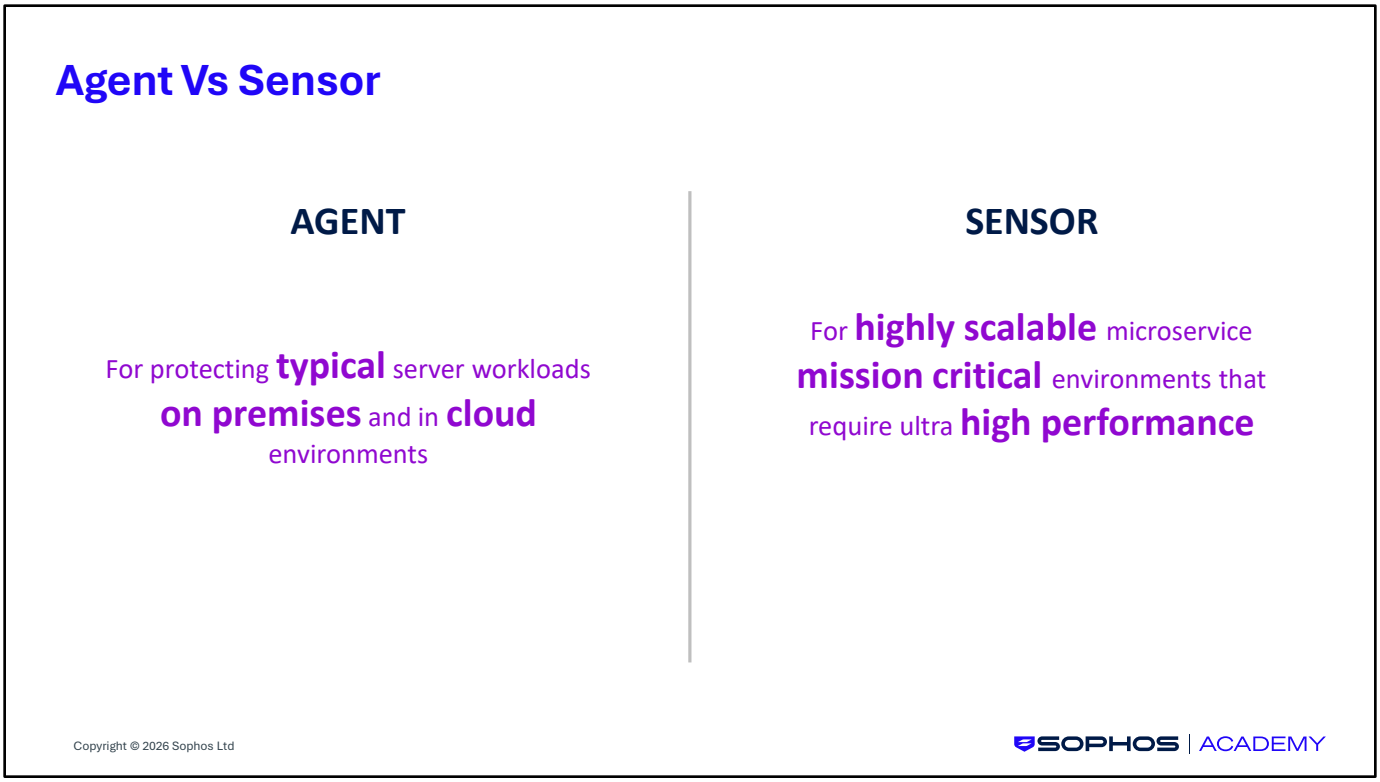
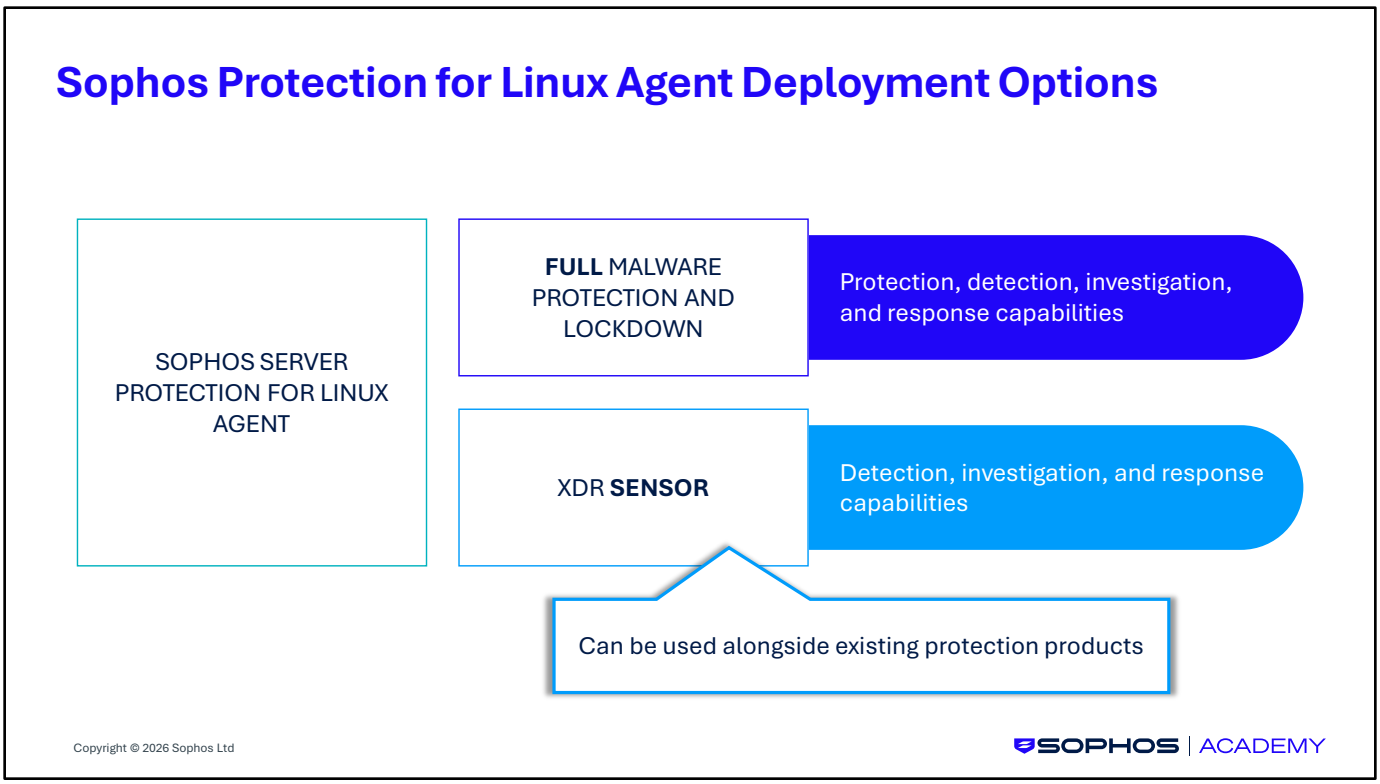
There are two types of deployment of Sophos Server Protection for Linux, agent or sensor. The type of deployment you choose, and the license will determine the features available. The features included in the agent and sensor are outlined in this table. Please note that some features of the agent require an advanced, an XDR license, or an MDR license.



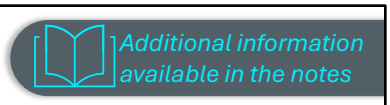
Most administrators looking to provide protection for typical server workloads, either on premises or in cloud environments, install the Linux protection agent.

For highly scalable microservice environments that are mission-critical and require ultra-high performance, the sensor may be more appropriate. Sensor deployments don't report detections back to Sophos Central; third party applications are used to collate and take action based on the detection data.



The Sophos Server Protection for Linux agent can be deployed in two ways: full malware protection and lockdown, and XDR sensor. When installed for full malware protection and lockdown, a full set of protection, detection, investigation, and response capabilities is included with the agent. When installed as an XDR sensor, there are no protection capabilities. Detection, investigation, and response capabilities from XDR are included that can be used alongside existing protection products that are already deployed.

Agent System Requirements and Licensing



SYSTEM REQUIREMENTS

- 2.5 GB free disk space
- 2 GB of memory
- X64 system and ARM64
- Systemd supported and running
- Kernel that supports glibc 2.17 or later
  - For ARM64 2.18 or later
  - Minimum kernel of 5.3
- Bash is installed

SUPPORTED PLATFORMS

- Amazon Linux 2/2023
- CentOS Stream
- Debian 10/11
- Miracle Linux 8
- Oracle 8/9
- RHEL 8/9
- SUSE Linux Enterprise Server 15
- Ubuntu 20.04(LTS)/22.04 (LTS)/24.04 (LTS)

RELEASE NOTES: https://docs.sophos.com/releasenotes/output/en-us/esg/linux_protection_rn.html

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To use Sophos Server Protection for Linux agent, the device must meet the system requirements and run a supported platform shown here. For the latest system requirements, please check the release notes.

[Additional Information]
For more information regarding system requirements and supported platforms please see the current release notes.
Sophos release notes
https://docs.sophos.com/releasenotes/output/en-us/esg/linux_protection_rn.html

Sophos Linux Sensor System Requirements and Licensing

SYSTEM REQUIREMENTS

- 2.5 GB free disk space
- 2 GB of memory
- x84_64 system and ARM64* system

* We support ARM64 and AWS Graviton 2 and Graviton 3 platforms for kernel versions 5.3 or later

SUPPORTED PLATFORMS

- Amazon Linux 2/2023
- CentOS Stream
- Debian 11/12
- Miracle Linux 8
- Oracle 8/9
- RHEL 8/9
- SUSE Linux Enterprise Server 15
- Ubuntu 20.04 (LTS)/22.04 (LTS)/24.04 (LTS)

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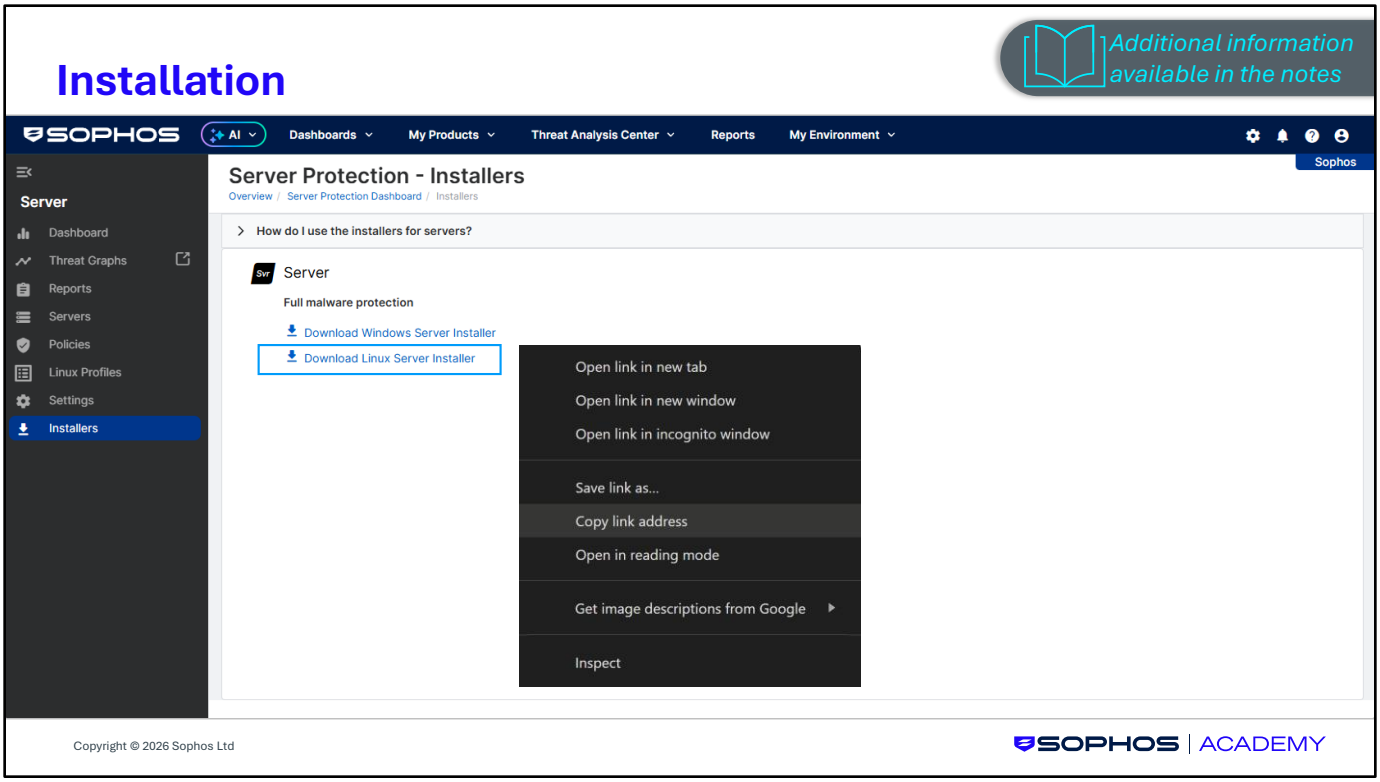
The system requirements for the sensor are very similar, but there are some differences, including a lower disk space requirement and the addition of ARM support.

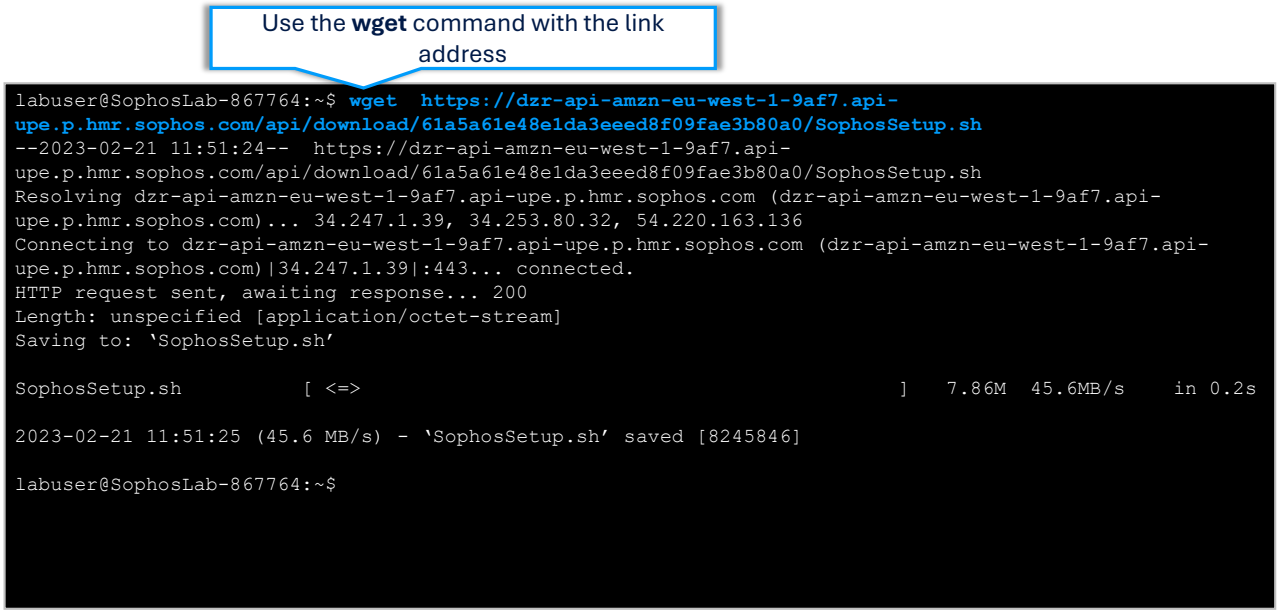
Installation



To install Sophos Protection for Linux, download the installer from your Sophos Central account. In your Central account, navigate to **Installers** in the 'Server' **My Products** menu. To download the agent, right-click on either the **Download Linux Server Installer** or **Download XDR Sensor Linux Server installer** link. Select **Copy link address.**

[Additional Information]
[How to install Sophos Linux Sensor from the Sophos package registry. - Sophos Linux Sensor](https://doc.sophos.com/esg/sls/help/en-us/gettingStarted/installSensor/Installing_SLS_from_Sophos_Repo/index.html)
https://doc.sophos.com/esg/sls/help/en-us/gettingStarted/installSensor/Installing_SLS_from_Sophos_Repo/index.html

Installation



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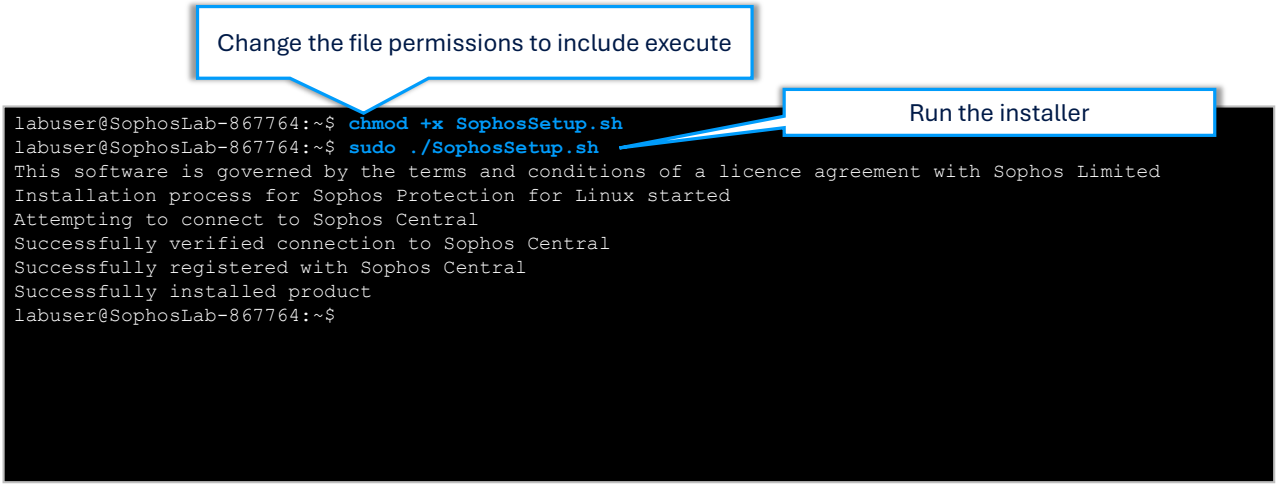
On your Linux server, at a command prompt or in a script, use the **wget** command with the link address. You can paste the link address directly from your Sophos Central account. An example of this is shown here.

Other commands, such as **curl**, can be used to download the installer, or if you are using a graphical desktop environment, you can use a browser.

Installation

Additional information available in the notes



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You can change the permissions of the file to include the execute permission. To do this, run **`chmod +x SophosSetup.sh`**.

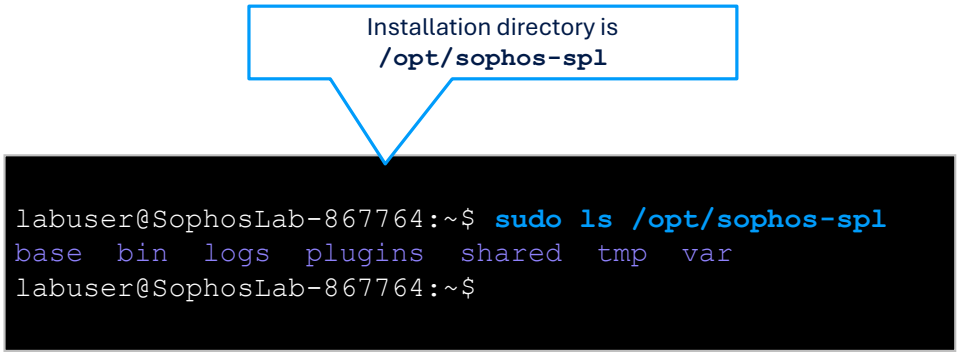
Once this has been completed, run the installer. If you aren't logged in as the root user, run the installer with the **`sudo`** command.

[**Additional Information**]
Installation documentation can be found here: Server - Sophos Central Admin
https://docs.sophos.com/central/customer/help/en-us/PeopleAndDevices/ProtectDevices/ServerProtection/index.html#download-and-run-the-linux-server-installer

Use this command to apply the execute permission: `chmod +x SophosSetup.sh`
Use this command to run the installer: `./SophosSetup.sh`
To run the installer when not logged in as the root : `sudo ./SophosSetup.sh`

Additional command line options for the installer can be found here: Installer command-line options for Linux - Sophos Central Admin
https://docs.sophos.com/central/customer/help/en-us/PeopleAndDevices/ProtectDevices/ServerProtection/SophosProtectionLinux/ServerProtectionAgentCommandLineOptions/index.html#products

Installation Directory



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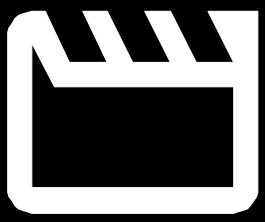
The Sophos Protection for Linux installation directory is **`/opt/sophos-spl`**.

Using the command **ls** you can view the directories included in the installation. Note that you need to have root privileges to access this directory, so if you are not logged in as the root user, use the **sudo** command.

Video Demo: Installation on Linux



In this video demonstration, Sophos Server Protection for Linux is installed on a Linux server.

https://training.sophos.com/ce/demo/LinuxInstall/2/play.html

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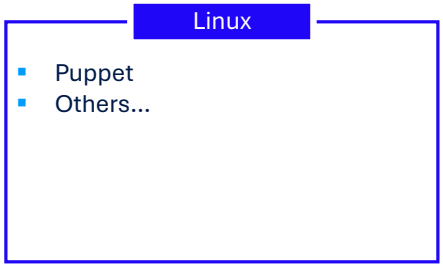
[Additional Information]

Bulk Installation to Existing Devices

Additional information available in the notes



- Use the installer from the Central Admin Dashboard
- Use third-party tools to run the installer on target devices with administrator rights

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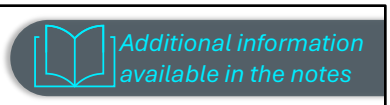
If you need to install the Sophos Endpoint agent on multiple devices, you can create a script that will automatically install it. However, bulk deployments should **NOT** be created using an installer sent using the email setup link. If this installer is used, all devices will be associated with the user to whom the email setup link was sent.

[Additional Information]
The steps required to force devices to re-register with Sophos Central can be found in knowledge base article **KB-000035040**.
Sophos Endpoint: Automate the software deployment to Windows devices
https://support.sophos.com/support/s/article/KB-000035049

Including Sophos Central in a 'Gold' Image



- Device **identity** is **set during install**
- **Multiple images** of the same device will **try to use the same identity**

To resolve this...

Install then remove the identity causing it to register on next boot

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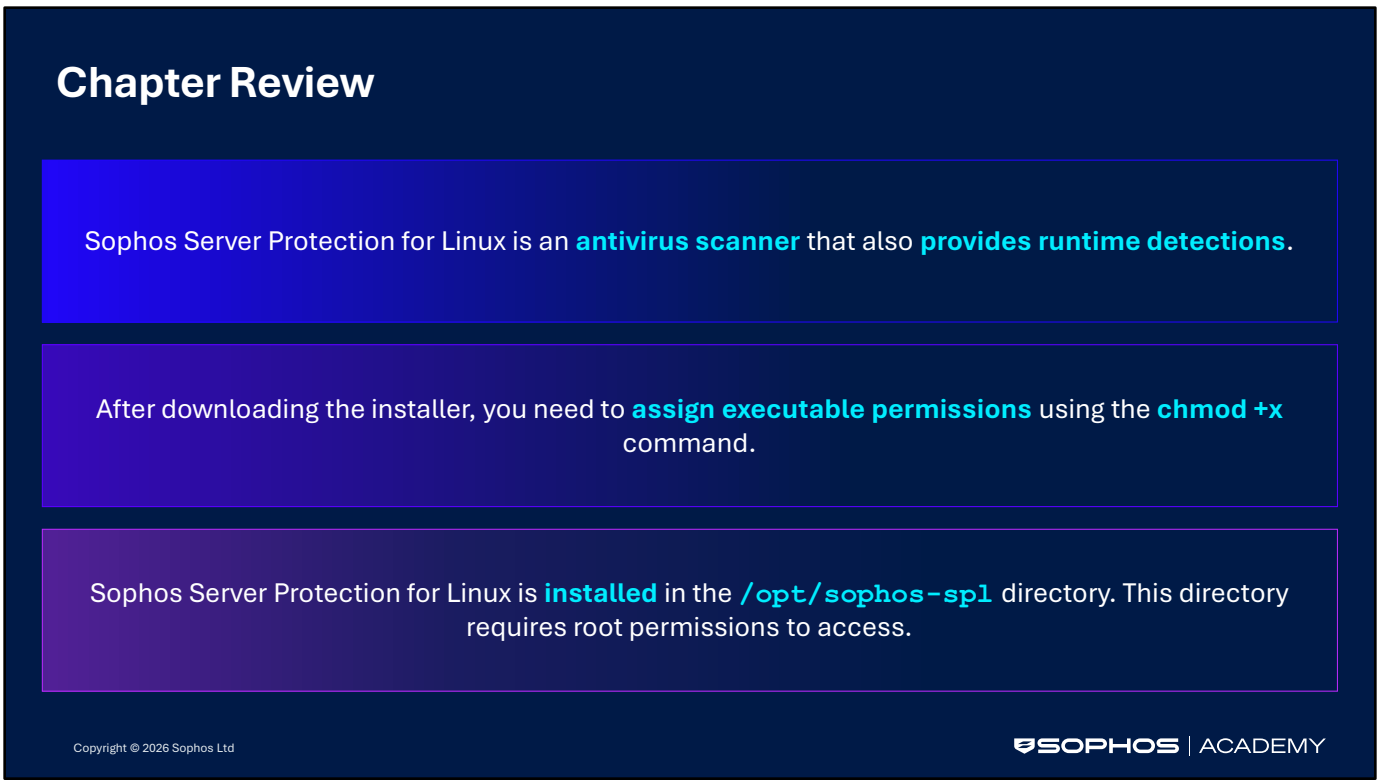
For organizations using virtual machines, it is common to create a gold image and run multiple instances of that image. During the installation of the Sophos Endpoint Agent the device identity is set, this is used by Sophos Central to identify individual devices. If you run multiple images using the same identity, all devices will report to Sophos Central as the same device. To prevent this issue, new images created from the gold image must register for a new identity. You can remove the identity, which causes the Sophos Endpoint agent to register for a new identity when it next starts.

[Additional Information]
Creating a Linux gold image: Create a Linux gold image - Sophos Central Admin
https://docs.sophos.com/central/customer/help/en-us/PeopleAndDevices/ProtectDevices/ServerProtection/SophosProtectionLinux/LinuxGoldImage/index.html



Here are the main things you learned in this chapter.

Sophos Server Protection for Linux is an antivirus scanner that also provides runtime detections.

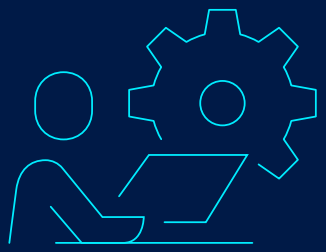
After downloading the installer, you need to assign it executable permissions using the chmod command.

Sophos Server Protection for Linux is installed in the /opt/sophos-spl directory. This directory requires root permissions to access.

Lab Tasks

Complete the lab tasks for **Sophos Endpoint Agent Deployment**

- **Task 1**: Install Sophos Endpoint on Windows



SOPHOS | ACADEMY

Complete the lab tasks for this module.

The lab task information can be found in the Lab Workbook which is available in the **Lesson Resources.**

Sophos Endpoint Updating

SOPHOS | ACADEMY

[Additional Information]

Sophos Endpoint
EP2005: Getting Started with Sophos Endpoint Updating

May 2026

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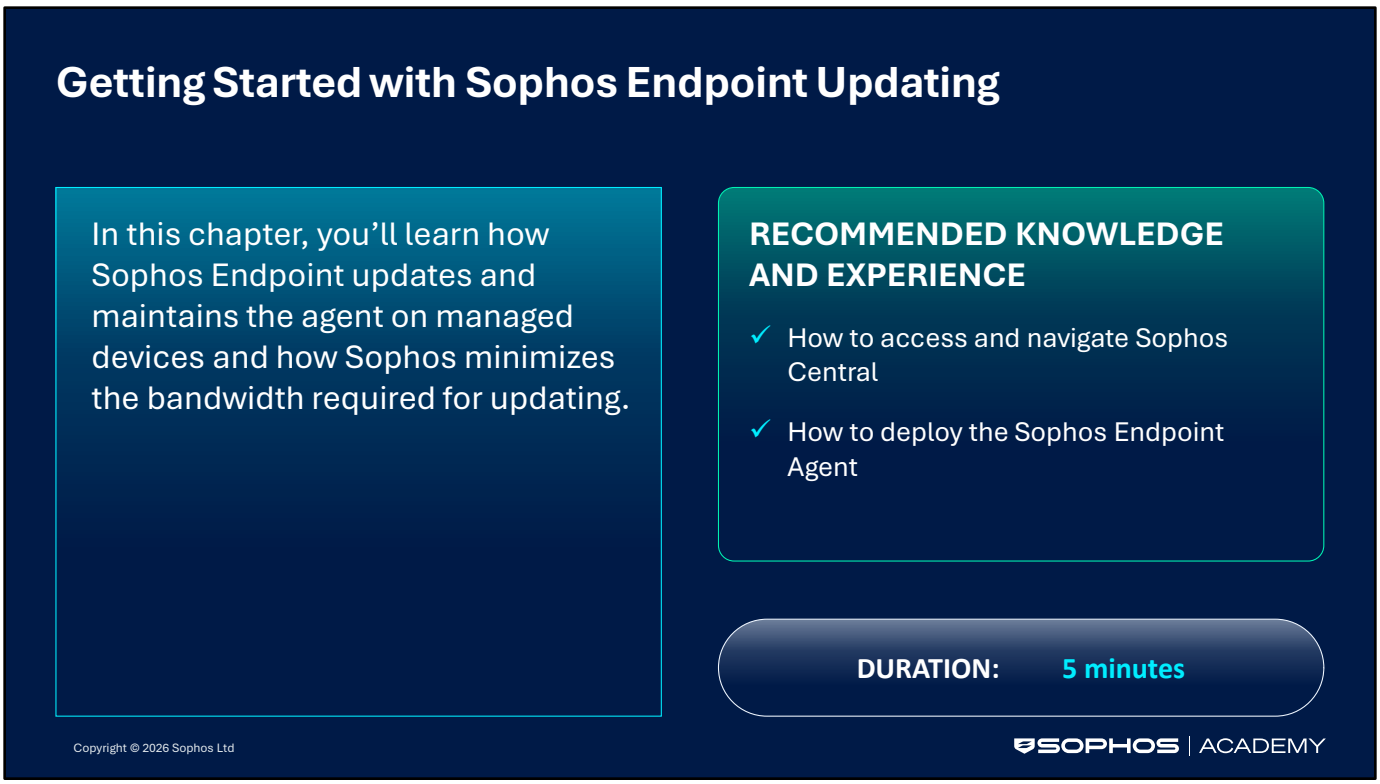
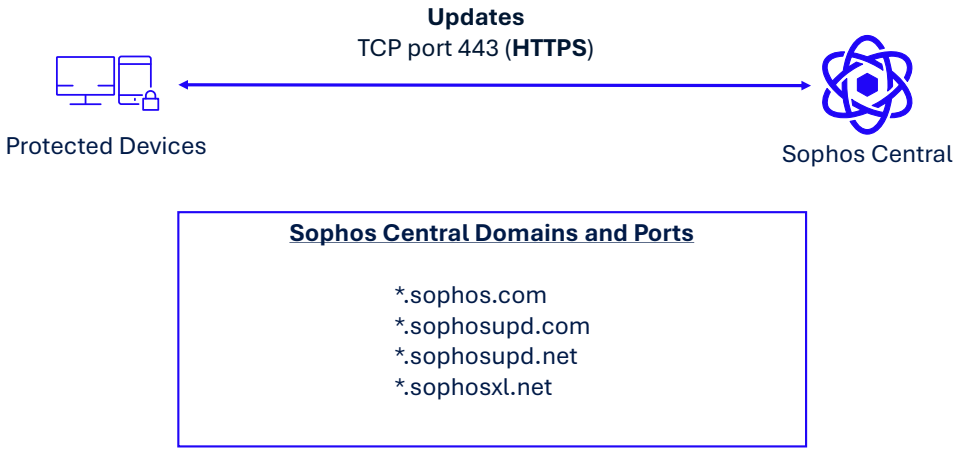


In this chapter, you'll learn how Sophos Endpoint updates and maintains the agent on managed devices and how Sophos minimizes the bandwidth required for updating.

Sophos Endpoint Updating Overview

Additional information available in the notes



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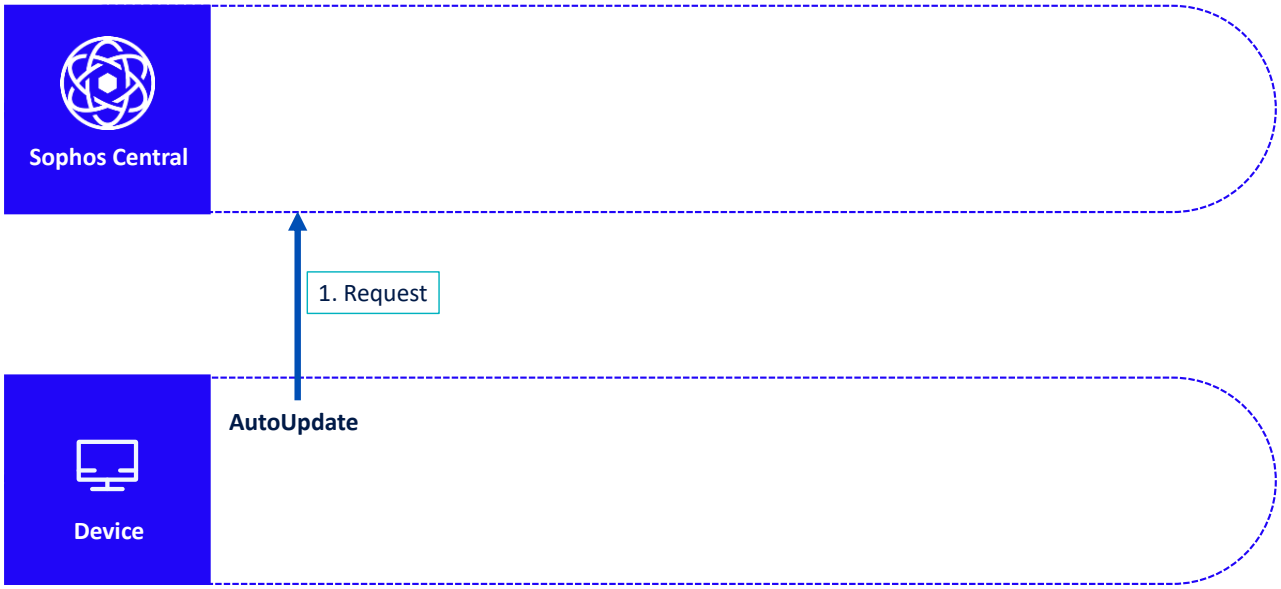
Once a device has been protected, all installed components are maintained by an updating service. Sophos Endpoint updating uses TCP port 443 to communicate updates between Sophos Central and protected devices.

If you need to allow updating through a firewall or proxy, you need to ensure that the domains shown are allowed.

If your proxy or firewall doesn't support wildcards, you must identify the exact Sophos domains you need and then enter them manually.

[Additional Information]
Full list of domains and ports that need to be allowed: Domains and ports to allow - Sophos Central Admin
https://docs.sophos.com/central/customer/help/en-us/PeopleAndDevices/ProtectDevices/DomainsPorts/index.html#sophos-central-admin-domains

How Sophos Endpoint Updates



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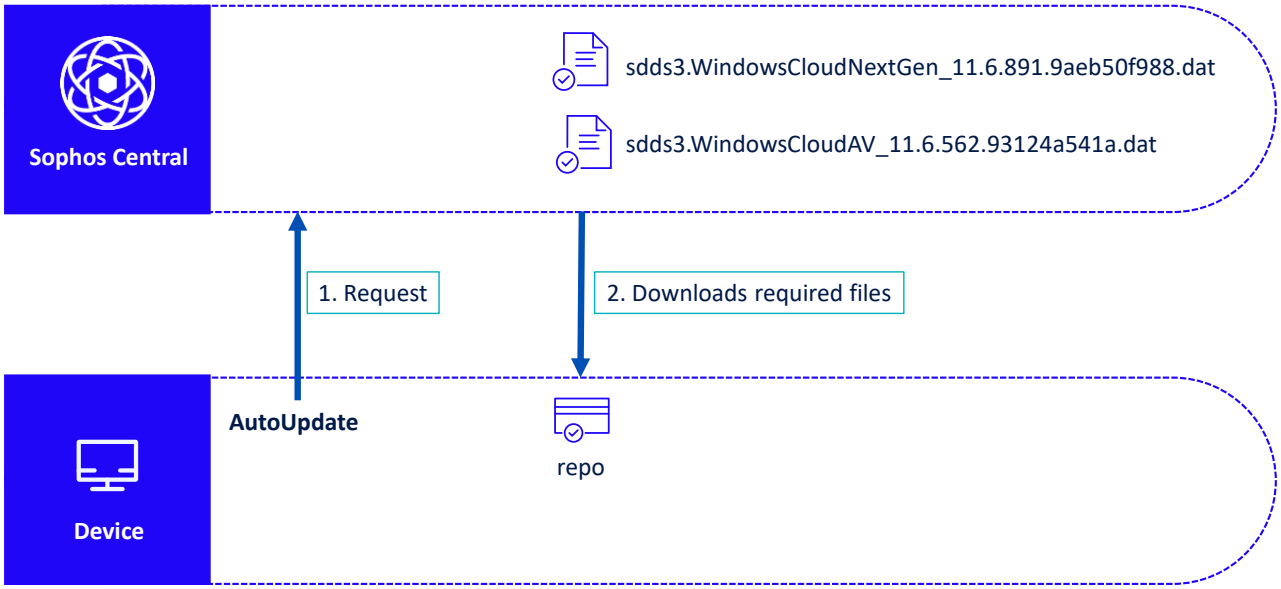
Let’s examine how updating works. The endpoint requests a manifest of the files required for the latest version of the Sophos Endpoint Agent.

How Sophos Endpoint Updates

Additional information available in the notes



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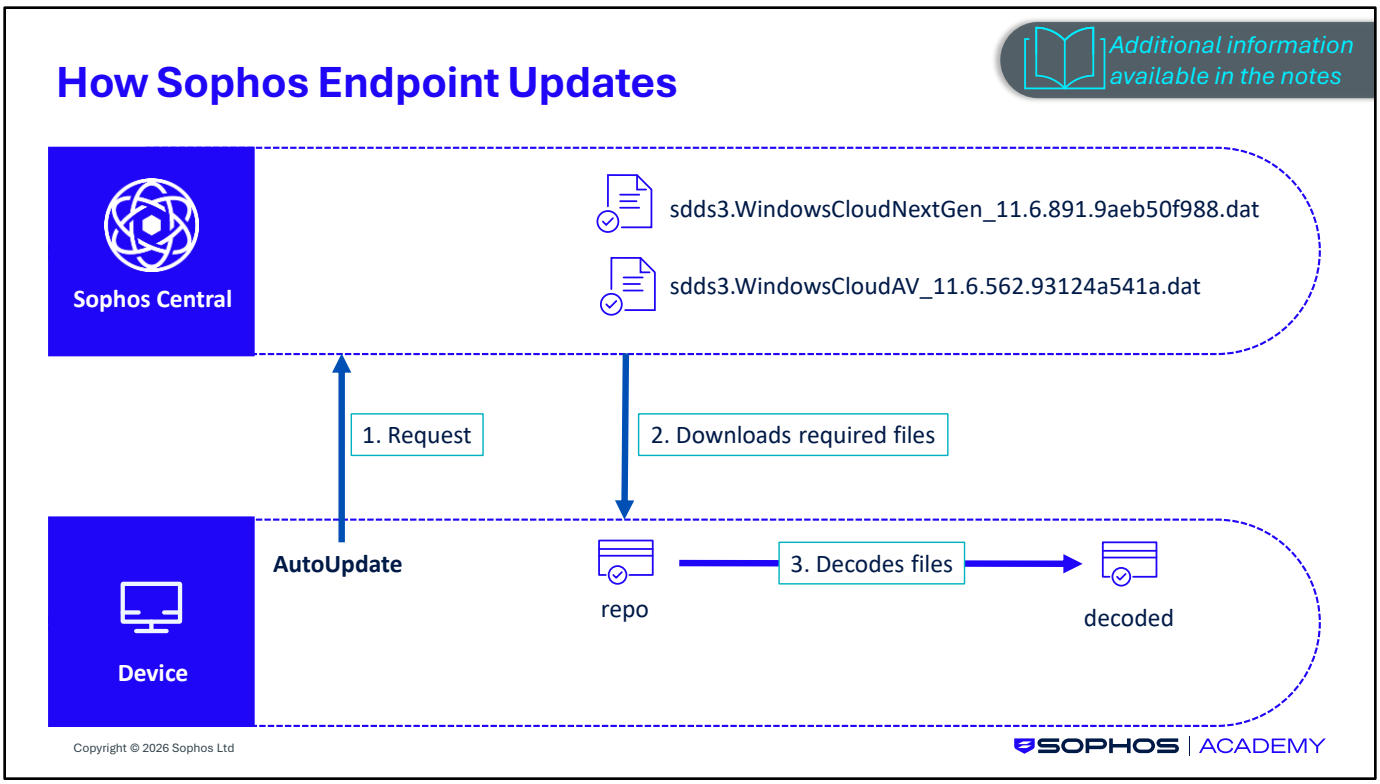
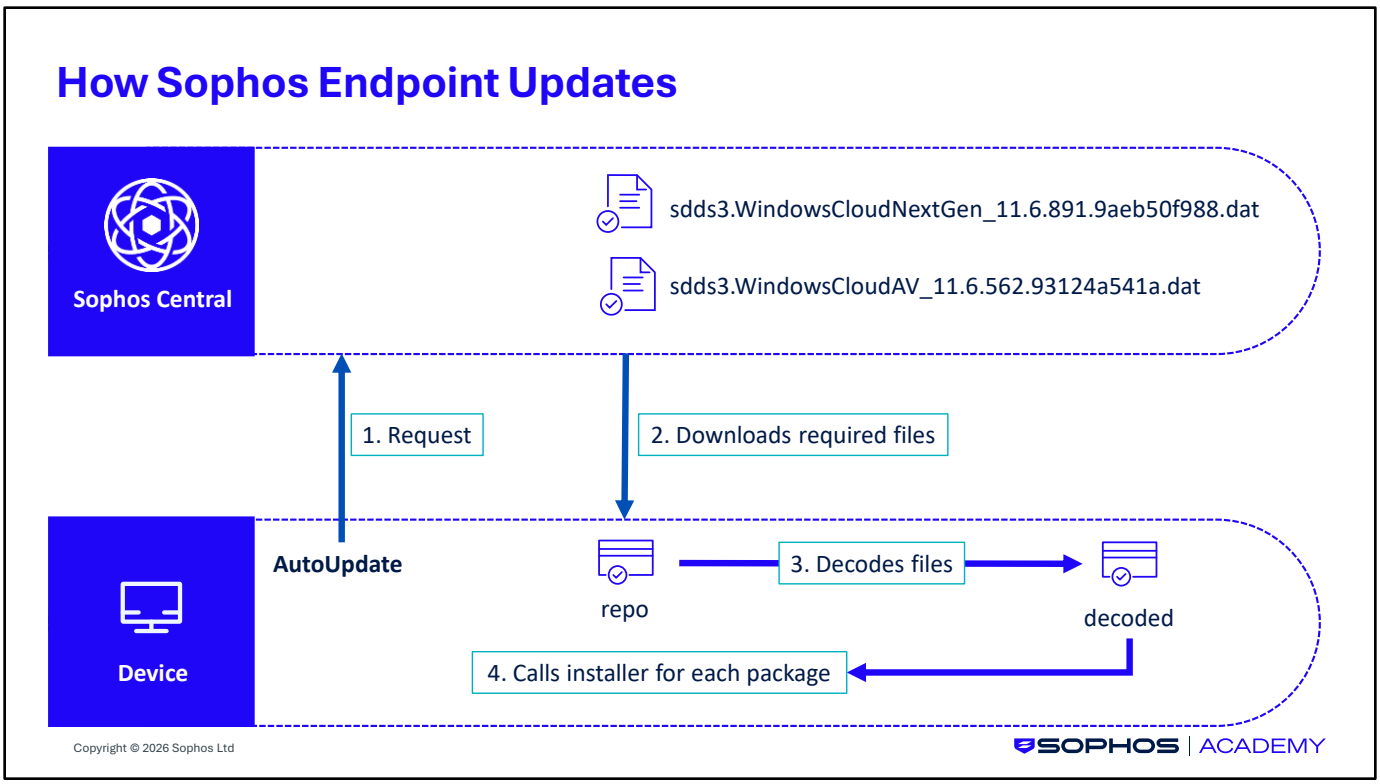
Once the required files have been identified, they are downloaded to the device. Updating stores the downloaded files in the **repo** folder.

[Additional Information]
Files are downloaded to C:\ProgramData\AutoUpdate\data\repo



and decodes them into a local cache folder named **decoded**.

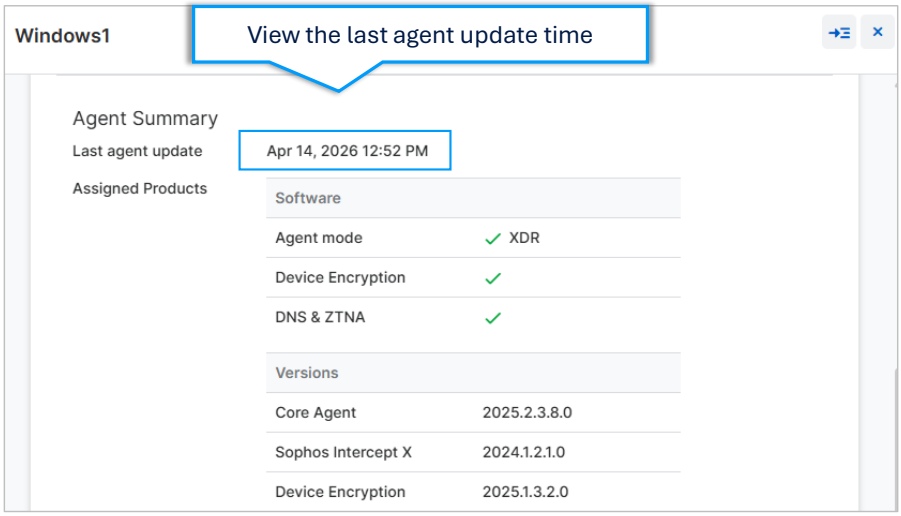
[Additional Information]
The local cache folder can be found here: C:\ProgramData\AutoUpdate\Cache\decoded



Once decoded, the installer for each package performs any required updates. If a product is added to a device, for example, Device Encryption, the device's subscription package is updated. When the device receives the new policy, the new product is identified, downloaded, and installed.

Updating Status

- View the updated status of a device in Sophos Central



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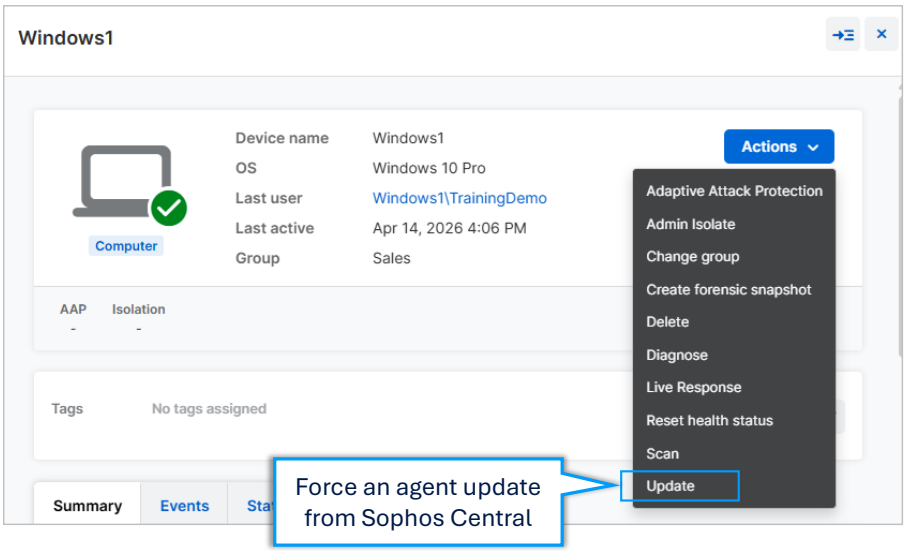
The updated status of a device is displayed in the device record. In the 'Agent Summary' section, you can see the 'Last Agent Update' time and whether it was successful or not.

Updating Status

- Force an update of the Sophos Endpoint agent



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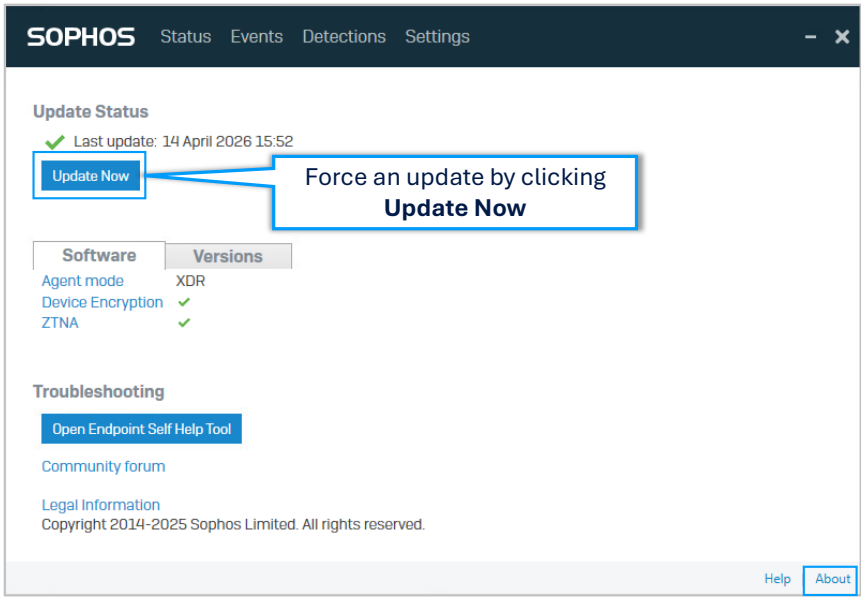
You can force an update from Sophos Central by clicking **Update**.

Updating on Windows



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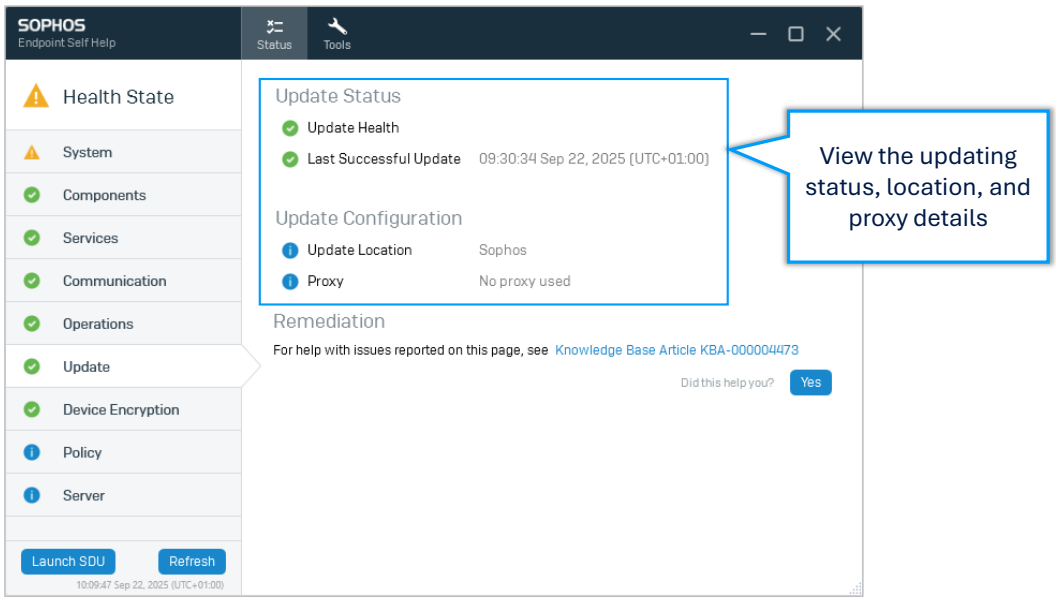
On a Windows device, the Sophos Endpoint Agent displays the 'Update Status' in the **About** menu. You can select to force an update by clicking **Update Now**.

Updating on Windows



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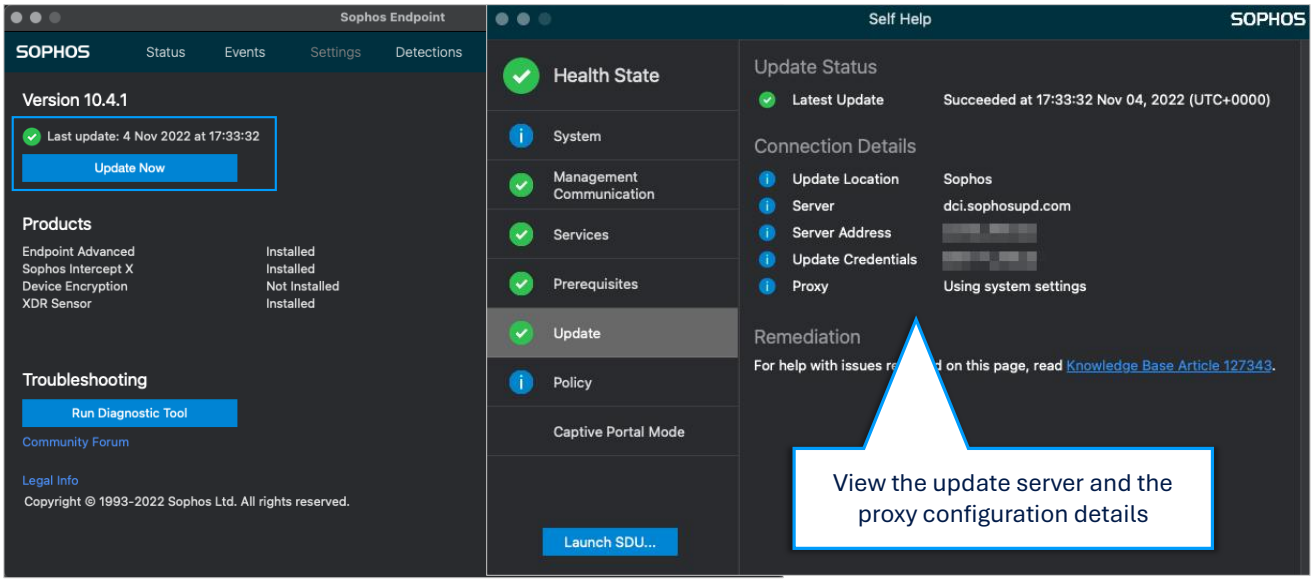
Opening the Endpoint Self Help tool allows you to view further updating information. You can see where the device is updating from; in this example, the device is updating directly from Sophos. If a proxy server has been configured for updating, the proxy server details will be displayed here.

Updating on macOS



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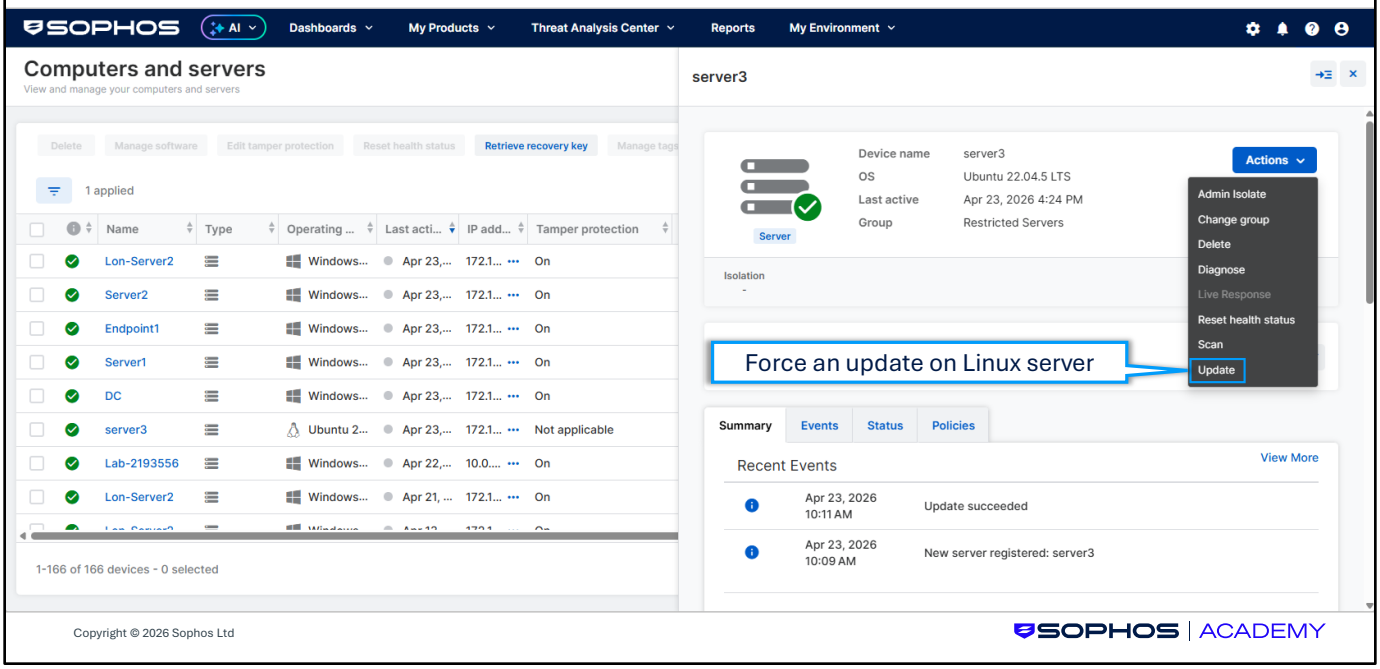
On a macOS device, the Sophos Endpoint Agent displays the update status on the **About** page.

The diagnostic tool's Update tab details the latest update date and time and the connection details. You can view the update location and server, along with any proxy server details if they have been configured.

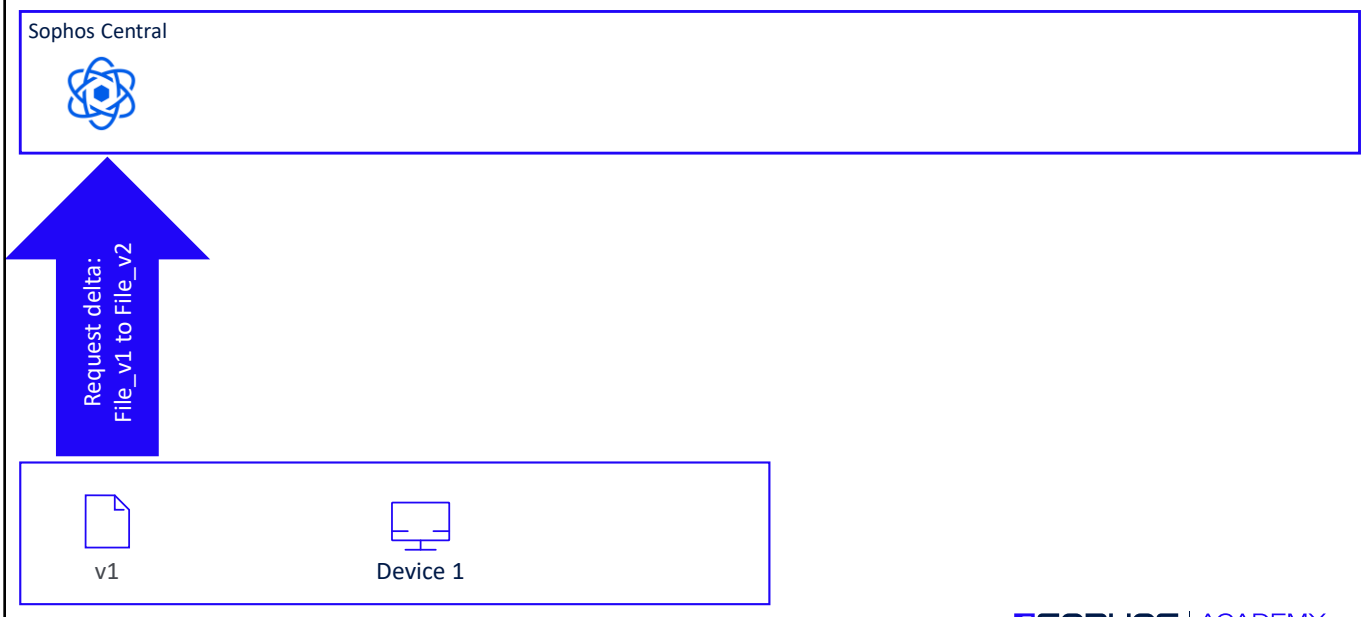
Updating on Linux



For Linux servers, you cannot force an update directly on the server.

You can click **Update** in the Actions drop-down menu in Sophos Central to force an update on the server.

How Sophos Minimizes Bandwidth Usage



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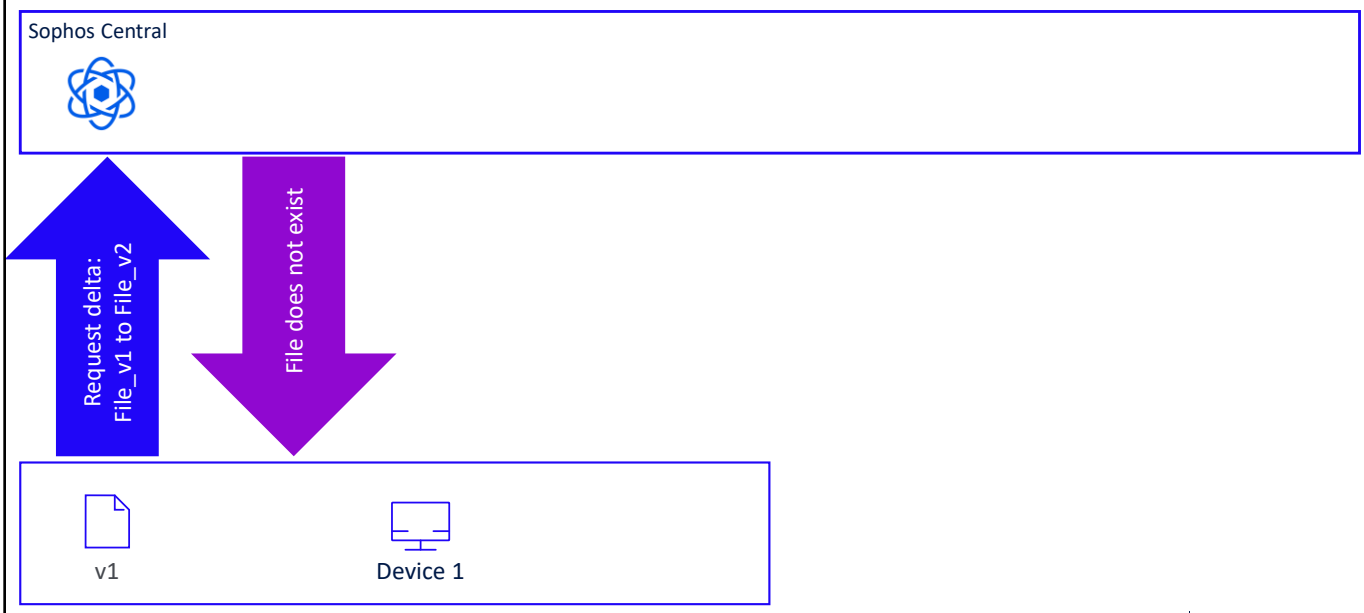
Sophos uses dynamic file deltas to reduce the amount of bandwidth required for devices to update. Let's look at how this works.

Device 1 has version 1 of a file but needs version 2. Device 1 sends a request to Sophos for the delta between version 1 and version 2 of the file.

How Sophos Minimizes Bandwidth Usage



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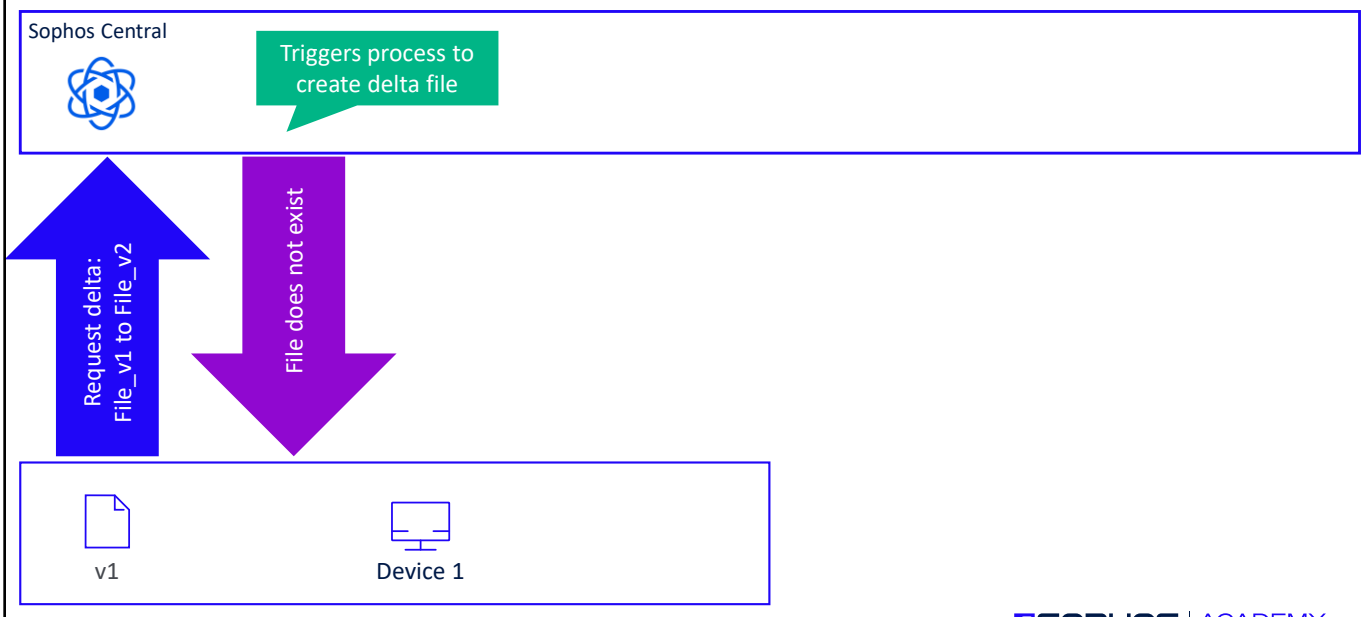
This is the first time the device has requested the delta file, which currently does not exist.

How Sophos Minimizes Bandwidth Usage



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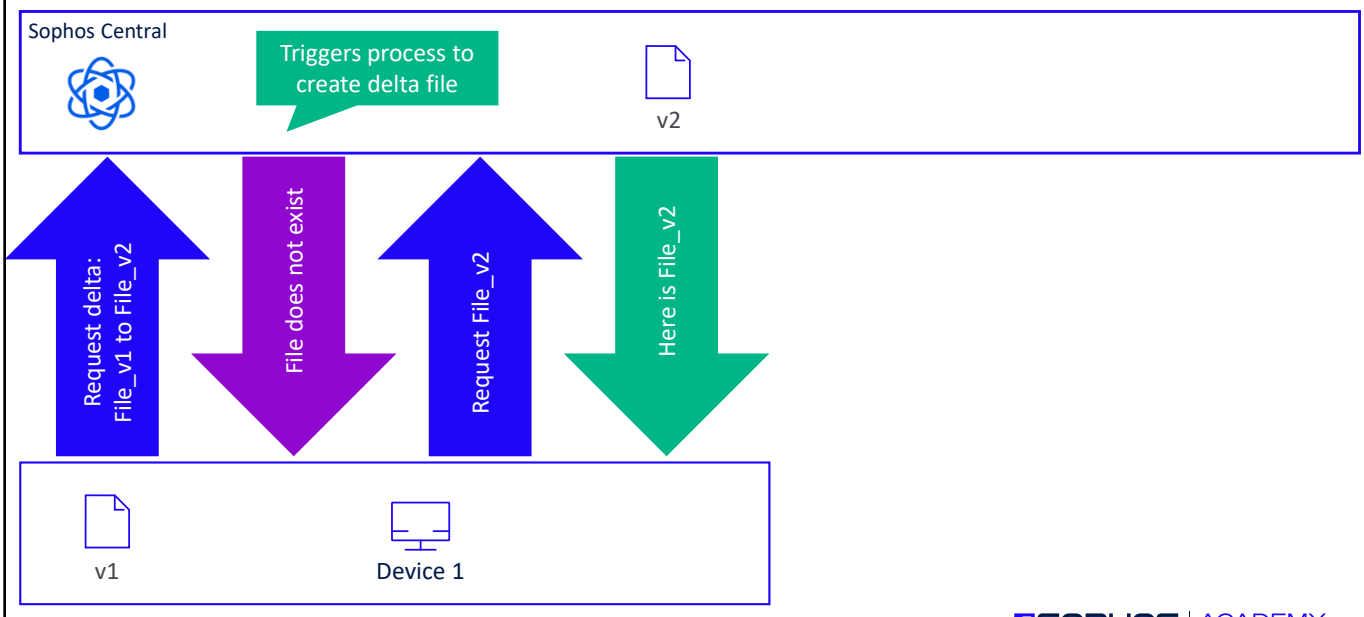
Sophos responds to the device that the file does not exist and triggers the process to create that delta file.

How Sophos Minimizes Bandwidth Usage



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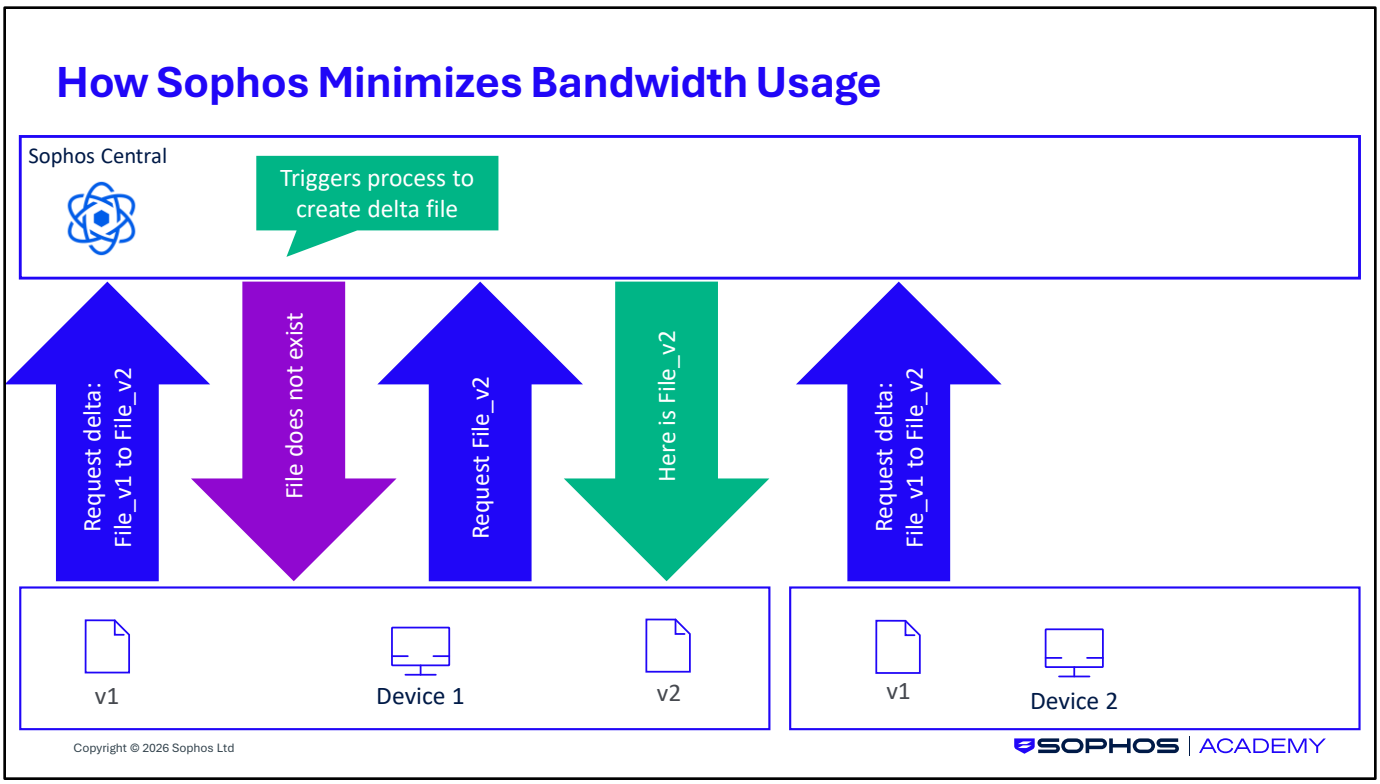
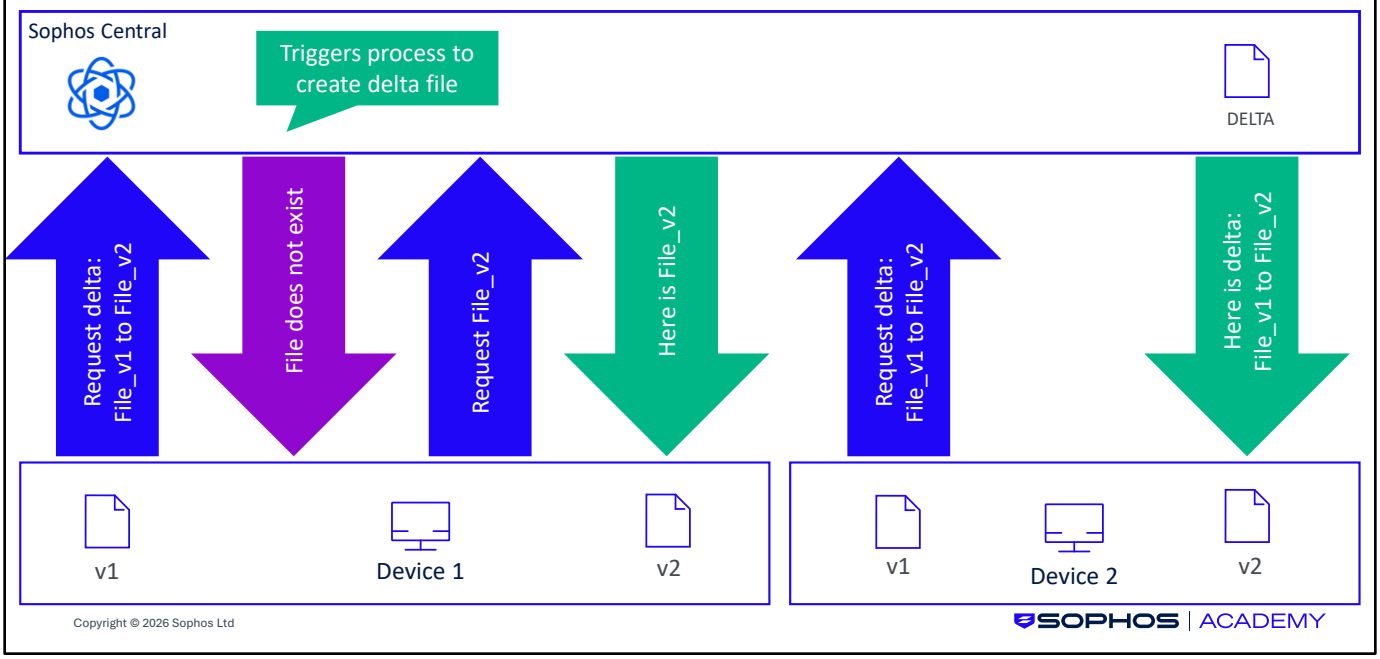
As the delta file does not exist, Device 1 requests the full version 2 of the file. Version 2 of the file is sent to Device 1.

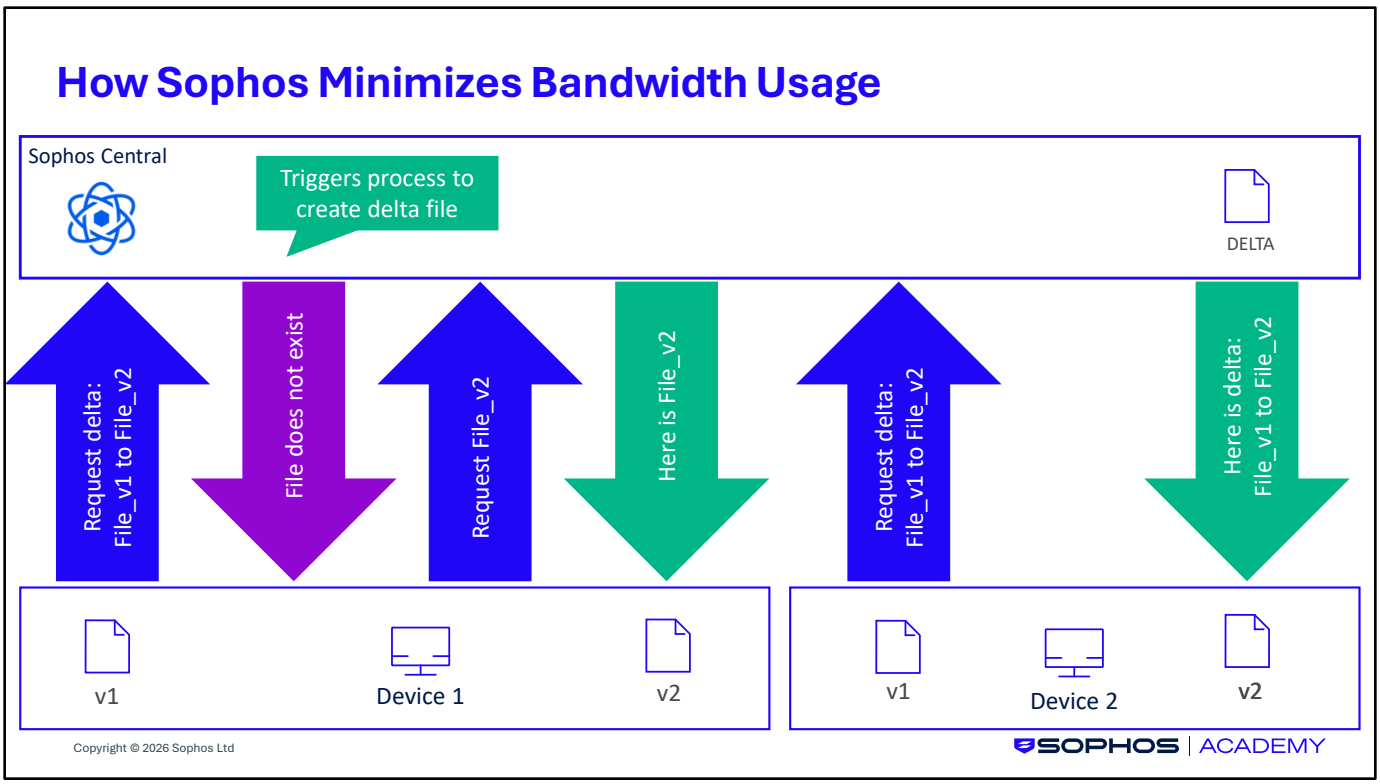


Device 2 needs to update from version 1 to version 2 for the same file. Device 2 sends a request to Sophos for the delta between version 1 and version 2 of the file.

How Sophos Minimizes Bandwidth Usage

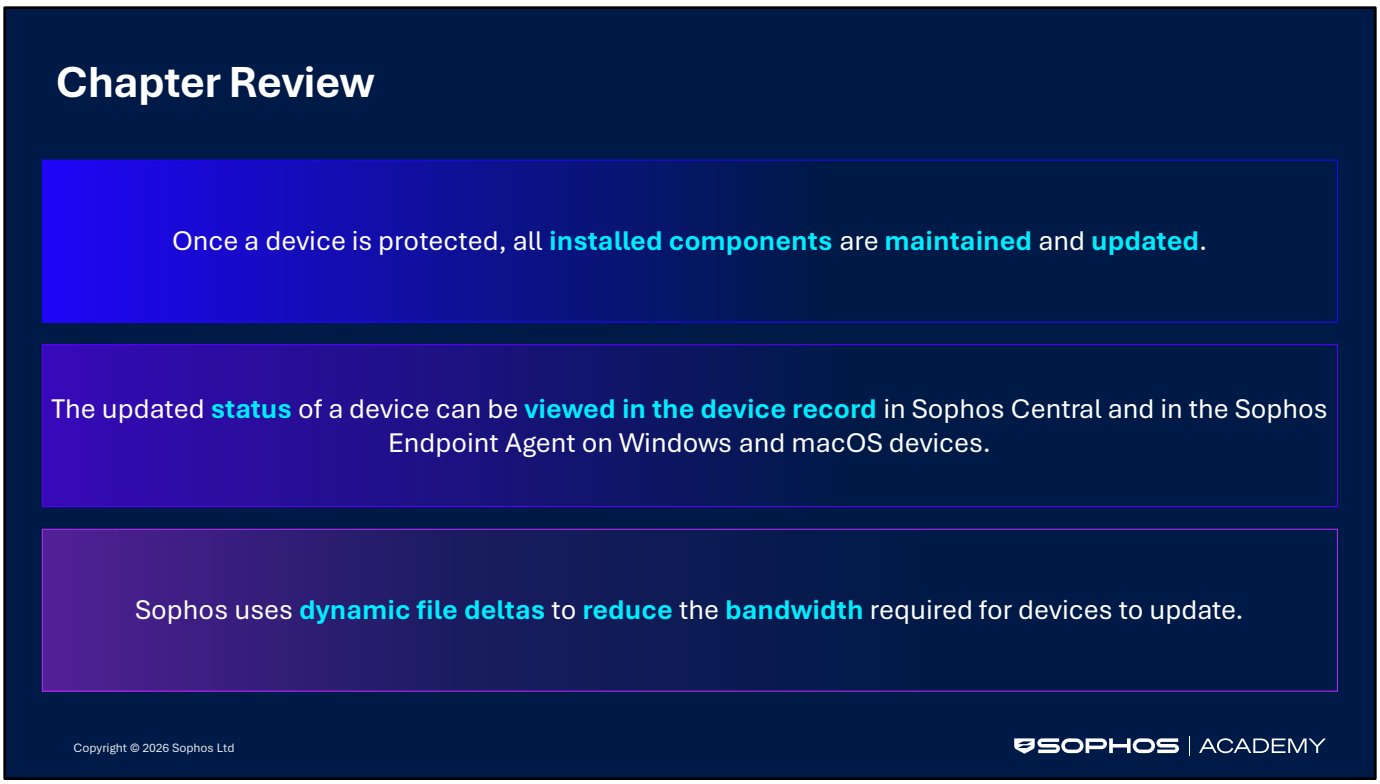


Sophos creates the delta file following Device 1's request and sends it to Device 2.



Device 2 merges version 1 of the file with the delta file received to create version 2 of the file.

Note that not all files are suitable for a delta to be created for them. Additionally, this technique is only applicable to updates. It does not apply to the initial installation of the Sophos Endpoint Agent.



Here are the three main things you learned in this chapter.

Once a device is protected, all the installed components are maintained and updated.

The updated status of a device can be viewed in the device record in Sophos Central and in the Sophos Endpoint Agent on Windows and macOS devices.

Sophos uses dynamic file deltas to reduce the bandwidth required for devices to update.

[Additional Information]

Sophos Endpoint
EP2025: Introduction to Update Caches and Message Relays

May 2026

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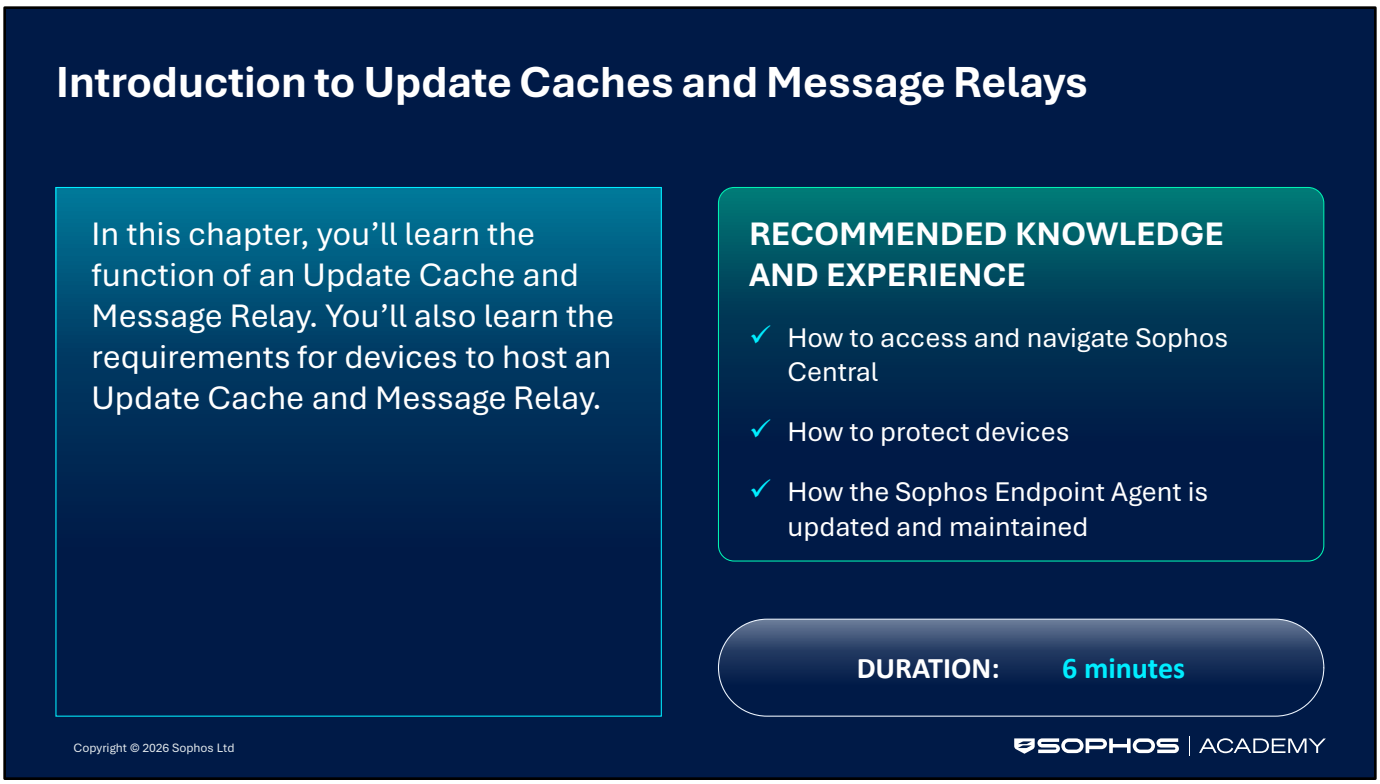
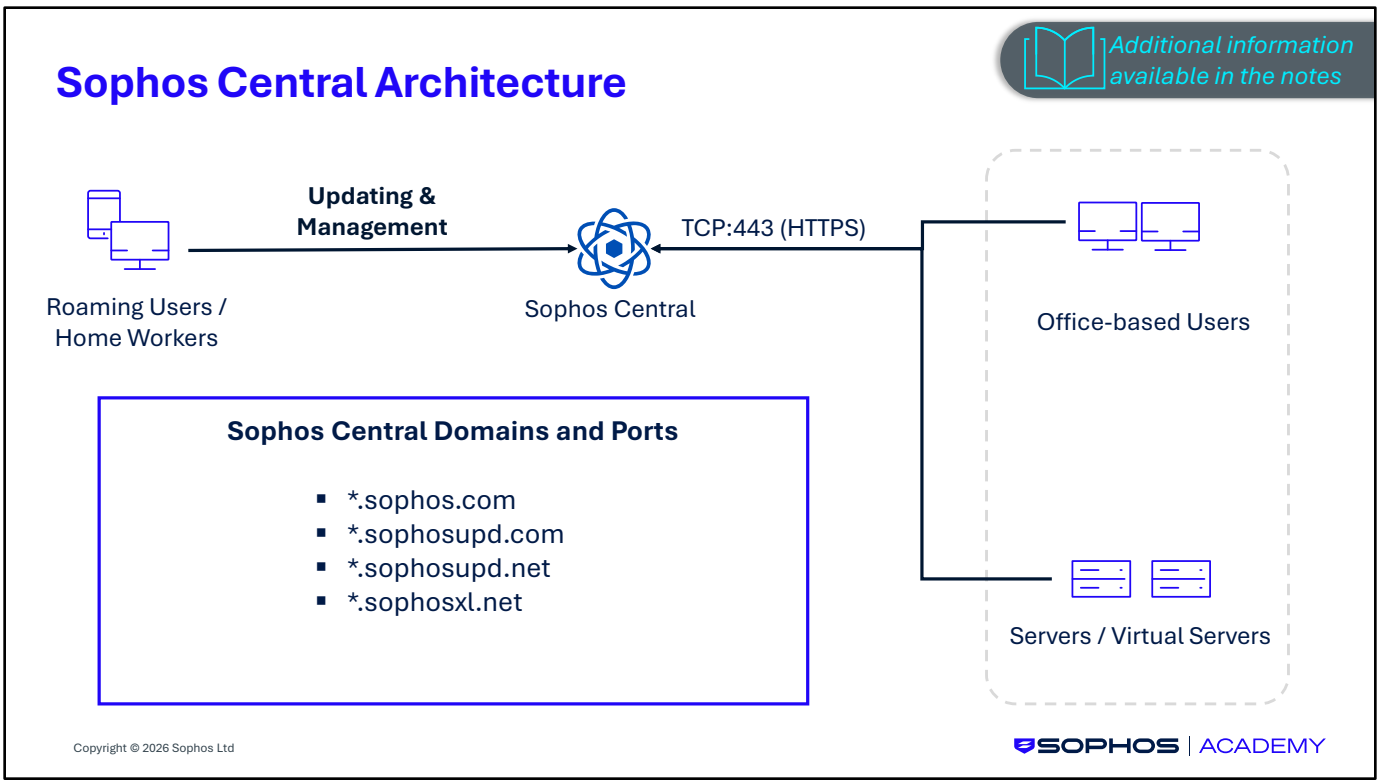


In this chapter, you'll learn the function of an Update Cache and a Message Relay. You'll also learn the requirements for devices to host an Update Cache and Message Relay.

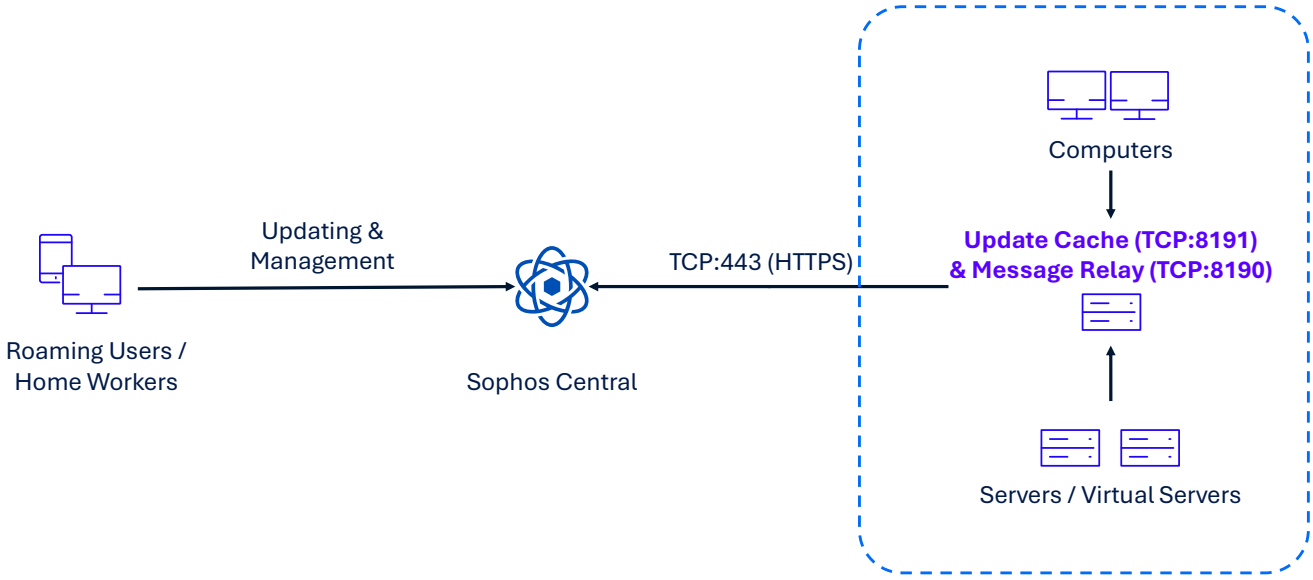


For most organizations, protected devices will update from and be managed directly by Sophos Central. In this configuration, devices use TCP port 443 (HTTPS) for updating and management.

Sophos uses the domains shown here for updating and management. We recommend using DNS names for creating exceptions, as IP addresses may change.

[Additional Information]
Further information can be found in the help documentation here: Domains and ports to allow - Sophos Central Admin
https://docs.sophos.com/central/customer/help/en-us/PeopleAndDevices/ProtectDevices/DomainsPorts/index.html#sophos-central-admin-domains

Update Caches and Message Relays



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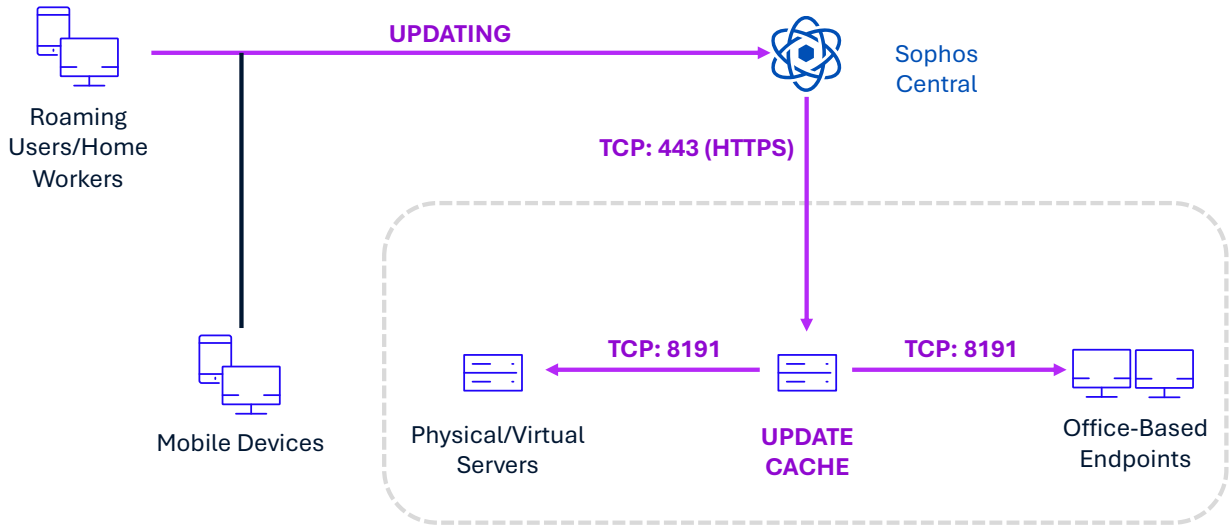
In some scenarios, either the default deployment will not work because of the way the network is designed, or an organization's experience can be improved by deploying Update Caches and Message Relays. A Sophos Update Cache enables devices to receive updates from a cache on your network. This saves bandwidth, as updates are downloaded once by the Update Cache and devices then get their required updates from the Update Cache.

You can also enable devices to communicate with Sophos Central through a Message Relay on your network. This is especially useful if an organization has devices that are unable to connect to the internet directly. In this example, a server is being used as an Update Cache and Message Relay. Whilst the server still connects directly to Sophos Central, other devices connect to the server for update and management communication. Roaming users and home users will continue to update from and be managed directly by Sophos.

How Does an Update Cache Work?



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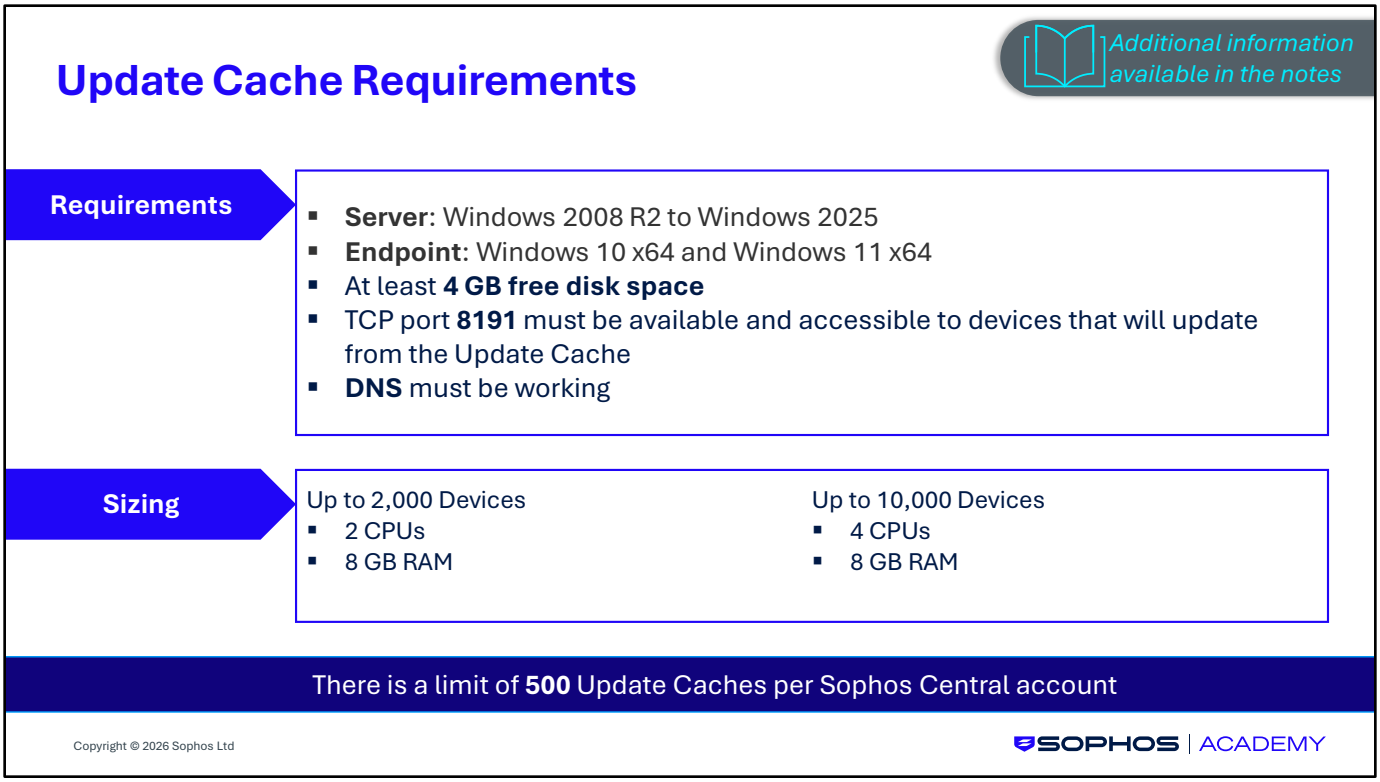
The Update Cache software is a modified version of the Apache webserver. It creates a local copy of the installation files and stores them in a cache on your network. Protected devices update from the cache location instead of directly from Sophos.

Update Caches use TCP port 8191 to communicate updates with devices, and TCP port 443 is used to communicate with Sophos Central.

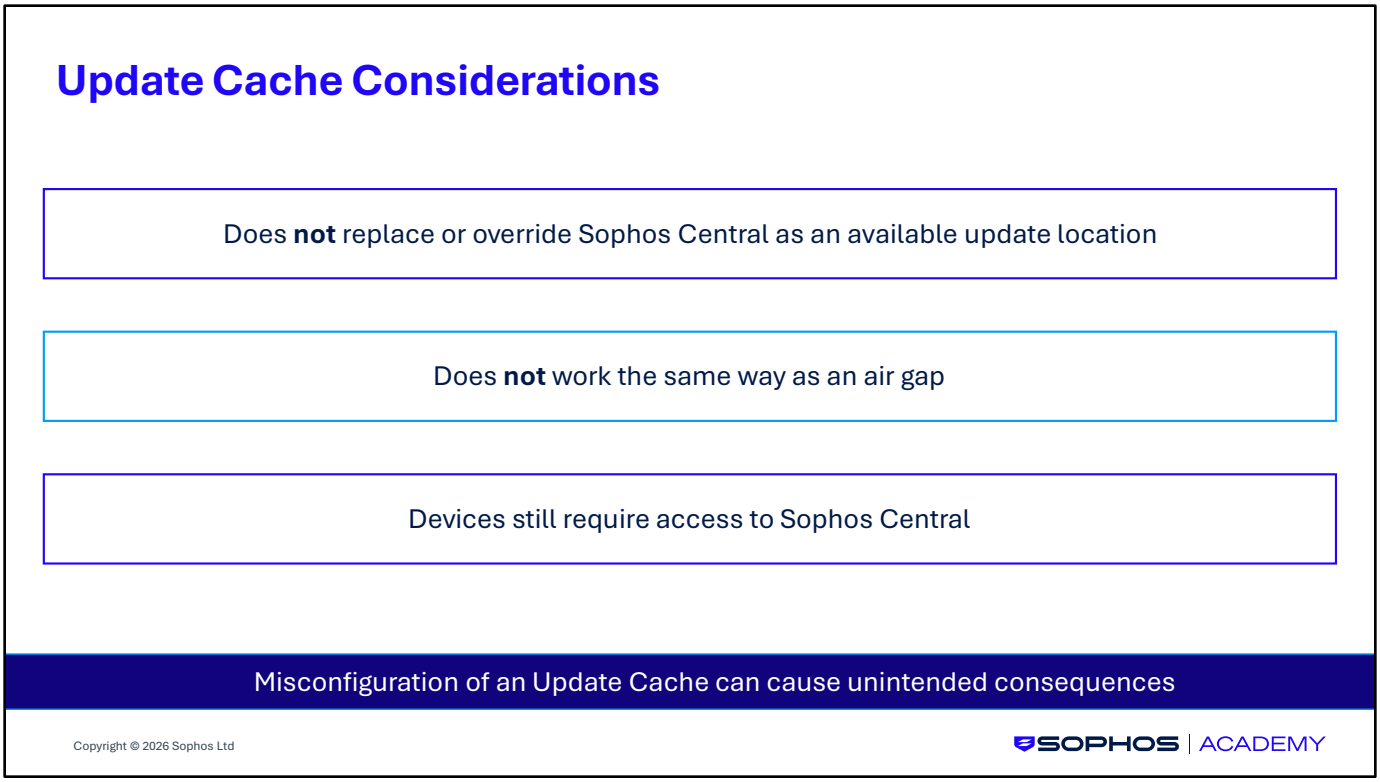


For a device to become an Update Cache, it must meet specific requirements. The device must have at least 4 GB of free disk space, and TCP port 8191 must be open for inbound and outbound traffic. When an Update Cache is deployed, TCP port 8191 is allowed on the Windows firewall. Additionally, DNS must be working to resolve the Update Cache IP address from the hostname.

Any device on which you deploy an Update Cache must be protected by Sophos Central **BEFORE** the Update Cache can be deployed. If the device is performing other roles, additional RAM and CPUs may need to be added.

There is a limit of 500 Update Caches per Sophos Central account.

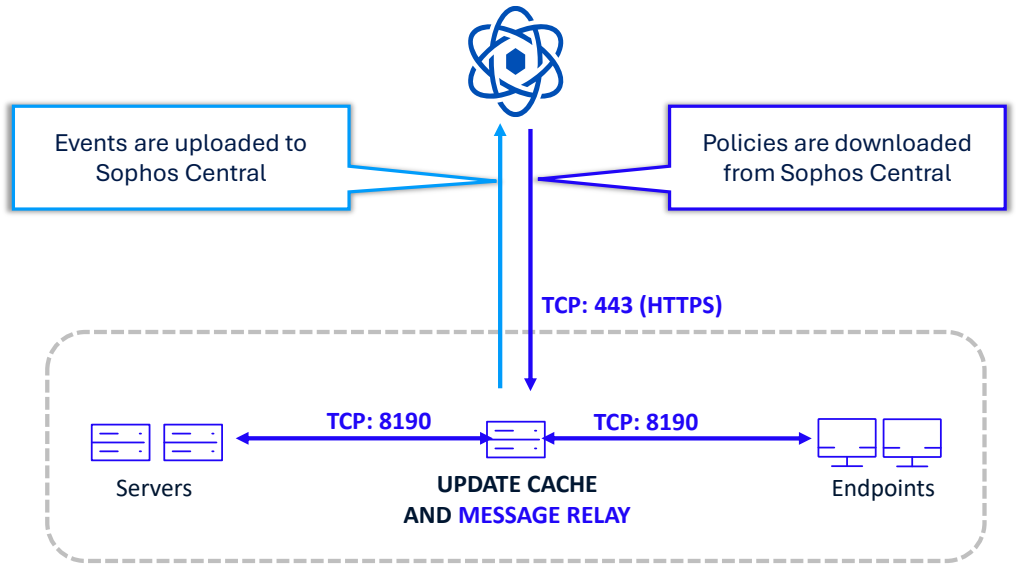
[Additional Information]
We recommend viewing the FAQ available in **KB-000035498**. Sophos Server: Update Cache and Message Relay FAQs
https://support.sophos.com/support/s/article/KB-000035498



It is important to understand that an Update Cache does not replace or override Sophos Central as an available update location, and it does not work in the same way as an air gap. Your protected devices still require access to Sophos Central.

We strongly recommend that you take the time to understand what an Update Cache will do if configured on your network. The misconfiguration of an Update Cache can cause unintended consequences.

What is a Message Relay?



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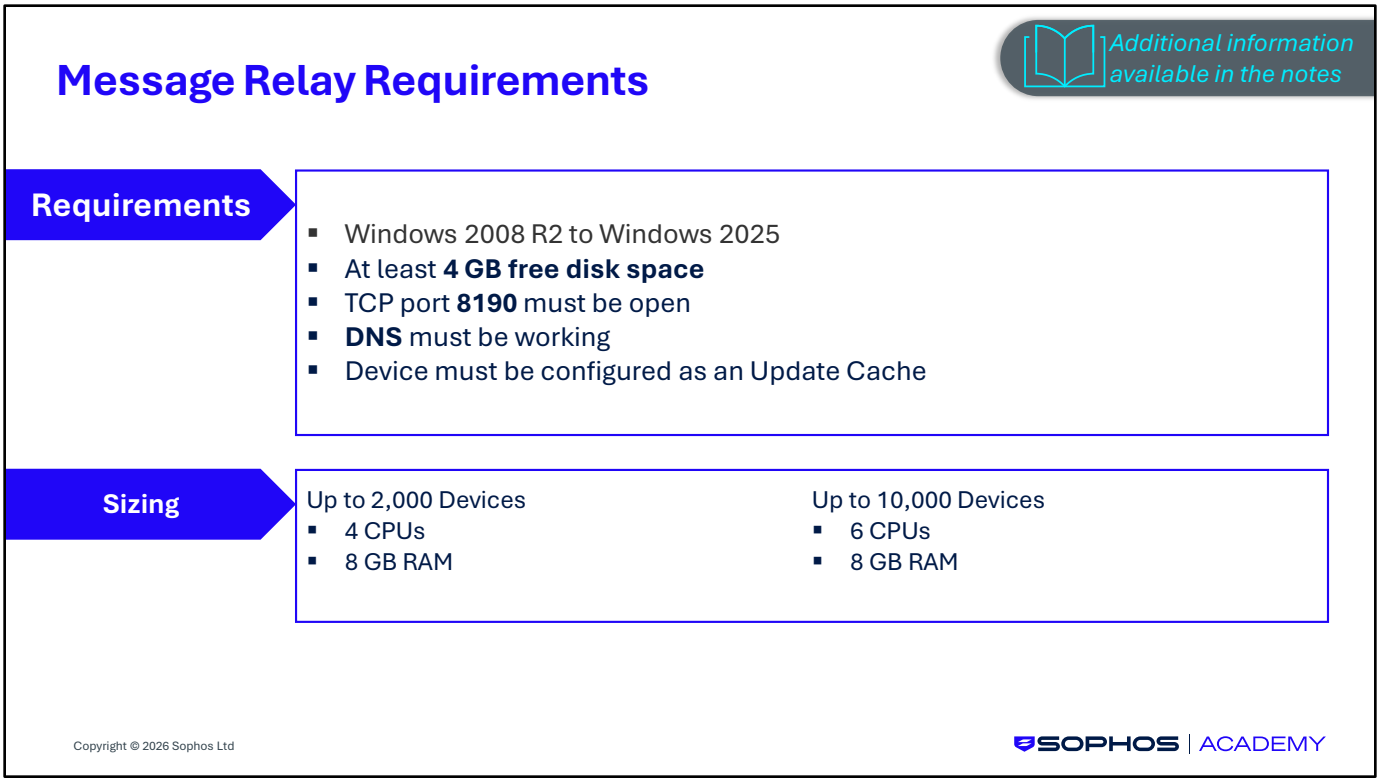
If there are devices on a network that do not have direct internet access, you can make use of a Message Relay.

A Message Relay enables devices to communicate all policy and reporting data via a Message Relay server. All management traffic is routed through the message relay. We define management traffic as any communication traffic that is sent and received by the Management Communication System (MCS) on a protected device.

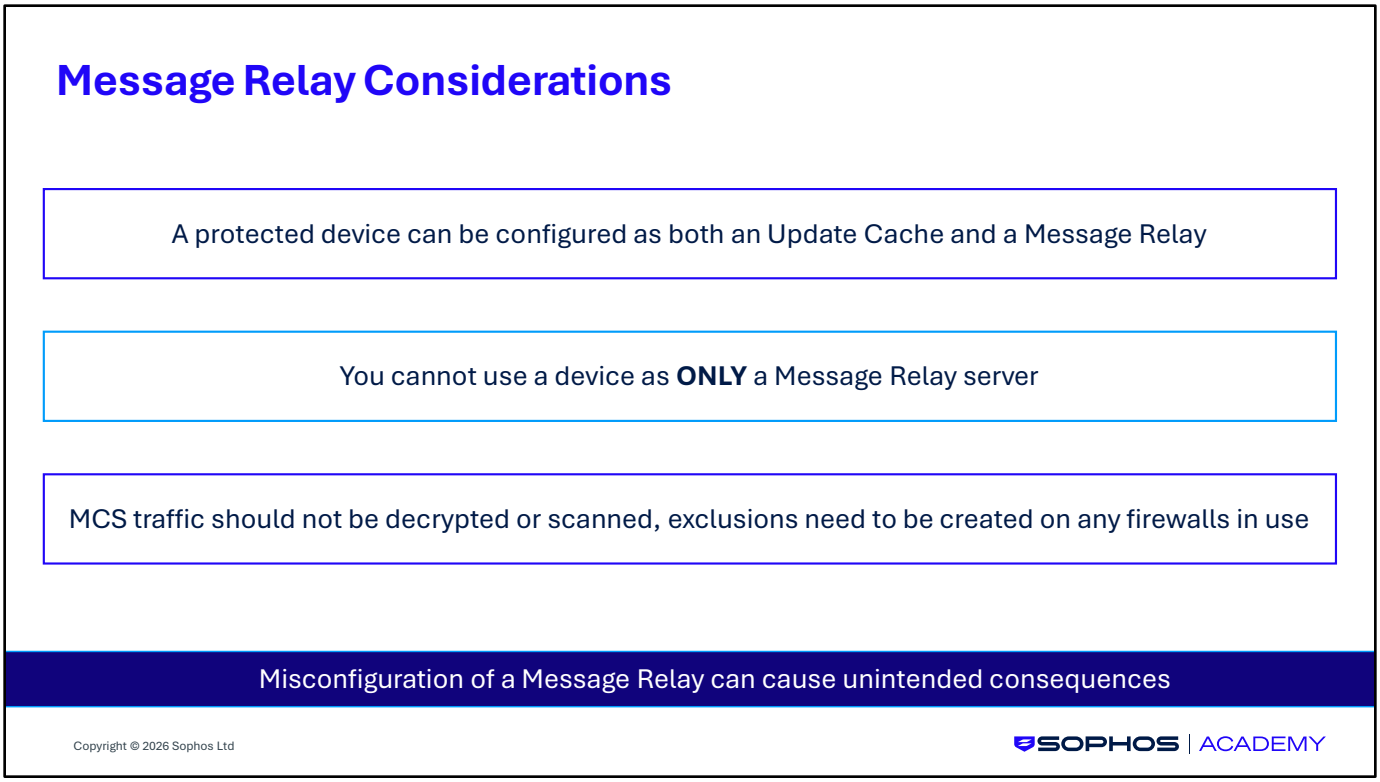
Protected devices use MCS to download new policies from Sophos Central and to upload events, such as malware detections or health status changes, to Sophos Central.



For a device to be used as a Message Relay, it must be a Windows Server running 2008 R2 or later. It must have at least 4 GB of free disk space, and TCP port 8190 must be available and accessible for devices to communicate. Additionally, the device must be configured as an Update Cache.

Note the sizing requirements shown here when using a device as both an Update Cache and a Message Relay.

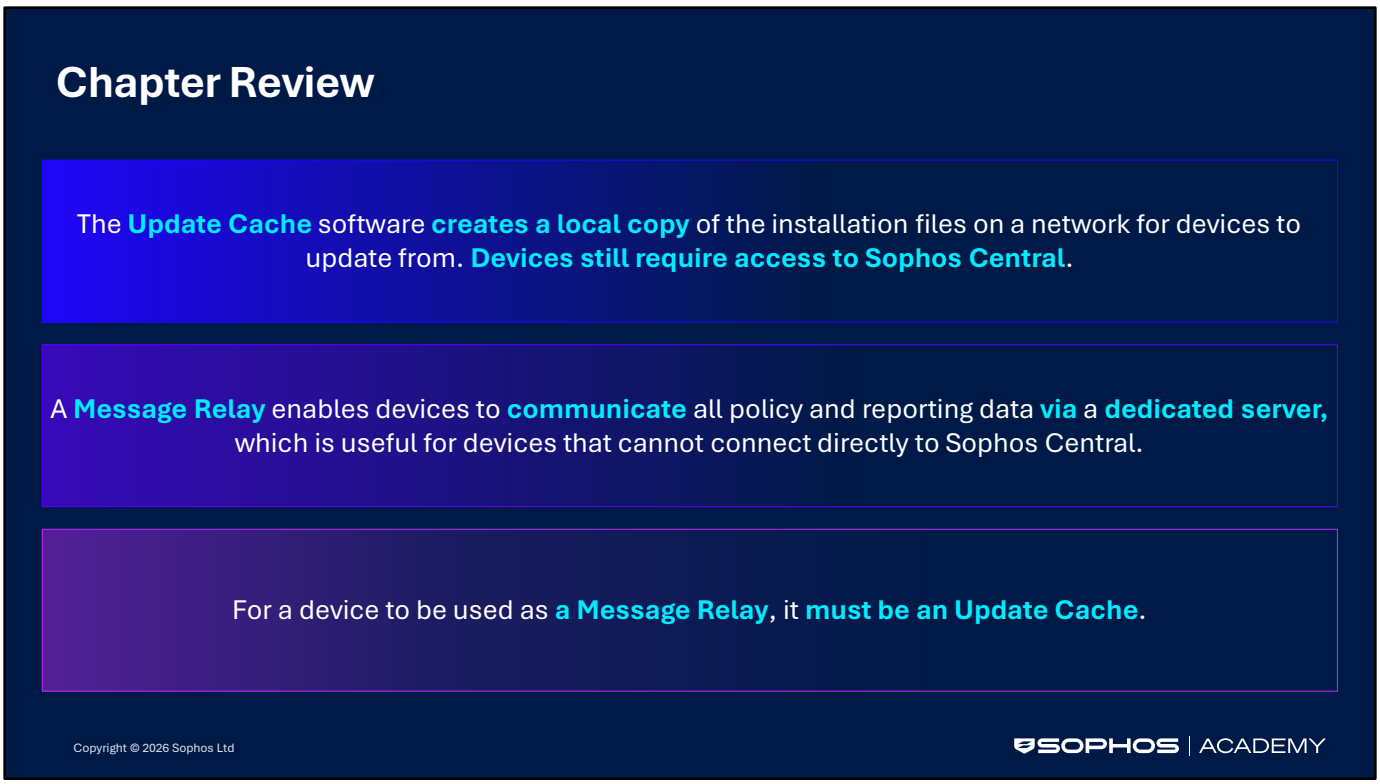
[Additional Information]
We recommended viewing the FAQ available in **KB-000035498**. Sophos Server: Update Cache and Message Relay FAQs
https://support.sophos.com/support/s/article/KB-000035498



A protected device can be configured as an Update Cache and as a Message Relay. However, you cannot use a device as **only** a Message Relay server.

We strongly recommend that you take the time to understand what a Message Relay will do in your network if configured correctly. A Message Relay misconfiguration can cause unintended consequences.

It is important that MCS traffic is not subject to decryption and scanning; exclusions may need to be created on any firewalls in use.



Here are the three main things you learned in this chapter.

The Update Cache software creates a local copy of the installation files on a network for devices to update from. Devices still require access to Sophos Central.

A Message Relay enables devices to communicate all policy and reporting data via a dedicated server, which is useful for devices that cannot connect directly to Sophos Central.

For a device to be used as a Message Relay, it must be an Update Cache.

[Additional Information]

Sophos Endpoint
EP2030: Getting Started with Update Cache and Message Relay Deployment

May 2026

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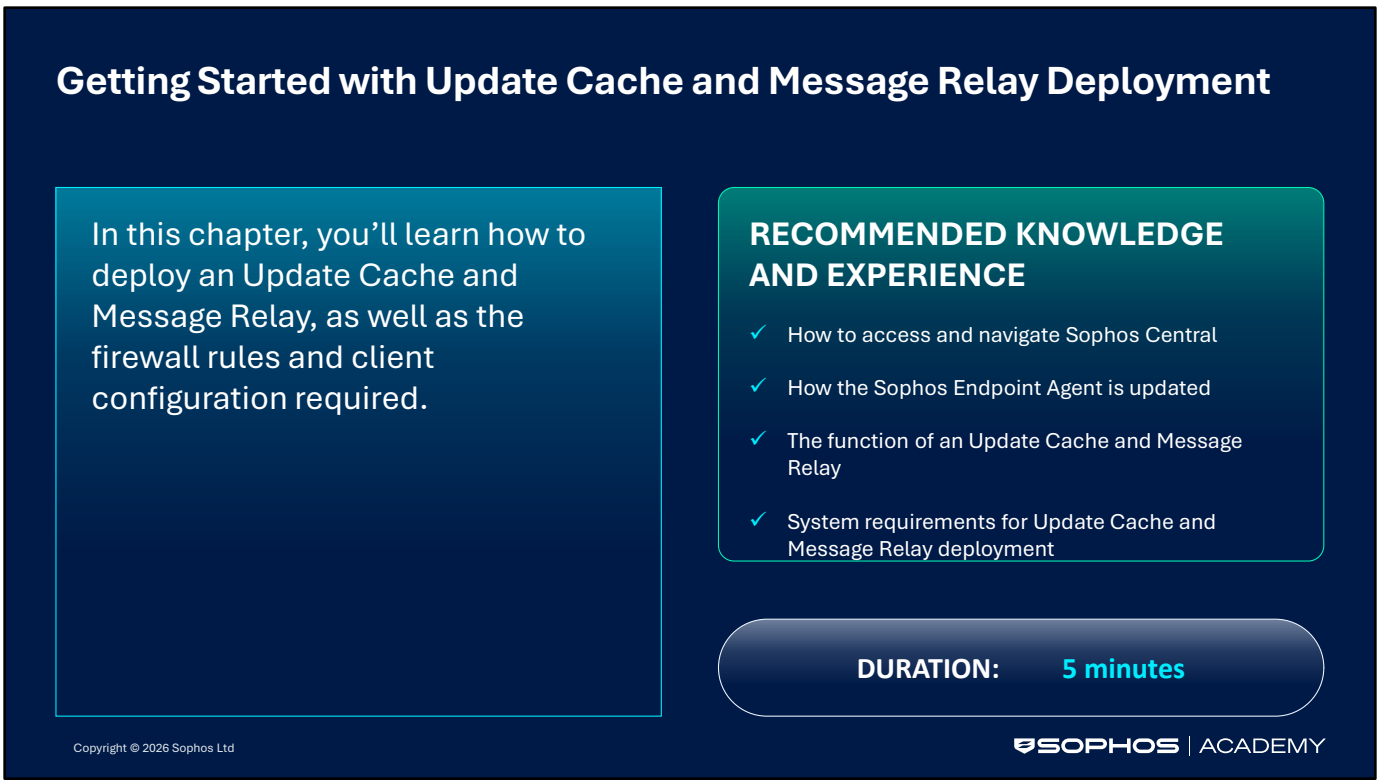
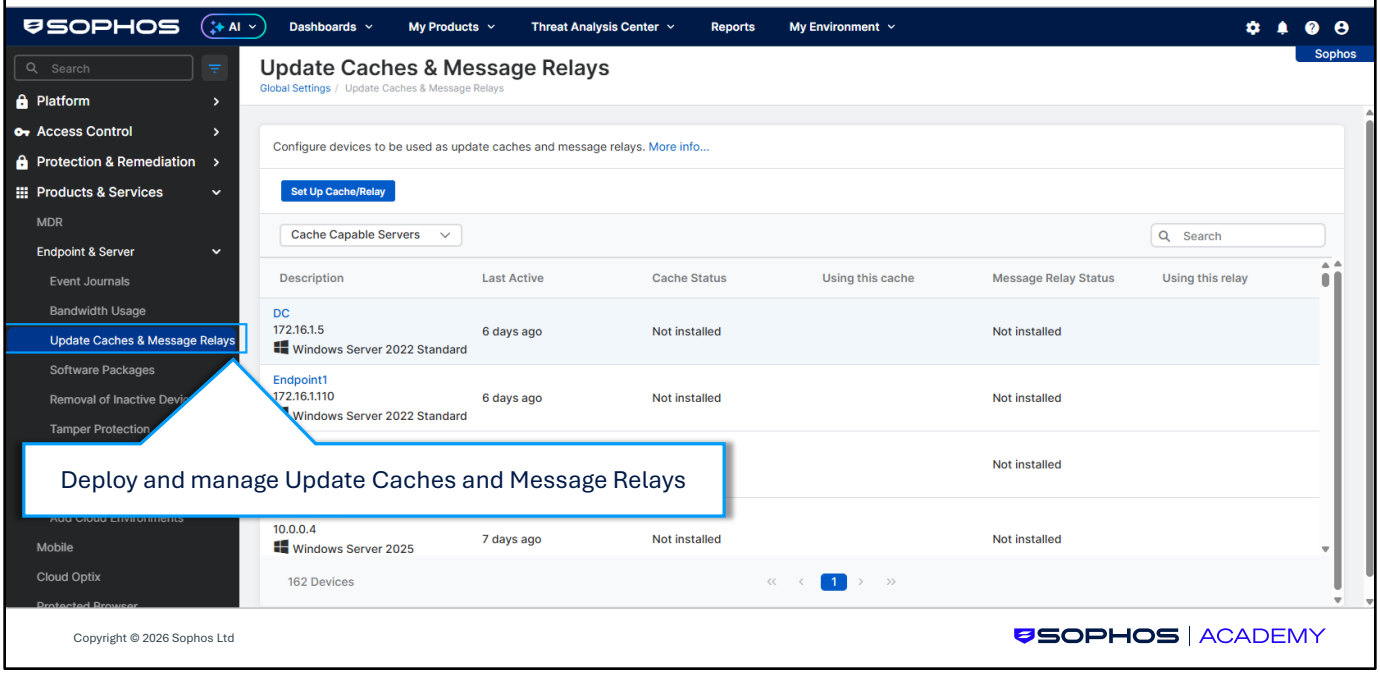


In this chapter, you'll learn how to deploy an Update Cache and Message Relay, as well as the firewall rules and client configuration required.

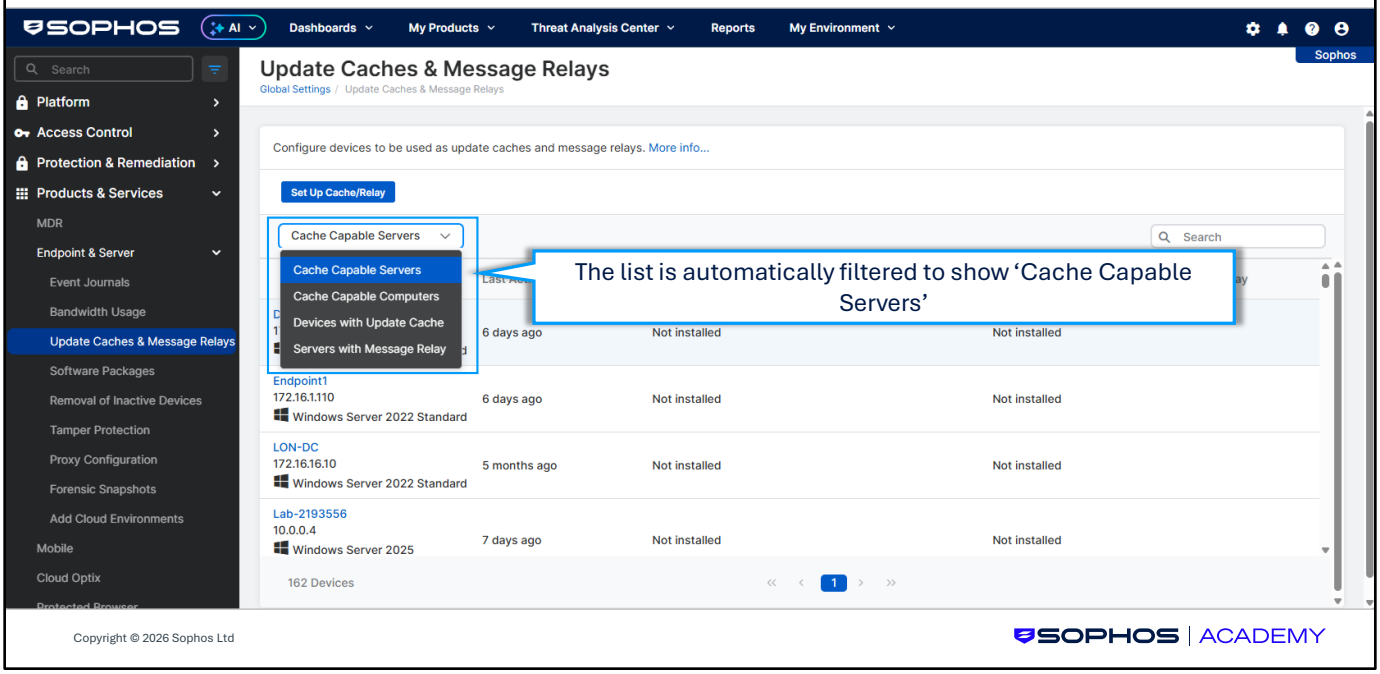
Manage Update Caches and Message Relays



Update Caches and Message Relays are deployed and managed in **Global Settings**.

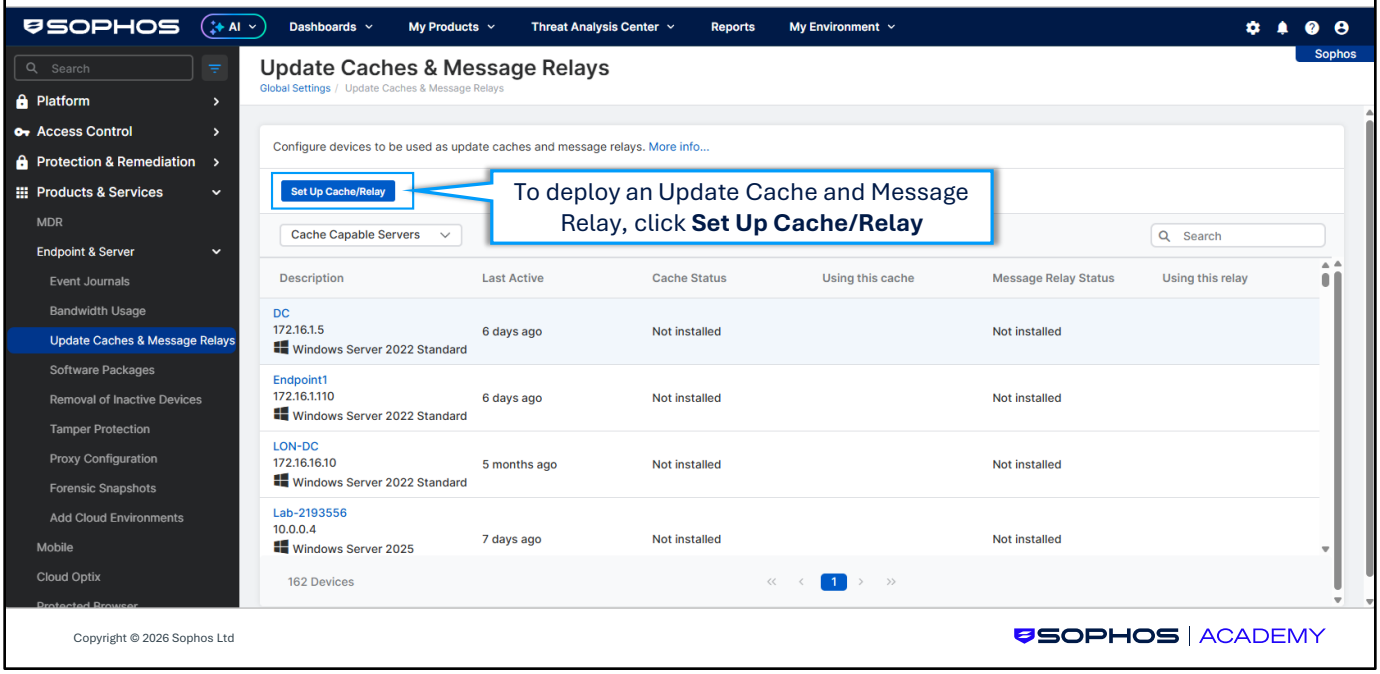
In the Products & Services section, the setting is listed in the **Endpoint & Server** drop-down menu. **Update Caches and Message Relays**.

Manage Update Caches and Message Relays



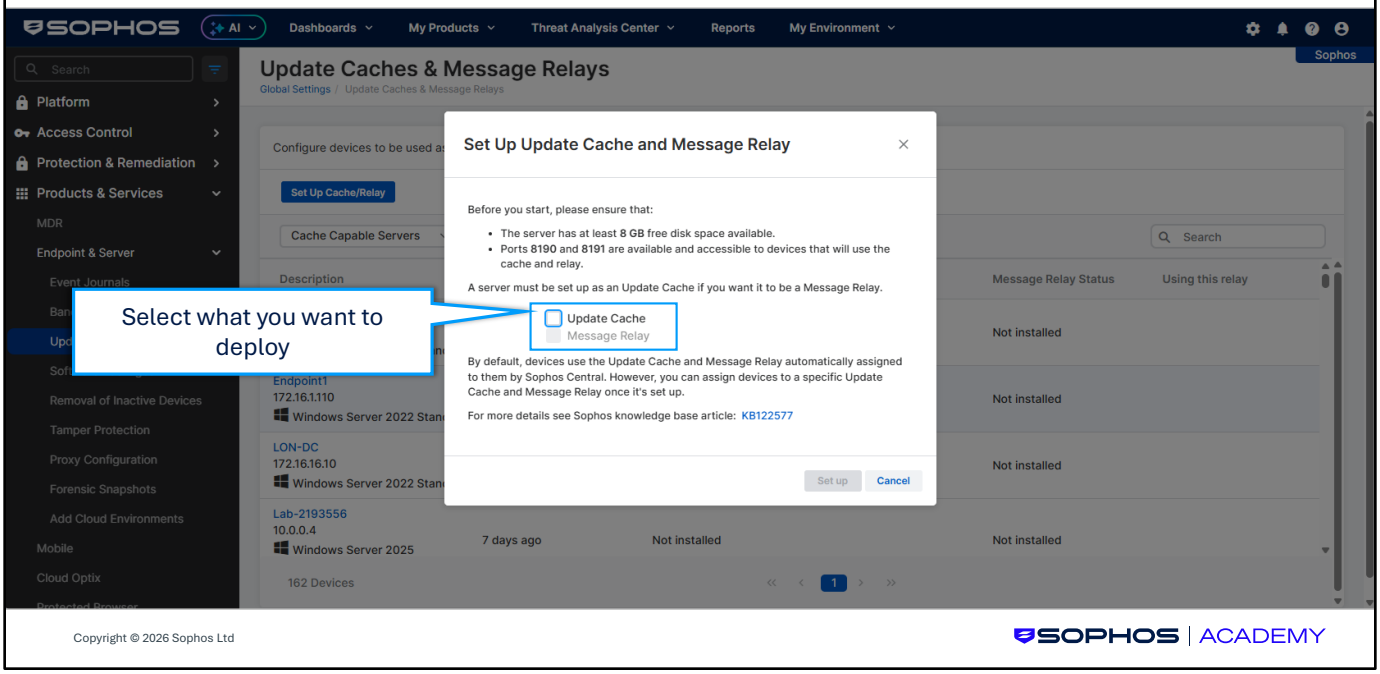
A list of devices displayed is filtered automatically to show 'Cache Capable Servers'. This view can be changed by using the drop-down menu.

Deploy an Update Cache



To deploy an Update Cache and Message Relay, select a Cache Capable device from the list and click **Set Up Cache/Relay**.

Deploy an Update Cache



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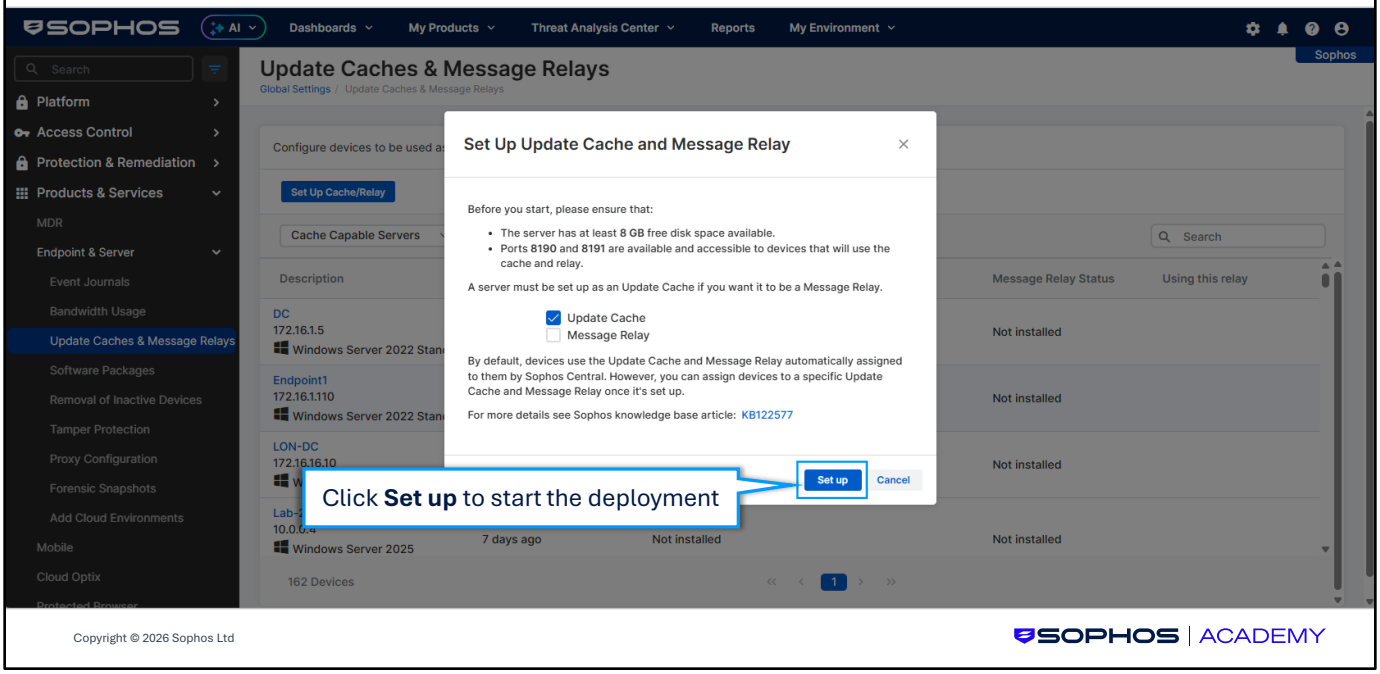
Select what you want to deploy. In this example, we will deploy only an Update Cache.

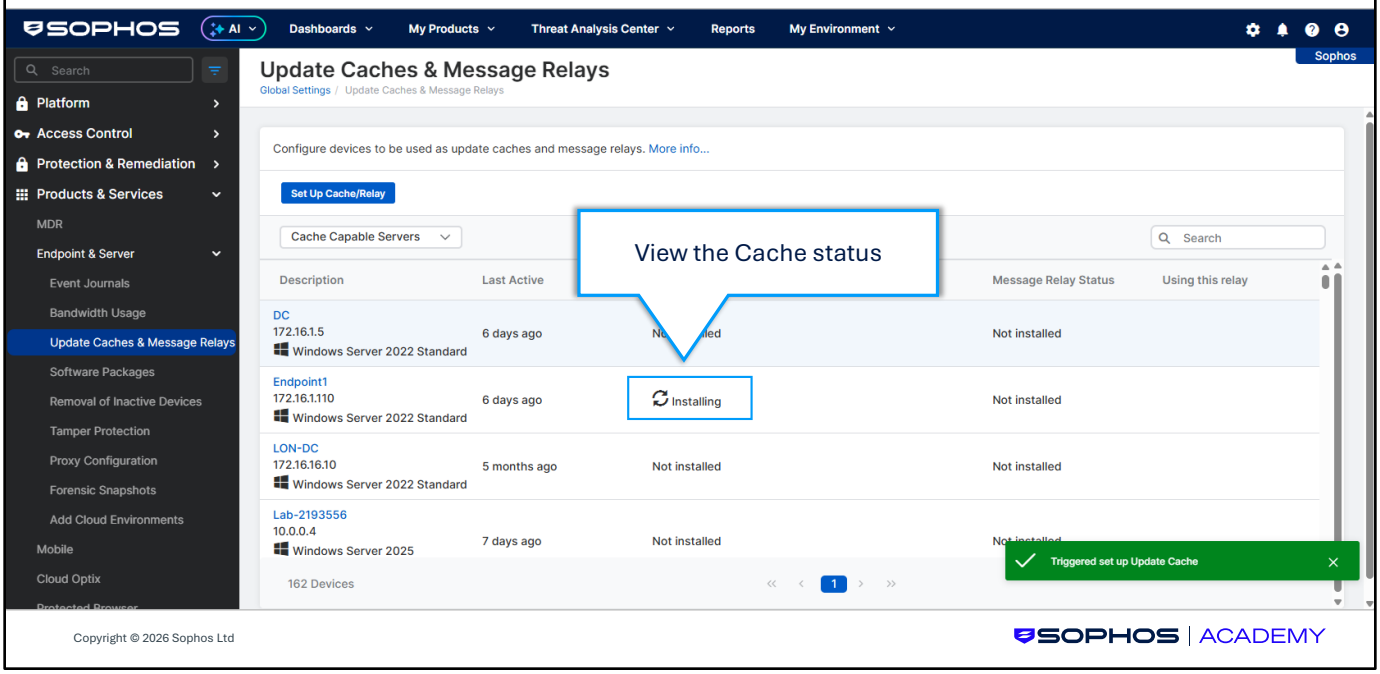
Deploy and Update Cache



Notice that you can only select Message Relay if you have selected Update Cache. This is because a server cannot be a Message Relay without being an Update Cache.

Click **Set Up** to start the deployment.

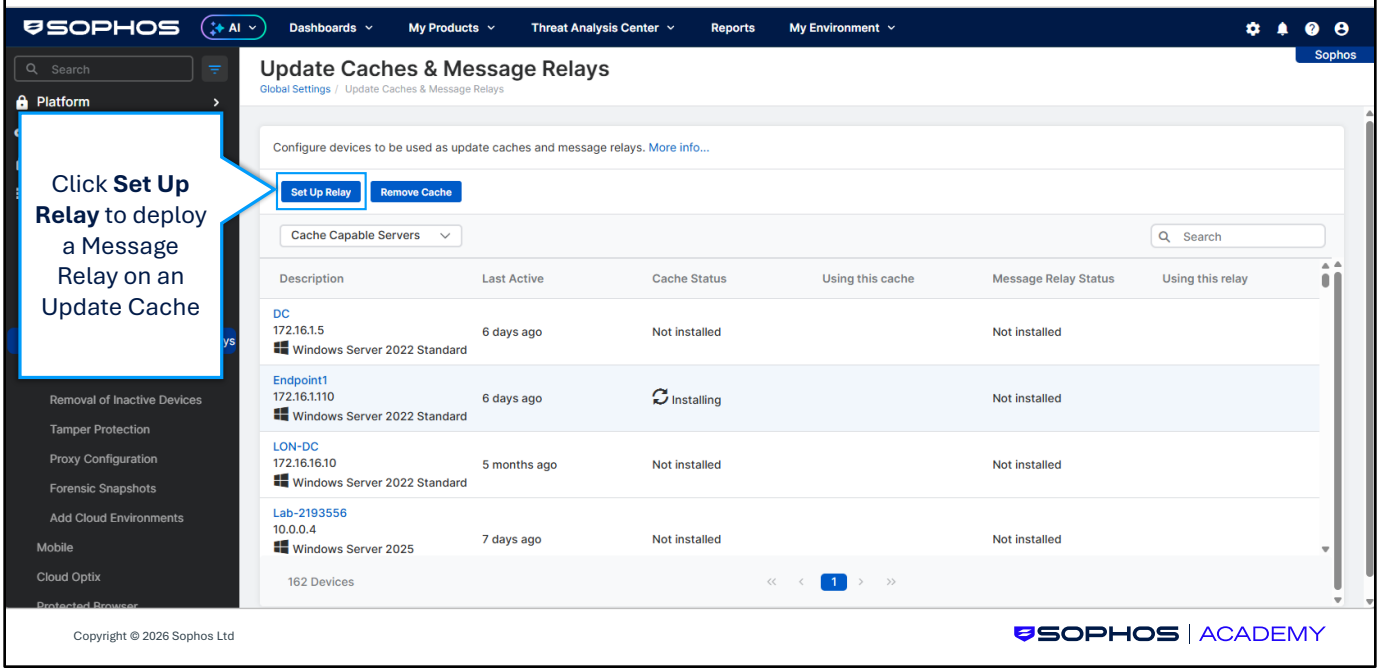
Installing, Configuring, and Downloading



The device receives a new AutoUpdate policy and performs an update to download and install the Update Cache. This is indicated by the ‘installing’ cache status.

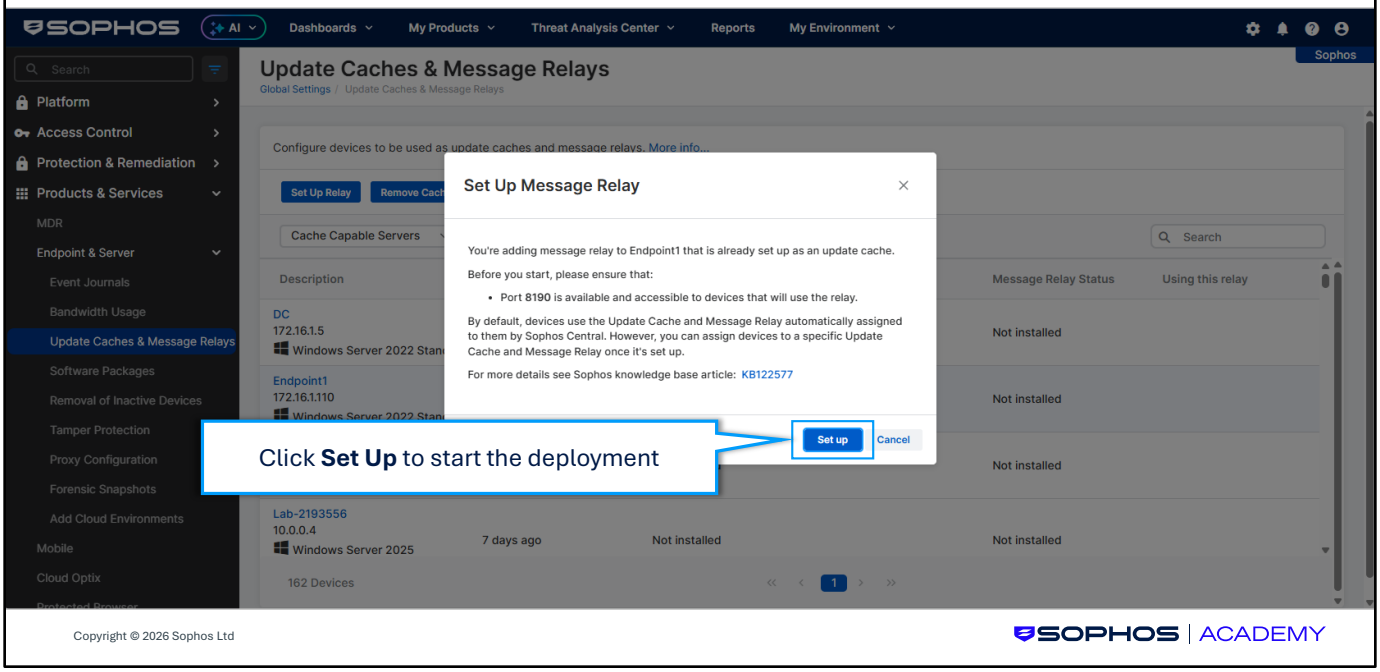
The next step is to download the Update Cache policy and configure the device. Once configured, the Update Cache will download the software to the repo folder; this may take some time to complete.

Deploying a Message Relay



You can deploy a Message Relay to a device that has already been setup as an Update Cache by selecting the device and then clicking **Set Up Relay**.

Deploying a Message Relay



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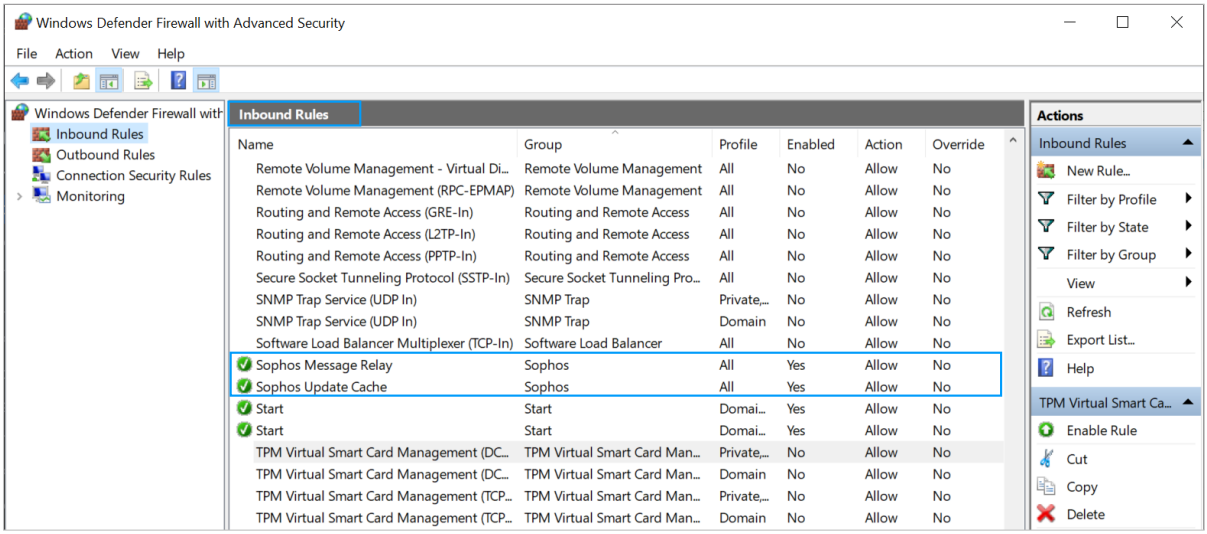
You are reminded that port 8190 must be available and accessible to devices that will use the relay. Click **Set up** to start the deployment.

Firewall Rules



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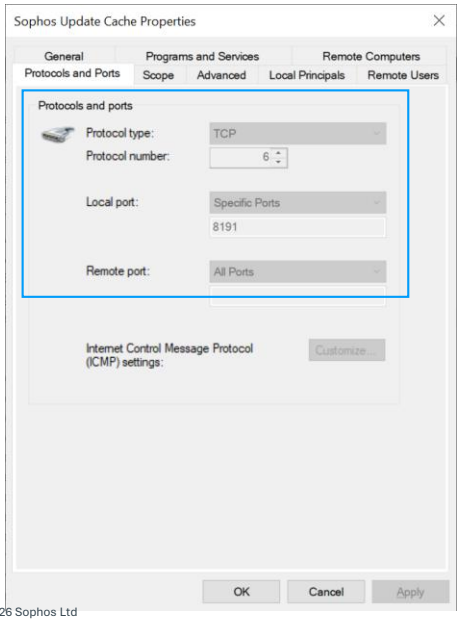
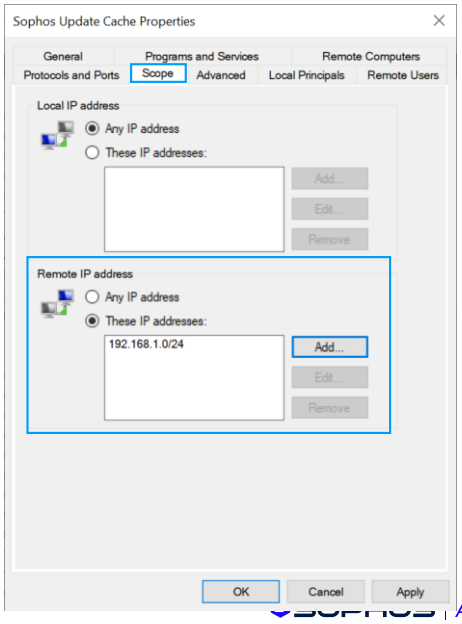
As part of an Update Cache and Message Relay deployment, inbound firewall rules are added to the Windows firewall to allow TCP traffic to port 8191 for an Update Cache and port 8190 for a Message Relay.

Firewall Rules





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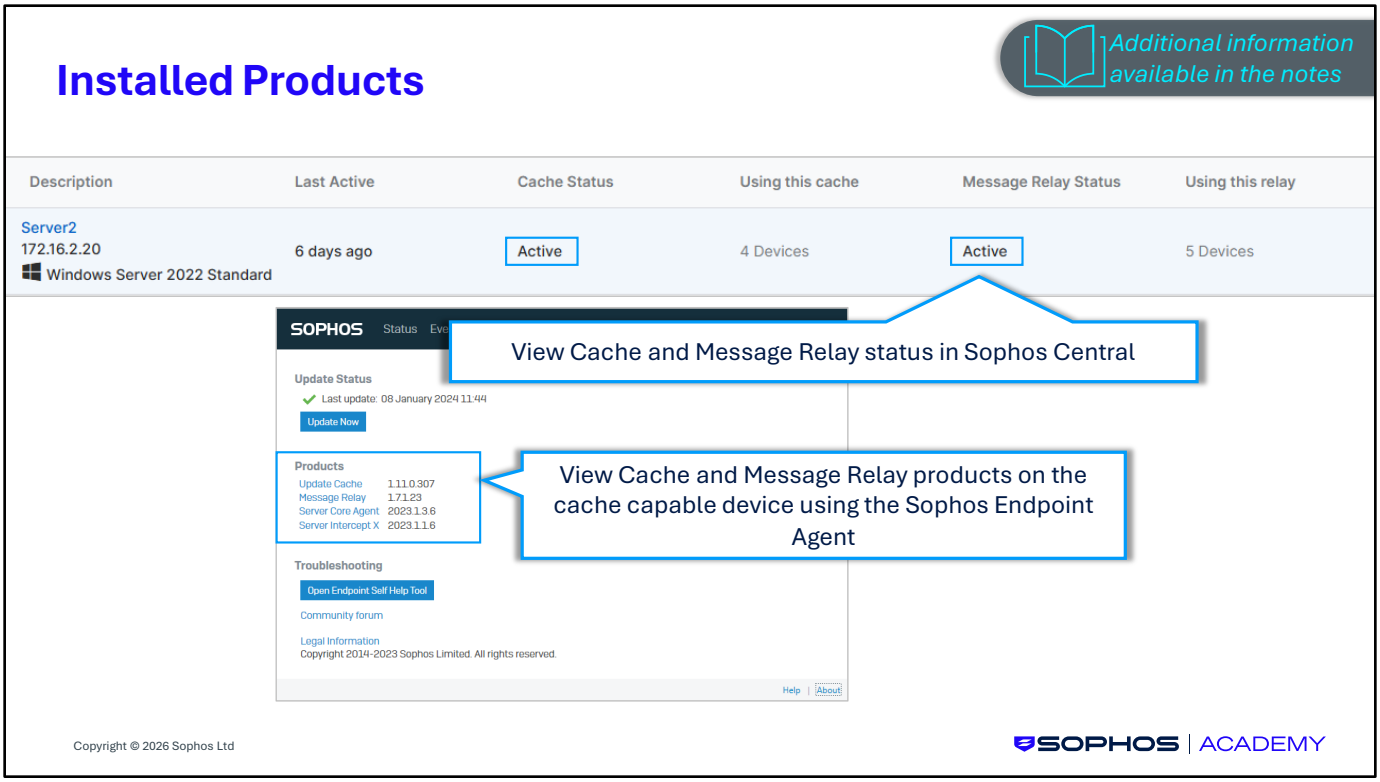
Details of the firewall rules can be viewed. The example shows the protocol and ports configured for the Update Cache rule. If required, the rules can be modified to control access to the Update Cache and Message Relay.

This is achieved on the **Scope** tab of the rule properties by replacing the default of 'Any IP address' with the allowed IP addresses.

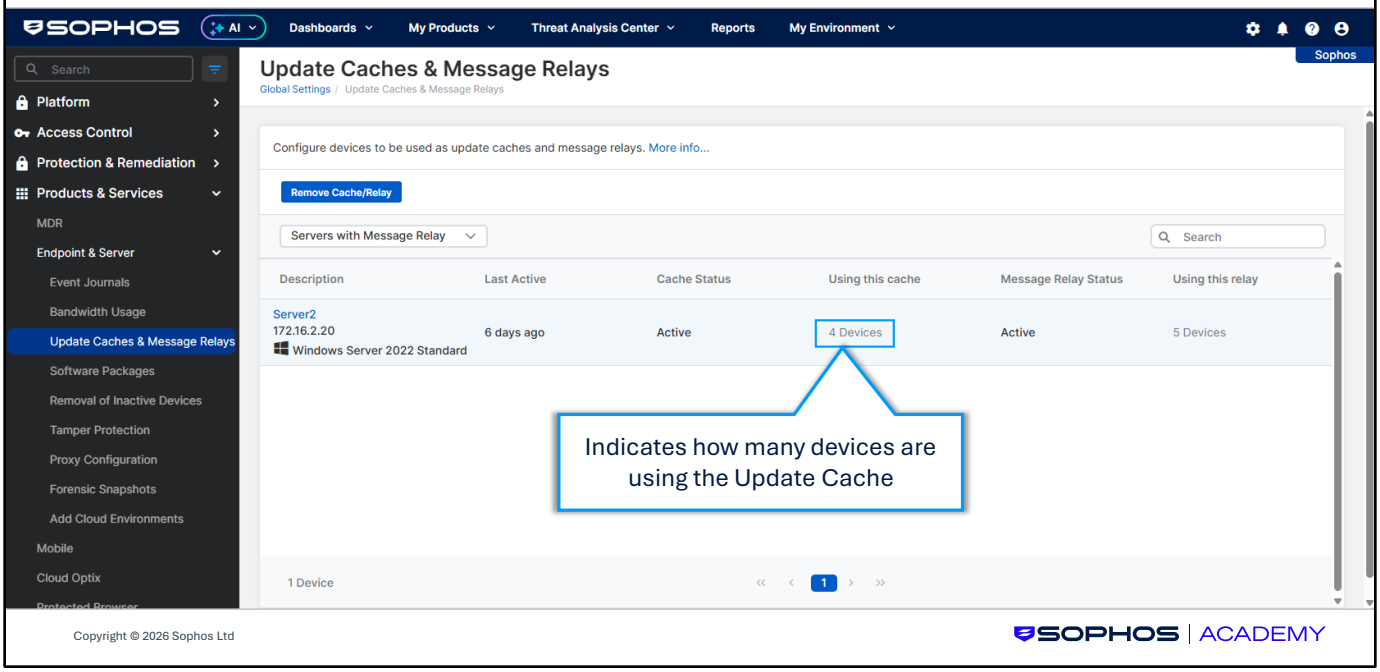


You can view the successful deployment of an Update Cache and Message Relay in Sophos Central by navigating to **General Settings > Manage Update Caches and Message Relays**. The 'Cache Status' and 'Message Relay Status' will show as 'Active'. You can also confirm the deployment on the Cache Capable device by opening the Sophos Endpoint Agent.

Click **About** in the bottom right-hand corner. A list of installed products is displayed. Update Cache and Message Relay should be listed.

[Additional Information]
You can view a video of Update Cache and Message Relay deployment here: Sophos Central: Configure Update Caches and Message Relays - Sophos Techvids – Expert Tutorials & Cybersecurity Insights
https://techvids.sophos.com/watch/EvRDgY9Tbn9eNMGthq4BYr

Managing Devices



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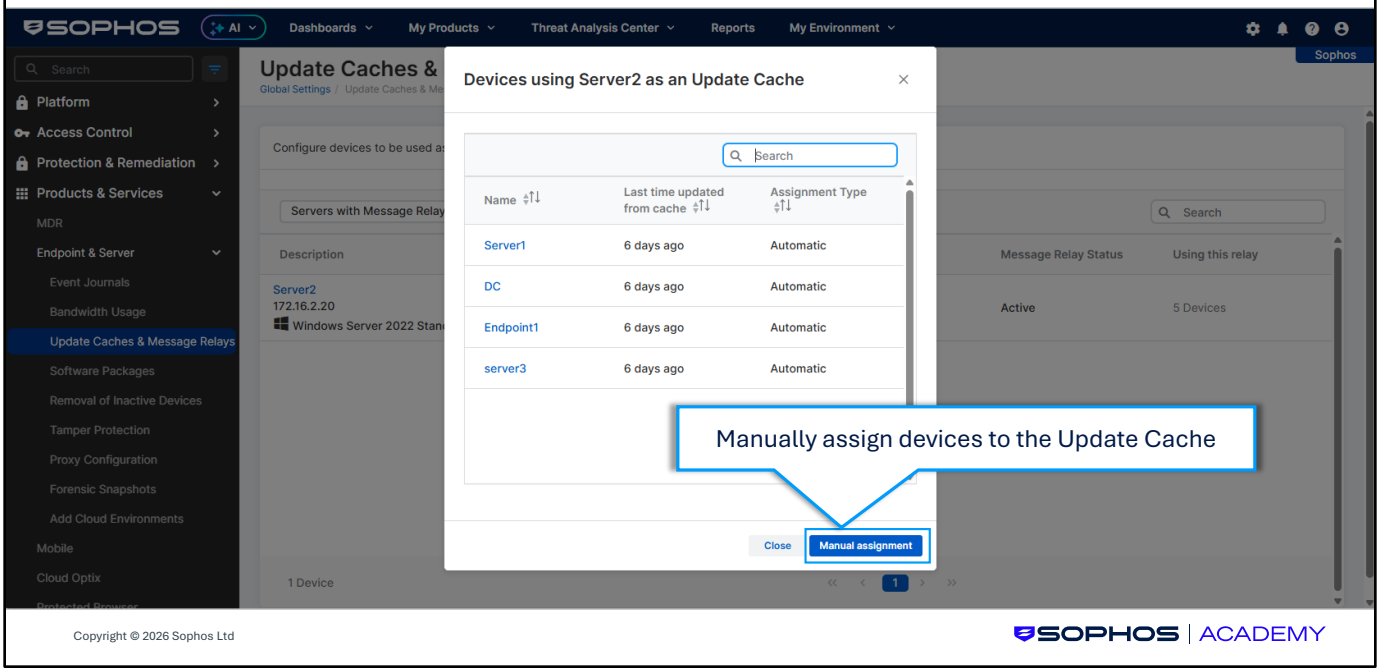
Protected devices will automatically use the closest Update Cache; however, you can manage which devices use the Update Cache manually if required.

This example shows that two devices are currently using the Update Cache. The number of devices in the ‘using this cache’ column is a clickable link.

Managing Devices



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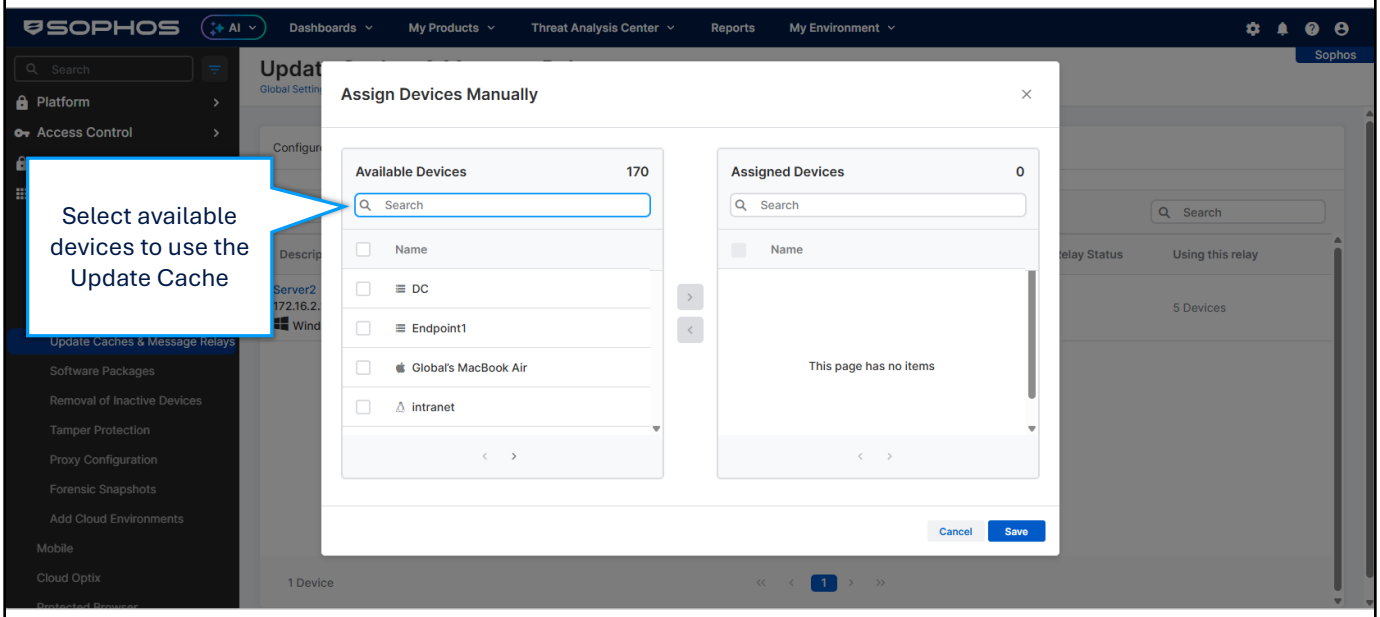
Clicking on the link allows you to see which devices are using the Update Cache. View this a few hours following deployment to ensure that no devices are updating from an Update Cache that should not be.

To manually manage devices that are using the Update Cache, click **Manual assignment**. As Message Relays must be deployed with an Update Cache, assignments made for any Message Relay will also apply to the Update Cache.

Managing Devices



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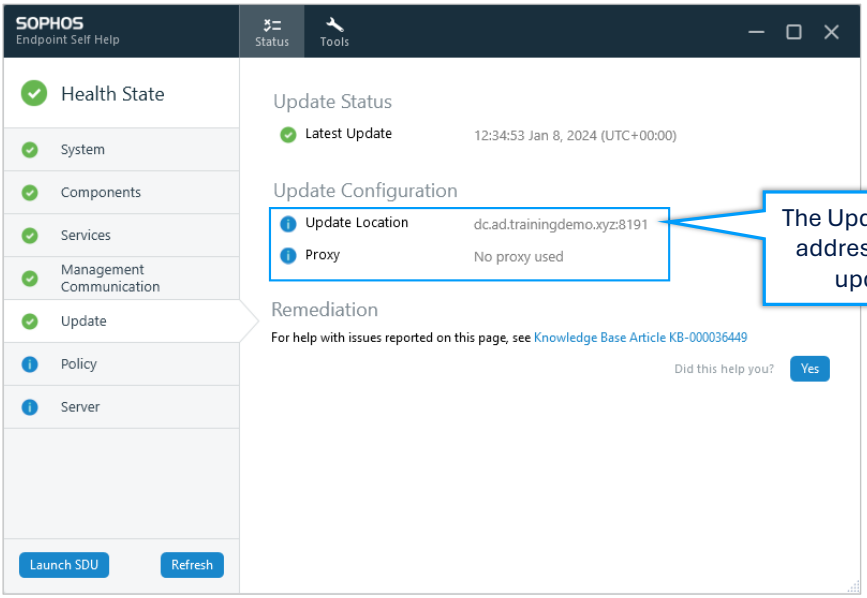
To assign devices manually, move them from the 'Available Computers' list in the left column to the 'Assigned Computers' list in the right column.

This function is most useful for overriding outlying devices that may be numerically close to an inappropriate Update Cache.

Note that it is not possible to select computer groups for Update Cache and Message Relay assignment.

Managing Devices



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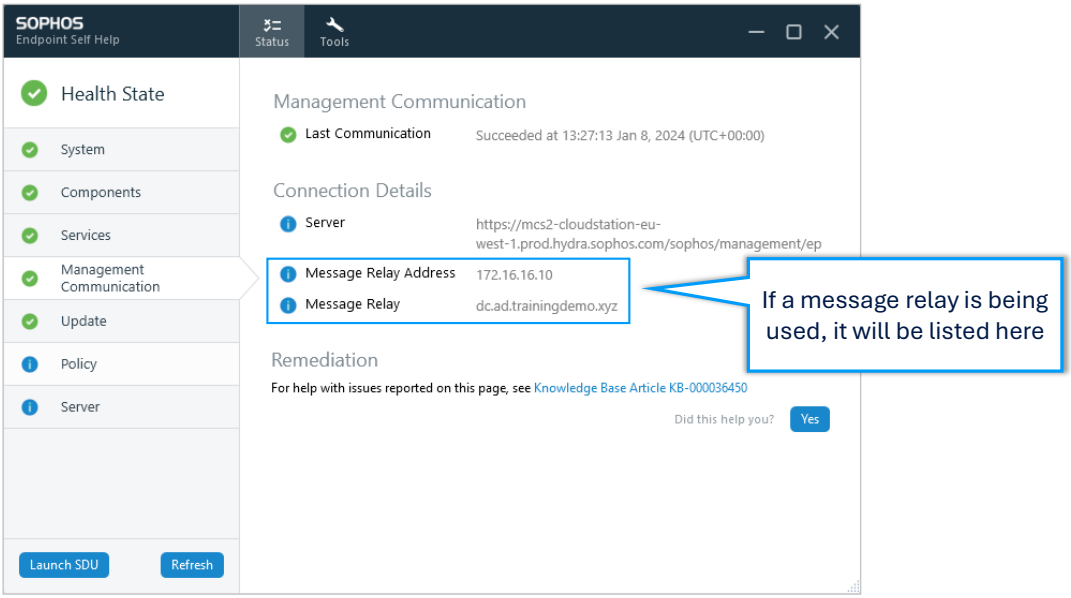
On a protected device, you can use the Endpoint Self Help Tool to check the updating and communication status.

The 'Update Configuration' section on the **Update** tab displays the update location. If the device is using an Update Cache, the Update Cache server address is shown.

If the device is using Sophos to update, it will show Sophos in the update location.

Managing Devices



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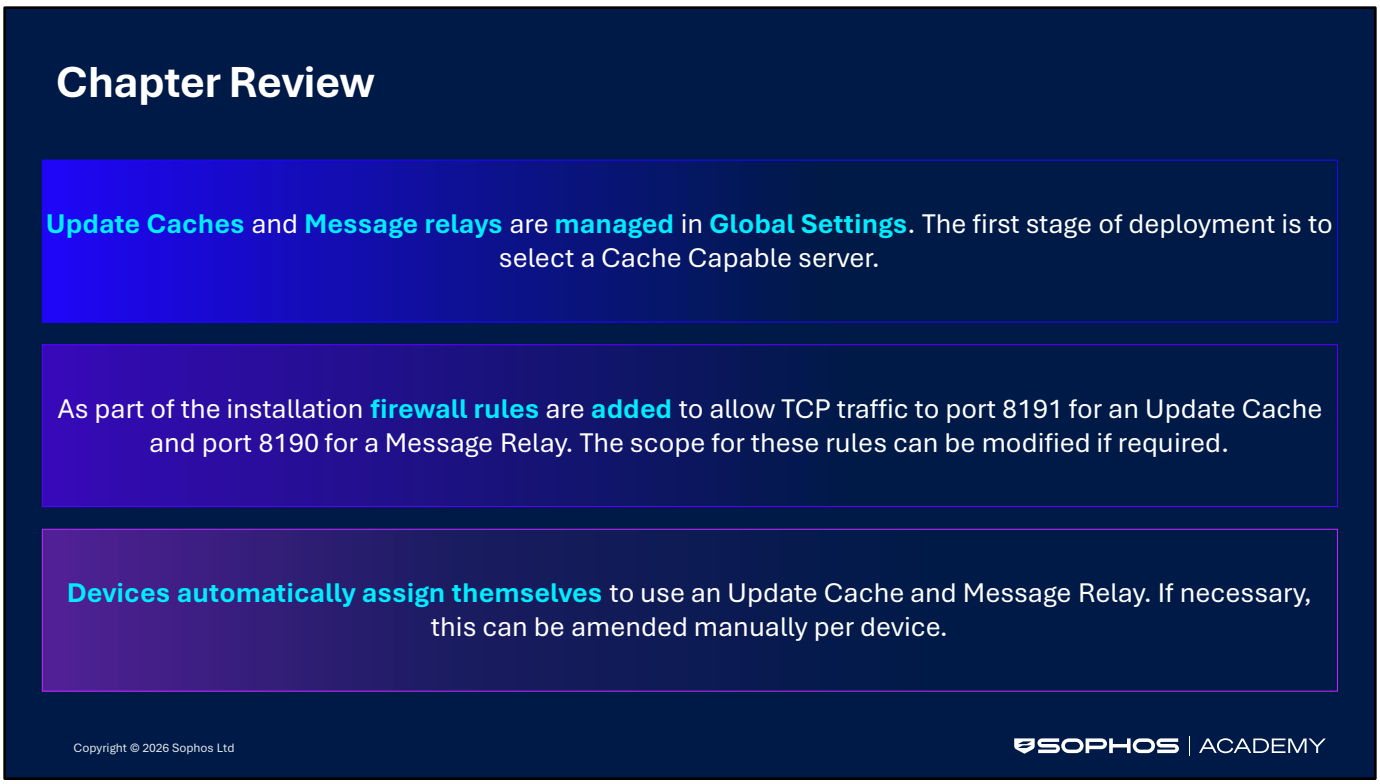
On the **Management Communication** tab, you can view whether a device is using a Message Relay.

The server address of the Message Relay server is displayed.



Here are the three main things you learned in this chapter.

Update Caches and Message Relays are managed in Global Settings. The first stage of deployment is to select a Cache Capable server.

As part of the installation, firewall rules are added to allow TCP traffic to port 8191 for an Update Cache and port 8190 for a Message Relay. The scope for these rules can be modified if required.

Devices automatically assign themselves to use an Update Cache and Message Relay. If necessary, this can be amended manually per device.

Virtual Machine Protection

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[Additional Information]

Sophos Endpoint
EP2505: Getting Started with Sophos Endpoint Virtual Protection

May 2026

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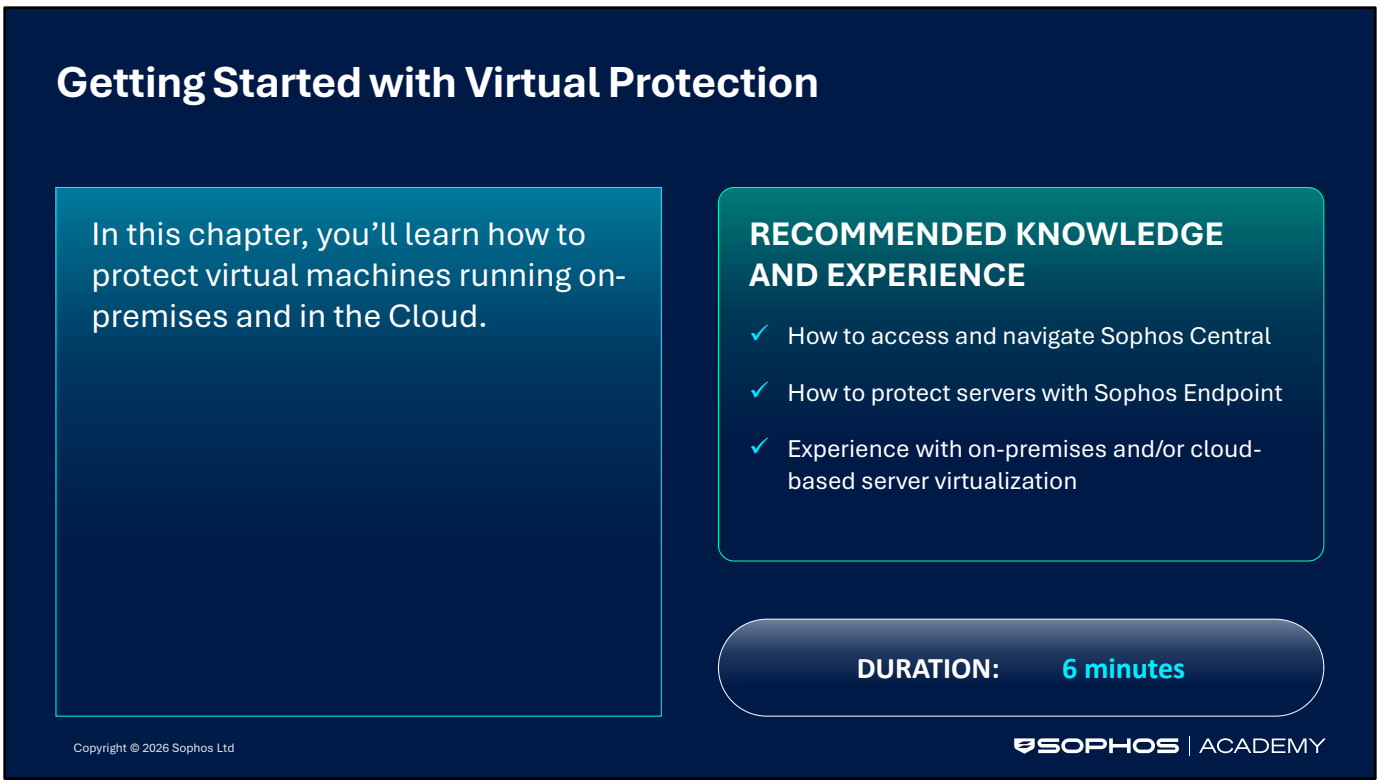
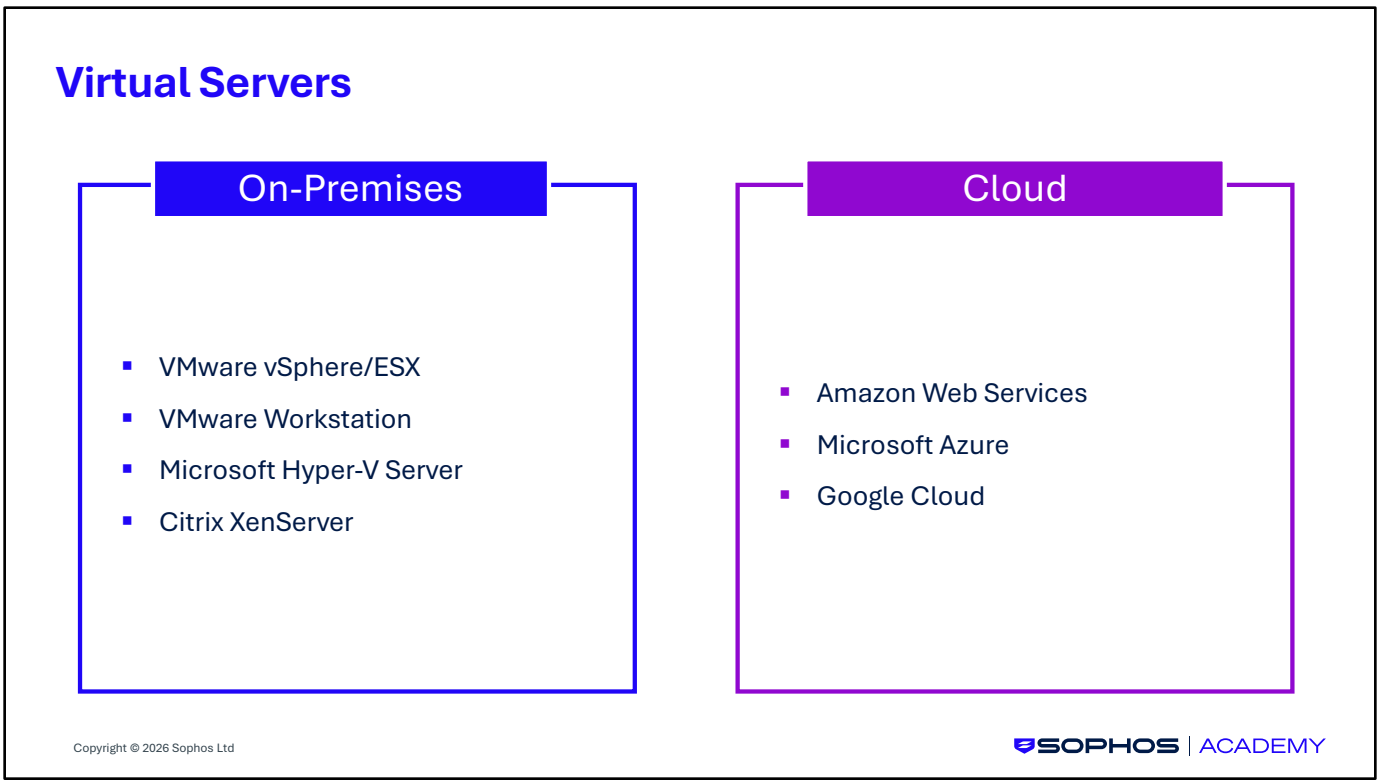


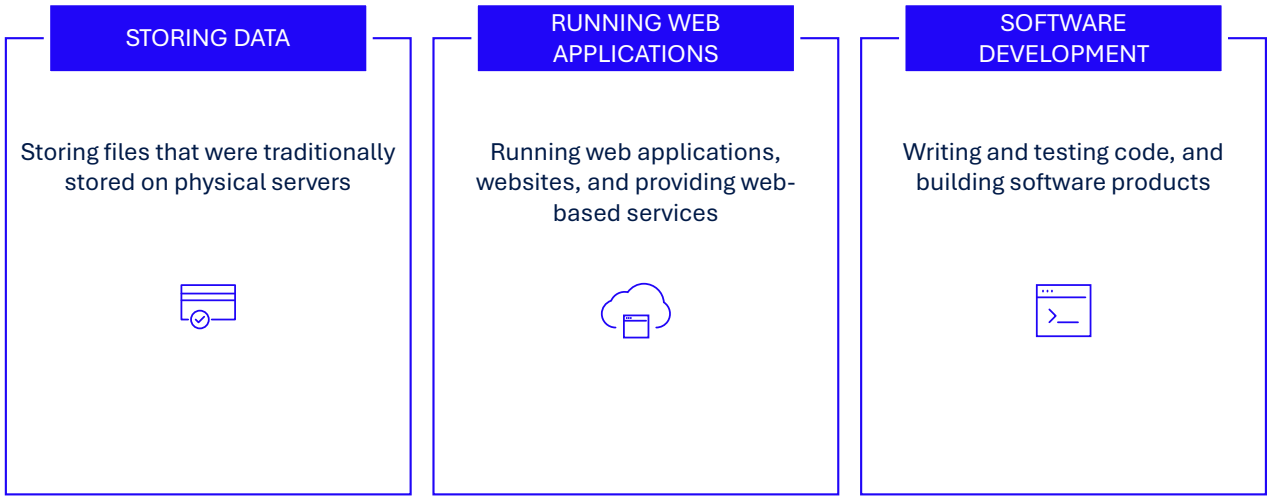
In this chapter, you'll learn how to protect virtual machines running on-premises and in the Cloud.



Sophos Endpoint provides antimalware and anti-ransomware protection to virtual servers in the same way it does for physical servers.

The servers may be hosted on-premises, using platforms such as VMware and Hyper-V, or hosted in the Cloud using Microsoft Azure or Amazon Web Services (AWS).

Cloud-Based Virtual Machines



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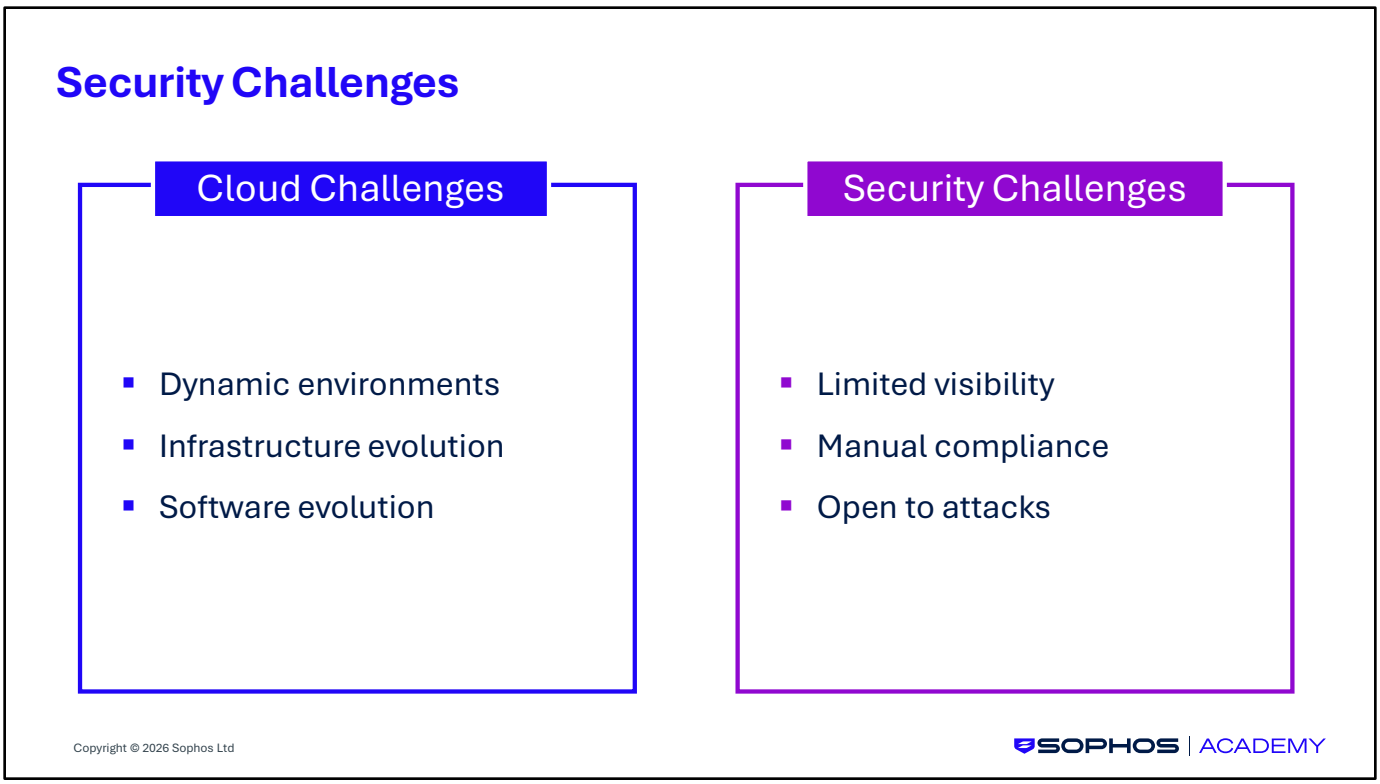
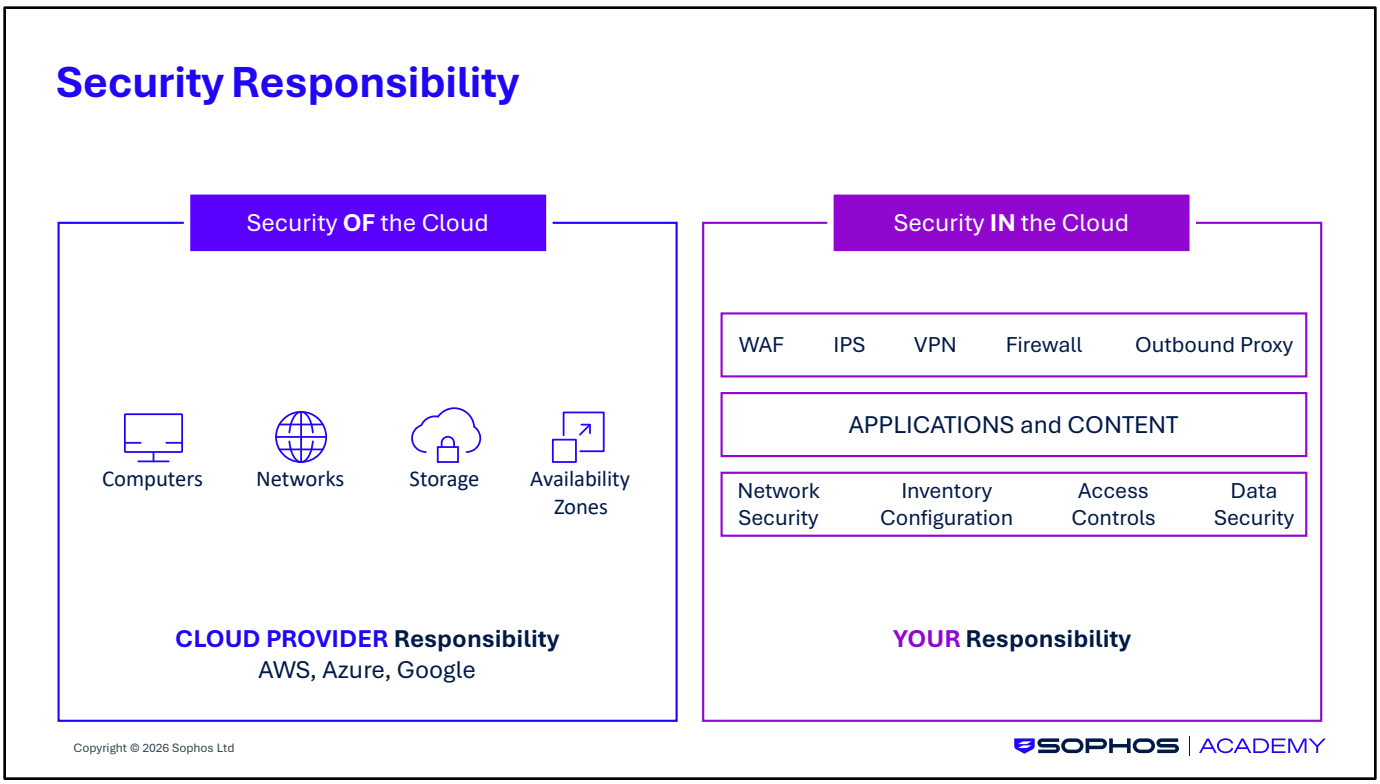
Many organisations use virtual machines hosted in the public cloud as they provide a replacement for physical servers. Instead of maintaining on-premises servers, they store their data in the cloud. Virtual machines are used for running web applications, which could be running a website or providing web-based services. Increasingly software engineers are developing software using public cloud servers as these are quicker and easier to build and remove.



There are several challenges to ensure your cloud resources are secure. The public cloud platform allows for dynamic environments, with multiple virtual machines starting and terminating regularly. This infrastructure can be hard to secure, as you want to provide flexibility and functionality without exposing your resources.

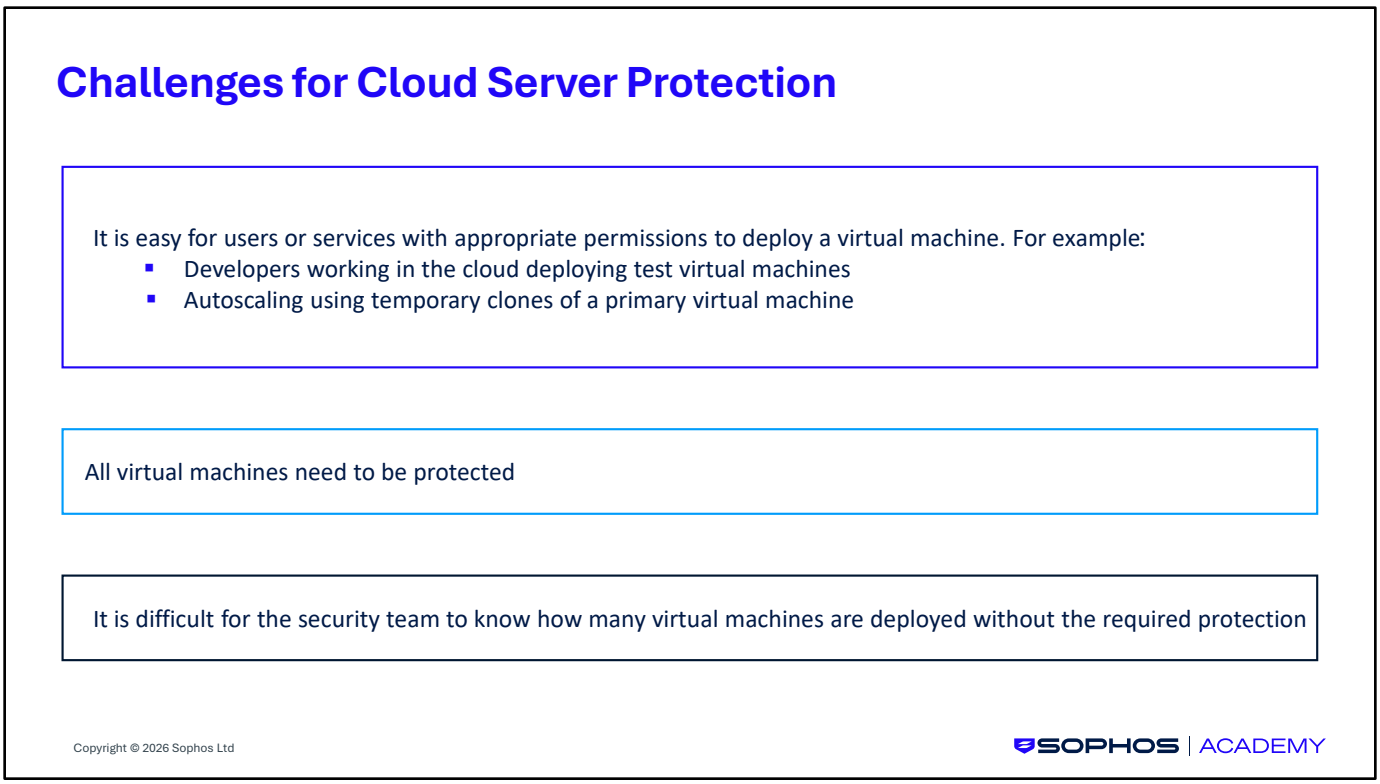
Because of the changing environment, you have limited visibility of what is happening and therefore must manually ensure each virtual machine meets your compliance needs. This can take up a lot of time and whilst you are busy ensuring your network is secure, an attacker could be compromising your resources.



Securing your cloud environment is not all your responsibility. Typically, a cloud provider will take full responsibility for physical assets. For example, the security of data centres, storage, and network availability. However, they can only account for those things within their control.

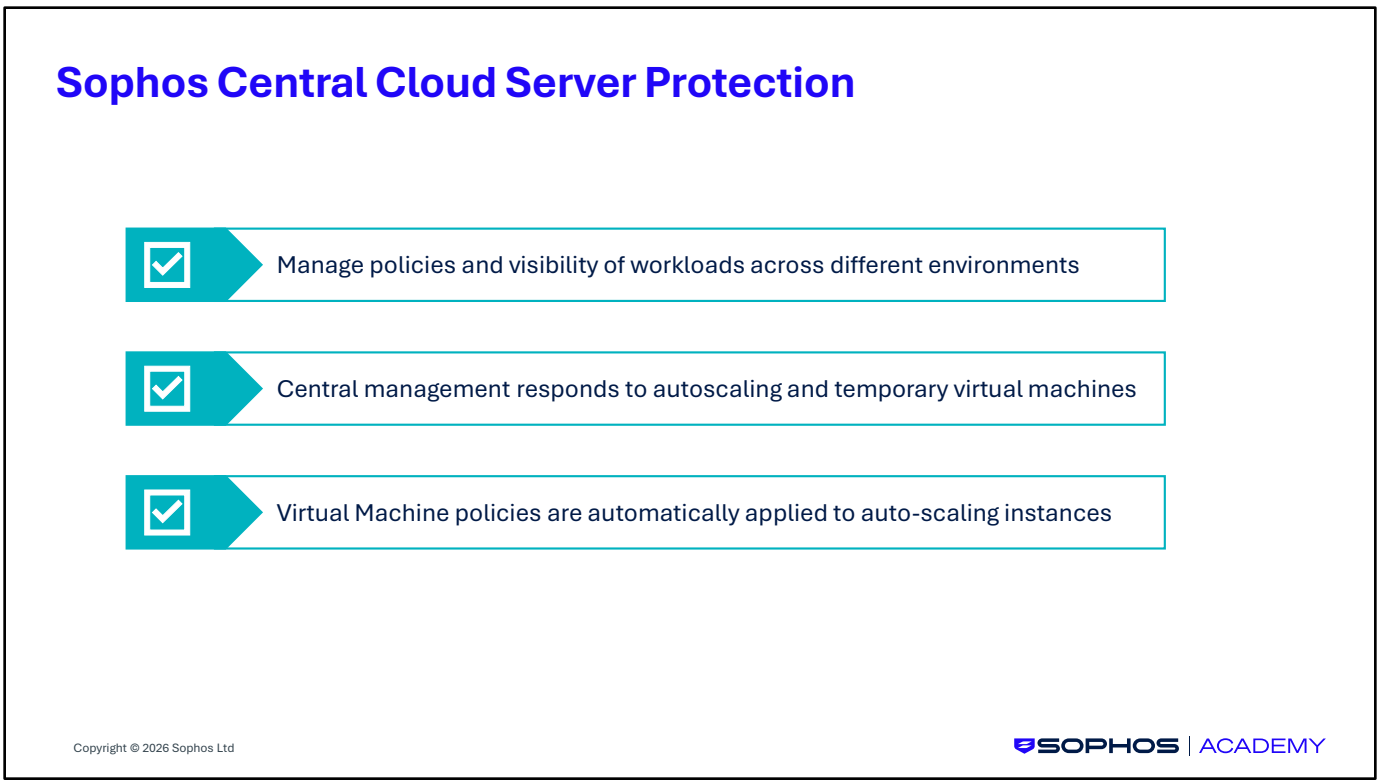
The responsibility of providing a secure platform is shared when the platform is used within your environment. Most cloud providers provide tools to aid with security; however, the user is responsible for ensuring that the tools are implemented and that best practice recommendations are followed. For example, a cloud platform that allows public access is a valid environment, but for most organizations, this will not provide a secure environment for their data and users.

Cloud providers are not all-knowing; they rely on users to let them know what assets need protecting, to what standard of protection, and who can access them. Most providers supply recommendations for extended services via third-party tools that enhance security.



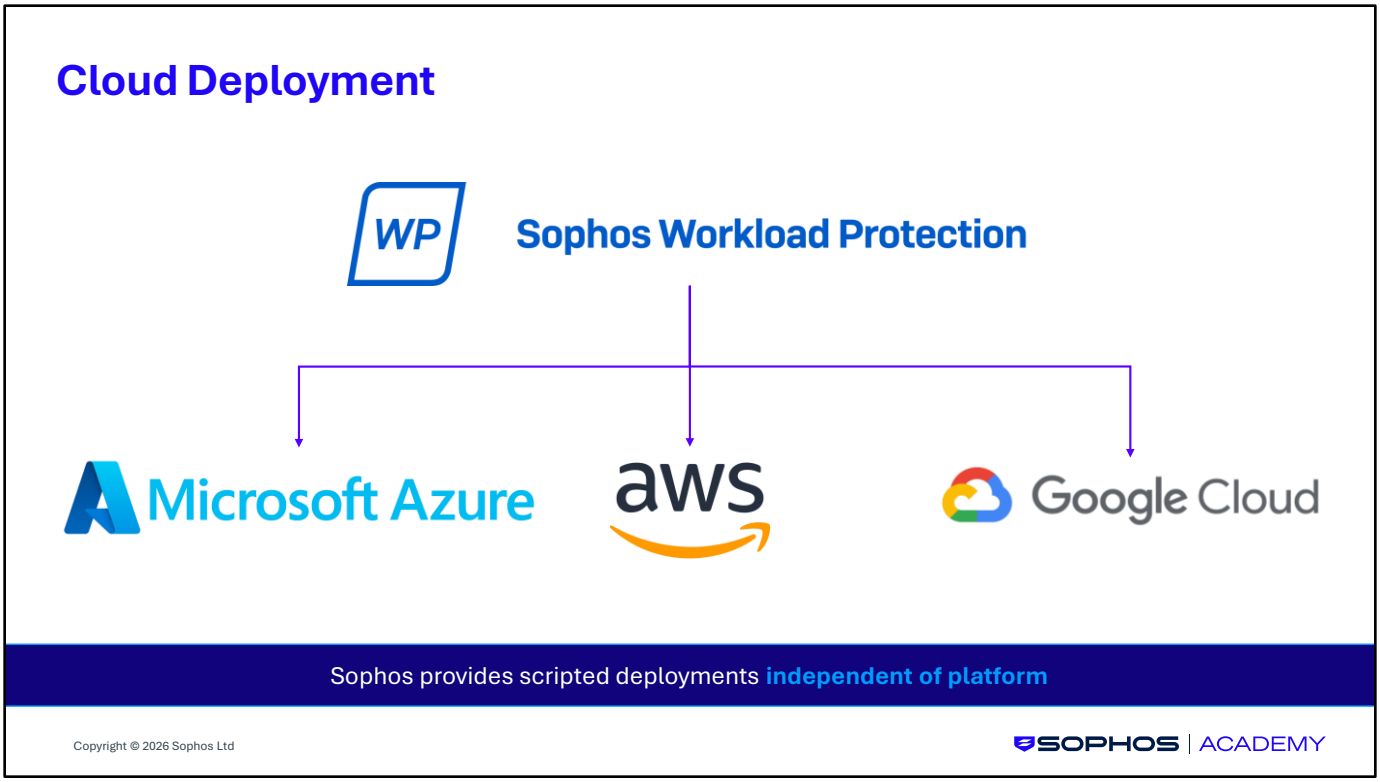
In the cloud, it's very easy for users or services with appropriate permissions to deploy a virtual machine. For example, developers working in the cloud may be deploying multiple test virtual machines. Alternatively, if autoscaling is being utilized, several temporary clones of a primary virtual machine could be deployed and suspended on demand.

In all cases, any provisioned virtual machines need to be protected as you would a physical device. It can be difficult for a security team to know how many virtual machines are provisioned without the required protection.



Sophos Endpoint allows you to secure virtual-hosted Windows and Linux devices. Policies can be applied to all devices, whether they are virtual or physical, making deployment, configuration, and management quick and easy.

Sophos Central management responds to autoscaling and temporary virtual machines by using policies that automatically apply to auto-scaling instances.



Virtual servers can be protected manually in the same way you protect a physical server. Sophos supports manual and scripted automatic installations with scripted deployment independent of the underlying platform. If the script provided can run on the virtual machine, Sophos can install the Sophos Endpoint Agent.

Cloud Deployment

Central Connectors allow you to connect your Sophos Central account to your AWS and/or Azure accounts. This provides integrated features such as **dynamic licensing**.

Integration using APIs helps with the challenge of workload protection by **ensuring that all virtual machines have the Sophos Endpoint Agent installed**.

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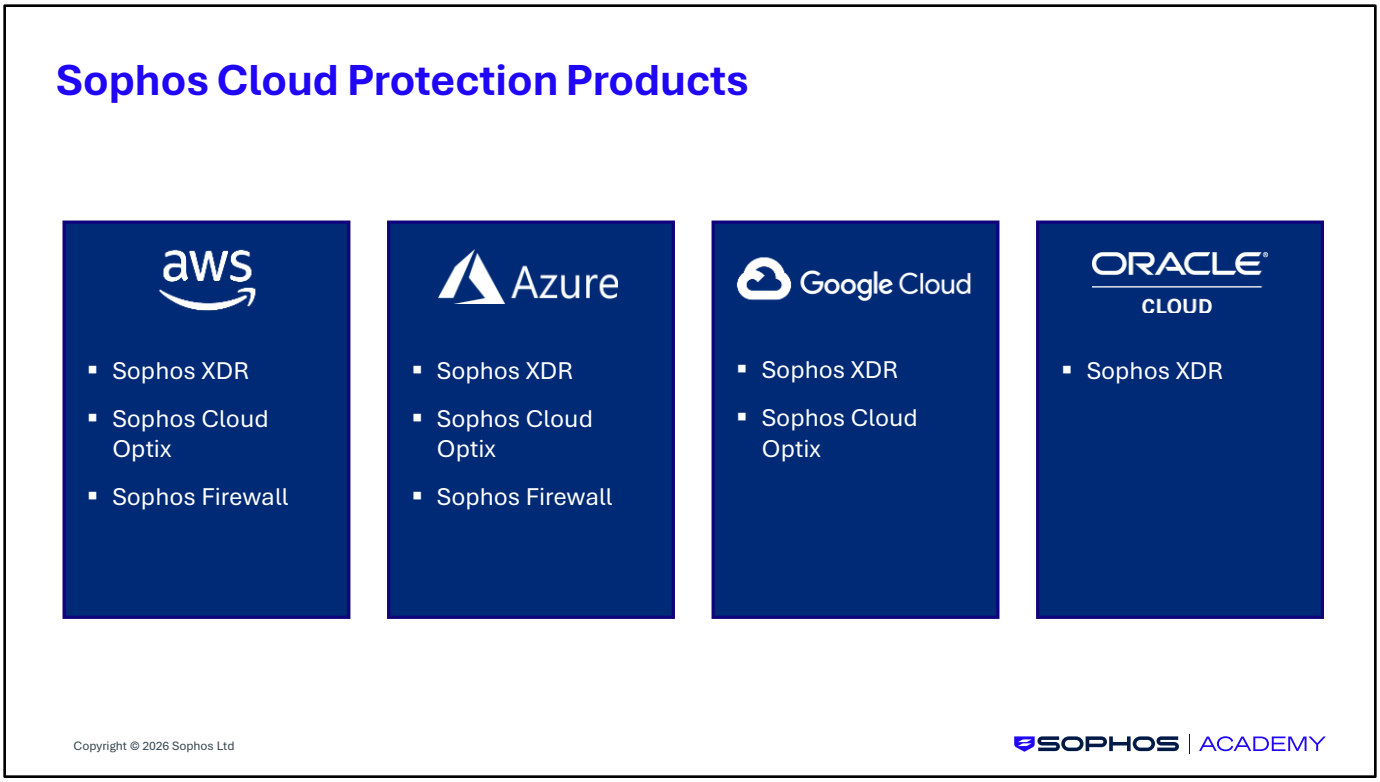
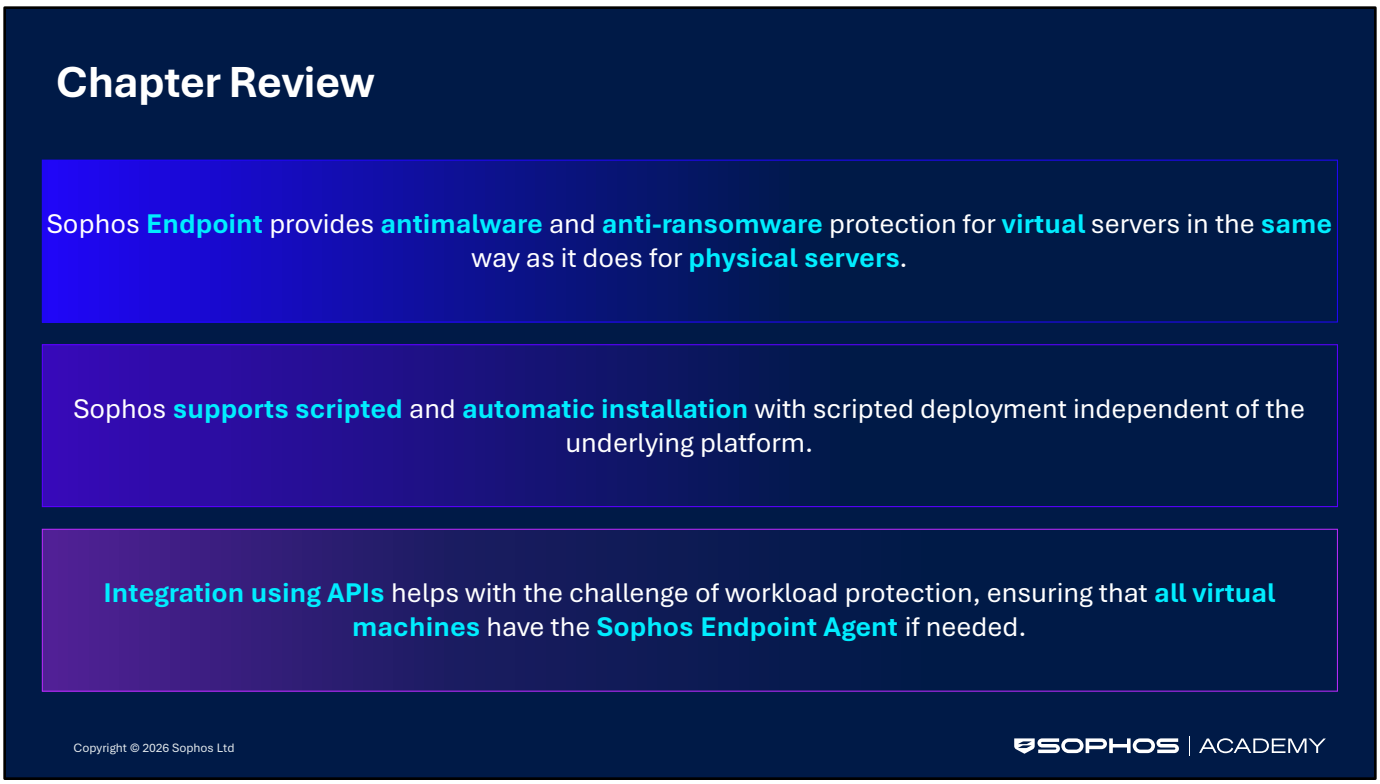
Additional functionality is provided when deploying the Sophos Endpoint Agent onto AWS or Azure. Central Connectors allow you to connect your Sophos Central account to your AWS and/or Azure accounts, which provide integrated features such as dynamic licensing, where new machines receive a license from a pool of licenses, and terminated machines automatically have their license re-added to the pool of licenses.

Server protection allows integration using APIs to create new workloads. This helps with a key challenge in the cloud, which is usually referred to as workload protection. At a high level, this would be deploying the Sophos Endpoint Agent to protect virtual machines running in the cloud.



Sophos Endpoint is one of multiple Sophos products available for Public Cloud. Its protection can be enhanced by Sophos Firewall.



Here are the three main things you learned in this chapter.

Sophos Endpoint provides antimalware and anti-ransomware protection for virtual servers in the same way as it does for physical servers.

Sophos supports scripted and automatic installation with scripted deployment independent of the underlying platform.

Integration with APIs helps with the challenge of workload protection, ensuring that all virtual machines have the Sophos Endpoint Agent if needed.

Device Management and Communication

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[Additional Information]

Sophos Endpoint
EP3005: Getting Started with Device Management

May 2026

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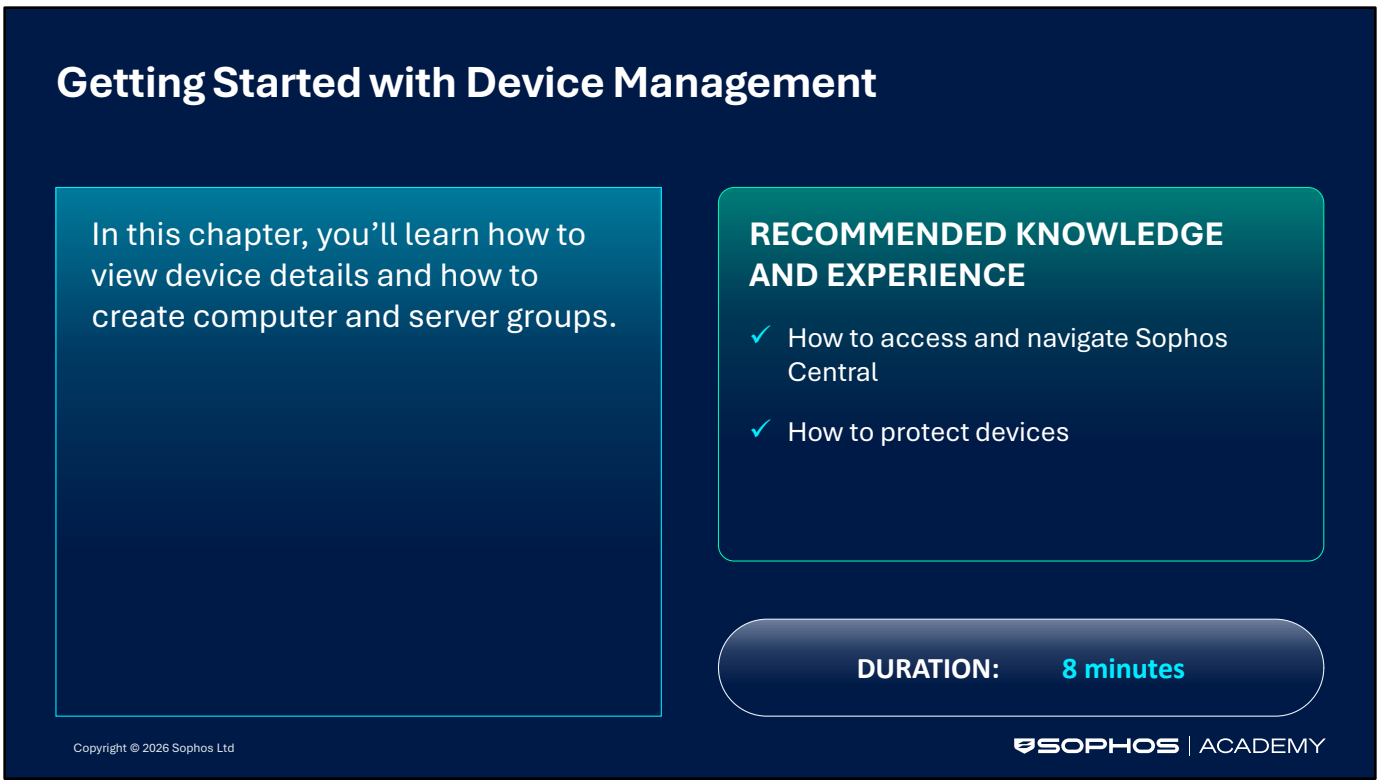
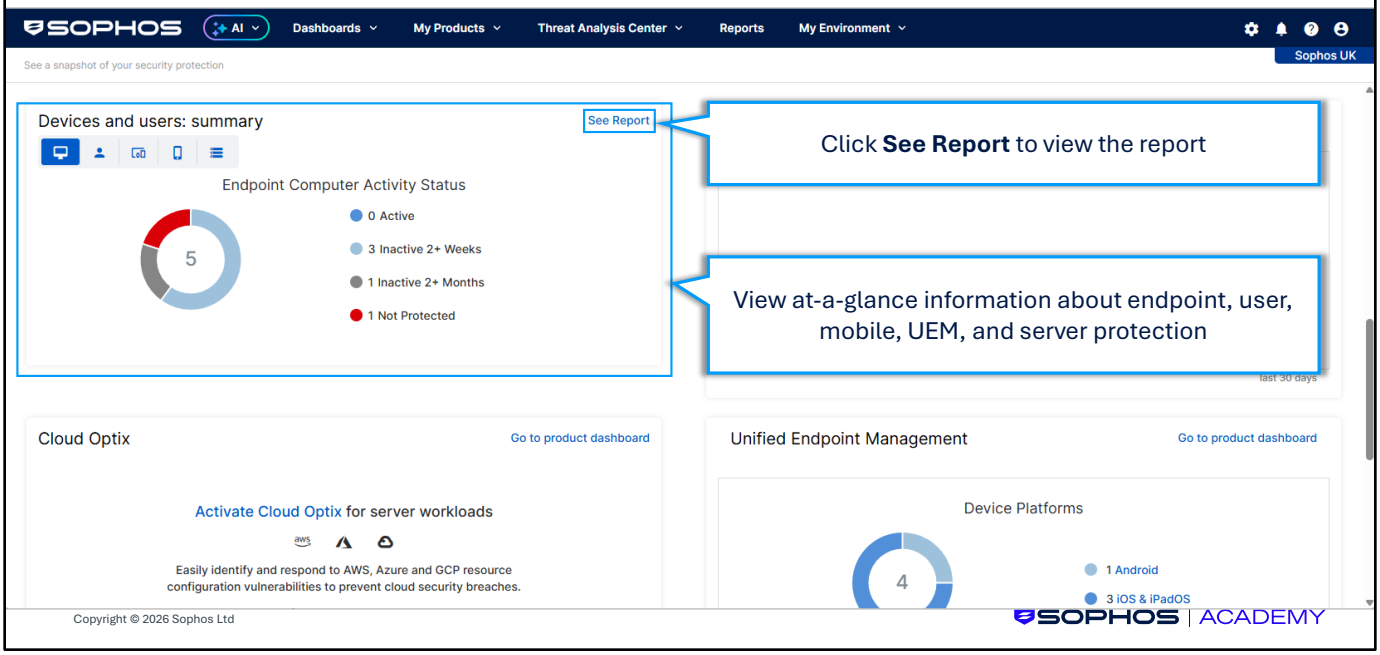


In this chapter, you'll learn how to view device details and how to create computer and server groups.

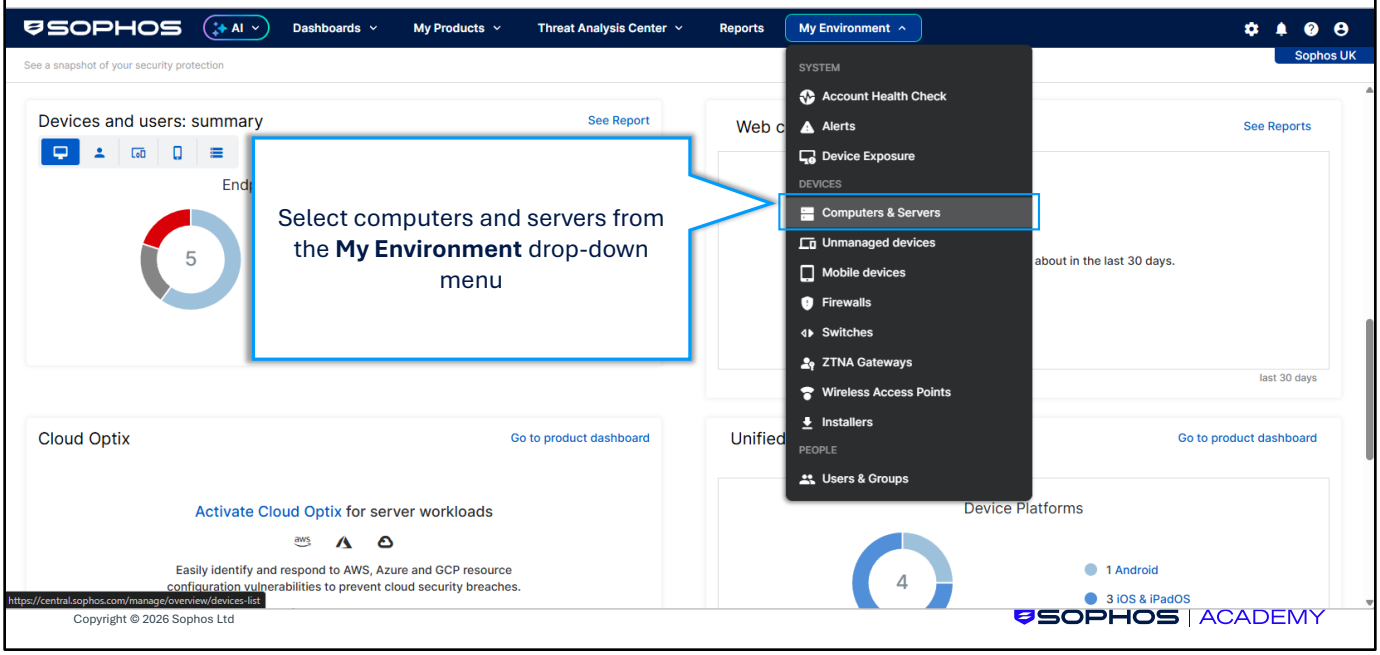
Devices Summary



The ‘Devices and users: Summary’ widget on the default Sophos Central Dashboard displays information about protected devices, users, and servers at a glance.

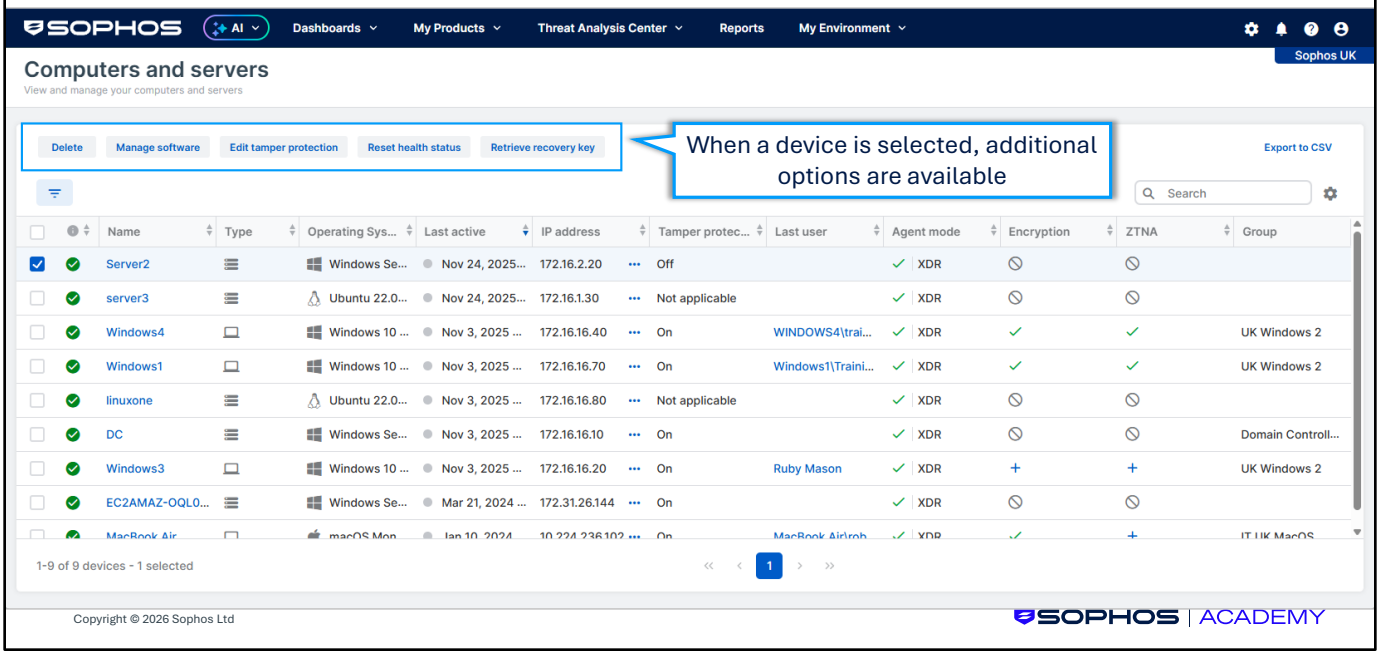
The widget displays device data based on activity status. The **See Report** link takes you directly to the computer report, which provides further details on protected devices.

Devices



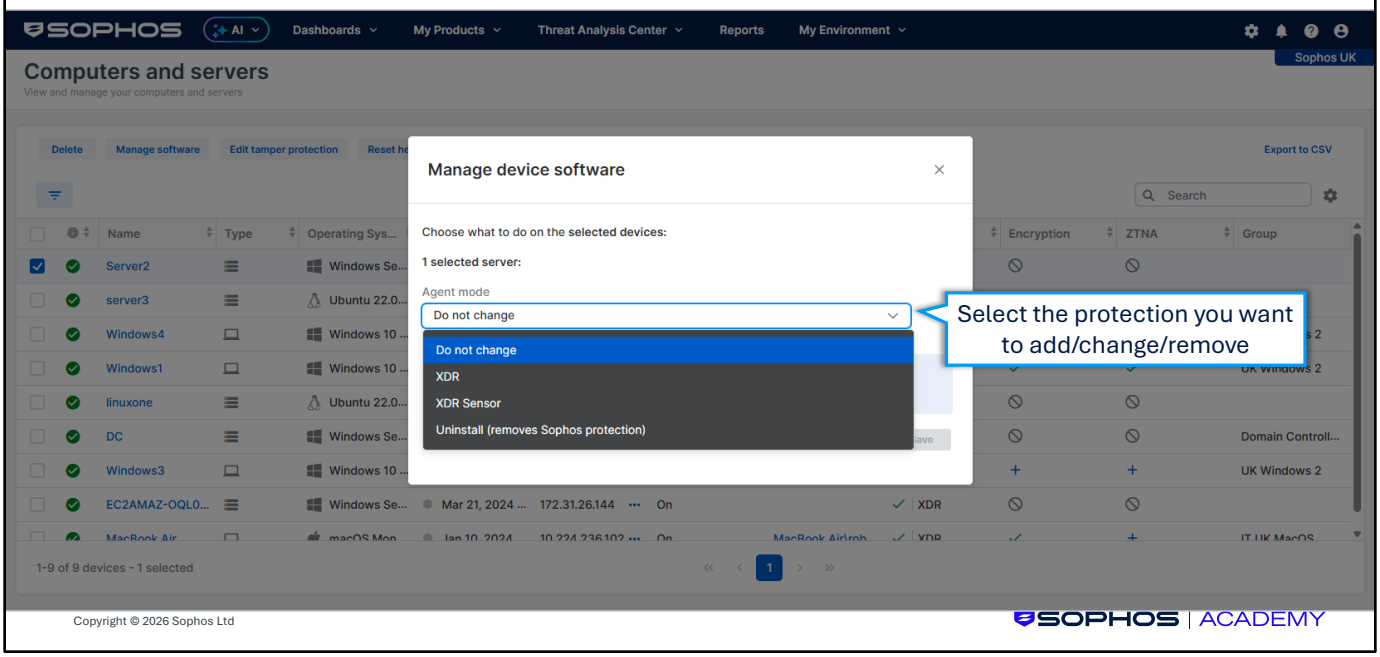
Navigating to the **My Environment** drop-down menu, you can select to view computers and servers, mobile devices, firewalls, switches, ZTNA Gateways, wireless access points, and the available product installers.

Manage Endpoint Software



You can manage protected devices in Sophos Central on the Computers and servers page. Selecting a device from the list will show additional options available for the device. For example, to manage the software installed on a device, click **Manage Software**.

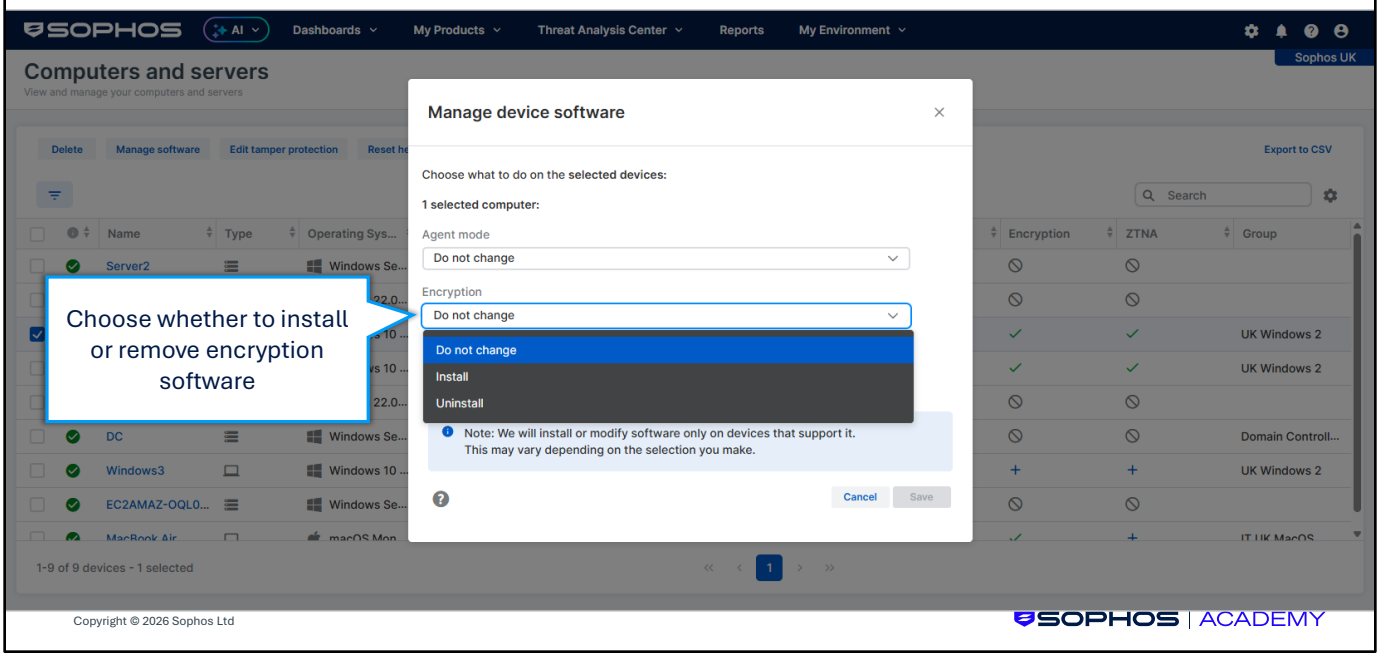
Manage Endpoint Software



From the ‘Agent mode’ drop-down menu, select to change the protection of a single device or multiple devices.

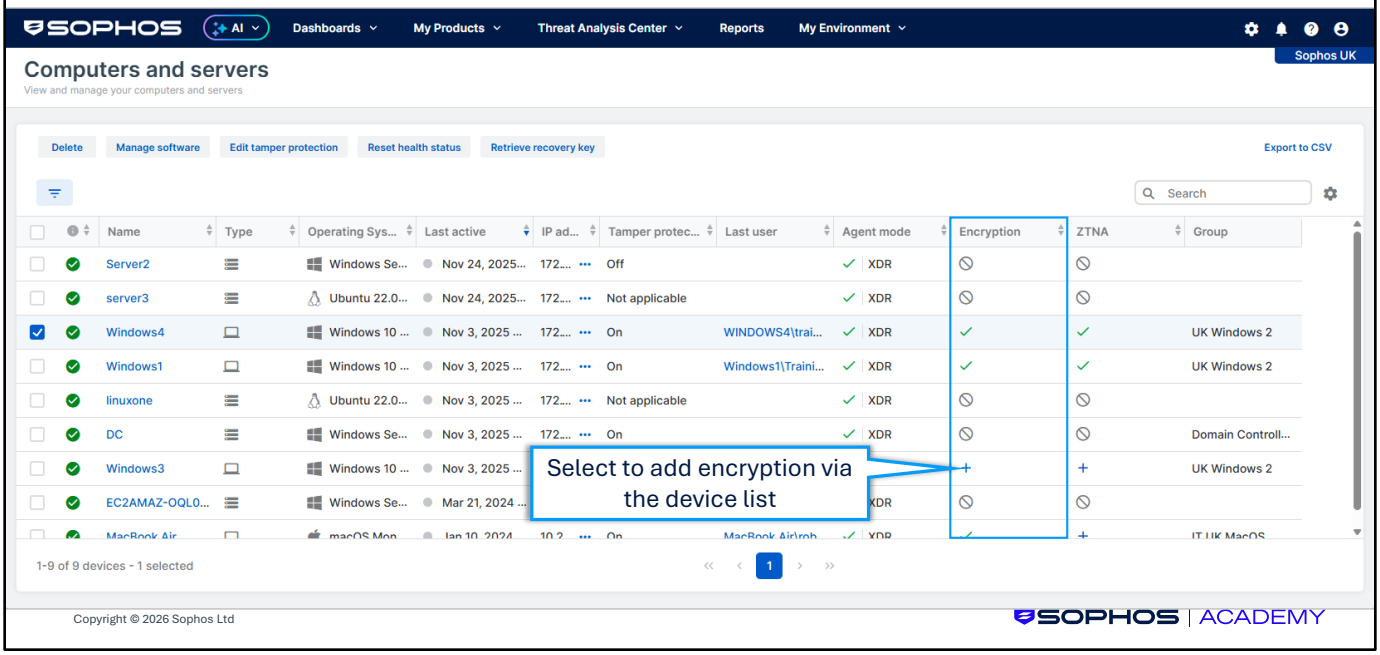
The protection options include licensed software that you can install on devices already protected. Additionally, you can choose to remove the protection of a managed device.

Manage Endpoint Software



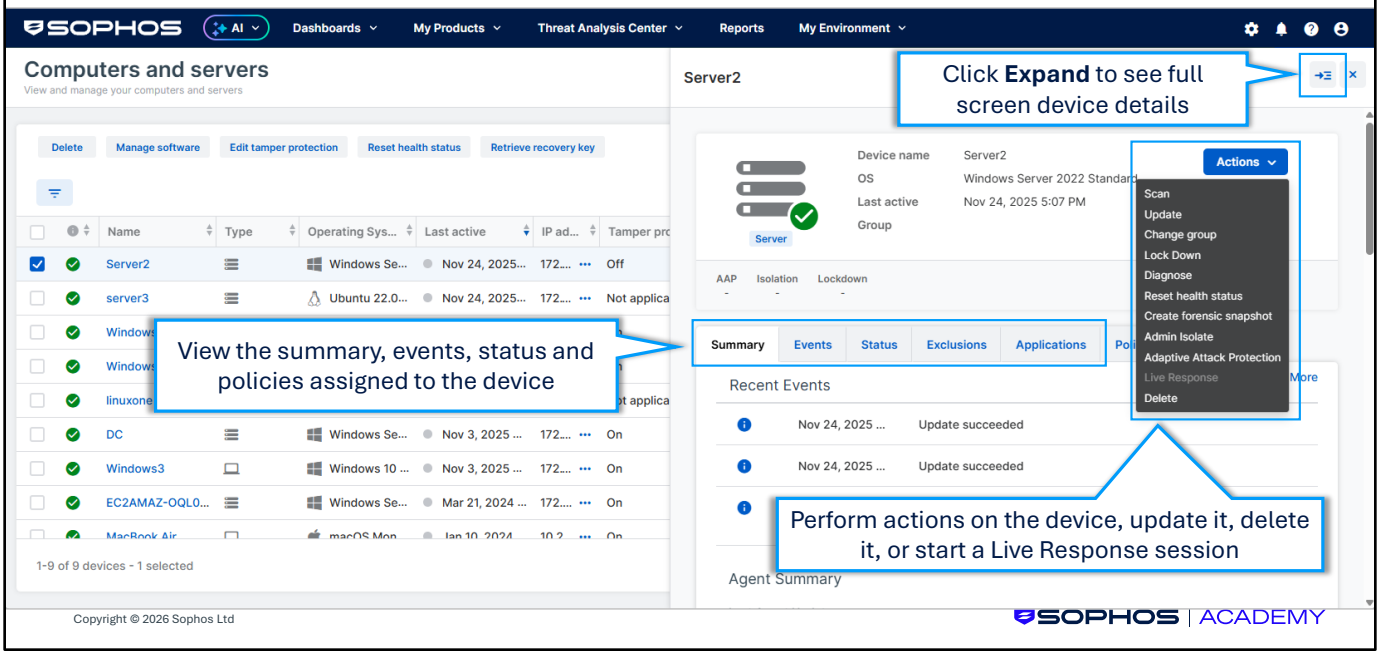
Encryption software is included in the full installer for Sophos Endpoint. If you select to install only specific components, you may find that devices don't have encryption installed. You can select from the drop-down menu to either install or uninstall encryption. Once you select to change the endpoint protection, you'll see a progress bar. Note that you cannot install software on a device that does not support it.

Manage Endpoint Software



In the encryption column of the device list, you can select to add the encryption software to supported devices if required.

Device Details: Computer



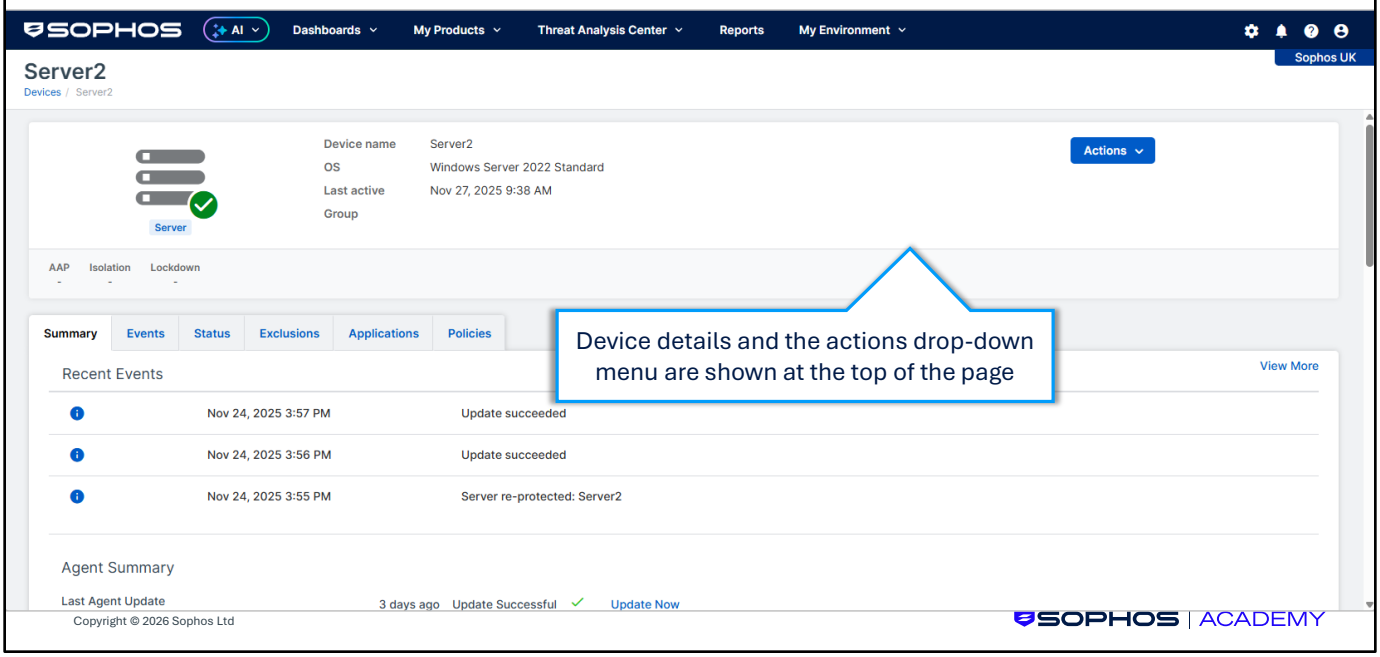
Selecting a device from the list will show the device details. The status of a device is denoted with a green, orange, or red icon. The device name, operating system, last user, last activity, and device group are shown.

The **Actions** menu provides the options to perform an update, delete the device from the Sophos Central account, or start a Live Response session. You can select to change the device group, start a scan, and reset the health status of the device. You can also select 'diagnose' to perform troubleshooting steps or create a forensic snapshot. An administrator user can select to isolate the device or turn on adaptive attack protection for either 24, 48, or 72 hours.

The **Summary** tab displays the most recent events, an agent summary, and additional information, for example, tamper protection status and Windows firewall details. The **Events**, **Status,** and **Policies** tabs display the events, the security state, and the policies assigned to the device.

Click the expand button to view the device details in full screen.

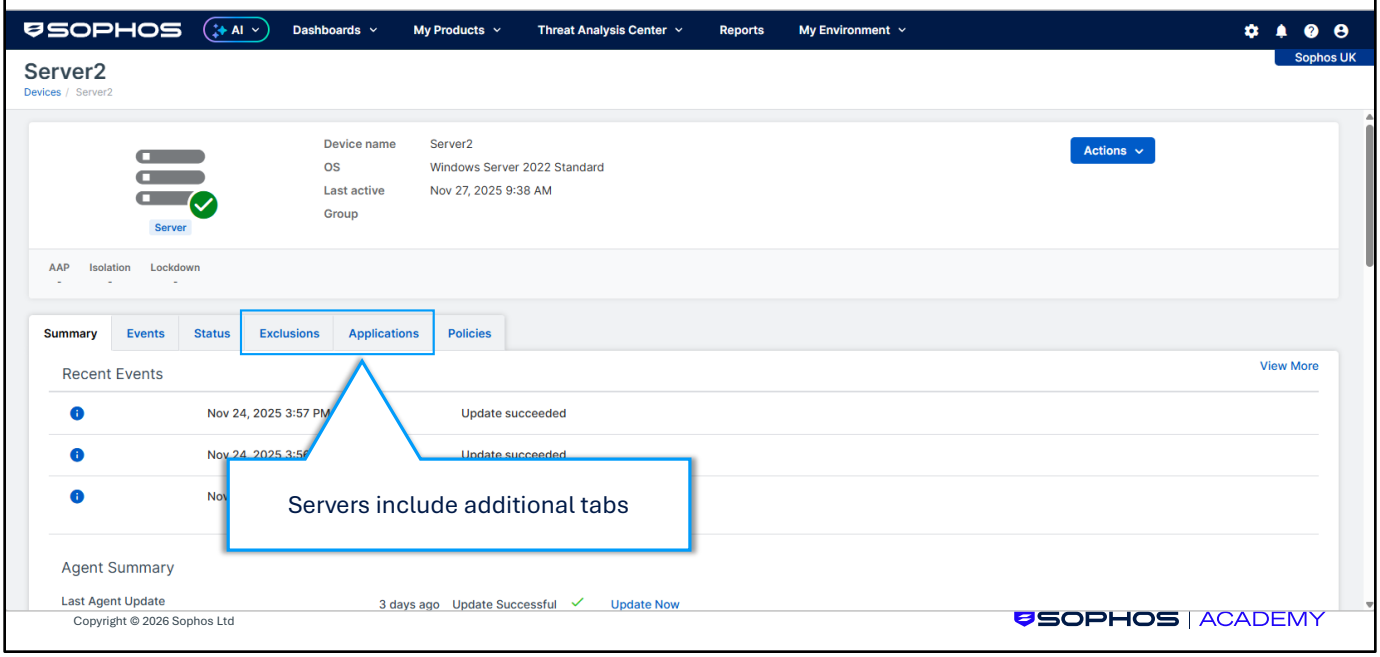
Device Details: Computer



In full screen, the device details are displayed at the top of the screen. The 'Actions' drop-down menu is available here as well as in the flyout menu.

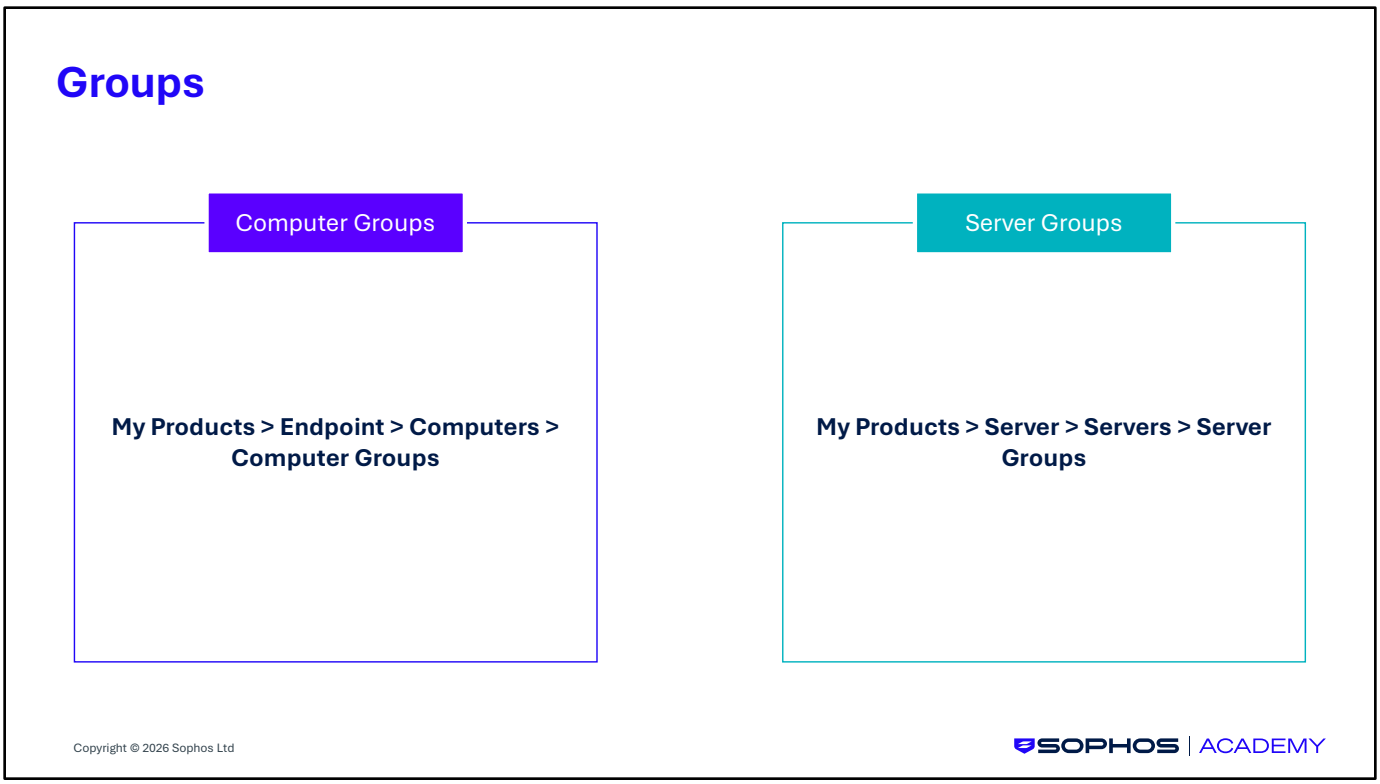
To return to the devices list, select **Devices** in the breadcrumb menu or select **My Environment > Computers and servers** from the top drop-down menu.

Device Details: Server



When a server is selected from the device list, extra tabs and actions may be available.

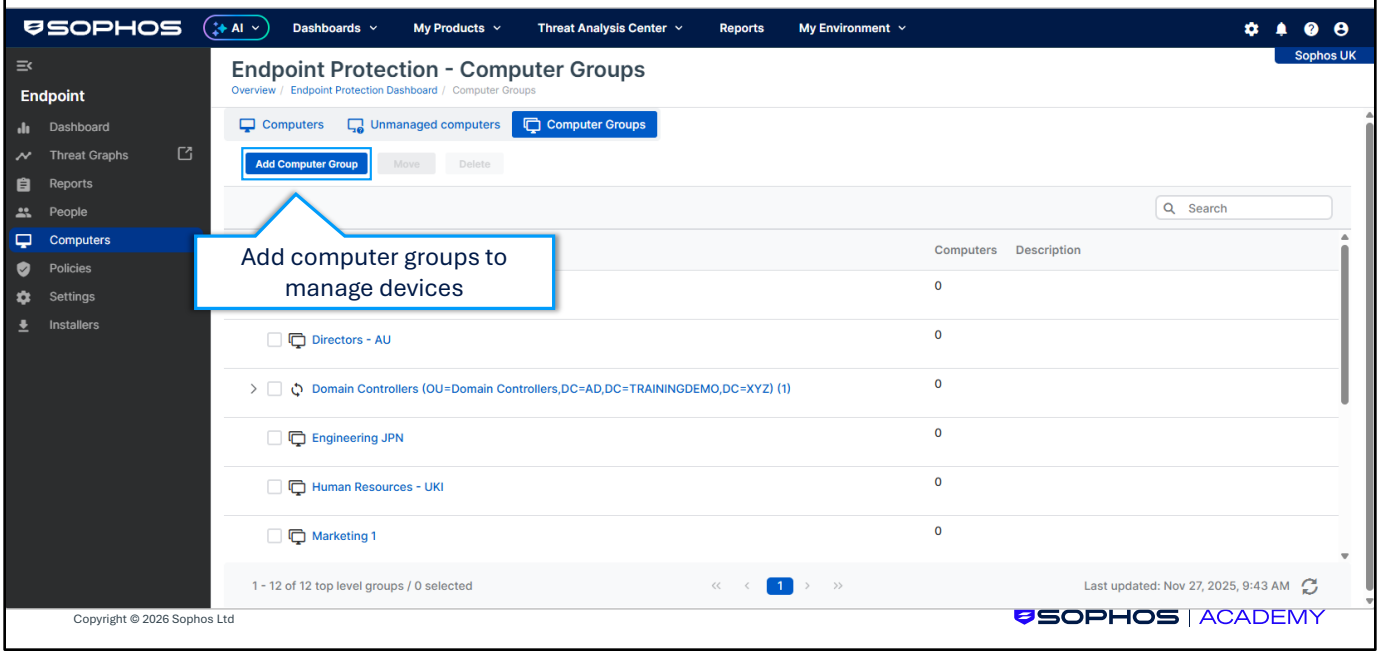
An exclusions and applications tab is included. The **Exclusions** tab allows you to review the exclusions applied to the server. You can search and filter all exclusions. The **Applications** tab allows you to view a list of applications that are currently installed on the server.



You can create device groups to make it easier to manage protected devices. With devices grouped, you can assign the same policy to multiple devices at the same time.

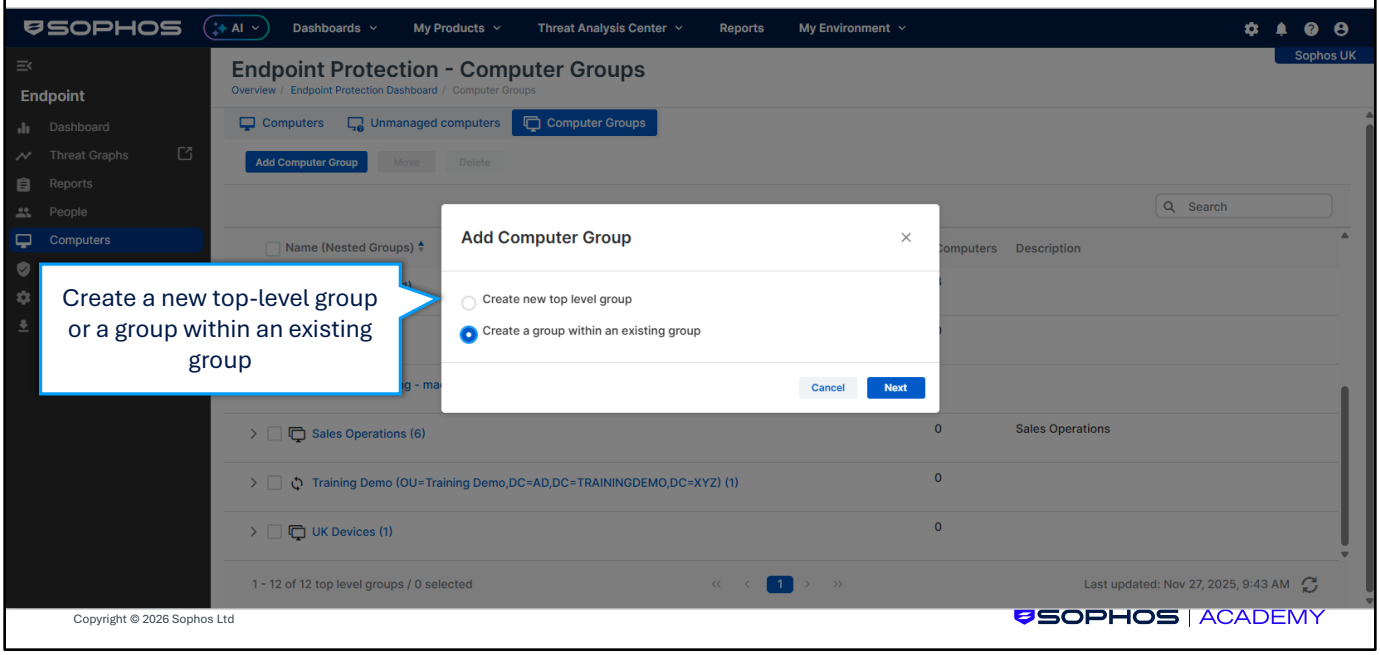
Computer and server groups are created in the product pages. For **Computers**, go to **My Products > Endpoint > Computers** and select the **Computer Groups** tab**.** For **Servers**, go to **My Products > Server > Servers and select** the **Server Groups** tab.

Computer Groups



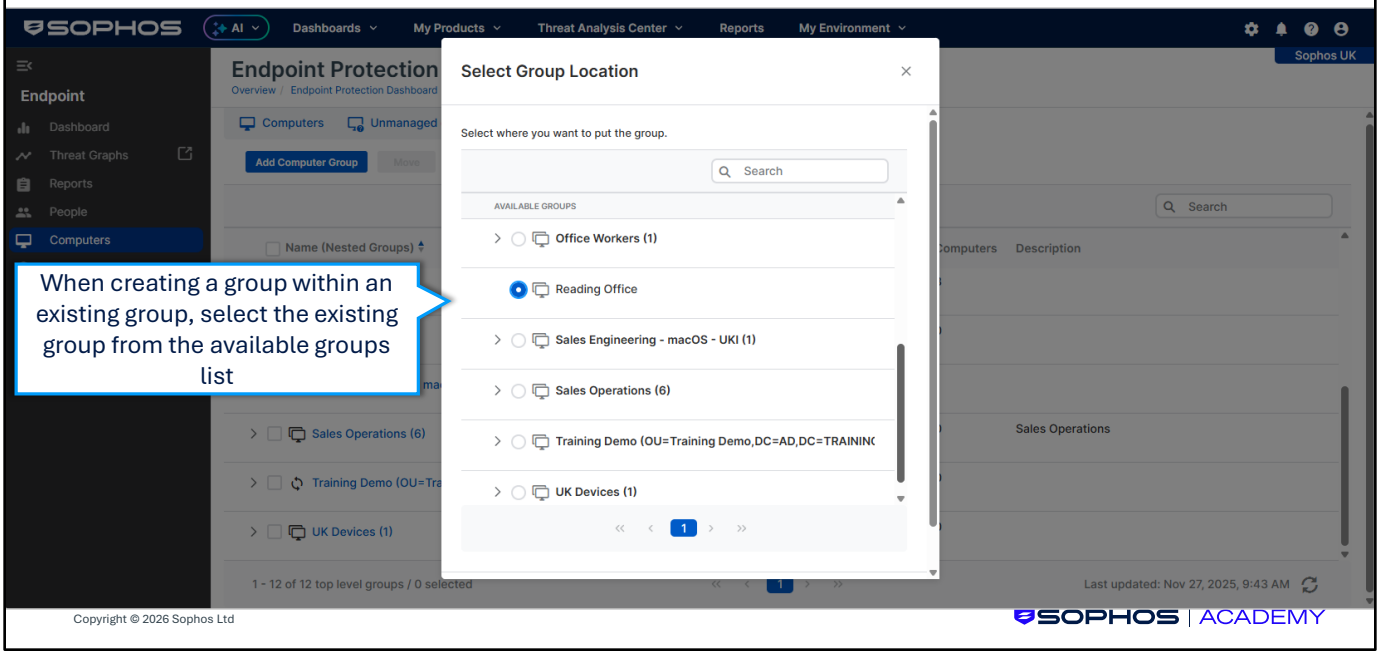
If you have synchronised the Sophos Central account with a directory, you may already have computer groups listed here. The number of devices assigned to a group is displayed, and you can also search this list by entering the name of the group you are searching for into the search box. You can manually create a computer group by selecting **Add Computer Group**.

Computer Groups



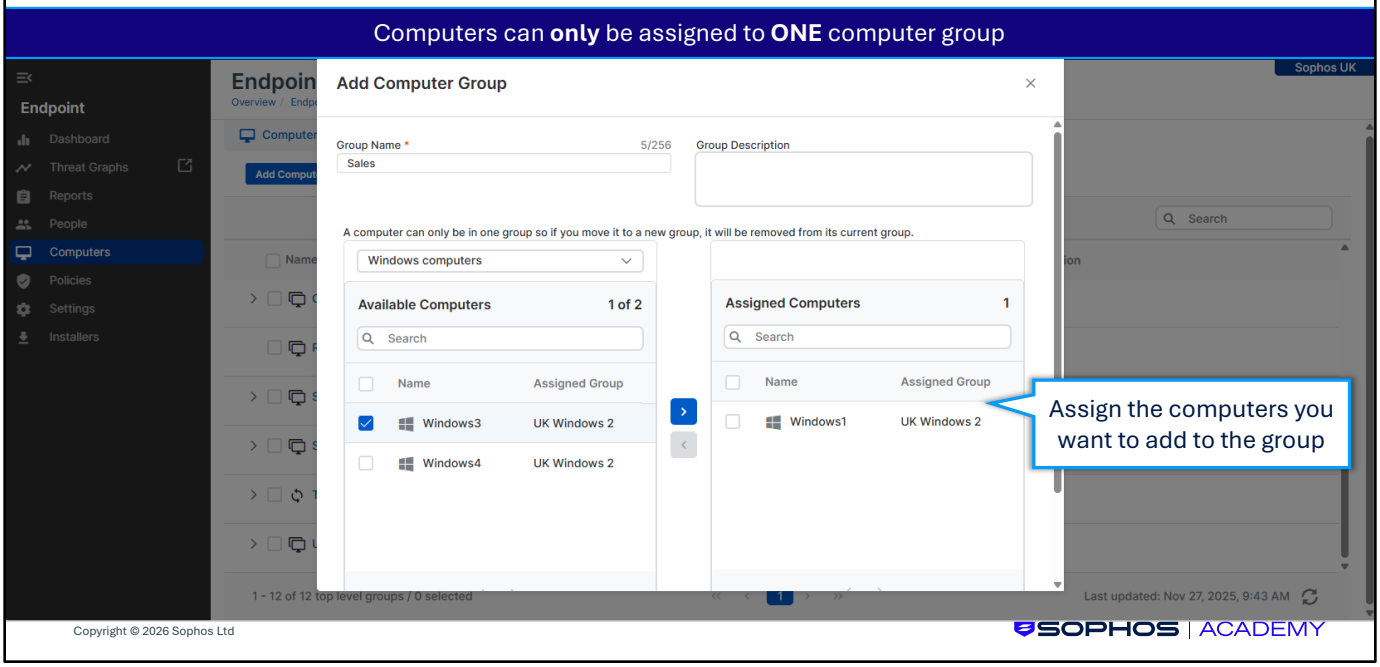
You can create a new top-level group or a group within an existing group. In this example, we will create a group within an existing group.

Computer Groups



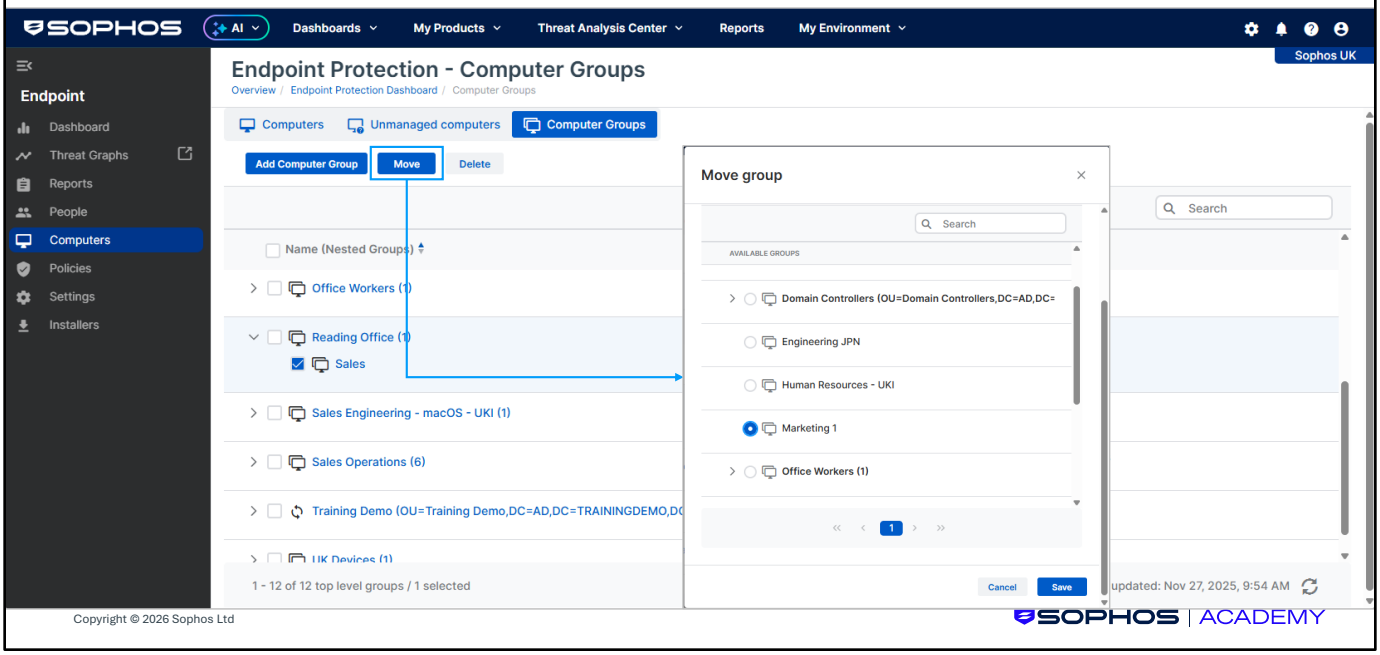
When you're creating a group within an existing group, you'll select the existing group you want to create the sub-group in.

Computer Groups



Name the group and assign the required computers from the available computers list. This list is filtered to show unassigned computers by default; however, you can change this to show all computers or show computers filtered by operating system. Computers can only be assigned to **ONE** computer group.

Computer Groups



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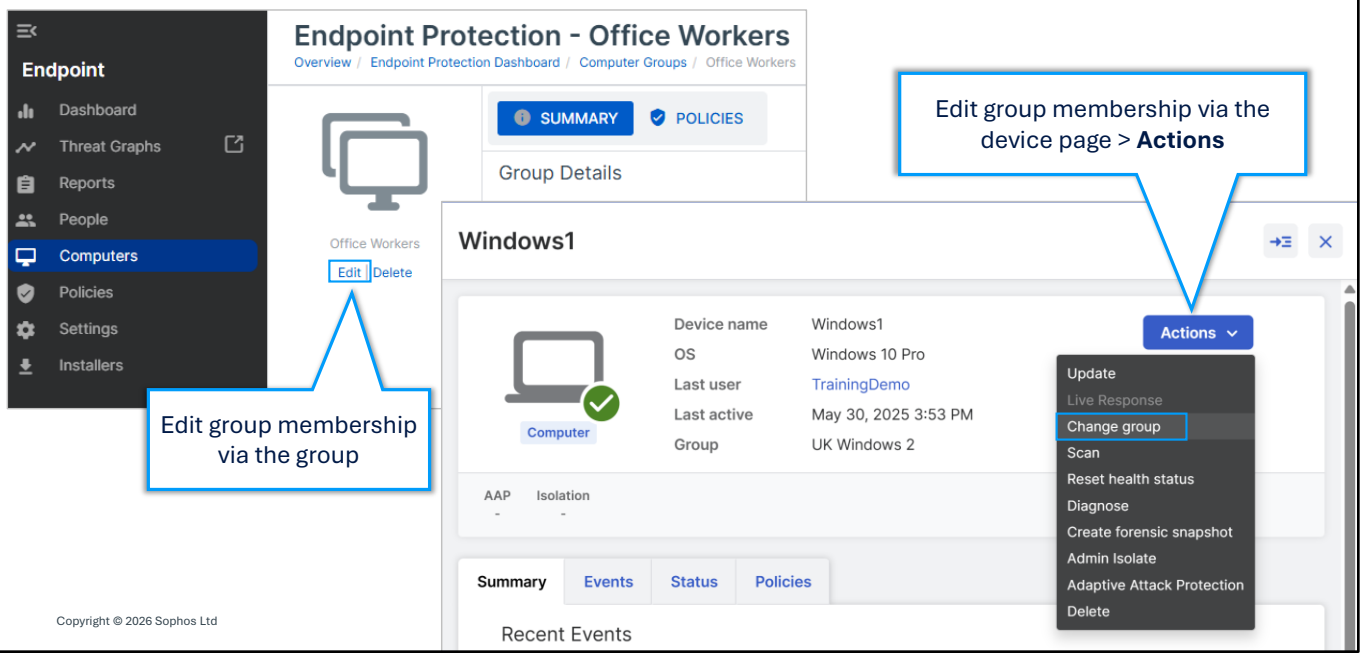
If you have a group that is not in the correct place. For example, a top-level group that should be a sub-level group, you can move the group to the correct place.

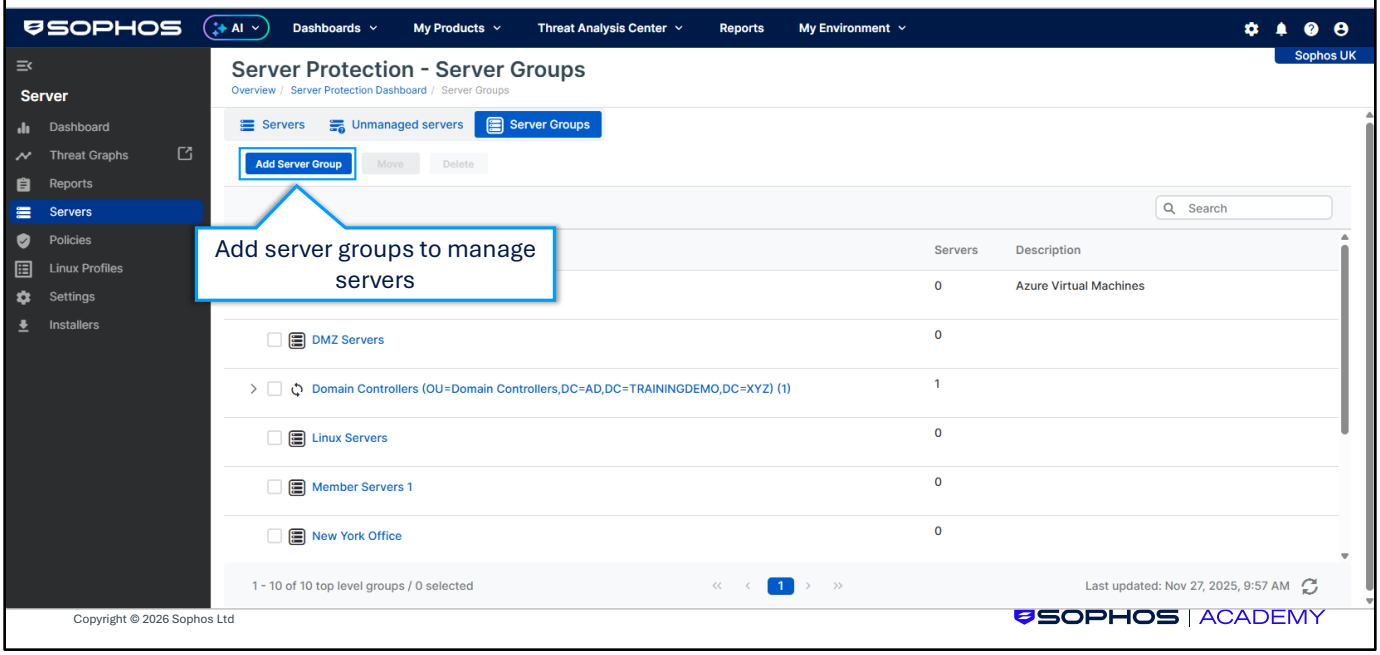
Select the group you want to move and then select where you want to move it and click **Save**.

Computer Groups



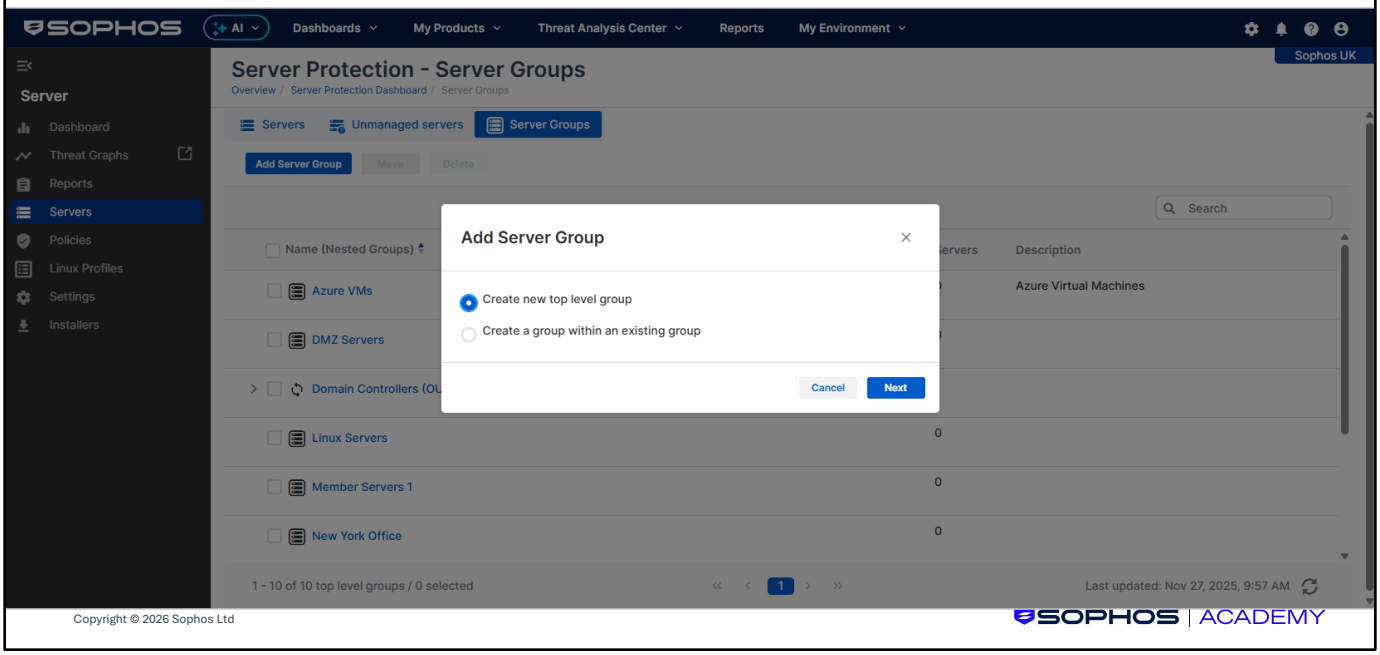
You can edit the devices that belong to each computer group using the **Computer Groups** tab and editing the group membership, or for individual devices via the **Device** page.

Server Groups



Server groups are created in the exact same way as computer groups. Click **Add Server Group**.

Server Groups



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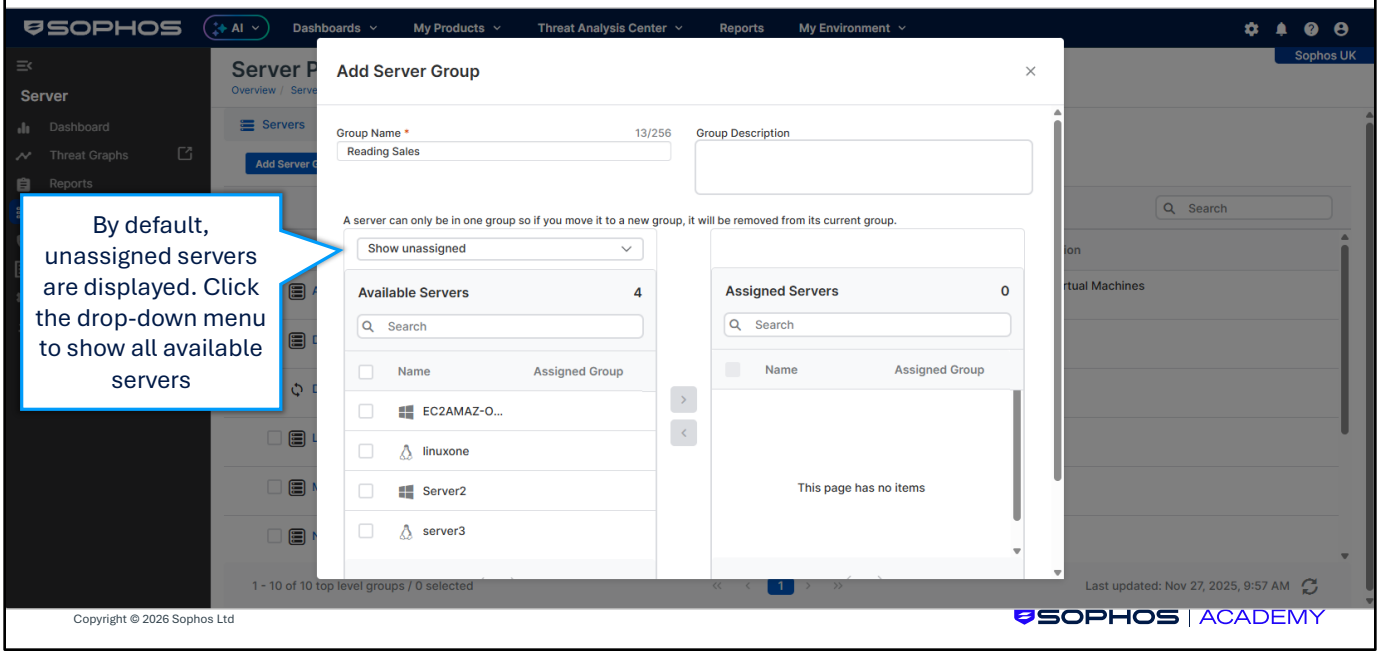
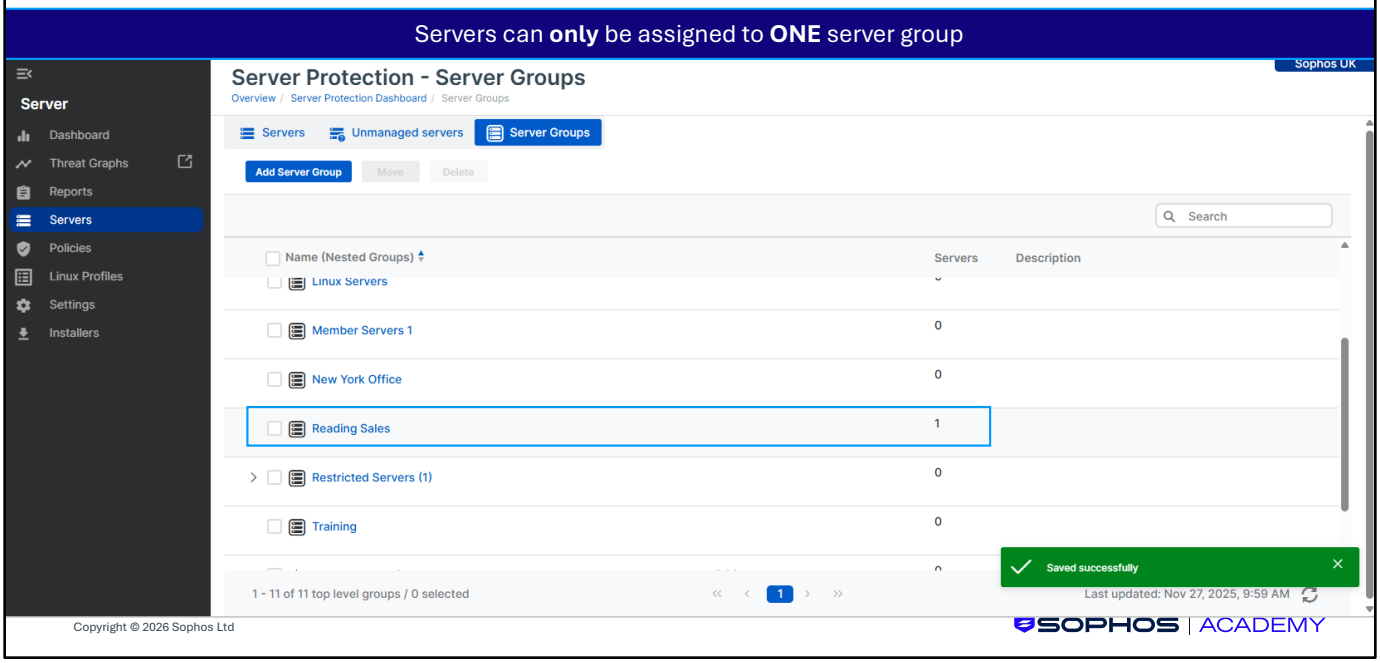
Select whether you want to create a new top-level group or create a group within an existing group. In this example, we will create a new top-level group.

Server Groups

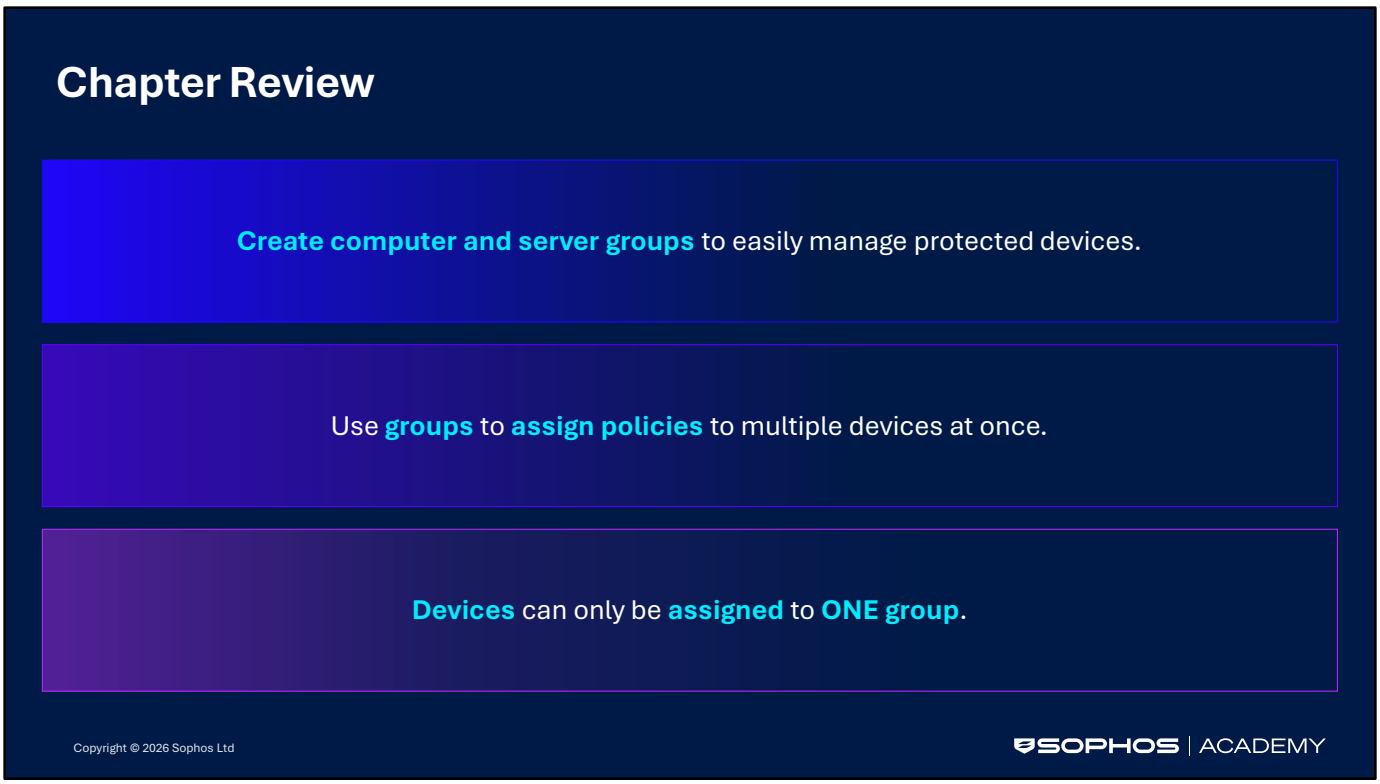


Give the server group a name and assign the servers that will be included in it. By default, unassigned servers are displayed in the available servers list. Use the drop-down menu to change the servers listed, filtering to show all protected servers or servers by operating system.

Server Groups



Once the server group has been saved, it will be listed in the server groups list. Remember, a server can only be a member of **ONE** group.



Here are the three main things you learned in this chapter.

Create computer and server groups to easily manage protected devices.

Use groups to assign policies to multiple devices at once.

Devices can only be assigned to **ONE** group.

[Additional Information]

Sophos Endpoint
EP3010: Getting Started with Device Communication

May 2026

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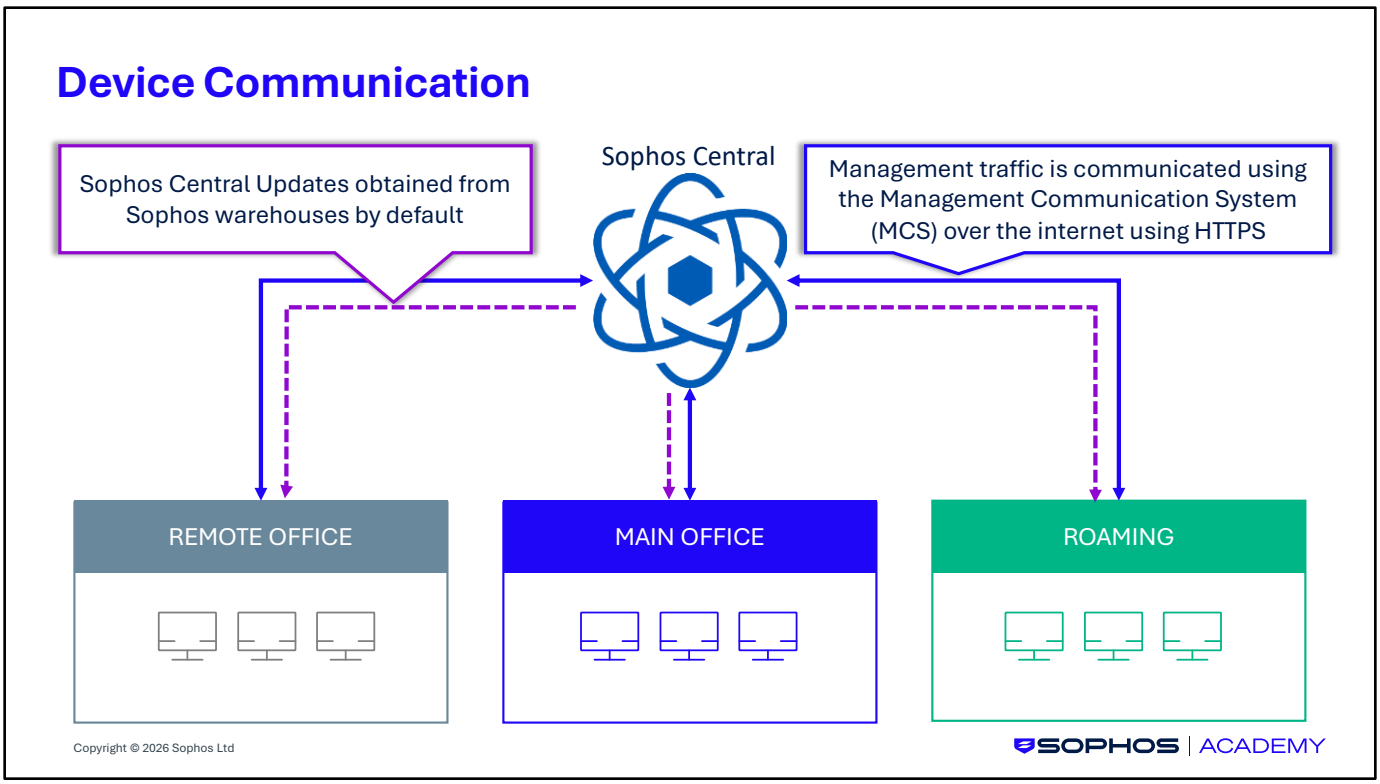
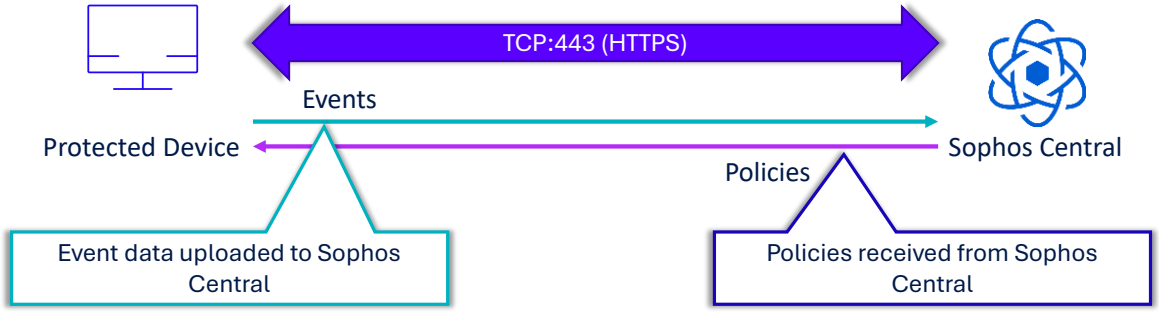
In this chapter, you'll learn how protected devices communicate management traffic to Sophos Central.



A key benefit of Sophos Central is that it does not matter where protected devices are located. No hardware is required to manage devices. All device management takes place in the cloud-based management system. Management traffic is communicated between devices and Sophos Central using the Management Communication System (MCS) over the internet using HTTPS.

By default, all devices obtain the latest threat updates from online Sophos warehouses; however, you can configure a server Update Cache if required.

Management Communication System (MCS)



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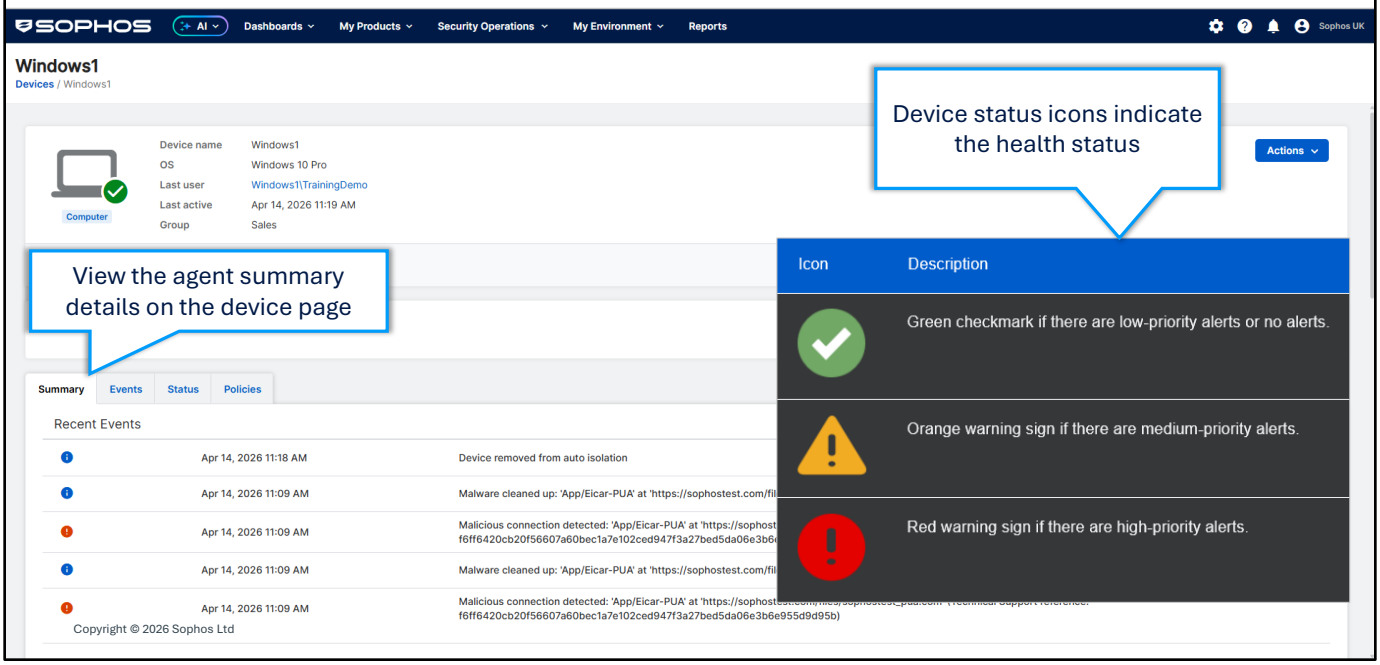
We define management traffic as all data sent and received by MCS on a device. Devices use MCS to download new policies from Sophos Central and to upload event and detection data to Sophos Central.

MCS has an adaptor installed for each component of the Sophos Endpoint Agent that allows it to exchange messages, receive policies, and provide events.

Sophos Endpoint Agent Summary

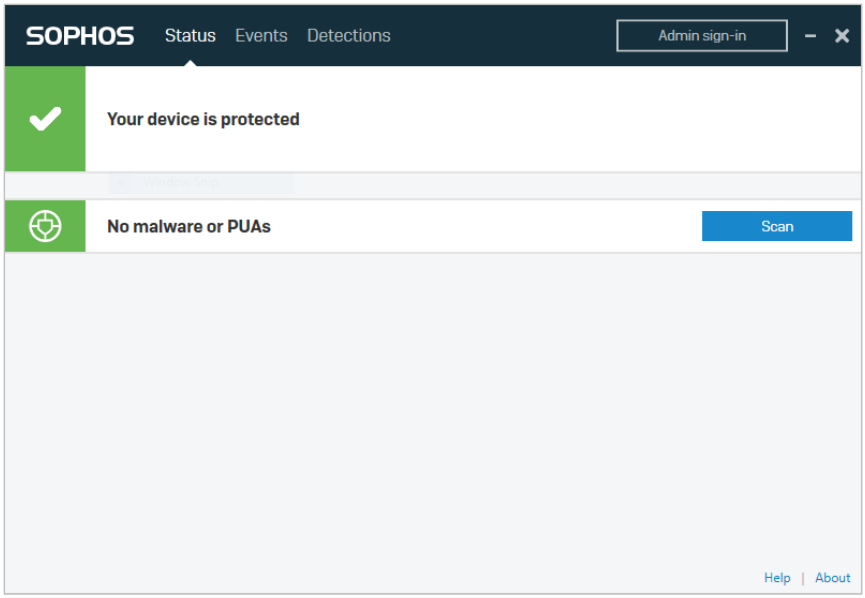


Devices communicate their health status back to Sophos Central as well as event, detection, and additional feature data such as web and application control data. The ‘Agent Summary’ section on the device page lists the last activity time of the device along with the last time the agent was updated. You can see which licensed products have been assigned to the device and the version installed.

Expanding the ‘Installed component versions’ displays a full list of the components installed. Please note that this is only displayed for Windows devices.

Sophos Endpoint Agent

Status displays the status of the endpoint agent



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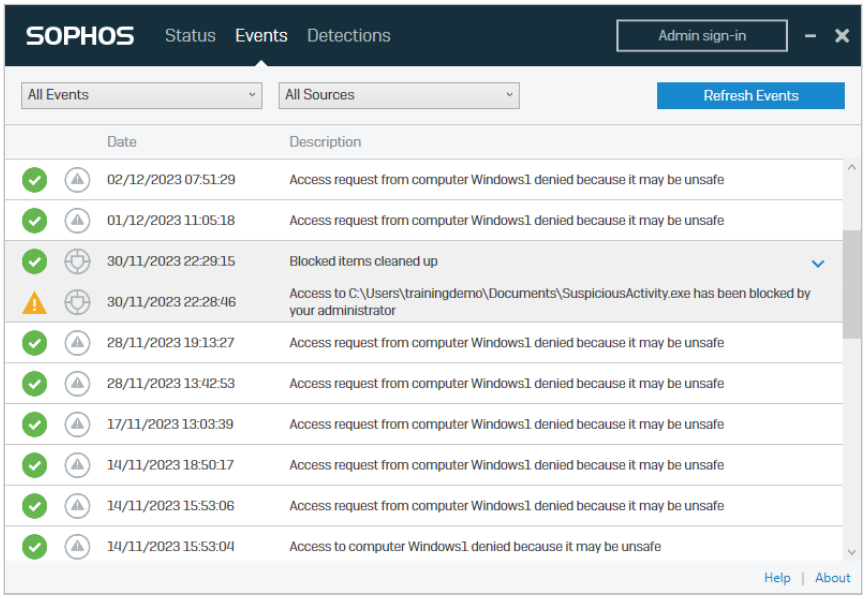
The Sophos Endpoint Agent displays the health status, event and detection information which is communicated back to Sophos Central using MCS.

The agent is accessed from the system tray on a Windows device. Opening the agent displays the **Status** of the device. If there has been a detection that has not been automatically cleaned up, the details of the detection will be displayed.

Sophos Endpoint Agent

Status displays the status of the endpoint agent

Events displays all events that have happened on the device



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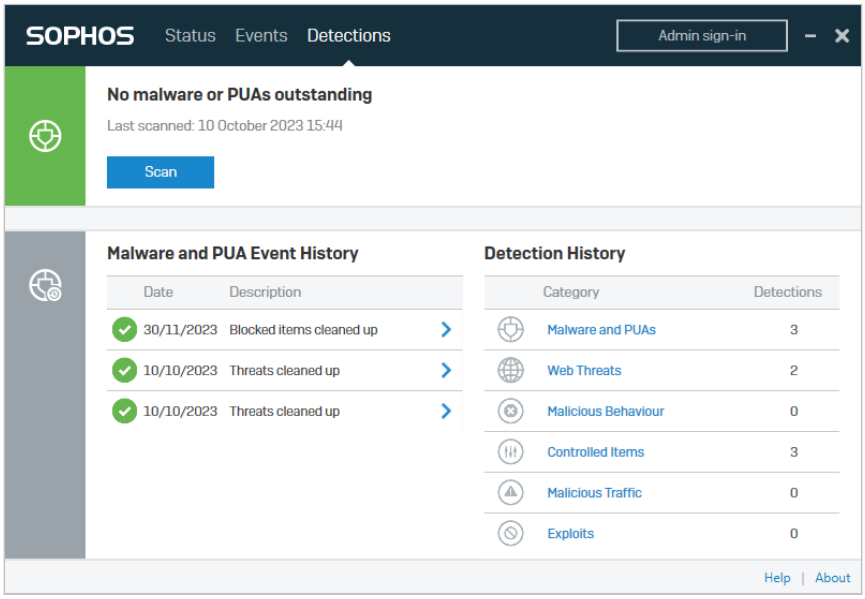
To view all events that have happened on the device, select the **Events** tab.

Sophos Endpoint Agent

Status displays the status of the endpoint agent

Events displays all events that have happened on the device

Detections displays detection history split into categories



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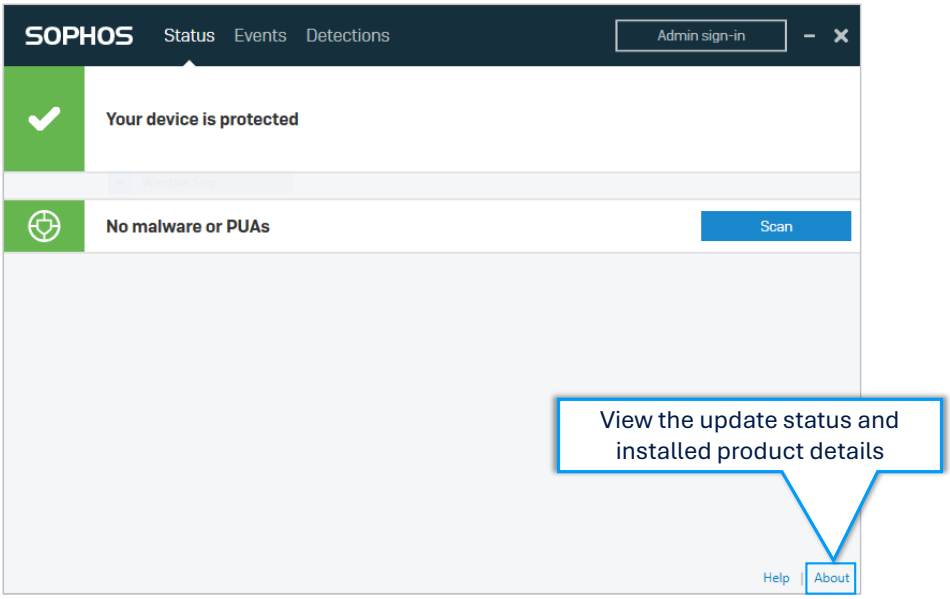
The **Detections** tab displays malware and PUA history along with the detection history of the device split in threat categories.

Sophos Endpoint Agent



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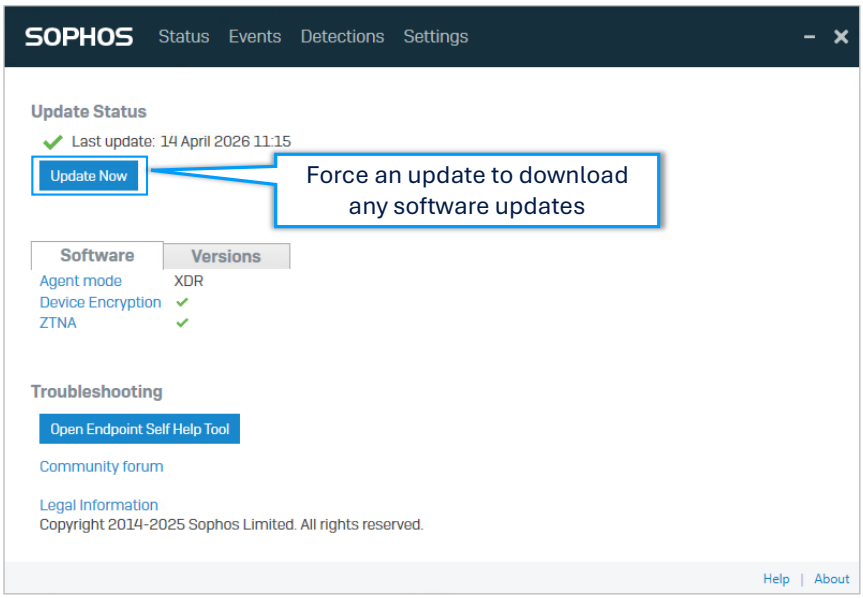
Clicking **About** displays the 'Update Status' of the device along with the products installed. Devices receive updates from Sophos Central warehouses by default. Here you can see the date and time of the last update received by the device and whether it was successful.

Update Communication



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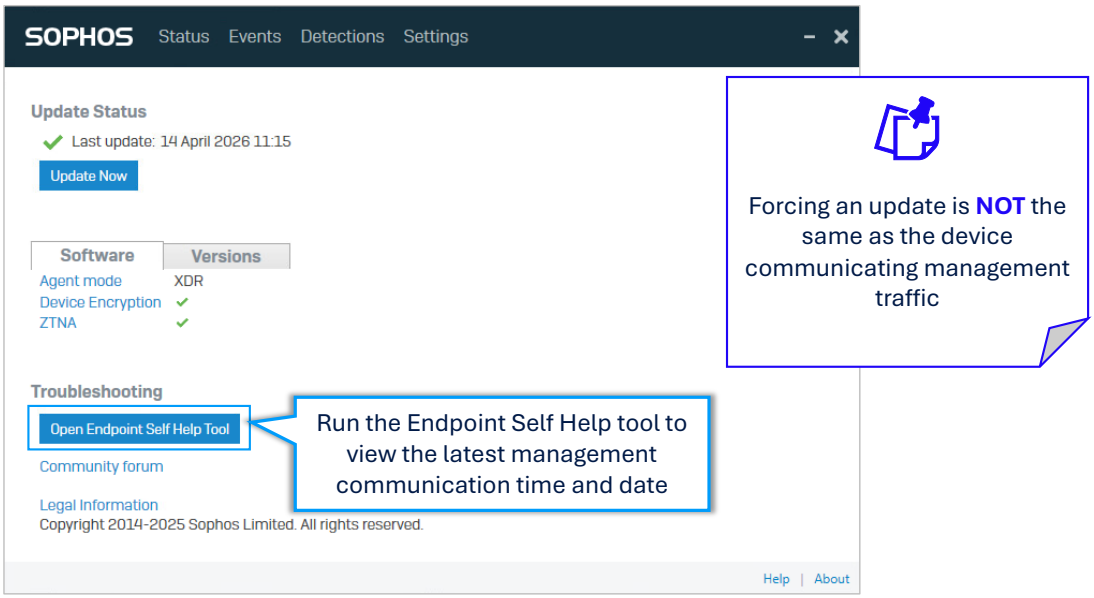
A device can be forced to update locally by clicking **Update Now**. This will force the device to communicate with the update server and download any required software updates.

Management Communication



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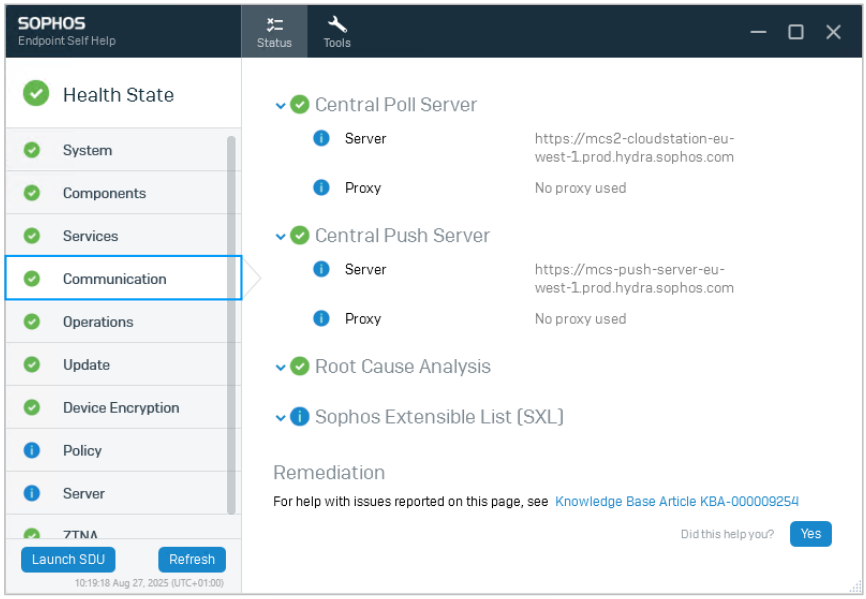
It is important to understand that forcing an update is not the same as the device communicating management traffic. The Endpoint Self Help Tool can be used to view the latest communication time between a device and Sophos Central.

Management Communication



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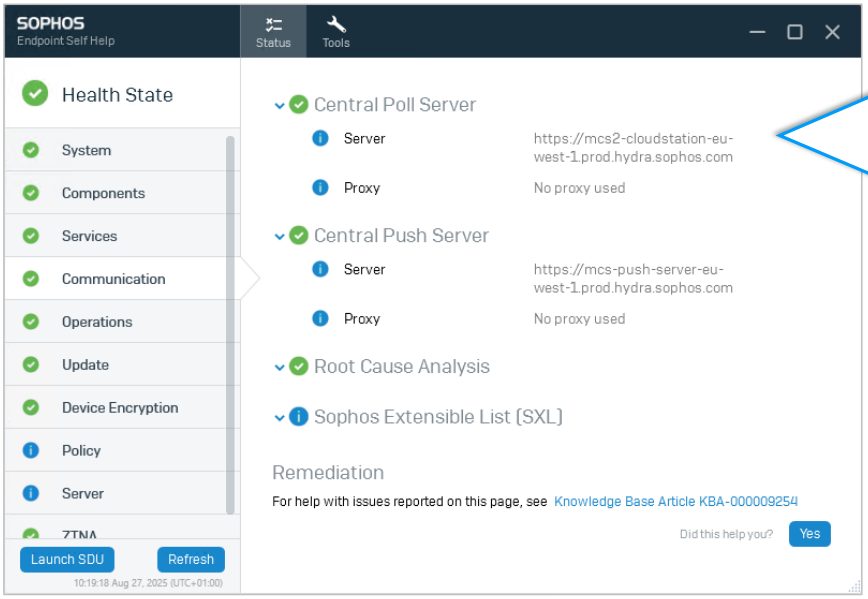
The Endpoint Self Help Tool is split into categories. To view the management communication information between a device and Sophos Central select the **Communication** tab.

Management Communication

Additional information available in the notes



View the communication servers being used to communicate with Sophos Central

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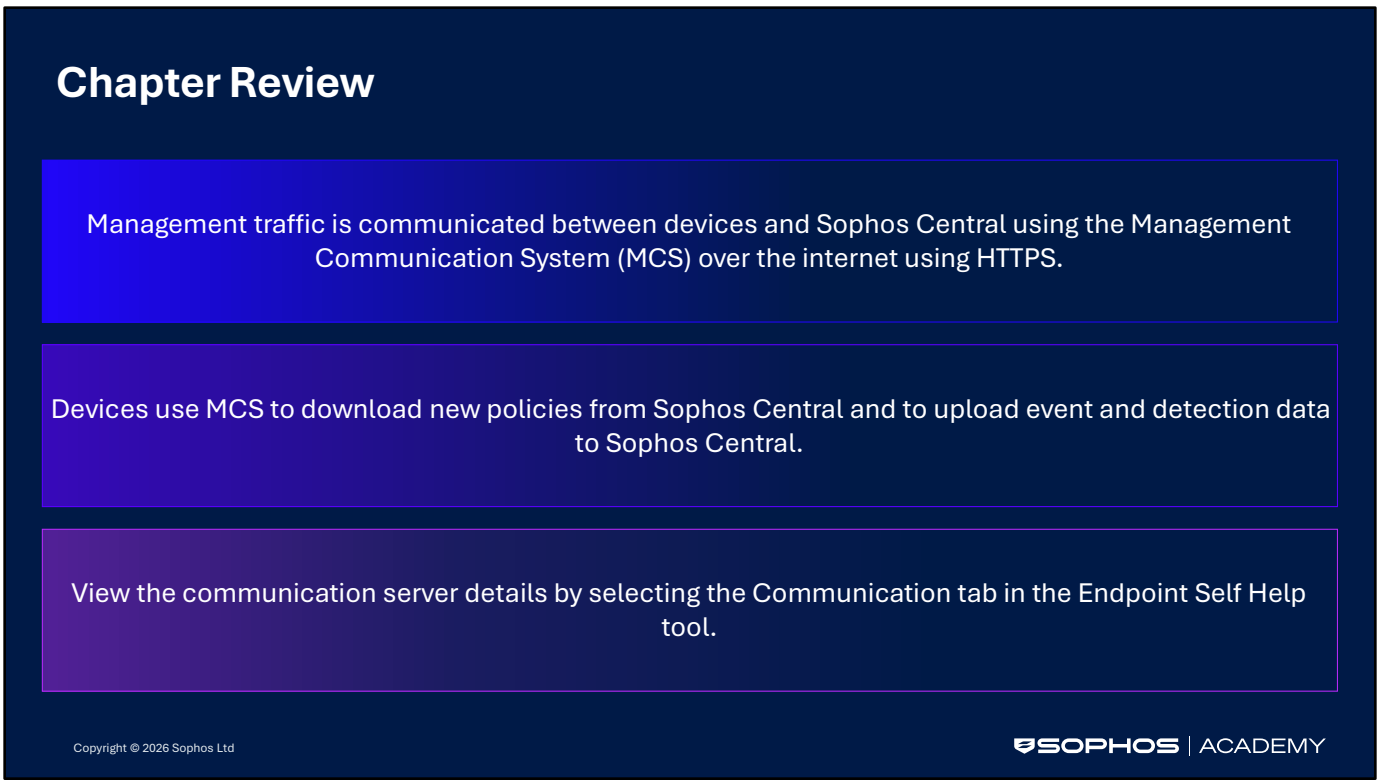
This tab displays the details of management traffic communication. In this example, the communication is currently successful. The connection details provide the name of the Sophos server and the proxy address, if used. If a Message Relay has been used; the Message Relay DNS will be displayed here. If there's a communication failure, the status will turn red on this tab and will show how long it has been since the last successful connection.

[Additional Information]
For more information about the communication process, see the knowledge base article:
https://support.sophos.com/support/s/article/KBA-000009254



Here are the three main things you learned in this chapter.

Management traffic is communicated between devices and Sophos Central using the Management Communication System (MCS) over the internet using HTTPS.

Devices use MCS to download new policies from Sophos Central and to upload event and detection data to Sophos Central.

View the communication server details by selecting the Communication tab in the Endpoint Self Help tool.

[Additional Information]

Sophos Endpoint
EP3015: Sophos Central Tamper Protection

May 2026

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In this chapter, you will learn about Tamper Protection, what it does, and how to recover Tamper Protection passwords.

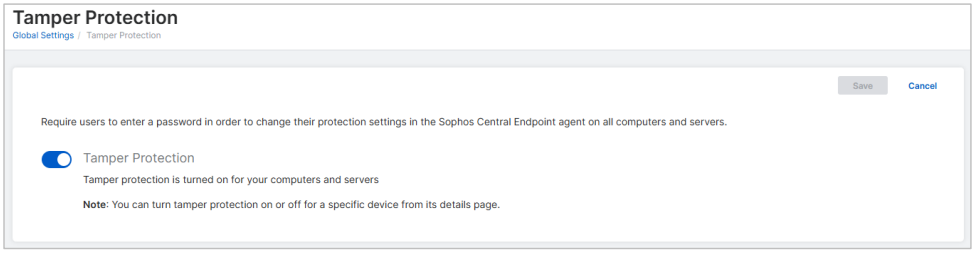
What is Tamper Protection?

Prevents the **uninstallation** of the Sophos Endpoint Agent

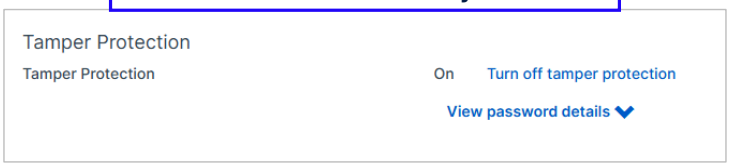
Prevents the **modification** of protection settings

Enabled by default

Global Settings > Products & Services > Endpoint & Server > Tamper Protection



Device > Summary



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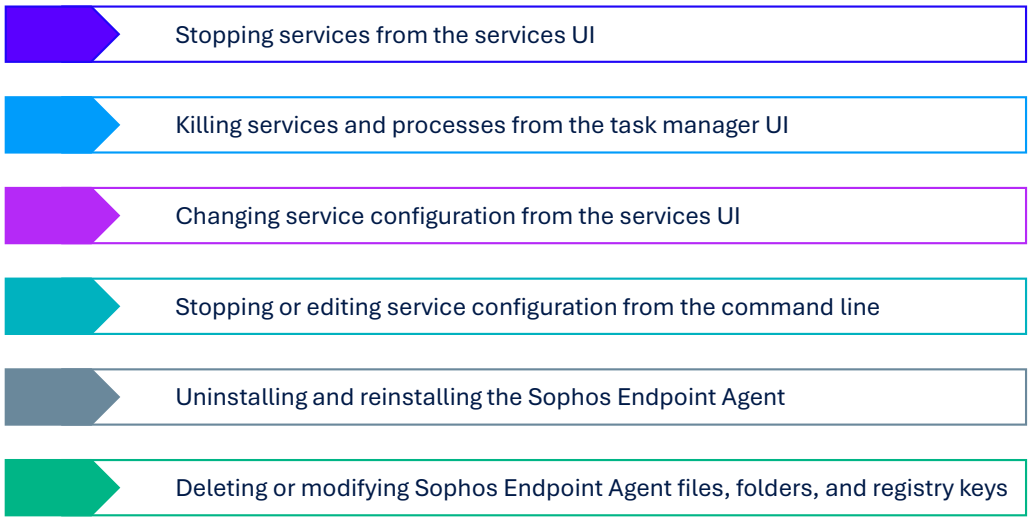
Tamper Protection prevents modification of protection settings and the uninstallation of the Sophos Endpoint Agent. It is enabled by default as a global setting. Any attempt to disable Tamper Protection, either by an unauthorized user or by malware, triggers an alert in Sophos Central. Tamper Protection can be turned off for all protected devices; however, this is not recommended. It can be disabled for individual devices which allows you to troubleshoot issues, re-install the agent, or remove the agent if required.

What Does Tamper Protection Prevent?



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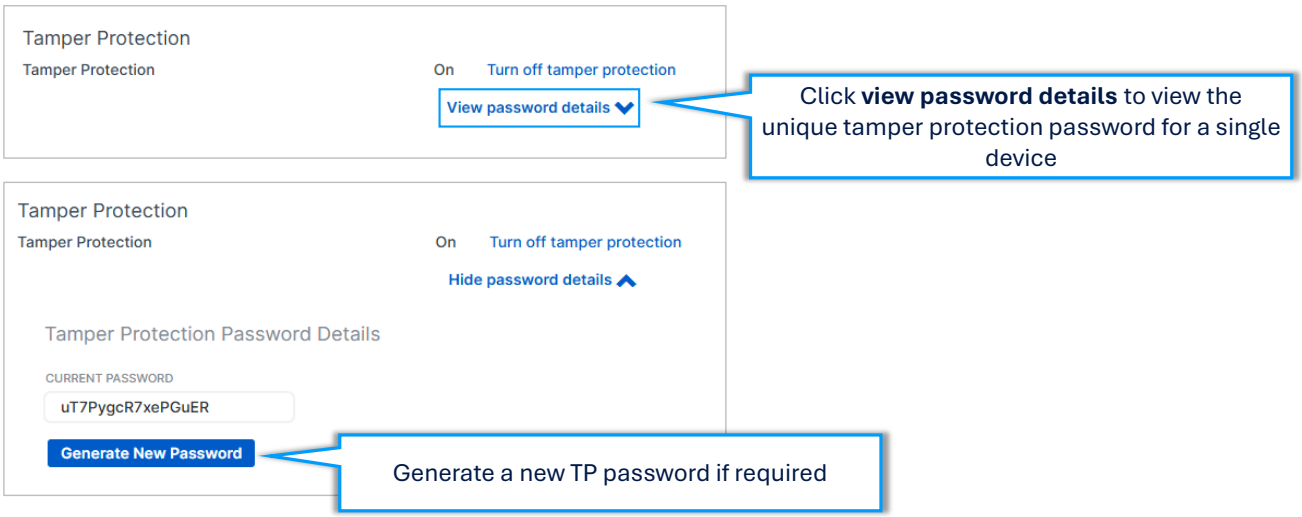
Tamper Protection's primary function is to prevent the modification of protection settings and the uninstallation of the Sophos Endpoint Agent. Additionally, it prevents users from stopping services and processes, changing service configurations, and stopping or editing service configurations from a command line. It also prevents the removal or modification of files, folders, and registry keys related to the Sophos Endpoint Agent.

Tamper Protection



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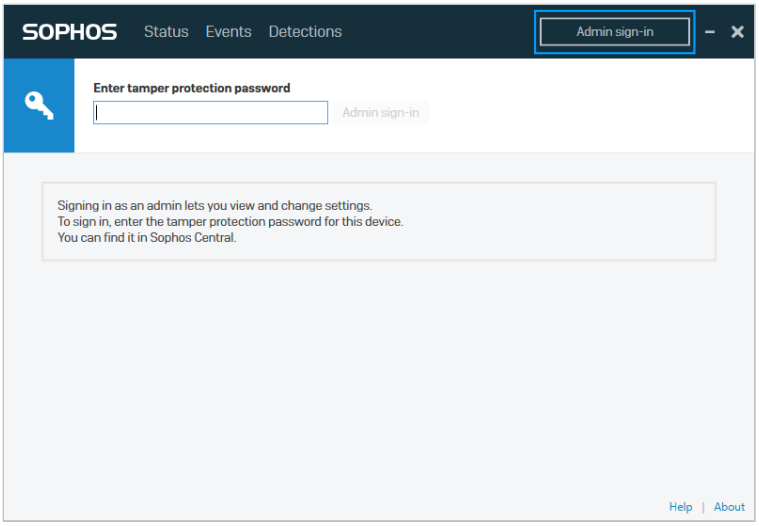
Each endpoint has a unique Tamper Protection password that can be viewed in Sophos Central on the **Device > SUMMARY** tab. In the 'Tamper Protection' section, click **View password details** to view the Tamper Protection password for the device. You can generate a new password if this is required.

Tamper Protection



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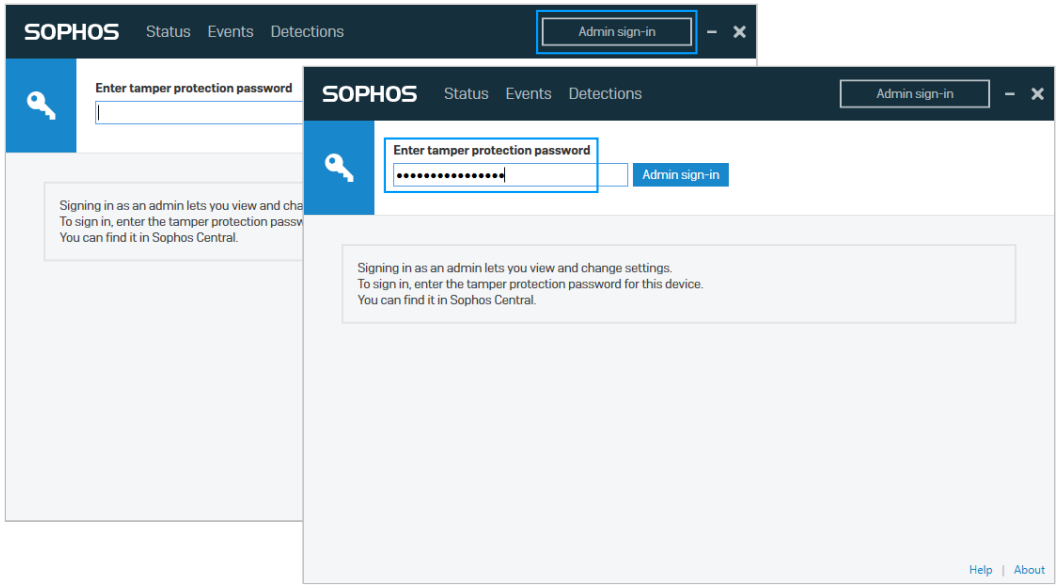
The Tamper Protection password for a device is used to access the settings of the Sophos Endpoint Agent.

Tamper Protection



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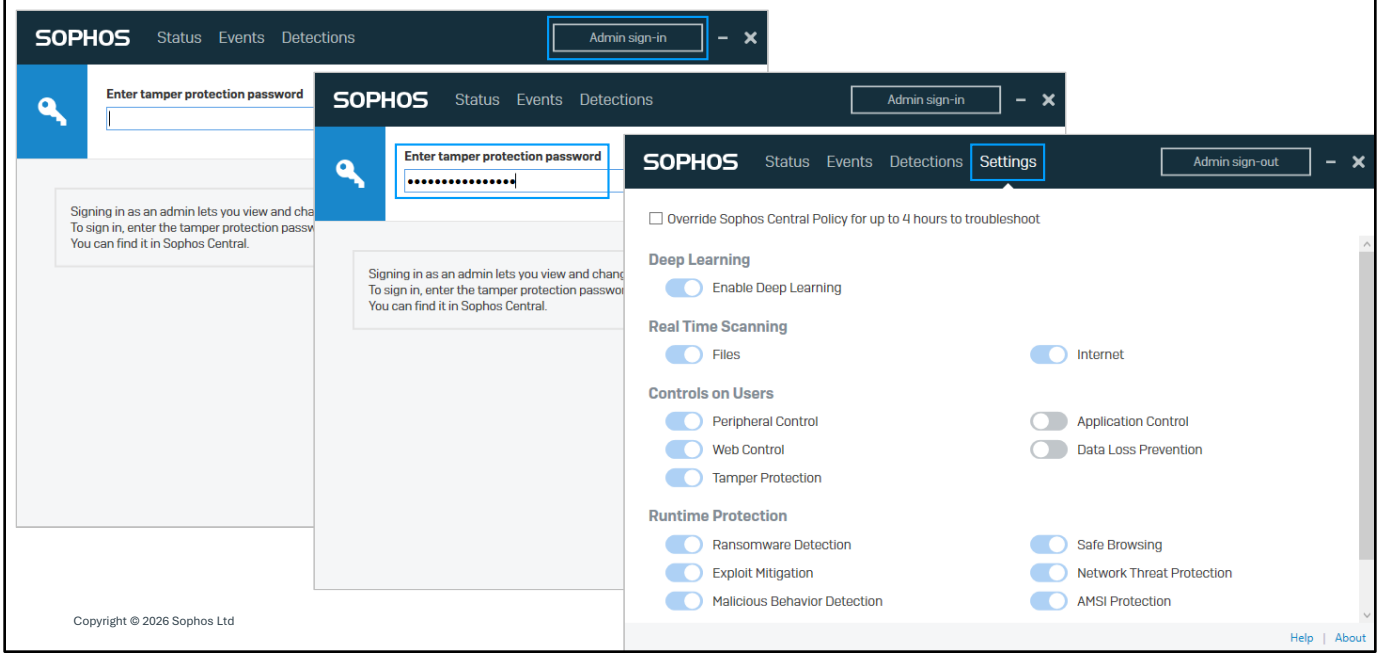
This may be required if protection settings need to be modified or if you need to troubleshoot an issue.

Tamper Protection



Notice that once the sign-in has been completed, the ‘Settings’ tab is displayed.

When to Disable Tamper Protection

Recommended scenarios for disabling Tamper Protection

- Performing an upgrade to the operating system of a device
- When re-protecting a device
- When restoring a Windows device to a restore point
- To remove the Sophos Endpoint Agent from a device

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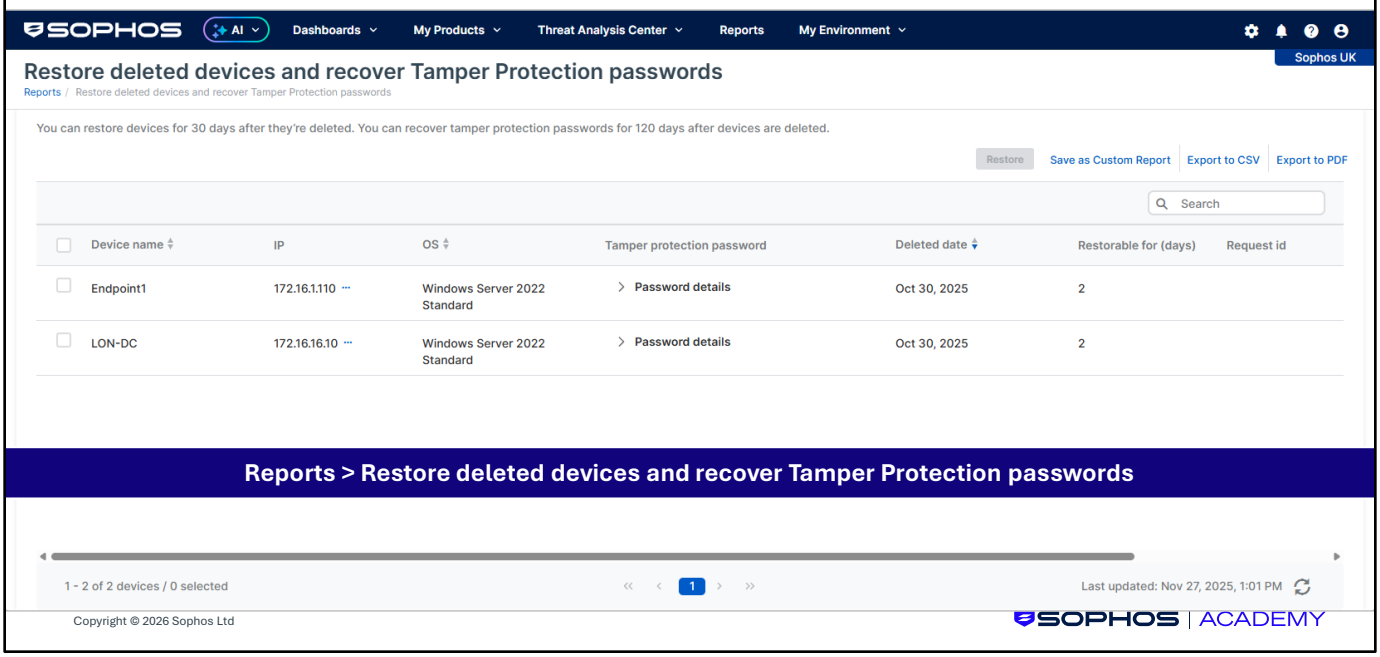
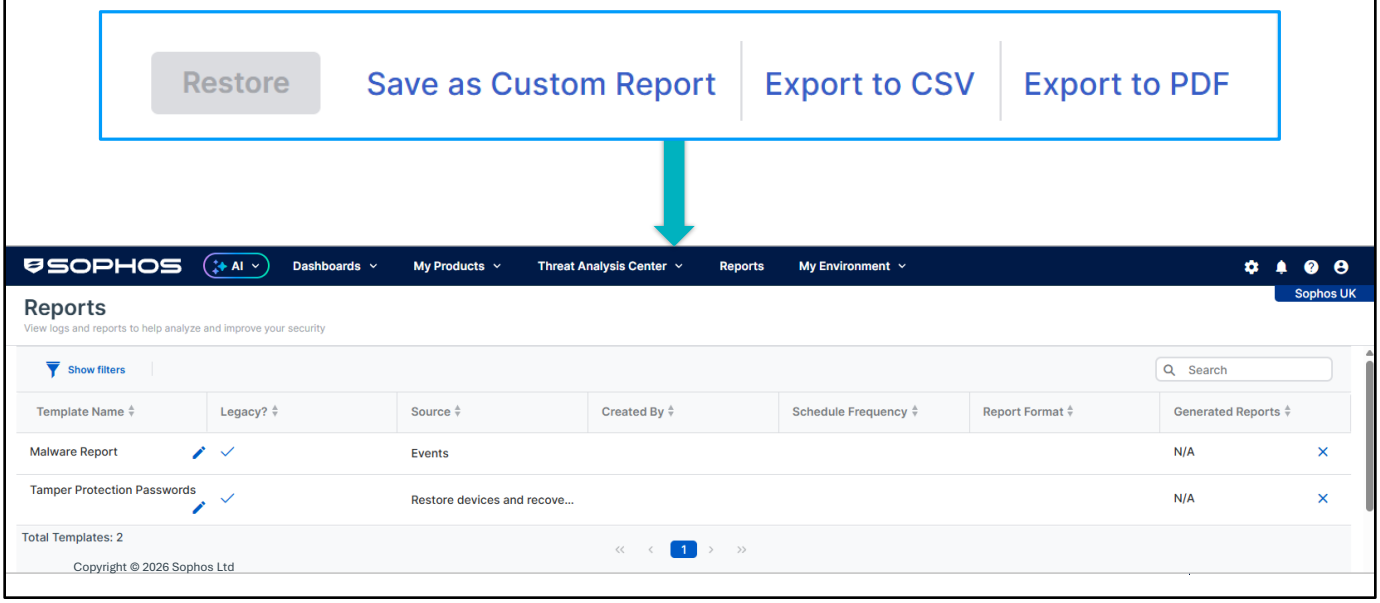
We do not recommend disabling Tamper Protection for any device as this reduces your protection. However, there are some scenarios where disabling Tamper Protection may be required. For example, if you plan to perform an upgrade to the operating system of a device, when you are re-protecting a device, when restoring a Windows device to a restore point, or remove the Sophos Endpoint Agent from a device.

Recover Tamper Protection Passwords



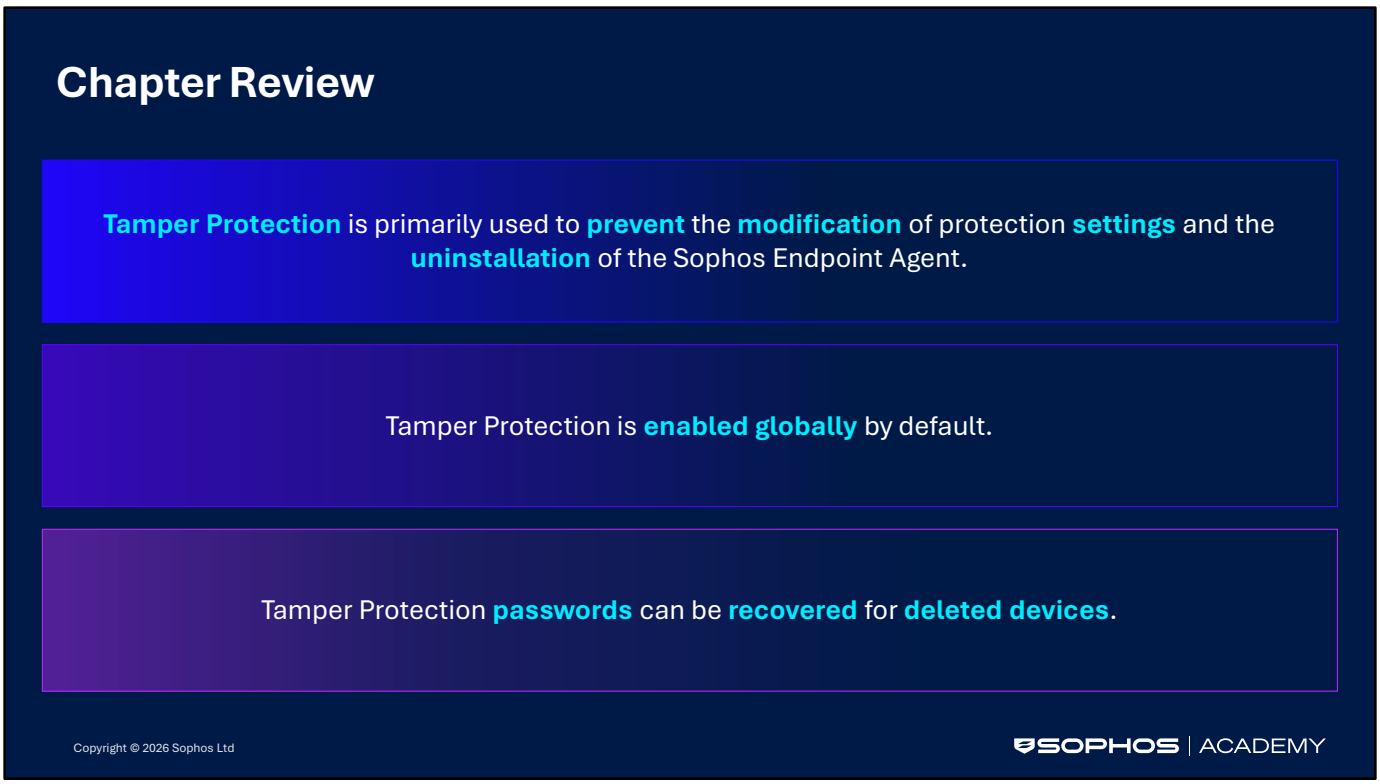
Tamper Protection passwords can be recovered if the device has been deleted from Sophos Central. To recover a Tamper Protection password, navigate to **Reports > Restore deleted devices and recover Tamper Protection passwords**.

Recover Tamper Protection Passwords



Passwords are available for devices that have been deleted in the last 120 days. This may be necessary to uninstall the Sophos Endpoint Agent if the device was deleted in Sophos Central, before the agent was uninstalled. To view the password, click the “View password details” link.

The report option allows you to save it as a custom report and to export it. This is especially useful for providing a recovery plan for accidentally deleted devices. If you regularly save the report, you can recover deleted devices further back than the report’s 120-day limit.



Here are the three main things you learned in this chapter.

Tamper Protection is primarily used to prevent the modification of protection settings and the uninstallation of the Sophos Endpoint Agent.

Tamper Protection is enabled globally by default.

Tamper Protection passwords can be recovered for deleted devices.

[Additional Information]

Sophos Endpoint
EP3020: Deleting Devices from Sophos Central

May 2026

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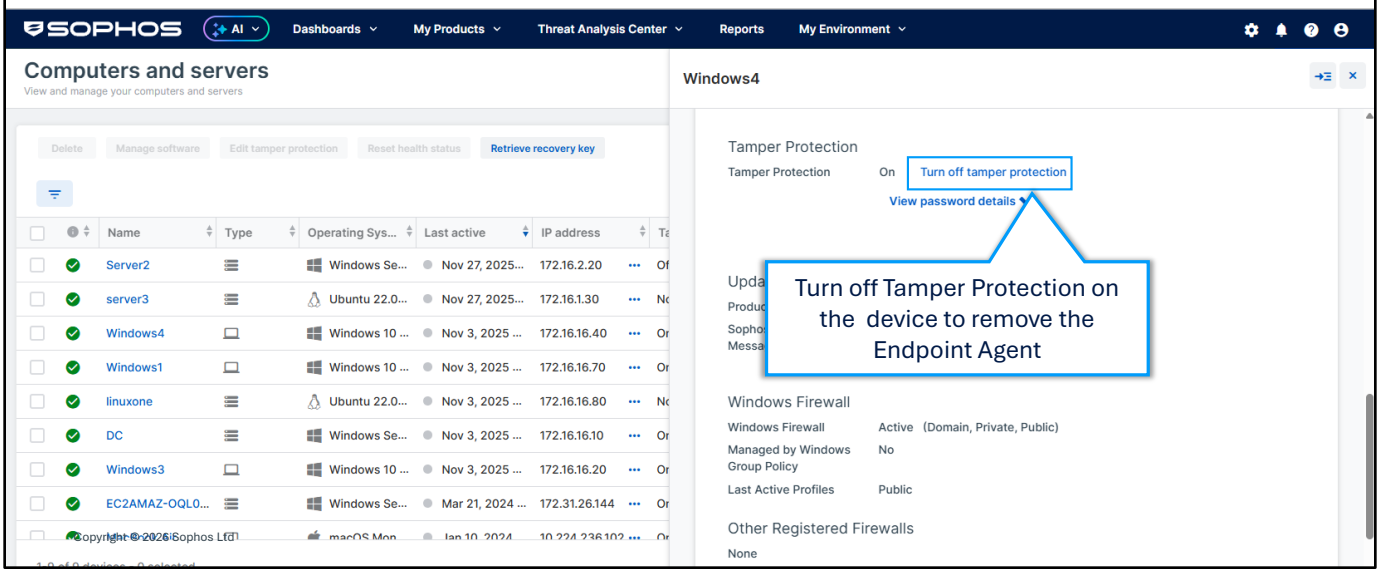
In this chapter, you'll learn how to correctly remove the Sophos Endpoint Agent from protected devices and how to remove devices from Sophos Central.

Deleting Devices

Step 1 **Disable Tamper protection** for the device in Sophos Central

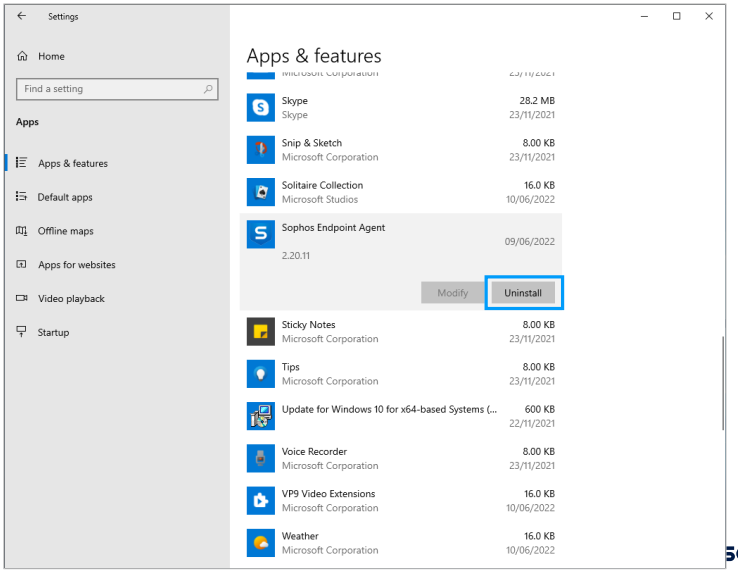


When you need to remove a device from Sophos Central, you first need to uninstall the Sophos Endpoint Agent from the device.

To do this, you must turn off Tamper Protection for that device.

Uninstall Sophos Endpoint Agent: Windows

Step 2 Locate the **Sophos Endpoint Agent** on the device and select **Uninstall**



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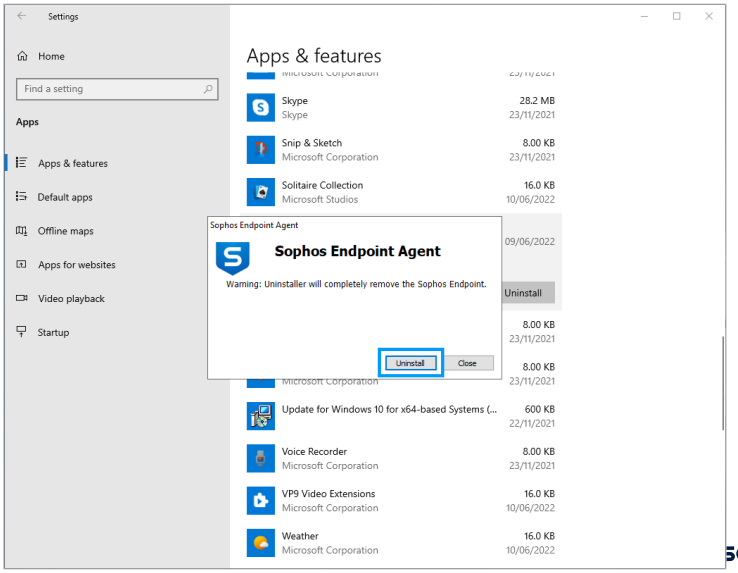
On a Windows device, navigate to the ‘Apps & features’ menu. Locate the Sophos Endpoint Agent and select **Uninstall**.

As part of the uninstall process, the Sophos AutoUpdate service is stopped. This cannot be stopped if an update is in progress, and therefore, the uninstall will fail. You must ensure that the device is not updating when you uninstall the Sophos Endpoint Agent.

Uninstall Sophos Endpoint Agent: Windows

Step 2 Locate the **Sophos Endpoint Agent** on the device and select **Uninstall**



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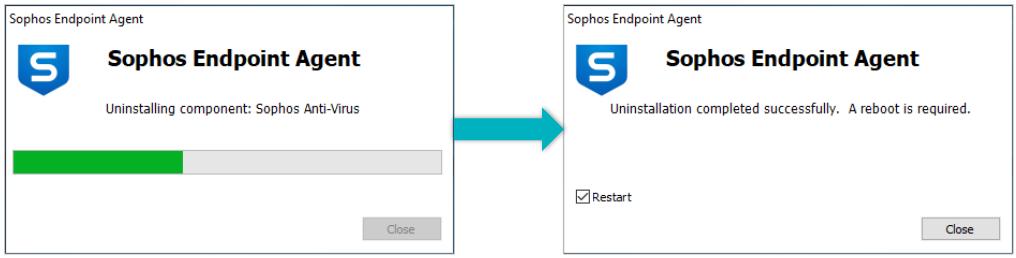
A confirmation message will be displayed for removal confirmation.

Click **Uninstall**.

Uninstall Sophos Endpoint Agent: Windows

Step 3 Confirmation that the Sophos Endpoint Agent has been removed



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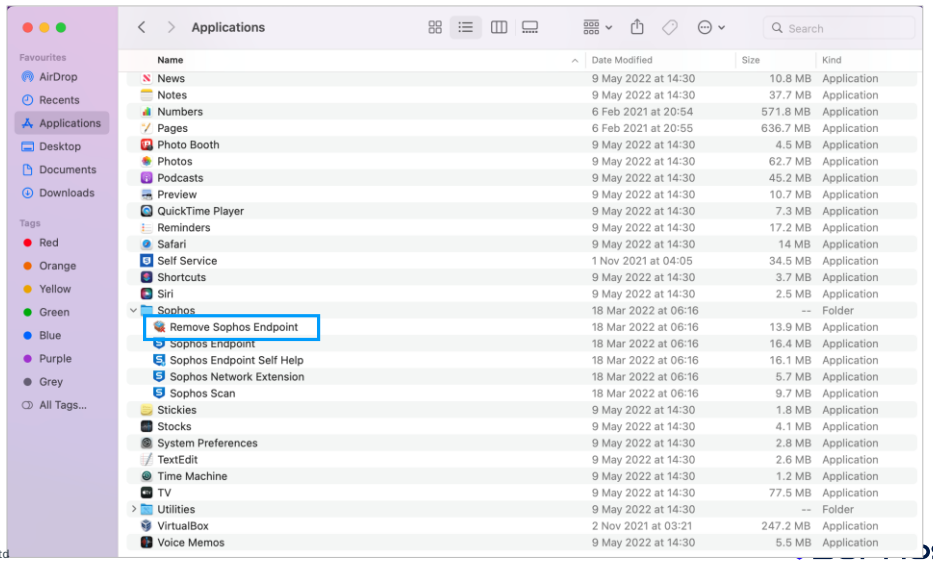
Once the Sophos Endpoint Agent has been removed successfully, a confirmation message will be displayed on the device.

Uninstall Sophos Endpoint Agent: macOS

Step 2 Locate the **Remove Sophos Endpoint** application in Finder



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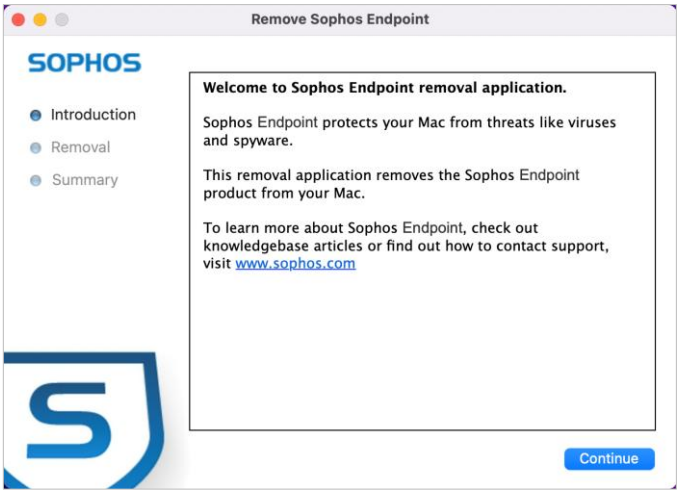
When the Sophos Endpoint Agent is installed on a macOS device, a **Remove Sophos Endpoint** program is also installed.

To remove the Sophos Endpoint Agent, run **Remove Sophos Endpoint.**

Uninstall Sophos Endpoint Agent: macOS

Step 3 Click **Continue** to start the removal process



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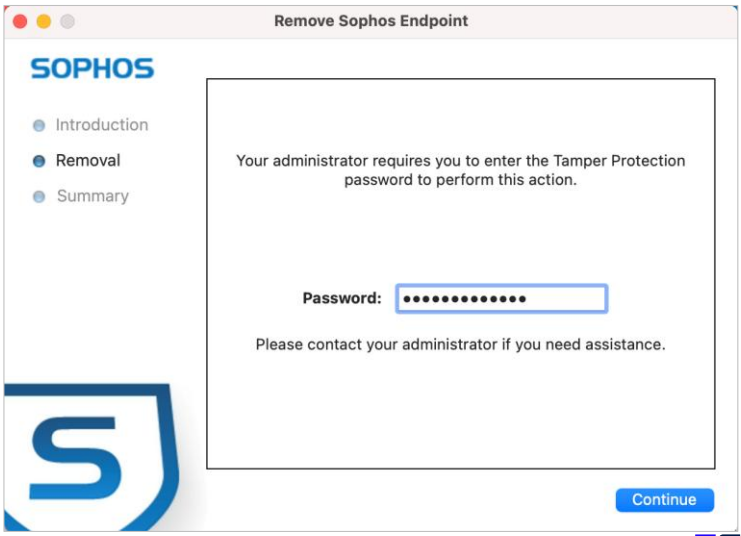
The removal tool will be opened. Click **Continue**.

Uninstall Sophos Endpoint Agent: macOS

Step 4 Enter the **Tamper Protection password** if it has not been disabled in Sophos Central



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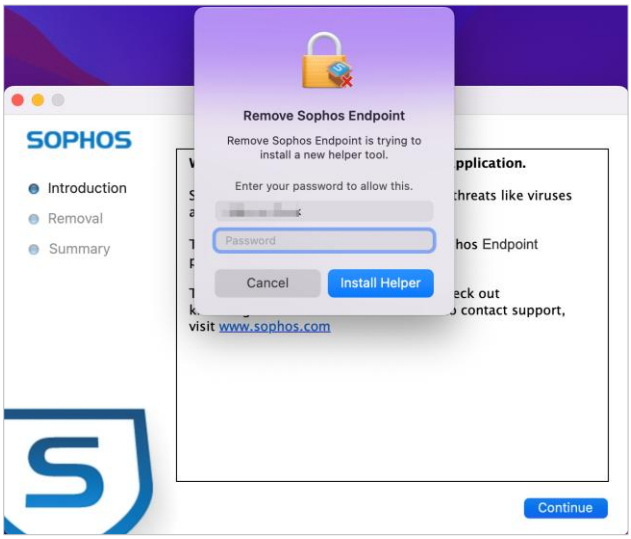
If you have not disabled Tamper Protection from Sophos Central for the device, you will need to enter the Tamper Protection password to continue with the removal of the Sophos Endpoint Agent.

Uninstall Sophos Endpoint Agent: macOS

Step 5 Enter the **password for the device** to install the helper



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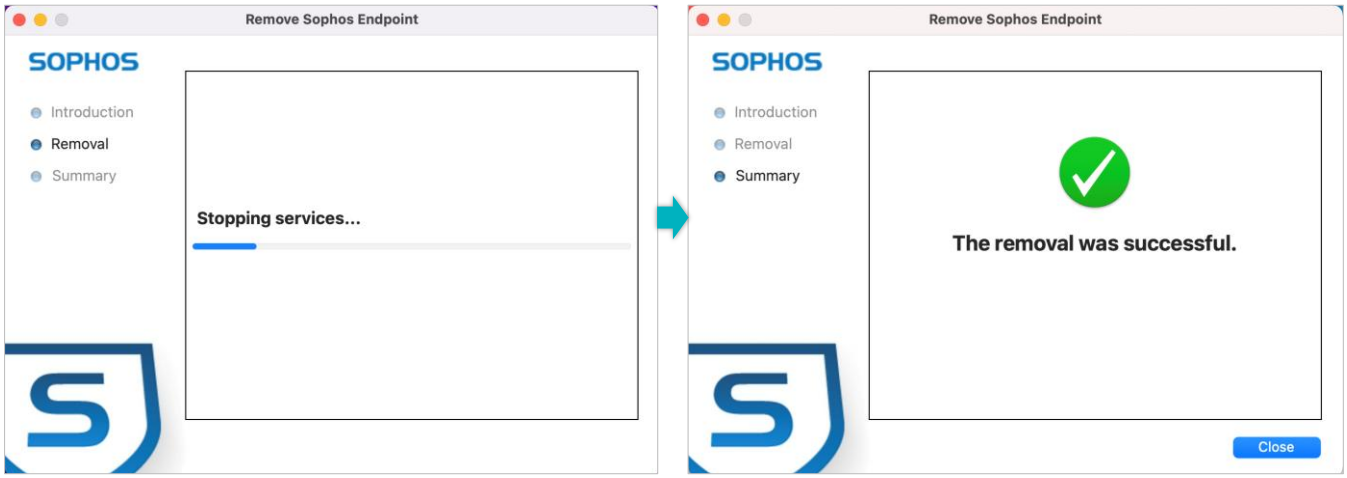
A prompt to use the ‘Install Helper’ will be displayed. Enter the device password to start the removal.

Uninstall Sophos Endpoint Agent: macOS

Step 6 Confirmation that the Sophos Endpoint Agent has been removed



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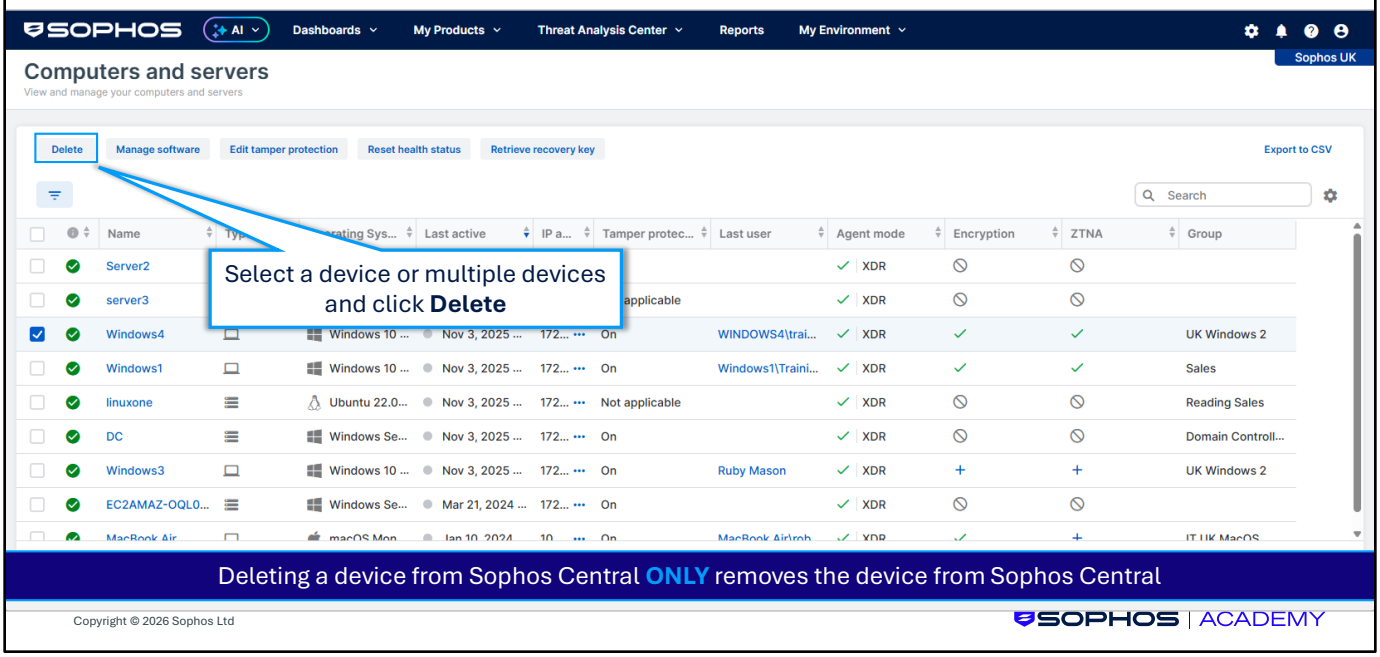
Once the Sophos Endpoint Agent has been removed successfully, a confirmation message will be displayed on the device.

Deleting Devices in Sophos Central



Now that the Sophos Endpoint Agent has been uninstalled from the device, the device can be deleted in Sophos Central.

Navigate to the **My Environment** drop-down menu and select Computers and servers. Select the device(s) you want to delete and click **Delete**. You will see a confirmation message.

Note that deleting a device from Sophos Central **ONLY** removes the device from appearing in the Sophos Central console. It DOES NOT uninstall the Sophos Endpoint Agent from the device itself.

Supported Uninstall Methods

Additional information available in the notes

- Uninstall using command line or a batch file: **KB-000035419**

- Uninstall manually: **KB-000035097**
- Uninstall using removal tool: **KB-000035182**
- Uninstall via Terminal**: KB-000033340**

- Uninstall manually: **KB-000044199**

- How to escalate, upgrade, and uninstall: **KB-000034599**

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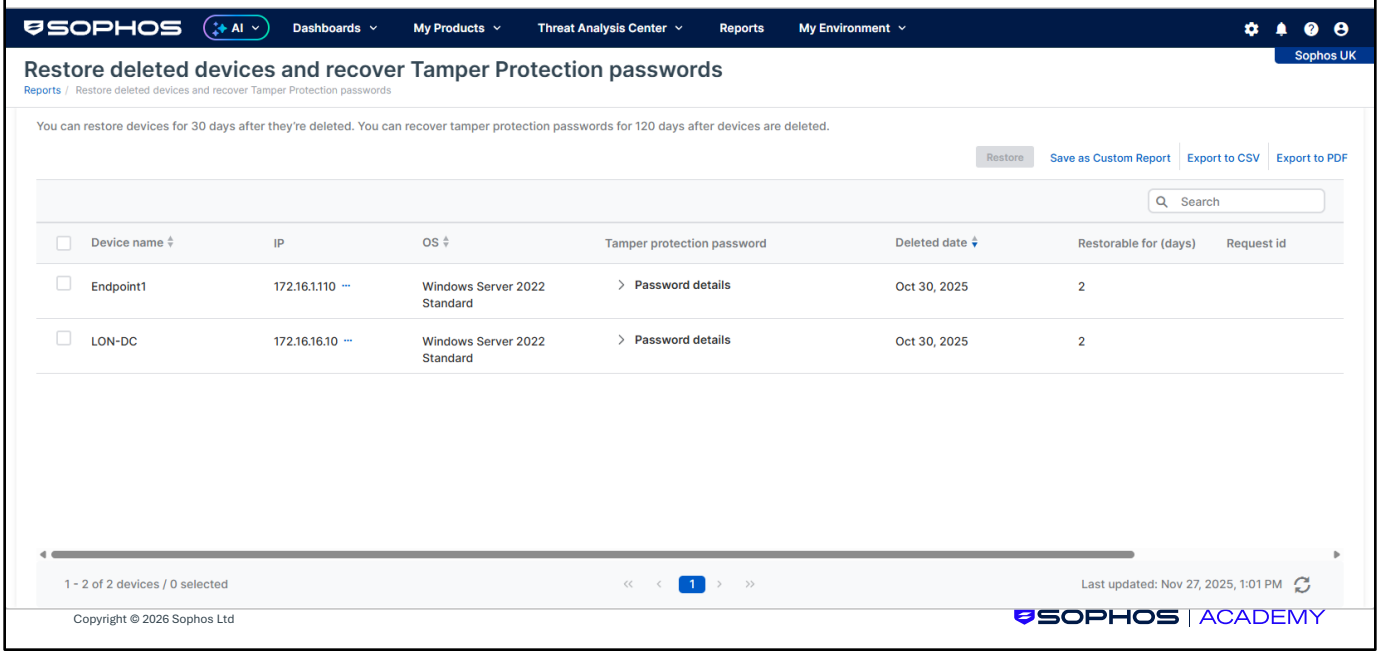
Sophos have published several supported methods to carry out the uninstallation of the Sophos Endpoint Agent on various platforms.

Ensure that you always follow the supported methods of uninstallation. If you encounter an issue with uninstallation, please seek technical support from Sophos.

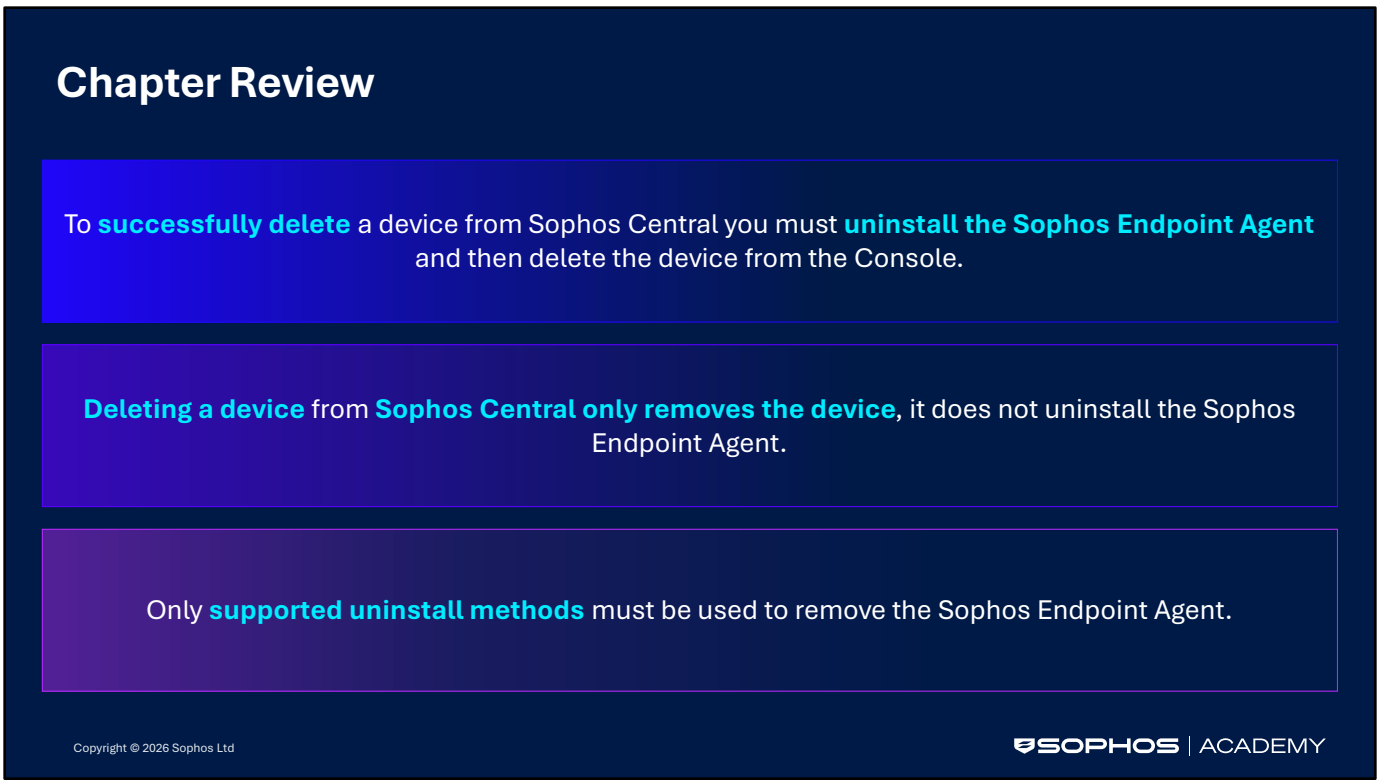
[Additional Information]
Windows:
How to uninstall Sophos using the command line or a batch file: Sophos Endpoint and Server: Uninstall Sophos using the command line or a batch file
https://support.sophos.com/support/s/article/KB-000035419
MacOS: How to uninstall: Sophos Endpoint for Mac: How to uninstall
https://support.sophos.com/support/s/article/KB-000035097
Removal tool: Sophos Endpoint for macOS: Removal tool
https://support.sophos.com/support/s/article/KB-000035182
How to install or uninstall using the terminal: Sophos Endpoint for Mac: Install or uninstall using the Terminal
https://support.sophos.com/support/s/article/KB-000033340
Linux: How to perform a manual uninstall: Sophos Protection for Linux: How to uninstall
https://support.sophos.com/support/s/article/KB-000044199
General Uninstall: How to escalate upgrade and uninstall issues: Sophos Endpoint: Escalate upgrade and uninstall issues
https://support.sophos.com/support/s/article/KB-000034599
Devices or Users: How to recover a deleted device or user: Deleted and expired devices - Sophos Central Admin

https://docs.sophos.com/central/Customer/help/en-us/PeopleAndDevices/Devices/RecoverDeletedDevices/index.html
Uninstall Sophos Endpoint: Uninstall Sophos Endpoint - Sophos Endpoint
https://docs.sophos.com/esg/endpoint/help/en-us/help/Uninstall/index.html

Recovering Deleted Devices



If you need to recover a deleted device, the ‘Restore deleted devices and recover Tamper Protection passwords report’ can be used. You can restore devices for 30 days after deletion.



Here are the three main things you learned in this chapter.

To successfully delete a device from Sophos Central, you must uninstall the Sophos Endpoint Agent and then delete the device from the Console.

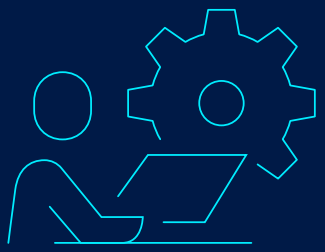
Deleting a device from Sophos Central only removes the device, it does not uninstall the Sophos Endpoint Agent.

Only supported uninstall methods must be used to remove the Sophos Endpoint Agent.

Lab Tasks

Complete the lab tasks for **Device Management**

- **Task 1**: Create Software Packages
- **Task 2**: Create a Server Group



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Complete the lab tasks for this module.

The lab task information can be found in the Lab Workbook which is available in the **Lesson Resources.**

Sophos Endpoint Policies

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[Additional Information]

Sophos Endpoint
EP3505: Getting Started with Sophos Central Policies

May 2026

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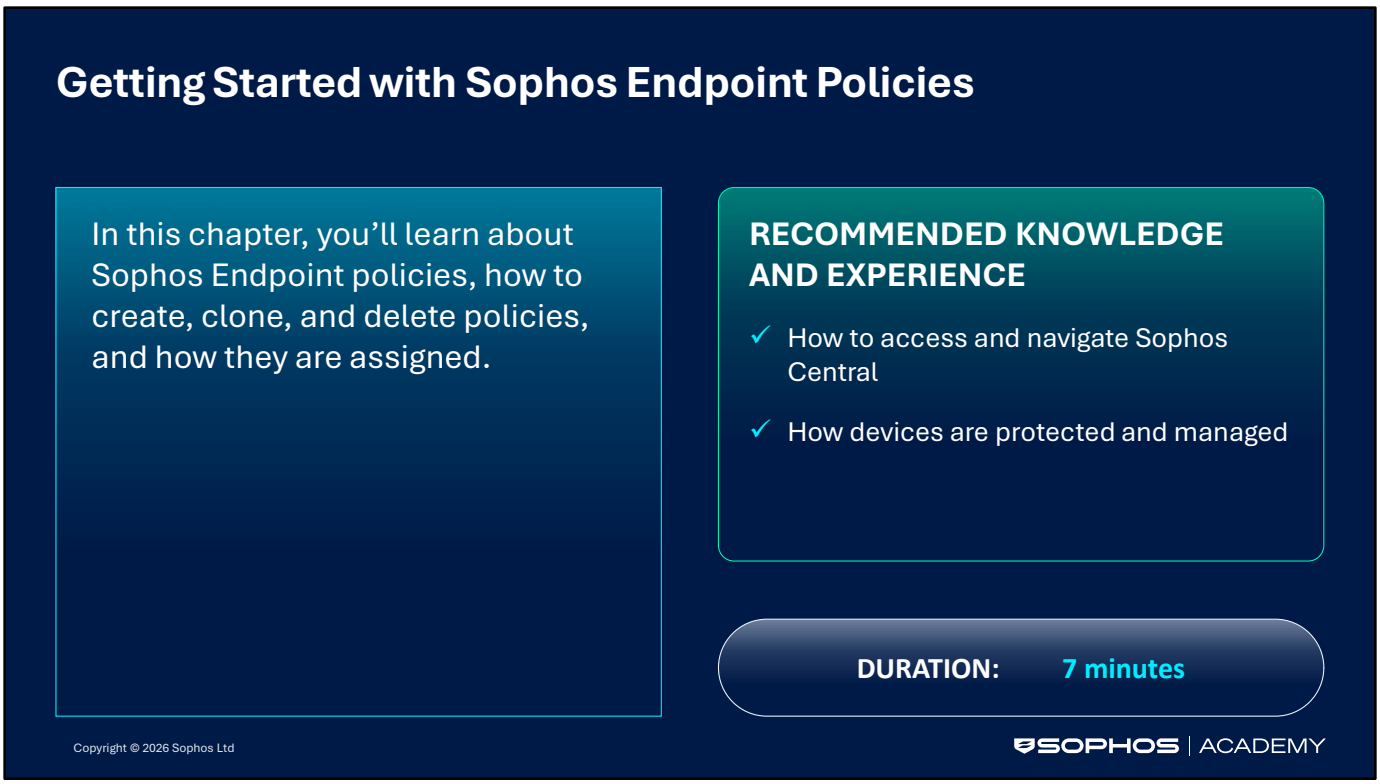

In this chapter, you will learn about Sophos Endpoint policies, how to create, clone, and delete policies, and how they are assigned.

Sophos Endpoint Policies

Policies define the security settings applied to protected devices

- Policies can be **assigned** to users, computers, servers, and groups
- **Base policies** are **pre-configured** and contain **Sophos' recommended security settings**
- Base policies are split into **feature types** to allow granular control

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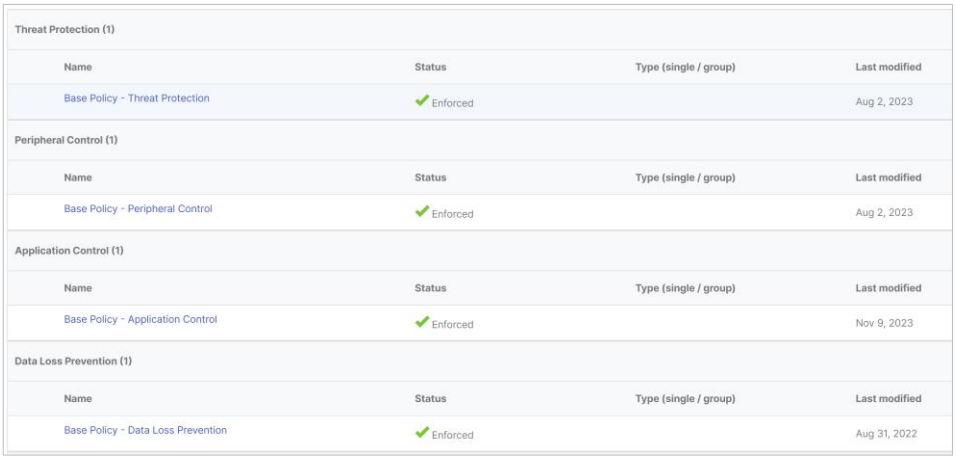
Sophos Endpoint policies define security settings applied to protected devices. Policies can be assigned to users, computers, servers, and groups. Base policies are pre-configured by Sophos and contain recommended security settings.

Base policies are split into feature types, which allows for granular control.

Base Policies

- Base policies are enforced by default
- The threat protection policy is the only policy that has Sophos' recommended security settings applied by default



Threat Protection (1)

Name	Status	Type (single / group)	Last modified
Base Policy - Threat Protection	Enforced		Aug 2, 2023

Peripheral Control (1)

Name	Status	Type (single / group)	Last modified
Base Policy - Peripheral Control	Enforced		Aug 2, 2023

Application Control (1)

Name	Status	Type (single / group)	Last modified
Base Policy - Application Control	Enforced		Nov 9, 2023

Data Loss Prevention (1)

Name	Status	Type (single / group)	Last modified
Base Policy - Data Loss Prevention	Enforced		Aug 31, 2022

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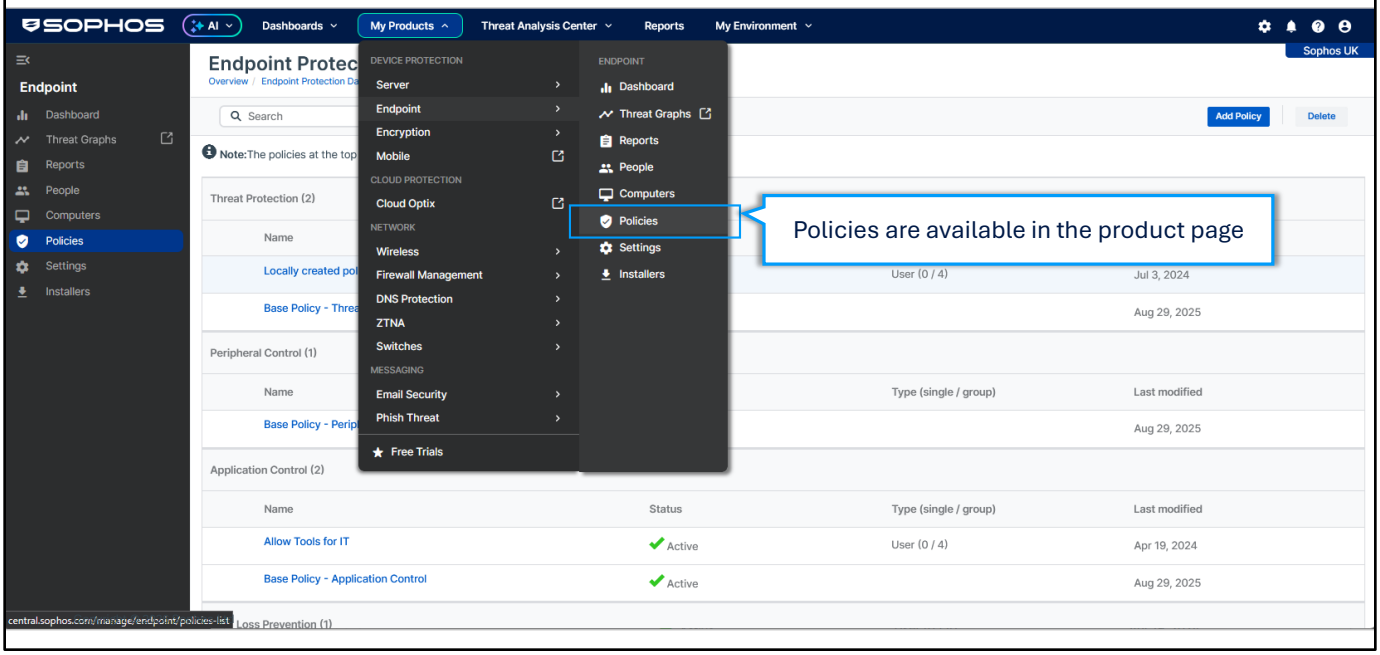
Base policies are enforced by default; however, only the threat protection policy is configured with recommended security settings.

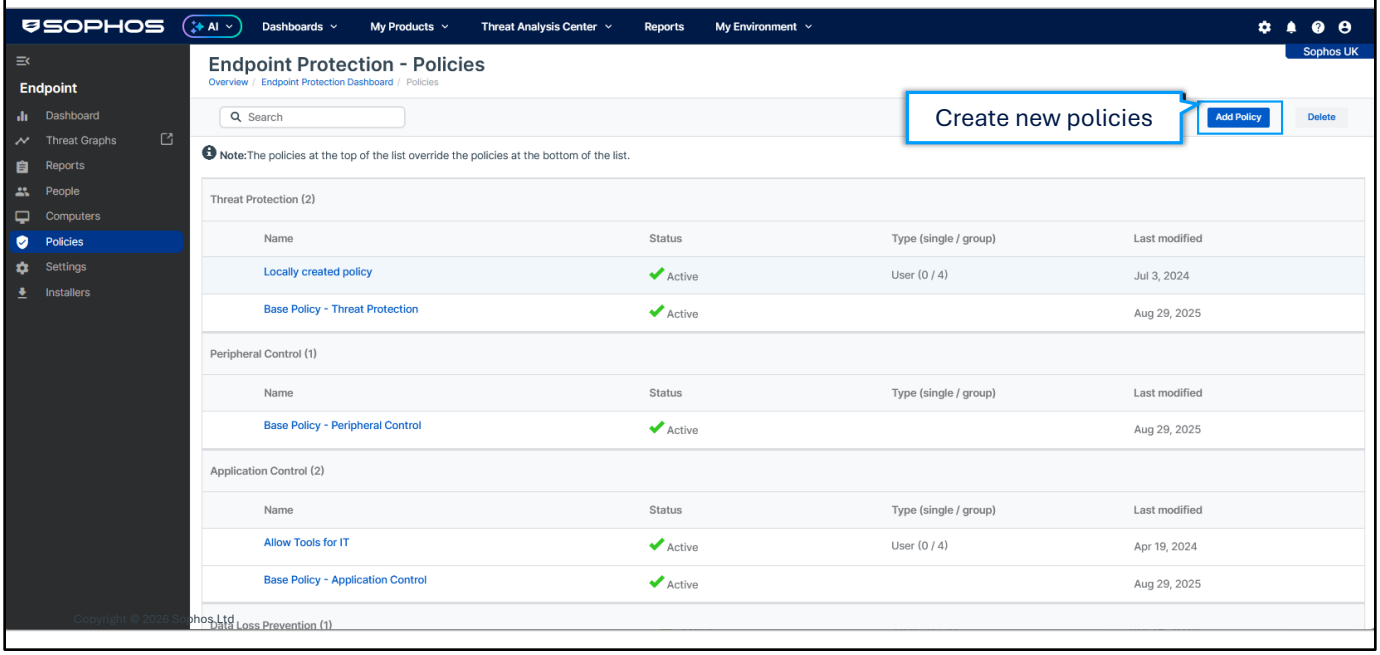
This is because the base policies for controlling peripheral devices, applications, websites, and data loss prevention are environment-specific.

Creating a Policy



You can configure new policies to override some or all the settings in a base policy. You can use new policies to apply different settings to different users, devices or servers. You can also create new policies to test new features for specific devices. To create a new policy in Sophos Central, navigate to the **My Products** drop-down menu. Select the product and then select **Policies**.

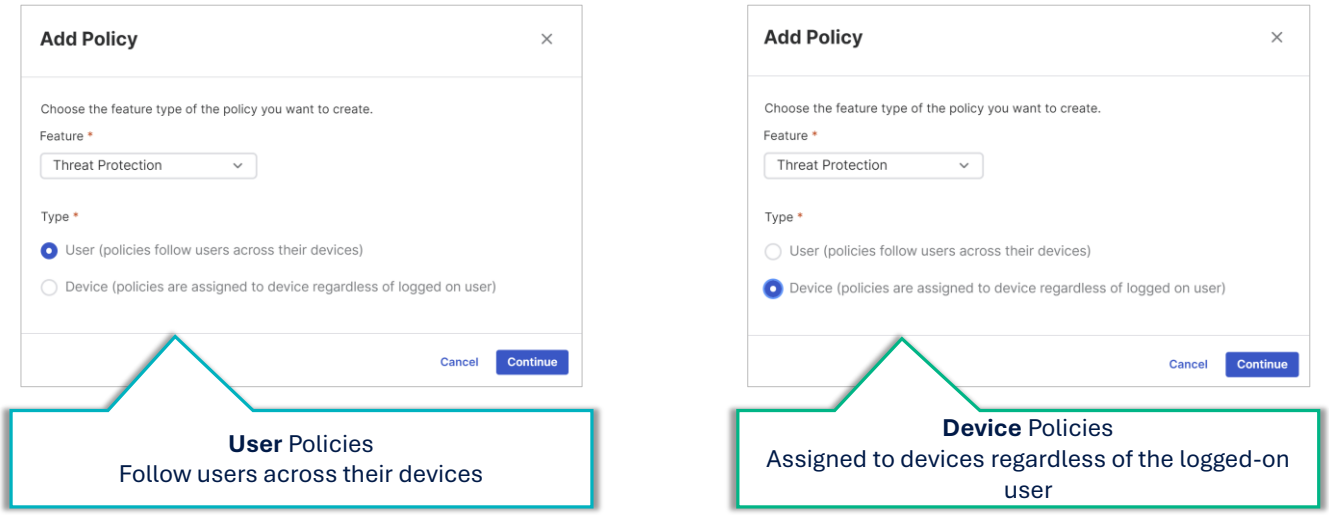
Creating a Policy



To create a new policy, click **Add Policy**.

Creating a Policy

Endpoint Protection Policies



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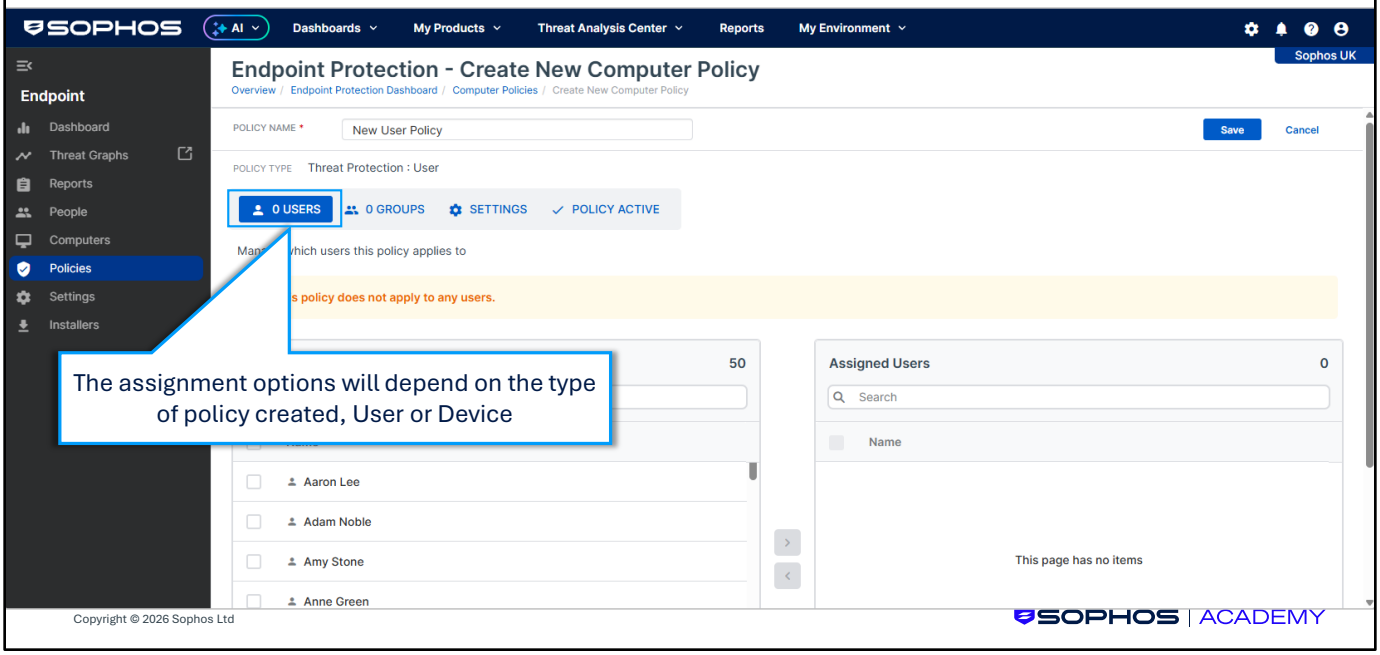
Select the feature you want to create the policy for. In this example, we have selected **Threat Protection**.

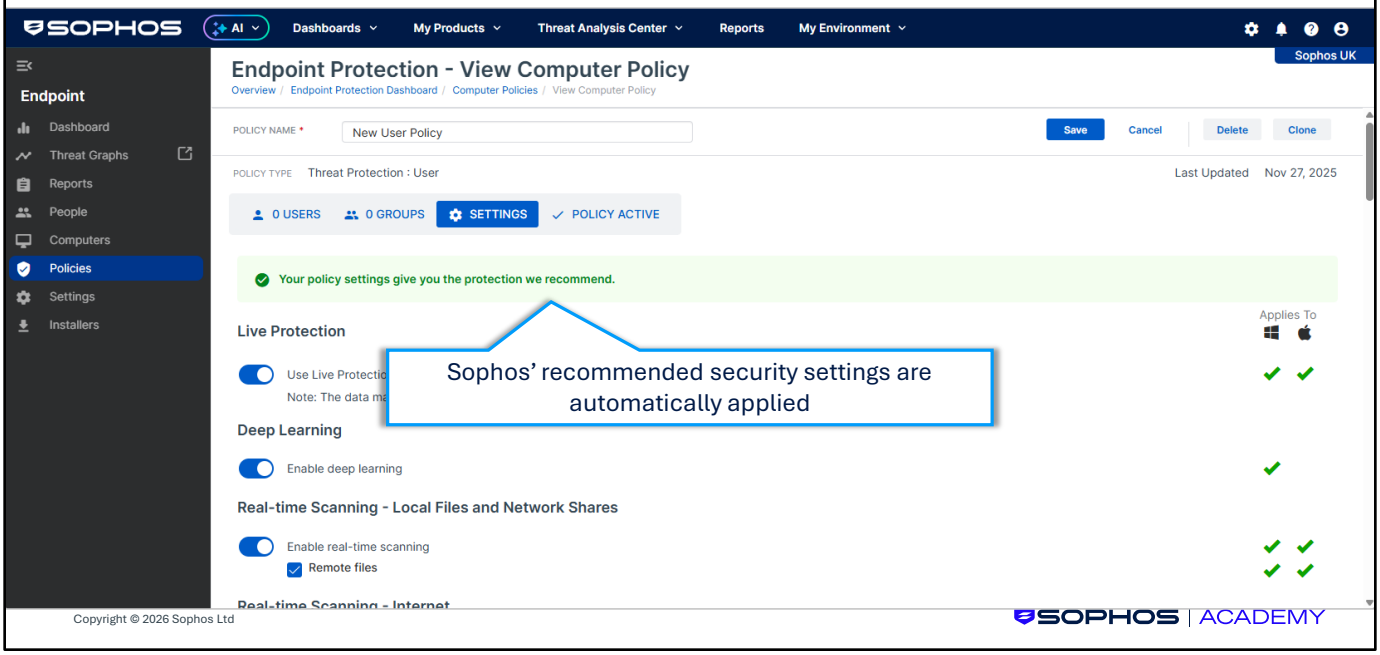
For Sophos Endpoint policies, you will also need to select whether the policy will be a user or a device policy. User policies follow users across their devices, whereas device policies are assigned to devices regardless of the logged-on user.

Creating a Policy



The options of assigning the policy will depend on the type of policy created. For example, a server protection policy can only be applied to specific servers or server groups.

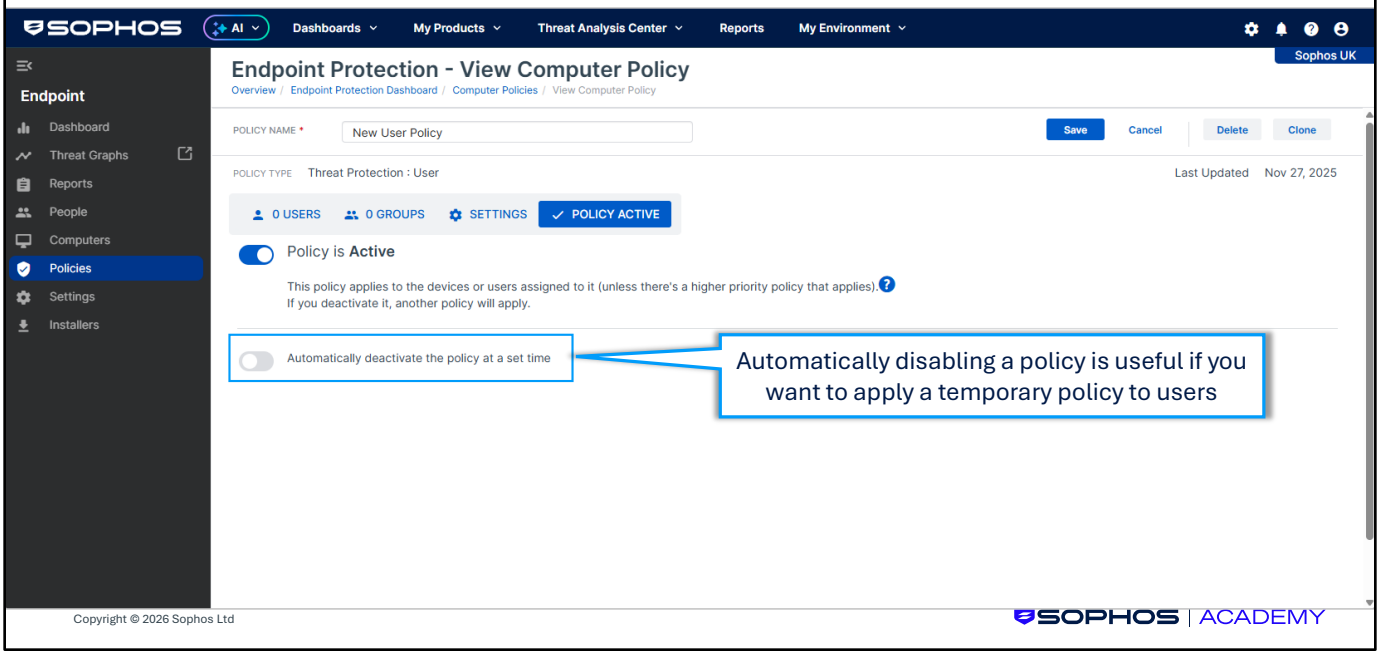
Creating a Policy



On the **SETTINGS** tab, you can configure the policy to your specifications. New policies will have Sophos' recommended security settings automatically applied.

There are some security settings that are not applied automatically. You can configure these based on your requirements and can also configure scheduled scanning, device isolation, and policy exclusions.

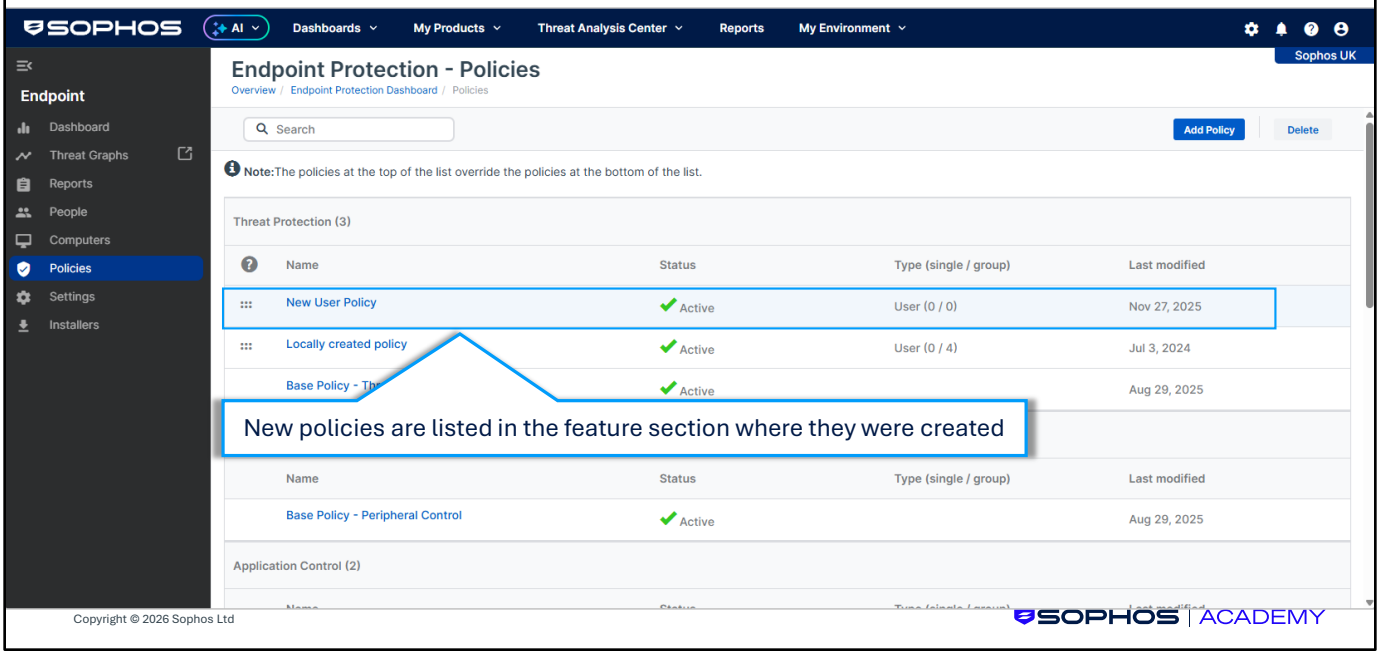
Creating a Policy



New policies are automatically enforced. If you want to bypass the policy, you must amend the setting on the **POLICY ACTIVE** tab.

You can select to automatically disable the policy at a specific time. This is useful if you want to apply a temporary policy to users.

Creating a Policy

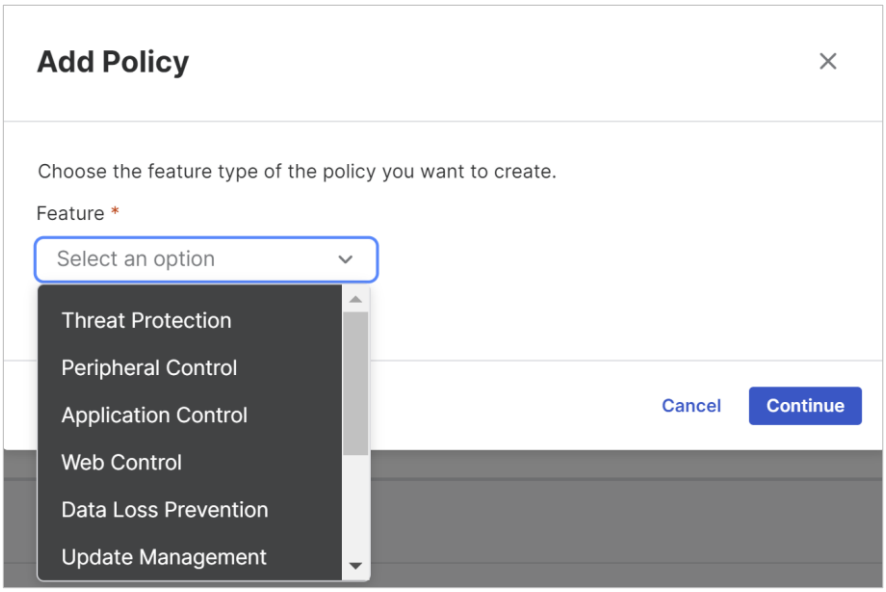


New policies are saved in the feature policy section where they were created.

Server Policies

Server Policies

- Server policies are always device-based
- Server policies have been modified for server use
- Additional policies for servers allow for the management of file integrity monitoring, server lockdown, and Linux runtime detection



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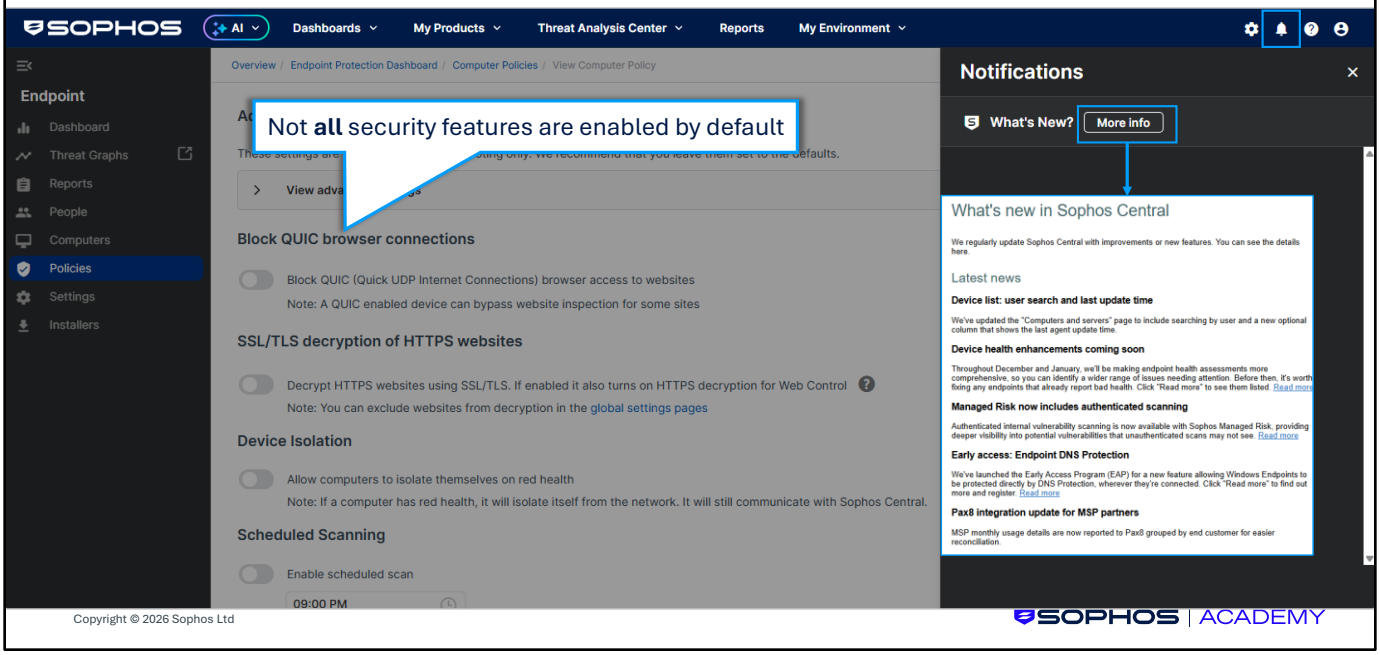
Server policies are always device-based. When you add a new server policy, it can only be assigned to specific servers or server groups. Base policies for threat protection, peripheral, application, and web control, data loss prevention, and update management have been modified where appropriate for server use.

Additional policies for servers allow you to manage Server Lockdown, File Integrity Monitoring, and Linux runtime detection.

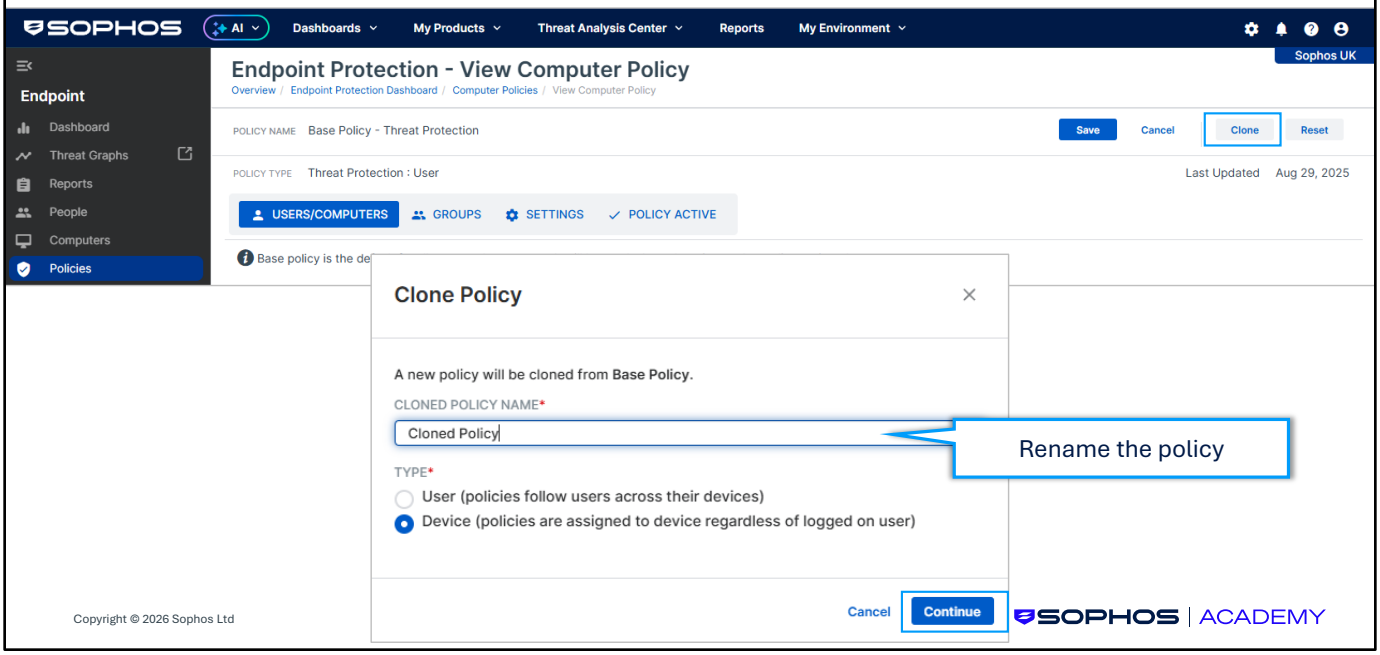
New Features



It is important to understand that not all new threat protection features are enabled by default. This is because enabling new functionality without warning could have unexpected consequences. A notification is added to Sophos Central announcing any new security features. You can make an informed decision regarding the enablement of new features on all protected devices, or only a couple at a time to monitor the effect the security feature has.

You can also access information on any new features by browsing the ‘What’s new!’ help menu.

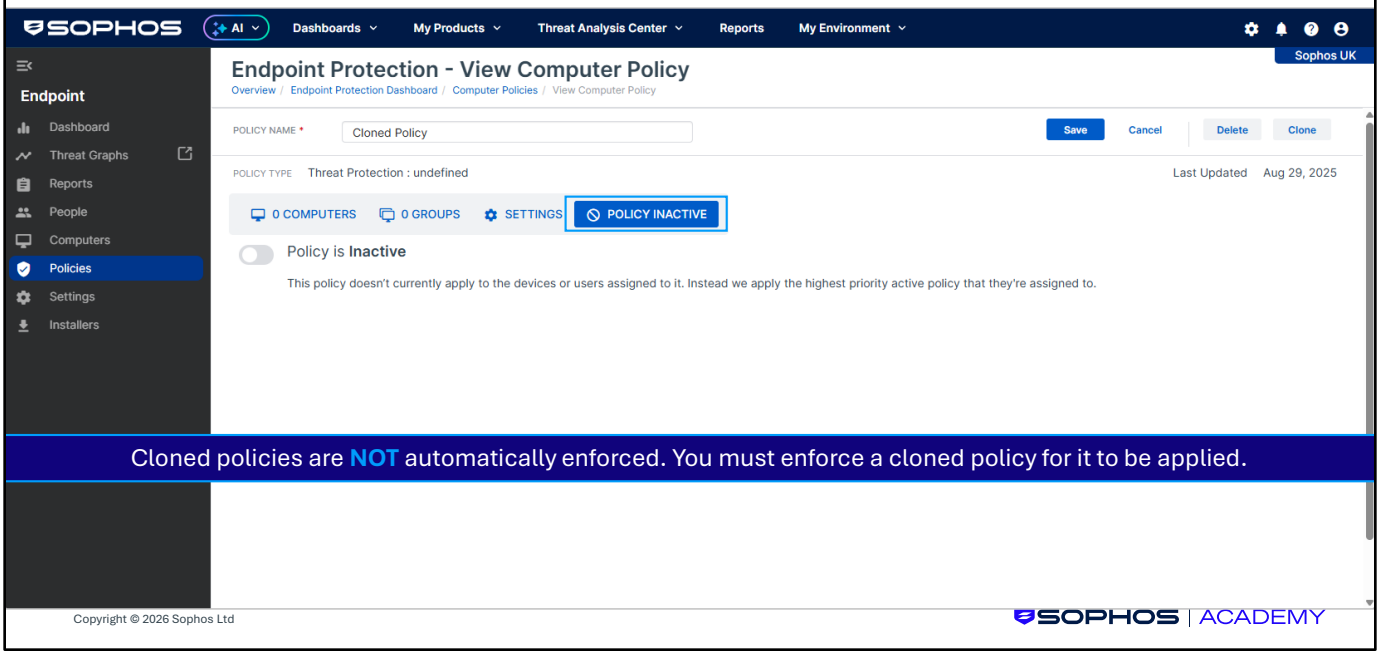
Cloning a Policy



You can create a new policy by cloning an existing policy. In this example, we are cloning the threat protection base policy. To clone a policy, open the policy you want to clone. In the top-right, click **Clone**.

You must re-name the policy, for endpoint protection policies you will also need to select either user or device and then click **Continue**.

Cloning a Policy

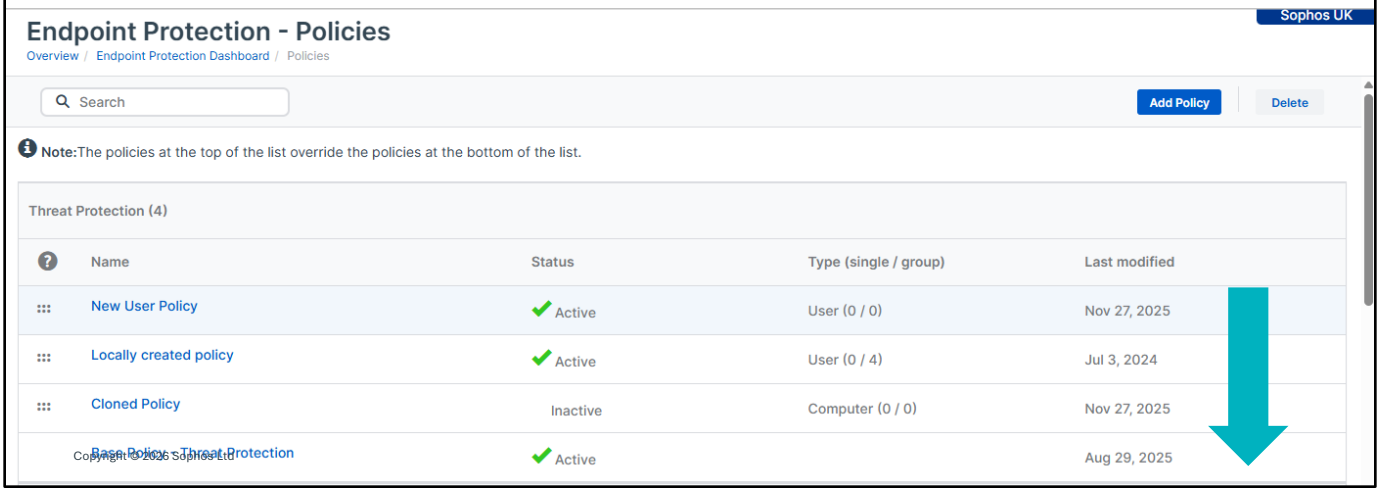


It is important to note that when cloning a policy, it will not be automatically active. You must manually make a cloned policy active for it to be applied.

To do this, select the **POLICY INACTIVE** tab and toggle the policy setting. This will activate the policy.

Policy Precedence

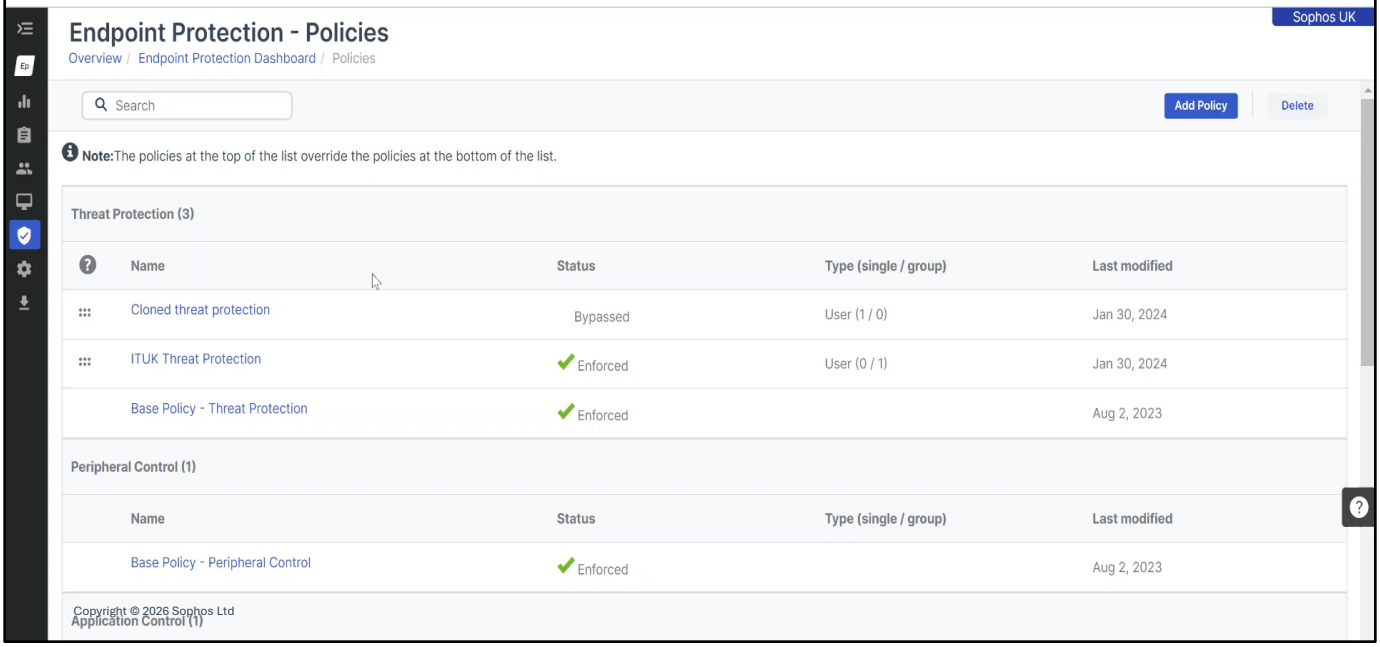
- Policies are applied in the order they appear
- Sophos Central uses a first match approach for policy application



Policy settings can be received from multiple policies. The order in which the policies appear in Sophos Central dictates the order in which they are applied to protected devices.

Policies are processed using a first match approach, which means that the first policy that matches either the user, user group, device, or server, or device or server group it was assigned to will be used.

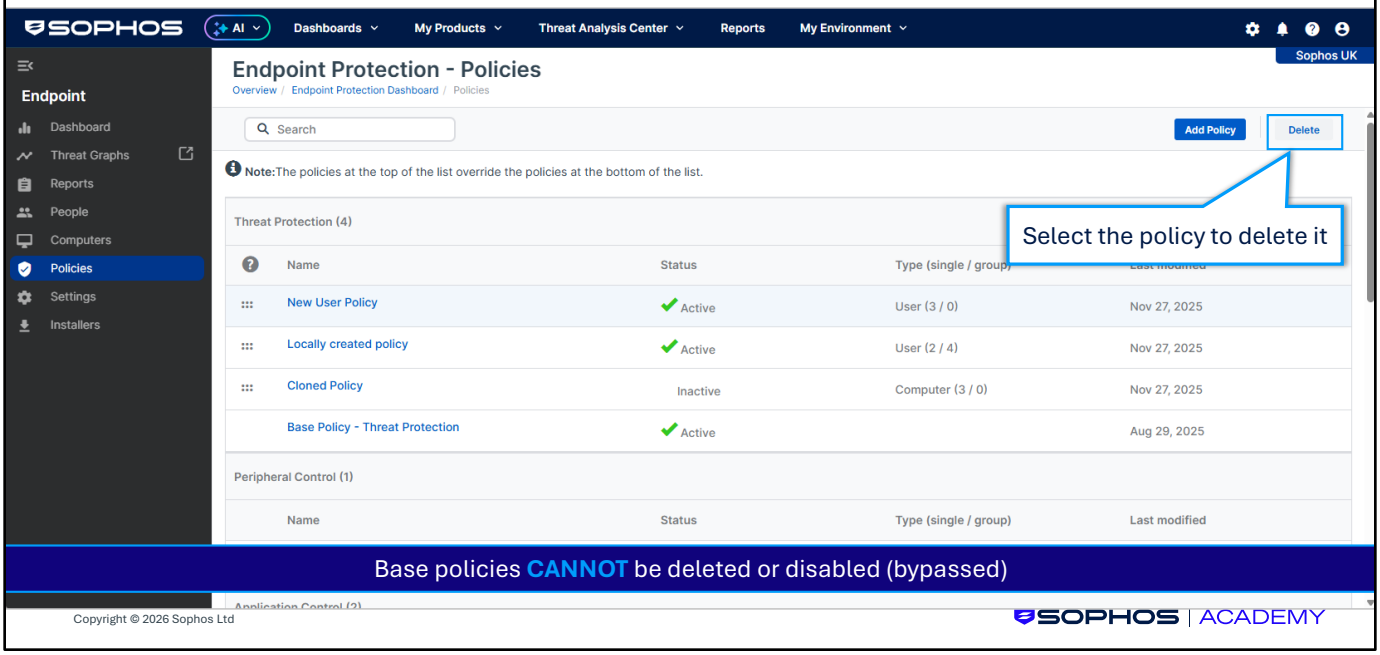
Managing Policies



We recommend that you place the most specific policies at the top of the policy list, and general policies further down. Otherwise, a general policy might apply to a device where you wanted an individual policy to apply.

The base policy is always at the bottom, and is applied to any users, devices, or servers that aren't covered by policies higher in the list. You can re-arrange the policy list by clicking on a policy and dropping it into the position you want it.

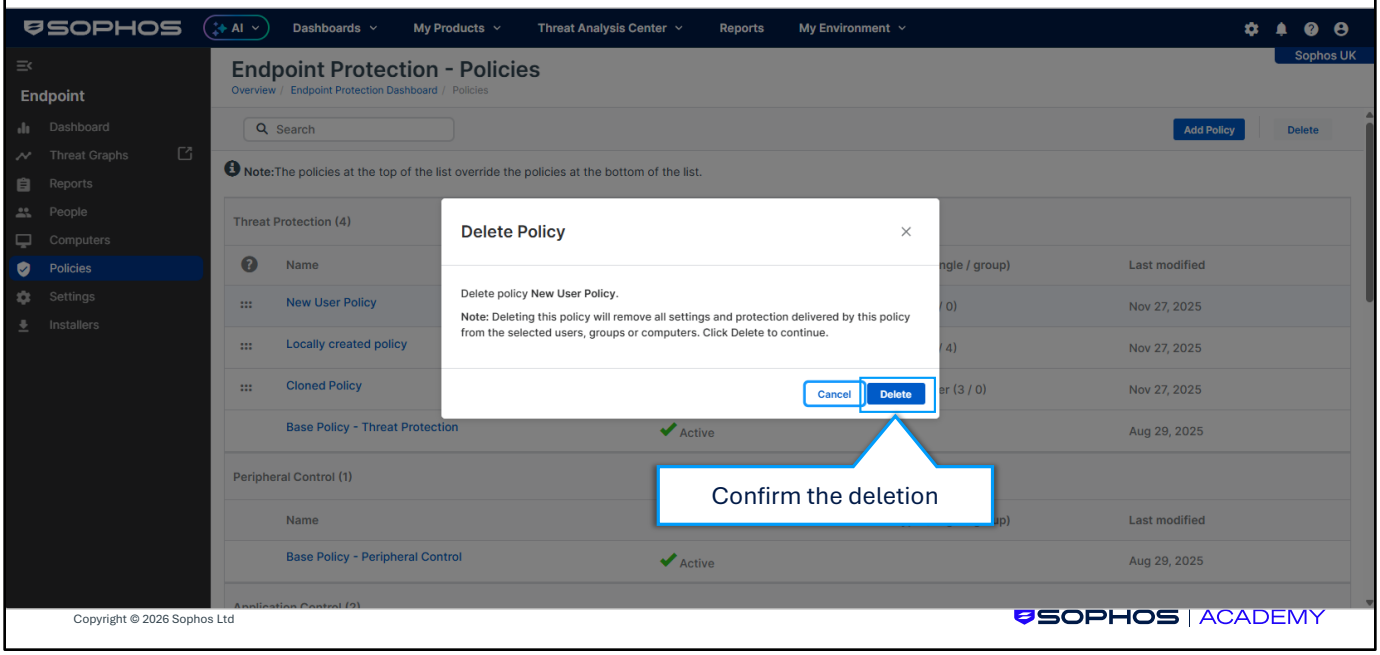
Deleting a Policy



Policies that are created or cloned can be deleted. Base policies cannot be deleted or disabled.

To delete a policy, select it from the list and click **Delete**.

Delete a Policy



Confirm that you want to delete the policy by clicking **Delete**.

Deleting a policy will remove all settings protection delivered by the policy from any assigned users, groups, or devices.

General Policy Recommendations

Use default settings within a policy where possible

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When configuring policies, we generally recommend that you use the default settings within a policy where possible.

General Policy Recommendations

Use default settings within a policy where possible

Consider the role of the endpoint when changing default policy settings or creating new policies

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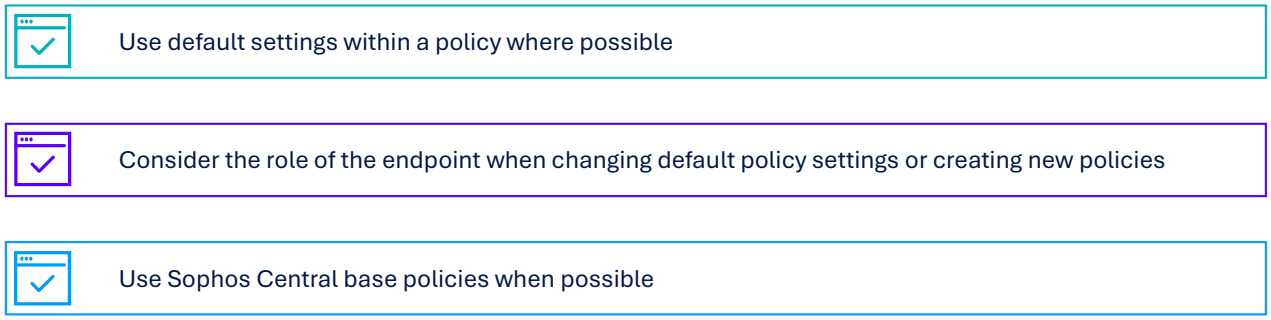
…and consider the role of the device when creating new device-based endpoint and server policies.

General Policy Recommendations



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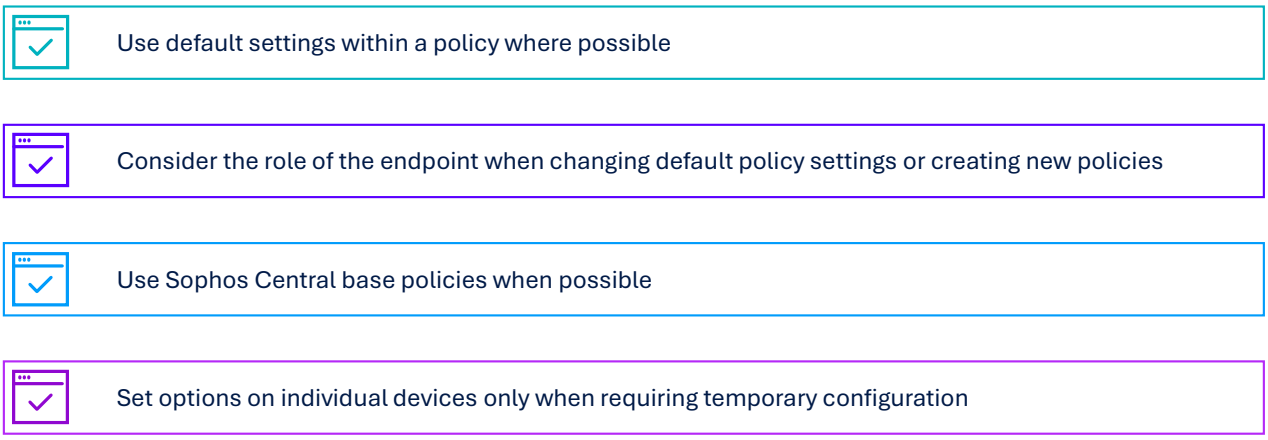
We recommend that you use the base policies where possible.

General Policy Recommendations



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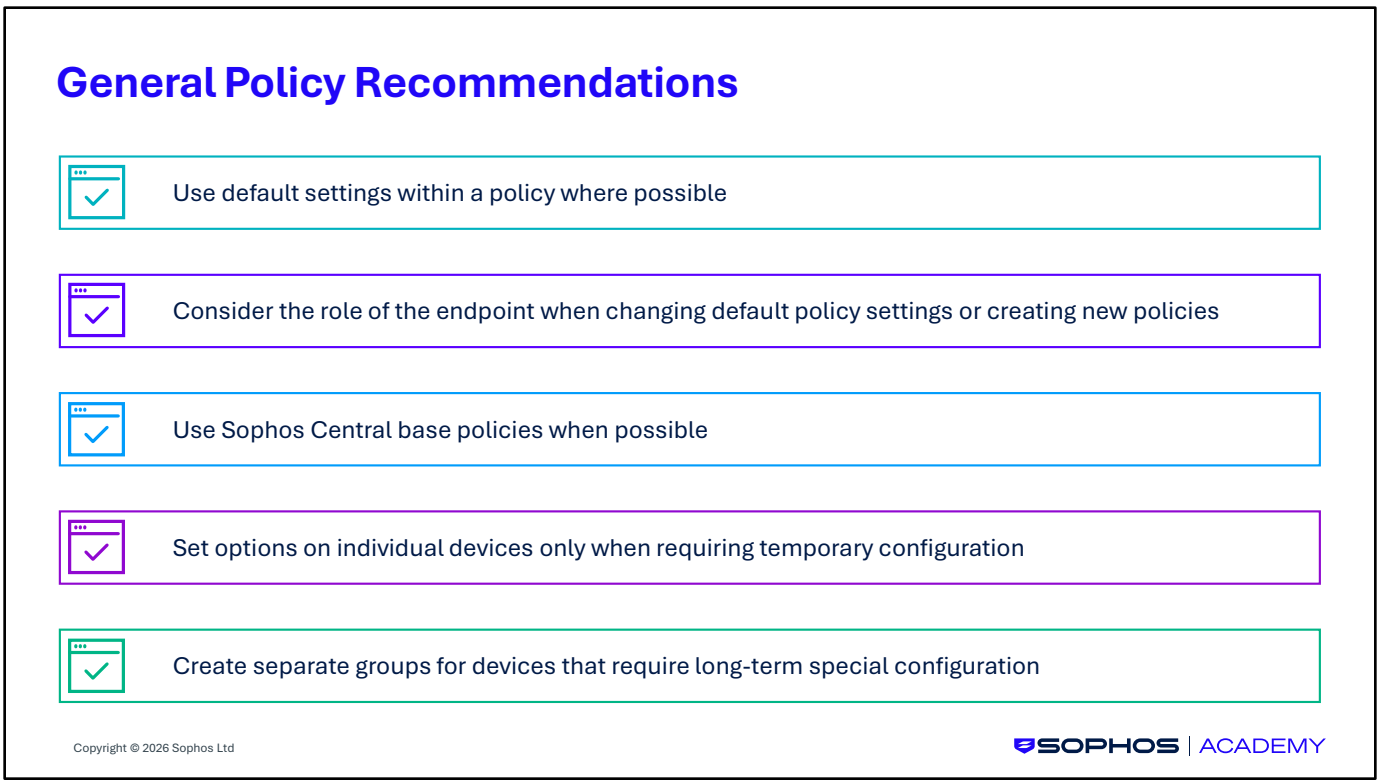
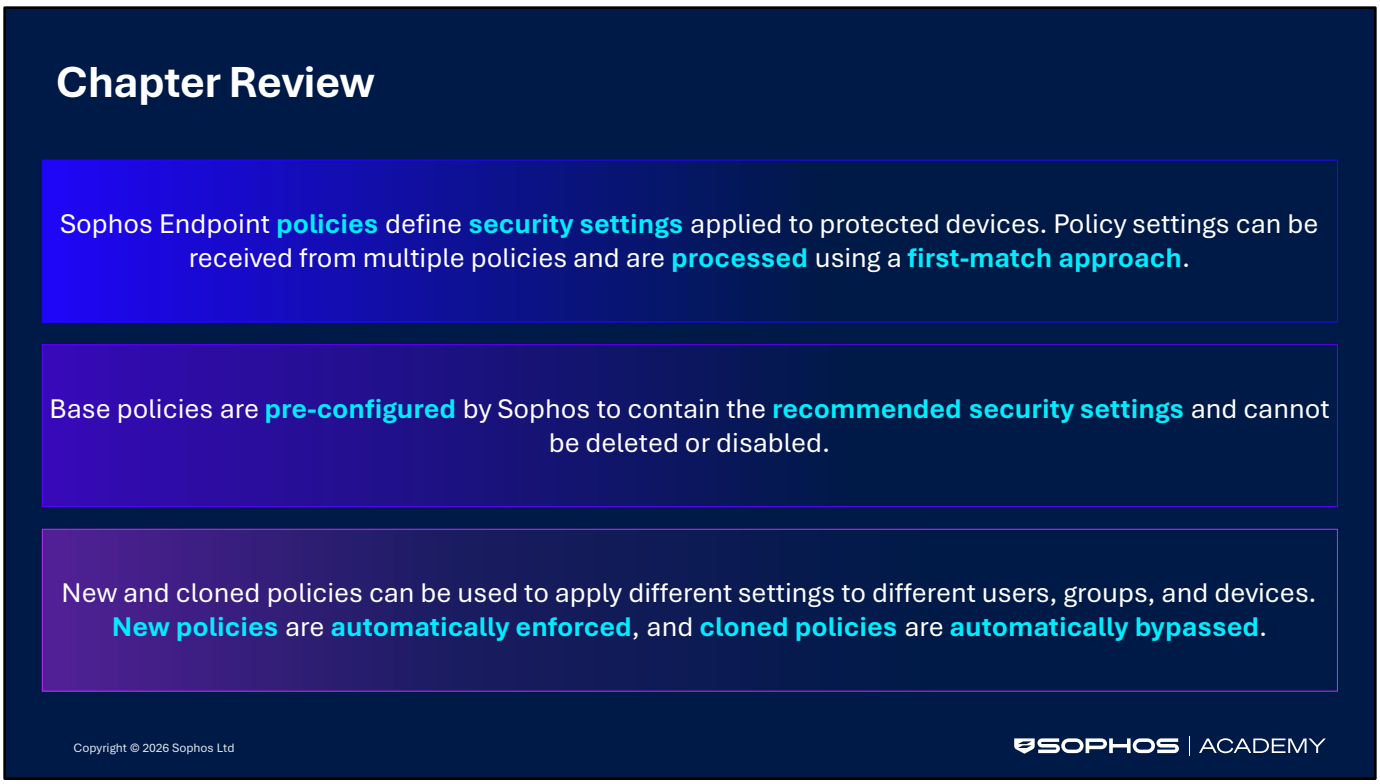
…and set options on individual devices when making temporary configuration changes.



Additionally, create separate groups for devices that require long-term special configuration.

Note that policy changes should be limited and precise so that the effects can be evaluated. They should be applied to a small group of devices for testing before being applied to all protected devices.



Here are the three main things you learned in this chapter.

Sophos Endpoint policies define security settings applied to protected devices. Policy settings can be received from multiple policies and are processed using a first match approach.

Base policies are pre-configured by Sophos to contain the recommended security settings and cannot be deleted or disabled.

[Additional Information]

Sophos Endpoint
EP3510: Getting Started with the Threat Protection Policy

May 2026

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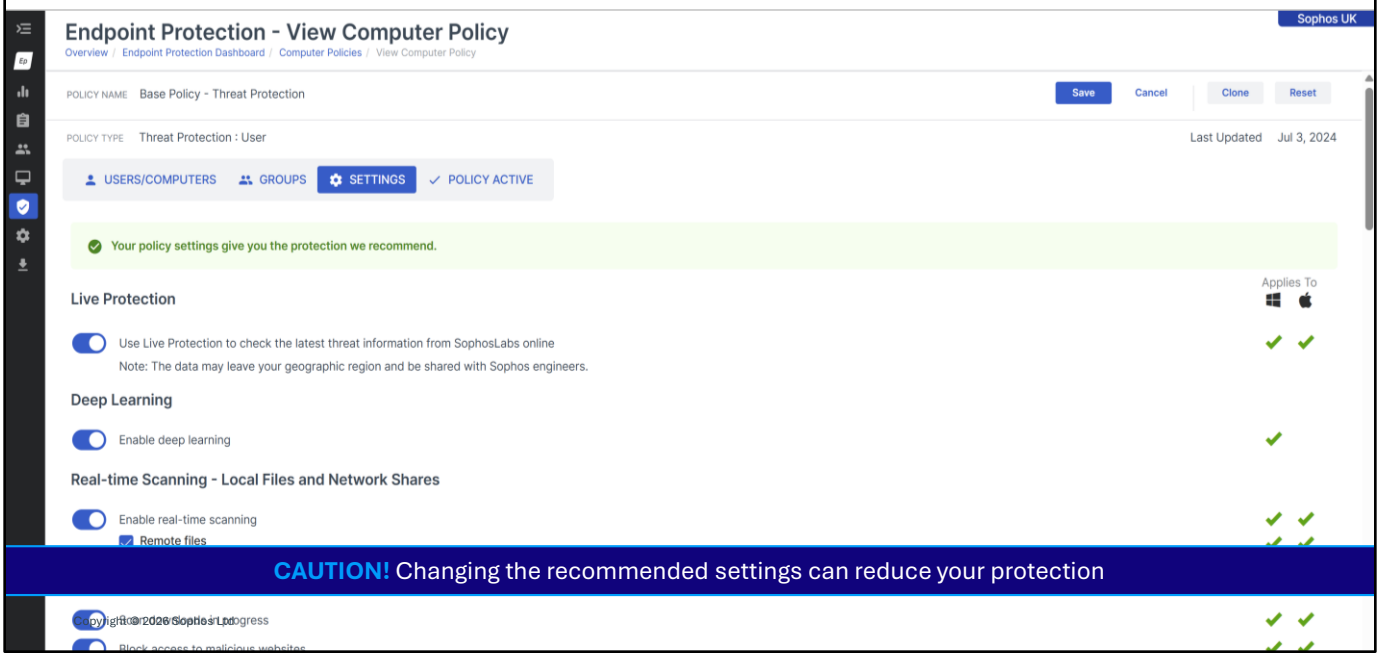
In this chapter, you'll learn which features are included in the threat protection policy.

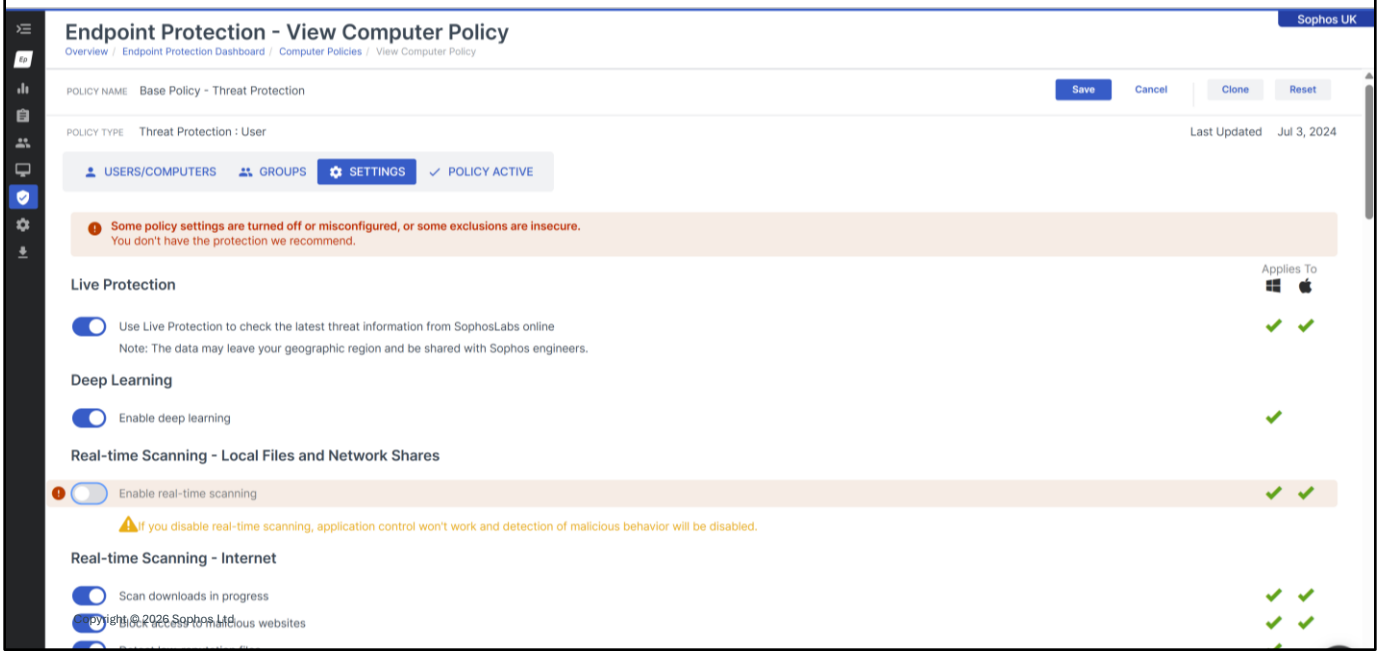
Threat Protection Policy



The threat protection policy protects against malware, risky file types, websites, and malicious network traffic. The threat protection base policy is automatically configured with Sophos' recommended security settings. These provide the best protection without complex configuration, including the detection of known malware, live lookups for the latest malware known to Sophos, proactive detection of unknown malware, and the automatic clean-up of malware.

Sophos automatically checks the threat protection policy, and the configuration of each threat protection policy is compared to the recommended settings. Think carefully before you change the recommended settings because any changes can reduce your protection.

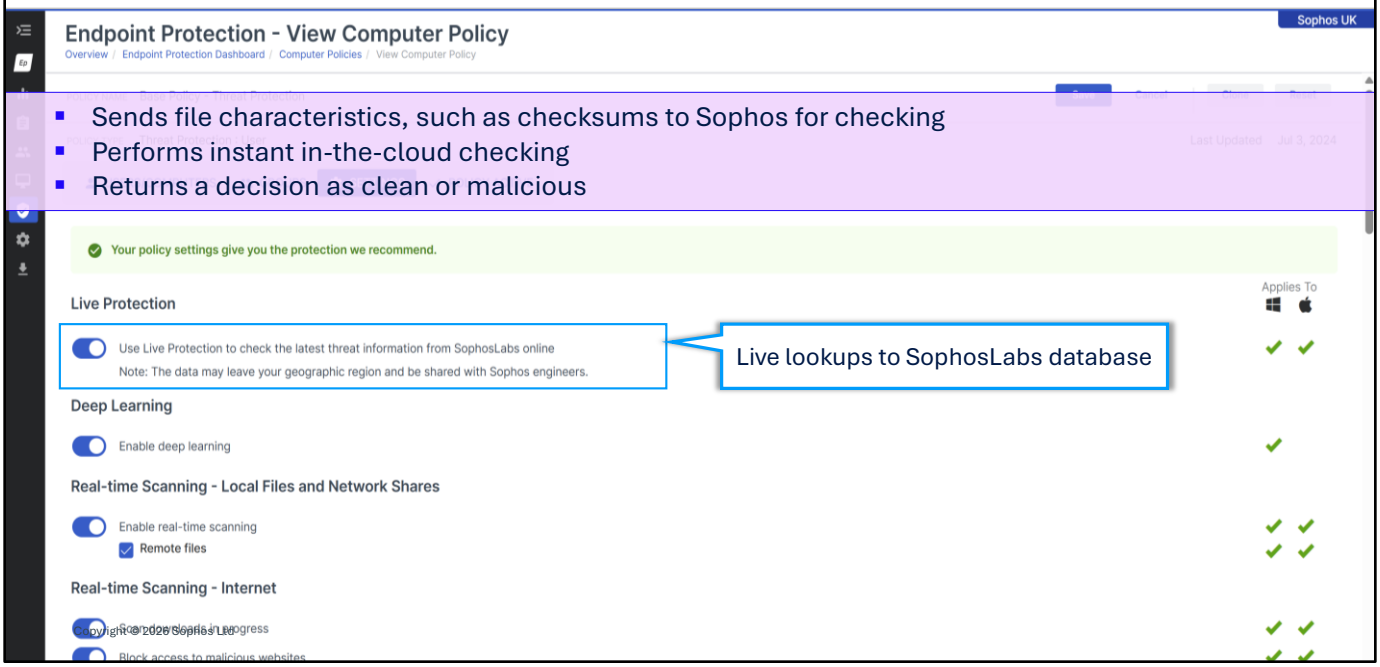
Threat Policy Check



If a setting does not match the recommended settings applied, you will see a banner message indicating that the policy settings do not match the recommended protection. Additionally, the setting that is misconfigured or not applied will be highlighted.

Any setting that is turned off in the threat protection policy must be carefully considered, as the security of any protected devices will be compromised.

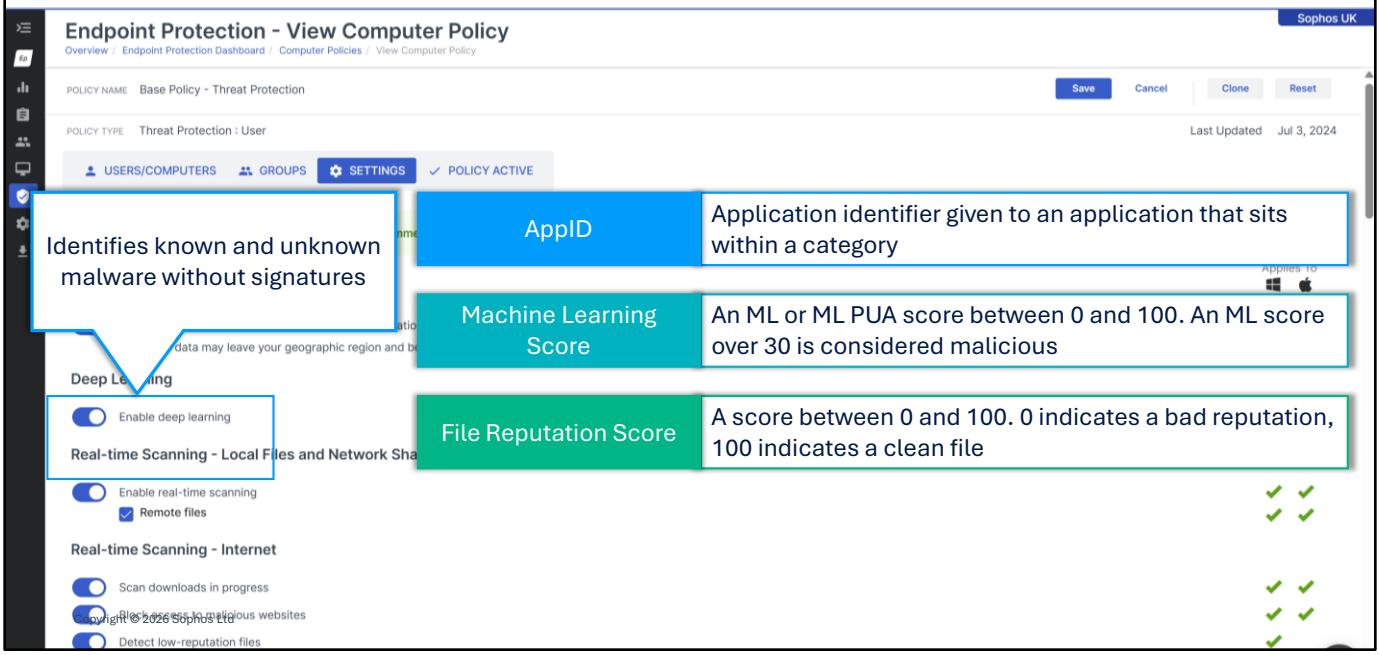
Live Protection



Whilst the settings in the threat protection policy are automatically enabled, it is useful to understand what they mean.

Sophos Live Protection determines whether a file is malicious. It provides instant lookups against the latest known malware. Live Protection means that virus definition files do not have to be downloaded to each device, ensuring that the latest information is used.

Portable Executable (PE) Scanning



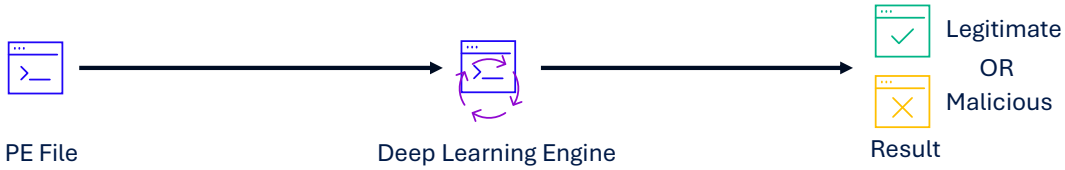
Deep learning uses advanced machine learning to detect threats. It can identify known and previously unknown malware without using signatures. When a PE file is scanned, it returns three pieces of data; The **AppID** which is the application identifier given to an application that sits within a category. The **machine learning score** which is also known as the ML or ML PUA score. This is a number between zero and one hundred. If a file has an ML score of over 30 it will be considered malicious. If a file has a ML PUA score of below 20, it is considered a PUA. The **file reputation score**. If a file has a reputation score of zero, this indicates a bad reputation. If a file has a reputation score of one hundred, the file is considered clean.

Note that a file will return a reputation score of one hundred if you have excluded the file either globally or through a policy.

Portable Executable (PE) Scanning

Additional information available in the notes

- Deep learning is enabled by default in the threat protection policy
- Deep learning evaluates files based on file characteristics



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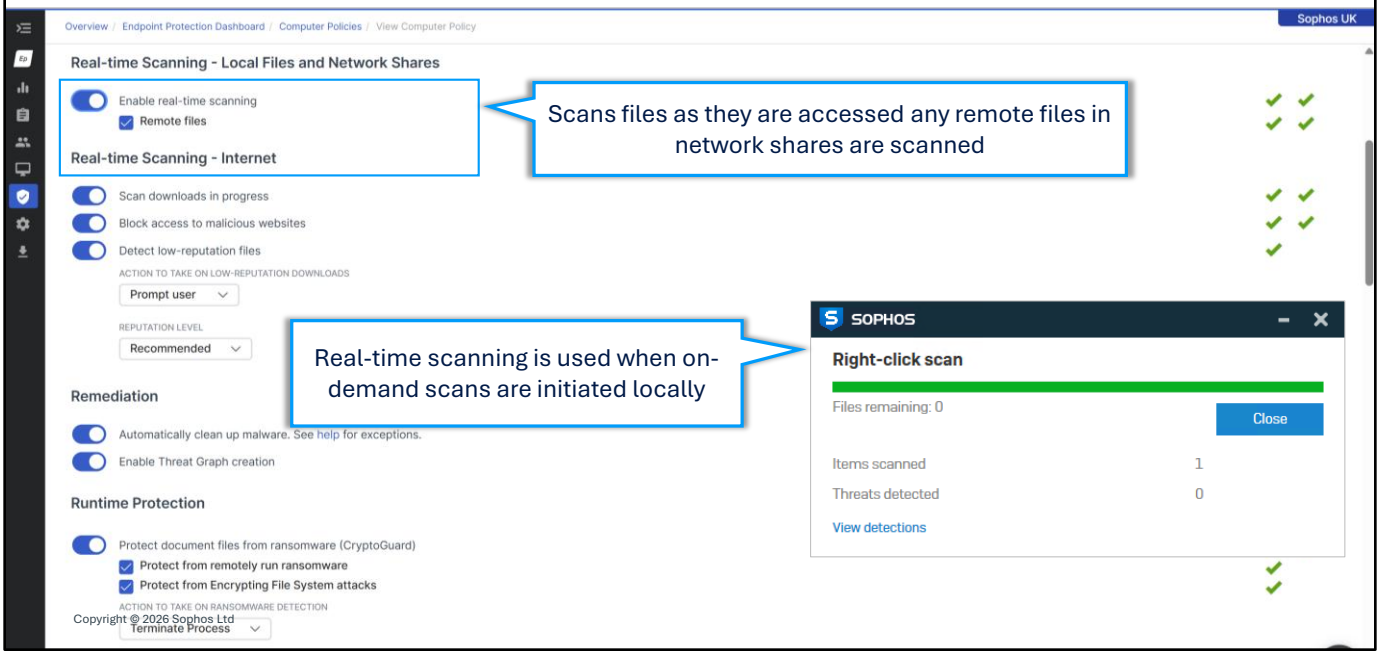
The deep learning engine evaluates files based on the information returned, determining if the file is legitimate or malicious. If the file is categorized as malicious, it is removed from the device.

PE scanning is enabled by default in the threat protection policy.

[Additional Information]
For more information about the reputation scores for files please see knowledge base article **KB-000037118**. Sophos Endpoint Self Help: File Information
https://support.sophos.com/support/s/article/KB-000037118

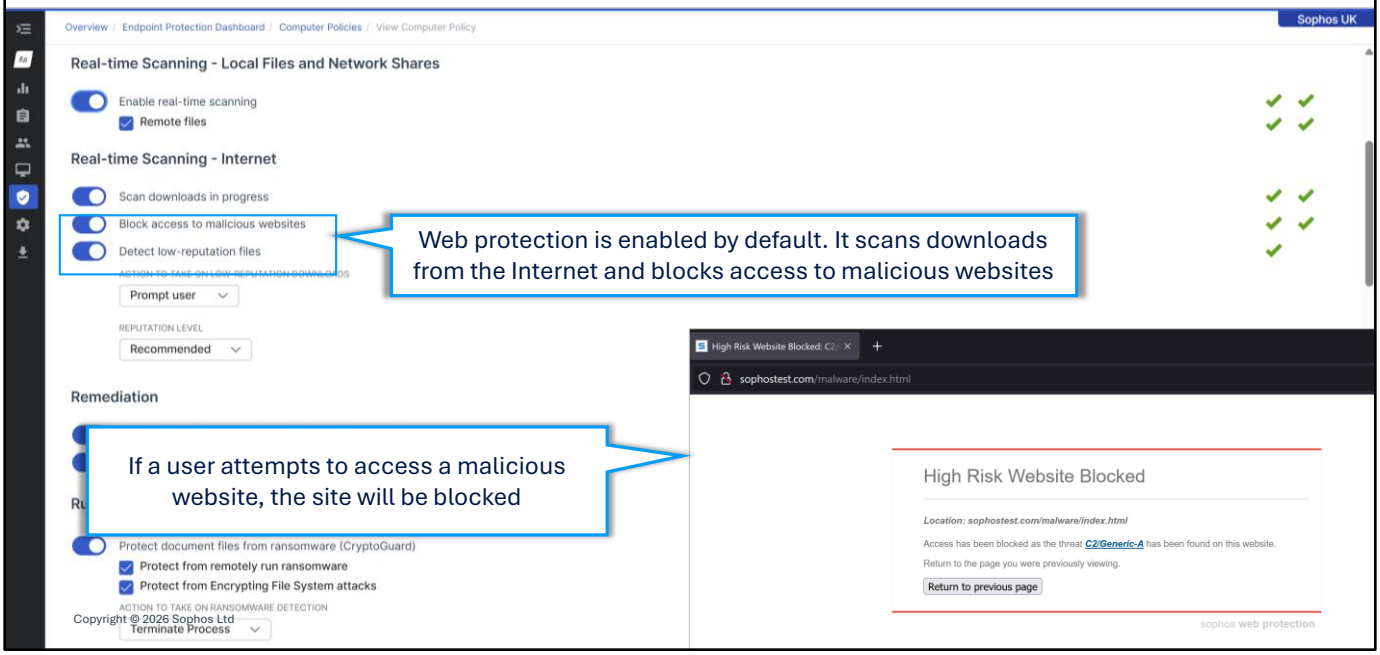
Real-Time Scanning



'Real-time scanning of files and network shares' scans files when they are accessed. File access will be denied if the file is determined to be malicious. 'Remote files' means that files in network shares are scanned.

Real-time scanning is also used when an on-demand scan is initiated on a protected device.

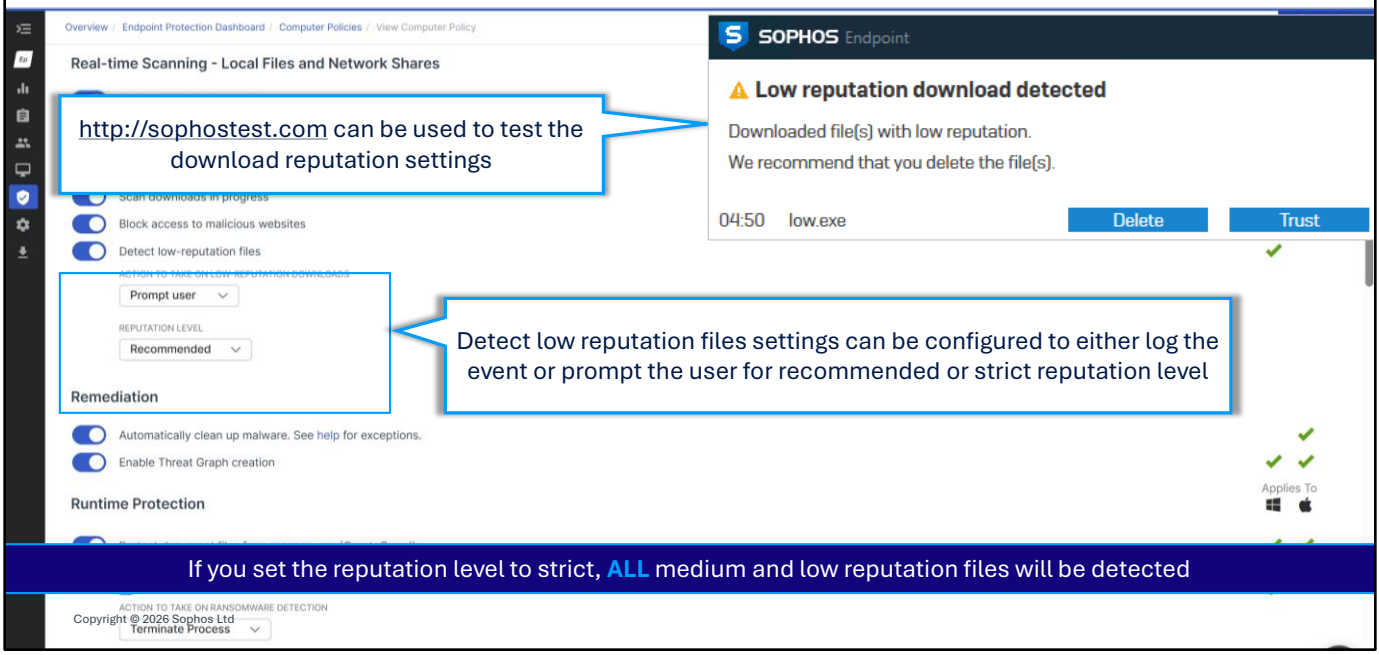
Web Protection



Web protection protects users against malicious websites and downloads. It checks the reputation of a URL or IP address that is being accessed. All major internet browsers are supported.

Web protection utilizes Sophos Extensible List (SXL) lookups and settings for web protection are configured in the threat protection policy in the 'Realtime scanning – Internet' section.

Download Reputation

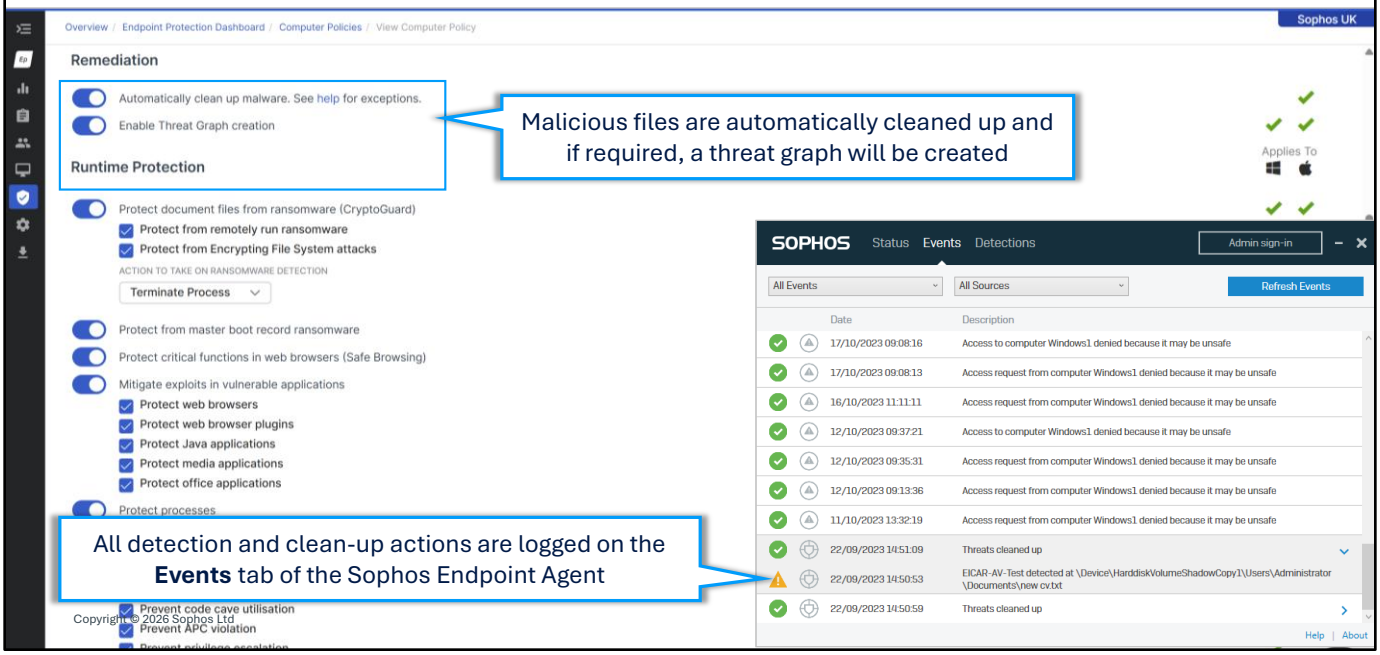


'Detect low-reputation files' warns if a download has a low reputation. All downloaded files are checked to determine the file type. If the file is an executable, for example a .exe file, a full reputation lookup is performed. A files reputation is determined by performing a file checksum lookup from the device against known files and their reputation created by SophosLabs.

You can edit the 'detect low-reputation files' setting. The default is to prompt the user; however, you can change this to log the event only. You can also determine the reputation level, which is automatically configured to recommended; however, this can be changed to strict.

Note that if you set the reputation level to strict, all medium and low reputation files will be detected, which may cause issues for users. You can use sophostest.com to test the reputation settings for various website categories.

Remediation

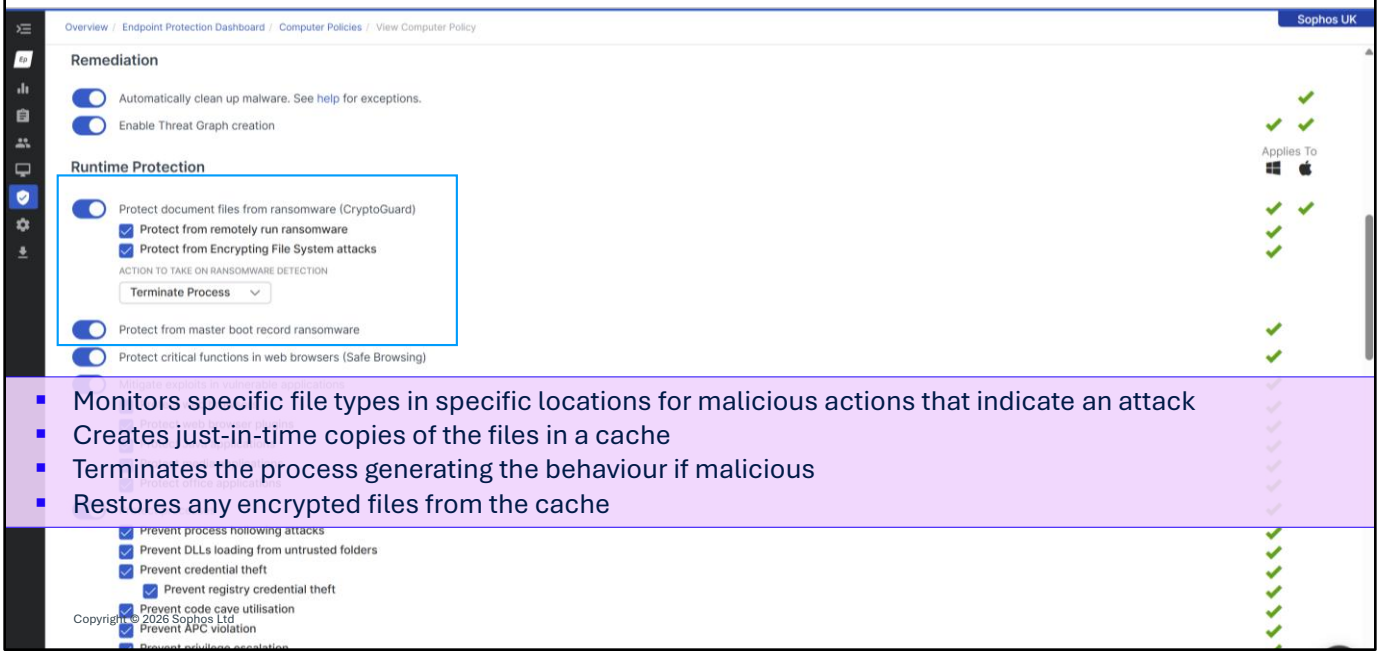


By default, detected malware will automatically be cleaned up. All detection and clean up actions are displayed in the **Events** tab of the Sophos Endpoint Agent.

If a PE file is detected as malicious, it will be cleaned up, even if automatic clean-up has been disabled. The file is quarantined and can be restored in the case of a false positive.

Threat graphs are created by default for some detections where necessary. Threat graphs can assist with investigations into malicious activity.

Runtime Protection: CryptoGuard



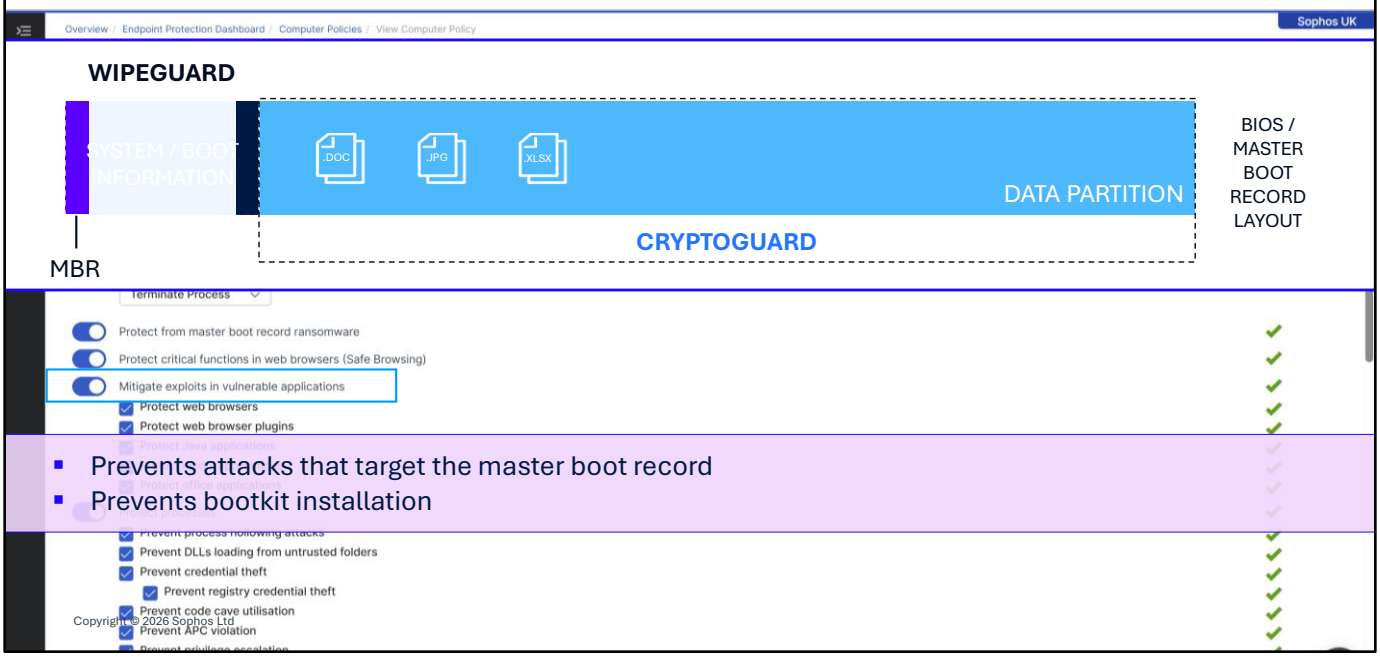
- Monitors specific file types in specific locations for malicious actions that indicate an attack
- Creates just-in-time copies of the files in a cache
- Terminates the process generating the behaviour if malicious
- Restores any encrypted files from the cache

The runtime protection features detect suspicious or malicious behaviour or traffic. CryptoGuard protects against remotely run ransomware and file encryption. It does this by monitoring specific file types in specific locations looking for actions that indicate a ransomware attack. One indication could be a process that opens and writes to multiple files in a short period of time.

If an action like this is detected, just-in-time copies of the targeted files are created and stored in a local cache on the device. If CryptoGuard determines the action as malicious, the process is terminated.

Once the attack has been prevented, CryptoGuard restores any files it can from the cache. For some detections, a threat graph will be created to determine how the attack process started along with identifying events happening on the device that may relate to the root cause of the attack.

Runtime Protection: WipeGuard

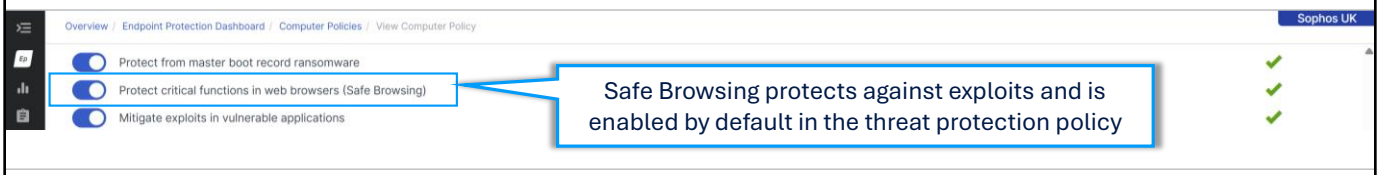


- Prevents attacks that target the master boot record
- Prevents bootkit installation

Some forms of ransomware overwrite the master boot record which leaves the operating system in an unbootable state. The MBR is a code stored in the first sectors of a hard disk drive. It holds information about the disk partitions and launches the operating systems boot loader. Without access to the MBR, the device is unable to determine which disk partition contains the operating system or how to start it.

WipeGuard prevents attacks that target the master boot record and prevents rootkit installation. A bootkit is a variant of a rootkit that infects a devices start up code and can be used to attack full disk encryption systems.

Runtime Protection: Safe Browsing



- For example, man-in-the-browser (MitB) which infects a web browser by exploiting browser security vulnerabilities
- This allows an attacker to modify web pages, modify transaction content or insert additional transactions

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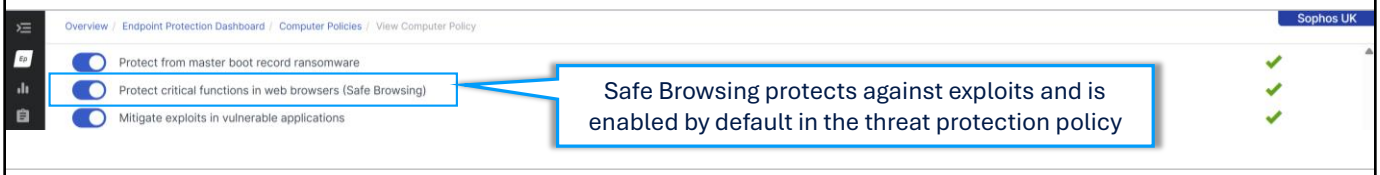
Internet browser exploits are a class of threat where an attacker targets a vulnerability in either the Internet browser or in an application that browser calls to process a web request, such as Flash Player or Java.

An example of this is a Man-in-the-Browser attack, a form of Internet threat that infects an Internet browser by taking advantage of vulnerabilities in browser security. This allows an attacker to modify web pages, modify transaction content, or insert additional transactions.

Runtime Protection: Safe Browsing



- For example, man-in-the-browser (MitB) which infects a web browser by exploiting browser security vulnerabilities
- This allows an attacker to modify web pages, modify transaction content or insert additional transactions

- Safe browsing monitors the crypto, network and presentation DLLs of a browser to detect when another application is interfering
- Safe browsing only warns the user that a browser compromise was detected
- The browser session is not terminated but the administrator is provided with event information

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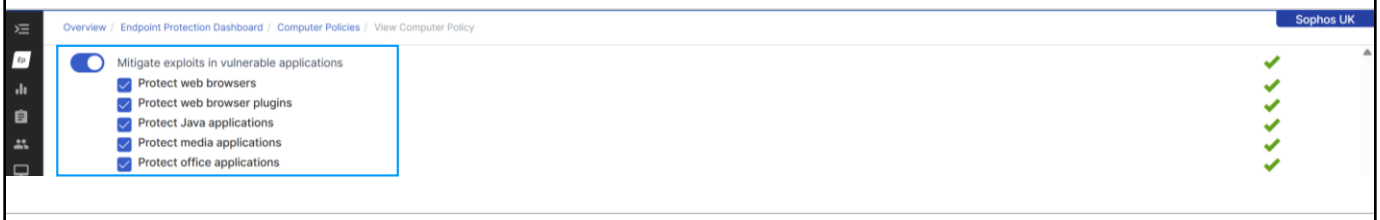
Safe Browsing monitors the crypto, network, and presentation DLLs of a browser to detect when another application is interfering. Safe Browsing only warns the user that the browser was compromised. It will initiate a scan but will not terminate the browser session, and the administrator is provided with event information to support an investigation.

Runtime Protection: Mitigate Exploits

- Protect applications that are susceptible to malicious exploitation



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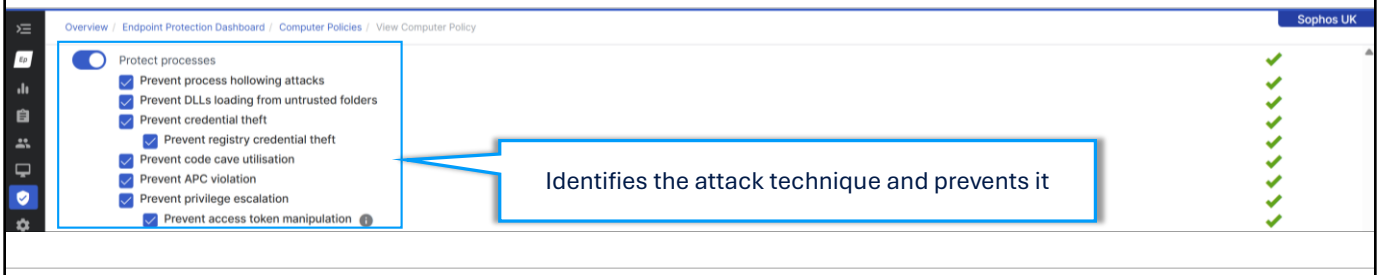
Mitigating exploits in vulnerable applications protects applications that are vulnerable to being exploited for malicious intent.

Runtime Protection: Process Protection



Attacker migrates from process to process to establish persistence.

Intercept X protects against this by identifying the attack technique and preventing it.

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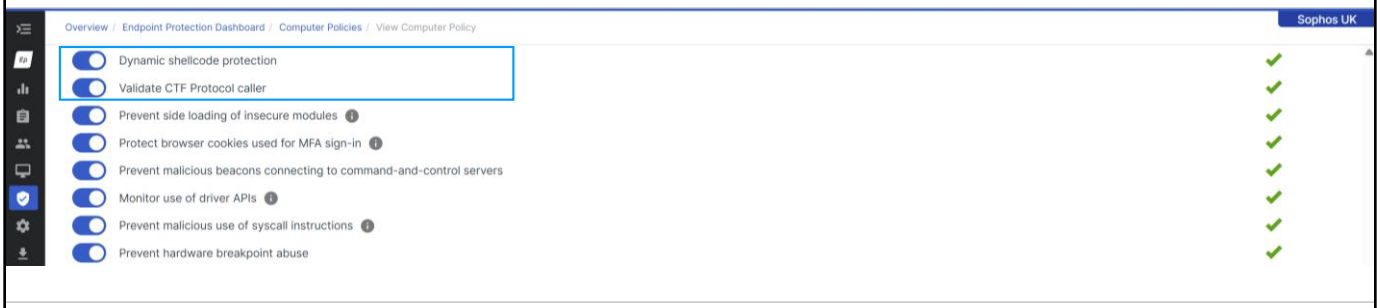
If an attacker has gained access to a device, the malicious code they can use is only useful while the process they have targeted is running.

If the process is terminated, the communication with the attacker is also stopped. An attacker will attempt to move to another running process on the device to maintain a connection. This type of process migration is a common practice for attackers.

Sophos protects against this by identifying the technique being used and preventing it.

Runtime Protection



Dynamic shellcode protection	Detects behaviour of covert remote access agents
Validate CTF Protocol caller	Intercepts and blocks applications that attempt to exploit CTF on Windows devices

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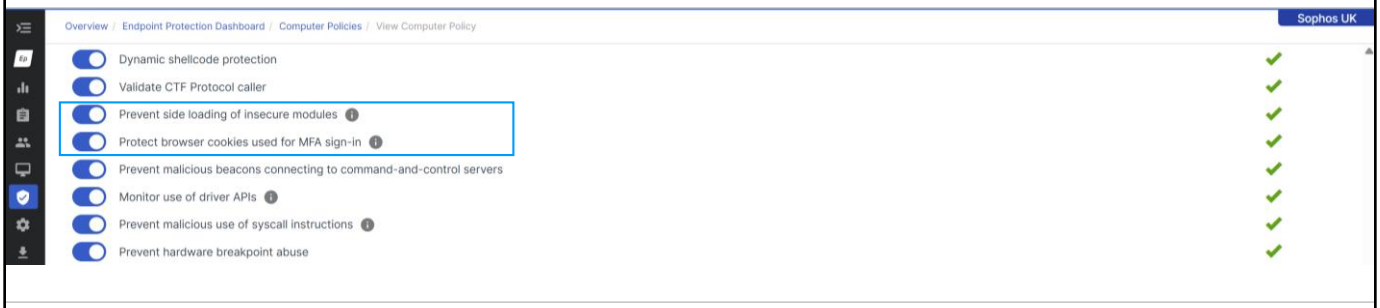
These protection features are enabled by default in the threat protection base policy.

Dynamic shellcode protection detects the behaviour of covert remote access agents and prevents attackers from gaining control of the network.

Validate CTF Protocol caller intercepts and blocks applications that attempt to exploit a vulnerability on Windows devices. This vulnerability, CTF, allows non-administrative and unauthorized users to hijack any Windows process, including applications that are running in a sandbox.

Runtime Protection



Prevent side loading of insecure modules	Detects behaviour of covert remote access agents
Protect browser cookies used for MGA sign-in	Prevents unauthorized applications from decrypting the AES keys used to encrypt MFA cookies

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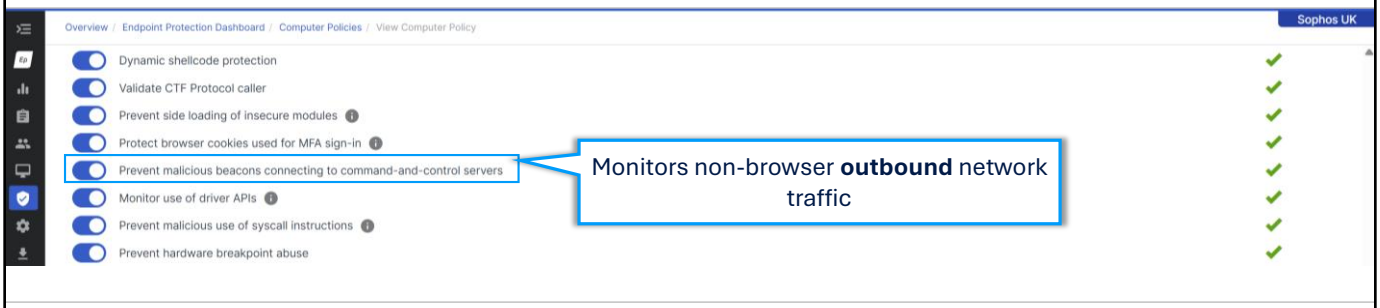
Prevent side loading of insecure modules prevents an application from side-loading a malicious DLL that poses as a DLL that serves as a proxy to maintain compatibility between older applications and new operating system versions. Attackers may place malicious DLLs to manipulate this functionality, or bypass Tamper Protection and remove the Sophos Endpoint Agent.

Protect browser cookies used for MFA sign-in prevents unauthorized applications from decrypting the AES key used to encrypt MFA cookies.

Runtime Protection: Malicious Traffic Detection

Additional information available in the notes



- Detects processes which attempt to connect outbound to known bad URLs and malware sites
- Reports traffic to trigger memory scans
- If a HP/Mal detection is triggered, the threat is automatically cleaned up

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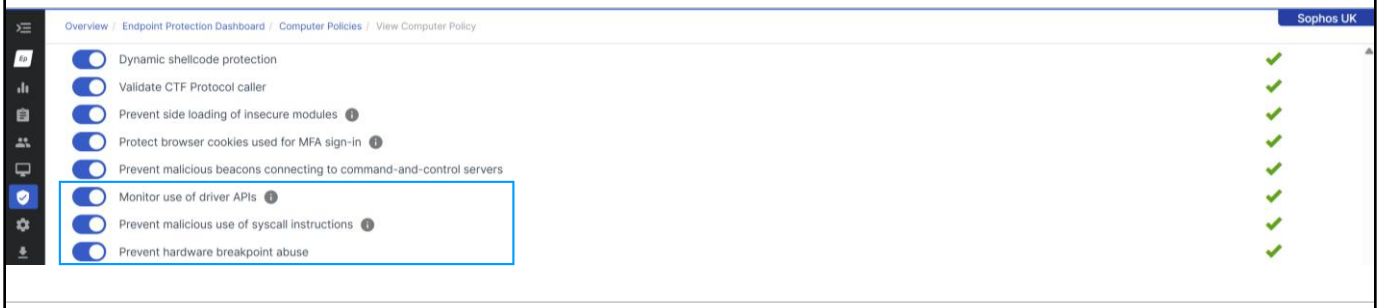
Malicious Traffic Detection monitors outbound web traffic that does not originate from a browser. It monitors HTTP traffic for signs of connectivity to known bad URLs and other malware sites.

If malicious traffic is detected, it can be an early indicator that a new piece of malware may be present. If a process attempts to connect to a known malware URL, the traffic is reported and can trigger memory scans. If this results in a detection, the threat will be cleaned up.

[Additional Information]
Sophos provides a test script for malicious traffic detection that can be downloaded from the Knowledge base article **KB-000035314**. Sophos Endpoint: Run Mtd.vbs to test the Malicious Traffic Detection
https://support.sophos.com/support/s/article/KB-000035314

Runtime Protection



Monitor use of driver APIs	Detects attempted abuse of legitimate APIs to interact with kernel-mode code
Prevent malicious use of syscall instructions	Blocks attempts to evade monitoring through direct calls to system APIs
Prevent hardware breakpoint abuse	Prevents abuse of hardware breakpoints

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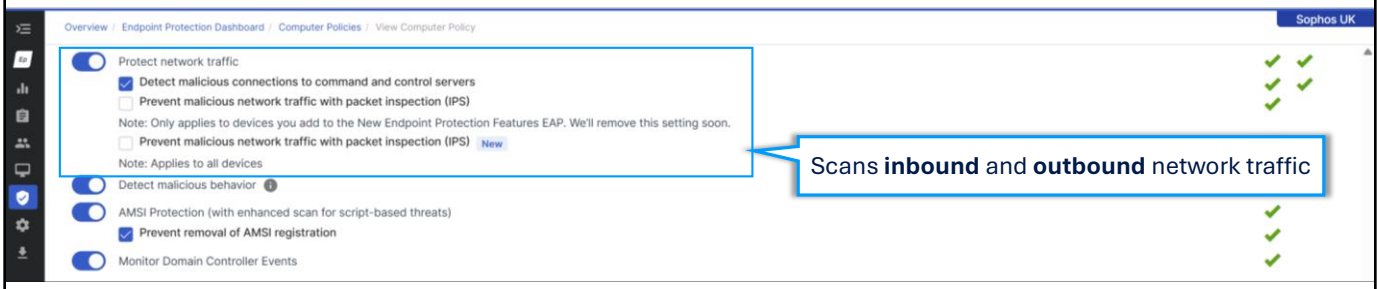
Monitor use of driver APIs applies to those computers with Sophos Core Agent version 2024.2 or later, it detects attempted abuse of legitimate application APIs such as printers or virtual network adapters to interact with kernel-mode code.

Prevent malicious use of syscall instructions, supported on computers with the latest version of Sophos Intercept X, it blocks attempts to evade monitoring through direct calls to system APIs.

Prevent hardware breakpoint abuse, prevents abuse of hardware breakpoints.

Runtime Protection: Malicious Traffic Detection



- Traffic is scanned for known attacks
- Blocks threats before they can infect the operating system or targeted application

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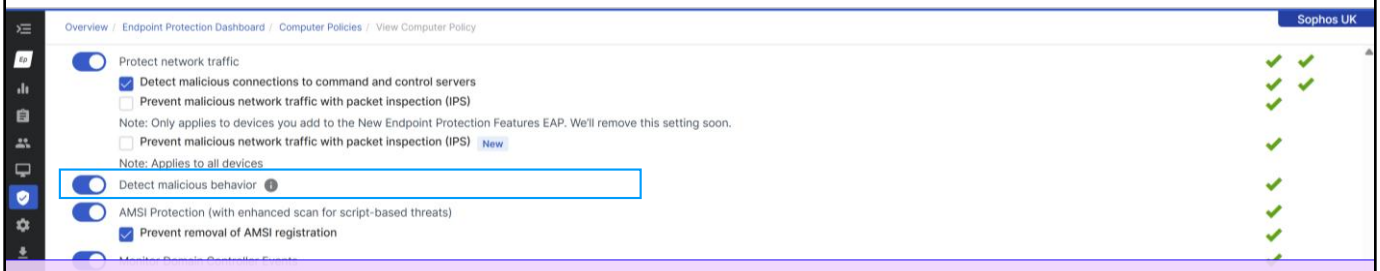
Malicious Traffic Detection makes use of packet inspection to scan inbound and outbound network traffic for known attacks.

If an attack is detected, it is blocked. This protects against lateral movement as well as external attacks.

Runtime Protection: Detect Malicious Behaviour



- Scans inbound and outbound network traffic for malicious behaviour patterns
- If an attack is detected in outbound traffic, it could indicate a botnet attack

Inbound traffic	Communication sent **from** a **remote device** to a device inside the network
Outbound traffic	Communication sent from a device inside the network **to** a **remote device**

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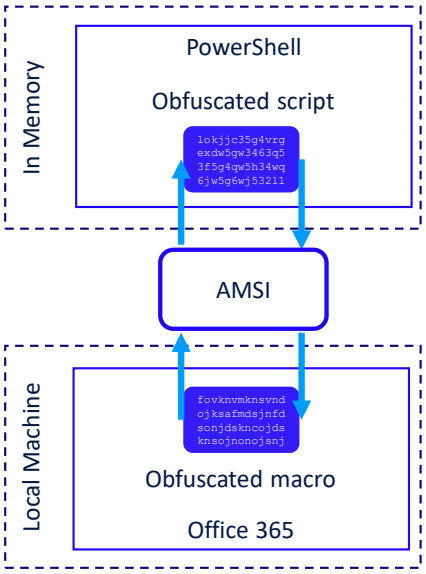
The detect malicious behaviour feature scans inbound and outbound network traffic for malicious attack behaviour patterns. If an attack is detected in outbound traffic, it could indicate that the device is being used as part of a botnet attack to communicate with other devices on the network.

Inbound traffic is communication sent from a remote device outside of the network to a device inside the network.

Outbound traffic is communication sent from a device inside the network to a remote device outside of the network.

Runtime Protection: AMSI Protection



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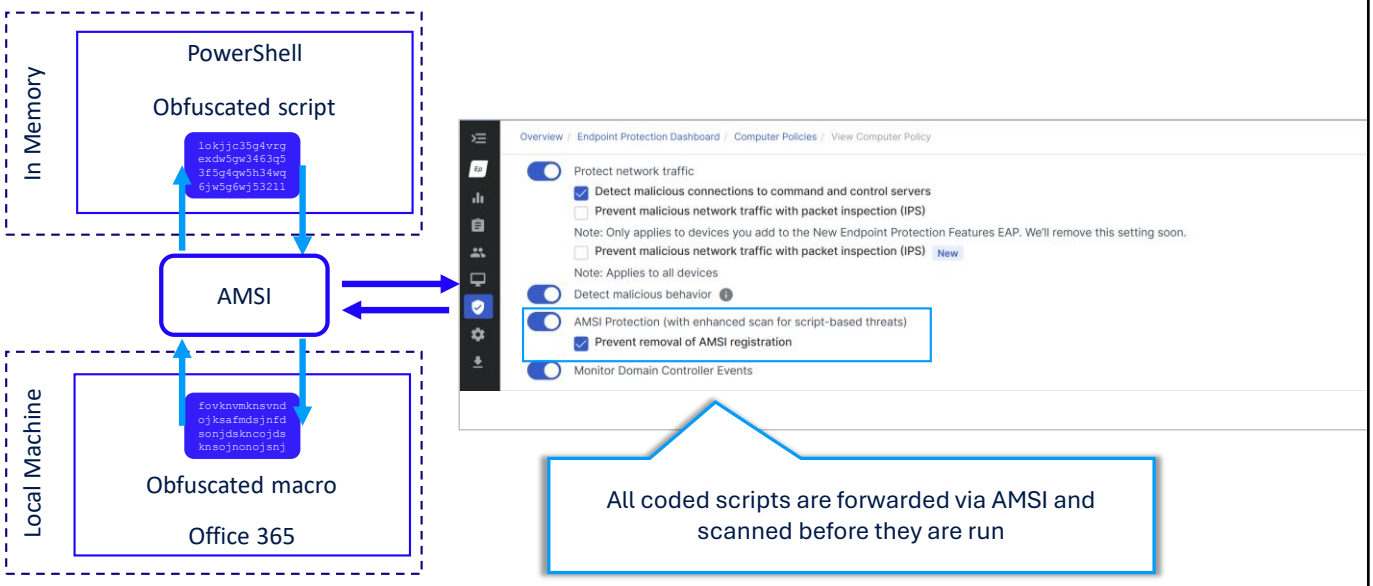
The Anti-Malware Scan Interface (AMSI) is a versatile interface standard that enables applications and services to integrate with any antimalware product; it's agnostic of anti-virus vendors.

Microsoft designed AMSI so that all scripts, statements of support applications, and languages can be scanned, whether originating from a local file or executed in memory. For example, a PowerShell script can be called directly from a URL and executed in memory.

Runtime Protection: AMSI Protection

Additional information available in the notes



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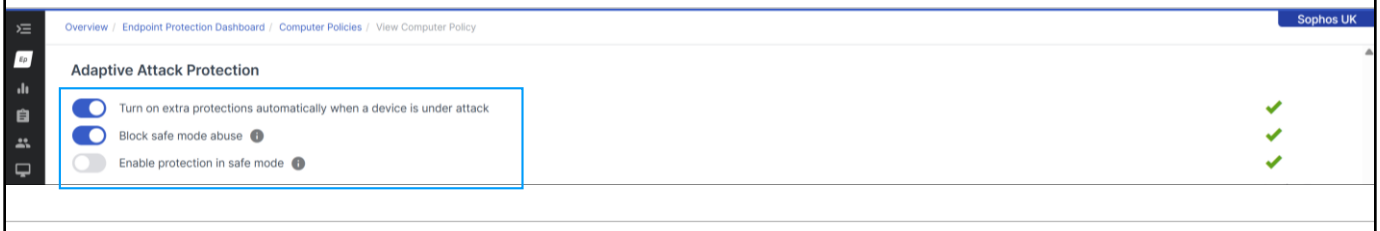
When Sophos registers their AMSI provider, all AMSI calls are passed to the Sophos Endpoint Agent so that all executed code is scanned, regardless of whether it's run in memory or from a local file.

Malicious and sometimes benign scripts are often obfuscated. Usually, an obfuscated script is used to prevent users from viewing sensitive data, such as passwords; however, malware authors obfuscate their scripts, hoping that antimalware vendors won't detect or scan the code. Sophos protects against this type of attack by scanning all scripts forwarded via AMSI before they're executed. The application that runs the code is notified of any detected threat, and an event is logged.

[Additional Information]
To find out what data is collected by AMSI, please see knowledgebase article **KB-000038919**: Sophos Endpoint: Data collected by Sophos AMSI Protection
https://support.sophos.com/support/s/article/KB-000038919

Adaptive Attack Prevention



- Enforces a more aggressive set of protections when an attack is detected
- Optionally choose to enable Sophos protection when devices are running in safe mode
- Detect and block activities that indicate an attacker is trying to put a device in safe mode

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Adaptive attack protection enforces a more aggressive set of protections when an attack is detected, designed to disrupt the attacker's actions.

Block safe mode abuse detects and blocks activities that indicate an attacker is trying to put a device in safe mode. You can optionally choose to enable protection in safe mode which enables Sophos protection when devices are running in safe mode. Note that some Sophos features such as Message Relay and Update Cache are not available in safe mode.

Activity: Ransomware Threat Examples

View the following examples of threats and determine what they have in common.

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View the following examples of threats and determine what they have in common.

Activity: Ransomware Threat Examples

	BitPaymer	SamSam	Ryuk	Dharma	GandCrab
Type	Targeted	Targeted	Targeted	Targeted	RaaS
Deployment	RDP	RDP	RDP	RDP	RPD/Email/Exploit Kits
Targets	Medium/Large organization	Medium/Large organization	Medium/Large organization	Medium/Large organization	Any
Typical ransom demand	$50,000-1M+	$40,000	$100,000	$5,000	$1,000-$8,000+
Frequency of attacks	Multiple a week	1+ a day	Multiple a week	Multiple a day	Frequency is unknown due to anyone being able to use the kit, however, it is very popular
Desired damage	All servers	All servers and endpoints	All servers	Critical servers	Any
Regions affected	Global	Global with highest % in US	Global	Global	Global
Can be decrypted without paying	No	No	No	No	Some variants but mostly not
Payment method	Bitcoin arranged via email, sometimes dark web onion site	Bitcoin arranged via dark web onion site	Bitcoin arranged via email	Bitcoin arranged via email	Bitcoin arranged via dark web onion site
Additional insights	Spends spend to ensure all backups are deleted before the attack	Has a history of targeting healthcare	Spends time to ensure all backups are deleted before the attack; attempts to disabled anti-virus	Manually attempts to disable anti-virus before attacking	Regular updates and support from developers. Released all the encryption keys for Syrian victims.

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Review this table of threats, do you notice what these threats have in common?

Activity: Ransomware Threat Examples

	BitPaymer	SamSam	Ryuk	Dharma	GandCrab
Type	Targeted	Targeted	Targeted	Targeted	RaaS
Deployment	**RDP**	**RDP**	**RDP**	**RDP**	**RPD/Email/Exploit Kits**
Targets	Medium/Large organization	Medium/Large organization	Medium/Large organization	Medium/Large organization	Any
Typical ransom demand	$50,000-1M+	$40,000	$100,000	$5,000	$1,000-$8,000+
Frequency of attacks	Multiple a week	1+ a day	Multiple a week	Multiple a day	Frequency is unknown due to anyone being able to use the kit, however, it is very popular
Desired damage	All servers	All servers and endpoints	All servers	Critical servers	Any
Regions affected	Global	Global with highest % in US	Global	Global	Global
Can be decrypted without paying	No	No	No	No	Some variants but mostly not
Payment method	Bitcoin arranged via email, sometimes dark web onion site	Bitcoin arranged via dark web onion site	Bitcoin arranged via email	Bitcoin arranged via email	Bitcoin arranged via dark web onion site
Additional insights	Spends spend to ensure all backups are deleted before the attack	Has a history of targeting healthcare	Spends time to ensure all backups are deleted before the attack; attempts to disabled anti-virus	Manually attempts to disable anti-virus before attacking	Regular updates and support from developers. Released all the encryption keys for Syrian victims

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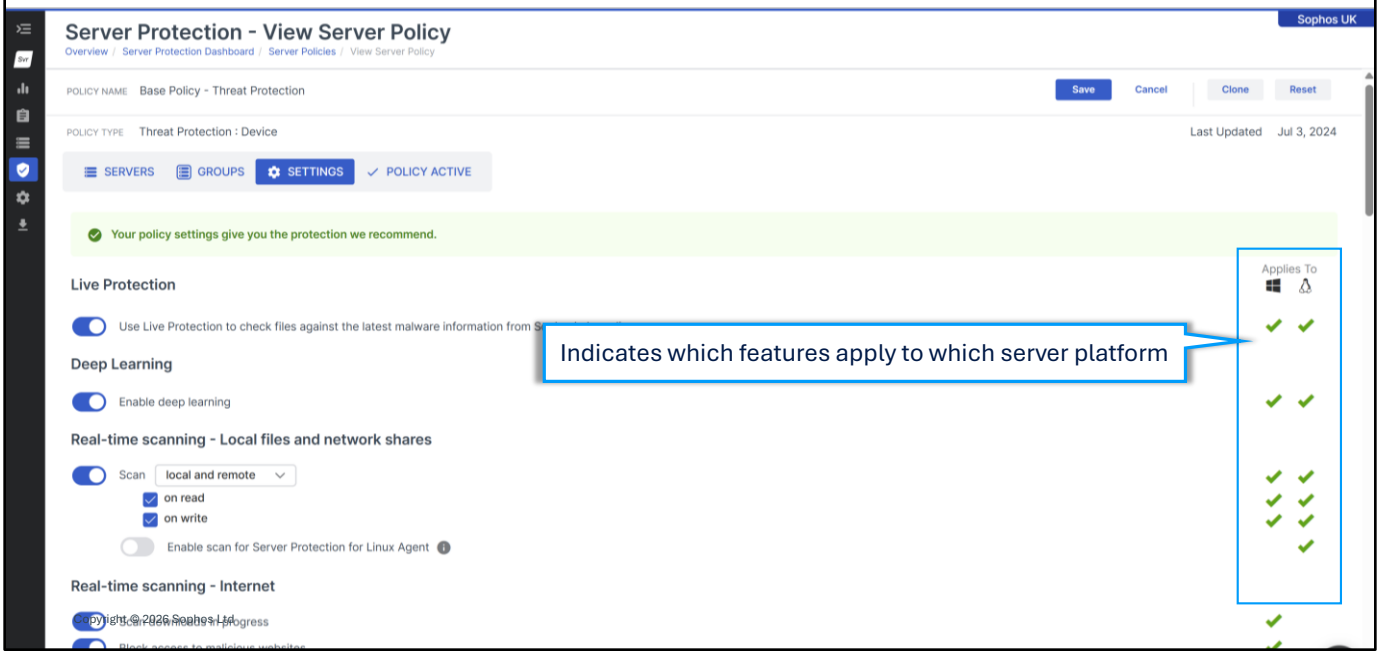
The common factor is RDP. Many of the millions of RDP servers connected to the internet are protected by only a username and password, and many of those passwords are weak enough to be guessed. Correctly guess a password on just one of those devices, and you are into an organization's network.

It's not a new technique, and it sounds almost too simple to work, yet it's popular enough to support criminal markets selling both stolen RDP credentials and compromised devices. The technique is so successful that the criminals are crippling organizations with targeted ransomware, demanding five-figure ransoms.

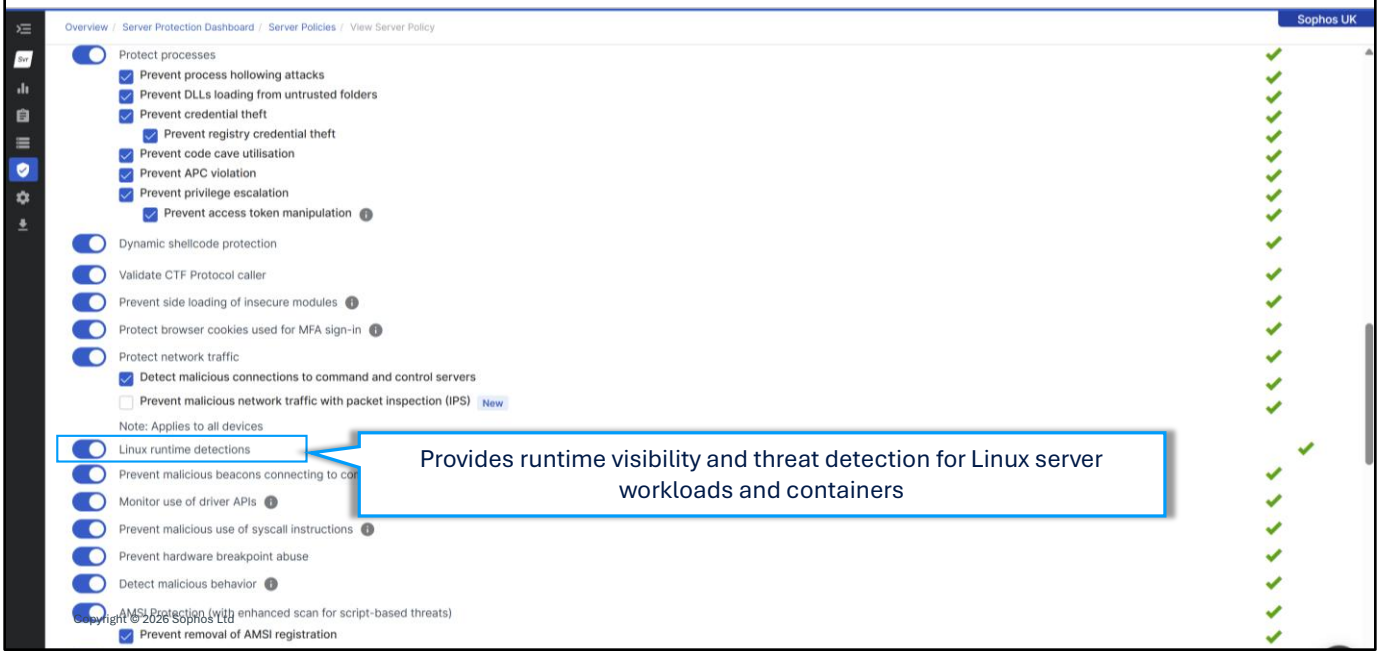
Server Protection



The threat protection base policy for servers includes the same protection features as the endpoint policy; however, some features have been adapted for server use.

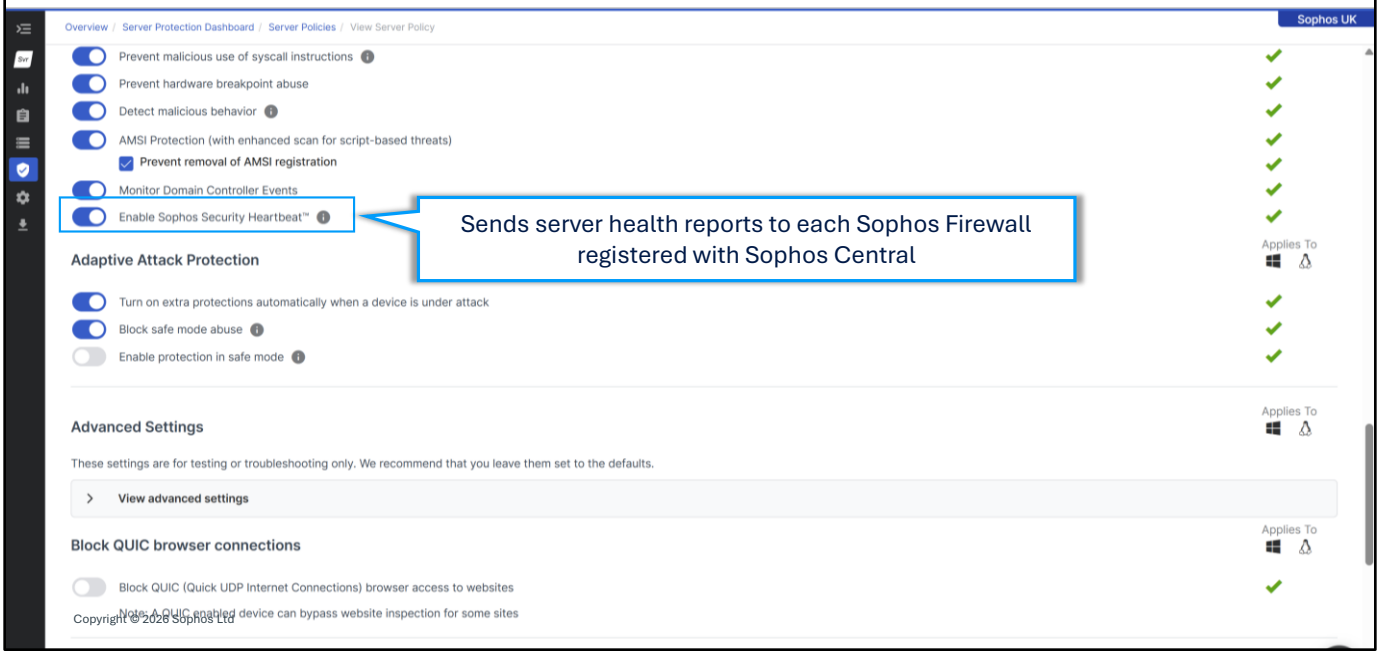
In the server threat protection policy, a column indicator is included down the right-hand side to indicate which features apply to which platforms.

Server Protection



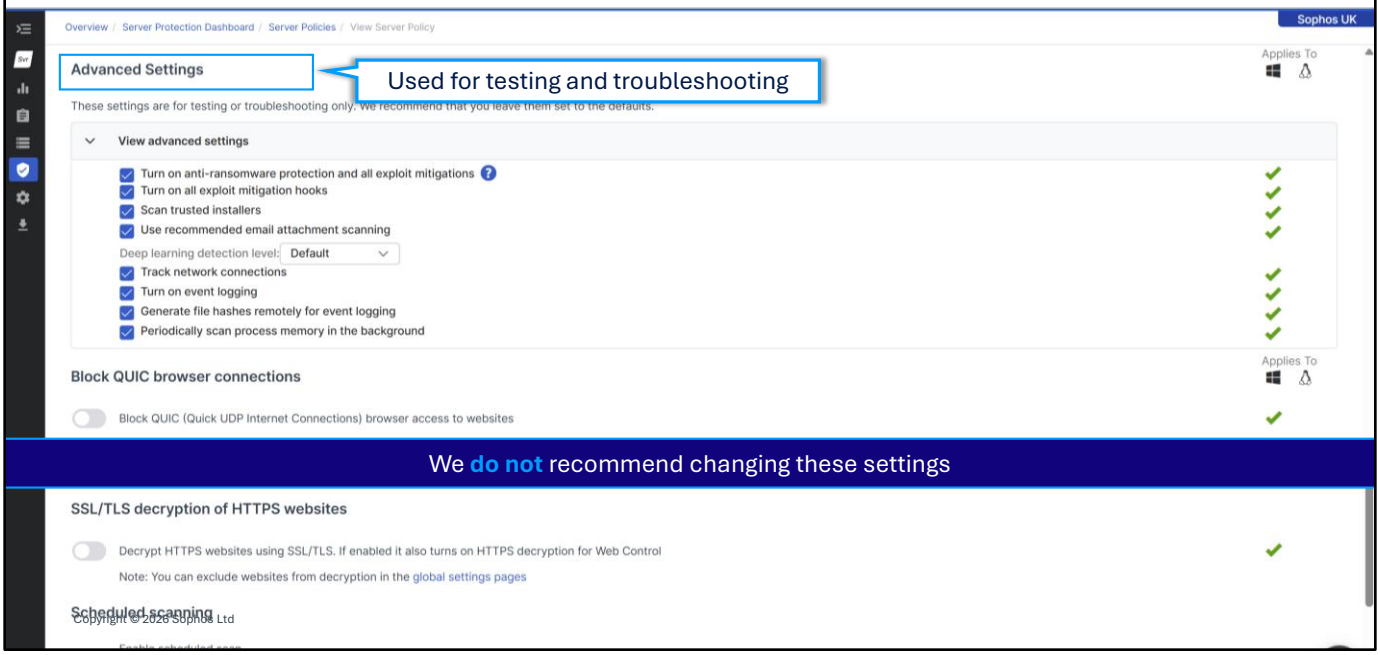
Linux runtime detections provide runtime visibility and threat detection for Linux server workloads and containers. You can manage these alerts in the Threat Analysis Center.

Server Protection



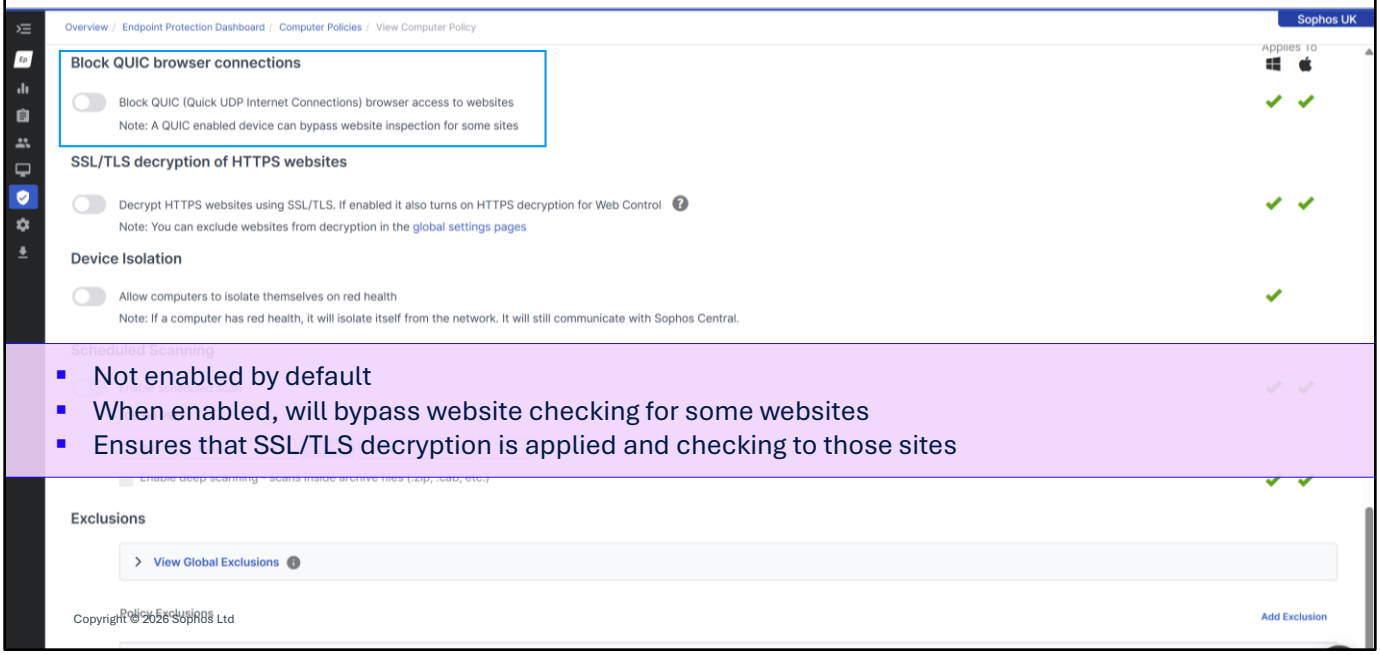
Enable Security Heartbeat, which sends server health reports to each Sophos Firewall registered with your Sophos Central account. If more than one firewall is registered, reports go to the nearest one available. If a report shows that a server may be compromised, the firewall can restrict its access.

Advanced Settings



Advanced settings are for testing and troubleshooting use only. We **do not recommend** changing these settings.

Block QUIC Browser Connections



- Not enabled by default
- When enabled, will bypass website checking for some websites
- Ensures that SSL/TLS decryption is applied and checking to those sites

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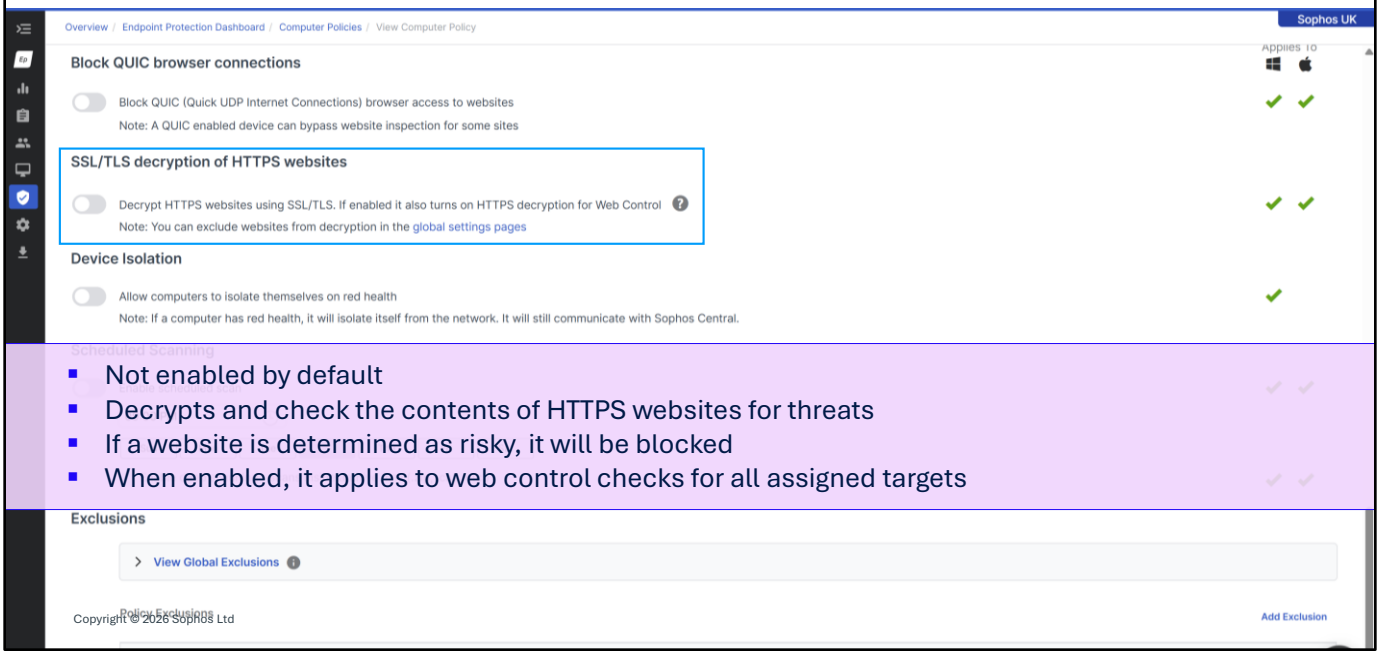
QUIC enabled browsers can bypass website checking for some sites. Blocking QUIC ensures that SSL/TLS decryption is applied and checking to those sites.

SSL/TLS Decryption of HTTPS Websites



- Not enabled by default
- Decrypts and check the contents of HTTPS websites for threats
- If a website is determined as risky, it will be blocked
- When enabled, it applies to web control checks for all assigned targets

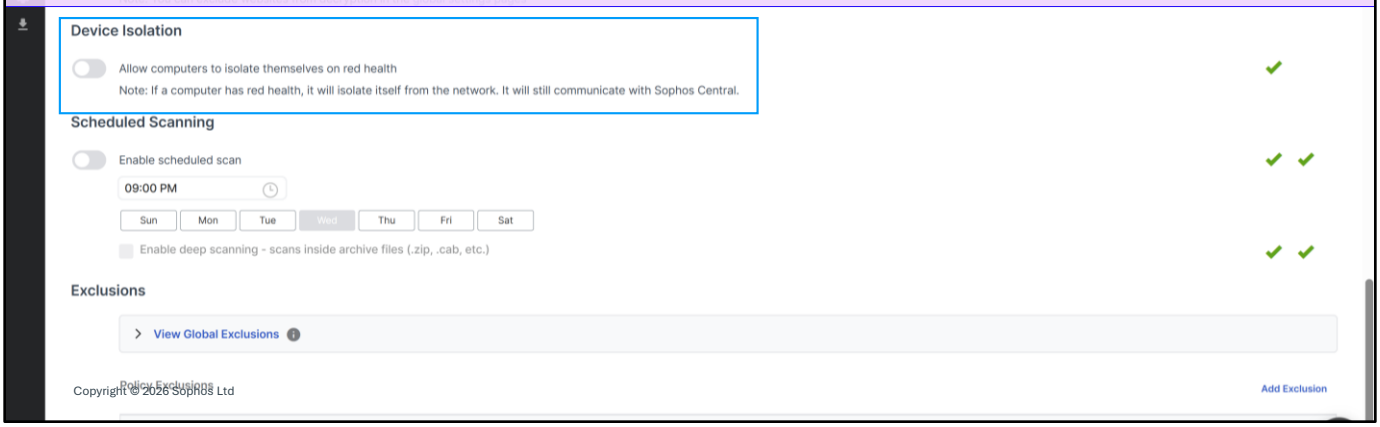
Selecting to decrypt websites using SSL/TLS means that the contents of HTTPS websites are decrypted and checked for threats.

If a website is determined to be risky, it will be blocked. The Sophos Endpoint Agent will display a message to the user, giving them the option to submit the website to SophosLabs for re-assessment.

Note that if decryption is enabled, it applies to the devices, device groups, users, and user groups to which the policy is assigned. It is also applied to web control checks for all assigned targets.

Device Isolation

- Not enabled by default
- Only listed in the endpoint threat protection policy (**not server**)
- A device with a red health status will automatically isolate itself from the network
- Access to the network and the internet is disconnected
- Remains in communication with Sophos Central



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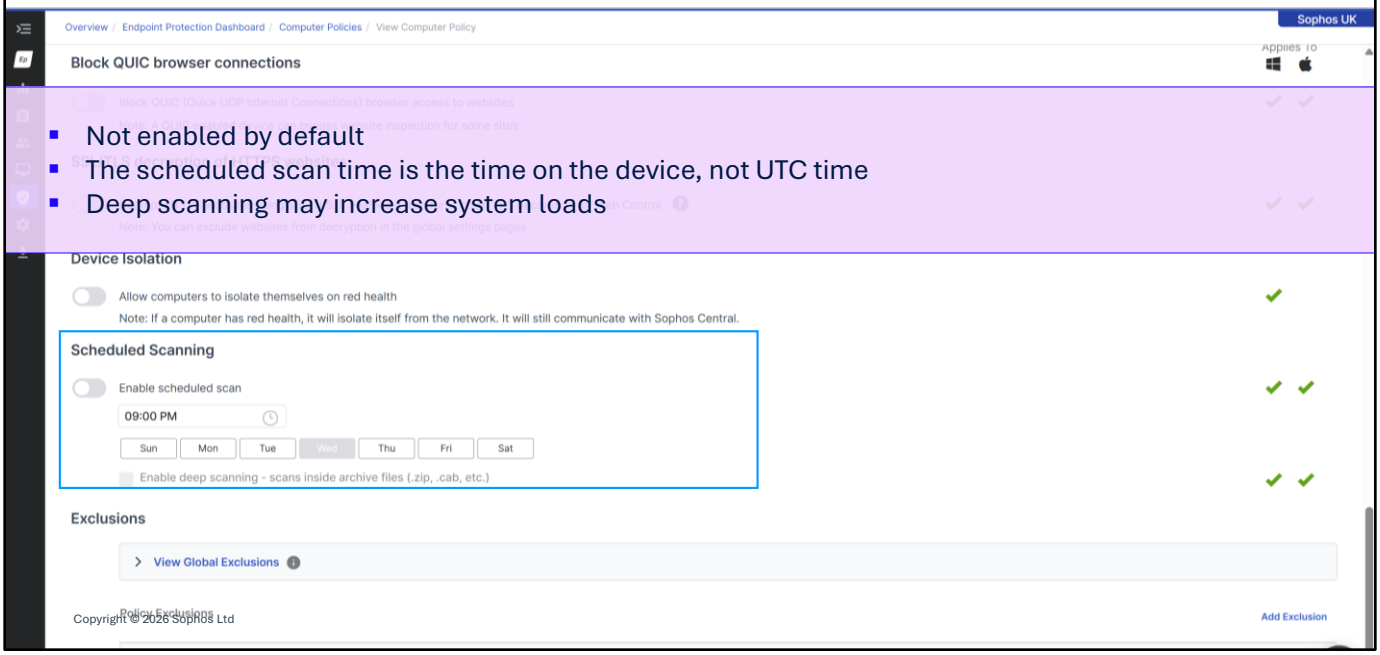
Device isolation is not enabled by default and is only available in the endpoint threat protection policy. When enabled, it allows devices to isolate from the network automatically if their health status of the device is red. Once isolated, the device cannot access the network or the internet. However, it will still communicate with Sophos Central.

Once the health state of the device is healthy, either green or amber, the device isolation will be removed automatically. Access to the network and the internet will be restored. Device isolation protects the network from lateral movement attacks.

Scheduled Scanning

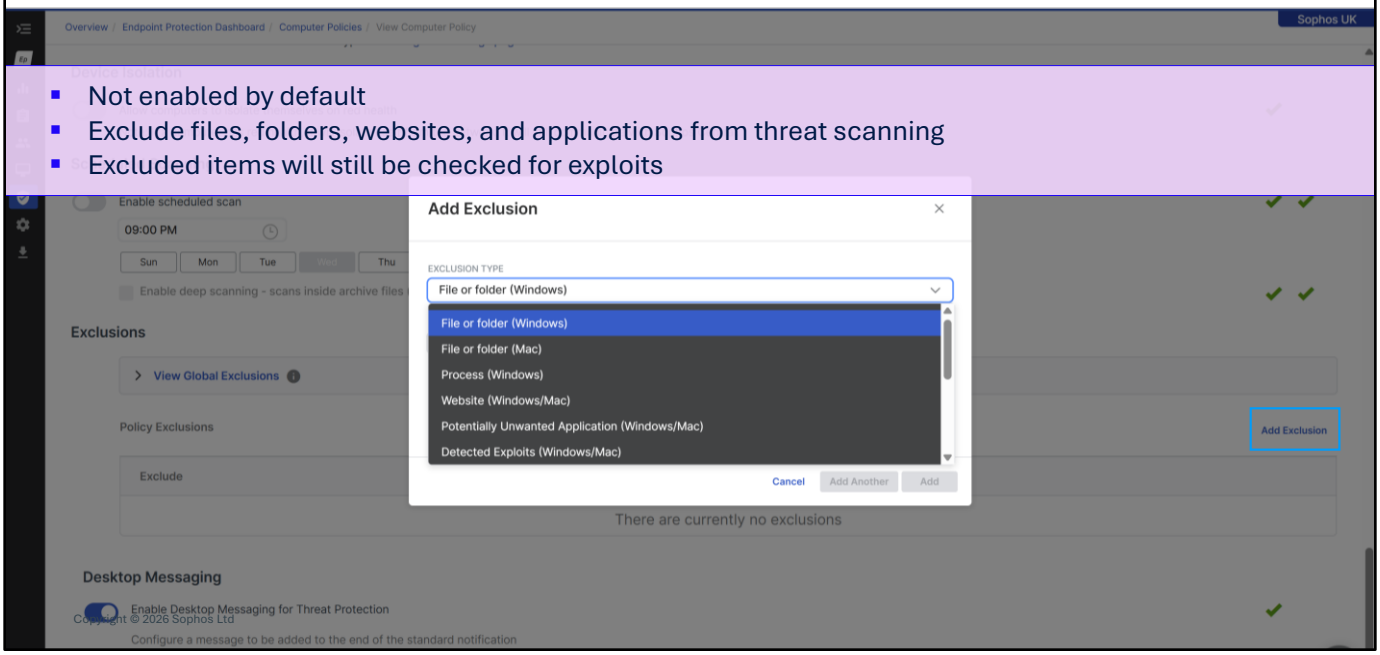


- Not enabled by default
- The scheduled scan time is the time on the device, not UTC time
- Deep scanning may increase system loads

Scheduled scanning is not automatically enabled. It can be enabled, and a schedule can be set. Note that the scheduled scan time displayed is the time on the device, not UTC time.

If you select to enable deep scanning, the scheduled scan will scan inside archive files. This may increase the system load and make the scan time significantly slower. We recommend that if you choose to enable deep scanning, your schedule is configured so that the scanning takes place outside of active hours to minimize any disruption to users.

Policy Exclusions

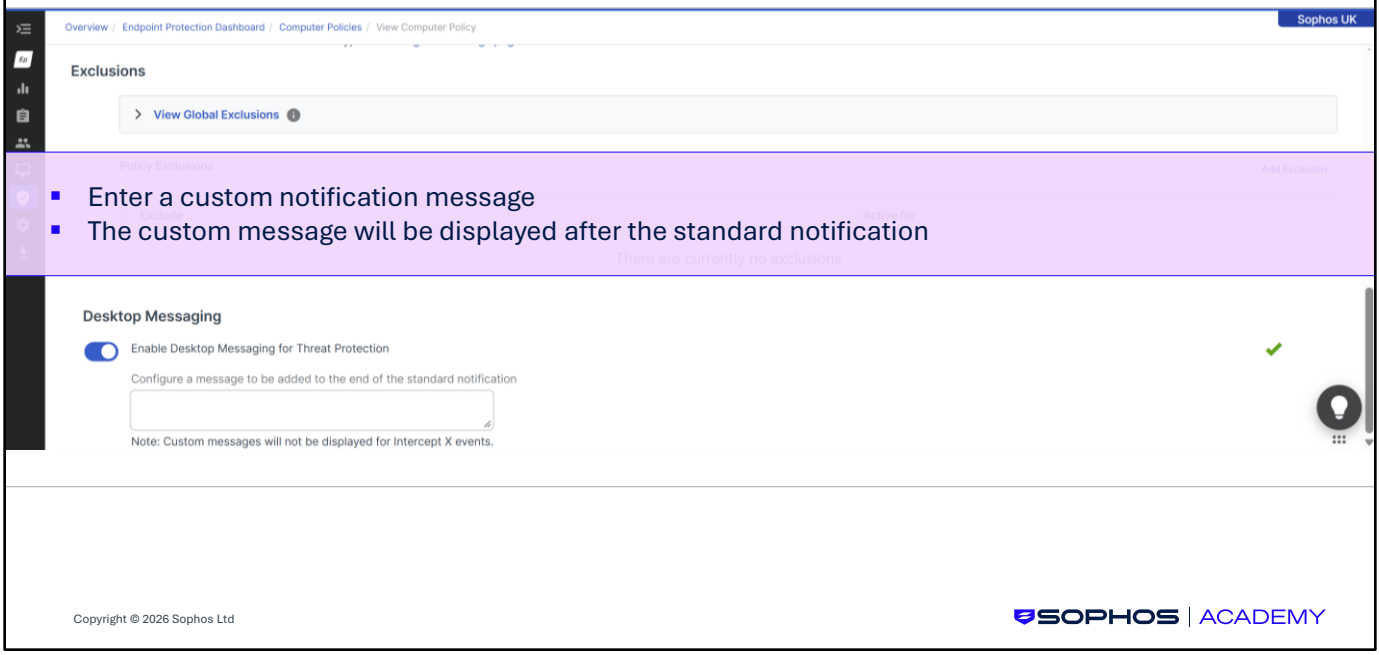


- Not enabled by default
- Exclude files, folders, websites, and applications from threat scanning
- Excluded items will still be checked for exploits

You can exclude files, folders, websites, and applications from threat scanning. Any exclusions applied in a threat protection policy are only used for the assigned devices or users of that policy.

Excluded items will still be checked for exploits; however, you can stop checking for a detected exploit by using an exploit exclusion.

Desktop Messaging



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In the ‘Desktop Messaging’ section, you can add a custom message that will be displayed at the end of any standard notification.

If you leave the message box empty, the standard message will be displayed.

Here are the three main things you learned in this chapter.

The threat protection policy protects against malware, risky file types, websites, and malicious network traffic.

Some security settings are not enabled by default in the threat protection policy.

You can exclude files, folders, websites, and applications from scanning for threats. Excluded items will still be scanned for exploits.

[Additional Information]

Sophos Endpoint
EP3515: Getting Started with the Peripheral Control Policy

May 2026

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Getting Started with the Peripheral Control Policy

In this chapter, you'll learn about the peripheral control policy, what it does, and how it can be configured.

RECOMMENDED KNOWLEDGE AND EXPERIENCE

- ✓ How to access and navigate Sophos Central
- ✓ How to protect and manage devices
- ✓ What policies are and how they are assigned

DURATION: 4 minutes

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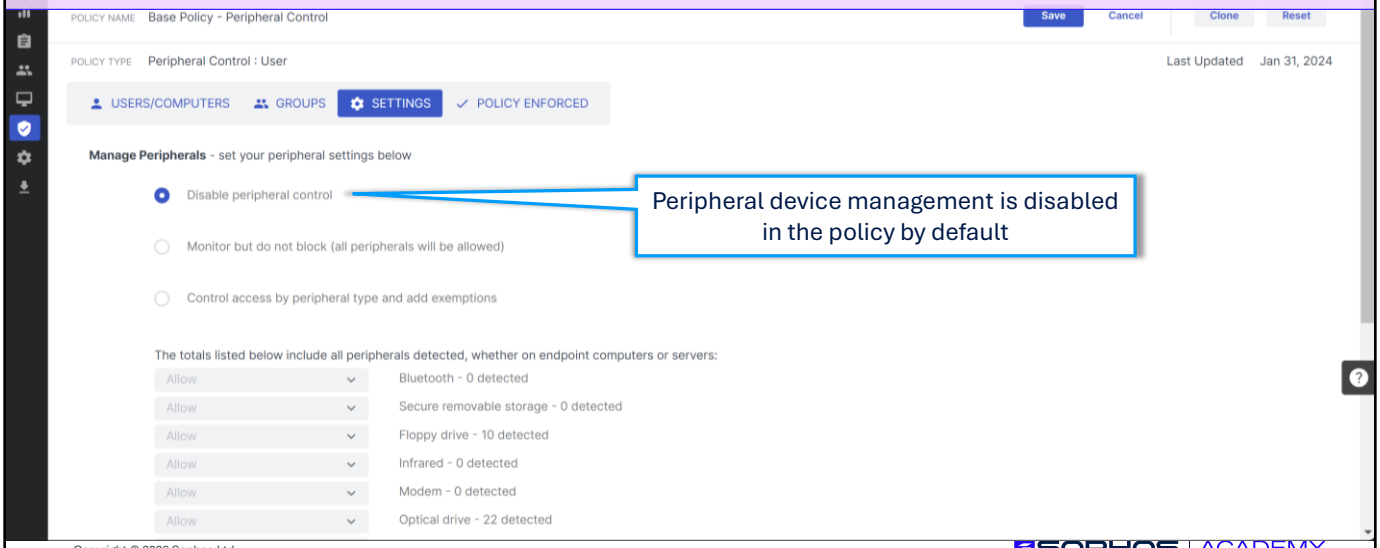
In this chapter, you will learn about the peripheral control policy, what it does, and how it can be configured.

Peripheral Control Policy

Restricts access to removable devices and can be used to prevent the use of untrusted devices which may contain malware



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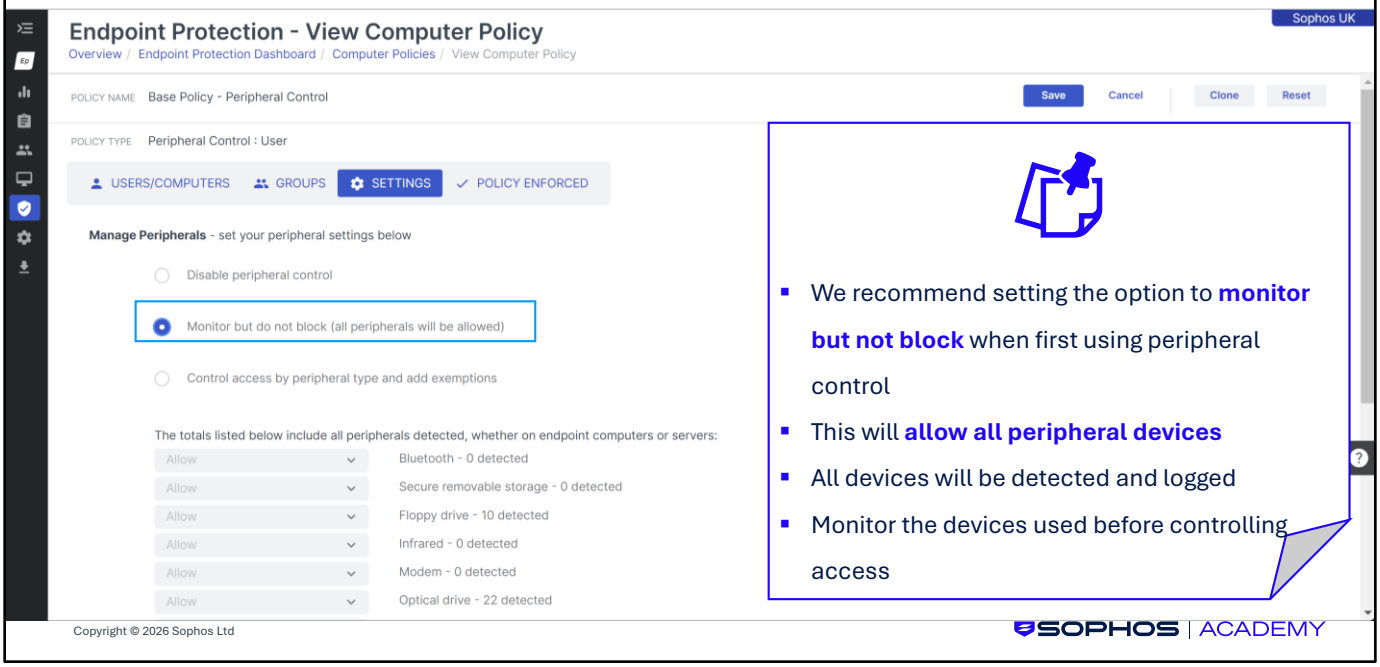
Peripheral control restricts access to removable devices such as USB drives. It can be used to prevent the use of untrusted devices, which may contain malware.

Peripheral control is managed using the peripheral control policy. By default, the peripheral control base policy isn't configured.

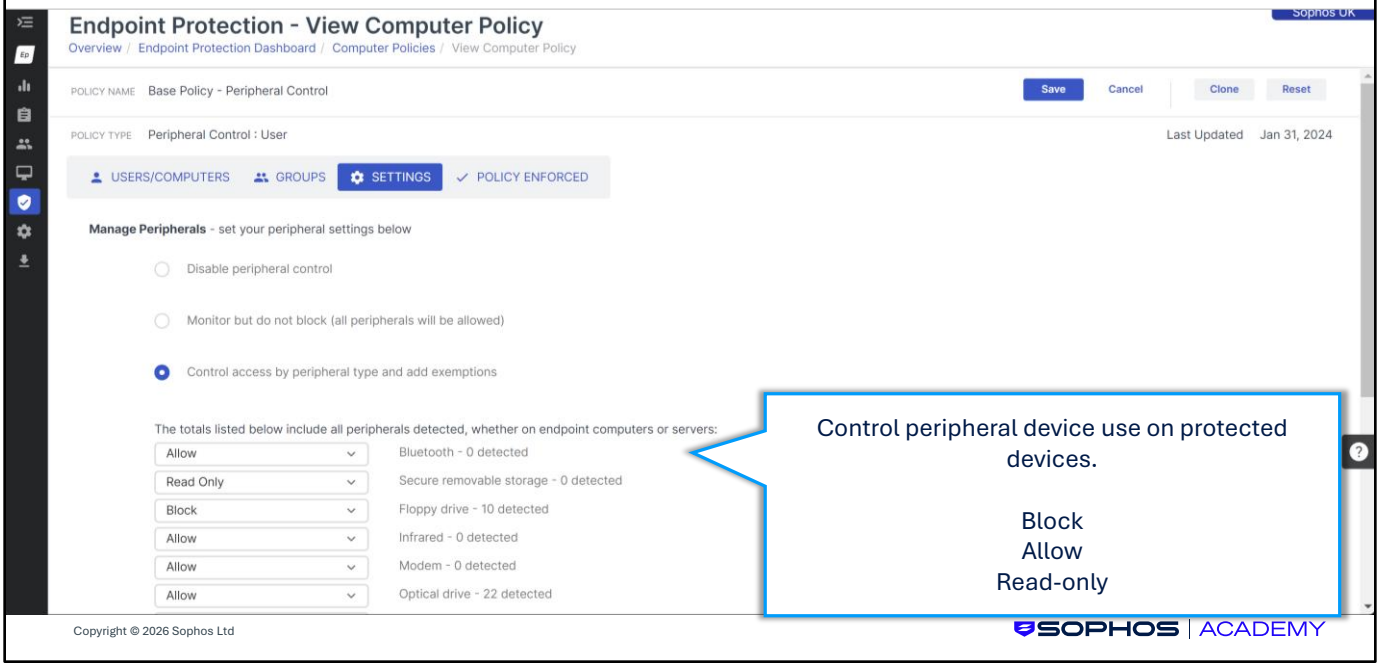
Peripheral Control Policy



The management of peripheral devices is configured in the **SETTINGS** tab of the policy.

The option to 'Monitor but do not block' can be selected to allow all peripheral device use across the network. Any peripheral devices used will be detected and logged, collecting information about the devices in use. This allows you to make an informed decision regarding control.

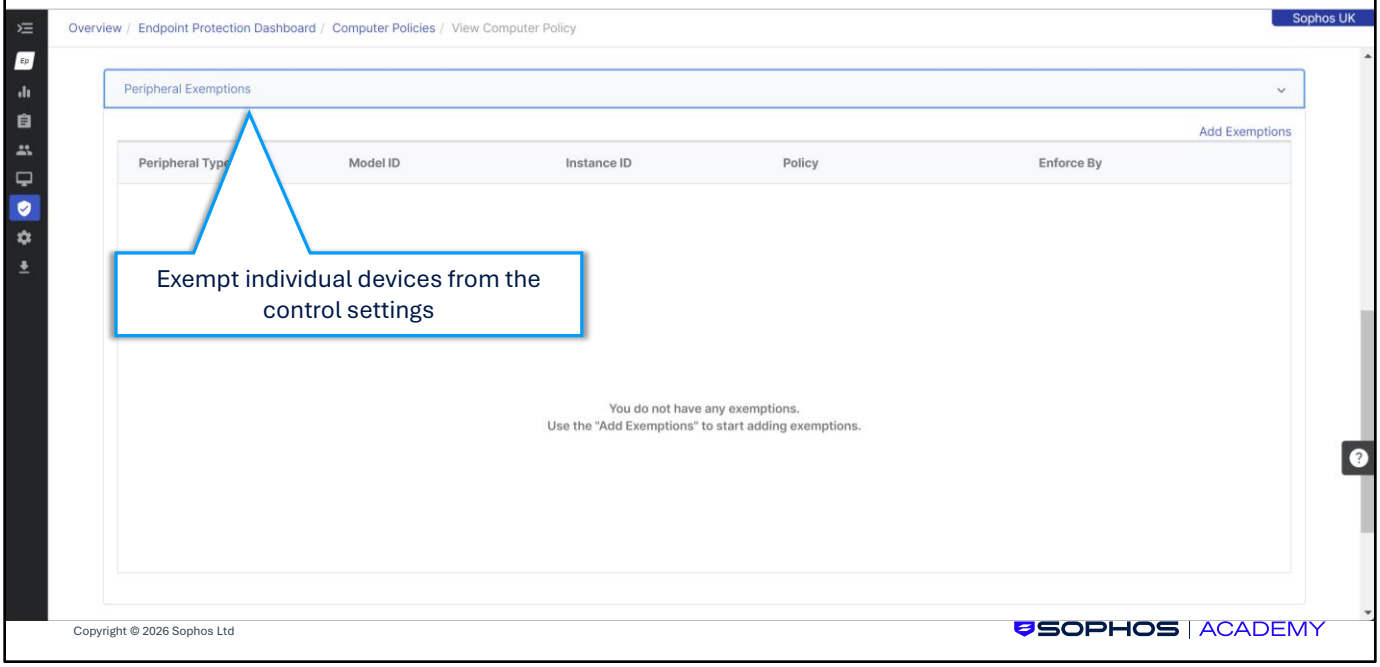
Peripheral Control Policy



When the peripheral control setting is changed to 'control access', each category of device can be set to allow or block. Additionally, secure removable storage, floppy drives, and optical drives all have the option of read-only. For wireless devices, the option to block bridged networks is available.

In this example, if a floppy drive is used on a protected device, the drive will be blocked based on this policy.

Peripheral Exemptions



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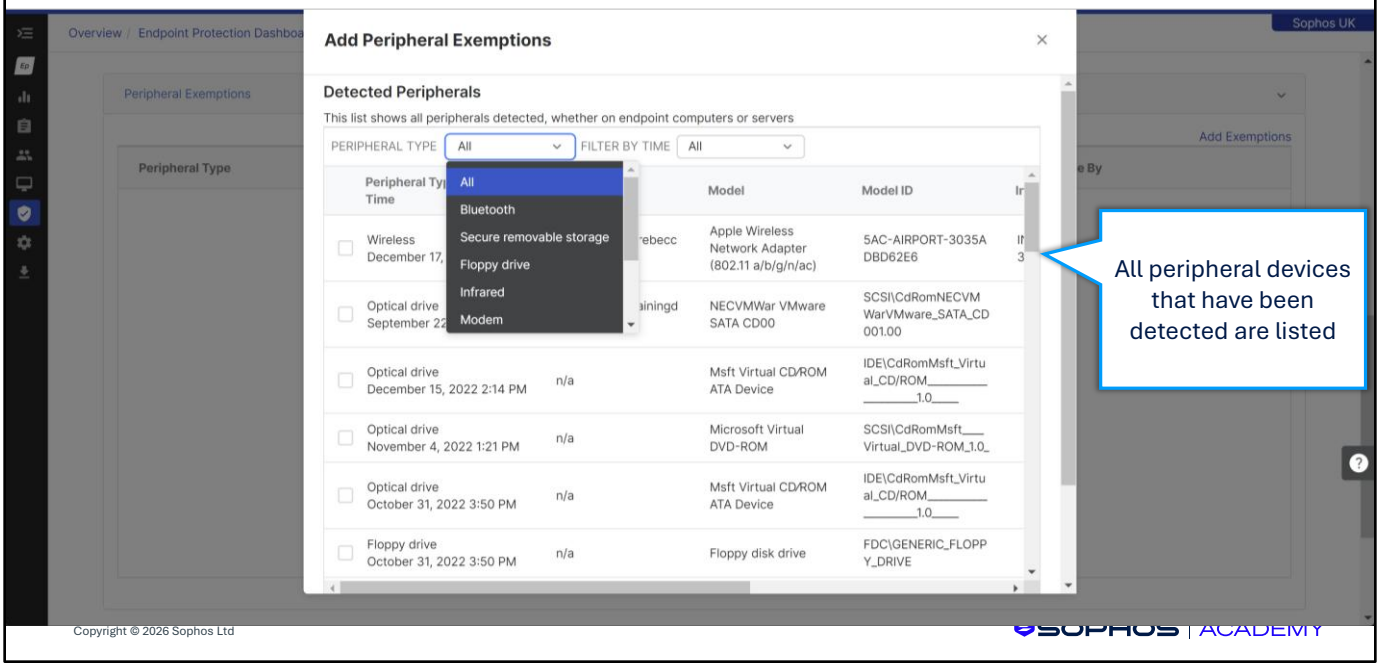
Exemptions can be made for individual devices. Any devices added to the exemption list are not subject to the policy's control settings, allowing you to apply less restrictive controls for individual devices when necessary.

To add an exemption, click **Add Exemptions**.

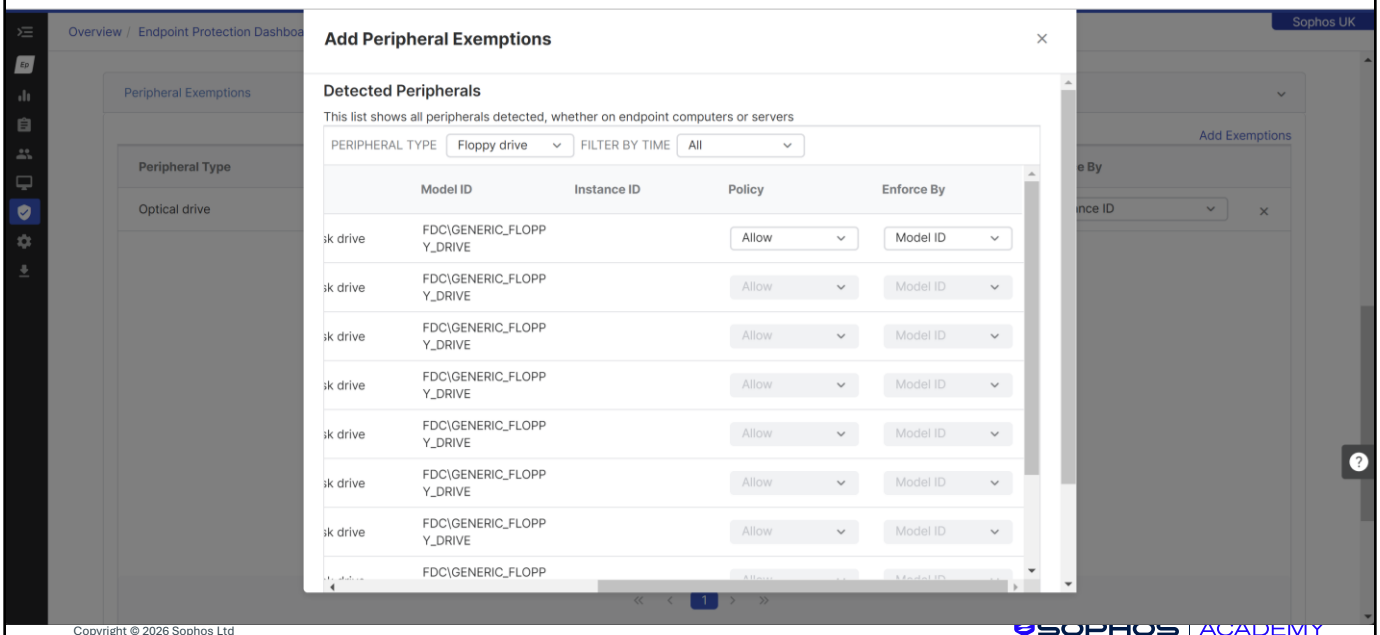
Peripheral Exemptions



The detected peripherals list displays all peripheral devices that have been detected on protected devices. This makes it easier to set consistent exemptions for all devices.

The list can be filtered by time or peripheral type.

Peripheral Exemptions



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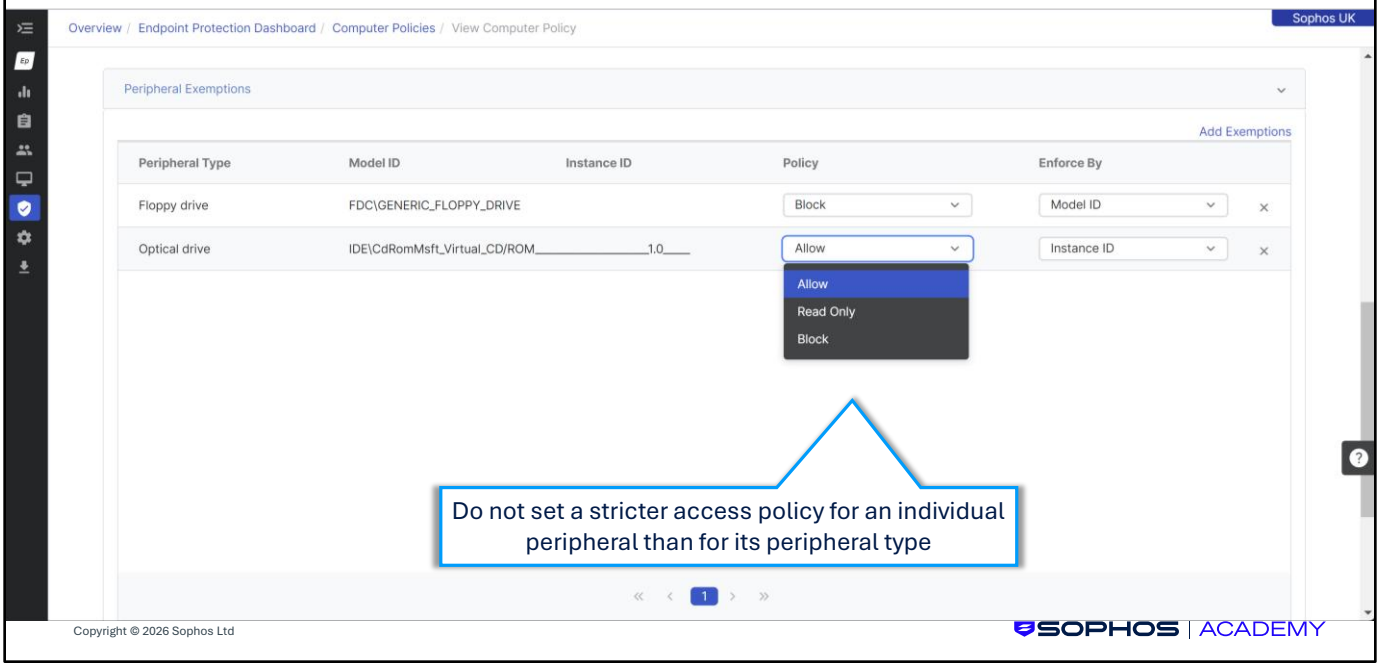
Select the device or devices you want to exempt from the control settings. The policy and enforce by drop-down menu's become available when a device is selected from the list. You can choose to allow or block the device or read-only. You can then enforce the policy by model ID or Instance ID.

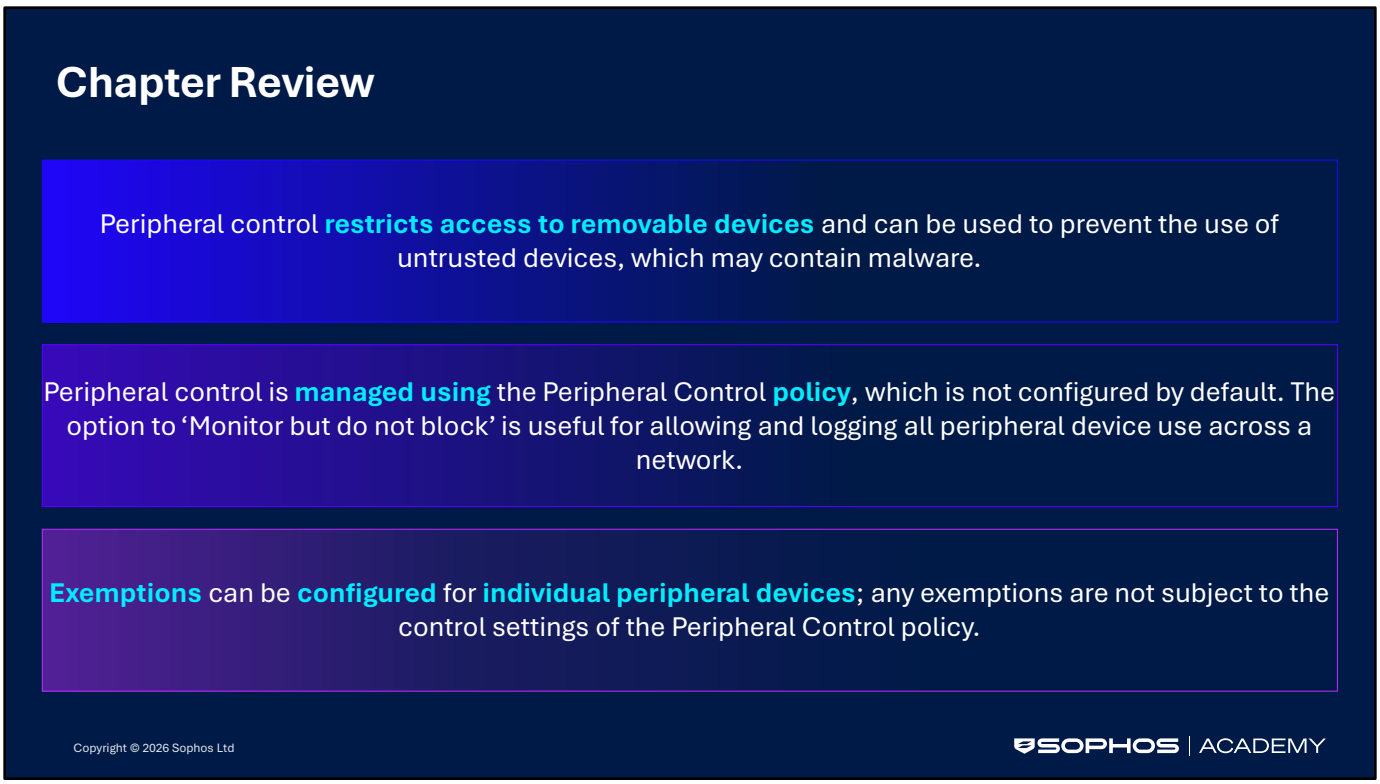
Click **Add Exemption(s)** to save the exemption.

Peripheral Exemptions



In the ‘Policy’ column, you can optionally use the drop-down list to change the policy for an exempt peripheral. You must not set a stricter access policy for an individual peripheral than its peripheral type. If you do, the setting for the individual policy is ignored, and a warning icon is displayed beside it.

In the ‘Enforce By’ column, you can optionally use the drop-down menu to apply the policy by model ID or by instance ID.



Here are the three main things you learned in this chapter.

Peripheral control restricts access to removable devices and can be used to prevent the use of untrusted devices, which may contain malware.

Peripheral control is managed using the Peripheral Control policy, which is not configured by default. The option to 'Monitor but do not block' is useful for allowing and logging all peripheral device use across a network.

Exemptions can be configured for individual peripheral devices; any exemptions are not subject to the control settings of the Peripheral Control policy.

[Additional Information]

Sophos Endpoint
EP3520: Getting Started with the Sophos Endpoint Application Control Policy

May 2026

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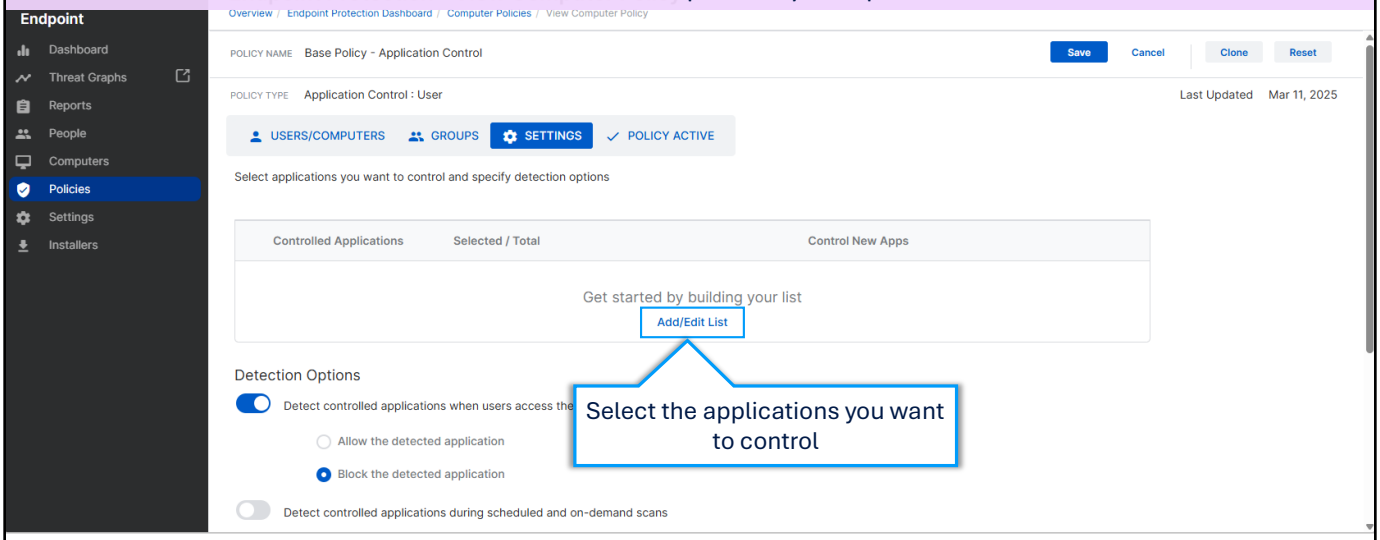
In this chapter, you'll learn how to monitor applications and how to configure the application policy to control the use of applications.

Application Control Policy

Prevents users from running applications and improves security by controlling the types of applications that are allowed, which reduces the possibility of exploit attacks.



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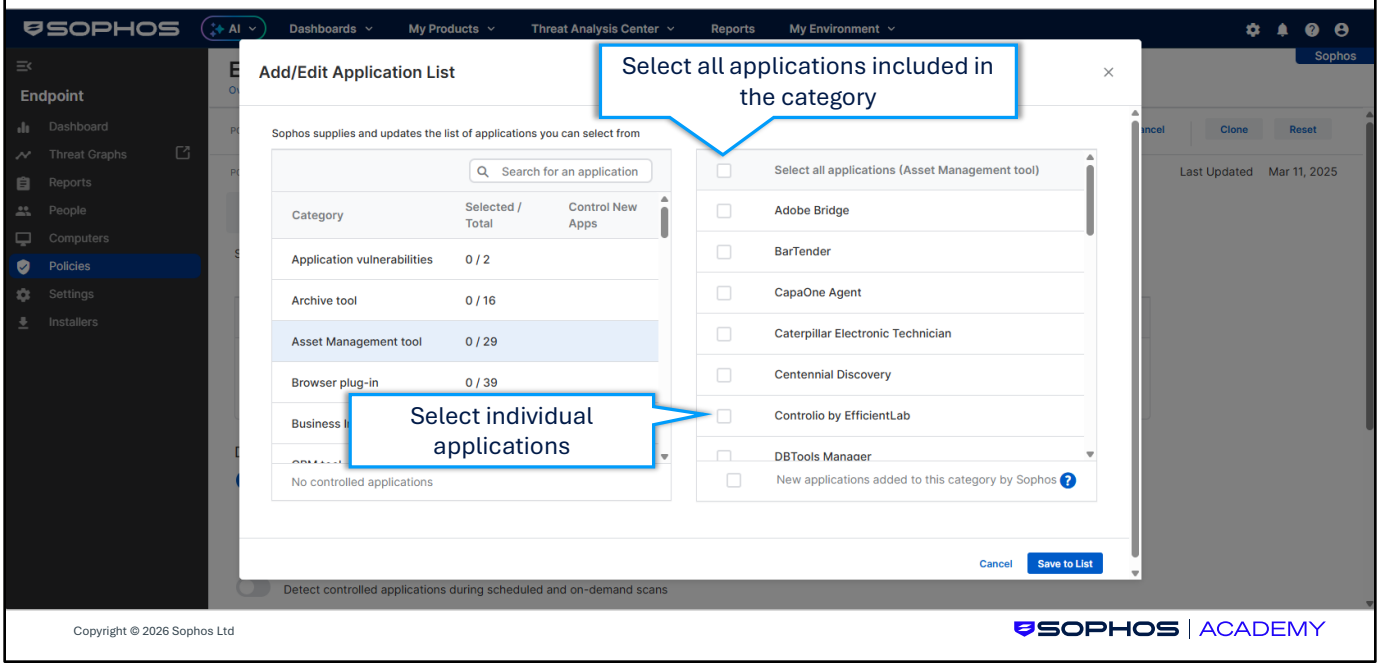
Application control prevents users from running applications that could be considered unsuitable for business use, such as games or instant messaging applications. It also improves security by controlling the type of applications that are allowed, which reduces the possibility of exploit attacks.

Application control is not enabled by default. Applications are controlled using the application control policy. On the **SETTINGS** tab in the policy, select **Add/Edit List**.

Application Control Policy



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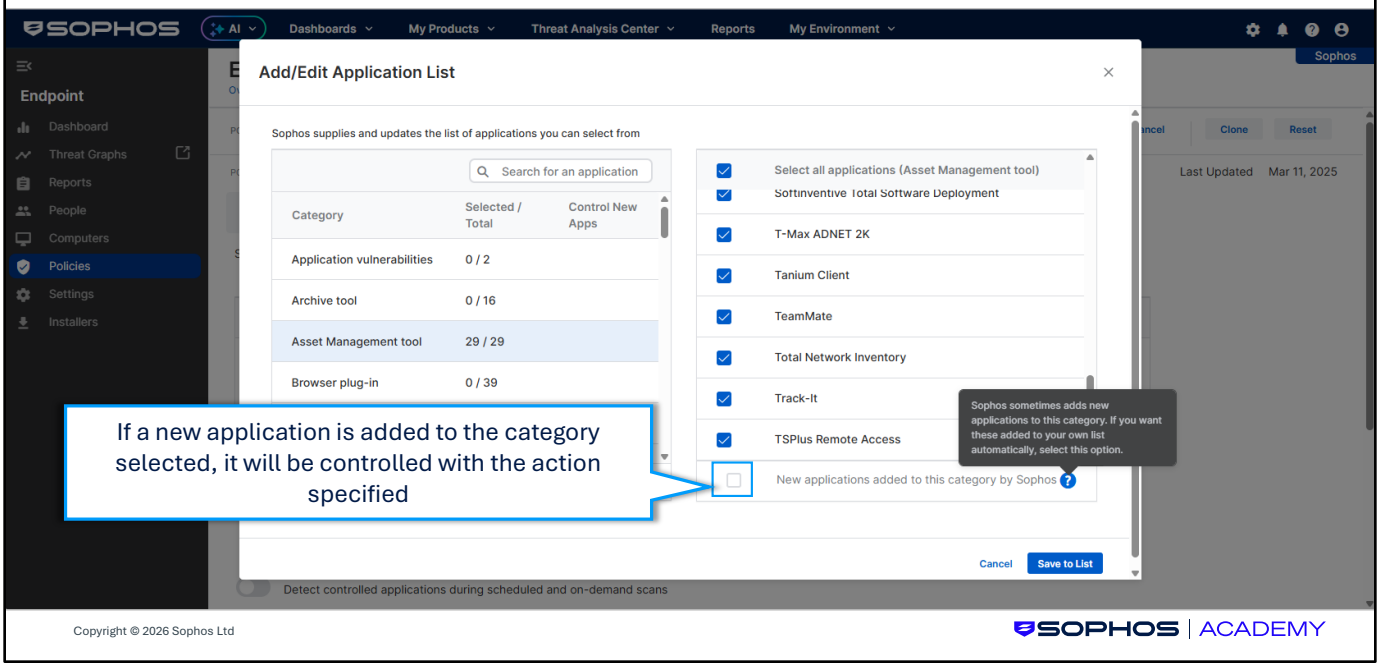
This opens a list of application categories. You can select an entire category or a single application within a category. This allows you to control all applications of a specific type or control an individual application. A full list of the applications in a category will be displayed when you select an application category. In this example, the 'System tool' category has been selected.

We recommend that you 'SELECT ALL APPLICATIONS' to begin with. You can refine your selection after detected applications have been logged. Click **Save to List** and repeat this process for each category you want to control.

Application Control Policy



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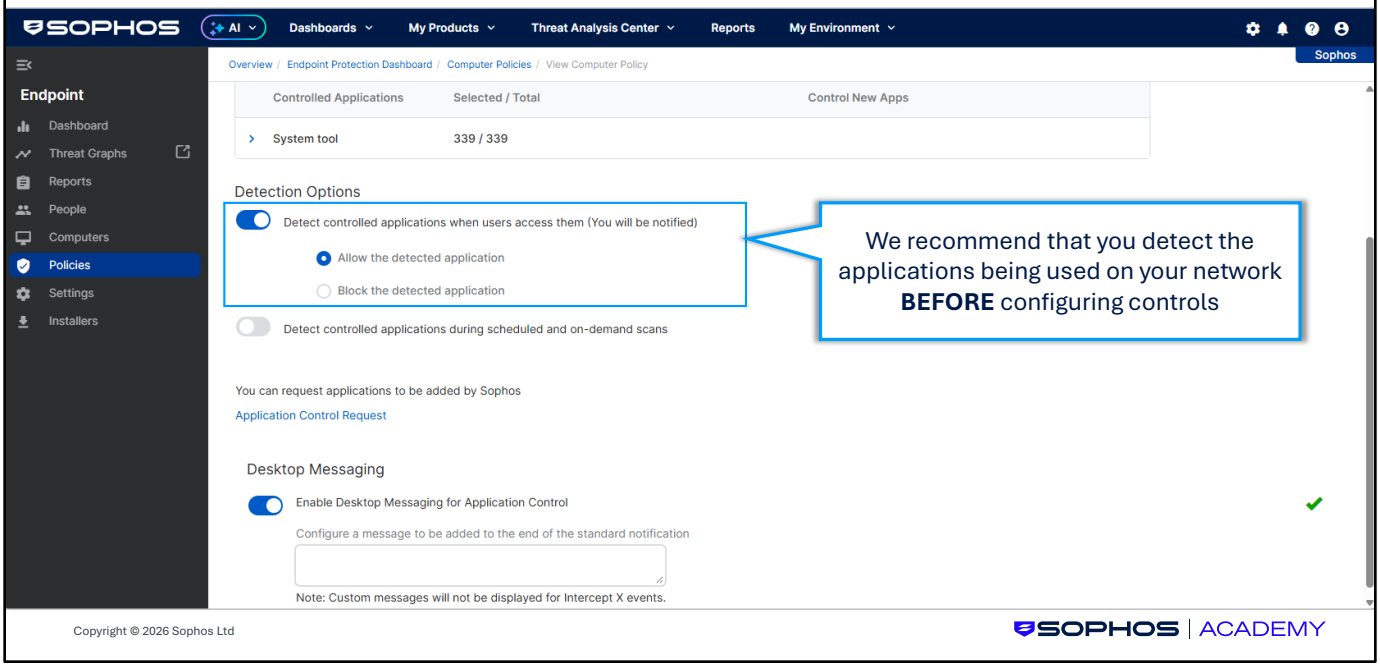
The option to include any new applications added to a category is available. This means that if an application is added to the selected category, it will also be controlled with the action specified.

Sophos supplies and maintains the list of applications and categories.

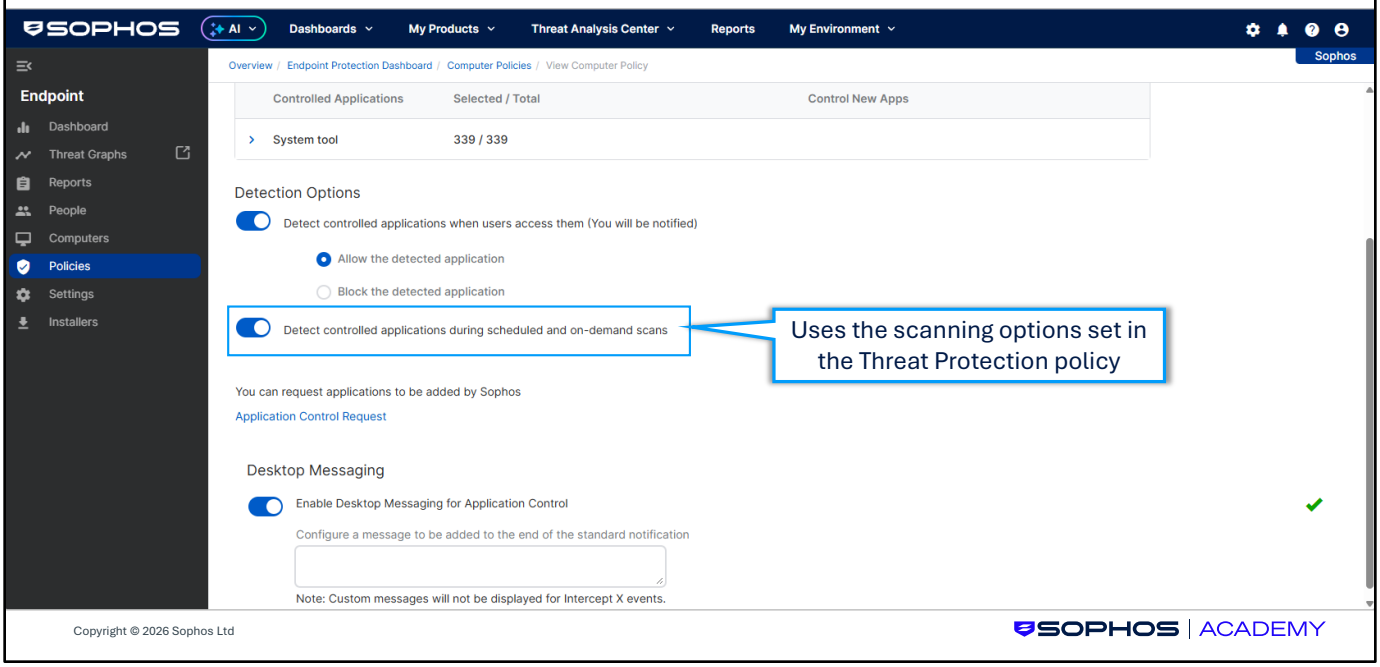
Application Control Policy



We recommend that you detect all applications being used on your network first. Then, you can decide which applications you want to control access to. To do this, select all the applications in the application list by selecting all categories.

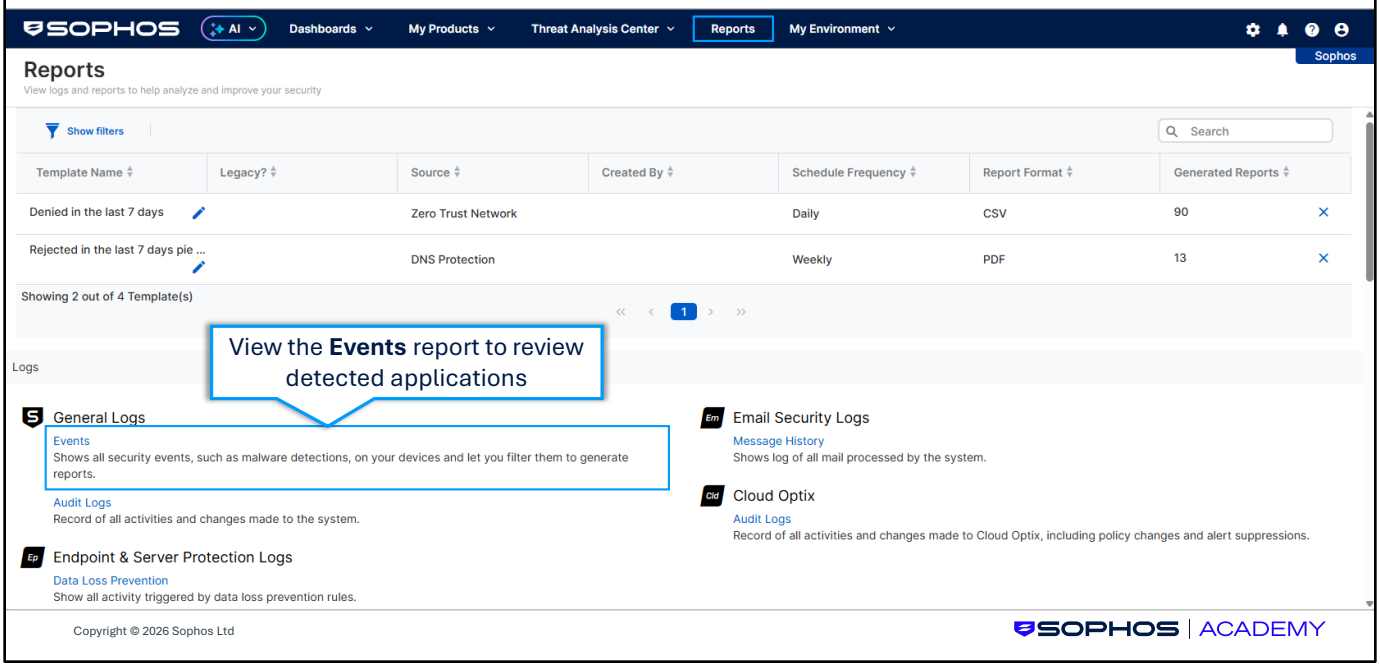
This will ensure that all listed applications are detected when they are in use on your network. It will also give you a comprehensive list of application use, which will allow you to decide what to control.

Application Control Policy



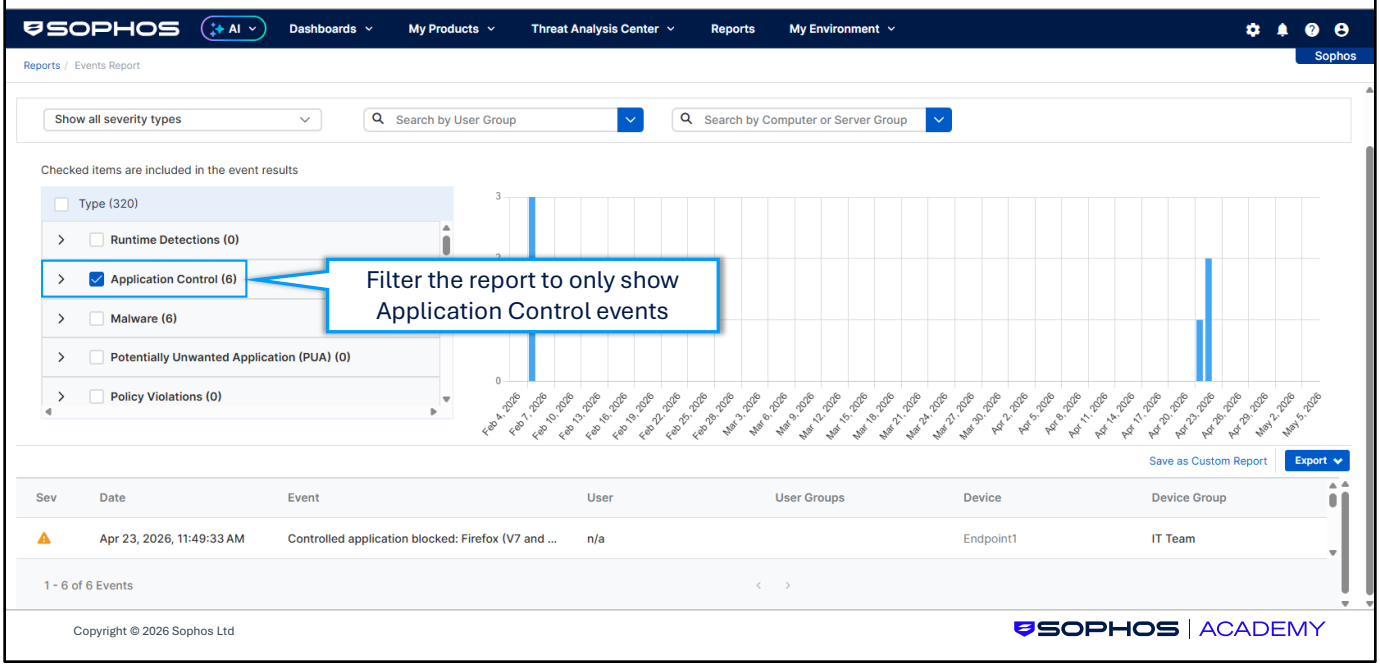
We recommend that you enable the 'detect controlled applications during scheduled and on-demand scans' option. This setting uses the scheduled scanning and on-demand scanning settings that have been applied in the threat protection policy.

Application Control Events



Once all protected devices have completed at least one scan, you will have a list of all applications that are being used. Navigate to **Reports** > **Events**.

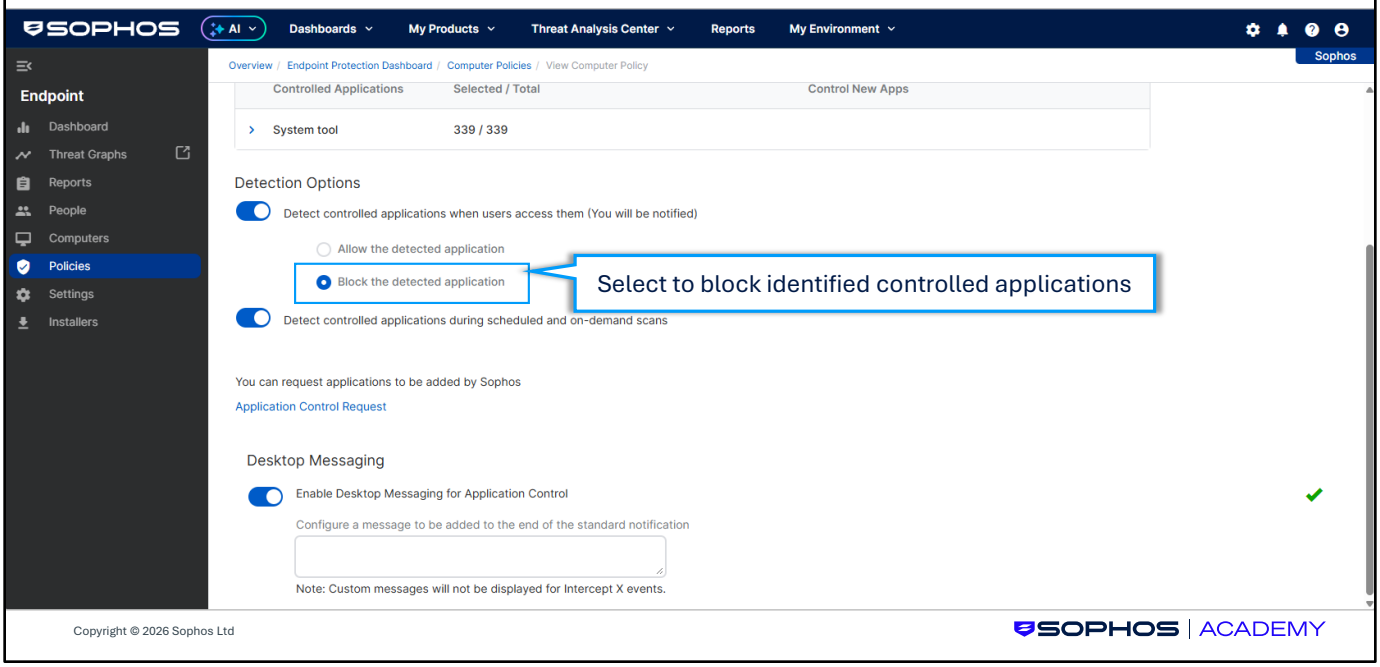
Application Control Events



In the list of event types, clear all the checkboxes except **Application Control**. Detected applications are shown in the list of events.

From here, you can note any applications you want to continue using on the network. The report can be exported to Excel and saved as a custom report if necessary.

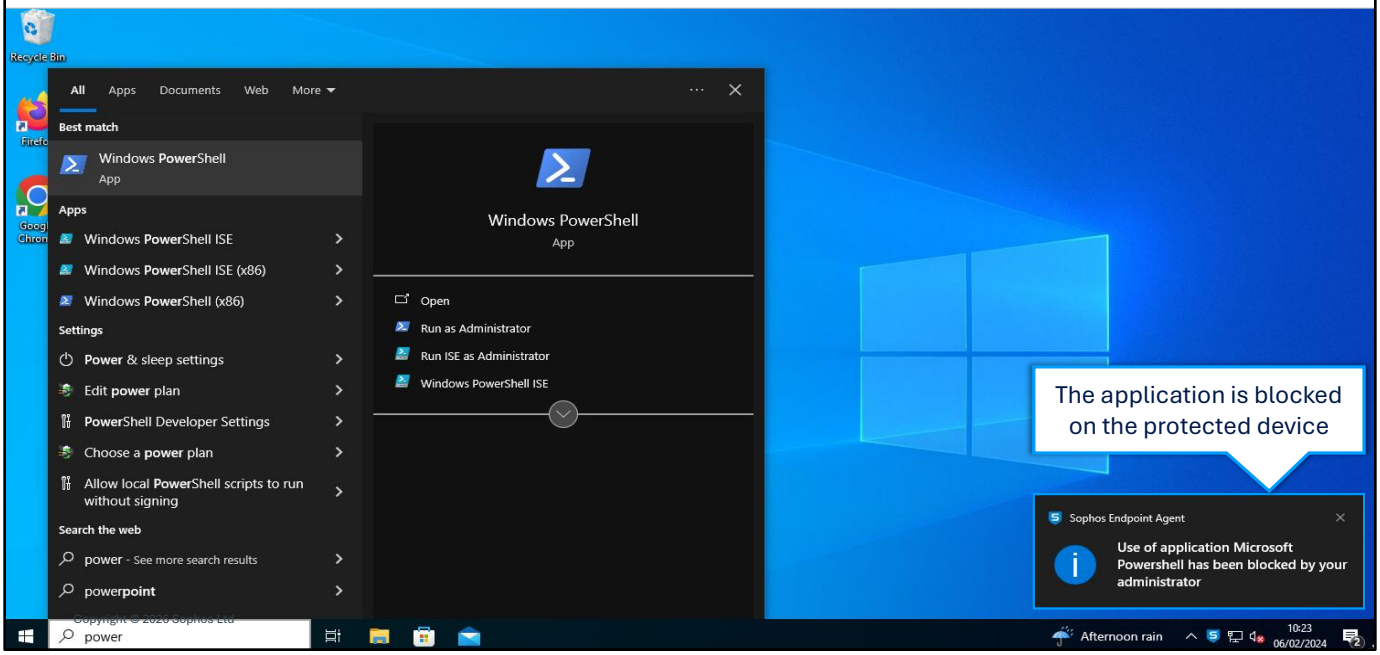
Application Control



You will now have a list of applications being used, which you can modify in the application control policy to match your requirements.

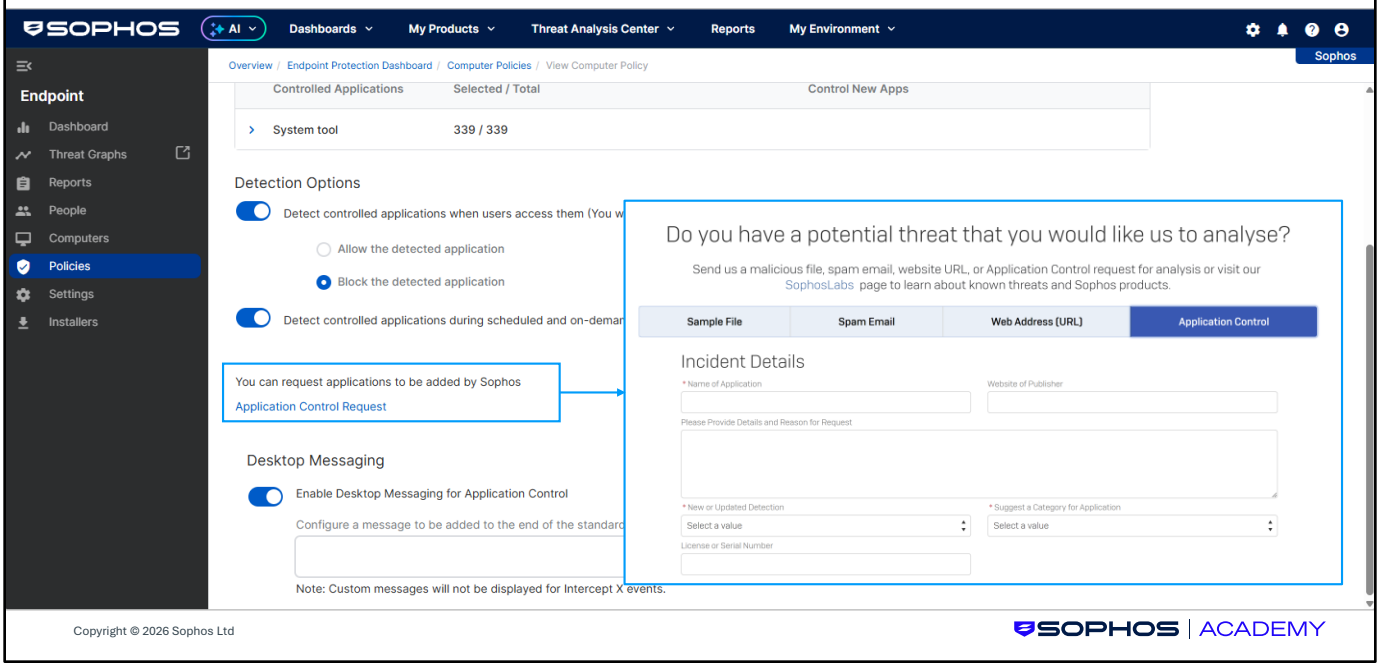
In this example, the PowerShell application is selected, and the detection setting is changed to block the application.

Application Control



On a protected device, when a user opens the blocked application, a message advising that the application has been blocked will appear.

Application Control



You can request that an application be added to the application list. This is useful if you want to control an application that isn't included in the current application list or if you believe an application is in the wrong category.

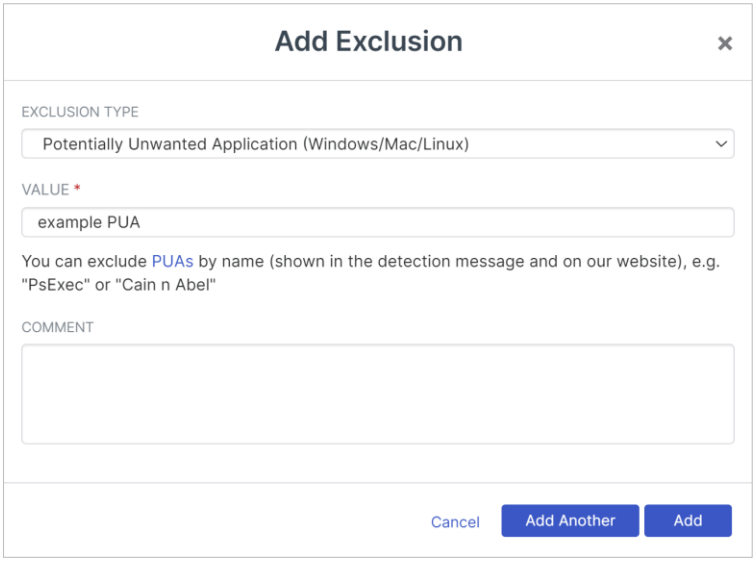
Click the **Application Control Request** link. A new tab will be opened, select the **Application Control** tab. You must fill out your contact information and then the details about the application you would like added, including the publisher of the application and the suggested category for the application.

Potentially Unwanted Applications

PUA
- Not malicious but unsuitable for business networks

PUA Detection
- Enabled by default
- All blocked PUAs are logged in the events report

Scanning Exclusions
- PUAs can be excluded locally in specific policies, or globally



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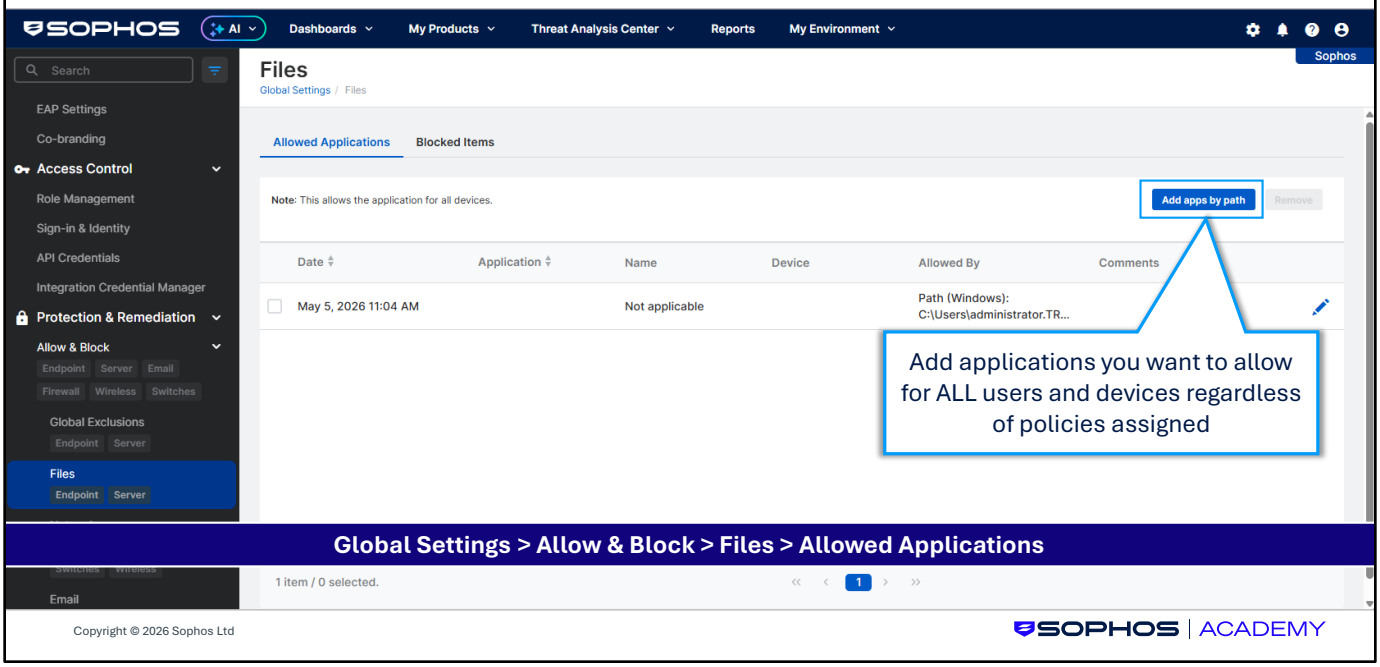
Potentially unwanted application (PUA) is a term used to describe applications that, while not malicious, are generally considered unsuitable for business use. The major PUA classifications are: adware, non-malicious spyware, and remote administration tools. Note that certain applications that fall into the PUA category may be considered useful by some users.

PUA scanning is enabled by default. If a PUA is detected, it will be blocked, and an event will be logged. You can configure a global exclusion for the application in **Global Settings > Global Exclusions,** which will apply the exclusion to all protected devices and users. Alternatively, you can add a policy exclusion for PUAs in a threat protection policy that will allow the PUA for only devices, groups, users, or servers assigned to the policy. We recommend applying exclusions in a policy, as this is less risky than globally excluding applications.

Allowed Applications



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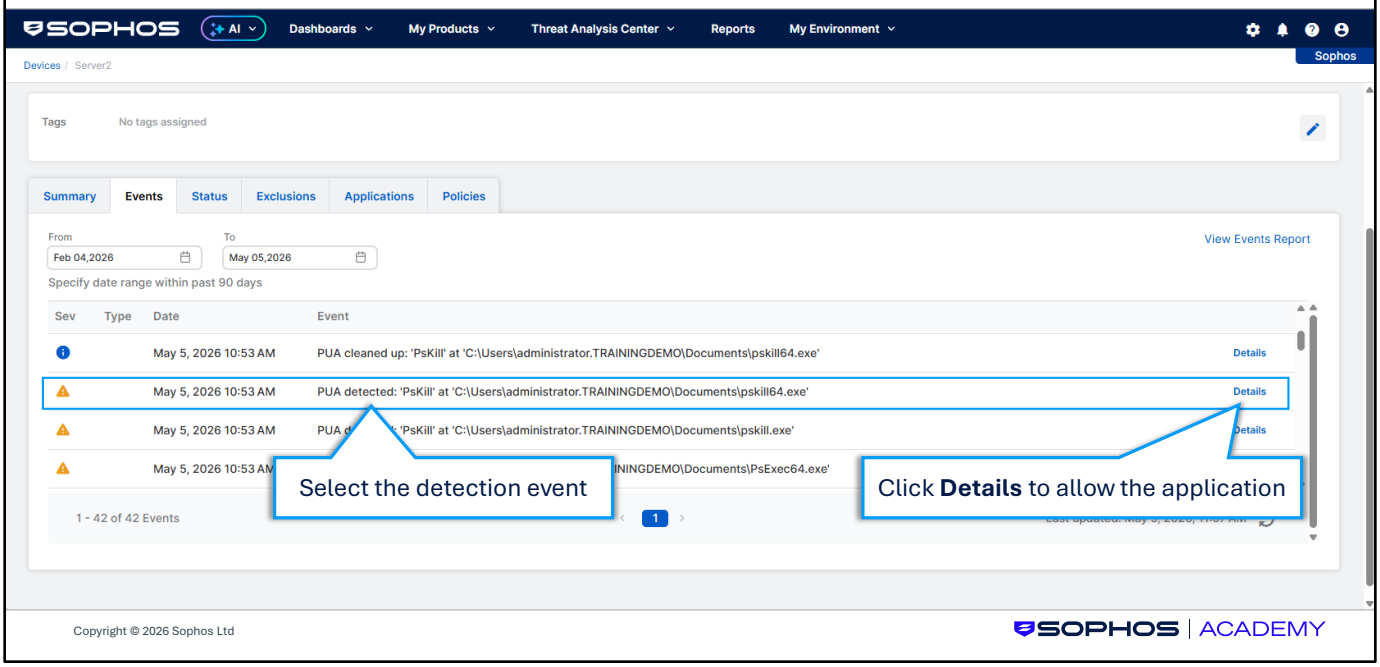
Detected applications that are not controlled can be allowed. To add an application to the global allowed applications list, navigate to **Global Settings > Protection & Remediation > Allow & Block > Files > Allowed Applications**.

Click **Add apps by path** and add the application you want to allow.

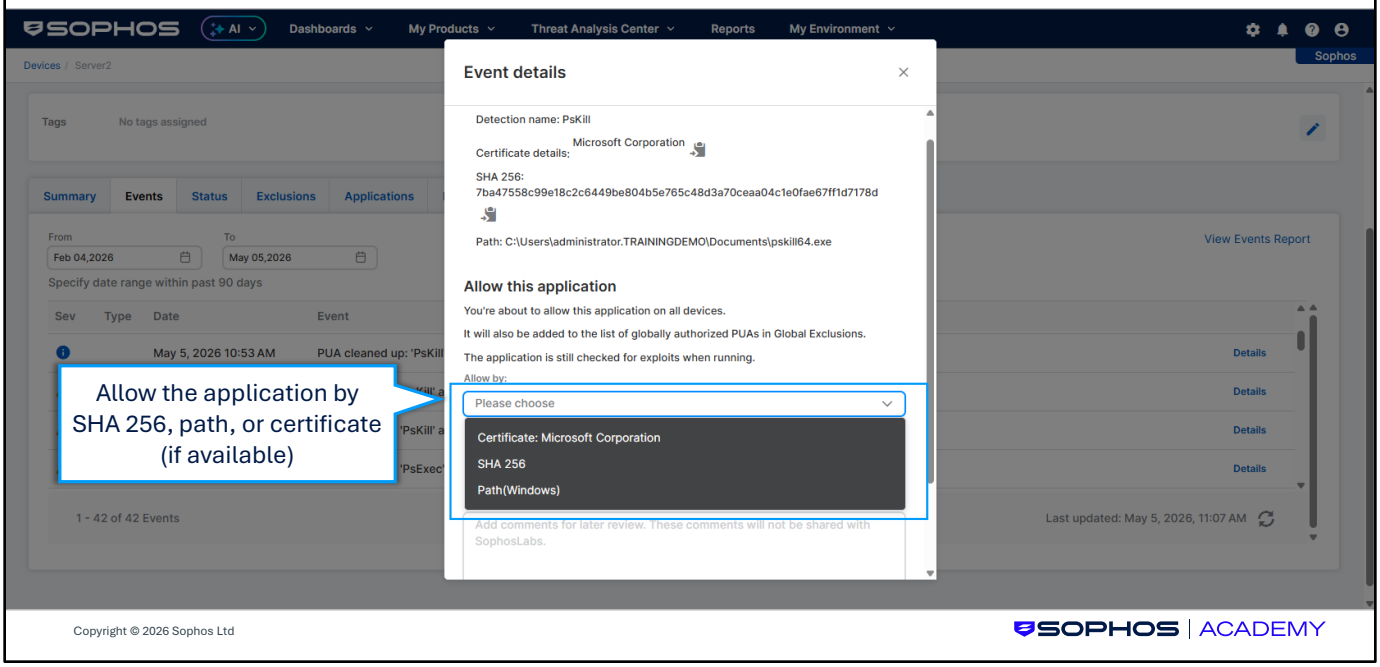
Allowed Applications



Alternatively, applications can be allowed following a detection.

On the device **EVENTS** tab, the detection event for the application will be logged. Click **Details** to allow the application.

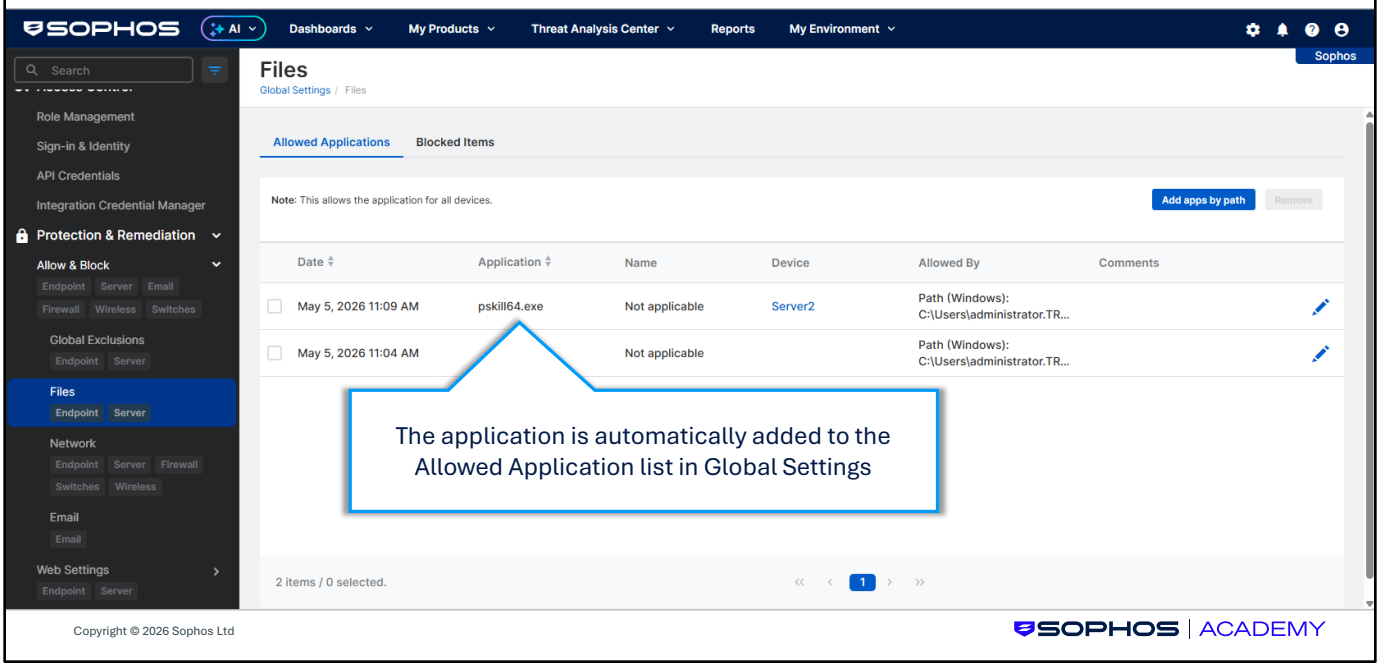
Allowed Applications



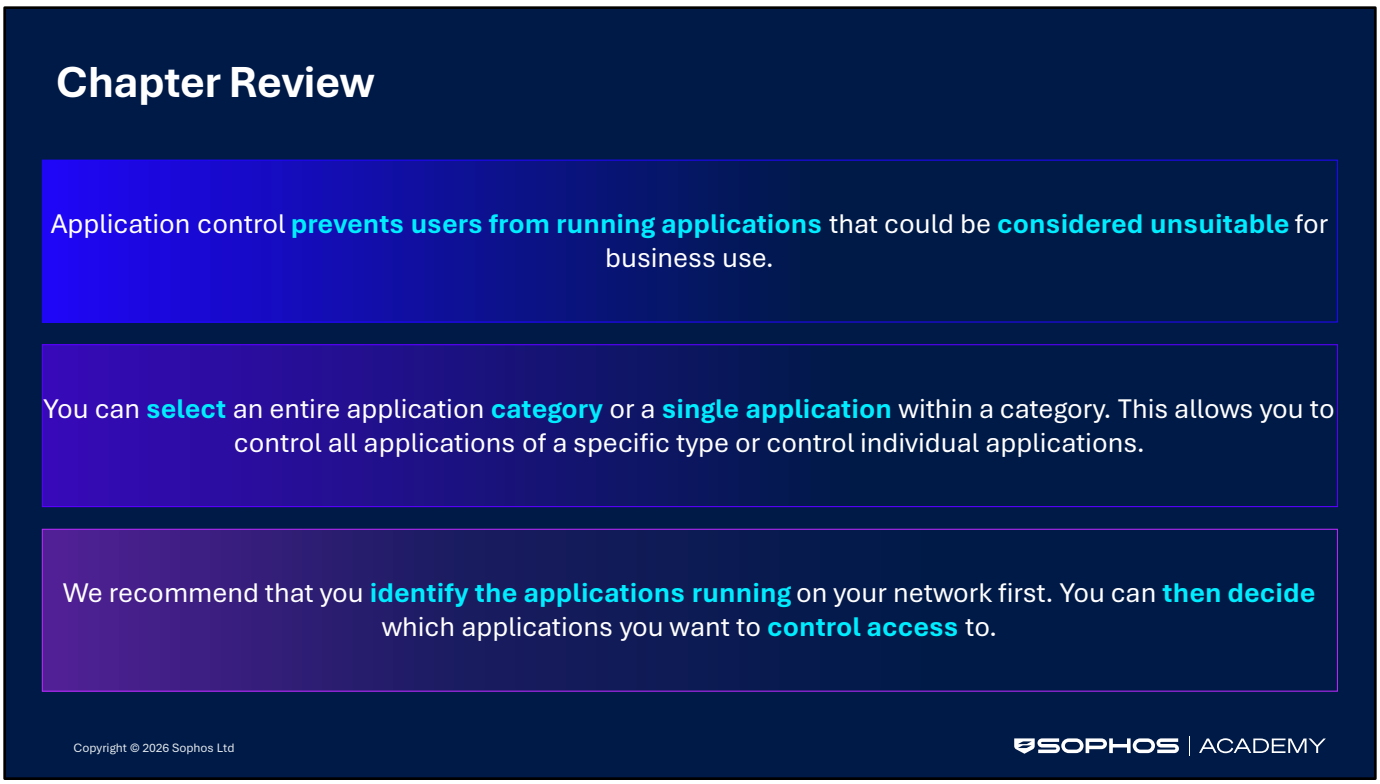
The event details display the detection data. You can allow the application by using the SHA-256, the certificate (if it is available), or the file path.

You can also indicate why you want to allow the application and add any comments explaining why the application is being allowed.

Allowed Applications



The application is automatically added to the ‘Allowed Applications’ list in Global Settings.



Here are the three main things you learned in this chapter.

Application control prevents users from running applications that could be considered unsuitable for business use.

You can select an entire application category or a single application within a category. This allows you to control all applications of a specific type or control individual application.

We recommend that you identify the applications running on your network first. You can then decide which applications you want to control access to.

[Additional Information]

Sophos Endpoint
EP3525: Getting Started with the Web Control Policy

May 2026

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Getting Started with the Web Control Policy

In this chapter, you'll learn how website access can be controlled using the web control policy.

RECOMMENDED KNOWLEDGE AND EXPERIENCE

- ✓ How to access and navigate Sophos Central
- ✓ How to protect and manage devices
- ✓ How to assign policies

DURATION: 10 minutes

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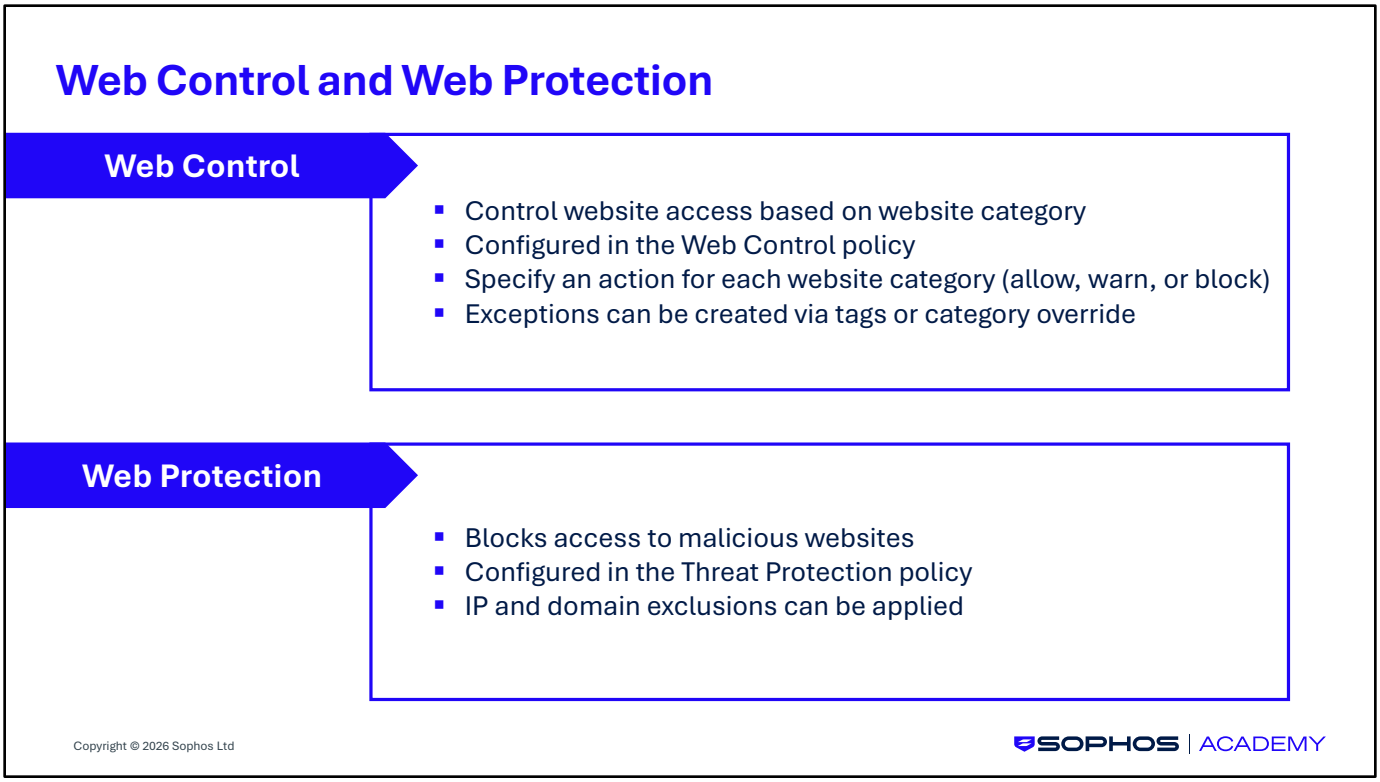
In this chapter, you'll learn how website access can be controlled using the web control policy.

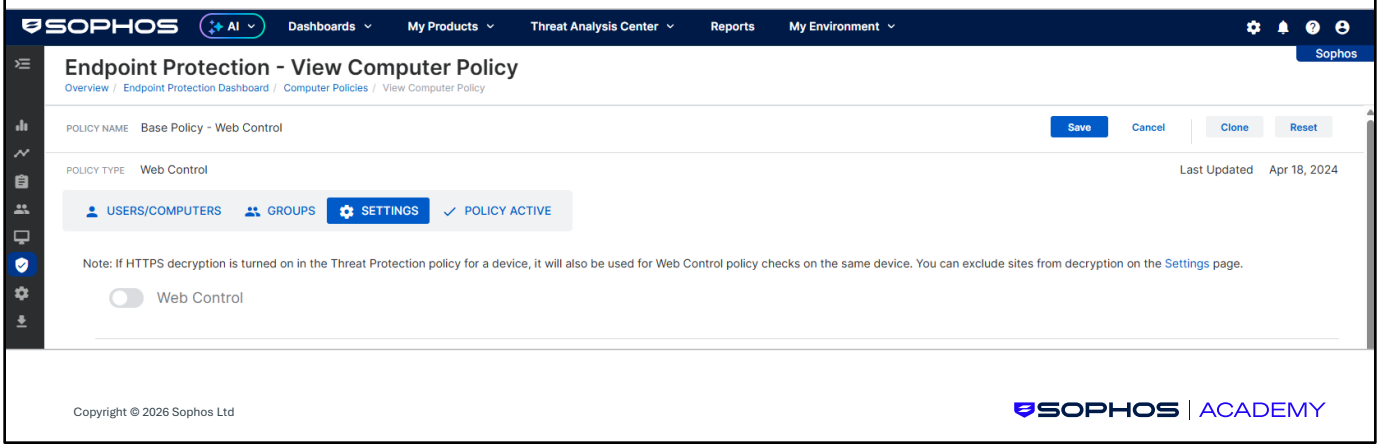


There are two types of protection for devices accessing internet resources. These are web control and web protection.

Web control can allow, warn, or block websites based on their category and is configured in the web control policy, whilst web protection blocks access to malicious websites. This setting is enabled by default and can be found in the threat protection policy.

Web Control Policy

- Used to define which website categories can be accessed
- Control access to inappropriate websites
- Assists with compliance and liability coverage



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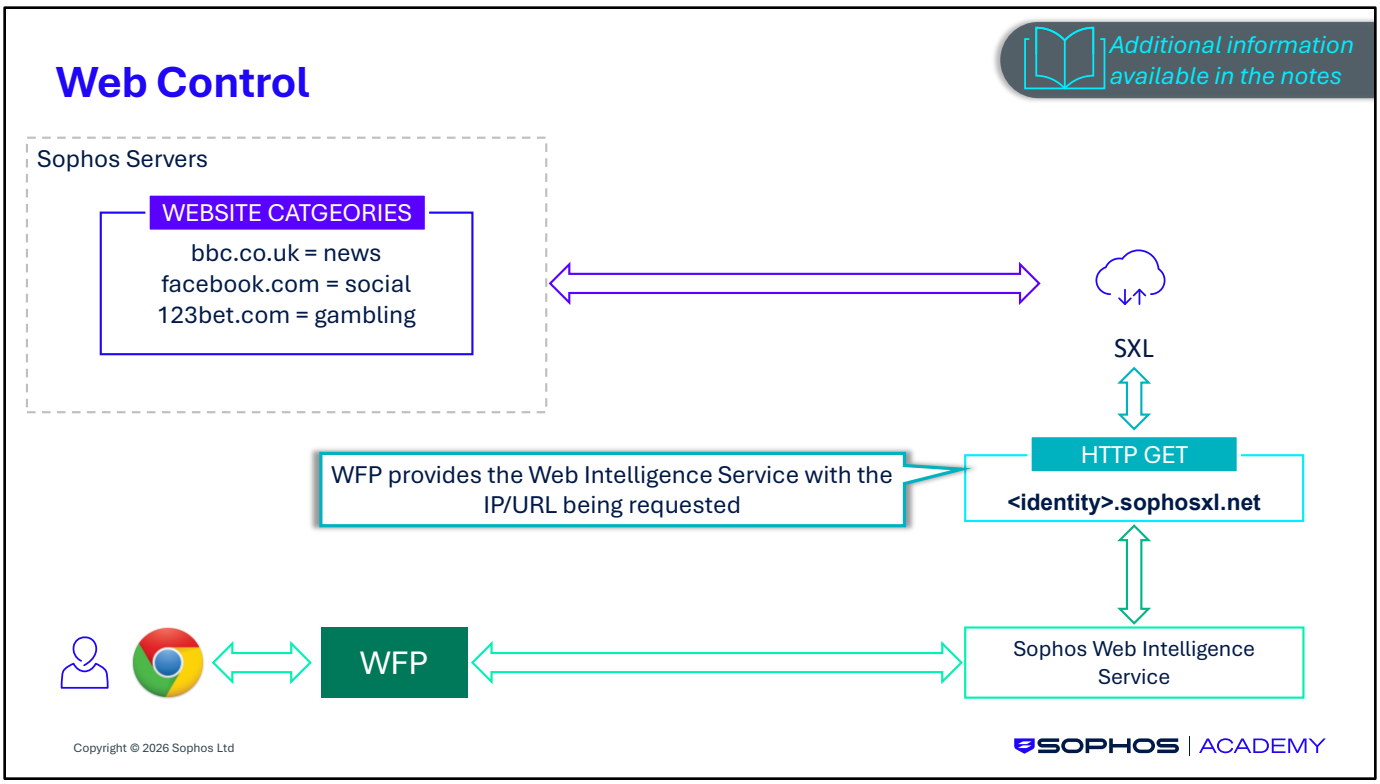
The web control policy is used to define which categories of websites can be accessed.

This allows you to control access to inappropriate websites and assists with compliance and liability coverage for inappropriate web browsing.

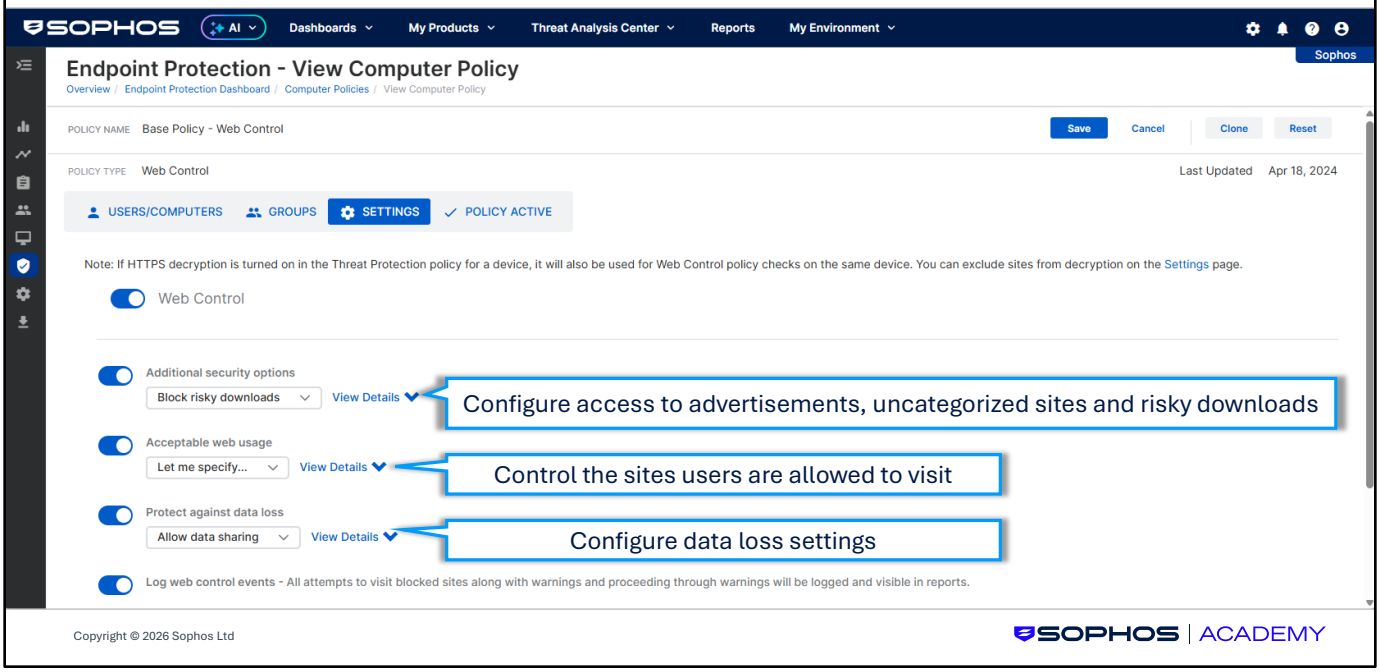


Web control is one of several components that use the Windows Filtering Platform (WFP) to integrate with networking applications such as internet browsers. Web control uses HTTP to contact the WFP. The information provided is used to perform SXL lookups to determine the category of a website. Web control utilizes Sophos Extensible List (SXL) lookups to provide the latest protection. The main purpose of SXL is to extend the protection offered on the endpoint by providing access to a wider amount of detection data and information when needed. It will allow lookups against live data using a checksum.

This diagram shows this in action: first, a user attempts to open a web page, in this example using the Chrome browser. WFP grabs the URL or IP address being requested. Finally, the Sophos Web Intelligence service performs the SXL lookup, which checks the website category.

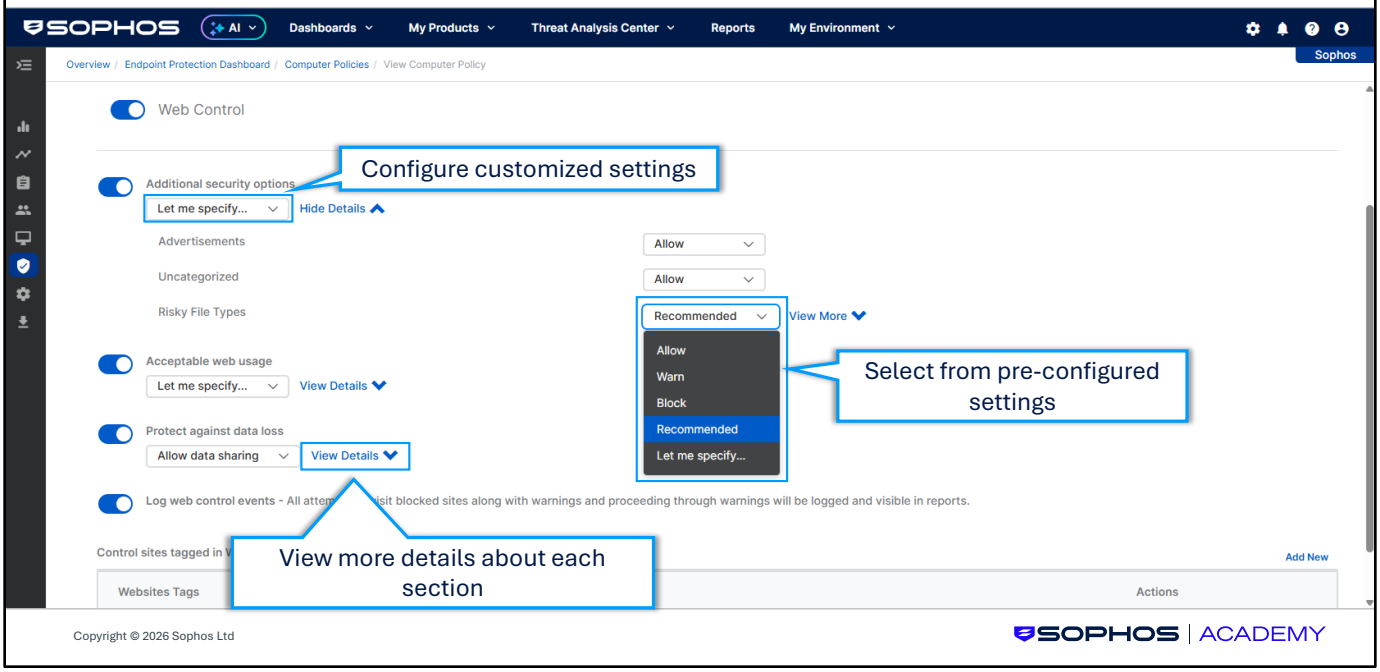
[Additional Information]
A full list of SXL lookup types can be found in Knowledgebase **KB-000034570**. Information about the Sophos Extensible List
https://support.sophos.com/support/s/article/KB-000034570

Web Control Policy



The web control policy is split into sections: Additional security options, which configure access to advertisements, uncategorized sites, and risky downloads. The acceptable web usage controls, which control the sites that users are allowed to visit. Lastly, the protect against data loss section, which is used to configure data loss settings.

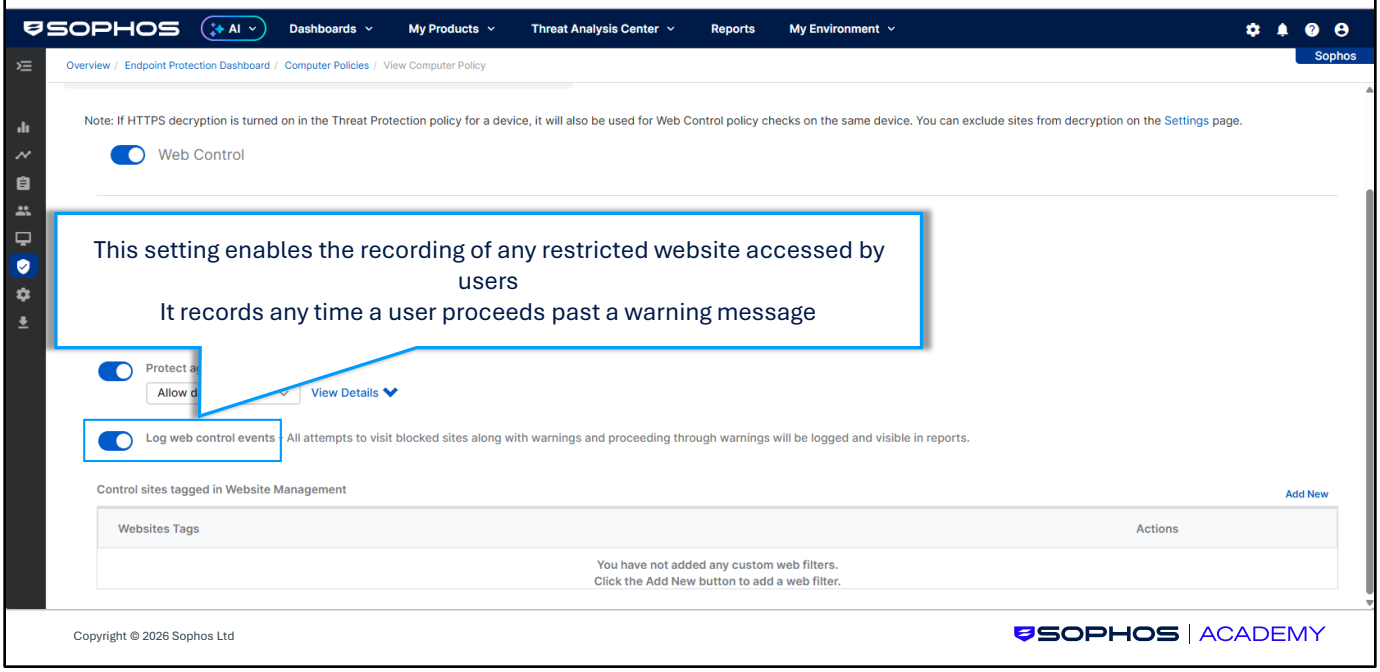
Web Control Policy



The policy settings are pre-configured; however, they can be changed to suit your requirements. To change the options, select "Let me specify" from the drop-down menu in each section.

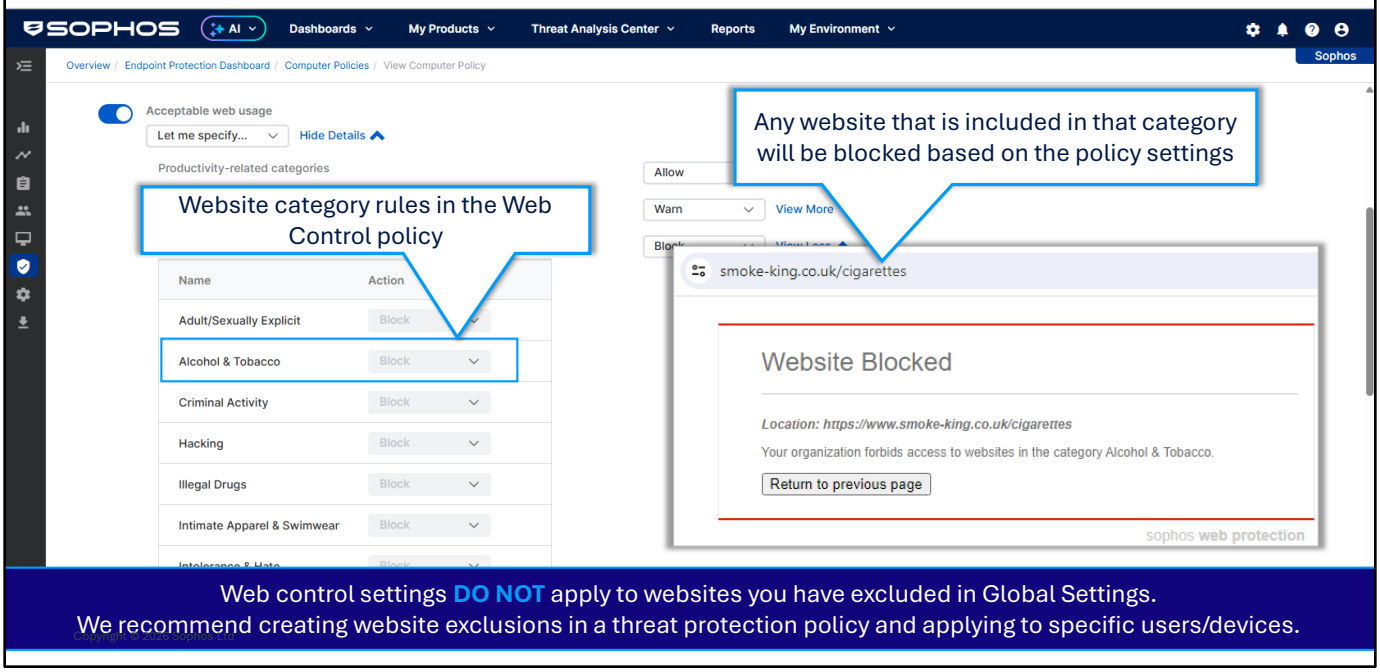
You can define the action to allow, warn, or block websites. Clicking the **View more** option will expand each section so you can view the website categories in more detail.

Web Control Policy



The option to log web control events records every time a user browses to a site that has been blocked. It'll also record whenever a user browses to a site with a warning control applied. This allows you to review the users who visit blocked or warned websites, and more importantly, when they proceed past the warning message to access the site.

Web Control Policy



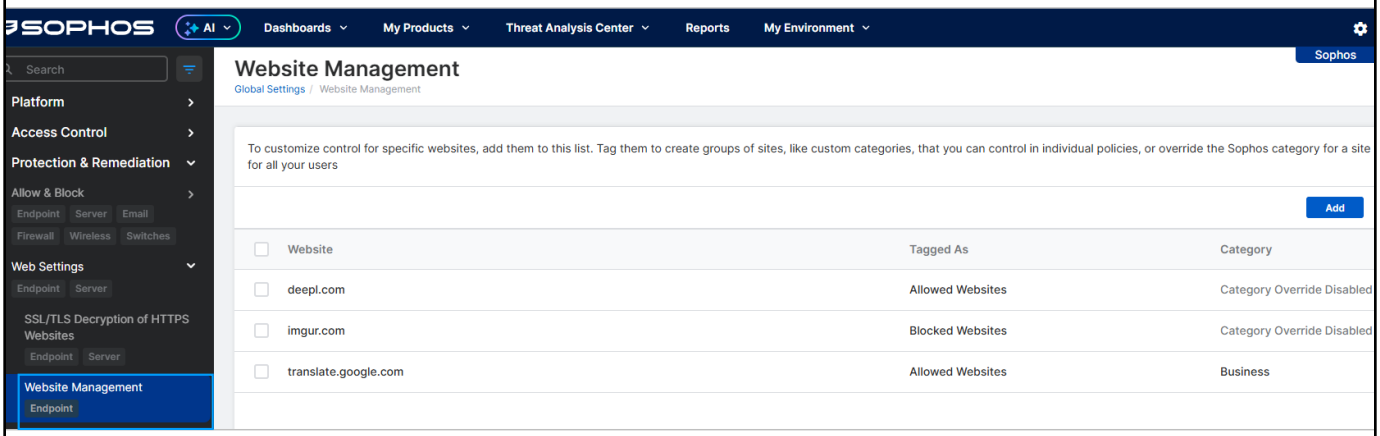
When a web control policy is applied, all websites accessed will be checked to confirm the website category. This is then compared to the policy settings, which will then either allow or block access to the site or warn the user about the site they are trying to access.

It is important to note that web control settings don't apply to websites you've excluded. When creating an exclusion for a website, create a policy exclusion in a threat protection policy.

Website Management

Global Settings > Website Management

- Website management is used to extend and customize website filtering



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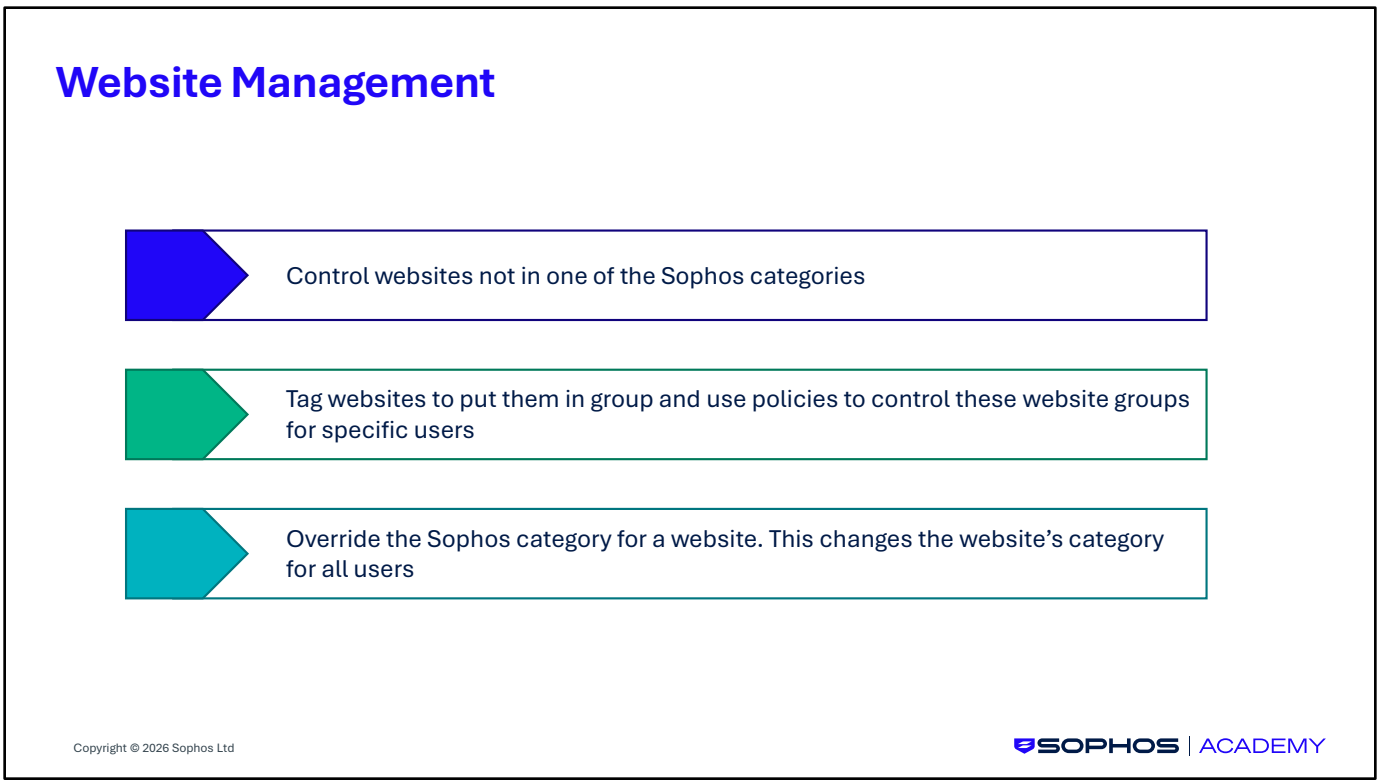
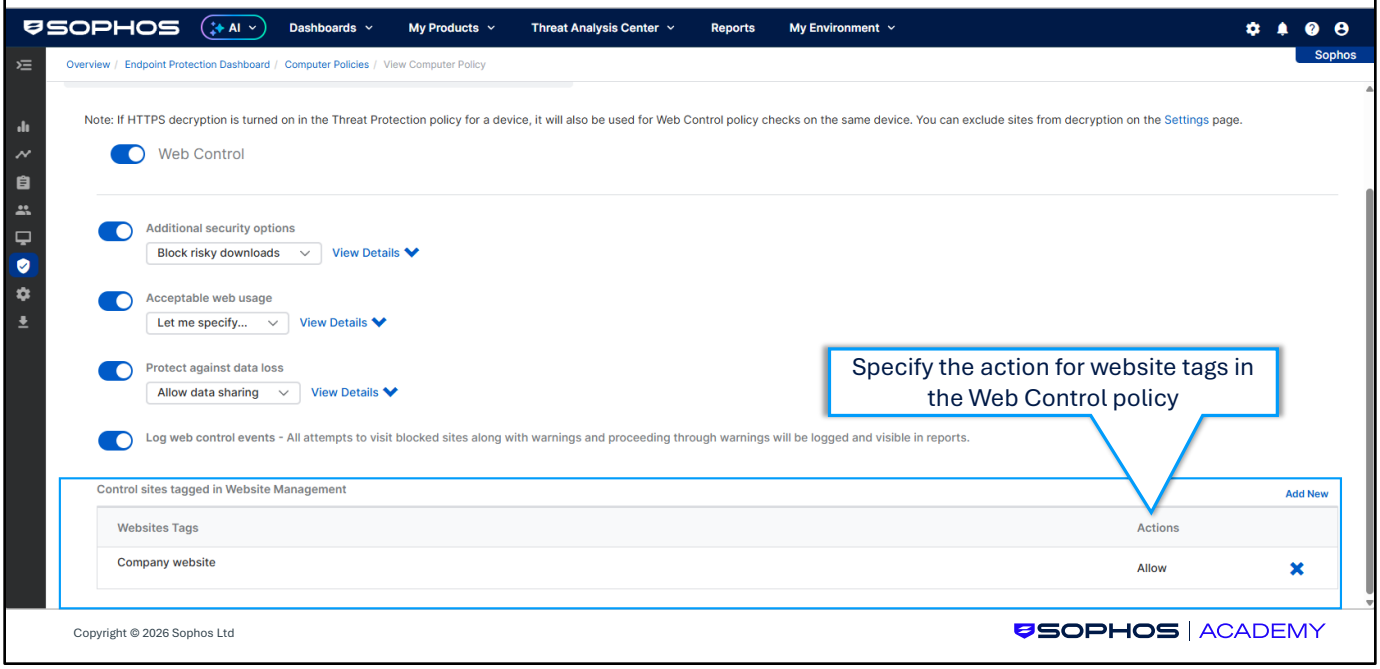
Website management is used to extend and customize website filtering.



You can use website management to control websites not in one of the Sophos categories, tag websites to put them in groups, which are like custom categories. You can then use policies to control these websites for certain users. You can also use them to override the Sophos category for a site. This changes that site's category for all your users.

If you think Sophos has put a website in the wrong category, you can request that Sophos change the category. We recommend that you submit a change request rather than overriding the category.

Website Management



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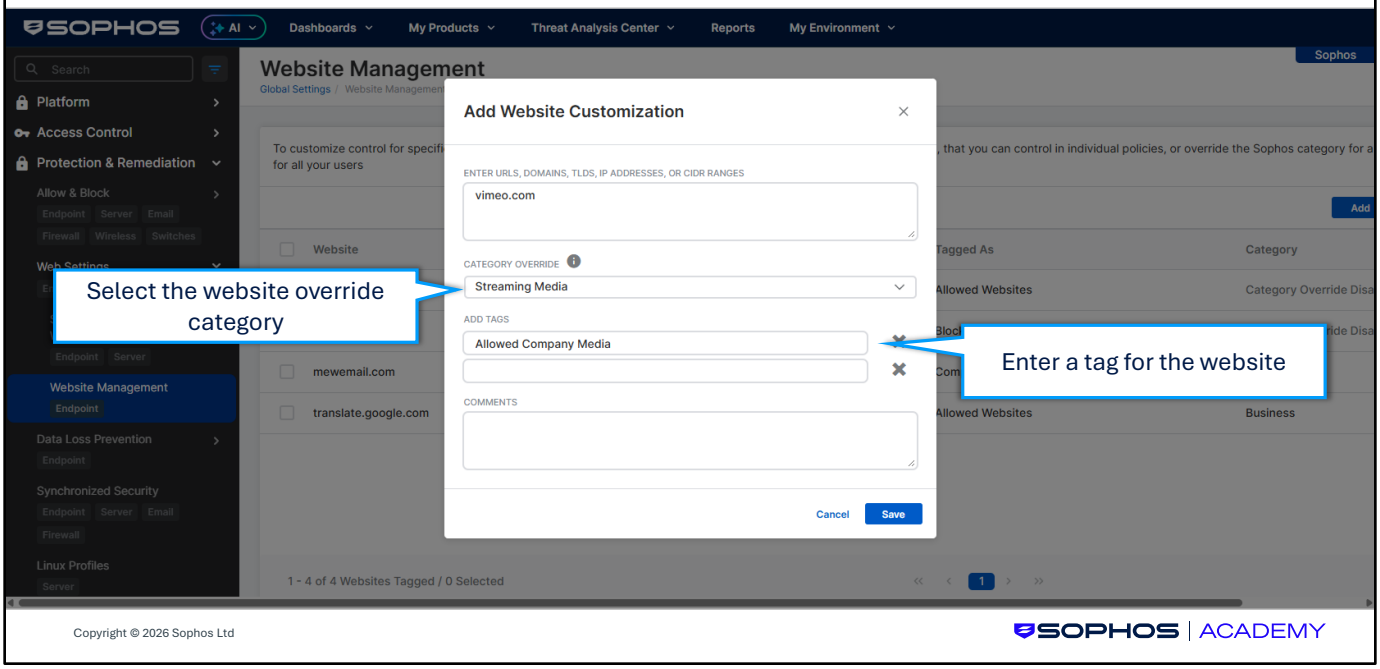
You can create a tag for a website and specify the action for that website tag in the web control policy. This will allow access to the specific website whilst still blocking the category it belongs to.

Let's look at how this works.

Website Management

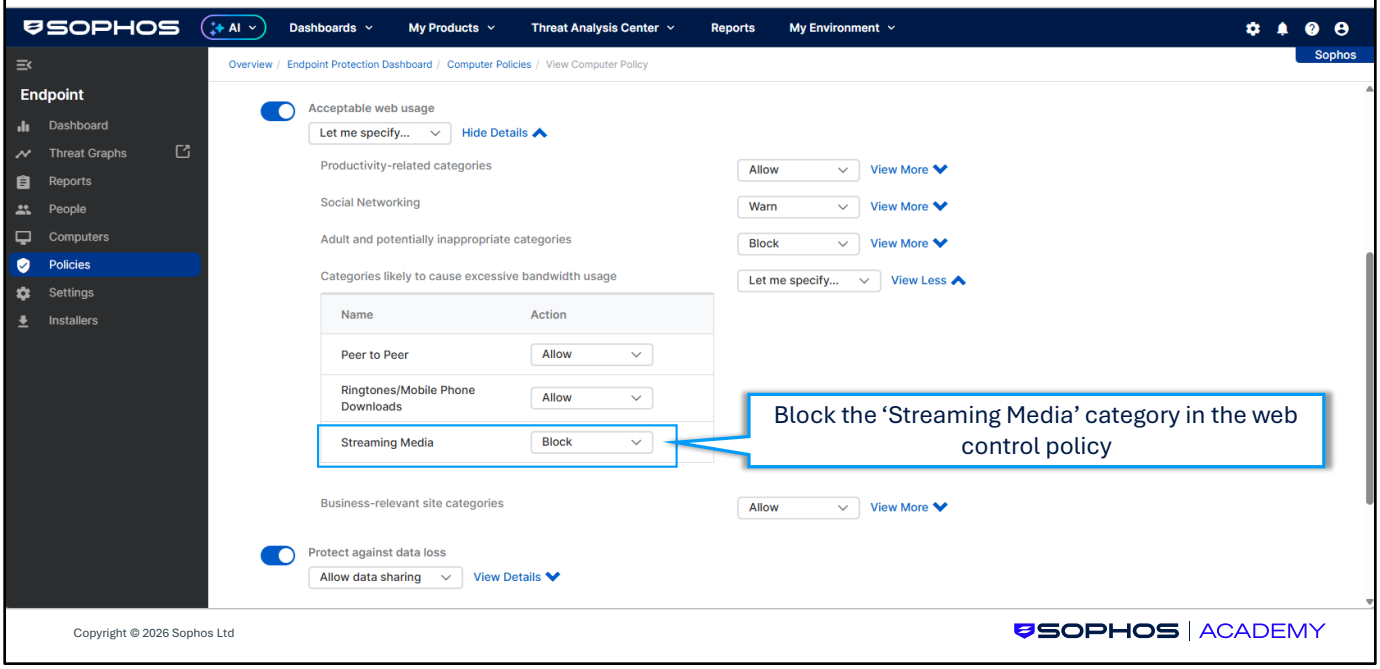


In this example, we will allow access to vimeo.com while blocking access to other websites in the streaming media category.

We start by adding the website to the website management list in Sophos Central. We add the website along with the override category, in this example, streaming media, and then give the website a new tag. In this example, 'Allowed company media'. It can be helpful to include information about tags created and categories overridden for troubleshooting policy issues in the future.

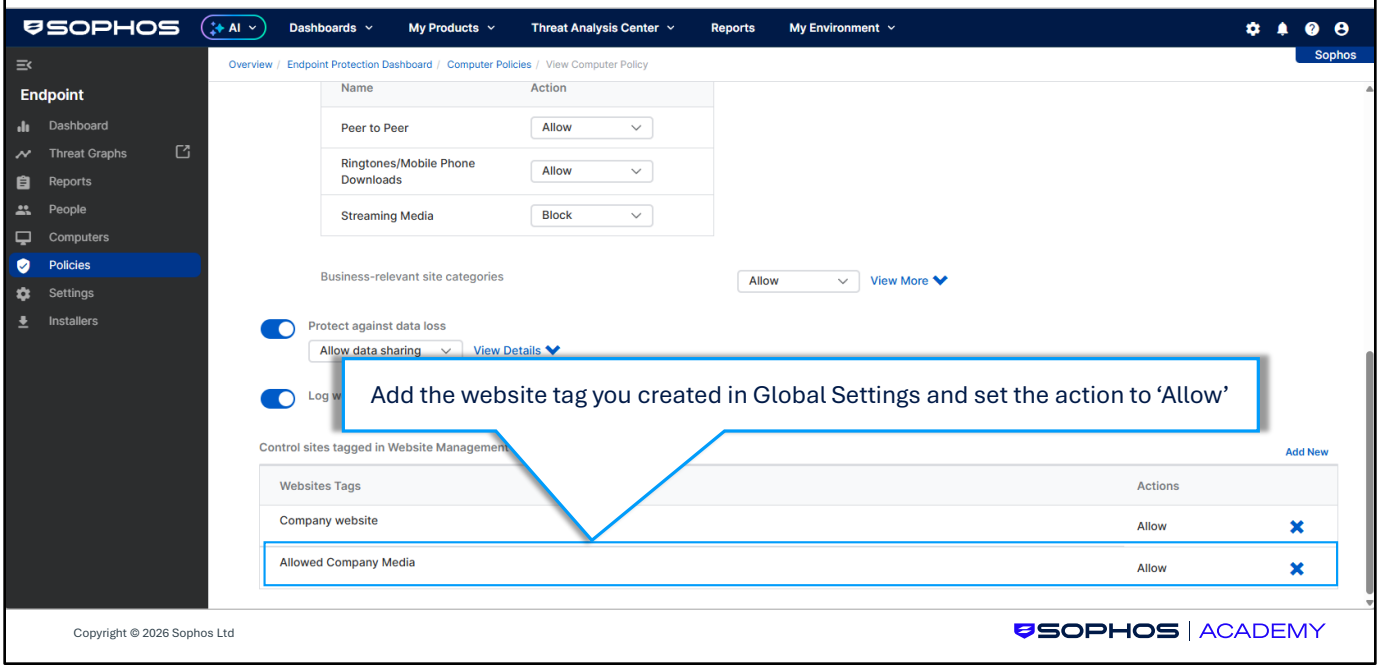
Note that entries in the website list can be single URLs, full domains, IP addresses, CIDR ranges, or even top-level domains. Managing websites using IP addresses only controls browser-based access. It does not block other applications or interact with rules for a local firewall.

Website Management



Next, set the action for the streaming media category to block in the web control policy.

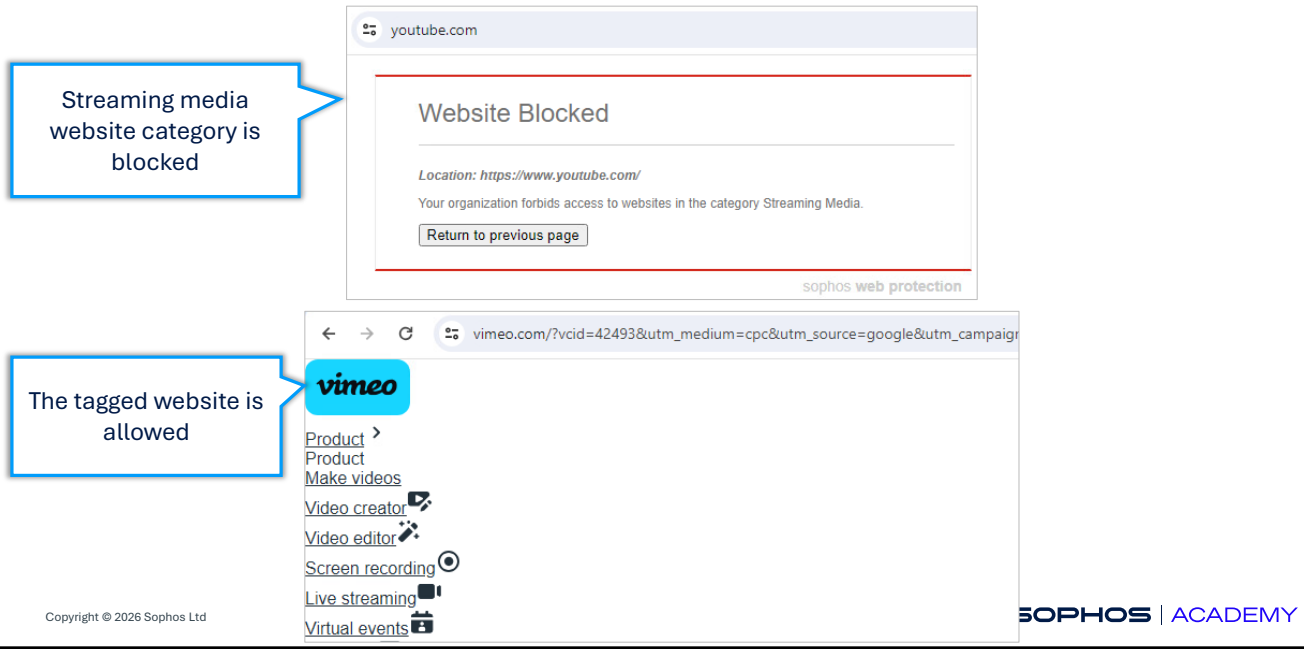
Website Management



In the 'Control sites tagged in Website Management' section, click **Add New** and select the 'WEBSITE TAG' you created from the drop-down menu and select an 'action'.

In this example, we set the action to **Allow**.

Website Management



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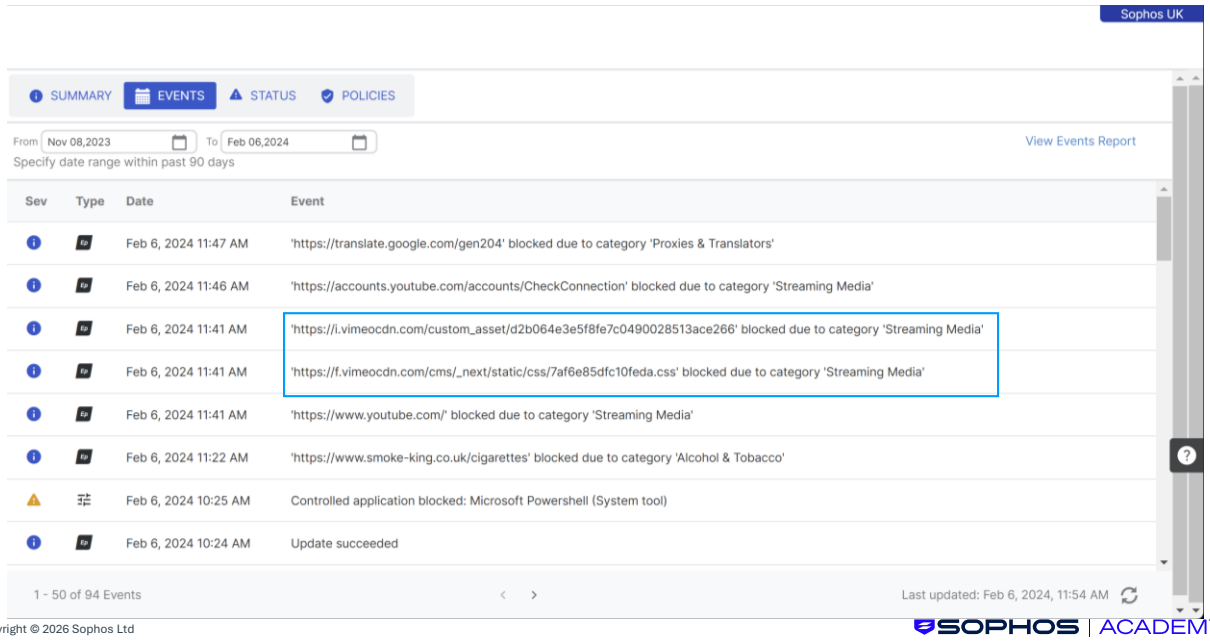
Once the policy has been applied to a protected device, when the user browses to a website categorized as streaming media, the site is blocked.

When the user browses to vimeo.com, the site is allowed. It might be necessary to add multiple website entries to allow the full functionality of the website.

Website Management



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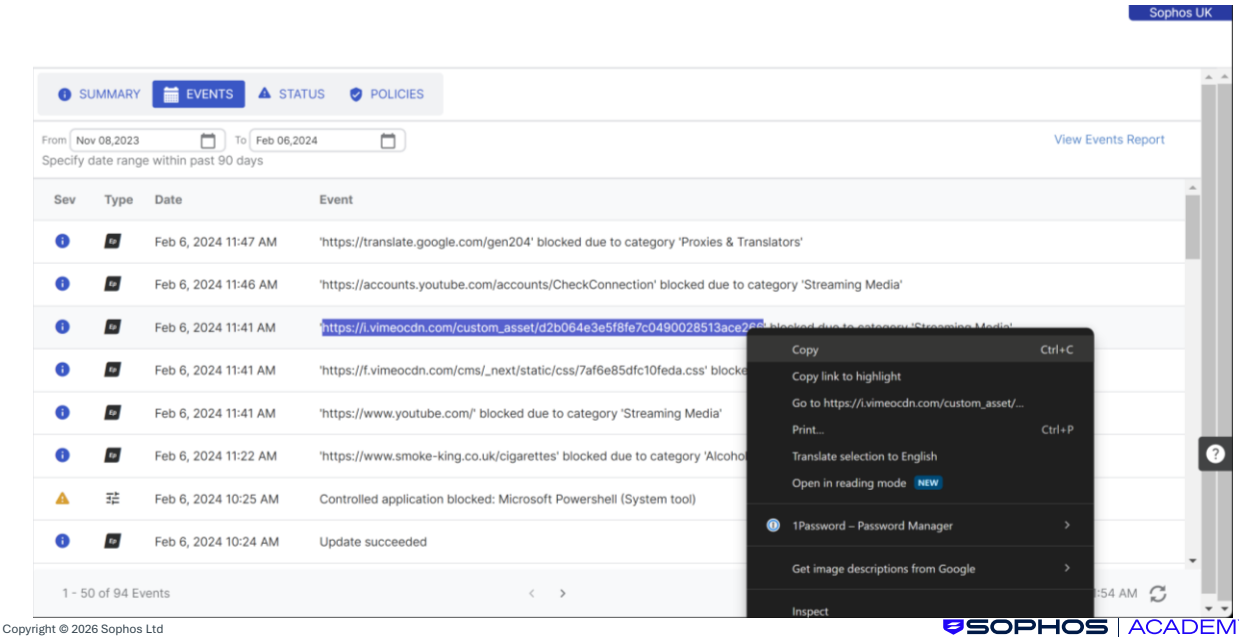
In Sophos Central, locate the device and select the **EVENTS** tab. The block events will be displayed.

Website Management



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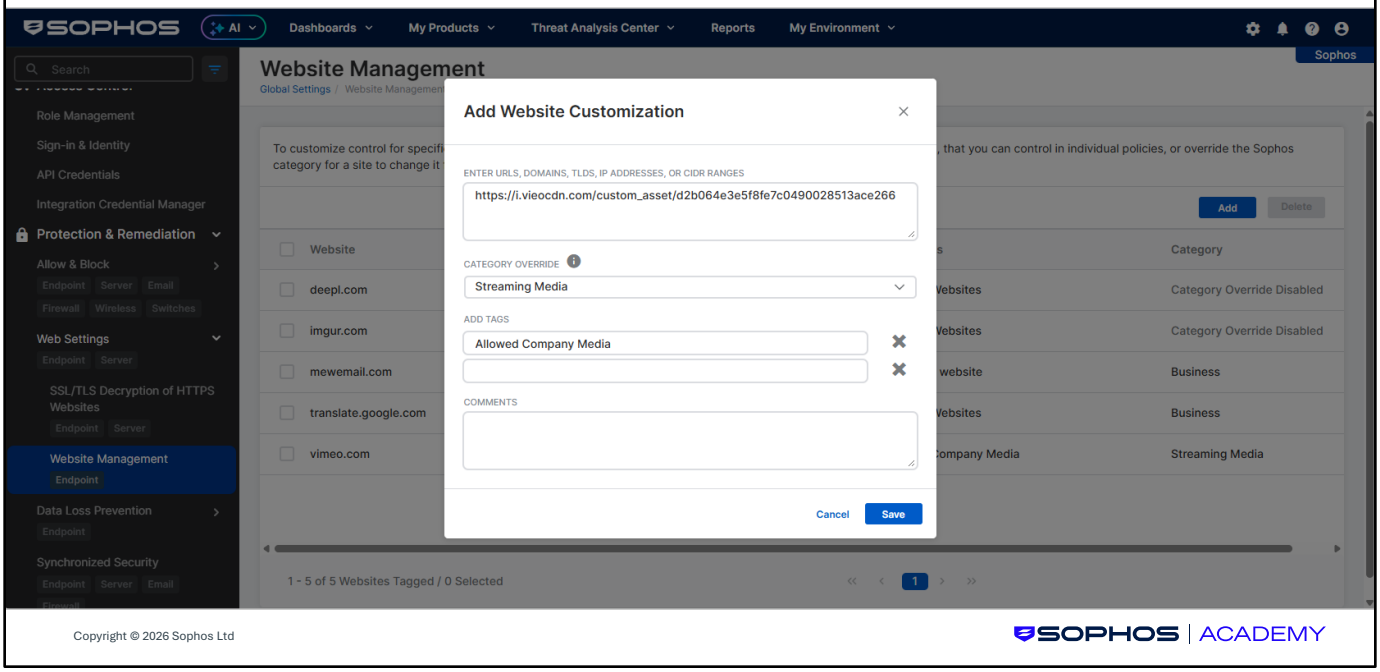
Select the website that is being blocked and copy it.

Website Management



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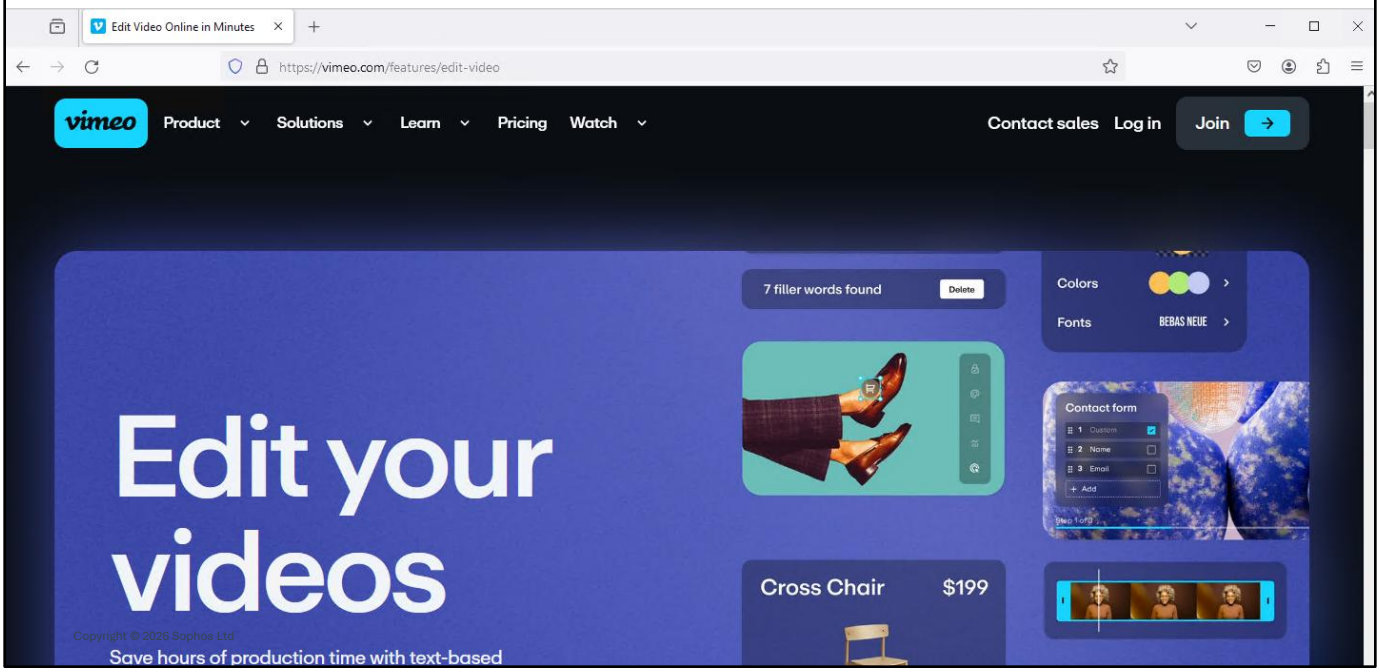
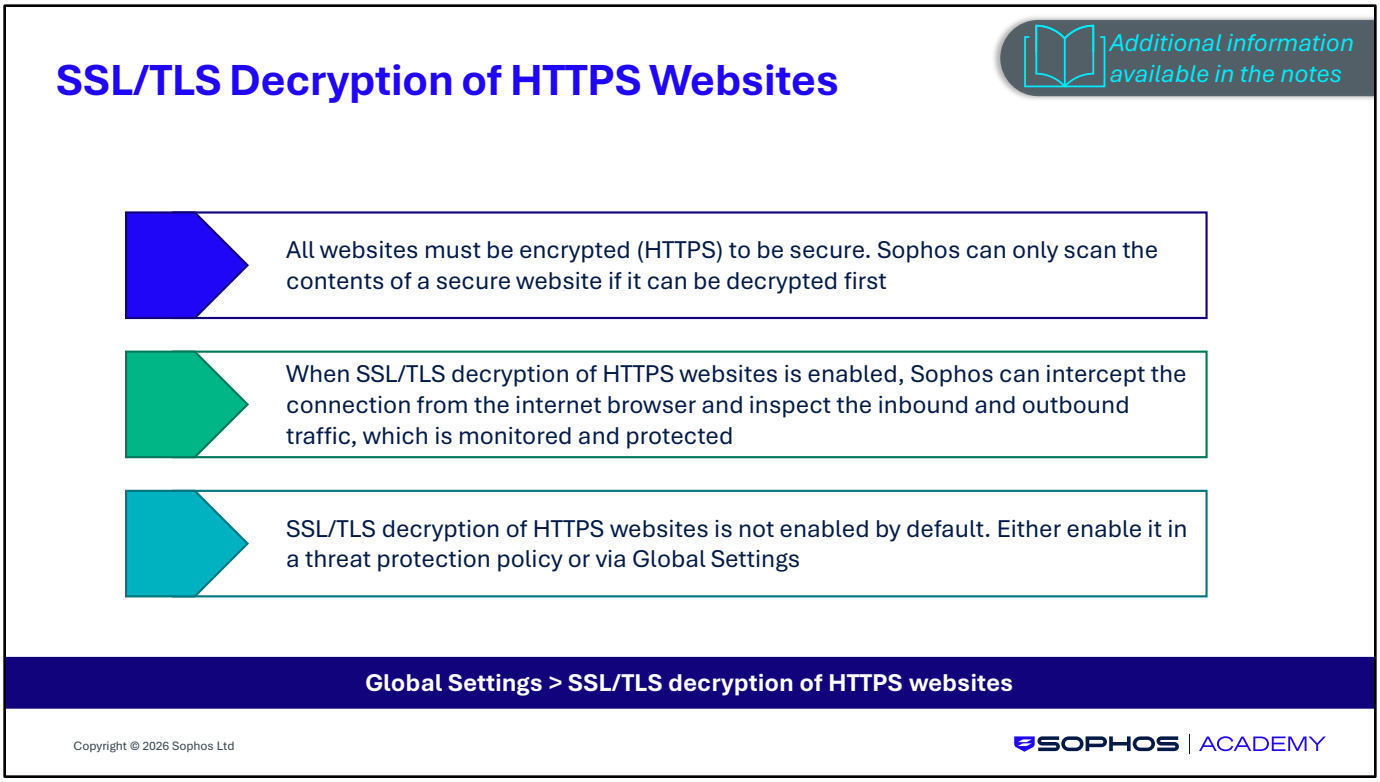
Add the URL as a new website entry. Ensure you use the same website tag you create for the initial website. In this example, Allowed Company Media.

Website Management



Once the policy has been applied to protected devices. The website page will load successfully.

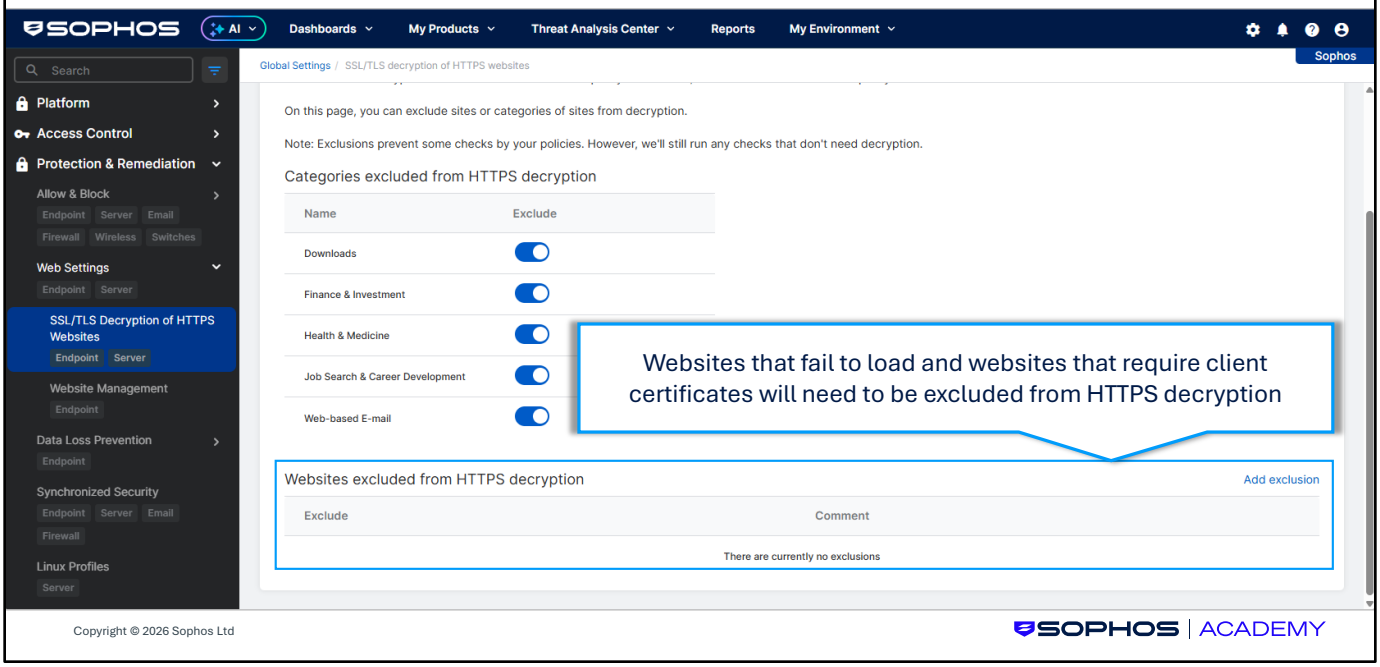


In modern web browsers, all sites must be HTTPS encrypted to be secure. It is only possible to scan the contents of a secure website if it can be decrypted first. SSL/ TLS decryption of HTTPS websites enables the scanning of IPv6 and HTTPS websites.

This works by intercepting the connection from an internet browser and inspecting both the inbound and outbound traffic, which is monitored and protected. HTTPS websites will not be scanned by default; this feature must be enabled either in a threat protection policy or via **Global Settings > SSL/TLS decryption of HTTPS Websites**. When this setting is enabled, it will enable HTTPS decryption for web protection and web control.

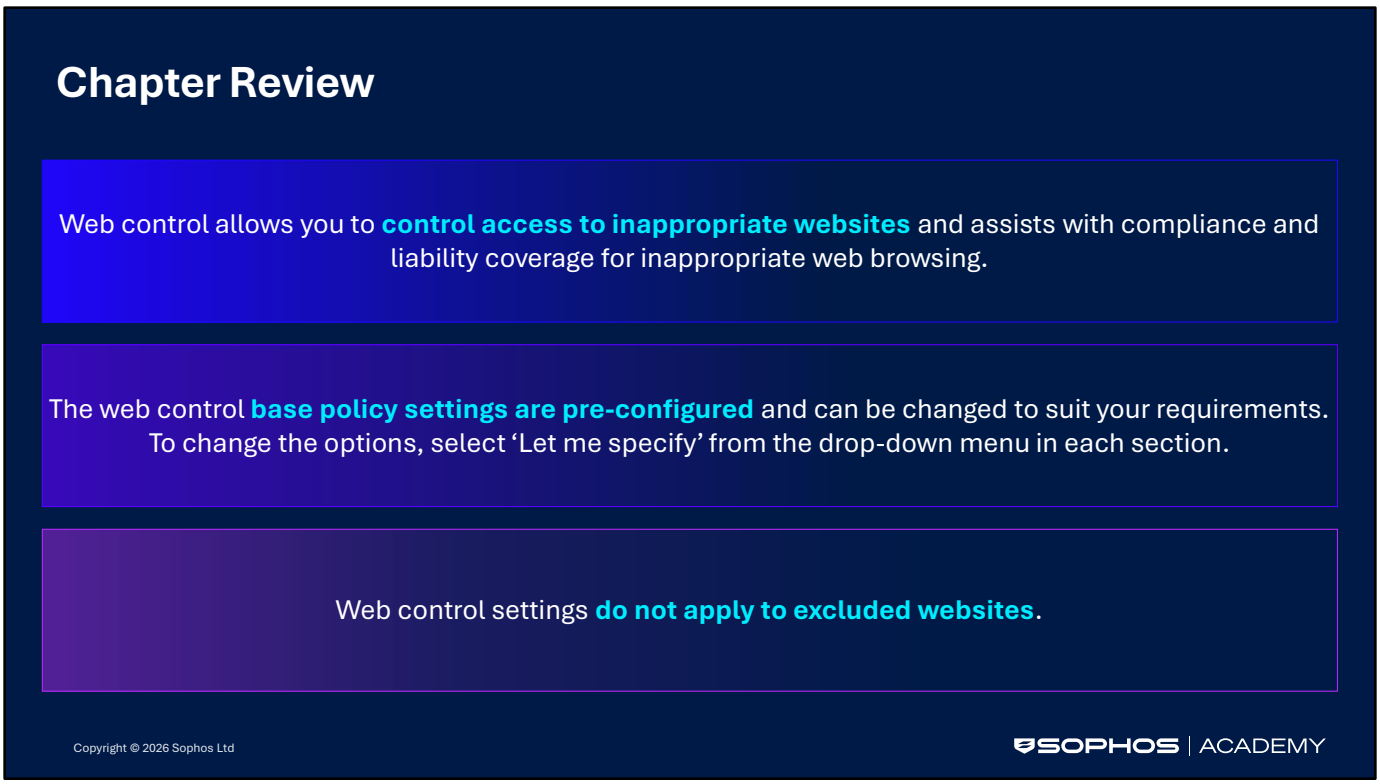
[Additional Information]
Further information about this setting can be found in the help here: SSL/TLS decryption of HTTPS websites - Sophos Central Admin
https://docs.sophos.com/central/Customer/help/en-us/ManageYourProducts/GlobalSettings/ProtectionRemediation/WebSettings/DecryptHTTPS/index.html

HTTPS Website Exclusions



Websites that fail to load and websites that require client certificates must be excluded from HTTPS decryption. These websites and website categories can be excluded in the global settings.

You can add domain names, IP addresses, or IP address ranges to be excluded by clicking **Add Exclusion** at the bottom right. Categories set to allow in the web control policy will also be added to categories excluded from HTTPS decryption. By adding a website exclusion, all subdomains will also be excluded from HTTPS decryption.



Here are the three main things you learned in this chapter.

Web control allows you to control access to inappropriate websites and assists with compliance and liability coverage for inappropriate web browsing.

The web control base policy settings are pre-configured and can be changed to suit your requirements. To change the options, select '**Let me specify'** from the drop-down menu in each section.

Web control settings do not apply to excluded websites.

[Additional Information]

Sophos Endpoint
EP3535: Getting Started with the Data Loss Prevention Policy

May 2026

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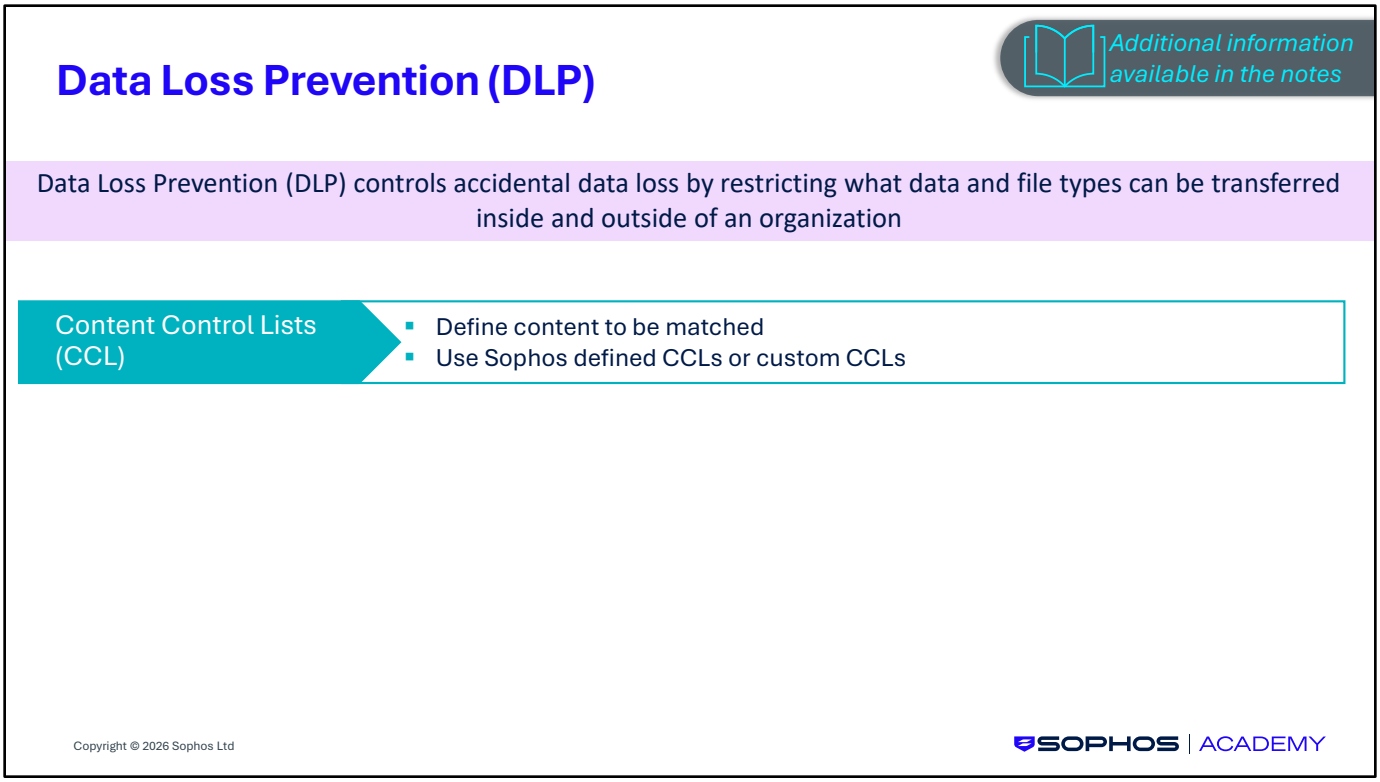
In this chapter, you'll learn how Sophos Endpoint helps to protect against data loss. You'll learn how to apply content control lists, rules, and pre-configured templates in the data loss prevention policy.



Data loss prevention (DLP) controls accidental data loss by restricting what data and file types can be transferred inside and outside of an organization. For example, it prevents a user from sending sensitive data outside of an organization.

DLP achieves this by using Content Control Lists (CCLs) , which are a set of conditions that describe file content.

[Additional Information]
For more information about the limitations of DLP, see Knowledge base article **KB-000033860**. Sophos Endpoint: Known limitations with data loss prevention (DLP)
https://support.sophos.com/support/s/article/KB-000033860

Data Loss Prevention (DLP)

Data Loss Prevention (DLP) controls accidental data loss by restricting what data and file types can be transferred inside and outside of an organization

Content Control Lists (CCL)	▪ Define content to be matched ▪ Use Sophos defined CCLs or custom CCLs
Rules	▪ **File** rule: match against a file name or file type ▪ **Content** rule: match against a CCL

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A CCL can contain file and content rules to determine what type of data can be transferred. These rules are applied to protected devices through the DLP policy.

Data Loss Prevention (DLP)

Data Loss Prevention (DLP) controls accidental data loss by restricting what data and file types can be transferred inside and outside of an organization

Content Control Lists (CCL)	▪ Define content to be matched ▪ Use Sophos defined CCLs or custom CCLs
Rules	▪ **File** rule: match against a file name or file type ▪ **Content** rule: match against a CCL
Destination	▪ Removable storage devices ▪ Applications, Internet browsers, email clients etc.

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DLP allows you to specify how sensitive data can be transferred.

Data Loss Prevention (DLP)

Data Loss Prevention (DLP) controls accidental data loss by restricting what data and file types can be transferred inside and outside of an organization

Content Control Lists (CCL)	▪ Define content to be matched ▪ Use Sophos defined CCLs or custom CCLs
Rules	▪ **File** rule: match against a file name or file type ▪ **Content** rule: match against a CCL
Destination	▪ Removable storage devices ▪ Applications, Internet browsers, email clients etc.
Action	▪ Allow or block transfer ▪ Allow transfer if user confirms

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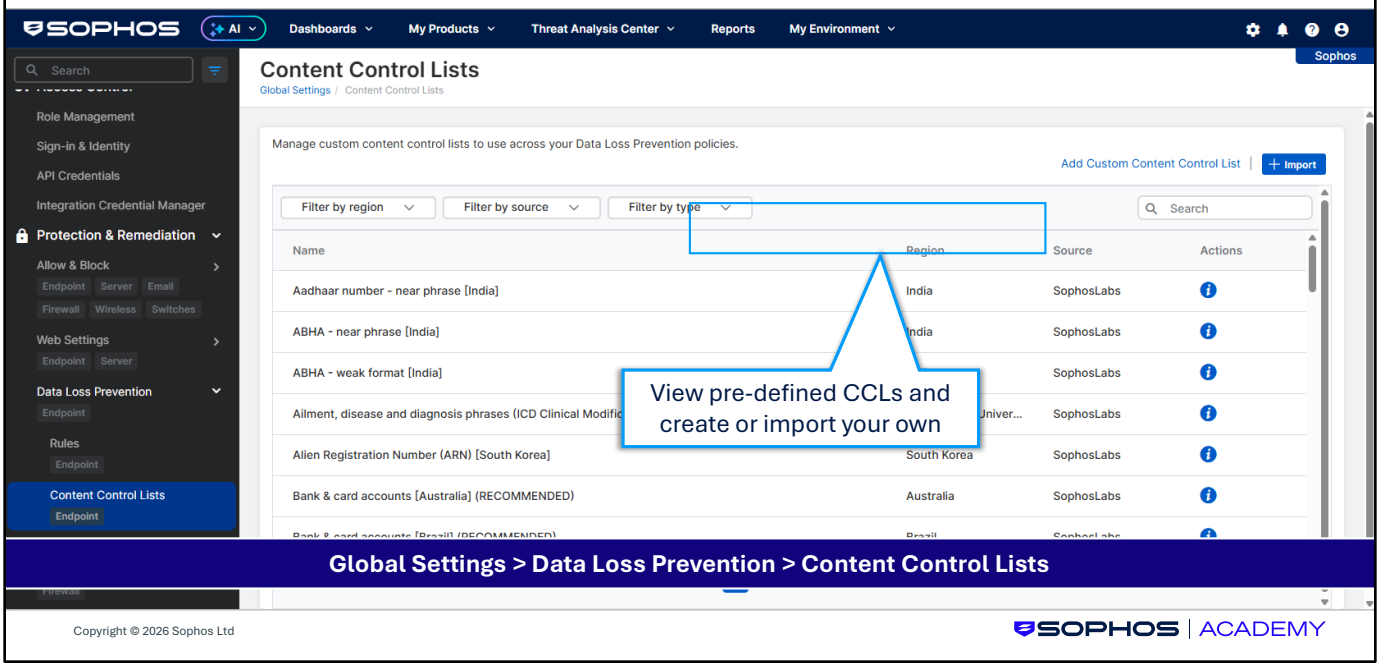
…and what action to take if the rule is violated. Please note that DLP will not work with encrypted data unless the application process is trusted by the encryption software to give visibility.

Content Control Lists (CCLs)

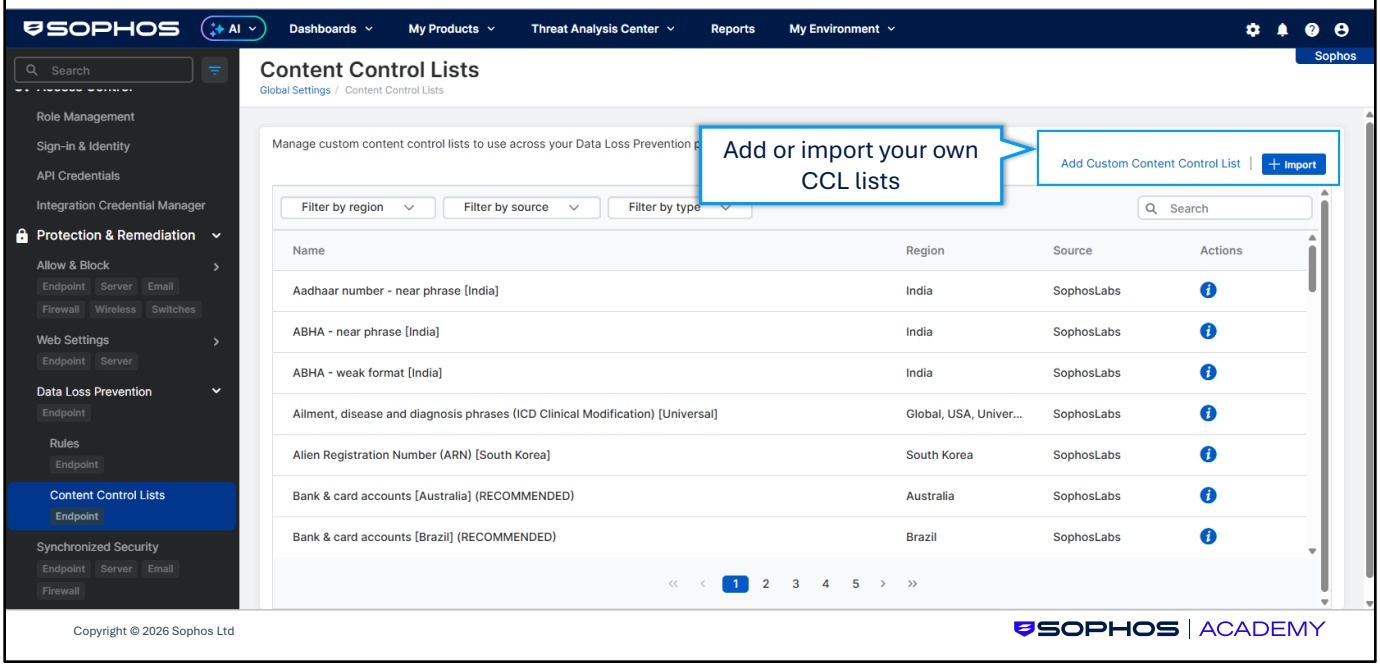


A Content Control List can describe a single data type, for example, a postal address or a social security number. Alternatively, it can contain a combination of data types.

SophosLabs provides a set of Content Control List definitions for common financial and personally identifiable data types, for example, credit card numbers or email addresses. Advanced techniques, such as checksums, are used in SophosLabs CCLs to increase the accuracy of sensitive data detection.

Content Control Lists can be found by navigating to **Global Settings**. In the Protection & Remediation section, select **Data Loss Prevention > Content Control Lists**.

Content Control Lists (CCLs)

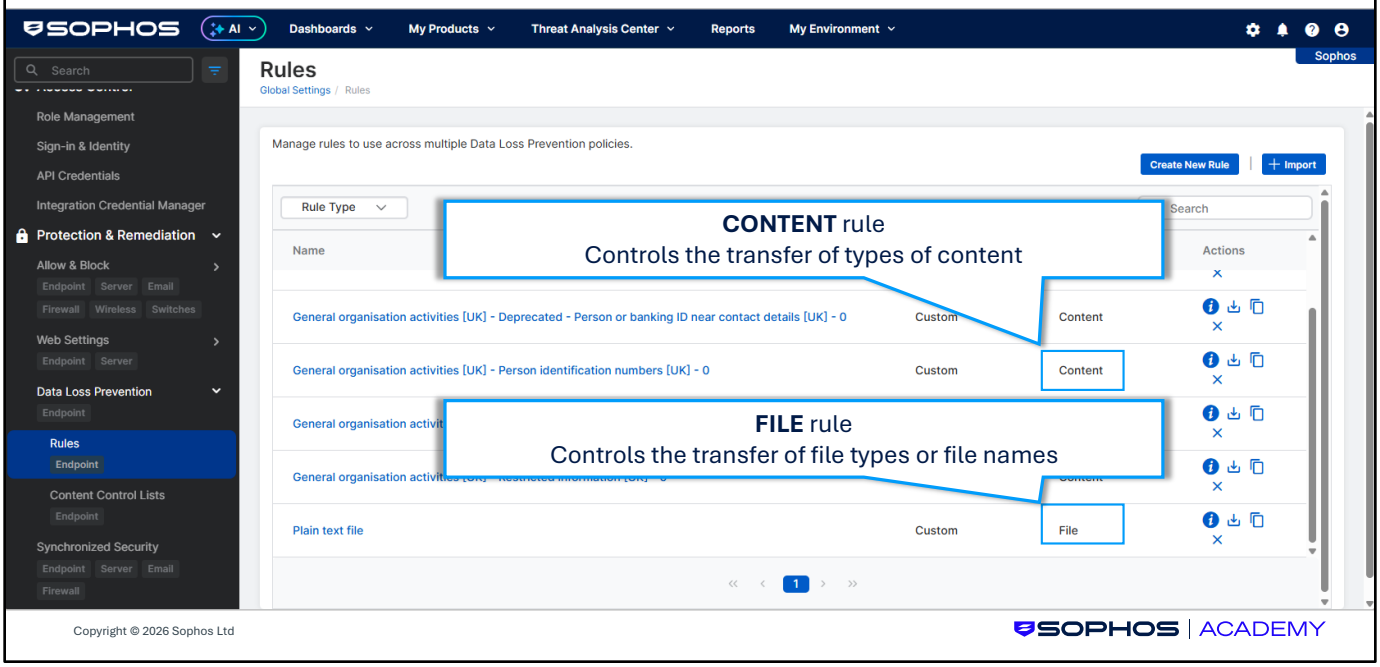


The CCLs defined by SophosLabs cannot be edited; however, you can submit a request to Sophos for a new CCL or to provide feedback on existing CCLs.

To view a description of each list, hover over the information icon. The Content Control List can be filtered by region, source, or type.

You can add your own Content Control List by creating a new custom list or by importing a list.

Data Loss Prevention Rules

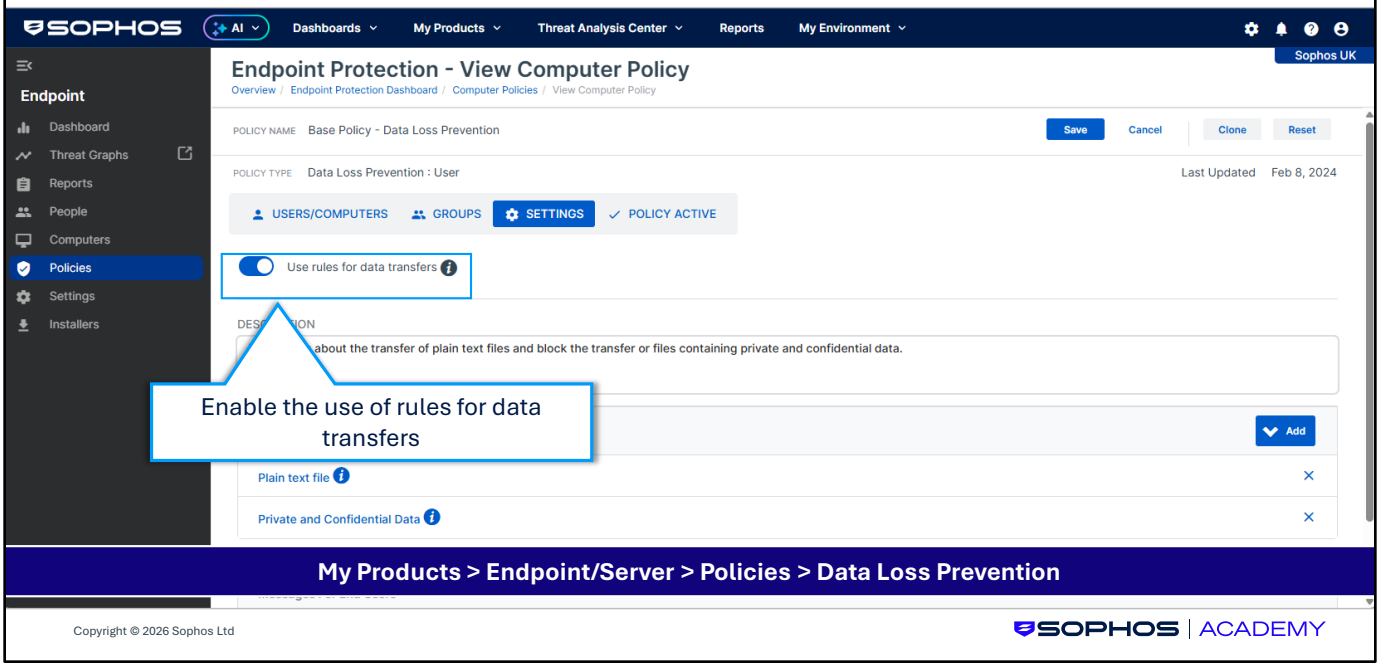


Rules define the action taken when a user interacts with a specific data type. They can be added and managed via **Global Settings > Rules**.

A content rule is a rule that controls the transfer of certain types of data, whereas a file rule controls the transfer of certain file types or file names.

Rules can also be added when a custom CCL is created and when a DLP policy is configured.

Data Loss Prevention Policy



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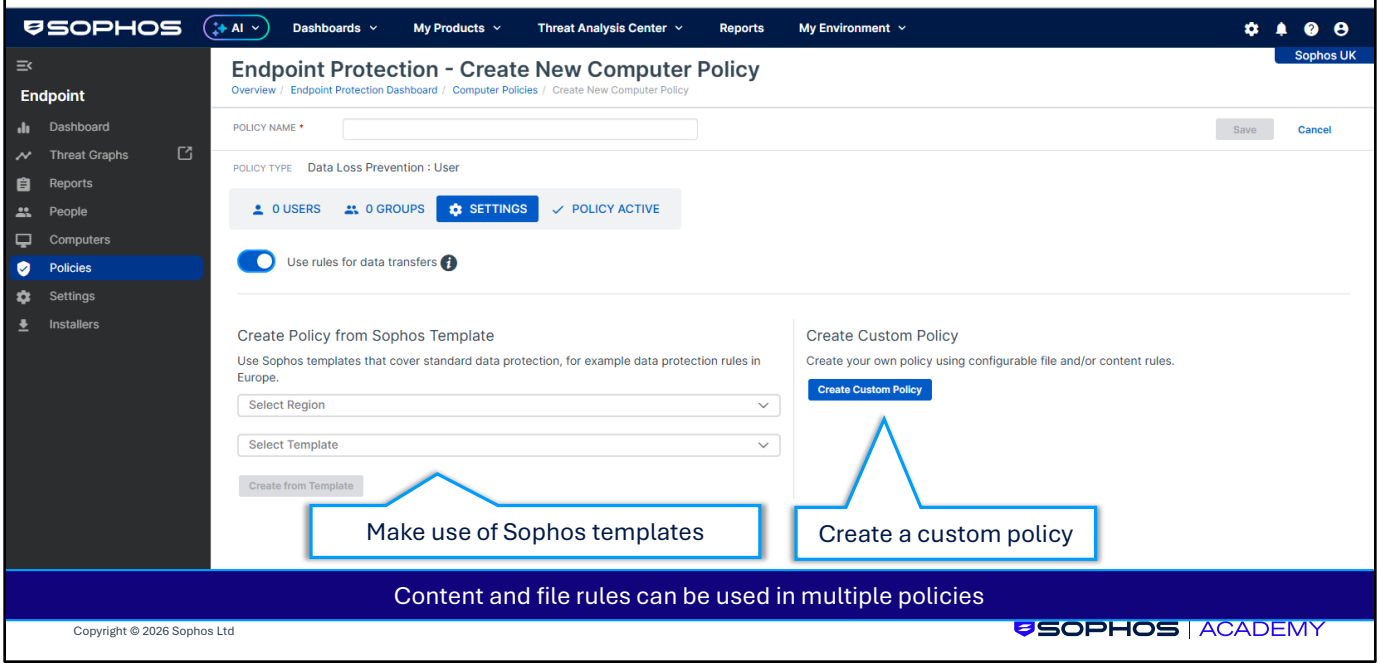
The Data Loss Prevention policy uses CCLs, content, and file rules to define a set of conditions that specify what data is allowed to be transferred both internally and outside of an organization.

The DLP policy is not enabled by default, enable the ‘Use rules for data transfers’ option to start configuring the policy.

Data Loss Prevention Policy

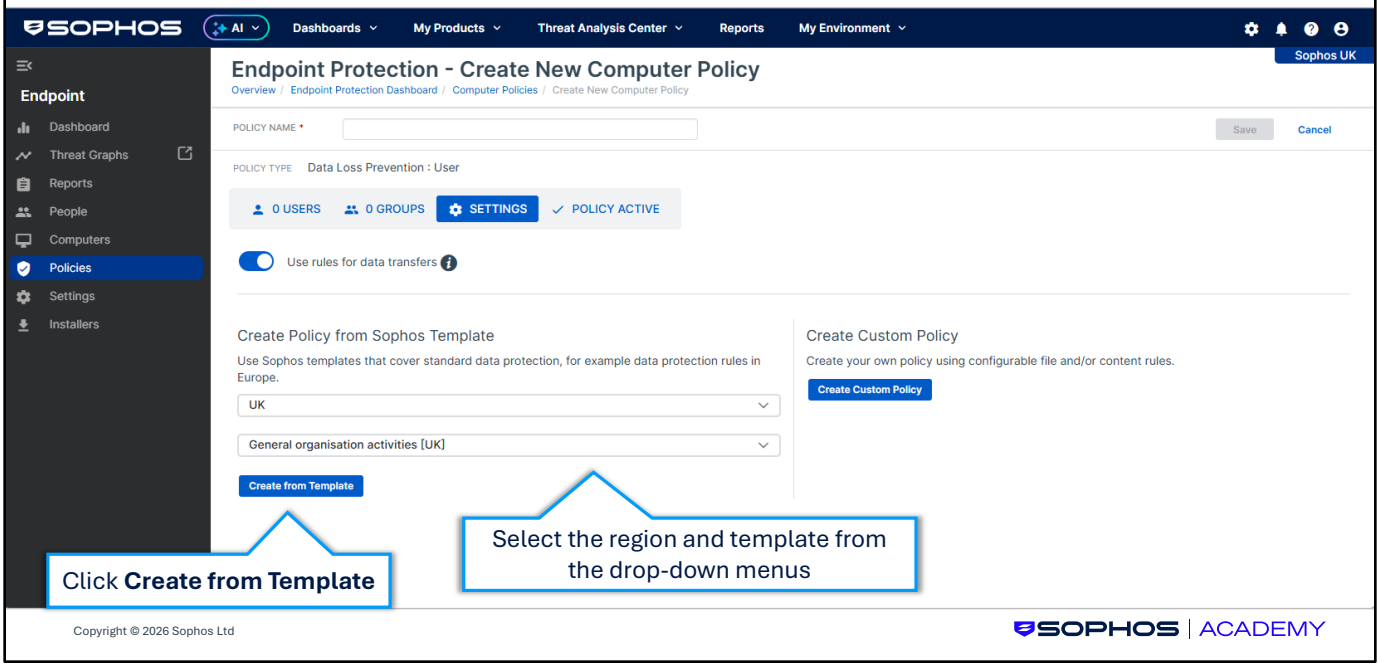


When you enable the use of rules for data transfers, you can either select from the existing Sophos templates that cover standard data protection for organization activities across multiple regions or create a custom policy. This is useful for specific requirements.

DLP policies can include one or more rules that specify matching conditions and actions when a rule is matched. When a DLP policy contains several rules, a file that matches any of the rules configured will violate the policy.

Content and file rules can be used in multiple policies.

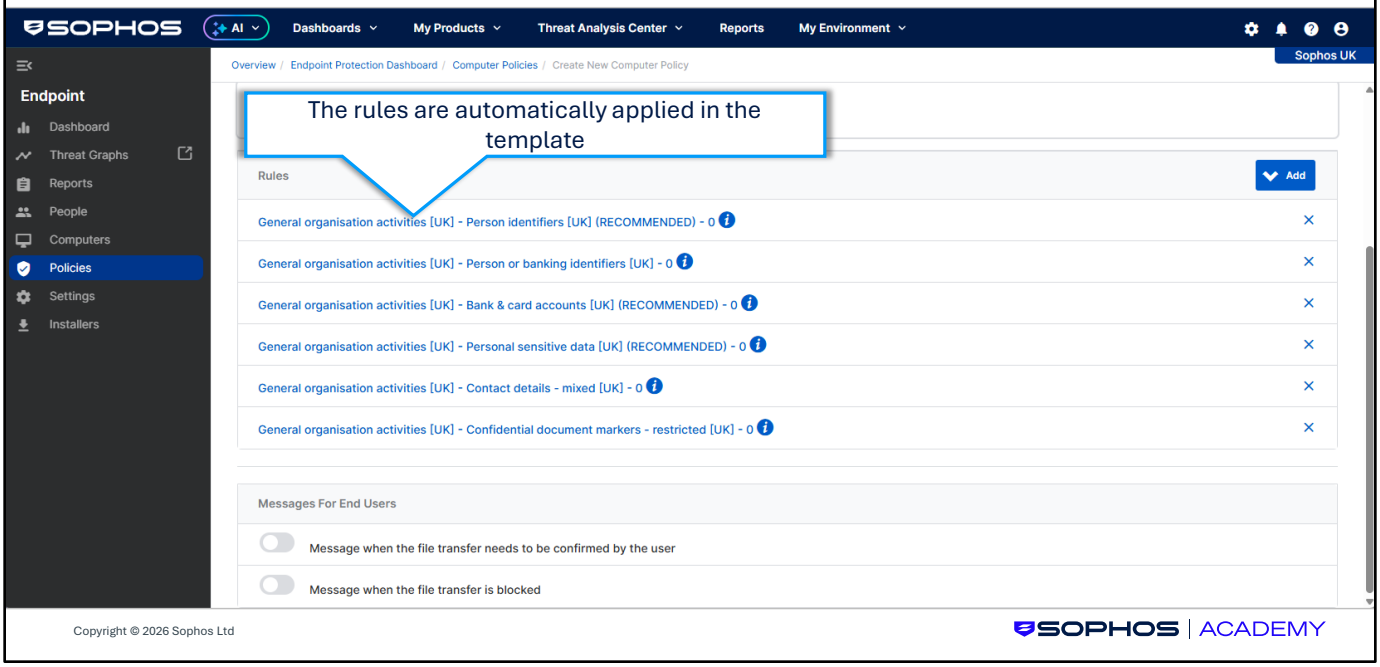
Creating a Policy from a Sophos Template



Select the region from the first drop-down menu and then select the available template from the second drop-down menu.

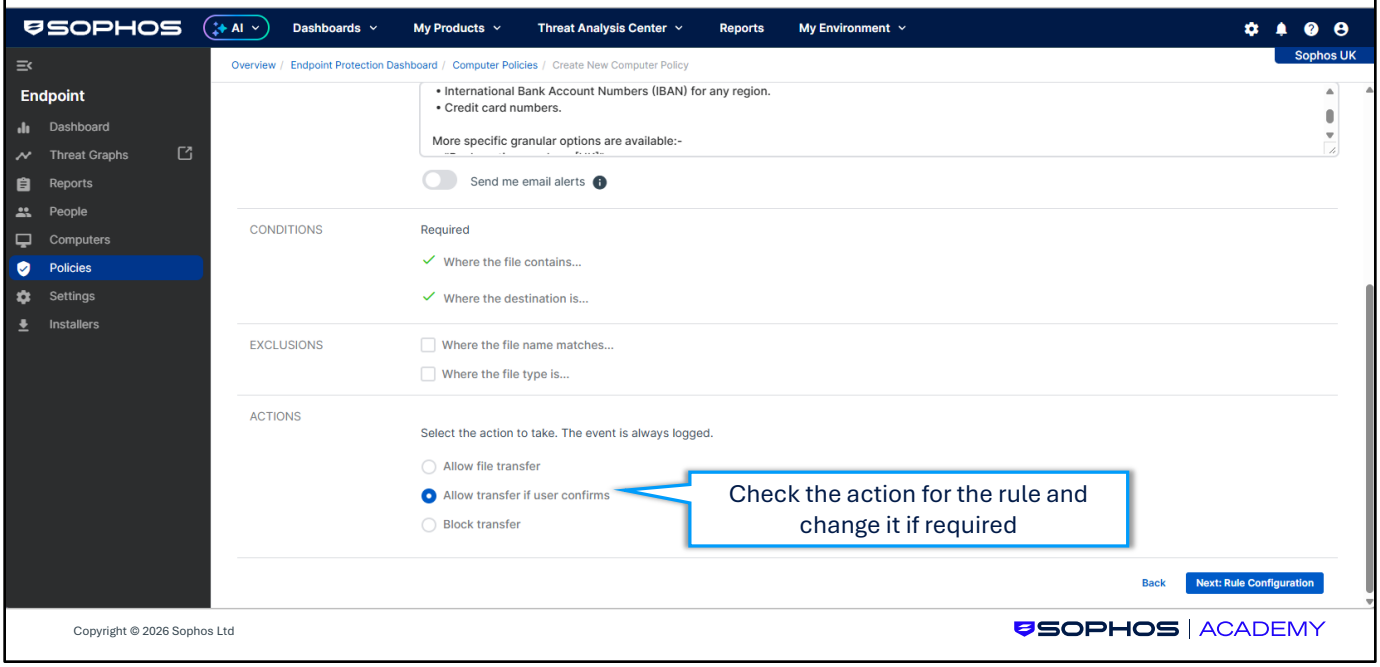
Click **Create from Template** to configure the DLP policy.

Creating a Policy from a Sophos Template



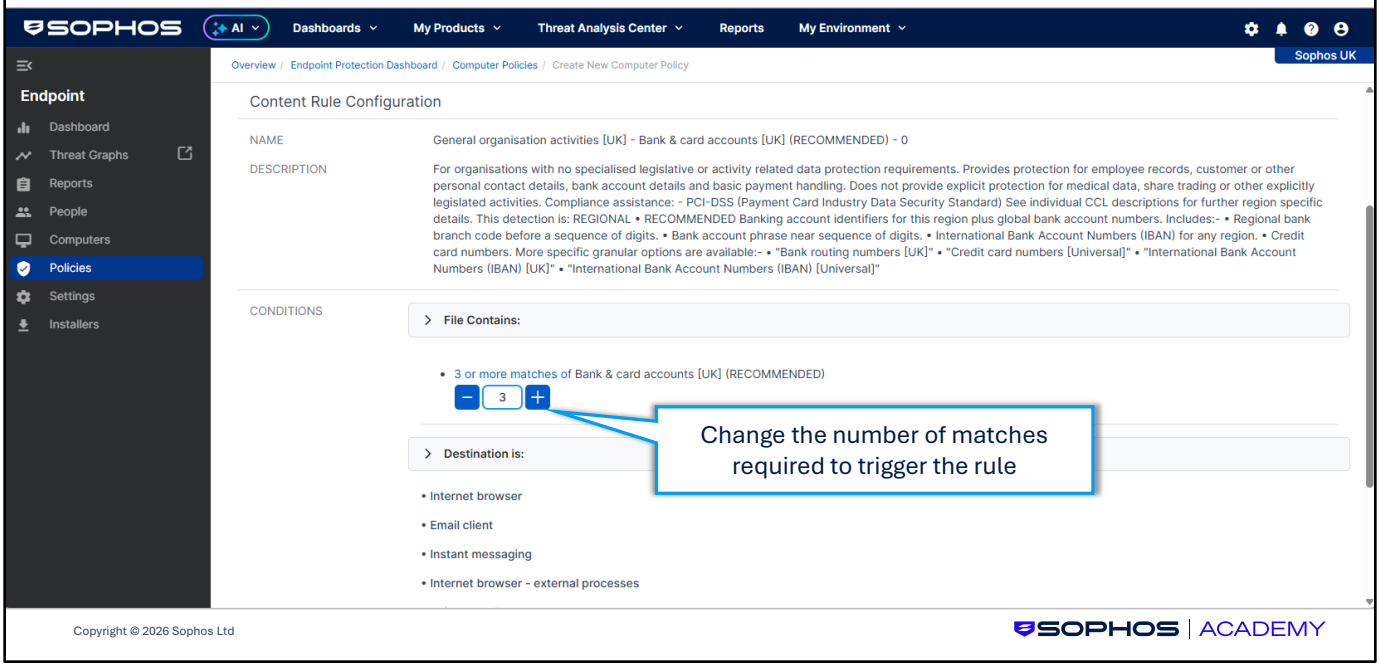
The rules listed are automatically applied as part of the selected template. To view the configuration for each rule, including the action taken by default, click on the rule in the list. You can edit the actions to best suit your environment.

Creating a Policy from a Sophos Template



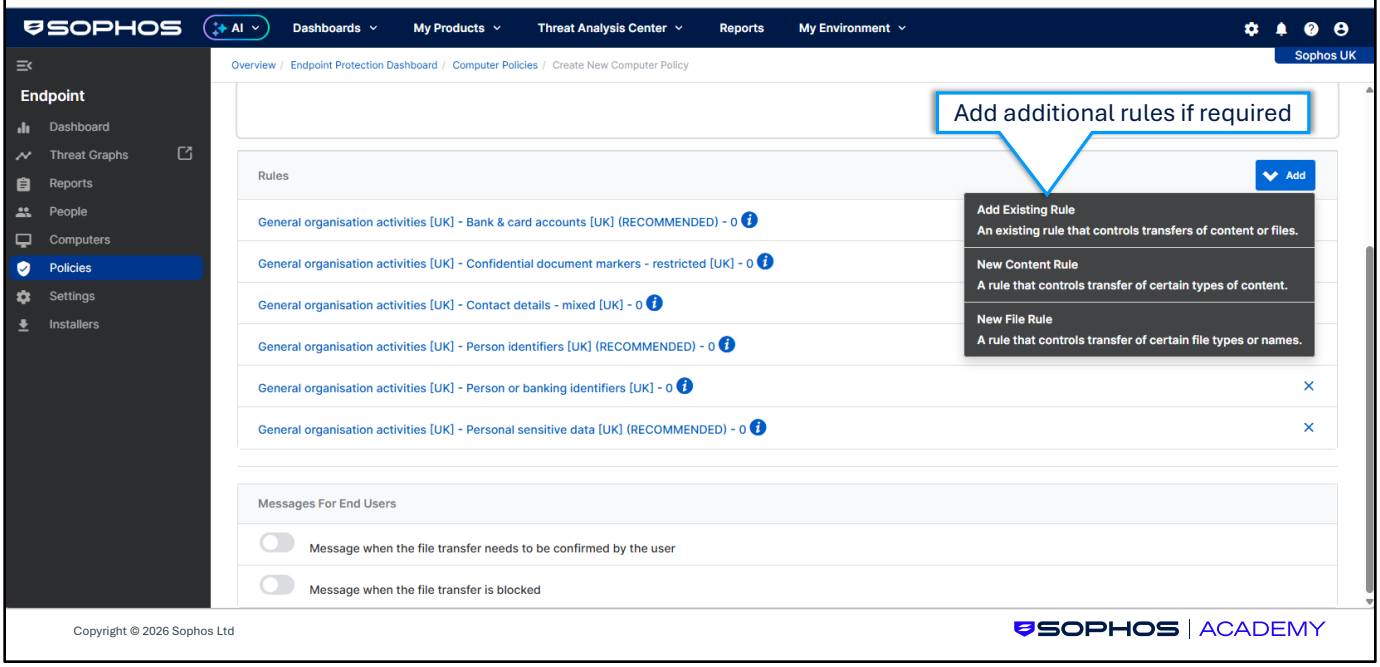
For example, if you want to prevent bank details from being transferred, click the Bank account details rule, set the action to block instead of allow.

Creating a Policy from a Sophos Template



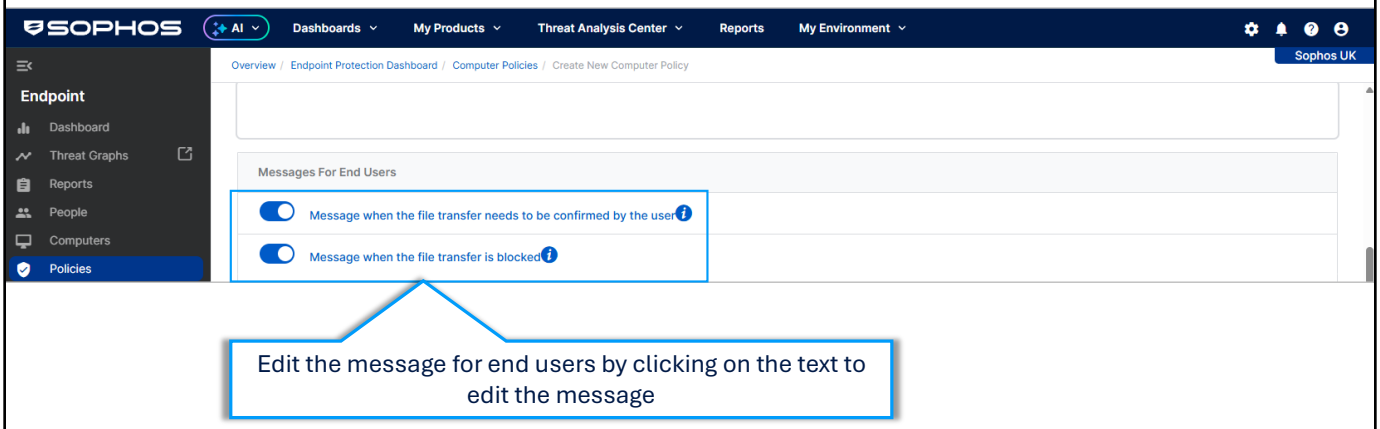
You can also change the number of matches needed to trigger the rule from 3 matches, to 2, or 1 depending on your requirements.

Creating a Policy from a Sophos Template



To add additional rules, you can select an existing rule that you have already configured or select to create a new content or file rule.

Creating a Policy from a Sophos Template



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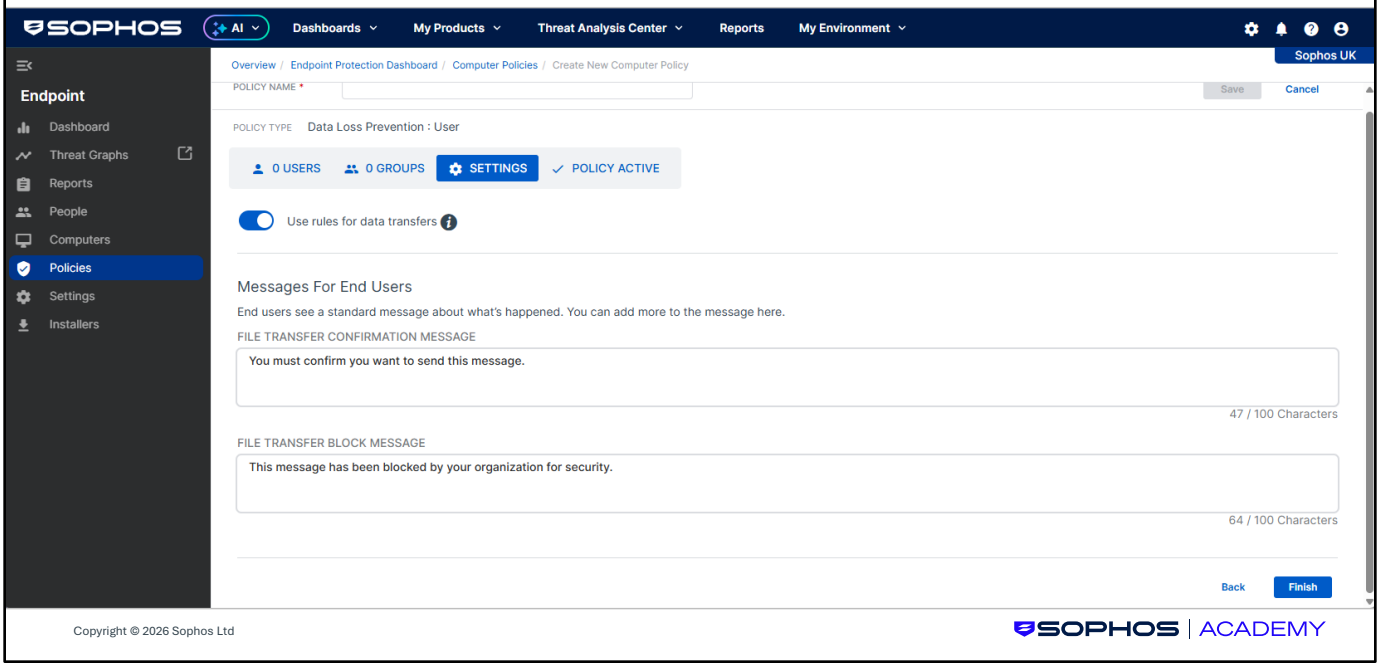
You can add text to the message shown on protected devices when a rule is triggered. Depending on the action configured in the rule, this will either be a confirmation or a block notification.

Click the link to configure the messages.

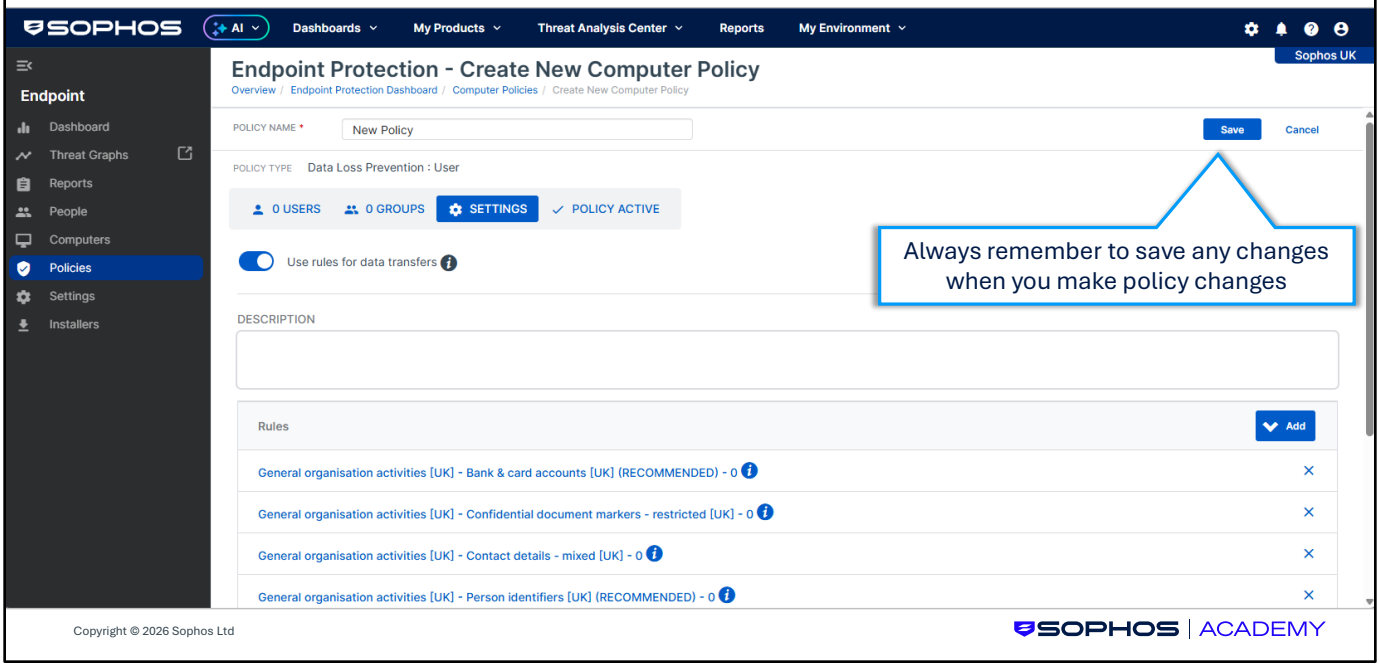
Creating a Policy from a Sophos Template



You can edit the messages to your requirements.

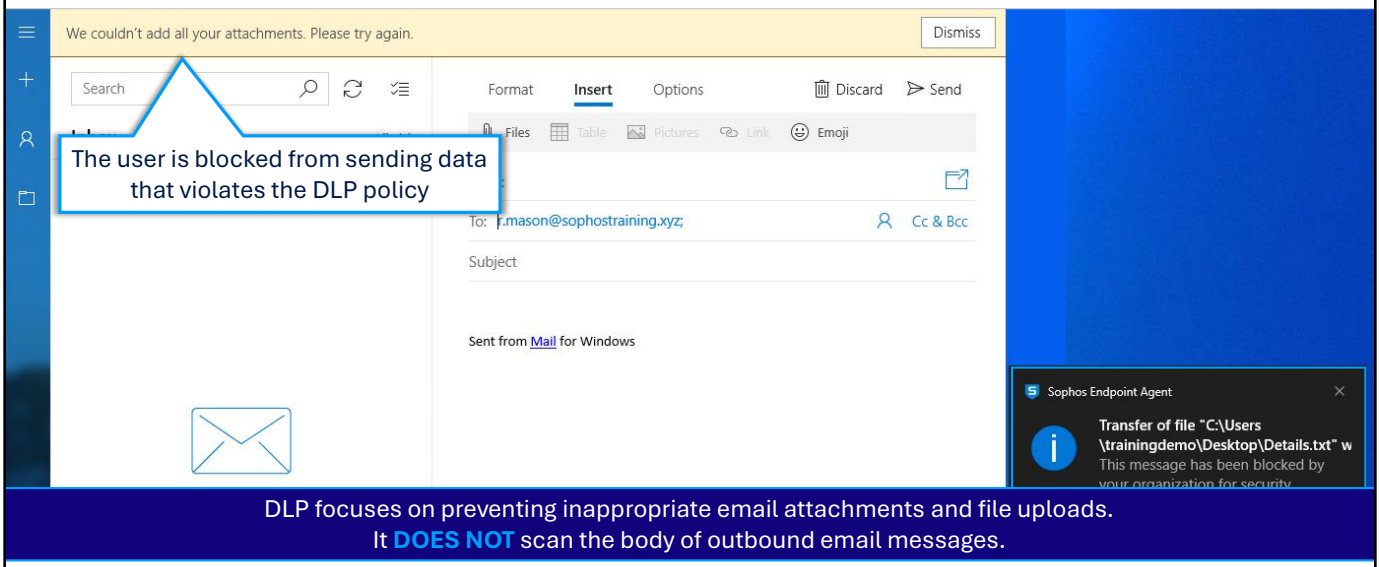
Click **Finish** to return to the DLP SETTINGS page.

Creating a Policy from a Sophos Template



Your DLP policy is now fully configured. Remember to save any changes when you make policy changes.

Creating a Policy from a Sophos Template



DLP focuses on preventing inappropriate email attachments and file uploads.
It **DOES NOT** scan the body of outbound email messages.

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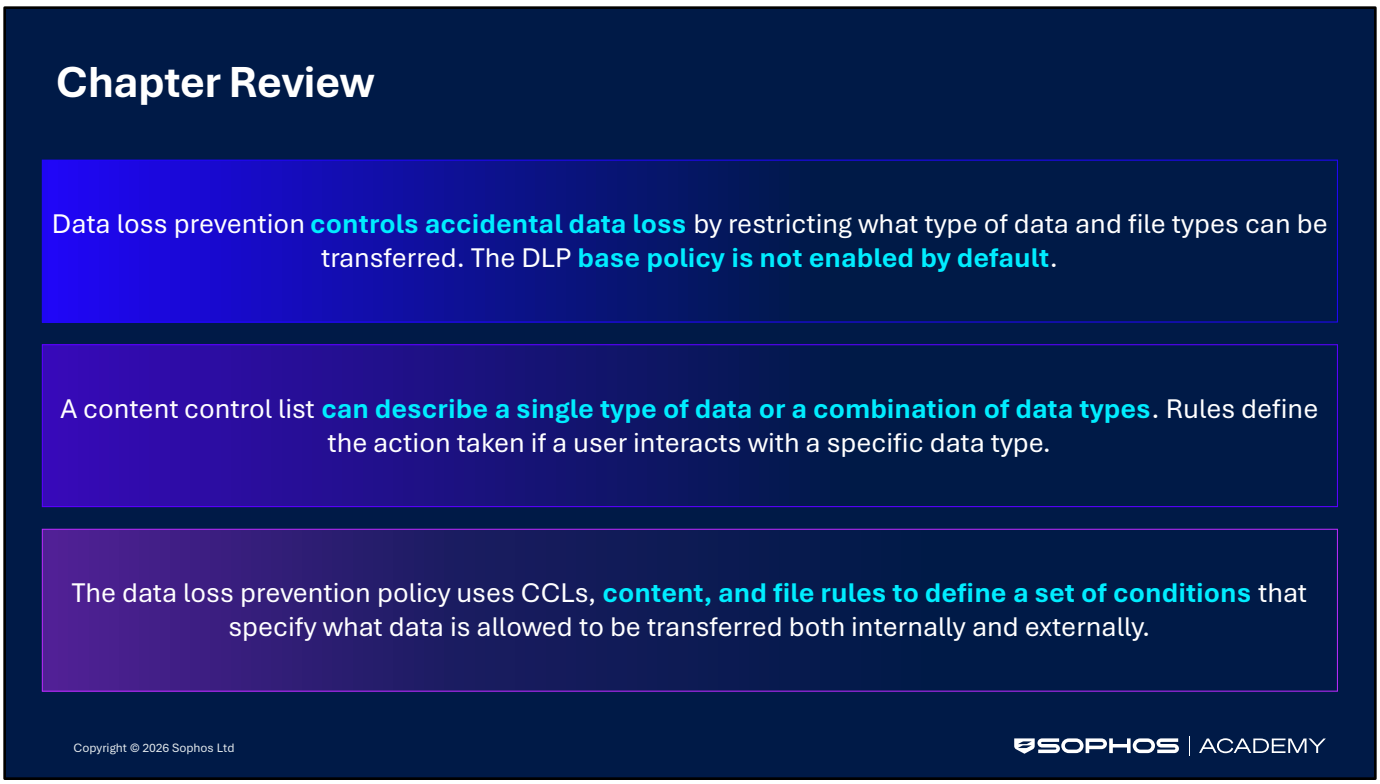
When a user attempts to transfer a file that violates the configured policy, the transfer will be blocked, or the user will be prompted to confirm the transfer, depending on the policy's configuration.

Note that for performance reasons, DLP focuses on preventing inappropriate email attachments and file uploads. It does not scan the body of any outbound email messages.



Here are the three main things you learned in this chapter.

Data Loss prevention controls accidental data loss by restricting what type of data and file types can be transferred. The DLP base policy is not enabled by default.

A Content Control List can describe a single type of data or a combination of data types. Rules define the action taken if a user interacts with a specific data type.

The Data Loss Prevention policy uses CCLs, content, and file rules to define a set of conditions that specify what data is allowed to be transferred both internally and externally.

[Additional Information]

Sophos Endpoint
EP3545: Getting Started with Sophos Endpoint Exclusions

May 2026

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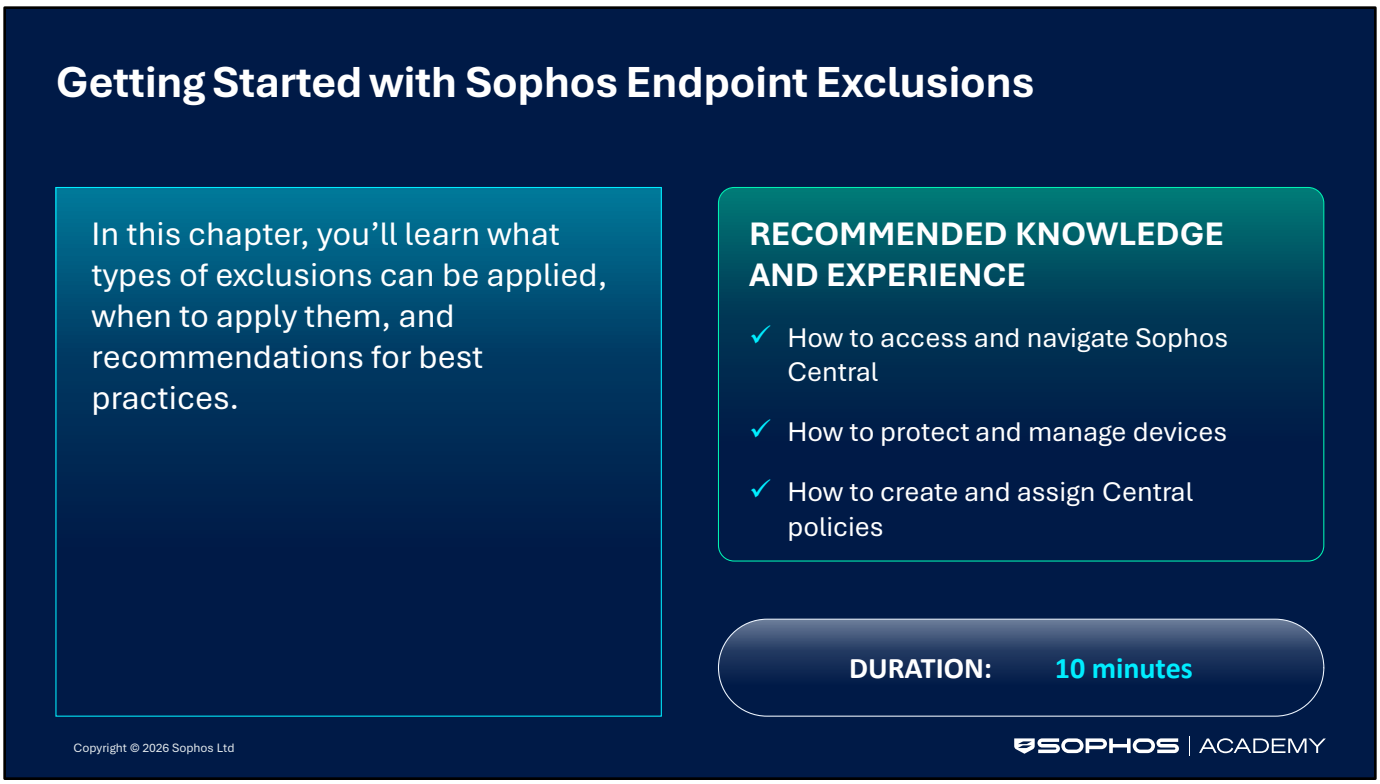
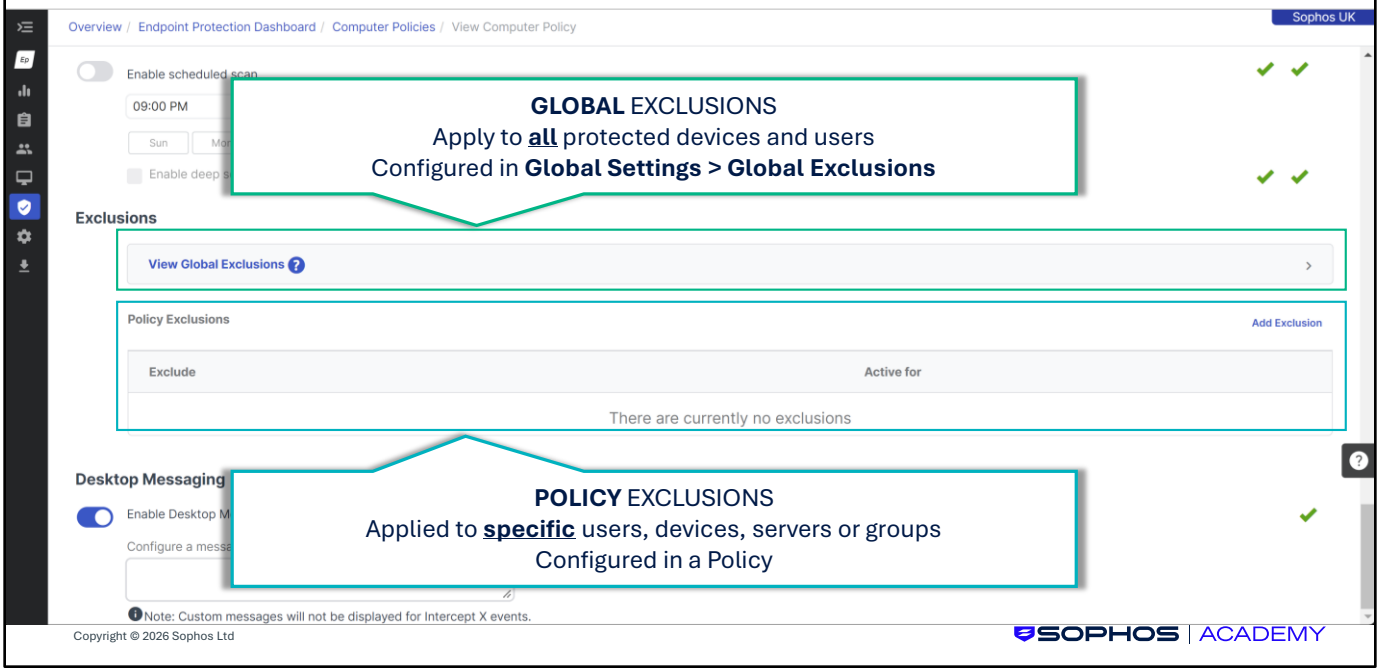


In this chapter, you will learn what types of exclusions can be applied, when to apply them, and recommendations for best practices.

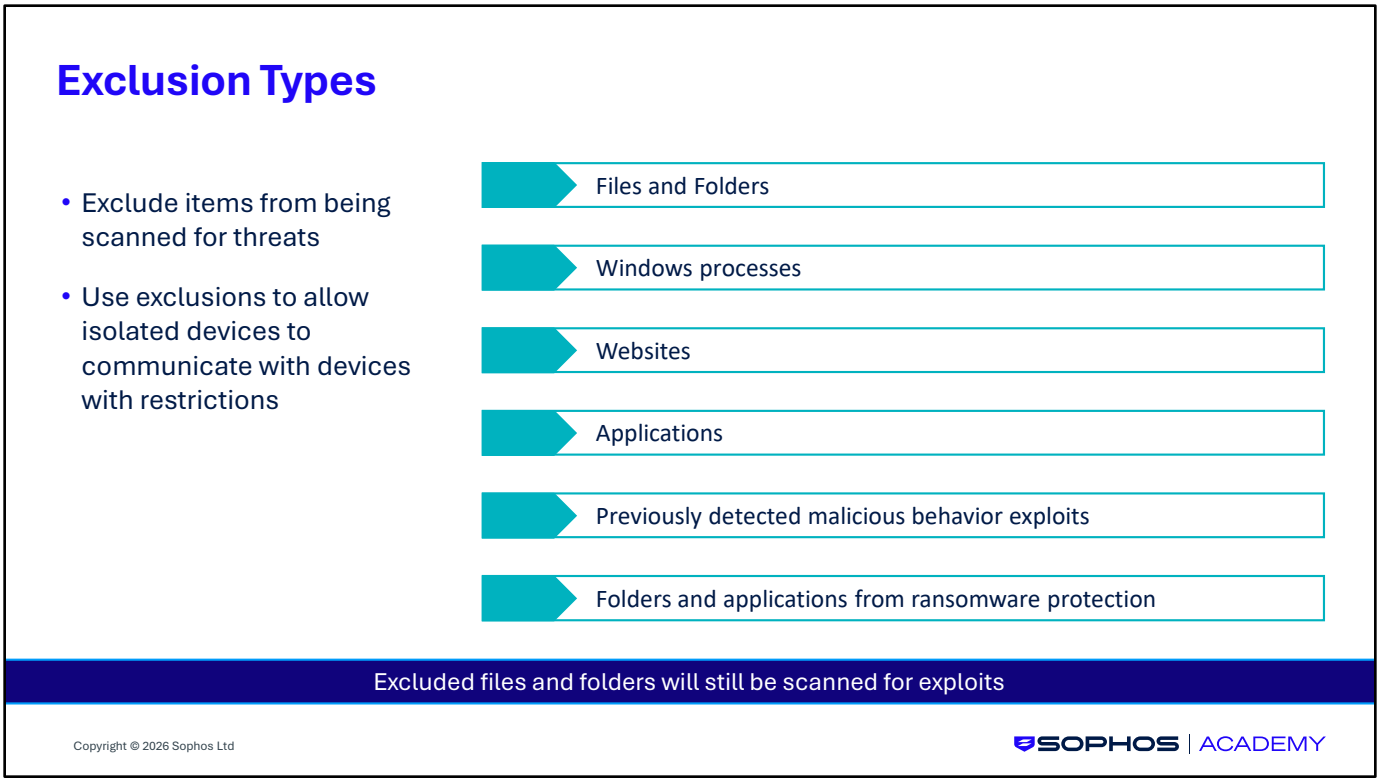
Exclusions



Sometimes it may be necessary to customize the operation of the protection policies and global settings by defining items for which the standard policy behavior should be overridden. For example, you may want to exclude an application that is incorrectly detected as a threat until the issue has been resolved.

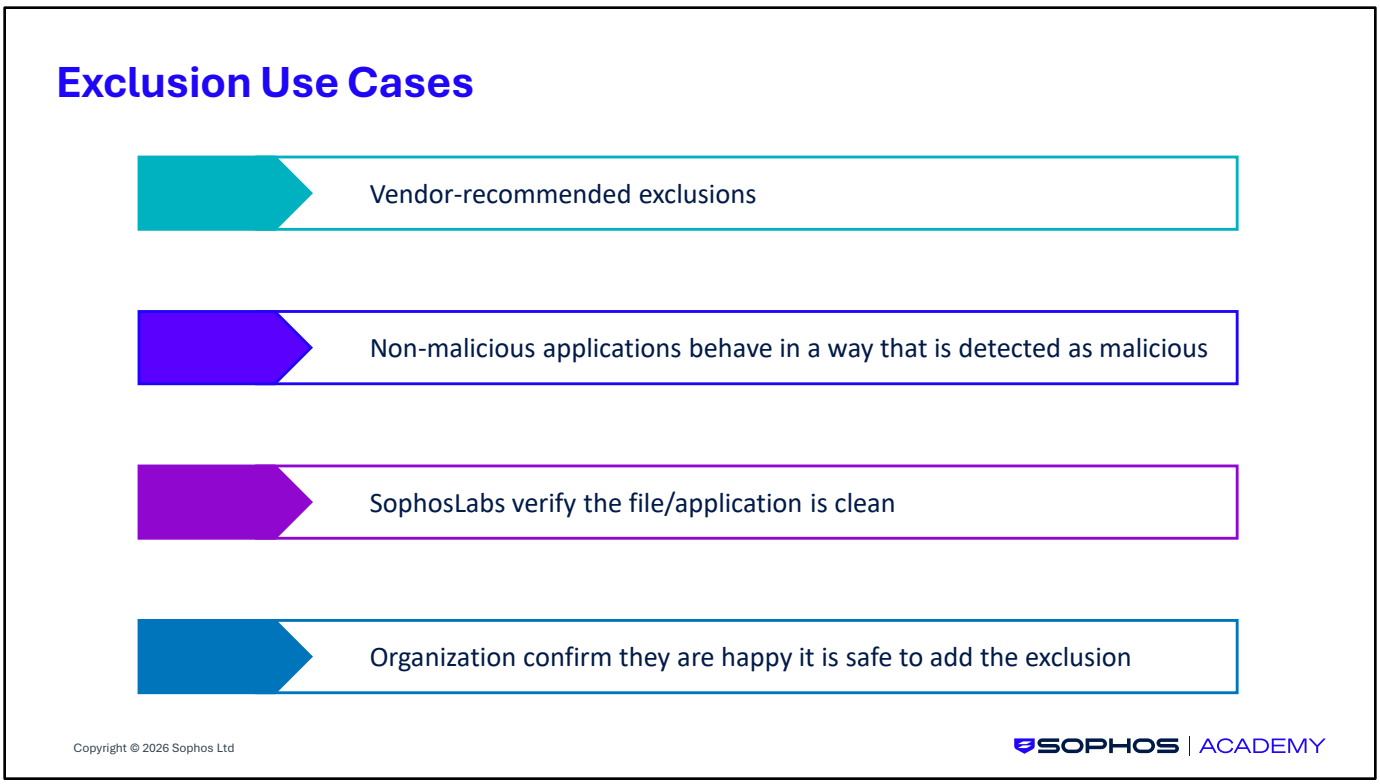
Global settings apply to all devices and users and allow the configuration of scanning and exploit mitigation exclusions, website management, and allowed applications.

To apply exclusions to specific devices, groups, or servers, use policy exclusions instead.



There are several exclusion types that can be configured. You can exclude files or folders. Note that excluded files and folders will still be scanned for exploits. You can also exclude Windows processes, websites, applications, previously detected malicious behavior exploits, and folders or applications from ransomware protection.

You can use exclusions to allow isolated devices to communicate with other devices under restrictions.



A common reason for excluding files and folders from antivirus scanning is that vendors recommend exclusions to ensure their applications operate successfully.

Sometimes, a non-malicious application behaves in a way that is detected as malicious by Sophos. Careful consideration must be given when deciding to exclude any application of this nature, as they allow behavior which is commonly considered harmful. Before adding an exclusion, the question should always be, ‘Why are these files doing this?’ And ‘Is this the type of behavior I want in my environment?’

It is important that you do not configure exclusions unless the file or application has been confirmed as clean by SophosLabs, or the organization has confirmed that they are happy it is safe and can be excluded.

Exclusion Investigation

Clean Indicators

- Known files that belong to legitimate applications
- Executable files that have a name relevant to the location/application they have been detected in
- A file which has been on the device for a long period of time
- If the file is detected by other antivirus vendors as clean

Malicious Indicators

- An unknown file, possibly with a random name
- An executable file in a temporary or user data location
- Detection of a file that was created at the time of the detection or shortly before
- Other recent detections on the same device
- If the file is detected by other antivirus vendors as malicious

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Before adding an exclusion or allowing an application, you must ensure that the files being detected are part of a legitimate application. It is important to treat every detection as malicious and not authorize anything unless you are confident it is safe to exclude.

A few examples of clean and malicious file indicators are shown here.

Applying Exclusions

Exclusions may significantly reduce your protection.

ONLY use them if you understand the risks.

- Ensure all exclusions are **specific**
- Use **policies** to apply exclusions to **target specific users or devices**
- **Check** all exclusions **regularly**
- **Remove** any **unnecessary** exclusions

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It is extremely important to be careful when adding any exclusions to a threat protection policy or globally via global settings as they can reduce your protection. Here are a few guidelines for applying exclusions safely.

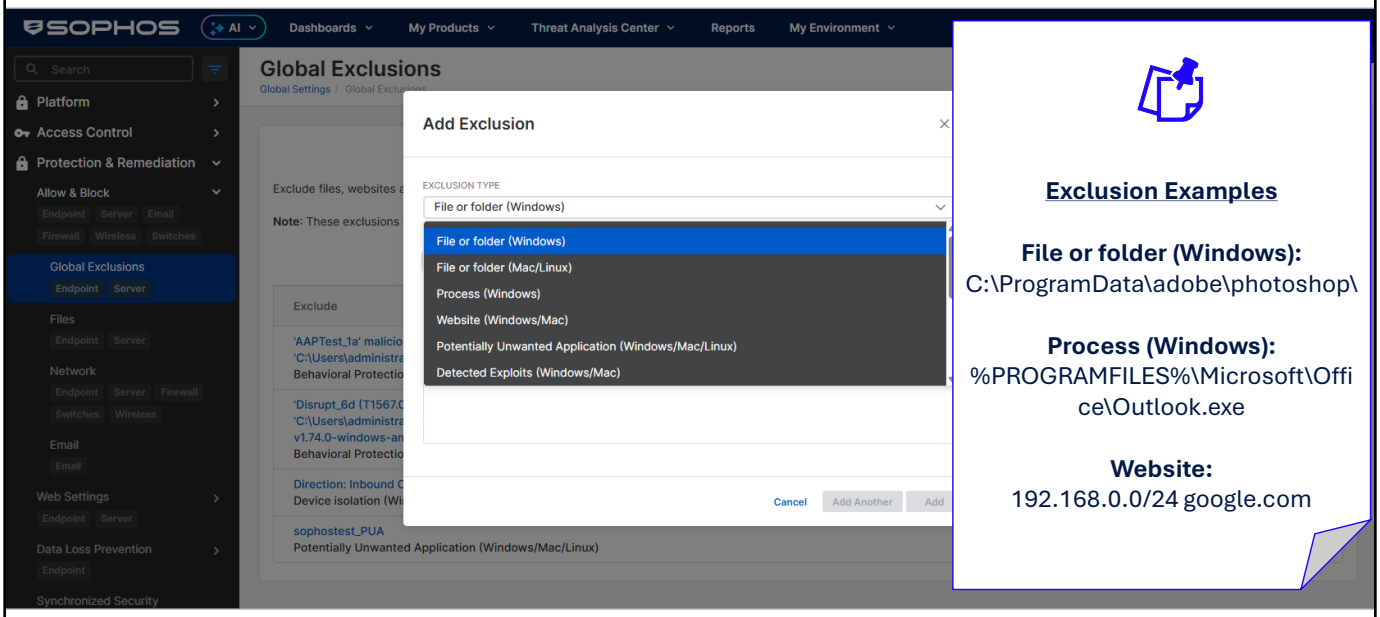
Firstly, make sure that any exclusions added are as specific as possible. Generalized exclusions may cover more files or folders than required. We recommend that you use policies to apply exclusions that target only specific users or devices.

Check all exclusions regularly to ensure that only exclusions that are necessary are applied. You may no longer need an exclusion that was applied to fix a specific issue or to comply with a vendor recommendation.

Lastly, remove any unnecessary exclusions.

Global Exclusions

Additional information available in the notes



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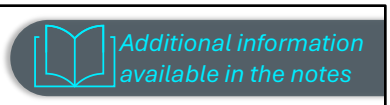
Global exclusions can be used to exclude files, websites, and applications from scanning for threats. Navigate to **Global Settings > Global Exclusions** to view existing exclusions and add new exclusions.

Global exclusions will apply to all users, devices, and servers.

[Additional Information]
For more information, see the scanning exclusions here: Global Exclusions - Sophos Central Admin https://docs.sophos.com/central/Customer/help/en-us/ManageYourProducts/GlobalSettings/ProtectionRemediation/AllowBlock/GlobalExclusions/index.html

Setting Up Specific Exclusions



Example specific exclusion for app.exe

NOT: *.exe
USE: C:\Program Files\Software\app.exe

These folders are **not** recommended as an exclusion:

- C:\Windows\
- C:\ProgramData\
- C:\Users\<Username>\
- C:\ProgramData\Microsoft\Windows\Start Menu\Programs\StartUp\

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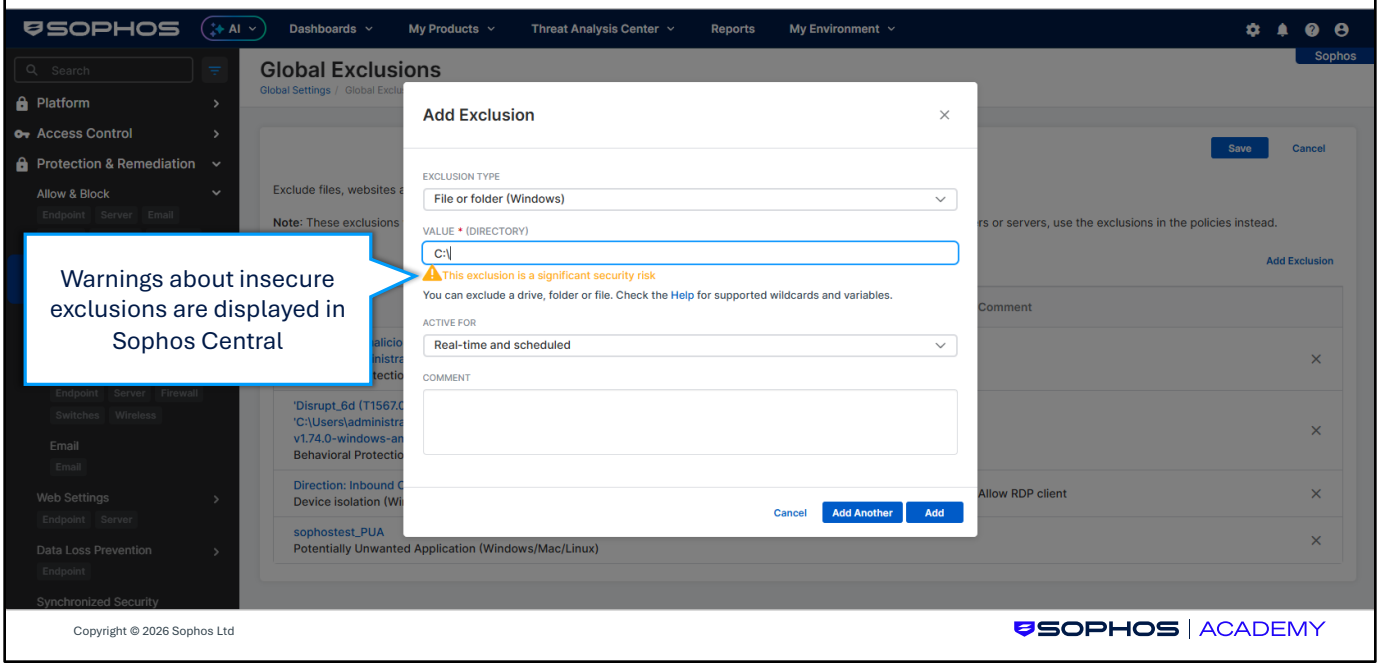
We recommend the use of specific exclusions. For example, if you needed to exclude an executable that exists in a software folder on the C drive in Program Files, an exclusion of *.exe would exclude the executable, however, it would also exclude ALL executables. This means that any malicious executable file will not be scanned or blocked. To make the exclusion specific, use the full path for the executable application.

We also recommend that you do not exclude folders where malware is most often located. For example, the Windows directory, ProgramData, Users and Startup.

[Additional Information]
An example of an exclusion. Instead of *.exe use C:\Program Files\Software\app.exe. Locations where malware is often found; C:\Windows\, C:\ProgramData\, C:\Users\<Username>\, C:\ProgramData\Microsoft\Windows\Start Menu\Programs\StartUp\.

Setting Up Specific Exclusions



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If you do apply an exclusion that is considered a security risk, a warning indicator will be shown. Additionally, for existing exclusions, a banner message is applied if that exclusion is not recommended by Sophos.

MacOS Scanning Exclusions

SYNTAX	ITEM(S) TO EXCLUDE
`myfolder/`	All files in any folder that is called myfolder, locally or on the network, and sub-folders recursively
`myfolder//`	All files in any folder that is called myfolder, locally or on the network, but not sub-folders
`myapplication`	The file myapplication anywhere locally or on the network
`/myfolder/myapplication`	The file myapplication in a specific folder
`/myfolder/`	All files in the folder myfolder in a specific location and sub-folder recursively
`/myfolder//`	All files in the folder myfolder in a specific location but not subfolders
`*.mov`	All files whose filename extension is .mov anywhere locally on the network
`/myfolder/*.mov`	All files whose filename extension is .mov in a specific location

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When you add or edit an exclusion for macOS, you can type any POSIX path, whether it is a volume, folder, or file. For example, /volumes/excluded.

This table displays the rules for excluded items on macOS.

Linux Scanning Exclusions

Additional information available in the notes

SYNTAX	ITEM(S) TO EXCLUDE
`/directory/sub-directory/file.name`	Absolute path to file excludes the named file
`/directory/sub-directory/`	Absolute path to directory excludes everything in the named directory and below
`file.name`	File name excludes files with this name in any directory
`directory/file.name` **SAV for Linux** `*.directory/file.name`	File name excludes any path ending with the named directory and file
`bar/` **SAV for Linux** `*/directory/*`	Directory name excludes everything below any directory with this name
`Directory/sub-directory/` **SAV for Linux** `*/directory/sub-directory/*`	Relative path to a directory excludes any path containing the named directory
`*.fileextension`	File extension excludes any file with this extension, in any directory
`/directory/*/file.name`	Wildcard path excludes any file with the named file name that matches the named directory and wildcard pattern

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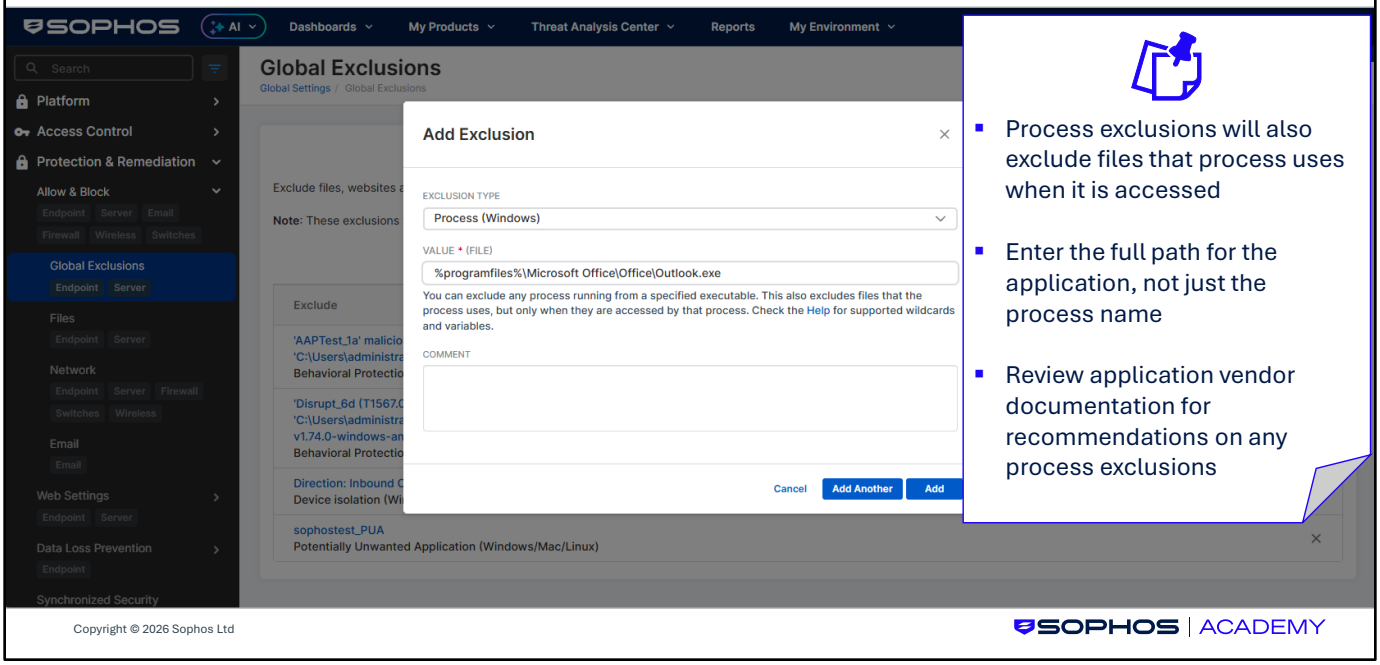
You can exclude a specific directory or file by its full path. To exclude a directory and all the directories and files below it, add a trailing slash.

[Additional Information]
Example exclusions; /mnt/hgfs/excluded excludes the file named excluded. /mnt/hgfs/excluded/ excludes the directory named excluded and all directories and files below it in the filesystem. We recommend that you use this exclusion type as specifically as possible. You can exclude a directory or file in any location. For example; */excluded excludes the file named excluded in any location. */excluded/* excludes the directory named excluded in any location and all directories and files below it in the filesystem. We recommend that you use this exclusion type as specifically as possible.

Process Exclusions (Windows)

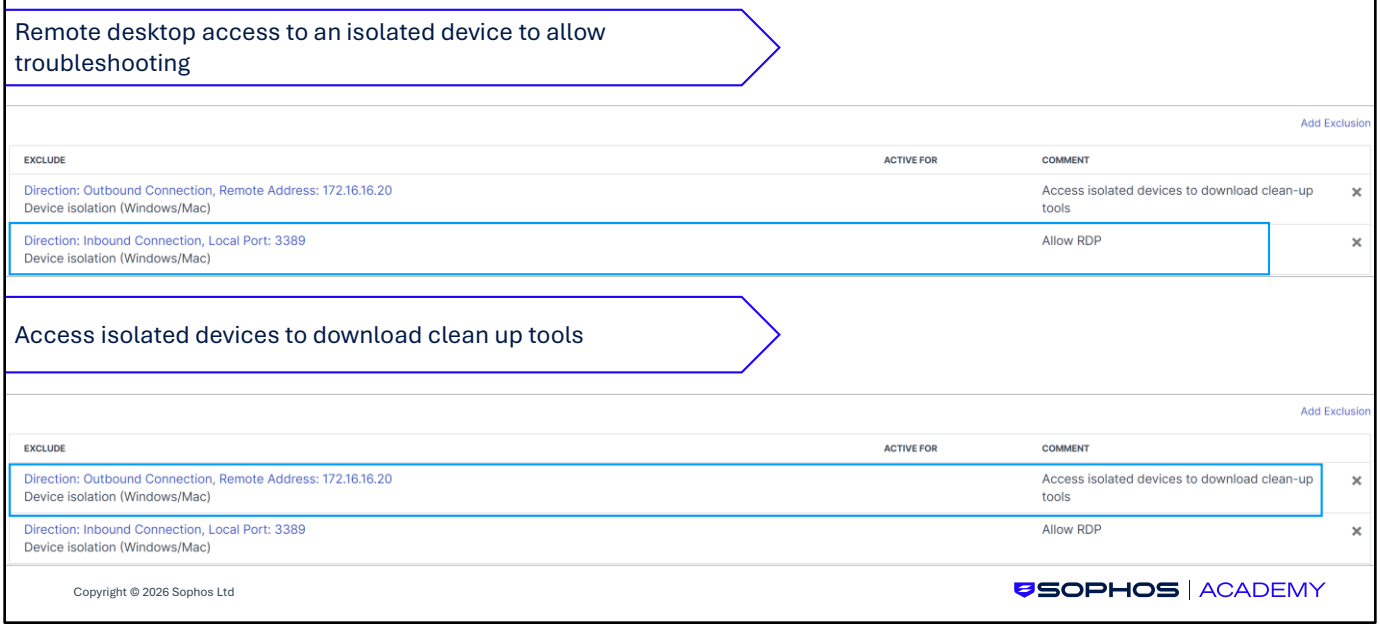


Excluding a process running from an application will also exclude files that the process uses when it is accessed.

When creating a process exclusion, enter the full path for the application and not just the process name shown in Task Manager.

To view all processes or other items that you may need to exclude for an application, see the application vendor's documentation.

Device Isolation Exclusion (Windows)

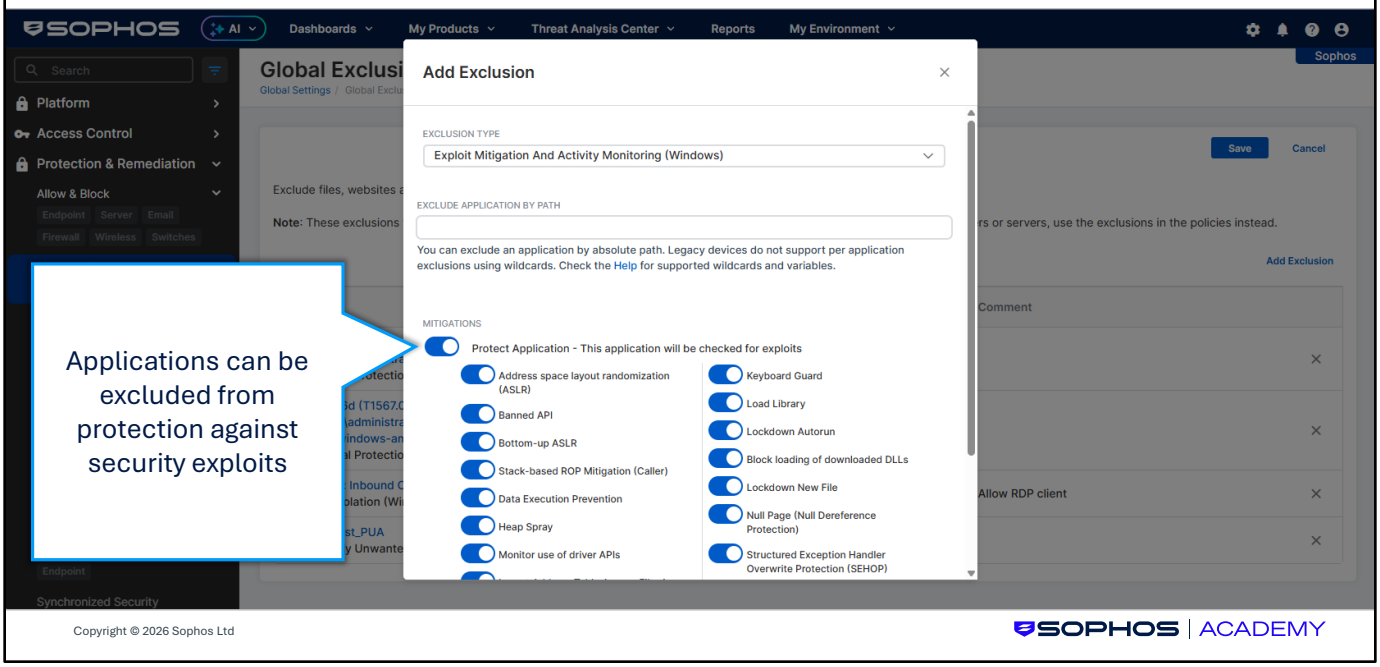


Here are a couple of examples of how to configure device isolation exclusions.

Remote desktop access to an isolated device is required to allow troubleshooting, to ensure this select inbound connection and enter the port number.

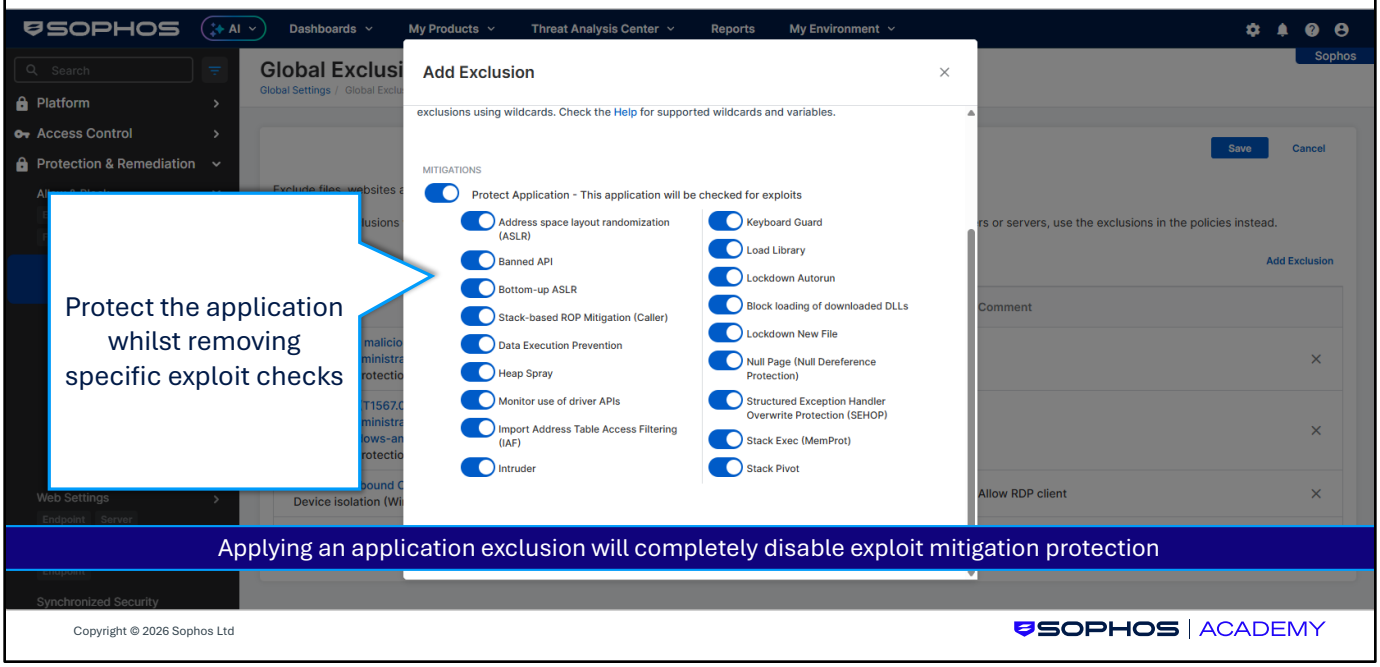
Should you want to access an isolated device to download a clean-up tool, select outbound connection and in the remote address, enter the address of the server.

Exploit Mitigation Exclusions



Applications can be excluded from protection against security exploits, which allows you to exclude any exploit that has already been detected. This can be useful if you want to exclude an application that has been incorrectly detected as a threat until the issue is resolved. Once you select an application from the list, you can then select to disable protection for that application.

Exploit Mitigation Exclusions



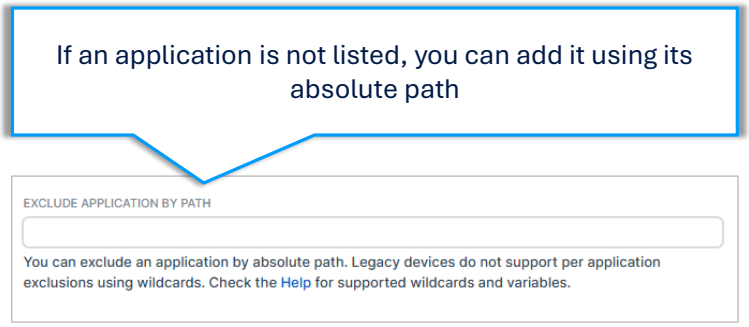
You can select the exploit types that you want to check for and those that you do not. This allows you to protect the application whilst removing specific exploit checks.

It is important to note that if used, this will completely disable exploit mitigations for the application it is applied to. Therefore, we recommend that you exclude detected exploit methods using exclusion settings.

Note that any applications excluded from exploit protection for all users and devices could allow behavior that is commonly considered to be bad.

Exploit Mitigation Exclusions

Additional information available in the notes



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If an application is not listed, you can add it using its absolute path. When you set up scanning exclusions, you can use wildcards and variables. We recommend that you make your wildcards as specific as possible.

Different variables are used for exploit mitigation exclusions, for example, using the variable $appdata will cover the local and roaming folders as well as the common app data folder and the folder ID. For all folder locations, see the additional information in the course notes.

[Additional Information]
Examples: C:\Users\<user>\AppData\Local, C:\Users\<user>\AppData\Roaming, CSIDL_COMMON_APPDATA, FOLDERID_LocalAppDataLow.

Wildcards and Variables

Additional information available in the notes

Wildcard examples:

Expression	Description
theory\document	Excludes any file named **document** in a folder named **theory** (in any location)
*.txt	Excludes all .txt files in any location
C:\theory\	Excludes all files and folders underneath C:\theory\ and including C:\theory\

Variable examples:

Expression	Description
%USERPROFILE%	Excludes C:\Users**\ from scanning
%appdata%	Excludes C:\Users**\AppData\Roaming\ from scanning

Wildcards and variables reduce your protection, be cautious when using them

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You can use wildcards and variables when setting up scanning exclusions. When you use a wildcard or a variable, ensure that it is specific to retain the protection of the organization.

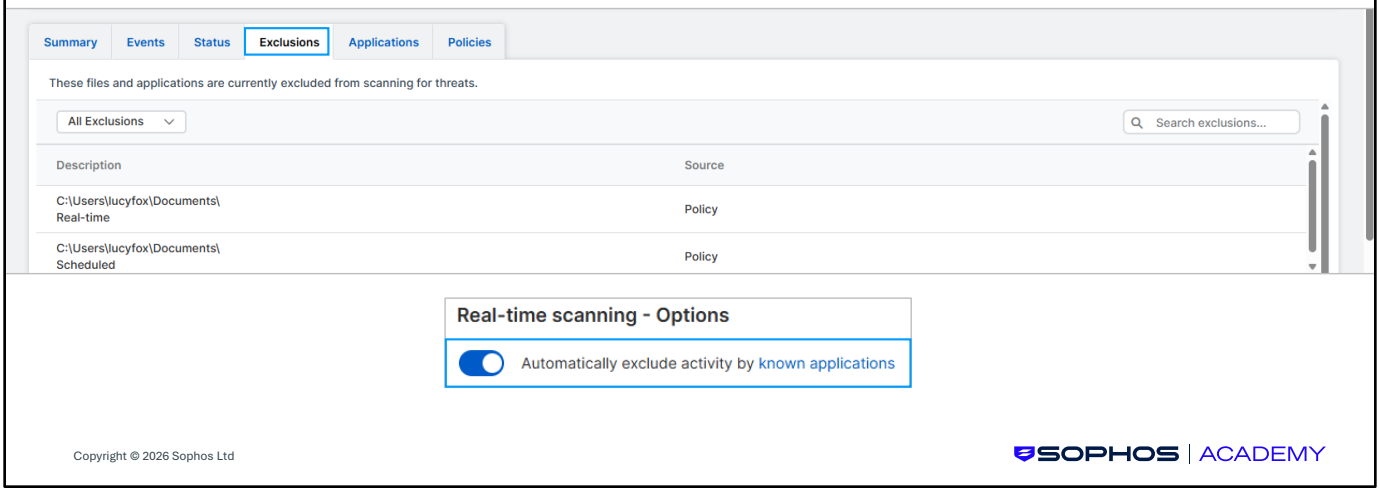
Here are a few examples of wildcards and variables that are supported when applying scanning exclusions.

[Additional Information]
For more examples, see the help documentation here: Exploit mitigation or ransomware wildcards and variables - Sophos Central Admin
https://docs.sophos.com/central/Customer/help/en-us/ManageYourProducts/GlobalSettings/ProtectionRemediation/AllowBlock/GlobalExclusions/MitigationExclusionsVariables/index.html

Server Exclusions

Additional information available in the notes

- Exclusions for common server roles
- Process exclusions
- Environment variables
- Server specific policies



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Server protection is designed specifically for servers. Exclusions for common server roles are automatically applied. Process exclusions and environmental variables can be added to server policies, which provide a greater level of control for protected server security.

Server exclusions include both automatically applied and manually applied exclusions. Exclusions for common Windows server applications are automatically applied and delivered as a data feed to enable Sophos to add new roles over time. All server exclusions are displayed on the **EXCLUSIONS** tab in the server details in Sophos Central. In the threat protection policy, the option to automatically exclude activity by known applications is enabled by default.

[Additional Information]
You can view all known application exclusions in knowledge base article **KB-000035264**. Sophos Server: Automatically excluded third-party products
https://support.sophos.com/support/s/article/KB-000035264

Virtual Server Scanning Exclusions

EXCLUSION	NOTES
`C:\programdata\adobe\photoshop\`	Excludes the folder. You must suffix the back slash for this type of exclusion
`C:\program files\program\*.com`	Excludes files with a .com extension in the specified folder
`file.txt`	Excludes files with this name in any location
`File.*`	Excludes all files called 'file' with any extension in all locations
`*.txt`	Excludes all files with a .txt extension in all locations
`C:\file??.docx`	Excludes C:\file12.exe but not C:\file123.exe

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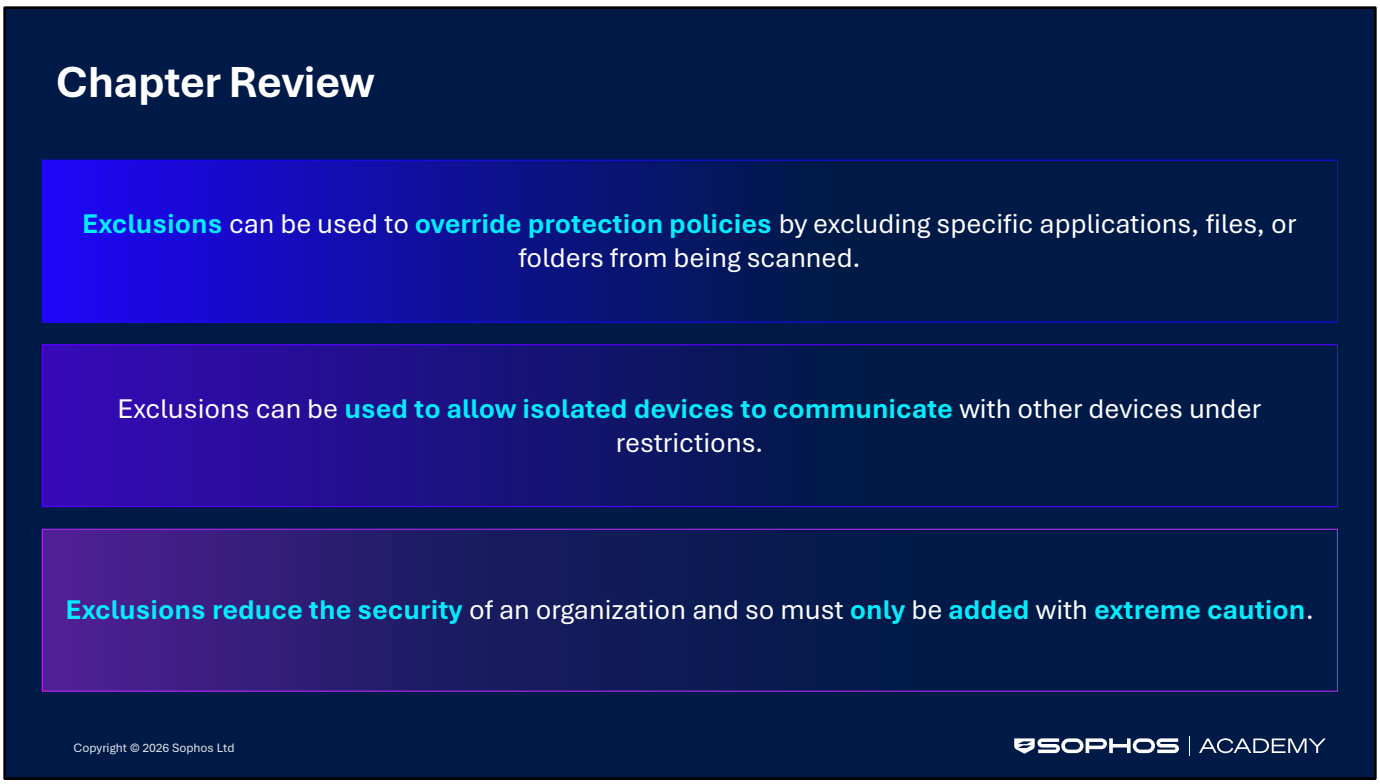
For virtually protected servers, you can exclude drives, folders, or files by file path. However, there are restrictions on specifying items without a full path and on using wildcards.

When you apply an exclusion without a full path, you must include the extension; for example, a file should be applied as file.txt. You can use wildcards when setting up scanning exclusions, but as with all exclusions, it is recommended that you make these as specific as possible.

The exclusions shown here are valid for virtual server exclusions.



Here are the three main things you learned in this chapter.

Exclusions can be used to override protection policies by excluding specific applications, files, or folders from being scanned.

Exclusions can be used to allow isolated devices to communicate with other devices under restrictions.

Exclusions reduce the security of an organization and so must only be added with extreme caution.

Remediation and Reports

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[Additional Information]

Sophos Endpoint
EP4005: Getting Started with Logs and Reports

May 2026

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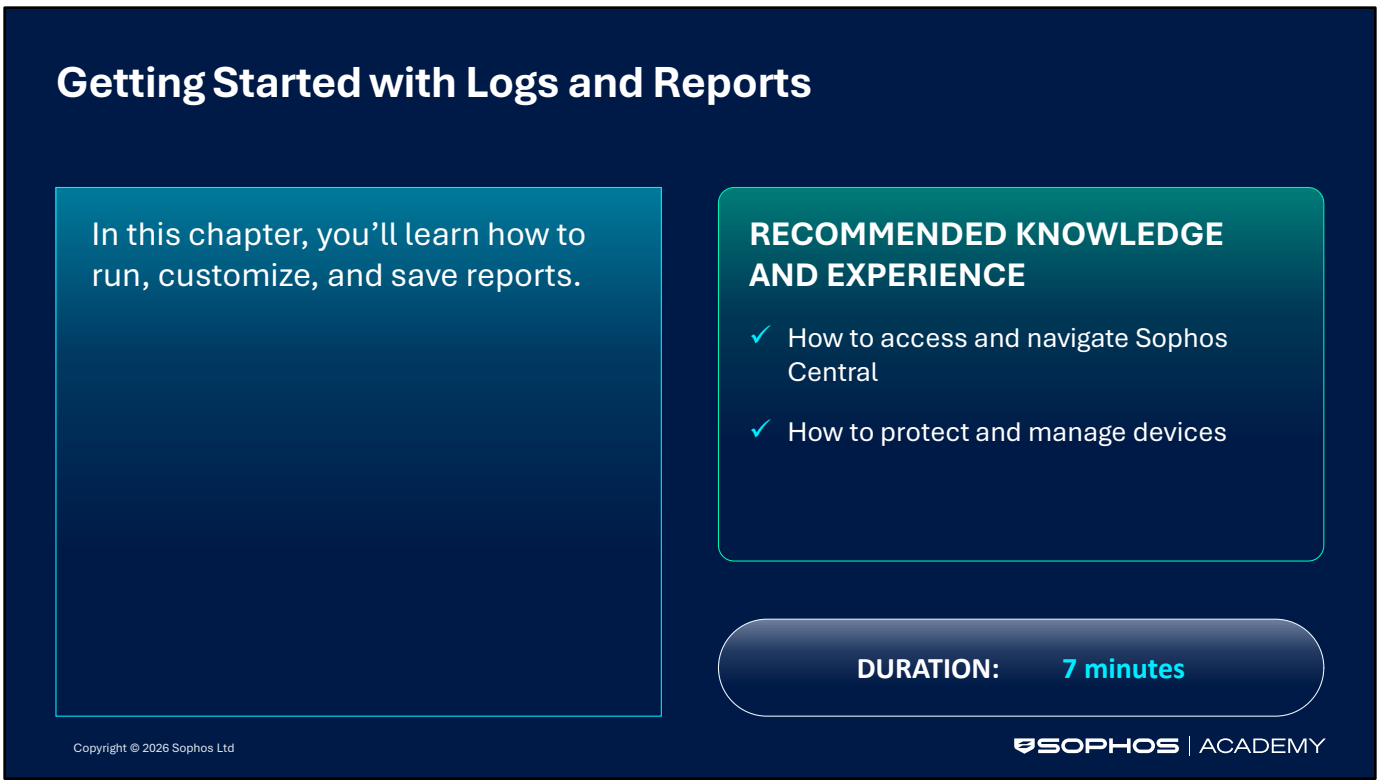
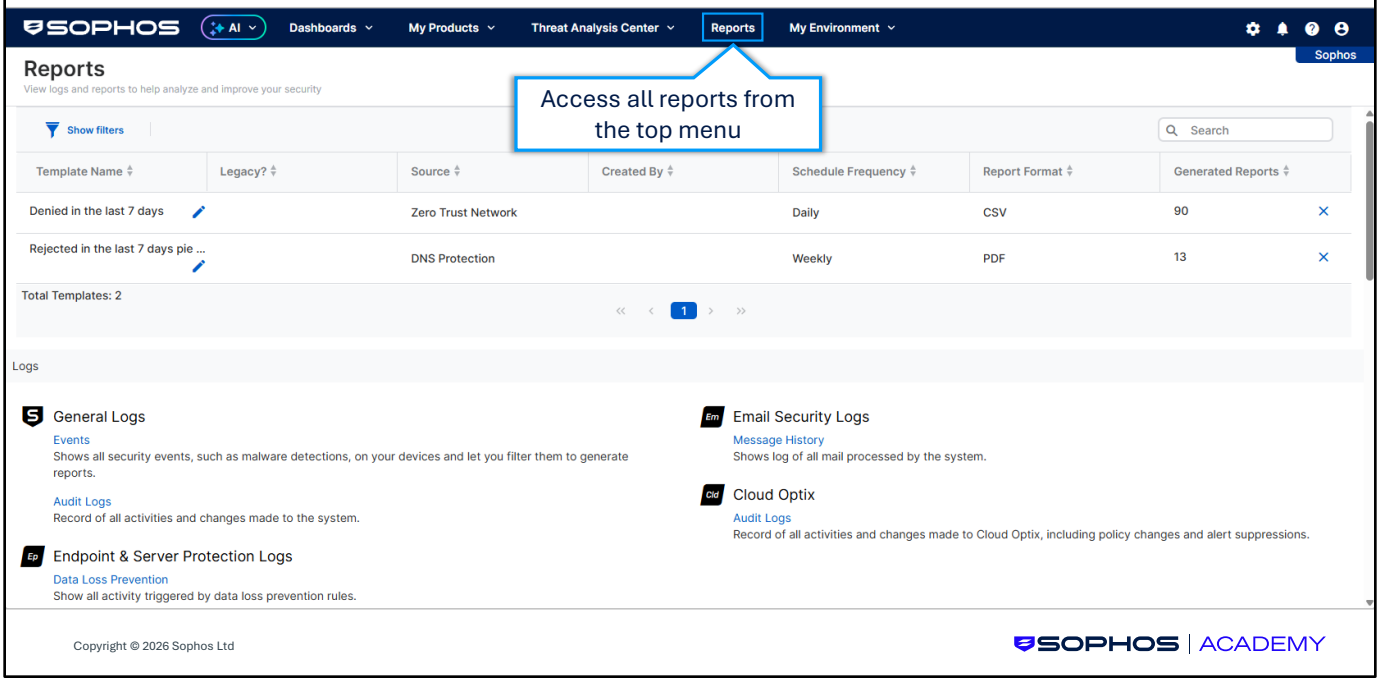


In this chapter, you'll learn how to run, customize, and save reports.

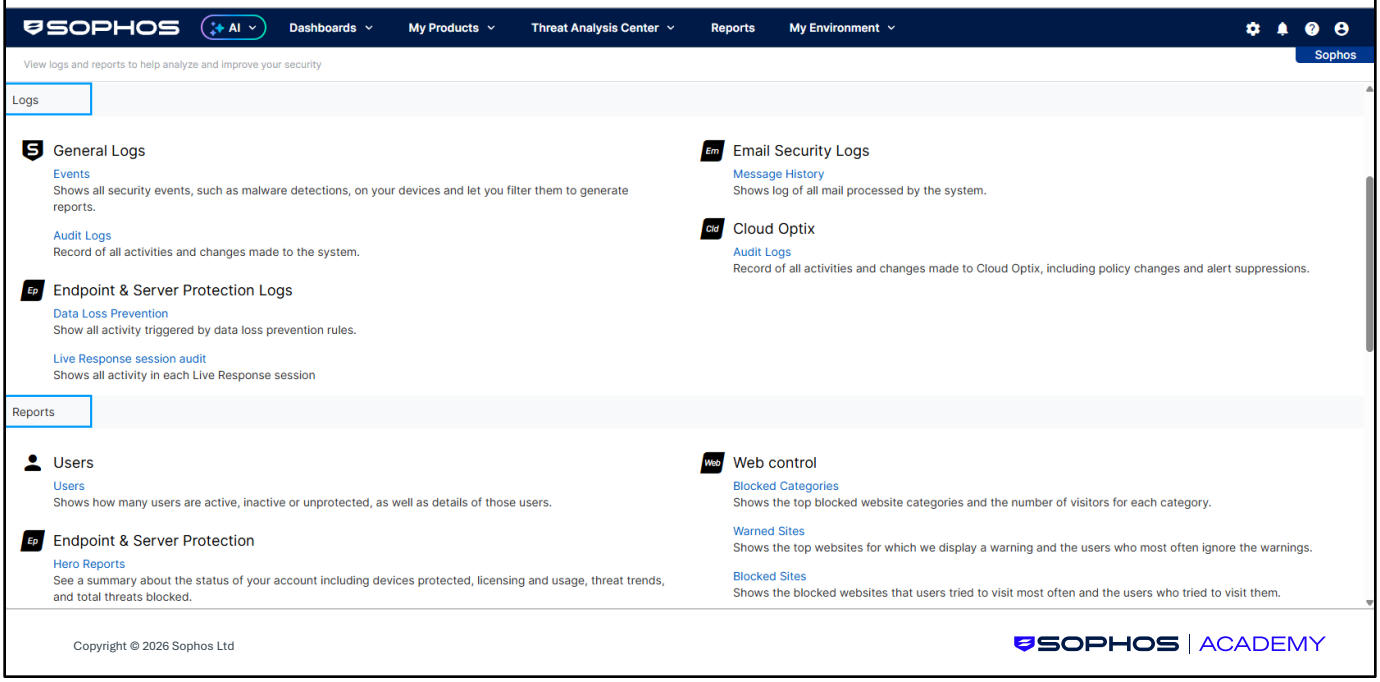
Overview



Sophos Endpoint provides an extensive range of logs and reports.

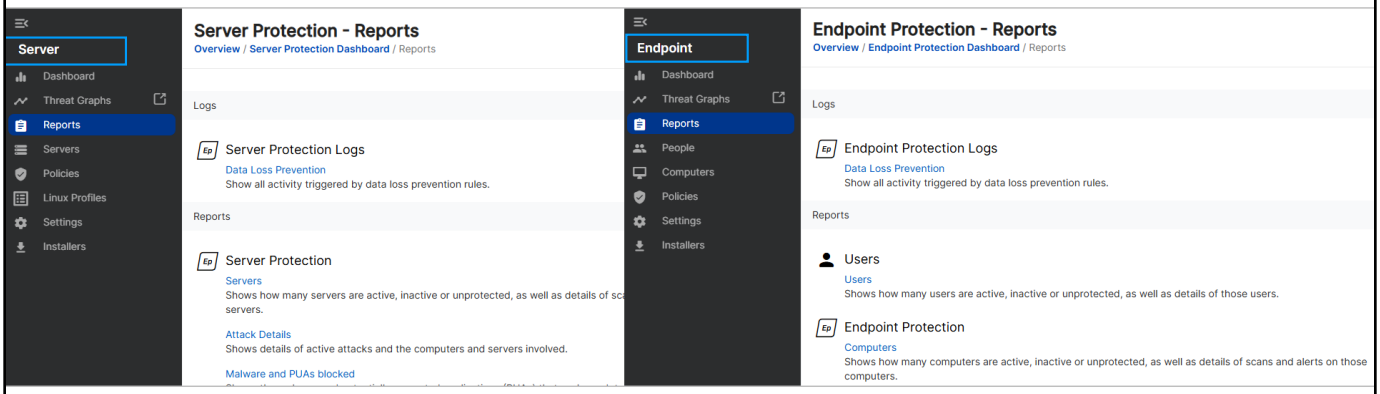
All logs and reports can be viewed by navigating to **Reports** in the top menu of Sophos Central.

Overview



The licenses held will determine which logs and reports are available.

Product Specific Reports



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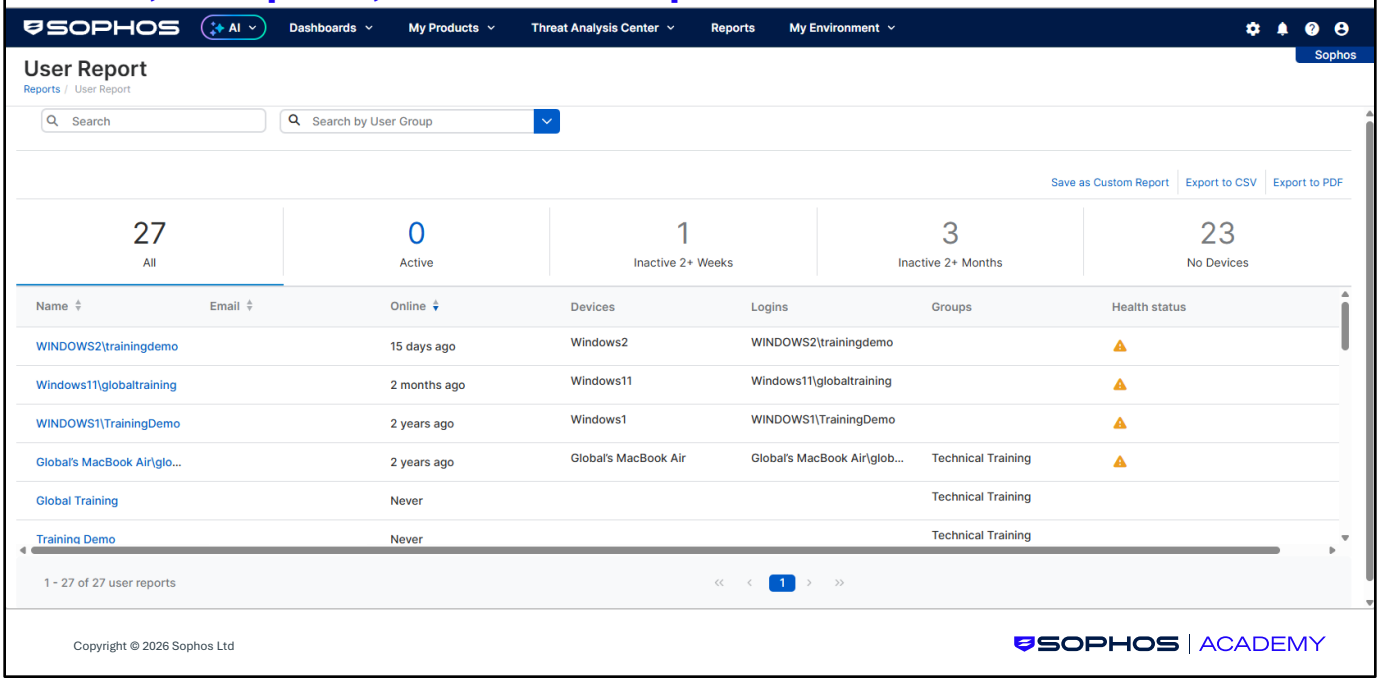
If you prefer to view only the logs and reports that are available for a specific product, navigate to the product-specific dashboard.

On the **Reports** page, you will find the reports and logs relevant only to that product.

User, Computer, and Server Reports



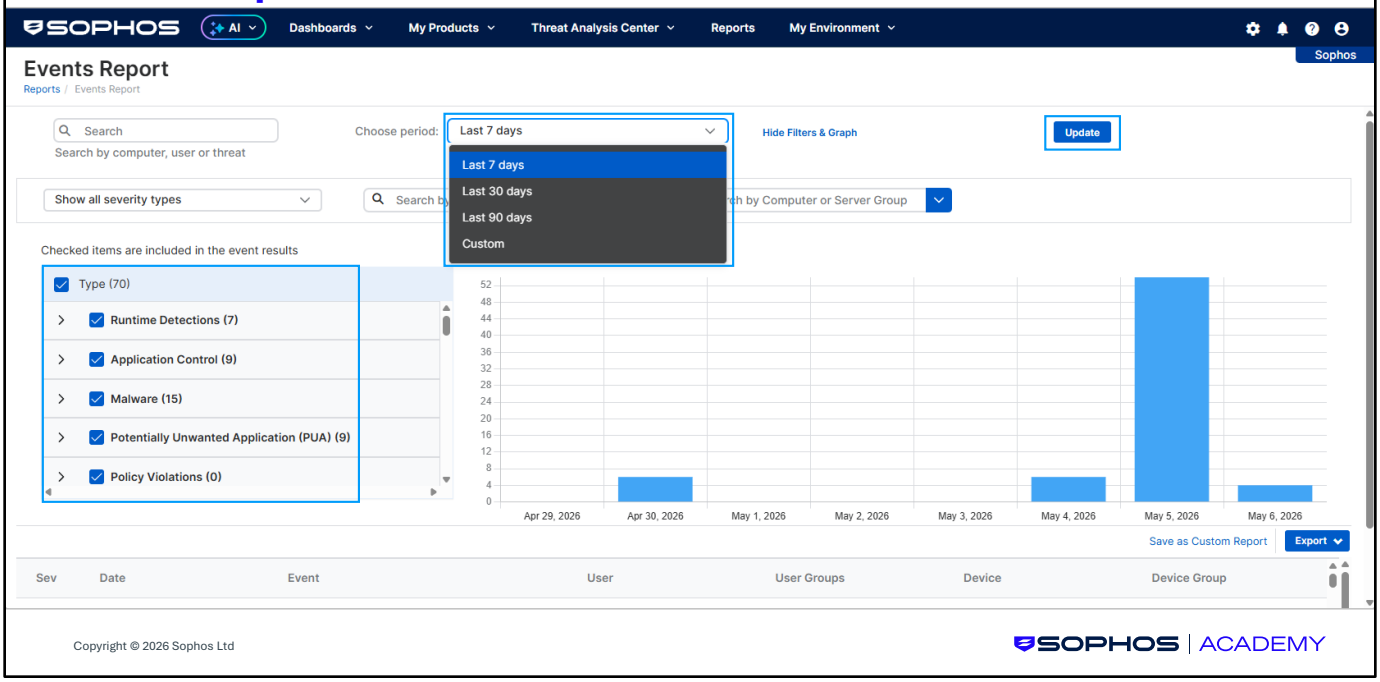
The reports for users, endpoints and servers all look similar.

They contain a summary view at the top of the page. Clicking on the numbers in the summary view will filter the report for the selected category.

The detailed information varies depending on the report; however, reports typically show details like associated devices, health status, login information, and management information.

You can use all this information to monitor protected devices and users and spot any inconsistencies.

Events Report

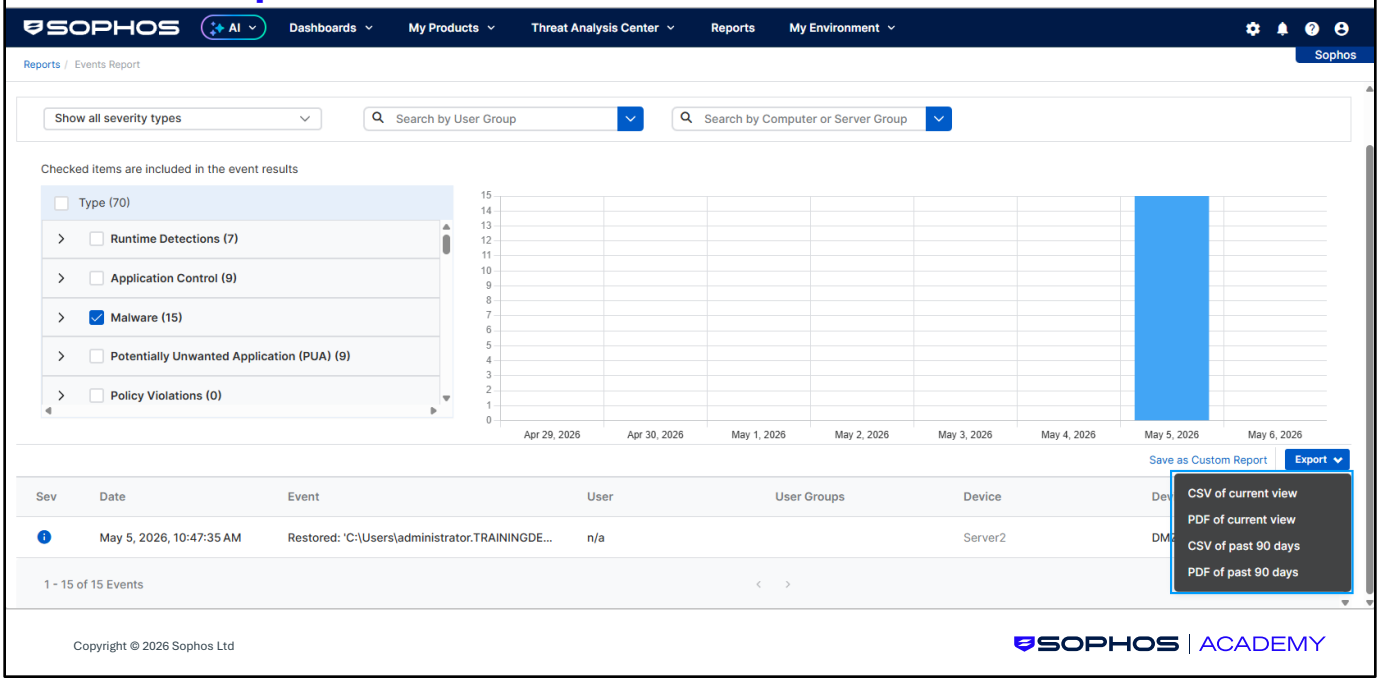


The events report provides information on all events. You can search for events and filter the date range allowing you to narrow down your search. Once you change any of the filters, click **Update** to update the report.

In the event list next to the graphical representation of events, you can filter the event types that are displayed. This filter is useful if you only want to focus on a particular event type, for example policy violations, or malware detections.

These filters can be further expanded for each event type so that you can report on the specific actions taken, for example, malware that has been detected, cleaned up, not cleaned up or locally cleared.

Events Report



In this example, we have filtered the report to show only malware events.

The report can be exported to either a CSV or a PDF. You can select to export the report details for the past 90 days, or use the current time filter you have configured.

Exporting event details can assist with the offline manipulation or presentation of the data.

Events Report

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G
1	Severity	When	Event	User	User Groups	Device	Device Groups
98	Low	2024-02-04T01:39:45Z	User bypassed category block to 'https://api.e.next.co.uk'	WINDOWS2\trainingdemo		Windows2	
99	Low	2024-02-04T01:39:45Z	'https://api.e.next.co.uk' warned due to category 'Shopping'	WINDOWS2\trainingdemo		Windows2	
100	Low	2024-02-04T01:39:45Z	'https://execution-ci360.next.co.uk' warned due to category 'Shopping'	WINDOWS2\trainingdemo		Windows2	
101	Low	2024-02-04T01:39:44Z	'https://4419639.fls.doubleclick.net/activityi;src=4419639;type=nxt01;cat=land01;ord=5640573428441;npa=0;u18=undefined;u23=undefined;pscdl=noapi;gcu=1;auiddc=165	WINDOWS2\trainingdemo		Windows2	
102	Low	2024-02-04T01:39:44Z	'https://stats.g.doubleclick.net/j/collect' blocked due to category 'Advertisements & Pop-Ups'	WINDOWS2\trainingdemo		Windows2	
103	Low	2024-02-04T01:39:43Z	'https://ade.googlesyndication.com/ddm/activity/src=4419639;type=nxt01;cat=land01;ord=6432011250510;npa=0;u18=undefined;u23=undefined;pscdl=denied;gtm=45He4	WINDOWS2\trainingdemo		Windows2	
104	Low	2024-02-04T01:39:41Z	'https://xcdn.next.co.uk' warned due to category 'Shopping'	WINDOWS2\trainingdemo		Windows2	
105	Low	2024-02-04T01:39:41Z	User bypassed category block to 'https://xcdn.next.co.uk'	WINDOWS2\trainingdemo		Windows2	
106	Low	2024-02-04T01:39:40Z	'https://www.next.co.uk' warned due to category 'Shopping'	WINDOWS2\trainingdemo		Windows2	
107	Low	2024-02-04T01:39:40Z	User bypassed category block to 'https://next.co.uk'	WINDOWS2\trainingdemo		Windows2	
108	Low	2024-02-04T01:39:40Z	User bypassed category block to 'https://www.next.co.uk'	WINDOWS2\trainingdemo		Windows2	
109	Low	2024-02-04T01:39:40Z	'https://next.co.uk' warned due to category 'Shopping'	WINDOWS2\trainingdemo		Windows2	
110	Low	2024-02-04T01:39:23Z	'https://www.bet365.com/' blocked due to category 'Gambling'	WINDOWS2\trainingdemo		Windows2	
111	Low	2024-02-02T11:21:59Z	Restored: 'C:\Users\trainingdemo\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\Cache\Cache_Data\f_00014d' and associated items	WINDOWS2\trainingdemo		Windows2	
112	Low	2024-02-02T11:21:59Z	Restored: 'C:\Users\trainingdemo\Downloads\Unconfirmed 344313.crdownload' and associated items	WINDOWS2\trainingdemo		Windows2	
113	Low	2024-02-02T11:21:59Z	Restored: 'C:\Users\trainingdemo\Downloads\Unconfirmed 344313.crdownload' and associated items	WINDOWS2\trainingdemo		Windows2	
114	Medium	2024-02-02T11:18:25Z	Manual PUA cleanup required: 'KPortScan' at 'C:\Users\r.mason\Downloads\kportscan.zip'	Ruby Mason	Administrators (TRAININGDEMO)	Windows3	
115	Medium	2024-02-02T11:18:16Z	PUA detected: 'KPortScan' at 'C:\Users\r.mason\Downloads\kportscan.zip'	Ruby Mason	Administrators (TRAININGDEMO)	Windows3	
116	Medium	2024-02-02T11:04:49Z	Manual PUA cleanup required: 'PsExec' at 'C:\Users\r.mason\Downloads\PSTools.zip'	Ruby Mason	Administrators (TRAININGDEMO)	Windows3	
117	Medium	2024-02-02T11:04:49Z	Manual PUA cleanup required: 'PsKill' at 'C:\Users\r.mason\Downloads\PSTools.zip'	Ruby Mason	Administrators (TRAININGDEMO)	Windows3	
118	Medium	2024-02-02T11:04:49Z	Manual PUA cleanup required: 'PsExec' at 'C:\Users\r.mason\Downloads\PSTools.zip'	Ruby Mason	Administrators (TRAININGDEMO)	Windows3	
119	Medium	2024-02-02T11:04:49Z	Manual PUA cleanup required: 'PsKill' at 'C:\Users\r.mason\Downloads\PSTools.zip'	Ruby Mason	Administrators (TRAININGDEMO)	Windows3	
120	Medium	2024-02-02T11:04:38Z	PUA detected: 'PsExec' at 'C:\Users\r.mason\Downloads\PSTools.zip'	Ruby Mason	Administrators (TRAININGDEMO)	Windows3	
121	Medium	2024-02-02T11:04:38Z	PUA detected: 'PsKill' at 'C:\Users\r.mason\Downloads\PSTools.zip'	Ruby Mason	Administrators (TRAININGDEMO)	Windows3	
122	Medium	2024-02-02T11:04:38Z	PUA detected: 'PsExec' at 'C:\Users\r.mason\Downloads\PSTools.zip'	Ruby Mason	Administrators (TRAININGDEMO)	Windows3	
123	Medium	2024-02-02T11:04:38Z	PUA detected: 'PsKill' at 'C:\Users\r.mason\Downloads\PSTools.zip'	Ruby Mason	Administrators (TRAININGDEMO)	Windows3	
124	Low	2024-02-02T10:59:29Z	PUA cleaned up: 'DiskCryptor' at 'C:\Users\trainingdemo\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\Cache\Cache_Data\f_00014d'	WINDOWS2\trainingdemo		Windows2	
125	Low	2024-02-02T10:59:29Z	PUA cleaned up: 'DiskCryptor' at 'C:\Users\trainingdemo\Downloads\Unconfirmed 344313.crdownload'	WINDOWS2\trainingdemo		Windows2	
126	Low	2024-02-02T10:59:29Z	PUA cleaned up: 'DiskCryptor' at 'C:\Users\trainingdemo\Downloads\Unconfirmed 344313.crdownload'	WINDOWS2\trainingdemo		Windows2	
127	Medium	2024-02-02T10:58:55Z	PUA detected: 'DiskCryptor' at 'C:\Users\trainingdemo\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\Cache\Cache_Data\f_00014d'	WINDOWS2\trainingdemo		Windows2	
128	Medium	2024-02-02T10:58:55Z	PUA detected: 'DiskCryptor' at 'C:\Users\trainingdemo\Downloads\Unconfirmed 344313.crdownload'	WINDOWS2\trainingdemo		Windows2	
129	Medium	2024-02-02T10:58:55Z	PUA detected: 'DiskCryptor' at 'C:\Users\trainingdemo\Downloads\Unconfirmed 344313.crdownload'	WINDOWS2\trainingdemo		Windows2	
130	Low	2024-02-02T10:03:55Z	PUA cleaned up: 'Generic Reputation PUA' at 'C:\Users\r.mason\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\Cache\Cache_Data\f_000104'	Ruby Mason	Administrators (TRAININGDEMO)	Windows3	
131	Medium	2024-02-02T10:03:22Z	PUA detected: 'Generic Reputation PUA' at 'C:\Users\r.mason\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\Cache\Cache_Data\f_000104'	Ruby Mason	Administrators (TRAININGDEMO)	Windows3	
132							
133							

report

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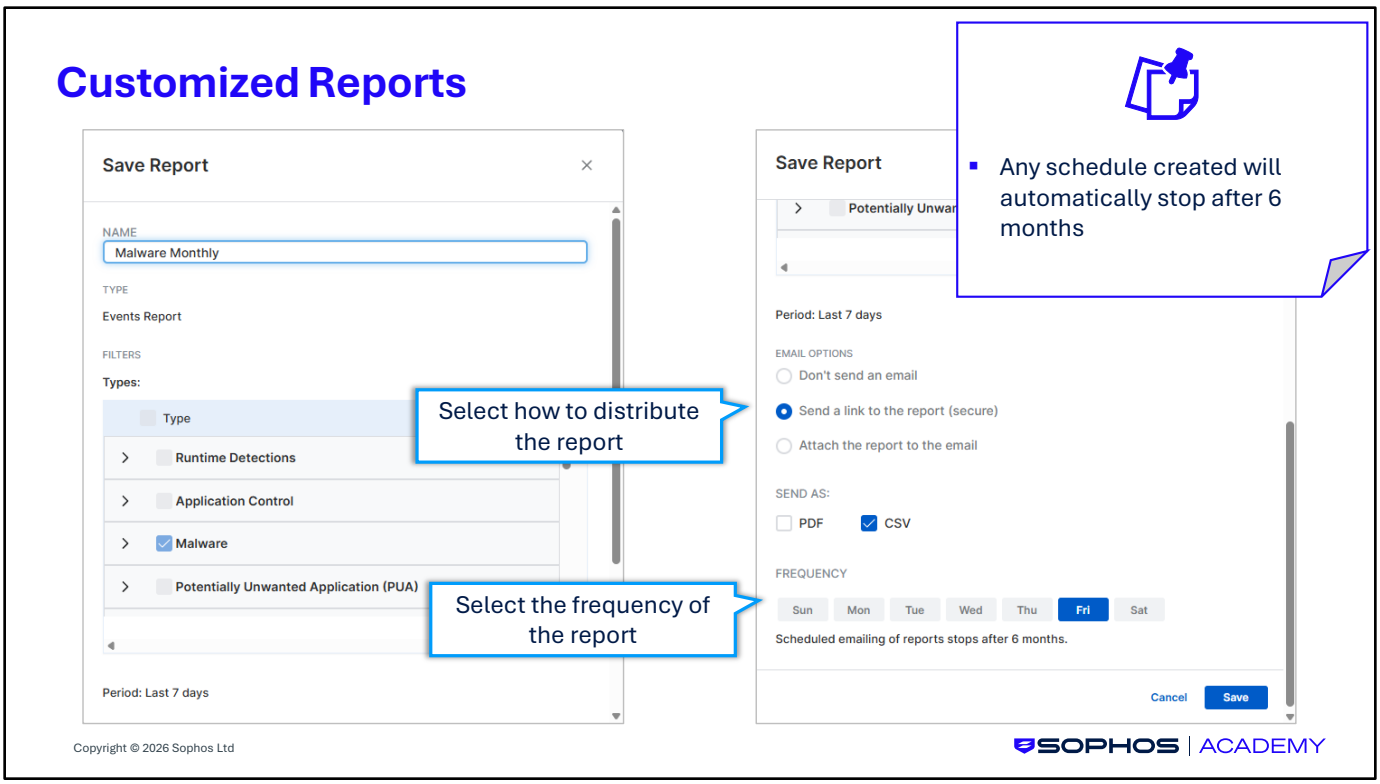
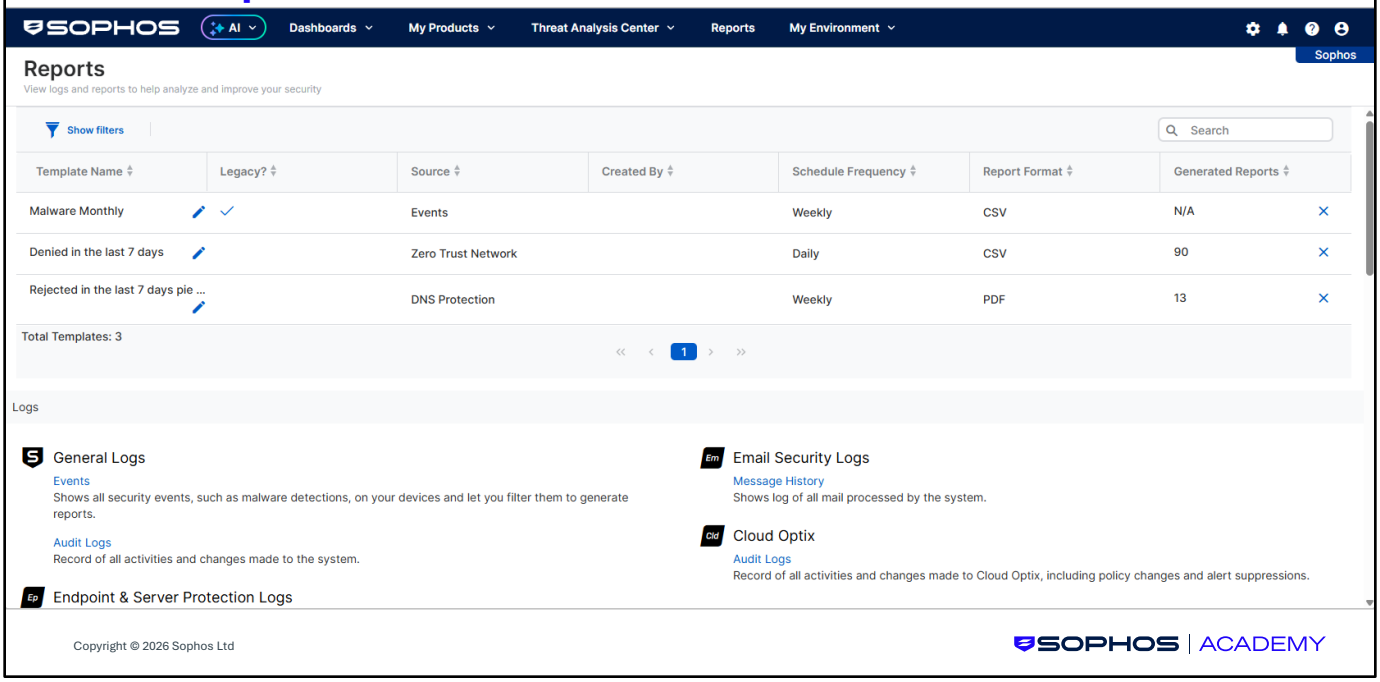
You can save the report to suit your individual requirements once it has been exported.



You can customize the events report and then save it. Once saved, it will retain all the filters applied.

To save a report, click **Save as Custom Report**. Name the report and select how you want to distribute the report. Note that if you are including personally identifiable information in the report, we recommend that you select to send a link to the report rather than attach the report to an email. Schedule the frequency at which the report is sent. Note that any schedule created will automatically stop after 6 months.

Saved Reports



Once you have saved a report, it is easily run from the **Reports** page. A list of all saved reports are displayed at the top of the **Reports** page. You can view who created them, their format and their scheduled frequency.

There are two types of report formats, legacy and newer. You can determine if a report is using the legacy format by viewing the legacy column.

Scheduled Reports

Legacy Reports

- Each administrator can configure up to 25 scheduled reports
- Scheduled reports expire after 6 months
- Maximum of 10,000 events per report or log
- Only the administrator who created the report can view them

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Legacy reports use an older format and have some restrictions. Each administrator can configure up to twenty-five scheduled reports. Scheduled reports expire after six months. You can edit the scheduled report and save it anew to reset this timer. There is a maximum of ten thousand events per report or log, and only the administrator who created the report can view the report.

Scheduled Reports

Newer Reports

- Each administrator can configure up to 100 scheduled reports
- Any administrator who has access can view the reports
- Reports are sent in the language of the Sophos Central Admin account configured

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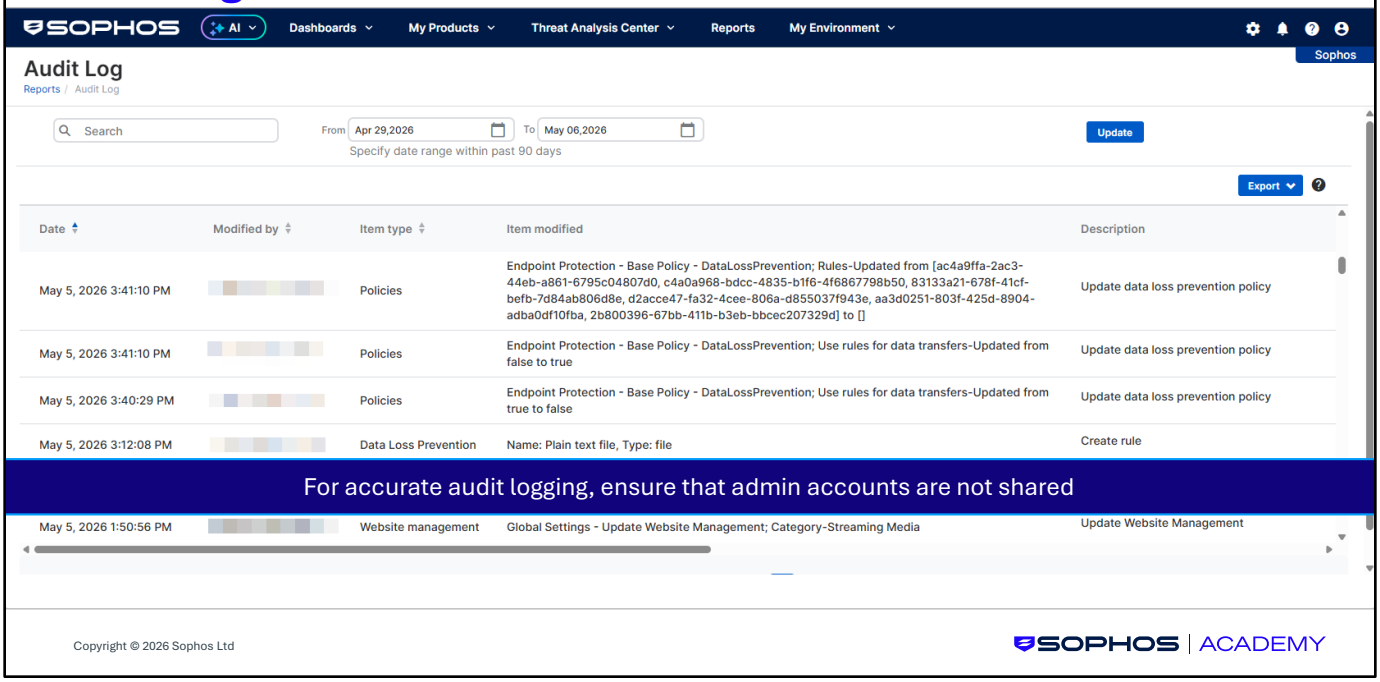
Newer reports do not have the same restrictions as the legacy format. Each administrator can configure a maximum of one hundred scheduled reports. This means you can have up to one hundred reports for all the features that use this report format. Any administrator who has access can view the reports, and reports are sent in the language of the Sophos Central Admin account configured.

Audit Log



Using the audit log report, you can review and export a record of all activities monitored by Sophos Central.

The audit log shows all activities for the past seven days by default; however, you can view all activities for up to 90 days and export the report.

For accurate audit logging, ensure that admin accounts are not shared.

Here are the three main things you learned in this chapter.

The available logs and reports will depend on your licensed products.

The events report details all events across all protected devices.

Reports can be customized and saved to be run at regular intervals.

[Additional Information]

Sophos Endpoint
EP4010: Getting Started with Health Checks

May 2026

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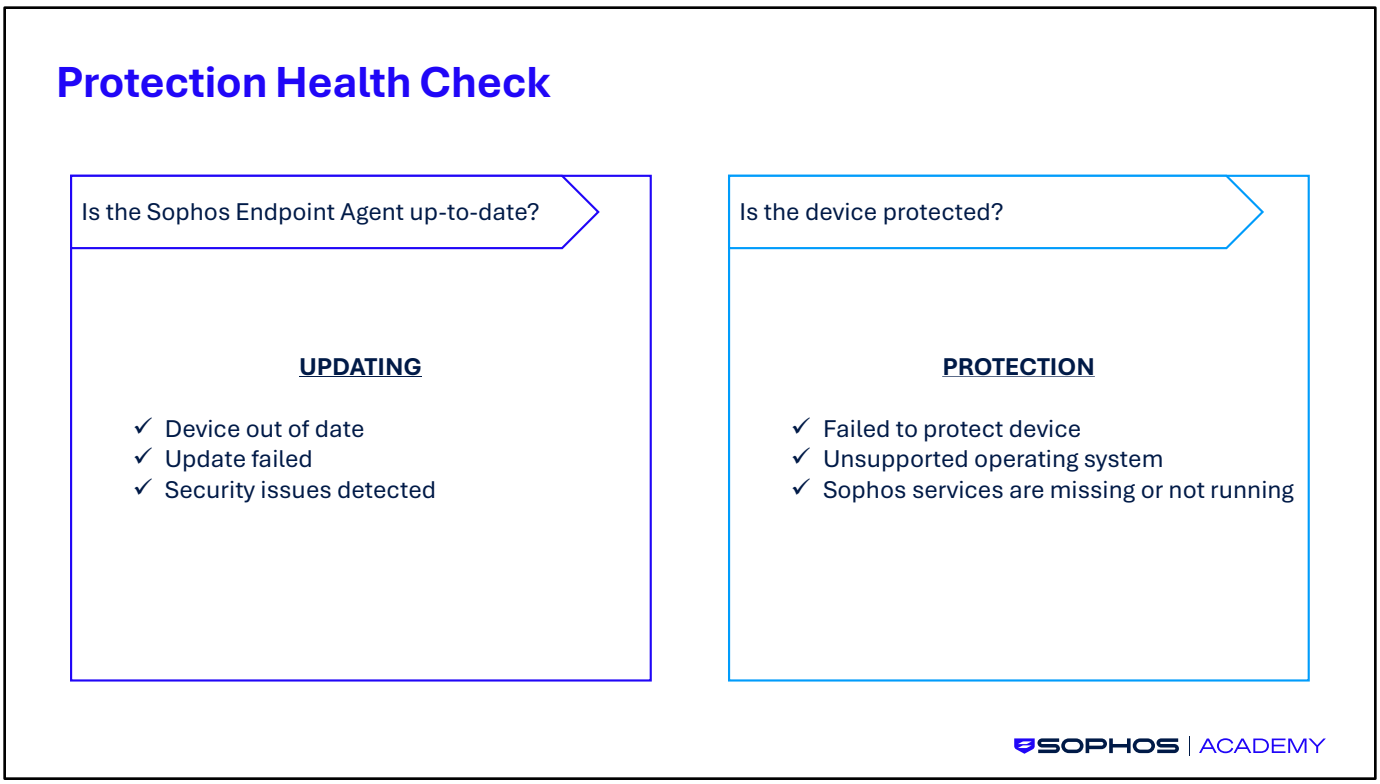
In this chapter, you will learn how to check the health of your protected devices and which tools are available in Sophos Central to help maintain security health.



We recommend that you review the protection and health of all protected devices. Ensure that all protected devices are up-to-date and reporting to Sophos Central. If you have devices that are not reporting back, ensure you know the reason why. To review the protection of your devices, evaluate both the update and protection status: Are devices able to update successfully? Are any protected devices out of date, or is the update failing? Have any security issues been detected?

The devices report allows you to review the protection of your devices in one place. You can filter the report by health status, allowing you to focus on those devices with a bad health status. Check your device protection to ensure that an installation has not failed and that Sophos services are running. Ensure there are no errors being returned and that the device is not running on an unsupported operating system. Check that the Sophos Central management has not been overridden on the device and that the Sophos Security Heartbeat is not missing or failed.

If any of these issues occur and cannot be remediated automatically, an alert will be displayed in Sophos Central requesting manual intervention.

Protection Health Check

How often?

- As part of a detection investigation
- When remediating events and alerts
- As frequently as possible

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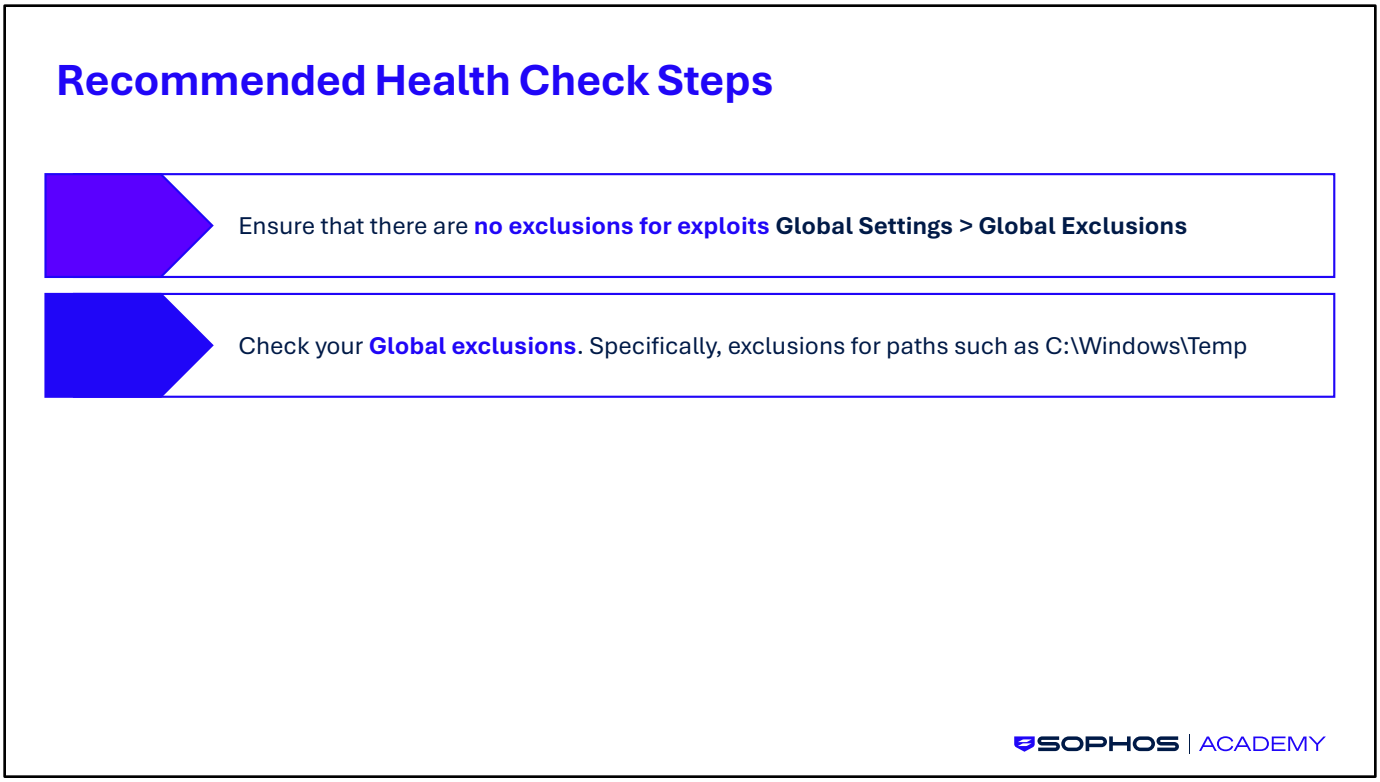
So, how often should you be running health checks? We recommend that if you are investigating a detection, you check the overall health of all protected devices.

Additionally, when remediating events and alerts, health checks should be carried out as frequently as possible to ensure security.

It is worth working through the following steps regularly to ensure security.

Ensure that no exploit exclusions have been turned on in Sophos Central. If an exclusion has been applied, an exploit will not be detected and can exploit your network.



Check your **global exclusions**, particularly exclusions to paths such as C:\Windows\Temp or other common directories. If an attacker has access to common directories, it makes it easier to move through your network.

Recommended Health Check Steps

- Ensure that there are **no exclusions for exploits** **Global Settings > Global Exclusions**
- Check your **Global exclusions**. Specifically, exclusions for paths such as C:\Windows\Temp
- Check your **endpoint and server threat protection policies**. Are there any local policy exclusions that have been applied to directories such as \\AppData\Local\Temp

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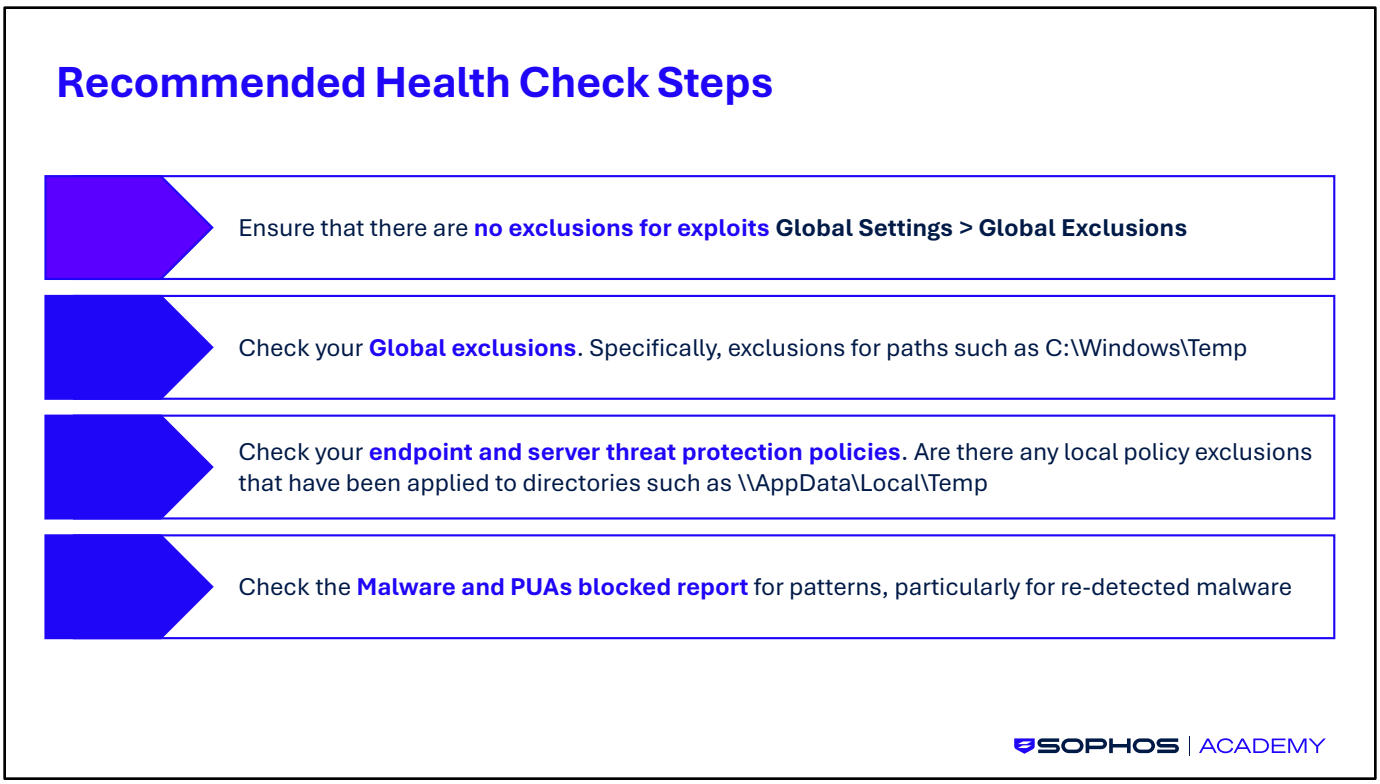
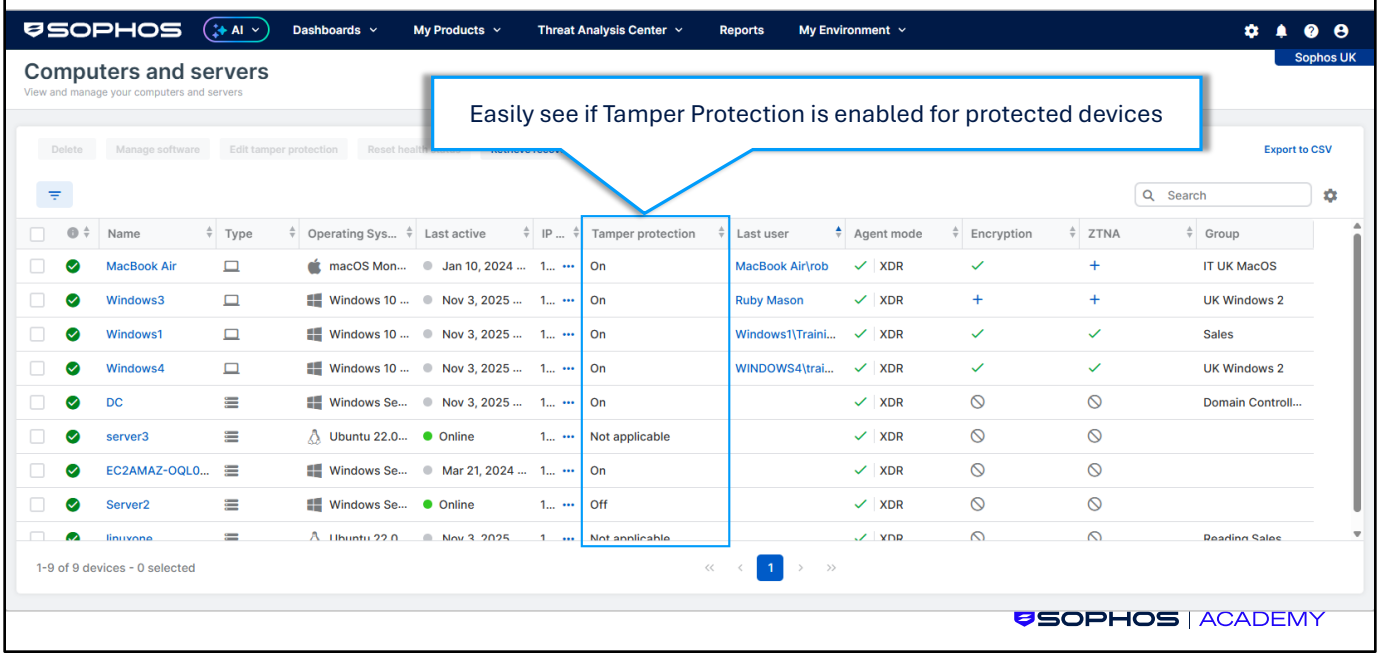
Check the threat protection policies for local exclusions that may have been applied to resolve an intermittent issue and not removed.



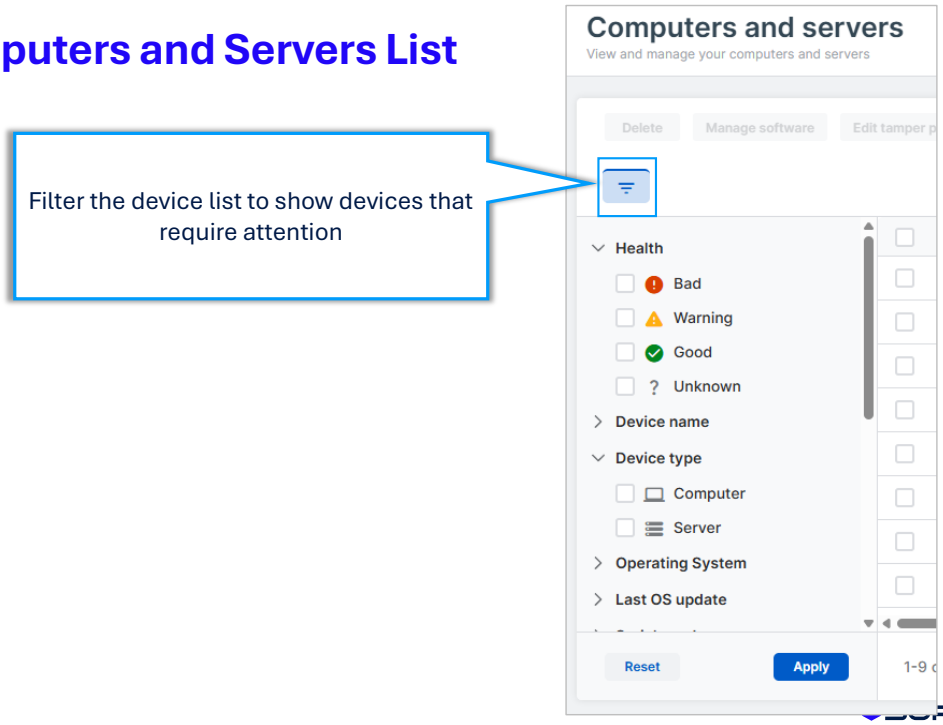
Check the **Malware and PUAs blocked report** in Sophos Central. This report is useful in determining patterns, particularly if malware is being re-detected across your network.

Computers and Servers List



Several built-in features alert you to issues during health checks. For example, on the Devices page, the ‘Tamper protection’ column indicates whether Tamper Protection is enabled or disabled for protected devices. We recommend that Tamper Protection be enabled for all protected devices.

Computers and Servers List



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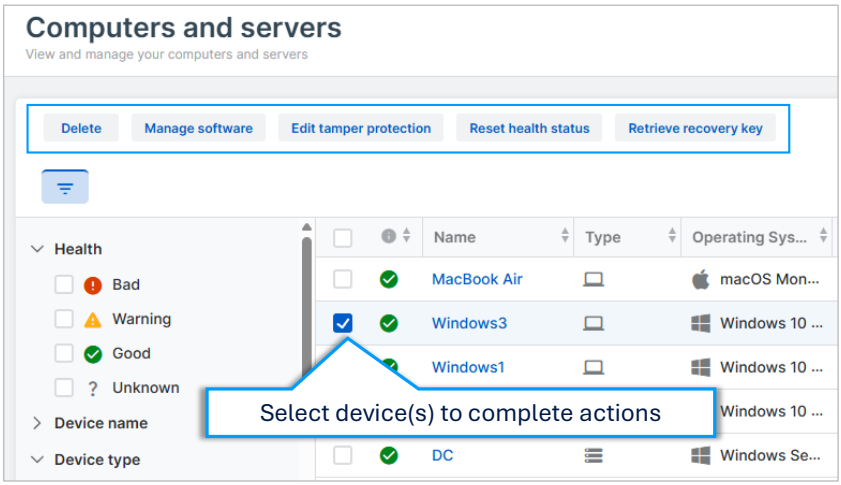
The protected device pages can be filtered by health and devices with Tamper Protection turned off. This allows you to filter the device page to show only those devices that require attention.

Computers and Servers List



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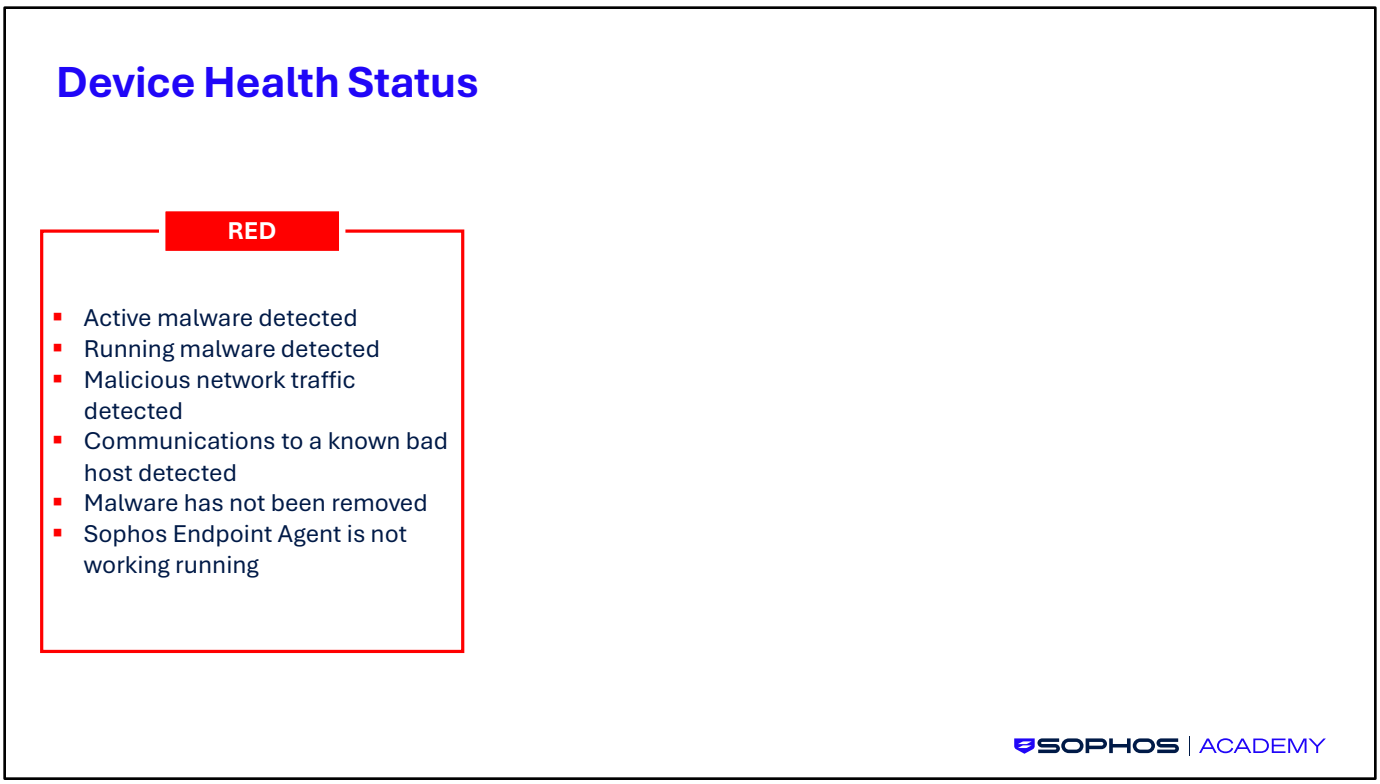
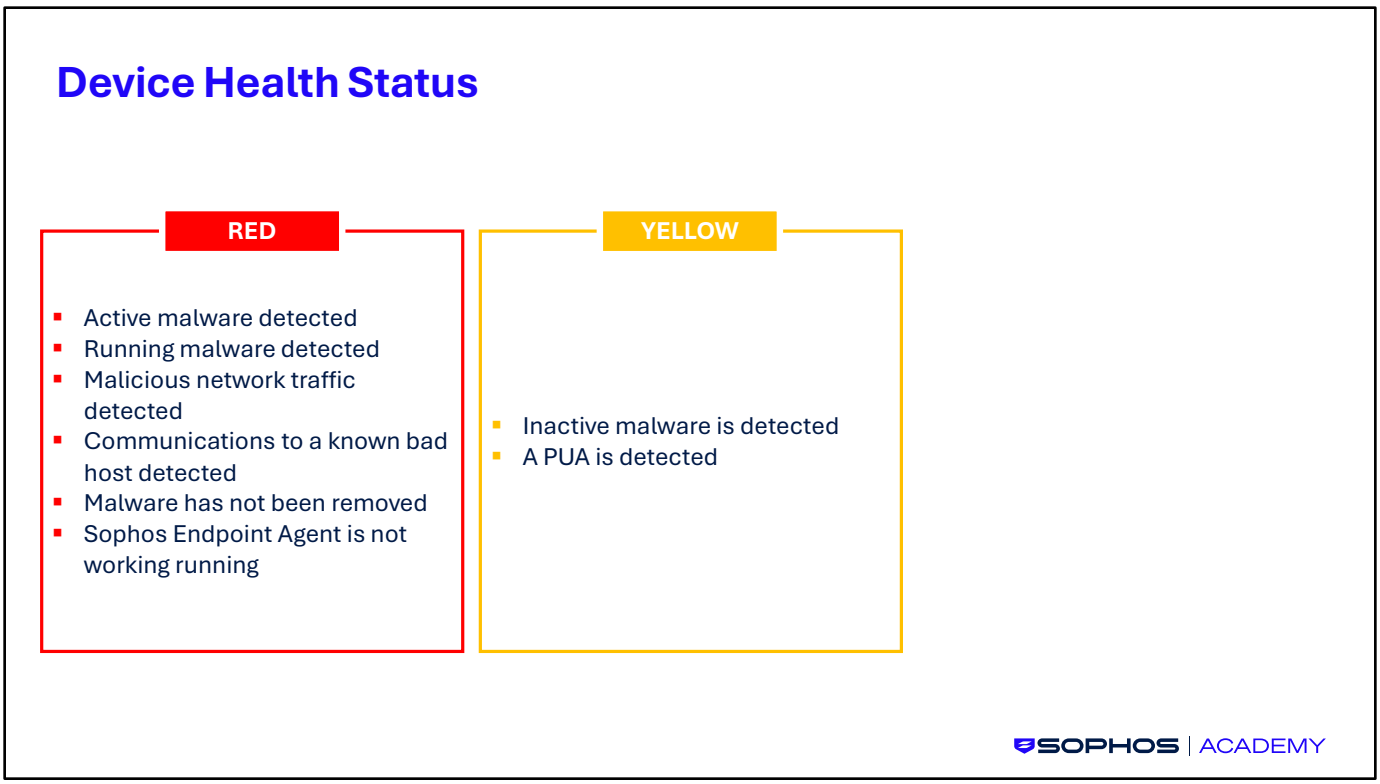
Selecting a device from the list will show additional options that help manage and remediate devices. For remediation, this means you can easily turn on Tamper Protection if it is turned off and reset the health status of a device.

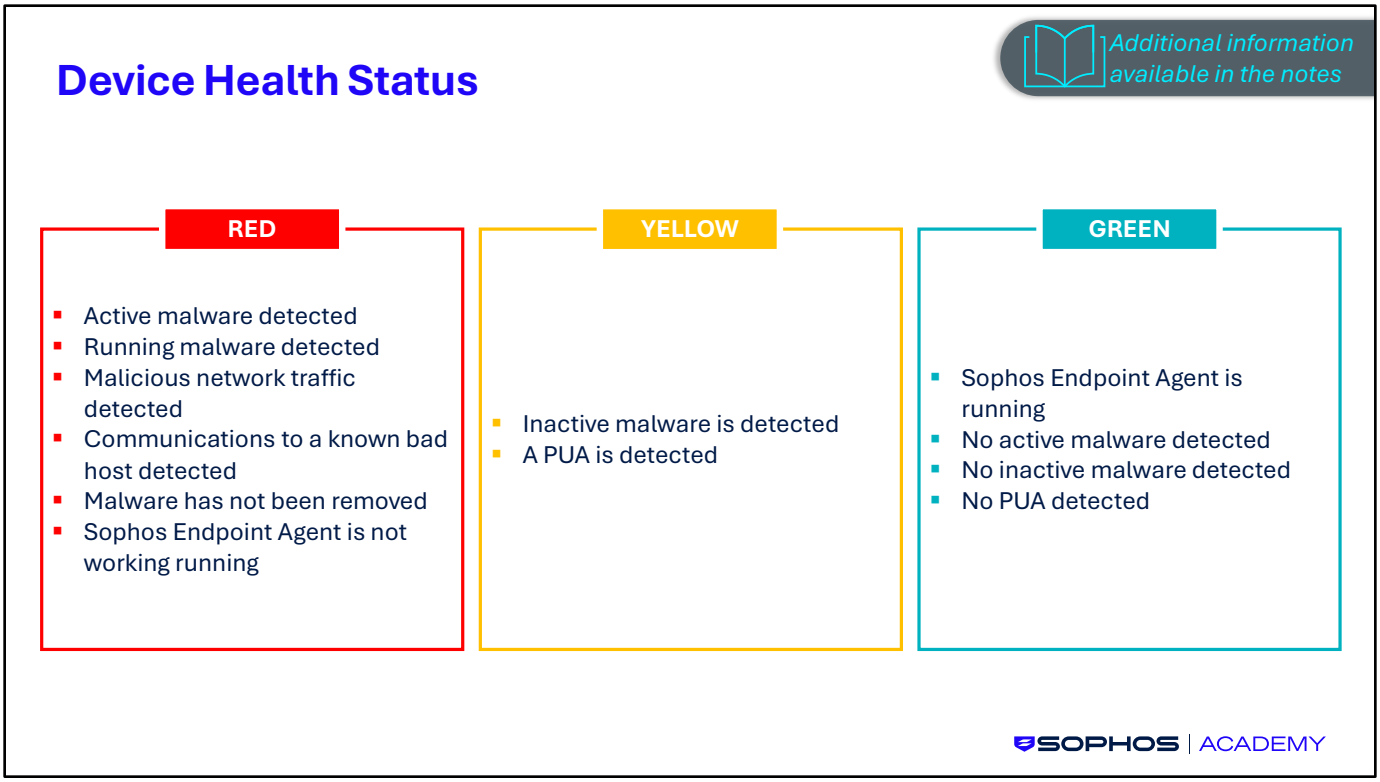


The health status of protected devices is important as it can indicate that a device has been compromised.

If a device shows a red status, it can indicate that active or running malware has been detected, malicious network traffic has been detected, or communications with a known bad host. It can also indicate that malware has not been removed automatically or that the Sophos Endpoint Agent is not running.



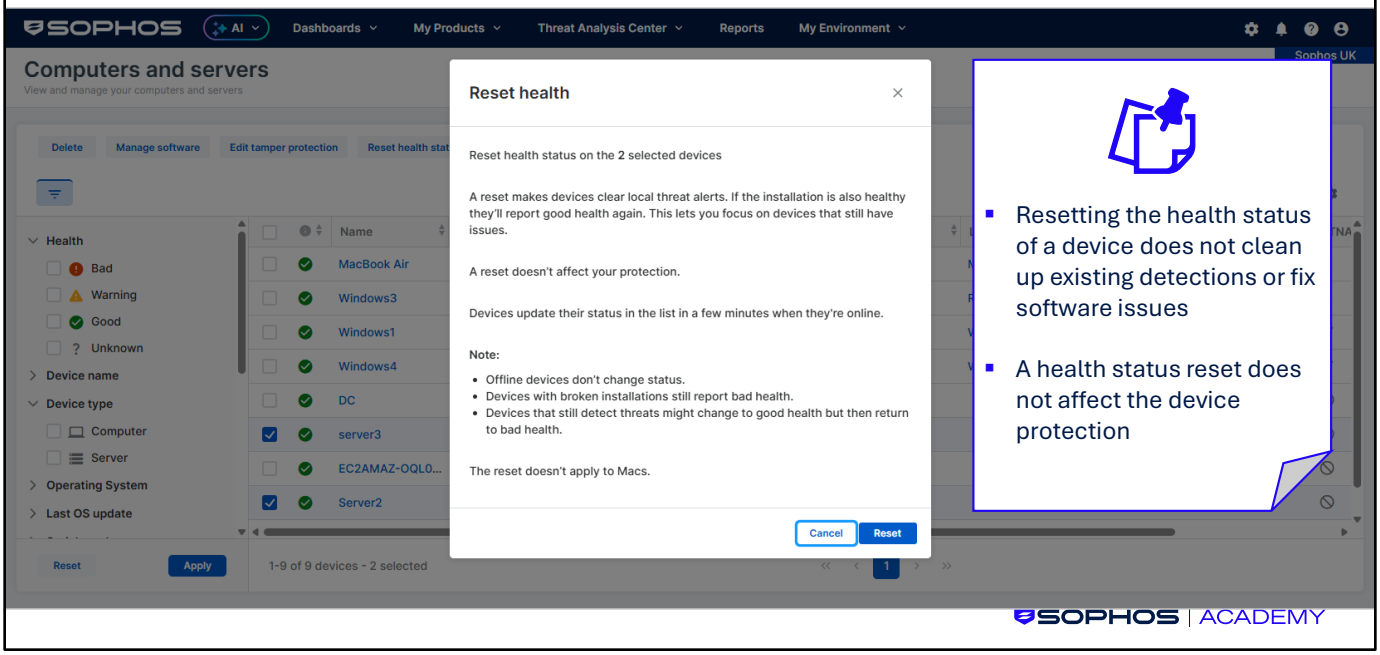
If a device is showing a yellow status, it can indicate that inactive malware has been detected or that a PUA has been detected.



A device with a green status is considered healthy. The Sophos Endpoint Agent is running with no errors, no active or inactive malware has been detected, and no PUAs have been detected.

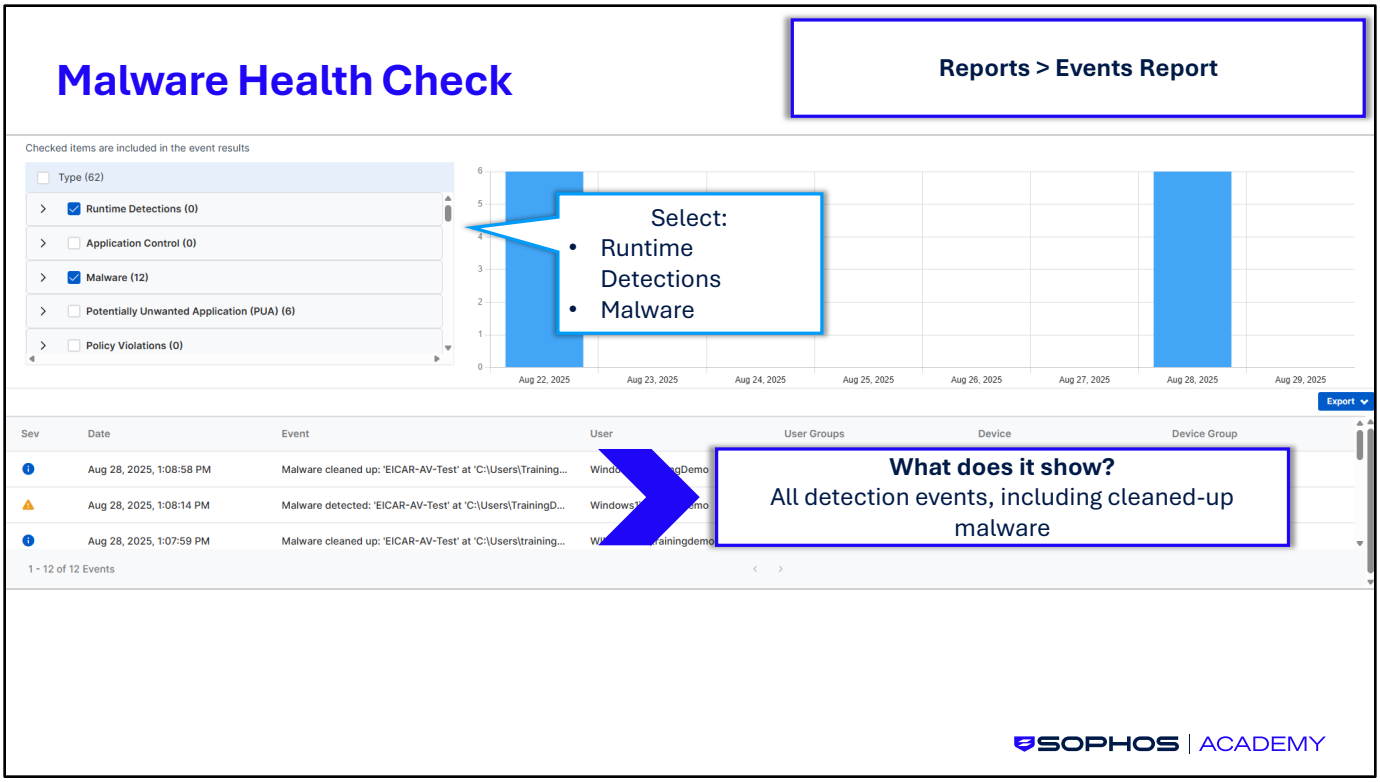
[Additional Information]
For further information regarding the health status of devices, see knowledge base article **KB-000035572**. Sophos Security Heartbeat: The different endpoint health status
https://support.sophos.com/support/s/article/KB-000035572

Device Health Status



You can reset the security health status of selected devices to green or ‘healthy’. It is important to note that resetting the health status of a device does not clean up threats or fix software issues. A health status reset will clear the alerts for a device in Sophos Central and in the Sophos Endpoint Agent. A health status reset can be completed if you want to clear old issues and focus on a current issue or future issues. Devices that are issue-free stay ‘healthy’ after the reset, so any current or future protection or malware issues will be more obvious.

To reset the health status, select the devices from the device list and click **Reset health status**. This doesn't affect protection, if a device has an issue that requires action, the status of the device will return to yellow or red to indicate a bad health status. Note that the option to reset the health status is not available for macOS devices.

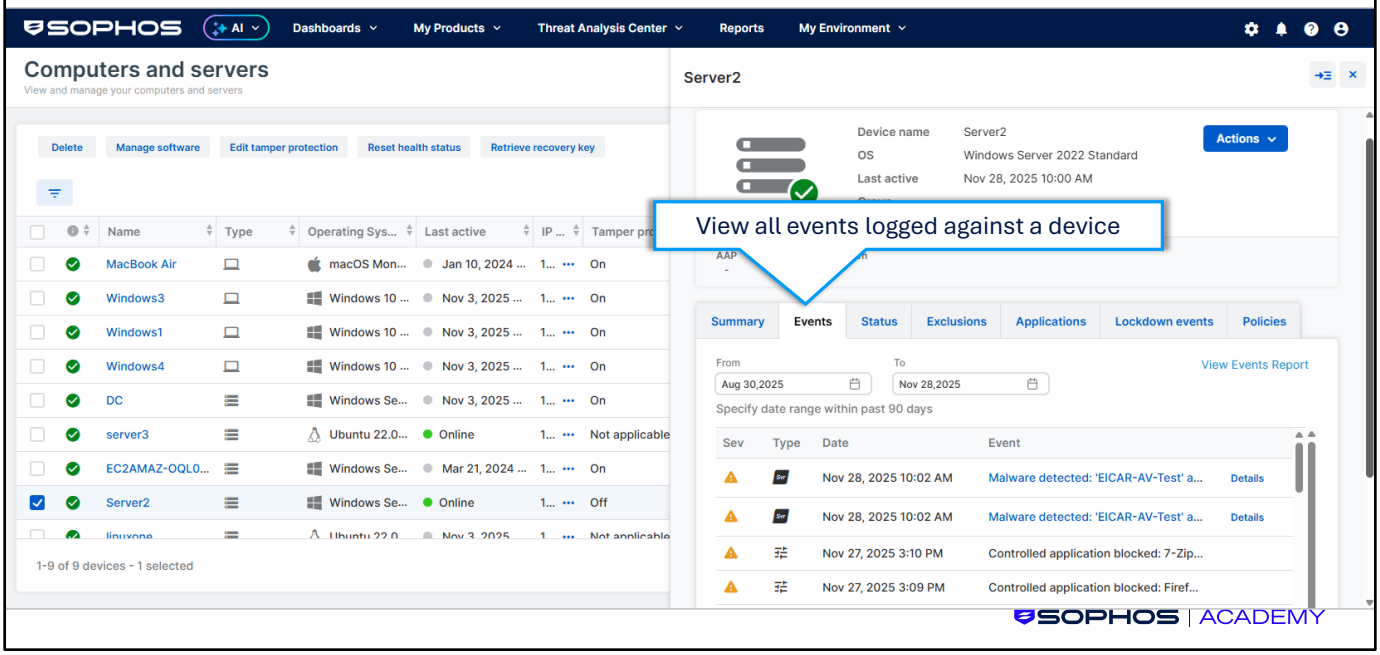


To check the malware health of your estate, you can filter the **Events Report** to display only runtime detections and malware events, including malware that has been cleaned up automatically.

For example, if you have a compromised device that is trying to contact other devices on the network. You may see several malware events shown in this report which could indicate that there is something on the device that needs manual investigation to remediate.

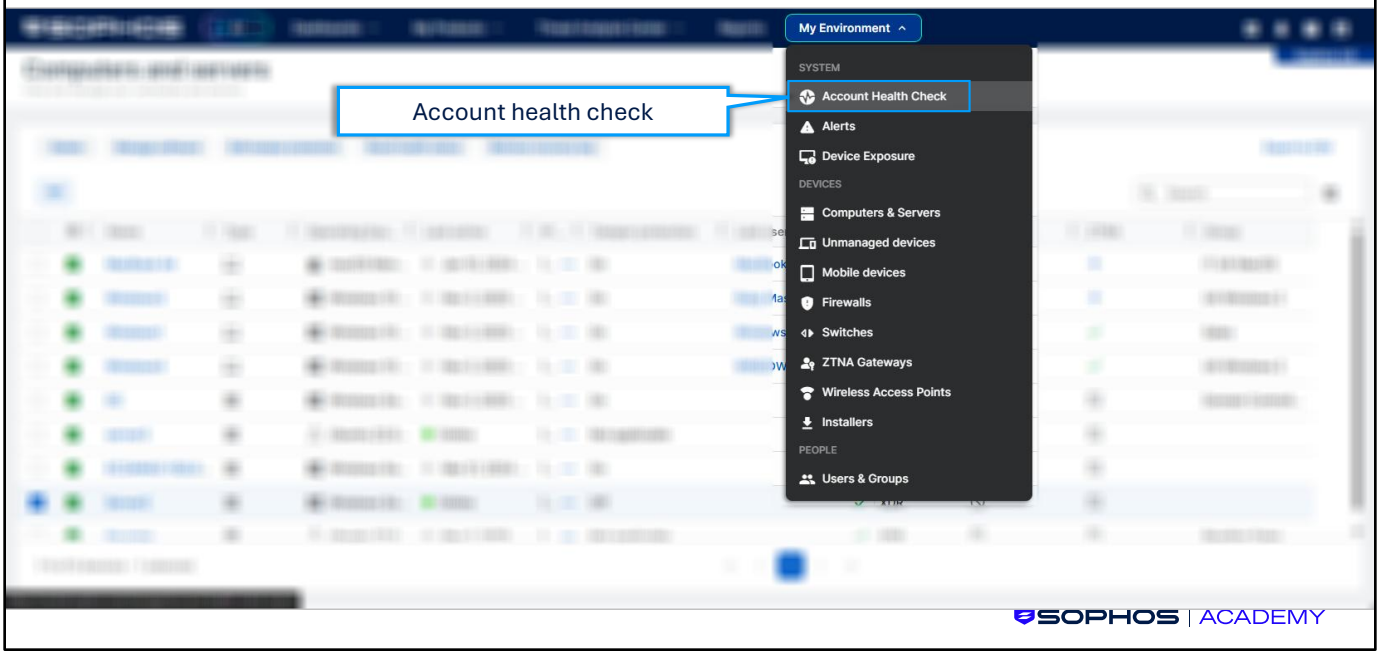
Optionally you can select to include potentially unwanted applications in the report. This can be useful, as attackers can make use of applications to exploit a device.

Device Health Status



The health status of any protected device is displayed on the device page. The **Events** tab allows you to view the events that have taken place on the device.

Account Health Check



The Account Health Check dashboard displays the overall health of your security products. The health check scores for each section reflect whether your devices or policies are using the recommended security settings.

All scores are out of 100, and a score of 100 indicates that no issues were found.

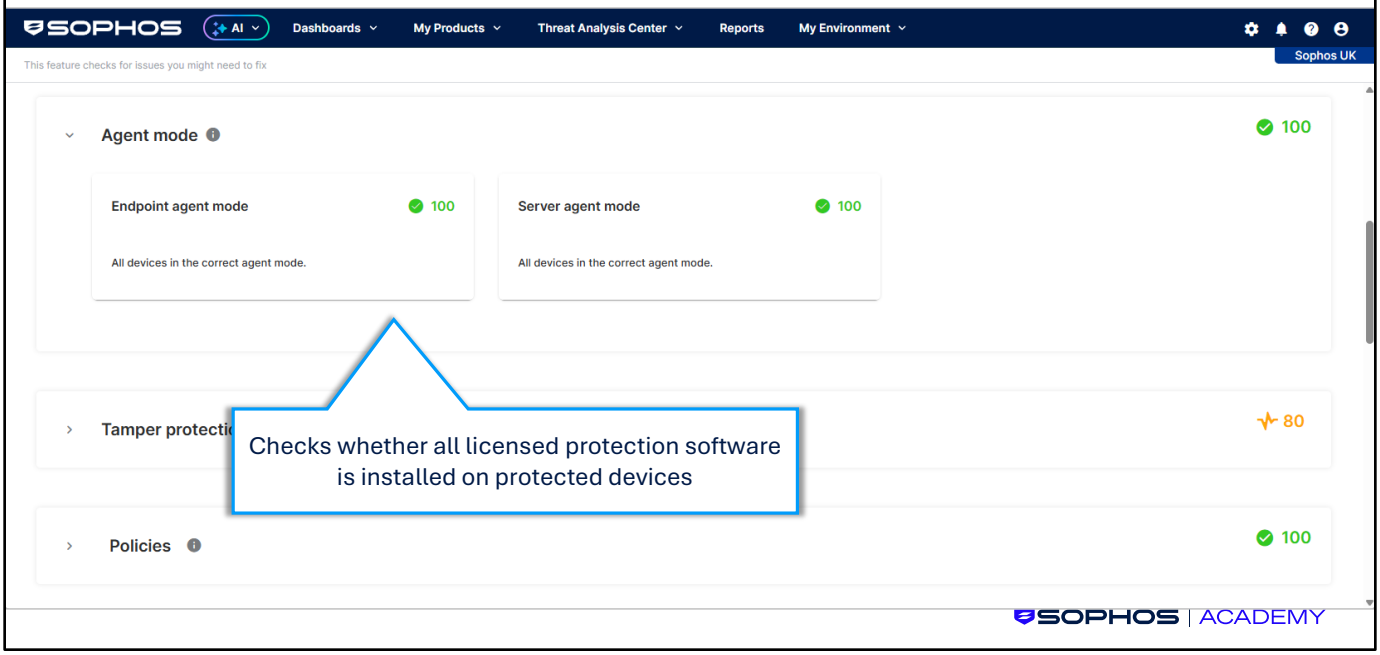
Account Health Check

An overall health score out of 100 is presented. This overall score is the lowest score of all the health checks combined. The score is split into good health, issues, and snoozed issues. Snoozed issues are those that have been postponed.

The health check scores are split by security feature and are calculated based on the number of devices or settings that comply with the recommended security settings.

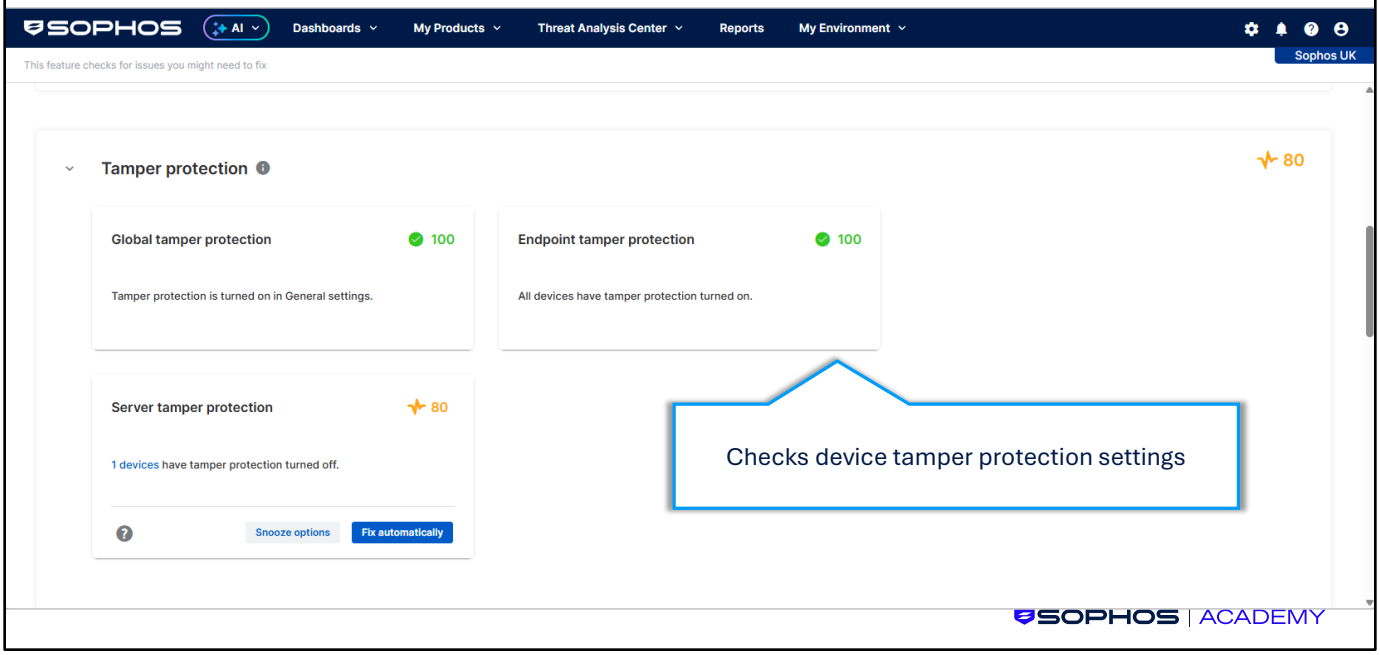
[Additional Information]
For information on how scores are calculated, view the help file here: [Health check scores - Sophos Central Admin](https://docs.sophos.com/central/Customer/help/en-us/ManageYourProducts/AccountHealthCheck/HealthCheckScores/index.html#scores-for-each-security-feature)
https://docs.sophos.com/central/Customer/help/en-us/ManageYourProducts/AccountHealthCheck/HealthCheckScores/index.html#scores-for-each-security-feature

Agent Mode



Let's have a look at the currently available sections. Firstly, the 'Agent mode' section which checks whether all the licensed protection software is installed on all protected devices. If Account Health Check warns that devices do not have all the licensed protection software installed, you can select to fix the issue automatically or manually.

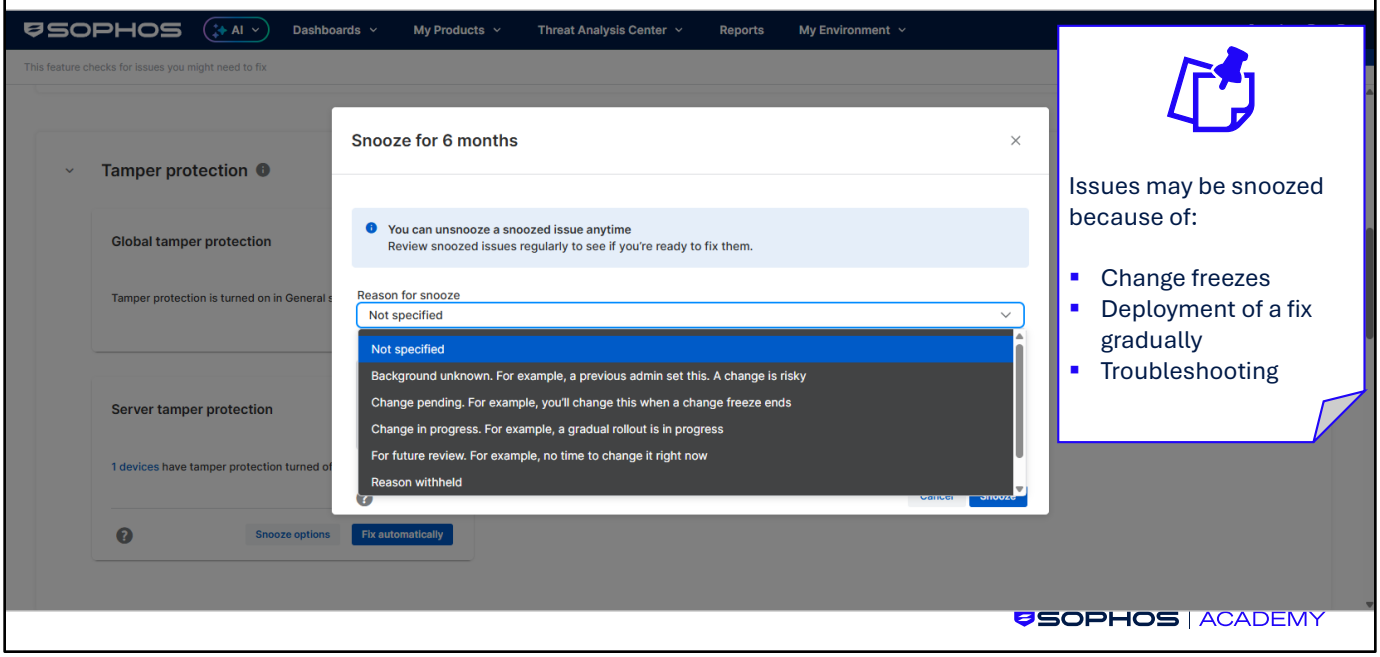
Tamper Protection



The ‘Tamper Protection’ section indicates if any devices have Tamper Protection turned off. The health check will also check the general settings for Tamper Protection.

If the general setting is disabled, it needs to be enabled before you can enable Tamper Protection for individual devices. We recommend checking those devices that have Tamper Protection disabled to understand why, without this protection, devices are more vulnerable to attack.

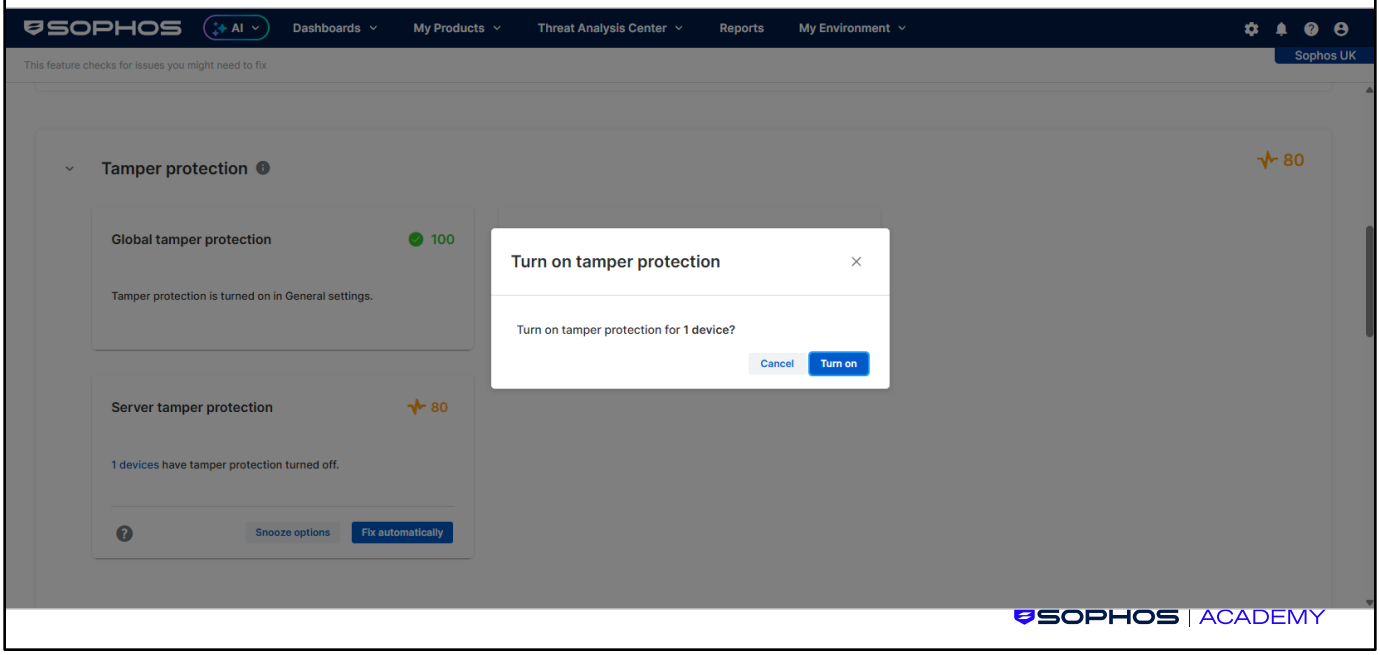
Snooze Options



You can select to snooze an account health check issues for six months. This means that you are postponing dealing with the issue identified. You may want to snooze an issue because of a change freeze, you are deploying a fix gradually, you are troubleshooting and require a setting to be applied for a known reason.

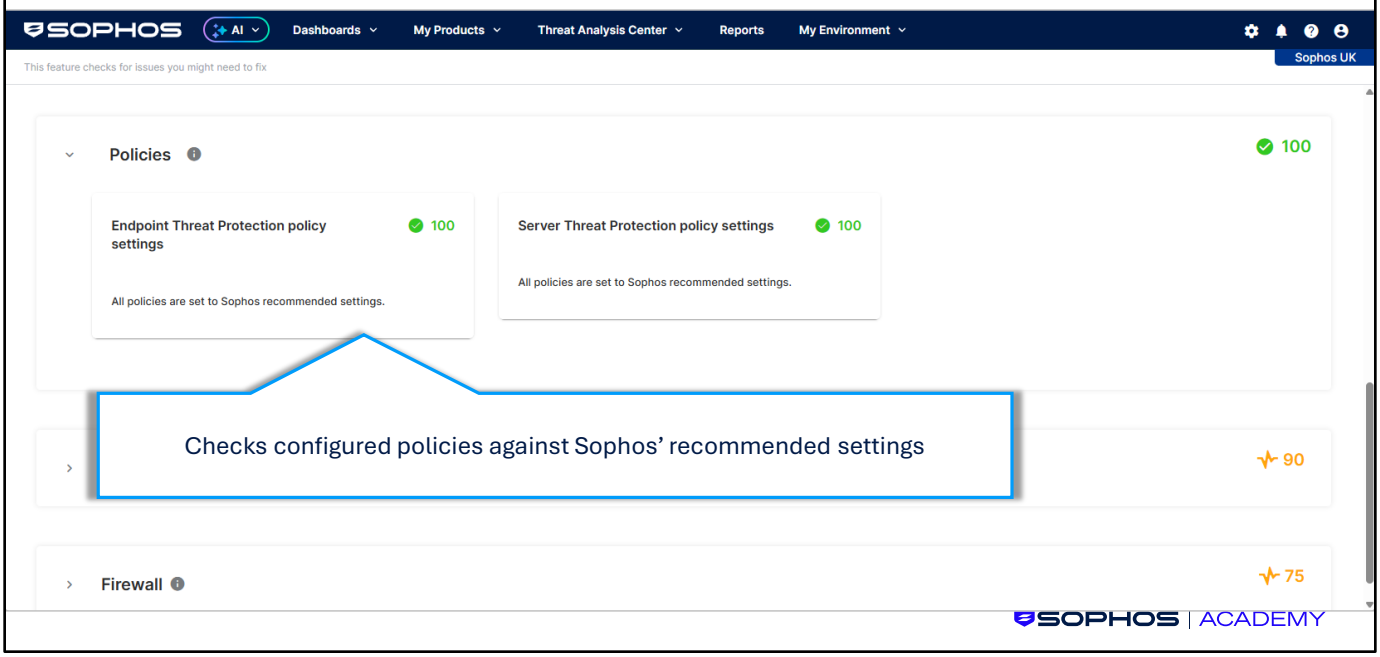
We recommend that you review snoozed issues regularly and ensure that you only use non-recommended settings only when you need to.

Fix Automatically



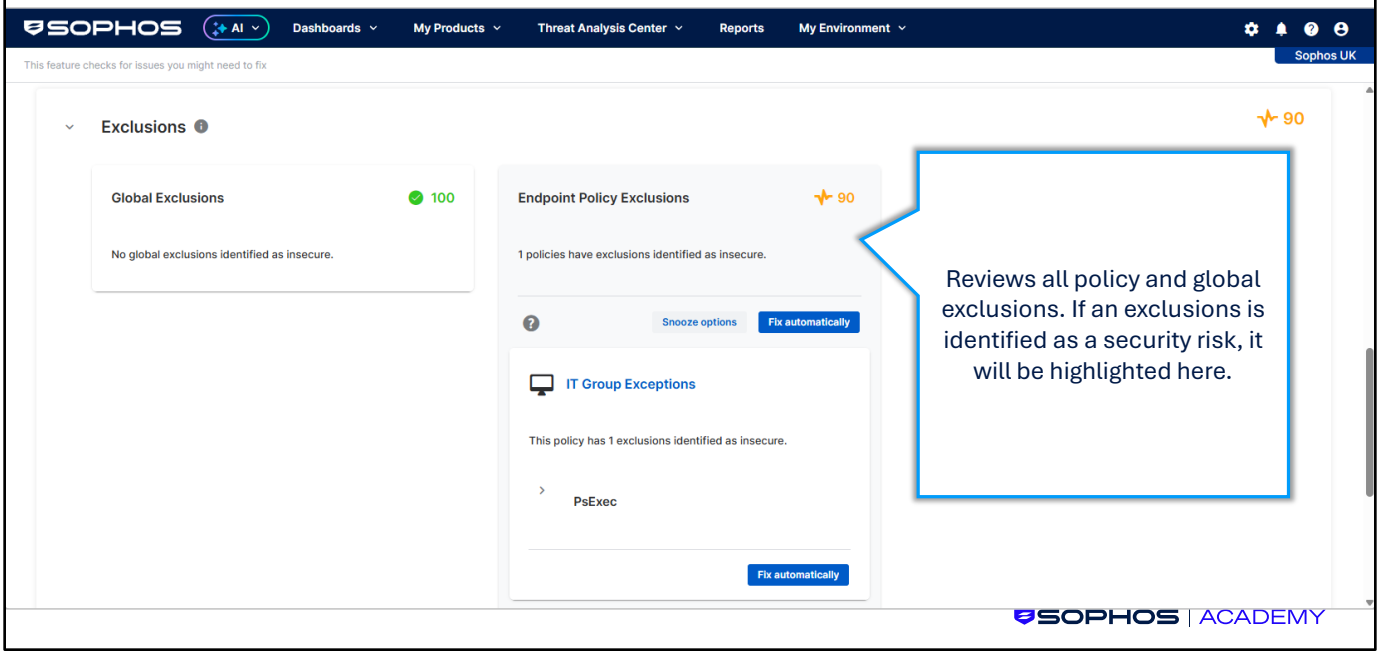
When you select the fix automatically button an additional window will be displayed asking you to confirm the fix.

Policies



The 'Policies' section checks your configured endpoint and server policies. If a policy setting differs from Sophos' recommended settings, a red warning is displayed in the policies section of the account health check. The recommended settings offer the best security. If you must change settings to fix issues, change as few as you can and apply them to as few devices as you can.

Exclusions

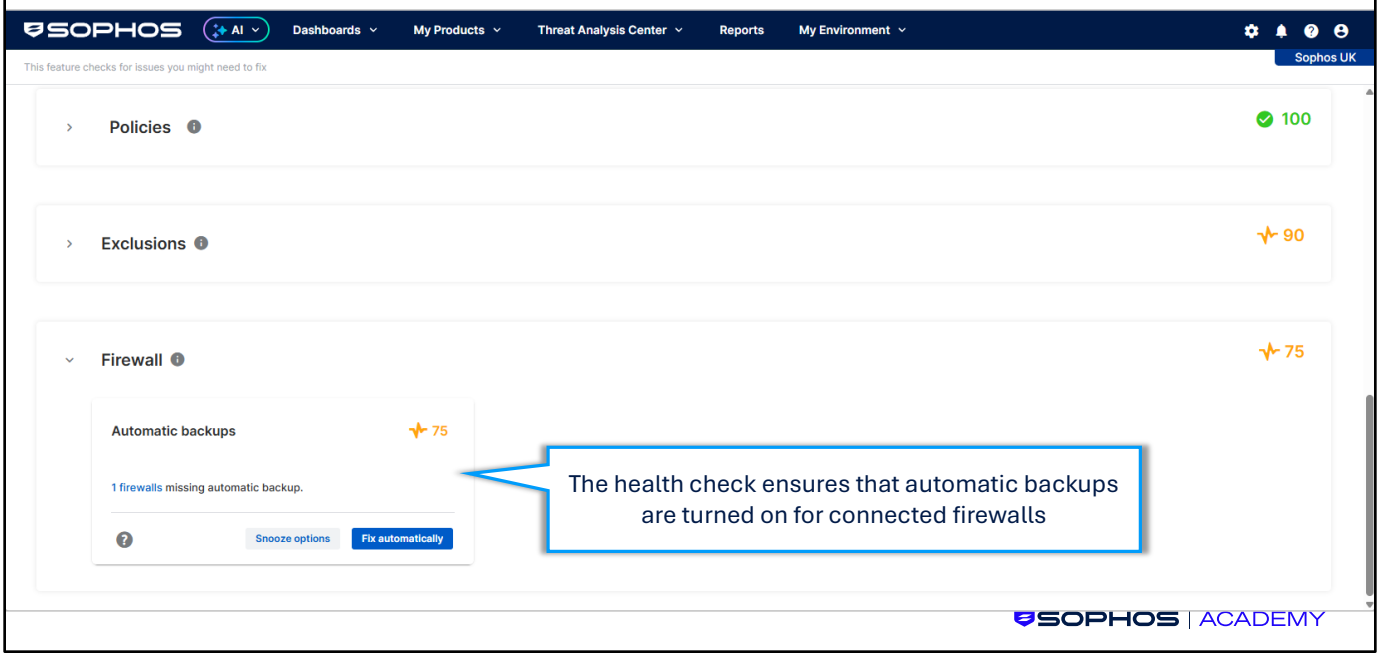


The ‘Exclusions’ health check will review all policy and global exclusions configured. If an exclusion is identified as a security risk, it will be highlighted here. You will also see a banner message in the policy and against the exclusion entry in the global exclusions list.

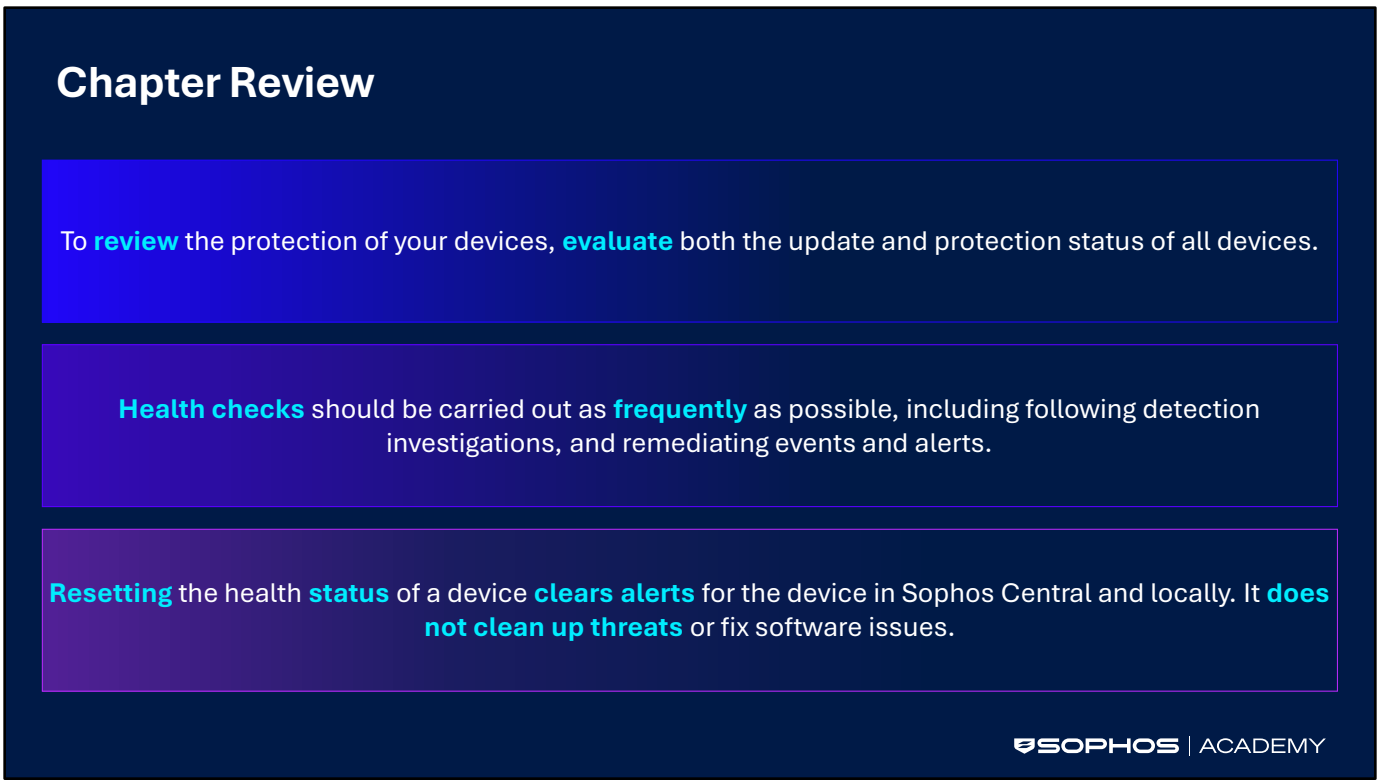
Whilst we do not prevent you from adding exclusions that pose a serious security risk, we will highlight the risk when you add the exclusion, when you view it either in a policy or globally, and in the health check. We encourage you to review all exclusions regularly to ensure that they are relevant and only applied to those users who require them.

Note that additional health checks may be added in future versions of Sophos Central.

Firewall



If any firewalls are connected to your Sophos Central account, the health check will ensure that automatic backups are turned on for those firewalls.



Here are the three main things you learned in this chapter.

To review the protection of your devices, evaluate both the update and protection status of all devices.

Health checks should be carried out as frequently as possible, including following detection investigations, and remediating events and alerts.

Resetting the health status of a device clears alerts for the device in Sophos Central and locally. It does not clean up threats or fix software issues.

[Additional Information]

Sophos Endpoint
EP4020: Getting Started with Sophos Endpoint Alerts and Events

May 2026

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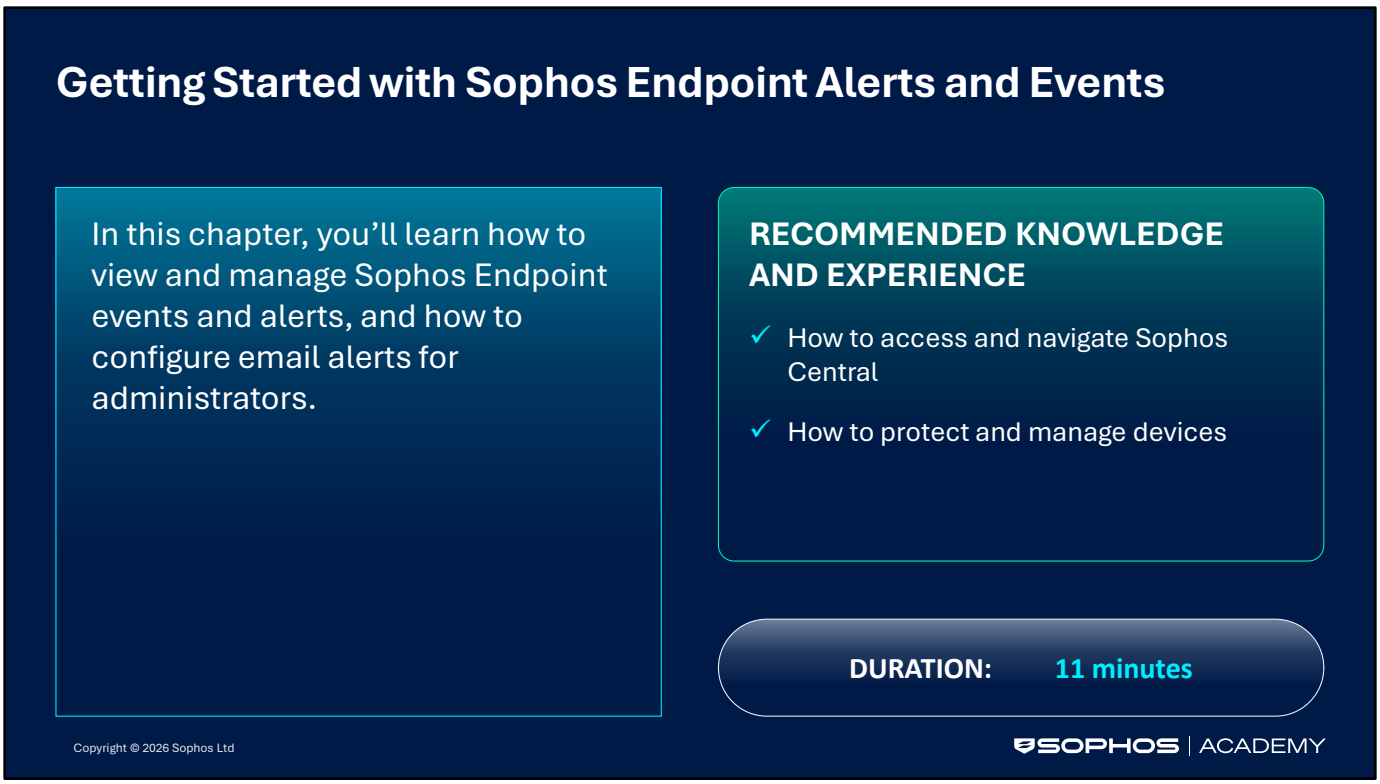

In this chapter, you'll learn how to view and manage Sophos Endpoint events and alerts, and how to configure email alerts for administrators.

Alerts and Events

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The Sophos Endpoint Agent will detect and cleanup malicious and suspicious items on protected devices. Sophos Endpoint allows administrators to view exactly what has happened across the organization. It does this by logging all events and creating alerts so that administrators are alerted to any behaviour that is not safe. Events are logged for **ALL** detection events, including cleanup events.

It is important to understand that to prevent the dashboard being flooded with information, alerts are only shown when an action is required. What the subsequent actions are, will depend on the alert.

Event Types

Informational

- No action required
- Examples:
  - Malware cleaned up
  - Update succeeded

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There are three event types. Informational events are logged for reference and require no action. Examples are when a detection has been cleaned up or a device has been updated successfully.

Event Types

Informational	Medium

▪ No action required
▪ Examples:
  ▪ Malware cleaned up
  ▪ Update succeeded
	▪ Action required
	▪ Examples:
	  ▪ Detections that are automatically remediated
	  ▪ Policy non-compliance
	  ▪ Reboot required

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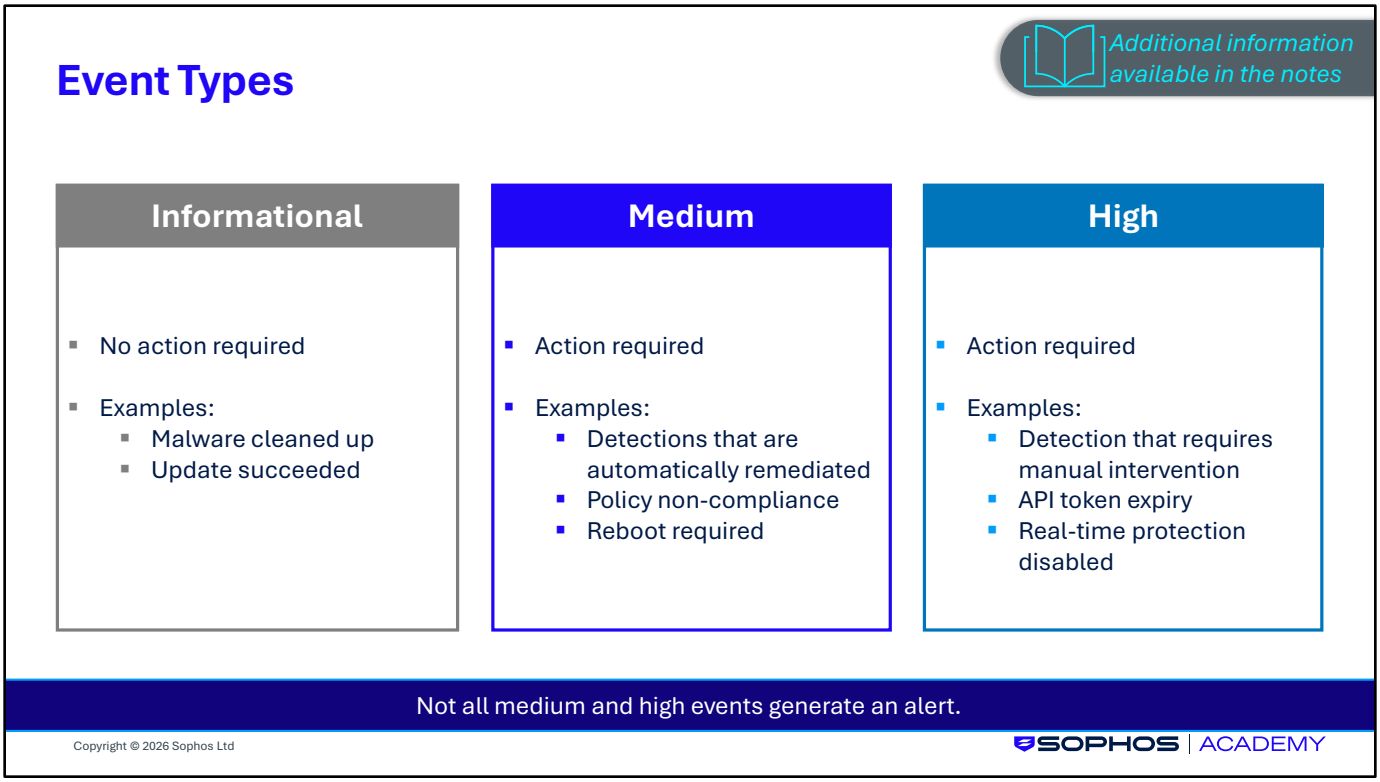
Medium severity events are logged when action is required, such as when a device is out of compliance or requires a reboot. Malware detections that are automatically remediated are reported as medium events; however, these events are only displayed until the detection has been cleaned up.

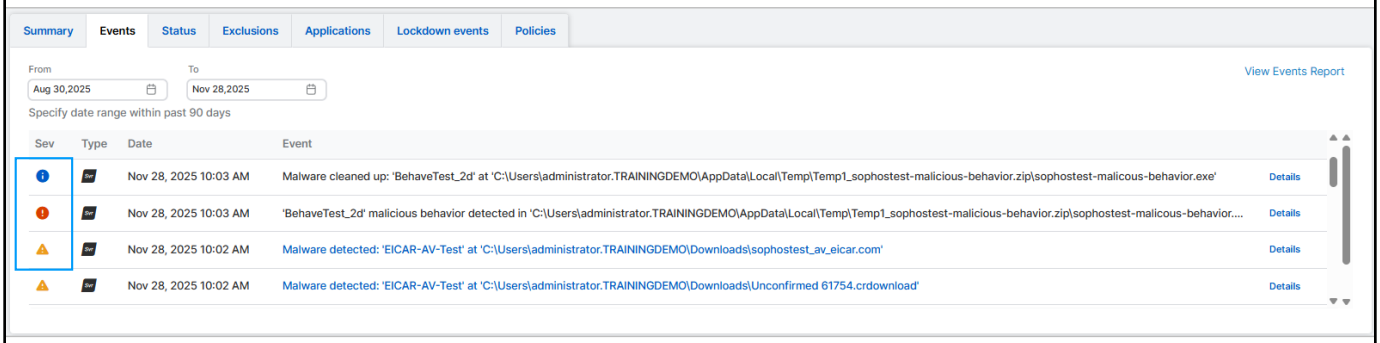


High severity events are logged when action is required and remain in the event lists until they are remediated or cleared by an administrator. This can include detections that require manual intervention or further investigation, API tokens expiring, or the disabling of real-time protection.

Please note that not all medium and high events will generate an alert for the event. For example, when a reboot is required, an alert is only triggered if the reboot is not performed within two weeks of the event.

[Additional Information]
For further information about alerts, see knowledge base article **KB-000038134**: Sophos Central Admin: Alerts page and settings FAQ
https://support.sophos.com/support/s/article/KB-000038134

Events



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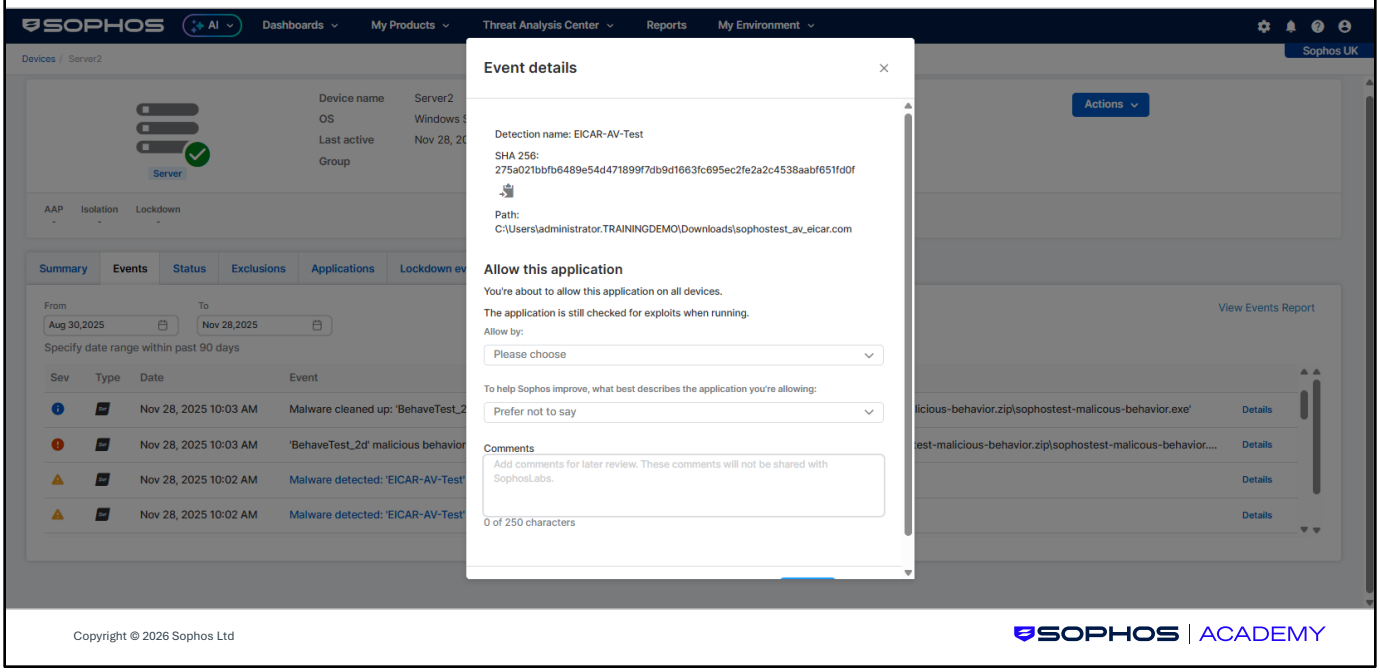
The **Events** tab for a protected device lists all events. The icon next to each event shows its severity. In this example, the severity of the first three lines is informational, confirming that the malware was cleaned up; high, as the volume of events indicates an outbreak; and medium for malware detection.

Event Details



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Clicking on the **Details** link for a detection event provides more information and includes the option to allow the detected item. This action must be taken with great caution and only if you are certain that the detected item is safe to allow.

Detection Types

Malicious Threats
ATK/, Troj/, Mal/ etc

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All detection events will display the detection type. It is useful to understand the type of detections you may see to know how best to remediate the threat. Let's take a quick look at the main types of detections. Malicious threats will typically be detected by the on-access scanner using definitions.

Detection Types

Malicious Threats	Suspicious Files and Malicious Behaviour
ATK/, Troj/, Mal/ etc	SUS/, C2/

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Suspicious detections are based on properties of the scanned file which determine if it is malicious. Malicious behaviour detections are triggered when an application performs actions that are classed as malicious. C2 detections are returned if malicious network traffic has been detected.

Detection Types

Malicious Threats	Suspicious Files and Malicious Behaviour	Unknown threats
ATK/, Troj/, Mal/ etc	SUS/, C2/	HPmal/ HPsus/

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Unknown threats are detections that match specific combinations of behaviours when running that indicate malicious intent. Unknown threats will be displayed as HPmal or HPsus detections.

Detection Types

Malicious Threats	Suspicious Files and Malicious Behaviour	Unknown threats
ATK/, Troj/, Mal/ etc	SUS/, C2/	HPmal/ HPsus/

New Threats
CXmail, CXmal and CXweb

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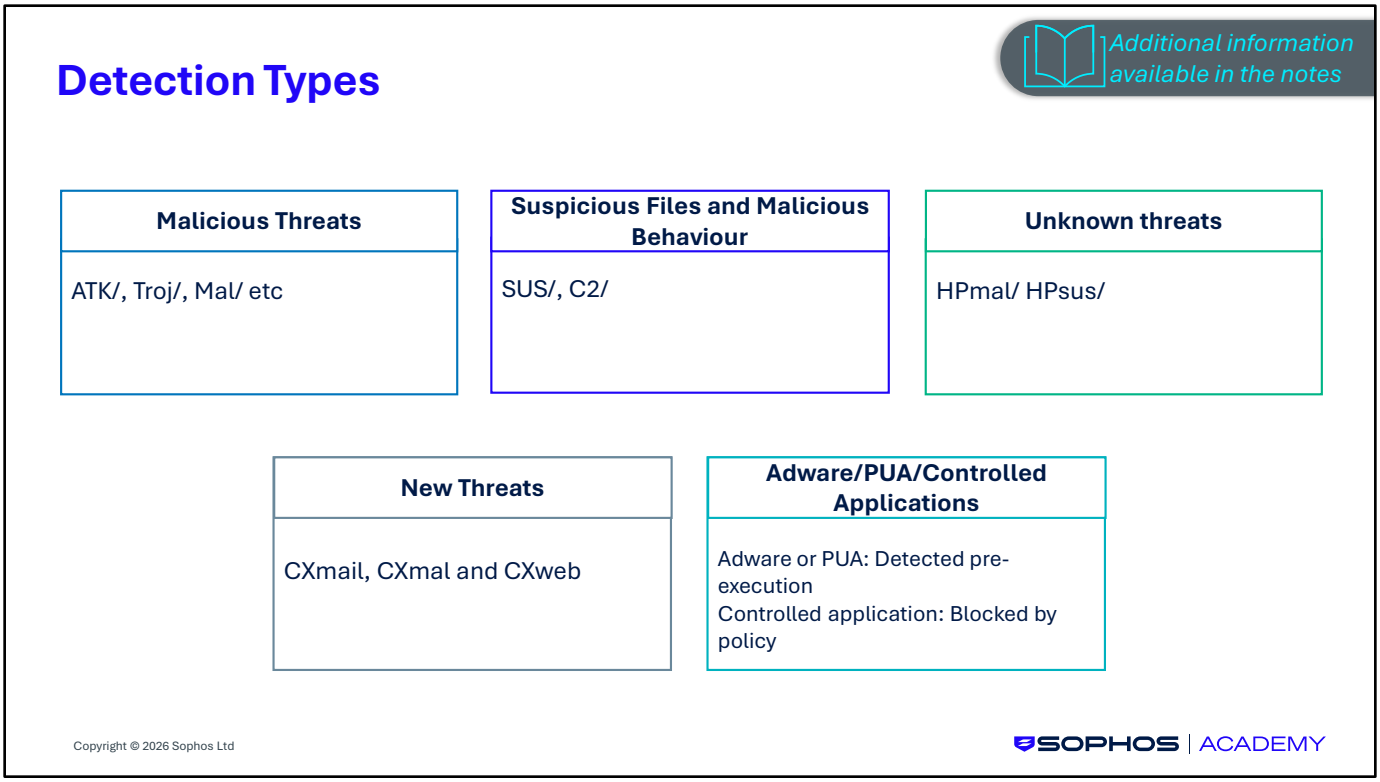
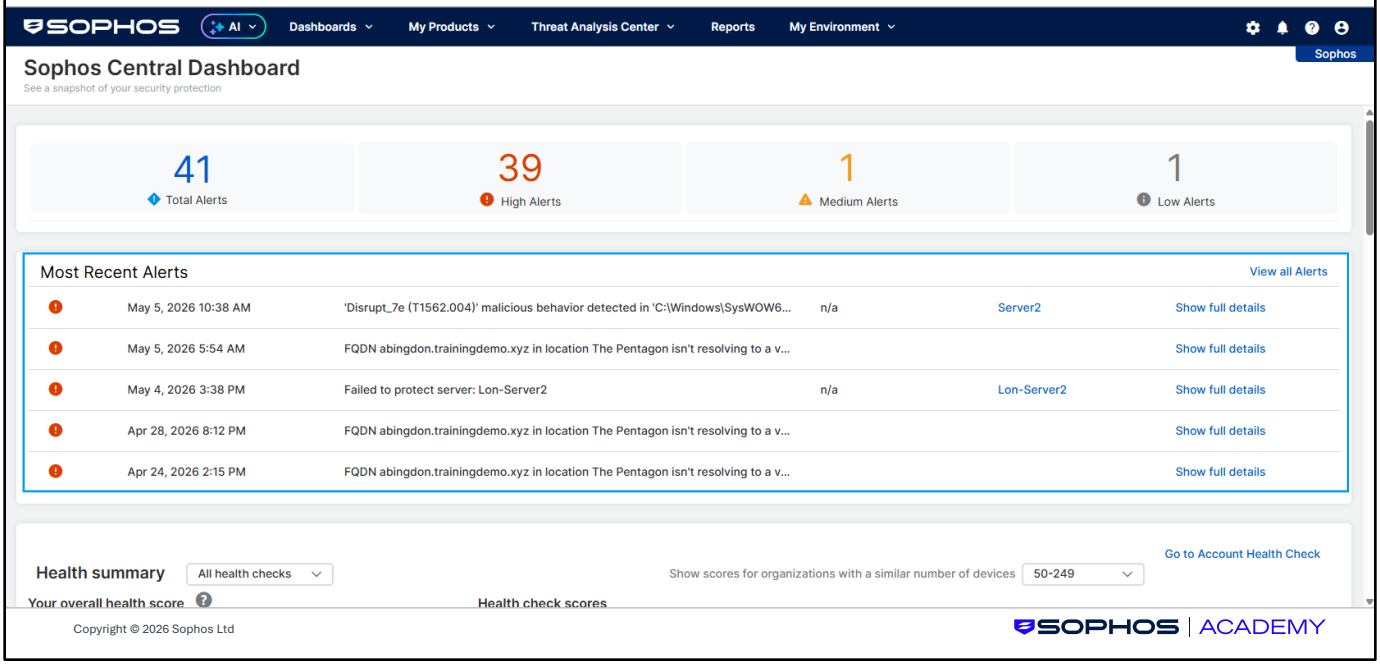
CXmail detections are email-born threats, CXweb detections are malicious files detected before a download takes place, and CXmal detections are threats that are detected in execution.



Adware and PUA detections are detections of applications that may be legitimate; however, they can pose a risk. Controlled application detections are legitimate applications that are being blocked by the application control policy.

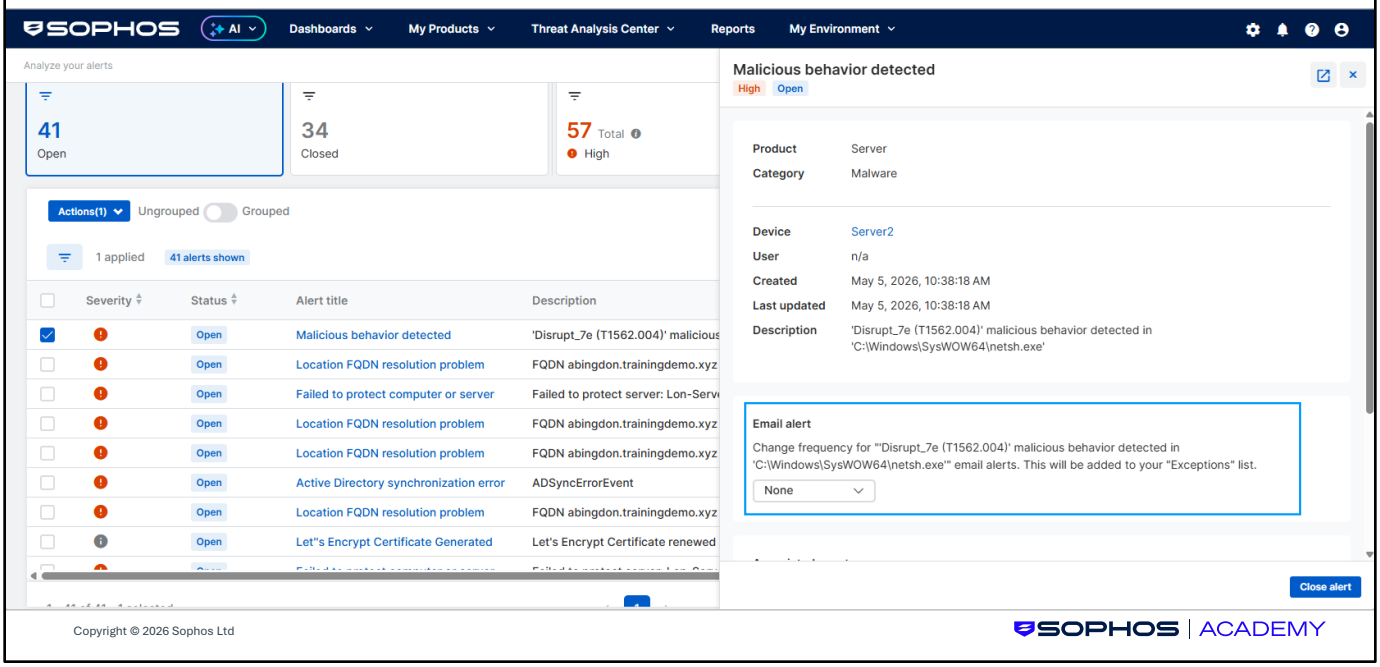
[Additional Information]
Comparison of Sophos's malicious file detection technologies **KB-000034084**. Comparison of Sophos malicious file detection technologies
https://support.sophos.com/support/s/article/KB-000034084

Most Recent Alerts



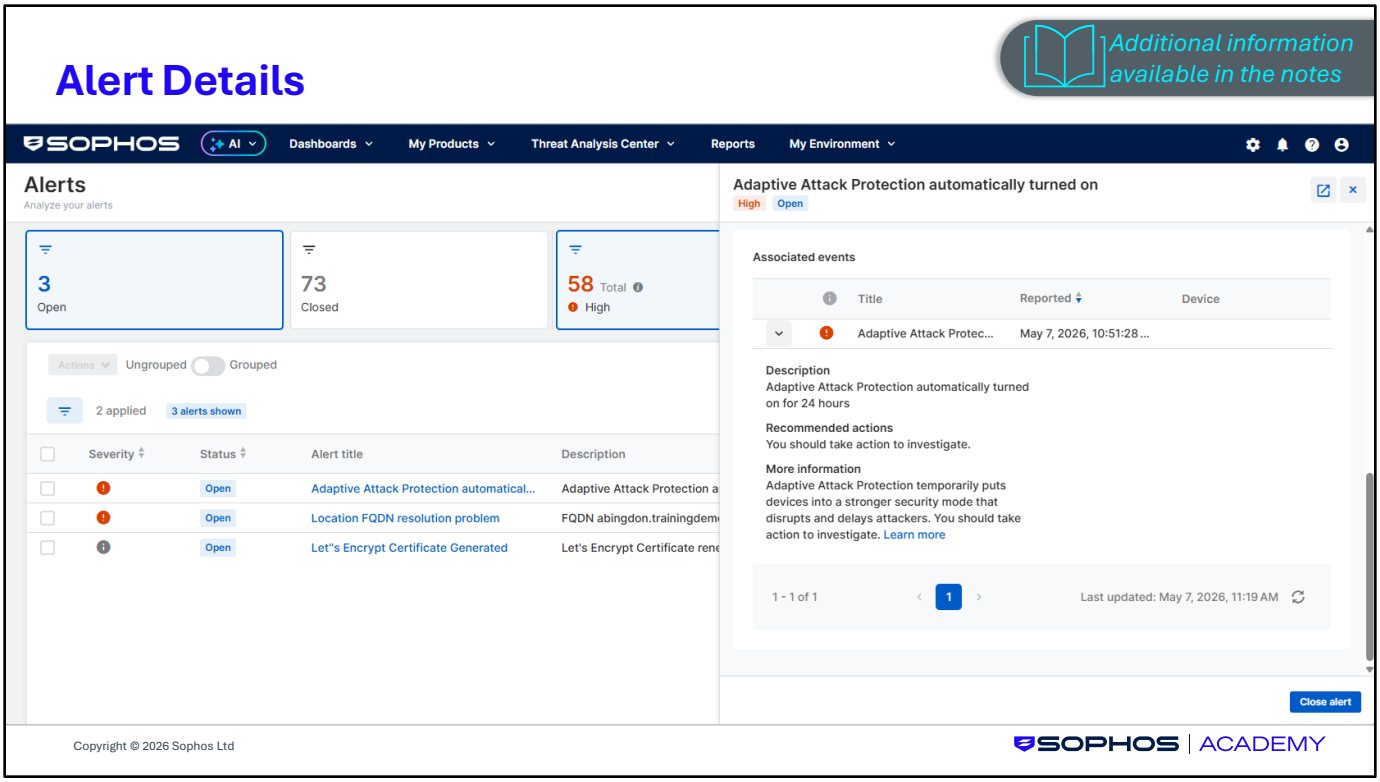
The **Dashboard** lists the most recent alerts, showing events that require attention.

Alerts



The **Alerts** page provides more details about each alert. Select the alert to view more information. In the flyout menu, you can set email alerts for the detection and view associated events.

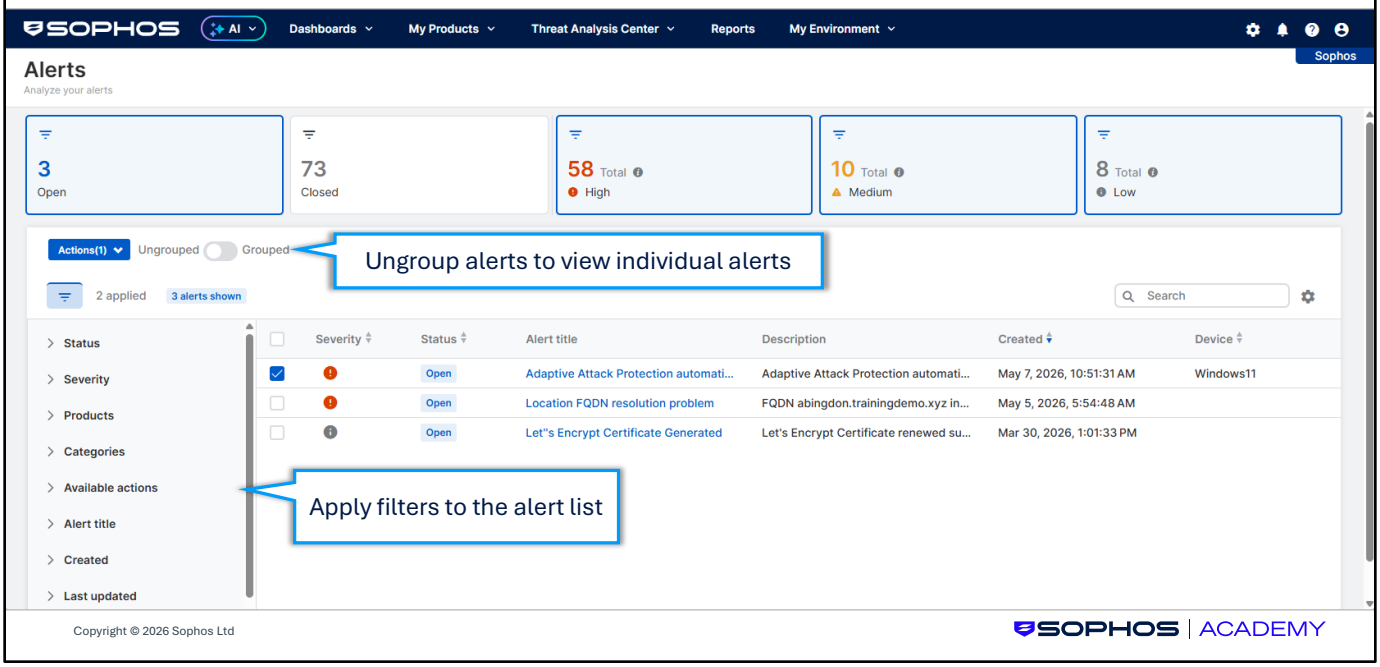
Alert Details



The alert and associated events show a description of the alert, information about the alert, and possible next steps. If there is a knowledge base article this will be linked in the alert details.

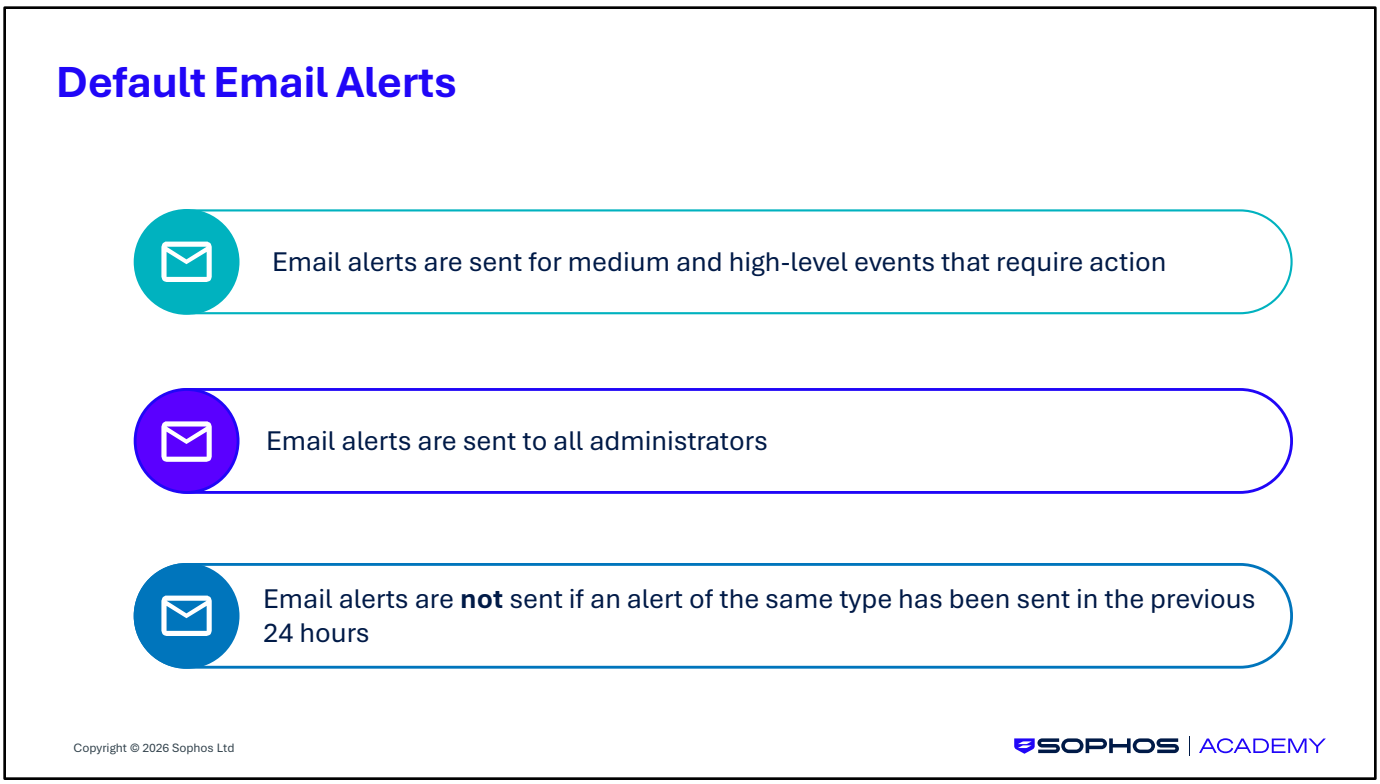
[Additional Information]
Alerts for threat protection documentation: [Alerts for Threat Protection - Sophos Central Admin https://docs.sophos.com/central/Customer/help/en-us/ManageYourProducts/Alerts/AlertsMalware/index.html](https://docs.sophos.com/central/Customer/help/en-us/ManageYourProducts/Alerts/AlertsMalware/index.html)

Alerts



The alert list can be filtered to show only high alerts or alerts only for a specific product.

All alerts for a specific threat or event are grouped together under a single entry in the list, which makes alerts easier to manage. You can select to ungroup the alerts if required. The ‘Count’ column shows the number of alerts for each group entry. To view all alerts in a group, click the arrow on the right to expand the group section.

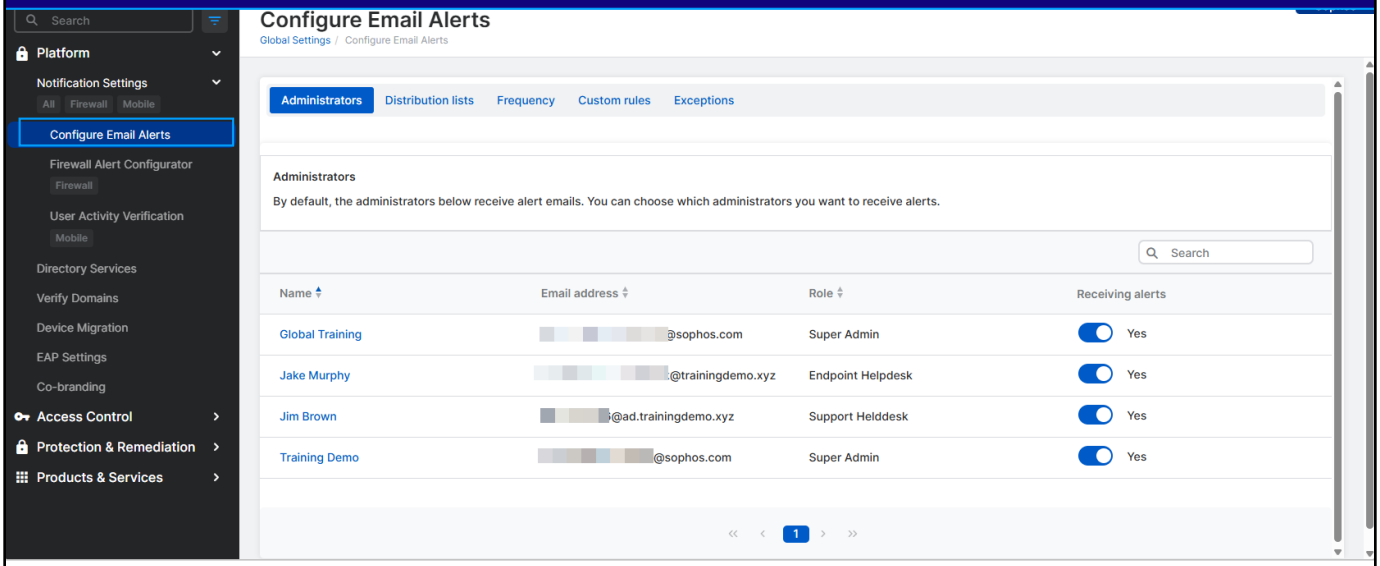


Administrators can view alerts when logged into the Sophos Central dashboard; however, they may not always have Sophos Central open. Email alerts can be configured to notify administrators about specific alerts by product, severity, or category.

By default, email alerts are sent for medium or high-level events that require action and are sent to all administrator users. Email alerts are not sent if an alert for the same type of event has been sent within the previous 24 hours, this is to prevent notification flooding if an outbreak occurs.

Configure Email Alerts

Only administrators with the **Super Admin** role can configure the default email alert settings



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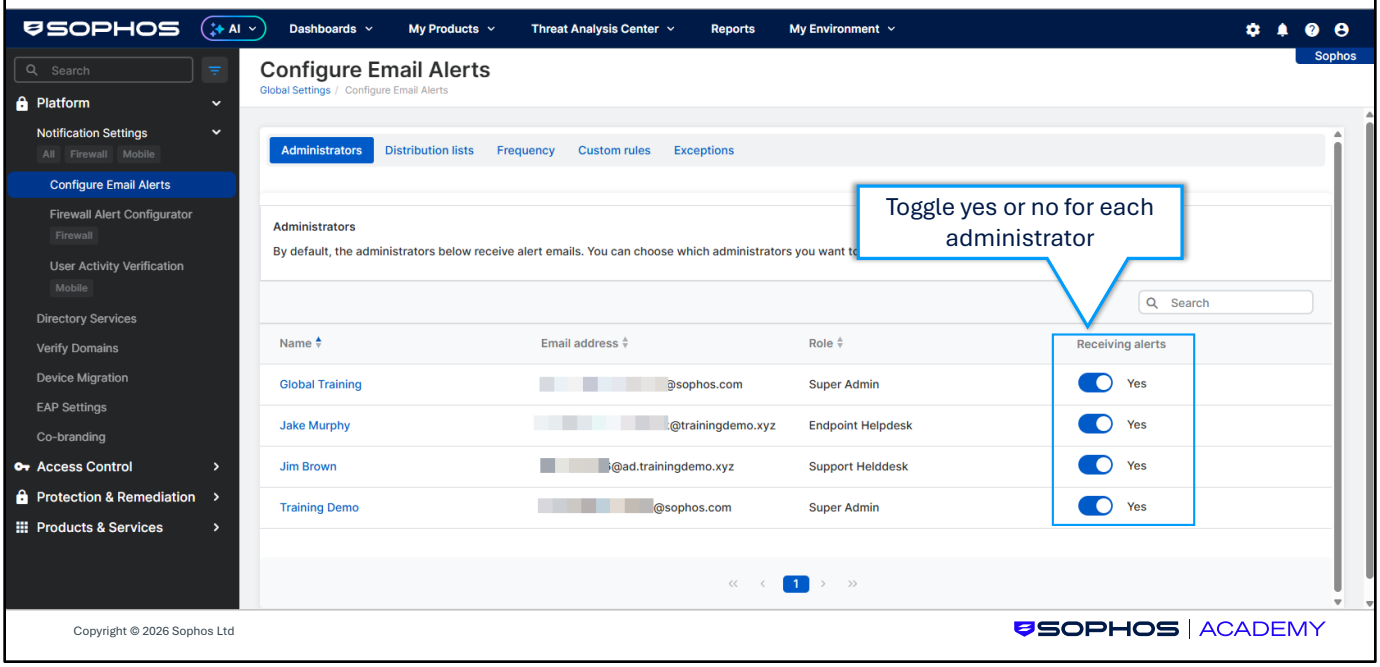
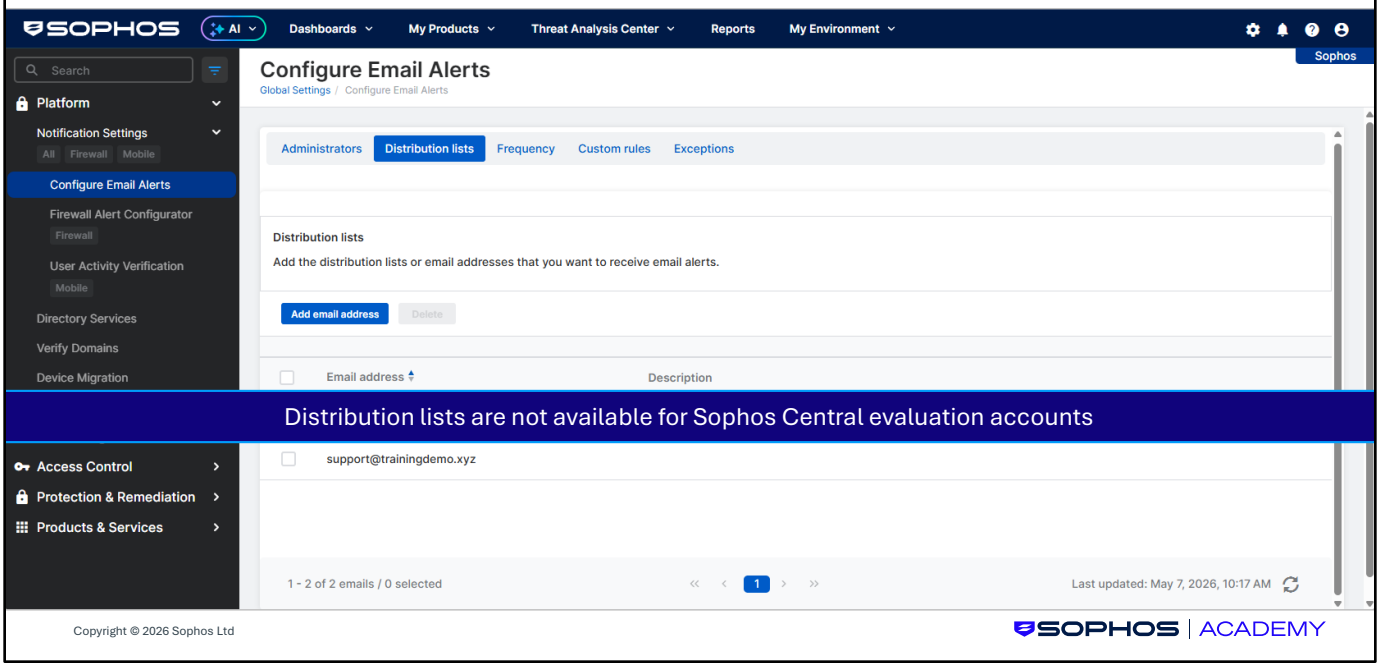
Only users with the Super Administrator role can change the default email alert settings. To view the settings, navigate to **Global Settings > Notification Settings > Configure Email Alerts**.

Configure Email Alerts



The first step of configuring email alerts is to define which administrators will receive alerts. Toggle the receiving alerts button to yes or no to configure who receives alerts and who doesn't.

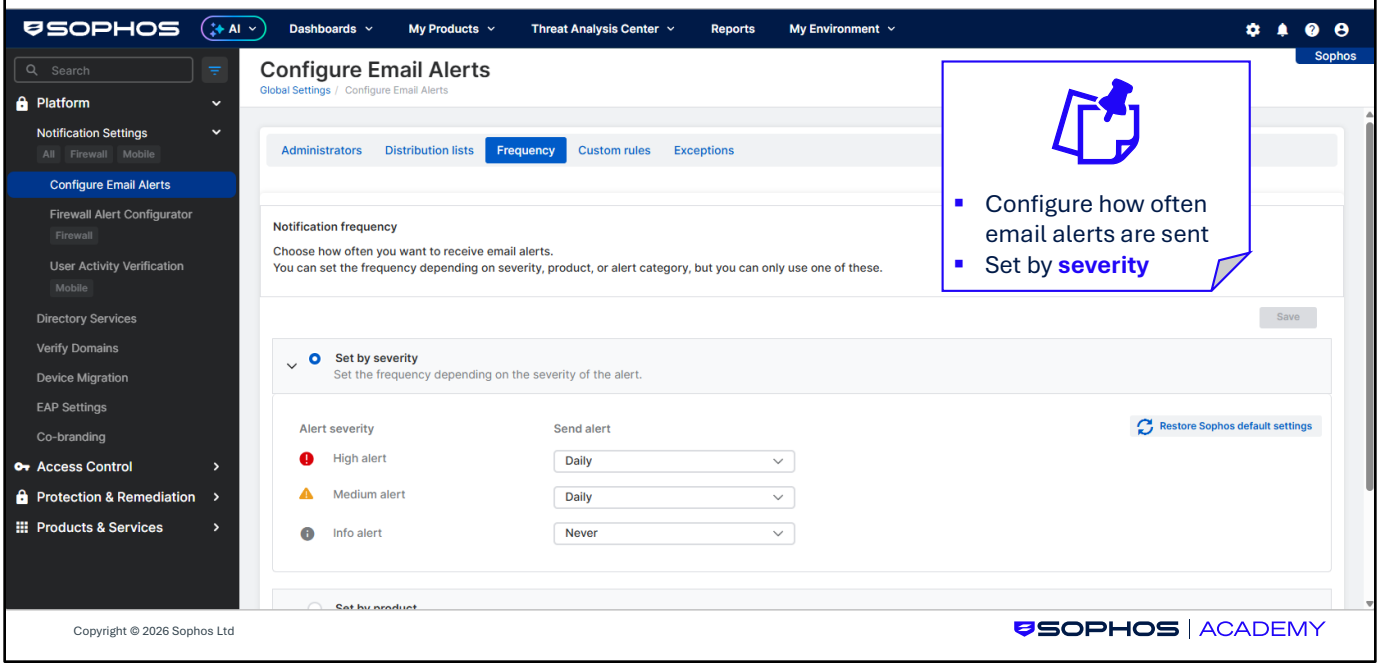
Configure Email Alerts



You can add and manage distribution lists, allowing you to add the email addresses of a ticketing system, or people you want to notify about alerts who do not have Sophos Central Admin access.

Please note that the distribution list feature is not available for Sophos Central trial accounts.

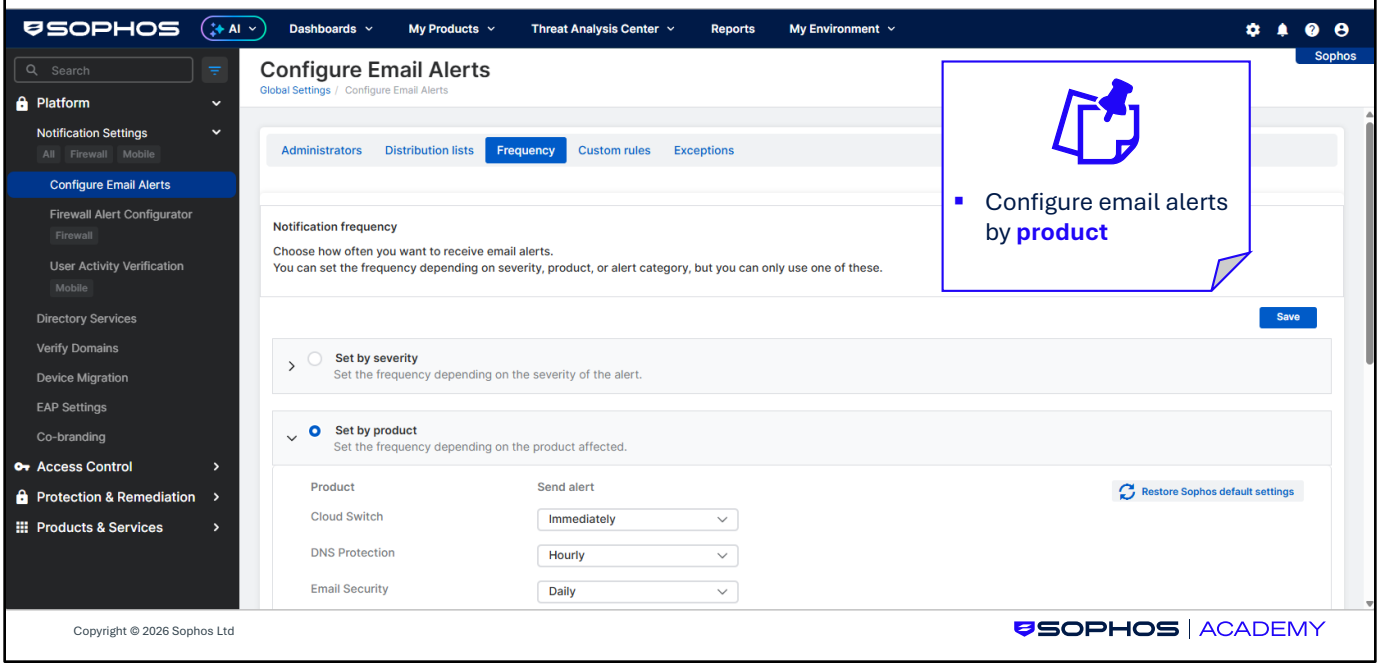
Configure Email Alerts



The frequency at which email alerts are sent can be configured by severity, product, or category.

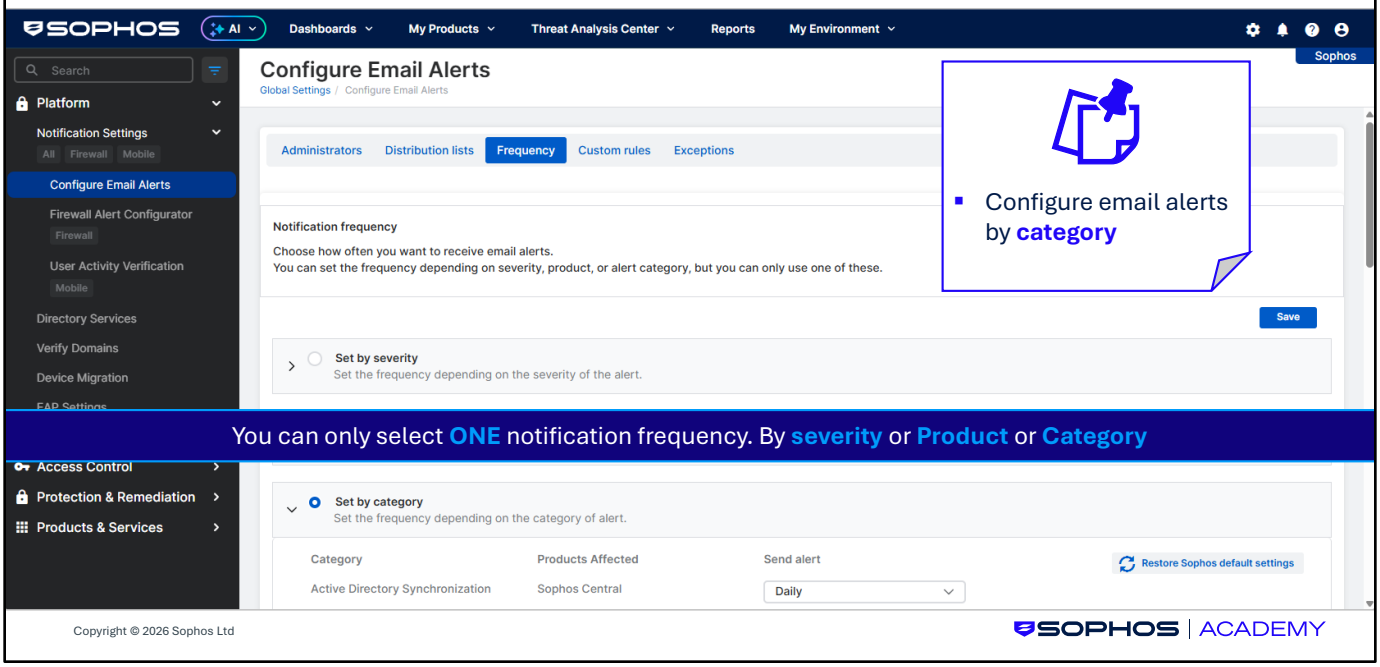
Selecting to send email alerts by severity allows you to configure how often an alert is sent based on its severity. You can select from immediately, hourly, daily, or never for high, medium, and informational alerts. It is good practice to configure high alerts to be emailed immediately so that administrators can respond to events quickly. Similarly, you may decide that informational alerts do not need an email notification and set these to never send an alert.

Configure Email Alerts



Setting the alerts by product allows you to control how often alerts are sent for each licensed product.

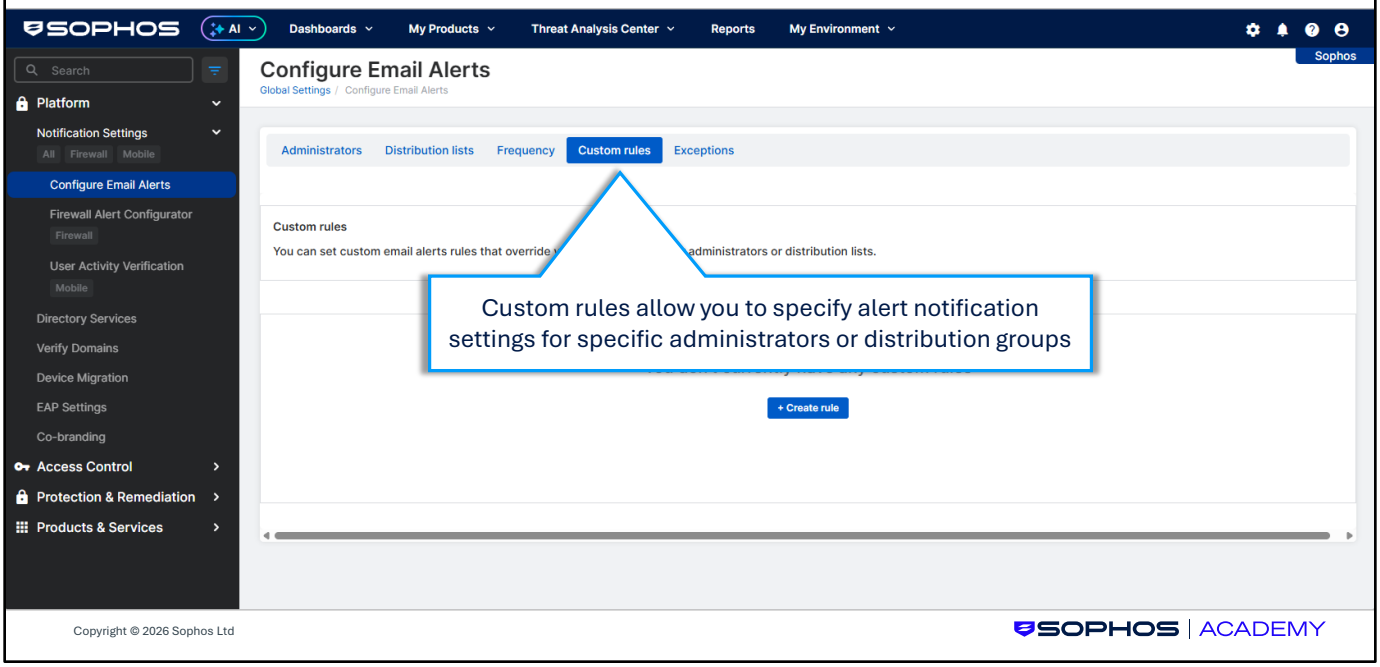
Configure Email Alerts



Alerts set by category splits alerts into the event categories. You can then configure how often alerts are received per alert category. For example, you can configure malware alerts to be sent immediately, whilst general Sophos Central alerts are sent daily or hourly.

Remember, you can only select one notification frequency type, either severity, product or category.

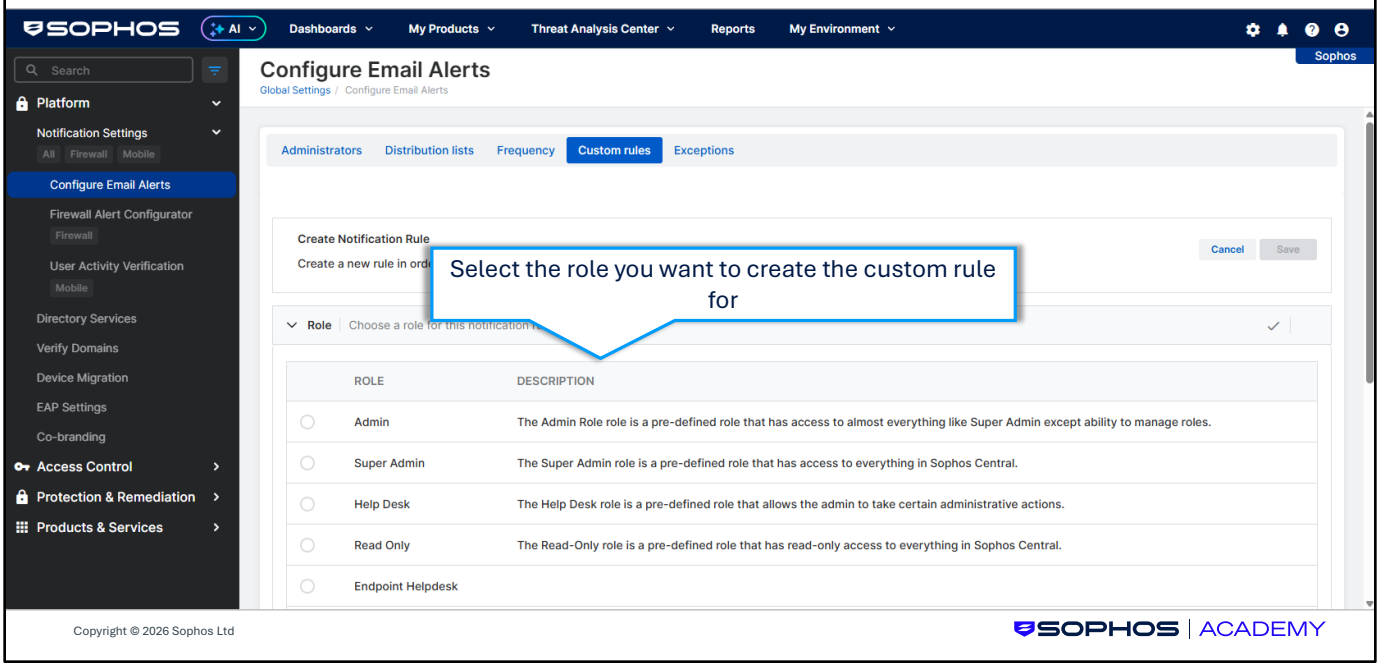
Configure Email Alerts



Custom rules allow you to specify alert notification settings for specific administrators or distribution groups. This is useful if you have a particular distribution group that you only want to receive malware alerts, or a help desk user that you only want to receive protection alerts for specific products.

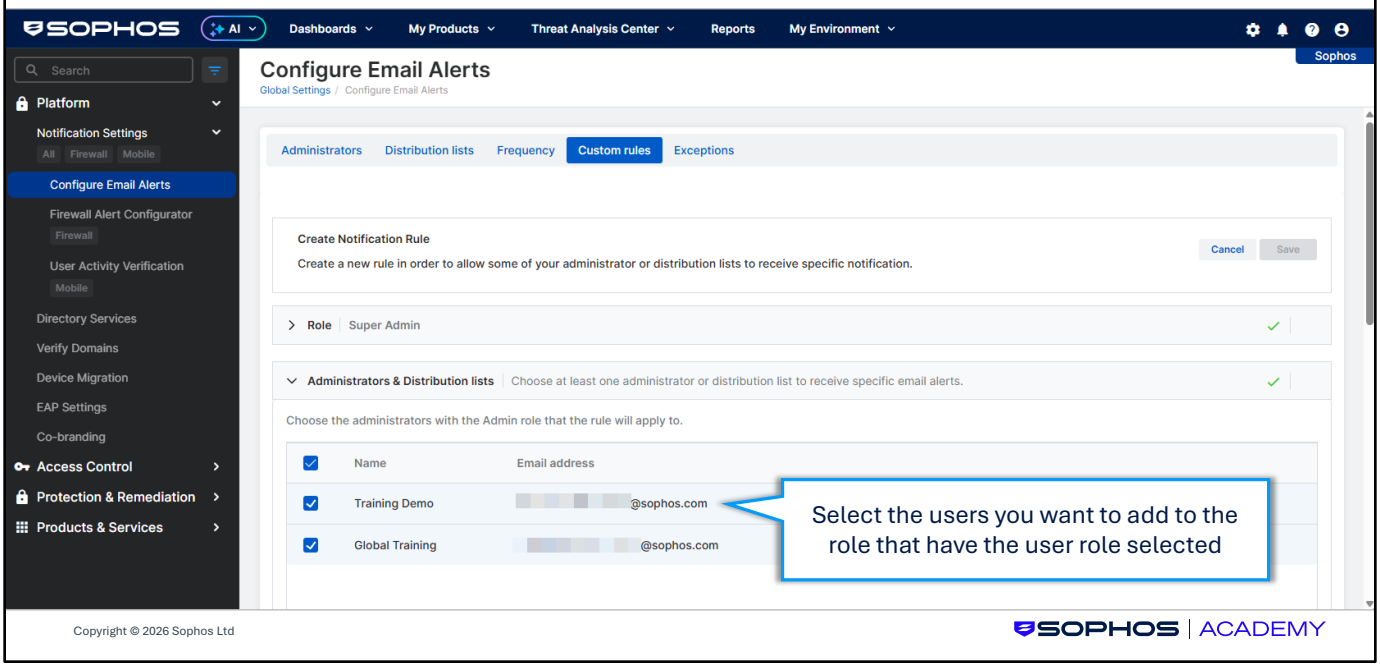
To get started, click **Create rule.**

Configure Email Alerts



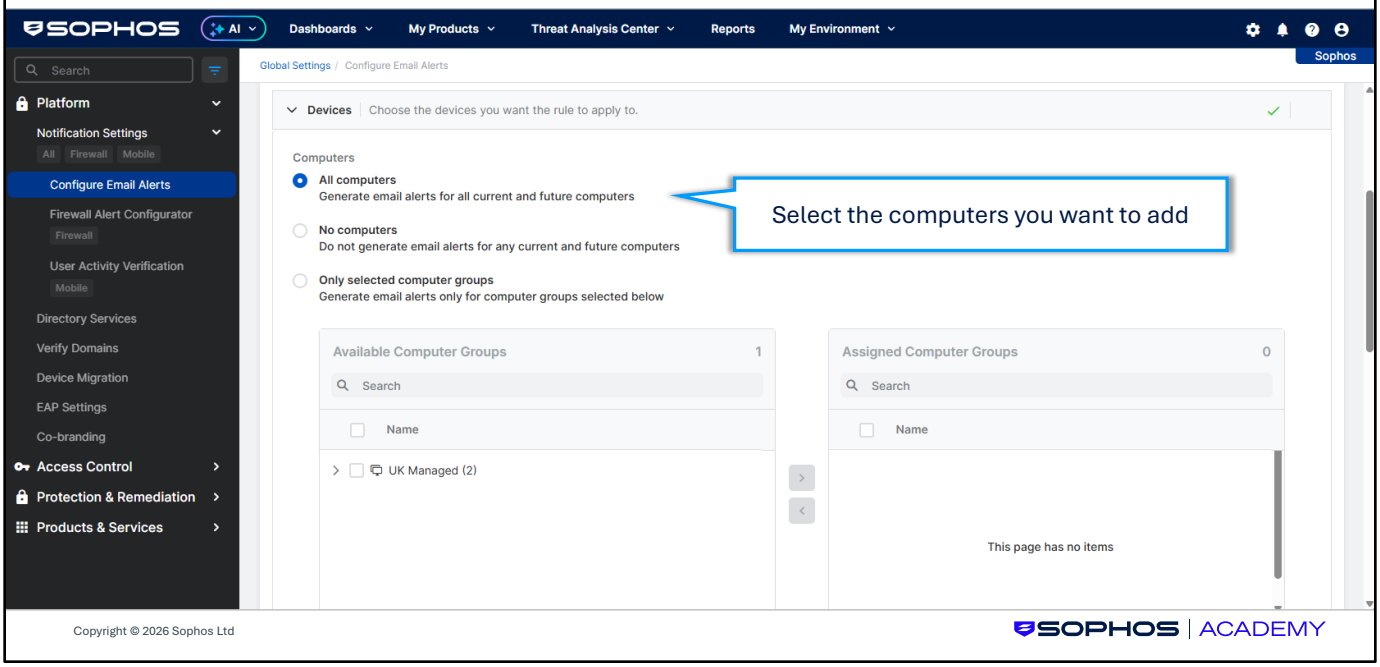
Select the user role you want to create the custom rule for.

Configure Email Alerts



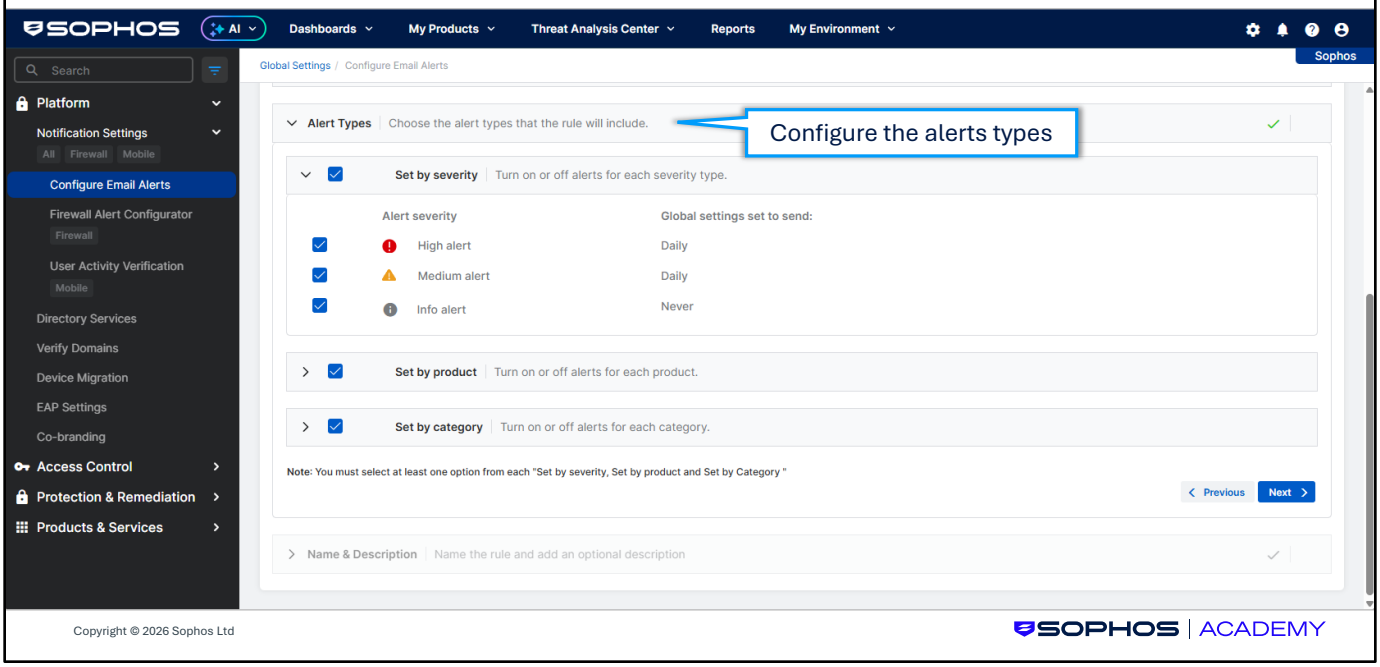
Select the specific administrators with the role you selected that you want to configure the custom rule for. Any distribution emails you have configured will also be displayed here.

Configure Email Alerts



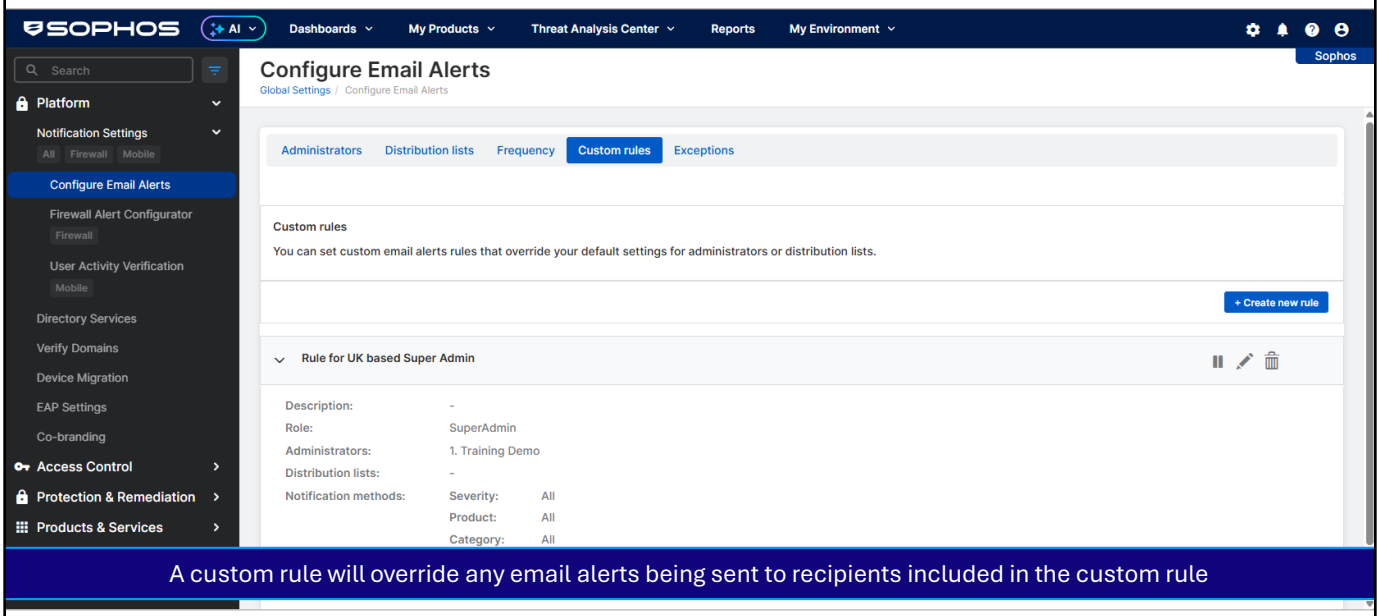
Select the computers or computer groups you want the rule to apply to.

Configure Email Alerts



Once you have selected the administrators the rule will apply to, configure the type of alerts you want them to receive. In this example, we are creating a custom rule for the help desk user and have selected high and medium severity alert types.

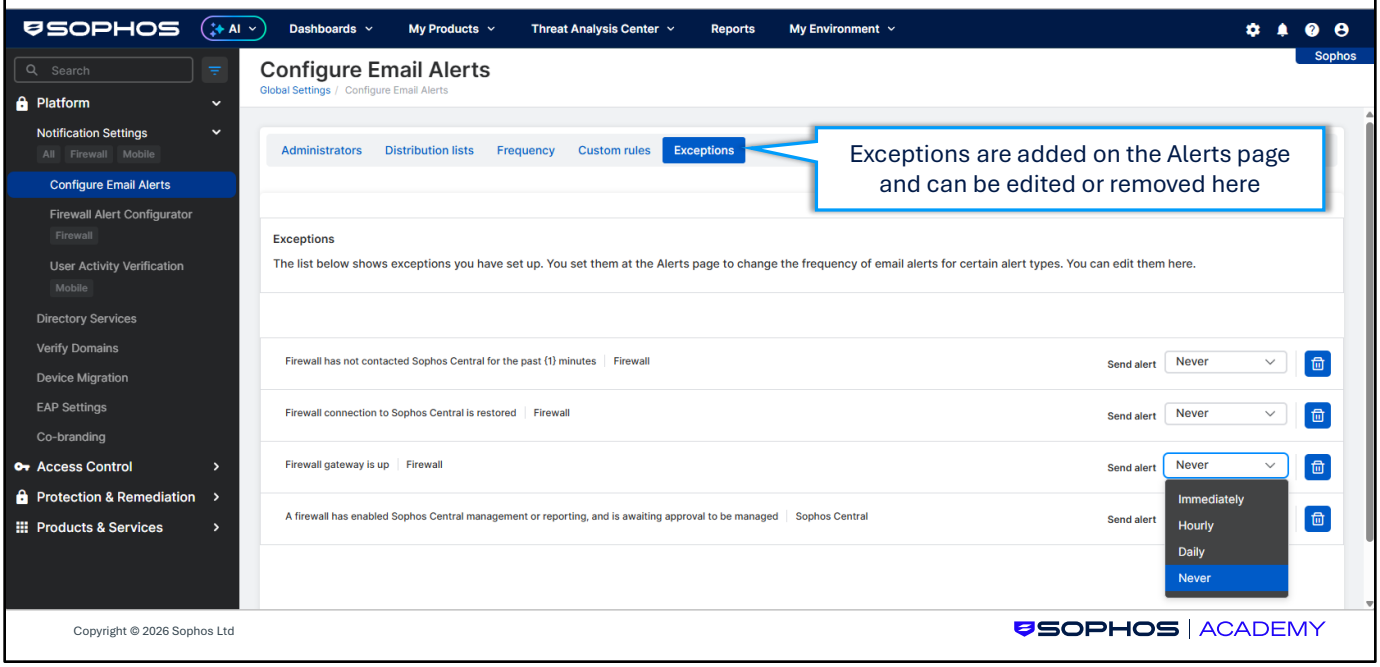
Configure Email Alerts



Once the rule has been named and saved, a summary of the custom rule is displayed. The custom rule list is expandable to view the rule details. You can select to pause, edit, or delete any custom rules created.

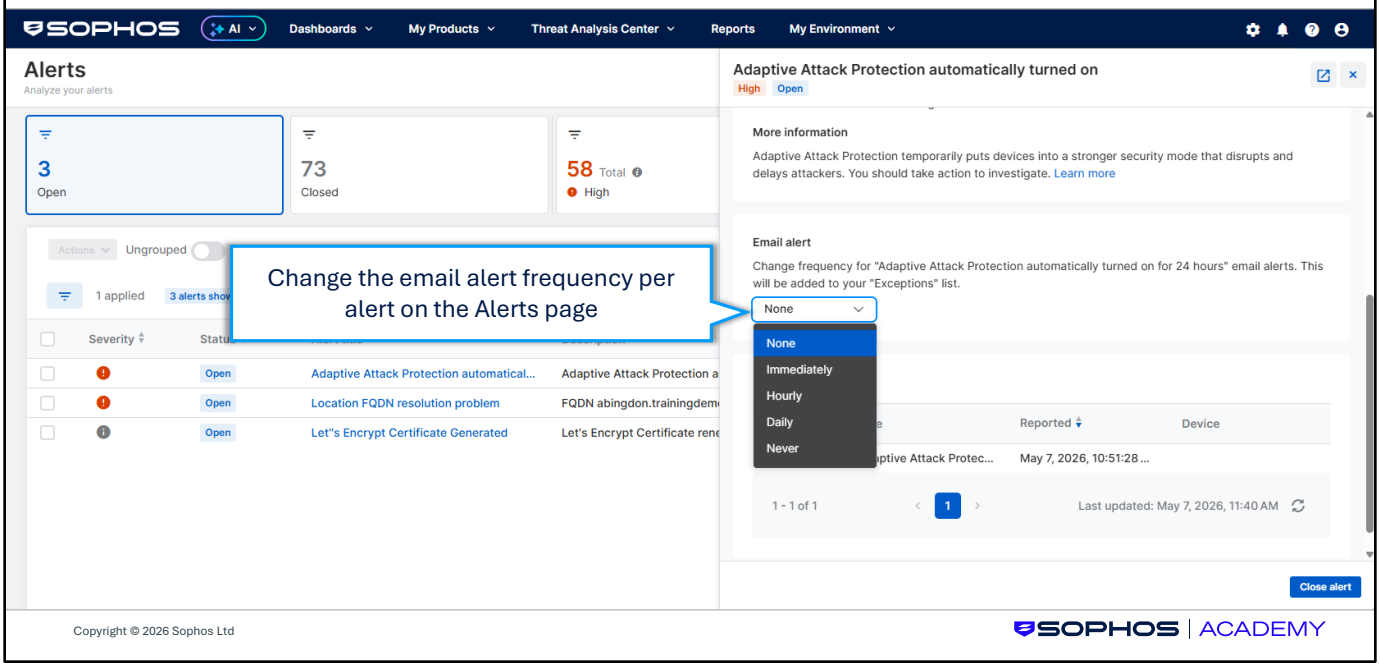
Please note that using a custom rule will override any email alerts being sent to recipients included in the custom rule.

Configure Email Alerts

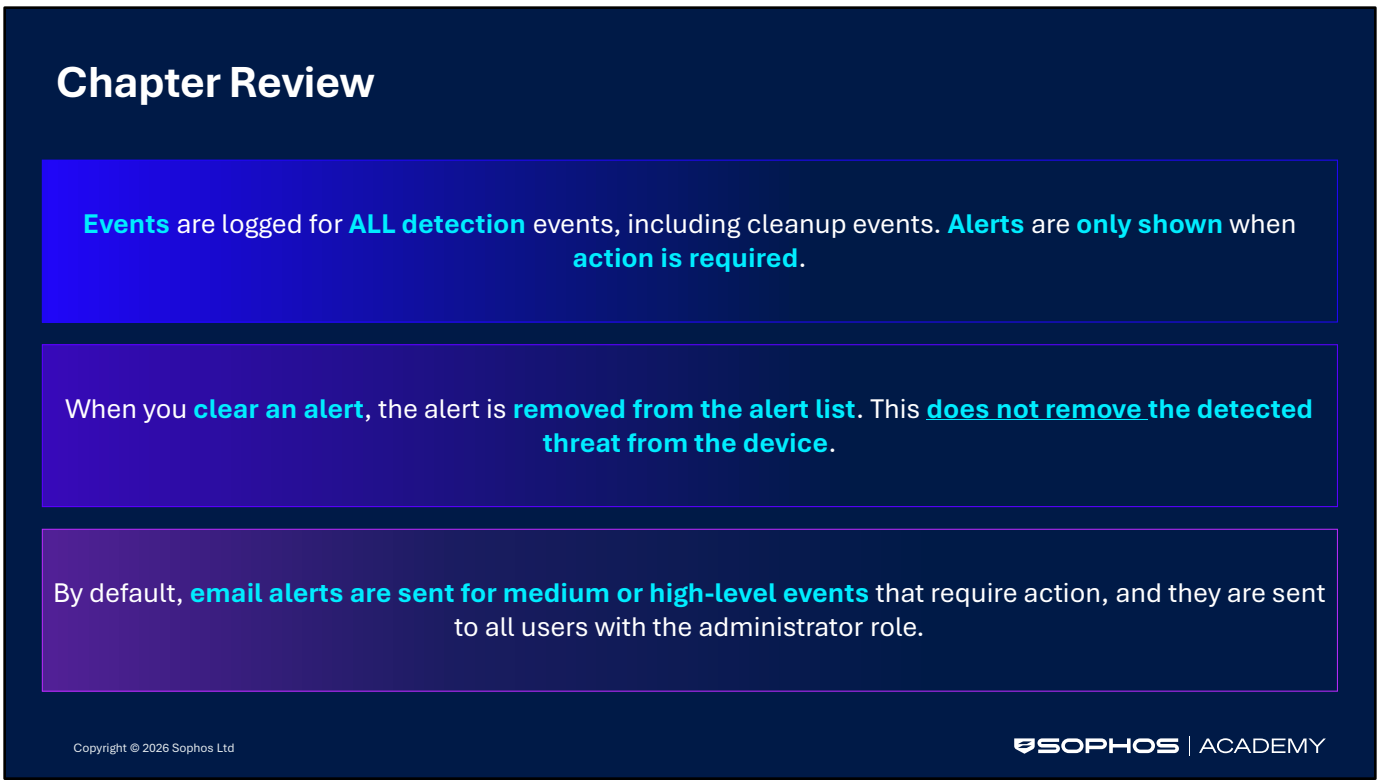


The **Exceptions** tab lists exceptions to the frequency of email alerts. These exceptions are set up for individual alerts on the **Alerts** page and can be edited or removed here.

Configure Email Alerts



The email frequency alert drop-down menu is displayed for alerts. Once you have changed the alert frequency, that alert type will appear on the **Exceptions** tab in **Configure email alerts**.



Here are the three main things you learned in this chapter.

Events are logged for **ALL** detection events, including cleanup events. Alerts are only shown when action is required.

When you clear an alert, it is removed from the alert list. However, this does not remove the detected threat from the device.

By default, email alerts are sent for medium or high-level events that require action, and they are sent to all users with the administrator role.

[Additional Information]

Sophos Endpoint
EP4025: Getting Started with Sophos Endpoint Threat Remediation

May 2026

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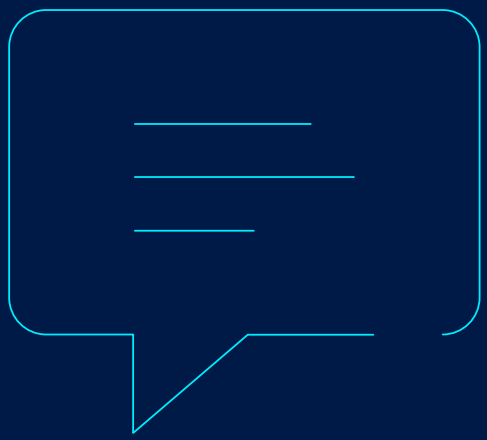
In this chapter, you'll learn how to view and manage threats, including those that are not automatically cleaned up.

Considerations

Take a moment to consider how a protected device might become infected.



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Let’s take a moment to consider how a protected device might become infected.

Why Might Devices Become Infected?

Unprotected device(s) on a network

No anti-malware software installed

Unprotected devices can provide a point of access for attacks to gain network access

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One attack vector is an unprotected device or devices on a network. Unprotected could be considered as any of the following states.

A device that has no anti-malware software installed. An unprotected device can provide a point of access for an attacker to gain access to a network and then access more of that network to get what they want.

Why Might Devices Become Infected?

Unprotected device(s) on a network

No anti-malware software installed

Unprotected devices can provide a point of access for attacks to gain network access

Running out of date anti-malware software

Devices that are not protected against the latest threats are vulnerable to attacks

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A device that is running out of date anti-malware software. Devices that are not protected against the latest threats can be vulnerable to attacks.

Why Might Devices Become Infected?

Unprotected device(s) on a network

No anti-malware software installed

Unprotected devices can provide a point of access for attacks to gain network access

Running out of date anti-malware software

Devices that are not protected against the latest threats are vulnerable to attacks

Anti-malware features are not enabled

All protection features should be enabled, without them, the device is vulnerable

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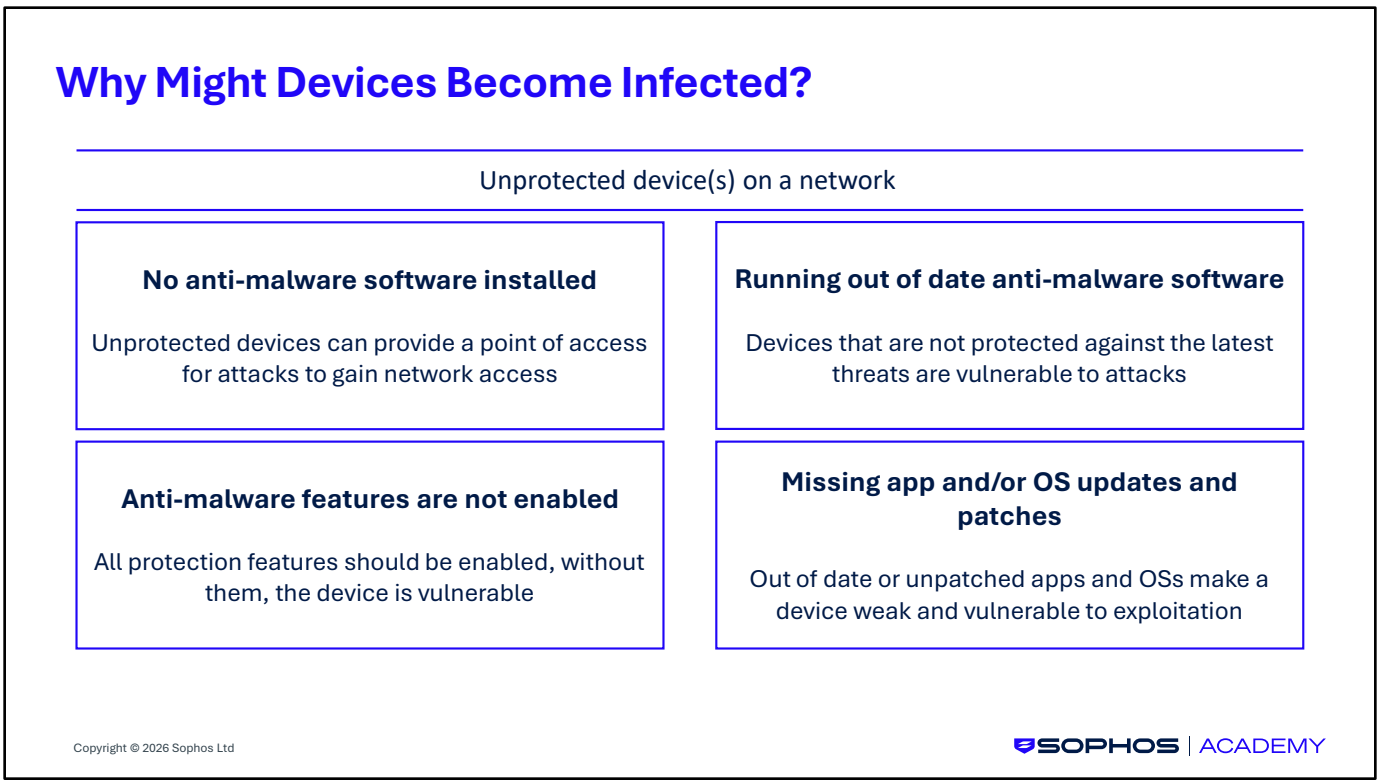
Devices that, whilst protected, do not have all of the recommended security features enabled. All protection features should be enabled, without them, the device is vulnerable.



Devices that are missing application or operating system updates and patches. Out of date and unpatched applications and operating systems make a device weak as the software is vulnerable to exploitation.

Why Might Devices Become Infected?

Inappropriate Exclusions

Malware can leverage legitimate applications and processes to evade detection

Excluding tools can create opportunities for malicious exploitation

Allowing a known PUA on all devices for example, could allow an attack to exploit that application

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Inappropriate exclusions can leave your network open to attack. Malware will also try to leverage legitimate applications and processes as much as possible to evade detection.

Creating exclusions for tools that you find useful or necessary can create an opportunity for malicious exploitation.

Why Might Devices Become Infected?

Zero-Day Threats

Attacks are constantly developing new attack techniques

Attackers will use malware that aims to bypass anti-malware software

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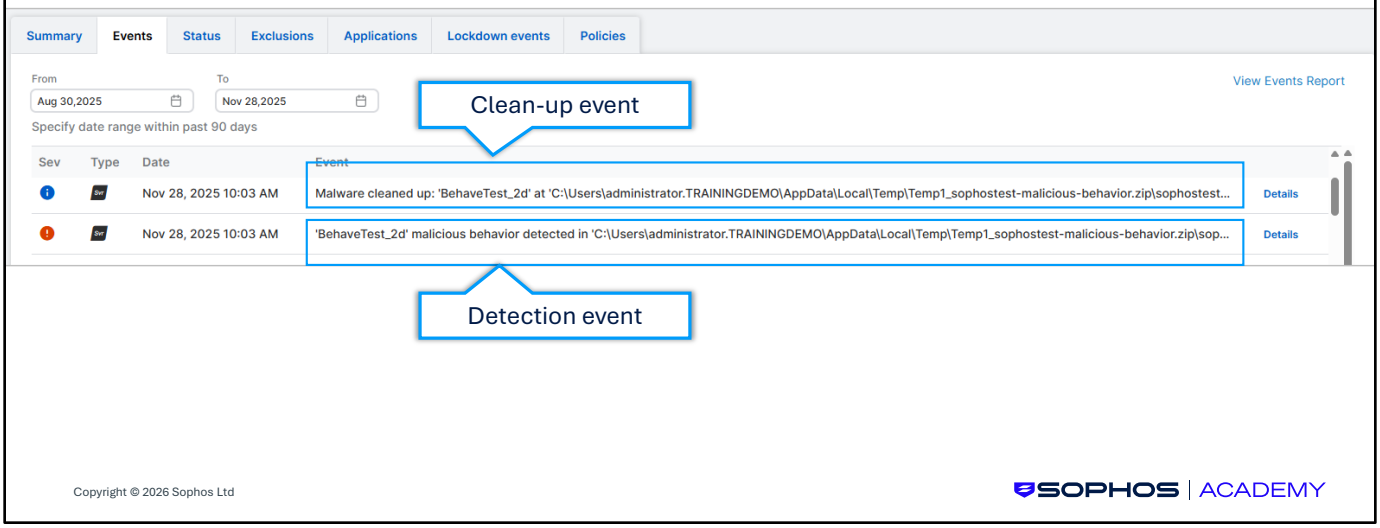
Sophos Central includes several techniques to detect and block zero-day threats, however, attackers do not generally release malware they know is going to be detected and blocked.

They will release malware they believe will bypass anti-malware software and are therefore constantly developing new techniques that a detection has not been created for.

Automatic Clean-Up



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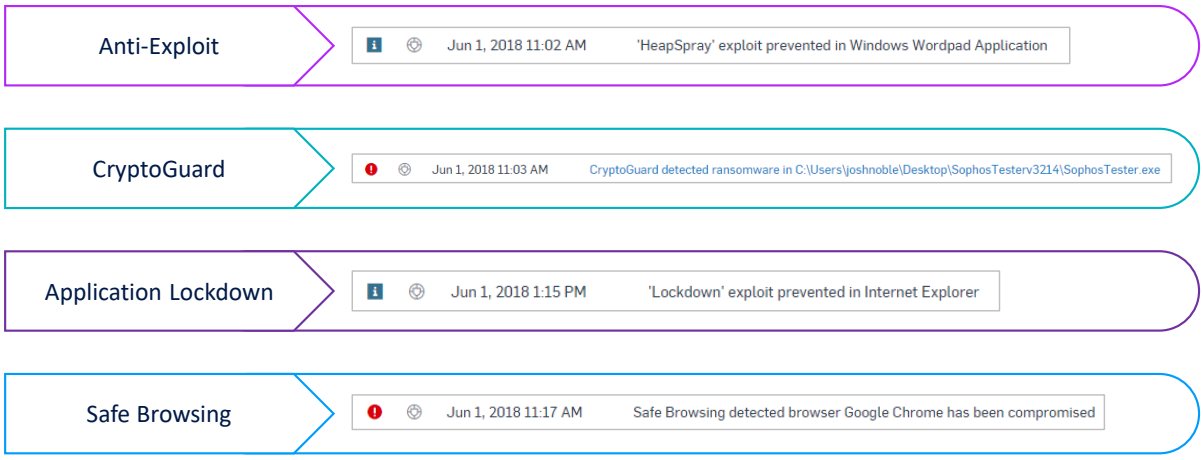
For a large majority of detections, the Sophos Endpoint Agent will automatically clean up any detected malicious files, folders, processes, or applications.

Detection Types



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The types of alerts you may see in Sophos Central will depend on the threat detected. These example detections would be automatically cleaned up where possible. For any threat that is not automatically cleaned up, you will see an alert for it in Sophos Central.

Detection Types

Additional information available in the notes

ML/PE-A

Malicious Portable Executable

KB-000036922

Examples of portable executables:

- .exe
- .sys
- .dll
- .scr

ML/PUA

Potentially Unwanted Application

KB-000034357

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The Sophos Endpoint Agent will detect malicious files and can generate either a ML/PE-A detection for files categorized as malicious or an ML/PUA detection for files categorised as PUAs.

[Additional Information]
ML detections explained **KB-000036922**: https://support.sophos.com/support/s/article/KB-000036922
Understanding generic PUA detections **KB-000034357**: https://support.sophos.com/support/s/article/KB-000034357

Remotely Run Ransomware

Alerts

- An alert for the server in Sophos Central reporting the detection and which IP address it came from
- An alert for the device in Sophos Central where the attack originated
- The server blocks any write access requests from the remote device

Action

- A clean-up action will be triggered automatically
- In Sophos Central both alerts can be marked as resolved
- Once resolved the server unblocks the remote device allowing write access

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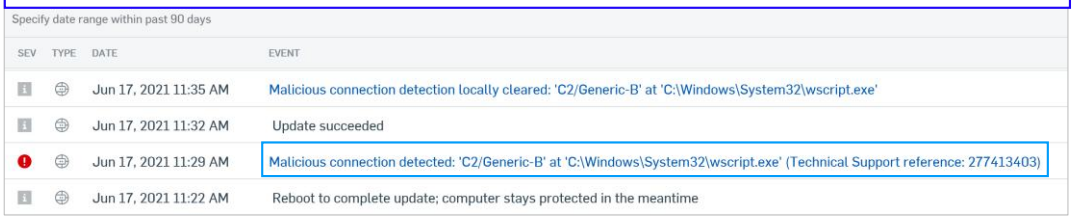
Runtime protection includes protection from remotely run ransomware. Detections are triggered when ransomware is remote to a device but attacks files that are stored on the device, such as files stored on a shared drive.

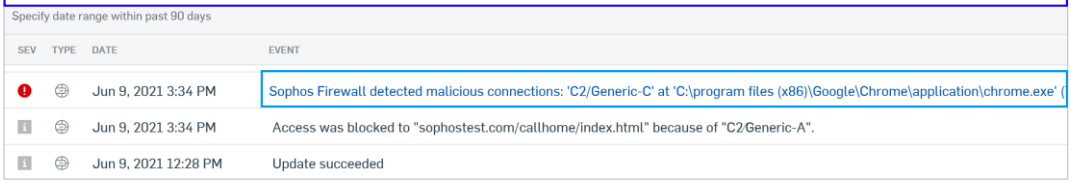
If such an attack is detected, a clean-up action will be triggered automatically and any files that may have been encrypted are restored.

Malicious Traffic Detections

C2/Generic-B: Not blocked and not cleaned up



C2/Generic-A and **C2/Generic-C**: Blocked but not cleaned up



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A C2 detection indicates malicious traffic has been detected. There are three C2 detection variants.

C2/Generic-B is the most serious. This detection means that malicious traffic was detected but not blocked and that the threat has not been cleaned up. This type of detection requires investigation as active malware is on the device. The malware is not blocked, as the malicious traffic is detected at the point of connection and so has already happened.

C2/Generic-A and C detections are returned when the malicious traffic detected has been blocked. C2/Generic-A detections are generally only seen on Sophos Firewalls, unless the URL is being accessed by an internet browser process. C2/Generic-C detections are usually only seen on devices that are using Sophos Security Heartbeat with a Sophos Firewall.

Exploit Detections

What happens when an exploit is detected?

- The exploit is stopped
- The user is notified
- A threat graph is generated
- The threat is automatically cleaned up

What action needs to be taken?

- Investigate using the threat graph
- Determine if a user downloaded or authorized a vulnerable application
- Ensure that the operating system and applications are up-to-date
- Provide user training

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If an exploit is detected, it will be stopped. The user of the device is notified, and a threat graph is created. These detections are automatically cleaned up.

Following an exploit detection, an administrator should investigate using the threat graph which provides the details of where the threat originated, how it spread, which processes were involved, and which files were affected. An administrator should determine if a user downloaded or authorized a vulnerable application that allowed the exploit. Additionally, an administrator should ensure that the operating system and applications are up to date and that all patches are installed on the device. Finally, the administrator should educate users on safe browsing techniques and review user policies in Sophos Central.

As a result of an investigation, an administrator may decide to block downloads from specific websites and internet browsers, or to restrict user access to applications.

Web Browser Detections

What happens when a web browser threat is detected?

- Sophos Endpoint Agent warns the user to close the browser
- A threat graph is generated
- The threat is automatically cleaned up

What action needs to be taken?

- Use the threat graph to identify the IP address and URL connection associated with the attack
- Determine if the IP address or URL should be blocked

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If a web browser threat is detected, the threat is automatically cleaned up, and the user is warned to close the internet browser. A threat graph is automatically created in Sophos Central.

Following this type of detection, an administrator can use the threat graph to identify the IP address and URL connection associated with the attack. They should determine if the IP address or URL should be blocked. The user should also advise to check any accounts if they entered credentials and to change any passwords if they were entered on the website.

Malware Detections

What happens when malware is detected?

- Malware is detected and automatically cleaned up
- The malware and associated files are quarantined
- The user is notified
- A threat graph is generated

What action needs to be taken?

- No further action is required
- The threat has been detected and cleaned up
- All associated files have been removed from the device
- If the item was incorrectly detected as malware, it can be restored

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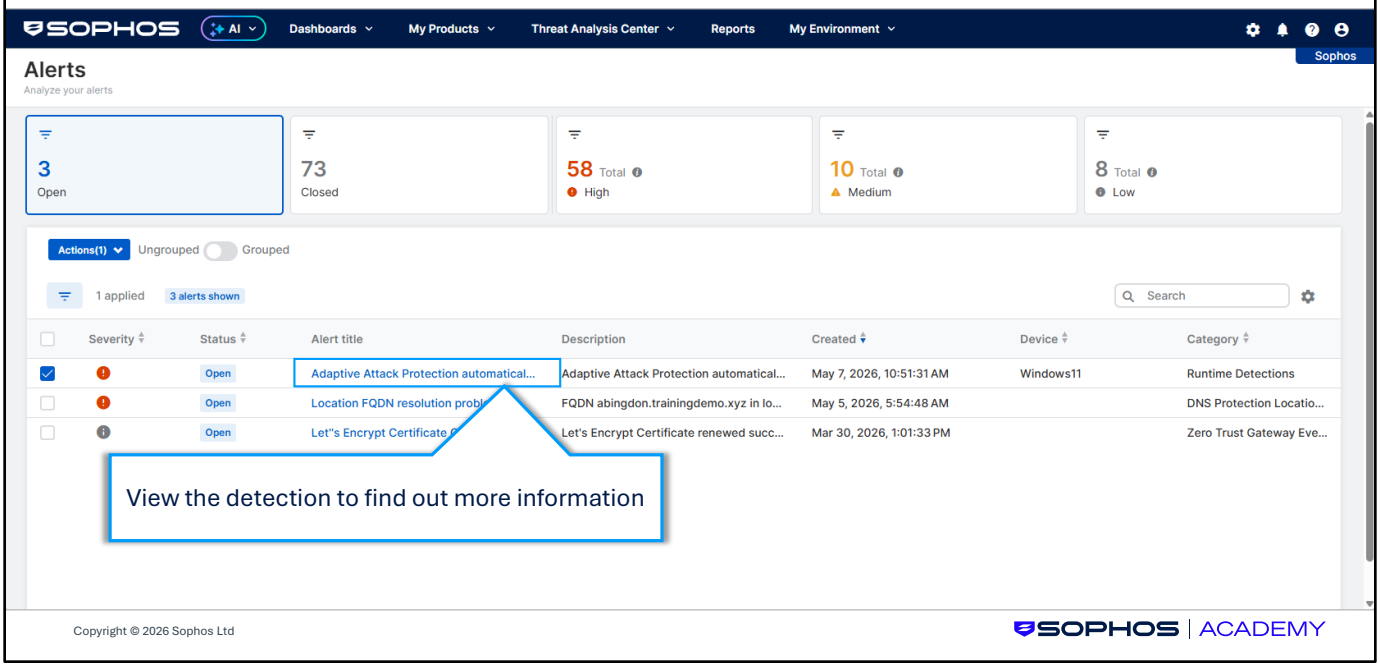
If malware is detected on a device, it will be automatically cleaned up. The malicious items and all associated files are quarantined. The user is notified, and a threat graph is generated in Sophos Central.

In this case, there is no action required as the threat has been detected and removed from the device. If the item was incorrectly detected, it can be restored.

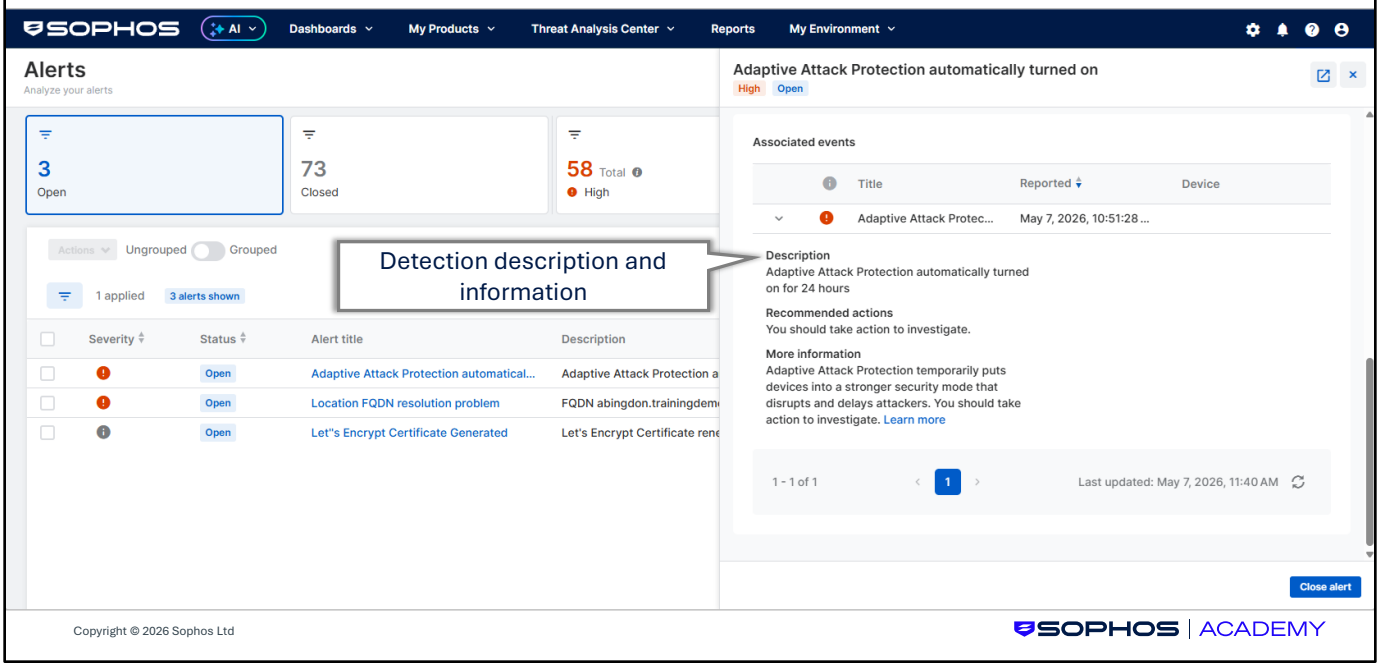
Manual Clean-Up



For those detections where manual intervention is required, an alert will be triggered and displayed in Sophos Central.

If you select the alert from the most recent alerts list on the dashboard, you can view more information about the detection.

Manual Clean-Up

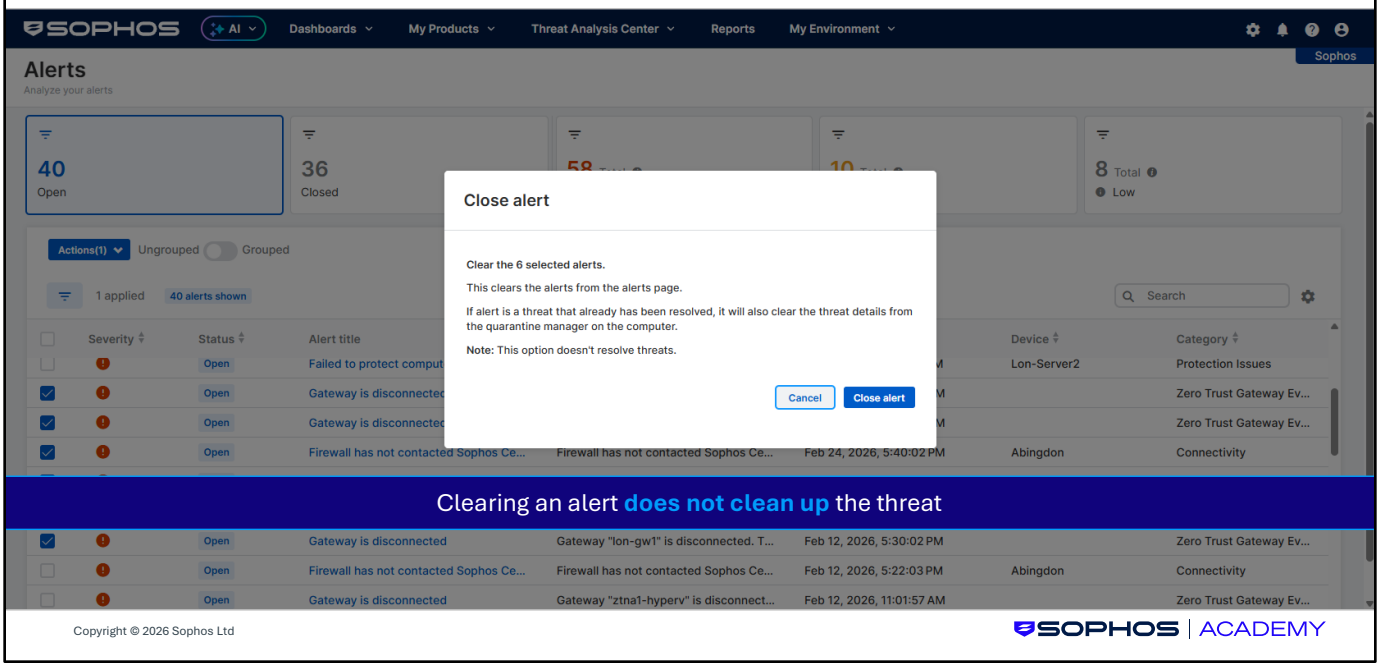


The expanded alert view displays information about the detection. A description of the detection and any further information available. Links and information are provided to assist with cleaning up the detection.

Information about where the detection was found, the device type, the operating system, and the device name and user that was logged in at the time the detection was triggered are displayed.

You can amend the frequency of email alerts for the detection type.

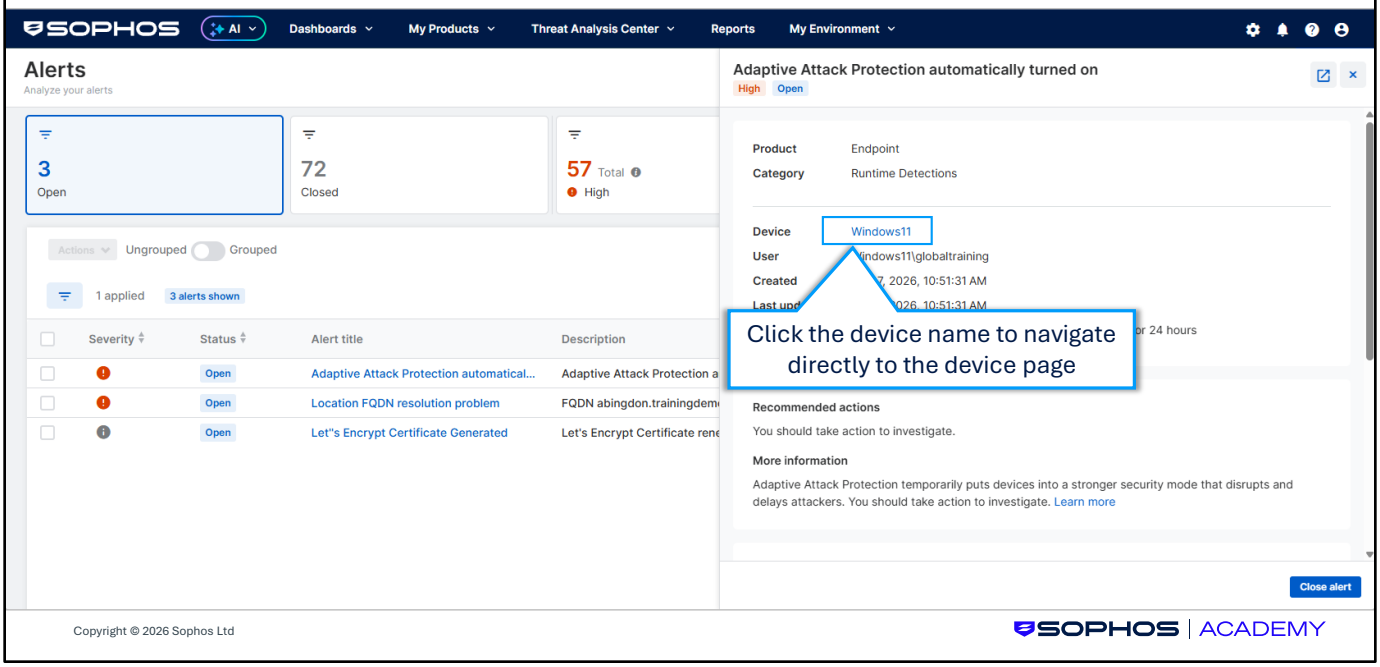
Manual Clean-Up



If you select to close the alert from the Action drop-down menu, you will clear the alert from Sophos Central.

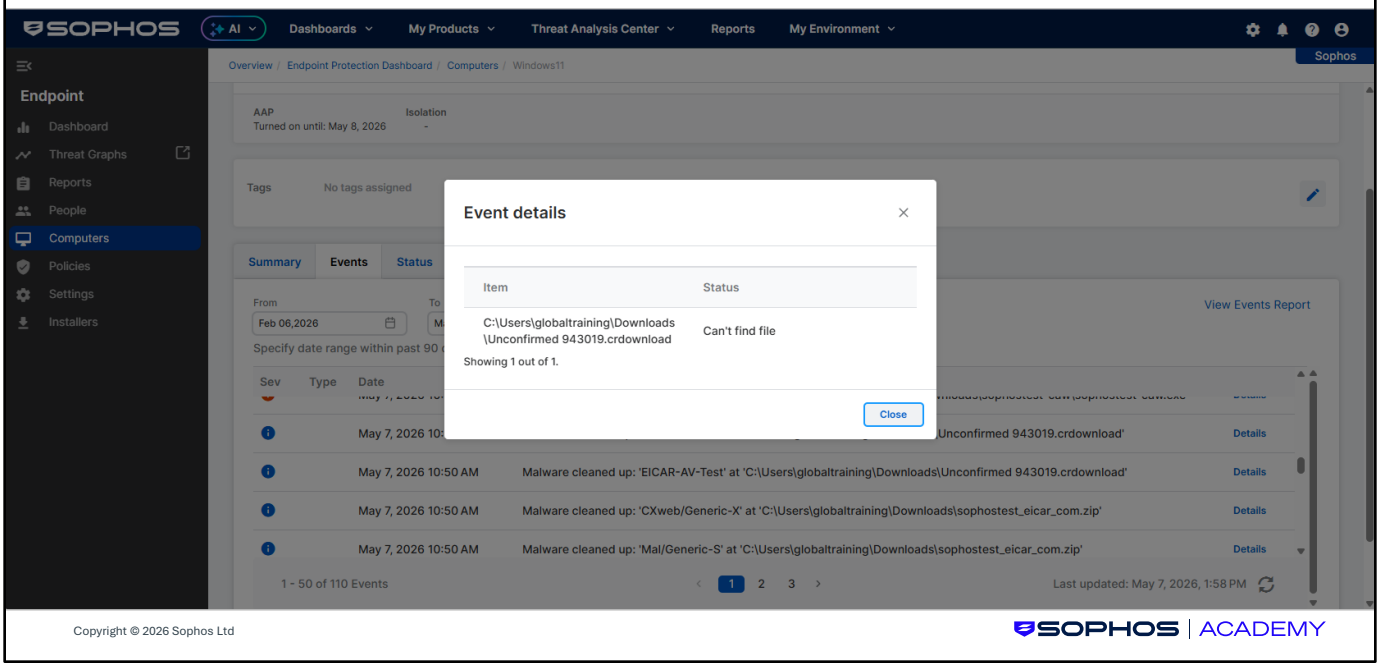
This action **DOES NOT** clean up the detected threat. It **ONLY** clears the alert.

Manual Clean-Up



If you select the device name, you will be redirected to the device page where you can review the status of the device and view the detection on the **Events** tab.

Manual Clean-Up



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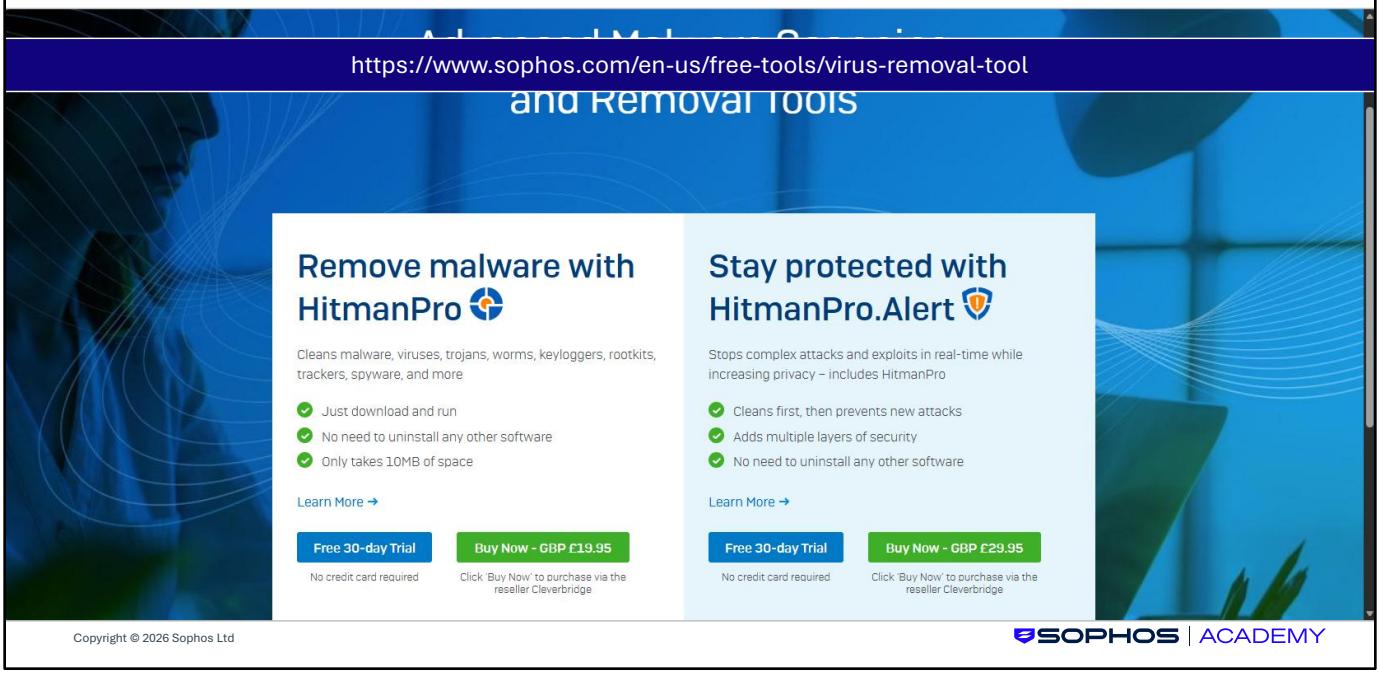
On the **EVENTS** tab of the device page, the manual clean-up required event is displayed, along with the detection event. Clicking the **Details** link for the manual clean-up event will display when automatic clean-up failed.

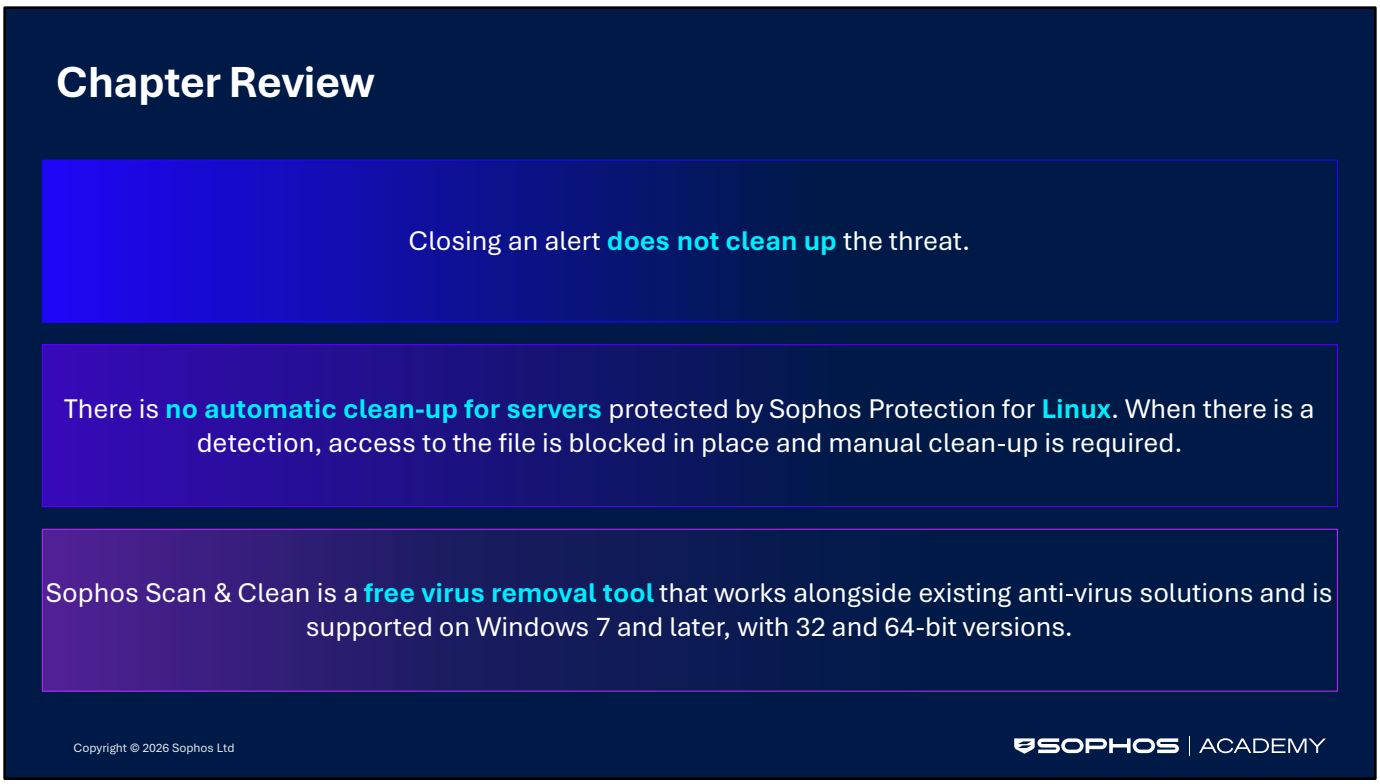
Virus Removal Tool

Additional information available in the notes



HitmanPro is a second-opinion virus removal scanner that is capable of both detecting and removing threats and other malware. It works alongside existing anti-virus solutions and is supported on Windows 7 and later, with 32 and 64-bit versions.

[Additional Information]
HitmanPro is a Sophos product. More information can be found here: HitmanPro Advanced Malware Removal Tools
https://www.sophos.com/en-us/free-tools/virus-removal-tool



Here are the three main things you learned in this chapter.

Closing an alert does not clean up the threat.

There is no automatic clean up for servers protected by Sophos Protection for Linux . When there is a detection, access to the file is blocked in place and manual clean up is required.

Hitman Pro is a virus removal tool that works alongside existing anti-virus solutions.

[Additional Information]

Sophos Endpoint
EP4030: Getting Started with Sophos Endpoint SafeStore

May 2026

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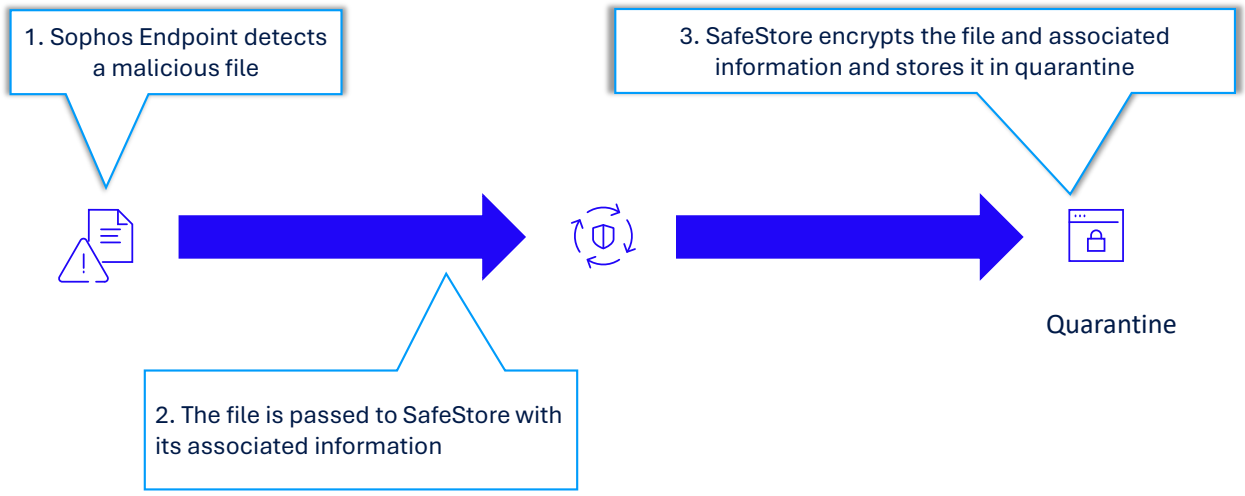
In this chapter, you'll learn how Sophos Endpoint quarantines detected files and restores them if required.

SafeStore Overview



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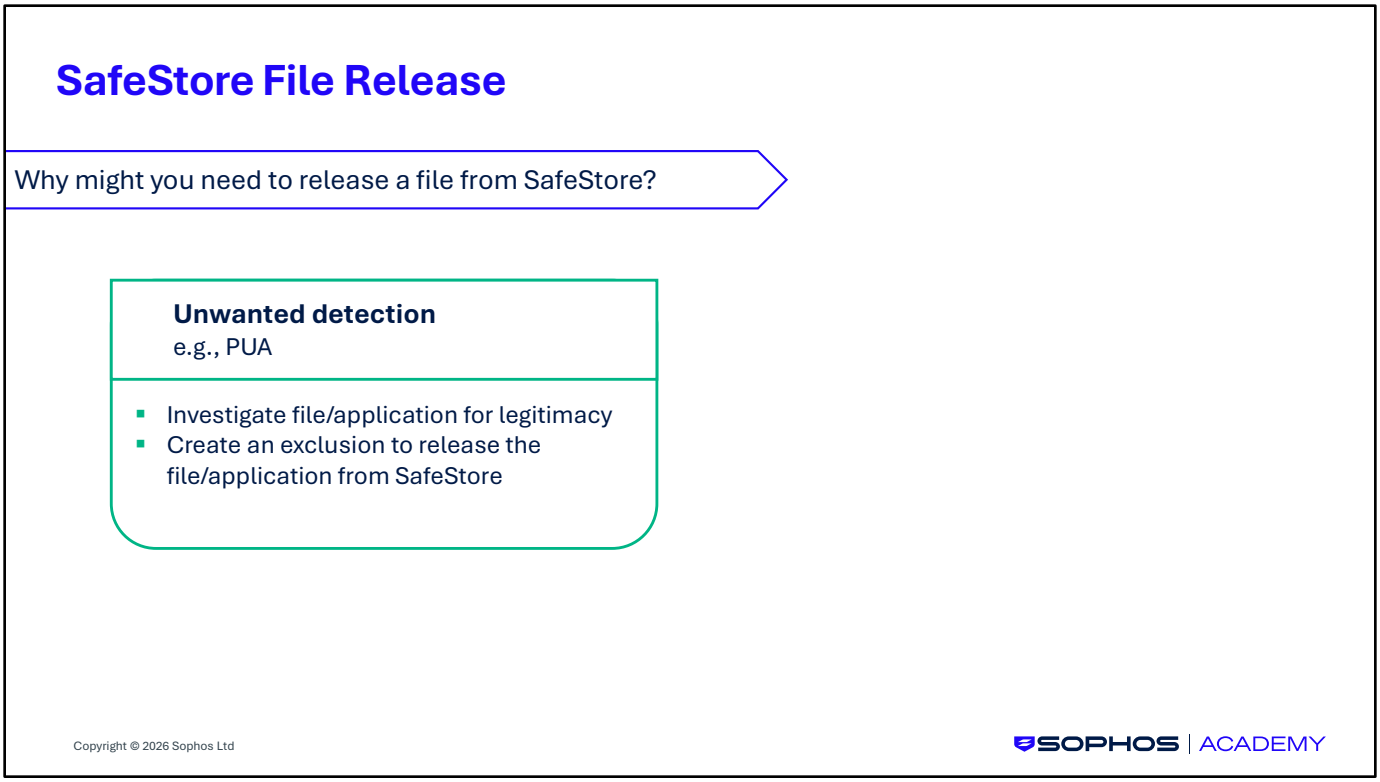
When Sophos cleans up a file, it passes it to SafeStore with its associated information. SafeStore encrypts the file and associated information and stores it in the quarantine.

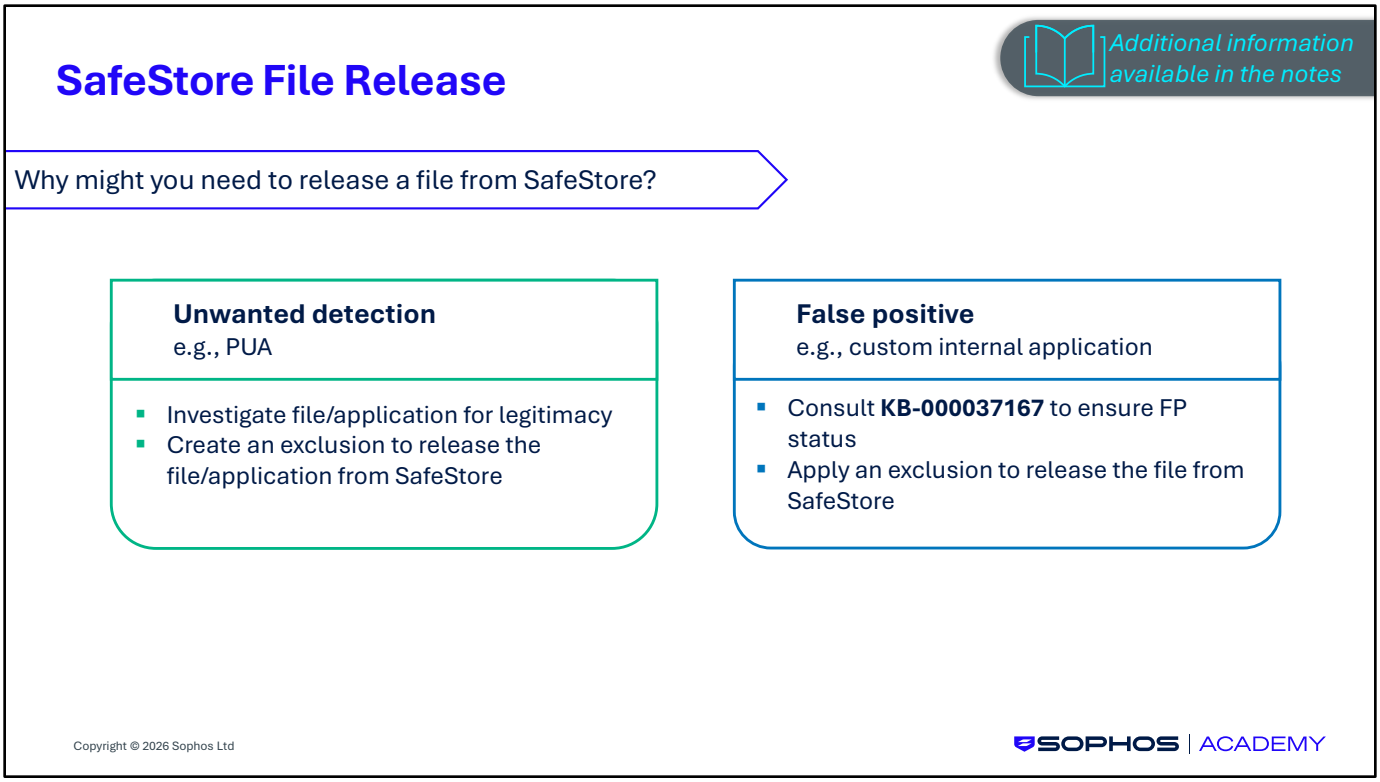
The associated file information can include registry keys, permissions, and service information. If a file needs to be restored, this ensures that it is restored in a fully functioning state.

Note that if a file is disinfected and the malicious code removed, the remaining file is clean and is not sent to SafeStore.



There are several reasons you may choose to release a file that has been quarantined. Two possible reasons for releasing a file from SafeStore are if a file or a PUA has been detected and cleaned up, and you want to continue using it, or if a file has been quarantined due to a false positive detection.

If you want to use a cleaned-up file or application, it is recommended that you create an exclusion in the local threat protection policy for the file or application. Please note that any exclusions should be carefully considered before being implemented, as they reduce your security. Once the exclusion has been applied to a device through a policy, the files related to the detection are released from the SafeStore.

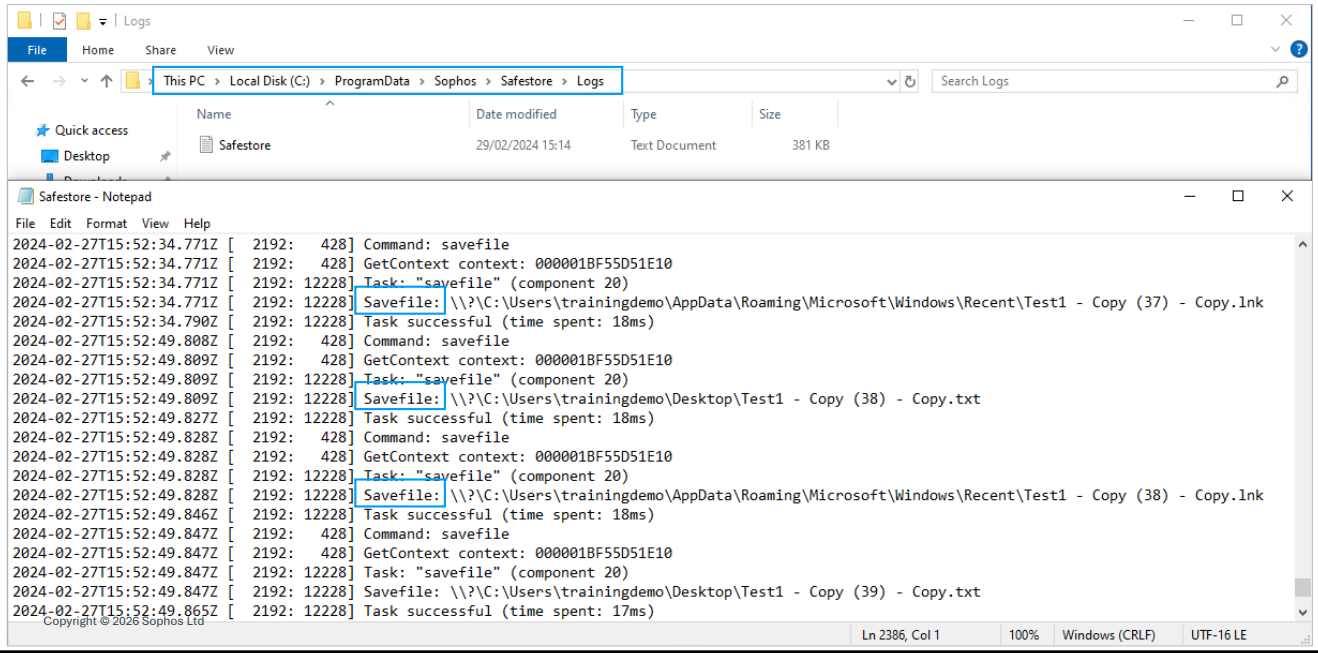


If you suspect a file is a false positive detection, we recommend that you investigate it before releasing the file. If files are detected due to a false positive, and Sophos later releases an update that resolves the detection, those files will be restored. This is because the contents of SafeStore are rechecked whenever there is an update.

[Additional Information]
To ensure a file is a false positive, see knowledge base article **KB-000037167**. Sophos Central: Investigate and resolve a potential false positive or incorrect detection
https://support.sophos.com/support/s/article/KB-000037167

SafeStore Logs

Additional information available in the notes

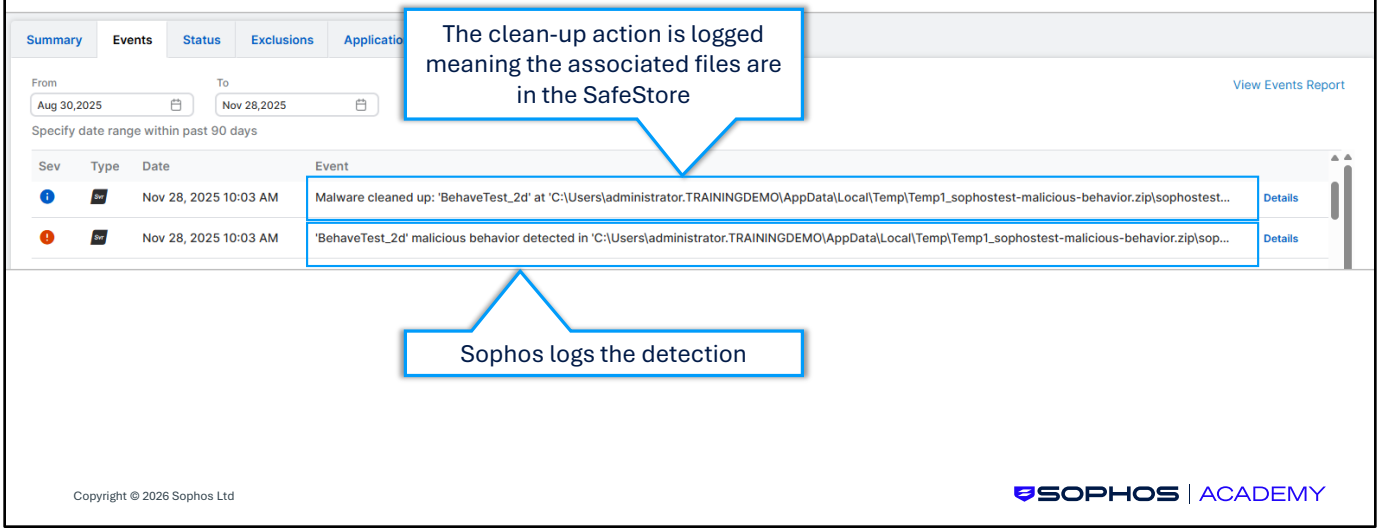


The SafeStore quarantine is stored in the SafeStore directory.

If we look at the log file, we can see a ‘savefile’ action for detected files.

[Additional Information]
SafeStore log directory: C:\ProgramData\Sophos\SafeStore\Logs

SafeStore Events



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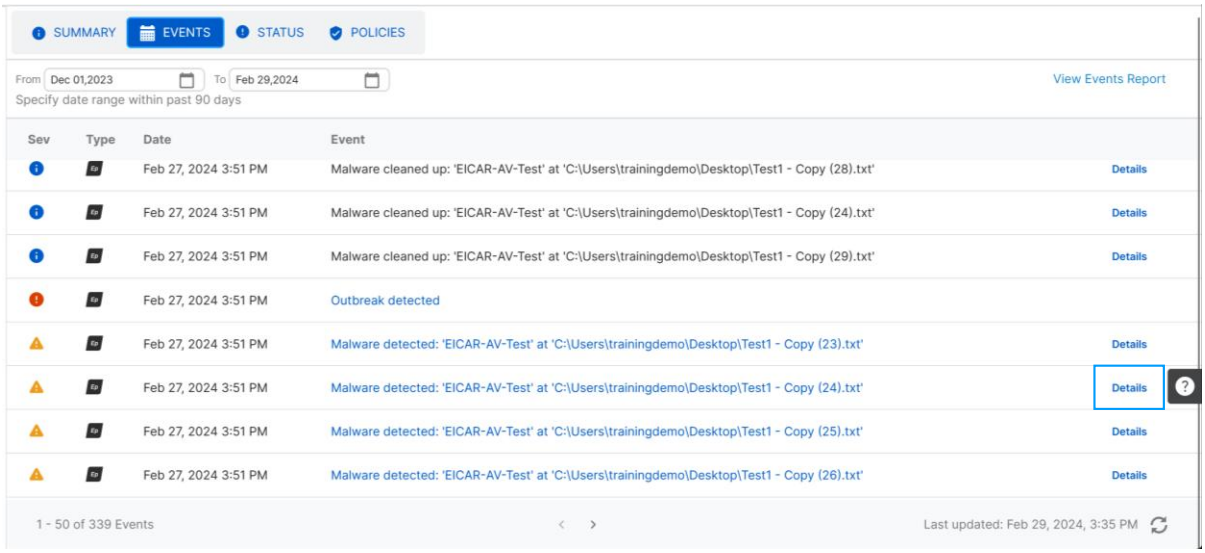
The **Events** tab on a device record details all device events, including detections of unwanted files or applications and false positives.

In the events list, you will see two lines per detection. The first line is the detection event, and the second line is the clean-up event. When a file is cleaned up, it and its associated files are encrypted in the SafeStore.

SafeStore Events



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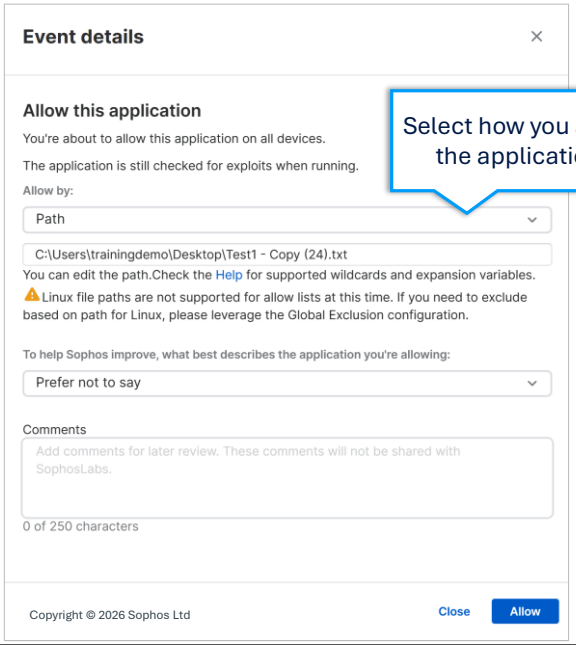
To release a file from the SafeStore, locate the detection event in the **Events** tab of the device where it has been detected.

Scroll to the right to view the **Details** link.

SafeStore File Recovery



- SHA 256
  - Allow the files by the SHA 256 which will allow any file with the same SHA 256
- File Path
  - Allow the file by the specific file path will whitelist any file with the same name in that specific location
- Certificate
  - Allow the file by the certificate whitelists all files signed by the digital signature

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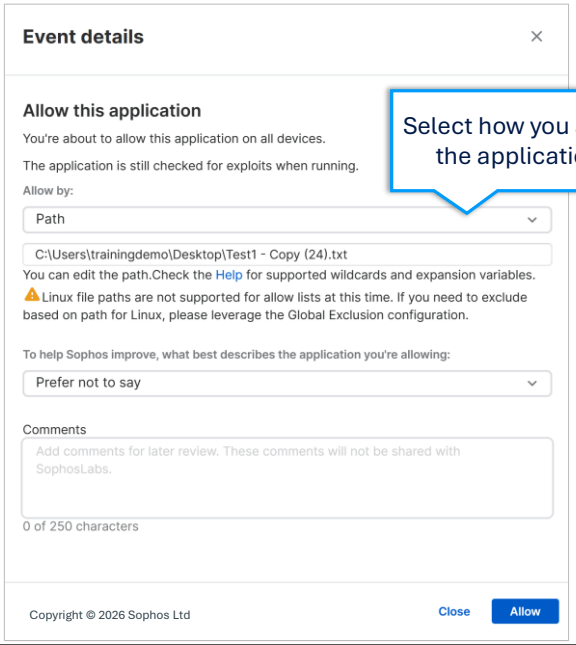
The event details include the detection name, certificate, SHA-256, and the path where the file was detected. If you suspect the detection is a false positive, you can use this information to check if other vendors are categorizing the file as malicious or legitimate. You can choose to allow the application, either by the SHA-256, the file path, or the certificate.

If you select to release a file using the file path, it will whitelist any file with the same name in that specific location. This helps when legitimate files are detected again after they have been updated, even if the SHA-256 has changed. If you select to release a file using the certificate, it will whitelist every file signed by this digital signature, which can be useful to ensure legitimate applications that are signing their files do not get detected. However, if you have reason to believe the certificate might have been compromised, then it is safer to use the SHA-256 instead.

SafeStore File Recovery



- SHA 256
  - Allow the files by the SHA 256 which will allow any file with the same SHA 256

File Path

- Allow the file by the specific file path will whitelist any file with the same name in that specific location

- Certificate
  - Allow the file by the certificate whitelists all files signed by the digital signature

- Allowing an application will result in the SHA 256, file path or certificate being **whitelisted for your entire environment**.
- SafeStore restores the file on **all** devices it was detected on

Note that allowing an application using any of the above methods will result in the SHA-256, file path, or certificate being whitelisted for your entire environment. This means that if you have multiple devices that detect the same file, it will be restored on all of them.

SafeStore File Recovery

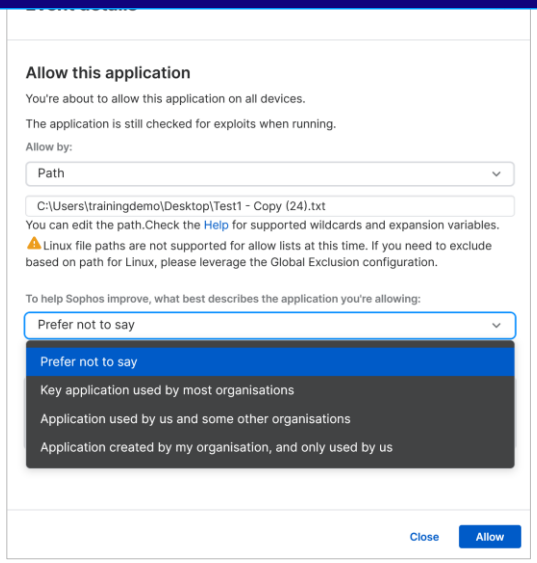
Sophos **does not recommend** allowing detected applications UNLESS you are sure they are safe

When allowing detected applications. Classify the application type:

- Key application used by most organizations
- Application used by us and some other organizations
- Application created by my organization, and only used by us

Once a detected application is allowed, it will be released from SafeStore on **ALL** devices when it has been **detected.**

The detected application is added to the allowed applications list in **Global Settings**.



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Once you have selected how to allow the detected file or application, select the option to log why the file has been released. It is Important to understand that Sophos does not recommend allowing any detected applications unless you are sure they are safe.

When you allow a detected application, you can also classify what type of application it is; A key application used by most organizations, an application used by us and some other organizations, an application created by the organization, or an application only used within the organization. You can select not to say.

Once an application is allowed, it will be released from SafeStore on all devices where it was detected. Once a detected application has been allowed, it will be added to the allowed applications list in **Global Settings**.

Policy Exclusions

Additional information available in the notes

SafeStore is scanned when a policy is updated.

Excluded files/applications are restored.
If a location is excluded **ALL** detected items are restored.

Locations **NOT** recommended for whitelisting

- × C:\
- × C:\TEMP\
- × C:\users\[username]\
- × C:\users\[username]\downloads\
- × C:\users\[username]\documents\
- × C:\users\[username]\documents\my received files\

Whitelisting locations could restore convicted malicious items across your network

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When a policy is updated and the endpoint receives the update, the SafeStore is scanned. If a new exclusion has been added, the files and items related to that exclusion will be restored.

You must take extreme caution when excluding items. Excluding locations will return any previously convicted applications to that location, including associated files and registry entries. If this happens, you could accidentally restore malicious items across your network.

[Additional Information]
We recommend that the following locations are never whitelisted as they are the most common attack locations:

- C:\
- C:\TEMP\
- C:\users\[username]\
- C:\users\[username]\Downloads\
- C:\users\[username]\Documents\
- C:\users\[username]\Documents\My Received Files\

Allowing Detected Items

WARNING: Only allow items that are legitimate

Application

In the event details select
Allow this application

Select either:

- Certificate
- SHA-256
- Path

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Think carefully before you add any exclusions, as this significantly reduces your protection. Exclusions can be added from the event details created by a detection for applications, exploits, and ransomware. The detection and exclusion of applications have already been covered.

Allowing Detected Items

WARNING: Only allow items that are legitimate

Application	Exploit
In the event details select **Allow this application** Select either: ▪ Certificate ▪ SHA-256 ▪ Path	In the event details select **Don't detect this again** Select either: ▪ Allow by detection ID (most secure) ▪ Allow by mitigation ▪ Allow by application

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To allow an exploit, select the event details and then select 'Don't detect this again'. You can select 'Allow by detection ID', which prevents the specific detection. This is the most secure way of excluding a detected exploit. Items excluded using this method go into the **Global Exclusions** list. 'Allow by mitigation' stops the device from checking a specific exploit on the affected application. For example, if a 'Safe Browsing' detection was triggered in Microsoft Edge, using this option will mean the endpoint no longer checks for the Safe Browsing exploit type in Edge. 'Allow by application' prevents any checks for exploits in the application. For example, if a code cave exploit was triggered in Excel and you choose this method to exclude Excel, Excel will cease to be protected from **ANY** exploits in the future, not just the code cave exploit. Applications excluded via this method go into the **Exploit Mitigation Exclusion** list in case you need to go back and remove the respective exclusion.

Allowing Detected Items

WARNING: Only allow items that are legitimate

Application

In the event details select **Allow this application**

Select either:

- Certificate
- SHA-256
- Path

Exploit

In the event details select **Don't detect this again**

Select either:

- Allow by detection ID (most secure)
- Allow by mitigation
- Allow by application

Ransomware

In the event details select **Don't detect this again**

Select:

- Allow by detection ID

We **DO NOT** recommend stopping the detection of ransomware

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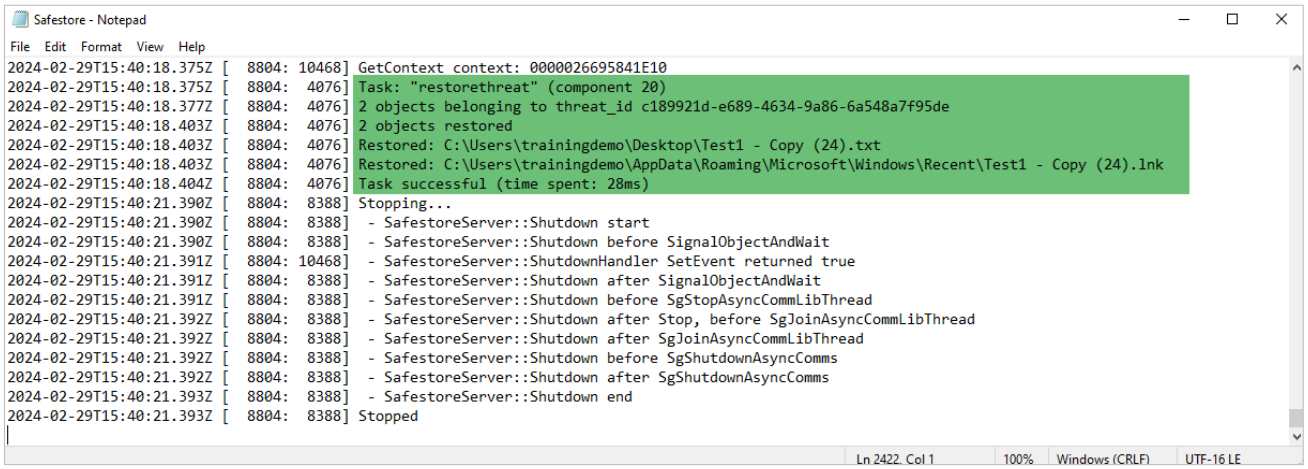
We recommend excluding the detection ID of a detected item first, as this provides a better target. If the same detection happens again, use the 'Mitigation' method, then, if required, exclude the application on the next occurrence. To allow ransomware, **which is not recommended**, you can select to exclude this detection ID from checking. This will prevent the detection.

SafeStore File Recovery

Files can only be restored to their original location



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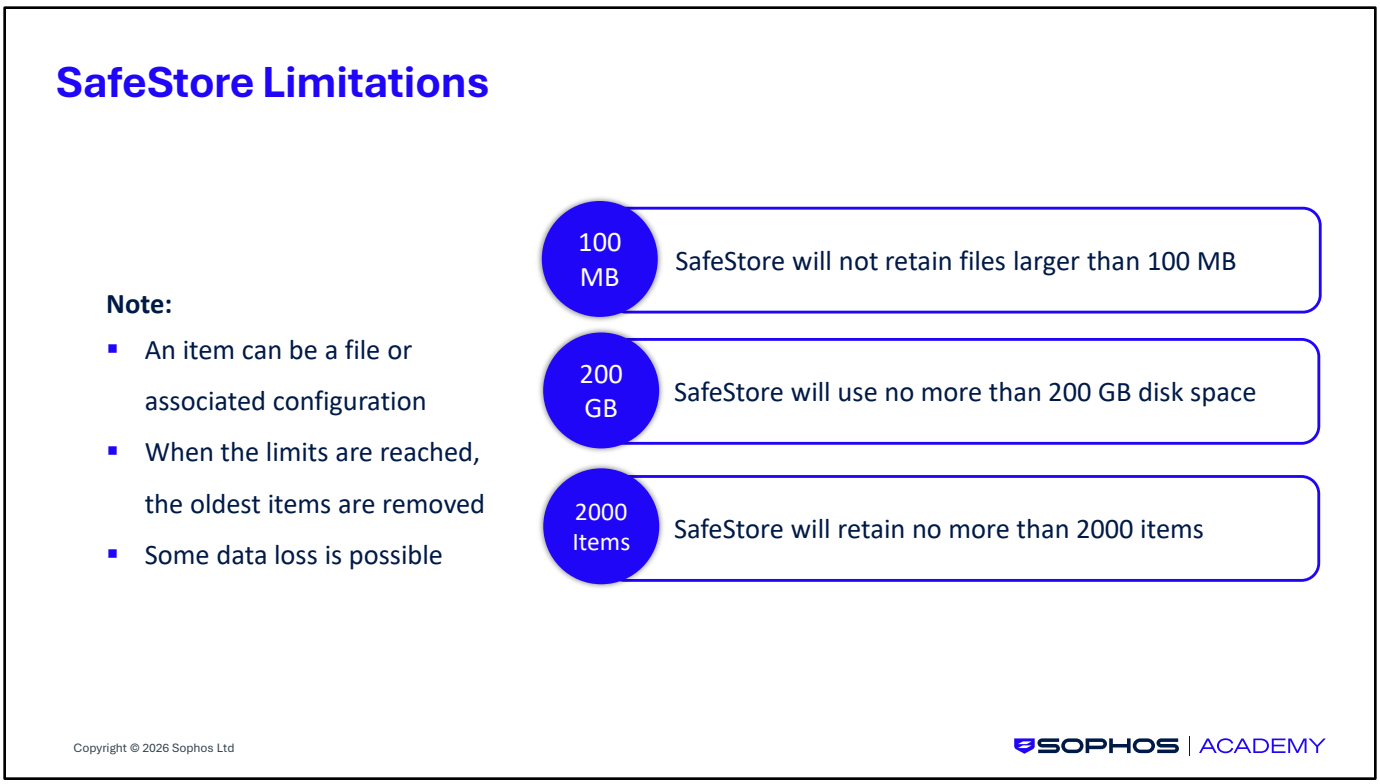
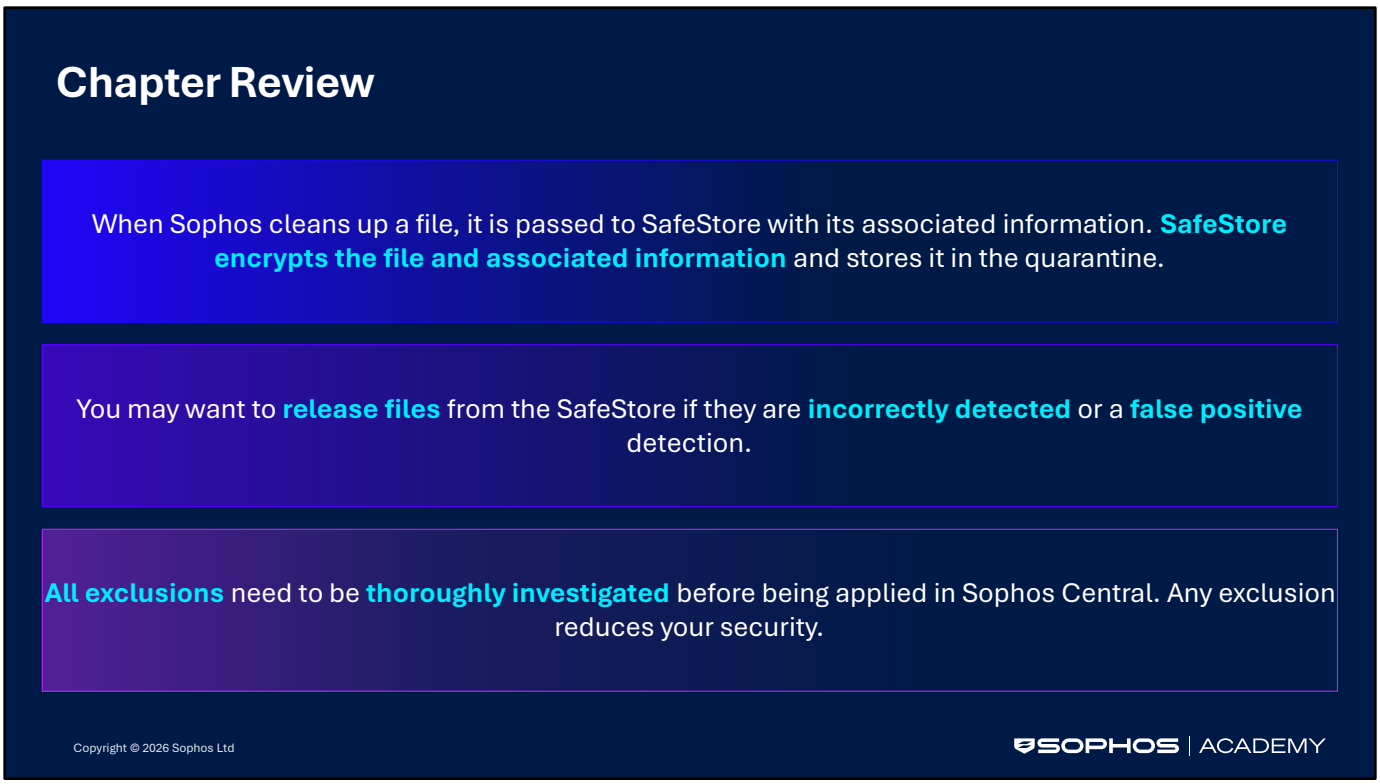
In the SafeStore log file you can see the ‘restorethreat’ command being run and the detected application being restored.

It is important to note that files can only be restored to their original location. If that location no longer exists, the restore operation will fail.



SafeStore has some limitations to prevent it from consuming too much disk space. These are 100 MB file size limit per file. It is very uncommon for larger files to be detected as malware. 200 GB limit on how much space SafeStore will use and a 2000 item limit on the number of items SafeStore will keep.

Please note that an item can be a file or associated configuration such as registry keys. When the maximum number of files limit is reached, the oldest item will be removed from SafeStore. Due to these limitations some data loss is possible.



Here are the three main things you learned in this chapter.

When Sophos cleans up a file, it is passed to SafeStore with its associated information. SafeStore encrypts the file and associated information and stores it in the quarantine.

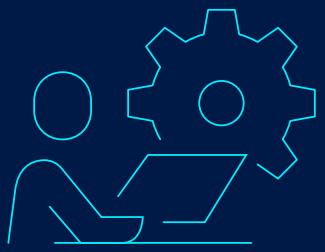
You may want to release files from the SafeStore if they are incorrectly detected or a false positive detection.

All exclusions need to be thoroughly investigated before being applied in Sophos Central. Any exclusion reduces your security.

Lab Tasks

Complete the lab tasks for **Remediation and reports**

- **Task 1**: Review Control Reports



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Complete the lab tasks for this module.

The lab task information can be found in the Lab Workbook which is available in the **Lesson Resources.**

Sophos Endpoint Detection and Response

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[Additional Information]

Sophos Endpoint
EP4505: Introduction to Detection and Response

September 2026

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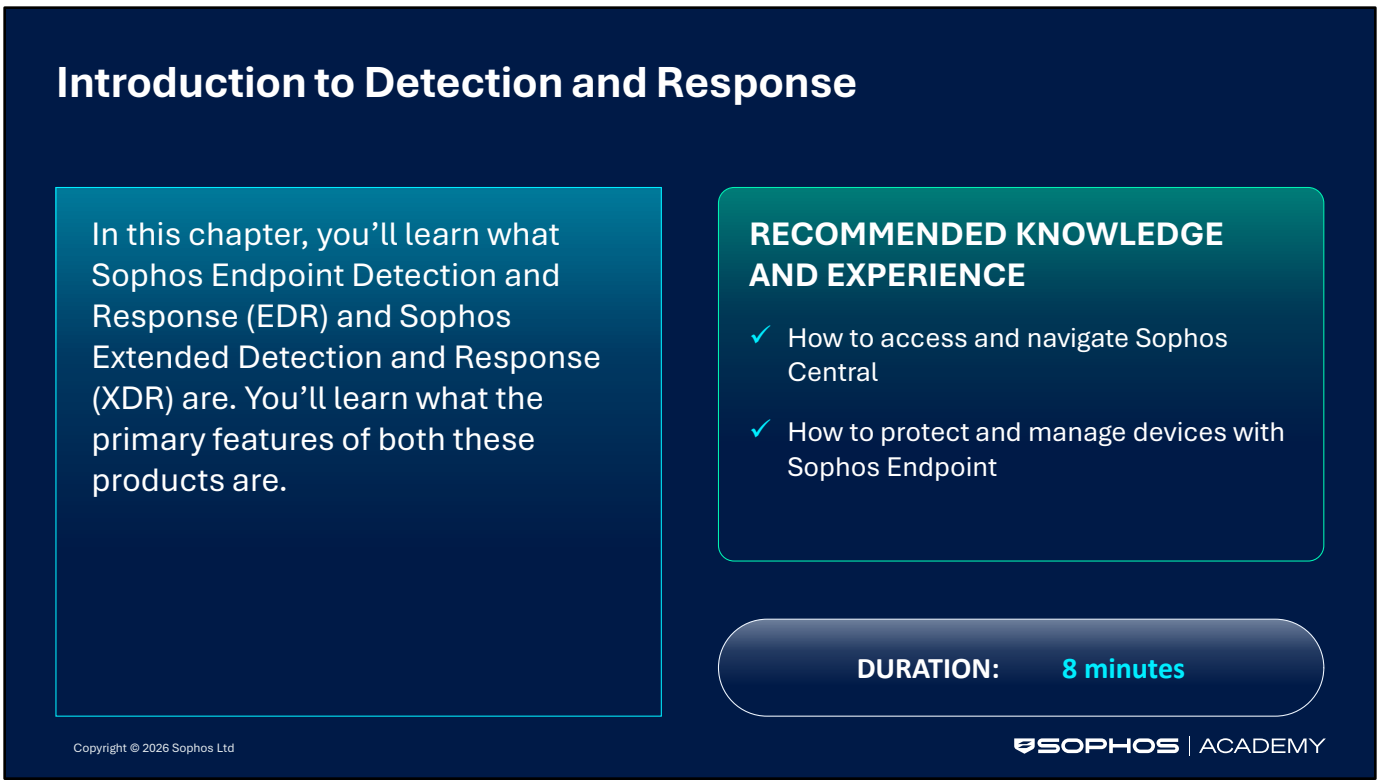
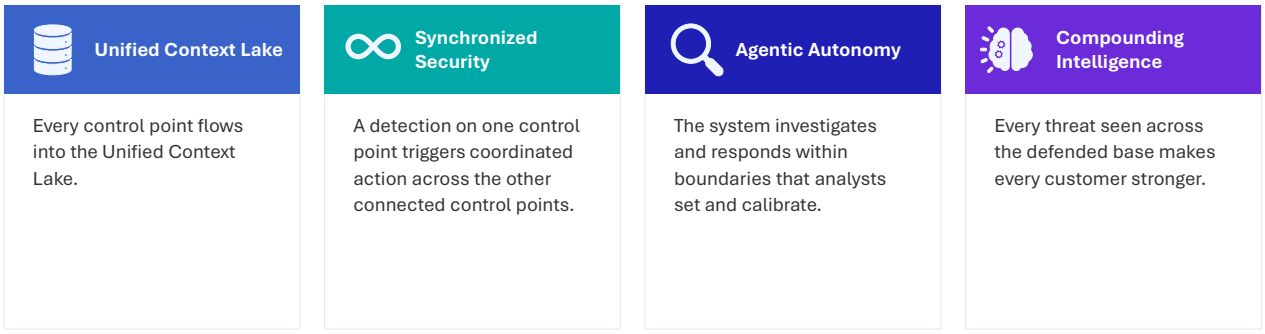


In this chapter, you'll learn what Sophos Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) and Sophos Extended Detection Response (XDR) are. You'll learn what the primary features of both these products are.

Sophos Unified Security Operations

Sophos brings together tools, intelligence, and products into one system, defined by four characteristics.



One system: native and third-party data converge in the Unified Context Lake, so detection, investigation, and response run on one dataset.

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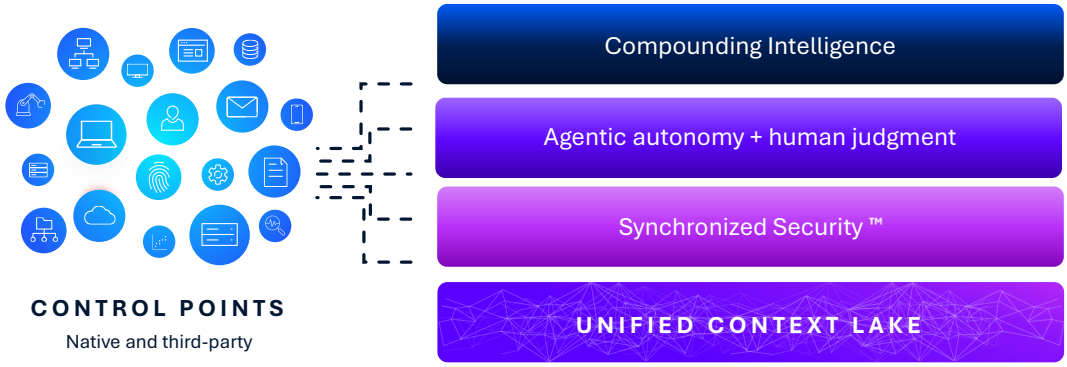
Sophos' unified defense system uses telemetry from Sophos Endpoints that flows into a single Unified Context Lake where it is normalized and correlated across domains, so detection, investigation, and response operate on one consistent dataset.

Unified Context Lake



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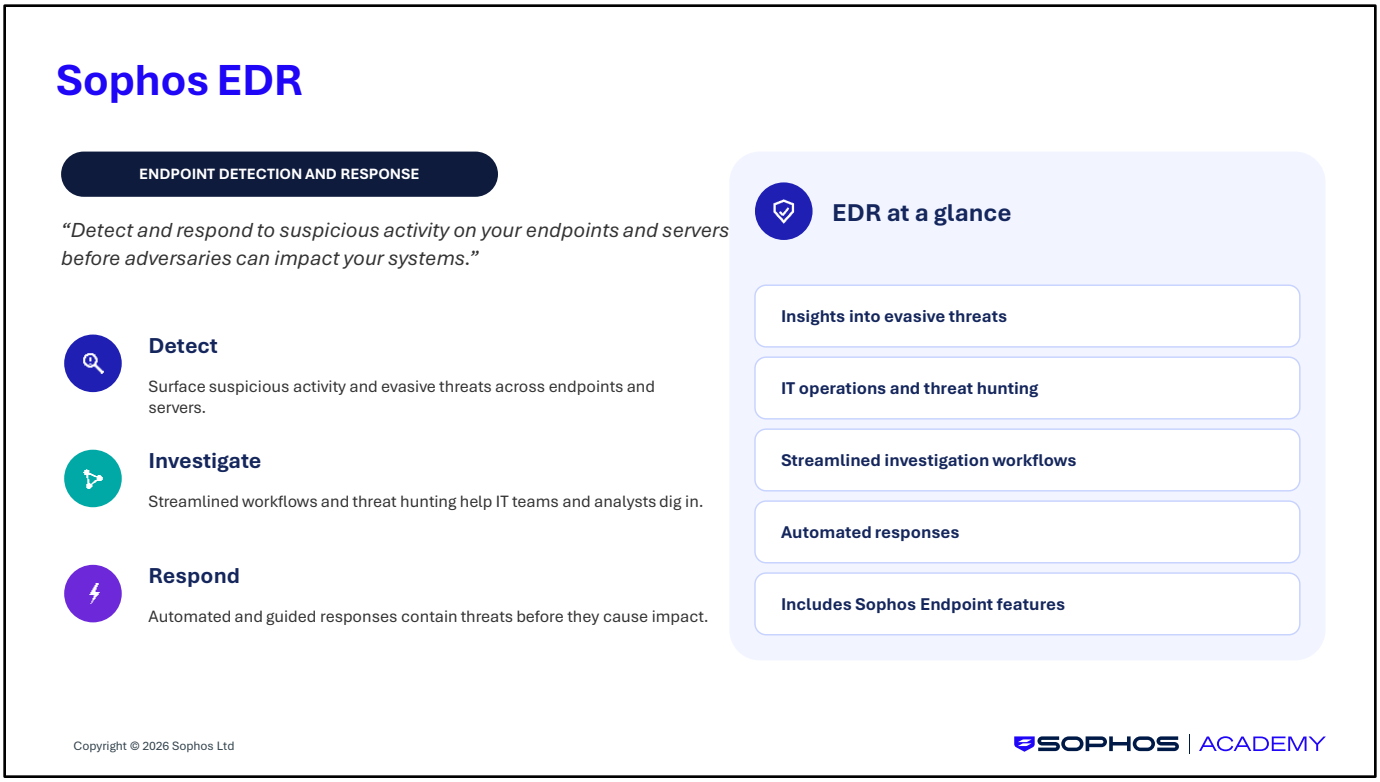
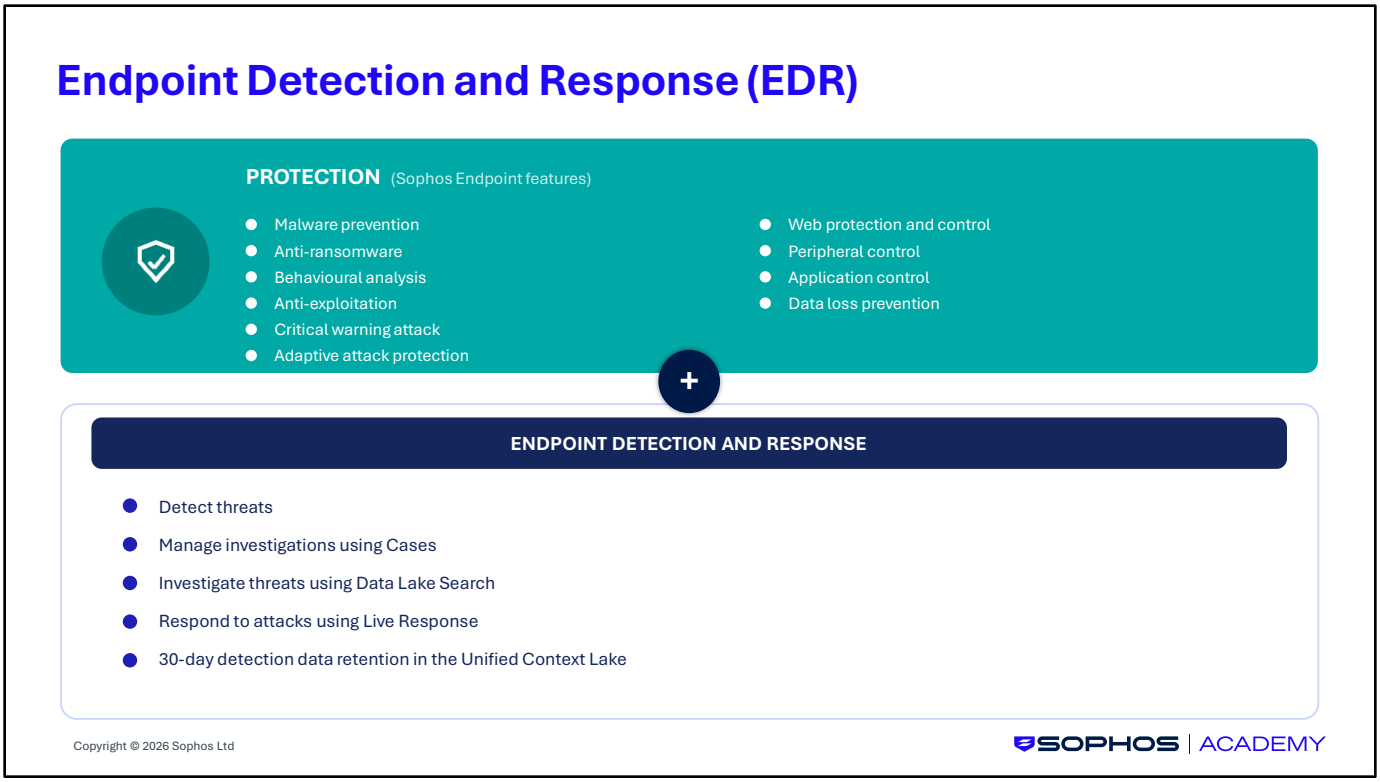
Unified operations rely on a centralized data architecture in which the Unified Context Lake stores data ingested from multiple sources across the environment. This includes endpoints and servers, network infrastructure, cloud environments, email systems, third-party products, and identity providers.

Bringing this data together in a single location supports cross-product investigation and enables historical analysis. It also enables security teams to perform threat hunting at scale, using a consistent dataset spanning the entire environment.

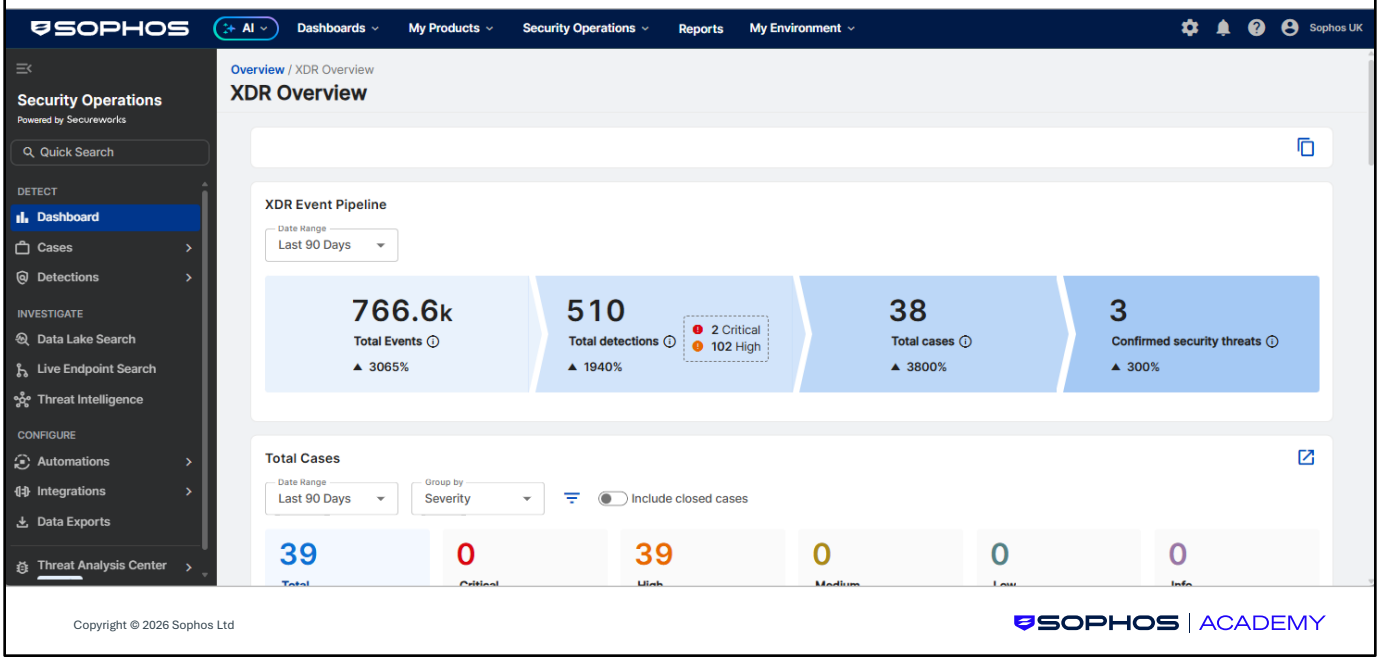


Sophos Endpoint Detection and Response provides protection, detection, and response capabilities. It reduces risk, provides insights into suspicious activity and evasive threats, and empowers IT generalists and security analysts to do more.



Sophos Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) includes the protection features of Sophos Endpoint and adds to them by providing the tools to investigate threats and respond to them. It gives you access to search the Unified Context Lake, which comes with a thirty-day detection data retention period.

Security Operations



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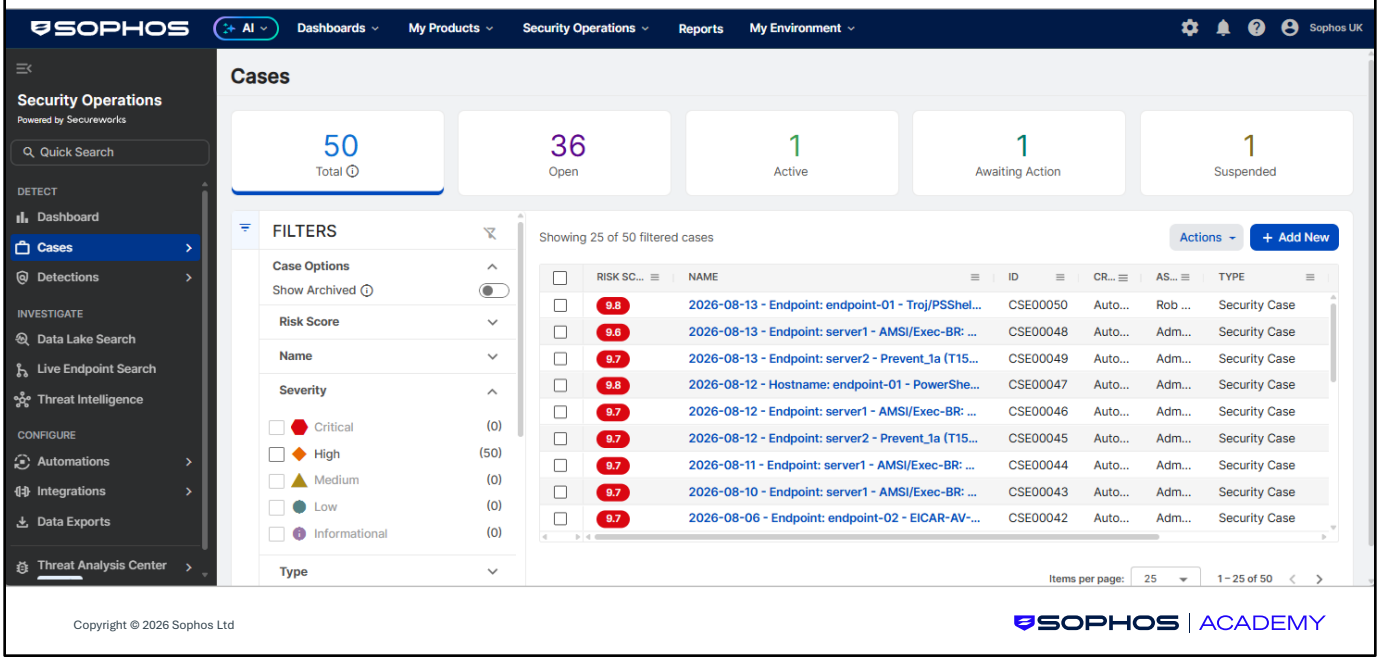
The detection and response features can be found in the Security Operations workspace. The **Dashboard** displays the event pipeline. This breaks down the total number of events, detections, cases, and confirmed security threats across your environment.

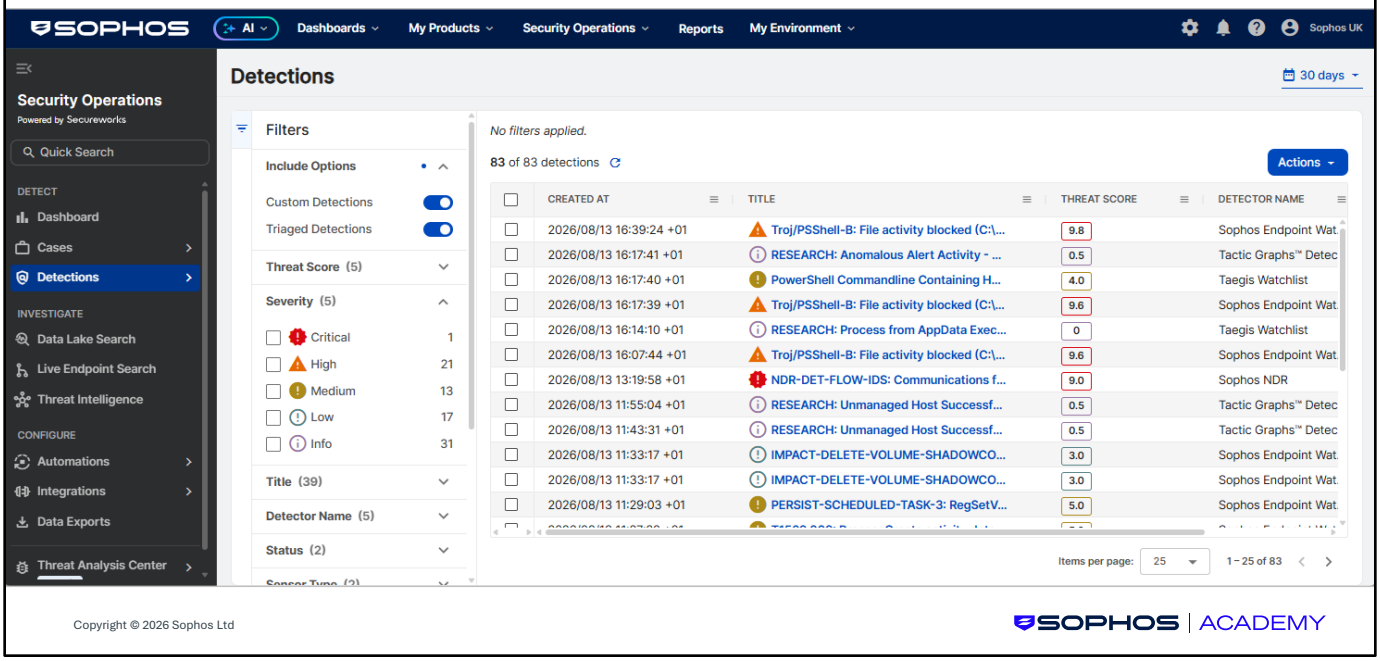
The widgets on the dashboard can be customised if required.

Cases



Suspicious events that are reported by detections are grouped together to aid forensic investigations. **Cases** are created automatically when a high-risk activity is detected. Cases can be created by administrators to collect all investigation information in one place.

Detections



The **Detections** page displays activities that you might need to investigate. Detections identify unusual or suspicious activity on your devices that has not been blocked. They differ from events where we detect and block activity that we already know to be malicious.

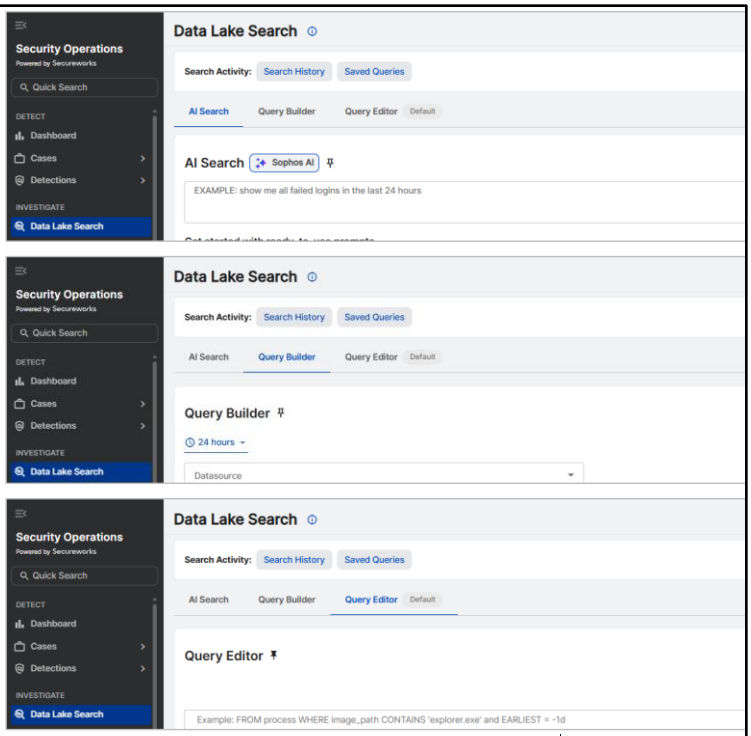
We generate detections based on data that devices upload to the Unified Context Lake. We check that data against threat classification rules, when there is a match, we display a detection.

Data Lake Search

AI Search

Query Builder

Query Editor



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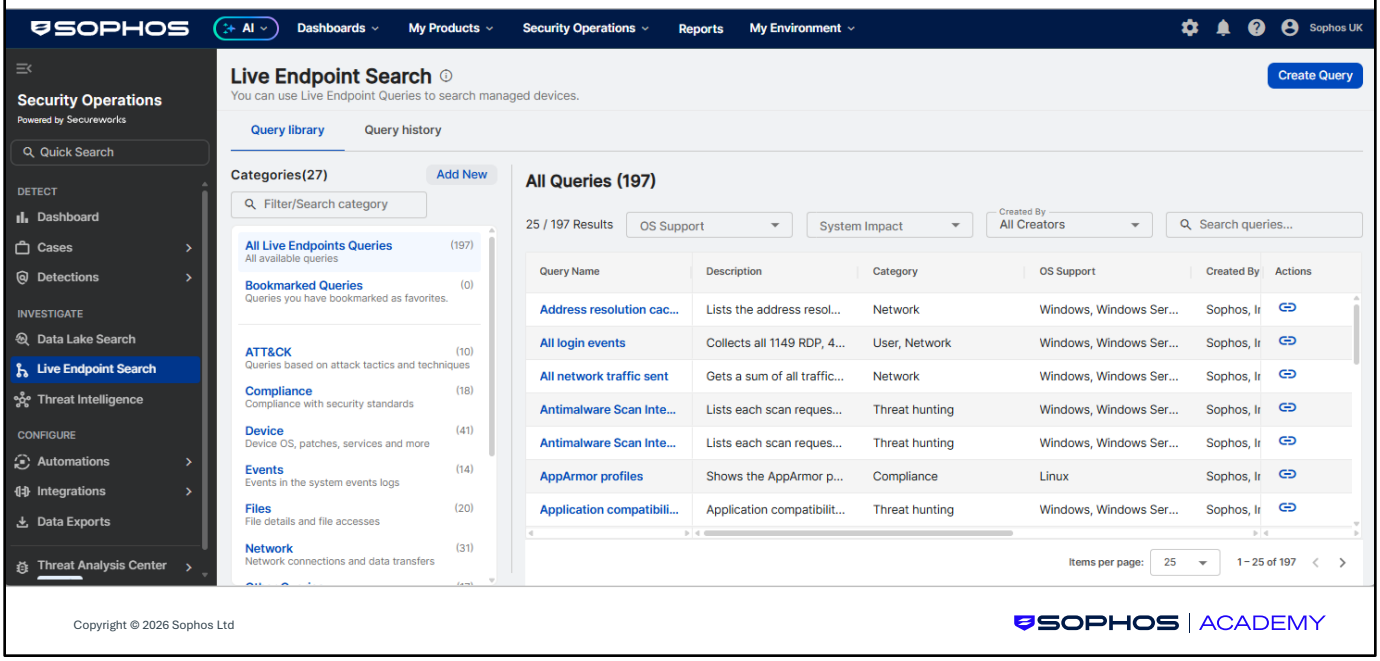
Data Lake Search provides tools that allow you to search for data in the Unified Context Lake.

AI Search allows you to search without using search language. Enter a search request using plain language, and a search will be returned.

Query Builder allows you to build a query, and Query Editor allows you to write your own queries.

Live Endpoint Search



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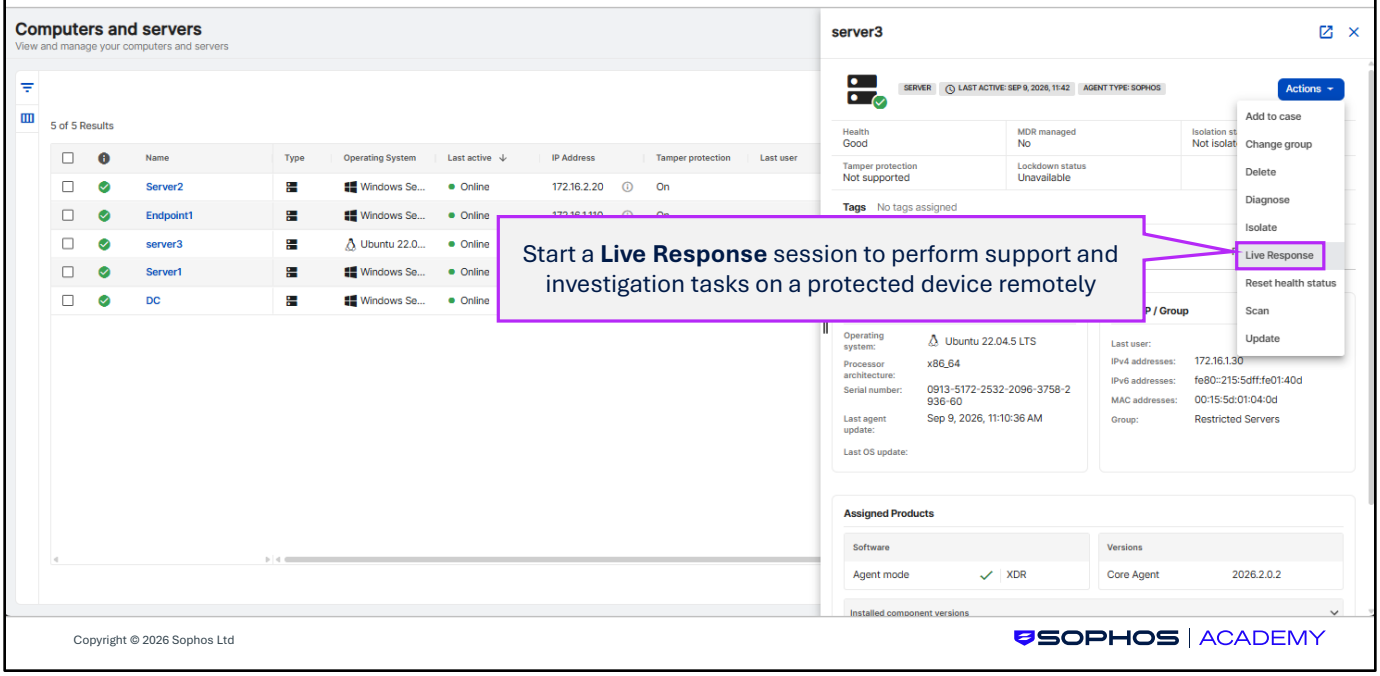
Live Endpoint Search allows you to run queries on protected endpoints that are online. The Query library lists pre-written queries that allow you to find the data you are looking for, or you can create your own query.

Live Response



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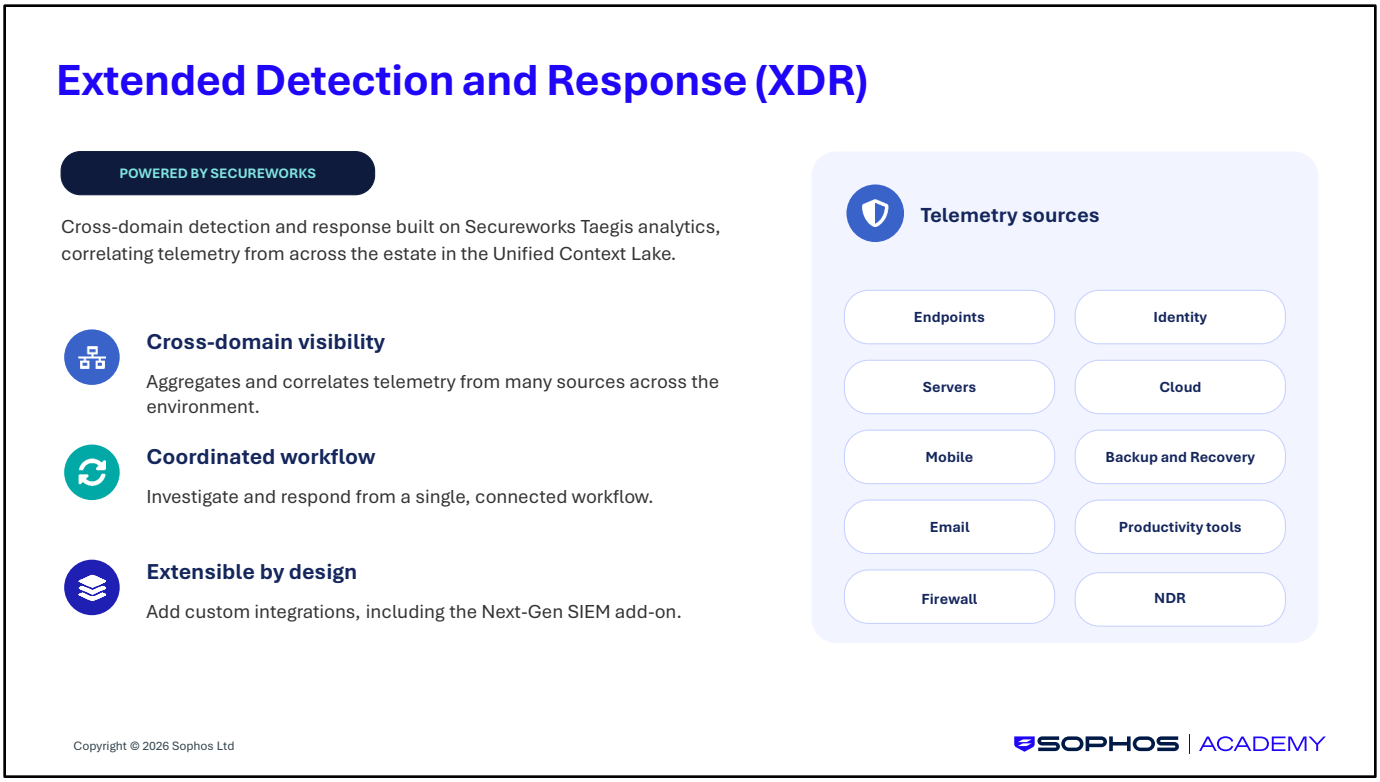
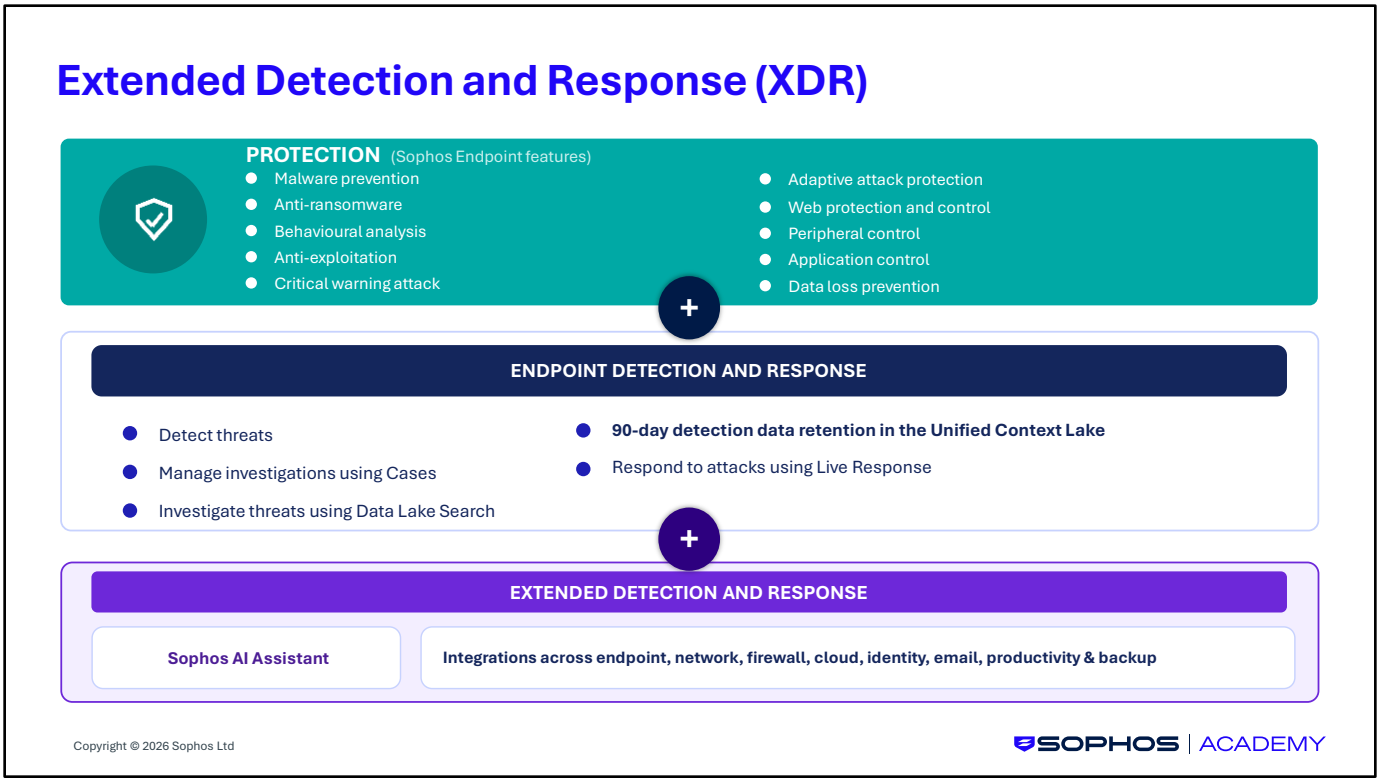
Live Response is an extended response feature that enables administrators to remotely connect to a protected device to perform support and investigative tasks.

Live Response is available on each individual device page. A device must be online for Live Response to be available.



Extended Detection and Response provides cross-domain visibility by aggregating and correlating telemetry from multiple security sources across the environment. Rather than focusing solely on endpoint data, it expands detection coverage to encompass a broader range of systems and services.

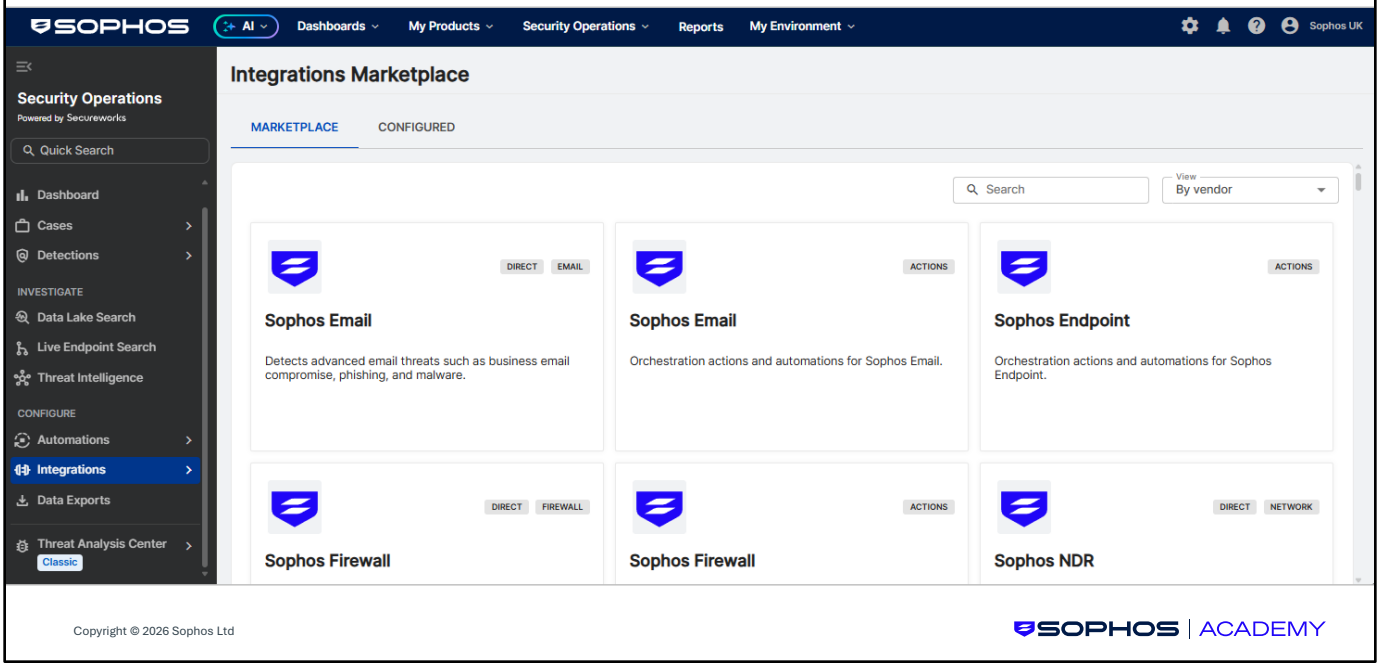
This approach involves ingesting telemetry from multiple sources and consolidating it into the Unified Context Lake to support investigation and analysis. By correlating detections across different systems, it becomes possible to identify activity that might not be visible when looking at individual data sources in isolation. This is supported by integrated investigation and response workflows, allowing security teams to move from detection through to analysis and remediation within a single, coordinated process.



Sophos XDR combines the protection features of Sophos Endpoint with the detection and response capabilities of Sophos EDR. It adds to these by providing Sophos AI Assistant, and integrations.

This allows you to integrate and use data from other Sophos products and third-party products with Sophos Central.

Integrations



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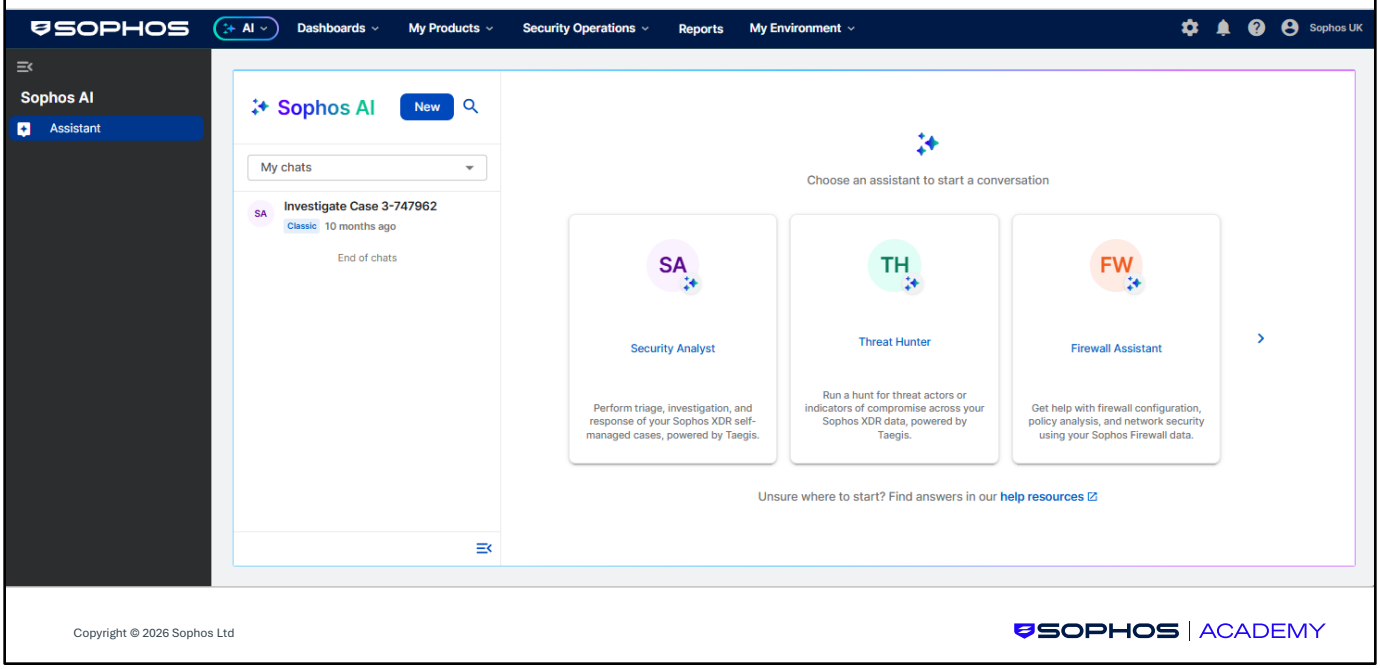
With Sophos XDR, you can integrate other security products or services with Sophos Central. For example, you can add Sophos Cloud Optix anomaly alerts.

When a third-party product or service is integrated, it can send data to the Unified Context Lake. This allows you to query data for protected devices as well as other security products and services.

Please note that only users with the Admin or Super Admin role can view and configure integrations.

AI Assistance



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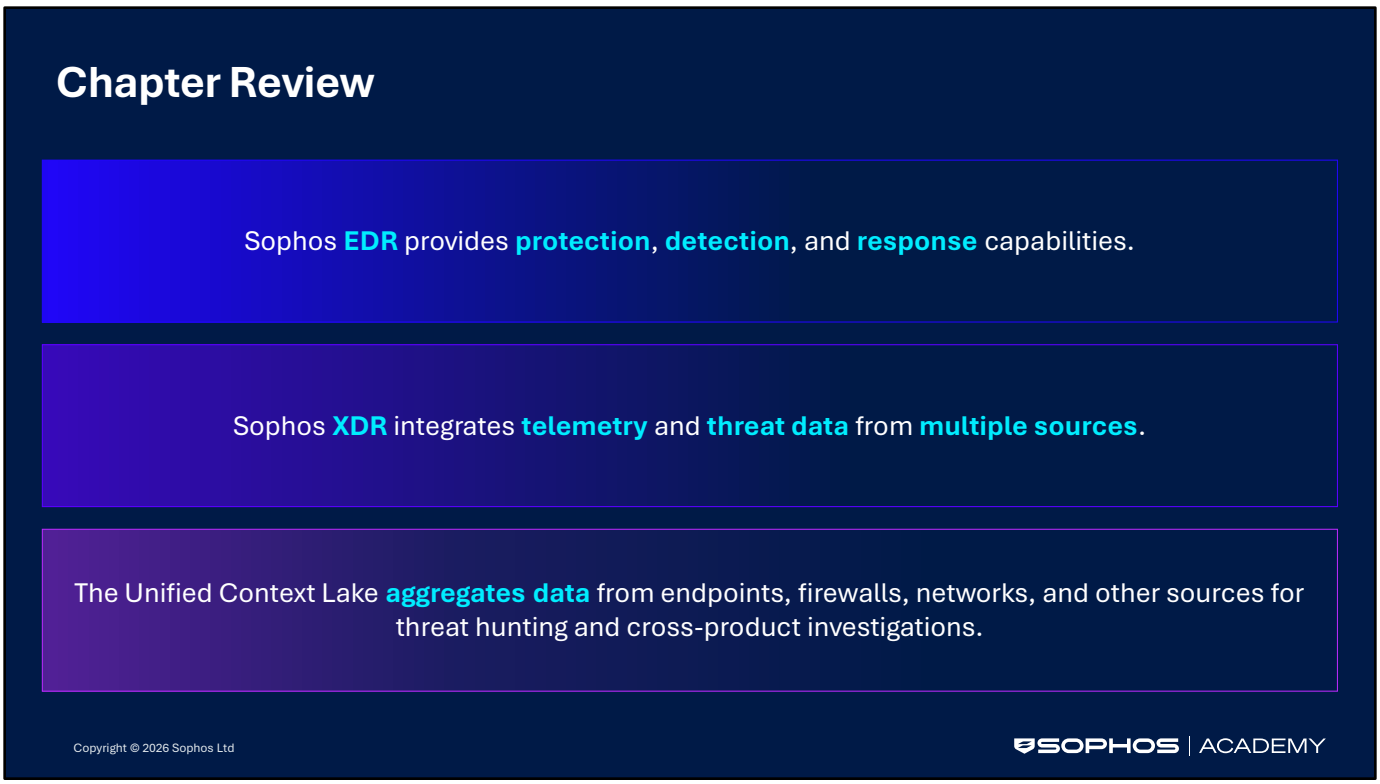
The Sophos AI Assistant is a generative AI-powered tool that enables you to investigate security issues using natural language prompts. The assistant utilizes data from the Unified Context Lake and AI-driven analytics to enhance the effectiveness of security analysis.

You can use it to investigate cases by selecting predefined prompts. These can generate a case summary, get details of activity on devices, and show actions you can take. You can enter your own prompts and add the AI assistant's responses to your case notebook.

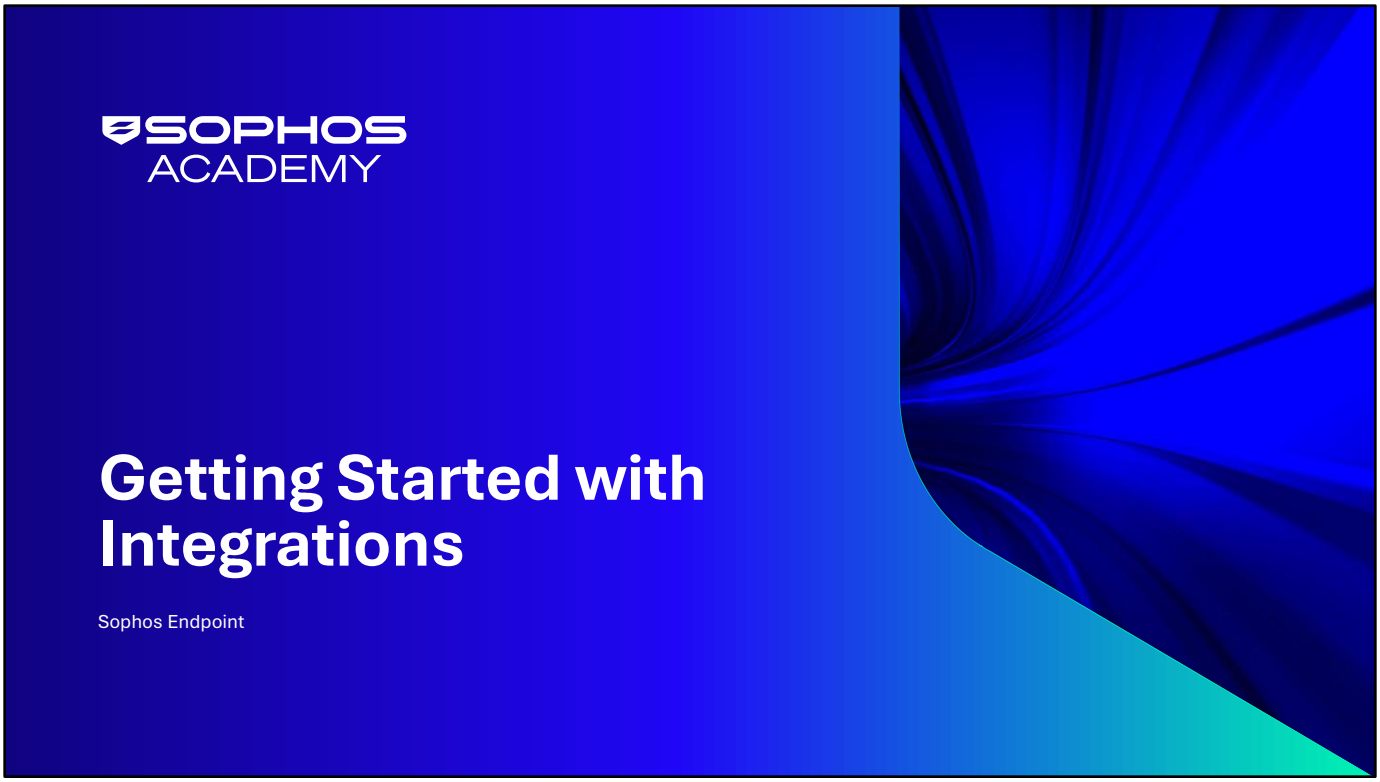


Here are the three main things you learned in this chapter.

Sophos EDR provides protection, detection, and response capabilities.

Sophos XDR integrates telemetry and threat data from multiple sources.

The Unified Context Lake aggregates data from endpoints, firewalls, networks, and other sources for threat hunting and cross-product investigations.



[Additional Information]

Sophos Endpoint
EP4515: Getting Started with Integrations

September 2026

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Getting Started with Integrations

In this chapter, you'll learn how to configure integrations.

RECOMMENDED KNOWLEDGE AND EXPERIENCE

- ✓ How to access and navigate Sophos Central
- ✓ What Sophos Endpoint is
- ✓ What Sophos EDR is
- ✓ What Sophos XDR is

DURATION: 5 minutes

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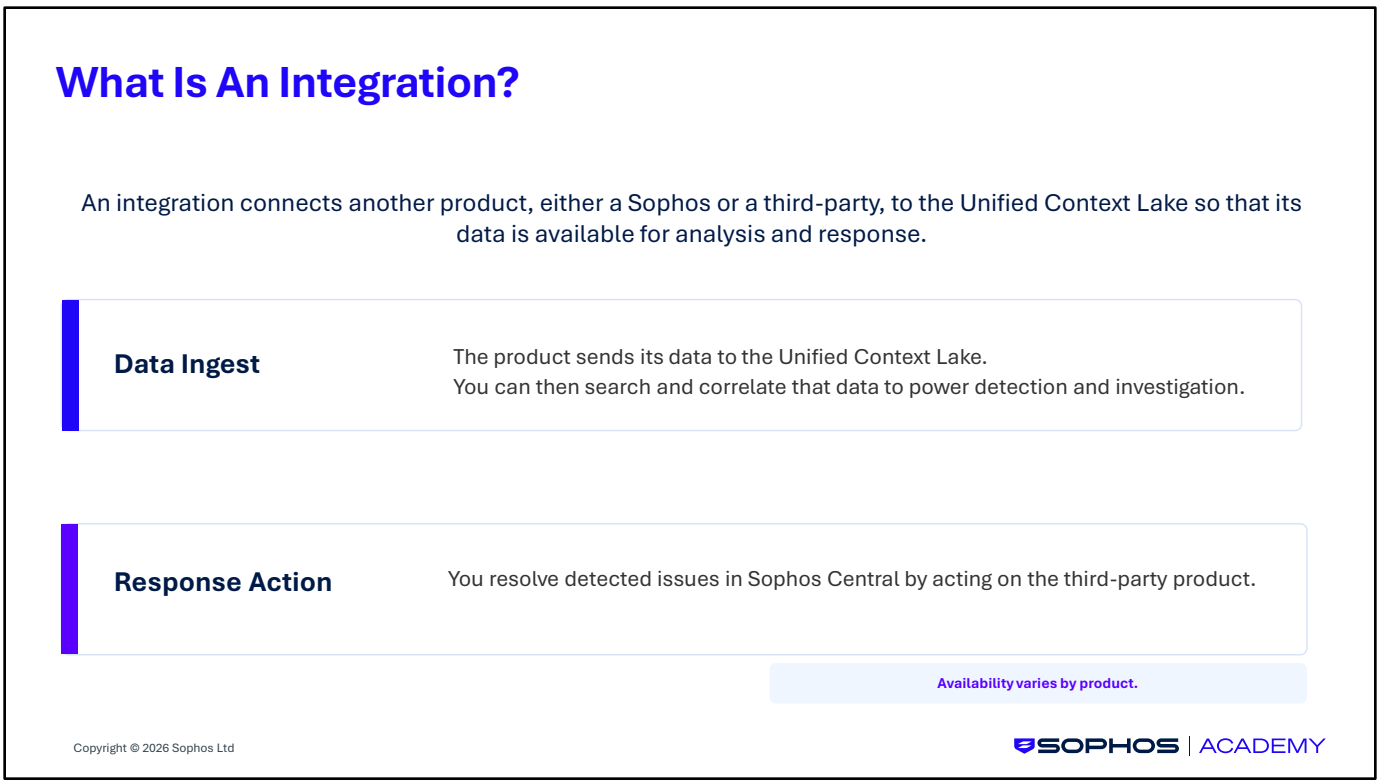
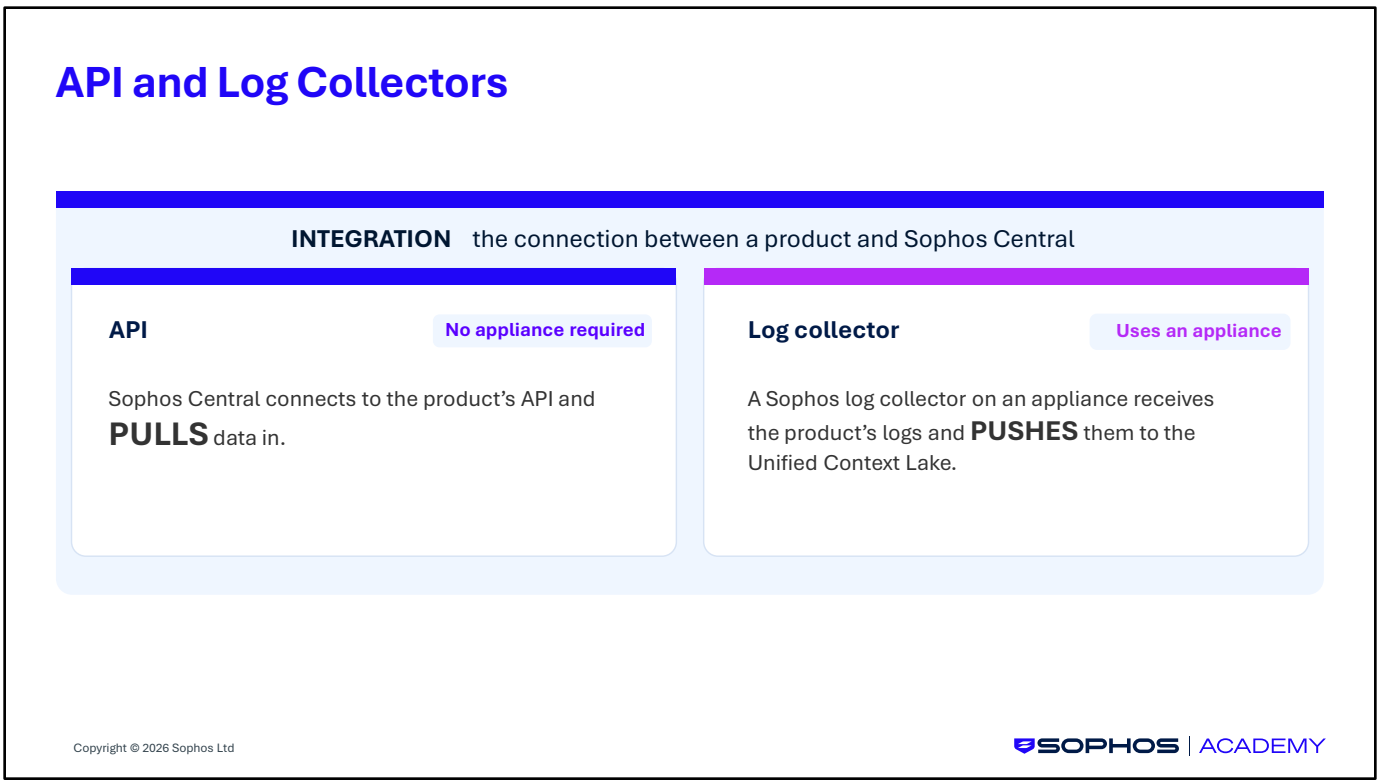
In this chapter, you'll learn how to configure integrations.



An integration is simply a connection between a product and Sophos Central; the product's data or actions become available in the Unified Context Lake. An integration can be another Sophos product or a third-party one.

Every integration serves one of two purposes:

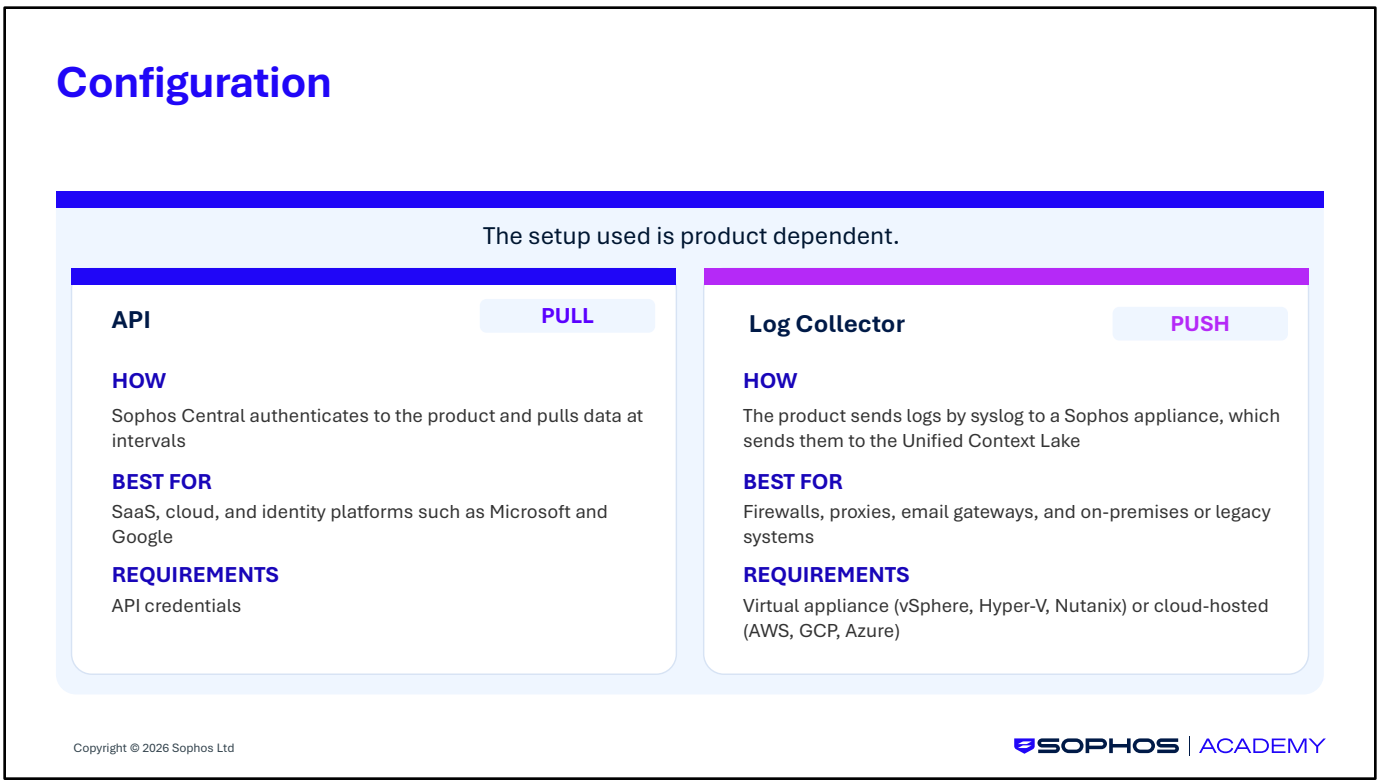
The first is data ingestion: the product sends its data to the Sophos Unified Context Lake, and you can then search and correlate that data to support detection and investigation.
The second is response action, which lets you resolve detected issues from Sophos Central by acting on the third-party product. Response Action is not available for every product yet.



There are two primary ingestion models to understand. API integrations are pull-based and rely on authenticated access to external platforms. These are commonly used for services such as identity providers or email security platforms.

Data collectors, by contrast, operate as log receivers within the environment. They handle push-based ingestion, typically via syslog, allowing integration with network and on-premises systems.

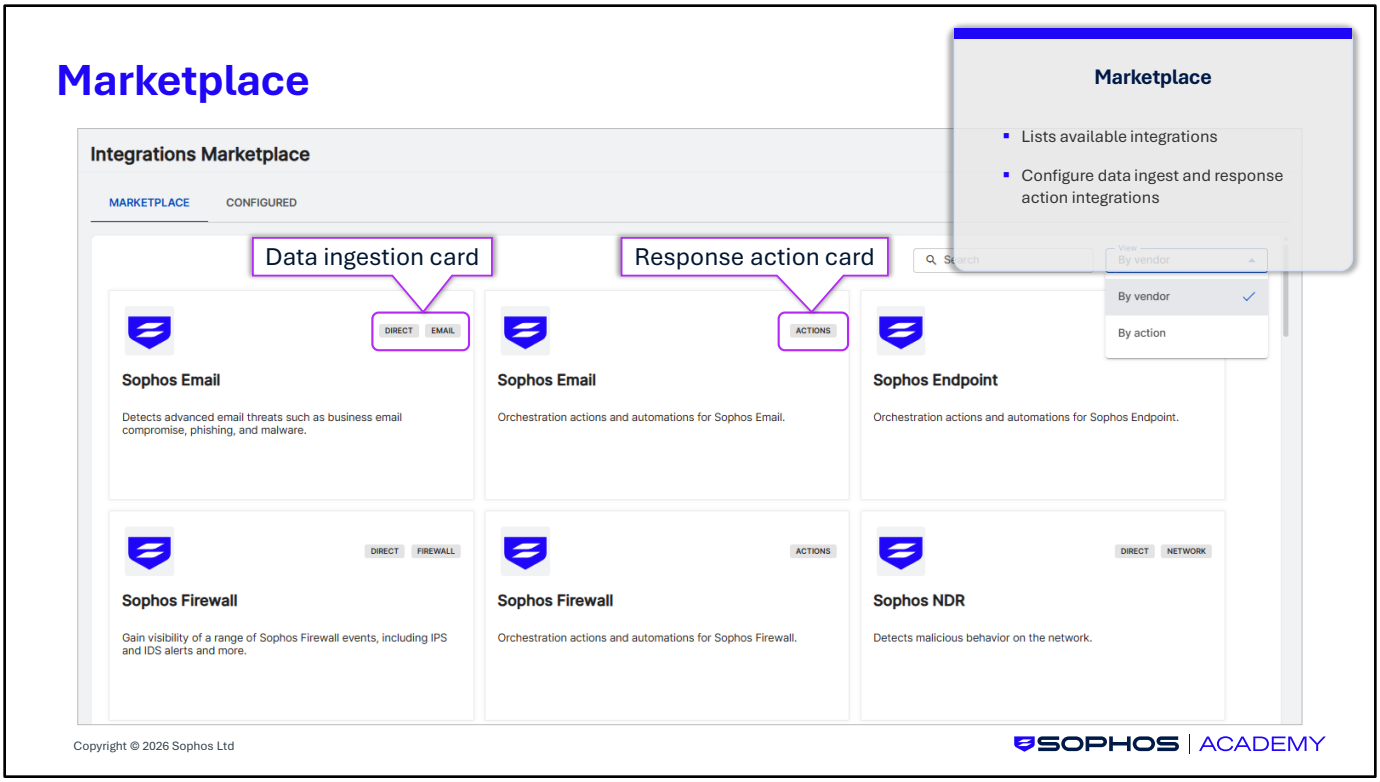
A question that often comes up is whether a log collector is different from an integration. The answer is that a log collector is not separate; it is simply one of the methods an integration can use to ingest data into the Unified Context Lake. The integration is the connection between a product and Sophos Central, which can be set up as either an API to pull data or a log collector that pushes data. The difference is that a log collector requires an appliance.



As the API and log collector use different methods to hydrate the Unified Context Lake with data, the configuration to set them up can differ.

API integrations require authentication to pull data into the Unified Context Lake, often using API credentials, Oauth, or application-based permissions. The ingestion process retrieves data at regular intervals, ensuring near-real-time visibility while managing rate limits. These integrations are designed for platforms that expose structured security telemetry through APIs and is best for SaaS, cloud, and identity platforms such as Microsoft and Google.

Log collectors sit between your log sources and XDR, gathering event data locally before it reaches the platform. When products are integrated this way, a Sophos integration appliance is required to fulfill that role. Sophos integration appliances receive data and forward it to the Unified Context Lake for analysis. They're typically deployed within the customer environment to receive logs from devices such as firewalls, proxies, or email gateways. Syslog is widely used due to its simplicity and compatibility. Collectors ensure reliable delivery by buffering logs and securely forwarding them to the platform, even during temporary connectivity issues.



The **Marketplace** workspace lists available integrations. The **Marketplace** view defaults to listing integrations by vendor; however, you can edit the list to display the integrations by action.

Depending on the product, you may see two types of cards; in this example, both Sophos Email and Sophos Firewall have two cards displayed. One of these is for the data ingestion, and the other is for response actions.

Some products will show both cards, some only the ingest, and others only the response action card.

Marketplace

API

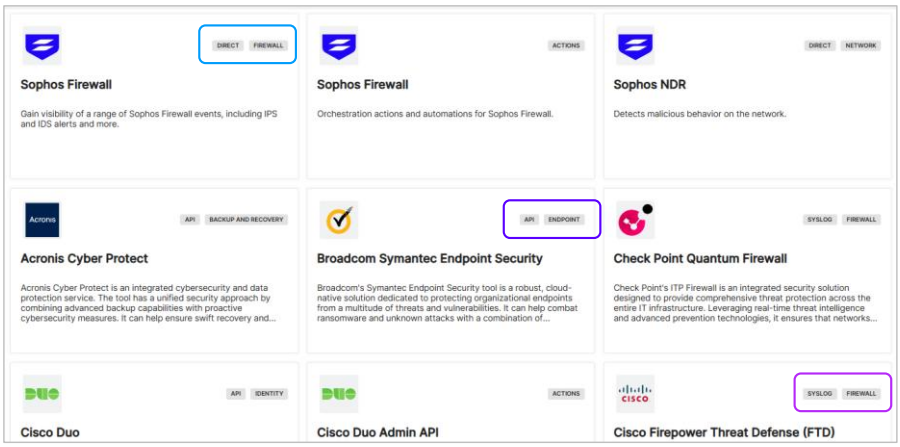
Third-party security products integrated by API

Syslog

Third-party security products integration by syslog with a data collector

Direct

Sophos products, such as Sophos NDR, or Sophos Firewall



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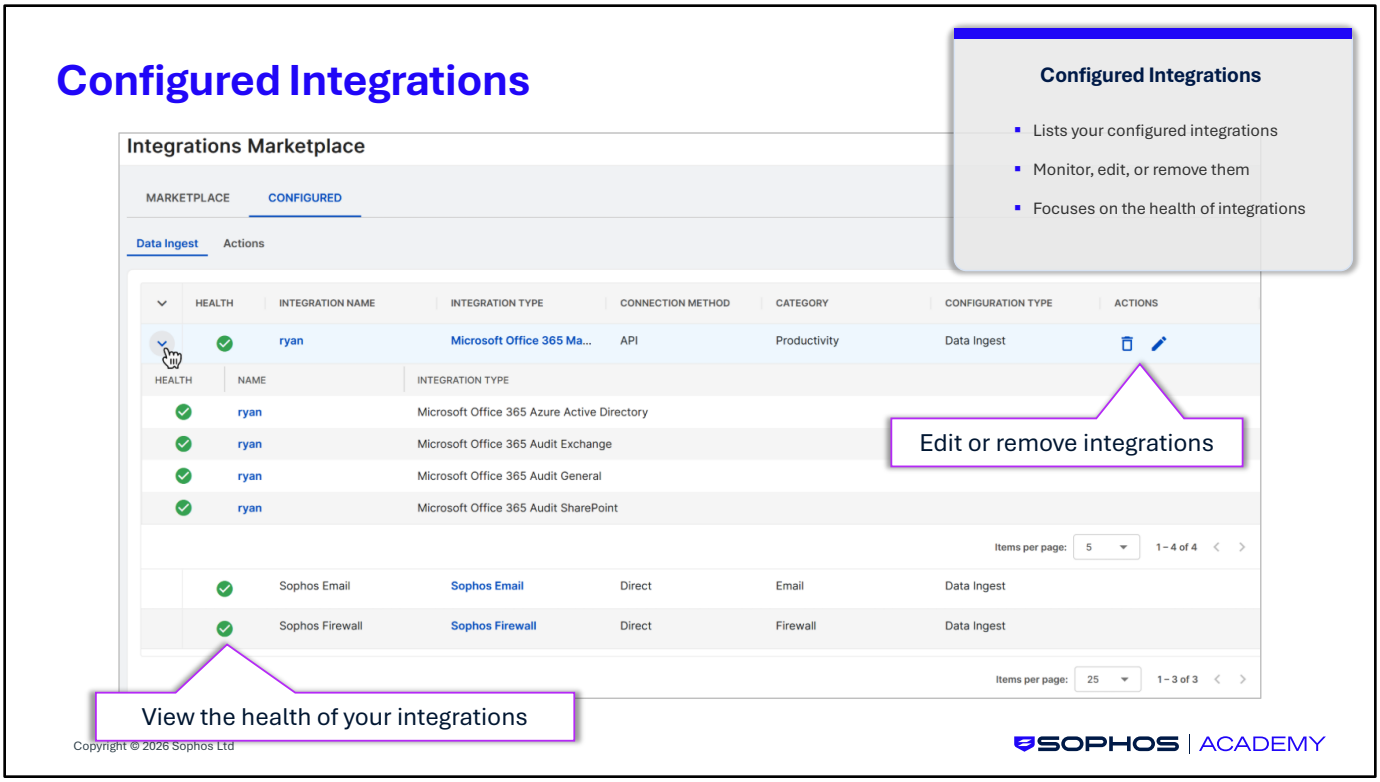
Ingest cards include a category label, such as firewall or productivity, and one of the following integration method labels:

API. Third-party security products integrated by API.
Syslog. Third-party security products integrated by syslog with a data collector.
Direct. Sophos products, such as Sophos NDR or Sophos Firewall.

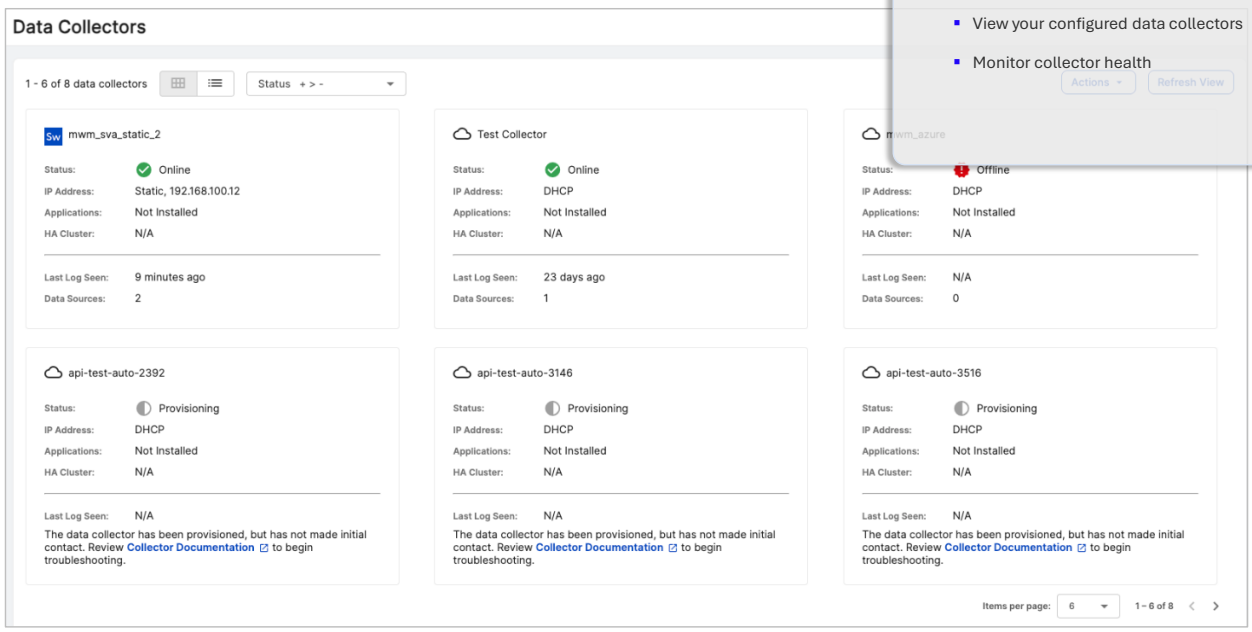
Action cards for a product may contain multiple supported actions.



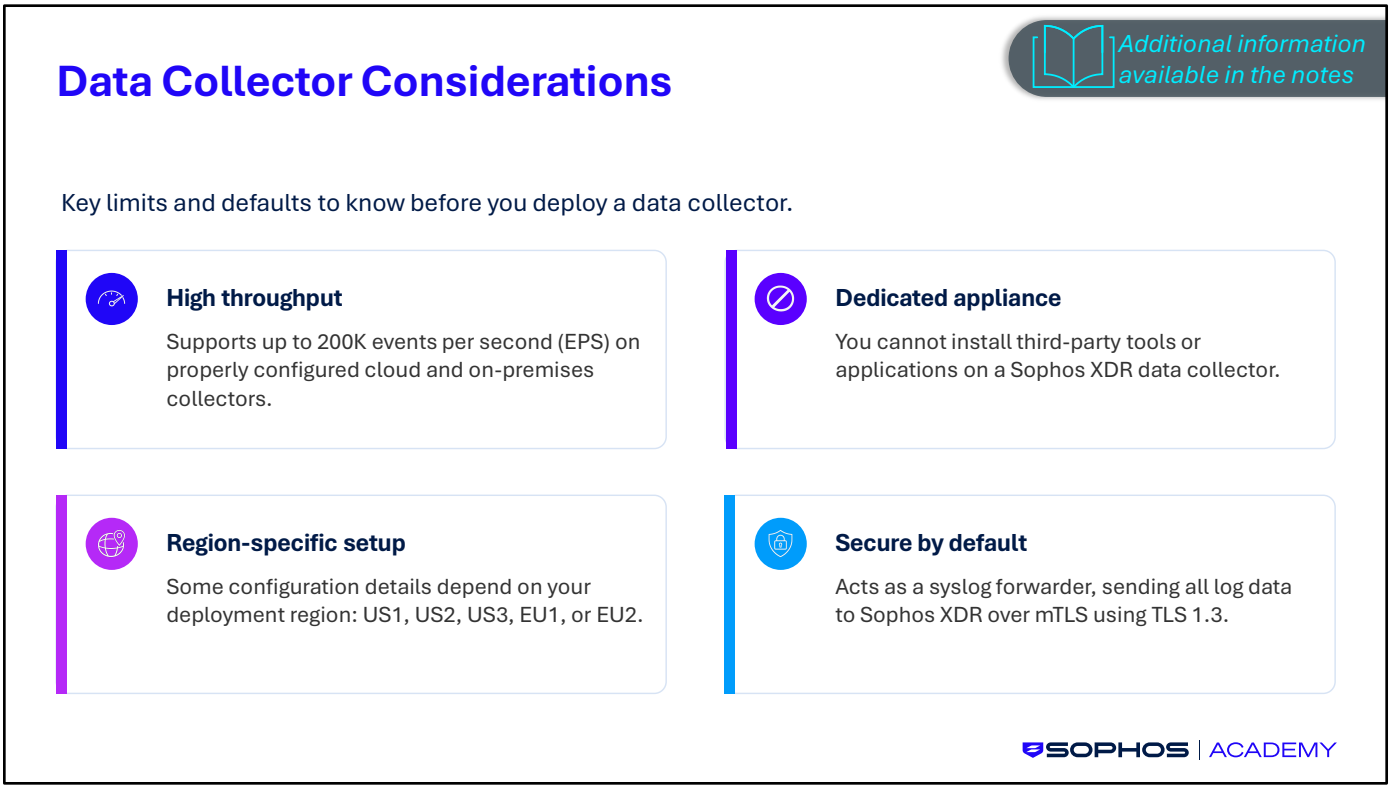
The **Configured Integrations** workspace displays the integrations you have set up; this is where you monitor, edit, or remove them. Please note that Sophos product integrations cannot be edited, as they are included with your Sophos XDR subscription.

Hierarchical API integrations are nested in expandable rows. A single parent API integration can include multiple child integrations, each typically representing a different but related API endpoint.

Data Collectors



The Data Collectors workspace displays the appliances that host your log collectors, along with their health and status. The data collector is an on-premises or cloud-based device that is used with syslog integrations; available data collectors include AWS, Azure, GCP, and on-premises.

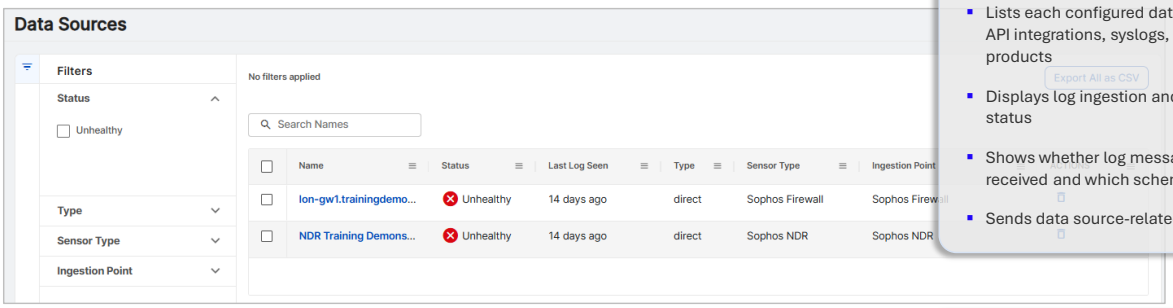


Before you deploy a data collector, there are a few practical considerations worth noting. These are the limits and default behaviors that shape how you set up a data collector.

First, throughput. A properly configured cloud or on-premises collector supports up to 200,000 events per second, so a single collector can handle very high log volumes.
Second, it is a dedicated appliance, so you cannot install third-party tools or applications on it, which keeps it secure and supportable.
Third, some configuration details depend on your deployment region, whether that is US1, 2, or 3, EU1, or EU2, so always check the guidance for your region.
Fourth, it is secure by default. The collector acts as a syslog forwarder, sending all log data to Sophos XDR over an mTLS connection using TLS 1.3, so your data is encrypted in transit.

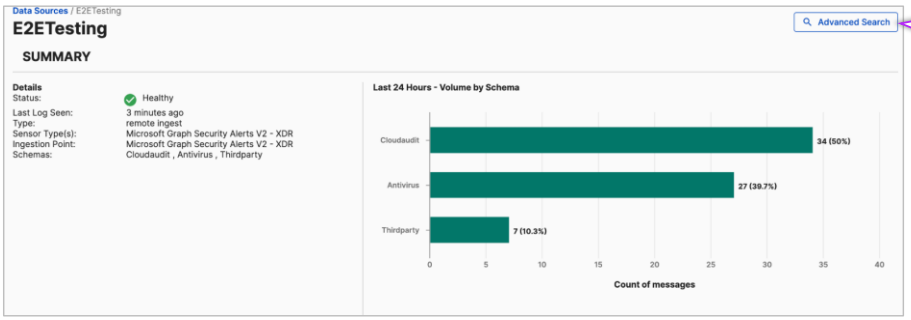
[Additional Information]
https://docs.sophos.com/central/Customer/eap/4.1/en-us/ManageYourProducts/XDRSecOps/Integrations/DataCollectors/index.html

Configured Data Sources



Configured Data Sources

- Lists each configured data source, including API integrations, syslogs, and Sophos products
- Displays log ingestion and normalization status
- Shows whether log messages are being received and which schema they map to
- Sends data source-related email notifications



Pivot search from the data source

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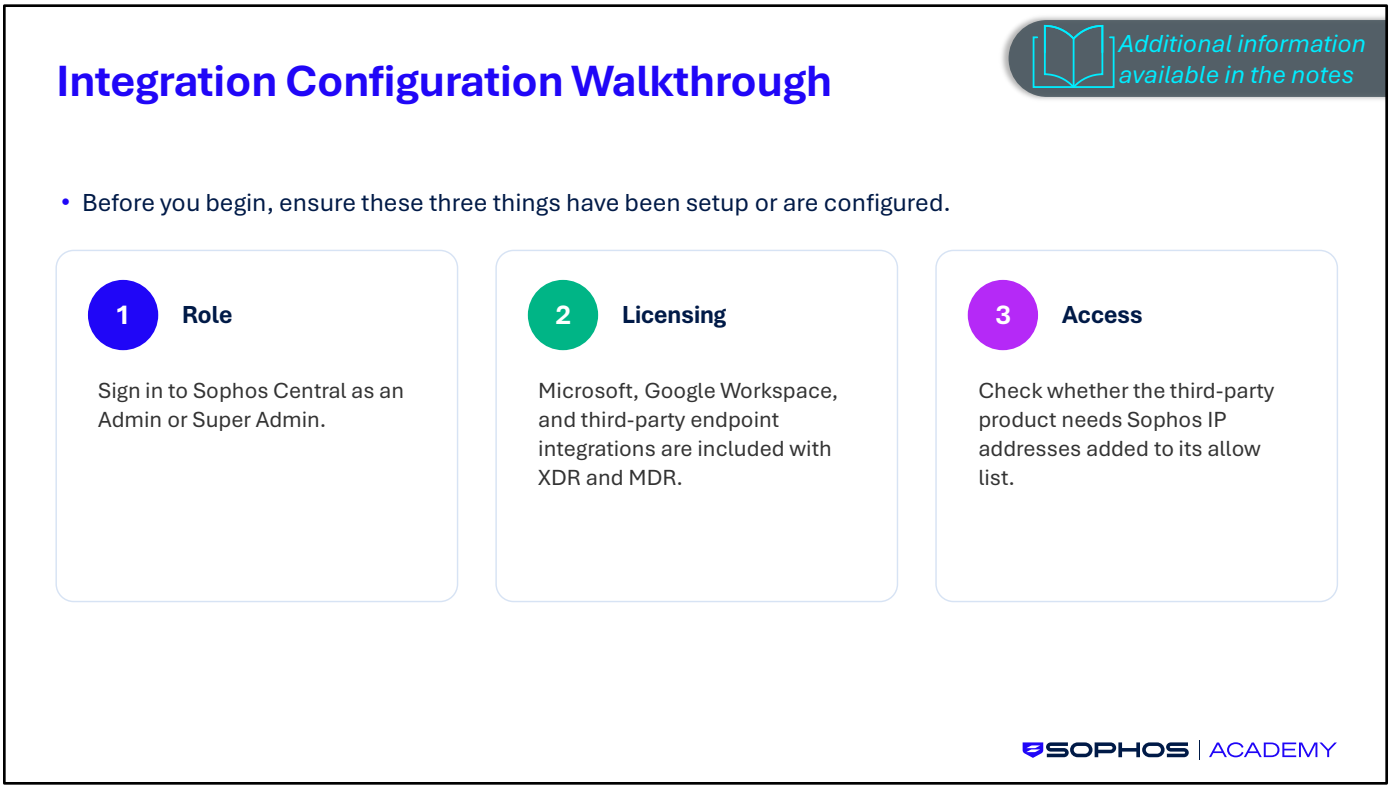
The **Data Sources** table lists each configured data source, including API integrations, syslogs, and Sophos products, and shows its log ingestion and normalization status. It also shows whether log messages are being received and which schema they map to after normalization. It also sends data source–related email notifications.

In this workspace, you can view integration details; selecting an integration from the list will display a fly-out menu. This page shows the integration summary, including it's current status and basic information. From here you can use the Advanced Search option to pivot into running an AI-Search on the selected integration.



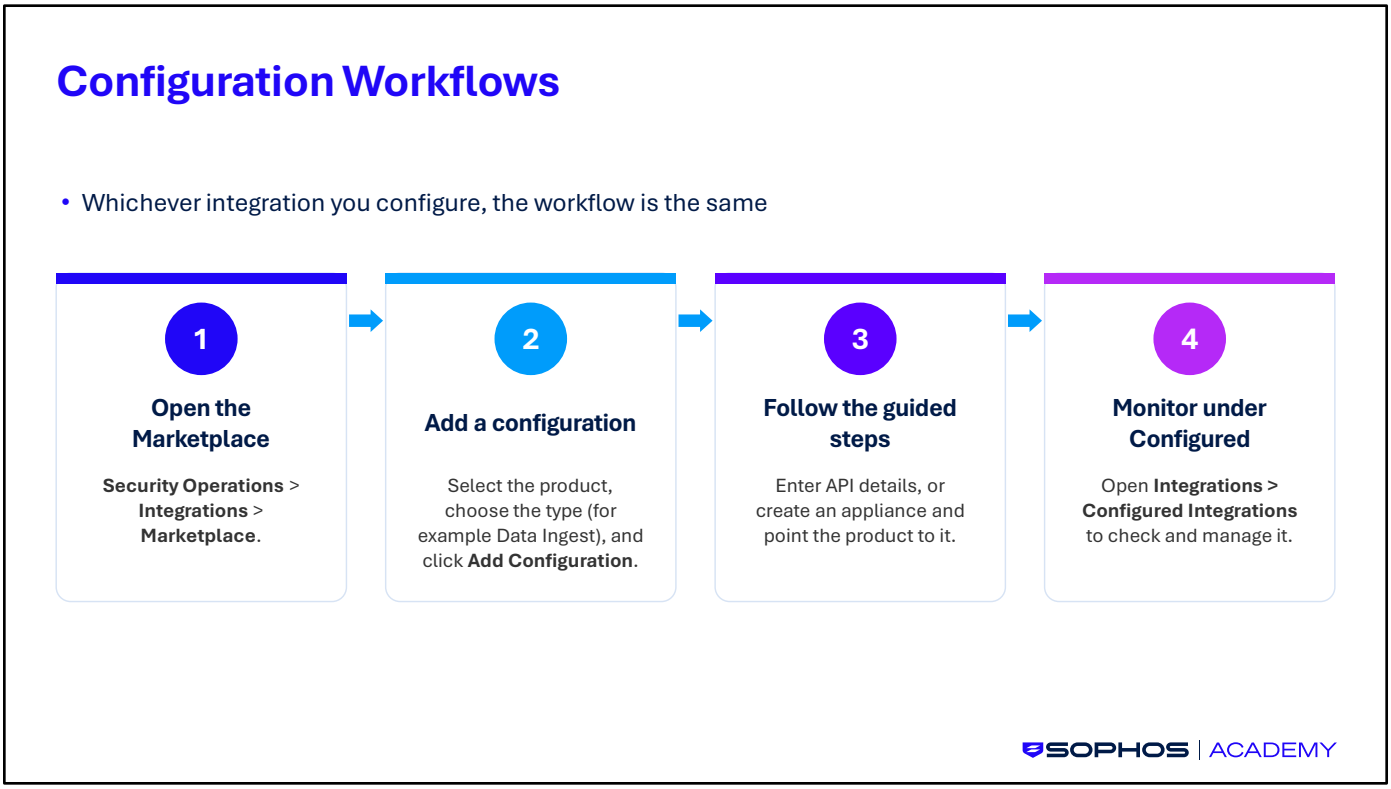
Before you configure anything, it is worth checking three things so that setup goes smoothly.

First, your role: you need to sign in to Sophos Central as an Admin or a Super Admin.

Second, licensing: Microsoft, Google Workspace, and third-party endpoint integrations are included with XDR and MDR.

Third, access: some third-party products only allow administrative access from specific addresses, so check whether you need to add Sophos IP addresses to that product's allow list. And if you are using a log collector, you will also need an appliance that meets the requirements.

[Additional Information]
For more information on integration requirements please see the help documents available here: https://docs.sophos.com/central/Customer/eap/4.1/en-us/ManageYourProducts/XDRSecOps/Integrations/Products/index.html



Whichever integration you need, the configuration path is the same.

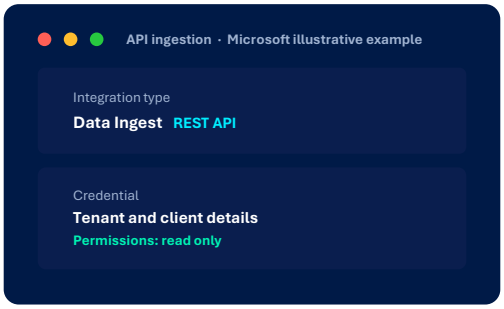
First, open the **Marketplace** workspace. Second, choose the product you want, select the integration type, for example Data Ingest, and click **Add Configuration**. Third, follow the guided steps: the assistant walks you through the setup, where you either enter the API information or create an appliance and point the product to it. Fourth, once the integration has been configured, open the **Configured Integrations** workspace to monitor and manage the integration.

Let’s walk through this process using an example.

Integration Example: API (Microsoft O365)

Example: Microsoft, an API Data Ingest integration that brings in identity and activity data.

1. In **Marketplace**, select Microsoft, choose the Data Ingest integration, and click **Add Configuration.**
2. In Microsoft, register an application and grant the required read permissions, following least privilege.
3. Ensure credentials are configured
4. **Validate**. Ensure the telemetry data is pulled and normalized in the Unified Context Lake.



Note: API integrations show an expiration date on the Marketplace page, based on your Sophos license, not the third-party product.

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Microsoft Graph is a common example of an API integration. It provides access to identity data, authentication events, and activity logs across Microsoft services. When integrated, this data enhances visibility into user behavior, authentication patterns, and potential identity compromise. This allows detections to correlate endpoint and identity signals, improving accuracy and investigation depth.

The integration process begins by selecting to add a new configuration from the Marketplace in XDR Security Operations. Then, in Microsoft, register an application in Azure Active Directory and grant it read permissions. This application acts as the identity used to access Microsoft Graph. Permissions must be assigned carefully to ensure the required data is accessible.

Ensure the configuration is set up with the correct credentials so that access can be granted successfully.

Once configured, ingestion begins and should be validated to confirm that events are being received and normalized correctly. Validation is a critical step to ensure visibility is complete.

Integration Example: API (Microsoft O365)

Additional information available in the notes

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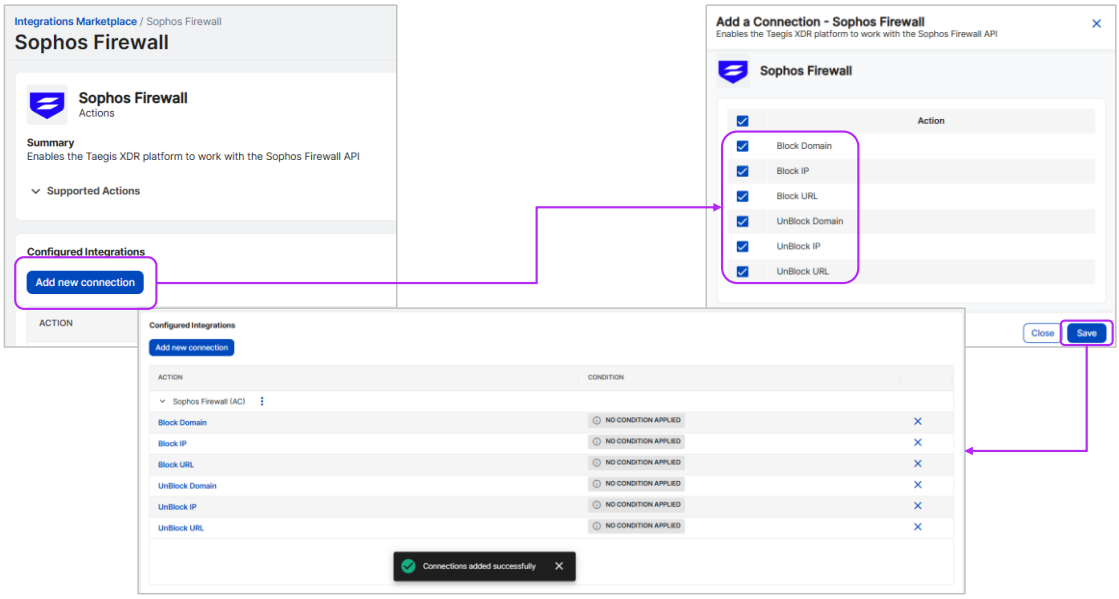
Here is a Sophos TechVids video that explains the integration setup.

[Additional Information]
The video is available here: Sophos XDR/Sophos MDR: Enable Microsoft 365 Response Actions
https://techvids.sophos.com/share/watch/J9Ytkm1wUy33gDzE6HJhj8

Integration Example: Direct (Sophos Product)



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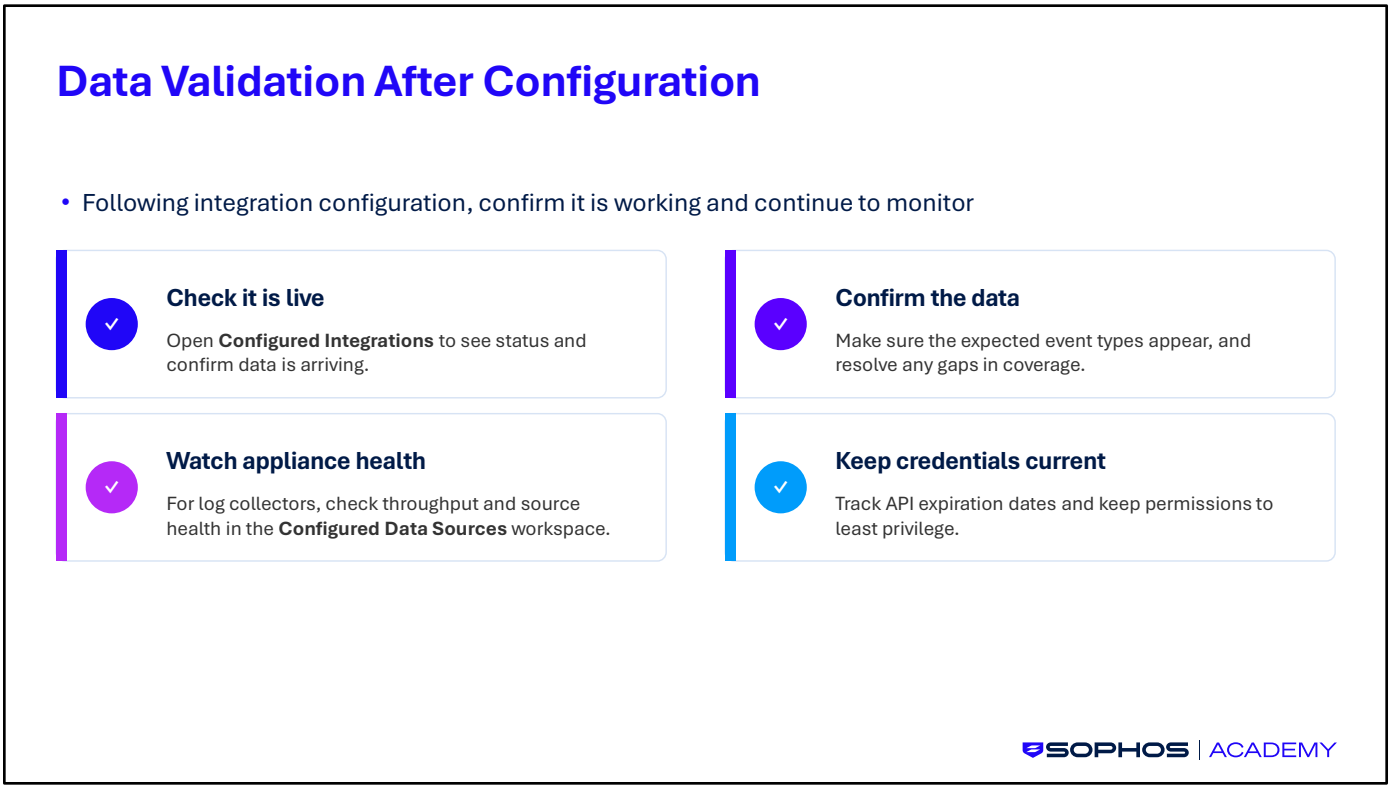
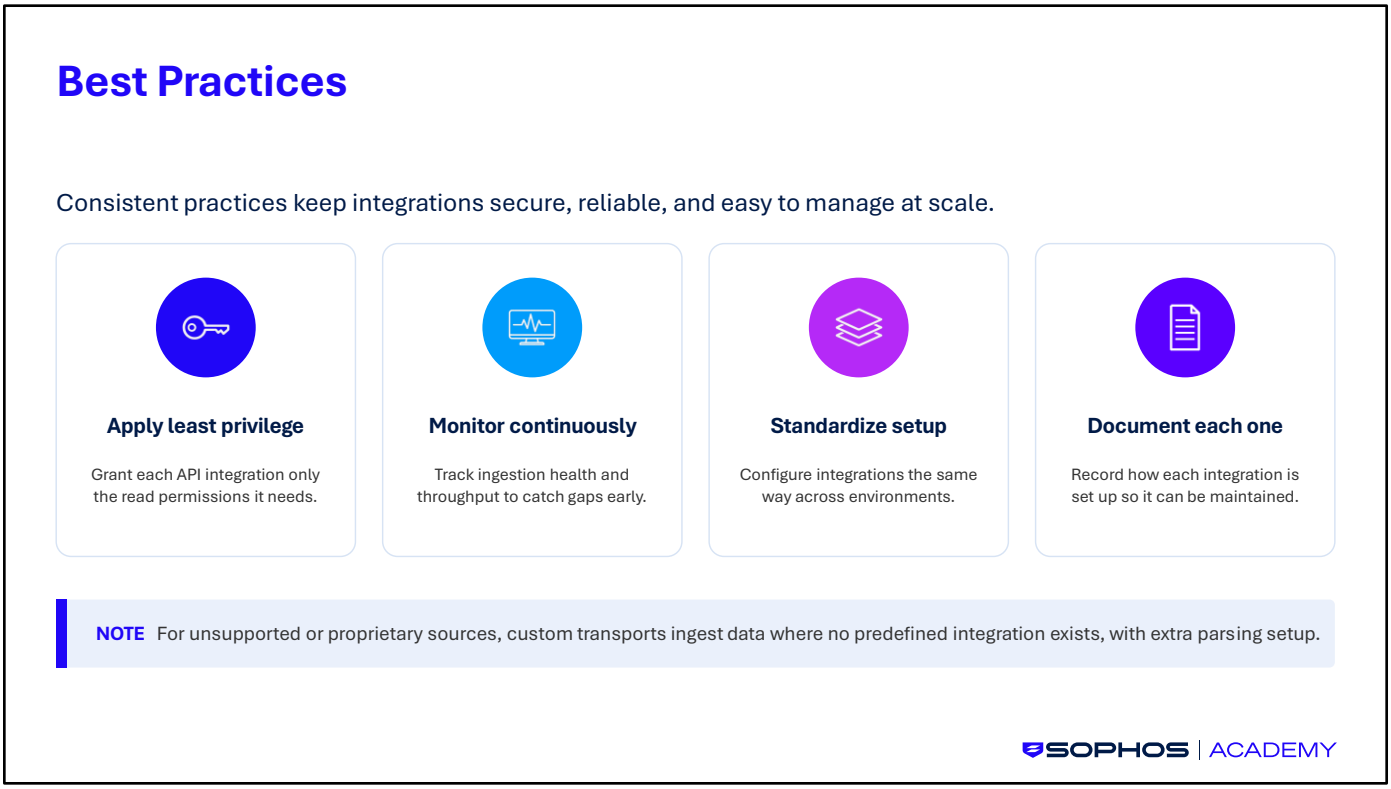
For Sophos Email and Sophos Firewall no integration steps are required. Sophos NDR requires integration, which is covered in the NDR deployment chapter of this course.

You can configure the actions for the Sophos products from Marketplace. In this example, we have selected the Sophos Firewall Actions card. We click **Add new connection**, select the actions we want to add, and click **Save.**



After configuring any integration, validation is essential. This involves confirming that data is being ingested, that the correct event types are visible, and that there are no gaps in coverage. Validation ensures the integration is delivering the expected visibility and supports detection use cases.

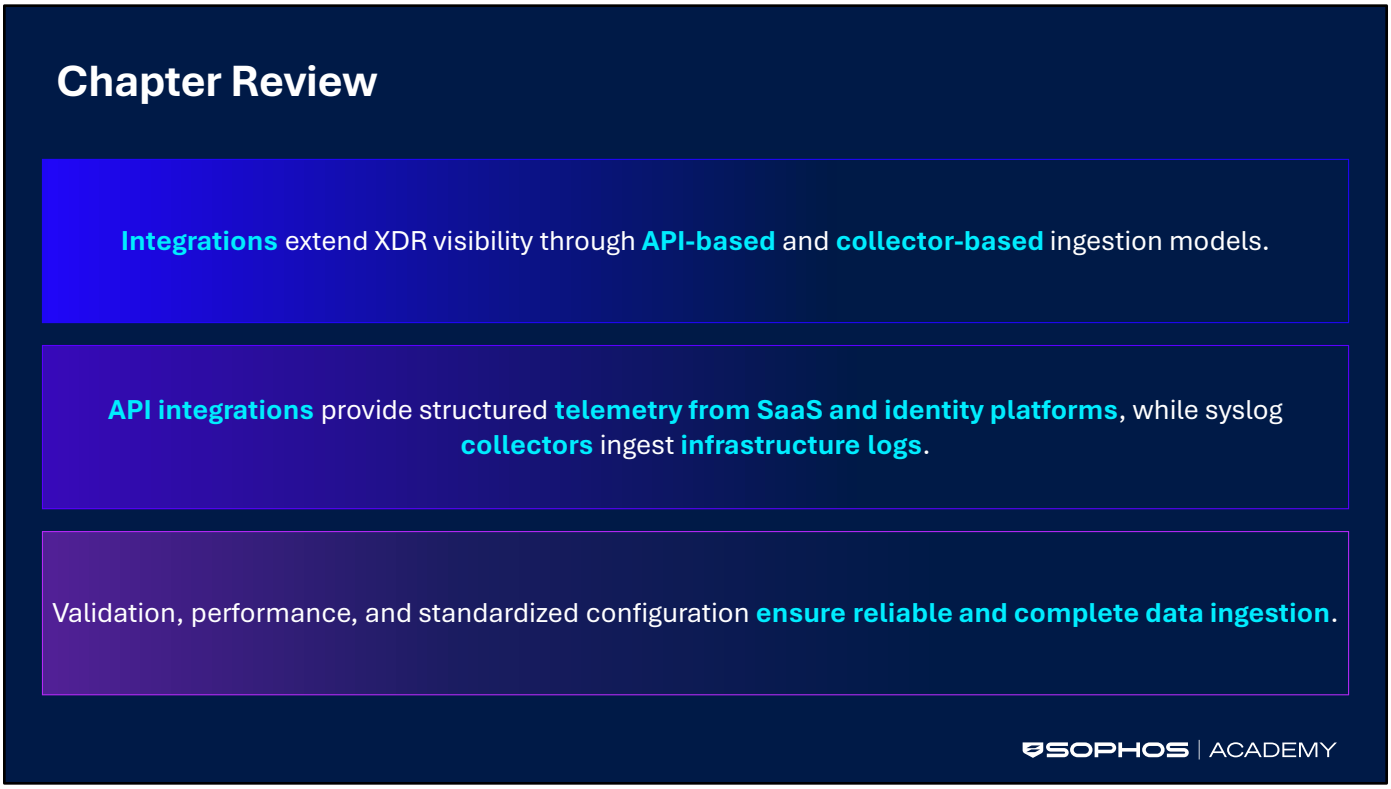
Finally, once you have configured any integration, confirm it is working and keep an eye on it over time. Start by checking it is live: open Integrations, then Configured, to see its status and confirm data is arriving. Next, confirm the data itself: make sure the event types you expect are appearing, and resolve any gaps in coverage. For log collector integrations, keep an eye on appliance health, checking throughput and source health under Integration Appliances. And finally, keep your credentials current: track those API expiration dates, and keep permissions to least privilege. Validation is what turns a configured integration into reliable, complete visibility.



Let us finish with the practices that keep integrations working well over time. Good integration hygiene really comes down to four habits.

First, apply least privilege. Give each API integration only the read permissions it needs, so that if a credential is ever exposed, the impact is limited. Second, monitor continuously. Keep an eye on ingestion health and throughput so your data stays reliable and any gaps are caught early. Third, standardize your configuration. Setting integrations up the same way across environments makes them far simpler to manage as you scale. Fourth, document each integration, so anyone can maintain or update it later without guesswork.

One more thing to know. Where a product has no predefined integration, custom transports let you ingest data from unsupported or proprietary sources. They need extra setup, including parsing rules to normalize the data, but they mean you are never blocked from bringing a source in. Applied together, these practices give you broad, reliable coverage, which is what drives better correlation, fewer false positives, and faster investigations.



Here are three main things you learned in this chapter.

Integrations extend XDR visibility through API-based and collector-based ingestion models.

API integrations provide structured telemetry from SaaS and identity platforms, while syslog collectors ingest infrastructure logs.

Validation, performance monitoring, and standardized configuration ensure reliable and complete data ingestion.

[Additional Information]

Sophos Endpoint
EP4530: Understanding the Unified Context Lake

September 2026

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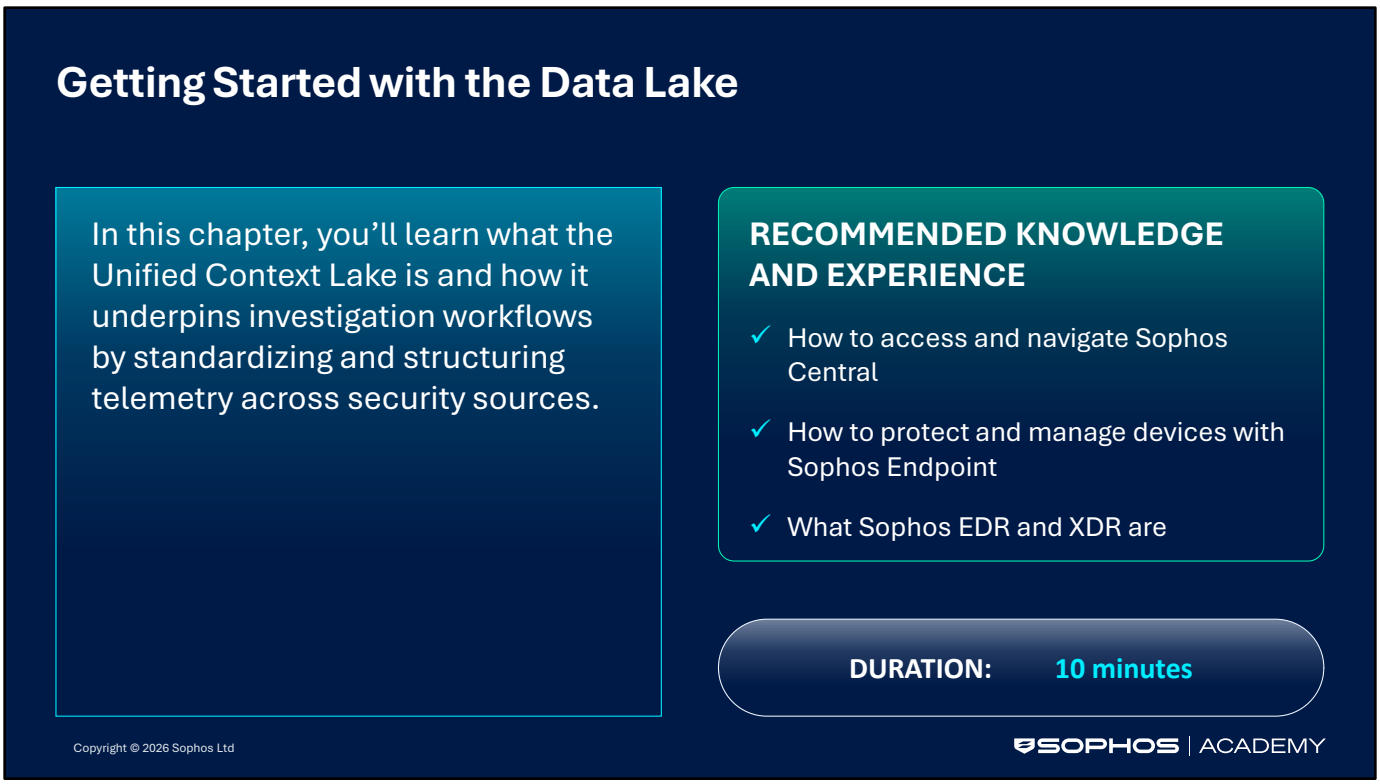

In this chapter, you'll learn what the Unified Context Lake is and how it underpins investigation workflows by standardizing and structuring telemetry across security sources.

What is the Unified Context Lake?

- The Unified Context Lake centralizes all telemetry
- Allows for the search and analysis of ingested data
- Enables analysts to use raw data to conduct meaningful investigations

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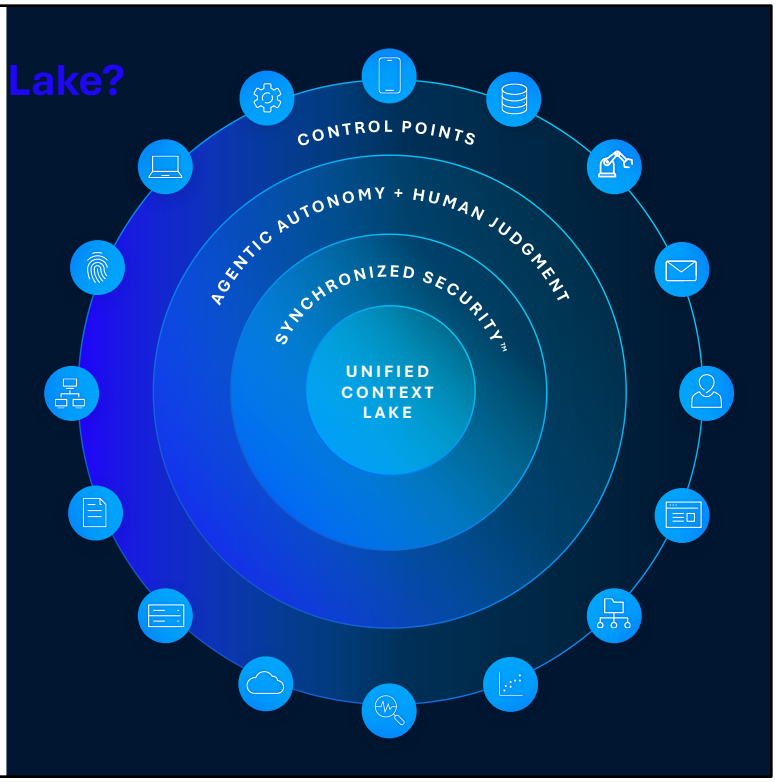
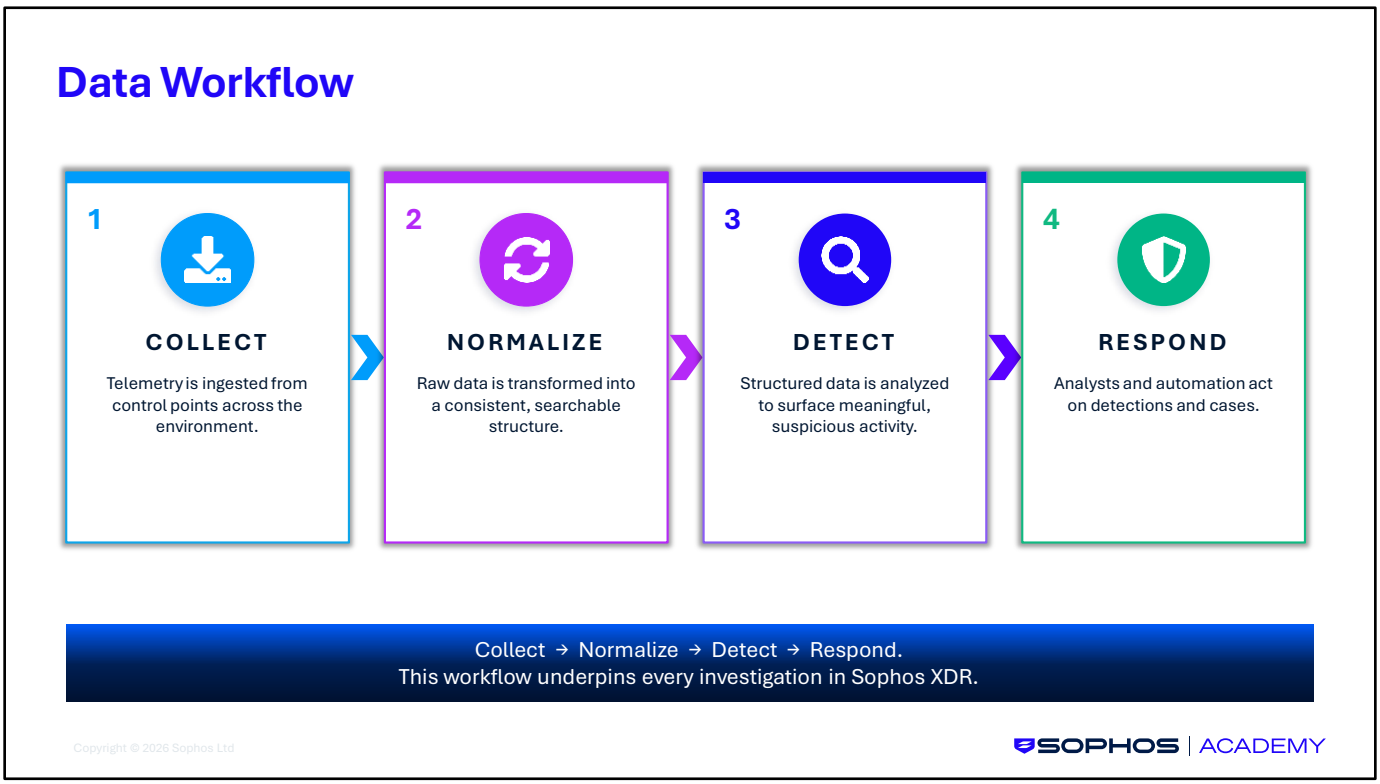


Sophos' Unified Context Lake is the foundation of its AI-native cybersecurity defense system. It centralizes telemetry across the environment and structures it for efficient search and analysis.

The Unified Context Lake is a data lake that stores all ingested telemetry data. This data provides visibility across endpoints, network, cloud, and identity, helping analysts identify patterns that would otherwise remain hidden.



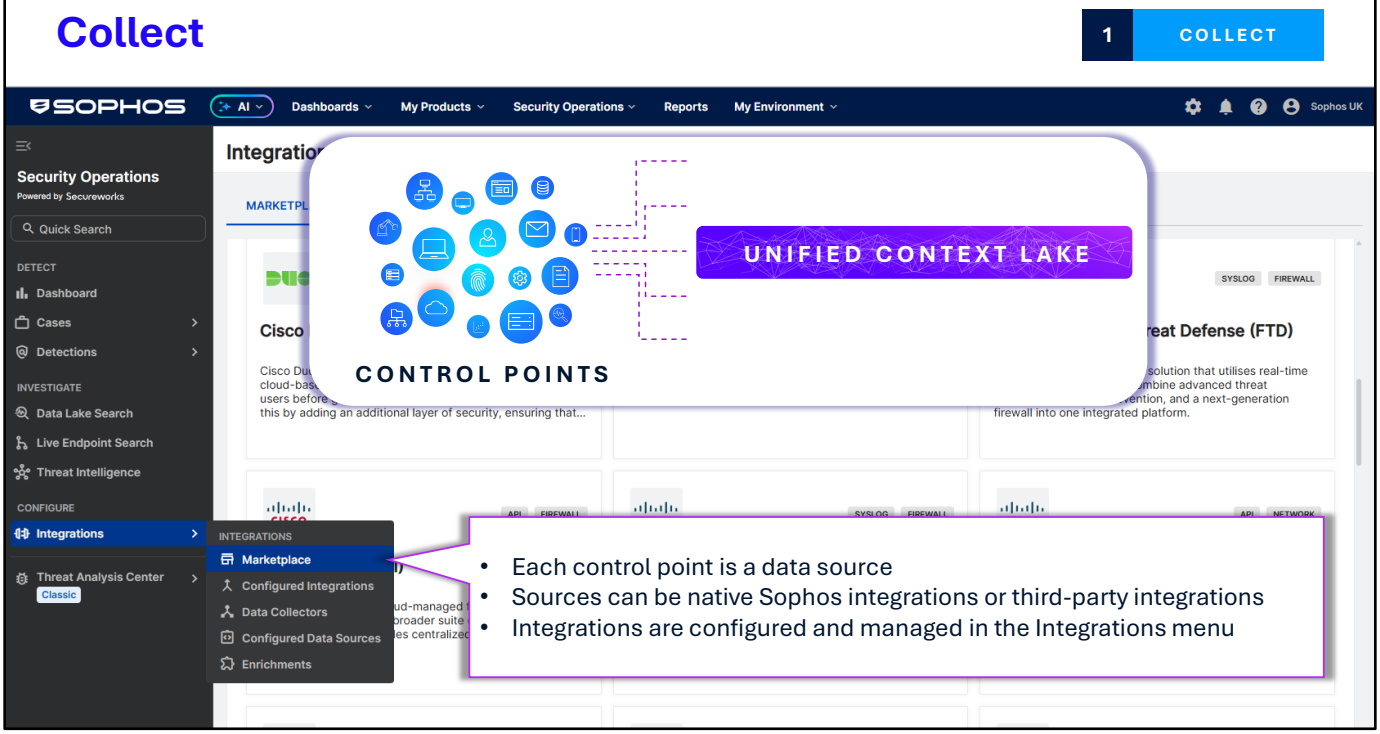
Data that is ingested and stored in the Unified Context Lake moves broadly through four phases.

Firstly, data is collected from control points; these can be your protected endpoints, Sophos Firewall, email, log collectors, and third-party integrations. The ingested data is normalized into a consistent, searchable format.

Once the data is normalized, it can be used for detection and investigation. Lastly, analysts respond to the data either manually or with the use of automation.

This is the workflow that underpins how data is ingested, investigated, and responded to in Sophos XDR. Tying it all together is Synchronized Security, which lets your control points share threat intelligence and coordinate their response, so a detection in one place can trigger action across the others.

Collect



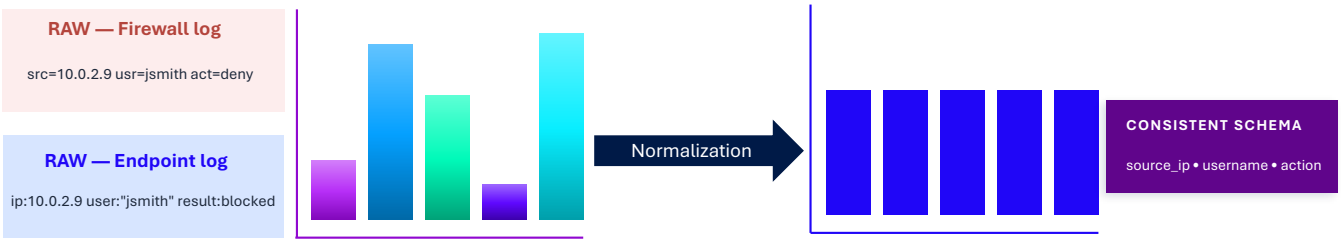
The Unified Context Lake ingests data from multiple sources; these can be considered control points. Each control point is a layer of defense or data source that is transmitting data into the Unified Context Lake.

Data sources can be native Sophos product integrations, such as Sophos Endpoint or Sophos Firewall, or configured as integrations in Security Operations.

Normalization

2 NORMALIZE

- All raw data is normalized
- Transforms the data into a consistent schema
- Enables identification of behavior across multiple domains and data sources



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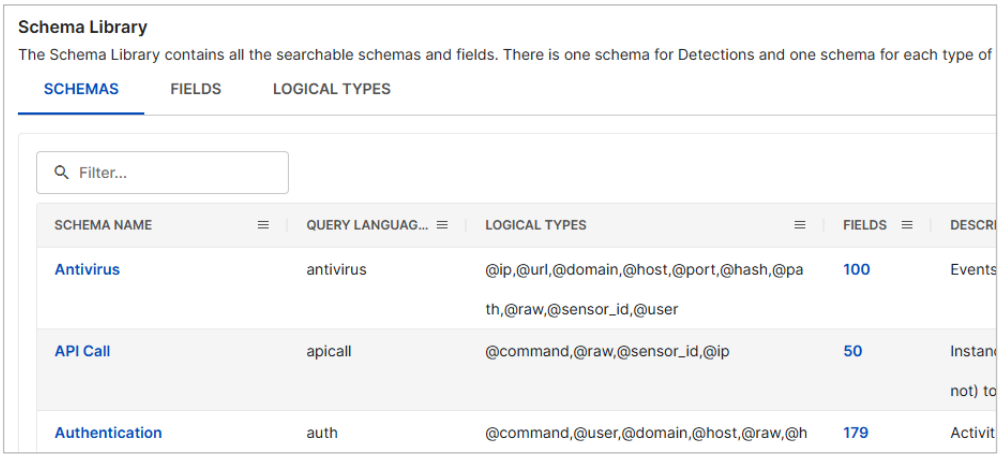
Once data is ingested into the Unified Context Lake, the data is normalized. Normalization ensures that data from different products and platforms becomes consistent. Without it, correlation across systems would not be possible. This step enables the detection engine to identify behavior that spans multiple domains.

Introduction to Schemas

2 NORMALIZE

- Schemas organize data, defining how data is structured
- Related activities are grouped into categories
- Analysts can target specific data types



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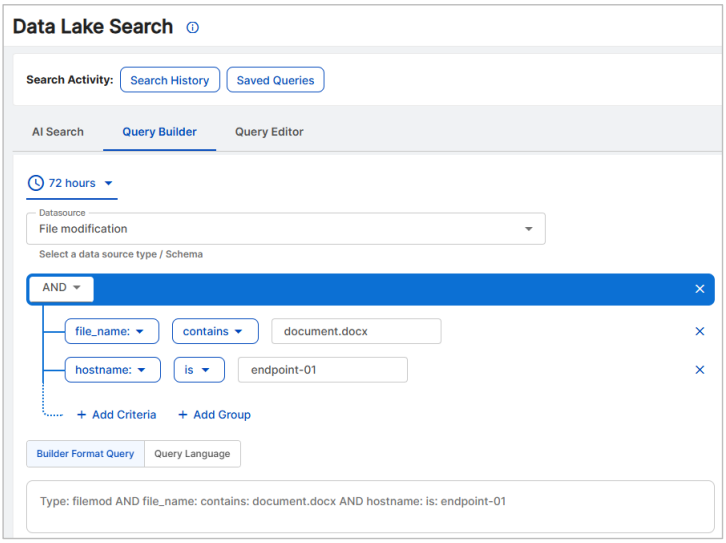
Schemas define how data is structured within the Unified Context Lake. They group related activities into categories such as authentication, process execution, or network traffic. This structure allows analysts to target specific data types during investigations.

Logical Types

2 NORMALIZE

- Unified way to query data across schemas
- The query language and AI features allow you to search the Unified Context Lake using natural language
- Abstract field names ensure that a reference search is run against all data sources
- Use the query builder to build out queries that ask for specific data from the Unified Context Lake



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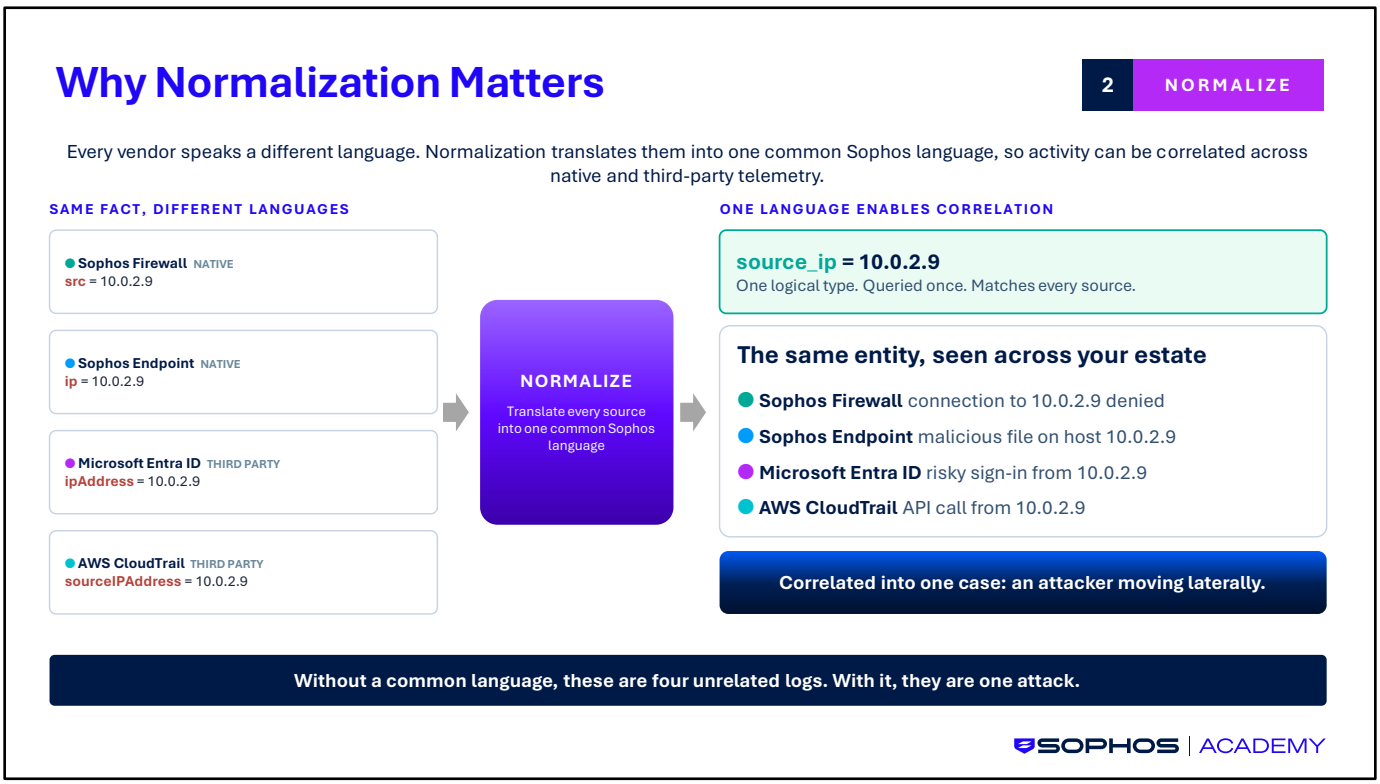
Schemas organize data; logical types make that organized data easy to search and query. The problem they solve is simple. Different schemas may store the same concept, say an IP address, under different field names: src_ip in one, source.ip in another, ipAddress somewhere else.

A logical type abstracts those field names behind a single reference. Instead of remembering every variant, an analyst applies one logical reference, and all the relevant sources will be returned. This improves both efficiency and consistency: everyone queries the same way, and nobody misses a source because they forgot a field name. You can use logical types through Quick Search, natural-language AI search, or build precise queries with them in the Query Builder



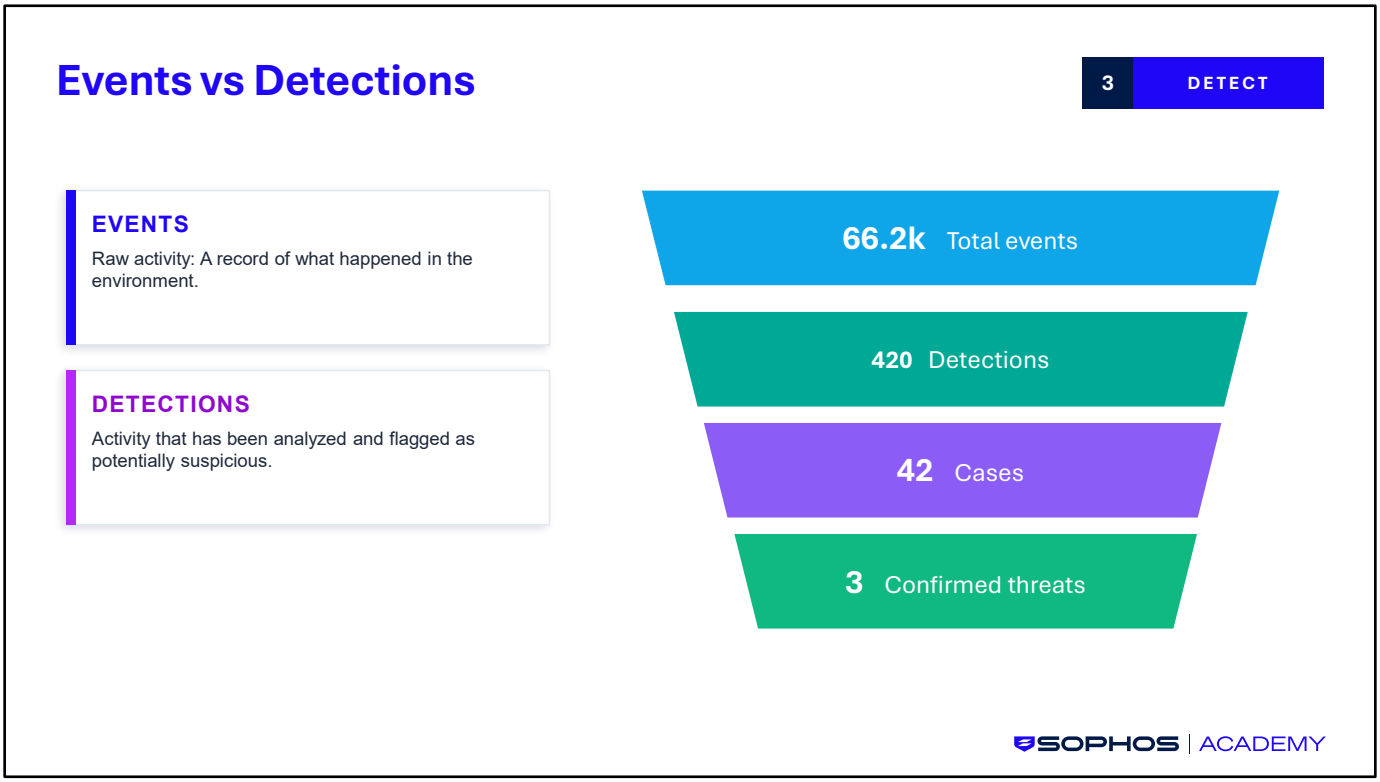
So far you have seen how data is collected, normalized, structured into schemas, and made searchable with logical types. Let's bring those ideas together and talk about why this matters.

Think of it like language. Every vendor describes the same event in its own way. Your firewall records a source address as src, your endpoint calls it ip, Microsoft Entra ID calls it ipAddress, and a cloud platform calls it sourceIPAddress. Same fact, four different words for it. On their own, those four logs look like four unrelated events.

Normalization is the translation step. It takes each of those raw formats and rewrites them into one common Sophos language, a consistent schema where that value is always source_ip. Schemas give the data a shared structure, and logical types let you search that structure with a single reference instead of memorizing every vendor's field name.

Once everything speaks the same language, the platform can correlate. That single address, 10.0.2.9, now links a denied firewall connection, a malicious file on the endpoint, a risky sign-in, and a suspicious cloud API call into one picture. What looked like four isolated logs becomes one story: an attacker moving laterally across your estate.

Without a common language, you would be chasing four separate alerts and might never connect them. With it, you see the whole attack. That is the real value of normalization, and it works the same way across both native Sophos sources and third-party integrations.



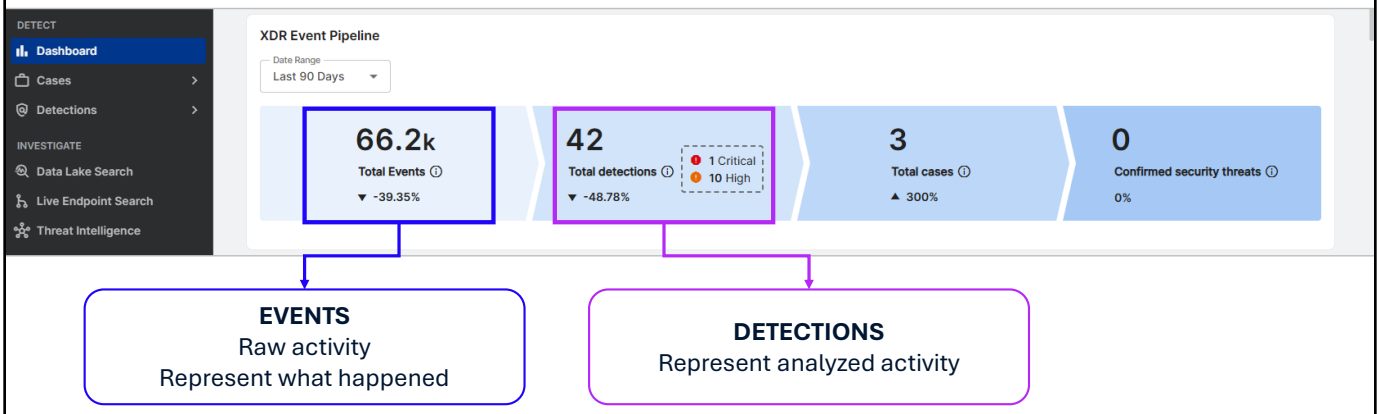
With data collected, normalized, and structured, we can now detect meaningful activity. Two terms are central here, and it's important not to confuse them: events and detections.

An event is raw activity. A simple record that something happened.
A detection is activity that has been analyzed and identified as potentially suspicious.

Tens of thousands of events might reduce to a few hundred detections, then to a handful of cases, and finally to just a few confirmed threats. The analysis at each stage is what makes the volume manageable. In practice, an investigation usually begins with a detection, because that's what's been flagged as worth attention, and then pivots into the underlying events to reconstruct exactly what happened. Detections tell you where to look; events tell you the full story.

Events vs Detections

3 DETECT



EVENTS
Raw activity
Represent what happened

DETECTIONS
Represent analyzed activity

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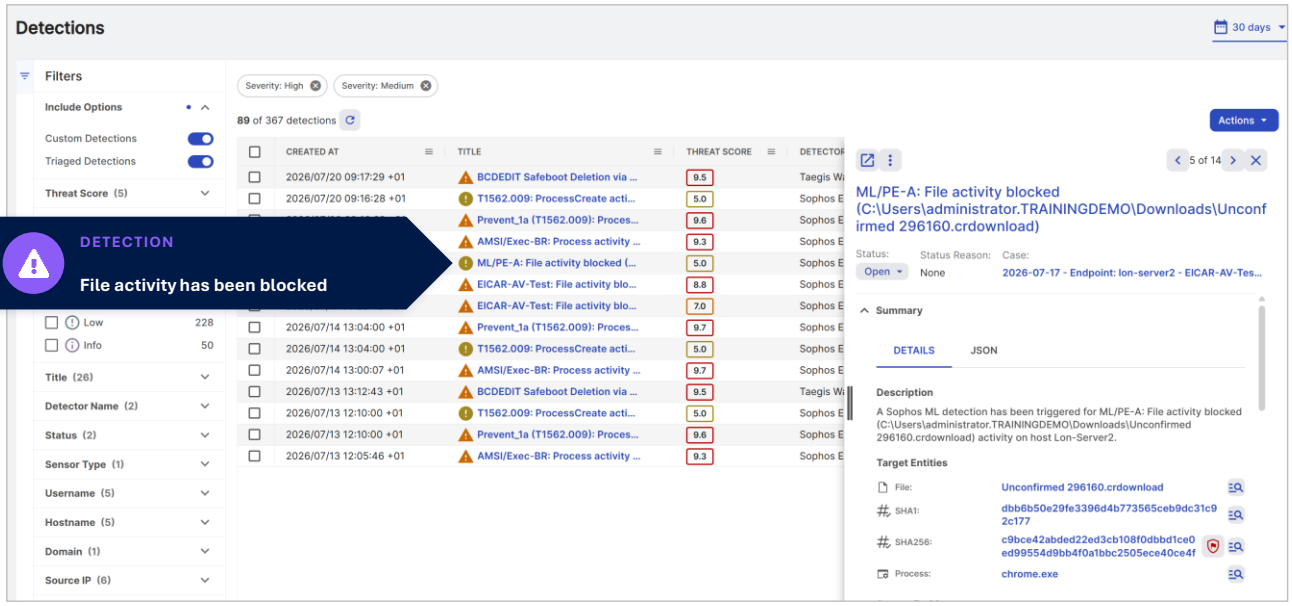
On the Sophos XDR dashboard, the event pipeline is displayed. Here you can view a summary of events, detections, cases, and security threats.

Events represent what happened in the environment. Detections represent activity that has been analyzed and identified as potentially suspicious.

Detection Context

3 DETECT



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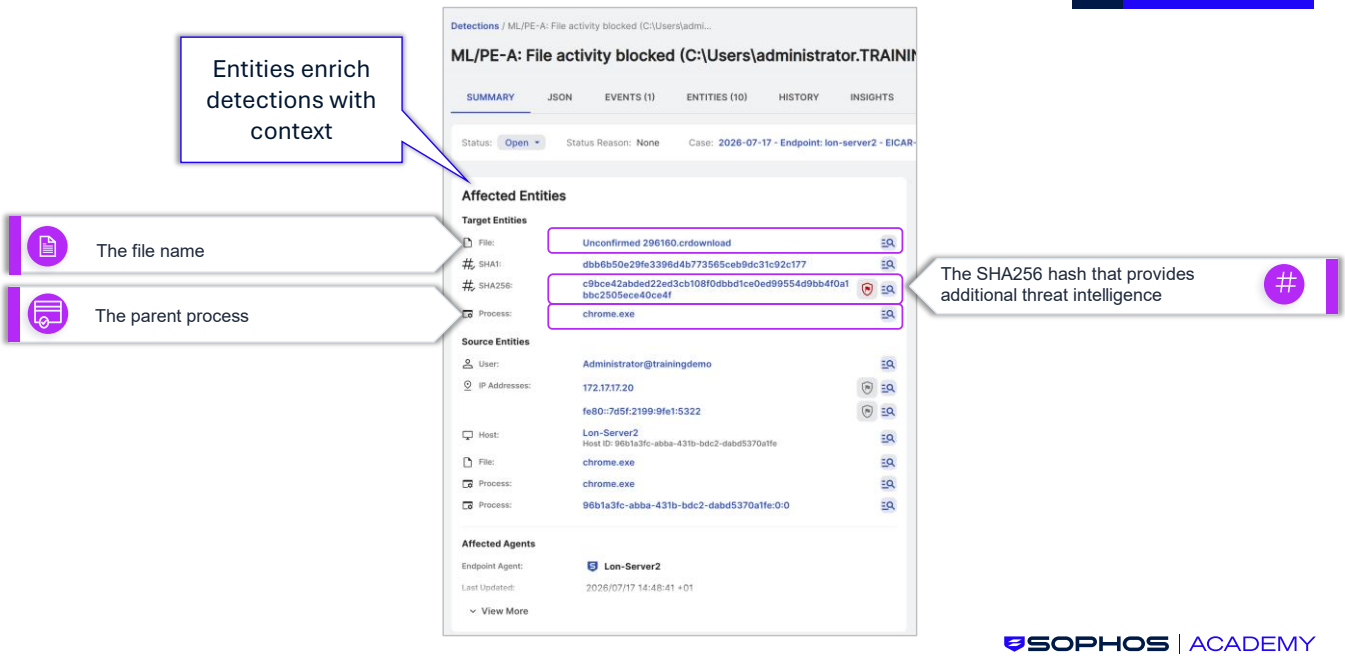
A detection tells you that something is suspicious. In this example, a detection classified as a malicious portable executable file. The file activity has been blocked. On its own, that's a flag.

Detection Context

3 DETECT



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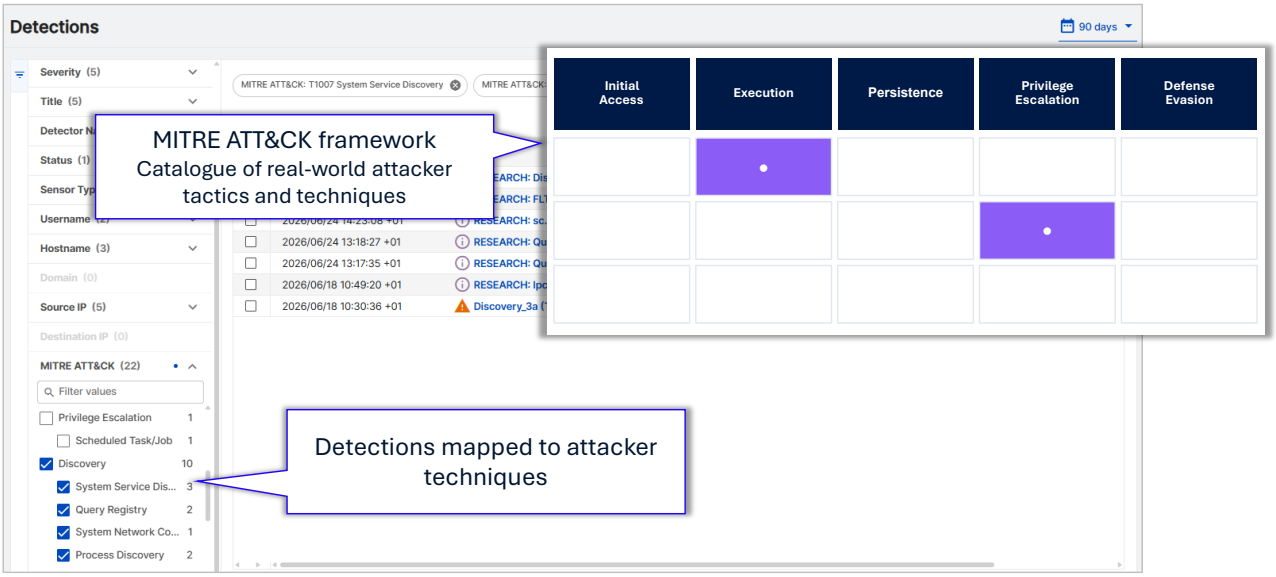
Entities tell you why; they enrich a detection with additional context and evidence that explains the significance of what was observed. In this example, the target entities provide the file name, the SHA256 hash of the file, and the process the file was created from. This tells an analyst that the file was downloaded from Google Chrome by the user detailed in the source entities.

MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

3 DETECT



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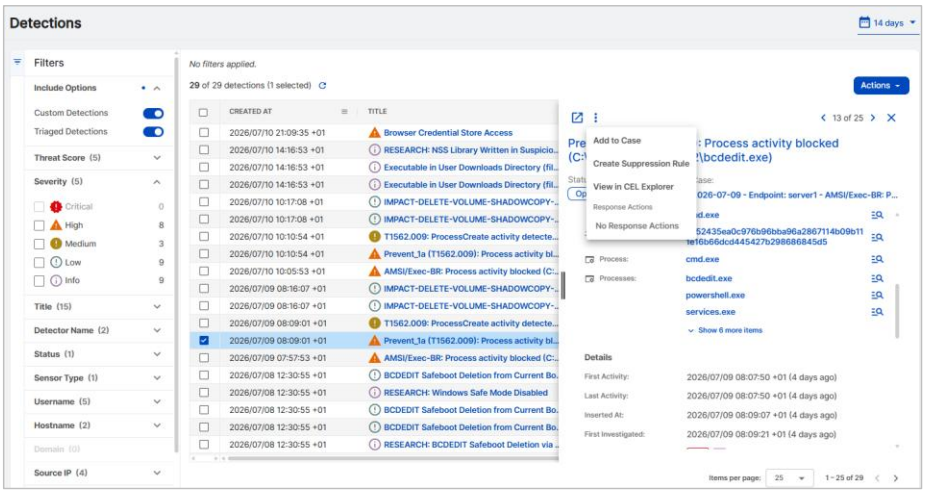
Detections are mapped to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, a widely used, industry-standard catalogue of real-world attacker tactics and techniques. This MITRE ATT&CK mapping provides a consistent way to understand attacker behavior. Think of the matrix shown here. The columns are tactics, the attacker's goals, like execution or privilege escalation, and within each column sit the specific techniques used to achieve them.

That indicates to an analyst what kind of behavior the detection represents and where it might sit in an attack. It also gives the whole team a shared language: instead of describing activity in your own words, you can point to a specific technique. That makes it far easier to assess impact, spot a broader attack pattern across several detections, and communicate findings clearly.

Respond

4 RESPOND

- Use detections and cases to organize response actions for detections
- Possible actions
  - Add detection to a case
  - Create a suppression rule
  - Entity pivot
  - Isolate the device
  - Reset user logon
- Response actions will depend on the integrations configured



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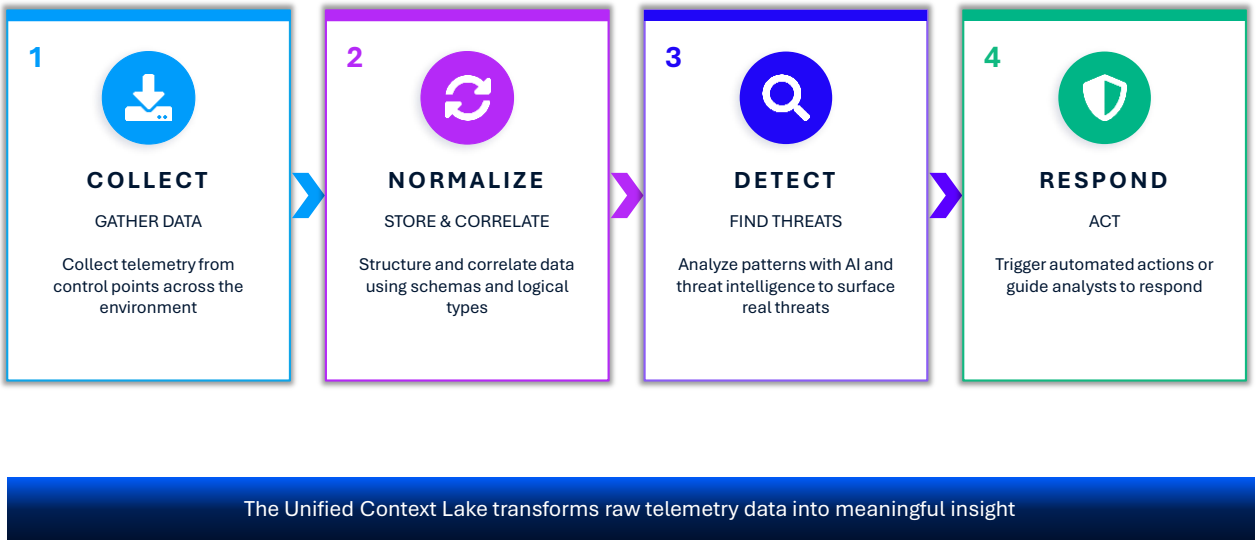
Sophos XDR Security Operations provides analysts with functional responses to detections. For example, an analyst can select to create a suppression rule for detections that aren't harmful but create a lot of noise. Analysts can perform pivot actions in the data included in a detection and case.

Response actions will appear when integrations have been configured and automated response actions have been configured. These actions could be isolating the named device or resetting a user logon.

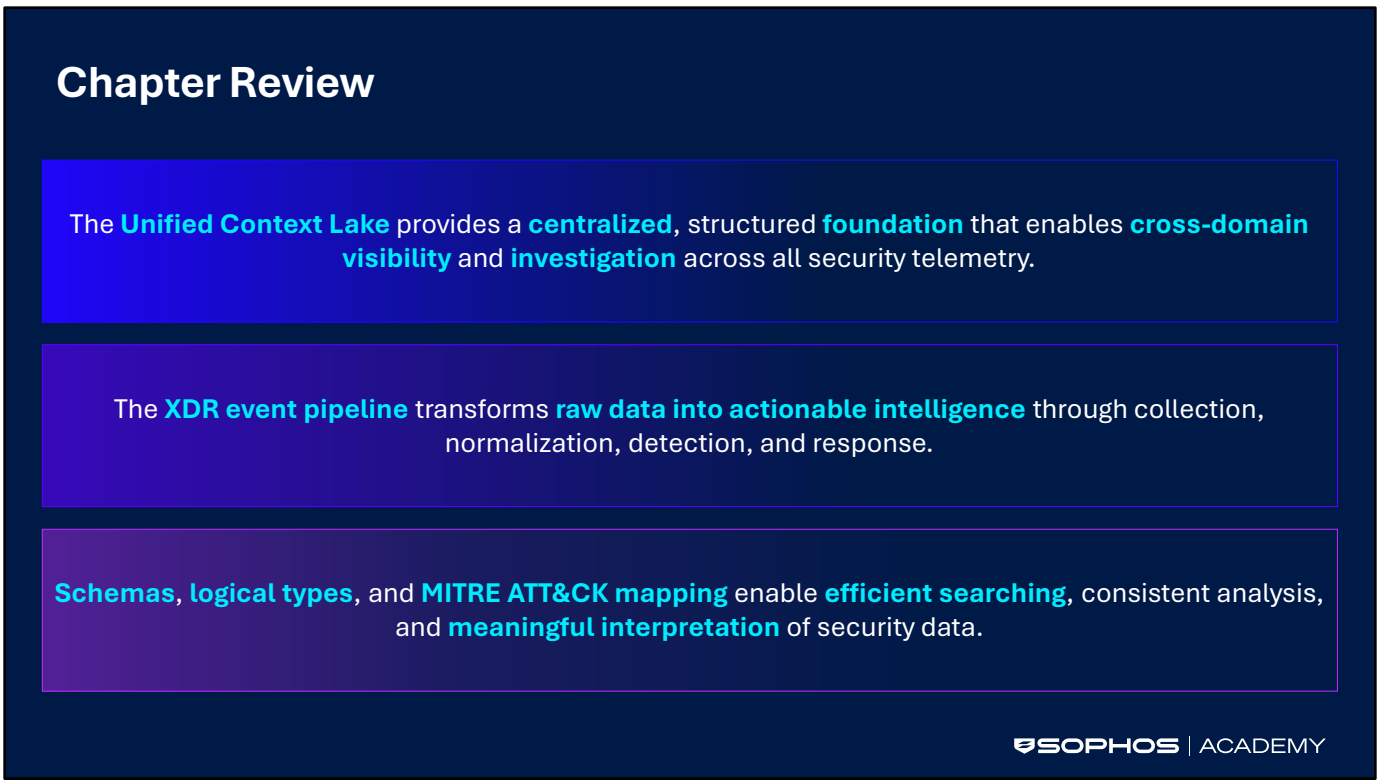
Summary



Let's bring it all together. The Unified Context Lake is what makes efficient investigation possible.

Data is collected from your control points. It's normalized and structured so it can be correlated. It's analyzed to find the threats that genuinely matter. And finally, it's acted upon, either automatically or by an analyst.

These four phases transform raw telemetry into meaningful insight.



Here are the three main things you learned in this chapter:

The Unified Context Lake provides a centralized, structured foundation that enables cross-domain visibility and investigation across all security telemetry.

The XDR event pipeline transforms raw data into actionable intelligence through collection, normalization, detection, and response.

Schemas, logical types, and MITRE ATT&CK mapping enable efficient searching, consistent analysis, and meaningful interpretation of security data.

[Additional Information]

Sophos Endpoint
EP4540: Investigation Techniques and Search Methods

September 2026
7.0v1

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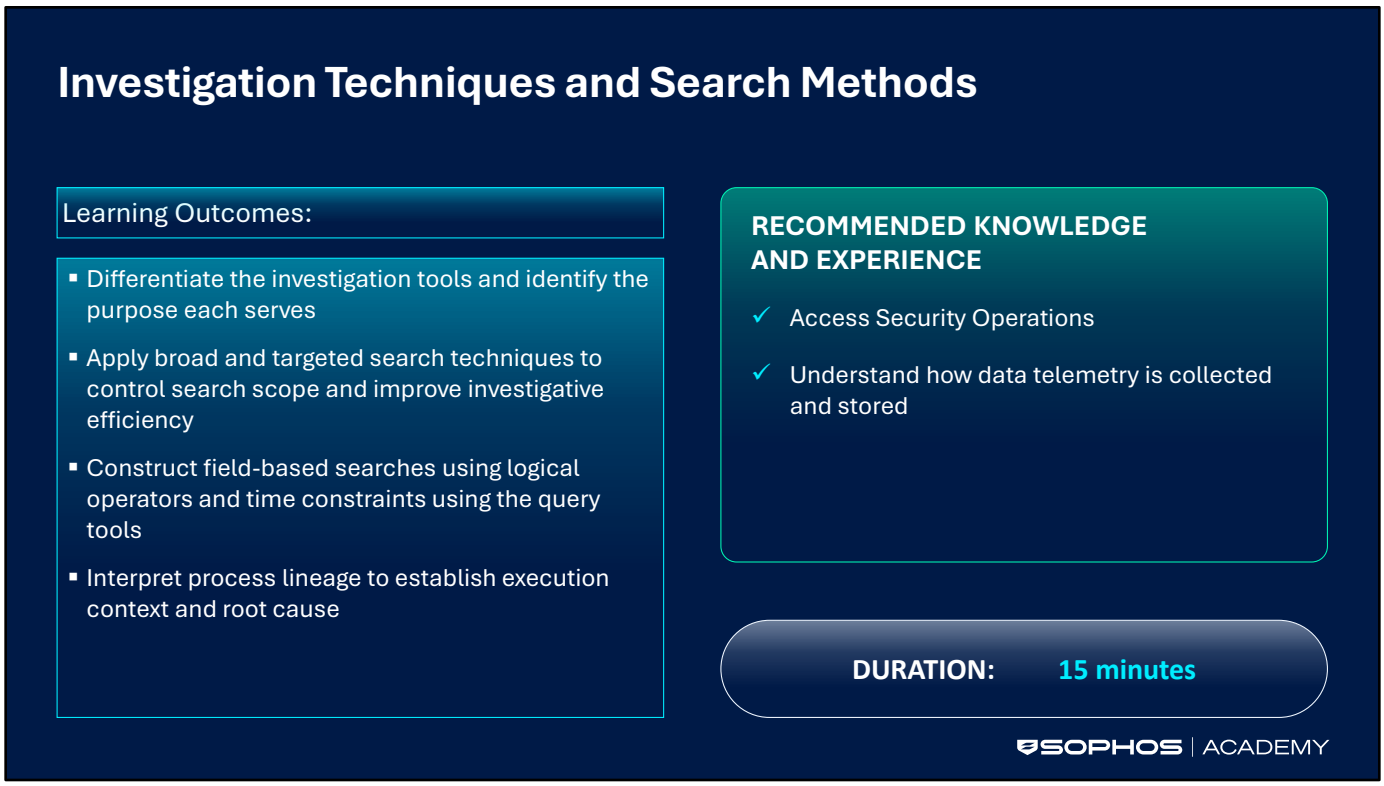

In this chapter, you'll learn how to investigate security events using the search capabilities. You'll use different search methods to locate relevant data, pivot between related artifacts, examine endpoint activity, and build evidence-based conclusions during security investigations.

Investigative Data Analysis

Provides the ability to search across multiple devices on your network

- ✓ Analysts **transform raw data** into actionable security insights
- ✓ **Structured querying** and **contextual understanding**
- ✓ **Discovering risks before** they result in a **breach**
- ✓ Performing **threat investigations** and **security monitoring**

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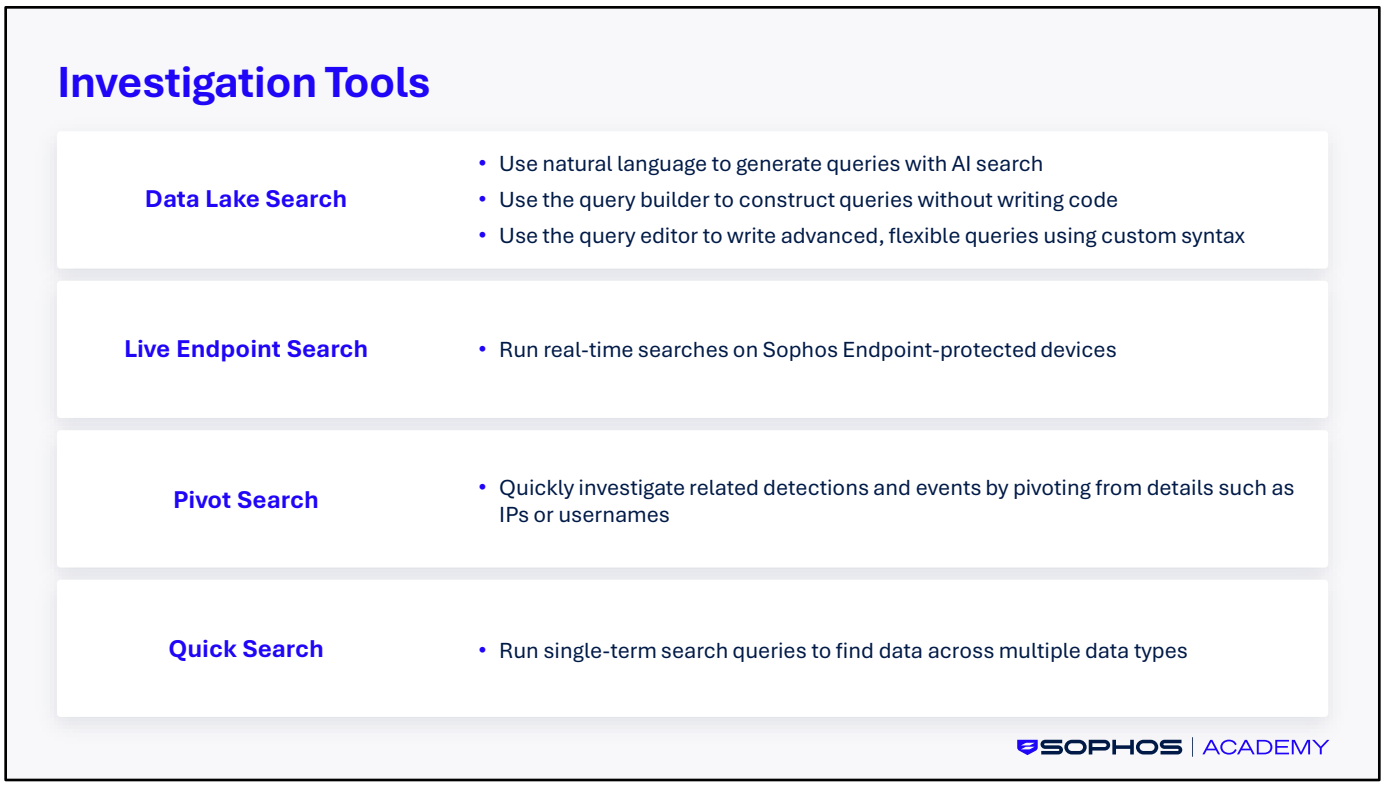
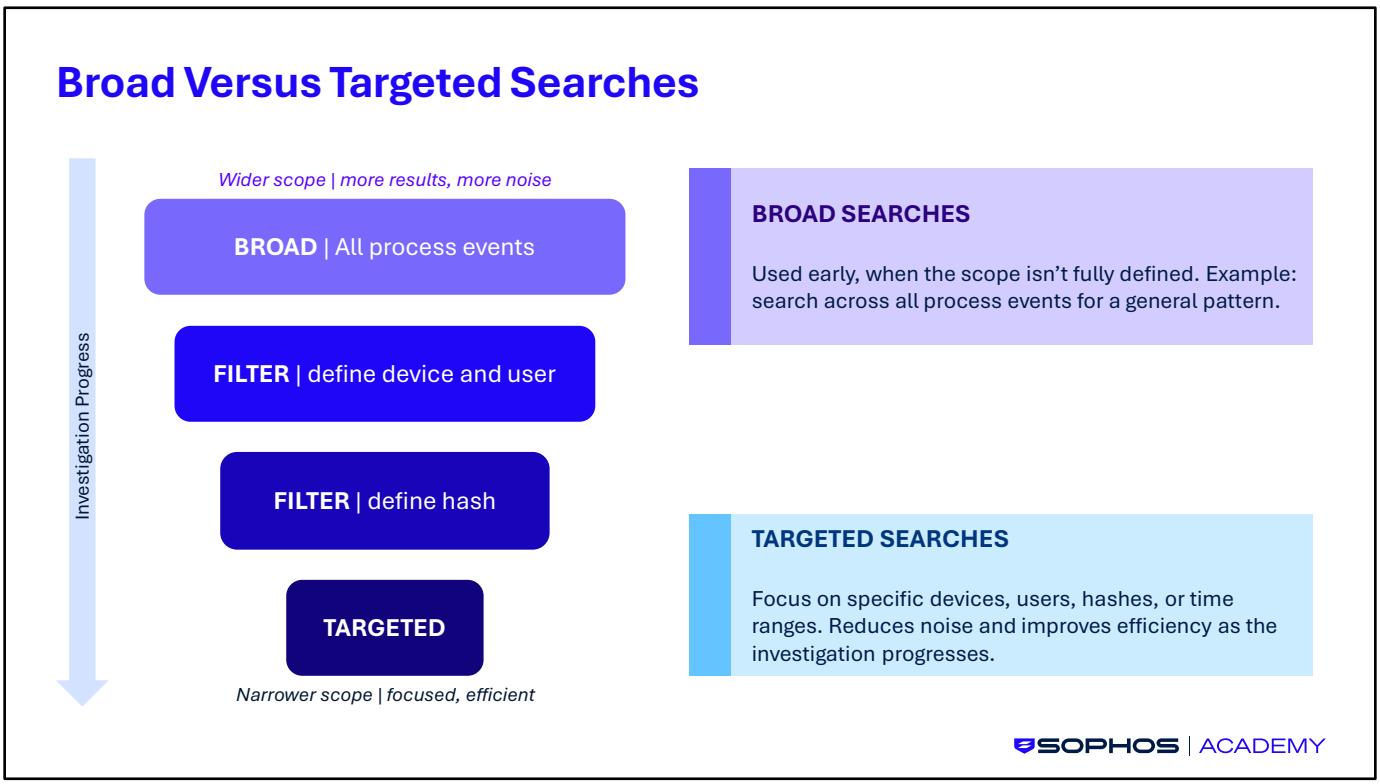
Analysts can use the investigation tools to interrogate data. Analysts aren't just retrieving data; they're forming hypotheses and validating them against telemetry. This requires an understanding of both the data structure and the available query and search tools. The goal is to progress from an initial detection, through suspicion, to a validated conclusion supported by evidence.



The investigation tools provide search functionality to investigate security data across your environment.

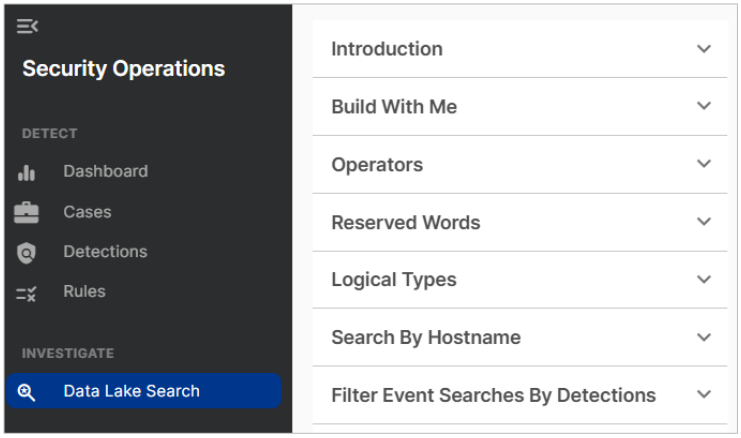
Data Lake Search, Live Endpoint Search, Pivot Search, and Quick Search allow analysts to query detections and events, build and save searches, use AI to generate natural-language queries, and pivot on key data points. Data Lake Search queries telemetry that devices and integrated products upload to the cloud-hosted Unified Context Lake, which retains data for up to 90 days and returns results for all devices, whether they are currently connected or not. Live Endpoint Search runs queries in real time against connected Sophos Endpoint-protected devices.



Broad queries are typically used early in an investigation when the scope isn't fully defined. For example, searching across all process events for a general pattern. As the investigation progresses, targeted queries become more important. These reduce noise and improve efficiency by focusing on specific devices, users, hashes, or time ranges. The transition from broad to targeted querying is a key skill in efficient investigations. Narrowing the time range also matters; constraining the period reduces noise and improves performance.

Data Lake Search Fundamentals

- Searches are written using a query language
- An on-page help guide introduces the language
- It includes instruction and information on:
  - How to build a query
  - Operators used
  - Time ranges
  - Functions
  - Aggregations



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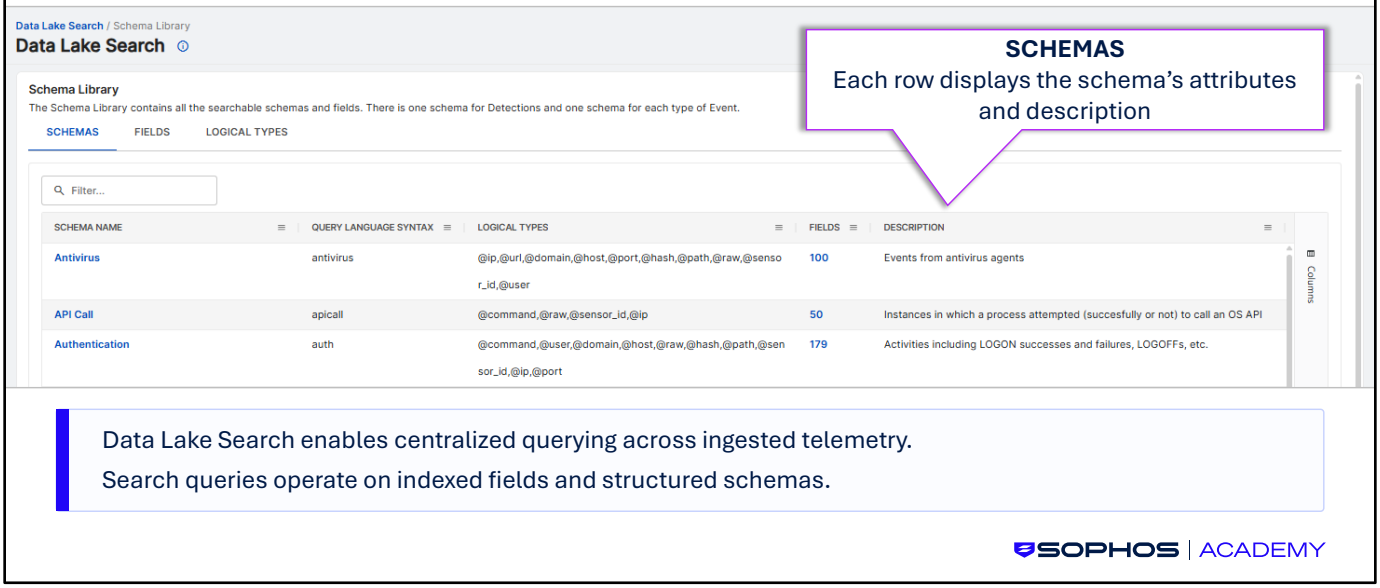
Data Lake Searches are written using a query language. On-page Search Help, accessed from the Query Editor page, along with worked examples, reduces the learning curve. The AI query generator, covered later in this chapter, also means analysts can be productive before they have fully learned the syntax.

Data Lake Search Fundamentals



Data Lake Search enables centralized querying across ingested telemetry.
Search queries operate on indexed fields and structured schemas.

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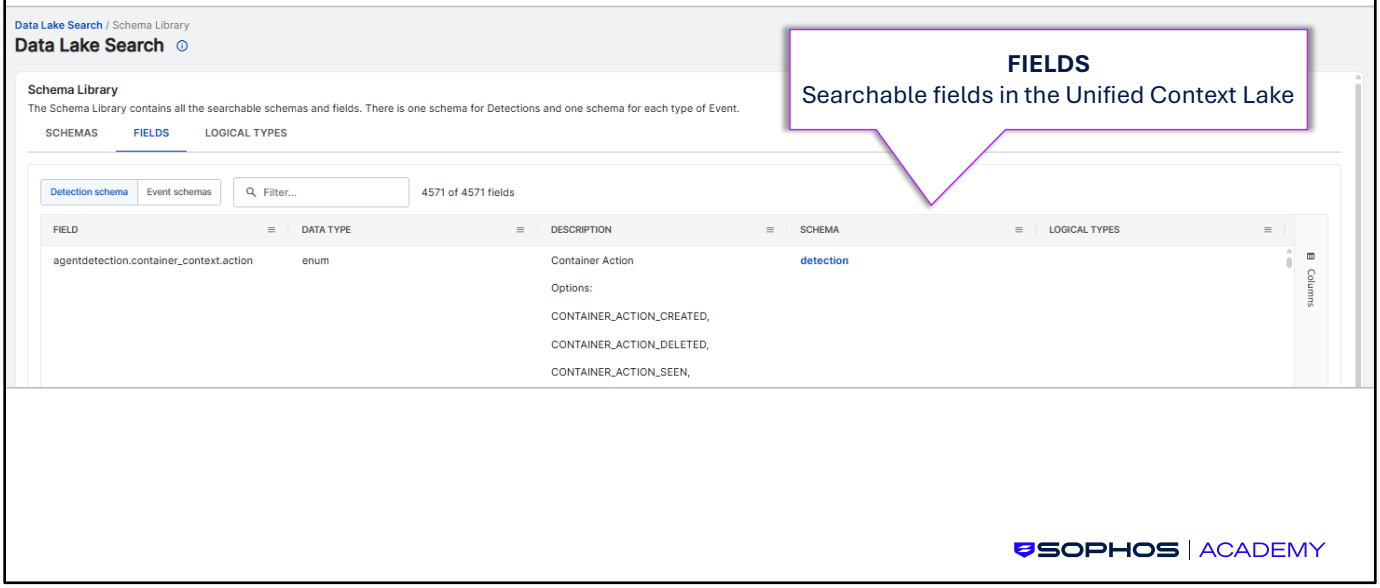
The Unified Context Lake aggregates telemetry from endpoints, network devices, and integrations. This data is indexed and structured, which allows for high-performance querying. Understanding field names and schema design is important because queries rely on these structures. Analysts are effectively querying a unified dataset, even though the data originates from different sources.

The schemas and structures for the data can be found in **Data Lake Search > Schema Library.** The page is split into tabs. The first tab displays the schemas available, with each row showing the schema's attributes and description.

Data Lake Search Fundamentals



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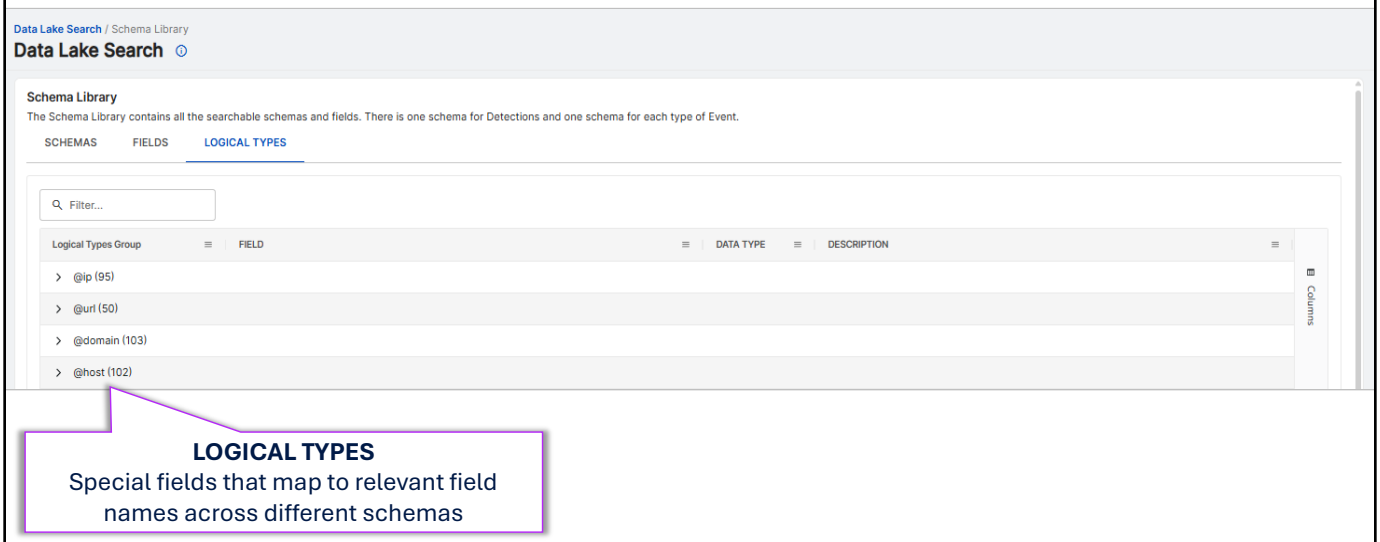
The second tab lists the available fields. These are fields that are searchable in the Unified Context Lake. Use the search bar to filter fields by your input.

Data Lake Search Fundamentals



LOGICAL TYPES
Special fields that map to relevant field names across different schemas

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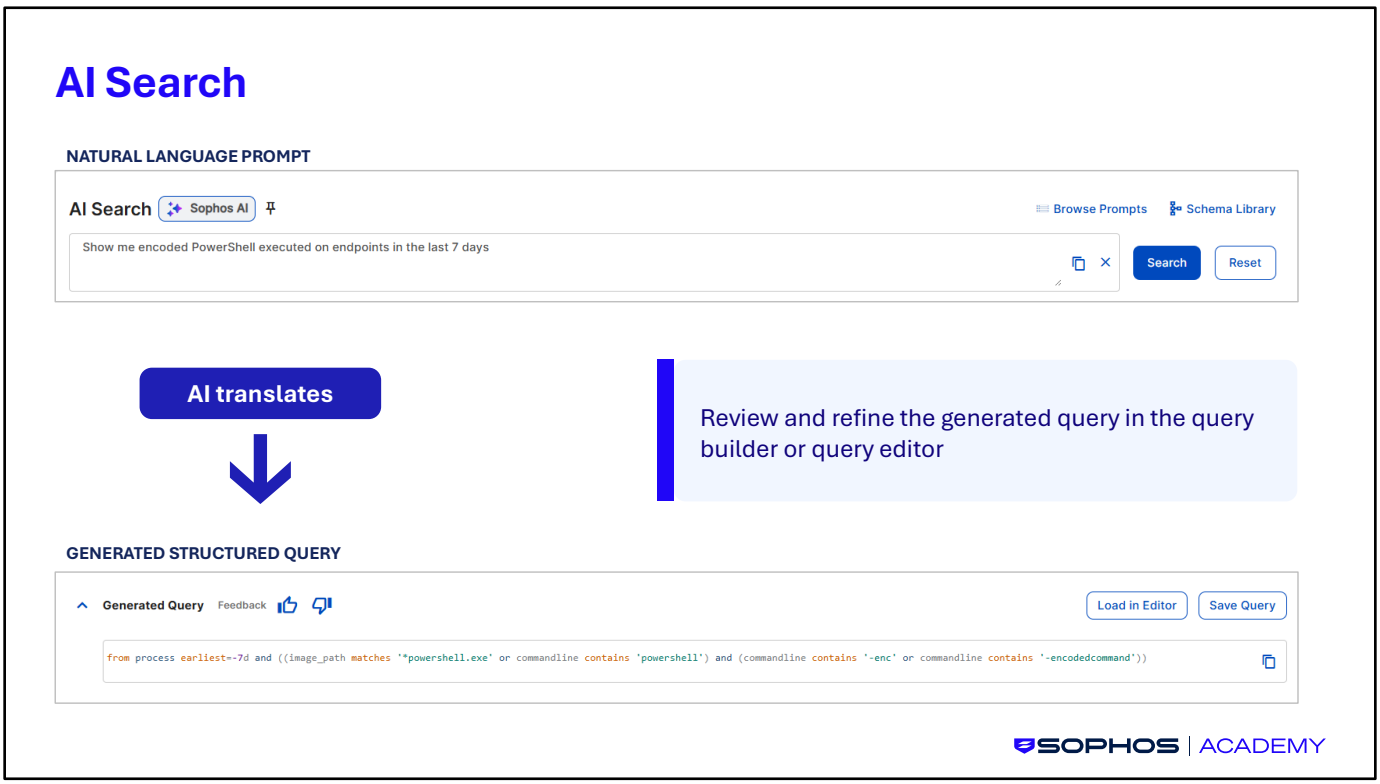
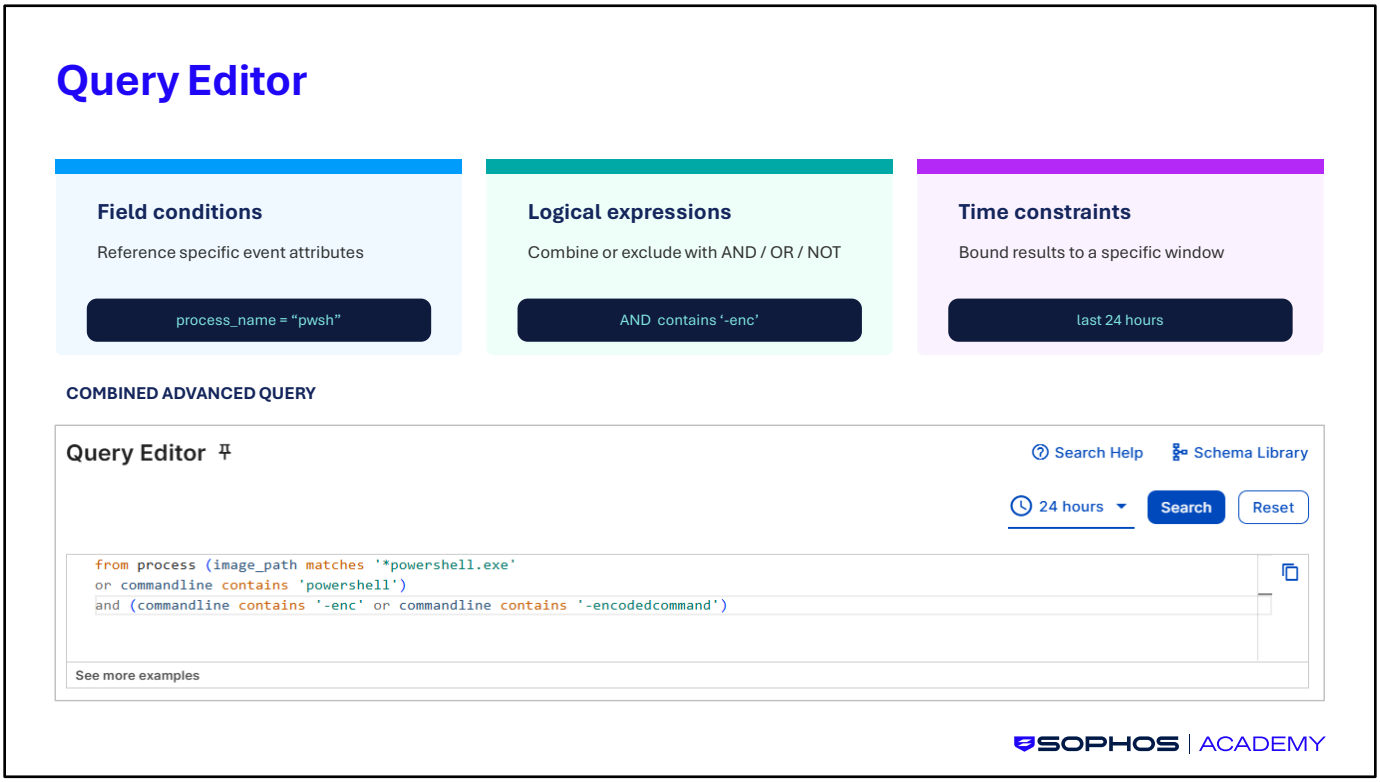
And the third tab lists the logical types. These are special fields that map to relevant field names across different schemas. They use the @ prefix and allow you to query all related fields without specifying each one individually.

Logical types simplify queries because a single term returns all relevant data. They provide automatic field mapping, so all relevant fields for the selected schema and data type are included in the search results without the analyst having to remember or specify each individual field name.



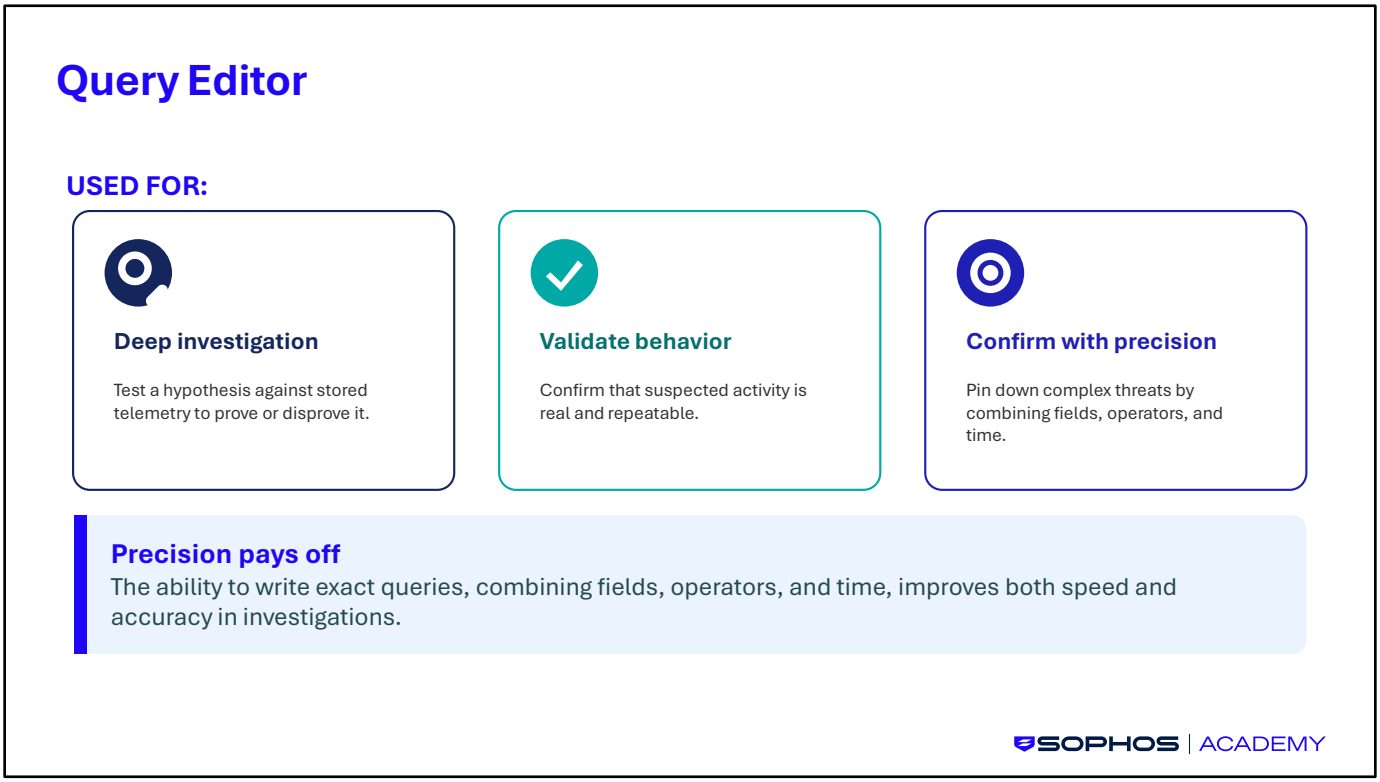
AI Search allows you to describe what you are looking for in natural language, which is then translated into a structured query. In the example, the plain-English request for encoded PowerShell on endpoints in the last 7 days is converted into a field-based query with a time constraint. You can also start from the ready-to-use prompts by selecting **Browse Prompts**, rather than writing a request from scratch.

Review the generated query results; does it give you the data you want? You can load the query in the query editor to fine-tune it to what you want. While it does not replace technical understanding, AI accelerates query-building, especially in the early stages of investigation, and helps less-experienced analysts work effectively with complex datasets.



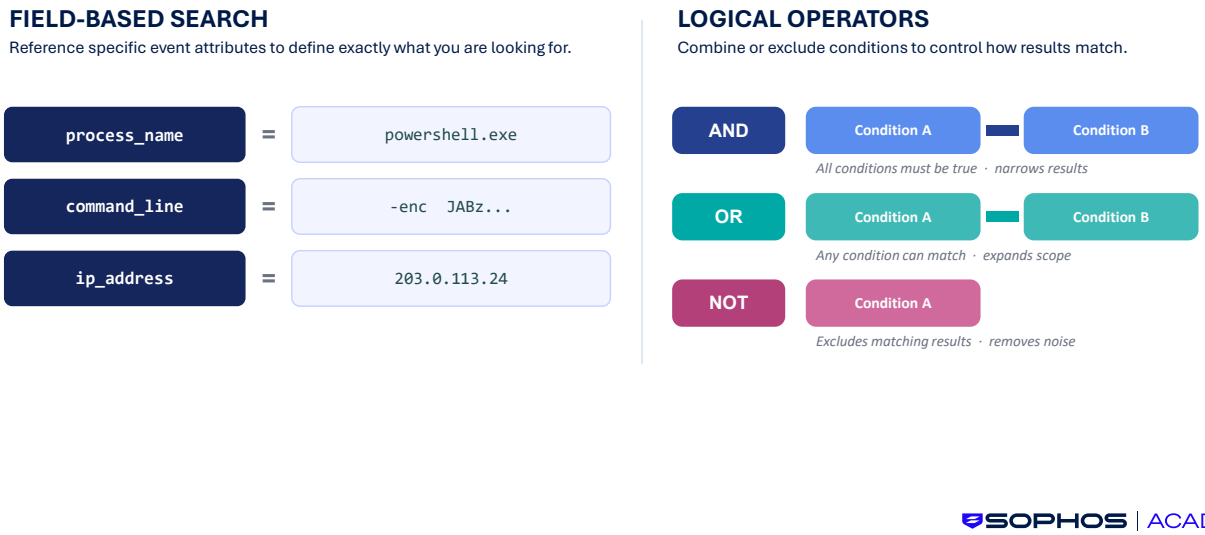
The Query Editor provides advanced search functionality, giving full control over the query logic. You can define detailed conditions, combine multiple fields, and constrain results by time or other parameters.

The three building blocks shown are field conditions (referencing specific event attributes), logical expressions (combining or excluding conditions with AND, OR, and NOT), and time constraints (bounding the window). The combined example brings all three together: searching for encoded PowerShell commands that have been run in the last 24 hours. Please note that the time constraint can be selected from the drop-down menu in the query editor.



Using the Query Editor to create advanced searches is particularly useful when investigating complex threats or validating suspected behaviors. The ability to write precise queries significantly improves both speed and accuracy in investigations, which is why it underpins deep investigation and hypothesis testing.

Field-Based Searching and Logical Operators



Field-based searching lets you define exactly what you are looking for by referencing specific event attributes, rather than searching on a single free-text term. Common examples include process name, command line, and IP address, as shown on the left.

Logical operators then let you combine or exclude those conditions. AND requires all conditions to be true, so it narrows the results. OR matches any of the conditions, so it expands the scope. NOT excludes matching results, which is useful for removing known-good activity and cutting noise.

Query Builder

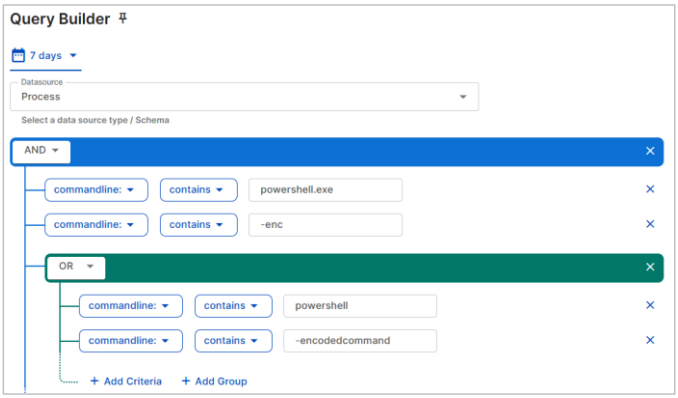
REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE Hunt for encoded PowerShell run on endpoints in the last 7 days.

```
from process earliest=-7d AND((image_path matches '*powershell.exe' or commandline contains 'powershell')
AND (commandline contains 'enc' or commandline contains '-encodedcommand'))
```

In the Query Builder

Terms in one rule default to **AND**; group rules into nested queries and choose **AND** / **OR** between them

No code is required.



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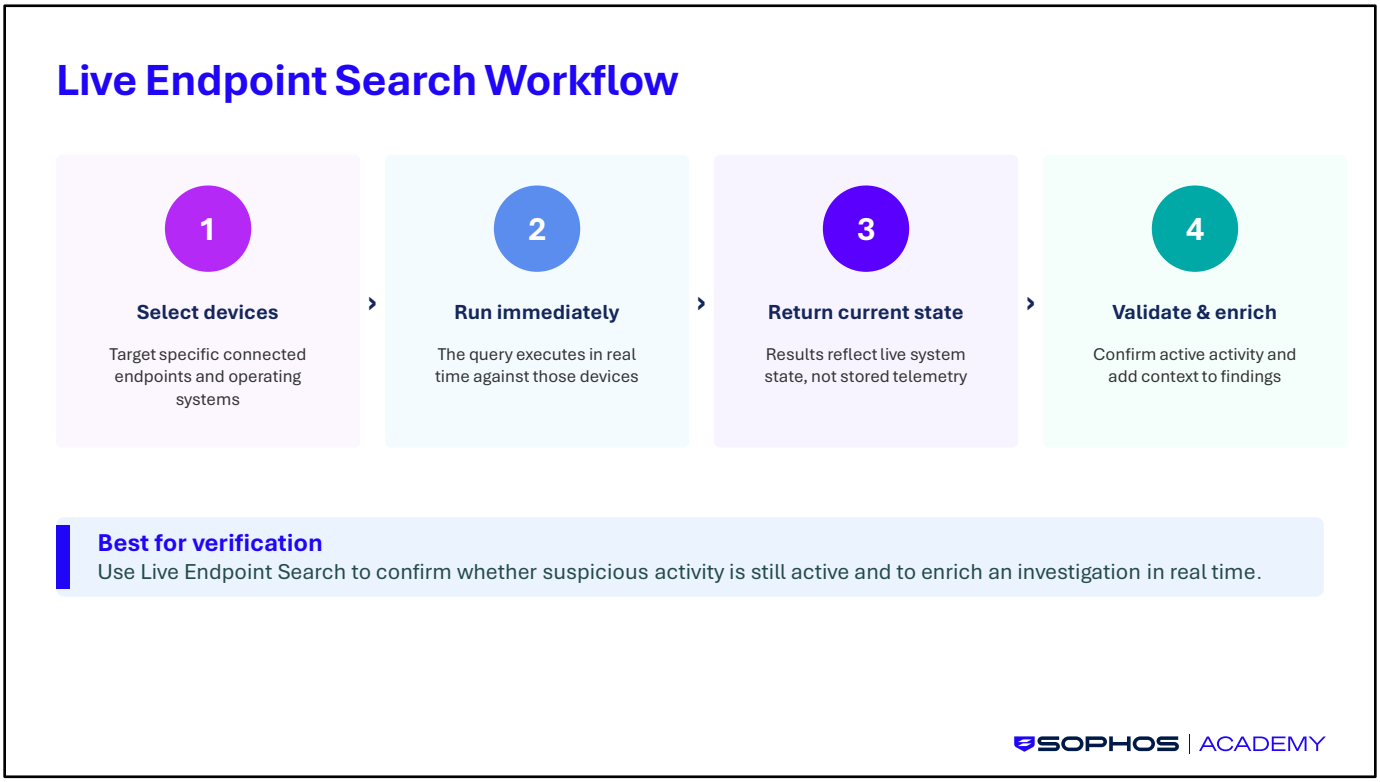
In this example, we are hunting for encoded PowerShell that ran on endpoints. The query is read left to right:

From the process field
Using the earliest date from 7 days ago
AND the image_path matches '*powershell.exe' OR commandline contains 'powershell'
AND commandline contains 'enc' OR commandline contains '-encodedcommand' narrows to encoded commands, a common obfuscation technique.

Each clause references a specific field, and the operators chain them into a precise, efficient query. This is a simple example; the query builder means that you do not have to write this by hand. In the Query Builder, multiple terms within a single rule are combined with AND by default, and you can group rules into nested queries and choose AND or OR between them to build more complex conditions without writing code. Mastering these operators is critical for building efficient and accurate queries.

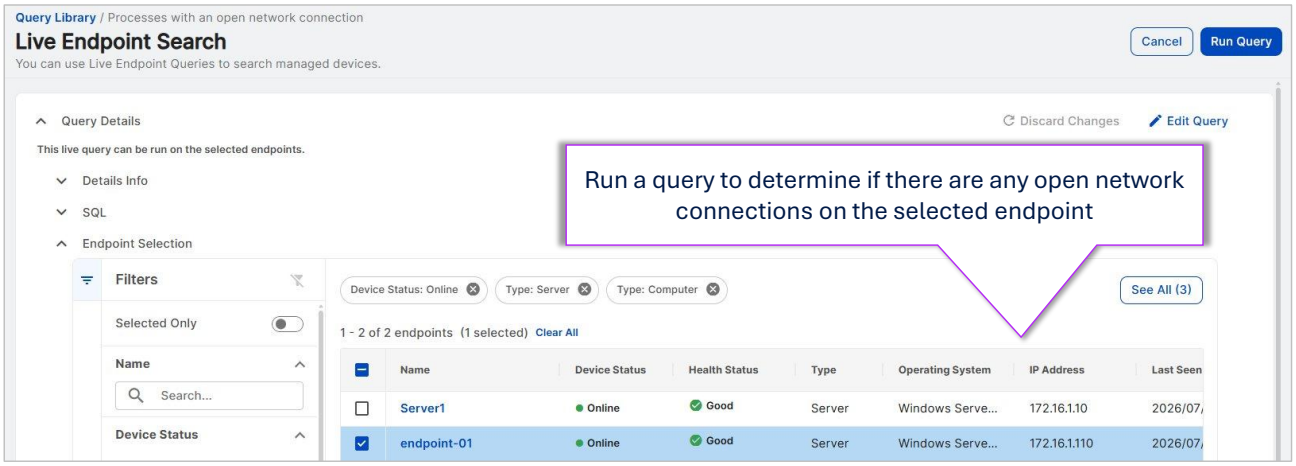


When using Live Endpoint Search, target specific connected devices, select the operating systems to include, and execute queries that run immediately. Select from the query library, which includes multiple queries split by category. Once you have selected a query to run, follow this workflow stream.

Select the target devices, run the query in real time, return current state information, and use those results to validate or enrich the investigation.

Because the search runs live, results reflect the current state of the system rather than stored telemetry. This is particularly useful when verifying whether suspicious activity is still active. It also allows collection of additional context that may not be captured in standard telemetry, which is why this capability bridges the gap between detection and response.

Live Endpoint Search



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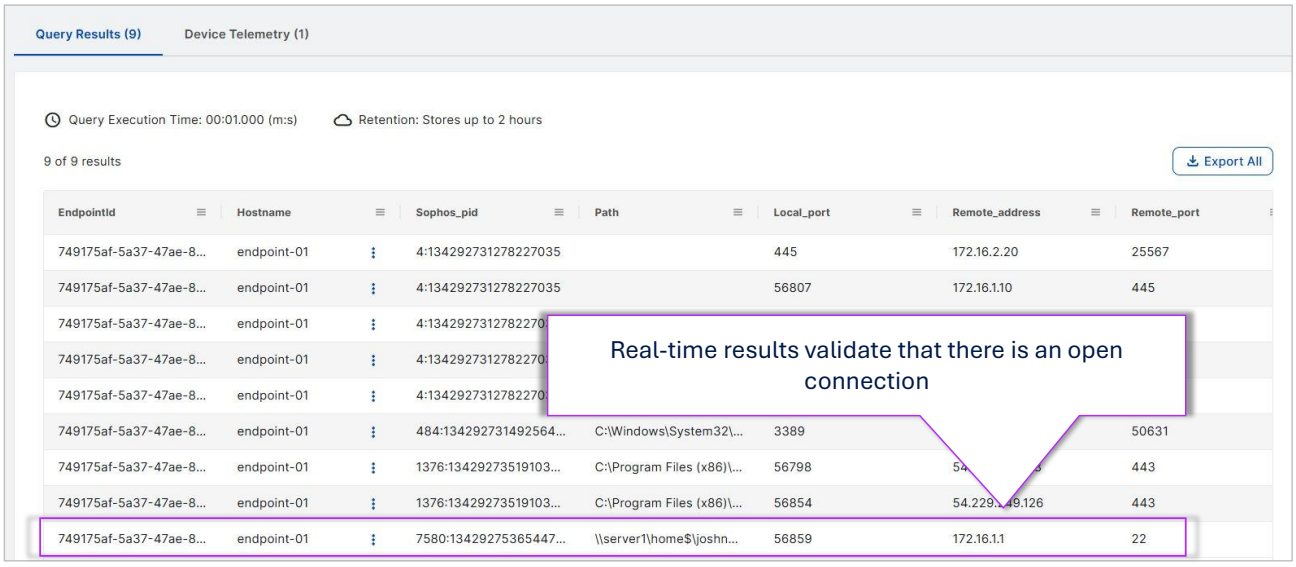
Let's look at an example. In this scenario, a suspicious process has been identified as running. We are using the Live Endpoint Search to determine if there are any open network connections.

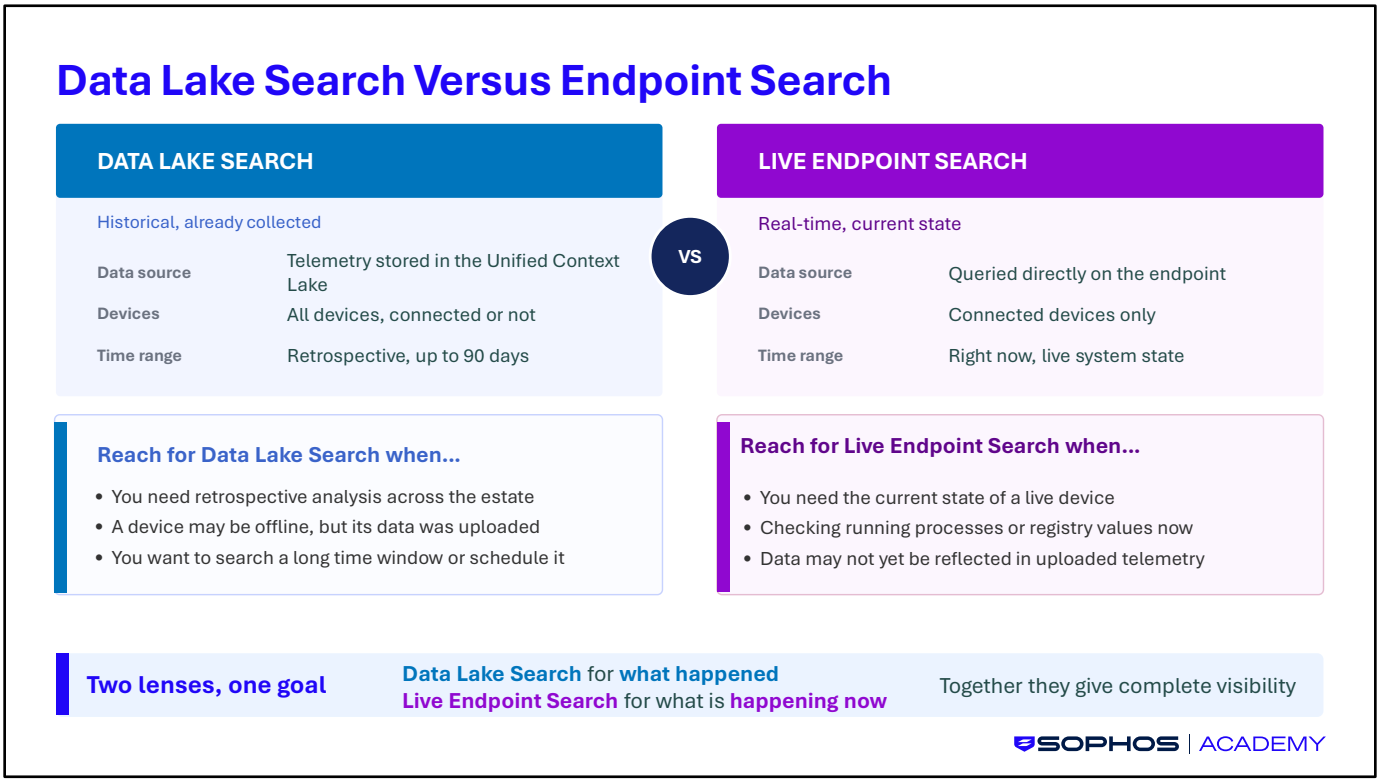
Here, we have selected our query to find this information and are selecting the endpoint to run the query against. This query will execute in real time.

Live Endpoint Search



The query results are returned and reflect the current activity on the selected endpoint. In this example, the results show that PuTTY is connected to 172.16.1.1 on port 22, the standard SSH port. The path shows that it's being run from a network location.

This result confirms and validates that there is an open network connection. Any follow-up actions can then be determined based on the investigation.

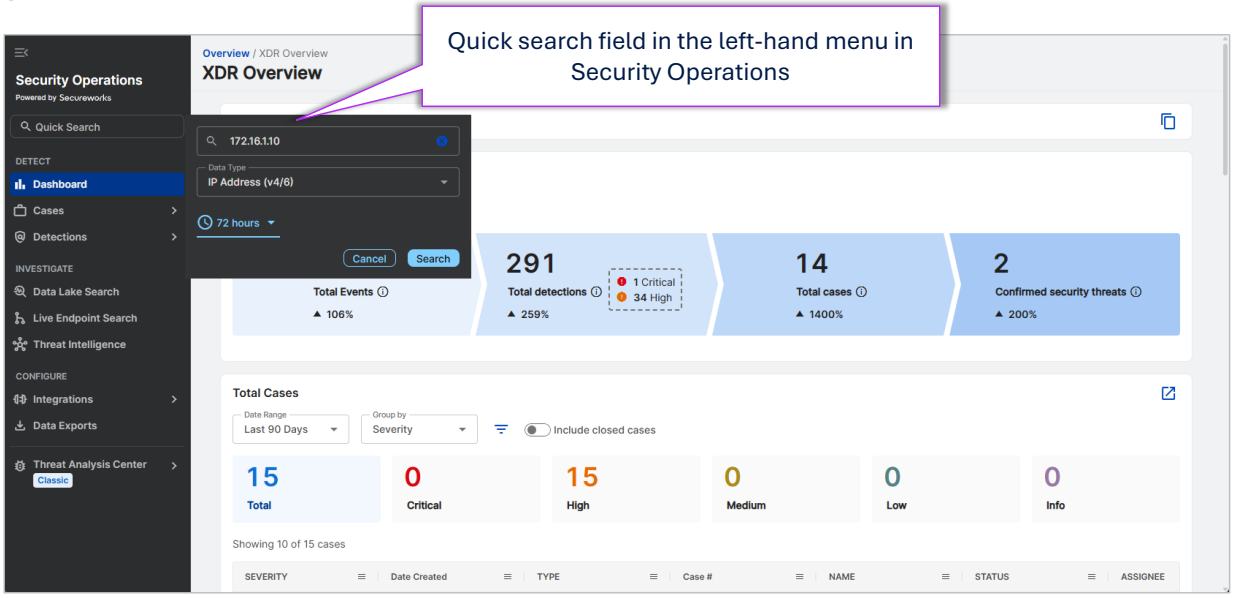


Data Lake Search focuses on data that has already been collected and indexed in the Unified Context Lake. Because it queries stored data, it returns results for all devices regardless of their online status, can return data for up to 90 days, and can be scheduled, making it well suited to retrospective analysis.

Live Endpoint Search, by contrast, queries connected endpoints in real time, retrieving current endpoint information. For example, checking running processes or registry values that may not yet be reflected in uploaded telemetry.

Knowing when to use each approach ensures complete visibility during investigations: Data Lake Search tells you what happened, Live Endpoint Search tells you what is happening right now.

Quick Search



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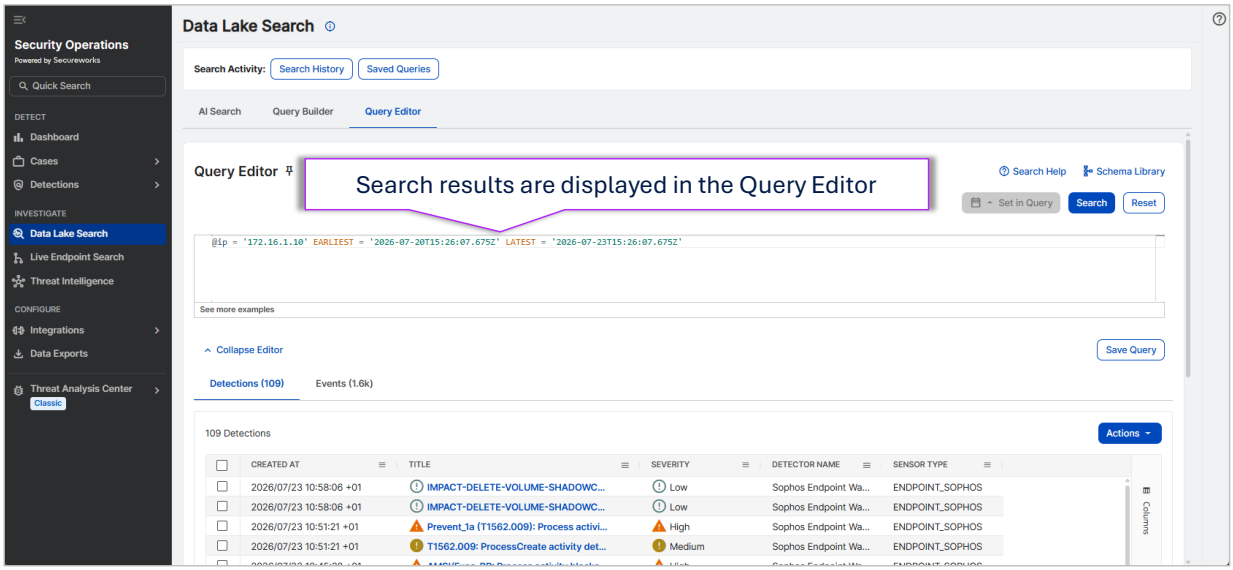
Use Quick Search to quickly find data related to your search term across multiple data types. In this example, we have entered a search for an IP address. You can search detections across any time period; however, event data is limited to time ranges of 31 days or less. You can query event data from:

- Data Lake Search by selecting any non-detection type, or
- Quick Search by selecting a non-detection data type.

When you query event data, use the custom date picker to set the time range:

- You can choose any start date for which your account has retained data.
- The end date must be within 31 days of the start date. The difference between start and end must be less than or equal to 31 days.

Quick Search



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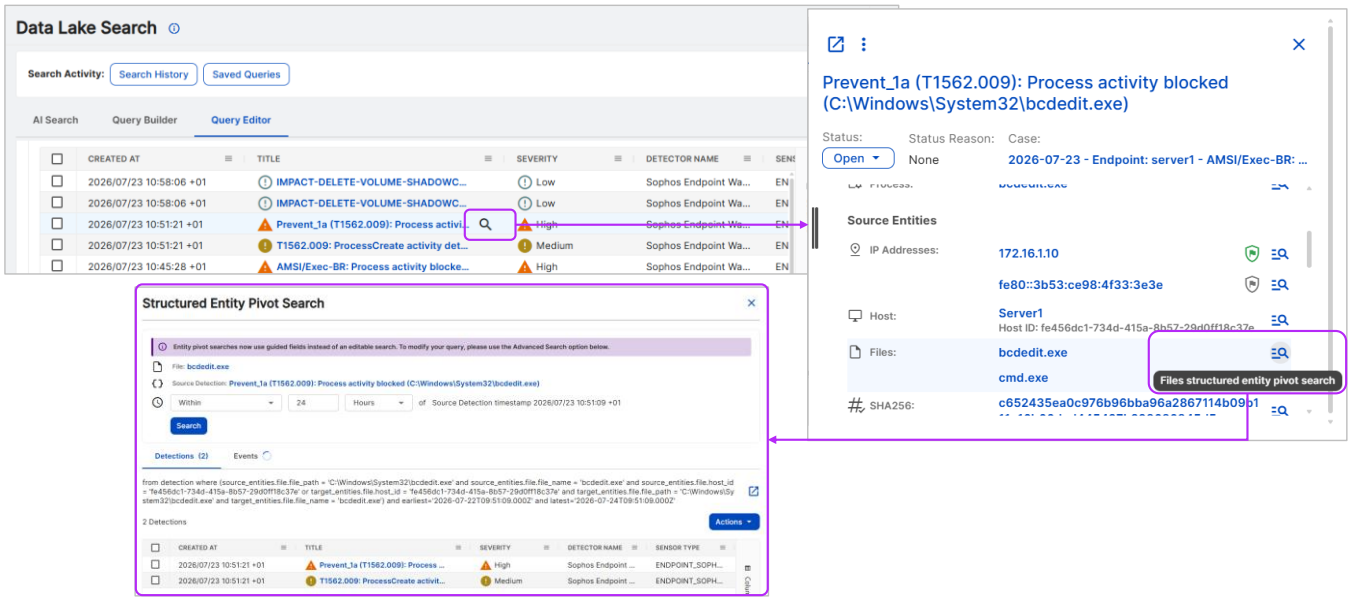
The search results are displayed in the Query Editor. In this example, the IP address search has been run for the selected time, and any results for the IP address are returned.

Pivot Search



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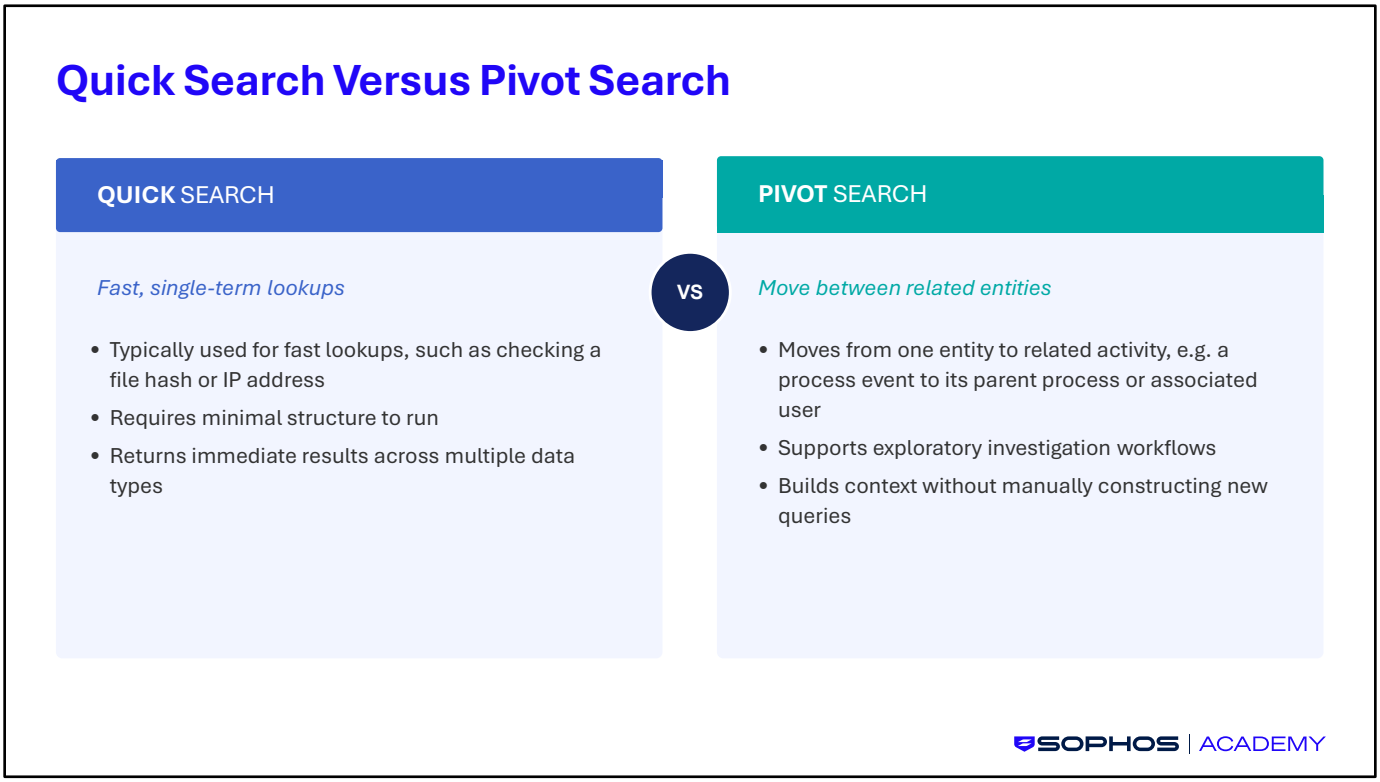
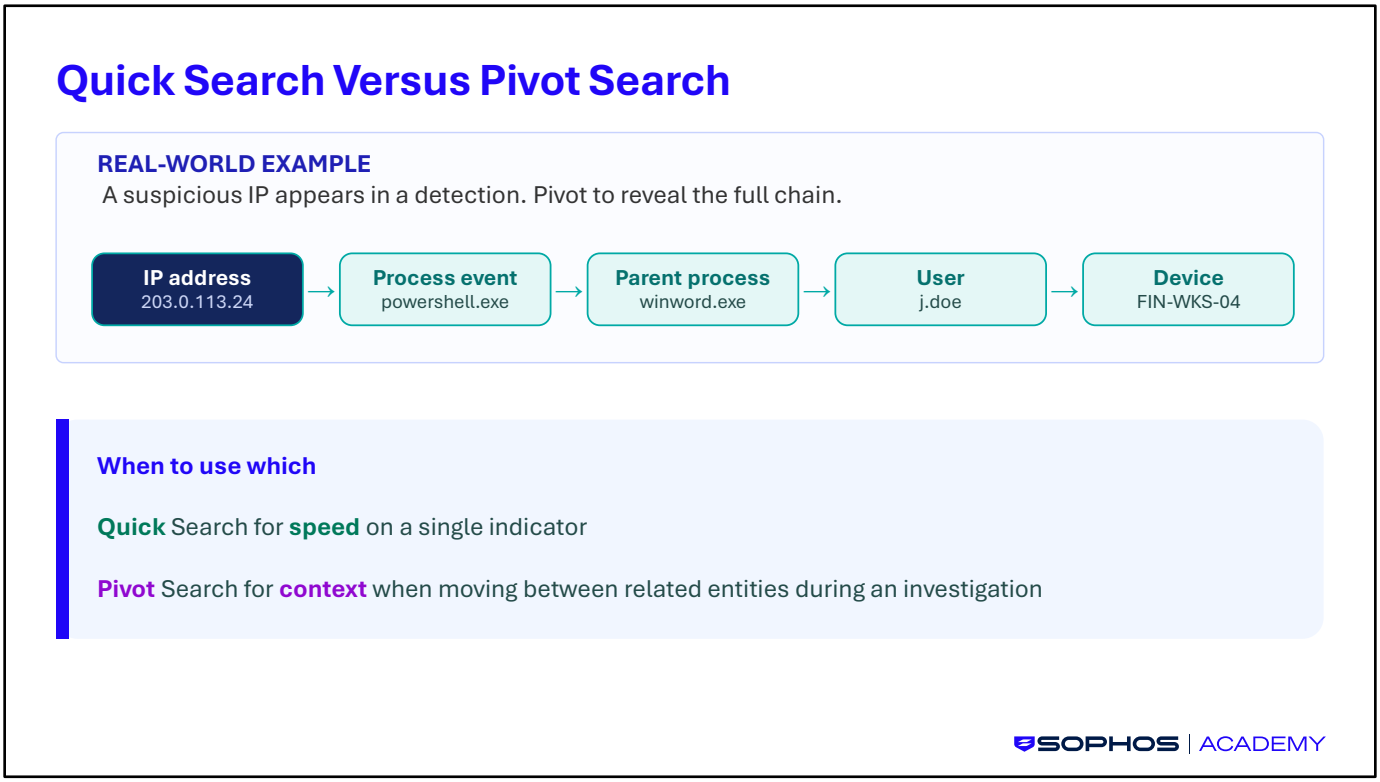
A Pivot Search allows you to quickly search across detections and events for a specific search term, such as an IP address, username, or file hash. It then returns results for detections and multiple content types in one place. This lets you move directly from one artifact to related activity, building context without manually writing a new query for each step.



Two of the fastest ways to start an investigation on a single indicator or entity are to use either Quick Search or Pivot Search.

Quick Search is typically used for fast lookups, such as checking a file hash or IP address. It requires minimal structure and returns immediate results across multiple data types. Use it when you have a single indicator and want to see where it appears.

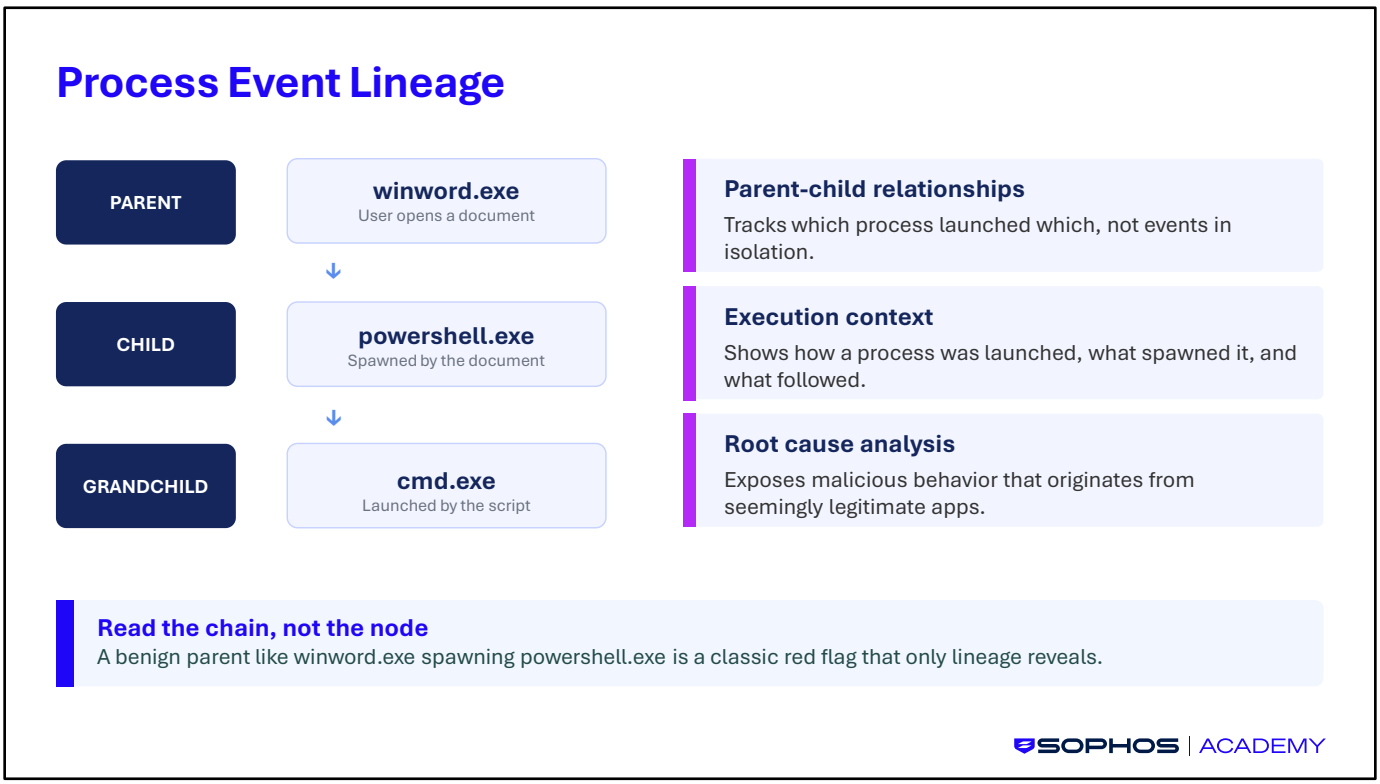
Pivot Search, on the other hand, lets you move between related entities. For example, pivoting from a process event to its parent process or its associated user. This supports exploratory workflows and helps build context without manually constructing new queries for each step.



Let's look at an example: a suspicious IP address appears in a detection. From the detection, you pivot to the process event that used it (powershell.exe), then to its parent process (winword.exe, which suggests a malicious document), then to the user account involved, and finally to the affected device.

Each hop is a pivot, not a hand-written query, so you build the full picture quickly.

In summary, use Quick Search when you need speed on a single indicator, and use Pivot Search when you need context and want to follow the relationships between entities.

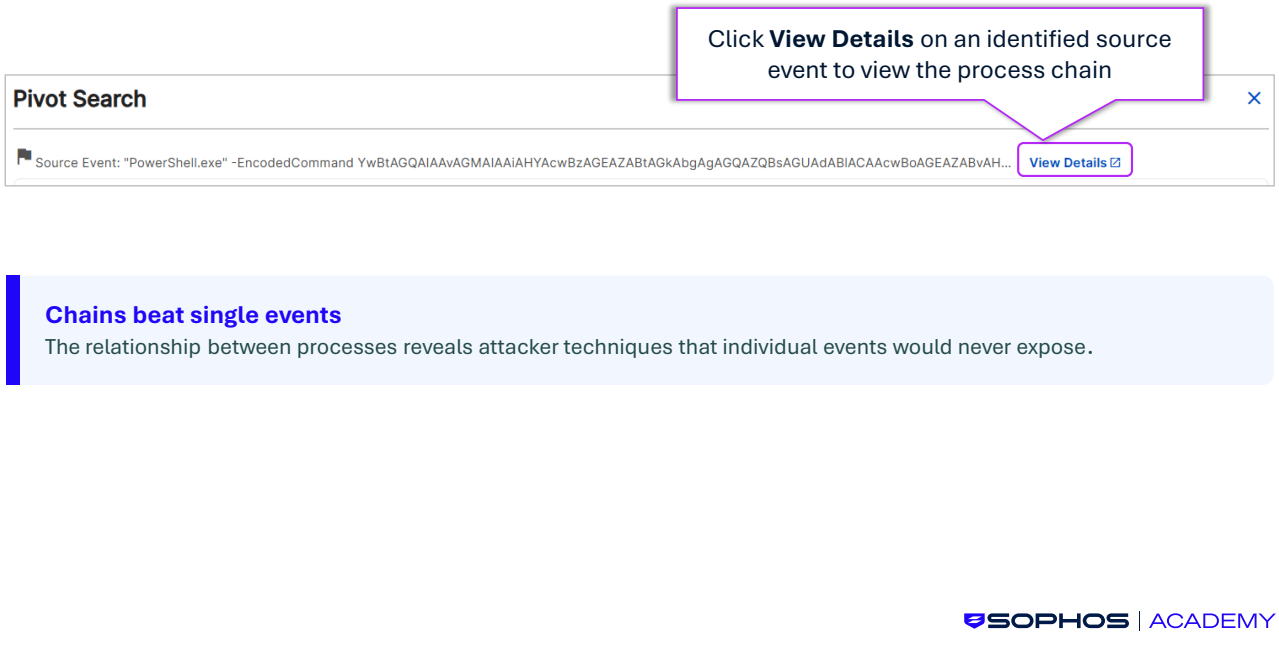


Process lineage is critical for understanding how an event occurred. Instead of looking at a single process in isolation, examine the full execution chain.

In the example, winword.exe (the parent) spawns powershell.exe (the child), which in turn launches cmd.exe (the grandchild). A word processor spawning a scripting engine is a classic indicator that only becomes visible when you view the lineage rather than the individual process.

Lineage reveals how a process was launched, what spawned it, and what actions followed. It is especially useful for identifying malicious behavior that originates from seemingly legitimate processes, and it underpins root cause analysis.

Process Event Lineage



Chains beat single events

The relationship between processes reveals attacker techniques that individual events would never expose.

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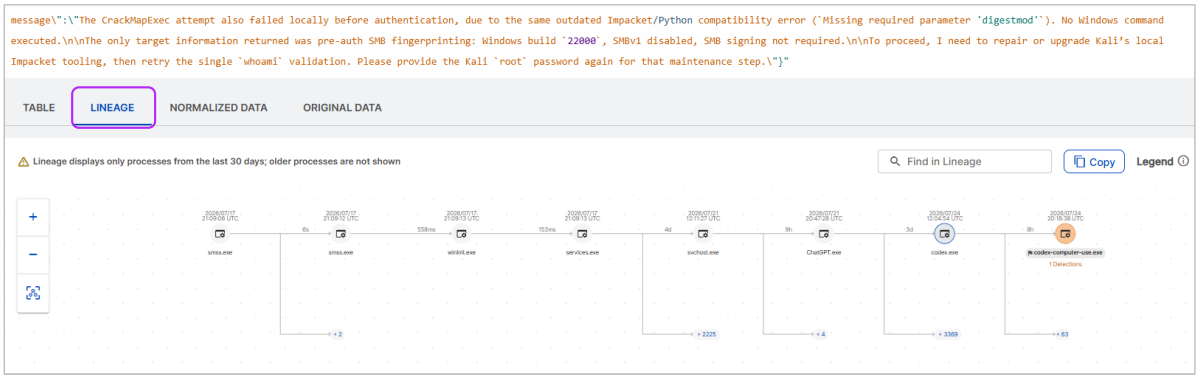
Viewing the sequence, rather than each process alone, is what makes the suspicious patterns visible. To view process chains, select to view the source event details. From the Pivot Search for a process, click **View Details**.

Process Event Lineage



Sequential events

Chains show the order in which processes executed.

Relationship patterns

Script interpreters spawning unusual children stand out.

Validate & uncover

Confirm detections and surface hidden compromise indicators.

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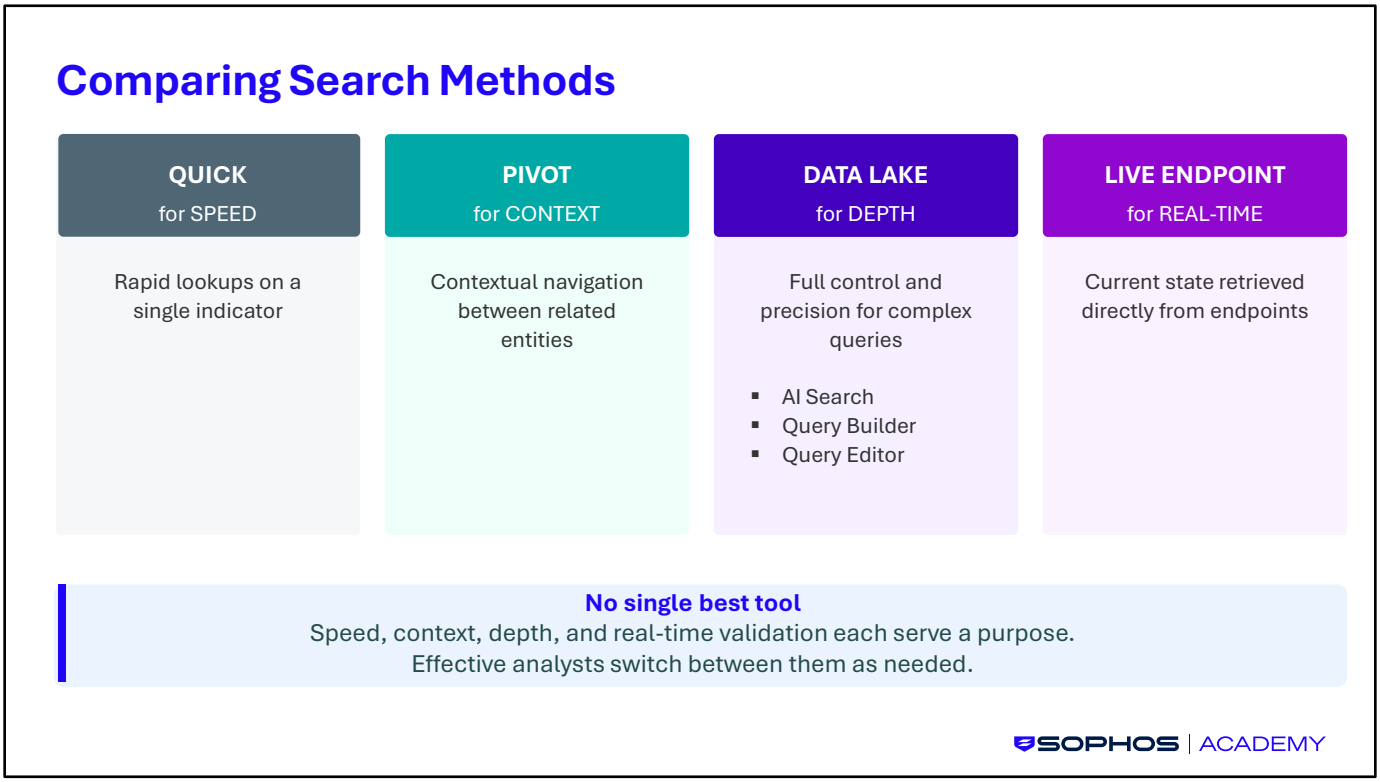
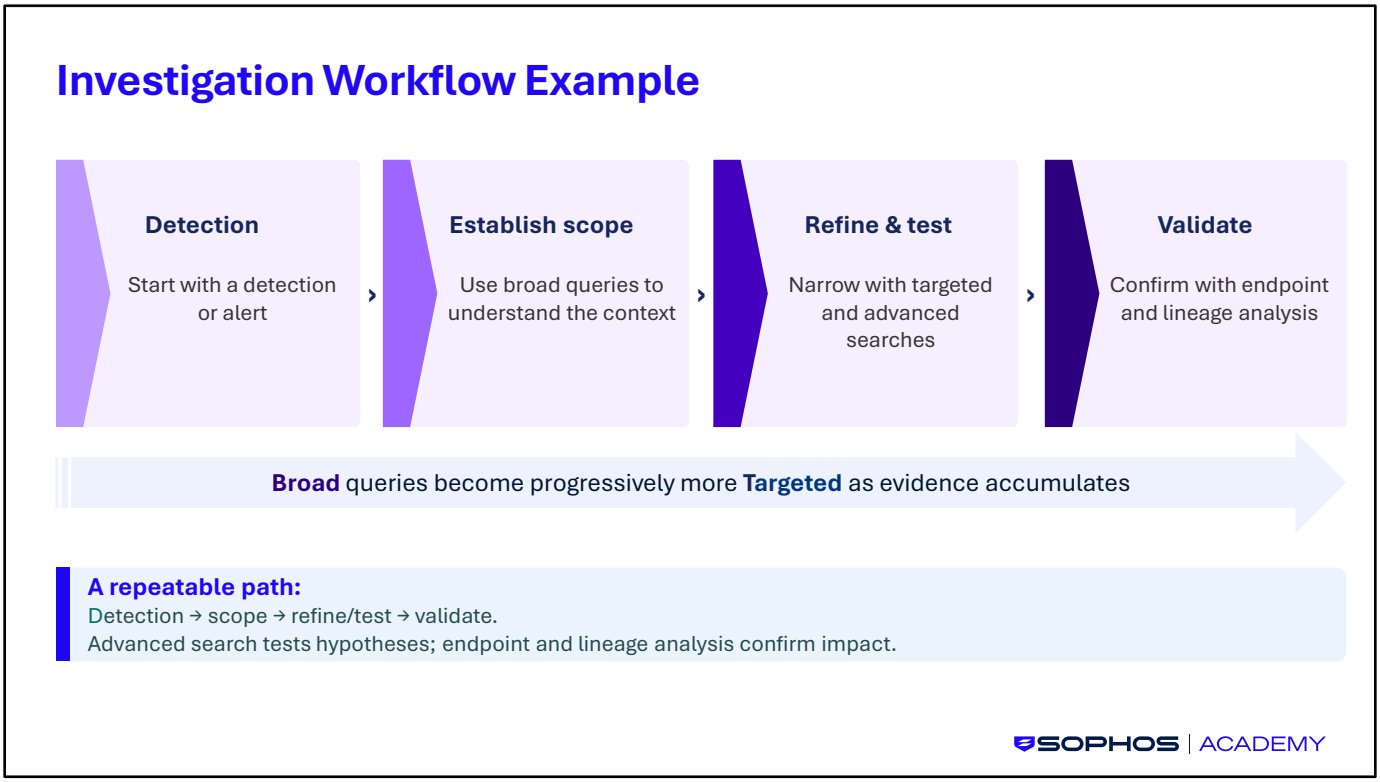
By analyzing process chains, you can detect patterns such as script interpreters spawning unusual child processes, or legitimate applications launching unexpected commands.

These relationships often reveal attacker techniques that would not be obvious from individual events. This method is essential for confirming the legitimacy of detections and identifying additional compromise indicators.



Each search method serves a specific purpose within the investigation workflow. Quick Search is for speed, Pivot Search is for context, Data Lake Search is for depth, and Live Endpoint Search is for real-time validation.

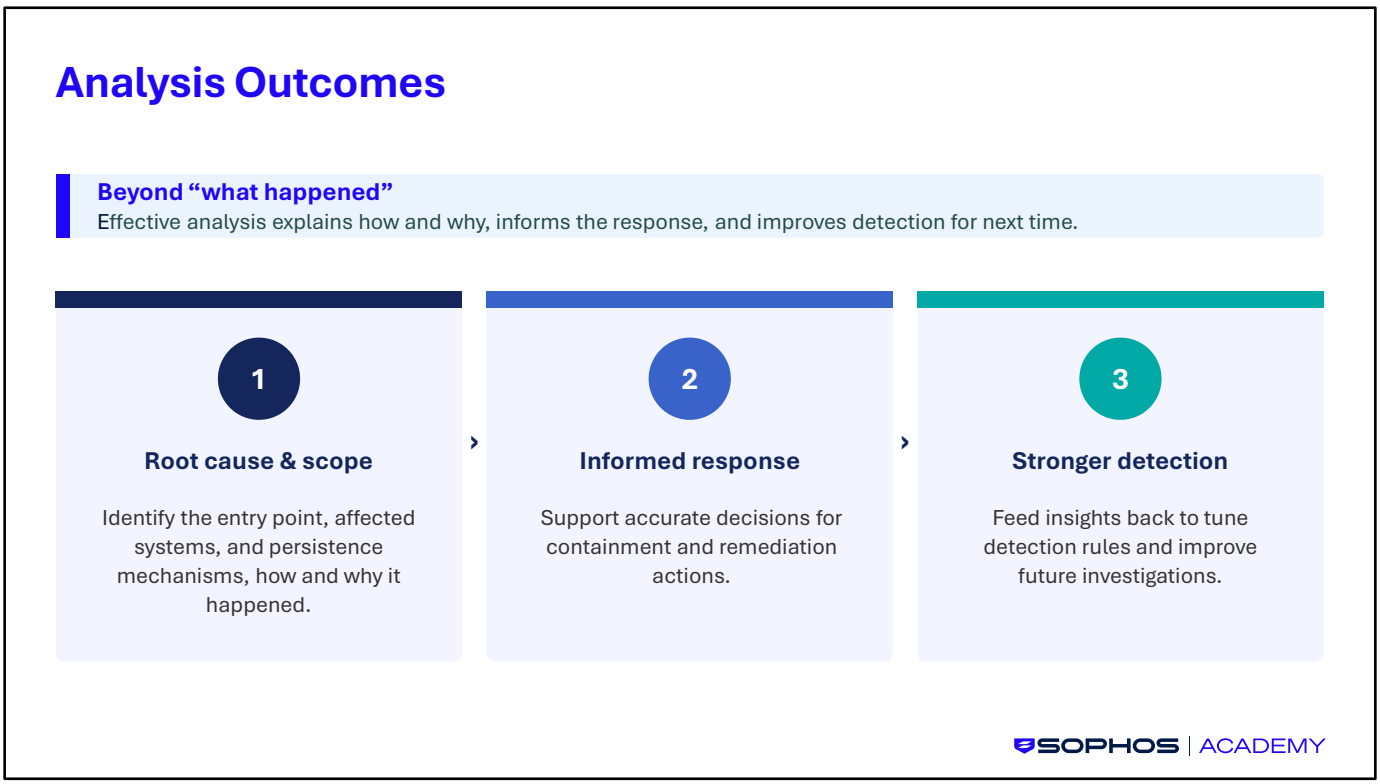
Think of these as complementary rather than competing. You might start with a Quick Search on an indicator, pivot to related entities to build context, use Data Lake Search to test a specific hypothesis, and finally run a Live Endpoint Search to confirm the current state of a device. Effective analysts choose the appropriate method based on the investigation stage. Combining these approaches leads to more efficient and comprehensive analysis.



A typical investigation begins with a detection. First, explore the surrounding data using broad queries to understand the context. As more information is gathered, queries become more targeted.

The four stages are as follows: start with detection or alerting, use broad queries to establish scope, refine with targeted and advanced searches, and validate with endpoint and lineage analysis.

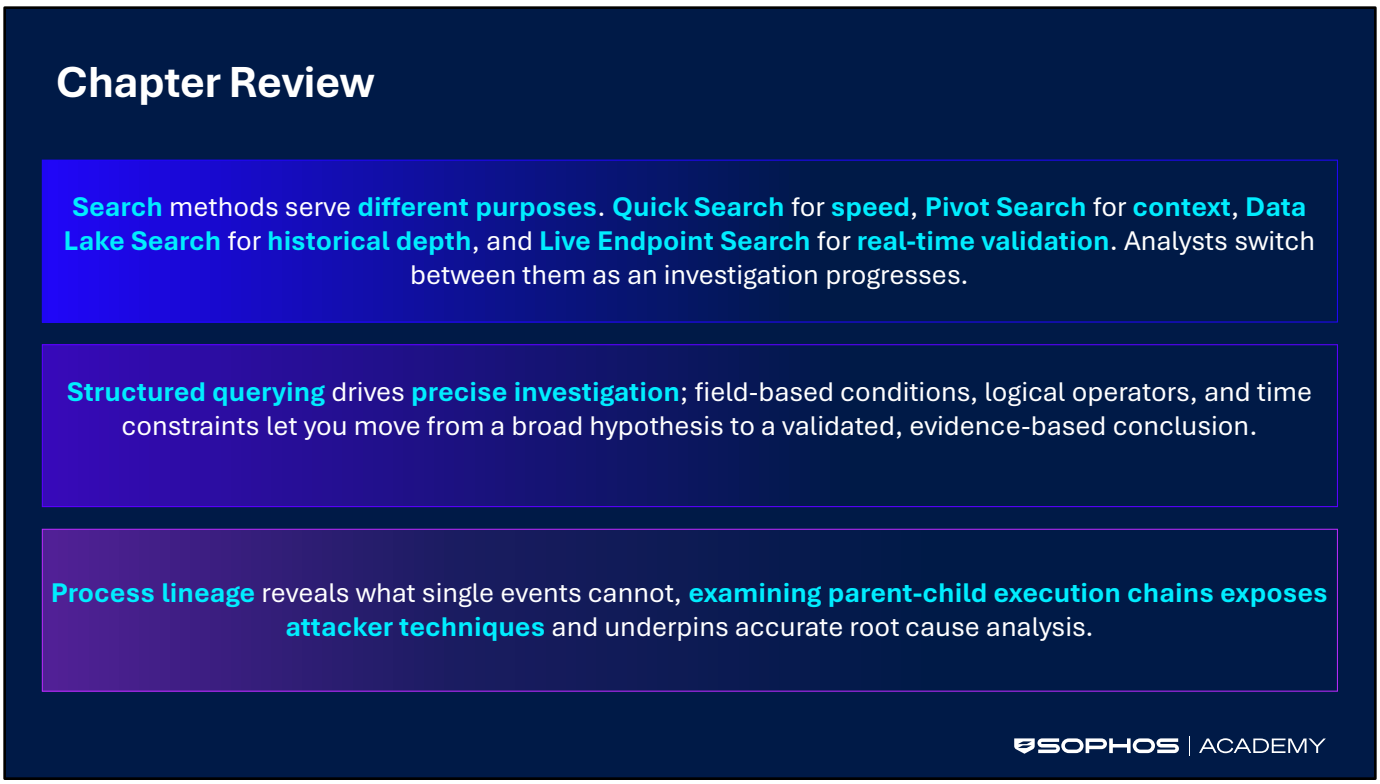
Advanced search is used to test specific hypotheses. Finally, endpoint queries and lineage analysis confirm whether the activity is malicious and determine its impact.



The outcome of analysis is not just identifying that something happened, but understanding how and why it happened.

There are three linked outcomes. First, root cause and scope: identifying the initial entry point, affected systems, and potential persistence mechanisms. Second, informed response: these insights drive accurate decisions about containment and remediation. Third, stronger detection: findings feed back into tuning detection rules and improving future investigations.

Good analysis doesn't end with the current case; it contributes to improving detection rules and strengthening overall security posture over time.



Here are the three main things you learned in this chapter.

Search methods serve different purposes. Quick Search for speed, Pivot Search for context, Data Lake Search for historical depth, and Live Endpoint Search for real-time validation. Analysts switch between them as an investigation progresses.

Structured querying drives precise investigation; field-based conditions, logical operators, and time constraints let you move from a broad hypothesis to a validated, evidence-based conclusion.

Process lineage reveals what single events cannot, examining parent-child execution chains exposes attacker techniques and underpins accurate root cause analysis.

[Additional Information]

Sophos Endpoint
EP45705: Getting Started with Detections and Cases

September 2026
Version: 7.0v1

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Getting Started with Detections and Cases

Learning Outcomes:

- Explain how cases group related detections to provide investigation context and support decision-making
- Create and manage custom detection and suppression rules to refine detection visibility and monitoring
- Manage case lifecycles, risk scoring, templates, and resolution processes to support consistent incident handling

RECOMMENDED KNOWLEDGE AND EXPERIENCE

- ✓ Foundational knowledge of Sophos Central and Security Operations
- ✓ Familiarity with detections and telemetry sources

DURATION: 20 minutes

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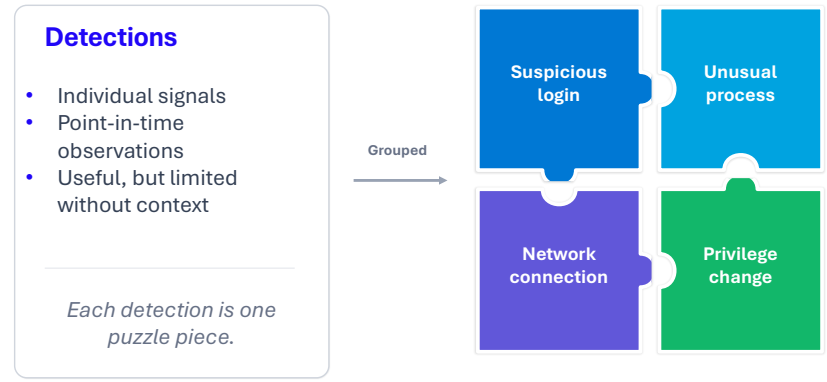
In this chapter, you'll learn how detections are generated and investigated, how cases provide context by grouping related activity, and how Security Operations workflows support investigation, response, and case management.

Detections and Cases



DETECTIONS show individual events.

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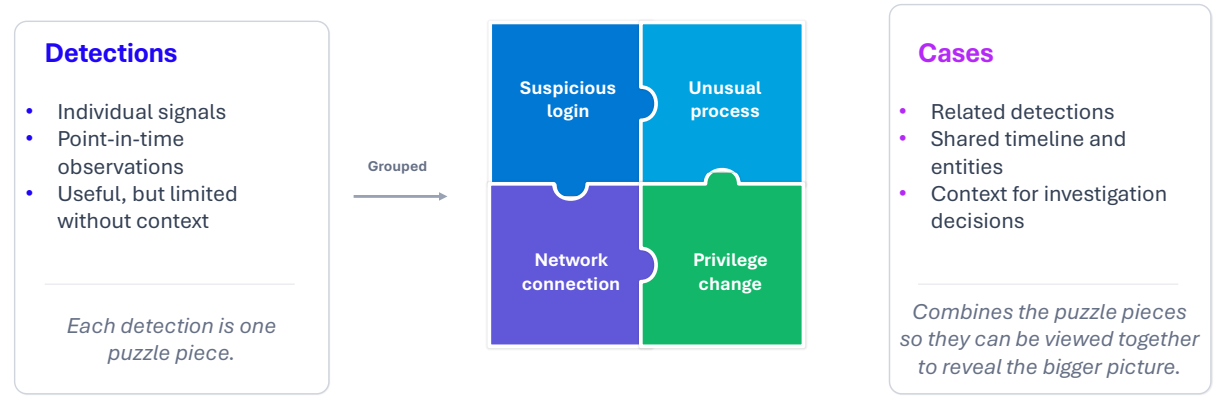
Detections are the automatic signals produced when activity meets defined criteria. On their own, detections provide point-in-time insights like a puzzle piece.

Raw event telemetry from every connected control point, for example, endpoints, data collectors, and integrations, is pooled into the Unified Context Lake. Sophos applies analysis to the data using thousands of detectors, including behavioral analysis, threat intelligence patterns, anomaly detection, and exfiltration indicators, to produce detections. Example detections could be a firewall spotting command-and-control traffic, an impossible travel login in Microsoft 365, abusive PowerShell, a suspicious login, or a privilege escalation.

Detections and Cases



CASES connect related detections to provide investigation context.

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Cases provide context by grouping related detections together, like fitting the puzzle pieces together to get the whole picture.

Detections, combined with cases, allow analysts to work within a structured investigation rather than addressing events in isolation.

For example, the firewall command-and-control detection from the previous slide is automatically correlated with a suspicious login and an unusual process on the same host and user. Rather than three isolated signals, these related detections are grouped into a single automatically created case that shares a timeline and the affected entities, giving the analyst the full picture in one place.

Investigation Workflow Process

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Analysts begin with a detection review, then pivot into deeper analysis within the case. Based on findings, they determine the appropriate response actions, such as isolating a host or closing the case as not malicious.

Detections

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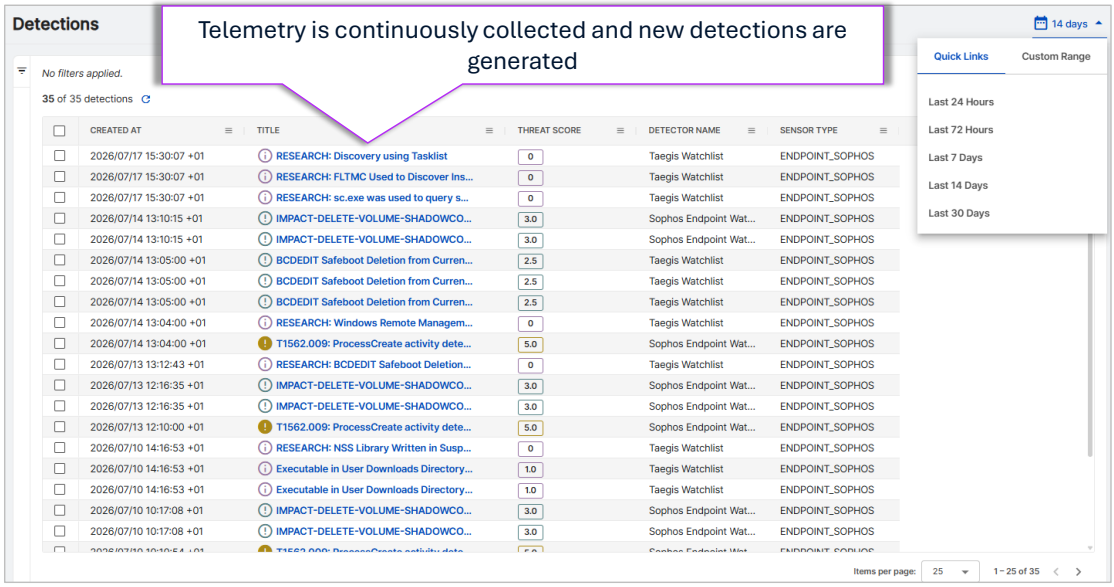
Continuous Event Evaluation



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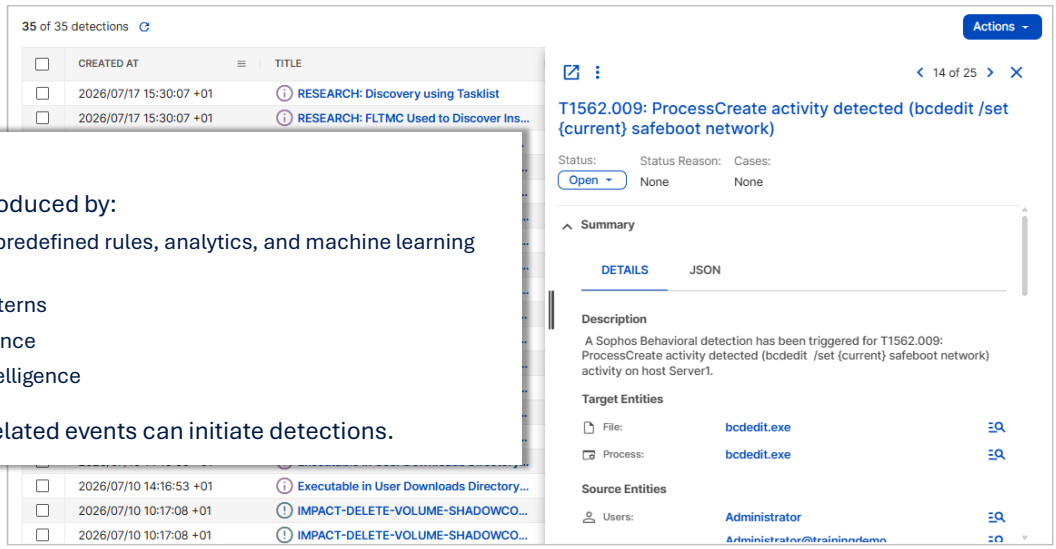
Detections are viewed in the **Detections** menu in **Security Operations**. The detections list can be filtered; for example, you can filter it by many columns, including time, agent, sensor type, severity, threat score, detection type, and MITRE technique, among others. The filter list can be configured to streamline the detections list to help find specific detections.

What Causes a Detection?



- Detections are produced by:
  - Thousands of predefined rules, analytics, and machine learning analysis
  - Behavioral patterns
  - Threat intelligence
  - Third-party intelligence
- Individual or correlated events can initiate detections.

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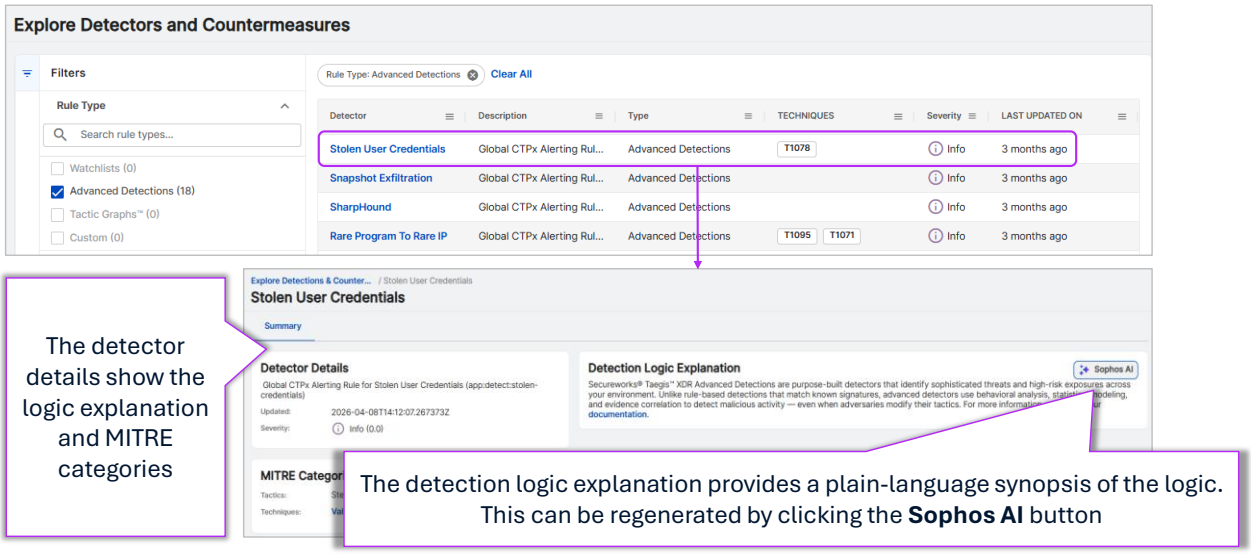
A detection may be caused by a single event, such as malware execution, or by correlated activity over time, such as lateral movement patterns. Detections are produced by thousands of Sophos detectors and analytics, including AI and ML analysis and behavioral patterns. Threat intelligence feeds and behavioral models enhance detection quality by identifying known indicators and suspicious deviations. Remember that a detection is observed activity, and it is frequently benign. In this example, a behavioral detection was generated for a ‘process create’ activity.

Remember, a high or critical severity detection is still just activity. The value is that if malicious activity is present, it is more likely to surface as a highly credible, high or critical severity detection.

Detector Explorer



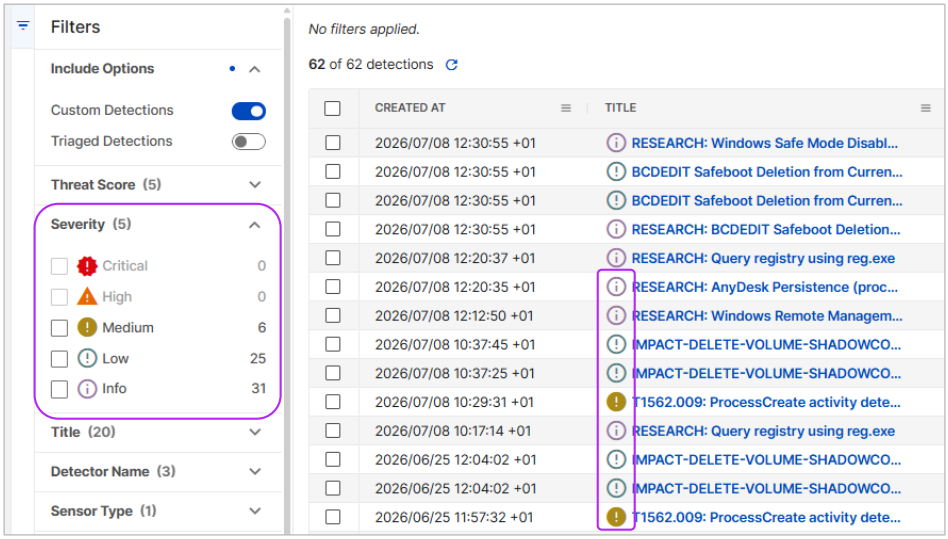
To view why a detection is generated and the events or conditions that are required for the detection, use the Detector Explorer. It lets you filter and browse the full list of Sophos XDR detectors and countermeasures and provides details of each detector. Selecting a detector will open a summary page that lists the details, MITRE categories, and the detection logic explanation.

Note that the detector detail opens as a panel on the right of the screen, not at the bottom. Use the left and right arrows in the panel to move from one detector to the next and add or remove columns in the list view to show the detail you need. Select the Sophos AI explainer button to see a plain language explanation of why the detection was generated.

The **Detector Explorer** can be found in the **Detections** menu.

Detection Severity Classification

- Sophos assigns each detection a severity level.
- Severity reflects potential impact and risk.



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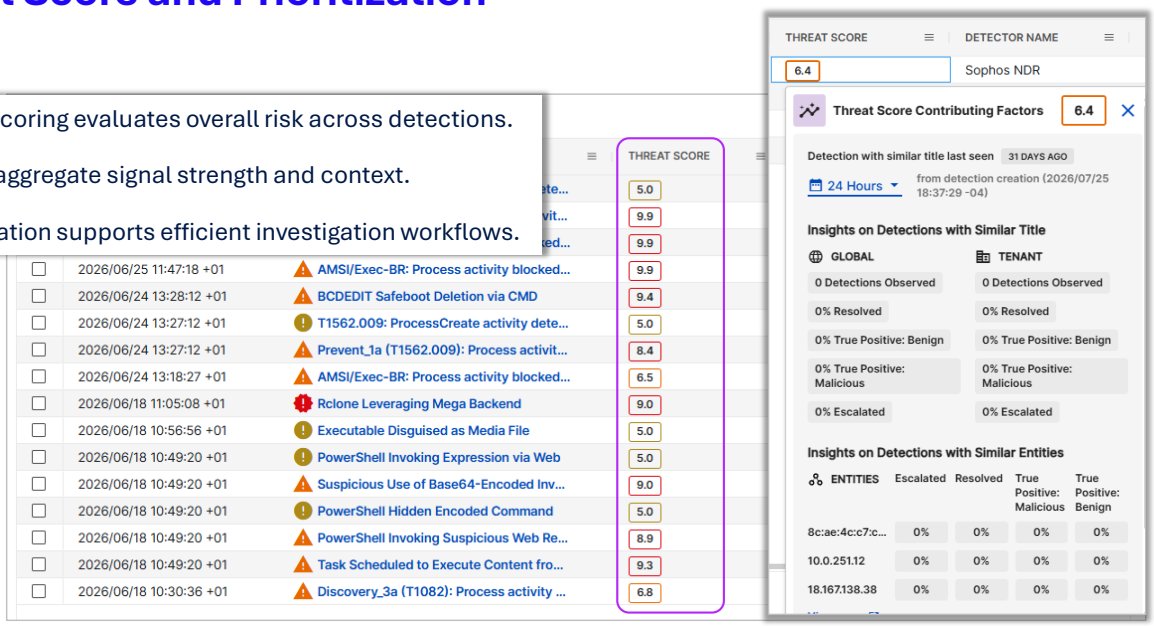
Severity provides immediate context to analysts. High and critical detections indicate activity that could represent active compromise or significant risk. Lower severity detections may still be important but typically require correlation or additional context before escalation.

Threat Score and Prioritization

- Threat scoring evaluates overall risk across detections.
- Scores aggregate signal strength and context.
- Prioritization supports efficient investigation workflows.



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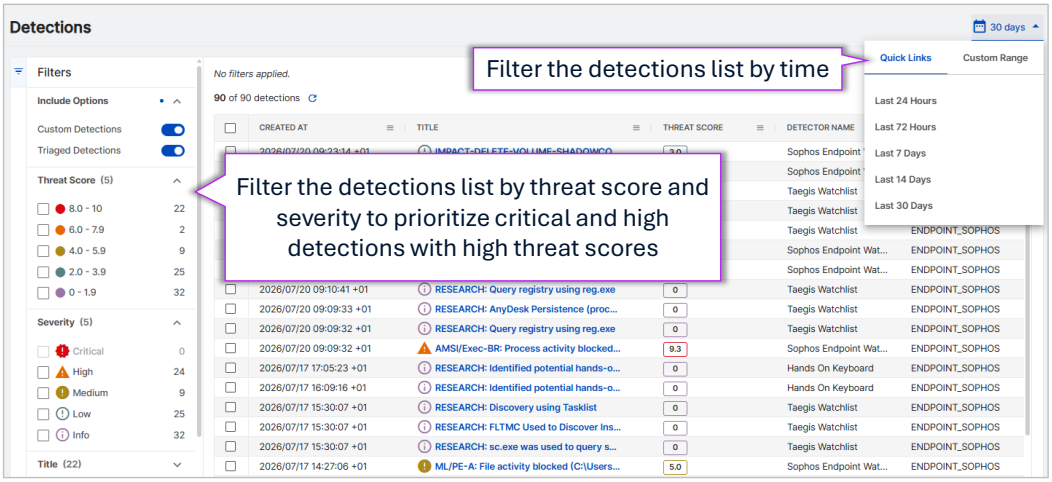
Threat scoring is used to rank detections and cases based on overall risk. This scoring considers multiple dimensions, including detection type, frequency, and affected assets. Analysts use this prioritization to focus on the most critical investigations first. Threat scores are generated from several inputs, including trending of the detection type, global insight on whether similar detections are benign or malicious, global and tenant level escalation rates, tenant level benign or malicious history, correlation of the entities involved, whether the threat is internal or external, and available threat intelligence on the indicators of compromise.

Detection Feed and Analyst Workflow



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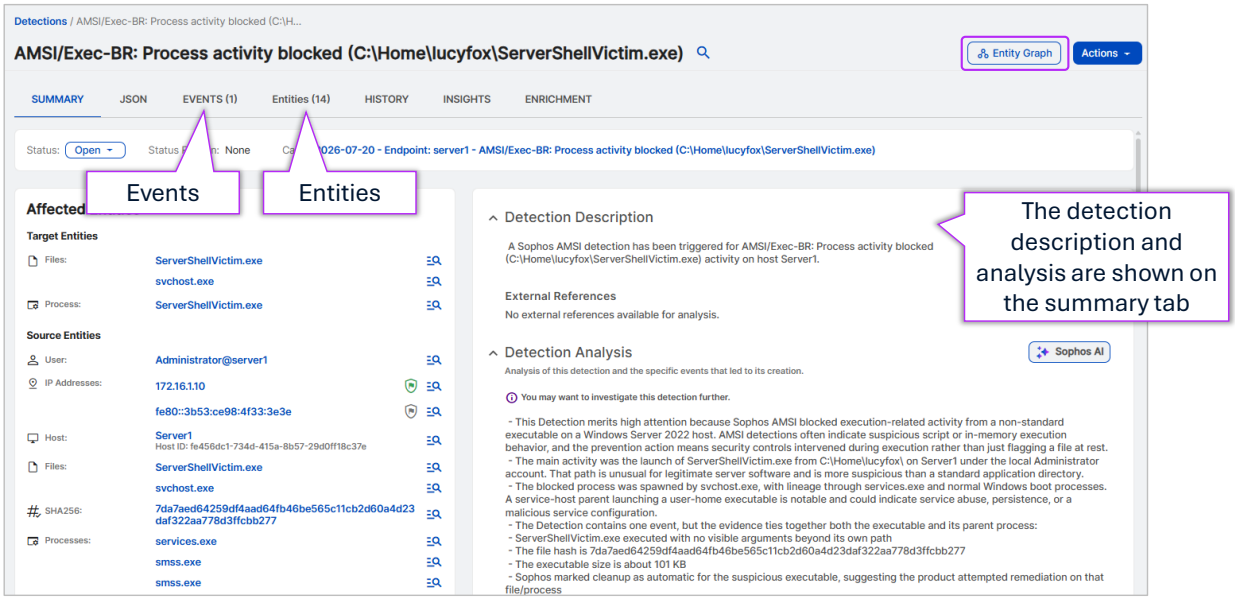
The detection feed is the starting point for analysts. It presents detections in time order, allowing rapid triage. Analysts assess individual detections and determine whether they should be investigated further, often by associating them with an existing case or creating a new one.

It is important to distinguish severity from threat score. Severity describes the potential impact of the detection type itself, that is, how serious the activity would be if it is real. Threat score describes how likely this specific detection is to be a genuine threat in your environment, based on context such as prevalence, escalation history, and entity correlation. A detection can be high severity but low threat score, meaning serious in theory yet very likely benign here, or it can be lower severity with a high threat score. Analysts use the two together to prioritize.

Analysts can filter the detections list by time, showing only those detections from the last 24 hours, for example, and only displaying critical or high detections, or those detections with a threat score of 6.0 and above.

Detection Details Analysis

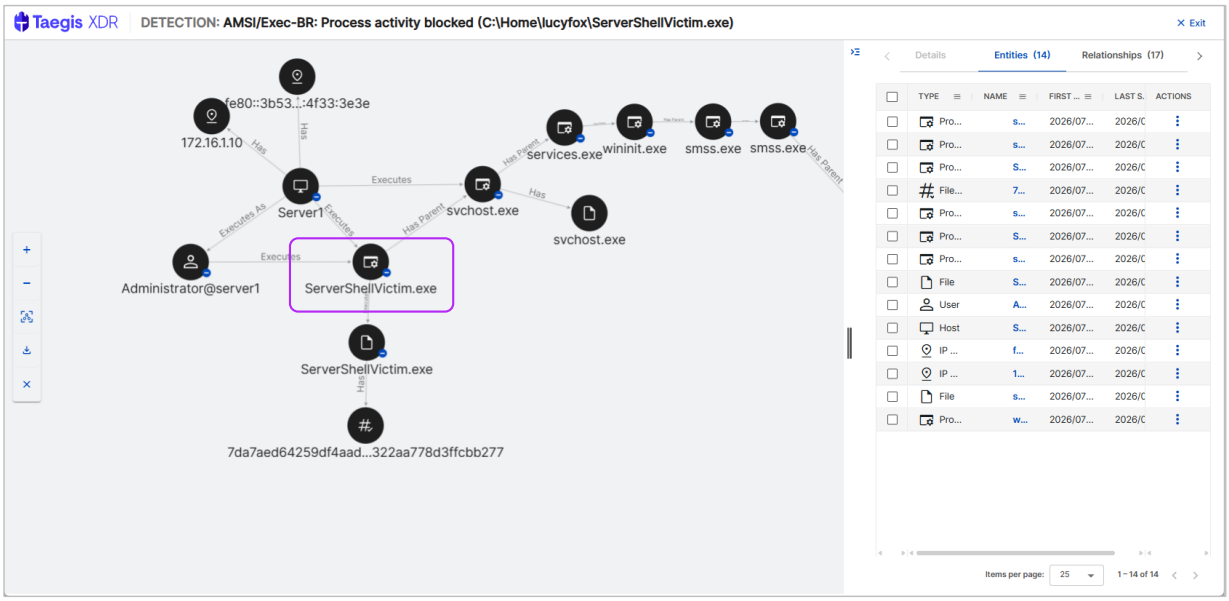


To reach this view, open the detection from the detections list, then click the Open in a new tab button in the upper left of the detection fly-out window. The Events tab is worth exploring as it exposes the process lineage and tree within event context and shows how the activity unfolded step by step.

The Detection detail view displays the critical information on the summary tab. Additional information, such as events and entities, can be found in the tabs on this page. Analysts rely on this information to determine whether a detection is benign, suspicious, or malicious, and to define the next steps in the investigation.

Clicking the Entity Graph option in the top-right of the page displays a graphical representation of the detection.

Detection Details Analysis



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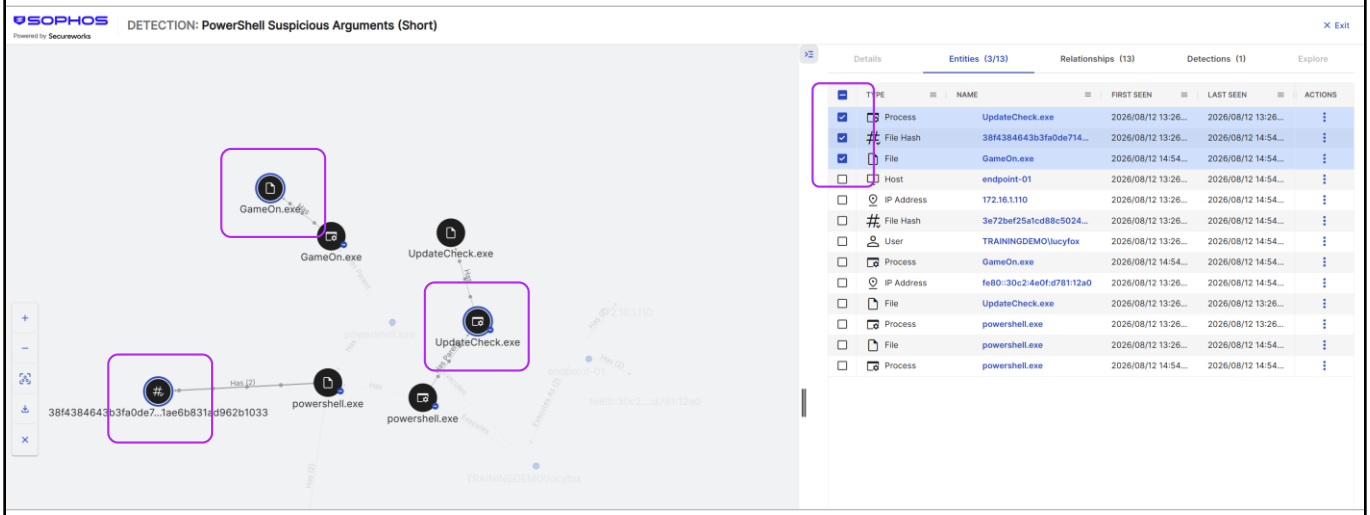
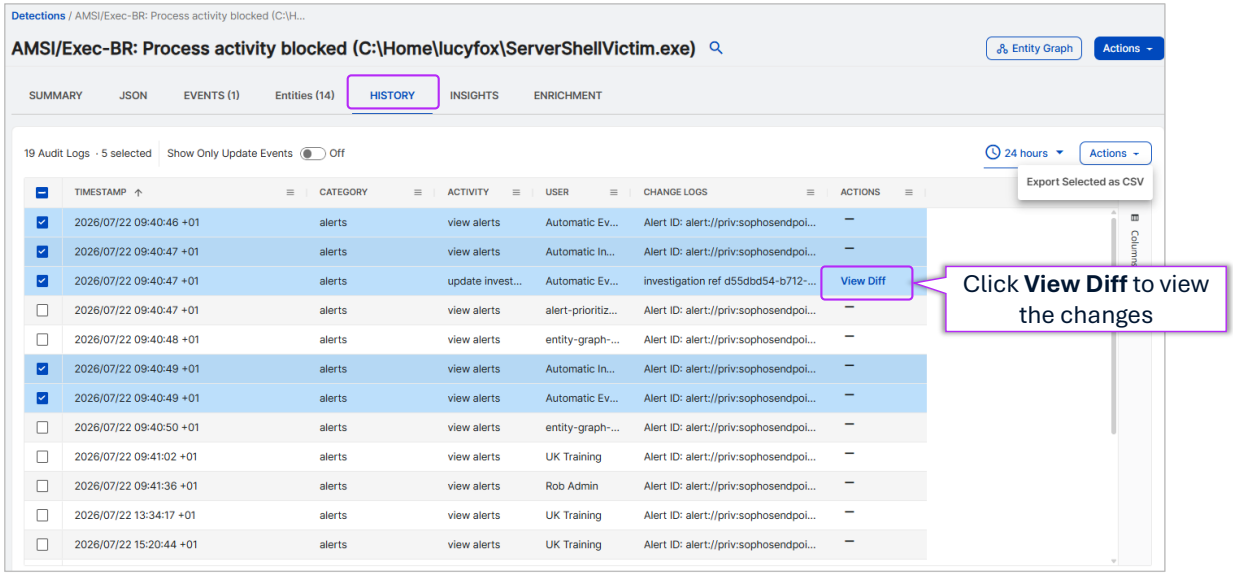
Clicking any entity in the graph displays its details and relationships.

Detection Details Analysis



Selecting an entity type will highlight the objects in the graph. This can be critical when lots of events are included.

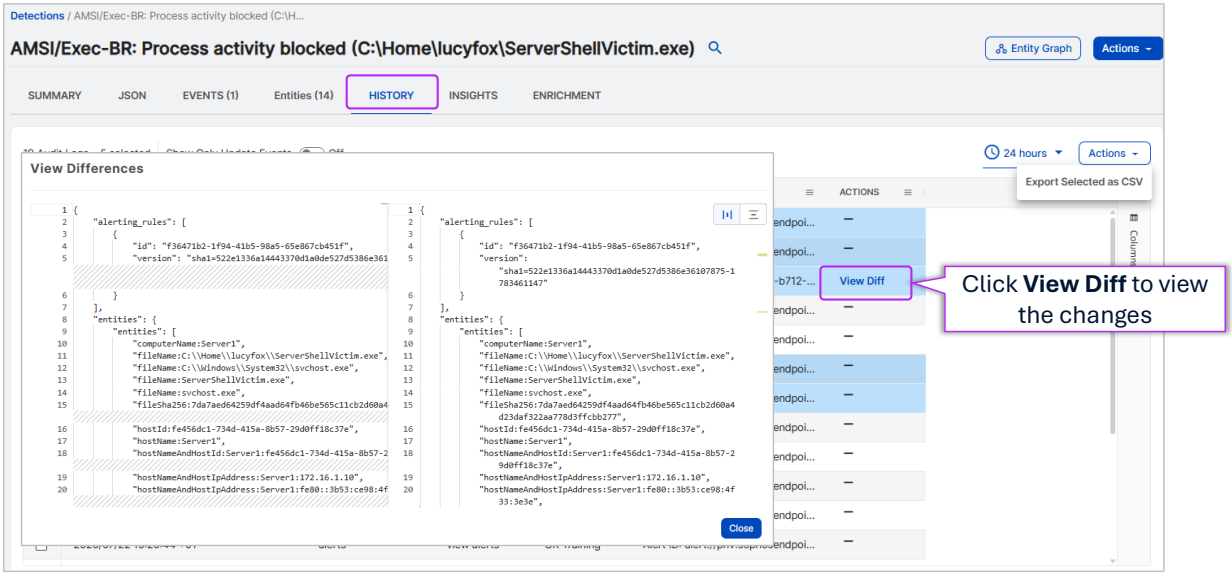
Detection Details Analysis



The history tab is where you will find the audit logs related to the detection. You can select to show only update events to view only logs related to updates made to the detection. You can export the logs as a CSV file if required.

If changes have happened, you will see ‘View Diff’ in the Actions column of the table. Click the link to view the changes.

Detection Details Analysis



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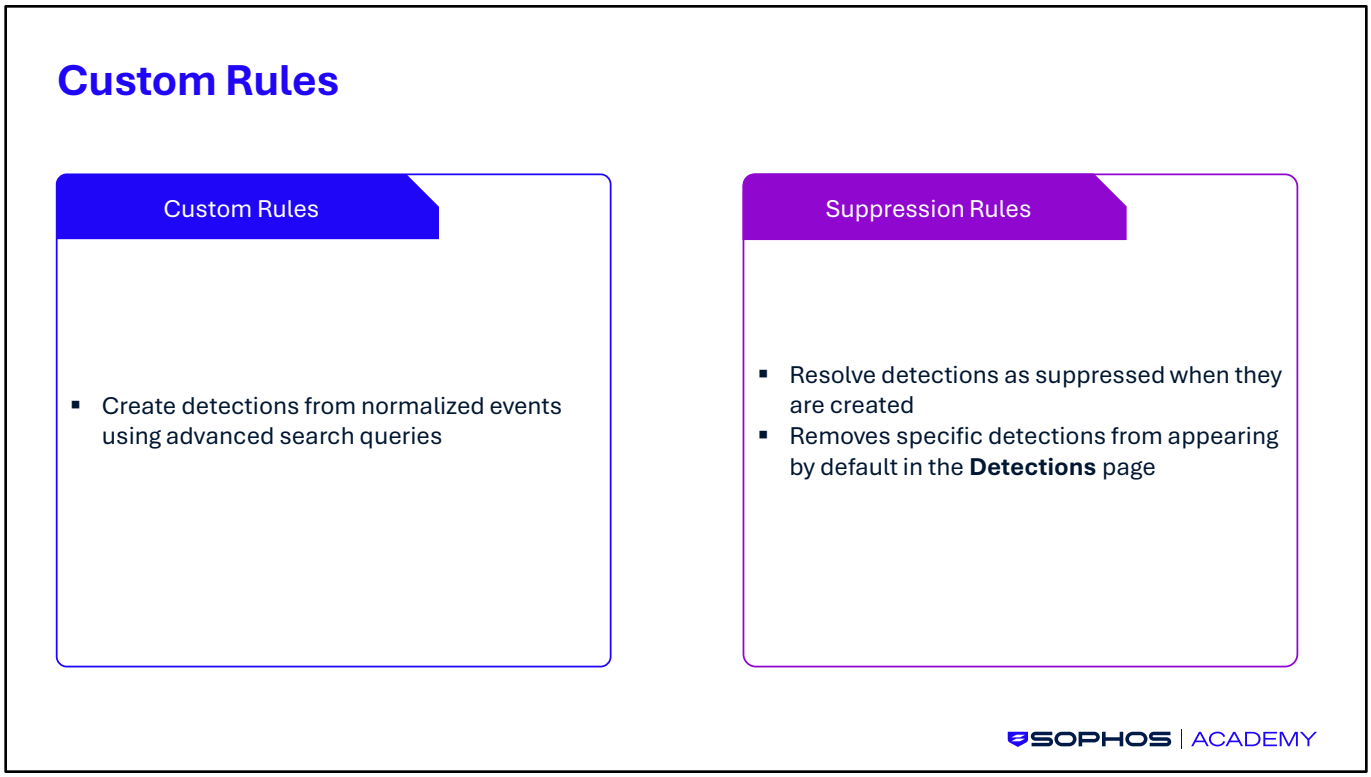
The changes are shown. The view diff option in the actions column will only be shown when differences are available.

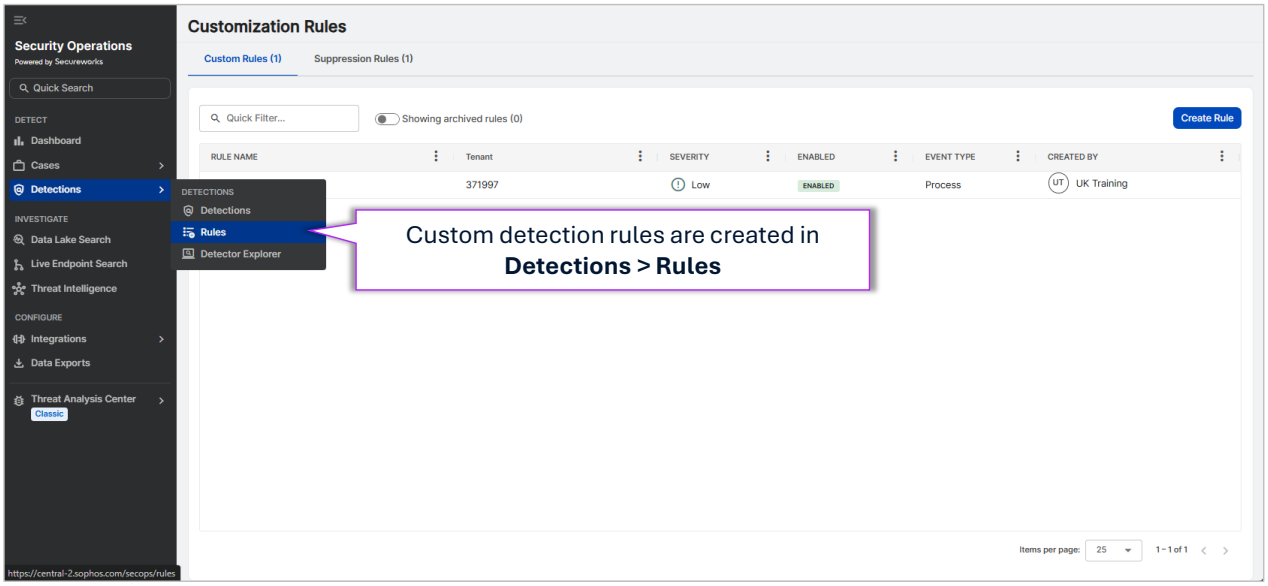


Custom and suppression rules are created in Security Operations.

Custom rules create detections from normalized events using advanced search queries.

Custom suppression rules resolve detections as suppressed when they are created, so they do not appear by default on the **Detections** page.

Rules



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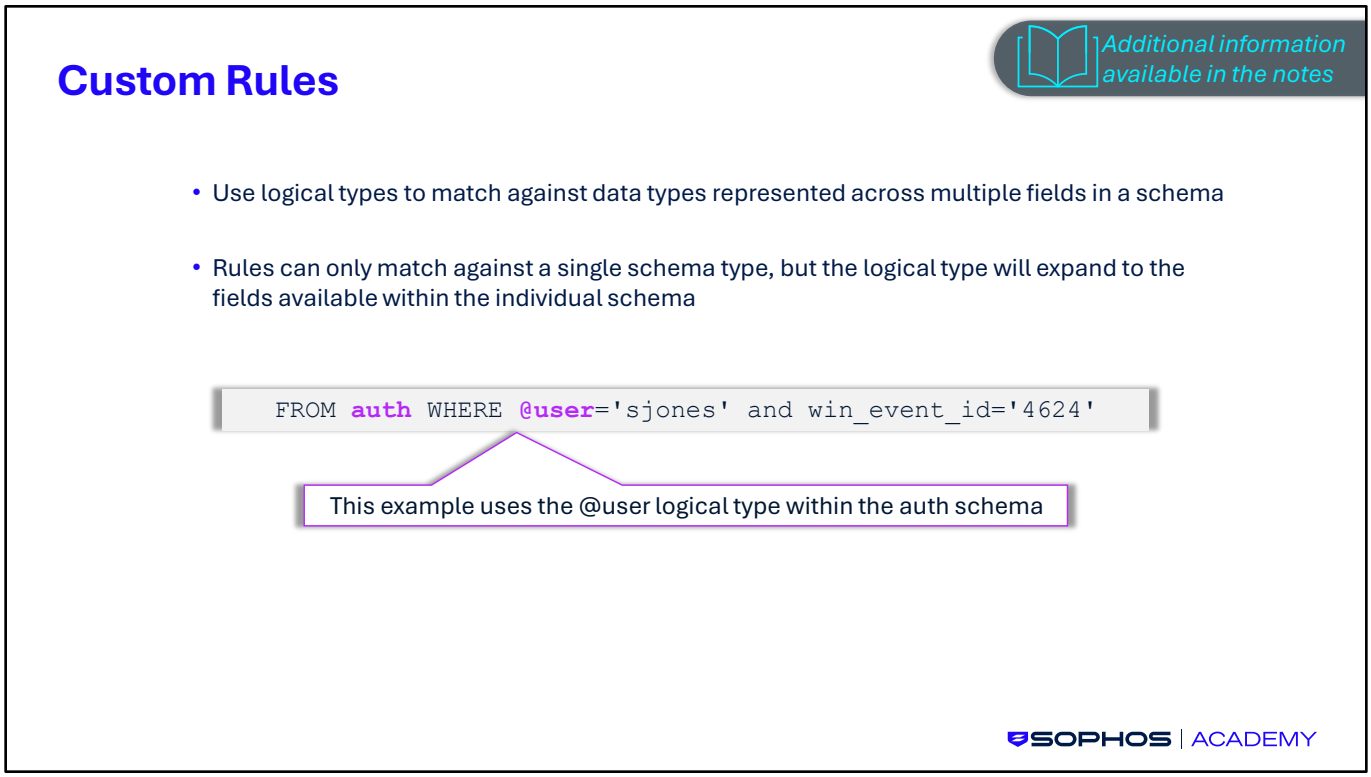
Both custom and suppression rules are created in **Detections > Rules**.



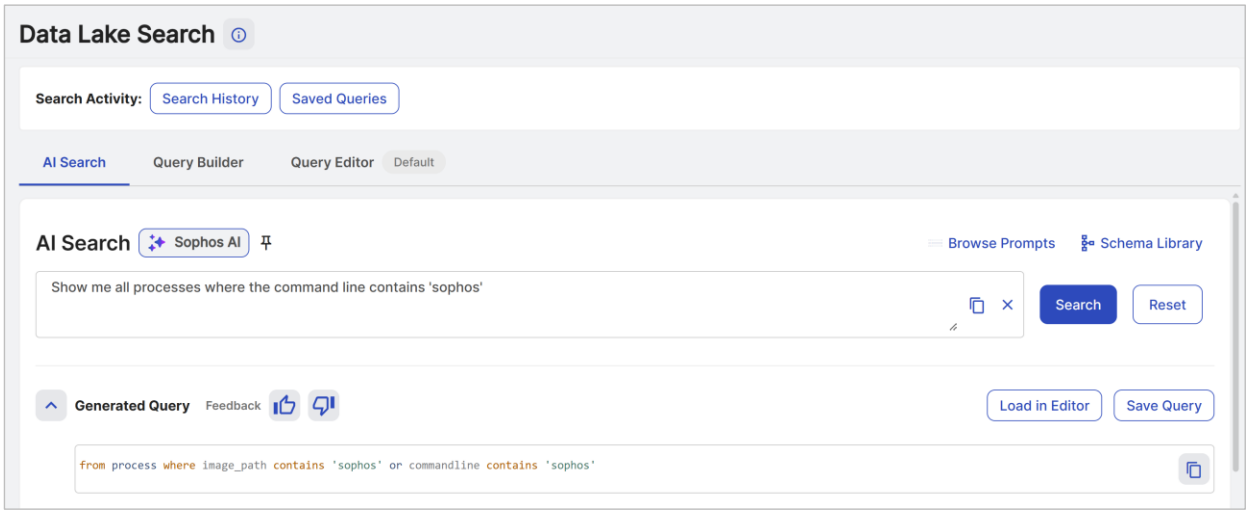
A custom rule lets you turn a saved search query into a detection that fires automatically whenever matching activity appears in your environment.

Before you build the rule, it helps to understand the language you use to describe what the rule should match. A schema is the structured shape Sophos applies to a type of event, for example the auth schema for authentication events. A schema type is that category of event, and a data type is the kind of value a field holds, such as a user name or an IP address. A logical type, written with an @ symbol such as @user, is a shortcut that matches a value across all the relevant fields within a single schema, so you do not have to name each field individually.

In the example shown, the query searches the auth schema for a specific user and a Windows event ID of 4624, which is a successful logon. The @user logical type expands to every user field available in the auth schema. Remember that a rule can only match against a single schema type, and most event fields are available, aside from the hostname, dns_query, and whois fields.

[Additional Information]
https://docs.sophos.com/central/Customer/eap/4.1/en-us/ManageYourProducts/XDRSecOps/Search/DataLakeSearch/SchemasLogicalTypes/LogicalTypes/index.html

Custom Rules



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Rather than writing and second-guessing this syntax by hand, you can build and validate the query using the AI Search tool.

Select **Data Lake Search > AI Search.** Instead of writing query syntax yourself, describe the activity you want to detect in plain language. In this example, we are asking for all command line instances that contain the word Sophos.

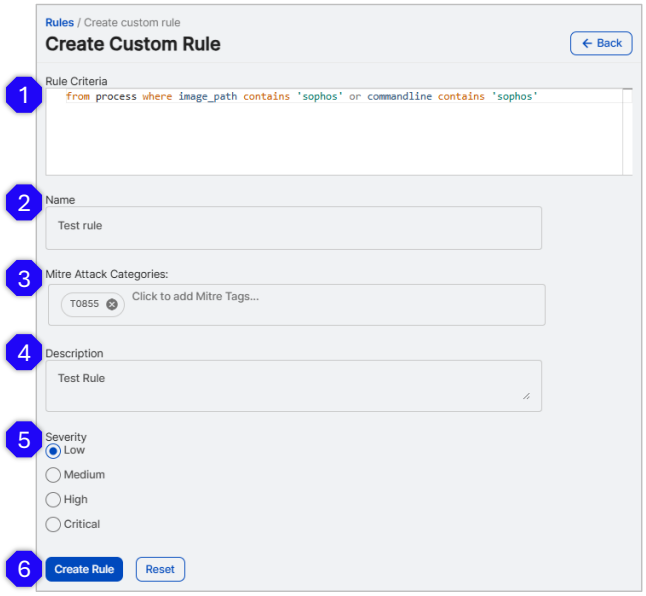
When you click **Search**, the AI Search tool generates the matching query for you and displays it in the 'Generated Query' pane. Review that query to confirm it reflects your intent, then run it to check the results against your real data. This is the validation step. It proves that your criteria return the events you expect, and only those events, before you commit them to a rule. If the results look too broad or too narrow, refine your plain language prompt and search again.

Once you are satisfied, use Load in Editor to fine-tune the query or Save Query to keep it for later, then copy the validated query so it is ready to paste into your custom rule. Validating here means the rule you create in the next step is already proven against live data.

Custom Rules

To create a custom detection rule:

1. Paste the advanced search query that targets the desired events in the criteria field
2. Name the rule
3. Select the MITRE ATT&CK categories
4. Enter a description
5. Select the severity for the detection that the rule creates
6. Click **Create Rule**



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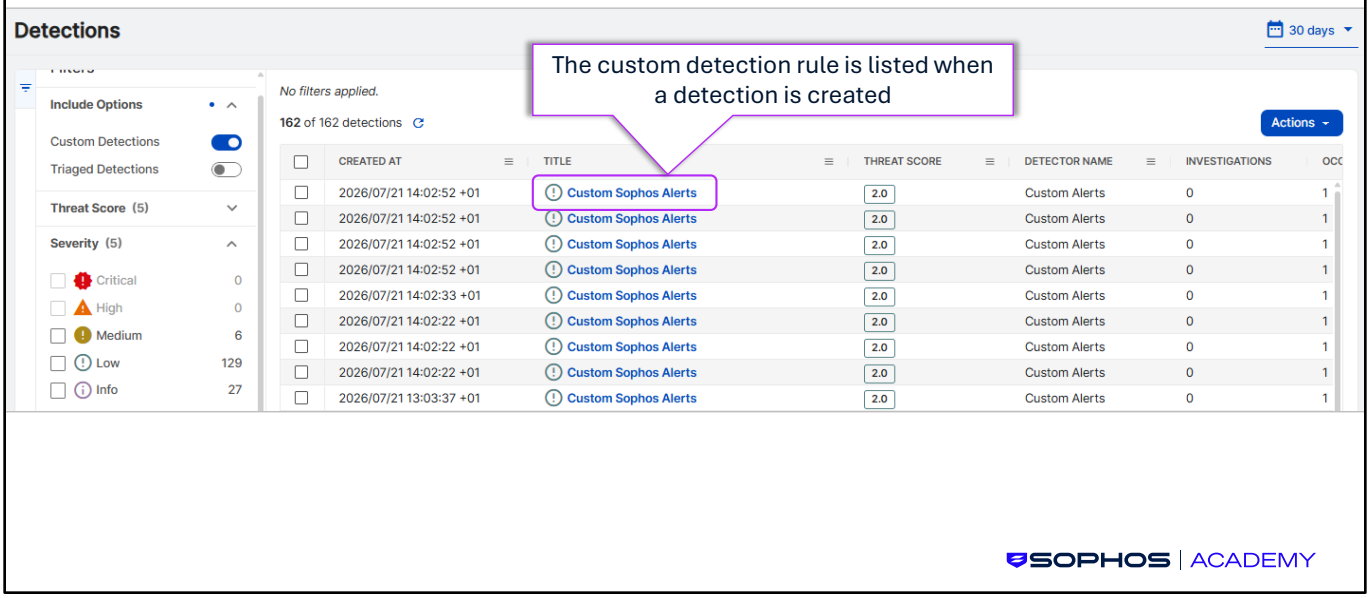
To create the custom rule, click **Create Rule**. Enter your search query in the 'Rule Criteria' field. Because the rule runs on a different engine from Data Lake Search, a small number of advanced regex constructs are not supported, so knowing this up front avoids building a rule that silently fails to compile or match.

Next, name the rule so it is easy to recognize later. Select the relevant MITRE ATT&CK categories so the detections it creates are mapped to known adversary techniques. Enter a clear description that explains what the rule detects and why. Then select the severity you want the resulting detections to carry, which helps analysts prioritize them in the feed. Finally, click Create Rule.

Once created, the rule is turned on immediately and added to the Custom Rules table, where you can edit, disable, or remove it at any time.

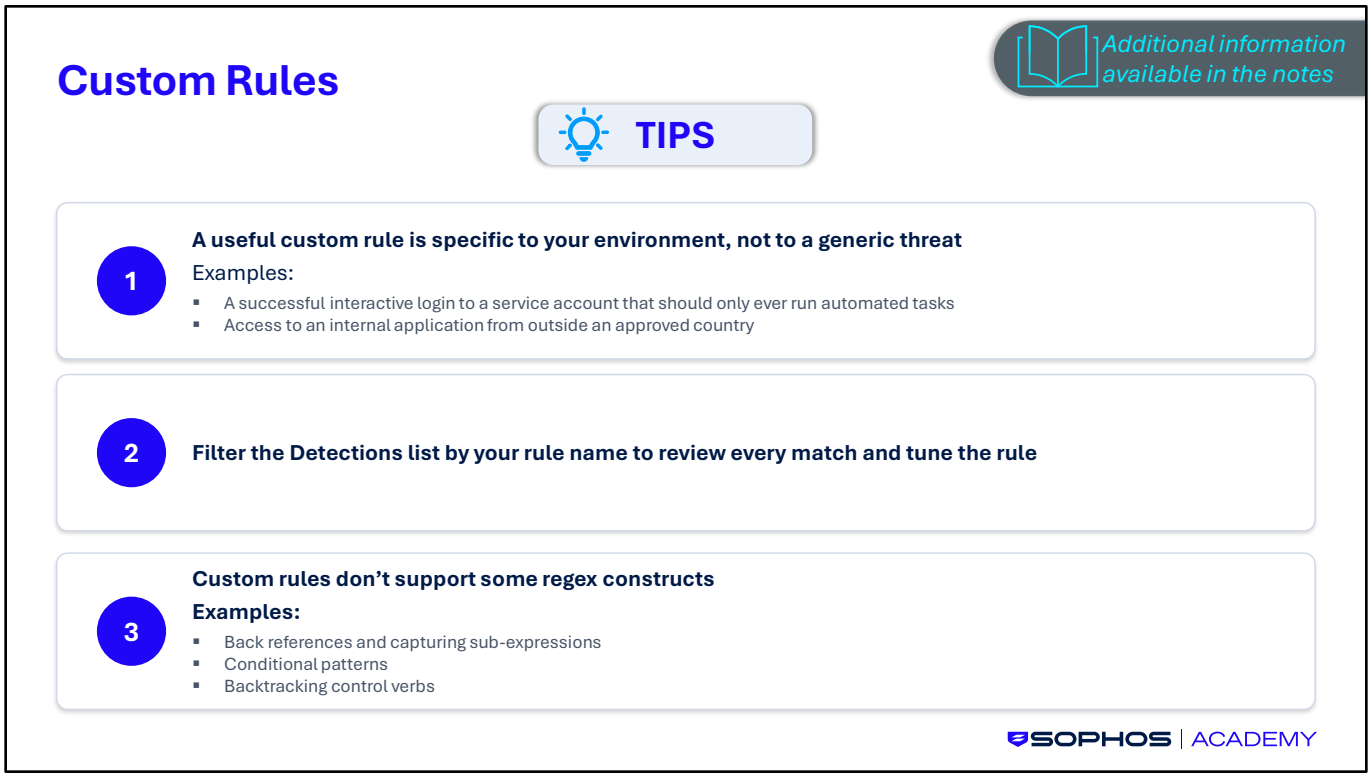
Custom Rules



Finally, you confirm the outcome. With the rule active, any event that matches your validated criteria now generates a detection automatically. These detections appear in the Detections list, and you can identify them by your custom rule name shown in the ‘TITLE’ column.

This closes the loop on the workflow. You built and validated your criteria with AI Search, created a rule from that proven query, and can now see the detections it produces feeding into the same triage workflow as every other detection.

Custom rules generate XDR detections, which create self managed cases that your own administrators investigate and respond to. The MDR SOC does not investigate these. The severity you assign affects prioritization and scoring only; it does not cause the SOC to pick up the detection.



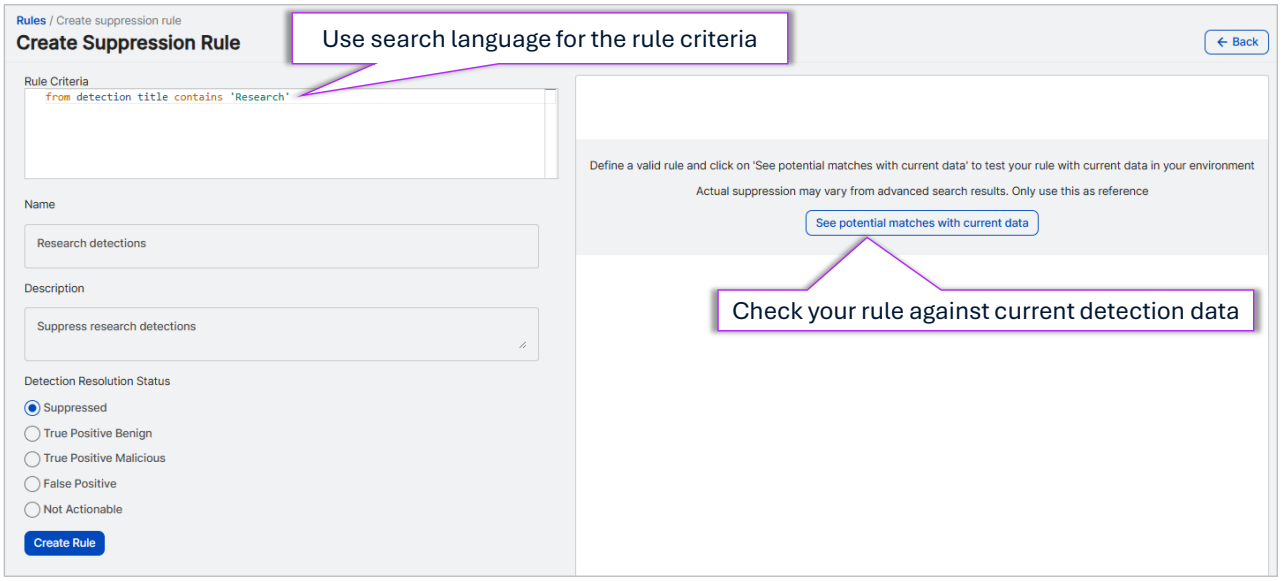
A useful custom rule is one that is specific to your environment rather than a generic threat. For example, you might flag any successful interactive login to a sensitive service account that should only ever run automated tasks or detect access to an internal application from outside an approved country. These are meaningful in your environment and would not already exist as a built in detector.

Filtering the Detections list by your rule name lets you quickly review everything it has caught and tune the rule if needed.

Custom rules do not support some regex constructs. For more information on special characters, limitations, and supported values, please see the help page reference in the student handout.

[Additional Information]
https://docs.sophos.com/central/Customer/eap/4.1/en-us/ManageYourProducts/XDRSecOps/Detections/DetectionRules/CustomDetectionRules/index.html#custom-rule-characteristics-and-constraints

Suppression Rules



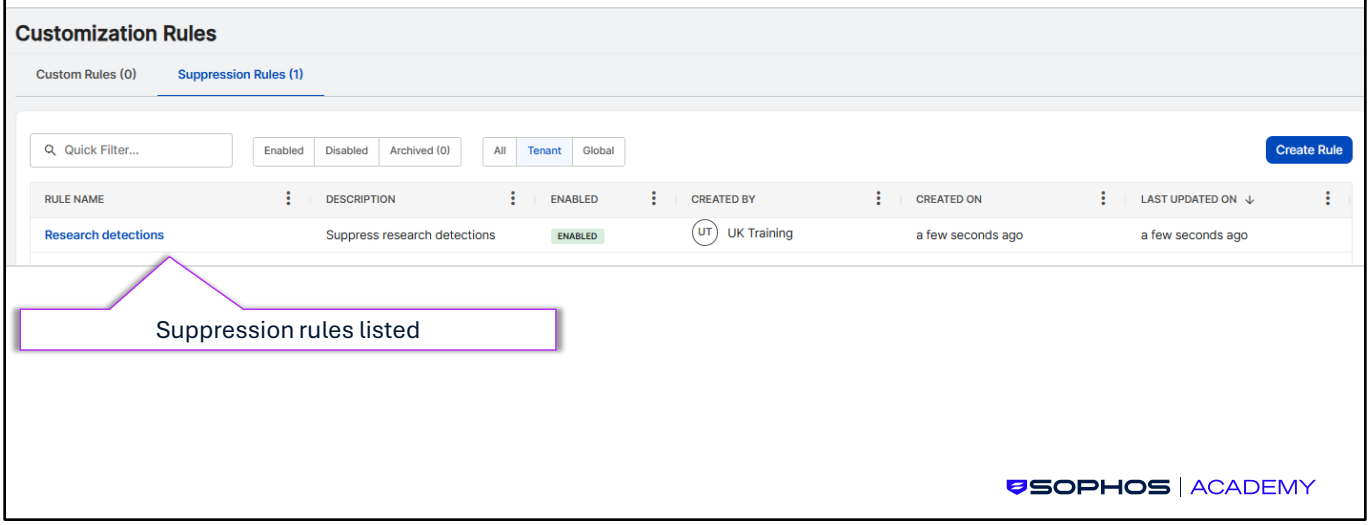
Suppression rules follow the same setup and configuration workflow as custom rules.

To create a suppression rule, click **Create Rule** and enter the details. The rule criteria uses the same language used for Data Lake Search and live endpoint searches. Our recommendation is to use Data Lake Search to get the data you want to return and validate the rule, and then use that query to create the suppression rule.

In this example, we are suppressing the informational detections for research. In the right-hand pane, run the option to see potential matches with your current data. This will run your rule against your current detection data for validation.

It is important to be aware that suppression rules apply regardless of severity, so a rule that is too broad can hide genuine alerts from your analysts. Always validate a suppression rule against current detection data before saving it.

Suppression Rules



Once this rule is saved, it will be displayed in the **Suppression Rules** tab in your **Customization Rules**.

Cases

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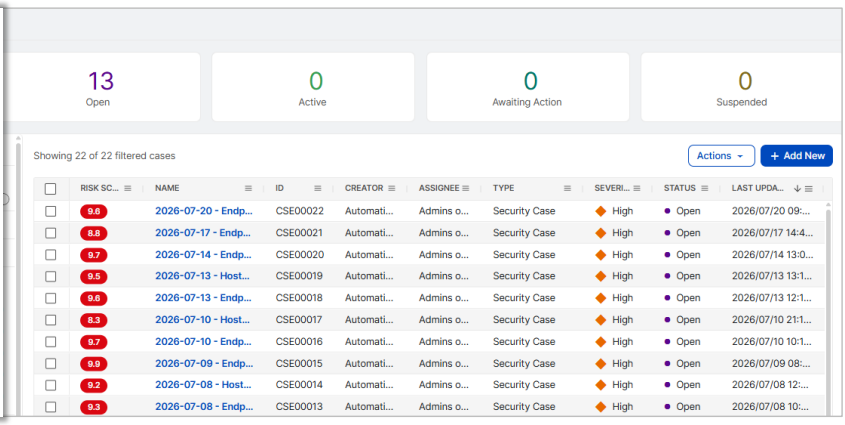
Introduction to Cases

- Cases group related detections into a unified investigation.
- Cases provide context across multiple events.
- Cases reduce analysis fragmentation.



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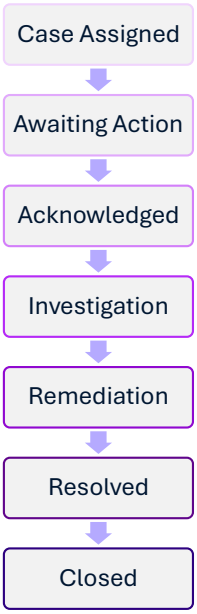
Cases are created to organize related detections into a single investigative workflow. Instead of reviewing individual detections separately, analysts can access relationships between activities, users, and systems in one place.

Cases bring an incident into full view, using detections together with analyst case notes, severity, and status tracking. Grouping related detections this way avoids fragmented analysis, where the same incident would otherwise be investigated as many disconnected signals in separate places.

Cases Lifecycle Overview

- Cases progress through defined lifecycle stages
- This lifecycle starts after detections have been generated and a case has been automatically created
- Lifecycle tracking ensures accountability and closure.



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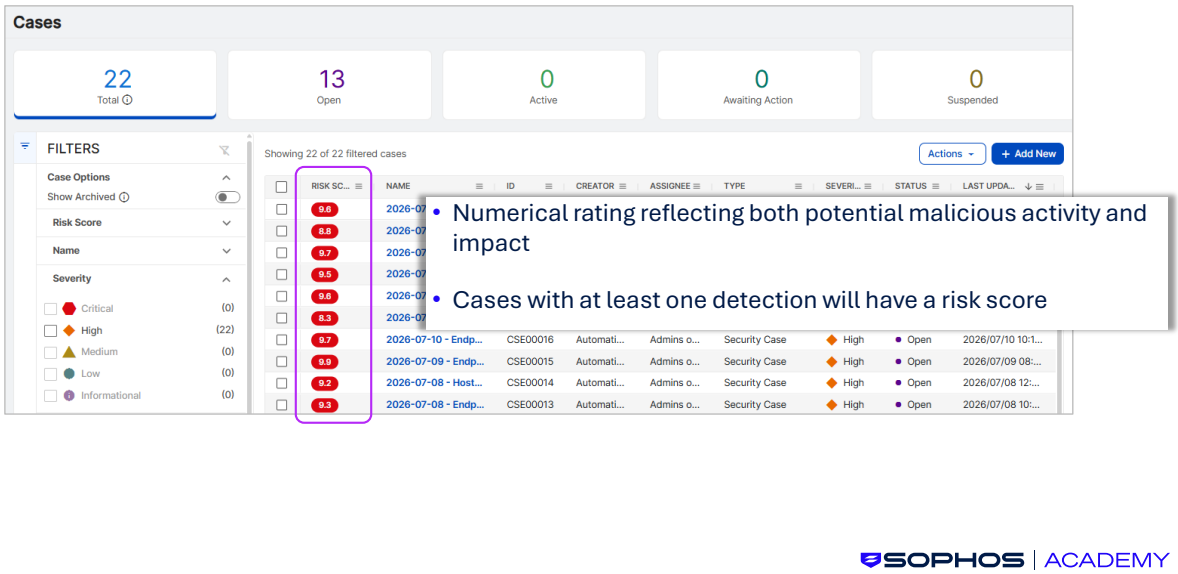
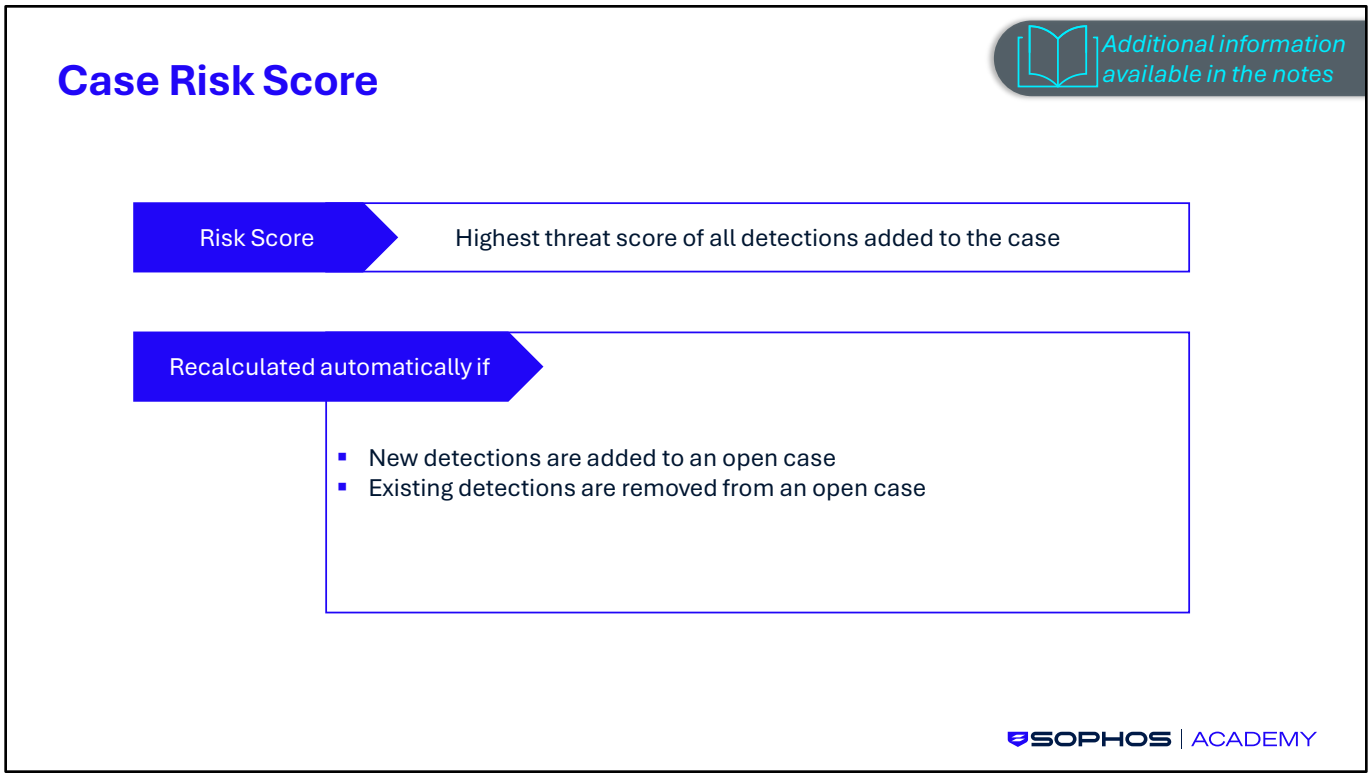
Each case moves through a lifecycle from initial creation to final resolution. During this process, analysts assess detections, gather evidence, and act. Proper lifecycle management ensures investigations are completed and documented correctly.

Case Risk Score



The case risk score is a numerical rating that reflects both the likelihood of the activity being malicious and the potential impact it may have on your environment.

Cases with at least one detection are assigned a risk score, while those without any detections have a risk score of zero. The risk score shows in the table on the Cases page and next to the case name on the case details page.



The case risk score is the highest threat score of all detections added to the case. In time, this score calculation will include multiple risk factors to provide an accurate and nuanced score.

The risk score is recalculated automatically if:

- New detections are added to an open case
- Existing detections are removed from an open case

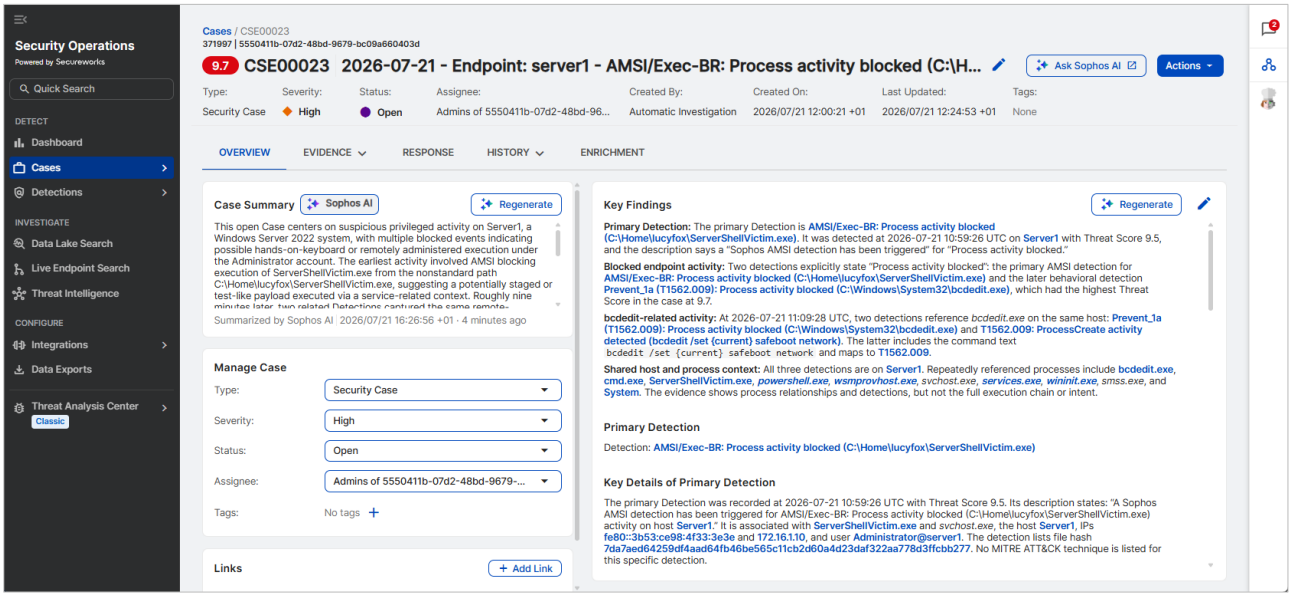
Closed cases do not receive score updates, even if detections are modified.

[Additional Information]
https://docs.sophos.com/central/Customer/eap/4.1/en-us/ManageYourProducts/XDRSecOps/Detections/ThreatScore/index.html

Without cases, analysts must manually correlate events across multiple views. Cases automate this grouping and provide a central workspace. This ensures investigations are consistent, traceable, and easier to manage across teams.

Selecting a case from the list will open a pop-out that summarizes the case. Click the full screen icon to open the case in full screen mode.

Case Details



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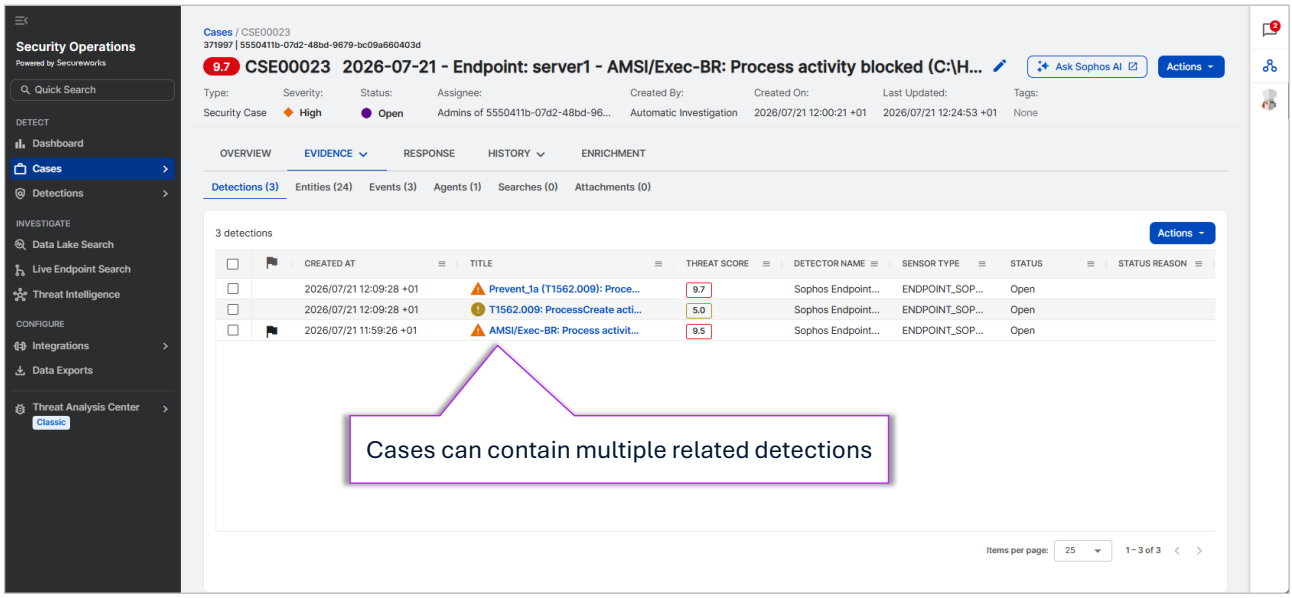
The case is split into tabs: the overview, evidence, response, history, and enrichment.

Case Details



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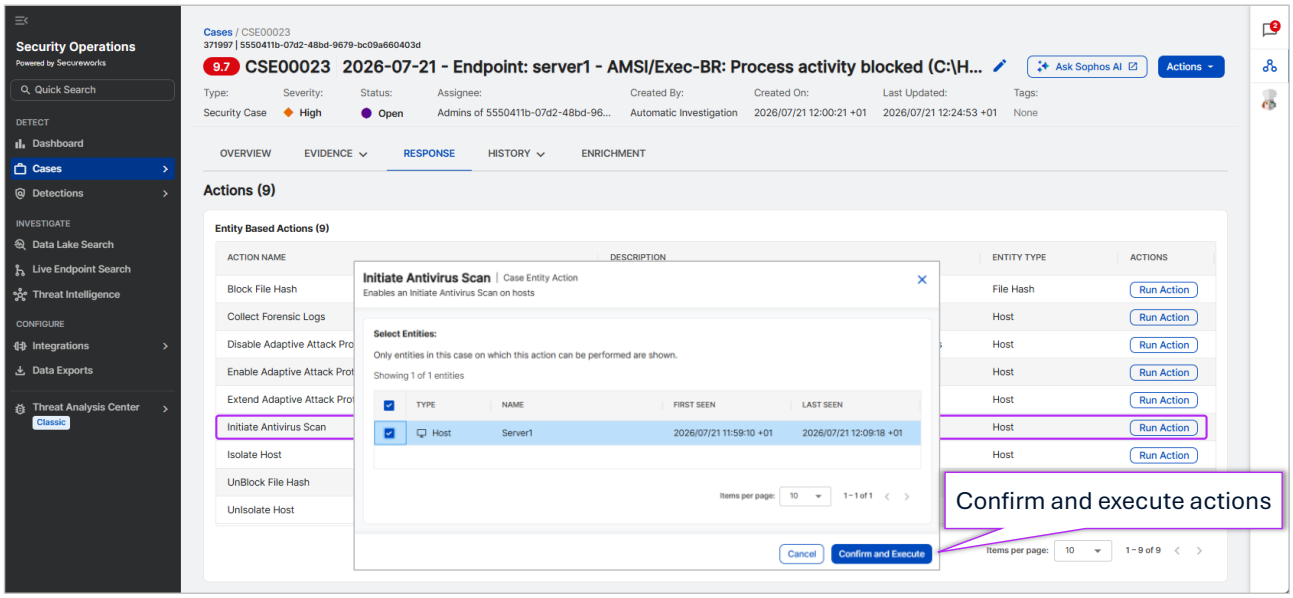
The evidence tab details the detections included in the case, the entities, events, agents, searches, and attachments if there are any. Detections are grouped into cases based on shared attributes such as device, user, IP address, or behavioral linkage. As new detections that match these relationships are made, they are added to existing cases, ensuring investigations remain current.

In the top-right menu you can select to view the evidence in a graphical representation.

Case Details



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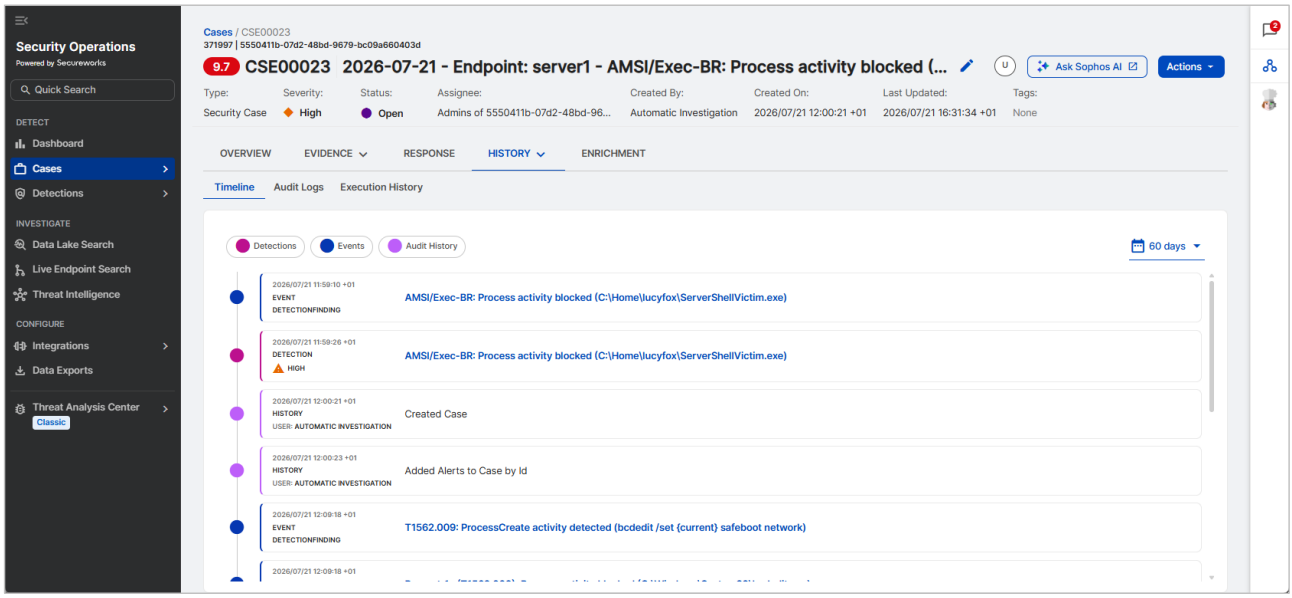
To respond to the detections in the case, use the **Response** tab. Here you can perform actions based on the entities included in the case.

For example, we can initiate an antivirus scan from this page.

Case Details



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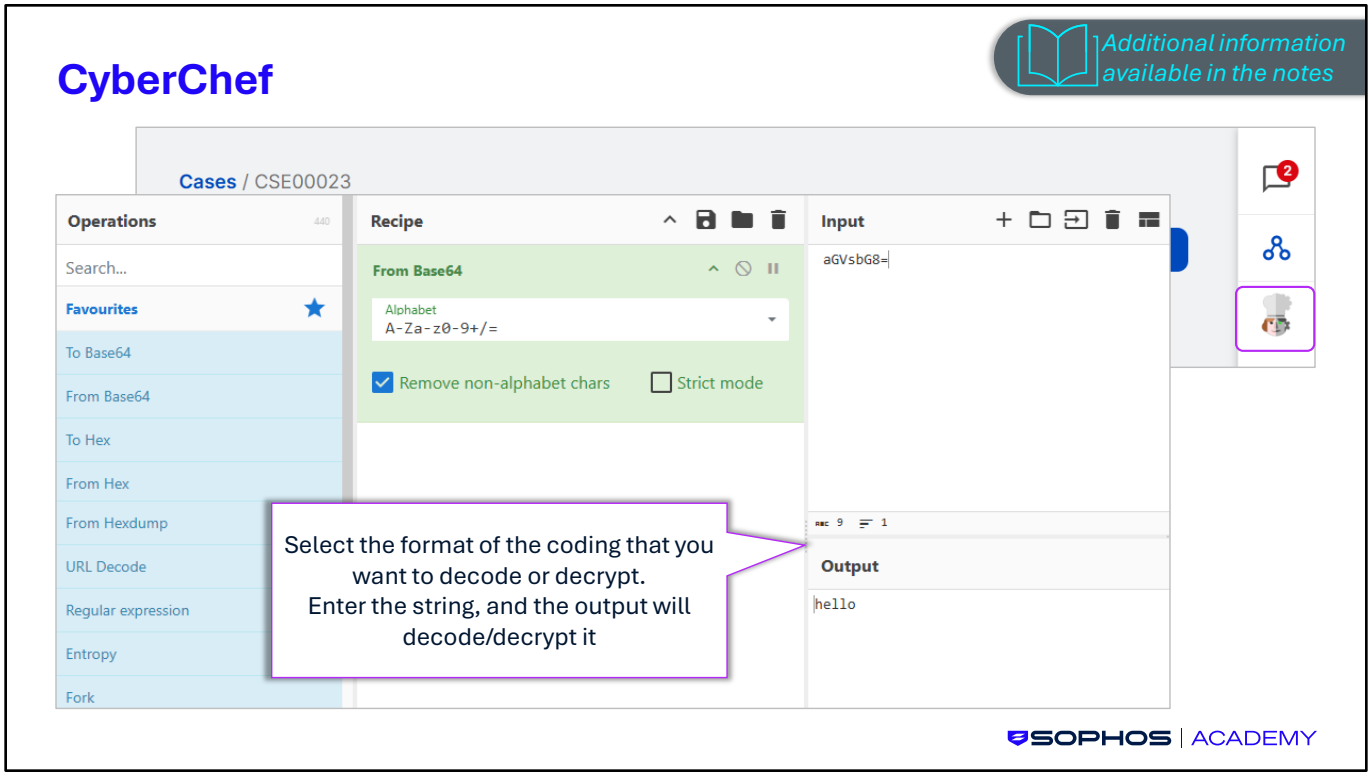
The history tab provides the timeline of the case, the audit logs, and the execution history.

The execution history is a log of any actions that have been carried out. The initiation of the antivirus scan will be listed in the execution history. This allows multiple administrators to work on cases knowing that all actions completed are logged in the case, reducing work duplication or cross-wires.



In the top-right of a case, you will see a comments icon, the topical graph icon, and the CyberChef icon.

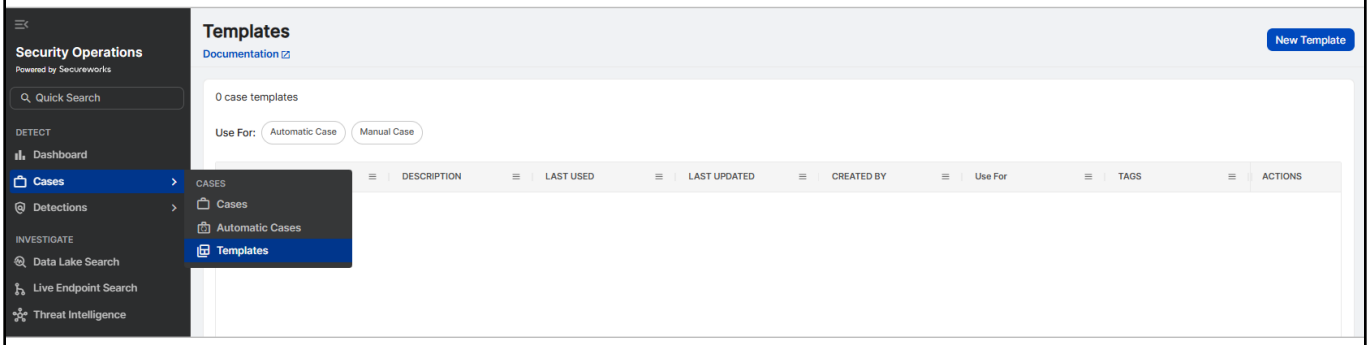
CyberChef is a web-based tool for encrypting, encoding, decoding, and analyzing data. Known as the "Cyber Swiss Army Knife," it helps complete simple and complex data manipulation tasks in Sophos XDR, for example, decoding base64 data or decrypting and disassembling shellcode.

You can create and save recipes for later use.

[Additional Information]
https://github.com/gchq/CyberChef

Case Templates

- Case templates standardize investigation workflows.
- Templates define tasks and processes.
- Templates ensure consistent handling of incidents.



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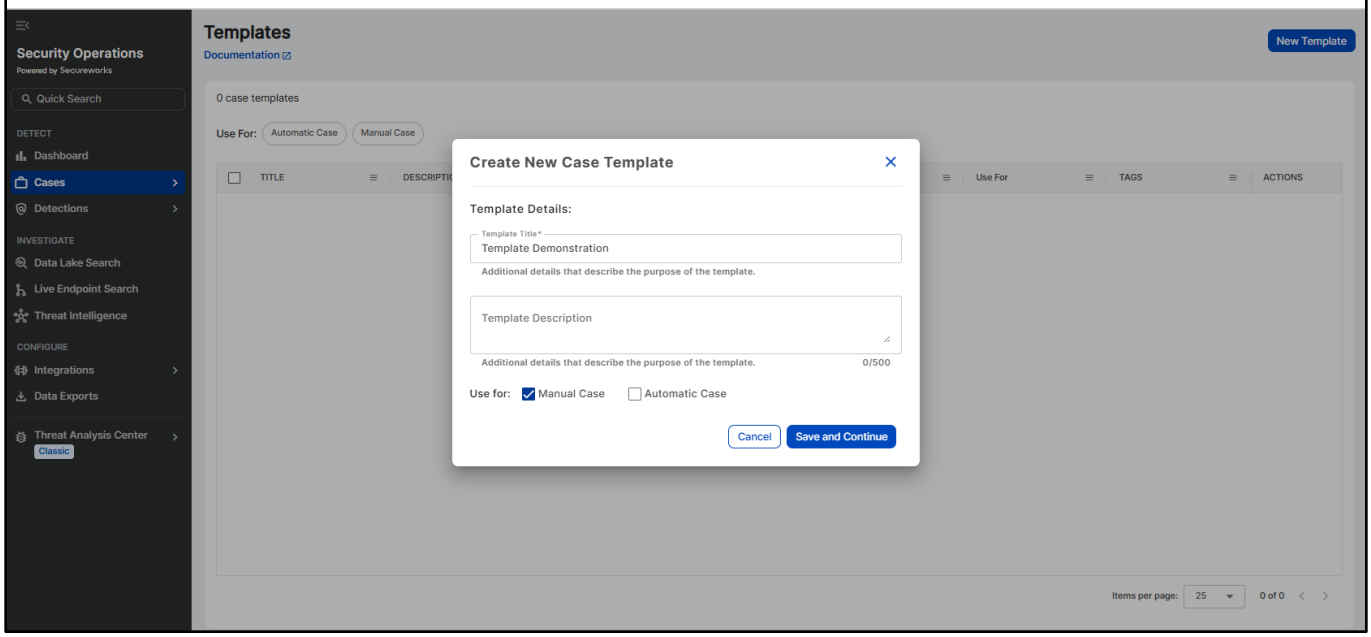
Case templates give analysts a repeatable, prebuilt set of investigation steps so that a given type of incident is handled the same way every time. Their purpose is consistency and speed: instead of remembering each step, an analyst applies a template that lays out the tasks to complete, such as evidence collection, containment actions, and escalation criteria.

Case Templates



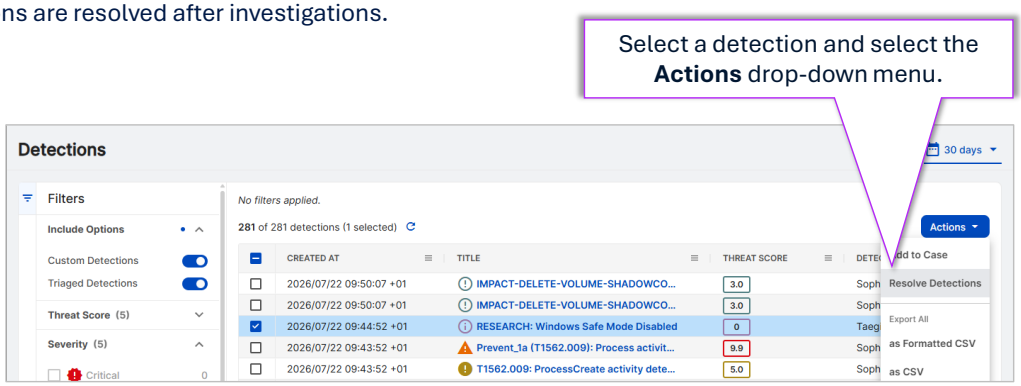
This is especially valuable for common or high-priority scenarios, for example, a phishing report or a ransomware indicator, where following a proven checklist reduces mistakes, supports newer analysts, and makes handovers between team members easier.

To create a case template, select **Cases > Templates > New Template.** Fill out the template details and select to apply it to either manual or automatic cases.

Resolving Detections and Cases

Resolving Detections

- Detections are resolved after investigations.



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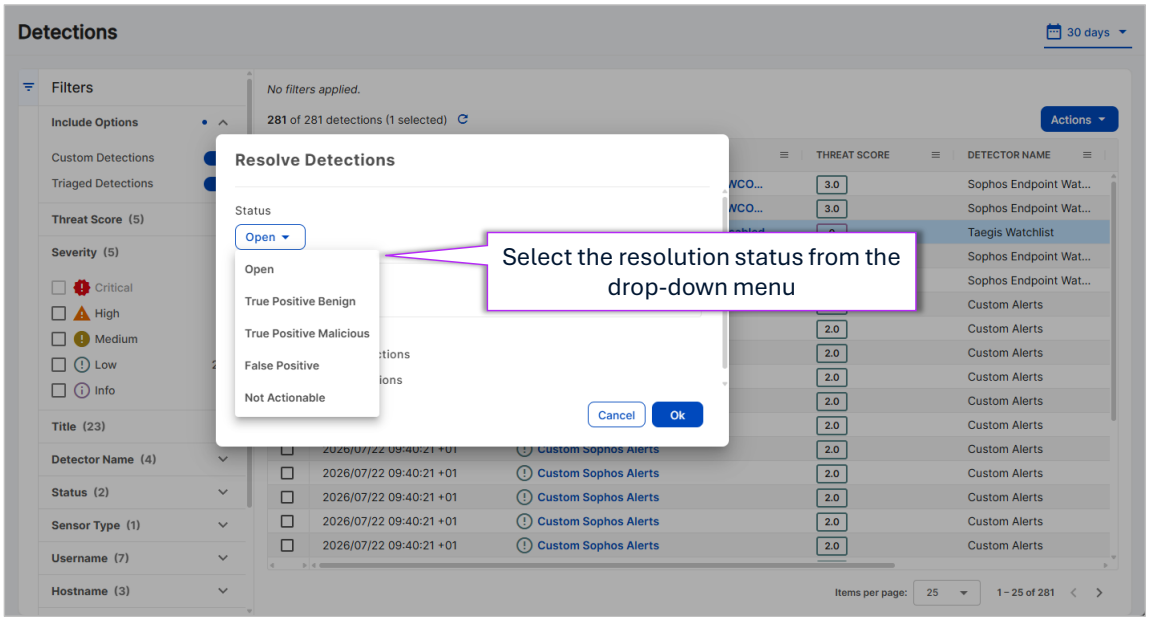
Once a detection has been investigated, you can remove it from the detections list by resolving it. To resolve a detection, select it in the detections list and click the **Actions** drop-down menu.

Select **Resolve Detections**.

Resolving Detections



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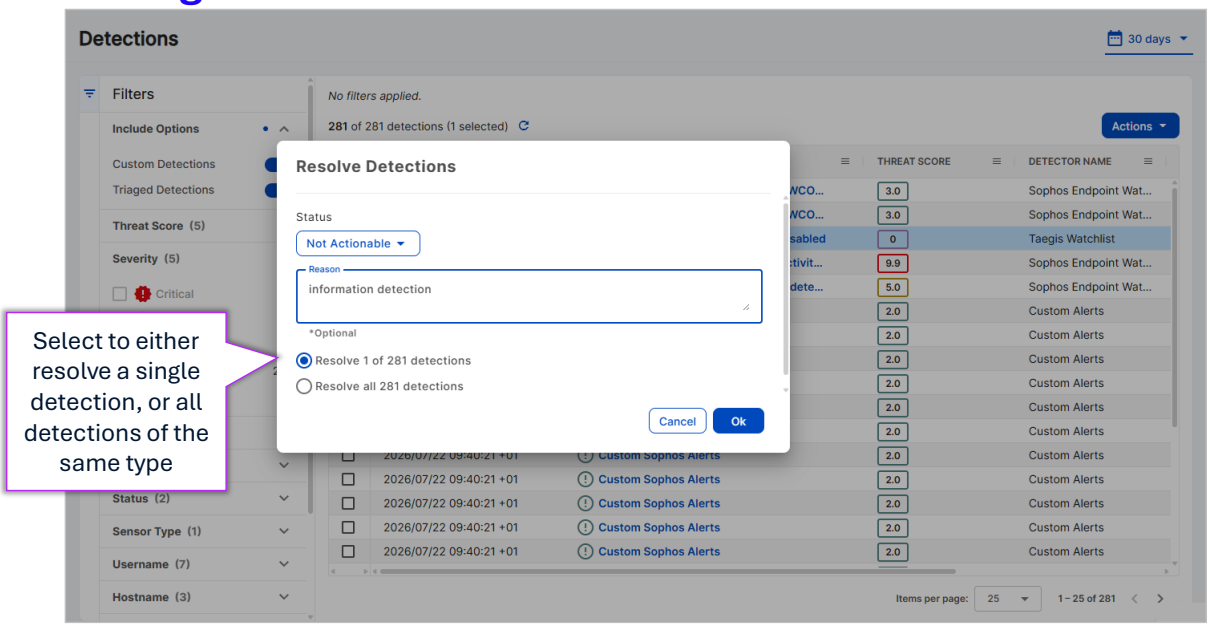
Resolution requires analysts to classify detections as either true positive benign, true positive malicious, false positive, or not actionable.

Select the status from the drop-down menu.

Resolving Detections



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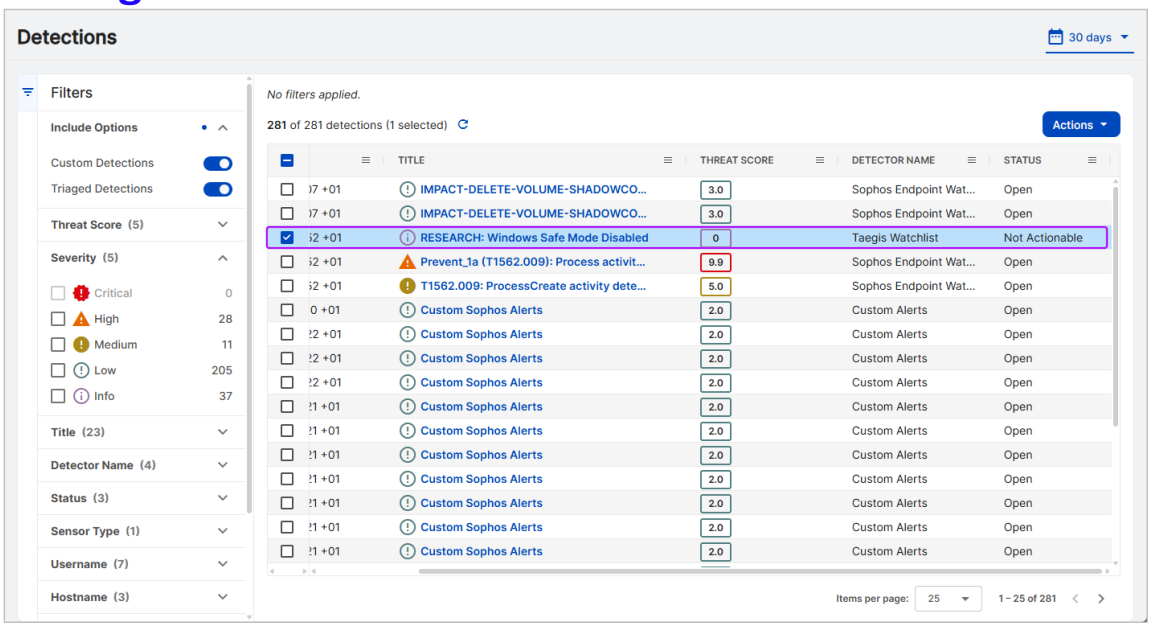
Once a status has been selected, add a reason for the detection resolution.

Select to either resolve just this instance of the detection or all detections of the same type.

Resolving Detections



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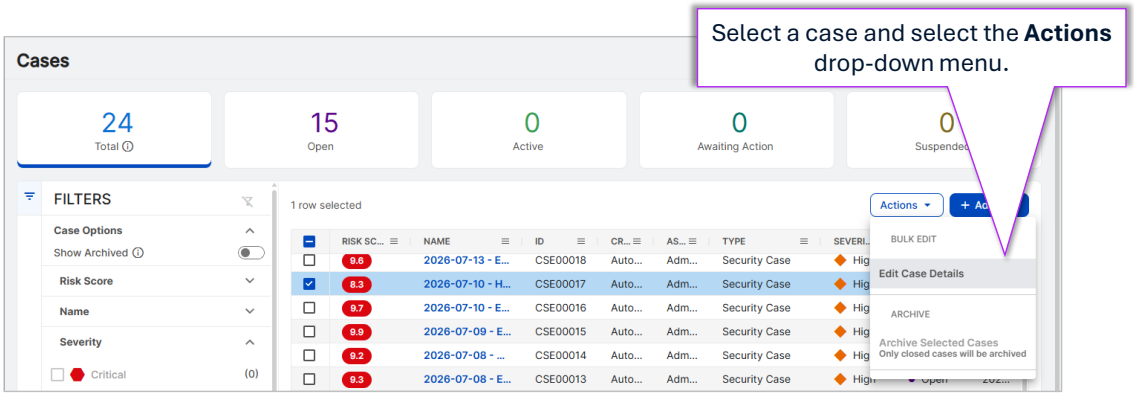
Once resolved, the detection will display in the list with the selected status applied.

Closing Cases

- Cases are closed when all related detections are addressed.



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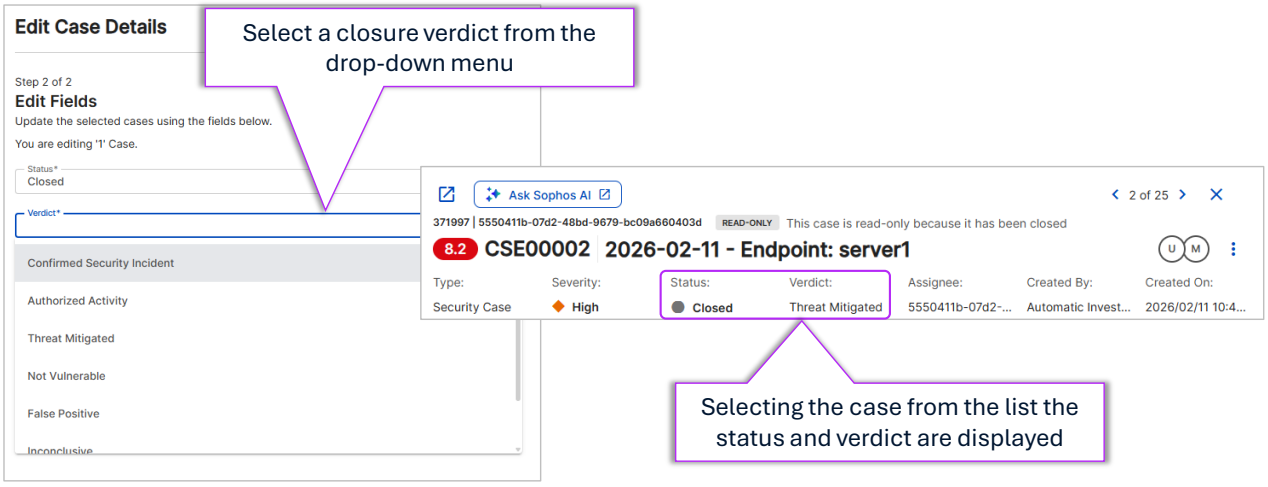
Cases are closed once all associated detections are resolved and appropriate actions have been completed.

When you edit the case details, you can change the status, selecting from closed, open, awaiting action, active, or suspended.

To close a case, select it from the cases list and click the **Actions** drop-down menu. Select **Edit Case Details**.

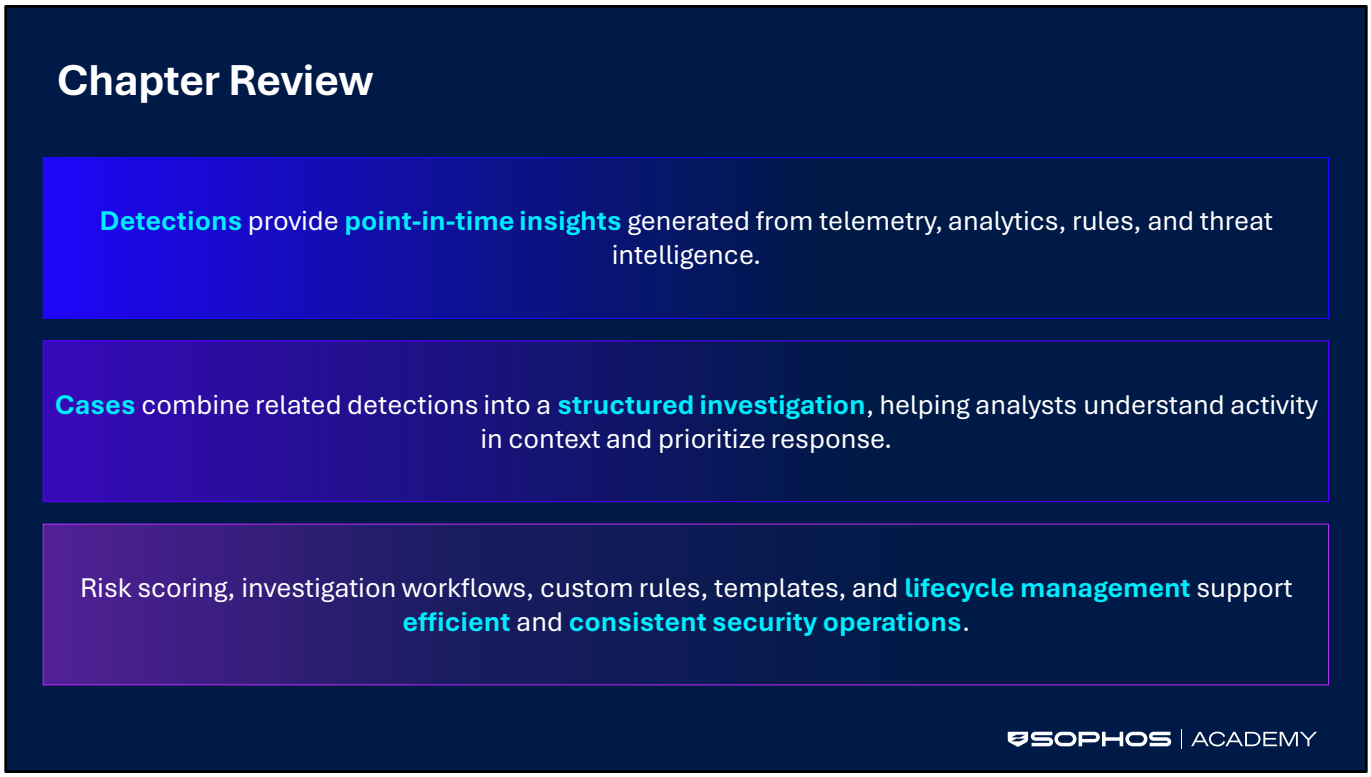
Closing Cases



When you select to close a case, you must select a verdict to close the case with. You can select from this list:

- Confirmed security incident
- Authorized activity
- Threat mitigated
- Not vulnerable
- False positive
- Inconclusive
- Information

Once a case has been closed and a verdict selected, the case status and verdict are displayed in the case details.



Here are the three main things you learned in this chapter.

Detections provide point-in-time insights generated from telemetry, analytics, rules, and threat intelligence.

Cases combine related detections into a structured investigation, helping analysts understand activity in context and prioritize response.

Risk scoring, investigation workflows, custom rules, templates, and lifecycle management support efficient and consistent security operations.

[Additional Information]

Sophos Endpoint
EP4575: Response Actions and Live Response

September 2026
7.0v1

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Response Actions and Live Response

Learning Outcomes:

- Describe how response actions deliver containment, blocking, and investigation directly from detection workflows.
- Select and run a single action across one or more integrations for a given scenario.
- Configure a response action using a CEL condition that controls when it runs.
- Describe how Live Response provides privileged command line access to a device

RECOMMENDED KNOWLEDGE AND EXPERIENCE

- ✓ How to configure and apply Sophos Endpoint policies and roles
- ✓ How to protect and manage devices
- ✓ Familiarity with detections, cases, and triage workflow

DURATION: 15 minutes

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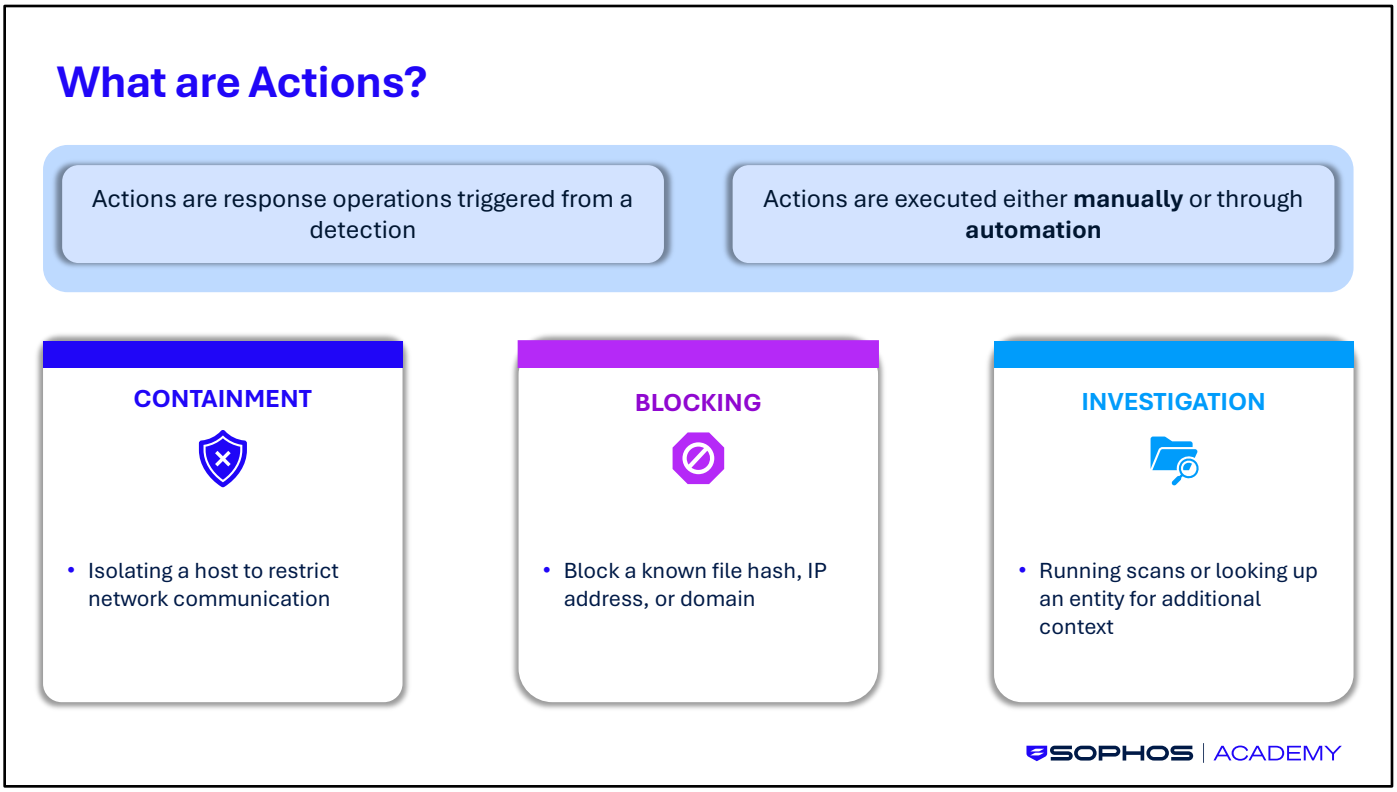
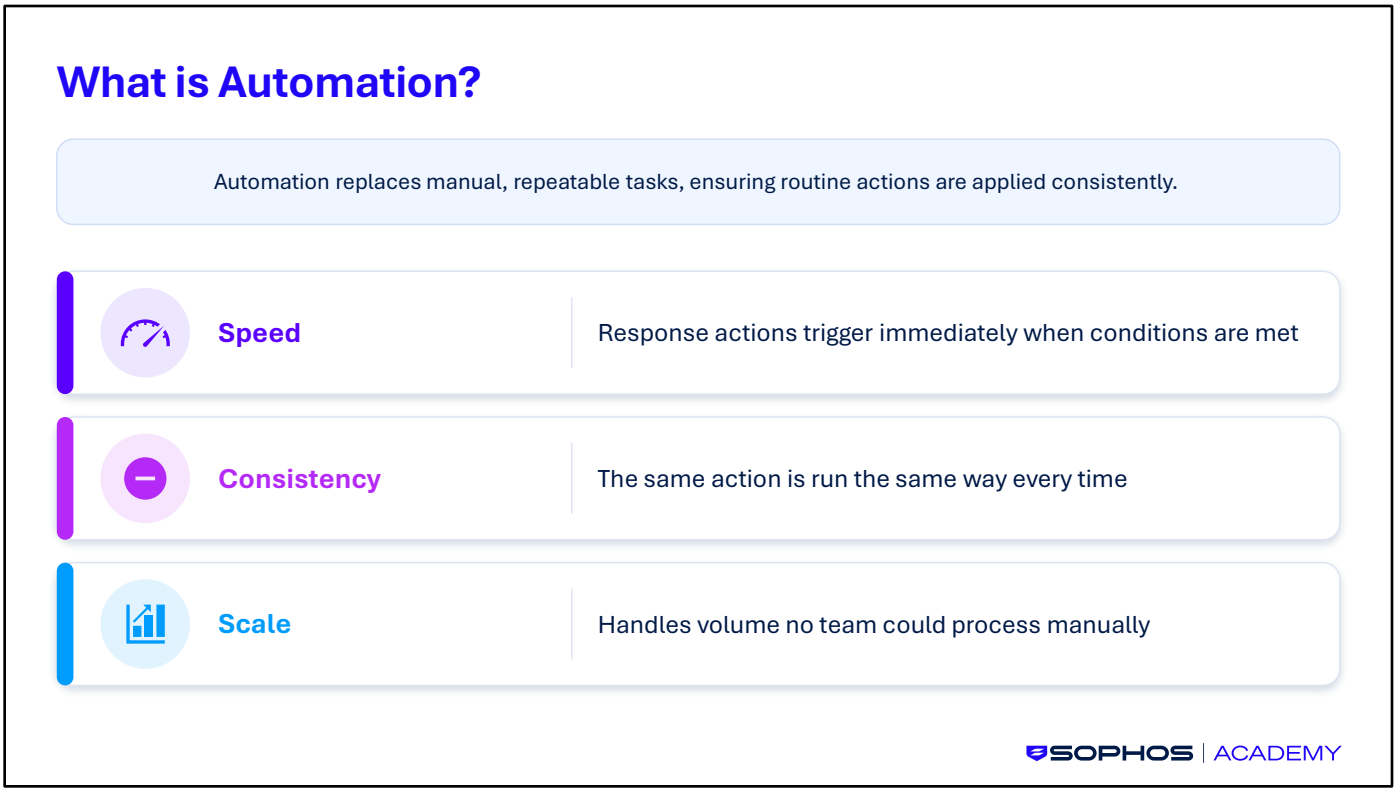
In this chapter, you'll learn how actions and automations operate within detection workflows, including manual and automated response options, configuring actions with CEL, and the categories of automatable tasks



Actions are response operations triggered from a detection. A detection identifies suspicious or malicious activity, but it does not resolve the issue on its own. Actions close that gap by allowing an analyst or automated logic to respond directly to the threat. Actions form the operational response layer of the platform. They fall into three broad purposes:

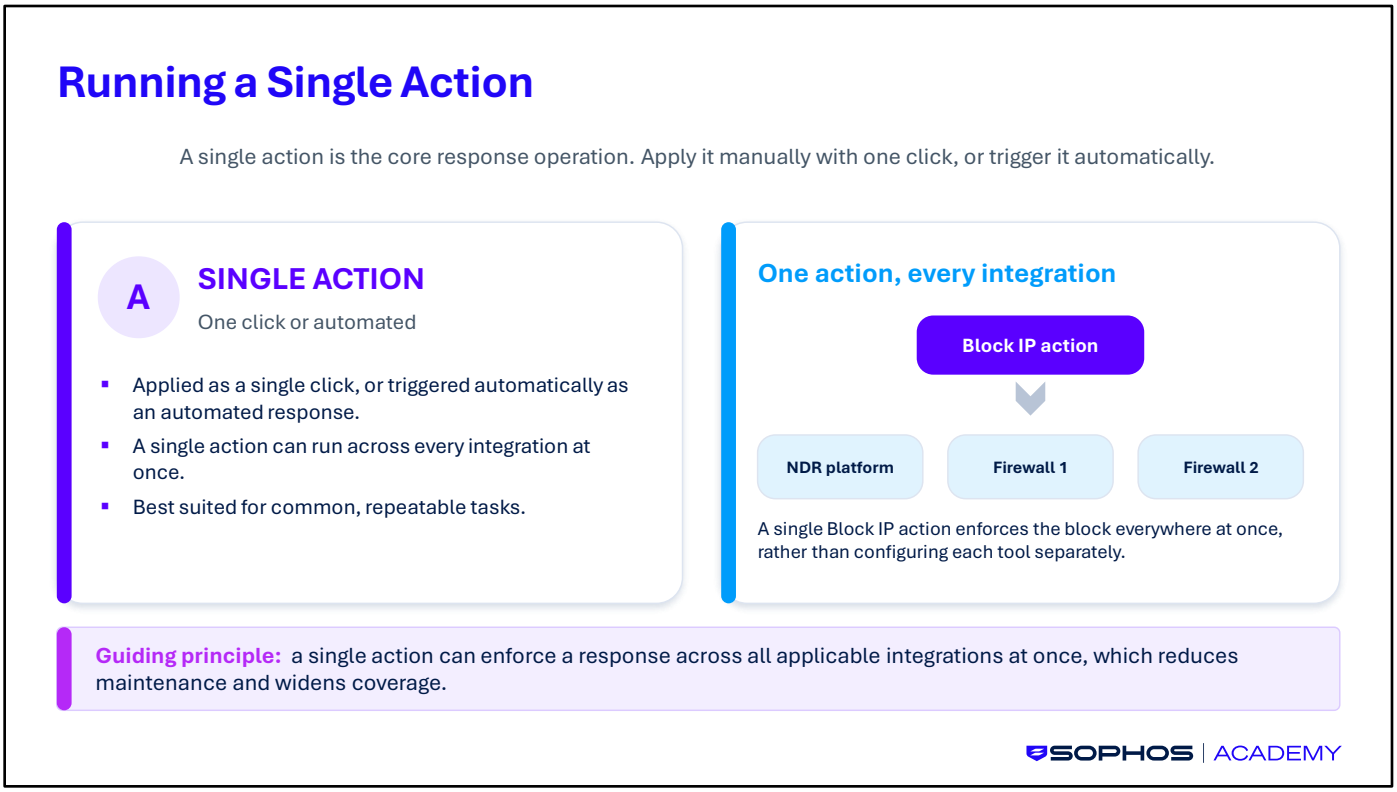
Containment: for example, isolating a host to restrict network communication.
Blocking: for example, preventing a known file hash, IP address, or domain.
Investigation and enrichment: for example, running an antivirus scan or looking up an entity for additional context.

Actions are executed either manually by an analyst or automatically through automation. Because they operate on live systems, they must be run with awareness of operational impact.



Automation replaces manual, repeatable tasks so the security team can spend more time on work that requires human judgment. As the volume of detections grows, automation ensures that routine actions happen consistently and without delay. Automation delivers three core benefits:

Speed: response actions can trigger the moment defined conditions are met, which is critical for fast-moving threats such as ransomware.
Consistency: the same action runs the same way every time, reducing human error.
Scale: the platform can handle detection volume that no team could process manually.



A single action can be applied manually with one click, or triggered automatically as an automated response. Because one action can run across every applicable integration at once, a single Block IP action can enforce the block on an NDR platform and multiple firewalls at the same time, rather than configuring each tool separately. This reduces maintenance while widening coverage.

Understanding when to use these response actions is important for streamlining and scaling your response workflow.

Key Terminology

Term	Meaning
Detection	An alert generated when a detector identifies suspicious or malicious activity.
Action	A response operation run from a detection or entity, such as isolate host or block IP.
CEL	Common Expression Language. A lightweight syntax that evaluates to true or false to control when automation runs.

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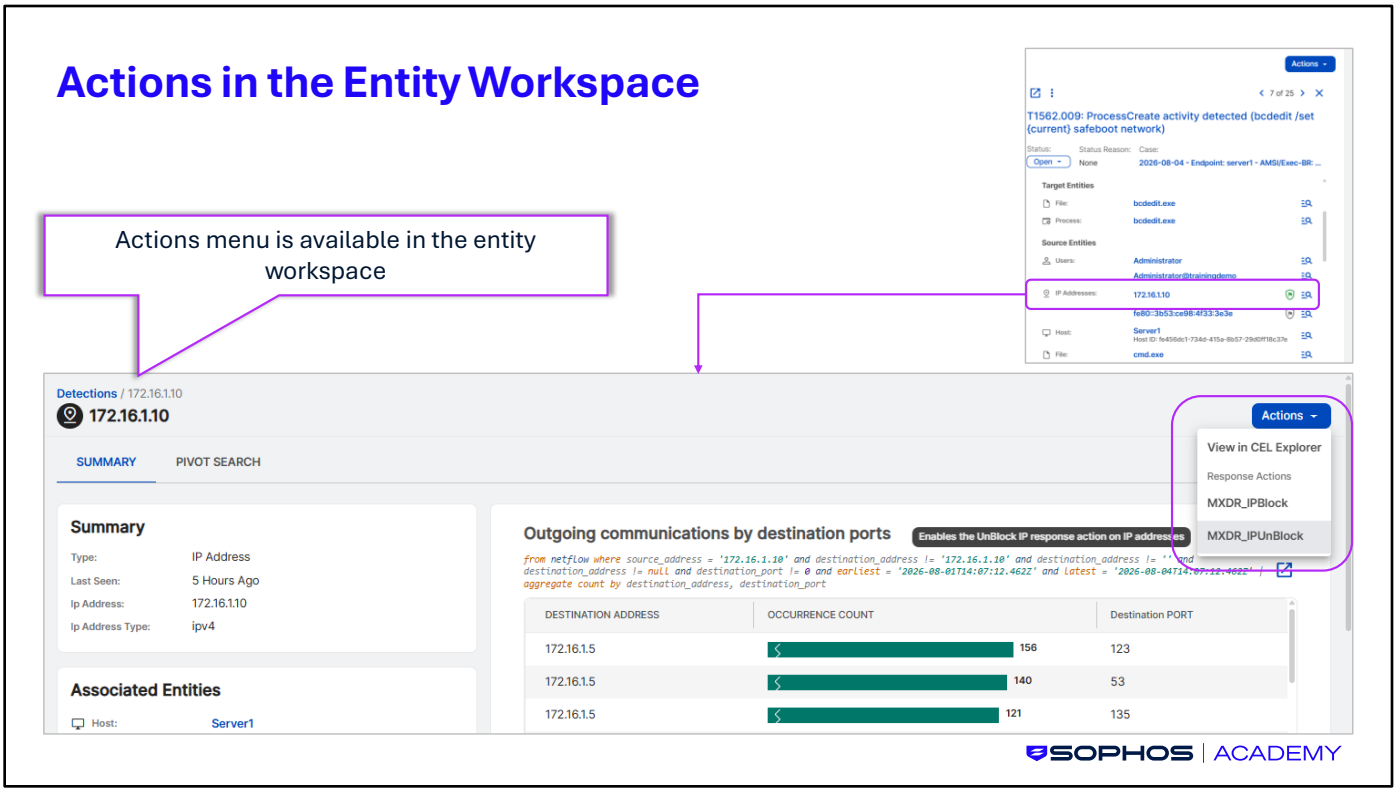
When talking about response actions, it is useful to understand the words being used and their meaning in this context.

In particular, understanding that CEL stands for Common Expression Language, which is a lightweight syntax that evaluates and controls automation runs.

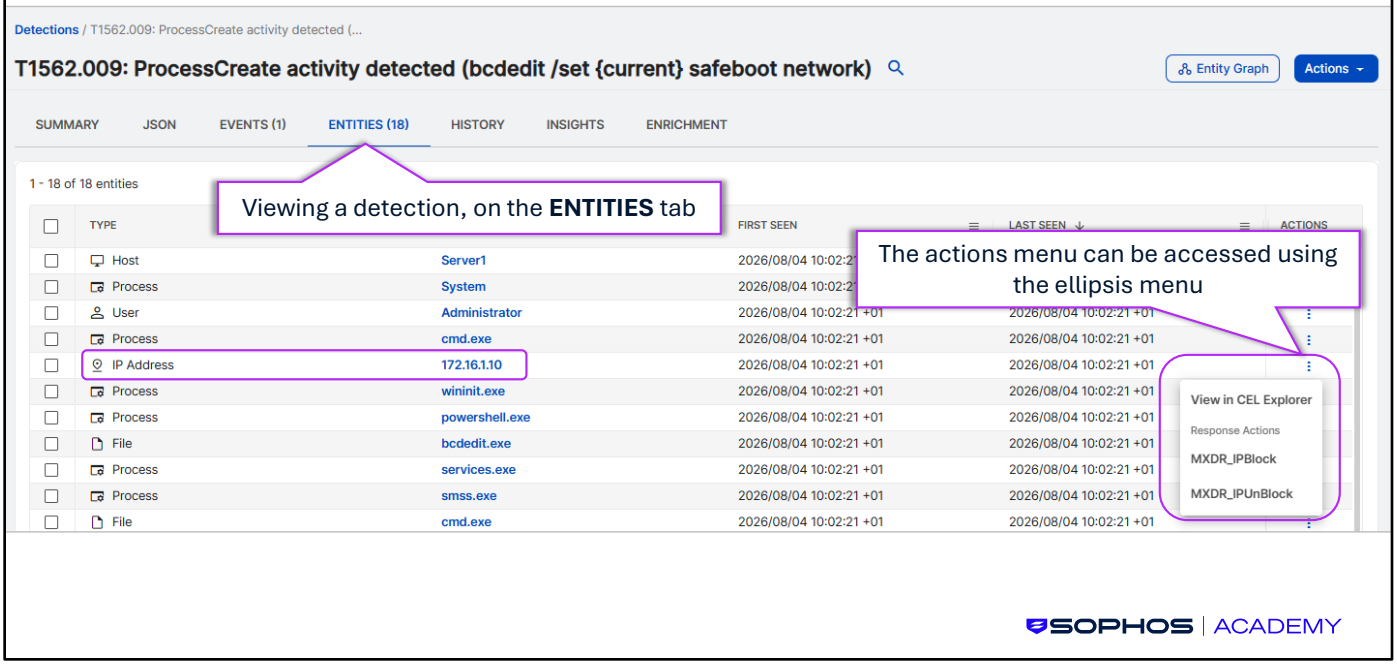
Actions in the Entity Workspace



The **Actions** menu is surfaced in a few workspaces.

It is presented on the entity workspace. When you select an entity from a detection, the actions drop-down menu is available.

Actions from a Detection



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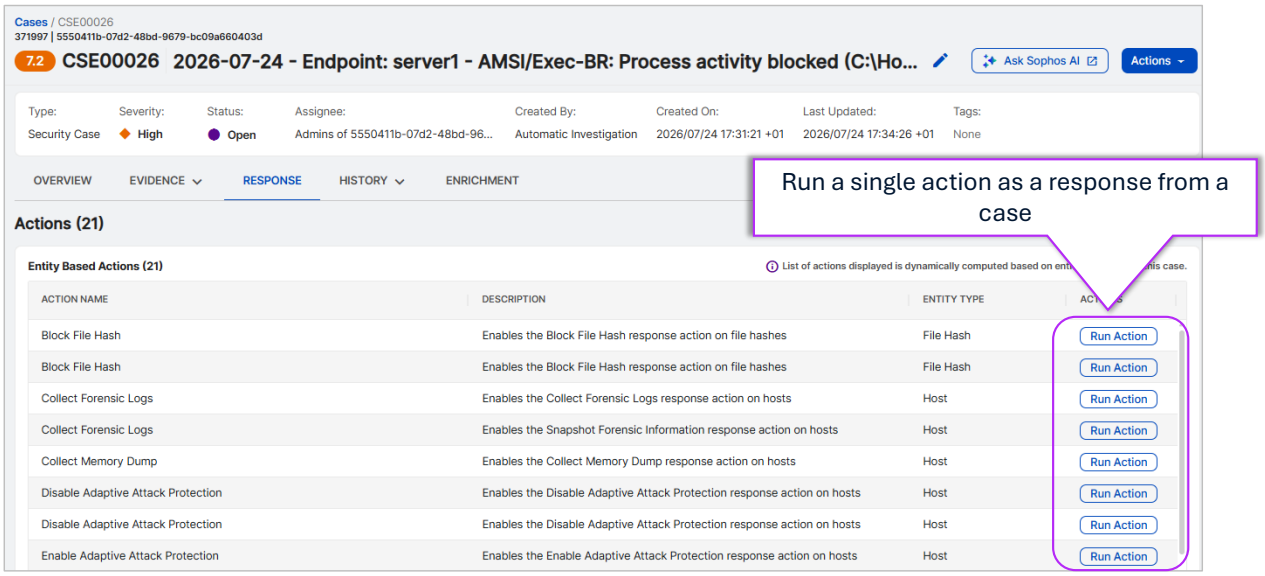
It is presented when viewing a detection on the **ENTITIES** tab. Clicking the ellipsis menu for an entity will display the action options.

Actions from a Case

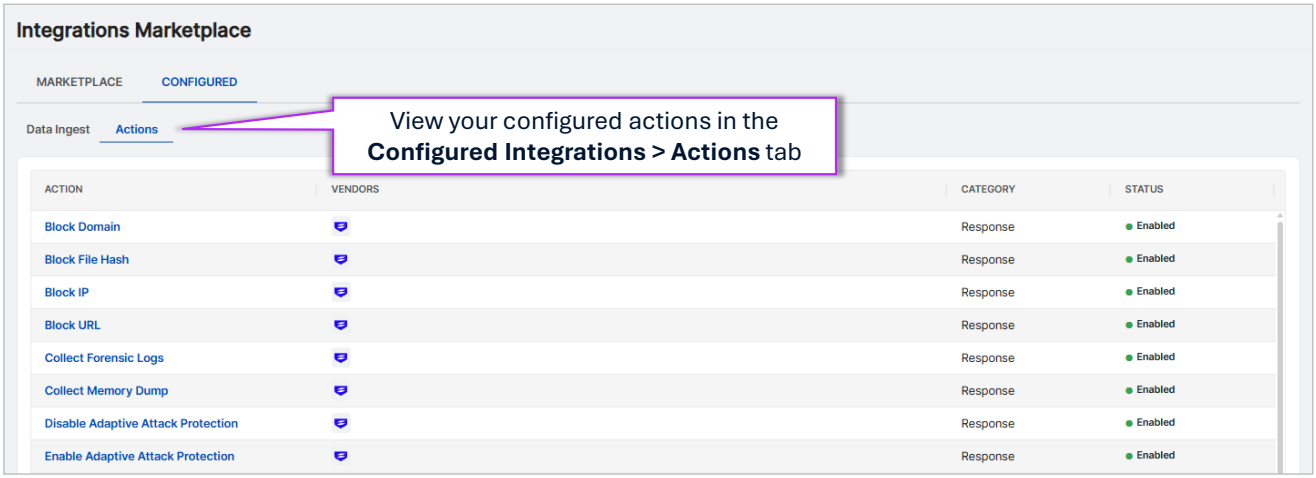


Actions can also be run from a case on the **RESPONSE** tab. It's important to note that the actions presented are not static; they are dynamically determined based on the type of detection, the available integrations, and the telemetry associated with the affected entity. For example, endpoint-based detections may expose host isolation or antivirus scan options, while network detections may focus on blocking indicators. This contextual approach ensures that only valid and executable actions are presented.

Available Actions

Additional information available in the notes

CONFIGURE > Integrations > Configured Integrations



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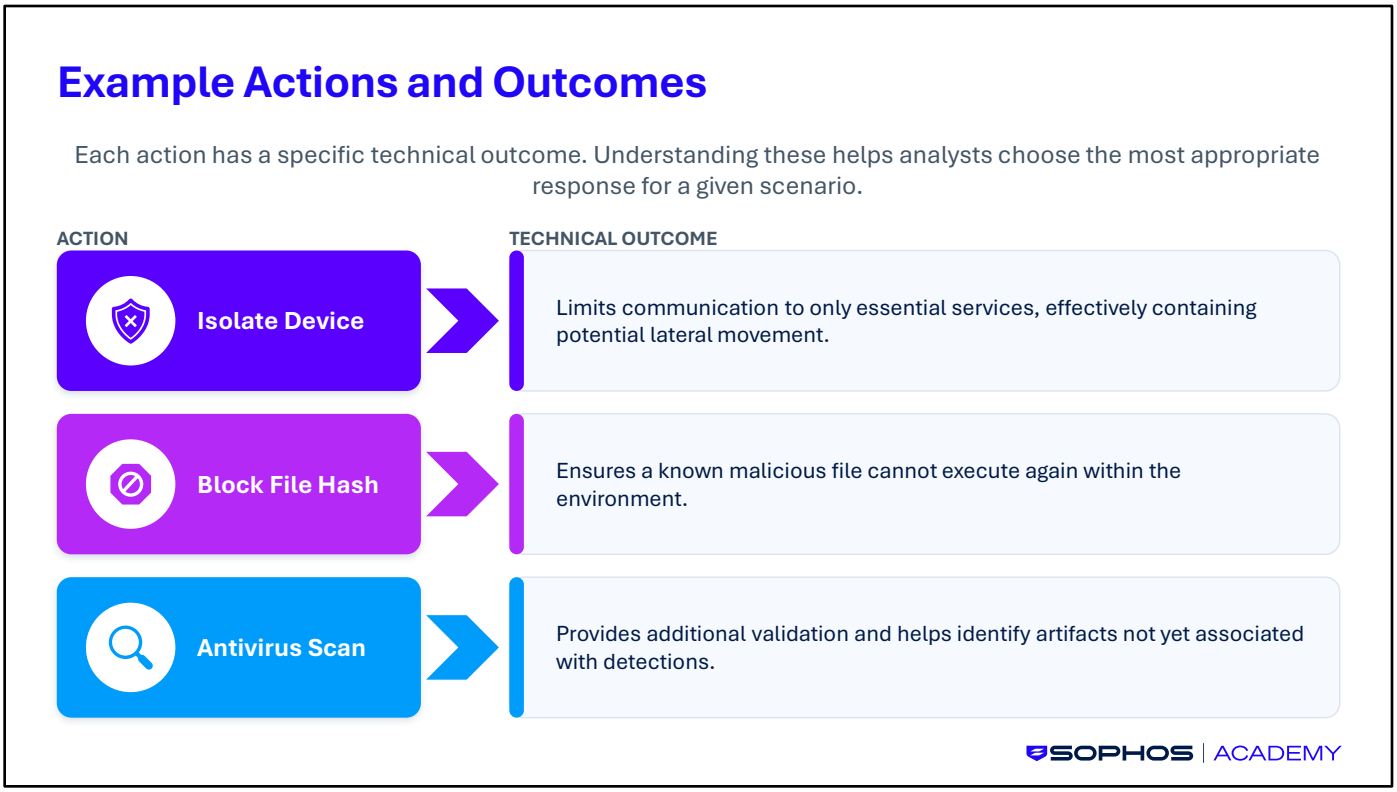
The available actions listed will depend on what you have configured for your integrations.

Sophos Endpoint integration actions are automatically applied; however, Sophos Firewall actions are added through the response card integration in the **Marketplace**.

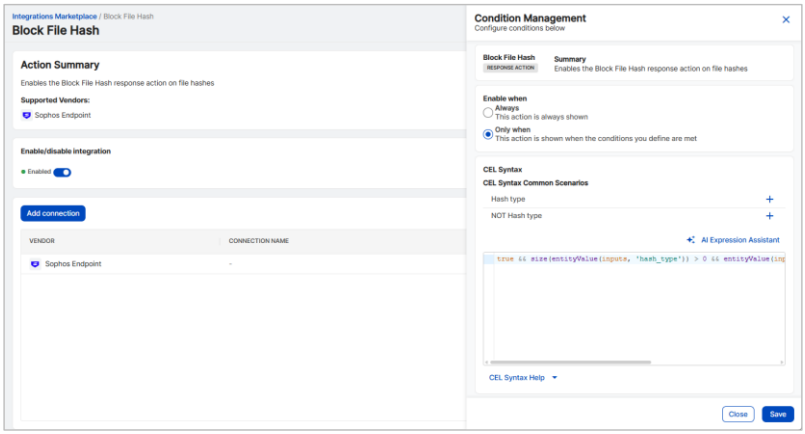
Actions can be broadly categorized by what they target and the outcomes they achieve. Endpoint-focused actions include isolating a device or initiating a scan. Indicator-based actions include blocking hashes or IP addresses. There are also investigative actions, such as querying telemetry or enriching context. Because these actions operate on live systems, they must be executed with awareness of operational impact, especially in production environments.

Additional information
Please see the help documentation for more information on actions.
https://docs.sophos.com/central/customer/help/en-us/ManageYourProducts/XDR/



Each action has a specific technical outcome. Device isolation limits communication to only essential services, effectively containing potential lateral movement. Blocking a hash ensures that a known malicious file cannot execute again with the environment. Running an antivirus scan provides additional validation and can help identify artifacts not yet associated with detections. Understanding these outcomes helps analysts choose the most appropriate response for a given scenario.

Configuring a Response Action



CONFIGURATION STEPS

1. Select an Action from the 'Actions' list
2. Click **Edit Conditions**
3. Select **Only When**
4. Build a CEL expression
   The CEL Helper and AI Expression Assistant appear inline.

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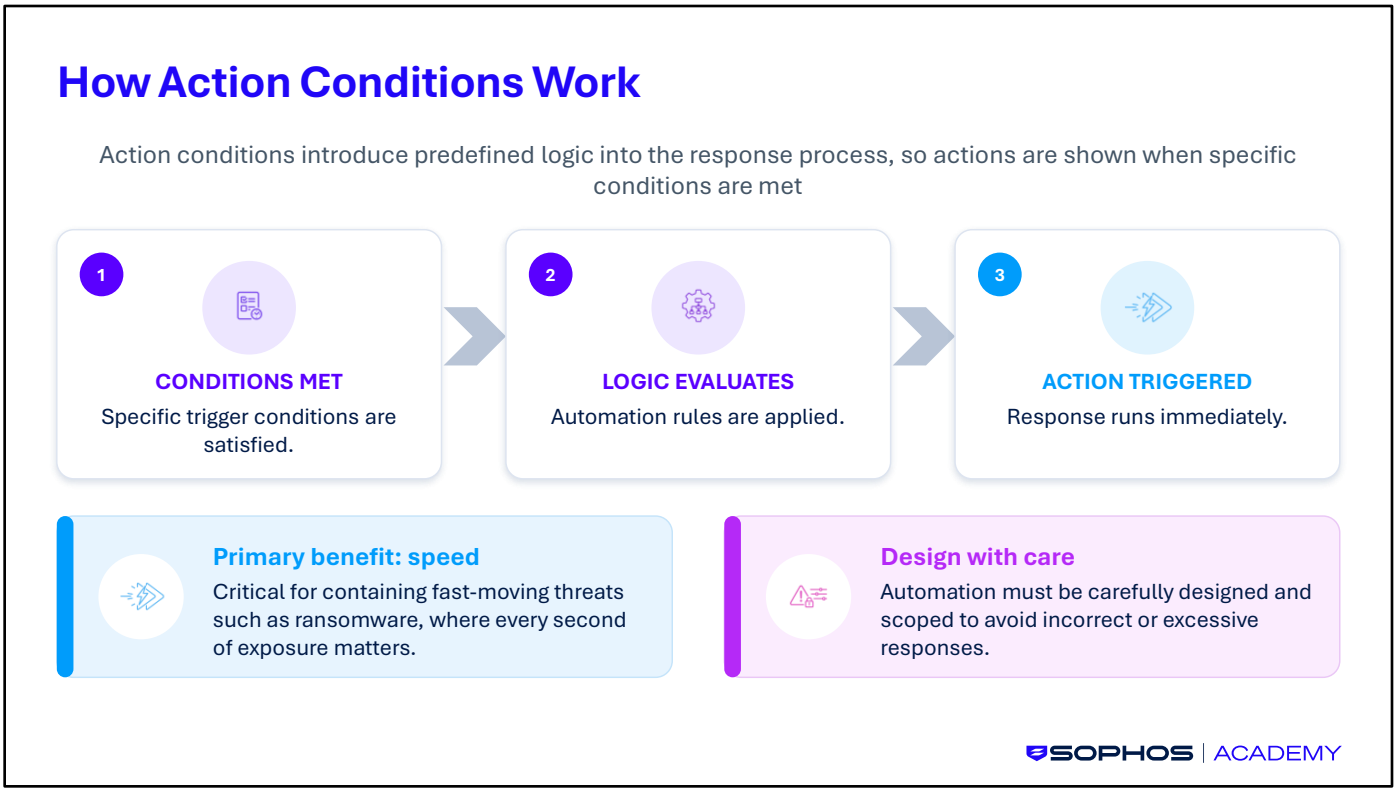
Actions can be configured to be shown when specific conditions are met.

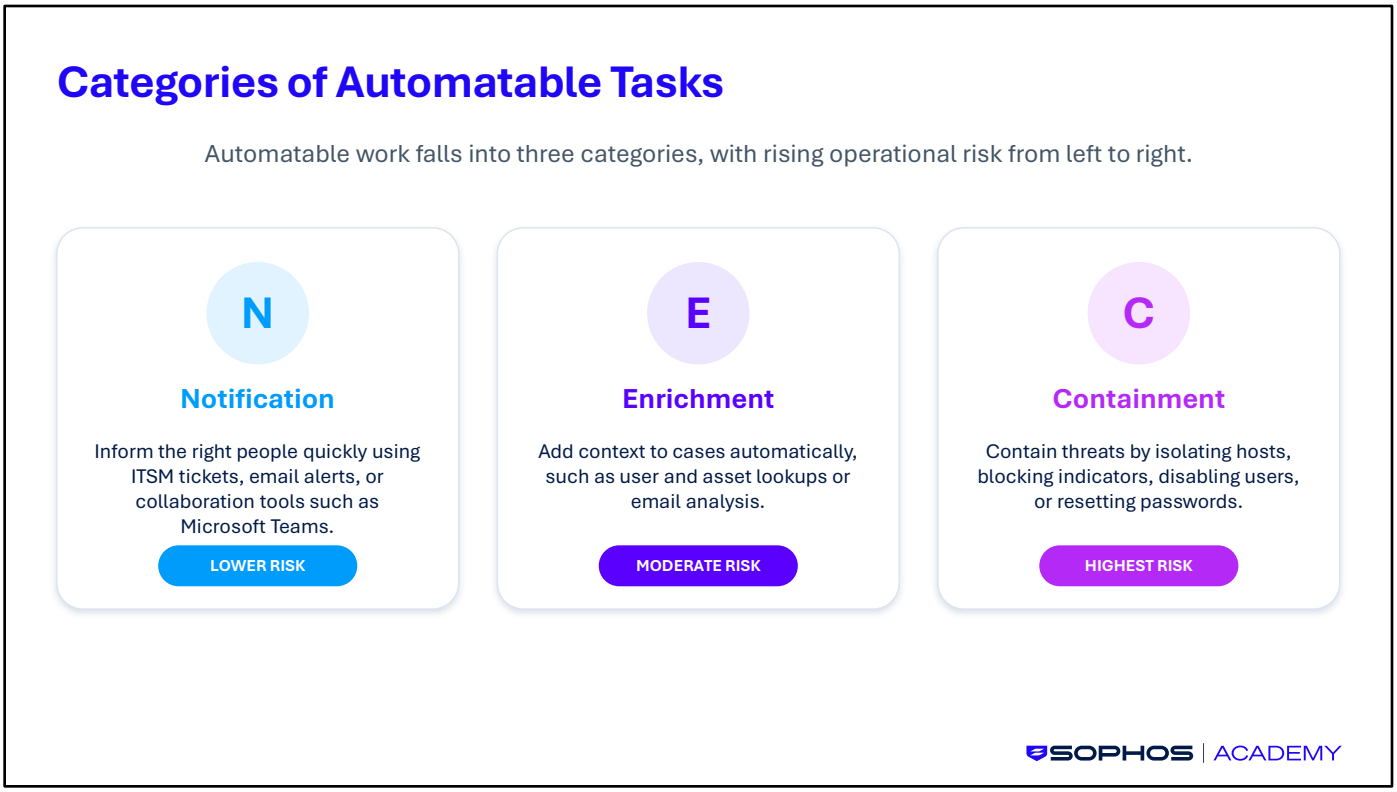
To edit an action:
1. Select an action from the 'Actions' list.
2. Click **Edit Conditions**.
3. Select **Only When**.
4. Build a CEL expression.

The CEL Helper appears inline; an expression can be created here, and an AI expression assistant is available to help you write an expression in natural language that will then be translated into CEL.

Once saved, the action appears enabled and is immediately available in the analyst workflow. Be cautious when selecting multiple integrations. For example, selecting multiple endpoint types for Isolate Host may isolate a device through more than one agent if it is running them at the same time.



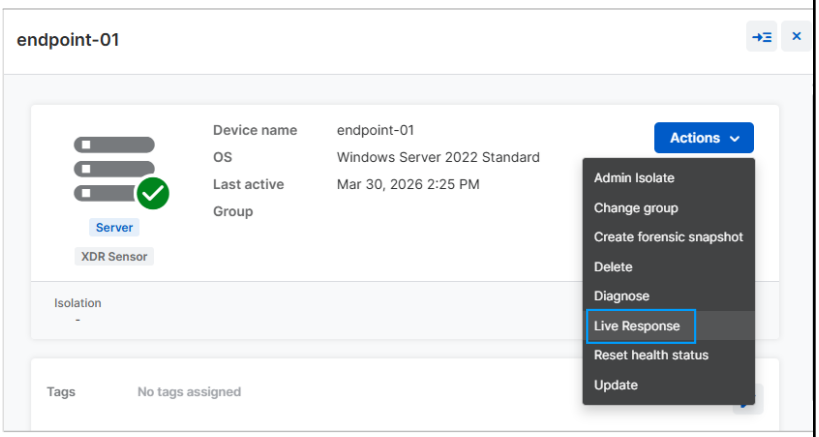
Automation introduces predefined logic into the response process. Instead of waiting for human intervention, actions can be triggered immediately when specific conditions are met. This is typically implemented using automation rules. The primary benefit is speed, which is critical in containing threats such as ransomware or fast-moving attacks. However, automation must be carefully designed to avoid incorrect or excessive responses.



Response actions that can be automated generally fall into three categories: Notification responses inform the right people quickly, using tickets, email alerts, or collaboration tools such as Microsoft Teams. Enrichment responses add context to cases automatically, such as user and asset lookups or email analysis. Containment responses contain threats, such as isolating hosts, blocking indicators, disabling users, or resetting passwords.

Live Response Overview

- Direct command line interface
- Privileged remote terminal session
- Gives full system-level access
- Allows IT operations to be carried out remotely



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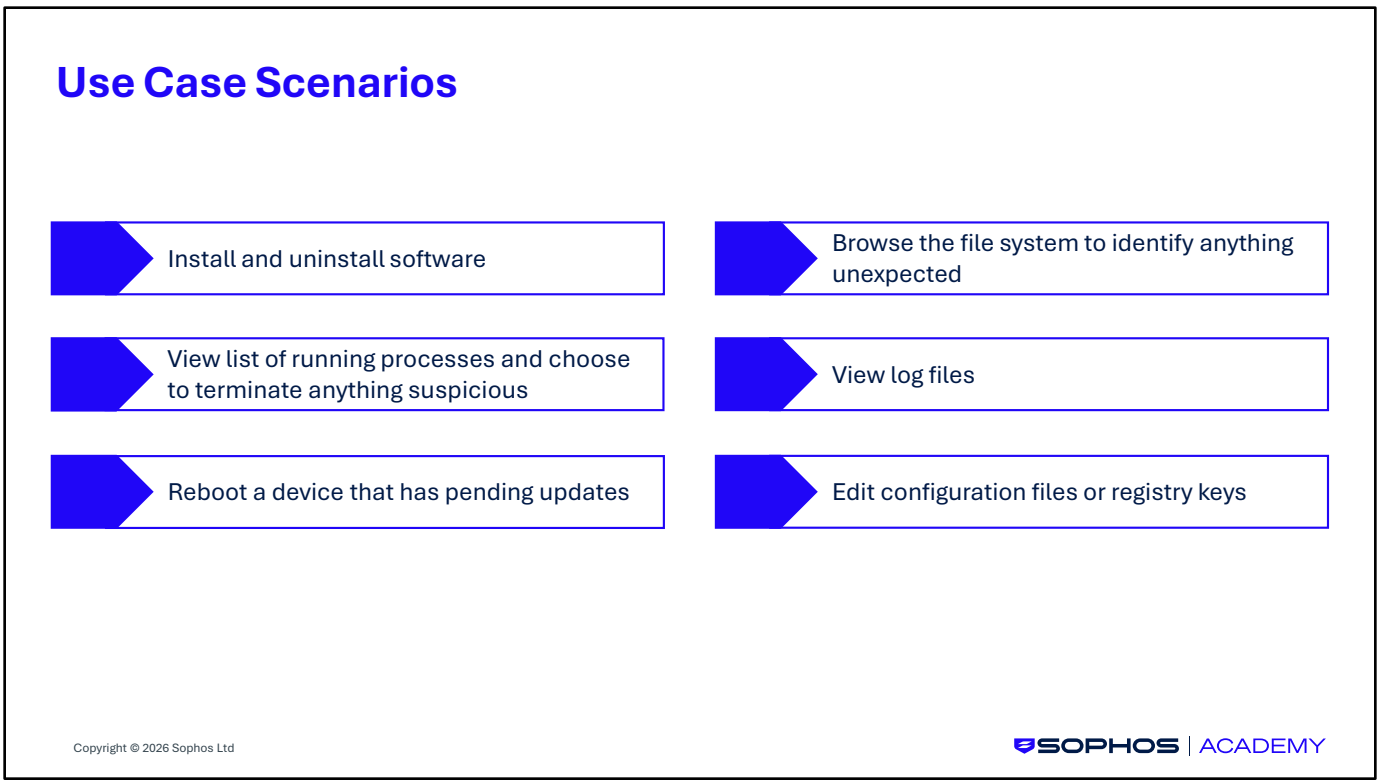
Live Response provides direct command line access to any managed device from Sophos Central.

The direct command line is a privileged remote terminal session that gives full system level access to any Sophos protected device in your network.



You can use Live Response to run a terminal command remotely on any protected endpoint in your network. For example, you can install and uninstall software, view a list of running processes and choose to terminate anything suspicious. You can reboot a device that has pending updates or browse the file system to identify anything unexpected. You can view log files and edit configuration files or registry keys.

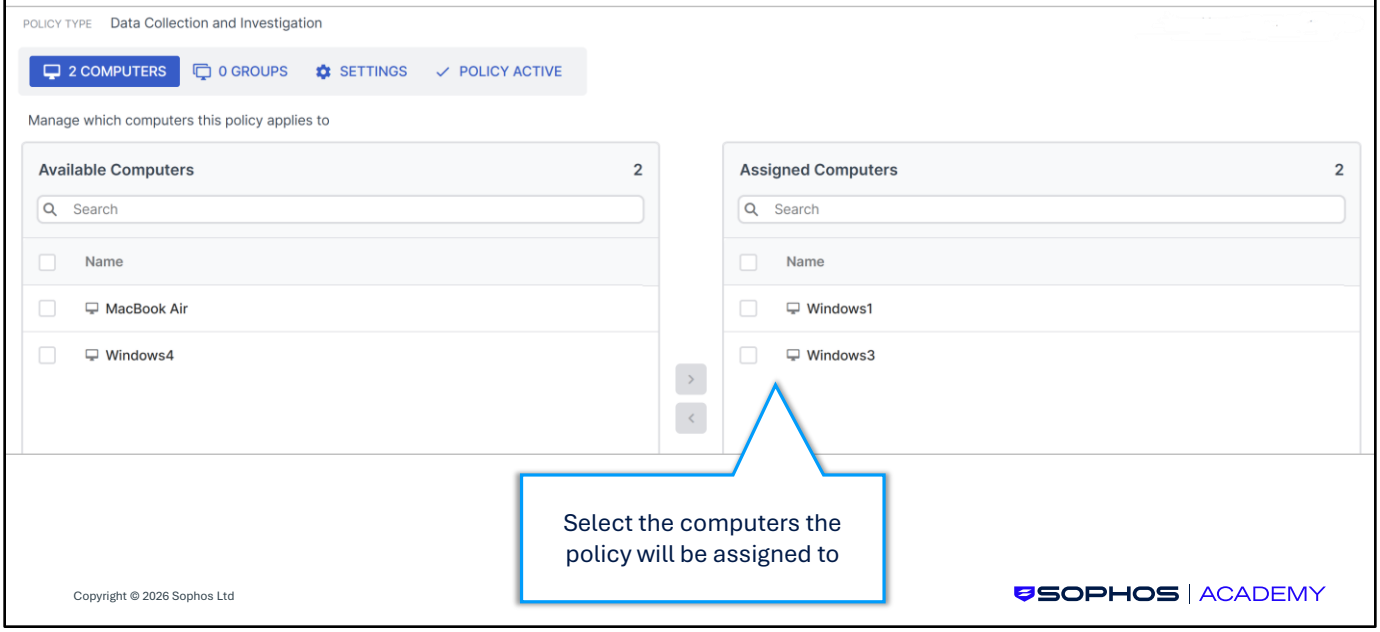
How To Get Started

Administrators must have the **Super Admin** role to enable Live Response

To use Live Response, you must be a Super Admin or have a role that includes ‘Start Live Response session on computers’. Live Response must also be enabled for supported endpoints in the Data Collection and Investigation policy.

Ensure the policy is configured for computers, in the Sophos Endpoint policy and for servers, in the Server Protection policy.

How To Get Started



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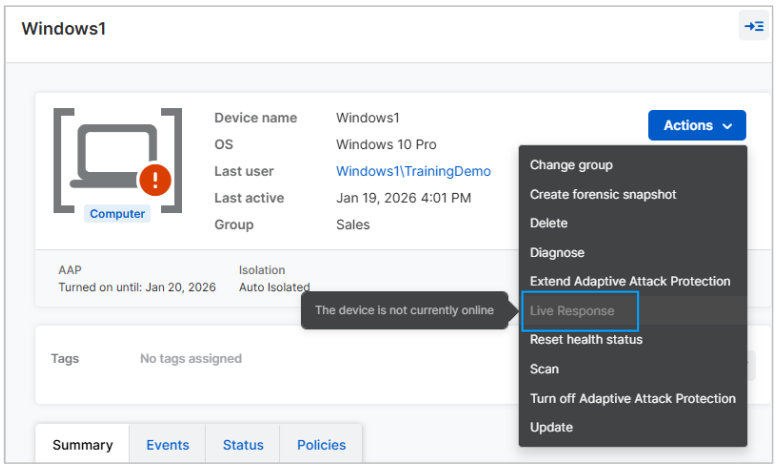
The base policy will be applied to all protected endpoints. To apply required settings to specific endpoints, create a new policy, or clone the base policy and assign those computers you want the policy to apply to. For example, if you want to prevent Live Response sessions on specific computers, you can apply the policy with the setting disabled to those computers only.

As policies are assigned in the order shown, the cloned or new policy will be assigned before the base policy.

How To Get Started

Live Response will be disabled if:



- The **endpoint** is **offline**
- The **data collection and investigation policy** assigned does **not allow Live Response sessions**

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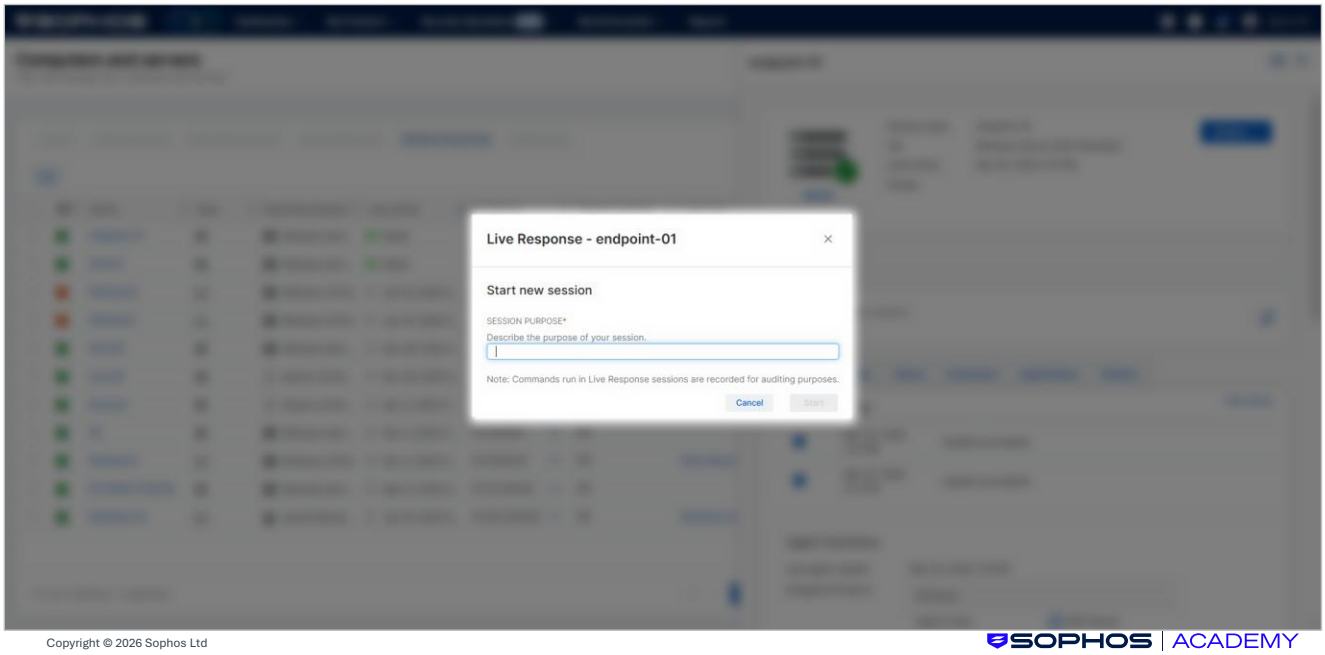
Once enabled, Live Response is launched from the **Devices** page. The option will be greyed out if the device is offline or if a data collection and investigation policy has been applied to the endpoint that does not allow Live Response sessions.

Start a New Session



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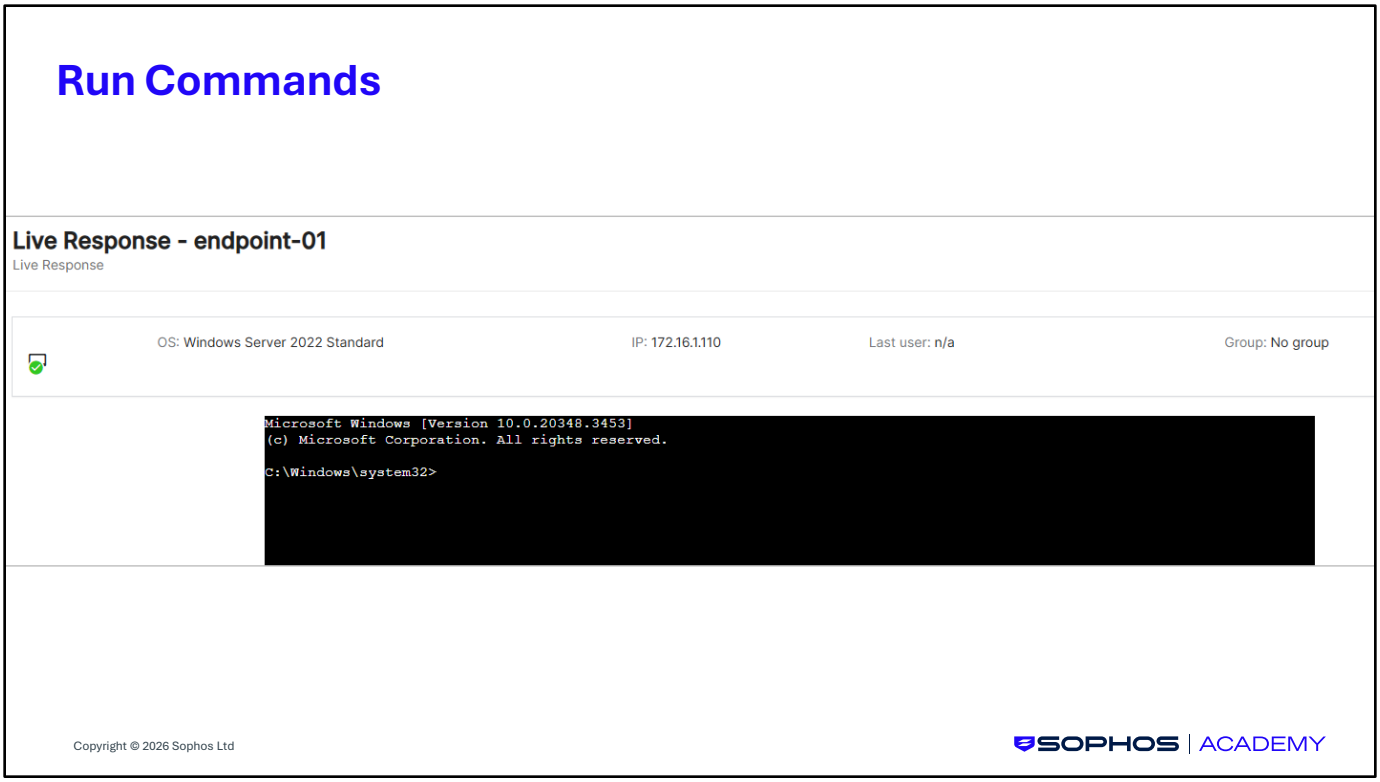
To start a Live Response session, navigate to the endpoint you want to connect to. Click **Live Response** to start a terminal session. Enter the session purpose, which has a minimum of 10 characters. The description must directly relate to what you plan to do on the device.

Click **Start** to start the session. You'll need to ensure that pop-ups for Sophos Central are allowed in your internet browser.

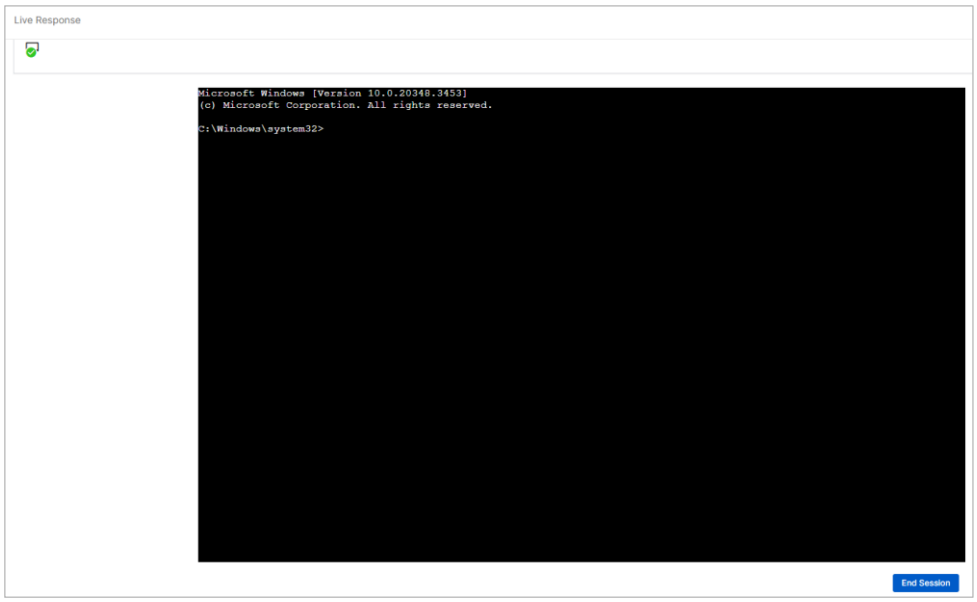
Run Commands



The Live Response window will be opened, and the connection status will display when the endpoint has been connected to.

Once the connection has been established you can run the commands that are required.

End The Session



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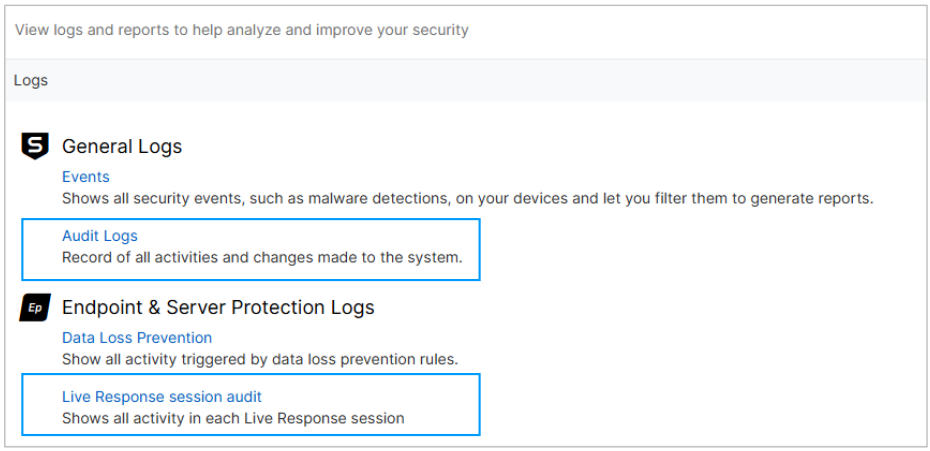
Once you have completed the remote session, click **End Session**. This will terminate the running session to the device.

Audit Logs



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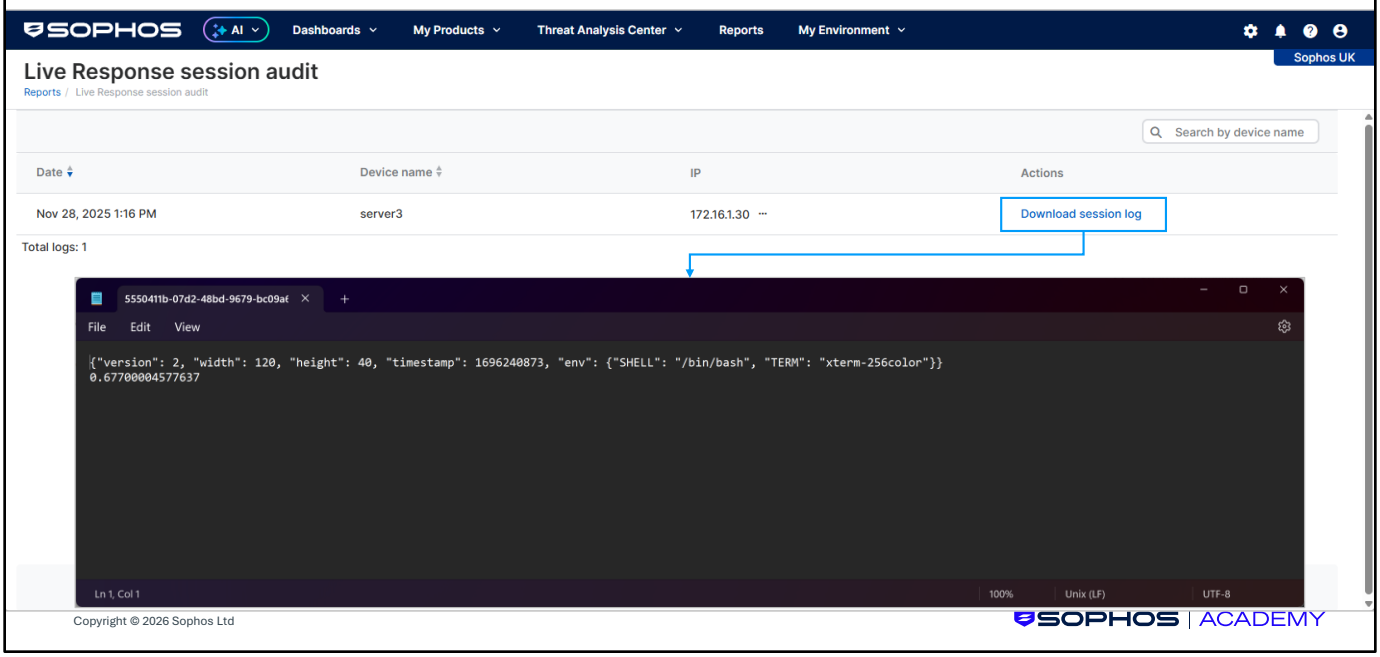
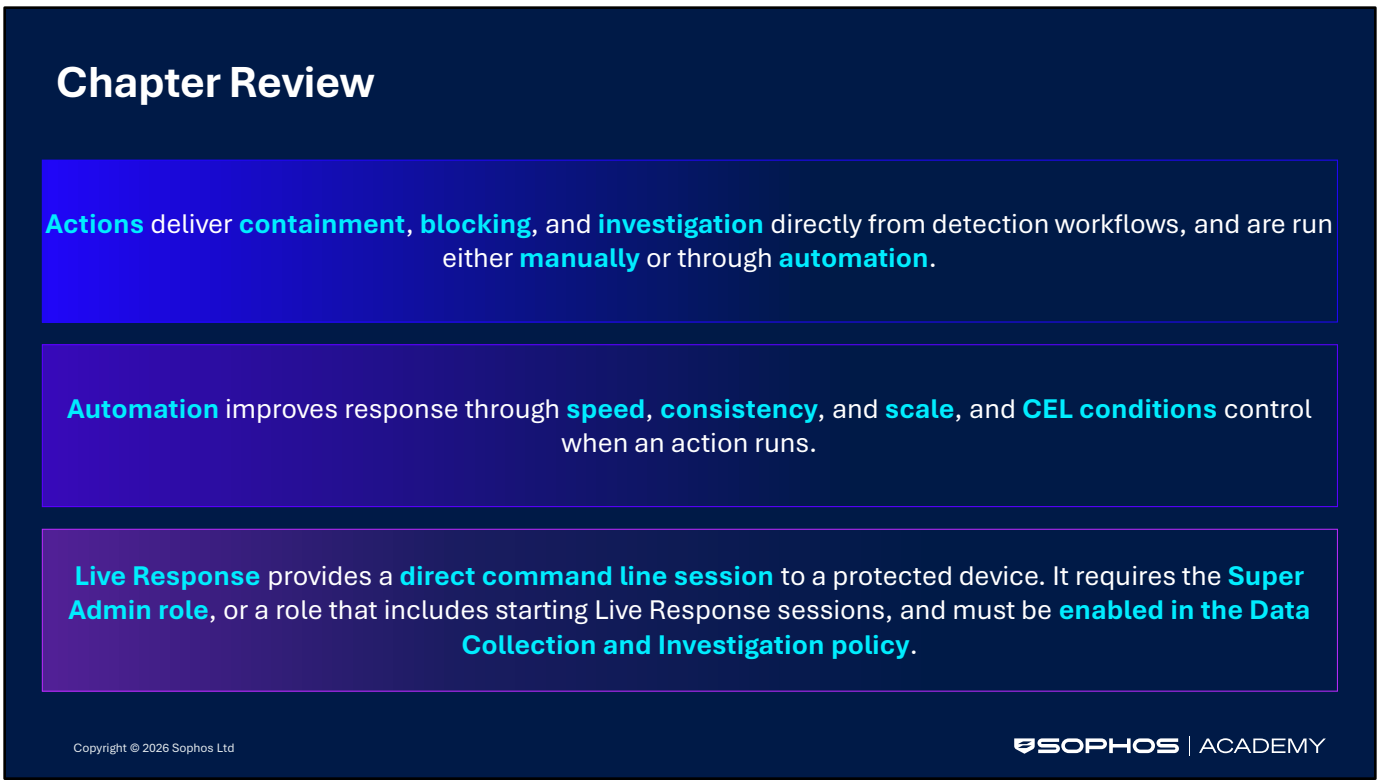
An audit log is created for all Live Response sessions that are started and ended. This log can be found in **Reports > Audit Logs**.

A **Live Response session audit** is also available. This session audit displays the date and time of each session along with the device name and IP address.

Session Logs



The session log can be downloaded and shows the commands that were issued during the session.



Here are the three main things you learned in this chapter.

Actions deliver containment, blocking, and investigation directly from detection workflows and are run either manually or through automation.

Automation improves response through speed, consistency, and scale, and CEL conditions control when an action runs.

Live Response provides a direct command line session to a protected device. It requires the Super Admin role, or a role that includes ‘starting Live Response sessions’, and must be enabled in the Data Collection and Investigation Policy.

Sophos Support

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[Additional Information]

Sophos Endpoint
EP5005: How To Find Help From Sophos

May 2026

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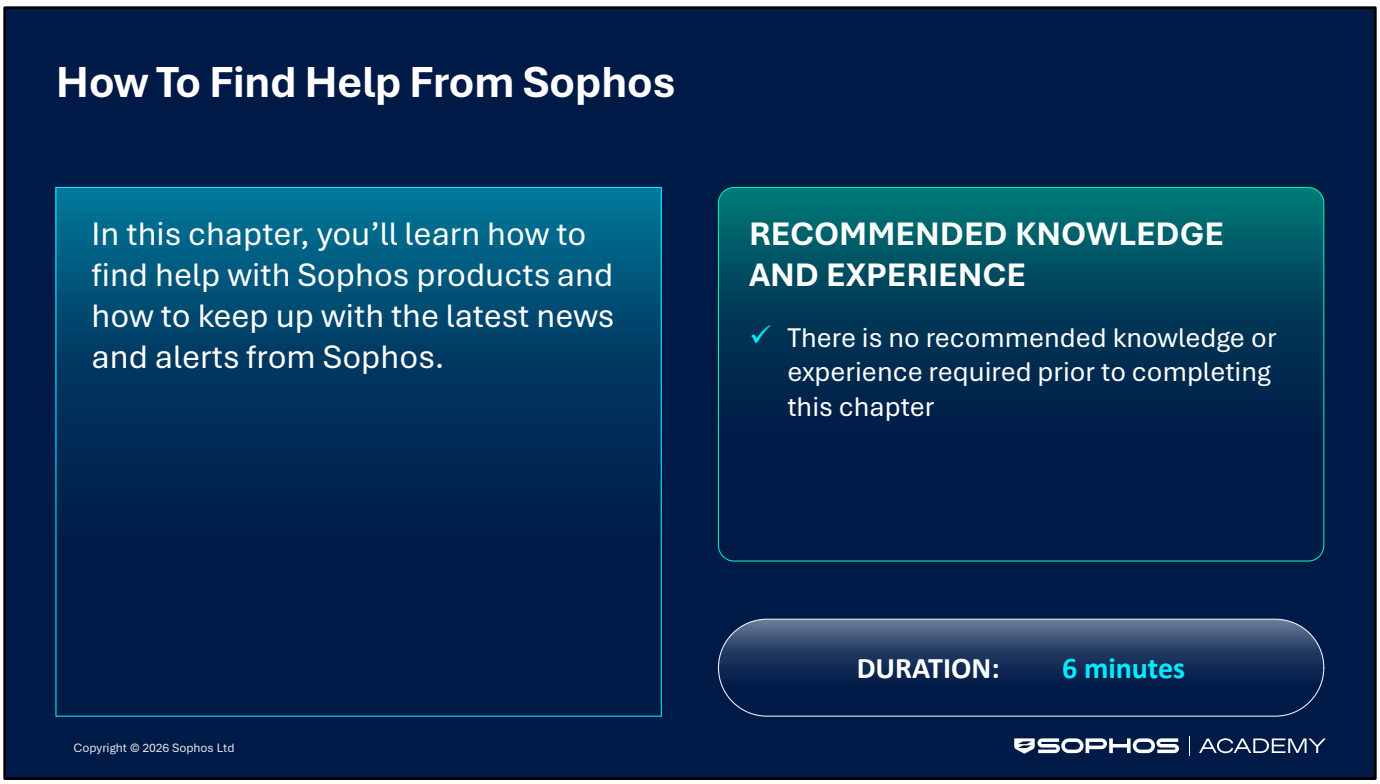
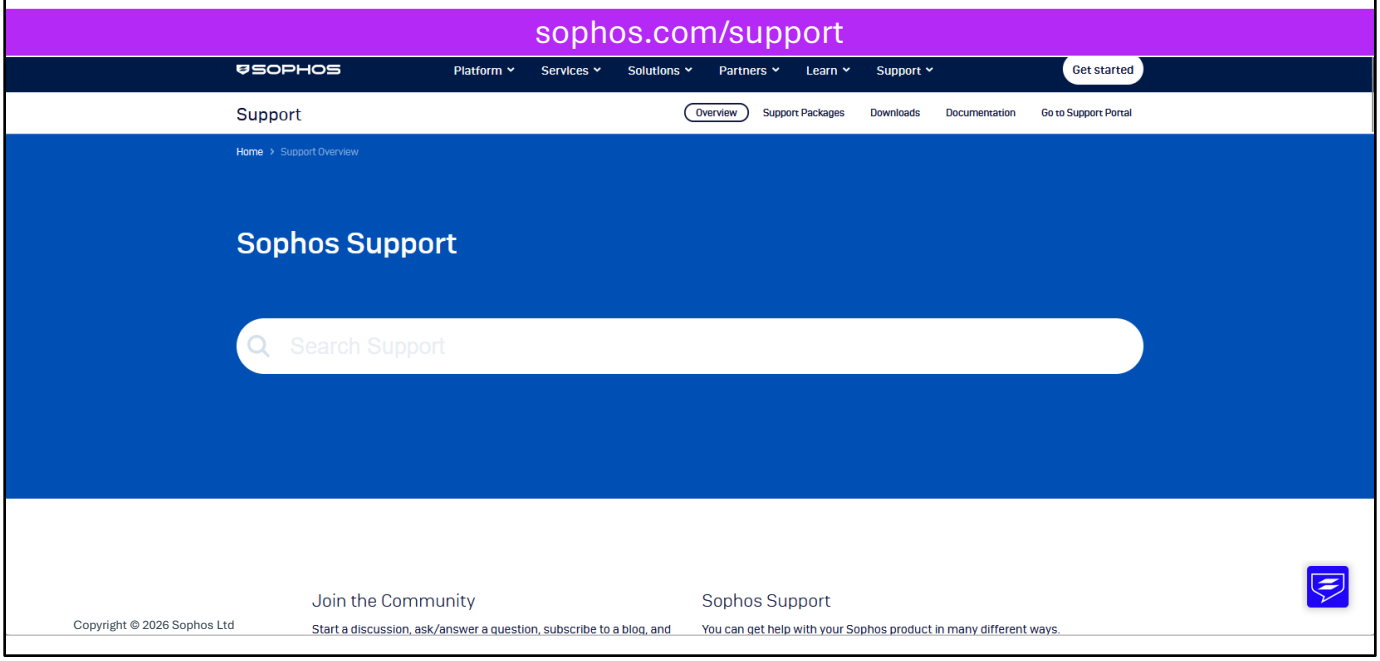


In this chapter, you'll learn how to find help with Sophos products and how to keep up with the latest news and alerts from Sophos.

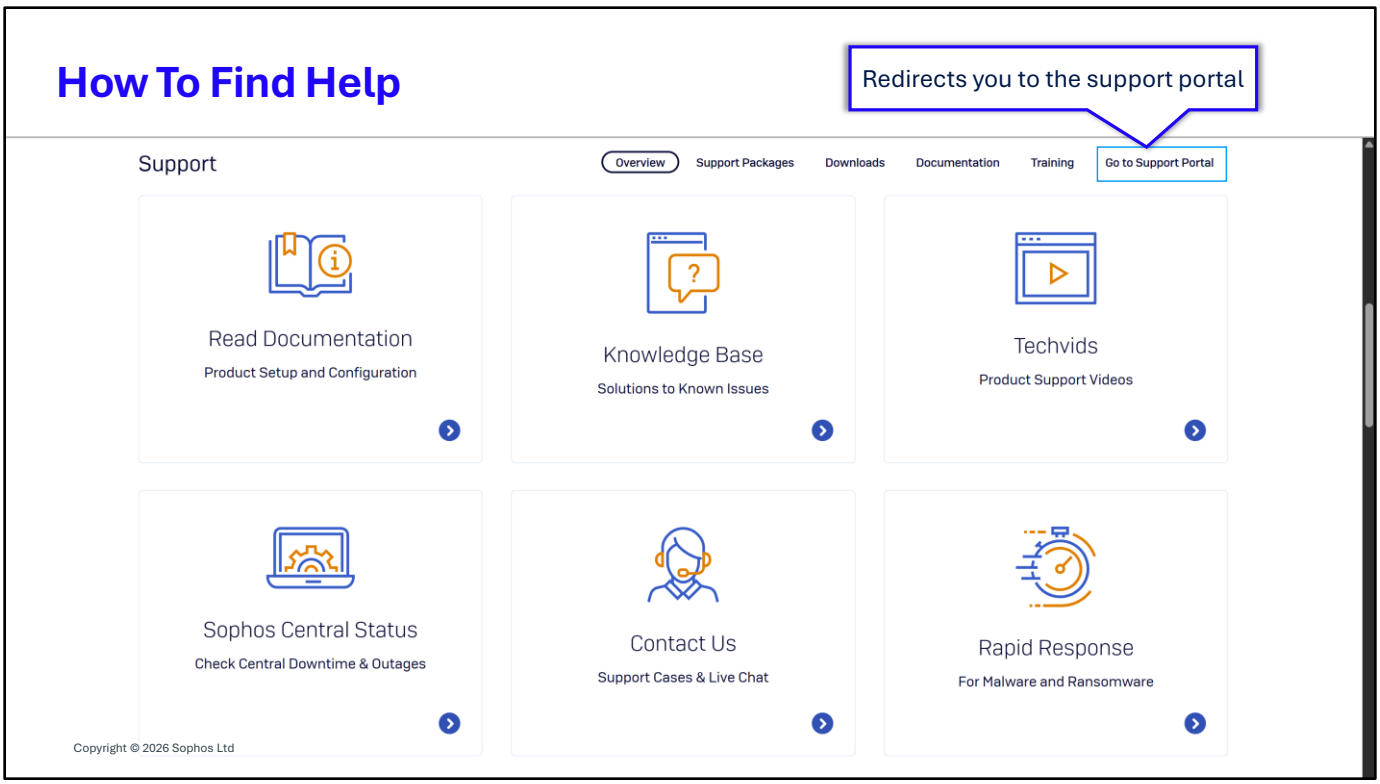
How To Find Help

Additional information available in the notes



If you require support, go to **sophos.com/support** to access documentation, downloads, training, and support packages.

[Additional Information]
https://www.sophos.com/support

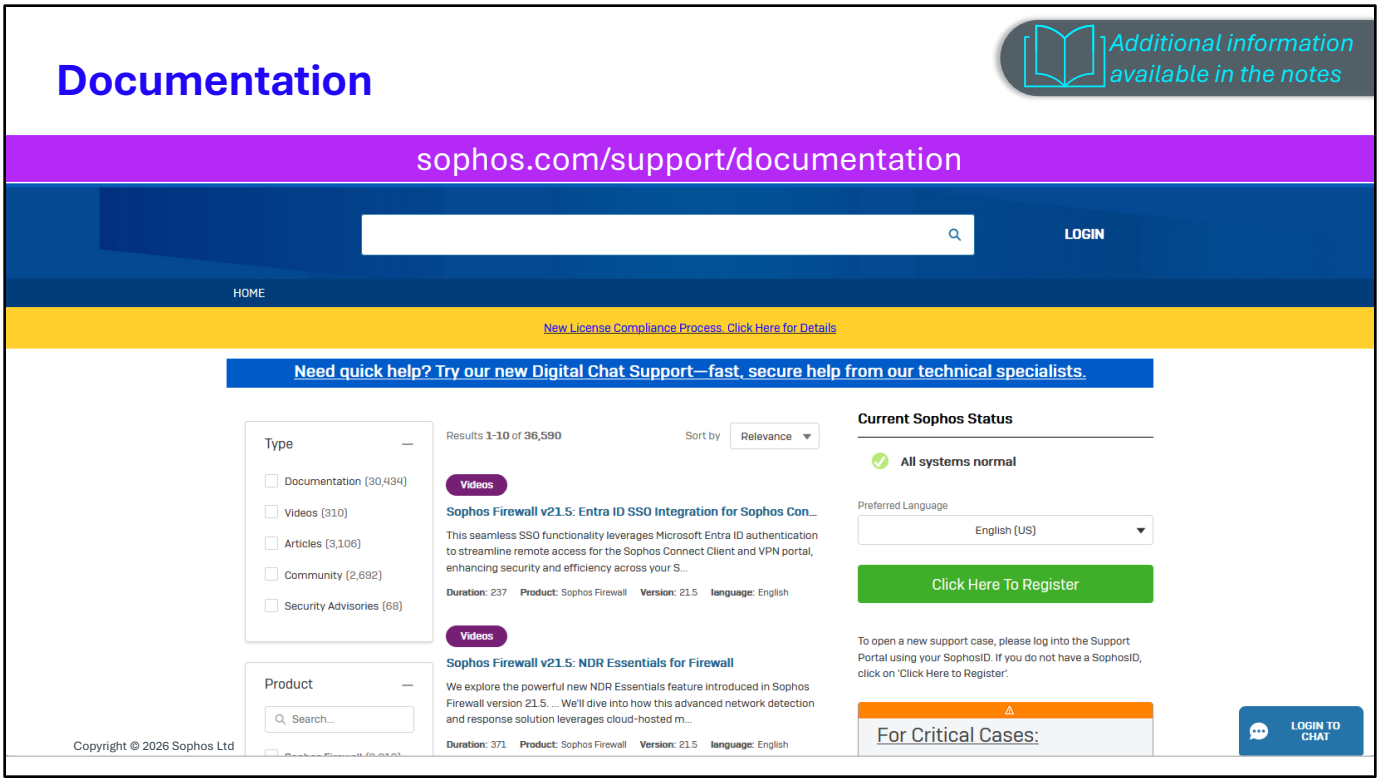


There are several ways to find information and support for Sophos products. The overview page provides quick access to the Support Portal, documentation, technical videos, the Sophos Status Page, and the latest malware information. You can also chat with Sophos Support and raise any support issues.

Clicking **Go to Support Portal** will redirect you to the Support Portal.

Documentation

Additional information available in the notes

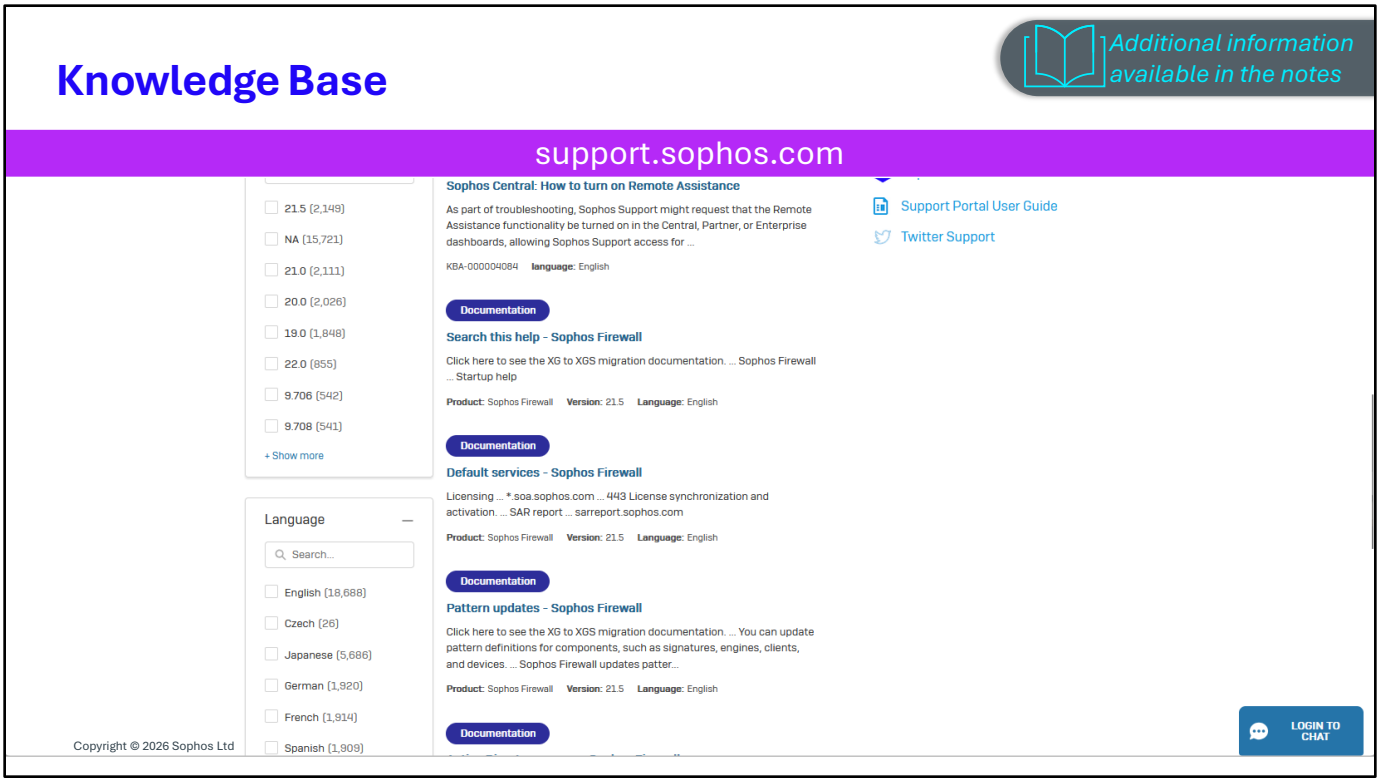


Documentation includes product user guides, release notes, pocket guides, and other useful information.

[Additional Information]
https://www.sophos.com/support/documentation

Knowledge Base

Additional information available in the notes

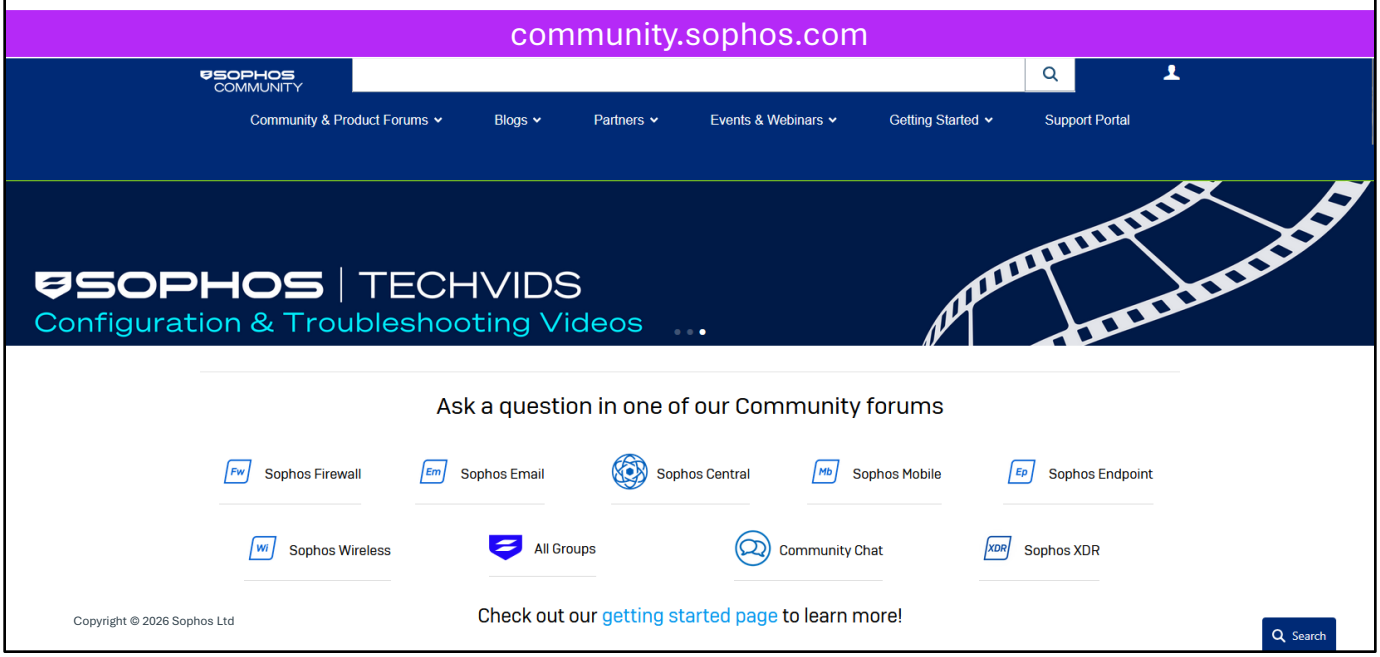


The Sophos Knowledgebase contains technical documents on specific configurations and issues.

[Additional Information]
https://support.sophos.com

Sophos Community

Additional information available in the notes

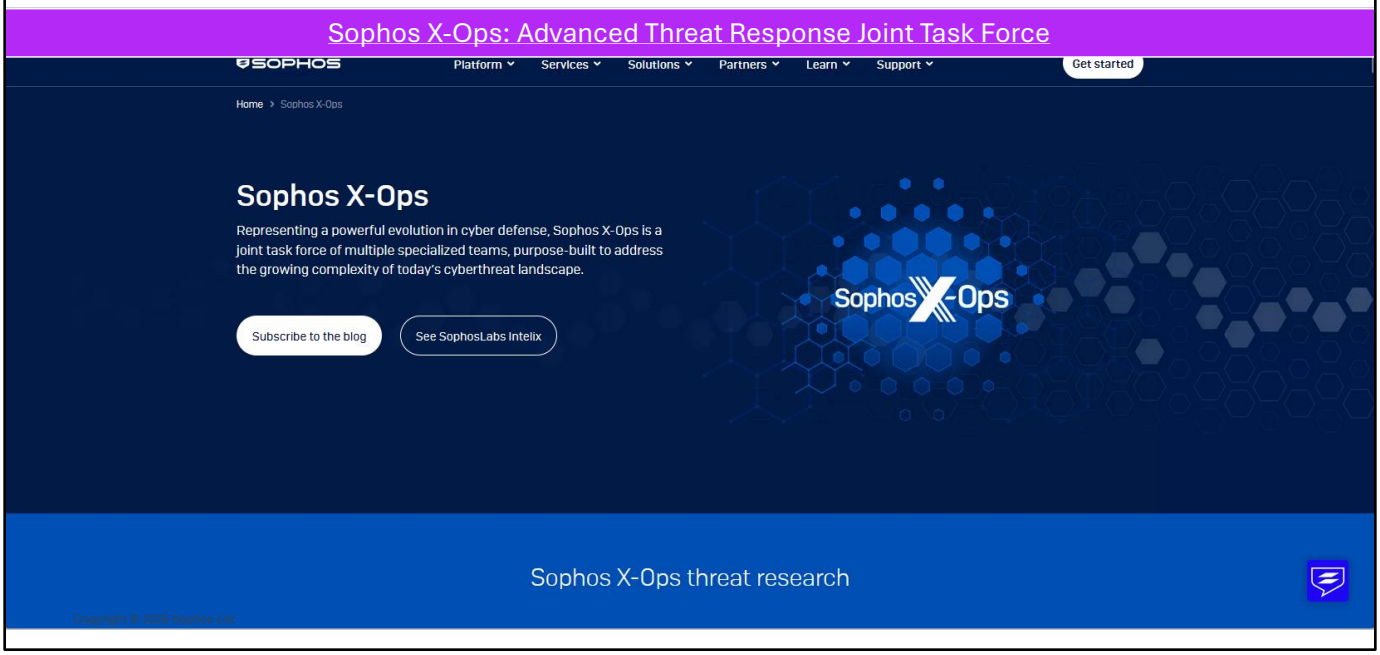


Using the Sophos community, you can reach Sophos staff for help, as well as participating in discussions, and receiving assistance. This forum allows you to raise questions, share knowledge, and discuss your experiences with Sophos products.

[Additional Information]
https://community.sophos.com

SophosLabs

Additional information available in the notes



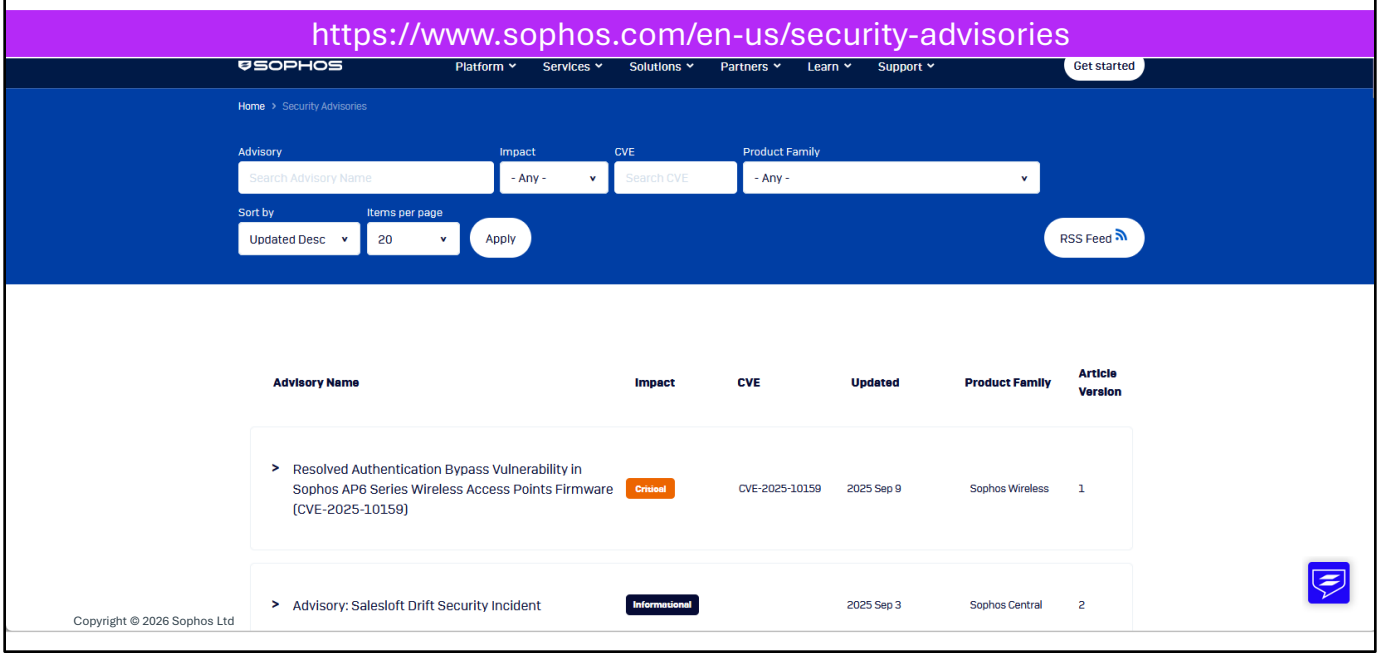
SophosLabs provides access to Sophos reports, real-time data, and Sophos threat reports.

[Additional Information]

Sophos X-Ops: Advanced Threat Response Joint Task Force

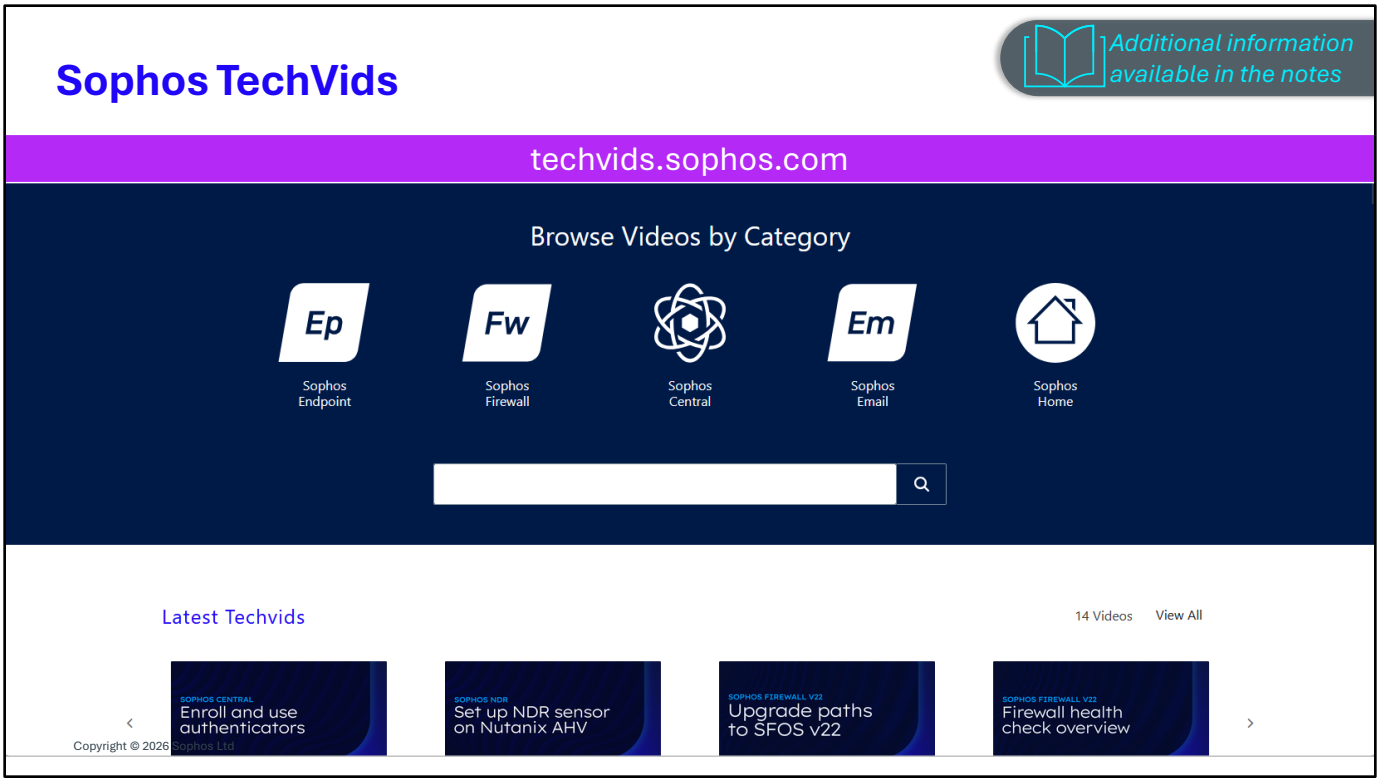
Threat Information

Additional information available in the notes



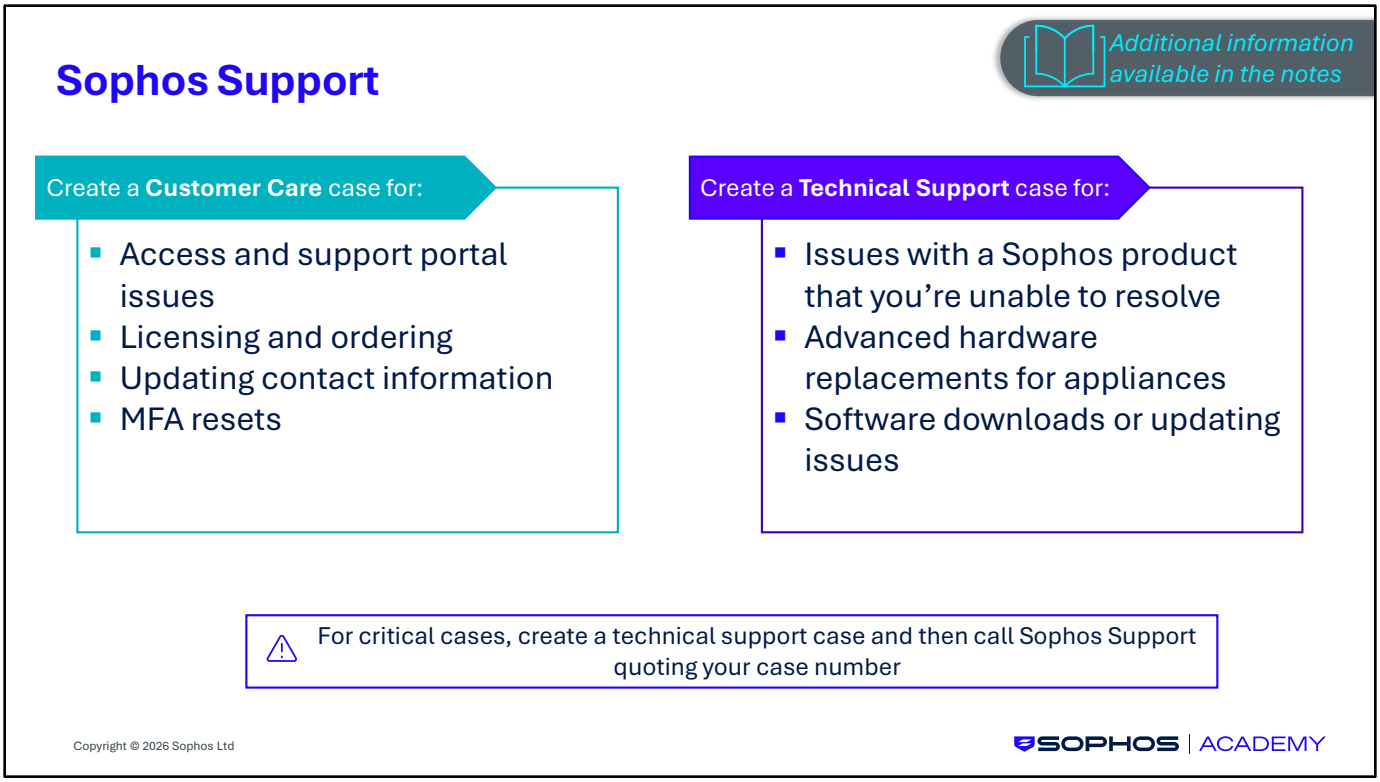
SophosLabs keeps a library of all known threats. You can search for a threat and view important information, such as its characteristics or how it spreads. The threat library also includes suggested instructions on how to remove it.

[Additional Information]
https://www.sophos.com/en-us/security-advisories



Sophos provides a series of technical videos that cover configuration tasks, self-help, remediation, and how-to videos for common issues.

[Additional Information]
https://techvids.sophos.com

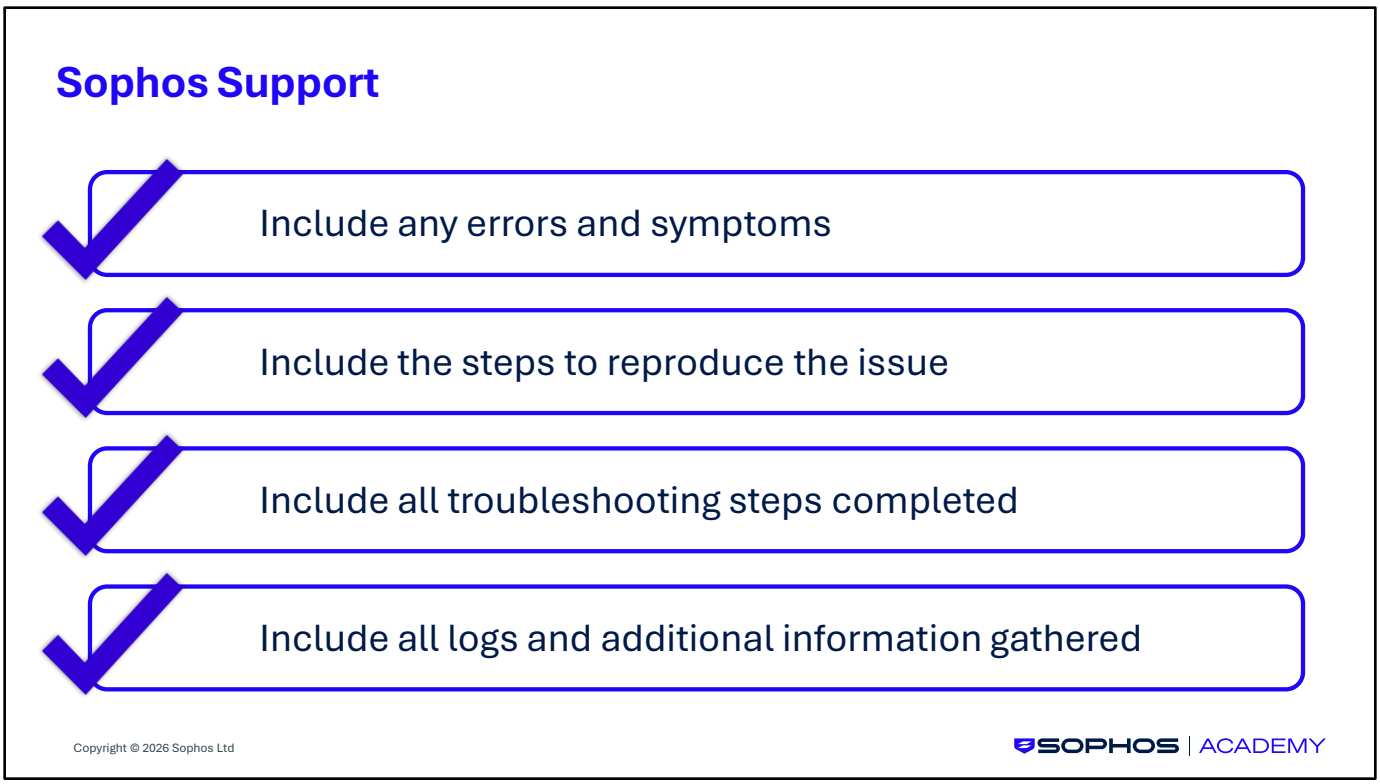


Support cases are opened through the support portal at sophos.com/support. Log in with your Sophos ID; if you do not have a Sophos ID, you can create one. In the support portal, you can create a customer care case for issues such as access and support portal issues, licensing and ordering, updating contact information, or multifactor authentication resets.

Sophos Technical Support provides comprehensive support through trained technical support representatives. Create a technical support case for issues with a Sophos product that you are unable to resolve, advanced hardware replacements for appliances, software downloads, or updating issues.

For critical cases, we recommend that you create a technical support case first. Once you have received the automated case number, follow up on the case with a phone call to the technical support team.

[Additional Information]
How to use the Sophos Support Portal to raise a support case:
https://techvids.sophos.com/watch/yBi5NcvMQTBNWVyunmm4u1

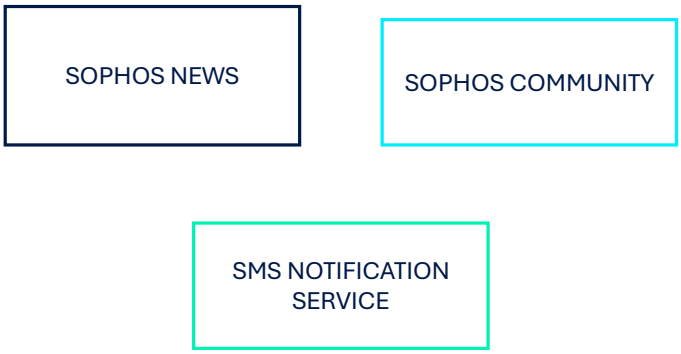


When raising a support case, it's important to be specific about the issue and provide all the known information. This enables our support team to assist you as quickly as possible.

When raising a support case, include any errors that are displayed along with details of all the symptoms experienced. If the issue can be reproduced, provide detailed steps on how to reproduce it, and any troubleshooting steps taken when attempting a resolution. Include any log files that have been collected and any commands that have been run during troubleshooting.

Sophos News and Alerts

Additional information available in the notes



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We want to ensure you're aware of everything we're doing with our products, from tips, to updates and improvements. You can keep up with the latest alerts and news by visiting our blog sites for our Sophos community and Sophos News.

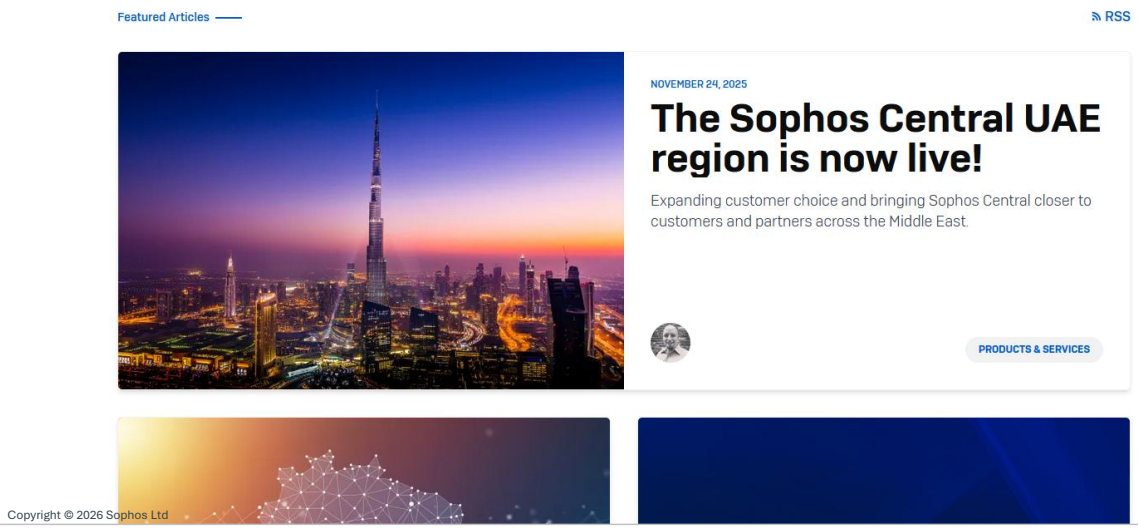
You can also subscribe to our Sophos Status Page for email and SMS alerts, and follow Sophos on X. If a high-profile incident occurs, we publish advisory banners to our support and community pages linking to applicable documentation, knowledgebase articles, and additional information.

[Additional Information]
Further information about how to contact your support team, get alerted, and be informed can be found in the knowledge base article **KB-000038559**. https://support.sophos.com/support/s/article/KB-000038559

Sophos News

Additional information available in the notes

news.sophos.com

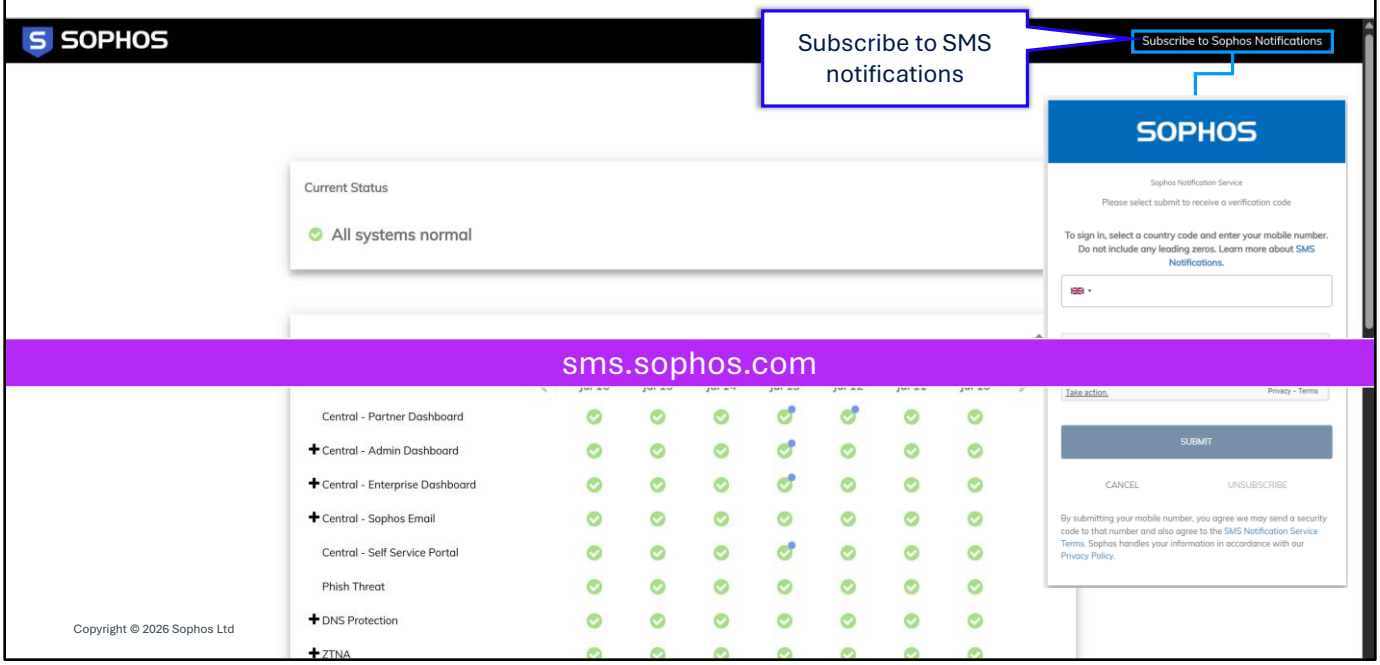


Sophos News publishes the latest news about Sophos, our products, and the latest information for reporters who want to write about Sophos.

[Additional Information]
https://news.sophos.com

SMS Notification Service

Additional information available in the notes



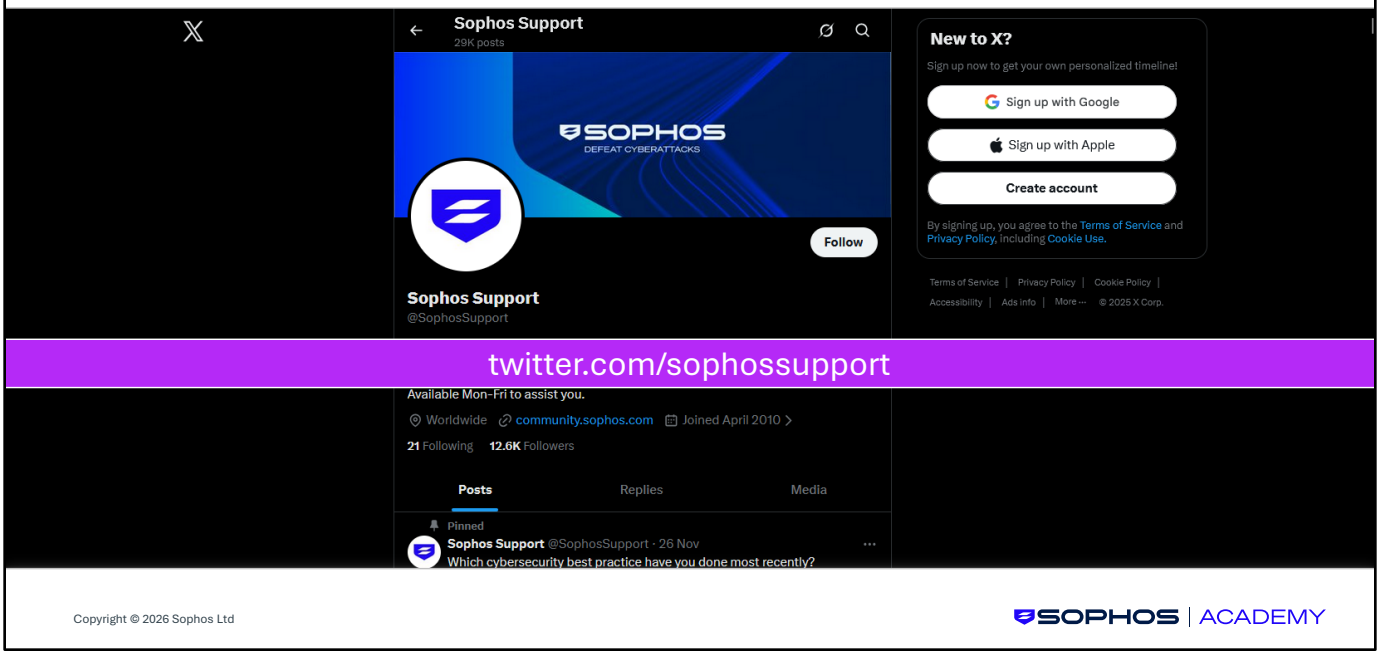
The Sophos SMS Notification Service is a free-of-charge service that provides proactive SMS alerting for Sophos products and services. You're immediately prompted in the event an issue arises, so you'll know exactly what is happening, what the impact is, and how to fix it.

You can sign up for the service and select the products for which you would like to receive alerts. Once configured, you'll receive instant notifications on technical issues or product updates. The SMS message will contain the product name and a link to a knowledge base article on our support page, where you can find more details.

[Additional Information]
Sign up for SMS Alerts: https://sms.sophos.com

Social Media

Additional information available in the notes



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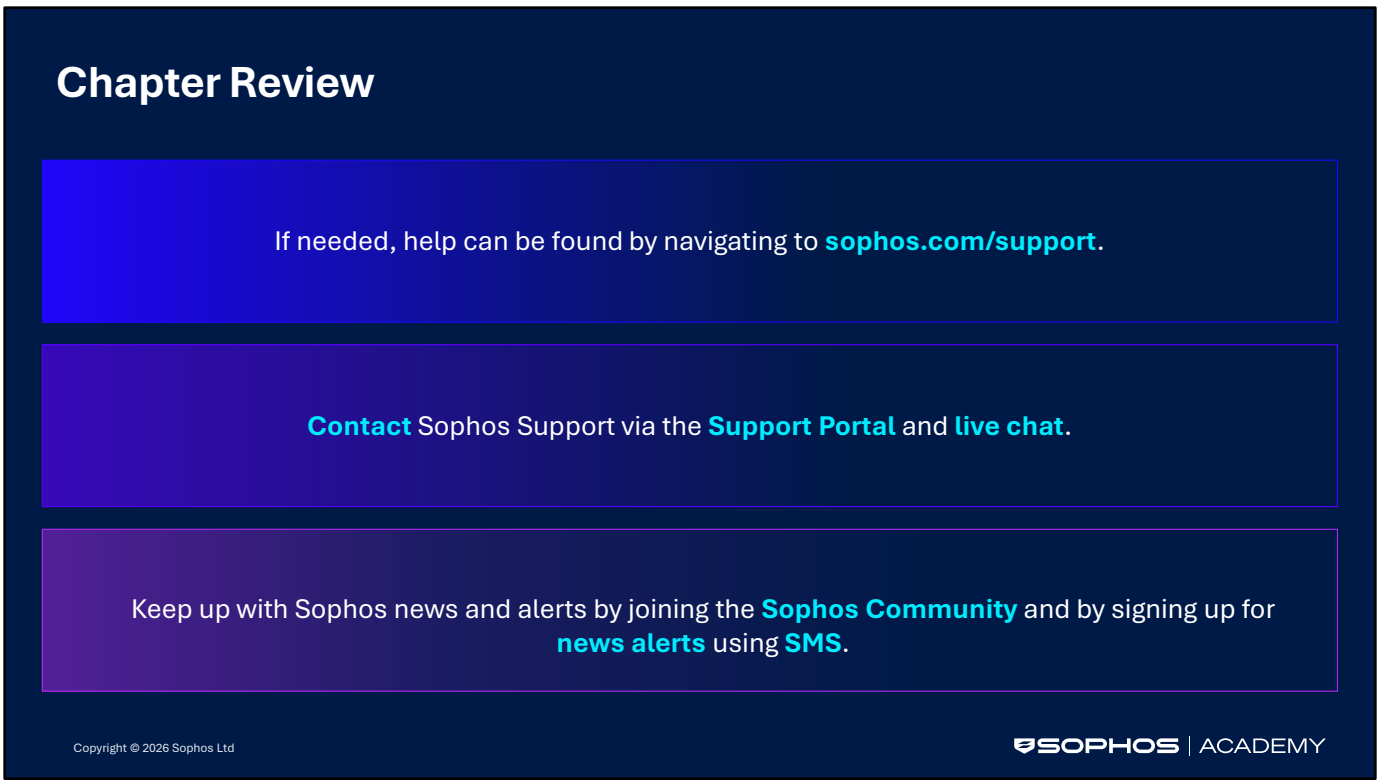
At Sophos, we use the X platform (formerly known as Twitter) to help educate and connect with partners, customers, and interested prospects. When we send out alerts via social media, it allows channel followers and users to search for hash tag sophos to find out the latest information. Follow Sophos to hear about community solutions, news, articles, the latest product releases, and the latest issues.

[Additional Information]
https://twitter.com/sophossupport



Here are the three main things you learned in this chapter.

If needed, help can be found by navigating to sophos.com/support.

Contact Sophos Support via the Support Portal, live chat, and X.

Keep up with Sophos news and alerts by joining the Sophos Community and by signing up for news alerts using SMS.

Resources to Complete

Now you've completed this chapter, here are the resources to work through:

Video: Getting Started with the Support Portal
https://techvids.sophos.com/watch/wYUCz9rJ4CgY8CmLtEnPMn

You'll find the links to these resources in the lesson resources document.

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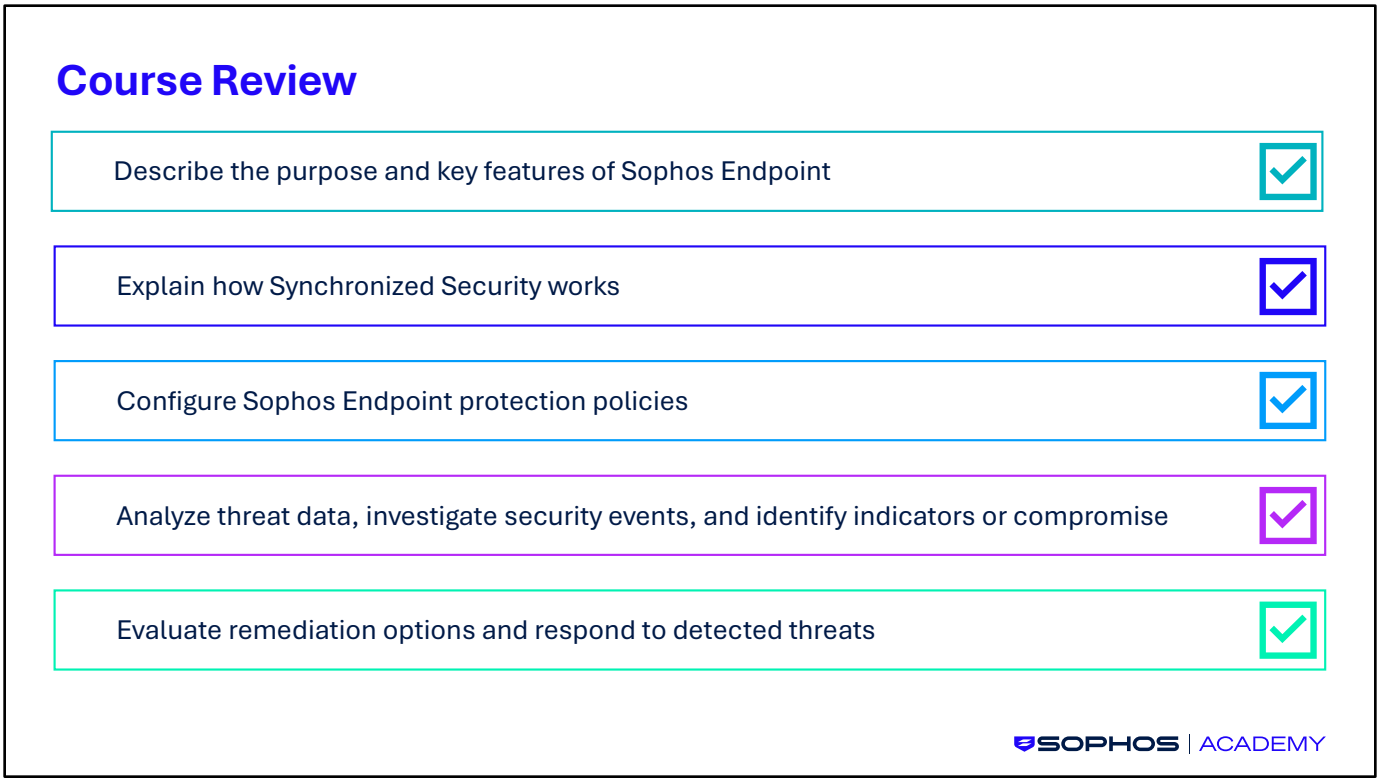
Now you've completed this chapter, here are the resources to work through.

Watch the 'Getting Started with the Support Portal' video. The video provides an overview of the Sophos Support Portal to help customers explore the available self-service resources, learn how to start a Live Chat, create a technical support case, and much more.

You'll find the links to these resources in the lesson resources document.

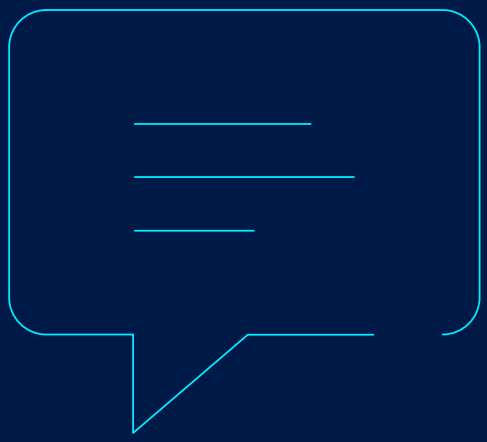
[Additional Information]
Getting Started with the Support Portal video:
https://techvids.sophos.com/watch/wYUCz9rJ4CgY8CmLtEnPMn



Now that this course has been completed, you should have learned the following skills:

Describe the purpose and key features of Sophos Endpoint
Explain how Synchronized Security works
Configure Sophos Endpoint protection policies
Analyze threat data, investigate security events, and identify indicators or compromise
Evaluate remediation options and respond to detected threats

Feedback



Feedback is always welcome

Please email globaltraining@sophos.com

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While we regularly review the survey feedback, if you would like a response to your comments or if you spot something that requires more immediate attention, please email us at globaltraining@sophos.com.

We really appreciate all the feedback we receive, as it helps us to create better courses for you.

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